פְּרִי צַדִּיק

Pri Tzaddik

Interlinear Translation with Annotated Footnotes

Daled Parshiyos and Purim

אַרְבַּע פָּרָשִׁיוֹת וּפוּרִים

Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin
(1823–1900)

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Pri Tzaddik

A Bilingual Interlinear Edition

Daled Parshiyos and Purim

This volume presents Pri Tzaddik on Parshas Shekalim, Rosh Chodesh Adar, Purim Katan, Rosh Chodesh Adar Sheni, Parshas Zachor, Purim, Shushan Purim, Parshas Parah, and Parshas HaChodesh in bilingual interlinear form. The vocalized Hebrew is followed phrase by phrase by its English translation, with source quotations and annotated parallel teachings in numbered footnotes.

Methodological note: This edition was prepared with the assistance of AI tools for drafting, translation, source organization, and formatting. The original Hebrew remains the controlling text for study. Editorial headings and explanations are aids to understanding and are distinct from Rav Tzadok's original words.

Original work פרי צדיק by Rabbi Tzadok HaKohen Rabinowitz of Lublin (1823–1900).

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פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים

Parshas Shekalim

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר א׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Aleph

מִכְּתַב יַד קָדְשׁוֹ From his holy manuscript

יֵשׁ לְדַקְדֵּק לָמָּה תִּיקְנוּ **One must examine closely why they instituted** קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה בַּשַּׁבָּת שֶׁלִּפְנֵי רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **the reading of the parshah on the Shabbos before Rosh Chodesh** וְלֹא בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **and not on Rosh Chodesh Adar itself,** דְּאָז מַשְׁמִיעִין עַל הַשְּׁקָלִים[1] **for that is when they announce concerning the shekalim,** וּקְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה בִּמְקוֹם הַכְרָזָה לְהַשְׁמִיעַ **and the reading of the parshah takes the place of the proclamation to announce it,** וְהָיָה לָהֶם לְתַקֵּן זֶה בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ. **so they should have instituted it on Rosh Chodesh.** וּבְלָאו הָכִי צָרִיךְ טַעַם **And even without this, a reason is needed** עַל תַּקָּנַת הַקְּרִיאָה **for the institution of the reading itself:** דִּבְזְמַן הַבַּיִת שֶׁהָיוּ מַשְׁמִיעִין **for in the time of the Beis HaMikdash, when they would announce** בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר **on the first of Adar,** מַה צּוֹרֶךְ לִקְרוֹת עוֹד הַפָּרָשָׁה **what need was there to read the parshah as well** בַּשַּׁבָּת הַקּוֹדֶם. **on the preceding Shabbos?** וְעַכְשָׁיו דְּאֵין מַשְׁמִיעִין **And now that they do not announce,** מַה צּוֹרֶךְ לִקְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **what need is there for reading the parshah,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁאֵין לָנוּ בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **since we have no Beis HaMikdash** וְאֵין צָרִיךְ לָתֵת הַשְּׁקָלִים כְּלָל. **and there is no need to give the shekalim at all?** וּבְתַנְחוּמָא תִּשָּׂא סוֹף סִימָן ג׳ **And in Tanchuma, Ki Sisa, at the end of siman 3:** וּפָרָשִׁיוֹת שֶׁקּוֹרִין וְכוּלֵי **"Moshe learned..." etc.,** מֹשֶׁה לָמַד וְכוּלֵי **"and the parshiyos that are read..." etc.,** מַזְכִּירִים אוֹתוֹ בְּכָל פָּרָשָׁה וּפָרָשָׁה **"they mention him in each and every parshah,** וּבְפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים אָמַר מֹשֶׁה וְכוּלֵי **and in Parshas Shekalim Moshe said..." etc.,** מְשָׁאֲנִי מֵת אֵין אֲנִי נִזְכָּר **"once I die I will not be remembered.** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא כְּשֵׁם וְכוּלֵי **The Holy One, blessed is He, said to him: Just as..." etc.,** כָּךְ בְּכָל שָׁנָה שֶׁקּוֹרִין אוֹתָהּ לְפָנַי כְּאִלּוּ **"so every year that they read it before Me,** אַתָּה עוֹמֵד בְּאוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁן עַד כָּאן.[2] **it is as if you are standing at that time and lifting up their heads." End of quote.** הִנֵּה דְּקְרִיאַת פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ בְּכָל שָׁנָה **We see that reading this parshah every year** הוּא כְּדֵי לְזָקוֹף **is in order to lift up** וּלְהָרִים רֹאשׁ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **and raise the head of Bnei Yisrael.** אֲבָל הַדָּבָר צָרִיךְ בֵּיאוּר **But the matter needs explanation:** בַּמֶּה נִזְקָף בָּזֶה **in what way is the head lifted by this?** וְשָׁם הֲרָמַת הָרֹאשׁ **And there, the raising of the head** דְּעַל זֶה אָמַר כִּי תִשָּׂא וְגוֹמֵר **for about this it says, "When you lift up..." etc.,** לִפְקוּדֵיהֶם וְגוֹמֵר בִּפְקוֹד וְגוֹמֵר **"according to their numbering..." etc., "when you count..." etc.** [שְׁמוֹת ל, יב][3] **(Shemos 30:12).** הוּא עַל יְדֵי הַמִּנְיָן **is through the counting,** וּבְפָשׁוּטוֹ נִרְאֶה **On the simple level it appears** כִּי הַמִּנְיָן מוֹרֶה חֲשִׁיבוּת הַדָּבָר **that counting indicates the importance of the thing,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ מִטַּעַם זֶה **and as they said for this reason,** דְּכָל דָּבָר שֶׁבְּמִנְיָן לֹא בָטֵל **that anything sold by count is not nullified,** וַחֲכָמִים אוֹמְרִים רַק שִׁשָּׁה דְּבָרִים **and the Chachamim say only six items:** אֱגוֹזֵי פֶּרֶךְ וְכוּלֵי **soft-shelled nuts and so on** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בֵּיצָה ג, ב) **(as written in Beitzah 3b),** שֶׁאֵלּוּ חֲשׁוּבִים **for these are important** וְדָרֶךְ לְמוֹכְרָם בְּמִנְיָן.[4] **and are customarily sold by count.** אֲבָל הַלָּשׁוֹן נְשִׂיאַת רֹאשׁ **But the expression "lifting the head"** הוּא לְשׁוֹן הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת עַל הַשְּׁאָר **denotes being elevated above the rest,** כְּמוֹ רָאשֵׁי הַמַּטּוֹת **as in "the heads of the tribes,"** [בַּמִּדְבָּר ל, ב] **(Bamidbar 30:2)** רָאשֵׁי בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **"the heads of Bnei Yisrael,"** [שָׁם יג, ג] **(ibid. 13:3)** רָאשֵׁי בֵּית אָב **"the heads**

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[1] **Mishnah Shekalim 1:1** — "On the first of Adar they make announcements concerning the shekalim and concerning mixed plantings." The announcement initiates the collection of the annual half-shekel. Rav Tzadok asks why the public Torah reading precedes this announcement rather than coinciding with it.

[2] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tisa 3** — "Moshe taught Torah to Israel, guided them in the commandments, and gave them the Torah readings read each Shabbos, each month, and each festival; they mention him in every reading. Concerning the section of shekalim, Moshe said before the Holy One, blessed be He: 'Master of the world, after I die I will no longer be remembered.' The Holy One, blessed be He, told him: 'By your life, just as you now stand and give them the section of shekalim and lift up their heads, so each and every year when they read it before Me, it is as though you were standing there at that moment and lifting up their heads.'"

[3] **Exodus 30:12** — "When you lift up the head of the children of Israel according to their count, each man shall give Hashem a ransom for his soul when they are counted, so that no plague will befall them when they are counted." Rav Tzadok develops the literal wording, lifting the head, beyond the numerical act of taking a census.

[4] **Beitzah 3b** — "Rabbi Meir would say: That which is customarily counted renders the mixture prohibited. The Sages say: Only six things render it prohibited; Rabbi Akiva says: Seven. These are Perech nuts, Badan pomegranates, sealed casks, beet shoots, cabbage stalks, and the Greek gourd. Rabbi Akiva adds the loaves of a householder." The discussion distinguishes competing definitions of the important items that resist nullification. Rav Tzadok uses their being counted as an illustration of recognized importance; the cited opinions do not all establish the same legal category.

of the fathers' houses," [רְאֵה שָׁם א, ד][5] **(see ibid. 1:4)** וְכֵן נָשִׂיא **and likewise nasi, a prince;** וּמָצִינוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם יַחַד [לח, ב] בְּיחֶזְקֵאל **and we find both together in Yechezkel (38:2)** נְשִׂיא רֹאשׁ מֶשֶׁךְ[6] **"the prince, the head of Meshech."** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ הַמִּתְנַשֵּׂא לְכֹל לְרֹאשׁ **It is like "He who is exalted as head above all,"** [דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א כט, יא][7] **(I Divrei HaYamim 29:11),** כִּי הַמְנוּשָּׂא הוּא הָרֹאשׁ וְרִאשׁוֹן **for the one who is exalted is the head and the first,** דּוּגְמַת רֹאשׁ הָאָדָם **like the head of a person** לְשְׁאָר אֵיבָרִים. **relative to the other limbs.** וַה' יִתְבָּרַךְ צִיְּוָה **And Hashem, may He be blessed, commanded** לְנַשֵּׂא רֹאשׁ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּפוּלָּם. **to lift up the head of all of Yisrael, every one of them.** כִּי בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל כָּל אֶחָד **For in Yisrael each individual** הוּא דָּגוּל וּמְנוּשָּׂא בְּאֵיזֶה דָּבָר **is distinguished and exalted in some matter** מַה שֶּׁאֵין בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּמוֹתוֹ **in which there is none like him in all of Yisrael** בְּדָבָר זֶה[8] **in that respect,** כַּיָּדוּעַ דְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל **as is known that the root of the souls of Yisrael** מֵהַתּוֹרָה הוּא **is from the Torah:** שִׁשִּׁים רִיבּוֹא דְּדוֹר הַמִּדְבָּר **the six hundred thousand of the generation of the wilderness** הֵם מֵהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **are from the Written Torah.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **And therefore they said in the Midrash** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ע, ט) **(Bereishis Rabbah 70:9)** דְּאִלּוּ הָיָה חָסֵר אֶחָד מֵהֶם **that had even one of them been missing,** לֹא נִתְּנָה תּוֹרָה.[9] **the Torah would not have been given.** דְּהָיָה חָסֵר אוֹת אַחַת **For a single letter would have been missing** [אוֹ חֵלֶק מֵאוֹת הַפּוֹסֵל] **or part of a letter, which disqualifies,** וְהַסֵּפֶר תּוֹרָה פְּסוּלָה **and a Sefer Torah is invalid when a letter is missing,** וַאֲפִילּוּ קוֹצוֹ שֶׁל יוֹד מְעַכֵּב[10] **and even the tip of a yud is indispensable;** [מְנָחוֹת לד, א] **(Menachos 34a),** וְעַל זֶה נִמְנוּ.[11] **and for this reason they were counted.** וְאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר (חֵלֶק ג' קיז, ב) **And they said in the Zohar (III 117b)** דְּהֵם חַיָּילִין דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא **that they are "the hosts of the Torah,"** שְׁמִסְפַּר נַפְשׁוֹת אִלּוּ **for the number of these souls** הֵם כּוֹלְלִים כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כּוּלָּהּ.[12]

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[5] **Numbers 30:2; 13:3; 1:4** — "Moshe spoke to the heads of the tribes of the children of Israel, saying: This is the matter Hashem commanded. ... Moshe sent them from the wilderness of Paran at Hashem's command; they were all men of standing, heads of the children of Israel. ... With you there shall be one man from each tribe, each a head of his ancestral house." These three passages use head for a position of precedence or leadership. They establish the linguistic basis of Rav Tzadok's distinction between being counted and being raised above others.

[6] **Ezekiel 38:2** — "Son of man, set your face toward Gog of the land of Magog, prince and chief of Meshech and Tuval, and prophesy concerning him." Rav Tzadok places prince and head together to illustrate the language of elevation.

[7] **I Chronicles 29:11** — "Yours, Hashem, are the greatness, the might, the splendor, the enduring victory, and the majesty, for all that is in heaven and on earth is Yours. Yours, Hashem, is the kingship, and You are exalted as head over all." The phrase head over all supplies the sense of precedence that Rav Tzadok develops here.

[8] Parallel: **Tzidkas HaTzadik 231** — "Every individual has a hold in a letter of the Torah, and a Torah scroll lacking one letter is invalid. Consequently, just as this person needs that one, that one needs this person. Although one possesses a greater share in words of Torah, he nevertheless knows nothing of the portion belonging to this lesser person."
Connection: This explains the particular elevation Rav Tzadok attributes to every Jew: a larger overall attainment does not absorb another person's indispensable Torah portion. It also guards against reading elevation here as a license for arrogance.

[9] **Bereshit Rabbah 70:9** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Yehudah of Kefar Akko said in the name of Rabbi Shmuel: Had Israel been short of even one more person, they would not have received the Torah." The Midrash interprets the gathering of all the flocks at the well as Israel's assembly at Sinai. Rav Tzadok develops this into the indispensability of every individual's Torah-root.

[10] **Menachot 34a** — "The four passages in tefillin are indispensable to one another, and even a single written character is indispensable. Is that not obvious? Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: It was necessary only for the point of a yud." The immediate passage concerns tefillin; Rav Tzadok invokes its principle of textual completeness in explaining why the absence of even one Torah-root cannot be disregarded.

[11] **Zohar III 117b, Bamidbar** — "Once the Torah and the Mishkan had been established, the Holy One, blessed be He, wished to count the hosts of the Torah: how many were the hosts of the Torah, and how many were the hosts of the Mishkan. Come and see: anything that needs to be established in its place is not established until it is mentioned aloud and appointed over. Here too, the Holy One, blessed be He, wished to count the hosts of the Torah and the hosts of the Mishkan. They were all as one and were not separated from one another, all patterned after what is above; for Torah and Mishkan are not separated from one another, and they go together." The retrieved source marks this passage as Vilna folio 117b. Rav Tzadok interprets Israel's census through the Zohar's designation of Israel as the hosts of the Torah.

[12] **Koheles Rabbah, on Ecclesiastes 1:4** — "A generation goes and a generation comes. Rabbi Yudan said in the name of Rabbi Levi: There is no day on which six hundred thousand are not born and six hundred thousand do not die. What is the reason? A generation goes and a generation comes. ... How do we know that a generation is six hundred thousand? For it is said: If any man among these people, this evil generation, shall see—and that generation numbered six hundred thousand." In the retrieved verse-based numbering this is the exposition of Ecclesiastes 1:4. The Midrash speaks of the number of a generation; Rav Tzadok's formulation, no generation has fewer, condenses its teaching for his discussion of the collective soul-roots.

encompasses the entire Torah. וּנְפָשׁוֹת **And the souls in each generation** [שֶׁהֵם מִצֶּאֱצָאֵי דּוֹר הַמִּדְבָּר] **who are among the descendants of the generation of the wilderness** הוּא מֵהִתְחַדְּשׁוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **stem from the new insights of Torah she'b'al peh** [הַנּוֹבֵעַ וְיוֹצֵא מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **which flows and issues forth from the Written Torah,** כְּאוֹר הַלְּבָנָה הַמְקַבֶּלֶת מֵהַחַמָּה] **like the light of the moon, which receives from the sun in that generation;** שֶׁבְּאוֹתוֹ דּוֹר וּכְלַל הַמִּסְפָּר הֵם שִׁשִּׁים רִיבּוֹא **and the total number is six hundred thousand,** מִסְפַּר דּוֹר הַמִּדְבָּר **the number of the generation of the wilderness,** שֶׁהֵם שׁוֹרֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹת כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת **who are the root of the souls of all the generations,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּקֹהֶלֶת רַבָּה א׳ [פִּסְקָא ה] **as they said in Koheles Rabbah 1 (section 5),** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת נח, א) **And therefore they said (Berachos 58a)** דְּעַל אוּכְלְסֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אוֹמֵר שֶׁאֵין דַּעְתָּם דּוֹמָה זֶה לָזֶה **that upon seeing multitudes of Yisrael one says, "Blessed is He Who knows the secrets," for their minds are not like one another,** בָּרוּךְ חֲכַם הָרָזִים וְאֵין אוּכְלָסָא פְּחוּתָה מִשִּׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא **and a multitude is no less than six hundred thousand** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם) **(as they said there);** דְּדַעַת כָּל אֶחָד בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ **for the mind of each one individually** הוּא כְּפִי שָׁרְשׁוֹ בַּהַתּוֹרָה[14] **accords with his root in the Torah.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן יג כט, א) **And therefore they said (Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 13, 29a):** יַעֲקֹב מִלְבַר מֹשֶׁה מִלְגָּאו[15] **"Yaakov is outside, Moshe is within";** דְּיַעֲקֹב נַפְשׁוֹ כּוֹלֵל כָּל נַפְשׁוֹת דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **for Yaakov's soul encompasses all the souls of Yisrael,** מִצַּד שֶׁכּוּלָּם צֶאֱצָאָיו וְחֵלֶק מִנַּפְשׁוֹ וּכְלָלוּת נַפְשָׁם כְּלוּלִים בּוֹ. **since they are all his descendants and a portion of his soul, and the totality of their souls is included in him.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא בְּסוֹד הַדַּעַת כַּיָּדוּעַ **who is in the secret of Daas, as is known —** דְּעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא דּוֹר הַמִּדְבָּר דּוֹר דֵּעָה **which is why the generation of the wilderness is called "the generation of knowledge,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה יט, ג) **as they said (Bamidbar Rabbah 19:3)** וְדַרְדַּע [מְלָכִים א ה, יא][16] עַל פָּסוּק **on the verse (I Melachim 5:11) "and Darda" —** כִּי הוּא כּוֹלֵל הַנְּפָשׁוֹת כּוּלָּם **for he encompasses all the souls** מִצַּד הַדַּעַת **from the aspect of Daas,** וְהוּא הַפְּנִימִיּוּת דְּנֶפֶשׁ. **which is the inner dimension of the soul.** כַּיָּדוּעַ דְּעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **As is known, regarding the ten sefiros,** אֵין הַדַּעַת נִמְנֶה מִצַּד חִיצוֹנִיּוּתָם **from the aspect of their outer dimension,** בִּכְלָלָם **Daas is not counted among them,** רַק מִצַּד הַפְּנִימִיּוּת **but only from the aspect of the inner dimension,** דְּאֵין הַכֶּתֶר נִמְנֶה **where Kesser is not counted,** כִּי הוּא הַנִּקְרָא אַיִן **for it is what is called Ayin, Nothingness,** שֶׁהוּא הַגּוּלְגַּלְתָּא **which is the skull** וְקַרְקַפְתָּא דִּתְפִילִין **and the crown of the head where tefillin are placed,** שֶׁלְּמַעְלָה מֵהַמּוֹחַ **which is above the brain;** וְהַחָכְמָה שֶׁהוּא תְּחִלַּת הַהִתְגַּלּוּת יֵשׁ מֵאַיִן. **and Chochmah, which is the beginning of revelation, something from nothing.** וְלָזֶה בַּפְּנִימִיּוּת **Therefore, in the inner dimension,** הַיְינוּ דְּדַעַת מְמַלֵּא מְקוֹם הַכֶּתֶר **Daas fills the place of Kesser.** דְּרַשִׁ״י הַמּוּשָׂג לָאָדָם **meaning what is grasped by man,** פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא [שְׁמוֹת לא, ג פֵּירֵשׁ] **For Rashi in Parshas Ki Sisa (Shemos 31:3) explained** וּבְדַעַת רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ[17]

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[13] **Berakhot 58a** — "The Sages taught: One who sees the multitudes of Israel says, 'Blessed is the Knower of secrets,' for their minds are unlike one another and their faces are unlike one another. It was taught: A multitude numbers no fewer than six hundred thousand." The blessing acknowledges God's knowledge of the inward differences concealed within an outwardly gathered multitude. Rav Tzadok identifies those differences with the distinct Torah-root of each soul.

[14] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 13, 29a** — "When the sukkah was completed with its thigh, it was said of Yaakov: Yaakov came complete. Yaakov is indeed the image of the middle pillar from its outer aspect. Was Moshe not there too? Rather, he was from the inner aspect: this one from the body, and that one from the soul." The source itself distinguishes outer and inner as body and soul. Rav Tzadok applies that distinction to Yaakov's encompassing Israel through descent and Moshe's encompassing their inward daas.

[15] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:3** — "'Darda' refers to the generation of the wilderness, for they possessed understanding." This occurs in the Midrash's exposition of the figures mentioned in the description of Shlomo's wisdom. Rav Tzadok reads the wilderness generation's daas through their connection to Moshe.

[16] **Rashi on Exodus 31:3** — "Daas: the holy spirit." Rashi distinguishes this from the preceding qualities of wisdom and understanding in the description of Betzalel. Rav Tzadok uses the distinction to identify daas here with apprehension beyond ordinary intellectual acquisition.

[17] Parallel: **Tanya, Likkutei Amarim 42** — "Every soul of the house of Israel contains something of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him. ... Moshe Rabbeinu encompasses them all and is called the faithful shepherd, meaning that he draws daas into the community of Israel, so that each person may know Hashem according to the apprehension and higher root of his soul and its nurture from the root of Moshe Rabbeinu's soul. Furthermore, in every generation sparks of Moshe Rabbeinu's soul descend and clothe themselves in the body and soul of the sages of that generation, the eyes of the congregation, to teach the people daas, to know Hashem's greatness and to serve Him with heart and soul, for the service of the heart is according to daas."

"and with knowledge" as Ruach HaKodesh, וְהוּא הַשָּׂגָה שֶׁלְּמַעְלָה **which is a perception that is above the wisdom in the brain** מֵהַחָכְמָה שֶׁבְּמוֹחַ. **and beyond the bounds of its grasp.** וּמִגְּדָר הַשָּׂגָתוֹ. **And therefore Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** וְעַל כֵּן מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **is the inner dimension of all the souls of Yisrael,** הוּא הַפְּנִימִיּוּת שֶׁל כָּל נַפְשׁוֹת דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **namely the perception of Daas** הֵיינוּ הַשָּׂגַת הַדַּעַת **that stems from the root and source of the soul** וּמְקוֹר הַנֶּפֶשׁ **in the letters of the Torah;** מֵאוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה וְהוּא **and he is the Daas within the souls of all Yisrael** הַדַּעַת שֶׁבְּנַפְשׁוֹת כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁבְּכָל הַדּוֹרוֹת[18] **in all the generations.** וְעַל כֵּן אִיתָא בִּגְמָרָא **And therefore it is stated in the Gemara** (שַׁבָּת קא, ב וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **(Shabbos 101b and elsewhere):** מֹשֶׁה שַׁפִּיר קָאָמַרְתָּ **"Moshe, are you speaking well?"** בְּעִנְיַן דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה. **regarding words of Torah,** וּבְכָל דּוֹר יֵשׁ גַּם כֵּן מִבְּתִמְיָה אַיֵּה הַדַּעַת שֶׁלְּךָ[19] **said in astonishment: Where is your knowledge?** **And in every generation there is also a soul or souls** נֶפֶשׁ אוֹ נְפָשׁוֹת שֶׁל רָאשֵׁי יִשְׂרָאֵל אַלְפֵי **of the heads of the thousands of Yisrael,** הַכּוֹלְלִים כַּמָּה אֲלָפִים נְפָשׁוֹת. **which encompass many thousands of souls.** וְיֵשׁ רָאשֵׁי הַדּוֹר **And there are leaders of the generation** שֶׁהֵם כּוֹלְלִים נְפָשׁוֹת **who encompass the souls** כָּל אוֹתוֹ הַדּוֹר **of that entire generation,** וּבָהֶם שׁוֹרֶשׁ מִמֹּשֶׁה **like Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** דּוּגְמַת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and they have a root from Moshe;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִ״י זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **and as the Arizal, of blessed memory, wrote** עַל לְשׁוֹן מֹשֶׁה שַׁפִּיר קָאָמַרְתָּ **on the expression "Moshe, are you speaking well?"** כֵּן דְּגְדוֹל הַדּוֹר נִקְרָא **that the great one of the generation is called so** שֶׁהוּא נִיצוֹץ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **because he is a spark of Moshe Rabbeinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם עַצְמוֹ **peace be upon him, himself,** הַמִּתְגַּלְגֵּל בְּכָל דּוֹר[20] **which is reincarnated in every generation.** (בְּרָכוֹת נח, ב וּבַגְּמָרָא) **And in the Gemara (Berachos 58b)** דְּרַב חֲנִינָא בְּרֵיהּ דְּרַב אִיקָא **Rav Chanina the son of Rav Ika** וְרַב הוּנָא בְּרֵיהּ דְּרַב יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **made a blessing upon Rav Pappa** בַּיְרֵךְ עַל רַב פָּפָּא **and Rav Huna the son of Rav Yehoshua:** חָכִם הָרָזִים **"He Who knows the secrets";** וַאֲמַר לְהוּ כֵּינָן דַּחֲזִיתִינְכוּ **and he said to them: "Since I saw you,** חֲשַׁבְתִּינְכוּ עֲלָאי כְּשִׁשִּׁים רִיבּוֹא **I considered you, for me, like six hundred thousand";** וַאֲמַרוּ לֵיהּ חֲכִימַת כּוּלֵּי הַאי וְכוּלֵּי **and they said to him, "Are you that wise?" and so on;** עַיֵּין שָׁם[21] **see there.** וְחָשְׁבוּ זֶה לְחָכְמָה גְּדוֹלָה **And they considered this great wisdom,** שֶׁהִשִּׂיג עַל יְדֵי רְאִיָּיתוֹ אוֹתָם **that he perceived, through his seeing them** עַל דָּרָךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר יִתְרוֹ **in the manner of what is said in the Zohar, Yisro,** [חֵלֶק ב׳ ע, א] **(Zohar II 70a)** [עַל פָּסוּק וְאַתָּה תֶּחֱזֶה[22]] **on the verse "And you shall discern",** שֶׁהֵם חֲשׁוּבִים

Connection: The Tanya distinguishes the share of Moshe present in every soul from the special descent into the sages who teach the generation. This clarifies both levels in Rav Tzadok's account and gives their practical expression: daas should inform the service of the heart.

[18] **Shabbat 101b** — "Rav Safra said to him: 'Moshe, have you spoken correctly? We learned: They may carry from one to the other!' Rather, Rav Safra said: It was necessary to permit joining them by an eruv and carrying from one to the other." In its immediate setting, the expression challenges a proposed explanation of carrying between tied ships. Rav Tzadok explicitly reads it as a question; its deeper association with Moshe's daas is his interpretation.

[19] **Shaar HaGilgulim, Introduction 36, passage on Hillel** — "Hillel was one spark among the six hundred thousand sparks of the root of Moshe Rabbeinu's soul, which reincarnates in every generation. Therefore both were humble, and both lived one hundred and twenty years." This passage supplies an explicit example in the writings of Rabbi Chaim Vital of a later sage as a spark from Moshe's soul-root. It establishes the underlying teaching. The Arizal's explanation of the expression itself is transmitted by the Chida, Midbar Kedmus, Ma'areches Mem, os 7: "'Moshe, you have spoken well' is said in several places in the Talmud, and our master the Arizal explained that every outstanding Torah scholar in his generation has in him a spark of Moshe Rabbeinu."

[20] **Berakhot 58b** — "Rav Pappa and Rav Huna son of Rav Yehoshua were traveling and met Rav Chanina son of Rav Ika. They told him: 'On seeing you we recited two blessings: Who has apportioned of His wisdom to those who fear Him, and Who has kept us alive.' He replied: 'I too, when I saw you, regarded you as equivalent to six hundred thousand of the house of Israel and recited three blessings over you: those two, and the Knower of secrets.' They said to him: 'Are you so very wise!' They set their eyes upon him, and he died." The account's severe ending belongs to the source and should not be omitted from its context. Rav Tzadok focuses on Rav Chanina's extraordinary recognition of the collective spiritual scope of these two sages.

[21] **Zohar II 70a, Yitro, Raza deRazin** — "We have learned that Moshe found this difficult until the Shechinah came and taught him. She perceived and selected all those men who were recognizable through their countenance, and there Moshe learned this wisdom and entered into it. This is what is written: And you shall perceive from among all the people—the One of whom it is written: You are He, and Your years will not end; You give life to them all; You, Hashem, are a shield for me. And you shall perceive and look into this: you, and no other, to know and contemplate the six hundred thousand." This is the opening of Raza deRazin, whose digital source explicitly marks folio 70a. It concerns discernment of inward character through outward appearance and specifically joins that discernment with Moshe and the six hundred thousand.

[22] **Eruvin 13b** — "Rabbi said: 'The reason I am sharper than my colleagues is that I saw Rabbi Meir from behind. Had I seen him from the front, I would have been sharper still, as it is written: Your eyes shall see your teachers.'"

כְּשִׁשִּׁים רִיבּוֹא **that they were equivalent to six hundred thousand,** הֱיוֹתָן שֶׁנַּפְשׁוֹתָם כּוֹלְלוֹת **meaning that their souls encompassed** נַפְשׁוֹת כָּל הַדּוֹר **the souls of the whole generation,** וּכְלוּלִים מִשִּׁשִּׁים רִבּוֹא דֵּיעוֹת.[23] **and were composed of six hundred thousand minds.** וּמַה שֶּׁאָמַר עָלָיו **And as for what he said, "to me,"** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר עַל דָּרֶךְ **one can say that this means** שֶׁהוּא בְּרְאִיָּתוֹ אוֹתָם הִשִּׂיג זֶה **that he grasped this by seeing them,** הַאי דְּמַחַדַּדְנָא מֵחַבְרַאי **in the manner of what is said in Eruvin 13b: "The reason I am sharper than my colleagues** דַּחֲזִיתָא[24] לְרַבִּי מֵאִיר וְכוּלֵי **is that I saw Rabbi Meir..." and so on;** וְעַיֵּין שָׁם ע״ג א׳ **and see there, 53a,** דְּלָמַד רַבִּי יוֹחָנָן **that Rabbi Yochanan learned** לֵב כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד **the heart of each and every one** וְחָכְמַת כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד[25] **and the wisdom of each and every one;** וְהָכָא עַל יְדֵי הָרְאִיָּה דִּידְהוּ **and here, through seeing them,** הִשִּׂיג לֵב וְחָכְמַת שִׁשִּׁים רִיבּוֹא. **he grasped the heart and wisdom of six hundred thousand.** וּמְבָרְכִין עַל זֶה לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **And for this one blesses the Holy One, blessed is He,** שֶׁהוּא חָכַם הָרָזִים **that He knows the secrets,** שֶׁבְּכָל אֶחָד מֵהֶם יֵשׁ רָז וְסוֹד **for within each one of them there is a mystery and secret** בִּבְנֵי עַצְמוֹ שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹ. **of his own, which is the root of his soul.** וַאֲפִילּוּ בָּאֲנָשִׁים הַפְּשׁוּטִים **And even among simple people,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בִּמְקוֹם אַחֵר **as was explained elsewhere,** מִבָּבָא קַמָּא צ״ב **from Bava Kamma 92** [עַמּוּד ב][26] **(side b)** וְסַנְהֶדְרִין ז׳ א׳[27] **and Sanhedrin 7a** וְעוֹד מִכַּמָּה דּוּכְתֵּי **and from several other places,** דְּיֵשׁ בְּכָל אֶחָד **that within each one there is** אֵיזֶה שׁוֹרֶשׁ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **some root of words of Torah;** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ אֵיזֶהוּ חָכָם **and about this they said, "Who is wise?** [אָבוֹת פֶּרֶק ד מִשְׁנָה א] **(Avos 4:1):** הַלּוֹמֵד מִכָּל אָדָם.[28] **One who learns from every person."** וְדַוְקָא אָדָם אָמַר **And it specifically says "person,"** דְּאַתֶּם קְרוּיִם אָדָם **for "you are called adam,"** [יְבָמוֹת סא, א][29] **(Yevamos 61a),** דְּרַק בְּנֶפֶשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל **since only in the soul of Yisrael** יֵשׁ בְּכָל **there is in each one some matter of wisdom** אֶחָד אֵיזֶה דָּבָר חָכְמָה מִיּוּחָד שֶׁמִּזֶּה שׁוֹרֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹ **unique to him, from which his soul is rooted.** וְעַל כֵּן רַק עַל אוּכְלְסֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **Therefore only upon multitudes of Yisrael** מְבָרֵךְ חָכָם **does one bless "He Who knows the secrets,"** שֶׁחָכְמָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ כּוֹלֵל **for His wisdom, may He be blessed, encompasses** כָּל אוֹתָם הָרָזִים **all those secrets** וְהַדֵּיעוֹת שׁוֹנוֹת **and the differing minds,** כִּי הוּא בְּרָאָם. **for He created them.** וְחָכְמַת כָּל חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **And the wisdom of all the sages of Yisrael** הוּא חֵלֶק מֵחָכְמָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **is a portion of His wisdom, may He be blessed,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁתִּקְנוּ בַּבְּרָכָה **as they instituted in the blessing** דְּעַל חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **said over the sages of Yisrael:** שֶׁחָלַק מֵחָכְמָתוֹ לִירֵאָיו **"Who has apportioned of His wisdom to those who fear Him";** [בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם] **(Berachos ibid.);** וְזֶהוּ חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **and these are the sages of Yisrael,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהֶם חָכְמָה גְּלוּיָה. **in whom there is revealed wisdom.** וּשְׁאָר כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **And every other individual of Yisrael** יֵשׁ בּוֹ אֵיזֶה סוֹד **has within him some secret** מֵחָכְמָתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **of His wisdom, may He be blessed,** טָמוּן בְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹ **hidden in the root of his soul,** שֶׁהוּא עַצְמוֹ אֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ **which he himself does not know,** וְהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ חִיּוּתוֹ **and it is**

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[23] **Eruvin 53a** — "Rabbi Yochanan said: 'Rabbi Oshaya had twelve disciples. I grew up among them for eighteen days and learned the heart of each one and the wisdom of each one.'" The Gemara distinguishes learning their inward understanding and wisdom from acquiring a body of transmitted teachings. This distinction supports Rav Tzadok's account of recognizing the particular wisdom present in another person.

[24] **Bava Kamma 92b** — "Rava said to Rabbah bar Mari: From where do we know this saying that people use: If there is a defect in you, be the first to speak of it? He answered him: For it is written: He said, I am Avraham's servant." The Gemara finds a scriptural basis for a proverb in ordinary speech. Such examples support Rav Tzadok's claim that even a simple person can hold a particular element of Torah wisdom.

[25] **Sanhedrin 7a** — "A certain person used to go about saying: Fortunate is one who hears and pays no heed; a hundred misfortunes pass him by. Shmuel said to Rav Yehudah: A verse is written: The beginning of strife is letting out water —meaning the beginning of a hundred judgments." An everyday saying about overlooking provocation is shown to contain scriptural wisdom. Rav Tzadok points to this kind of instance when locating a Torah-root even in those without manifest scholarship.

[26] **Pirkei Avot 4:1** — "Ben Zoma says: Who is wise? One who learns from every person, as it is said: From all my teachers I have gained understanding, for Your testimonies are my meditation."

[27] **Yevamot 61a** — "The graves of the nations do not impart impurity through a tent, for it is said: You, My flock, the flock of My pasture, are adam. You are called adam, while the nations are not called adam." The immediate discussion concerns the technical use of adam in the laws of corpse impurity through a tent. Rav Tzadok applies that expression within his account of the distinctive spiritual root of Israel.

[28] **Ecclesiastes 7:12** — "For wisdom provides shelter as money provides shelter; the advantage of knowledge is that wisdom gives life to those who possess it." Rav Tzadok applies the life-giving quality of wisdom to the hidden particular wisdom at the root of each soul.

[29] **Ecclesiastes 8:1** — "Who is like the wise person, and who knows the interpretation of a matter? A person's wisdom illuminates his face, and the sternness of his face is changed." The verse connects inward wisdom with outward expression. Rav Tzadok develops the varying illumination of each face from its distinctive point of wisdom and daas.

the root of his vitality, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [קֹהֶלֶת ז, יב] **as it says (Koheles 7:12):** וְהַחָכְמָה תְּחַיֶּה בְעָלֶיהָ[30] **"And wisdom gives life to those who possess it."** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵשׁ לְכָל אֶחָד **And through this, each one has** נְשִׂיאוּת רֹאשׁ עַל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **an elevation of the head above all of Yisrael,** מִצַּד חֵלֶק אֱלוֹהַּ מִמַּעַל **by virtue of the portion of G-d from above** שֶׁבְּנִשׁוֹרֵשׁ נַפְשׁוֹ **that is in the root of his soul,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ רָז וְסוֹד **in which there is a mystery and secret** נֶעְלָם מִכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **hidden from all of Yisrael.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם בְּהָרוֹאֶה **And this is what they said there, in the chapter HaRo'eh:** [בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם] **(Berachos ibid.):** שֶׁאֵין דַּעְתָּם שָׁוָה **that their minds are not alike** וְאֵין פַּרְצוּפֵיהֶם דּוֹמִים זֶה לָזֶה **and their faces do not resemble one another;** דְּשִׁינּוּי צוּרַת הָאָדָם **for the difference in a person's form** מִצַּד שִׁינּוּי הַדַּעַת שֶׁבְּכָל אֶחָד **comes from the difference in the mind within each one,** כִּי הַפָּנִים פְּנֵי אָדָם **for the face, the face of a man,** הוּא **is in the image of G-d,** וְזֶהוּ מִצַּד הַנֶּפֶשׁ חֵלֶק אֱלוֹהַּ מִמַּעַל **and this is by virtue of the soul, a portion of G-d;** וְחָכְמַת אָדָם תָּאִיר פָּנָיו **and "a man's wisdom lights up his face."** [קֹהֶלֶת ח, א][31] **(Koheles 8:1);** וְכָל אֶחָד כְּפִי נְקוּדַּת **And each one, according to the point** חָכְמָה וְדַעַת שֶׁבּוֹ **of wisdom and knowledge within him,** שֶׁאֵין דּוֹמָה לַחֲבֵירוֹ **which does not resemble his fellow's,** כֵּן אוֹר הַפָּנִים שֶׁלּוֹ אֵין דּוֹמֶה. **so too the light of his face is not alike.** וּבְסַנְהֶדְרִין (לח, א) אִיתָא **And in Sanhedrin (38a) it is stated** בְּקוֹל בְּמַרְאֶה דְּבִשְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים אָדָם מְשֻׁתָּנֶה מֵחֲבֵירוֹ **that in three things a person differs from his fellow:** מְשׁוֹרֵשׁ הַחִיּוּת וְקוֹל הוּא גַּם כֵּן נִמְשָׁךְ **And the voice too is drawn from the root of vitality,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁתִּרְגֵּם אוּנְקְלוֹס עַל נֶפֶשׁ חַיָּה [בְּרֵאשִׁית ב, ז] **as Onkelos translated "a living soul"** (Bereishis 2:7) רוּחַ מְמַלְלָא **as "a speaking spirit,"** שֶׁזֶּהוּ עִיקַּר חִיּוּת צוּרַת אָדָם **for this is the essence of the vitality of the human form,** וְקוֹל הוּא הַדִּבּוּר.[33] **and voice is speech.** וְהָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת גַּם כֵּן **The idolatrous nations too** וְהַקְּלִיפּוֹת שֶׁמִּשָּׁם שׁוֹרֶשׁ חִלּוּקִים מִצַּד הַסִּטְרָא אַחֲרָא **are differentiated by virtue of the Sitra Achra and the kelipos, from which their souls are rooted;** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר עֲלֵיהֶם נַפְשָׁם **and therefore it says about them,** בּוֹשָׁה אִמְּכֶם וְגוֹמֵר **"Your mother is ashamed..." etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם) **(as stated in Berachos there),** שֶׁבְּהִקָּבְצָם יַחַד **for when they are gathered together** — כִּינּוּס לָרְשָׁעִים רַע **"the gathering of the wicked is bad for them and bad for the world"** (סַנְהֶדְרִין עא, ב[34]) **(Sanhedrin 71b) —** דְּאִיגְּלֵי בַּהֲתַיְיהוּ **their shame is revealed,** וְנִבְעוּ מַצְפּוּנָיו **and "his hidden things are sought out,"** שֶׁיְּבוֹשׁוּ בְּשׁוֹרְשָׁם. **so that they are shamed in their root.** וּמְקוֹרָם הָרַע הִיא אִמָּם **And their evil source is their mother** יְלָדָתַם **who bore them** [אִמּוֹ כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל[35] **"his mother is Knesses Yisrael";** וּכְדָרְכָּךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **as they said regarding Yisrael,** (בְּרָכוֹת לה, ב) **(Berachos 35b):** דְּבָכָל אֶחָד שׁוֹרֶשׁ רַע מְיוּחָד **for each one has a particular root of evil,** וּבְקִיבּוּצָם נַעֲשֶׂה רַע הַכּוֹלֵל. **and in their gathering it becomes an all-inclusive evil.** וְהַהֵיפֶךְ בְּכִינּוּס צַדִּיקִים **And the opposite is so with the gathering of the righteous,** הֵם יִשְׂרָאֵל **who are Yisrael,** דְּעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים **for "Your**

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[30] **Sanhedrin 38a** — "It was taught: Rabbi Meir would say: A person differs from his fellow in three things: voice, appearance, and understanding. Voice and appearance are differentiated because of forbidden relationships; understanding, because of robbers and violent appropriators." The Gemara supplies practical reasons for these differences. Rav Tzadok develops their inward spiritual basis; the mystical explanation is his contribution.

[31] **Onkelos Genesis 2:7** — "Hashem God created man as dust from the earth, breathed into his nostrils the breath of life, and it became in man a speaking spirit." Onkelos renders the verse's living being as a speaking spirit. Rav Tzadok accordingly relates the distinct voice to the individual source of human vitality.

[32] **Sanhedrin 71b** — "Scattering the wicked benefits them and benefits the world; for the righteous it is bad for them and bad for the world. Gathering the wicked is bad for them and bad for the world; for the righteous it benefits them and benefits the world." Rav Tzadok develops the spiritual effect of combining distinct soul-roots. The Mishnah's contrast concerns the wicked and the righteous, rather than the mere fact of a gathering.

[33] **Berakhot 35b** — "Rabbi Chanina bar Pappa said: Whoever benefits from this world without a blessing is as though he robs the Holy One, blessed be He, and the congregation of Israel, for it is said: One who robs his father and mother and says there is no transgression is a companion to a destructive man. His father means the Holy One, blessed be He ... and his mother means the congregation of Israel, as it is said: Hear, my son, the instruction of your father, and do not forsake the Torah of your mother." Rav Tzadok borrows the identification of mother with the collective source. The immediate Talmudic setting is the obligation to bless before benefiting from the world.

[34] **Isaiah 60:21** — "Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever, the branch of My planting, the work of My hands, in which to be glorified."

[35] **Proverbs 10:25** — "When the tempest passes, the wicked person is no more, but the righteous person is the foundation of the world." Rav Tzadok reads foundation of the world in relation to the unique contribution through which each righteous soul sustains the whole.

people are all righteous," [יְשַׁעְיָה ס, כא[36]] **(Yeshayah 60:21),** וְצַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם[37] **and "the righteous one is the foundation of the world."** (סַנְהֶדְרִין לז, א) וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ **And therefore they said (Sanhedrin 37a):** כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד חַיָּיב לוֹמַר **"Each and every one is obligated to say,** בִּשְׁבִילִי נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם[38] **'For my sake the world was created,'"** שֶׁבָּאֱמֶת בִּשְׁבִיל כָּל אֶחָד **for in truth, for the sake of each one** מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל נִבְרָא **of Yisrael it was created;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּבְרָכוֹת (ו, ב) **and as they said in Berachos (6b)** עַל פָּסוּק [קֹהֶלֶת יב, יג] **on the verse (Koheles 12:13)** כִּי זֶה כָּל הָאָדָם **"for this is the whole of man":** שָׁקוּל זֶה **this one is equal** כְּנֶגֶד כָּל הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ. **to the entire world.** וְכָל הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ לֹא נִבְרָא **And the entire world was created** אֶלָּא בִּשְׁבִיל זֶה **only for the sake of this one,** וּלְצַוּוֹת לָזֶה[39] **to be a companion to this one;** וְזֶהוּ עַל כָּל אֶחָד **and this applies to every individual,** כִּי כָּל אֶחָד הוּא מְדוּגָּל וּמְנוּשָּׂא בְּעִנְיָן מְיוּחָד בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ **for each one is distinguished and exalted in a unique matter of his own,** שֶׁעֲבוּר זֶה כָּל הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ בִּשְׁבִילוֹ[40] **on account of which the whole world exists for his sake,** וּצְרִיכִים לוֹ בָּזֶה.[41] **and they need him for this.** (אָבוֹת ד, ג) **(Avos 4:3):** שֶׁאֵין לְךָ אָדָם שֶׁאֵין לוֹ שָׁעָה[42] **"There is no person who does not have his hour,"** כִּי הַכֹּל בָּעוֹלָם **for everything in the world is** שָׁנָה וְנֶפֶשׁ **time and soul,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁבְּנֵי אָדָם חֲלוּקִים זֶה מִזֶּה **and just as people differ from one another,** כֵּן בַּזְּמַן **so too in time,** כָּל שָׁעָה חֲלוּקָה מֵחֲבֶרְתָּהּ **each hour differs from the next,** הַכֹּל כְּפִי חֲלוּקַת הַנְּפָשׁוֹת **all according to the division of the souls** בְּאוֹתוֹ דּוֹר. **in that generation.** וְכָל אֶחָד יֵשׁ לוֹ **And each one has** שָׁעָה מְיוּחֶדֶת. **an hour designated for him.** וְכָל הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת נִקְרָא **And every elevation is called** דְּקַיְימָא לֵיהּ שַׁעְתָּא **"the hour stands for him"** גַּבֵּי רַבִּי יוֹחָנָן **regarding Rabbi Yochanan** (תַּעֲנִית כא, א)

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[36] **Sanhedrin 37a** — "A person stamps many coins with one seal, and they are all alike; but the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed be He, stamped every person with the seal of Adam the first man, and no one is like his fellow. Therefore every individual must say: For my sake the world was created." The Mishnah joins individual worth with the incomparable greatness of the Creator. Rav Tzadok explains this responsibility through the particular contribution for which each person is needed.

[37] **Berakhot 6b** — "What is meant by: For this is the whole of man? Rabbi Elazar said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said: The entire world was created only for this person. Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said: This person is equivalent to the entire world. Rabbi Shimon ben Azzai says—and some say Rabbi Shimon ben Zoma: The entire world was created only to accompany this person." The preceding verse concerns fearing God and keeping His commandments (Ecclesiastes 12:13). Rav Tzadok applies these formulations to the particular good for which each person is needed.

[38] Parallel: **Mei HaShiloach I, Vayakhel 1** — "When they saw the joining together of all the work, all the curtains and the boards, they saw that each part belonged with the other as though one person had made them. They understood that everything they had done was not through their own intellect alone, but through the Blessed God's assistance to every worker on the Mishkan, so that afterward the form of the building would be complete. How could one then boast over another? ... The Divine Presence would not rest even if a single peg were missing. They therefore could not boast over one another at all, even the maker of the Ark over the maker of the courtyard pegs."

Connection: The Mishkan supplies a concrete model of the mutual necessity described here. Different levels and tasks remain distinct, yet the complete dwelling for the Divine Presence needs the contribution of each.

[39] **Pirkei Avot 4:3** — "Do not despise any person, and do not dismiss any thing, for there is no person who does not have his hour, and no thing that does not have its place." Rav Tzadok develops the hour as the particular time at which a person's distinctive good is desired above.

[40] **Sefer Yetzirah 3:5** — "The three mothers, aleph, mem, shin: He engraved them, hewed them, combined them, and sealed with them three mothers in the world, three mothers in the year, and three mothers in the soul, male and female." The source describes corresponding structures in world, year, and soul. Rav Tzadok extends this correspondence to a person's particular contribution and its appointed time.

[41] **Nedarim 32a** — "Rabbi Hoshaya said: Whoever conducts himself with wholeheartedness has the hour stand for him, for it is said: Walk before Me and be wholehearted, and it is written: You shall become the father of a multitude of nations." The source joins the idiom of one's hour with elevation promised to Avraham. Rav Tzadok's treatment also cites Eruvin 13b, whose discussion of yielding to or forcing the hour provides a complementary usage.

[42] **Taanit 21a** — "Rabbi Yochanan heard one angel say to the other: Let us throw this wall upon them and kill them, for they are leaving the life of the World to Come and engaging in temporal life. The other replied: Leave them, for one of them has his hour standing for him. Rabbi Yochanan heard, but Ilfa did not hear. Rabbi Yochanan said to Ilfa: Did the master hear anything? He replied: No. Rabbi Yochanan said: Since I heard and Ilfa did not hear, learn from this that my hour stands for me. ... Rabbi Yochanan returned, while Ilfa did not return. By the time Ilfa returned, Rabbi Yochanan had become head of the academy." The narrative connects his hour with Rabbi Yochanan's coming elevation. Rav Tzadok uses that expression to explain the time when a person's particular soul-root comes to the fore.

[43] **Berakhot 7b** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: If you see a wicked person upon whom the hour smiles, do not contend with him, for it is said: His ways prosper at all times. Moreover, he prevails in judgment, as it is said: Your judgments are far above, beyond him; moreover, he sees the downfall of his enemies, as it is said: All his adversaries—he puffs at them." Rav Tzadok distinguishes this language of the hour smiling from the hour standing for the person whose particular good is desired above.

(Taanis 21a), וּבְכַמָּה דּוּכְתֵּי **and in several places;** [עֵירוּבִין יג, ב; נְדָרִים לב, א] **(Eruvin 13b; Nedarim 32a):** שֶׁהַשָּׁעָה עוֹמֶדֶת לוֹ[44] **that the hour stands for him,** שֶׁבְּאוֹתוֹ זְמַן הָיָה הוּא **meaning that at that time he was** מְמֻנוּשָׁא וְרֹאשׁ[45] **the exalted one and the head,** כִּי חִיּוּתוֹ וְשׁוֹרֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹ **for his vitality and the root of his soul** הוּא הַמִּתְנַשֵּׂא בְּאוֹתָהּ הַשָּׁעָה **is the one elevated at that hour** דְּשַׁיְיכָא לֵיהּ **which belongs to him.** [וּבְרָשָׁעִים נִקְרָא **And regarding the wicked it is called** לוֹ שֶׁהַשָּׁעָה מְשַׂחֶקֶת **"the hour smiles upon him,"** וּבְכַמָּה דּוּכְתֵּי (ז, ב[46]) בִּבְרָכוֹת **in Berachos (7b) and in several places,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ יוֹשֵׁב בַּשָּׁמַיִם יִשְׂחָק **in the manner of "He Who sits in heaven laughs,** אֲדֹנָי יִלְעַג לָמוֹ **Hashem mocks them"** [תְּהִלִּים ב, ד[47]]] **(Tehillim 2:4);** וְכֵן לְכָל אֶחָד יֵשׁ אֵיזוֹ שָׁעָה **and likewise each one has some hour** שֶׁה' יִתְבָּרַךְ רוֹצֶה **when Hashem, may He be blessed, desires** בְּאוֹתוֹ חֵלֶק טוֹב **that good portion** שֶׁהוּא שֶׁל אָדָם זֶה. **which belongs to this person.** וְאָז אוֹתָהּ הַשָּׁעָה קַיְימָא לֵיהּ **And then that hour stands for him,** לִהְיוֹת הוּא הַמְמֻנוּשָׁא:[48] **for him to be the exalted one.**

וּבְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה עִטְּרוּ **And at the giving of the Torah they crowned** לְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל שְׁנֵי כְּתָרִים **each one of Yisrael with two crowns,** (שַׁבָּת פח, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shabbos 88a).** הַכֶּתֶר הוּא סִימָן הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת **The crown is a sign of elevation,** כְּכֶתֶר מַלְכוּת **like a royal crown;** וּבְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה נִתְגַּלָּה **and at the giving of the Torah there was revealed** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַדַּעַת שֶׁבְּכָל אֶחָד **the root of Daas within each one,** שֶׁהֵן הֵם אוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה **which are the letters of the Torah,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above;** דְּעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵשׁ לְכָל אֶחָד **through which each one has** הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת וְכֶתֶר **elevation and a crown** נֶגֶד כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **relative to all of Yisrael** בְּאוֹתוֹ פְּרָט דִּידֵיהּ. **in that particular aspect of his own.** וְהֵם שְׁנַיִם כִּי דַּעַת **And they are two, because Daas** הוּא חִבּוּר חָכְמָה וּבִינָה **is the joining of Chochmah and Binah,** שֶׁהֵם מוֹחָא וְלִבָּא. **which are the brain and the heart.** נִשְׁמַע הוּא הַשָּׂגַת חָכְמָה **"We will hear" is the grasp of the wisdom in the brain,** וְנַעֲשֶׂה הוּא עַל יְדֵי **and "we will do" comes about** שֶׁנִּכְנָס הַבִּינָה בַּלֵּב **when Binah enters the heart,** שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ תּוֹצְאוֹת חַיִּים **from which flow the issues of life** לְכָל הָאֵיבָרִים בְּמַעֲשֶׂה[49] **to all the limbs in action;** וּמִזֶּה בָּא אוֹר הַפָּנִים **and from this comes the light of the face,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְהֵם הִקְדִּימוּ נַעֲשֶׂה לְנִשְׁמַע **And they put "we will do" before "we will hear,"**

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[44] **Psalms 2:4** — "He who sits in heaven laughs; the Lord mocks them." In the psalm the nations' opposition to Hashem and His anointed is met by divine laughter. Rav Tzadok invokes this verse to explain the qualified sense in which an apparently successful wicked person has the hour smiling upon him.

[45] **Eruvin 13b:13** — "This teaches you that whoever lowers himself, the Holy One, blessed be He, raises him; whoever raises himself, the Holy One, blessed be He, lowers him. Whoever pursues greatness—greatness flees from him; whoever flees from greatness—greatness pursues him. Whoever forces the hour—the hour presses against him; whoever yields before the hour—the hour stands for him." The Talmud joins the proper hour to humility and to the acceptance of prominence. Rav Tzadok develops the final expression through the particular moment assigned to each soul's distinctive good.

[46] **Mishlei 4:23** — "Guard your heart with the utmost vigilance, for from it issue the sources of life." The verse places the heart at the source of lived conduct. Rav Tzadok applies its language to understanding entering the heart and then animating action.

[47] **Shabbos 88a** — "Rabbi Simai expounded: When Israel placed 'We will do' before 'We will hear,' six hundred thousand ministering angels came, and tied two crowns to each individual of Israel, one corresponding to 'We will do' and one to 'We will hear.' When Israel sinned, twelve hundred thousand destructive angels descended and removed them, as it says: 'The children of Israel stripped themselves of their ornaments from Mount Chorev.' Rabbi Yochanan said: Moshe merited them all and took them. Reish Lakish said: In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will return them to us, as it says: 'Those redeemed by Hashem will return and come to Zion with song, with everlasting joy upon their heads'—the joy that had been upon their heads from of old. Rabbi Elazar said: When Israel placed 'We will do' before 'We will hear,' a heavenly voice went forth: 'Who revealed to My children this secret used by the ministering angels?' For it is written: 'Bless Hashem, His angels, mighty in strength, who perform His word, to hear the voice of His word'—first performing, and afterward hearing." This is the source both for the two crowns and for the angelic precedence of doing over hearing. Its account of Moshe receiving the lost crowns and their eventual restoration also underlies the ensuing discussion.

[48] **Vayikra Rabbah 1:1** — "Rabbi Tanchum bar Chanilai opened: 'Bless Hashem, His angels, mighty in strength, who perform His word.' Of whom does Scripture speak? If it speaks of those above, has it not already said: 'Bless Hashem, all His hosts'? It therefore speaks of those below. Concerning those above, who can fulfill the assignments of the Holy One, blessed be He, it says 'all His hosts.' But concerning those below, who cannot fulfill His assignments, it says 'His angels,' and not 'all His angels.'" The Midrash subsequently interprets the mighty ones as those who observe Shemittah, and also as Israel at Sinai who put doing before hearing. Rav Tzadok develops its opening distinction in relation to human transmitters of Torah.

[49] **Malachi 2:7** — "For the lips of a kohen should preserve understanding, and Torah should be sought from his mouth, for he is a messenger of Hashem of Hosts." The Hebrew malach means a messenger as well as an angel. The verse supplies the language used by the Gemara for the qualifications of a Torah teacher.

וְאָמְרוּ שָׁם דְּהוּא רָז **and they said there that this is the secret** שֶׁמַּלְאָכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת מְשָׁתַּמְּשִׁין בּוֹ **which the ministering angels use:** עוֹשֵׂי דְבָרוֹ **"who do His word"** וְהָדַר לִשְׁמוֹעַ.[50] **and only then "to hear."** וּבְרֵישׁ וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה אָמַר **And at the beginning of Vayikra Rabbah it says** דְּקְרָא זֶה לֹא קָאֵי אַעֶלְיוֹנִים **that this verse does not refer to the celestial beings,** דְּנָאֲמַר אַחַר כָּךְ כָּל צְבָאָיו **since afterward it says "all His hosts,"** רַק בַּתַּחְתּוֹנִים **but rather to those below;** שֶׁאֵינָן יְכוֹלִין לַעֲמוֹד וְכוּלֵי **and therefore it does not say "all His angels,"** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא אָמַר כָּל מַלְאָכָיו **for they cannot stand... etc.;** עַיֵּין שָׁם.[51] **see there.** וְנִרְאֶה דְּמַלְאָכָיו הַיְינוּ רַבָּנָן **And it appears that "His angels" refers to the Rabbis,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מַלְאָכִי ב, ז] **as it says (Malachi 2:7):** כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן וְגוֹמַר **"For the lips of the kohen..." etc.,** וְאָמְרוּ מִזֶּה (חֲגִיגָה טו, ב) **and from this they said (Chagigah 15b):** אִם הָרַב דּוֹמֶה לְמַלְאָךְ **"If the teacher resembles an angel,** יְבַקְשׁוּ תּוֹרָה מִפִּיהוּ **let them seek Torah from his mouth,** וְאִם לָאו וְכוּלֵי **and if not..." etc.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם אָמְרוּ **And nevertheless they said** שֶׁאֵינָן יְכוֹלִין לַעֲמוֹד **that they cannot withstand** בְּתַקְפָּקִידָיו שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא. **the charges of the Holy One, blessed is He.** וְגַם אוֹתוֹ שֶׁאֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לַעֲמוֹד **And even one who cannot withstand** בְּכָלַל מַלְאָכָיו **would be included among "His angels"** דְּאִלּוּ אָמַר כָּל. **had it said "all."** כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת גַּם בָּהֶם **For in truth, even in them** יֵשׁ שֶׁהֲרֵי נִשְׁנוּ דִּבְרֵי אַחֵר בַּמִּשְׁנָה **there are true words of Torah,** דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה אֲמִיתִּים **for the words of Acher were taught in the Mishnah,** פֶּרֶק ד׳ דְּאָבוֹת מִשְׁנָה כ׳ **in Avos, chapter 4, mishnah 20,** וּבְשָׁמוֹ.[53] **and in his name.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (שָׁם) דְּנִמְשָׁל לֶאֱגוֹז **And in the Gemara (there) he is compared to a nut,** שֶׁאֵין תּוֹרָתוֹ נִמְאֶסֶת **whose Torah is not rendered repulsive;** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְרַק מַלְאַךְ ה׳ צְבָאוֹת **It is only "an angel of Hashem of Hosts"** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּאֵין נִקְרָא **that one can say he is not called,** וְגַם מִפִּיו מַמָּשׁ אֵין לִלְמוֹד **and also one should not learn directly from his mouth,** דְּיוּכַל לְהַכְנִיס בּוֹ **since he may insert into it** גַּם קְלִיפָּתוֹ **his husk as well,** וְרַק רַבִּי מֵאִיר יָדַע **and only Rabbi Meir knew how** [לְזָרוֹק הַקְּלִיפָּה [שָׁם][54] **to throw away the husk (ibid.).** אֲבָל יֵשׁ בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן **But there are in him too** דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה אֲמִיתִּים **true words of Torah,** שֶׁהֵם דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים **which are the words of the living G-d;** וּבָזֶה נִקְרָא מַלְאָךְ **and in this sense he is called an angel,** שְׁלִיחַ מֵה׳ **a messenger from Hashem** לְהַגִּיד דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה אֵלּוּ **to relate these words of Torah,** דְּלְכָךְ הִשְׁפִּיעוּ זֶה לְלִבּוֹ. **for that is why it was bestowed upon his heart.** וְהֵם נִקְרְאוּ עוֹשֵׂי דְבָרוֹ וְכוּלֵי **And they are called "who do His word..." etc.,** כִּי דְּבַר ה׳ **because "the word of Hashem"** הוּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּשַׁבָּת (קלח, ב) **as they said in Shabbos (138b)** עַל פָּסוּק [עָמוֹס ח, יב] **on the verse (Amos 8:12)** יְשׁוֹטְטוּ לְבַקֵּשׁ אֶת דְּבַר ה׳ **"they shall roam about seeking the word of Hashem":** זוֹ הֲלָכָה[55] **this is halachah;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּגִּיטִּין (ס, ב) **and as they**

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[50] **Avos 4:20** — "Elisha ben Avuyah says: One who learns as a child—to what is he compared? To ink written on fresh paper. One who learns when old—to what is he compared? To ink written on erased paper." The Mishnah preserves this teaching under Elisha ben Avuyah's own name, although the Gemara calls him Acher. This is Rav Tzadok's specific evidence that true Torah statements can remain within a compromised teacher's legacy.

[51] **Chagigah 15b** — "How could Rabbi Meir learn Torah from Acher? Rabbi Yochanan said: If the teacher resembles an angel of Hashem of Hosts, Torah should be sought from his mouth; otherwise, Torah should not be sought from his mouth. 'There is no difficulty: one case concerns a mature person, the other an immature one.' ... Rava expounded: Why are Torah scholars compared to a nut? Just as a nut, although soiled with mud and filth, has contents that do not become repulsive, so a Torah scholar, although he has gone astray, does not thereby render his Torah repulsive. ... Rabbah bar Sheila said to Eliyahu: 'Rabbi Meir found a pomegranate; he ate its inside and discarded its rind.'" The nut and the pomegranate are two distinct images in the same discussion. The former preserves the value of the Torah within; the latter describes Rabbi Meir's exceptional ability to separate it from the teacher's corrupt influence. The distinction concerning the learner prevents the passage from becoming an unrestricted license.

[52] **Shabbos 138b on Amos 8:11–12** — "'They will wander to seek the word of Hashem, but will not find it.' 'The word of Hashem' means halachah; 'the word of Hashem' means the end; 'the word of Hashem' means prophecy." The quoted prophecy is Amos 8:11–12. Rav Tzadok selects the Gemara's first interpretation: halachah itself is called the word of Hashem.

[53] **Gittin 60b** — "Rabbi Yochanan said: The Holy One, blessed be He, made a covenant with Israel only on account of the oral teachings, as it says: 'For on the basis of these words I have made a covenant with you and with Israel.'" The cited verse is Shemos 34:27. The exposition reads al pi as indicating what is transmitted by mouth, explaining why the covenant is identified here particularly with the Oral Torah.

[54] **Megillah 6b** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: If a person tells you, 'I labored but did not find,' do not believe him; 'I did not labor but found,' do not believe him; 'I labored and found,' believe him. These words concern Torah. ... In Torah itself, this was said only regarding sharpening understanding; establishing one's learning securely depends on assistance from Heaven." The Gemara explicitly limits the labor-and-finding statement to sharpening understanding. Rav Tzadok then explains why even such a finding is experienced as a gift beyond the learner's prior knowledge.

[55] Parallel: **Dover Tzedek, Likkutim 3, paragraph 13** — "I also heard an explanation of the Sages' statement, 'I labored and found': after the labor one sees that it is a finding. A finding can also come unexpectedly, without labor; yet

said in Gittin (60b) עַל פָּסוּק כִּי עַל פִּי הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה **on the verse "for by the mouth of these words** כָּרַתִּי וְגוֹמֵר **I have made..." etc.,** [שְׁמוֹת לד, כז] **(Shemos 34:27),** דְּרָשָׁה לוֹמַר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[56] **that it means Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּאֵינוֹ בִּכְתָב **which is not in writing,** רַק דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים **but rather words of the living G-d** הַיּוֹצְאִים מִלִּבּוֹת **which emerge from the hearts of people;** בְּנֵי אָדָם וְהֵם בֶּאֱמֶת דְּבַר ה׳ **and they are truly the word of Hashem** וְדִבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים **and words of the living G-d.** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם הָאָדָם **But nevertheless it is the person** הוּא **who, through his toil, brings forth the matter,** בִּיגִיעָתוֹ מַמְצִיא הַדָּבָר **as they said in Megillah 6b:** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּמְגִילָה ו׳ ב׳ **"I toiled and I found — believe it..." etc.,** יָגַעְתִּי וּמָצָאתִי תַּאֲמַן וְכוּלֵי[57] **"for sharpness..." etc.** וּלְשׁוֹן מָצָאתִי **And the expression "I found"** מַשְׁמַע כְּמִצִיאָה **implies like a found object,** שֶׁהוּא בְּהֶיסֵּח הַדַּעַת **which comes when one is not thinking of it;** כִּי הוּא אֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ **for he does not know** עַל מָה לְיַיגֵּעַ **what to toil toward,** וְהוּא אַחַר כָּךְ אָצְלוֹ **and afterward it is to him** כְּמִצִיאָה שֶׁבְּהֶיסֵּח הַדַּעַת **like something found unexpectedly;** רַק עַל יְדֵי הַיְגִיעָה **only through the toil** ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ נוֹתֵן בְּלִבּוֹ **does Hashem, may He be blessed, place in his heart** הֲבָנַת הַדָּבָר **the understanding of the matter;** וְעַל כֵּן הוּא דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים.[58] **and therefore it is the words of the living G-d.** וְזֶהוּ עוֹשֵׂי וְגוֹמֵר **And this is "who do..." etc.:** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי יְגִיעָתוֹ וְעִיּוּנוֹ **that through his toil and his study** הוּא עוֹשֶׂה הַדָּבָר **he makes the matter,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ לִשְׁמוֹעַ **and afterward "to hear** בְּקוֹל ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **the voice" of Hashem, may He be blessed,** הוּא הַמְצִיאָה **which is the finding,** מַה שֶּׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ מַמְצִיא לוֹ הַדָּבָר. **what Hashem, may He be blessed, provides him.** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ בְּשַׁבָּת ל״א א׳ **And about this they said in Shabbos 31a:** "פִּלְפַּלְתָּ בְּחָכְמָה **"Did you engage in the dialectic of wisdom,** הֲבַנְתָּ דָּבָר מִתּוֹךְ דָּבָר[59] **did you understand one thing from another?"** וְעַל יְדֵי הַפִּלְפּוּל **And through the dialectic** הוּא עוֹשֶׂה הַדָּבָר **he makes the matter,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ שׁוֹלֵחַ ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **and afterward Hashem, may He be blessed, sends** הַבִּינָה בְּלִבּוֹ **understanding into his heart;** [יְשַׁעְיָה נה, י–יא] כִּי דְּעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **as it says about this (Yeshayah 55:10–11):** "דְּבָרִי אֲשֶׁר יֵצֵא מִפִּי וְגוֹמֵר **"My word that goes forth from My mouth..." etc.,** כַּאֲשֶׁר וְגוֹמֵר **"For just as..." etc.,** לְלַמֵּד לְבָנֵי אָדָם כִּי הַדִּיבּוּרִים הֵם שְׁלוּחָיו[60] **"that for which I sent it";** אֲשֶׁר שְׁלַחְתִּיו **for the words are His emissaries** דַּעַת **to teach people knowledge;** וְעַל כֵּן הַתַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **and therefore talmidei chachamim** נִקְרְאוּ מַלְאָכָיו. **are called His angels.** [סֵדֶר) וְכֵן נִקְרְאוּ גִּבּוֹרֵי כֹחַ **And likewise they are called "mighty in strength,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ הוּבָא רַשׁ״י סוּכָּה מד, א **cited by Rashi,** עוֹלָם רַבָּה פֶּרֶק כה **as they said (Seder Olam Rabbah, chapter 25,**

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before the labor one does not see that finding. Only after the labor does the finding appear."

Connection: This parallel clarifies the apparent tension in the present passage: strenuous analysis is required, yet the resulting insight exceeds what the learner could knowingly produce in advance. Rav Tzadok presents the insight as a divine finding recognized through, and after, the labor.

[56] **Shabbos 31a** — "Rava said: When a person is brought to judgment, they ask him: Did you conduct business faithfully? Did you fix times for Torah? Did you engage in establishing a family? Did you await salvation? Did you reason deeply in wisdom? Did you understand one matter from another? Even so, if fear of Hashem is his treasure, it endures; if not, it does not." Rav Tzadok distinguishes the effort of analysis from the understanding subsequently placed in the heart, drawing on the two adjoining questions.

[57] **Yeshayahu 55:10–11** — "As rain and snow descend from heaven and do not return there without watering the earth, making it bear and sprout, and giving seed to the sower and bread to the eater, so will My word that goes forth from My mouth be: it will not return to Me empty, but will accomplish what I desire and succeed in that for which I sent it." Rav Tzadok applies that mission to the Torah understanding communicated through human teachers.

[58] **Seder Olam Rabbah 25, cited by Rashi on Sukkah 44a** — "'All were mighty men, makers of war.' What might could people display while going into exile, and what war could men do while bound in shackles and chains? Rather, all were mighty in Torah, as it says: 'Bless Hashem, His angels, mighty in strength.' They were makers of war because they debated in the warfare of Torah. Among them were the thousand called the craftsman and the smith: when one spoke, all fell silent; before one all sat and learned." The exposition concerns the exiles of Yechonyah in II Melachim 24:16. Rashi on Sukkah 44a, s.v. Veha'amar Rabbi Yochanan, cites this teaching when explaining how the Torah strength of the craftsmen and smiths endured in Bavel.

[59] **Chagigah 14a on Yeshayahu 3:2** — "'A mighty man' means a master of transmitted teachings. 'A man of war' means one who knows how to engage in the give-and-take of Torah warfare. 'A judge' means a judge who renders a genuinely true judgment." This exposition of Yeshayahu 3:2 supplies the parallel usage: strength and warfare describe forms of Torah mastery.

[60] **Nedarim 20b** — "Ameimar said: Who are the ministering angels mentioned here? The Sages. If you were to say actual ministering angels, why would Rabbi Yochanan say that the law does not follow Yochanan ben Dahavai? They would know the formation of the child better. Why, then, are the Sages called ministering angels? Because they distinguish themselves in appearance like ministering angels." The surrounding discussion concerns Yochanan ben Dahavai's reports about marital conduct. Rav Tzadok cites the identification and description of the Sages, not a ruling that all the reported teachings are accepted.

Sukkah 44a, s.v. VeHa'amar (דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וְהָאָמַר) **on the verse "mighty men of valor,"** עַל פָּסוּק גִּבּוֹרֵי חַיִל **of the craftsmen and the smiths:** [מְלָכִים ב כד, טז] **(II Melachim 24:16):** וְכִי מַה גְּבוּרָה וְכוּלֵּי **"And what might is there..." etc., "rather, they were mighty** אֶלָּא שֶׁגִּבּוֹרִים הָיוּ בְּמִלְחַמְתָּהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה.[61] **in the battle of Torah."** וְכֵיוֹצֵא בּוֹ בַּחֲגִיגָה י״ד א׳ **And similarly in Chagigah 14a** עַל פָּסוּק [יְשַׁעְיָה ג, ב] **on the verse (Yeshayah 3:2)** גִּבּוֹר וְאִישׁ מִלְחָמָה[62] **"the mighty man and the man of war."** וְעַיֵּין בִּנְדָרִים כ׳ ב׳ **And see in Nedarim 20b:** מַאן מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת דְּמִצַּיְינֵי כְּמַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת רַבָּנָן וְכוּלֵּי[63] **"Who are the ministering angels? The Rabbis..." etc., for they are distinguished like ministering angels;** וְכֵיוֹצֵא בּוֹ בְּשַׁבָּת כ״ה ב׳ **and similarly in Shabbos 25b:** וְדוֹמֶה לְמַלְאָךְ ה׳ צְבָאוֹת.[64] **"and he would wrap himself and sit** מִתְעַטֵּף וְיוֹשֵׁב **in fringed linen sheets** בְּסָדִינִין הַמְצוּיָּצִין **and resemble an angel of Hashem of Hosts."** וְנִרְאֶה דְּקָרֵי לְהוּ **And it appears that the reason** דְּכַוָּנָתוֹ לְחַכְמֵי **Yochanan ben Dahavai there calls them** יוֹחָנָן בֶּן דַּהֲבַאי שָׁם **"ministering angels"** מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת **is that he means the sages of Bavel,** בָּבֶל שֶׁאָמַר בְּקִידּוּשִׁין **as was said in Kiddushin 72** א׳ ע״ב סוֹף עַמּוּד **, end of side a:** דּוֹמִים לְמַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת **they resemble ministering angels";** הֲרְאִינִי תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּבָבֶל **"Show me the talmidei chachamim of Bavel —** עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּרַשִׁ״י **see there in Rashi,** הֲבִיא גְּמָרָא הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל.[65] **who cites the aforementioned Gemara.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ שֶׁבְּבָבֶל **And one can say that therefore they said "of Bavel,"** שֶׁהֵם מְצוּיָּנִים **for they are distinguished,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּשַׁבָּת קמ״ה ב׳ **as they said in Shabbos 145b:** וּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁאֵינָן בְּנֵי מְקוֹמָן **"and they are distinguished like ministering angels."** וּמְצַיְינֵי כְּמַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת **And as for what they said, "because they are not natives of their place,"** בְּפָשׁוּט הָיָה נִרְאֶה **simply, it would appear** שֶׁהָיוּ עוֹלִים לְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל לִלְמוֹד **that it refers to the natives of Bavel** דְּקָאֵי אִבְּנֵי בָּבֶל **who would go up to Eretz Yisrael to learn,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּקִידּוּשִׁין כ״ט ב׳ **as they said in Kiddushin 29b:** הָא לַן וְהָא לְהוּ **"this is for us and that is for them";** עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּרַשׁ״י וְתוֹסָפוֹת **see there in Rashi and Tosafos;** וְשָׁם בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **and there, in Eretz Yisrael,** הָיוּ מְצוּיָּנִים.[66] **they were distinguished.** אֲבָל מִמַּה דְּקִידּוּשִׁין הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **But from the aforementioned Gemara in Kiddushin,** דַּאֲמַר לֵיהּ רַבִּי הָרְאִינִי וְכוּלֵּי **where Rebbe said to him, "Show me..."**

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[61] **Shabbos 25b** — "Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: This was Rabbi Yehudah bar Ilai's practice: on the eve of Shabbos they brought him a basin filled with hot water, and he washed his face, hands, and feet, wrapped himself, and sat in linen garments bearing tzitzis, resembling an angel of Hashem of Hosts." The Gemara continues with the dispute over tzitzis on a linen garment. Rav Tzadok returns below to this particular image of white linen and the title "angel of Hashem of Hosts."

[62] **Kiddushin 72a; Rashi, s.v. Domim lemalachei hashareis** — "Rabbi said to Levi: 'Show me the Torah scholars of Bavel.' He answered: 'They resemble ministering angels.'" Rashi, s.v. Domim lemalachei hashareis, explains: "They are dressed in white and wrapped like ministering angels," and connects the description to Rabbi Yehudah's linen garments and to the Sages described in Nedarim. These comparisons are the material Rav Tzadok now distinguishes.

[63] **Kiddushin 29b; Rashi and Tosafos, s.v. Ha lan veha lehu** — "The Sages taught: If one must learn Torah and marry, he should learn Torah and then marry; if he cannot remain without a wife, he should marry and then learn. Shmuel said: The law is that he marries and afterward learns Torah. Rabbi Yochanan said: With a millstone about his neck, can he engage in Torah? They do not disagree: this applies to us, and that to them." Rashi explains that the Babylonians traveled to Eretz Yisrael to study the Tannaim's teachings, so while away from home they did not bear its daily burdens. Tosafos, s.v. Ha lan veha lehu, quotes this explanation, records Rabbeinu Tam's objections and reverse assignment of the two rulings, and notes that some Eretz Yisrael scholars also traveled to Bavel. Rav Tzadok invokes the travel pattern described by Rashi rather than treating this disputed practical explanation as uniform.

[64] **Shabbos 145b; Rashi, s.v. She'einan bimkoman** — "Why do the Torah scholars of Bavel distinguish themselves by their appearance? Because they are not in their own place. As people say: 'In my town, my name; outside my town, my clothing.' Rav Yosef taught concerning the verse 'Those who come shall take root in Yaakov; Israel shall blossom and flower': These are the Torah scholars of Bavel, who produce blossoms and flowers for the Torah." Rashi explains "not in their place" as meaning that they were exiled there from Eretz Yisrael, and explains the proverb: in one's own city one is recognized by name, whereas in a foreign place one's clothing supplies the public distinction. This is Rabbi Yochanan's answer, correcting the earlier suggestion that the dress compensates for a lack of Torah.

[65] **Kesubos 106a** — "When the scholars departed from Rav's academy, twelve hundred scholars would remain; from Rav Huna's academy, eight hundred would remain. Rav Huna lectured through thirteen interpreters. When the scholars rose from Rav Huna's academy and shook out their cloaks, dust rose and covered the daylight, and in Eretz Yisrael they would say: 'They have risen from the academy of Rav Huna the Babylonian.'" The passage attests the extraordinary size of the Babylonian academies. It is the evidence Rav Tzadok cites for their large body of scholars; the figures do not themselves provide a complete census of Jewish populations.

[66] **Shabbos 114a; Rashi, s.v. Mashni'ai** — "Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: Any Torah scholar found with a grease stain on his garment is liable to death, as it says: 'All who hate Me love death'; do not read it as 'those who hate Me,' but as 'those who cause Me to be hated.'" Rashi explains the public consequence: "People say, 'Woe to those who learn Torah, who are repulsive and disgraceful,' and thus this person causes the Torah to be hated." Rav Tzadok therefore understands care in dress as honor for Torah, rather than self-aggrandizement.

etc., מַשְׁמַע דְּאַאוֹתָם שֶׁבְּבָבֶל קָאֵי **it implies that it refers to those who were in Bavel,** שֶׁלֹּא רָאָם בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל. **whom he had not seen in Eretz Yisrael.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּעַל כֵּן **And one can say that this is why** פֵּירֵשׁ רַשׁ״י שָׁם **Rashi explained there** שֶׁגָּלוּ לְבָבֶל **"they are not natives of their place"**.[67] **as meaning that they were exiled to Bavel.** אֲבָל כִּפְשָׁטֵיהּ **But according to its plain sense,** מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב רַשׁ״י **what Rashi wrote,** בְּמָתַאי וְכוּלֵי אֲנִי נִיכָּר **"in my town..." etc.,** שֶׁהַגּוֹלֶה לְמָקוֹם נָכְרִי וְכוּלֵי **"that one exiled to a foreign place..." etc.,** דְּזֶה שַׁיָּיךְ אַאוֹתוֹ הַגּוֹלֶה **for this applies to the one who himself went into exile;** אֲבָל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּבָר הָיוּ אָז **but Bnei Yisrael had already been at that time** מִכַּמָּה מֵאוֹת שָׁנִים בְּבָבֶל **in Bavel for several hundred years,** וְהָיוּ שָׁם יְהוּדִים אָז **and there were then more Jews there** יוֹתֵר מִבְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **than in Eretz Yisrael,** כִּדְמַשְׁמַע בִּכְתוּבוֹת ק״ו א׳ **as is implied in Kesubos 106a:** רַב הוּנָא הָוָה וְכוּלֵי **"Rav Huna would..." etc.,** וְאָמְרוּ בְּמַעֲרָבָא וְכוּלֵי **"and they said in the West..." etc.;** עַיֵּין שָׁם לְעִנְיָן **see there regarding** רִיבּוּי הַתַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים בְּנֵי הַיְשִׁיבָה.[68] **the great number of talmidei chachamim of the yeshivah.** וּמַה שַׁיָּיךְ עֲלֵיהֶם לוֹמַר **So how could one say about them** בְּלֹא מָתַאי **"not in my town"?** אֲבָל יֵשׁ לוֹמַר **But one can say that** בָּלְאוֹ הָכִי וַאַי **in any case, certainly** לֹא הָיָה כַּוָּנָתָם **their intent was not** לְהִתְפַּגֵּד בְּעֵינֵי הַבְּרִיּוֹת **to gain honor in the eyes of people,** לִהְיוֹת לָהֶם לְכָבוֹד וּלְתִפְאֶרֶת **to have honor and glory for themselves,** רַק בִּשְׁבִיל כְּבוֹד הַתּוֹרָה **but only for the sake of the honor of the Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שַׁבָּת קי״ד א׳ **as they said in Shabbos 114a:** מַשְׁנִיאַי עַיֵּין תַּלְמִיד חָכָם שֶׁנִּמְצָא רְבָב וְכוּלֵי **"A talmid chacham on whose garment a stain is found..." etc.,** שָׁם[69] **"those who cause Me to be hated"; see there;** וְכֵן בְּרַשׁ״י בְּעֵירוּבִין נ״ד א׳ **and similarly in Rashi on Eruvin 54a,** סוֹף דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל שֶׁמַּסְרַחַת **at the end of the comment beginning "she'masrachas":** שֶׁדַּרְכָּן תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים וְכוּלֵי **"that the way of talmidei chachamim..." etc.,** וְשָׁם מְשַׂנְאַי וְגוֹמֵר.[70] **"those who hate Me..." etc.** וּבְשַׁבָּת רַבִּי יוֹחָנָן אָמַר זֶה **And there in Shabbos, Rabbi Yochanan said this,** אֶבָל הוּא אָמַר רַק עַל רְבָב **but he spoke only about a stain;** וּבְבָבֶל הוֹסִיפוּ לְצַיֵּין עַצְמָם **whereas in Bavel they went further, distinguishing themselves** מִשְּׁאָר בְּנֵי אָדָם **from other people,** (פְּסָחִים קיא, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Pesachim 111b):** סוּדָרֵיהּ דְּמָר **"the master's scarf** כִּצְווּרְבָא מֵרַבָּנָן[71] **is like that of a young Torah scholar,"** וּבְשַׁבָּת ע״ז ב׳ **and in Shabbos 77b;** עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּרַשׁ״י **see there in Rashi,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל סוּדָרָא.[72] **the comment beginning "sudara."** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ שֶׁאֵינָן בְּנֵי מְקוֹמָן **And about this they said "they are not natives of their place,"** כִּי מְקוֹם יִשְׂרָאֵל **for the place of Yisrael** הוּא בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **is in Eretz Yisrael,** שֶׁהוּא אֶרֶץ הַמְיוּחָד לָהֶם **which is the land designated for them** וְשַׁיָּיךְ לִקְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **and belongs to the holiness of Yisrael;** וְשָׁם נִיכָּר קְדוּשַׁת תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **and there the holiness of talmidei chachamim is recognized** גַּם בְּלֹא צִוּוּין.[73] **even without any distinguishing mark.** וּכְדָרֶךְ

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[67] **Rashi on Eruvin 54a, s.v. Shemasrachas** — "Throughout the Talmud we find that Torah scholars are particular about their food, as a matter of dignity and honor, and about their clothing, as it is written: 'Those who cause Me to be hated love death.'" Rashi says this while weighing two explanations of the image of a beast wallowing and eating. The closing observation is the portion relevant to Rav Tzadok's discussion.

[68] **Pesachim 111b** — "'The master's headcloth is like that of a young Torah scholar, but we have tested the master and found that he does not know even the blessing.'" In the story, this is the mocking chant heard after an inadequate amulet was written. Rav Tzadok cites only the recognizable headcloth as evidence that a Torah scholar was publicly marked by dress.

[69] **Rashi on Shabbos 77b, s.v. Sudara** — "It is the manner of Torah scholars to wrap themselves in a headcloth."

[70] **Nedarim 49b** — "A matron said to Rabbi Yehudah: 'A teacher, and drunk?' He answered: 'On my word to this woman, I taste wine only for kiddush, havdalah, and the four cups of Pesach; I must bind my temples from Pesach until Shavuos. Rather, a person's wisdom illuminates his face.'" His radiant face is attributed to wisdom, rather than wine. Rav Tzadok uses the account to contrast visible spiritual radiance in Eretz Yisrael with external marks of dress.

[71] **Birchos HaTorah, Veha'arev na** — "May the words of Your Torah be sweet in our mouths and in the mouths of Your people, the house of Israel. May we and our descendants and the descendants of Your people, the house of Israel, all know Your Name and learn Your Torah for its own sake. Blessed are You, Hashem, Who teaches Torah to His people Israel." Rav Tzadok emphasizes the blessing's designation of God as the Teacher: human teachers act as His messengers.

[72] **Kiddushin 41b** — "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Korcha said: From where do we learn that a person's agent is like the person himself? It says: 'The whole assembly of the congregation of Israel shall slaughter it in the afternoon.' Does the entire congregation slaughter? Only one person slaughters! Rather, from here we learn that a person's agent is like the person himself." The Gemara derives the agency principle from the korban Pesach. Rav Tzadok applies the language to teachers who convey God's Torah; this is a spiritual application of the principle, not the immediate legal subject of the passage.

[73] **Vayikra 16:32** — "The kohen who is anointed and ordained to serve in place of his father shall effect atonement, and he shall put on the linen garments, the sacred garments."

שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּנְדָרִים (מט, ב) **As they said in Nedarim (49b)** עַל רַבִּי יְהוּדָה **concerning Rabbi Yehudah,** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה לוֹ מַלְבּוּשִׁים **who had no garments,** וְאָמְרָה לוֹ מוֹרָה וְרוֹי וְכוּלֵי **and she said to him, "Teacher and drunkard!" and so on:** חָכְמַת אָדָם תָּאִיר פָּנָיו.[74] **"a man's wisdom lights up his face."** וְהַכָּרָה זוֹ רַק בְּמָתַאי **And this recognition is only "in my town,"** בִּמְקוֹם הַקְּדוּשָּׁה בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **in the place of holiness, in Eretz Yisrael;** אֲבָל בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ **but outside the Land** אֵין הַשָּׂגַת קְדוּשַּׁת תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **the perception of the holiness of talmidei chachamim** נִיכֶּרֶת לְכָל רוֹאֵיהֶם **is not recognized by all who see them,** וּצְרִיכִים לְצַיֵּין. **and they need to distinguish themselves.** וּבְקִרְאָ דְּשִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן הַנִּזְכָּר **And in the verse "the lips of the kohen" mentioned above,** בְּרַבִּי יְהוּדָה בַּר אִלְעַאי הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **regarding Rabbi Yehudah bar Ilai mentioned above,** וְכֵן בְּשַׁבָּת (כה, ב) **and likewise in Shabbos (25b)** דְּשָׁם קָאֵי הַלָּשׁוֹן מַלְאַךְ ה׳ צְבָאוֹת **the expression is "an angel of Hashem of Hosts,"** כְּרַבִּי הַמְלַמֵּד תּוֹרָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **who teaches Torah to Yisrael,** עַל רֹאשׁ יְשִׁיבָה **for there it refers to a rosh yeshivah** דְּאָמַר תּוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ **of whom it says "they shall seek Torah from his mouth";** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא מַלְאָךְ ה׳ **and therefore he is called "an angel of Hashem,"** כִּי הֵם שְׁלוּחֵי דְּרַחֲמָנָא **for they are emissaries of the Merciful One** לְלַמֵּד תּוֹרָה לְעַמּוֹ יִשְׂרָאֵל. **to teach Torah to His people Yisrael.** שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ נִקְרָא הַמְלַמֵּד וְכוּלֵי **For Hashem, may He be blessed, is called "Who teaches..." etc.,** [בִּרְכוֹת הַתּוֹרָה][75] **(Birchos HaTorah),** וְהֵם שְׁלוּחוֹ.[76] **and they are His emissaries,** שֶׁל אָדָם כְּמוֹתוֹ **and "a person's emissary is like himself."** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן תּוֹאַר צְבָאוֹת **And this is also the title "of Hosts"** שֶׁאָמַר כָּאן **which it says here:** עַל שֵׁם צְבָאוֹתָיו **on account of His hosts,** עַמּוֹ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **His people Bnei Yisrael,** שֶׁאֵלֵיהֶם שָׁלוּחַ. **to whom he is sent.** וְשָׁם רַבִּי יְהוּדָה בַּר אִלְעַאי **And there, Rabbi Yehudah bar Ilai was** בְּסָדִינִין שֶׁל פִּשְׁתָּן **in sheets of linen,** וְכֹהֵן גַּם כֵּן בִּבְגָדֵי בַד **and the kohen too in garments of linen,** [רְאֵה וַיִּקְרָא טז, לב][77] **(see Vayikra 16:32),** דּוּגְמַת מַלְאָךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עָלָיו **like the angel of whom it is said** שֶׁהוּא לְבוּשׁ הַבַּדִּים **that he is "clothed in linen"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יְרוּשַׁלְמִי יוֹמָא) **(as stated in Yerushalmi Yoma,** פֶּרֶק ז׳ הֲלָכָה ב לז, ב[78]). **chapter 7, halachah 2, 37b).** וּבְבָבֶל כָּל בְּנֵי תוֹרָה הָיוּ **And in Bavel, all the bnei Torah** וְצוּרְבָא מֵרַבָּנָן מְצוּיָנִין **and young scholars were distinguished,** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר לְשׁוֹן מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת **and therefore it uses the expression "ministering angels"** וְלֹא מַלְאַךְ ה׳ צְבָאוֹת. **and not "an angel of Hashem of Hosts":** שֶׁהֵם עוֹסְקִים בַּעֲבוֹדַת ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **for they are engaged in the service of Hashem, may He be blessed,** כָּל הַיּוֹם וּלְשָׁרְתוֹ **all day, and in ministering to Him** כְּמַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת הַמְשָׁרְתִים. **like the ministering angels who serve.** וּבְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה **And in Eretz Yisrael** בֶּגֶד פִּשְׁתָּן חָשׁוּב **a linen garment was considered fine,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ פְּסָחִים ק״ט א׳ **as they said in Pesachim 109a:** וְנָשִׁים וְכוּלֵי בְּבָבֶל **"and women..." etc., "in Bavel** בְּבִגְדֵי צִבְעוֹנִין **in colored garments,** בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּבִגְדֵי פִּשְׁתָּן[79] **in Eretz Yisrael in linen garments";** (נט, ב) וּבִכְתוּבוֹת **and in Kesubos (59b):** תָּנֵי רַבִּי חִיָּיא הָרוֹצֶה וְכוּלֵי **"Rabbi Chiya taught: One who wishes..." etc.,** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשִׁ״י שֶׁיְעַדֵּן זִינָהּ **and Rashi explained, "to enhance her** פִּשְׁתָּן **"linen";**

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[74] **Yerushalmi Yoma 7:2** — "Why does he serve in white garments? Rabbi Chiya bar Ba said: The service below resembles the service above. Just as above there is 'one man among them dressed in linen,' so below: 'He shall put on a sacred linen tunic.'" The Yerushalmi compares the kohen's service to the heavenly figure described in Yechezkel 9:2. The manuscript's printed folio designation and the chapter-and-halakhah reference refer to the same cited discussion; the digital edition uses chapter-and-halakhah numbering.

[75] **Pesachim 109a** — "Rabbi Yehudah says: Men are gladdened with what is suitable for them, and women with what is suitable for them. Men—with wine. And women with what? Rav Yosef taught: In Bavel, with colored garments; in Eretz Yisrael, with pressed linen garments." The statement concerns rejoicing on the festival. Rav Tzadok draws on the regional difference in valued clothing when explaining linen's particular distinction in Eretz Yisrael.

[76] **Kesubos 59b; Rashi, s.v. Sheye'aden** — "Rabbi Chiya taught: One who wishes to enhance his wife's beauty should clothe her in linen garments." Rashi explains sheye'aden as refining "her radiance." This is the aesthetic quality of linen Rav Tzadok associates with the teaching's setting in Eretz Yisrael.

[77] **Rambam, Hilchos Kelei HaMikdash 8:13** — "Wherever the Torah says sheish or bad, it means flax, which is also called butz. Techeiles wherever mentioned is wool dyed the color of the sky, tending toward blue. Argaman is wool dyed red. Tola'as shani is wool dyed with the worm dye." The definitions establish the material distinction Rav Tzadok invokes: the colored threads are wool, while the linen component is identified separately.

[78] **Sanhedrin 24a** — "What does Bavel mean? Rabbi Yochanan said: It is intermingled with Scripture, intermingled with Mishnah, and intermingled with Talmud. 'He has made me dwell in dark places, like those long dead'—Rabbi Yirmeyah said: This is the Talmud of Bavel." Rav Tzadok reads the darkness as the setting in which deeper analysis produces new illumination in the Oral Torah.

[79] **Rashi, Chagigah 10a, s.v. Afilu miShas leShas** — "Even from one Talmud to another—from the Jerusalem Talmud to the Babylonian Talmud, which is profound, as we say in Sanhedrin: 'He has made me dwell in dark places, like those long dead'—this is the Talmud of Bavel." Rashi is explaining the difficulty of moving from one mode of Talmudic study to another. The depth of the Babylonian Talmud is the feature used here.

radiance"; עַיֵּין שָׁם[80] **see there.** וְשָׁנָה זֶה בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **And he taught this in Eretz Yisrael,** וְשָׁם הָיָה בָּזֶה יוֹפִי וְתִפְאָרֶת. **and there this was beauty and splendor.** וּבְבָבֶל אָמְרוּ סְתָם מְצוּיָנִים **And in Bavel they said simply "distinguished,"** וְהַסּוּדָר מַשְׁמַע דְּלֹא הָיָה דְּפִשְׁתָּן **and the scarf implies that it was not of linen,** וְכֵן שְׁאָר בְּגָדִים **and likewise other garments,** דְּשָׁם הָיָה הַחֲשִׁיבוּת **for there what was considered fine** בֶּגֶד צָבוּעַ וְהֵם דְּצֶמֶר **was a dyed garment, and these are of wool,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּבִגְדֵי כְהוּנָּה **as we find with the priestly garments,** דִּתְכֵלֶת וְאַרְגָּמָן וְתוֹלַעַת שָׁנִי **that the techeiles, purple and scarlet** הֵם דְּצֶמֶר **are of wool,** אֲבָל דְּפִשְׁתָּן לָבָן.[81] **whereas the linen is white.** וְיֵשׁ לָתֵת טַעַם **And one may give a reason:** כִּי בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל הַחֲסָדִים גּוֹבְרִים **for in Eretz Yisrael the chassadim prevail,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ: **which is not so outside the Land.**

וּלְפִי זֶה יֵשׁ לְפָרֵשׁ גַּם **And according to this one can also explain** לְשׁוֹן רָז שֶׁמַּלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת וְכוּלְיָ **the expression "the secret that the ministering angels..." etc.,** דְּבְשַׁבָּת (פח, א) הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **that in Shabbos (88a) mentioned above** עַל תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **it refers to talmidei chachamim,** וְקָרֵי לְהוּ מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת **and calls them ministering angels,** שֶׁכֵּן הָיוּ קוֹרִין בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּבָבֶל **for so they would call, in Eretz Yisrael, the talmidei chachamim of Bavel,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְנִקְטִינְהוּ מִשּׁוּם דְּקָאֵי לְעִנְיַן הַחִידּוּשִׁין דְּאוֹרַיְתָא **And it mentions them because it refers to the matter of chiddushim in Torah,** דְּעַל יְדֵי זֶה הֵם עוֹשֵׂי דְבָרוֹ וְגוֹמֵר. **through which they are "doers of His word..." etc.,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וּבְבָבֶל עִיקַּר הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת דְּעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ סַנְהֶדְרִין כ״ד א׳ **And in Bavel was the essence of the renewal of Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **as they said about this in Sanhedrin 24a:** בְּמַחֲשַׁכִּים **"In dark places" —** זֶה תַּלְמוּדָהּ שֶׁל בָּבֶל[82] **this is the Talmud of Bavel;** דְּשָׁם הֶעֱמִיקוּ בְּיוֹתֵר בְּפִלְפּוּל **for there they delved most deeply in dialectic,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשִׁ״י **as Rashi wrote,** בַּחֲגִיגָה י׳ א׳ **in Chagigah 10a,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אֲפִילוּ **in the comment beginning "afilu,"** מִשִּׁשָּׁה סְדָרִים[83] **from the Six Orders;** וַעֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר **and about them it is said,** [יְשַׁעְיָה ט, א] **(Yeshayah 9:1):** הָעָם הַהוֹלְכִים בַּחֹשֶׁךְ **"The people that walked in darkness** רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל **have seen a great light,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתַנְחוּמָא **as they said in Tanchuma,** פָּרָשַׁת נֹחַ ג **Parshas Noach 3;** עַיֵּין שָׁם.[84] **see there.** וּבְשַׁבָּת קמ״ה ב׳ **And in Shabbos 145b,** דְּתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּבָבֶל עוֹשִׂים צִיצִין וּפְרָחִים לַתּוֹרָה **that the talmidei chachamim of Bavel make buds and blossoms for**

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[80] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, did not write in the Torah, 'for the sake of these words,' or 'on account of these words,' or 'because of these words,' but rather 'by the mouth of these words.' This is the Oral Torah, which is difficult to learn and involves great hardship; it is compared to darkness, as it is said: 'The people walking in darkness have seen a great light.' These are the masters of Talmud, who have seen a great light, for the Holy One, blessed be He, enlightens their eyes regarding what is forbidden and permitted, impure and pure." The verse is Isaiah 9:1 in the Hebrew numbering. The Midrash explicitly connects the darkness of demanding study with the light of discerning Torah.

[81] **Sanhedrin 8a** — "The section of inheritances was fit to be written through Moshe Rabbeinu, but the daughters of Tzelafchad merited that it be written through them. The section of the wood-gatherer was fit to be written through Moshe Rabbeinu, but the wood-gatherer incurred guilt, and it was written through him. This teaches that guilt is brought about through one who is guilty, and merit through one who is worthy." The Gemara establishes that a particular person's merit can become the occasion for a Torah section's revelation. Rav Tzadok develops this into the individual's role in bringing his or her Torah-root into the world.

[82] **Sanhedrin 99b** — "Reish Lakish said: Whoever teaches his fellow's son Torah is regarded by Scripture as though he made him, as it is said: 'The souls they made in Charan.' Rabbi Elazar says: As though he made the words of Torah, as it is said: 'You shall keep the words of this covenant and do them.' Rava said: As though he made himself, as it is said: 'And do them'—do not read 'them,' but 'you.'" The verse quoted for Rabbi Elazar's statement is Deuteronomy 29:8. Rav Tzadok explains the making of Torah as bringing its understanding into a heart in which it was not previously present.

[83] **Zohar III 110b, Behar** — "Come and see: 'Trust in Hashem and do good.' What is 'do good'? We have learned that through an act below, an act above is aroused. They have explained 'and you shall do them': as it were, you make them, because through the awakening that you produce below, an awakening is produced above. Therefore it is written, 'do good.' Good refers to the righteous one, as it is written: 'Say of the righteous one that he is good.'" The Zohar describes an effective awakening above produced by observance below. Rav Tzadok applies this pattern to the making of words of Torah. The traditional folio is tracked by the retrieved text's Vilna-page markers.

[84] **Zohar III 113a, Bechukosai** — "'And you shall do them.' What is 'and you shall do them'? Once it has said 'you shall walk' and 'you shall keep,' why say 'you shall do'? Rather, one who performs the commandments of the Torah and walks in its ways is, as it were, regarded as making Him above. The Holy One, blessed be He, says: 'As though he made Me.' They have explained this, and therefore it says, 'and you shall do them.'" The expression is deliberately qualified by 'as it were.' The continuation, across the 113b page marker, explains that David 'made a name' above through Torah and mitzvos. This is the Zohar's account of establishing the revealed Divine Name, rather than creating the Divine essence.

the Torah, וְהַיְינוּ חִידּוּשִׁין דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא. **which means chiddushim in Torah.** וּבְשָׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה **And at the time of the giving of the Torah** אָמְרוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל נַעֲשֶׂה **all of Yisrael said "we will do,"** שֶׁהֵם עוֹשֵׂי דְבָרוֹ **for they are "doers of His word,"** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** דְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ נַפְשׁוֹתָם **For the root of their souls** מֵאוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה **is from the letters of the Torah,** וְהֵם בְּנַפְשׁוֹתָם **and they, with their very souls,** הֵם עוֹשֵׂי הַתּוֹרָה. **are the makers of the Torah.** (סַנְהֶדְרִין ח, א) וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה אָמְרוּ **And along these lines they said (Sanhedrin 8a)** בִּבְנוֹת צְלָפְחָד שֶׁזָּכוּ **regarding the daughters of Tzelafchad, that they merited** וְנֶאֱמְרָה פָּרָשַׁת נַחֲלוֹת עַל יָדָן **that the parshah of inheritances was said through them,** וְרָאֲתָה עֵינָם **and their eye saw** מַה שֶׁלֹּא רָאָה עַיִן **what the eye of** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, did not see;** וְהֵם הֵבִיאוּ הִתְגַּלּוּת **and they brought the revelation** פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ לָעוֹלָם.[85] **of this parshah to the world.** וְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל הֵבִיאוּ **And all of Yisrael brought** הִתְגַּלּוּת כָּל הַתּוֹרָה **the revelation of the entire Torah,** וְהֵם עוֹשֵׂי דְבָרוֹ **and they are "doers of His word";** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִשְׁמְעוּ בְּקוֹל דְּבָרוֹ **and through this they will hear "the voice of His word,"** דּוּגְמַת מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרַת **like the ministering angels,** רַבָּנָן בְּדִידְהוּ. **the Rabbis, in their own case.** וּמָצִינוּ כַּיּוֹצֵא בָּזֶה (שָׁם צט, ב) **And we find similarly (there, 99b)** דְּהַמְלַמֵּד בֶּן חֲבֵירוֹ תּוֹרָה **that one who teaches his fellow's son Torah** כְּאִלּוּ עֲשָׂאוֹ **as if he made the words of Torah,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [דְּבָרִים כט, ח] **as it says (Devarim 29:8):** וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם וְגוֹמֵר **"And you shall keep..." etc.,** וַעֲשִׂיתֶם אוֹתָם. **"and do them."** וּבִקְרָא לֹא נִזְכָּר מְלַמֵּד **And the verse does not mention teaching;** רַק הֵם דָּרְשׁוּ כֵּן **rather, they expounded it so,** כִּי אֵיךְ אֶפְשָׁר עַתָּה **for how is it possible now** לִהְיוֹת עוֹשִׂים לְדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **to be makers of the words of Torah** שֶׁכְּבָר נִיתְּנָה מִסִּינַי **which was already given from Sinai?** רַק עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמְּלַמֵּד בֶּן חֲבֵירוֹ **Only by teaching his fellow's son** וּמַכְנִיס לִלְבּוֹ דִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **and bringing words of Torah into his heart** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה מֵבִין וְיוֹדֵעַ. **which he had not understood or known.** אוֹתָן דִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **Those words of Torah** שֶׁמַּכְנִיס לִלְבּוֹ שֶׁל זֶה **which he brings into this one's heart —** הוּא כְּאִלּוּ הוּא עֲשָׂאָם[86] **it is as if he made them.** וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָּזֶה בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And similarly in the holy Zohar** עַל פָּסוּק וַעֲשִׂיתֶם אוֹתָם **on the verse "and you shall do them,"** [וַיִּקְרָא כו, ג] **(Vayikra 26:3)** לְעִנְיַן מִצְוֹת **regarding mitzvos,** דְּכְאִלּוּ עָשָׂה הוּא לְהַצִּיווּי **that it is as if he himself made the commandment;** עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּפָרָשַׁת בְּהַר **see there in Parshas Behar,** ק״ב דִּבּוּר **110** הַמַּתְחִיל וְכִי[87]**b, the passage beginning "ve'chi,"** וּבְפָרָשַׁת בְּחוּקֹתַי **and in Parshas Bechukosai,** קי״ג סוֹף עַמּוּד א׳ וְרֵישׁ עַמּוּד ב׳.[88] **113, end of side a and beginning of side b.** וּבְפָרָשַׁת נָשֹׂא קכ״ב א׳ **And in Parshas Naso, 122a:** דְּמְקַיֵּים עָלְמִין דִּלְעֵילָּא וְכוּלֵי **"that he sustains the upper worlds..." etc.,** הַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי **meaning through** שֶׁהוּא הָעוֹשֶׂה לְדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **his being the maker of the words of Torah,** שֶׁבָּהּ קִיּוּם הָעוֹלָם[89] **through which the world is sustained.** וְכַיּוֹצֵא בָּזֶה בְּמְכִילְתָּא **And similarly in the Mechilta,** סוֹף פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא **end of Parshas Ki**

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[85] **Zohar III 122a, Naso** — "Yisro was at first a priest of idolatry and served that side, drawing upon himself a spirit from that place. Afterward he separated from Kayin and attached himself to the Holy One, blessed be He. For whoever attaches himself to the Holy One, blessed be He, and performs the Torah's commandments is, as it were, sustaining worlds—the world above and the world below. They have explained this, for it is written: 'And you shall do them.'" The source speaks of sustaining the worlds through attachment to God and mitzvah observance. Rav Tzadok connects this with the making of Torah through which the world is sustained.

[86] **Mechilta, Ki Sisa, Shabbata 1, on Exodus 31:16** — "Rabbi Elazar ben Parta says: From where do you say that anyone who keeps Shabbos is regarded as though he made Shabbos? For it is said: 'The children of Israel shall keep Shabbos, to make Shabbos.'" The distinction between keeping Shabbos and making it supplies a direct rabbinic parallel to the active spiritual making discussed here.

[87] **Berachos 17a** — "Rav would often say: The World to Come is unlike this world. In the World to Come there is no eating or drinking, no procreation, no commerce, no jealousy, no hatred, and no competition. Rather, the righteous sit with their crowns on their heads and delight in the radiance of the Divine Presence, as it is said: 'They beheld God, and ate and drank.'" Rav Tzadok identifies these crowns with those bestowed at Sinai and destined to be restored; that identification joins this statement with the Shabbos 88a passage quoted earlier.

[88] **Arachin 11a** — "Rav Masna said: From here—'Because you did not serve Hashem your God with joy and with goodness of heart.' What service is performed with joy and goodness of heart? You must say: This is song. But perhaps it means words of Torah, as it is written: 'Hashem's precepts are upright, gladdening the heart'! They are called gladdening the heart, but are not called good." The sugya's question explicitly establishes Torah's power to gladden the heart, using Psalms 19:9. Its answer distinguishes that description from the combined wording by which it identifies the Levitical song.

[89] **Taanis 15a** — "Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: I too say that not all are destined for light and not all for joy. The righteous are destined for light, and the upright for joy. The righteous for light, as it is written: 'Light is sown for the righteous'; and the upright for joy, as it is written: 'And for the upright in heart, joy.'" The two clauses are from Psalms 97:11. Rav Tzadok develops the special association of uprightness with the heart's joy.

Sisa, עַל פָּסוּק לַעֲשׂוֹת אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת **on the verse "to make the Shabbos";** שָׁם.[90] עַיֵּין **see there.** וְזֶהוּ הַכְּתָרִים שֶׁנִּיתַּן לָהֶם **And these are the crowns given to them:** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד עָשָׂה וְהֵבִיא לָעוֹלָם **that each one made and brought to the world** שׁוֹרְשׁוֹ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **his root in words of Torah,** וּבָזֶה הוּא מוּכְתָּר **and in this he is crowned** וּמְעוּטָּר מֵהַכֹּל. **and adorned above all.** וְלֶעָתִיד צַדִּיקִים יוֹשְׁבִים **And in the future the righteous sit** וְעַטְרוֹתֵיהֶם בְּרָאשֵׁיהֶם[91] **with their crowns on their heads** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת יז, א) **(as stated in Berachos 17a),** הַיְינוּ אוֹתָם שְׁנֵי עֲטָרוֹת[92] **meaning those two crowns,** דְּעָתִיד לְהַחֲזִירָם לָנוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּשַׁבָּת פ״ח א׳ **as they said in Shabbos 88a, that He will in the future return them to us,** וְקָרֵי לָהּ שִׂמְחָה שֶׁמֵּעוֹלָם **and it calls it "the joy that is from of old";** כִּי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מְשַׂמְּחֵי לֵב **for words of Torah gladden the heart,** [תְּהִלִּים יט, ט] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 19:9):** פִּקּוּדֵי וְגוֹמֵר **"The precepts of Hashem..." etc.,**[93] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בָּעֲרָכִין י״א א׳ **and as they said in Arachin 11a;** רָצָה לוֹמַר שֶׁמְּיַישְׁרִים הַלֵּב **meaning that they straighten the heart,** וְקָרֵי לָהוּ בִּקְרָא יְשָׁרִים **and the verse calls them "upright,"** [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 97:11):** לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **"and gladness for the upright in heart,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתַעֲנִית ט״ו א׳.[94] **and as they said in Taanis 15a.** וְיִשְׁרַת הַלֵּב **And the straightness of the heart** עַל יְדֵי דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **through words of Torah** הוּא כַּאֲשֶׁר נִבְלַע בַּלֵּב **comes when they are absorbed into the heart,** וְזֶהוּ כְּשֶׁהֵם עוֹשֵׂי דְבָרוֹ **and that is when they are "doers of His word,"** כְּהַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** [תְּפִלַּת שַׁחֲרִית לְשַׁבָּת] וְעַל כֵּן נֶאֱמַר **And therefore it says (Shabbos morning prayer):** יִשְׂמַח מֹשֶׁה וְגוֹמֵר **"Moshe rejoiced..." etc.,** כְּלִיל תִּפְאֶרֶת וְגוֹמֵר **"a crown of splendor..." etc.;** כִּי מְמֶּנּוּ לֹא נִיטַּל **for from him was not taken** הַכֶּתֶר דְּהַר סִינַי **the crown of Har Sinai,** וְעַל כֵּן יִשְׂמַח.[95] **and therefore he rejoices.** וְשָׁם בְּשַׁבָּת אָמְרוּ **And there in Shabbos they said** דְּמֹשֶׁה נָטַל **that Moshe took** גַּם לְהַכְּתָרִים דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **the crowns of**

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[90] **Shabbos Shacharis Amidah, Yismach Moshe** — "Moshe rejoices in the gift of his portion, for You called him a faithful servant. A crown of splendor You placed upon his head when he stood before You on Mount Sinai. He brought down two tablets of stone in his hand, and the keeping of Shabbos was written upon them." The prayer joins Moshe's rejoicing, his crown at Sinai, and Shabbos. Rav Tzadok interprets that sequence through the crowns discussed in the Gemara.

[91] **Rashi, Shabbos 88a, s.v. UMoshe Yikach** — "Moshe would take—that ornament. Another explanation: 'the tent' is an expression like 'when His lamp shone,' and this was the radiance of the skin of his face." Rashi first relates Moshe's taking to Israel's ornament, then offers a reading associated with the radiance of Moshe's face. Rav Tzadok uses that luminous connection.

[92] **Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos 8** — "When Moshe ascended the mountain to receive the Torah, they gave him a thousand portions of light. When Israel made the Calf, these were lost to him because of Israel's sin, leaving him one portion alone. Moshe himself had not sinned; the loss came on account of Israel. The Holy One, blessed be He, therefore made up his loss from Israel's crowns and lights, the ornaments stripped from them at Chorev. Every Friday night Moshe again receives the thousand portions that he lost, receiving them as the added gift of Shabbos. He then returns Israel's crowns to them, and from these crowns Israel inherits the added gift of Shabbos. ... He rejoices in his own portion and returns their portion to them. Since You called him a faithful servant, he returns those crowns of Israel held in his trust to their owners." Pri Etz Chaim distinguishes Moshe's own original light from Israel's crowns held by him in trust. His own portion is restored on Shabbos, permitting him to return theirs. Rav Tzadok identifies the resulting addition for Israel with the additional soul.

[93] **Zohar II 88b, Yisro** — "Because all faith is found in Shabbos, a person is given another soul, a higher soul, a soul in which all completeness is found, in the likeness of the World to Come. For this reason it is called Shabbos. What is Shabbos? The Name of the Holy One, blessed be He—a Name complete on every side." The context discusses the spiritual completeness of Shabbos and its meals. The source directly connects the additional higher soul with the World to Come; Rav Tzadok then relates it to the restored crowns.

[94] **Berachos 57b** — "Five things are one-sixtieth of something else: fire, honey, Shabbos, sleep, and a dream. Fire is one-sixtieth of Gehinnom; honey, one-sixtieth of the manna; Shabbos, one-sixtieth of the World to Come; sleep, one-sixtieth of death; and a dream, one-sixtieth of prophecy." The Gemara describes Shabbos as a present foretaste of the World to Come. Rav Tzadok combines this with the Zohar's account of the additional soul.

[95] **Pesikta Rabbasi 10, the passage cited as section 6** — "When Moshe descended to meet Israel, they saw him as something exalted and praiseworthy. At that moment Israel was distressed. They said: 'We are brought low because we did that deed. Although the Holy One, blessed be He, has accepted us and forgiven our sins, and you, Moshe, were with us, Moshe's rays are raised while our horns remain low.' Moshe immediately came before the Holy One, blessed be He, and said: 'Master of the world, when You brought them low, I too was brought low with them. Now that You have raised my head, raise their heads as well.' The Holy One, blessed be He, told him: 'Go, raise their heads.' Rabbi Yonasan of Beis Guvrin said: He replied, 'No, my Master! Just as You raised mine, so You should lift the heads of Your children.' The Holy One, blessed be He, told him: 'Just as I raised your head, so I too will raise the heads of My children: When you lift up the head of the children of Israel.'" The Midrash links Moshe's rays of glory and Israel's renewed elevation after the Golden Calf. Rav Tzadok interprets the exchange through the restoration of the crowns. The digital edition presents this passage within chapter 10 without the manuscript's internal section numbering.

Yisrael as well, וּבְרַשִׁ"י שָׁם **and in Rashi there,** דְּהוּא הַקְּרֵנֵי הוֹד[96] **that these are the rays of glory;** וְעַיֵּין בְּפְרִי עֵץ חַיִּים **and see in Pri Etz Chaim,** שַׁעַר שַׁבָּת פֶּרֶק ח׳ **Shaar HaShabbos, chapter 8,** דְּבְלֵיל שַׁבָּת **that on Friday night** מַחֲזִיר מֹשֶׁה הַכְּתָרִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **Moshe returns the crowns to Yisrael,** וּמִזֶּה יוֹרְשִׁים הַתּוֹסָפוֹת שַׁבָּת **and from this they inherit the added holiness of Shabbos;** שָׁם עַיֵּין[97] **see there.** וְנִרְאֶה דְּרָצָה לוֹמַר **And it appears that he means** הַנְּשָׁמָה יְתֵירָה **the additional soul** הַנִּתּוֹסֶפֶת בְּשַׁבָּת **that is added on Shabbos,** שֶׁאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר יִתְרוֹ פ״ח ב׳ **which, as stated in the Zohar, Yisro 88b,** דְּהוּא בְּדוּגְמָא דְּעָלְמָא דְּאָתֵי[98] **is like a semblance of the World to Come;** (נז, ב) וְכֵן אִיתָא בִּבְרָכוֹת **and so it is stated in Berachos (57b)** דְּהוּא אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא.[99] **that it is one-sixtieth of the World to Come.** וְהֵיינוּ מֵאוֹתָן עֲטָרוֹת **And this is from those crowns** דְּעוֹלָם הַבָּא הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **of the World to Come mentioned above;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה חוֹזֵר וְנִתְנַשֵּׂא רֹאשׁ כָּל אֶחָד בְּשַׁבָּת: **and through this the head of each one is once again elevated on Shabbos.**

And in Pesikta Rabbasi, parshah 10, וּבְפִסְקְתָּא רַבָּתִי פָּרָשָׁה י׳ **at the end of siman 6:** סוֹף סִימָן ו׳ אָמַר לוֹ רִבּוֹנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם וְכוּלֵי **He said to Him, "Master of the World..." etc.,** שֶׁזָּקַפְתָּ רֹאשִׁי **"just as You lifted up my head"** [בְּקַרְנֵי הַהוֹד יְעוּיַּן שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת לְפָנֵי זֶה] **with the rays of glory; see there at length, before this** כָּךְ רוֹמֵם רֹאשָׁם **"so raise up their heads."** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **The Holy One, blessed is He, said to him,** לֵךְ רוֹמֵם רֹאשָׁם **"Go, raise up their heads."** אָמַר לוֹ וְכוּלֵי **He said to Him... etc.,** אַתָּה תְּלֵה רֹאשָׁם וְכוּלֵי **"You lift up their heads..." etc.** אָמַר לוֹ וְכוּלֵי **He said to him... etc.,** אֲנִי אֶזְקוֹף וְכוּלֵי **"I will lift up..." etc.,** כִּי תִשָּׂא וְגוֹמֵר **"When you lift up..." etc.;** יְעוּיַּן שָׁם.[100] **see there.** וְיֵשׁ לְפָרֵשׁ מַה שֶּׁאָמַר לוֹ **And one can explain what He told him,** לֵךְ רוֹמֵם וְכוּלֵי **"Go, raise up..." etc.,** הֵיינוּ שֶׁיַּחֲזִיר לָהֶם הַכְּתָרִים **means that he should return the crowns to them;** אֲבָל זֶה אִי אֶפְשָׁר **but this is impossible,** לְהַחֲזִיר לְגַמְרֵי כְּמוֹת שֶׁהָיָה דְּכְבָר חָטְאוּ וְנִיטְּלוּ **to return them entirely as they were, since they had already sinned and they were taken;** וּבְשַׁבָּת שֶׁמַּחֲזִיר **and on Shabbos, what he returns** הוּא רַק אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים **is only one-sixtieth** [בָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא] **of the World to Come,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** וְאֵין בָּזֶה כְּדֵי זְקִיפַת רֹאשׁ **and this is not enough for lifting the head;** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר לוֹ **and therefore he said to Him,** אַתָּה תְּלֵה רֹאשָׁם **"You lift up their heads";** וְהִסְכִּים הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עַל יָדוֹ **and the Holy One, blessed is He, agreed with him** בְּמַה שֶׁאָמַר כִּי תִשָּׂא וְגוֹמֵר **in what He said, "When you lift up..." etc.,** וְנָתְנוּ וְגוֹמֵר **"and they shall give..." etc.;** דְּבְתַנְחוּמָא פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא **for in Tanchuma, Parshas Ki Sisa,** סוֹף סִימָן ב׳ **at the end of siman 2:** מִי גָּרַם לַשְּׁבָטִים **"What caused the tribes** בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים וְכוּלֵי **in Parshas Shekalim..." etc.,** מַעֲשֵׂה הָעֶגֶל **"the**

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[96] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 2** — "Who caused the tribes, in the section of shekalim, to give a ransom for their souls? The deed of the Golden Calf. If the great sin they committed brought about a commandment and a merit, how much more so the commandments they perform!" The surrounding Midrash illustrates how an evil deed may be followed by an unexpected benefit, using Yosef's sale and his later provision of food. Here the half-shekel becomes the means of atonement following the Calf.

[97] **Exodus 32:34** — "Now go, lead the people to the place of which I spoke to you. My angel will go before you; but on the day of My accounting, I shall call them to account for their sin." Rav Tzadok draws on the shared root of accounting and counting: the very elevation represented by numbering Israel can renew scrutiny of the sin for which the ransom is needed.

[98] **Sanhedrin 92a** — "Rabbi Elazar said: Always remain obscure and endure. Rabbi Zeira said: We too have learned the same principle: One does not open windows in a dark house in order to inspect its plague-mark. Learn it from this." Here kavel means remaining in obscurity, as the example of the dark house shows. The teaching concerns avoiding exposure that would bring a defect under scrutiny. Rav Tzadok uses it to explain why withholding a higher revelation can protect those whose earlier fault has not yet been fully repaired.

[99] Parallel: **Yoma 86b** — "Reish Lakish said: Great is repentance, for deliberate sins become like unintentional transgressions for a person. ... Is this so? Did not Reish Lakish say: Great is repentance, for deliberate sins become like merits for a person? ... There is no contradiction: the latter is repentance from love, and the former, repentance from fear."

Connection: This distinguishes pardon that reduces the standing of a transgression from repentance that transforms it into merit. It clarifies Rav Tzadok's bracketed distinction between an earlier repair and a repair so complete that the sin no longer provides a basis for accusation.

[100] **Shaar HaGilgulim, Introduction 22** — "After a righteous person departs this world, he is prepared to ascend through great degrees in the World to Come, but not all at once. Immediately after his passing, he is punished to cleanse his more serious transgressions, and then he is admitted to one higher precinct. When his time comes to ascend to a still higher precinct, he is again punished to cleanse sins lighter than the first, and then he rises to a second, higher degree. Afterward he is again punished over fine points of the commandments, as slight as a hair, in the mystery of 'Around Him it is exceedingly stormy'; then they raise him to the true precinct appropriate to him." The source describes successively finer purification as the soul advances. Rav Tzadok applies this pattern to the renewed scrutiny that accompanies Israel's elevation after its earlier forgiveness.

deed of the Golden Calf"; שָׁם עֵיין[101] **see there.** וְהַיְינוּ כִּי מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is because what is said,** [שְׁמוֹת לב, לד] **(Shemos 32:34):** וּבְיוֹם פָּקְדִי וּפָקַדְתִּי[102] **"and on the day that I remember, I will visit..." etc.,** הַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁיָּבֹא לִפְקוֹד **means that when He comes to count** אֶת בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וּלְמַנּוֹתָם **Bnei Yisrael and number them,** דְּהוּא הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת רֹאשָׁם **which is the elevation of their heads,** שֶׁהוּא הַחֲזָרַת הַכְּתָרִים **which is the return of the crowns,** שֶׁבְּעֲבוּרָם נִסְתַּלְּקוּ אָז חוֹזֵר וּמִתְעוֹרֵר הַקְּטָרוּג **then the accusation is aroused again on account of which they had been removed,** וְיוּכַל לָבֹא גַּם נֶגֶף **and a plague too could come,** חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **Heaven forbid,** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁנִּזְכָּר הַחֵטְא. **through the sin being recalled.** לֹא הָיָה לְעוֹנֶשׁ דְּהִסְתַּלְּקוּת הַכְּתָרִים **For the removal of the crowns was not a punishment;** רַק עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין (צב, א) **in Sanhedrin (92a):** חֲזִי קַבֵּל וְקַיֵּים **"Remain obscure and endure** — דְּתָנַן בֵּית אָפֵל **for we learned: A dark house** — אֵין פּוֹתְחִין וְכוּ'[103] **one does not open..." etc.** וְכֵיוֹצֵא בָּזֶה כָּתְבוּ **And similarly they wrote** בְּשֵׁם הָאַרִ"י זְכרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **in the name of the Arizal, of blessed memory,** [שַׁעַר הַגִּלְגּוּלִים הַקְּדָמָה כב] **(Shaar HaGilgulim, Introduction 22)** דִּכְשֶׁמַּעֲלִין אָדָם **that when a person is raised** בָּעוֹלָמוֹת עֶלְיוֹנִים יוֹתֵר **to higher worlds,** אָז מִתְעוֹרֵר חֵטְא קַל **then a minor sin is aroused,** שֶׁבְּהְיוֹתוֹ בְּגַן עֵדֶן **which, while he was in Gan Eden** וּבָעוֹלָמוֹת תַּחְתּוֹנִים **and in the lower worlds,** לֹא הָיָה נֶחְשָׁב לְחֵטְא כְּלָל **was not considered a sin at all** [אוֹ שֶׁכְּבָר תִּיקְנוֹ] **or which he had already rectified,** אֲבָל לֹא לְגַמְרֵי **but not completely,** לִהְיוֹת כִּזְכִיּוֹת **so as to become like merits,** רַק כִּשְׁגָגוֹת[104] **but only like unintentional sins;** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ זֶה בְּחֵטְא הָעֵגֶל **and in this manner with the sin of the Calf,** שֶׁכְּבָר שָׁבוּ וְנִמְחַל **for they had already repented, and it was forgiven,** וְנִתְרַצָּה בְיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **and He was appeased on Yom HaKippurim,** וְעִם כָּל זֶה לֹא הָיָה לְגַמְרֵי **and nevertheless it was not complete,** דְּאָז הָיוּ חוֹזְרִים **for then they would have returned** לְמַה שֶּׁהָיָה בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **to what was at the giving of the Torah,** בְּהִסְתַּלְּקוּת הַיֵּצֶר **with the removal of the yetzer** [וּבִיטּוּל הַמִּיתָה] **and the abolition of death;** וְדָנִין אוֹתוֹ עַל אוֹתוֹ חֵטְא **and they judge him for that sin,** וְצָרִיךְ לְקַבֵּל עוֹנֶשׁ עַל זֶה מֵחָדָשׁ **and he must receive punishment for it anew,** אַף שֶׁכְּבָר קִיבֵּל עוֹנָשִׁים מִקּוֹדֶם[105] **even though he already received punishments beforehand** וְנִזְדַּכֵּךְ לִהְיוֹת בְּגַן עֵדֶן **and was purified to be in Gan Eden.** וְהָכִי נַמִּי בְּיוֹם פָּקְדִי וְגוֹמֵר **And so too, "on the day that I remember..." etc.;** עַל זֶה צִיְּוָה לָתֵת אָז **for this He commanded to give then** הַשְּׁקָלִים לְכוֹפֶר נַפְשׁ **the shekalim as an atonement for the soul,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה לֹא יוּכַל עוֹד לְקַטְרֵג **so that through this it will not be able to accuse any more** וּלְהָבִיא נֶגֶף חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. **and bring a plague, Heaven forbid.** אָמַר מֹשֶׁה לִפְנֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **Moshe said before the Holy One, blessed is He,** בַּמֶּה תָּרוּם קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל **"Through what will the horn of Yisrael be raised?"** אָמַר לוֹ בְּכִי תִשָּׂא **He said to him, "Through 'When you lift up.'"** וּבְבָבָא בַּתְרָא י"ט ב **And in Bava Basra 10b:** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אָמַר] **And Rashi explained (s.v. Amar):** אִם וְכוּ' **"If..." etc.,** קַח מֵהֶם כּוֹפֶר לִצְדָקָה.[106] **"take from them an atonement for tzedakah."** וּבָאֱמֶת בַּפָּסוּק מַיְירֵי **But in truth, the verse speaks** מִמְּשָׁקָלִים לַמִּשְׁכָּן וּמִקְדָּשׁ **of**

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[101] **Bava Basra 10b; Rashi, s.v. Amar lo be-Ki Sisa** — "Rabbi Abbahu said: Moshe said before the Holy One, blessed be He, 'Master of the world, through what will Israel's horn be raised?' He told him: 'Through When you lift up.'" Rashi explains: 'If you come to lift their heads in exaltation, take from them a ransom for charity.' The statement occurs between discussions of giving to the poor; the next teaching likewise asks how far the power of charity extends. This is the contextual basis for Rav Tzadok's extension from Temple shekalim to charity in the present.

[102] **Psalms 112:9** — "He has distributed freely and given to the needy; his righteousness endures forever; his horn will be raised in honor." In Bava Basra 10b, Rabbi Abbahu cites this verse as David's answer to the question of how far the power of charity extends.

[103] **Isaiah 33:16; Bava Basra 10b** — "He will dwell on high; fortresses of rock will be his stronghold; his bread will be provided, and his water will be secure." Rabbi Abba explains in Bava Basra 10b that dwelling on high is attained because bread and water have been given. The Gemara thus reads the verse in the context of providing sustenance to others.

[104] **Proverbs 14:34; Bava Basra 10b** — "Righteousness exalts a nation, but sin is a disgrace to peoples." Bava Basra 10b interprets the opening words as 'Charity exalts a nation' and applies them to Israel. This is the specific rabbinic reading invoked here; the verse itself continues with a clause whose reading is treated by several opinions in that discussion.

[105] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 11** — "Rabbi Yehudah bar Ilai said: When Moshe heard it, he began reasoning within himself: We find that the ransom of a human life is a talent of silver; each person in Israel will therefore have to give a talent of silver. Rabbi Yochanan said: He learned it from one who spreads a false accusation, whose fine is a hundred silver pieces. ... Rabbi Yehudah bar Simon said: He learned it from a goring ox, for thirty shekels are paid for a slave. ... The Holy One, blessed be He, knew what was in Moshe's heart. He pointed with His finger and told him: Moshe, this they shall give; like this they shall give." The Midrash discusses the large sums Moshe initially associated with redemption of a soul, before God indicated the half-shekel. Rav Tzadok probes how material wealth can answer to the value of a soul and why a visible demonstration was required.

shekalim for the Mishkan and Mikdash, וְלֹא נִזְכָּר צְדָקָה לַעֲנִיִּים כְּלָל **and tzedakah for the poor is not mentioned at all,** וּמִצְוַת צְדָקָה **and the mitzvah of tzedakah** נֶאֱמַר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר.[107] **is stated elsewhere.** אֲבָל כָּל הָעִנְיָן בַּגְּמָרָא שָׁם **But the whole discussion in the Gemara there,** לְפָנָיו וּלְאַחֲרָיו **before it and after it,** מַיְרֵי מִצְּדָקָה **speaks of tzedakah,** וְגַם אַחַר כָּךְ מַיְתֵי מִקְרָאֵי **and afterward too it cites verses:** פִּזַּר נָתַן לָאֶבְיוֹנִים וְגוֹמֵר **"He has scattered, he has given to the needy..." etc.,** קַרְנוֹ תָּרוּם בְּכָבוֹד. **"his horn shall be exalted with honor";** [תְּהִלִּים קיב, ט[108]] **(Tehillim 112:9);** הוּא מְרוֹמִים יִשְׁכּוֹן וְגוֹמֵר **"He shall dwell on high..." etc.,** לַחְמוֹ נִתָּן וְגוֹמֵר **"his bread shall be given..." etc.;** [יְשַׁעְיָה לג, טז[109]] **(Yeshayah 33:16);** צְדָקָה תְּרוֹמֵם גּוֹי וְגוֹמֵר **"tzedakah exalts a nation..." etc.** [מִשְׁלֵי יד, לד[110]] **(Mishlei 14:34);** יְעוּיַן שָׁם **see there.** וּמַשְׁמַע דִּבְזְמַן הַזֶּה **And this implies that nowadays,** דְּלֵיכָא בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **when there is no Beis HaMikdash,** צְדָקָה לַעֲנִיִּים נַמִּי **tzedakah for the poor also** מְהַנֵּי לְכוֹפֶר נֶפֶשׁ **is effective as an atonement for the soul,** כְּשִׁקְלֵי דְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. **like the shekalim of the Beis HaMikdash.** וְאַף עַל גַּב שֶׁזֶּהוּ **And although this is** רַק לְכוֹפֶר נֶפֶשׁ **only an atonement for the soul** כְּשֶׁנּוֹשְׂאִים רֹאשָׁם שֶׁלֹּא יַזִּיק **when He lifts up their heads, so that it will cause no harm,** וְלֹא שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה **and not that through this** הוּא נְשִׂיאַת רֹאשׁ. **there is the lifting of the head —** צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר לְפִי מַה שֶּׁנִּתְבָּאֵר **one must say, according to what was explained,** דְּהָרָמַת קֶרֶן **that the raising of the horn** הוּא עַל יְדֵי הַחְזָרַת הַכְּתָרִים **is through the return of the crowns,** וְכוֹפֶר נֶפֶשׁ דְּשִׁקְלִים **and the atonement of the shekalim** הוּא לְכַפֵּר אַעֶגֶל **is to atone for the Calf,** שֶׁבַּעֲבוּרוֹ הוּסְרוּ. **on account of which they were removed.** אִם כֵּן מִמֵּילָא **If so, automatically,** כְּשֶׁיְּכוּפַּר זֶה עַל יְדֵי כּוֹפֶר **when this is atoned for through the atonement,** עַל יְדֵי זֶה יַחְזְרוּ מִמֵּילָא **through this they will automatically return,** וְיָבֹאוּ לַהֲרָמַת קֶרֶן: **and they will come to the raising of the horn.**

And Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **had difficulty with this:** נִתְקַשָּׁה בָּזֶה אֵיךְ **how a silver coin** הַמַּטְבֵּעַ כֶּסֶף **could be an atonement for the soul,** יִהְיֶה כּוֹפֶר לַנֶּפֶשׁ וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא יא) **as they said (Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 11),** יִתֵּן בְּעַד נַפְשׁוֹ דְּאָמַר כֹּל אֲשֶׁר לָאִישׁ **that he said, "All that a man has he will give for his life,"** רָצָה לוֹמַר דְּהַנֶּפֶשׁ **meaning that the soul** יָקָר מִכָּל הוֹן **is more precious than all wealth,** וְאֵיךְ אֶפְשָׁר לָתֵת מָמוֹן כּוֹפֶר לַנֶּפֶשׁ.[111] **so how is it possible to give money as an atonement for the soul?** וְהָרְאָהוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **And the Holy One, blessed is He, showed him** מַטְבֵּעַ שֶׁל אֵשׁ **a coin of fire** מִתַּחַת כִּסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד **from beneath the Throne of Glory** וְאָמַר לוֹ זֶה יִתְּנוּ **and said to him, "This they shall give —** כָּזֶה יִתְּנוּ[112]

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[106] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 9** — "Rabbi Meir said: The Holy One, blessed be He, brought forth something resembling a coin of fire from beneath the Throne of Glory, showed it to Moshe, and told him: 'This they shall give; they shall give something like this.'" Rav Tzadok reads the fiery counterpart as revealing the spiritual life concealed within the apparently inanimate coin.

[107] **Devarim 4:35** — "You were shown this so that you should know that Hashem is God; there is none besides Him."

[108] Parallel: **Tzidkas HaTzadik 86** — "Everything belonging to a person's sphere—his wife and children, his servant and maidservant, his ox and donkey, his tent, silver, gold, and all that is his—comes from the root of his soul. For even all inanimate things, plants, and animals are rooted in the human soul, and the root of their vitality derives from it. What he possesses is that whose root of vitality comes from him."

Connection: This gives the wider principle behind the redemption effected through a coin: a person's material possessions are connected to the very soul being redeemed. Giving the half-shekel can therefore act upon an inward spiritual relationship rather than merely exchange an external object for the soul.

[109] **Nechemiah 9:6** — "You alone are Hashem. You made the heavens, the heavens of heavens and all their host, the earth and everything upon it, the seas and everything within them; You give life to them all, and the host of heaven bows before You." The verse attributes not only creation but the continuing life of all things to God. Rav Tzadok identifies this divine vitality within the material object with its spiritual counterpart.

[110] **Berachos 9a–9b** — "That righteous man might say: 'He fulfilled in them: They shall serve them and they shall afflict them; but He did not fulfill in them: Afterward they shall leave with great wealth.'" The statement begins at the end of 9a: God asks Moshe to urge Israel to request silver and gold from Egypt, so that Avraham will not have this complaint. Rav Tzadok asks why fulfillment must occur specifically through Egypt's possessions.

[111] **Chaggai 2:8** — "Mine is the silver and Mine is the gold, declares Hashem of Hosts."

[112] **Shemos Rabbah 52:3** — "One of Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's disciples went abroad and returned wealthy. The other disciples saw him, envied him, and wished to leave as well. Rabbi Shimon knew, brought them out to a valley before Meron, prayed, and said: 'Valley, valley, fill with golden dinars!' It began to draw forth golden dinars before them. He told them: 'If it is gold you seek, here is gold; take it. But know that whoever takes now is taking his portion of the World to Come, for the reward of Torah is given only in the World to Come.'" Yerushalmi Berachos 9:2 likewise records that Rabbi Shimon could say, 'Valley, valley, fill with golden dinars,' and it would fill. The Midrash's fuller narrative distinguishes the possibility of obtaining gold miraculously from the spiritual cost of taking it. Rav Tzadok

like this they shall give" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם סוֹף סִימָן ט) **(as stated there, end of siman 9).** **The intent is that He showed him** הַכַּוָּנָה דְּהֶרְאָהוּ יֵשׁ שֶׁאַף שֶׁהִיא חֲתִיכַת דּוֹמֶם **that even though it is a piece of inanimate matter, it too has spirituality,** בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן רוּחָנִיּוּת שֶׁהֲרֵי דּוּגְמָתוֹ לְמַעְלָה **for its counterpart above** כִּי בְּכָל שֶׁל אֵשׁ. **is of fire.** **For in everything there is spirituality,** דָּבָר יֵשׁ רוּחָנִיּוּת שֶׁמִּמֶּנָּה הִתְהַוּוּתוֹ וְקִיּוּמוֹ **from which comes its coming into being and its existence,** דְּאִין עוֹד מִלְבַדּוֹ כְּתִיב[113] דִּלְוֹלֵי כֵן אֵין לוֹ מְצִיאוּת **for were it not so, it would have no existence, since it is written, "There is none else besides Him"** [דְּבָרִים ד, לה]. **(Devarim 4:35).** **And in all of a person's possessions** הָאָדָם יֵשׁ רוּחָנִיּוּת **there is a spirituality** הַשַּׁיָּיךְ לְנֶפֶשׁ הָאָדָם[114] **that belongs to the person's soul,** וְכַיָּדוּעַ דְּאַתָּה מְחַיֶּה אֶת כּוּלָּם[115] **as is known: "and You give life to them all"** [נְחֶמְיָה ט, ו]. **(Nechemiah 9:6).** **And this is the meaning of "they emptied out Egypt":** וְזֶה עִנְיַן וַיְנַצְּלוּ אֶת מִצְרָיִם [שְׁמוֹת יב, לו] **(Shemos 12:36):** שֶׁלֹּא יֹאמַר אוֹתוֹ צַדִּיק וְכוּלֵי **"so that that righteous man should not say..." etc.,** בִּרְכוּשׁ גָּדוֹל לֹא קִיֵּים[116] **"'with great wealth' He did not fulfill"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּבָרָכוֹת ט, ב) **(as stated in Berachos 9b).** וְאִם ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ רָצָה **But if Hashem, may He be blessed, wanted** לִיתֵּן לָהֶם רְכוּשׁ **to give them wealth,** מַה צּוֹרֶךְ לִישָּׂא מִמִּצְרָיִם **what need was there to carry it from Egypt?** וְלִי הַכֶּסֶף וְלִי הַזָּהָב **"Mine is the silver and Mine is the gold,** נְאוּם ה'[117] **says Hashem"** [חַגַּי ב, ח]. **(Chaggai 2:8).** **And also Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai,** וְגַם רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן בֶּן יוֹחַאי **as they said in the Yerushalmi** אָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי (בְּרָכוֹת פֶּרֶק ט הֲלָכָה ב סה, א) **(Berachos 9:2, 65a)** וּמִדְרָשׁ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה נב, ג) **and the Midrash (Shemos Rabbah 52:3),** שֶׁאָמַר בְּקִעָה הִתְמַלְּאִי **that he said, "Valley, fill up** דִּינָרֵי זָהָב וְנִתְמַלְּאָה.[118] **with golden dinars," and it was filled.** **And even without this,** וּבְלָאו הָכִי אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **Avraham Avinu,** רְכוּשׁ עוֹלָם הַזֶּה עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם לֹא בִּיקֵּשׁ לְזַרְעוֹ **peace be upon him, did not ask for his offspring the wealth of this world,** וְלֹא יִתְרַעֵם עַל זֶה. **and would not complain about this.** **But the essence of "they emptied out" is known:** אֲבָל יָדוּעַ עִיקַּר וַיְנַצְּלוּ שֶׁעָשׂוּ כְּמִצּוּלָה **that they made it like the deep** שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ דָּגִים[119] **which has no fish,** הַיְינוּ שֶׁלֹּא נִשְׁאַר בָּהֶם שׁוּם חִיּוּת **meaning that there remained in them no vitality at all,** דְּהַתְחָלַת בְּרִיאַת חַיִּים **for the beginning of the creation of living things** הָיָה בַּדָּגִים[120] **was with the fish** [רְאֵה

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uses the miracle to sharpen his question: why was Egyptian wealth itself necessary?

[113] **Berachos 9b** — "'They emptied Egypt.' Rabbi Ami said: This teaches that they made it like a trap containing no grain. Reish Lakish said: They made it like a deep pool containing no fish." These are distinct readings of the expression 'they emptied.' Rav Tzadok interprets the fish as living vitality and the grain as the nourishment that sustains life and supports awareness.

[114] **Bereishis 1:20** — "God said: Let the waters swarm with a swarm of living beings, and let birds fly above the earth across the face of the expanse of heaven." This is the first command in the creation narrative concerning living creatures. Rashi explains the term sheretz as applying to living things whose bodies do not rise high above the ground; it includes aquatic creatures as well as other low-moving life.

[115] **Sanhedrin 70b** — "Rabbi Yehudah says: It was wheat, for a child does not know how to call 'father' and 'mother' until he tastes grain." This is Rabbi Yehudah's opinion identifying the Tree of Knowledge. Rav Tzadok draws on the association between grain and the emergence of a child's discernment.

[116] **Sukkah 42b** — "When a child can eat an olive-sized amount of grain, one must keep four cubits away from his excrement and urine. Rav Chisda said: This is when he can eat it within the time for eating a peras. Rav Chiyya son of Rav Yeiva said: For an adult, even if he cannot eat it within that time, the rule applies, as it is written: 'He who increases knowledge increases pain.'" The discussion connects the grain-eating stage to the laws of clean surroundings for sacred speech. Rav Tzadok cites it alongside the association of grain with developing awareness.

[117] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:11; cf. Sifrei Devarim 120:1** — "'We will make you circlets of gold'—this is the plunder of the Sea. 'With points of silver'—this is the plunder of Egypt. Just as there is a difference between silver and gold, so the wealth of the Sea surpassed the plunder of Egypt." This is the passage cited in the manuscript under the older division 1:55. Mekhilta, Pischa 13, similarly identifies the golden circlets with the Sea and the silver points with Egypt. The related Sifrei Devarim 120:1 identifies gold with the Sea's plunder and silver with Egypt's; it does not itself state the explicit greater-than comparison. The manuscript's Reeh 67 locator remains an edition-numbering qualification.

[118] **Shemos 14:31** — "Israel saw the great hand that Hashem had exercised against Egypt; the people feared Hashem, and they believed in Hashem and in Moshe His servant."

[119] **Zohar II 148a, Terumah** — "Gold is certainly exalted above all; this is the higher gold, the seventh of all the kinds of gold, the gold that shines and flashes to the eyes. ... When is that which is called gold termed gold? When it is radiant, elevated in the glory of awe, and in supernal joy, bringing joy to those below. ... Silver below is the mystery of the right arm." The passage associates silver with the right side and mercy, and higher gold with elevated awe and joy. Rav Tzadok applies this symbolic distinction to the love awakened at the Exodus and the awe at the Sea. His account of the remaining 'point' of love is his development of these sources.

[120] **Sotah 31a** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar says: Greater is one who acts from love than one who acts from fear, for the latter's reward is reserved for a thousand generations, while the former's is reserved for two thousand generations."

בְּרֵאשִׁית א, כ וּבְרַשִׁ"י]. **(see Bereishis 1:20 and Rashi).** וּמֵאן דְּאָמַר כְּמָצוּדָה **And according to the one who says, "like a trap** וְנוֹתֵן שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ דָּגָן **that has no grain" —** הַיְינוּ דְּבָר הַמְקַיֵּים הַחַיִּים **this is something that sustains life** דַּעַת בָּאָדָם **and gives understanding to a person,** (ע, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין **as they said in Sanhedrin (70b),** עַד שֶׁיִּטְעֹם טַעַם **that a child does not know** לִקְרֹאוֹ אַבָּא וְאִימָּא **to call "father" and "mother"** דְּתִינוֹק אֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ דָּגָן.[121] **until he tastes the taste of grain.** (מב, ב) וּבְסוּכָּה **And in Sukkah (42b),** דְּמַרְחִיקִין מְצוֹאָתוֹ אָז **that one then distances oneself from his excrement;** דְּיוֹסִיף דַּעַת וְגוֹמֵר.[122] **for "he who increases knowledge..." etc.** וְזֶהוּ הַקְלִיטָה **And this is the absorption** שֶׁהָיָה כָּל חָכְמָת מִצְרַיִם **of all the wisdom of Egypt,** לְמִילּוּי תַּאֲוָתָם **for all their wisdom was for fulfilling their desires.** שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה א, נה) וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **And about this they said (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:55,** וְכֵן הוּא בְּמְכִילְתָּא בֹּא יג **and so it is in the Mechilta, Bo 13,** וְסִפְרֵי רְאֵה סז) **and Sifrei, Re'eh 67)** עַל פָּסוּק [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים א, יא] **on the verse (Shir HaShirim 1:11)** תּוֹרֵי זָהָב וְגוֹמֵר **"Circlets of gold..." etc.,** עִם נְקוּדּוֹת הַכֶּסֶף **"with points of silver,"** דִּגְדוֹלָה בִּיצִיאַת הַיָּם **that the plunder at the Sea was greater** מִבִּיזַּת מִצְרַיִם[123] **than the plunder of Egypt.** הַיְינוּ דְּבִיצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם **This means that at the Exodus from Egypt** הָיוּ בְּתוֹקֶף הָאַהֲבָה **they were in the full force of love** לַה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **for Hashem, may He be blessed,** דְּעַל כֵּן חַג זֶה **which is why this festival** נָגַד אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם. **corresponds to Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him.** כִּי מִצְרַיִם עֶרְוַת הָאָרֶץ **For Egypt is "the nakedness of the land,"** שְׁטוּפֵי זִמָּה **steeped in lewdness,** בְּאַהֲבוֹת וְתַאֲוֹת רָעוֹת **in evil loves and desires;** וְזֶה שׁוֹרֶשׁ חִיּוּתָם **and this is the root of their vitality** וְכָל דַּעְתָּם וְחָכְמָתָם **and all their knowledge and wisdom** וּמַחְשְׁבוֹתָם וְקִיּוּם חַיָּתָם **and their thoughts and the sustaining of their life;** וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי נִיצוֹצוֹת שֶׁנָּפְלוּ בִּשְׁבִירַת הַכֵּלִים **and this is through holy sparks that fell in the shattering of the vessels,** מִמִּדַּת חֶסֶד קְדוֹשׁוֹת כַּיָּדוּעַ. **from the attribute of Chessed as is known.** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל הוֹצִיאוּ **And Yisrael brought out** הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **the holy sparks,** וְנִתְעוֹרֵר עַל יְדֵי זֶה בָּהֶם **and through this there was aroused in them** תּוֹקֶף הָאַהֲבָה דִּקְדוּשָׁה **the full force of holy love;** וְזֶהוּ נְקוּדַּת הַכֶּסֶף **and this is "the point of silver,"** [זֹהַר חֲלָק ב׳ קמח, א] כַּיָּדוּעַ **as is known (Zohar II 148a),** דְּכֶסֶף הוּא אַהֲבָה **that silver is love;** וְנִקְרָא נְקוּדּוֹת **and it is called "points"** כִּי דָּבָר זֶה הָיָה רַק לְשָׁעָה **because this was only for a time,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִסְתַּלֵּק כַּיָּדוּעַ **and afterward it departed, as is known,** וְנִשְׁאַר רַק נְקוּדָּה.[124] **and only a point remained.** וּבְקִרְיעַת יַם סוּף נֶאֱמַר **And at the splitting of the Yam Suf it says,** [שְׁמוֹת יד, לא] **(Shemos 14:31):** וַיִּירְאוּ הָעָם אֶת ה'[125] **"And the people feared Hashem";** מִמִּדַּת הַיִּרְאָה וְאַף דְּאַהֲבָה גְּדוֹלָה **the attribute of fear is called gold,** [זֹהַר שָׁם] כַּיָּדוּעַ. **as is known (Zohar ibid.).** נִקְרָא זָהָב[126]

The source compares the stature of service motivated by love and by fear. Rav Tzadok distinguishes that comparison from the question of which quality a person must first cultivate through his own effort.

[121] **Berachos 33b** — "Rabbi Chanina said: Everything is in the hands of Heaven except the fear of Heaven, as it is stated: 'And now, Israel, what does Hashem your God ask of you but to fear?' ... Rabbi Chanina said in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's name: The Holy One, blessed be He, has in His treasury only a store of the fear of Heaven, as it is stated: 'The fear of Hashem is His treasure.'"

[122] **Menachos 85a, with Rashi** — "Yochana and Mamre said to Moshe: 'Are you bringing straw to Aforayim?' He answered them: 'People say: Bring vegetables to a city of vegetables.'" Rashi explains that Yochana and Mamre were the leading Egyptian sorcerers. They thought Moshe's signs were sorcery and mocked his bringing such feats to Egypt, a land already full of sorcery. Moshe answered their comparison on its own terms.

[123] **Sanhedrin 67b** — "Rabbi Yochanan said: Why are they called keshafim, sorceries? Because they contradict the heavenly retinue." The expression describes sorcery's interference with the ordinary divine administration of the world; Rav Tzadok subsequently explains the spiritual source of that power in the fallen sparks.

[124] **Mekhilta, Yisro 1 (Amalek 3)** — "'For Hashem is great.' They said: Previously no slave was able to escape from Egypt, yet now He brought six hundred thousand people out of Egypt. Therefore it says: 'For Hashem is great.'" The Mekhilta states the impossibility of escape and the greatness of the Exodus. Its connection to Egypt's sorcery and the spiritual roots of Gevurah is Rav Tzadok's explanation.

[125] **Sanhedrin 67b** — "Zeiri came to Alexandria in Egypt and bought a donkey. When he came to give it water, the enchantment dissolved, and a plank from a bridge stood there. They said to him: 'Were you not Zeiri, we would not return your money. Does anyone buy something here without testing it with water?'" The story illustrates an illusion exposed by water. Rav Tzadok interprets the cancellation of the fiery power of sorcery by water through the relation of Gevurah and Chassadim.

[126] **Rashi, Shemos 15:22; cf. Tanchuma Buber, Beshalach 16, and Yalkut Shimoni 254:4** — "He moved them away against their will. The Egyptians had adorned their horses with gold and silver ornaments and precious stones, and Israel found them in the Sea. The plunder of the Sea was greater than the plunder of Egypt, as it is stated: 'We will make you circlets of gold, with points of silver.' He therefore had to move them away against their will." Rashi supplies the material setting for Rav Tzadok's account of the sparks gathered through the actual wealth. The separate Yalkut and Tanchuma Buber source references still require edition-specific checking.

And even though love is greater, זֶהוּ מִצַּד הַמַּעֲלָה עַצְמָהּ **that is from the standpoint of the level itself,** מַעֲלָה גְּדוֹלָה דְּוַדַּאי מִדַּת אַהֲבָה **for certainly the attribute of love is a greater level;** יוֹתֵר הָעִיקָּר יִרְאָה אֲבָל מִצַּד הִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת הָאָדָם **but from the standpoint of a person's own effort, the main thing is fear,** הַכֹּל בִּידֵי שָׁמַיִם **"Everything is in the hands of Heaven except the fear of Heaven,** חוּץ מִיִּרְאַת שָׁמַיִם [דְּבָרִים י, יב] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Devarim 10:12):** וְאֵין לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵי **and "the Holy One, blessed is He, has nothing..." etc.,** כִּי אִם לְיִרְאָה **'but to fear'";** מָה ה' וְגוֹמֵר **'What does Hashem...' etc.,** אֶלָּא אוֹצָר שֶׁל יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם[128] **"but a treasury of the fear of Heaven";** מֵהָא כִּי הָאַהֲבָה בָּא אַחַר כָּךְ **for love comes afterward of its own accord, as is known** מִמֵּילָא כַּיָּדוּעַ דְּדַרְכּוֹ שֶׁל אִישׁ וְכוּלֵי.[129] **from the principle "it is the way of a man..." etc.** וּמַה דְּמִצְרַיִם מְקוֹם כְּשָׁפִים[130] **And the fact that Egypt was a place of sorcery,** [מְנָחוֹת פה, א] **(Menachos 85a),** שֶׁמַּכְחִישִׁין פָּמַלְיָא שֶׁל מַעְלָה[131] **which contradicts the heavenly entourage,** [סַנְהֶדְרִין סז, ב] **(Sanhedrin 67b),** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה גָּבְרוּ **through which they prevailed** עַל כָּל הָאוּמּוֹת **over all the nations,** וְעֶבֶד לֹא יָכוֹל לָצֵאת מִשָּׁם[132] **so that no slave could escape from there — [מְכִילְתָּא יִתְרוֹ א] (Mechilta, Yisro 1) —** זֶה הָיָה עַל יְדֵי נִיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **this was through holy sparks** מִמִּדַּת הַגְּבוּרָה דִּשְׁבִירָה. **from the attribute of Gevurah of the shattering.** וּכְשָׁפִים מִתְבַּטְּלִים בַּמַּיִם **And sorcery is nullified by water,** (סַנְהֶדְרִין סז, ב[133]) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין **as they said in Sanhedrin (67b);** הַיְינוּ לְפִי שֶׁכֹּחָם מִגְּבוּרָה וְאֵשׁ **that is, because their power is from Gevurah and fire,** וּמַיִם חֲסָדִים מְכַבִּים אֵשׁ. **and water, which is chassadim, extinguishes fire.** וְעַל כֵּן טוּבְּעוּ בַּמַּיִם **And therefore they were drowned in the water,** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל קָלְטוּ **and Yisrael absorbed** הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת דְּיִרְאָה. **the holy sparks of fear.** וְזֶהוּ עַל יְדֵי הַבִּיזָּה **And this was through the plunder,** שֶׁהָיָה כְּפְשָׁטֵיהּ רְכוּשׁ **which was, in its plain sense, wealth,** כְּמִפּוֹרָשׁ בַּכָּתוּב [שְׁמוֹת יב, לה] וְדִים בְּדִבְרֵי חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה בְּמִצְרַיִם. **as stated explicitly in the verse (Shemos 12:35) regarding Egypt. And it is in the words of our Sages, of blessed memory,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשִׁ"י **(as Rashi wrote,** [שָׁם טו, כב] **(ibid. 15:22),** וְכֵן הוּא בְּיַלְקוּט שִׁמְעוֹנִי **and so it is in Yalkut Shimoni** [שְׁמוֹת רֶמֶז רנד] **(Shemos, remez 254)** בְּשֵׁם תַּנְחוּמָא [יָשָׁן בְּשַׁלַּח טז]) **in the name of Tanchuma (Yashan, Beshalach 16))** עַל פָּסוּק וַיַּסַּע מֹשֶׁה[134] **on the verse "And**

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[127] **Zohar III 63b, Acharei Mos** — "Esav is a hairy man: he comes from that which is called se'ir, for he comes from that side. ... The priest divides the two goats, one for his portion and one for the Holy One, blessed be He. Why? So that he should bear on his shoulders all Yaakov's sins, as it is written: 'The goat shall bear upon itself all their iniquities'—the iniquities of the innocent one." The Zohar connects Esav with the se'ir and explains the goat's bearing of the innocent one's iniquities. Rav Tzadok applies this pattern to Yaakov's gift: the separation of an element belonging to Esav makes possible Yaakov's subsequent wholeness.

[128] **Koheles 7:20** — "For there is no righteous person on earth who does good and does not sin."

[129] **Chagigah 15a** — "He created righteous people and wicked people; He created Gan Eden and Gehinnom. Each person has two portions, one in Gan Eden and one in Gehinnom. If the righteous person merits, he takes his own portion and his fellow's portion in Gan Eden. If the wicked person is found guilty, he takes his own portion and his fellow's portion in Gehinnom." Rav Tzadok interprets 'his fellow' through the correspondence of soul-roots and the separation of the good and evil that had become intermixed.

[130] **Koheles 7:14** — "On a day of good, be in good; on a day of adversity, consider: God has made this opposite that, so that a person will find nothing after him." The verse speaks of the juxtaposition of good and adversity. Rav Tzadok applies the phrase 'this opposite that' to corresponding spiritual structures.

[131] **Shaar HaPesukim, Yisro, s.v. Hineh haneshamot** — "All souls became intermixed with good and evil through Adam's sin, but each according to its level. Some consist mostly of evil and a little good, and some the reverse; there are many degrees in this. ... The good within them is sifted out and given to the one fit for it, who belongs to the root of that soul, as our Sages said: If he merits, he takes his portion and his fellow's portion in Gan Eden; the complete evil remains in the other." This is the precise passage behind Rav Tzadok's reference: 'his fellow' is explained through a shared soul-root, and the redistribution of portions through the sifting of good from evil. The archive's derived segment number is not used as a printed locator.

[132] **Shabbos 33b** — "'Yaakov arrived whole.' Rav said: Whole in his body, whole in his wealth, whole in his Torah." Rav Tzadok explains the completeness of Yaakov's wealth through the removal of what did not belong to his holy portion, rather than merely through the preservation of a monetary total.

[133] **Eruvin 54a** — "Rabbi Eliezer said: What is meant by 'engraved on the tablets'? Had the first tablets not been broken, Torah would not have been forgotten from Israel." The source links the breaking of the first tablets to forgetfulness. The comparison with the injury to Yaakov's thigh belongs to Rav Tzadok's argument.

[134] **Bava Basra 9a** — "Rabbi Elazar said: When the Beis HaMikdash stood, a person would weigh out his shekel and gain atonement. Now that the Beis HaMikdash does not stand, if they give charity, it is well; if not, the nations of the world come and take by force. Even so, it is reckoned for them as charity, as it is stated: 'Your exactors—charity.' ... If he merits: 'Is it not to share your bread with the hungry?' If he does not merit: 'You will bring the wandering poor into your house.'" The two teachings contrast willing charity with money taken through external pressure. Rav

Moshe led" [שְׁמוֹת טו, כב]. **(Shemos 15:22).** וְהַיינוּ כִּי בְּהָרְכוּשׁ **And this is because in the wealth** הָיָה גַּם כֵּן אוֹתָם[135] **there were also those** הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת. **holy sparks.** וְכֵן לְהֵיפֶךְ יֵשׁ **And likewise, the opposite also exists,** כְּמוֹ דוֹרֶן דְּיַעֲקֹב לְעֵשָׂו **such as Yaakov's gift to Esav,** שֶׁהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ **which is in the manner of** הַשָּׂעִיר וּלְפִי שֶׁרָאָה לַעֲזָאזֵל[136] **the goat sent to Azazel,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר **as they said in the Zohar** [חֶלֶק ג׳ סג, ב]. **(III 63b).** יַעֲקֹב **And because Yaakov saw,** דְּנָגַע בְּכַף יָרֵךְ **when he touched the hollow of his thigh,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ טַעֲנָה עֲדַיִן נֶגְדּוֹ **that there was still a claim against him** בְּחֵטְא מִצַּד עֵרְבּוּב הַטּוֹב וְרָע **because of the mixture of good and evil** אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן **in the sin of Adam HaRishon —** אָדָם[137] אֵין צַדִּיק וְגוֹמֵר **"for there is no righteous man..." etc. —** [קוֹהֶלֶת ז, כ] **(Koheles 7:20) —** וְיֵשׁ גַּם בּוֹ אֵיזֶה צַד **and that in him too there is some aspect** הַשַּׁיָּךְ לְעֵשָׂו בֶּאֱמֶת **that truly belongs to Esav,** (טו, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּחֲגִיגָה **as they said in Chagigah (15a):** נִתְחַיֵּב רָשָׁע **"When the wicked one is found guilty,** נוֹטֵל חֶלְקוֹ וְחֶלֶק חֲבֵירוֹ **he takes his own portion and his fellow's portion** בַּגֵּיהִנֹּם.[138] **in Gehinnom."** וְקָרֵי לֵיהּ חֲבֵירוֹ **And it calls him "his fellow,"** כִּי כָּל נֶפֶשׁ יֵשׁ לְעוּמָּתוֹ **for every soul has a counterpart** גַּם כֵּן בָּאָדָם בְּלִיַּעַל **in the Adam of Belial,** שֶׁהוּא דּוּגְמַת דְּאָדָם דִּקְדוּשָׁה **which is the counterpart of the Adam of holiness** הַכּוֹלֵל כָּל הַנְּפָשׁוֹת **that encompasses all the souls,** דְּזֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה **for "this opposite that** עָשָׂה הָאֱלֹהִים.[139] **G-d has made."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁם יֵשׁ **And just as there are** נִיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת הַמְחַיֶּה **holy sparks that give life,** כֵּן בָּזֶה יֵשׁ אֵיזֶה נְקוּדָּה מִשָּׁם **so in this one there is some point from there,** וְצָרִיךְ לְבָרֵר **and it is necessary to sift them,** דְּזֶה יִקַּח כָּל הַטּוֹב **so that this one takes all the good** וְזֶה כָּל הָרָע[140] **and that one all the evil** [רְאֵה שַׁעַר הַפְּסוּקִים **(see Shaar HaPesukim,** פָּרָשַׁת יִתְרוֹ דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל הִנֵּה]. **Parshas Yisro, s.v. Hineh).** וְכֵן הָיוּ יַעֲקֹב וְעֵשָׂו **And so were Yaakov and Esav,** שֶׁהֵם שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַטּוֹב וְרָע. **who are the root of good and evil.** וְאַחַר שֶׁשָּׁלַח לְעֵשָׂו חֶלְקוֹ **And after he sent Esav his portion,** נֶאֱמַר אַחַר כָּךְ **it then says,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית לג, יח] **(Bereishis 33:18):**

Tzadok understands these as paths by which the evil element associated with a person's wealth is removed or transformed.

[135] Parallel: **Rabbi Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Tanya, Likkutei Amarim, chapter 37, paragraphs 19–20** — "There is no commandment in which the vital soul is invested as fully as in the commandment of charity. In all the other commandments, only one power of the vital soul is invested, and only while the commandment is being performed. But when a person gives charity from the work of his hands, the whole strength of his vital soul has been invested in his labor or other occupation through which he earned this money. When he gives it to charity, his entire vital soul ascends to Hashem. Even someone who does not live from his own labor nevertheless gives the life of his soul to Hashem, since with this money he could have purchased what sustains his vital soul."

Connection: Tanya gives a concrete meaning to offering one's life through money: it embodies either the vitality spent earning it or the sustenance it could buy. This clarifies how the half-shekel can bring the donor's life into divine service.

[136] **Zohar II 187b, Raaya Mehemna, Ki Sisa** — "The commandment is to give half a shekel by the sacred shekel. The half shekel is like half a hin: vav, situated between the two hehs. The weight-stone is yud; 'twenty gerah is the shekel' is Yud. 'The rich shall not increase'—this is the middle column, which must not exceed ten. Thus it is said in Sefer Yetzirah: Ten sefirot of restraint, ten and not eleven. 'The poor shall not decrease'—this is the tzaddik; he must not diminish from ten, as it says, ten and not nine. 'From half a shekel'—which is yud." The ten-unit value is read as the complete tenfold structure. Rav Tzadok consequently understands the half-shekel's redemption of the soul as involving the wholeness of its spiritual configuration.

[137] **Zohar II 123b, Mishpatim** — "I saw Rabbi Shimon in a dream and asked him: We have learned that yud is Chochmah; why is heh Binah? He said: 'A river goes forth from Eden to water the garden.' The river from Eden is Binah, and yud is concealed within it. Yud spreads this river in every direction, forming heh. It then brings forth the son, vav. Thus we learned: Heh was originally dalet; when the male joined her, she conceived a son and was called heh. Afterward she gave birth to vav and placed him before her to nourish him." The passage explicitly affirms the identification of yud with Chochmah and explains the extension from yud to heh through Binah. Rav Tzadok associates the ten gerah of the half-shekel with this beginning of revealed wisdom.

[138] **Rashi on Shemos 15:1** — "Then, when he saw the miracle, it arose in his heart that he should sing a song. ... Here too, 'he will sing' means that his heart told him he should sing, and so he did: 'They said, saying: I will sing to Hashem.' ... This teaches us that the yud was said with reference to the thought." Rashi explains the grammatical yud of yashir through the thought preceding the act of singing. Rav Tzadok draws on that formulation as an allusion connecting yud and Chochmah.

[139] **Megillah 29b** — "Rabbi Tavi said in the name of Rabbi Yoshiyya: Scripture says, 'This is the burnt offering of the month in its month.' The Torah said: Renew the offerings and bring them from a new contribution. Since in Nisan they must bring offerings from a new contribution, we precede it and read on the first of Adar, so that they will bring shekels to the Temple." The discussion begins on 29a and continues on 29b. This sentence describes the public reading as preparation for the new sacrificial fund; Rav Tzadok asks how it relates to the separate proclamation.

[140] **Rashi, Megillah 29a, s.v. Mashmiin al hashekalim** — "They make announcements concerning the shekalim: by proclamation of the court."

וַיָּבֹא יַעֲקֹב שָׁלֵם **"And Yaakov came whole,"** (שַׁבָּת לג, ב) וְאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **and our Sages, of blessed memory, said (Shabbos 33b):** בְּגוּפוֹ וּבְמָמוֹנוֹ וּבְתוֹרָתוֹ[141] **in his body, in his wealth and in his Torah;** כִּי מַה שֶּׁחָסֵר מִמָּמוֹנוֹ **for what was lost from his wealth,** אַדְרַבָּה גָּרַם לוֹ **on the contrary, brought about for him** שְׁלֵימוּת הַמָּמוֹן **the wholeness of his wealth,** כְּשֶׁהִפְרִיד אֲשֶׁר לֹא טוֹב.[142] **when he separated off what was not good.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְרַפֵּא **And through this he was also healed** גַּם מִצַּלְעָתוֹ. **of his limp.** וְכֵן בְּתוֹרָתוֹ **And so too in his Torah,** כִּי הַנְּגִיעָה בְּכַף יְרֵכוֹ **for the touching of the hollow of his thigh** הוּא דּוּגְמַת שְׁבִירַת הַלּוּחוֹת **corresponds to the breaking of the Tablets,** שֶׁגָּרַם שִׁכְחַת הַתּוֹרָה **which caused forgetting of the Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (עֵירוּבִין נד, א[143]) **as our Sages, of blessed memory, said (Eruvin 54a);** וּמִדַּת אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב **and the attribute of truth belongs to Yaakov,** אֵין אֱמֶת אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה **and "truth" means only Torah;** דְּעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ **which is why they said** (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן יג כט, א) **(Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 13, 29a):** מֹשֶׁה מִלְּגָאו יַעֲקֹב מִלְּבַר **"Moshe is within, Yaakov is outside";** כִּי יַעֲקֹב דּוּגְמַת הַלּוּחוֹת אֶבֶן **for Yaakov corresponds to the stone Tablets** אוֹ יְרִיעוֹת הַסֵּפֶר תּוֹרָה **or the parchment sheets of the Sefer Torah,** שֶׁשָּׁם כְּתַב הָאוֹתִיּוֹת **on which the letters are written,** וְהָאוֹתִיּוֹת עַצְמָם **and the letters themselves —** זֶה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **this is Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ כָּל הַתּוֹרָה **who is the root of the entire Torah,** דְּנִקְרֵאת עַל שְׁמוֹ תּוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה **which is called by his name, "the Torah of Moshe,"** וְנִקְרֵאת גַּם כֵּן תּוֹרַת אֱמֶת. **and is also called "the Torah of truth."** וְנִשְׁתַּלֵּם בַּכֹּל **And he was made whole in everything** עַל יְדֵי זֶה הַדּוֹרָן **through this gift,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא ט, א) **And so they said (Bava Basra 9a):** וְנוֹגְשַׁיִךְ צְדָקָה **"and your taskmasters righteousness,"** דְּנָחְשָׁב לִצְדָקָה **that it is counted as tzedakah;** זָכָה [שָׁם] וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (ibid.): If he merits,** הֲלֹא פָרוֹס לָרָעֵב וְגוֹמֵר **"Is it not to share your bread with the hungry..." etc.;** [יְשַׁעְיָה נח, ז] **(Yeshayah 58:7);** לֹא זָכָה **if he does not merit,** [שָׁם][144] וַעֲנִיִּים מְרוּדִים וְגוֹמֵר. **"and the wretched poor..." etc. (ibid.).** כִּי מַה הָרָע שֶׁלָּהֶם לוֹקְחִים **For what they take** הוּא שֶׁיִּקְלְטוּ עַל יְדֵי זֶה **is so that through this they absorb the evil that is theirs;** וְאִם זָכוּ הוּא נִתְקָן **and if they merit, it is rectified** עַל יְדֵי צְדָקָה **through tzedakah,** שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה מֵהָרָע טוֹב.[145] **so that from the evil, good is made.** וְזֶהוּ גַּם כֵּן הַכּוֹפֶר נֶפֶשׁ **And this too is the atonement for the soul** דְּמַחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל[146] **of the half-shekel,** שֶׁהוּא עֲשָׂרָה גֵּרָה **which is ten gerah,** דְּרוֹמֵז לְעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **which alludes to the**

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[141] **Bartenura, Shekalim 1:1** — "The court sends throughout all the cities of Israel and proclaims that they should bring their shekalim. For on the first of Nisan the communal sacrifices must be brought from a new collection. ... Therefore they announce thirty days earlier, from the first of Adar, that the people should bring their shekalim." The intervening exposition derives the new collection from the annual renewal of the offerings. The announcement is a court-administered act, distinct from the Torah reading.

[142] **Rambam, Hilchos Shekalim 1:9** — "On the first of Adar they make announcements concerning the shekalim, so that each person will prepare his half-shekel and be ready to give it. On the fifteenth the money changers sit in every province and request payment gently: whoever gives to them, they accept from him; whoever has not given is not compelled to give."

[143] **Rambam, Hilchos Tefillah 13:20** — "When Rosh Chodesh Adar falls on Shabbos, they read the section of Shekalim and read the haftarah of Yehoyada the priest. Likewise, if Rosh Chodesh Adar falls during the week, even on Friday, they read the section of Shekalim in advance on the preceding Shabbos." The Rambam codifies the reading among the laws of public prayer, separately from the proclamation and collection in Hilchos Shekalim. This separation is the basis of Rav Tzadok's question.

[144] **Hosea 14:3** — "Take words with you and return to Hashem. Say to Him: Forgive all iniquity and accept what is good; we shall render bulls through our lips." The verse supplies the language by which prayer and verbal service take the place of animal offerings when they cannot be brought.

[145] **Anaf Yosef, Tanchuma, Ki Sisa §3** — "'Master of the worlds, after I die I am not remembered.' It is difficult: why did Moses become concerned in the section of shekels, and not in the section of offerings, since they too apply only when the Temple stands? We may answer that we have a wondrous premise: Elijah is the one who offers in the Temple. ... He has funds from the contribution of the chamber, hidden away for this purpose. Concerning this we learned, 'I have heard that sacrifices may be offered even though there is no Temple.' ... Therefore he did not become concerned about the section of offerings, because they are still offering them. But the section of shekels applies only when the Temple stands. He said: After I die, and the Temple is destined to be destroyed, I am not remembered. He replied: By your life! Since remembrance of the shekels remains through reading about them every year ... 'Ki tissa' is future tense: his name will forever be remembered in this section. (Gevul Binyamin.)" Anaf Yosef expressly cites Gevul Binyamin for this explanation. Rav Tzadok next challenges the explanation with other time-bound sections, then develops his own account of Moses restoring Israel's crowns.

[146] **Gevul Binyamin, I, derush 54, 104a** — "Elijah is the one who offers sacrifices in the Temple even in its ruined state, for the world cannot be without sacrifices. He has money from the withdrawal of the Temple treasury that was concealed for this purpose. Concerning this we learned: 'I heard that sacrifices may be offered even though there is no Temple building'; Maimonides likewise ruled this in chapter six of the Laws of the Chosen House. The shekels,

ten sefiros, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא **as they said in the Raaya Mehemna,** רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא **at the beginning of Parshas Ki Sisa,** [חֵלֶק ב׳ קפז, ב] **(II 187b),** שֶׁהוּא רוֹמֵז לִשְׁלֵימוּת **that it alludes to the completeness** כָּלַל הַקּוֹמָה כּוּלָּהּ[147] **of the entire stature;** וְאוֹת הַיּוּד רוֹמֵז לְחָכְמָה **and the letter yud alludes to Chochmah,** [זֹהַר חֵלֶק כַּיָּדוּעַ[148] ב׳ קכג, ב] **as is known (Zohar II 123b),** וְרָמוּז גַּם כֵּן בְּרַשִׁ״י **and it is also alluded to in Rashi** עַל פָּסוּק אָז יָשִׁיר **on the verse "Then Moshe sang,"** [שְׁמוֹת טו, א] **(Shemos 15:1),** דְּיוּד עַל שֵׁם הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה.[149] **that the yud is on account of thought.** וְהוּא הַתְחָלַת הַהִתְגַּלּוּת **And it is the beginning of revelation,** מֵאַיִן לְיֵשׁ **from nothing to something;** וְהוּא הַנְּשָׁמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ **and it is the soul in the brain,** דְּטָהוֹרָה הִיא: **which "is pure."** עַד כָּאן מִכְּתַב יַד קָדְשׁוֹ **Until here from his holy manuscript.**

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however, apply only while the Temple stands, as we learned at the end of tractate Shekalim. Moses therefore expressed no concern about the passage of the sacrifices, since they are still being offered. But concerning the passage of the shekels, which apply only while the Temple stands, he said: 'Once I die, and the Temple is destined to be destroyed, I will not be remembered.' God answered him: 'By your life!' The shekels still have a remembrance through the annual reading at that very season, on the Sabbath before the first of Adar. Thus 'when you shall lift up' uses the future tense: his name will always be remembered through this passage. It therefore says 'to atone for your souls,' since he too is included among Israel and remembered in this passage." Gevul Binyamin states this as the premise of his homiletical explanation. His references to Mishnah Eduyos 8:6 and Maimonides concern the permissibility of sacrifices without a standing Temple building; they do not independently attest Elijah's activity. Rav Tzaddik next questions and develops the premise.

[147] **Horayot 12a** — "When the Ark was hidden away, the anointing oil was hidden away with it, together with the jar of manna, Aharon's staff with its almonds and blossoms, and the chest that the Philistines sent as a gift to the God of Israel. Who hid it away? Yoshiyahu king of Yehudah hid it away." The preceding folio, 11b, teaches that Moshe's oil endures for the future. Its concealment by Yoshiyahu is stated on 12a; the two details should be distinguished.

[148] **Etz Yosef, Tanchuma, Ki Sisa §3** — "'After I die I am not remembered': for the shekels apply only while the Temple stands, as is explicitly stated at the end of tractate Shekalim. See Anaf [Yosef]. ... The future tense means that his name will forever be remembered through the reading of this section; thus the text should read." This is the precise interpretation Rav Tzadok questions. He reads 'after I die' as referring to Moses's death immediately, rather than to the later destruction of the Temple.

[149] **Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos 8** — "Every Friday night Moshe again receives the thousand portions that he lost, taking them as the additional sanctity of Shabbos. He then returns Israel's crowns to them, and from these crowns Israel inherits the additional sanctity of Shabbos each Friday. This is the meaning of Moshe rejoicing in the gift of his portion: on Shabbos the portion taken from him is given back to him as a gift, and he rejoices in what has been restored."

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ב׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Bais

בַּגְּמָרָא (מְגִילָּה כט, א) **In the Gemara (Megillah 29a)** תְּנַן הָתָם **we learned there:** בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר מַשְׁמִיעִין עַל הַשְּׁקָלִים וְקָרְיִנַן בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר **"On the first of Adar they announce concerning the shekalim, etc." And we read it on the first of Adar** כִּי הֵיכִי דְּלֵיתוּ שְׁקָלִים לְמִקְדָּשׁ[150] **so that they should bring shekalim to the Mikdash.** מִלְּשׁוֹן הַגְּמָרָא הָיָה נִרְאֶה **From the Gemara's wording it would appear** דְּהָא דְּתָנַן מַשְׁמִיעִין עַל הַשְּׁקָלִים **that what we learned, "they announce concerning the shekalim,"** הַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **means through the reading of the parshah,** וְאַף שֶׁמַּקְדִּימִין בַּשַּׁבָּת שְׁלִפְנֵי רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **and although they read it earlier, on the Shabbos before Rosh Chodesh Adar,** כְּשֶׁחָל בְּתוֹךְ הַשַּׁבָּת רַק בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר **when it falls in the middle of the week, the first of Adar is merely the latest time.** אֲבָל מִלְּשׁוֹן רַשׁ״י [שָׁם דִּבּוּר הַזְּמַן הַמְּאֻחָר **But from Rashi's wording** הַמַּתְחִיל מַשְׁמִיעִין] **(ibid., s.v. Mashmi'in),** מַשְׁמִיעִין בְּהַכְרָזַת בֵּית דִּין[151] **"they announce" means by proclamation of the beis din,** וְכֵן כָּתַב רַבֵּנוּ עוֹבַדְיָה מִבַּרְטְנוּרָא [פֶּרֶק א מִשְׁנָה א] בִּשְׁקָלִים **and so wrote the Bartenura in Shekalim (chapter 1, mishnah 1):** בֵּית דִּין שׁוֹלְחִין **the beis din sends** בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמַכְרִיזִין[152] **throughout all of Israel and proclaims;** וְכֵן הָרַמְבַּ״ם בְּהִלְכוֹת שְׁקָלִים (פֶּרֶק א׳ הֲלָכָה ט׳) **and likewise the Rambam, in Hilchos Shekalim (chapter 1, halachah 9),** הֵבִיא דִּין דְּמַשְׁמִיעִין עַל הַשְּׁקָלִים[153] **brought the law that they announce concerning the shekalim,** וּבְהִלְכוֹת תְּפִלָּה (פֶּרֶק י״ג הֲלָכָה כ׳) הֵבִיא דִּין **and in Hilchos Tefillah (chapter 13, halachah 20)** קְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **he brought the law of reading Parshas Shekalim.** מִבֹּאָר דְּהֵם שְׁנֵי עִנְיָנִים[154] **It is clear that these are two separate matters,** וְצָרִיךְ לְהָבִין טַעַם קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **and we must understand the reason for reading the parshah.** וְאִם נֹאמַר שֶׁבִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **And if we say that nowadays,** שֶׁאֵין שְׁקָלִים וּמִקְדָּשׁ **when there are no shekalim and no Mikdash,** קוֹרִין פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **we read Parshas Shekalim** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁקּוֹרִין פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **in the same way that we read the sections of the korbanos,** עַל שֵׁם וּנְשַׁלְּמָה פָרִים שְׂפָתֵינוּ[155] **on account of "And we will render for bulls the offering of our lips,"** לֹא יוּבַן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **then what they said in the**

[150] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tisa 10** — "Because they sinned at six hours, at the middle of the day, they shall give a half-shekel, which is six grammesin. Rabbi Yochanan said: Because they transgressed the Ten Commandments, each person shall therefore give ten gerah, which is a half-shekel." The Midrash links the half-shekel with the sin of the Calf through two numerical explanations. The second also underlies the ten-gerah symbolism developed in Maamar 4.

[151] **Kiddushin 40a** — "A good intention is joined to an action. ... What does for those who contemplate His name mean? Rav Assi said: Even if a person intended to perform a commandment but was prevented by circumstances and did not perform it, Scripture credits him as though he had performed it." The source concerns credit for a sincere intention frustrated by circumstances. Rav Tzadok applies it to Israel's yearning to offer sacrifices and give shekalim when the Temple service is unavailable.

[152] **Pesikta Rabbati 10** — "When David saw that through this they had atonement, he began saying: Come and see the wonders of the Holy One, blessed be He, and His works: through the very thing with which they angered Him, He provided atonement for them. For God judges: this He lowers and this He raises. This that lowered Israel to the pit of destruction was This is your god; and this that raises Israel, lifting their horn, is This they shall give." Rav Tzadok explains the repeated demonstrative this as something vividly present to the heart; he does not treat the exposition as a formal legal gezerah shavah.

[153] **Megillah 15b** — "And all this is worth nothing to me teaches that all the treasures of that wicked man were engraved upon his heart. Whenever he saw Mordechai sitting at the king's gate, he said: All this is worth nothing to me." The Gemara describes Haman's wealth as inwardly present to him. Rav Tzadok draws from the wording a general explanation of the demonstrative this; he does not endorse Haman's attachment to wealth.

[154] **Pesikta Rabbati 16, exposition of "They shall give a ransom for their souls"** — "Rabbi Yehudah bar Simon said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: Moses heard three things from the Almighty and was alarmed and recoiled. ... When they sinned, and it was said, 'Each shall give a ransom for his soul,' Moses said: Master of the worlds, who can give the ransom of his soul? 'A man cannot redeem his brother; he cannot give God his ransom; the redemption of their souls is costly.' The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: It is not as you suppose; rather, 'This they shall give'—they shall give something like this. Rabbi Meir said: The Holy One, blessed be He, brought out something like a coin of fire from beneath the Throne of Glory, showed it to Moses, and said to him: 'This they shall give'—they shall give something like this." The requested chapter contains the fiery coin and the seemingly impossible ransom. The detailed alternative monetary amounts cited here belong to the Tanchuma versions. The digital witness presents chapter 16 as a single text, so the manuscript's subsection 7 has not been separately collated.

[155] **Bamidbar Rabbah 12:3** — "When the Holy One, blessed be He, said: Each shall give a ransom for his soul, Moshe said: Who could give the ransom of his soul? ... Rabbi Meir said: The Holy One, blessed be He, took something like a coin of fire from beneath the Throne of Glory and showed it to Moshe: This they shall give; like this they shall give." The fiery coin is the Midrash's image. Rav Tzadok interprets its fire as the love and generosity accompanying the gift, rather than as the value of the metal.

Gemara cannot be understood: וְקָרִינַן בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר **"And we read it on the first of Adar** כִּי הֵיכִי דְּלֵיתוּ שְׁקָלִים לְמִקְדָּשׁ **so that they should bring shekalim to the Mikdash,"** שֶׁמְּפוֹרָשׁ דְּתַקָּנַת קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **which states explicitly that the enactment of reading the parshah** הָיָה אַף בִּזְמַן **was in force even at the time** שֶׁהָיָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּם **when the Beis HaMikdash was standing.** וְלָמָּה קָרְאוּ אָז **So why did they read it then?** הָא יִשְׁלְחוּ **Surely they would send out messengers** בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר לְהַכְרִיז **on the first of Adar to proclaim it!** אֲךָ הָעִנְיָן עַל פִּי **But the explanation is based on** (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא ג) מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **what they said (Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 3):** וְכֵן מֹשֶׁה לָמַד תּוֹרָה וְכוּ' **"And so Moshe learned Torah, etc.,** וּפָרָשִׁיוֹת שֶׁקּוֹרִין בָּהֶם בְּכָל שַׁבָּת וְכוּ' **and the parshiyos that are read each Shabbos, etc.,** וְהֵם מַזְכִּירִין אוֹתוֹ **and they mention him** בְּכָל פָּרָשָׁה וּפָרָשָׁה **in each and every parshah.** וּבְפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים אָמַר מֹשֶׁה **And at Parshas Shekalim Moshe said:** רִבּוֹנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **'Master of the world,** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא חַיֶּיךָ **The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: 'By your life,** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאַתָּה עוֹמֵד עַכְשָׁיו **just as you stand now** וְנוֹתֵן לָהֶם פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **and give them Parshas Shekalim** וְאַתָּה זוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁן **and lift up their heads,** כָּךְ בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה **so too every single year** שֶׁקּוֹרְאִין אוֹתָהּ לְפָנַי **that they read it before Me,** כְּאִלּוּ אַתָּה עוֹמֵד שָׁם **it is as if you stand there** וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁן וְכוּ' **and lift up their heads,' etc."** וּכְבָר הִקְשׁוּ **And it has already been asked** [עֲנַף יוֹסֵף עַל הַתַּנְחוּמָא שָׁם] **(Anaf Yosef on the Tanchuma, ibid.):** לָמָּה לֹא הִרְגִּישׁ מֹשֶׁה **why did Moshe not sense this** אֶלָּא בִּפְנֵי שֶׁאֵינָם נוֹהֲגִין גַּם כֵּן **which likewise apply** בְּפָרָשִׁיוֹת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **regarding the sections of the korbanos,** הַבַּיִת **only while the Beis HaMikdash stands?** וּמַה שֶּׁתֵּרְצוּ מִסֶּפֶר גְּבוּל בְּנְיָמִין **And as for the answer given from the sefer Gevul Binyamin** [חֵלֶק א דְּרוּשׁ נד **(part 1, derush 54,** לְפָרָשַׁת וַיַּקְהֵל וּשְׁקָלִים עַמּוּד קד] **for Parshas Vayakhel and Shekalim, p. 104),** שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ הַקְדָּמָה נוֹרָאָה **that he has an awesome premise:** שֶׁאֵלְיָהוּ מַקְרִיב קָרְבָּנוֹת בְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה גַּם כֵּן **that Eliyahu offers korbanos in the Beis HaMikdash even nowadays,** וְיֵשׁ לוֹ מָעוֹת מִתְּרוּמַת הַלִּשְׁכָּה **and he has funds from the terumas halishkah** שֶׁגִּנְזוּת לְכָךְ וְכוּ' **that were hidden away for this, etc.,** וְלָכֵן לֹא הִרְגִּישׁ **and therefore he did not sense anything** בְּפָרָשִׁיוֹת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת שֶׁנּוֹהֲגִין לְעוֹלָם **regarding the sections of the korbanos, which apply forever,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן שְׁקָלִים **which is not so with shekalim,** שֶׁבְּטֵלִין אַחַר חוּרְבָּן[156] וְכוּ' **which lapse after the Churban, etc.;** [157]עַיֵּן שָׁם **see there.** וַעֲדַיִן קָשֶׁה **Yet it is still difficult:** הָא יֵשׁ פָּרָשַׁת שָׁמֶן הַמִּשְׁחָה **there is the parshah of the anointing oil,** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה רַק מַה שֶּׁעָשָׂה מֹשֶׁה **of which there was only what Moshe made,** וְזֶה קַיָּם לָעָתִיד **and that endures for the future,** וְשֶׁמֶן הַמִּשְׁחָה נִגְנַז **and the anointing oil was hidden away** בְּסוֹף בַּיִת רִאשׁוֹן[158] **at the end of the First Temple** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב הוֹרָיוֹת יא, ב) **(as stated in Horayos 11b);** וְכֵן יֵשׁ כַּמָּה פָּרָשִׁיוֹת שֶׁלֹּא נָהֲגוּ רַק לְשָׁעָתָם **and likewise there are several parshiyos that applied only for their time, in that generation,** וְלָמָּה לֹא שָׁאַל עֲלֵיהֶם בְּאוֹתוֹ דּוֹר **so why did he not ask about them?** וּבֶאֱמֶת מַה שֶּׁמְּפָרְשִׁים [רְאֵה בְּעֵץ יוֹסֵף עַל הַתַּנְחוּמָא שָׁם] **And in truth, as for what they explain (see Etz Yosef on the Tanchuma, ibid.),** שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁ בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **that he sensed regarding Parshas Shekalim** שֶׁיִּבָּטֵל אַחַר הַחוּרְבָּן[159] **that it would lapse after the Churban—** מִלְּשׁוֹן הַמִּדְרָשׁ **from the Midrash's wording,**

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[156] **Song of Songs 8:6-7** — "Set me as a seal upon your heart, as a seal upon your arm, for love is strong as death, jealousy fierce as the grave; its flashes are flashes of fire, a mighty flame. Many waters cannot extinguish love, nor can rivers sweep it away. If a man offered all the wealth of his house for love, he would be utterly scorned." The verses join the seal upon the heart, fire, love, and the inability of wealth to buy love. These images explain why the small monetary gift can express an inward devotion greater than its price.

[157] **Zohar, Terumah 14** — "The mystery of Shabbos is Shabbos united in the mystery of one, so that the mystery of one may rest upon her. The prayer of Shabbos eve is offered when the precious holy Throne has been united in the mystery of one and has been prepared so that the supernal Holy King may rest upon it." This is the Shabbos passage also recited as Kegavna. Rav Tzadok draws its image of a throne prepared through unity into his explanation of the coin taken from beneath the Throne of Glory.

[158] **Exodus 30:13-15** — "This they shall give, everyone who passes among those counted: half a shekel by the sacred shekel; the shekel is twenty gerah. Half a shekel is an offering to Hashem. ... The rich shall not give more and the poor shall not give less than half a shekel when giving Hashem's offering to atone for your lives." The first and third verses are quoted here, with the intervening verse omitted. Rav Tzadok develops the ten gerah of the half-shekel and the equal obligation of rich and poor.

[159] **Zohar Chadash, Ki Sisa, beginning Davar acher zeh yitnu** — "Another interpretation of This they shall give: How carefully people must guard their ways! When that righteous one was sold, all ten levels shut off their lights, for the illumination of the Ancient One flows for the benefit of the earth only through him. ... Therefore the ten gerah that restore him to his place are a ransom for the soul. They shine upon the place called soul from the place called Israel; heaven shines upon this earth and gives her all her adornments, so that she may be joined above." The passage connects the sale of the righteous one with the darkening of the ten levels and their repair through the ten gerah. The

מִשְׁמַע שֶׁשָּׁאַל עַל אַחַר פְּטִירָתוֹ תֵּיכָף **"once I die, I am no longer mentioned,"** מִשֶּׁאֲנִי מֵת אֵין אֲנִי נִזְכָּר **it implies that he asked about the time right after his passing,** וְאָז הָיָה עוֹד מִשְׁכָּן שִׁילֹה **and then there was still to come the Mishkan of Shiloh,** וּבֵית עוֹלָמִים וּבַיִת שֵׁנִי **and the Eternal House, and the Second Temple—** יוֹתֵר מִשְּׁתֵּים שְׁבְּוַדַּאי לֹא שָׁאַל **more than twelve hundred years. Rather, the intent here is** אַךְ הַמְּכוּוָן בָּזֶה **that he certainly did not ask** עַל שׁוּם פָּרָשָׁה שֶׁאֵינָהּ נוֹהֶגֶת **about any parshah that is no longer in practice,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַקְּרִיאָה הוּא **since in any case the reading of it is** וּנְשַׁלְּמָה פָרִים שְׂפָתֵינוּ **"And we will render for bulls the offering of our lips,"** וְשִׂפְתוֹתָיו דּוֹבְבוֹת **and his lips move in the grave** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁנִּזְכָּר **through his being mentioned.** אַךְ שְׁאֵלָתוֹ עַל פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **Rather, his question concerned Parshas Shekalim,** דְּאִיתָא בְּפִסְיקְתָא רַבָּתִי **for it is brought in Pesikta Rabbasi** (פָּרָשָׁה י סִימָן ו) **(section 10, siman 6):** כֵּינָן שֶׁיָּרַד מֹשֶׁה לִקְרַאת יִשְׂרָאֵל **"When Moshe came down to meet Israel** וְרָאוּ אוֹתוֹ דָּבָר מְעֻלֶּה וּמְשֻׁבָּח **and they saw that excellent and praiseworthy thing"—** הֱיֵינוּ הַקַּרְנֵי הוֹד וְכוּ' **that is, the rays of glory, etc.—** הָיָה רַע עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **"it was distressing to Israel.** אָמְרוּ אֲנַחְנוּ בִּירִידָה וְכוּ' **They said: We are in decline, etc.,** וְאַף אַתָּה מֹשֶׁה הָיִיתָ עִמָּנוּ **and you too, Moshe, were with us,** וְקַרְנֵינוּ שְׁפָלוֹת וְקַרְנָיו שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה זָקוּף **yet Moshe's horns are raised while our horns are lowly.** מִיָּד בָּא מֹשֶׁה **Immediately Moshe came** אֵצֶל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּ' **before the Holy One, blessed be He, etc.** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him:** לֵךְ רוֹמֵם רֹאשָׁם וְכוּ' **Go, raise up their heads, etc.;** אַף אֲנִי אֶזְקוֹף רֹאשָׁם שֶׁל בָּנַי **I too will lift up the heads of My children:** כִּי תִשָּׂא וְגוֹמֵר **'When you lift up,' etc."** וְהֱיֵינוּ דִּכְמוֹ שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ מַחֲזִיר **That is: just as Moshe Rabbeinu restores** בְּכָל שַׁבָּת כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בִּפְרִי עֵץ חַיִּים **every Shabbos the crowns** דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **of Matan Torah to Israel, as written in Pri Etz Chaim** [שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת פֶּרֶק ח] **(Shaar HaShabbos, chapter 8),** בְּפֵירוּשׁ יִשְׂמַח מֹשֶׁה וְכוּ'[160] **in explaining "Yismach Moshe," etc.,** כֵּן בִּשְׁקָלִים כְּשֶׁשּׁוֹקְלִין הַשְּׁקָלִים **so too with shekalim: when they give the shekalim,** אַף שֶׁהוּא בְּחוֹל **even though it is on a weekday,** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, restores the crowns to them,** מַחֲזִיר לָהֶם הַכְּתָרִים וְאָז הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ זוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם **and then Hashem lifts up their heads** עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **through Moshe Rabbeinu.** וְיֵשׁ לְפָרֵשׁ שֶׁזֶּה מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And one may explain that this is what they said** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י, ב) **(Bava Basra 10b):** אָמַר מֹשֶׁה לִפְנֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"Moshe said before the Holy One, blessed be He:** בַּמֶּה תָּרוּם קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל **'Through what will the horn of Israel be raised?'** אָמַר לוֹ בְּכִי תִשָּׂא **He said to him: 'Through "When you lift up."'"** וְאַף שֶׁפֵּירֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י **And although Rashi** [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אָמַר] **(s.v. Amar) explained it as** קַח מֵהֶם כּוֹפֶר לִצְדָקָה **"take from them a ransom for charity,"** מִכָּל מָקוֹם פְּשָׁטֵיהּ קָאֵי עַל הַשְּׁקָלִים **nevertheless its plain sense refers to the shekalim,** וְתָרוּם קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל **and "the horn of Israel will be raised"** מוֹרֶה עַד לְמַעְלָה **indicates up to the very heights,** עַד כָּתֵר עֶלְיוֹן **up to Kesser Elyon,** שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה לְשׁוֹן רָם **for so the term "ram," exalted, indicates** אֲצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **when said of Hashem:** עַד לְמַעְלָה מִתְּפִיסַת בְּנֵי אָדָם[161] **beyond the grasp of human beings.** וְהֱיֵינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **That is: through the shekalim,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁבָּאוּ לְכַפֵּר עַל עֲוֹון הָעֶגֶל[162] **which came to atone for the sin of the Golden Calf—** שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **as they said in the Midrash** (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא י) **(Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 10),** וְכֵן הוּא בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **and so it is in the Yerushalmi** (שְׁקָלִים פֶּרֶק ב הֲלָכָה ג ט, ב) **(Shekalim, chapter 2, halachah 3, 9b)—** וּבְחַטְא הָעֶגֶל פֵּרְקוּם דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **and at the sin of the Calf they stripped off the crowns of Matan Torah,** וְזָכָה מֹשֶׁה וּנְטָלָן לַכְּתָרִים **and Moshe merited and took them,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּשַׁבָּת (פח, א) **as they said in Shabbos (88a);** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנִּיתְקַן הַחֵטְא

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exact digital paragraph is verified; the manuscript's printed folio 45b has not independently been checked against a scan.

[160] **Zohar, Vayikra, discourse 25** — "Ten, ten: why does it say this? Ten for the work of Creation, and ten for the giving of the Torah: ten utterances in the work of Creation and ten utterances at the giving of the Torah. What is this about? The world was created only for the Torah. Whenever Israel occupies itself with Torah, the world endures."

[161] **Sefer Yetzirah 1:4** — "Ten sefirot of restraint: ten and not nine, ten and not eleven. Understand with wisdom and be wise with understanding. Examine them and investigate them; establish the matter clearly, and restore the Creator to His place."

[162] Parallel: **Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 2** — "Every person who possesses daas is as though the Temple were built in his days. The Temple is the place specially set aside for the Divine Presence to dwell. One who possesses daas has attained the quality of daas, which is the inwardness of keser, as is known; this is apprehended through the holy spirit. Then his heart becomes a dwelling for the Divine Presence and is called My holy mountain, and it is as though the Temple were built in his days."

Connection: The same identification of daas as the inwardness of keser explains why spiritual wealth is more than accumulated information: it makes the heart a place for the Divine Presence, even when the physical Temple is absent. This clarifies the inward restoration associated here with the ten gerah.

and since the sin was rectified עַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **through the shekalim,** מַחֲזִיר לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, restores to them** הַכְּתָרִים אַף בְּחוֹל **the crowns even on a weekday,** וּבָזֶה מֵרִים קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל **and thereby he raises the horn of Israel** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א׳) **(as explained in discourse 1).** וְעַל כֵּן שֶׁאָז בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **Therefore he asked at Parshas Shekalim:** כֵּיוָן דְּהָרַמַת קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל **since the raising of Israel's horn** עַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **through the shekalim** צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה[163] **must come through Moshe,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** אָמַר מֹשֶׁאֲנִי מֵת **he said, "once I die"—** וְאַף שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ יִהְיֶה קַיָּם **even though the Beis HaMikdash would still stand** וְיִתְּנוּ שְׁקָלִים **and they would give shekalim,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם אֵינוֹ נִזְכָּר **nevertheless he would not be mentioned,** וּבַמֶּה תָּרוּם קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל **and through what would the horn of Israel be raised?** דְּהָיָה סָבוּר שֶׁיִּבָּטֵל **For he thought that there would cease** הָרַמַת קֶרֶן דְּהַחֲזָרַת הַכְּתָרִים **the raising of the horn by restoring the crowns.** וְאָמַר לוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **And Hashem told him** שֶׁבְּשָׁעַת קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **that at the time of the reading of Parshas Shekalim** בַּשַּׁבָּת שֶׁלְּפָנֵי אֲדָר **on the Shabbos before Adar,** דְּשְׁקָלִים יִהְיֶה לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **it will be before Hashem** כְּאִלּוּ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם עוֹמֵד **as if Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, were standing** וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם **and lifting up their heads.** וּכְשֶׁעָה שֶׁקּוֹרְאִין הַפָּרָשָׁה דְּשְׁקָלִים **And when they read the section of Shekalim** הוּא קְרִיאָה **on its own Shabbos, in Parshas Ki Sisa,** בְּשַׁבַּתּוֹ בְּפָרָשַׁת תִּשָּׂא **it is a reading like any reading of the Torah's parshiyos;** כְּכָל קְרִיאַת פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה רַק כְּשֶׁקּוֹרְאִין הַפָּרָשָׁה **only when they read the parshah** בַּשַּׁבָּת שֶׁלְּפָנֵי אֲדָר **on the Shabbos before Adar** אוֹ בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר **or on the first of Adar** אָז מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ זוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם **does Moshe Rabbeinu then lift up their heads.** שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה נִקְרֵאת תּוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה **For the Torah is called the Torah of Moshe,** שֶׁהוּא הָיָה כּוֹלֵל כָּל נַפְשׁוֹת **since he encompassed all the souls** שִׁשִּׁים רִיבּוֹא **of the six hundred thousand,** שֶׁהֵם אוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה **which are the letters of the Torah;** וּכְשֶׁקּוֹרְאִין הַפָּרָשָׁה **and when they read the parshah,** הָאוֹתִיּוֹת שֶׁהֵם נֶפֶשׁ **its letters, which are the soul** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him—** הוּא כְּאִלּוּ מֹשֶׁה עוֹמֵד **it is as if Moshe were standing** וְזוֹקֵף רֹאשָׁם אָז[164] **and lifting up their heads then,** וּמַחֲזִיר לָהֶם הַכְּתָרִים **and restoring the crowns to them.** רַק בַּשַּׁבָּת הוּא תָּמִיד **Only, on Shabbos he always** מַחֲזִיר הַכְּתָרִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **restores the crowns to Israel;** אֲבָל קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **but the reading of the parshah** בַּשַּׁבָּת שֶׁלְּפָנֵי אֲדָר **on the Shabbos before Adar** אוֹ בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר מוֹעִיל לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **or on the first of Adar benefits Israel,** שֶׁכְּשֶׁיָּבִיאוּ הַשְּׁקָלִים אַחַר כָּךְ בְּחוֹל **so that when they bring the shekalim afterward on a weekday,** אָז גַּם כֵּן יוּחְזַר לָהֶם הַכְּתָרִים **then too the crowns will be restored to them,** דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **the crowns of Matan Torah,** בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁשָּׁקְלוּ שִׁקְלֵיהֶן כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה מַחֲזִיר לָהֶם **just as he used to restore them** בְּשָׁעַת **at the time they gave their shekalim** בְּחַיֵּי מֹשֶׁה **during Moshe's lifetime,** וְהָיָה זוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **and he would lift up their heads, as mentioned above.** וְהִנֵּה הַהַקְדָּמָה הַנּוֹרָאָה **Now, the awesome premise** שֶׁהֵבִיא בְּסֵפֶר גְּבוּל בִּנְיָמִין **cited in the sefer Gevul Binyamin** הִיא מֵהָרַב מְנַחֵם עֲזַרְיָה זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **comes from the Rema MiPano, of blessed memory** (עֲשָׂרָה מַאֲמָרוֹת, מַאֲמַר אֵם כָּל חָי **(Asarah Maamaros, Maamar Em Kol Chai,** חֵלֶק ג׳ סִימָן כג**) part 3, siman 23),** וְלֹא יָדַעְנוּ שׁוֹרְשָׁהּ **and we do not know its source.** אַךְ יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **But one must understand:** בְּשִׁלְמָא הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת שֶׁמַּקְרִיב אֵלִיָּהוּ **granted, the korbanos that Eliyahu offers** מֵהַכְּבָשִׂים שֶׁקּוֹנֶה **from the lambs that he buys** יוּכְלוּ לְהוֹעִיל לְאוֹתוֹ הַדּוֹר **can benefit that generation;** אֲבָל הַשְּׁקָלִים שֶׁנִּגְנְזוּ לְשֵׁם כָּךְ **but the shekalim hidden away for this purpose** מִזְּמַן הַבַּיִת **from the time of the Beis HaMikdash—** מַה יּוֹעִילוּ לְאוֹתוֹ הַדּוֹר **how will they benefit that generation,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁלֹּא שָׁקְלוּ שְׁקָלִים **since they did not give shekalim?** אֲבָל יֵשׁ לוֹמַר **But one may answer,** עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמַרְנוּ **based on what we said** בְּעִנְיַן הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **concerning the korbanos,** שֶׁאָנוּ אוֹמְרִים [תְּפִלַּת מוּסָף] **that we say (Tefillas Mussaf),** וְאֶת מוּסַף פָּלוֹנִי הַזֶּה **"and the mussaf of this such-and-such day** נַעֲשֶׂה וְנַקְרִיב **we shall perform and offer,"** אַף שֶׁאֵין מִקְדָּשׁ **even though there is no Mikdash** וְאִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהַקְרִיבוֹ בְּיוֹמוֹ רַק כֵּיוָן שֶׁהָרָצוֹן וְהַחֶשְׁק **but since the will and the longing are there** לְקַיֵּים וּלְהַקְרִיב **to fulfill it and to offer it,** הַחֶשְׁק הַזֶּה כְּמַעֲשֶׂה[165] **this longing counts as the**

[163] **Nedarim 41a** — "Abaye said: We have received the tradition that there is no poverty except in understanding. In the West they say: One who has this has everything; one who lacks this, what does he have? If he has acquired this, what does he lack? If he has not acquired this, what has he acquired?" The Aramaic this refers to daas. Rav Tzadok uses the saying to distinguish wealth in understanding from wealth in money.

[164] **Proverbs 24:4** — "Through understanding the chambers are filled with every precious and pleasant treasure."

[165] **Pesach Haggadah, Echad Mi Yodea, eleven stanza** — "Who knows eleven? I know eleven: eleven stars, ten commandments, nine months of birth, eight days of circumcision, seven days of the week, six orders of Mishnah, five books of Torah, four mothers, three fathers, two tablets of the covenant; One is our God, in heaven and on earth." The cumulative song explicitly identifies eleven with stars and twelve with the tribes. Rav Tzadok interprets its numerical

deed, (קִידּוּשִׁין מ, א) עַל דָּרְכָּךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said (Kiddushin 40a):** "חָשַׁב אָדָם לַעֲשׂוֹת מִצְוָה **If a person intended to do a mitzvah** וְנֶאֱנַס וְלֹא עֲשָׂאָהּ **and was prevented and did not do it,** מַעֲלֶה עָלָיו הַכָּתוּב **Scripture credits him** כְּאִילּוּ עֲשָׂאָהּ[166] **as if he had done it."** וּבִפְרָט כְּשֶׁאוֹמְרִים פְּסוּקֵי הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **And especially when one recites the verses of the korbanos,** וּנְשַׁלְּמָה פָרִים שְׂפָתֵינוּ "**And we will render for bulls the offering of our lips,**" וַעֲקִימַת פִּיו הָוֵי מַעֲשֶׂה **and the movement of one's mouth constitutes a deed,** וְהוּא כְּאִלּוּ נַעֲשָׂה **and it is as if it were done.** וְכֵן בִּקְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **So too with the reading of Parshas Shekalim:** וְכָל יִשׂ לוֹ חֵשֶׁק וְרָצוֹן **every single Jew has a longing and a will** לְקַיֵּים בְּפוֹעַל **to fulfill it in actual practice,** וְאִם הָיָה מִקְדָּשׁ **and if there were a Mikdash,** בְּוַדַּאי הָיָה כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **certainly every single Jew would** מוֹצִיא כַּמָּה הוֹצָאוֹת **go to great expense** שֶׁיָּבֹא שִׁקְלוֹ לִירוּשָׁלַיִם **so that his shekel would reach Yerushalayim;** מִזֶּה הַחֵשֶׁק נַעֲשֶׂה שְׁקָלִים מַמָּשׁ[167] **from this longing actual shekalim are made.** וַהֲרֵי מָצִינוּ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה נב, ג) **And indeed we find (Shemos Rabbah 52:3)** בְּרַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן בֶּן יוֹחַאי שֶׁאָמַר **regarding Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai, who said,** הִתְחִילָה מוֹשֶׁכֶת דִּינָרֵי זָהָב בְּקָעָה הִתְמַלְּאִי דִּינָרֵי זָהָב **"Valley, fill up with golden dinars,"** וְהִתְחִילָה לְפָנֵיהֶם **and it began to pour forth golden dinars before them;** עַיִן שָׁם **see there.** כָּל שֶׁכֵּן שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יָכוֹל **All the more so can Hashem make something** לַעֲשׂוֹת מֵחֵשֶׁק יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִרְצוֹנָם **out of Israel's longing and their will** לְקַיֵּים מִצְוַת שְׁקָלִים **to fulfill the mitzvah of shekalim,** וְעוֹשֶׂה מִזֶּה שְׁקָלִים מַמָּשׁ **and He makes from it actual shekalim,** וּמִתְמַלֵּא בְּקָעָה שְׁקָלִים **and a valley fills up with shekalim,** וְאֵלְיָהוּ לוֹקֵחַ מֵהֶם **and Eliyahu takes from them** וְעוֹשֶׂה תְּרוּמַת הַלִּשְׁכָּה **and makes the terumas halishkah** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיוּ עוֹשִׂין בִּזְמַן הַבַּיִת **just as they did in the time of the Beis HaMikdash,** וְקוֹנֶה בָּהֶם קָרְבָּנוֹת וּמַקְרִיבָן **and buys korbanos with them and offers them,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַב מִנַּחַם עֲזַרְיָה זְכָרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **as the Rema MiPano, of blessed memory, wrote;** וְנוֹהֵג הַשְּׁקָלִים אַף בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **and so shekalim are in effect even nowadays.** וְאַדְרַבָּה הַחֵשֶׁק בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **On the contrary, the longing nowadays** יוֹתֵר מִמַּה שֶׁהָיָה בִּזְמַן הַבַּיִת כַּנּוֹדָע **is greater than it was in the time of the Beis HaMikdash, as is known,** וּמֵהֶם בָּאִים הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **and from them come the korbanos.** וְעַל זֶה מוֹעִיל קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה דְּשְׁקָלִים **And for this the reading of Parshas Shekalim is effective** אַף בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **even nowadays:** שֶׁכְּשֶׁיִּהְיוּ הַשְּׁקָלִים בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **so that when the shekalim come on Rosh Chodesh Nissan,** אִם יִהְיֶה חָל בְּחוֹל **if it falls on a weekday—** וְאִם חָל בַּשַּׁבָּת **and even if it falls on Shabbos,** הֲלֹא הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת יִקָּנֶה אֵלְיָהוּ בְּחוֹל **surely Eliyahu buys the korbanos on a weekday—** וְיוֹעִיל אָז קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **the reading of the parshah will then be effective** כְּאִלּוּ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם עוֹמֵד **as if Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, were standing** וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם **and lifting up their heads;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוּחְזַר לָהֶם **that is, that the crowns will be restored to them** אַף בְּחוֹל **even on a weekday,** דִּבְשַׁבָּת בְּלֹא זֶה גַּם כֵּן **for on Shabbos, even without this,** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** מַחֲזִיר הַכְּתָרִים **restores the crowns to Israel,** לְיִשְׂרָאֵל וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל מִפְּרִי עֵץ חַיִּים **as cited above from Pri Etz Chaim.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what the Gemara says:** בַּגְּמָרָא "וְכֵיוָן דְּבְנִיסָן וְכוּ' **"And since in Nissan, etc.,** קַדְּמִינַן וְקָרֵינַן בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר **we go ahead and read it on the first of Adar** כִּי הֵיכִי דְּלֵיתוּ שְׁקָלִים לְמִקְדָּשׁ **so that they should bring shekalim to the Mikdash";** וְהַיְינוּ אַף בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה מוֹעִיל **meaning that even nowadays it is effective,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נַעֲשֶׂה מֵהַחֵשֶׁק קוֹדֶם רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **before Rosh Chodesh Nissan,** שְׁקָלִים **so that shekalim are made from the longing** וְיִתְרוֹם מֵהֶן אֵלְיָהוּ **and Eliyahu will separate terumah from them** כְּדֵי לִקְנוֹת קָרְבָּנוֹת **in order to buy korbanos** לְהַקְרִיב מִתְּרוּמָה חֲדָשָׁה **to offer from the new terumah;** וְעַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה מוֹעִיל זֶה **and through the reading of the parshah this is effective,** כְּאִלּוּ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם עוֹמֵד **as if Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, were standing** וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם **and lifting up their heads.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאוֹתִיּוֹת הַתּוֹרָה **That is: the letters of the Torah,** שֶׁהֵם נֶפֶשׁ מֹשֶׁה **which are the soul of Moshe—** הוּא כְּאִילּוּ עוֹמֵד וְזוֹקֵף רֹאשָׁם **it is as if he stands and lifts up their heads,** שֶׁבְּשָׁעַת שֶׁיִּשְׁקְלוּ הַשְּׁקָלִים **so that when they give the shekalim** יָרוּם קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל **the horn of Israel will be raised,** וְיִתָּקֵן פְּגַם הָעֵגֶל **and the blemish of the Calf will be repaired,** שֶׁבְּסִבָּתוֹ פֵּרְקוּ הַכְּתָרִים מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **on account of which they stripped the crowns from Israel;** וְעַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **and through the shekalim** יַחֲזִיר לָהֶם מֹשֶׁה

correspondences through Yosef's dream.

[166] **Genesis 37:9** — "He dreamed another dream and told it to his brothers, saying: I have dreamed another dream; behold, the sun, the moon, and eleven stars were bowing down to me." The eleven stars are the dream's eleven brothers; Yosef stands outside that count. Rav Tzadok connects this with Yosef's particular unity with Yaakov.

[167] **Zohar, Vayeshev, discourse 5** — "These are the generations of Yaakov: Yosef. As has been said, the entire image of Yaakov was present in Yosef, and whatever happened to this one happened to that one; the two proceed as one. This is the mystery of the letter vav, in which the two go together, because they are one mystery and one image."

רַבֵּינוּ הַכְּתָרִים **Moshe Rabbeinu will restore the crowns to them.** וְנִתְקַן הַקְּרִיאָה בַּשַּׁבָּת **And the reading was instituted on Shabbos,** שֶׁהוּא מַתְּנַת חֶלְקוֹ **which is the gift of the portion** דְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** וּמַחֲזִיר אָז הַכְּתָרִים **and he restores the crowns then;** וּמוֹעִיל בַּשַּׁבָּת דְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **and the Shabbos of Parshas Shekalim is effective** שֶׁיּוּחְזַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל הַכְּתָרִים אַף בְּחוֹל **so that the crowns are restored to Israel even on a weekday,** כְּשֶׁיִּהְיוּ נַעֲשִׂים הַשְּׁקָלִים **when the shekalim are made** מֵרְצוֹן וְחֶשֶׁק יִשְׂרָאֵל כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: **from the will and longing of Israel, as mentioned above.**

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ג׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Gimmel

בִּפְסִיקְתָּא (סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה י סִימָן טו) **In the Pesikta (end of section 10, siman 15):** זֶה יַשְׁפִּיל וְזֶה יָרוּם **"This one He lowers and this one He raises:** זֶה שֶׁהִשְׁפִּיל יִשְׂרָאֵל לִבְאֵר שַׁחַת **the 'this' that lowered Israel to the pit of destruction** וְזֶה אֱלֹהֶיךָ **is 'This is your god';** וְזֶה יָרִים **and 'this one He raises,'** שֶׁמְּרוֹמֵם קַרְנָם בָּזֶה **the one that raises their horn by it,** זֶה יִתְּנוּ **is 'This they shall give.'"** אֵין הַפֵּירוּשׁ שֶׁדּוֹרֵשׁ גְּזֵרָה שָׁוָה **The meaning is not that he derives a gezeirah shavah** לְשׁוֹן זֶה[168] **from the word "this";** רַק הַמְכוּוָן **rather, the intent is** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as we have said several times,** דִּלְשׁוֹן זֶה מוֹרֶה **that the word "this" indicates** שֶׁהַדָּבָר מְפוֹרָשׁ לְנֶגֶד עֵינָיו **that the thing is plainly before one's eyes,** שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַרְאוֹת בְּאֶצְבַּע זֶה[169] **so that one can point with a finger and say "this";** וְכֵן כְּשֶׁחָקוּק בַּלֵּב **and likewise when it is engraved in the heart,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (מְגִילָּה טו, ב) **as they expounded (Megillah 15b)** שֶׁהָיוּ מִלְּשׁוֹן וְכָל זֶה [אֶסְתֵּר ה, יג] **from the words "yet all this" (Esther 5:13)** דְּכֵינָן שֶׁחֲקוּקִים בְּלוּחַ לִבּוֹ עַל לִבּוֹ[170] **engraved upon his heart;** כָּל גְּנָזָיו **that all his treasures were** הוּא כִּמְפוֹרָשׁ לְנֶגֶד עַיִן **since they are engraved on the tablet of his heart, it is as though plainly before the eye,** וְשַׁיָּיךְ לְשׁוֹן זֶה **and the word "this" fits.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ זֶה יַשְׁפִּיל **And this is what they meant by "this one He lowers":** שֶׁבְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל הָעֵגֶל **in that Israel said of the Calf** לְשׁוֹן זֶה אֱלֹהֶיךָ **the words "This is your god,"** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁלֹּא אָמְרוּ **which shows that they did not say it** מִן הַשָּׂפָה וְלַחוּץ לְבַד **merely from the lips outward,** רַק שֶׁלְּפִי שָׁעָה **but that for the moment** הָיָה חָקוּק בַּלֵּב **it was engraved in their heart—** עַל יְדֵי זֶה **through this He lowered them to the pit of destruction.** הִשְׁפִּילָם לִבְאֵר שַׁחַת וְזֶה יָרִים **And "this one He raises":** שֶׁנִּתְתַּקֵּן וְנִתְרוֹמֵם קַרְנָם **their horn was repaired and raised** עַל יְדֵי לְשׁוֹן זֶה יִתְּנוּ **through the words "This they shall give."** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **For in truth one must understand** לָמָּה נִכְתַּב תֵּיבַת זֶה **why the word "this" was written,** וּמַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בִּפְסִיקְתָּא **and what is written in the Pesikta** [רַבָּתִי פָּרָשָׁה טז סִימָן ז] **(Rabbasi, section 16, siman 7),** וְכֵן הוּא בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **and likewise in Midrash Tanchuma** (כִּי תִשָּׂא י יא) **(Ki Sisa 10–11),** שֶׁתָּמַהּ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, wondered,** מִי יָכוֹל לִיתֵּן כּוֹפֶר נַפְשׁוֹ **"Who can give a ransom for his soul?"** וְהָיָה סָבוּר שֶׁהוּא כְּכִכָּר **and he thought it would be like a talent,** אוֹ מֵאָה אוֹ חֲמִשִּׁים **or a hundred or fifty pieces of silver,** כֶּסֶף אוֹ שְׁלֹשִׁים שֶׁקֶל **or thirty shekels;** וְהֶרְאָהוּ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **and Hashem showed him:** זֶה יִתְּנוּ כָּזֶה[171] **"This they shall give—like this."** עֲדַיִן יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Still one must understand:** שֶׁהָיָה דַּי שֶׁהָיָה אוֹמֵר לוֹ **it would have sufficed to tell him** שֶׁיִּתְּנוּ עֲשָׂרָה גֵּרָה **that they should give ten gerah,** וְיֵדַע הַמַּטְבֵּעַ **and he would know the coin;** וְלָמָּה הֶרְאָהוּ **so why did He show it to him?** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **But the explanation is as they said** בְּתַנְחוּמָא שָׁם **in Tanchuma there** (נָשֹׂא יב, ג) וּבְמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **and in Midrash Rabbah (Naso 12:3):** דְּמִין מַטְבֵּעַ שֶׁל אֵשׁ נָטַל מִתַּחַת כִּסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד **"Something like a coin of fire He took from beneath the Throne of Glory** וְהֶרְאָהוּ זֶה יִתְּנוּ[172] **and showed him: 'This they shall give,'"** וּכְעֵין זֶה בִּפְסִיקְתָּא **and similarly**

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[168] **Keritot 6b** — "Rav Chana bar Bizna said in the name of Rabbi Shimon Chasida: Any fast that does not include some of the transgressors of Israel is not a fast, for galbanum has a foul smell, yet Scripture counted it among the ingredients of the incense." The source requires the inclusion of sinners in the communal fast, just as galbanum belongs in the incense mixture. Rav Tzadok develops its inclusion into the eventual transformation of the evil smell itself.

[169] **Eruvin 21b** — "The good figs are the completely righteous; the bad figs are the completely wicked. Lest you say their hope is lost and their prospect has ceased, Scripture says: The mandrakes have given fragrance; both these and those are destined to give fragrance." The Gemara explicitly preserves hope for those described as completely wicked. Rav Tzadok applies that future fragrance to the galbanum and to the lowest tribe.

[170] **Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10** — "The Sages say: The tribe of Dan, which the cloud expelled, were all worshippers of idols, as it is said: You were weary and exhausted, and did not fear God." This is one of the Midrash's explanations of those left behind whom Amalek attacked. Rav Tzadok cites it to establish the severity of Dan's condition before arguing that even this lowliness is ultimately repairable.

[171] **Sanhedrin 90a** — "All Israel has a share in the World to Come, as it is said: Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever, the branch of My planting, the work of My hands, in which to glory. These are the ones who have no share in the World to Come: one who says that resurrection of the dead is not taught in the Torah, that Torah is not from Heaven, and an apostate." The Mishnah states both the general promise and specified exclusions. Rav Tzadok's subsequent discussion concerns the ultimate repair of those whom the cited sources treat as excluded; it does not erase the Mishnah's distinctions.

[172] **Judges 18:30-31** — "The children of Dan set up the carved image for themselves. Yonasan son of Gershom, son of Menasheh, and his sons were priests to the tribe of Dan until the day the land went into exile. They established for themselves the carved image that Michah had made, throughout the time the house of God was in Shiloh." The biblical account explicitly joins the tribe of Dan to Michah's image and places its worship alongside the sanctuary at

in the Pesikta [פָּרָשָׁה י סִימָן יב] **(section 10, siman 12).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁתָּמַהּ **That is: he wondered** אֵיךְ יוֹעִיל פִּדְיוֹן כֶּסֶף **how a redemption of money could help,** שֶׁהוּא גַּשְׁמִי **since it is physical;** וְהָרְאָהוּ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **and Hashem showed him** כְּמִין מַטְבֵּעַ שֶׁל אֵשׁ **something like a coin of fire,** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַמְכוּוָּן **meaning that what is intended** רַק עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the manner of what is written** [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ח, ו] **(Shir HaShirim 8:6),** רִשְׁפֶּיהָ רִשְׁפֵּי אֵשׁ וְגוֹמֵר **"Its flashes are flashes of fire, etc.;** מַיִם וְגוֹמֵר הָאַהֲבָה[173] **many waters, etc.," said of love.** וּלְעִנְיַן זֶה **And for this purpose** אֵין כְּמַחֲצִית **no fixed sum is needed;** וְאַדְרַבָּה לְהֵפֶךְ מַטְבֵּעַ קָטָן **on the contrary, a small coin suffices,** צָרִיךְ סַךְ מְסוּיָם **such as the half-shekel,** הַשָּׁקֶל וְאַף לְעָשִׁיר גָּדוֹל **even for a very wealthy man.** שֶׁכָּל שֶׁהוּא קָטָן יוֹתֵר **For the smaller it is,** שֶׁזָּכָה שֶׁיְקַבֵּל מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים **the greater the love and the longing,** יְגִדַּל הָאַהֲבָה וְהַחֵשֶׁק **that he merited that the King of kings would accept** מַתָּנָה קְטַנָּה מִמֶּנּוּ **a small gift from him,** וְזֶה חָשׁוּב יוֹתֵר **and this is more precious.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ מִתַּחַת כִּסֵּא הַכָּבוֹד **And this is why they said "from beneath the Throne of Glory":** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָאַהֲבָה **for through love** נַעֲשָׂה הַיִּחוּד **the union is brought about** בֵּין קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְיִשְׂרָאֵל[174] **between the Holy One, blessed be He, and Israel,** עַל דְּאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קלה, ב) **as they said (Zohar II, 135b):** דְּהָא אִתְאַחֲדַת **"for there is united** כָּרְסְיָא יְקִירָא קַדִּישָׁא **the precious holy Throne** בְּרַעֲוָא דְּאֶחָד וְכוּלֵי[175] **in the mystery of One," etc.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן זֶה יִתְּנוּ **And this is the meaning of "This they shall give":** שֶׁעִיקַּר שֶׁיִּתְּנוּ הַחֵשֶׁק וְהָאַהֲבָה **that the main thing is that they give the longing and the love,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה חָקוּק אַהֲבַת ה׳ **that the love of Hashem be engraved** עַל לוּחַ לִבָּם **upon the tablet of their heart,** עַד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְפוֹרָשׁ לָעַיִן **until it is plain to the eye,** כְּמוֹרֶה בְּאֶצְבַּע **as though pointed to with a finger.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ וְזֶה יָרִים **And this is what they meant by "and this one He raises":** שֶׁרוֹמֵם קַרְנָם בָּזֶה **that He raised their horn through "this,"** הַיְינוּ בְּהַנְּדִיבוּת וְהָאַהֲבָה לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **that is, through the generosity and love for Hashem** שֶׁהָיָה חָקוּק עַל לוּחַ לִבָּם **that was engraved on the tablet of their heart.** וְעִנְיַן הָאַהֲבָה וְהַחֵשֶׁק **And this love and longing** הוּא בְּיוֹתֵר בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **is at its greatest nowadays,** שֶׁאֵין אָנוּ יְכוֹלִים **when we are unable** לְקַיֵּים מִצְוַת שְׁקָלִים בְּפוֹעַל **to fulfill the mitzvah of shekalim in practice,** וּמִשְׁתּוֹקֵק כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל לְקַיְּמָהּ **and every single Jew yearns to fulfill it;** וְאִם הָיָה אָפְשָׁר לְקַיְּמָהּ **and if it were possible to fulfill it,** הָיָה כָּל אֶחָד מוֹצִיא זֶה הוֹצָאָה רַבָּה עַל **each one would spend a great sum on it** שֶׁיָּבֹא שִׁקְלוֹ לַמִּקְדָּשׁ **so that his shekel would reach the Mikdash;** וּמִזֶּה הַחֵשֶׁק נַעֲשָׂה שְׁקָלִים מַמָּשׁ **and from this longing actual shekalim are made,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ (מַאֲמָר ב׳) **as we said (discourse 2),** וְיָרִים קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל׃ **and it raises the horn of Israel.**

Shiloh.

[173] **Tanna Debei Eliyahu Rabbah 26** — "I am Hashem your God teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, looked through the entire world, from its beginning to its end, and foresaw ten people who rebelled against Him. ... Against I am Hashem your God, Michah rebelled; against You shall have no other gods, Yeravam rebelled." The chapter arranges ten rebels against the Ten Commandments. Rav Tzadok focuses on Michah's position at the root represented by the first commandment.

[174] **Sanhedrin 103b** — "And trouble shall pass through the sea: Rabbi Yochanan said, This is the idol of Michah. It was taught: Rabbi Nasan says, From Garev to Shiloh is three mil, and the smoke of the altar and the smoke of Michah's idol would mingle with one another." Rav Tzadok understands the passage through the sea as the carrying of the silver later used for Michah's idol. The identification of the carried substance as silver is his explanatory reading, not an explicit statement in these words of the Gemara.

[175] **Rashi, Sanhedrin 101b, s.v. Nismachmech babinyan** — "He was crushed into the building: in Egypt they put him into the building in place of a brick. As explained in the aggadah, Moshe said to the Holy One, blessed be He: You have harmed this people, for now, if they lack bricks, they place Israel's children in the building. He told him: They are destroying thorns, for it is revealed before Me that if these children lived they would be utterly wicked. If you wish, test it and take one of them out. He went and took out Michah." Rashi records this as his first explanation and then offers another: Michah became impoverished through work in building. Rav Tzadok follows the first explanation.

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ד׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Daled

וְאִיתָא בְּזֹהַר חָדָשׁ **And it is brought in the Zohar Chadash,** פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא (מה, ב) **Parshas Ki Sisa (45b),** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל דָּבָר אַחֵר **in the passage beginning "Another explanation: This":** וְעַל דָּא עֲשַׂר גֵּרָה **"And for this reason, ten gerah,** דְּאַהְדַּר לְאַתְרֵיהּ וְכוּ׳ **which returned to its place, etc.";** עַיֵּין שָׁם[177] **see there.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמְּקוֹדָם אָמַר **That is: earlier it said** דְּכֻלְּהוּ עֶשֶׂר דַּרְגִּין **that all ten levels** אִסְתַּיְמוּ נְהוֹרַיְיהוּ וְכוּ׳ **had their lights concealed, etc.,** וְעַל יְדֵי הַמַּחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל **and through the half-shekel,** שֶׁהוּא עֲשָׂרָה גֵּרָה **which is ten gerah,** הַאִירוּ כָּל הָעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **all the ten sefiros shone** עַד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **up to Kesser Elyon.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים **that is, Yisrael are bound** בְּשֹׁרֶשׁ בְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה, **at the root, in the very beginning of Thought;** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ [מַאֲמָרִים א-ב] **and this is as we said (Maamarim 1–2),** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מִצְוַת שְׁקָלִים **that through the mitzvah of shekalim** זוֹכִין יִשְׂרָאֵל **Klal Yisrael merit** שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** מַחֲזִיר לָהֶם **returns to them** הַכְּתָרִים דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה. **the crowns of Mattan Torah.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **This is what they said in the Yerushalmi** (שְׁקָלִים פֶּרֶק ב׳ הֲלָכָה ג׳ ט, ב) **(Shekalim 2:3, 9b)** וּבְתַנְחוּמָא (כִּי תִשָּׂא י) **and in the Tanchuma (Ki Sisa 10):** עַל שֶׁעָבְרוּ עֲשֶׂרֶת הַדִּבְּרוֹת **"Because they transgressed the Ten Commandments,** יִתֵּן כָּל אֶחָד עֲשָׂרָה גֵּרָה **let each one give ten gerah, etc." —** דְּהַכֹּל אֶחָד **for it is all one,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג׳ יא, ב) **(vol. 3, 11b):** עֲשָׂרָה מַאֲמָרוֹת בְּמַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית **"Ten utterances in the work of Creation** וַעֲשָׂרָה מַאֲמָרוֹת בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה וְכוּ׳[178] **and ten utterances at Mattan Torah, etc."** וַעֲשָׂרָה מַאֲמָרוֹת דְּמַעֲשֶׂה בְרֵאשִׁית **And the ten utterances of Creation** הֵם עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת כַּיָּדוּעַ. **are the ten sefiros, as is known.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּהָעֲשָׂרָה גֵּרָה **So the ten gerah** נֶגֶד עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **correspond to the ten sefiros** דְּאִסְתַּיְמוּ נְהוֹרַיְיהוּ **whose lights were concealed,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּזֹהַר חָדָשׁ. **as they said in the Zohar Chadash.** וּבְרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא **And in the Ra'aya Mehemna** (זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ כִּי תִשָּׂא קפז, ב) **(Zohar, Ki Sisa 187b):** הָעָשִׁיר לֹא יַרְבֶּה [שְׁמוֹת שָׁם, טו] **"The rich shall not give more (Shemos ibid. 15) —** דָּא עַמּוּדָא דְּאֶמְצָעִיתָא **this is the Middle Pillar;** לֹא יַרְבֶּה עַל עֶשֶׂר **he shall not exceed ten,** הָכִי אִתְּמַר בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה **as it is said in Sefer Yetzirah:** עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת בְּלִימָה **ten sefiros of nothingness,** עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא אַחַד עָשָׂר **ten and not eleven.** וְהַדַּל לֹא יַמְעִיט [שָׁם] **And the poor shall not give less (ibid.) —** דָּא צַדִּיק **this is Tzaddik;** לֹא יַמְעִיט מֵעֶשֶׂר **he shall not diminish from ten,** כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא תְשַׁע **as it is said: ten and not nine";** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** וְהִנֵּה בְּכָאן מְפָרֵשׁ הָרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא **Now here the Ra'aya Mehemna explains** לְעִנְיַן עֲשִׁירוּת דְּתוֹרָה **"rich" and "poor" certainly as referring to wealth in Torah,** בְּוַדַּאי עָשִׁיר וְדַל מָמוֹן **and not to those wealthy in money,** כֵּיוָן דְּמַיְירֵי בְּעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת. **since it is discussing the ten sefiros.** וְעִנְיַן שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה[179] עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא אַחַד עָשָׂר **"ten and not eleven"** עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא תְשַׁע **And the matter of "ten and not nine,** פֵּרְשׁוּ עַל מִדַּת הַדַּעַת[180] **that is written in Sefer Yetzirah — they explained it as referring to the attribute of**

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[176] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:6; Midrash Tanchuma, Chukas 8** — "Things concealed from you in this world are destined to become visible in the World to Come, like a blind person who comes to see. It is written, 'I shall lead the blind by a way they did not know,' and 'These things I have done, and have not forsaken them.' It does not say, 'I shall do,' but 'I have done'—I have already done this for Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues. Things that were not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues. 'His eye has seen every precious thing'—this refers to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues." Earlier in the same section, the Midrash says that the reason for the red heifer is disclosed to Moshe while remaining a decree to others. Rav Tzadok distinguishes the kinds of disclosure and the portion assigned to each sage.

[177] **Sotah 12a** — "The Sages say: When Moshe was born, the whole house filled with light. Here it is written, She saw that he was good; and there it is written, God saw the light, that it was good." The association of good with light is explicit in the Gemara. Rav Tzadok reads Moshe's original spiritual portion through this image of light preceding encounter with evil.

[178] **Nedarim 22b** — "Rav Adda son of Rabbi Chanina said: Had Israel not sinned, they would have been given only the five books of the Torah and the book of Yehoshua, because it describes the division of the Land of Israel. What is the reason? For with much wisdom comes much vexation." The Gemara also includes the book of Yehoshua; Rav Tzadok abbreviates the quotation while focusing on the Torah's original sufficiency. His explanation of later oral development should be read with that full source context.

[179] **Rosh Hashanah 21b** — "Rav and Shmuel disagreed. One said: Fifty gates of understanding were created in the world, and all were given to Moshe except one, as it is said: You made him a little less than God." The identification of the fiftieth gate particularly with penitents is Rav Tzadok's development here; it is not stated in this sentence of the Gemara.

[180] **Vayikra Rabbah 22:1** — "Scripture, Mishnah, laws, Talmud, supplementary teachings, aggados, and even what an accomplished student will one day say before his teacher: all were said to Moshe at Sinai." Rav Tzadok distinguishes

[176] מַחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל הוּא **Half a shekel is** [רְאֵה שְׁמוֹת ל, יג] עֲשָׂרָה גֵּרָה. **ten gerah (see Shemos 30:13).**

Da'as, שֶׁהוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר.[181] **which is the inner aspect of Kesser.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר וְהָעָשִׁיר **This is what it says: "and the rich" —** הַיְינוּ עָשִׁיר בְּדַעַת **meaning rich in Da'as,** (נְדָרִים מא, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Nedarim 41a):** אֵין עָנִי אֶלָּא בְּדֵיעָה[182] **"None is poor except in knowledge";** וְכֵן לְהֵיפֶךְ **and likewise conversely,** עָשִׁיר הוּא בְּדַעַת **the rich one is rich in knowledge,** [מִשְׁלֵי כד, ד] וּכְעִנְיָן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as in the matter stated (Mishlei 24:4):** וּבְדַעַת חֲדָרִים יִמָּלְאוּ **"And by knowledge are the chambers filled** כָּל הוֹן יָקָר וְנָעִים[183] **with all precious and pleasant wealth."** וּמִי שֶׁהוּא עָשִׁיר בְּדַעַת **And one who is rich in Da'as** הוּא זוֹכֶה לְהוֹן יָקָר וְנָעִים **merits "precious and pleasant wealth,"** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל שָׁלֹשׁ רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת[184] **which alludes to the first three sefiros** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר) **(as explained elsewhere);** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **and about this it is said:** לֹא יַרְבֶּה עַל עֶשֶׂר **"He shall not exceed ten,** כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא אַחַד עָשָׂר. **as it is said: ten and not eleven."** וְהִנֵּה מִנְיַן אֶחָד עָשָׂר **Now regarding the number eleven,** [פִּיּוּט אֶחָד מִי יוֹדֵעַ] אִיתָא **it is brought (the piyut Echad Mi Yode'a):** אֶחָד עָשָׂר מִי יוֹדֵעַ וְכוּלֵי **"Who knows eleven, etc.?** אַחַד עָשָׂר כּוֹכְבַיָּא **Eleven are the stars."**[185] וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **We have already said** שֶׁחַס וְשָׁלוֹם **that it is unthinkable, chas v'shalom,** שֶׁהַפִּזְמוֹן חִדָּה וּדְבָרִים בְּטֵלִים **that the song is a mere riddle and idle words;** רַק הַמְּכוּוָן **rather, the intent is** שֶׁבְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנִּמְצָא מִסְפָּר זֶה **that wherever this number is found,** הַכַּוָּנָה לְמַה שֶׁפֵּרֵט. **the reference is to what it specified.** וְאַחַד עָשָׂר כּוֹכְבַיָּא **Now "eleven stars" —** לֹא מָצִינוּ **we do not find** רַק בַּחֲלוֹם יוֹסֵף **except in Yosef's dream,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית לז, ט][186] וְאַחַד עָשָׂר כּוֹכָבִים וְגוֹמֵר **"and eleven stars, etc." (Bereishis 37:9),** וְהַמְּכוּוָן עַל אַחַד עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים **and the intent is the eleven tribes** לְבַד יוֹסֵף **besides Yosef.** וּמִסְפָּר

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a teaching being disclosed to Moshe from its being given to him as his own particular Torah portion. The Midrash establishes the disclosure; Rav Tzadok supplies that distinction.

[181] **Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 2:3** — "We find everywhere 'a law to Moses from Sinai.' Since it says 'from Sinai,' why was it not written? We have said that this is Moses' Oral Torah, which the blessed God illuminated in Moses' understanding and which he innovated through his dialectical reasoning.... It is called 'a law to Moses from Sinai' because Moses knew explicitly that these teachings were from Sinai, like the entire Written Torah; he transmitted them to Israel as laws without their reasons.... This is what was said of Rabbi Akiva in Menachos 29b: his pupils asked him, 'Rabbi, from where do you derive this?' He answered them, 'It is a law given to Moses at Sinai.' Although the Midrash says, 'Every precious thing his eye has seen'—this refers to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues; things that were not revealed to Moses were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues—and the Gemara likewise says that Moses sat at the end of eight rows and did not understand what they were saying, Rabbi Akiva nevertheless did not attain the reason for the law given to Moses at Sinai: that was Moses our teacher's portion. Thus the Gemara says that Moses' mind was set at rest. From this he saw that his own understanding was higher, and that his portion in the Oral Torah had been attained by no other person. The portion of Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues in the Oral Torah did not belong to Moses, because he had never caused corruption. He did not need the increase of wisdom—the fiftieth gate entrusted to the penitent to repair the increase of vexation." This is the exact self-reference named here. Rav Tzaddik distinguishes Moses' uniquely understood Sinaitic oral teaching from Rabbi Akiva's restorative Oral Torah, associated with the fiftieth gate and repentance.

[182] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:5** — "From the beginning of the creation of the world, the Holy One, blessed be He, foresaw the deeds of the righteous and the deeds of the wicked. 'The earth was unformed and void' — these are the deeds of the wicked. 'God said: Let there be light' — these are the deeds of the righteous. But I do not know which He desires. Since it is written, 'God saw the light, that it was good,' He desires the deeds of the righteous and does not desire the deeds of the wicked." The Midrash itself explicitly distinguishes God's desire for good deeds from His foreknowledge of evil deeds. Rav Tzadok's discussion of the eventual good that emerges from darkness should be read with that distinction intact.

[183] **Ecclesiastes 10:1** — "Dead flies make the perfumer's oil give off a foul odor; a little folly outweighs wisdom and honor." In its plain meaning, a little folly can spoil or outweigh wisdom. Rav Tzadok develops a mystical reading of preciousness beyond wisdom and honor; that exposition should not be mistaken for the verse's straightforward warning.

[184] **Sanhedrin 104b** — "The interpreters of scriptural allusions would say: They all come to the World to Come, as it is said: Gilead is Mine, Menasheh is Mine, Ephraim is the stronghold of My head, Yehudah is My lawgiver. ... Gilead refers to Achav, who fell at Ramas Gilead; Menasheh is understood literally; Ephraim, the stronghold of My head, refers to Yeravam, who came from Ephraim." This aggadic interpretation supplies the restorative reading Rav Tzadok invokes. It should be distinguished from the Mishnah's earlier list of those denied a share.

[185] **Zohar, Tetzaveh, discourse 18** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, reveals deep and concealed things; He reveals all the hidden supernal depths. Why does He reveal them? Because He knows what is in darkness. Were it not for darkness, light would not be known. ... Were it not for darkness, deep and concealed things would not be revealed. And light dwells with Him: what light is this? The light that is revealed from within darkness." The precise Aramaic wording is verified in the original Zohar text. It explains the manifestation of light through what concealed it; the manuscript's adjacent printed-folio references require independent scan collation.

[186] **Psalms 97:11–12** — "Light is sown for the righteous, and joy for the upright of heart. Rejoice, righteous ones, in the Lord, and give thanks in remembrance of His holiness."

וְיֵשׁ מִסְפָּר שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר בְּכָל מָקוֹם **The number twelve, everywhere,** עַל שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים **refers to the twelve tribes,** וְהַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁחָלַם לְבַד יוֹסֵף **besides Yosef,** אַחַד עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים **namely when he dreamt** שֶׁיִּמְלוֹךְ עֲלֵיהֶם **that he would rule over them;** וְאָז נֶחְשָׁב גַּם כֵּן יוֹסֵף **and then Yosef too is considered** בְּחִינַת שֶׁמֶשׁ **in the aspect of the sun,** כְּמוֹ יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **like Yaakov Avinu, alav hashalom,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ קעו, ב) **as they said (Zohar vol. 1, 176b)** דְּיַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף חַד **that Yaakov and Yosef are one,** (וְשָׁם קפב, ב) **(and there, 182b):** וְתַרְוַיְיהוּ כַּחֲדָא אָזְלֵי **"and both of them go together,** וְדָא הוּא רָזָא **and this is the secret** דְּאָת וָאו **of the letter Vav,**[187] דְּאָזְלֵי תַּרְוַיְיהוּ כַּחֲדָא **for both go together."** וְאָז הַמִּסְפָּר אַחַד עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים. **And then the count is eleven tribes.** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ מִסְפָּר אַחַד עָשָׂר **Likewise we find the number eleven** בְּסַמְמָנֵי הַקְּטוֹרֶת **in the spices of the ketores:** וְהַיְינוּ דְּעֶשֶׂר סַמְמָנִים **ten spices** יֵשׁ לָהֶם רֵיחַ טוֹב **have a pleasant fragrance,** וְהֵם כְּנֶגֶד וּמְנָאָה **and they correspond to the ten sefiros,** וְחֶלְבְּנָה רֵיחָהּ רַע **while galbanum has a foul smell,** הַכָּתוּב **yet the verse counted it** בֵּין סַמְמָנֵי הַקְּטוֹרֶת **among the spices of the ketores;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאַף הַחֶלְבְּנָה **that is, even the galbanum** נוֹתֵן רֵיחַ טוֹב **gives a good fragrance**[188] כְּשֶׁהוּא יַחַד עִמָּהֶן **when it is together with them,** וּמְרַמֵּז לְפוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל[189] **and it alludes to the sinners of Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ כְּרֵיתוֹת ו, ב) **(as stated in Kerisus 6b);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעֲתִידִין גַּם כֵּן לִיתֵּן רֵיחַ טוֹב[190] **meaning that they too are destined to give off a good fragrance,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (עירובין כא, ב). **as stated in the Gemara (Eruvin 21b).** וּבַשְּׁבָטִים גַּם כֵּן מָצִינוּ **Among the tribes too we find** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה מ, ד) **(Shemos Rabbah 40:4):** אֵין לְךָ גָּדוֹל מִשֵּׁבֶט יְהוּדָה **"There is none greater than the tribe of Yehudah** וְאֵין לְךָ יָרוּד מִשֵּׁבֶט דָּן וְכוּלֵּי **and none lower than the tribe of Dan, etc."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּשֵׁבֶט יְהוּדָה **That is: from the tribe of Yehudah** יָצָא מִמֶּנּוּ מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד **came forth Mashiach ben David;** וְשֵׁבֶט דָּן אִיתָא **and of the tribe of Dan it is brought** (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא י) **(Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10):** שֵׁבֶט דָּן שֶׁפְּלָטוֹ הֶעָנָן **"The tribe of Dan, which the cloud expelled —** הֲיוּ כּוּלָּם עוֹבְדֵי עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה וְכוּלֵּי[191] **they were all idol worshippers, etc."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁפְּלָטָם הֶעָנָן **That is, the cloud expelled them** חוּץ לְמַחֲנֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל **outside the camp of Yisrael,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה דְּחַס וְשָׁלוֹם **which indicates, chas v'shalom,** אֵין לָהֶם חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **that they have no share in the World to Come,** שֶׁאֵינָם בִּכְלָל **that they are not included in** [סַנְהֶדְרִין צ, א[192]] **"All** כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם וְכוּלֵּי

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[187] **Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 13** — "There is no tribe greater than Yehudah, and none lower than Dan, which descended from the maidservants. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: Let him come and be joined to him, so that he should not grow arrogant, for great and small are equal before the Holy One, blessed be He. ... The Mishkan was made by these two tribes, and the Temple likewise: Shlomo from Yehudah and Chiram from Dan. ... His father was from Naftali and his mother from Dan." The Midrash reads the different tribal descriptions in Kings and Chronicles together. Rav Tzadok uses the partnership to show the equal necessity of the greatest and the lowest contribution.

[188] **Zohar, Balak, discourse 13** — "And its rider will fall backward: this is Serayah, who is destined to come with the Messiah of Ephraim. He will be from the tribe of Dan and will execute vengeance and wage wars against the other nations. When he arises, one then awaits Israel's redemption, as it is written: For Your salvation I have hoped, Hashem." The Zohar explicitly identifies Serayah's companion as the Messiah of Ephraim. Rav Tzadok's wording here refers generally to the messianic partnership of the tribe of Dan.

[189] **Piyyut for Mussaf of Parshas Shekalim, "Eshkol ivvuy," refrain** — "Master, lift the light of Your face upon us. I shall bear a shekel in a house established and exalted. In righteousness, utter the assessment of 'When you take a census.' Shield us with protection, God, high and exalted." The refrain returns before the conclusions of the seven blessings, with its final petition adapted to each blessing. These are the three recurring lines developed throughout this discourse.

[190] **Urim VeTumim, Kitzur Tokfo Kohen §§123–124, end** — "In my view, there is no doubt that everything was set down in writing through Hashem's guidance to them. Later authorities raised many difficulties against them and resolved them with sharp and deep reasoning. Likewise, they included many laws in the sweetness and brevity of their wording. Surely they did not intend all of them, for how would this have been possible given the great labor, the heavenly labor, incumbent upon them? Who could compose a work on the entire Torah, drawn from all the earlier and later authorities, without the labor, the heavenly labor, weighing heavily upon him? Rather, the spirit of Hashem stirred within them so that their language would accord with the halachah without the writer's conscious intention, and Hashem's purpose prospered in their hands." Eybeschütz is discussing the accepted authority of the Shulchan Aruch and Rema. Rav Tzadok extends this reasoning to accepted liturgical poems.

[191] **Zohar III 293a, Idra Zuta 31:1,3** — "This forehead is red as a rose. When the forehead of Atika is revealed in this forehead, it turns white as snow; that hour is called a time of goodwill for all. ... On Shabbat, at the time of the Mincha prayer, so that judgments should not awaken, the Holy Ancient One reveals His forehead. All judgments are subdued and quieted, and are not carried out." The revelation is placed explicitly at Shabbat Mincha. Rav Tzadok relates the third meal to that revelation and reads the piyyut's light of the face through it.

[192] **Shabbat 151b** — "'Before the sun and the light grow dark' — these are the forehead and the nose; 'and the moon' — this is the soul; 'and the stars' — these are the cheeks." The Gemara reads the verse as a description of human aging. Rav Tzadok draws on its association between light and the countenance when interpreting the piyut.

Yisrael have a share, etc." (Sanhedrin 90a). וְהֵם הֵקִימוּ פֶּסֶל מִיכָה **And they set up the idol of Michah** [רְאֵה שׁוֹפְטִים פֶּרֶק יח[193]], **(see Shoftim chapter 18);** (תַּנָּא דְּבֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ רַבָּה פֶּרֶק כו) וְאִיתָא **and it is brought (Tanna d'Vei Eliyahu Rabbah, chapter 26):** אָנֹכִי בָּעַט מִיכָה[194] **"At 'Anochi' Michah kicked"** — וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁבָּעַט בַּשּׁוֹרֶשׁ **meaning he rebelled against the very root;** וַחֲשָׁבוֹ קוֹדֶם יָרָבְעָם **and it listed him before Yeravam,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ [שָׁם]. לֹא יִהְיֶה בָּעַט יָרָבְעָם **of whom they said (ibid.), "At 'Lo yihyeh' Yeravam kicked."** וּמִיכָה בָּעַט עוֹד **And Michah kicked even earlier,** תֵּכֶף בִּיצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם **right at the Exodus from Egypt,** (סַנְהֶדְרִין קג, ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Sanhedrin 103b):** [וְעָבַר בַּיָּם צָרָה זְכַרְיָה י, יא] **"'And trouble passed through the sea' (Zechariah 10:11)** — זֶה פִּסְלוֹ שֶׁל מִיכָה[195] **this is the idol of Michah";** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁהֶעֱבִיר הַכֶּסֶף **that is, he carried across the silver** שֶׁעָשָׂה מִיכָה מִמֶּנּוּ הַפֶּסֶל. **from which Michah made the idol.** וּמִיכָה הוּא שֶׁנִּתְמַכְמֵךְ בַּבִּנְיָן **Michah was the one crushed into the brickwork** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם קא, ב) **(as stated there, 101b),** וְהוֹצִיאוֹ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom, took him out,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשִׁ"י[196] **as Rashi wrote** [שָׁם דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וְלָכֵן נִתְמַכְמֵךְ], **(there, s.v. Nismachmech);** וְהוּא בָּעַט בַּשּׁוֹרֶשׁ אָנֹכִי **and he rebelled against the root, "Anochi."** לְפִיכָךְ נִקְרָא שֵׁבֶט דָּן **Therefore the tribe of Dan is called** יָרוּד שֶׁבְּשִׁבָטִים. **the lowest of the tribes.** וְהֶעָשִׁיר בְּדַעַת **And the one rich in Da'as —** [מִשְׁלֵי כד, ד] וּכְתִיב **as it is written (Mishlei 24:4),** וּבְדַעַת חֲדָרִים יִמָּלְאוּ **"By knowledge are the chambers filled** כָּל הוֹן יָקָר וְנָעִים **with all precious and pleasant wealth"** — [אִיּוֹב כח, י] הוּא מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **this is what is said (Iyov 28:10):** וְכָל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ **"And every precious thing his eye beheld";** וְאִיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **and it is brought in the Midrash** (חֻקַּת רַבָּה יט, ו תַּנְחוּמָא ח) **(Bamidbar Rabbah, Chukas 19:6; Tanchuma, Chukas 8):** זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵרָיו **"This is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues:** דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא נִגְלוּ לְמֹשֶׁה נִגְלוּ לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵרָיו[197] **things that were not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues."** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **That is: Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** לֹא יָדַע כְּלָל מִשּׁוּם רַע **knew nothing at all of evil,** שֶׁכְּשֶׁנּוֹלַד **for when he was born** [סוֹטָה יב, א][198] נִתְמַלְּאָה הַבַּיִת אוֹר; **the house filled with light (Sotah 12a);** וְהוּא הָיָה בְּסוֹד הַדַּעַת **he was in the secret of Da'as,** בְּחִיבּוּר חָכְמָה וּבִינָה **in the joining of Chochmah and Binah;** וְהֵיינוּ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, the Torah she'b'al peh** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהוּא כָּלוּל **as it is contained** בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **within the Torah she'bichsav.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁהִמְצִיא **This is why he originated** הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי **halachah l'Moshe mi'Sinai,** שֶׁזֹּה חֶלְקוֹ **for this was his portion.** וְאִלְמָלֵא הַקְּלָקוּל **Had it not been for the sin,**

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[193] **Shabbat 88b** — "The congregation of Israel said before the Holy One, blessed be He: 'Master of the world, even though my Beloved constricts and embitters my lot, He lodges between my breasts.' 'A cluster of henna is my beloved to me in the vineyards of Ein Gedi' — He to Whom everything belongs atones for the sin of the kid that I gathered to myself." The exposition joins eshkol with "He to Whom all belongs," kofer with atonement, and gedi with the Calf. Rav Tzadok builds his reading of the piyut on these word associations.

[194] **Berakhot 11b** — "But then, concerning 'Who makes peace and creates evil,' do we say it as it is written? Rather, it is written 'evil,' but we say 'everything,' using a more refined expression." The Gemara explains the wording of the blessing preceding Shema. Rav Tzadok treats "everything" as including what is described in the verse as evil, rather than as excluding it.

[195] **Maggid of Mezritch, Ohr Torah (Remazei Torah), Bereishis §7, "Yesh litmoah"** — "One must wonder at what is written in the Torah, 'Behold, very good,' several times in the work of creation, whereas in Deuteronomy it is written, 'See, I have set before you today life and good, death and evil.' Where did evil come from? The meaning, however, is not actual evil as we speak of it. Rather, evil too is good, but it is a lower degree than complete goodness. ... When people act well, evil too becomes good; when they sin, Heaven forbid, it becomes actual evil. For example, a broom is made to clear the house: it is somewhat good, though of a lower degree. But when one must strike a child with it after he sins, the broom becomes wholly evil, and they strike the child with it." The opening asks about Deuteronomy 30:15. Rav Tzadok restates the question through Isaiah 45:7. The digital edition notes that "very good" actually occurs once, qualifying the opening's "several times."

[196] **Shabbat 149b** — "'Even punishing the righteous is not good': 'not good' means evil, as it is written, 'For You are not a God Who desires wickedness; evil shall not dwell with You.' You are righteous, Hashem, and evil shall not dwell in Your dwelling." Rav Tzadok uses the Gemara's identification of "not good" with evil in interpreting the absence of "that it was good" in particular stages of creation.

[197] **Midrash Tanchuma, Vayeshev 4** — "Come and see: When the Holy One, blessed be He, created the world, He created the angel of death from the first day. From where is this known? Rabbi Berechyah said: Because it is written, 'Darkness was upon the face of the deep' — this is the angel of death, who darkens the faces of creatures." This identifies the darkness mentioned at creation with mortality, the particular form of darkness invoked here.

[198] **Bava Batra 16a** — "Reish Lakish said: He is Satan, he is the evil inclination, and he is the Angel of Death. He is Satan, as it is written, 'Satan went out from before Hashem.' He is the evil inclination: there it is written, 'Only evil all day,' and here it is written, 'Only do not stretch out your hand against him.' He is the Angel of Death, as it is written, 'Only preserve his life'—showing that it is in his power."

מַהַתּוֹרָה **his portion in Torah she'b'al peh** לְחֶלְקוֹ בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **each one would have merited** הָיָה כָּל אֶחָד זוֹכֶה אֶלָּא חֲמִשָּׁה **from the Torah she'bichsav,** שֶׁבִּכְתָב דְּלֹא הָיָה נִיתָּן לָהֶם **for nothing would have been given to them** חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה[199] **but the five books of the Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ נְדָרִים כב, ב). **(as stated in Nedarim 22b).** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **Not so Rabbi Akiva,** שֶׁהָיָה בֶּן גֵּרִים **who was a son of converts:** הוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ **he was the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא הָרֹב חָכְמָה **which is the "much wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס[200] **that rectifies the "much anger";** וְהוּא מִשַּׁעַר הַחֲמִשִּׁים **and it is from the fiftieth gate,** שֶׁמְּיוּחָד לְבַעֲלֵי תְּשׁוּבָה **which is reserved for baalei teshuvah** וְלֹא נִיתַּן לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם[201] **and was not given to Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כא, ב) **(as stated in Rosh Hashanah 21b),** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה חֶלְקוֹ **for it was not his portion,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁמַּעוֹלָם לֹא יָדַע מַרָע. **since he never knew of evil.** רַק שֶׁנִּגְלָה לוֹ **Only, there was revealed to him** כָּל מַה שֶּׁתַּלְמִיד וָתִיק **all that a seasoned student** [וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה כב, א] עָתִיד לְחַדֵּשׁ[202], **would in the future innovate (Vayikra Rabbah 22:1),** אֲבָל לֹא נִיתַּן לוֹ **but it was not given to him,** שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה חֵלֶק רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא[203] **for this was the portion of Rabbi Akiva,** שֶׁהָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **who was the root of Torah she'b'al peh.** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ב׳ וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת[204]) **(This was explained in Chanukah, maamar 2, and elsewhere.)** וְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵרָיו **Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues** נִקְרְאוּ גַּם כֵּן עָשִׁיר בְּדַעַת **are likewise called rich in Da'as** — וּבְדַעַת וְגוֹמֵר יִמָּלְאוּ **"By knowledge... are filled** כָּל הוֹן יָקָר **all precious wealth"** — וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר **meaning that it is the inner aspect of Kesser.** וּבְמַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן **And in the first utterance,** שֶׁנֶּאֱגַד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **which corresponds to Kesser Elyon,** הוּזְכַּר הַחֹשֶׁךְ וְתוֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ **darkness and "tohu va'vohu" are mentioned** [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, ב] **(Bereishis 1:2),** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים[205] **which alludes to the deeds of the wicked** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, ב, ה) **(as**

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[199] **Pesachim 54a** — "Rabbi Yosei says: The fire that the Holy One, blessed be He, created on the second day has no extinction forever. Rabbi Benaah son of Rabbi Ulla said: Why was 'that it was good' not said on the second day? Because the fire of Gehinnom was created on it. Rabbi Elazar said: Although 'that it was good' was not said on it, Scripture returned and included it on the sixth day, saying, 'God saw everything that He had made, and behold, it was very good.'" The source explicitly joins the second day's omission to the comprehensive judgment of the sixth day; it supplies the structure of Rav Tzadok's argument here.

[200] **Zohar, Tetzaveh 10** — "Words of Torah become settled only there. There is no light except that which emerges from darkness: when this side is subdued, the Holy One, blessed be He, is raised on high and honored in His glory. There is no service of the Holy One, blessed be He, except from within darkness, and no good except from within evil. When a person enters an evil path and then abandons it, the Holy One, blessed be He, is exalted in His glory. The completion of everything therefore lies in good and evil together, and afterward in ascending through the good; there is no good except that which has emerged from evil. Through this good His glory is exalted, and this is complete service." The passage describes leaving the evil path, not remaining in it. It clarifies how transformed darkness becomes the occasion for a fuller revelation of divine glory. The source is identified by its preserved section coordinate; the manuscript's traditional folio awaits separate collation.

[201] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:7,9–10** — "'Behold, very good'—this is the good inclination; 'and behold, very good'—this is the evil inclination. Is the evil inclination very good? Without the evil inclination a person would not build a house, marry, beget children, or engage in business. ... Rabbi Zeira said: 'Behold, very good'—this is the Garden of Eden; 'and behold, very good'—this is Gehinnom. ... Whoever accumulates commandments and good deeds—there is the Garden of Eden; whoever does not—there is Gehinnom. Rabbi Shmuel bar Yitzchak said: 'Behold, very good'—this is the angel of life; 'and behold, very good'—this is the angel of death. ... Whoever accumulates commandments and good deeds—there is the angel of life; whoever does not—there is the angel of death." These are separate expositions within the same section. They distinguish the role of human conduct while identifying a purpose for forces commonly experienced as evil.

[202] **Shabbat 89b** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: If your sins are like these years that have been arranged and have come from the six days of creation until now, they shall become white as snow." The Gemara expounds shanim as years rather than merely as scarlet. Rav Tzadok relates this wording to the divine ordering of history and to the transformation accomplished by repentance.

[203] **Rashi on Rosh Hashanah 30a** — "If you ask how it could be built on the fifteenth, on the festival, or built at night, when we maintain that the Temple is built neither on a festival nor at night: That applies to a building made by human hands; but the building of the future will be by the hands of Heaven." Rashi offers this distinction in explaining Rabban Yochanan ben Zakkai's concern that the Temple might appear too late for the omer offering to be prepared by midday.

[204] **Zevachim 46b** — "'A pleasing aroma' — for the sake of bringing satisfaction. 'To Hashem' — for the sake of Him Who spoke and the world came into being." The Gemara enumerates the intended purposes of an offering. Rashi explains the satisfaction as that His will was expressed and fulfilled; Rav Tzadok emphasizes the desire to carry out that will.

[205] **Zohar III 160a, Shlach 10:7** — "What do those children of faith say? 'If Hashem desires us, He will give it to us.' Once a person strives toward the Holy One, blessed be He, with the desire of the heart, He asks of us only the heart, and that they guard that holy mark, as it is written, 'Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever.'"

stated in Bereishis Rabbah 2:5). [קֹהֶלֶת י, א] וְזֶהוּ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **This is what is said (Koheles 10:1):** יָקָר מֵחָכְמָה סִכְלוּת[206] מְעַט מִכָּבוֹד **"Weightier than wisdom and honor is a little folly" —** שֶׁמִּמְּרַמֵּז גַּם כֵּן לָזֶה **which also alludes to this:** שֶׁהַחֶלְבְּנָה שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְפוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **that the galbanum, which alludes to the sinners of Yisrael,** יִתֵּן גַּם כֵּן רֵיחַ טוֹב **will also give off a good fragrance,** וְיֵשׁ תַּקָּנָה אַף לְאֵלּוּ **and there is a remedy even for those** שֶׁנֶּחְשְׁבוּ שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם **who were considered as having no** חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **share in the World to Come,** כֵּינָן שֶׁהֵם מִזֶּרַע יַעֲקֹב **since they are of the seed of Yaakov —** וְאַף מִי שֶׁבָּעַט בַּשּׁוֹרֶשׁ **even one who rebelled against the root,** בְּאָנֹכִי וְלֹא יִהְיֶה **against "Anochi" and "Lo yihyeh,"** (קד, ב[207]) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין **as they said in Sanhedrin (104b).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּתְבָּרֵר **That is, it will become clear** שֶׁהַחֹשֶׁךְ הָיָה כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה **that the darkness existed so that there would be** נְהוֹרָא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא **"light that emerges from within darkness,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as it says in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ב׳ קפד, א) **(vol. 2, 184a);** (שָׁם קפז, א) וְאִיתָא **and it is brought (there, 187a):** קֻדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא גָּלֵא **"The Holy One, blessed be He, reveals** עֲמִיקָתָא וּמִסְתַּרְתָּא **the deep and hidden things** דְּכָל עֲמִיקִין **of all depths.** וּמַאי טַעְמָא גַּלֵּי לוֹן **And why does He reveal them?** בְּגִין דְּיָדַע מָה בַּחֲשׁוֹכָא וְכוּלֵּי **Because He knows what is in the darkness, etc.;** דְּאִי לָאו חֲשׁוֹכָא **for were it not for the darkness,** לָא יִתְגַּלְיָין **there would not be revealed** עֲמִיקִין וּמִסְתַּרְתָּן **the depths and the hidden things.** וּנְהוֹרָא עִמֵּיהּ שְׁרֵא **And the light dwells with Him —** דָּא נְהוֹרָא **this is the light** דְּאִתְגַּלְיָיא מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא וְכוּלֵּי[208] **that is revealed from within the darkness, etc."** וְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Yaakov Avinu, alav hashalom,** מְצִדּוֹ לֹא יָדַע קוֹדֶם מְשׁוּם רַע **on his own part knew nothing of evil,** שֶׁהָיָה כְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן **for he was like Adam HaRishon** הַקְלְקוּל **before the sin** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(as explained several times),** וְכָל עֵסֶק שֶׁלּוֹ הָיָה **and his whole endeavor was** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מִטָּתוֹ שְׁלֵימָה **that his bed be complete,** שֶׁלֹּא יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח **that none of his be cast away,** וְאַף הַחֶלְבְּנָה הָרוֹמֵז לְפוֹשְׁעִים יִתֵּן רֵיחַ טוֹב. **and that even the galbanum, alluding to sinners, should give off a good fragrance.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר הֶעָשִׁיר לֹא יַרְבֶּה **This is what it says: "The rich shall not give more —** דָּא עַמּוּדָא דְּאֶמְצָעִיתָא **this is the Middle Pillar";** דְּהַיְינוּ מִי שֶׁהוּא עָשִׁיר בְּדַעַת **meaning one who is rich in Da'as,** כְּיַעֲקֹב מִסִּטְרָא דְּעַמּוּדָא דְּאֶמְצָעִיתָא **like Yaakov, from the side of the Middle Pillar,** וְהִשִּׂיג כָּל הוֹן יָקָר וְנָעִים **and who has attained all precious and pleasant wealth,** יָכוֹל לַחְשׁוֹב **might think** שֶׁיֵּשׁ אַחַד עָשָׂר **that there are eleven —** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁיַּחְשׁוֹב עֲמִיקָתָא וּמִסְתַּרְתָּא בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ **that he would count the deep and hidden on its own,** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן גַּם מִדַּת הַדַּעַת **that is, he would count Kesser Elyon and also the attribute of Da'as.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **About this it said:** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת הַכֹּל אֶחָד **"ten and not eleven," for in truth it is all one** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א׳) **(as explained in maamar 1).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ לֹא יַרְבֶּה עַל עֶשֶׂר **This is what they said: "He shall not exceed ten" —** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת כְּשֶׁיִּתְבָּרֵר הַחֶלְבְּנָה **for in truth, when the galbanum is refined,** הַיָּרוּד שֶׁבַּשְּׁבָטִים **the lowest of the tribes** הוּא אֶחָד עִם הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבַּשְּׁבָטִים **is one with the greatest of the tribes;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאֵינוֹ בִּכְלָל בִּישָׁא כְּלָל **meaning, it is not part of evil at all,** רַק שֶׁהַבִּישָׁא הָיָה **rather the evil existed** כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה טוֹב מְאֹד **so that there would be "very good,"** דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ בִּישָׁא **which emerges from within evil,** דְּלֵית טוֹב אֶלָּא הַהוּא **for there is no good except that** (שָׁם) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. **as they said in the holy Zohar (there).** וְכֵן מִדַּת הַדַּעַת **Likewise the attribute of Da'as** הִיא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר **is the inner aspect of Kesser,** וְהַיְינוּ הַמּוּשָׂג לָאָדָם **namely the**

The source joins inward desire with guarding the holy mark of the covenant. Rav Tzadok applies the value of that desire to a commandment whose outward performance is presently unavailable.

[206] **Sanhedrin 106b** — "Rav Yehudah would remove his shoes and rain would come, whereas we cry out and no attention is paid to us. Rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, desires the heart, as it is written: 'Hashem sees into the heart.'" The contrast concerns the efficacy of prayer despite later scholars' extensive learning. Rav Tzadok invokes it for the value of sincere desire when the sacrificial action is unavailable.

[207] **Zevachim 116b** — "One verse says, 'David gave Ornan for the place six hundred shekels of gold by weight,' while another says, 'David bought the threshing floor and the cattle for fifty shekels of silver.' How can both be maintained? He collected fifty from each tribe, making six hundred. Rebbi said in the name of Abba Yosei ben Dostai: The cattle, wood and place of the altar cost fifty; the entire Temple site cost six hundred." Rav Tzadok follows the first resolution, which makes the purchase a contribution shared by all twelve tribes. The Gemara also preserves a second resolution; its fifty and six hundred refer to different parts of the purchase.

[208] **Zohar II, Bo 39b** — "At first it says, 'He smelled the fragrance of his garments.' When he perceived it, he said, 'See, the fragrance of my son,' knowing that the matter depended upon him, for on his account the fragrance arose: 'like the fragrance of a field that Hashem has blessed.' How did Yitzchak know the fragrance of a field that Hashem had blessed? ... It is written, 'Yitzchak went out to meditate in the field toward evening.' Did he have no house or other place to pray? Rather, that field was the one Avraham bought beside the cave. When Yitzchak entered it, he saw the Shechinah resting upon it, and sublime, holy fragrances arose. He therefore prayed there and established it as his place of prayer."

part graspable by man (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א׳) **(as explained in maamar 1).** וְכֵן הַכֹּל אֶחָד **And likewise it is all one:** עֲמִיקָא וּמִסְתַּרְתָּא וַחֲשׁוֹכָא **the deep, the hidden, and the darkness,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְמַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן **which alludes to the first utterance,** דְּיָשֶׁת חֲשֶׁךְ סִתְרוֹ **"He made darkness His hiding place,"** שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה. **in which there is no grasp whatsoever.** וּנְהוֹרָא עִמֵּהּ שְׁרֵא **"And the light dwells with Him** — דָּא נְהוֹרָא דְּאִתְגְּלְיָיא **this is the light that is revealed** מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא **from within the darkness,"** דְּהַכֹּל אֶחָד **for it is all one;** וְזֶהוּ עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא אַחַד עָשָׂר. **and this is "ten and not eleven."** וְהַדַּל דָּא צַדִּיק **"And the poor — this is Tzaddik":** הַיְינוּ צַדִּיק הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ **meaning a tzaddik who conquers his inclination** וְלֹא קִלְקֵל מֵעוֹלָם **and never sinned,** וְזָכָה לְאוֹר **and merited light,** [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 97:11),** אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק[209] **"Light is sown for the tzaddik";** וְהוּא אֵינוֹ מַשִּׂיג **but he does not attain** בְּחִינַת הַדַּעַת **the level of Da'as** דְּשַׁעַר חֲמִשִּׁים **of the fiftieth gate,** הַמְיוּחָד לְבַעֲלֵי תְּשׁוּבָה. **which is reserved for baalei teshuvah.** וְיָכוֹל לַחְשׁוֹב **And he might think** שֶׁיֵּשׁ רַק תֵּשַׁע סְפִירוֹת **that there are only nine sefiros** שֶׁהֶאֱצִיל ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **which Hashem Yisbarach emanated** לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם **for the creation of the world,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁמִּדַּת כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **since the attribute of Kesser Elyon** הוּא חֶשְׁךְ סִתְרוֹ **"made darkness its hiding place"** וְהוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן **and is hidden from all thought;** וְאָמַר שֶׁאֵינוֹ נֶחְשָׁב **and he would say that it is not counted** בִּכְלַל עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **among the ten sefiros** שֶׁהֶאֱצִיל ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ. **which Hashem Yisbarach emanated.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **About this it says:** וְהַדַּל לֹא יַמְעִיט מֵעֶשֶׂר **"And the poor shall not diminish from ten,** כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא תֵשַׁע **as it is said: ten and not nine"** — דְּזֶה מַכִּירִין **for this they recognize:** שֶׁיֵּשׁ שֵׂכֶל הַנֶּעְלָם **that there is a hidden intellect** שֶׁהוּא מְתֻפְּסַת בְּנֵי אָדָם לְמַעְלָה. **which is above human grasp.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **And through the shekalim,** שֶׁהוּא עֶשְׂרָה גֵּרָה **which are ten gerah,** זוֹכִין יִשְׂרָאֵל **Klal Yisrael merit** שֶׁיּוּחְזַר לָהֶם **that there be returned to them** הַכְּתָרִים דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **the crowns of Mattan Torah,** וְהַיְינוּ כָּל הָעֶשֶׂר **namely all ten lights** עַד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **up to Kesser Elyon,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּזֹהַר חָדָשׁ. **as they said in the Zohar Chadash.** וְכֶתֶר מוֹרֶה כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **A crown denotes a crown of kingship;** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁבְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **and since at Mattan Torah** קָשְׁרוּ הַכְּתָרִים **they tied the crowns** לְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **on each one of Yisrael** — עַל מִי מוֹלֵךְ וּמוֹשֵׁל, **over whom then does one reign and rule?** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת **But in truth** כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **each one of Yisrael** הוּא מְדוּגָּל בְּדָבָר אֶחָד **is distinguished in one thing** עַל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **above all of Yisrael,** וּבְדָבָר זֶה **and in this thing** הוּא בְּחִינַת מֶלֶךְ **he is in the aspect of a king** עַל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **over all of Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א׳) **(as explained in maamar 1).** וְזֶה שֶׁזִּיווֹג ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **This is why Hashem Yisbarach paired,** בְּמַעֲשֵׂה הַמִּשְׁכָּן **in the making of the Mishkan,** הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבַּשְּׁבָטִים **the greatest of the tribes,** שֶׁהוּא יְהוּדָה **which is Yehudah,** שֶׁיָּצָא מִמֶּנּוּ מָשִׁיחַ **from whom Mashiach came forth,** וְהַיָּרוּד שֶׁבַּשְּׁבָטִים **with the lowest of the tribes,** מִשֵּׁבֶט דָּן **from the tribe of Dan,** לְפִי שֶׁהַקָּטָן וְהַגָּדוֹל **because the small and the great** שָׁוִין לִפְנֵי הַמָּקוֹם **are equal before the Omnipresent.** וְכֵן הַמִּקְדָּשׁ נַעֲשָׂה **Likewise the Mikdash was built** בִּשְׁנֵי שְׁבָטִים אֵלּוּ **by these two tribes:** שְׁלֹמֹה מִיהוּדָה **Shlomo from Yehudah** וְחִירָם מִדָּן[210] **and Chiram from Dan,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מְלָכִים א ז, יד] **as it says (Melachim I 7:14),** בֶּן אִשָּׁה **"the son of a widow** אַלְמָנָה וּבְדִבְרֵי הַיָּמִים [ב ב, יג] כְּתִיב **while in Divrei HaYamim (II 2:13) it is written,** מִמַּטֵּה נַפְתָּלִי **of the tribe of Naftali,"** שֶׁהָיָה **"the son of a woman of the daughters of Dan"** — בֶּן אִשָּׁה מִבְּנוֹת דָּן (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא יג) וְאִמּוֹ מִדָּן[211] **and his mother from Dan** אָבִיו מִנַּפְתָּלִי **for his father was from Naftali** **(as stated in Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 13).** וְכֵן לֶעָתִיד יִשְׁתַּתֵּף עִם מָשִׁיחַ **Likewise in the future**

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[209] **Pesachim 88a** — "Rabbi Elazar said: What is meant by 'Many peoples shall go and say: Come, let us ascend Hashem's mountain, to the house of the God of Yaakov'? Is He the God of Yaakov and not the God of Avraham and Yitzchak? Rather, it is unlike Avraham, in whose case 'mountain' is written: 'As it will be said today: On Hashem's mountain He will be seen'; and unlike Yitzchak, in whose case 'field' is written: 'Yitzchak went out to meditate in the field.' Rather, it is like Yaakov, who called it a house: 'He called the name of that place Beis El.'" The Gemara identifies the patriarchal places of prayer with the future Temple. Rav Tzadok relates its 'field' to the field beside Machpelah in the Zohar; that identification is his synthesis of the sources.

[210] **Bereishis Rabbah 22:7** — "Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin said in Rabbi Levi's name: Both took land and both took movable property. Over what, then, did they dispute? One said, 'The Temple will be built in my territory,' and the other said, 'The Temple will be built in my territory.' For it says, 'When they were in the field,' and 'field' means the Temple, as in 'Zion shall be plowed as a field.' From this came 'Kayin rose against his brother Hevel.'"

[211] **Bereishis Rabbah 14:8** — "'From the earth': Rabbi Berechyah and Rabbi Chelbo said in Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman's name: He was created from the place of his atonement, as it says, 'You shall make Me an altar of earth.' The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'I am creating him from the place of his atonement; would that he endure!'" The Midrash makes the possibility of repair part of man's very creation. Rav Tzadok extends this to Adam's return to the altar after the sin and to the body's eventual entry through Machpelah.

there will join with Mashiach אֶחָד מִשֵּׁבֶט דָּן **one from the tribe of Dan,** וּשְׁמוֹ שְׂרָיָה[212] **whose name is Serayah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ קצד, ב) **(as stated in the Zohar, vol. 3, 194b).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַגָּדוֹל וְהַקָּטָן **That is, the great and the small** שָׁוִין לִפְנֵי הַמָּקוֹם **are equal before the Omnipresent,** וְכָל אֶחָד יֵשׁ לוֹ דָּבָר אֶחָד **and each one has one thing** שֶׁבָּזֶה הוּא נִכְתָּר בְּכֶתֶר **in which he is crowned with a crown** עַל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **over all of Yisrael.** וּבְשַׁבָּת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **On Shabbos, Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** מַחֲזִיר תָּמִיד **always returns** הַכְּתָרִים דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **the crowns of Mattan Torah to Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מִפְּרִי עֵץ חַיִּים **as we said from the Pri Etz Chaim;** וּבְפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים מוֹעִיל **and Parshas Shekalim is effective** שֶׁיּוּחְזַר הַכְּתָרִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **for the crowns to be returned to Yisrael** כְּשֶׁיִּשְׁקְלוּ הַשְּׁקָלִים אַף בְּחוֹל **when they give the shekalim, even on a weekday,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה [מַאֲמָר ב]: **as we said and explained above (maamar 2).**

[212] **Genesis 3:23** — "Hashem God sent him out of the Garden of Eden to work the earth from which he had been taken."

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ה׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Hei

אוֹמְרִים בִּתְפִלַּת מוּסָף **we say this in the Mussaf prayer,** אֲדוֹן נִשָּׂא **exalted Lord" —** אוֹר פָּנֶיךָ עָלֵינוּ **"The light of Your countenance upon us,** בַּפִּיּוּט[213] בְּכָל בְּרָכָה **in the piyut, in every blessing.** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנִּתְקַבְּלוּ הַפִּיּוּטִים **Since the piyutim have been accepted** בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל **throughout Klal Yisrael,** רָאוּי לְהָבִין בְּדִבְרֵיהֶם **it is fitting to understand their words;** וְאַף שֶׁמְּחַבְּרָם וּמְתַקְּנָם לֹא כִּיוֵּן לָזֶה **and even if their author and arranger did not intend this,** יָכוֹל לִהְיוֹת אֱמֶת[214] **it can be true,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בְּסֵפֶר אוּרִים וְתוּמִּים **as written in Sefer Urim V'Tumim** [קִיצּוּר תּוֹקְפּוֹ כֹּהֵן אות קכג-קכד בְּסוֹפוֹ] **(Kitzur Tokfo Kohen, os 123–124, at the end),** שֶׁדִּבְרֵי הַשֻּׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ וְכַדּוֹמֶה **that the words of the Shulchan Aruch and the like,** שֶׁנִּתְקַבְּלוּ בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל **which have been accepted throughout Klal Yisrael,** רְאוּיִם לְפָרֵשׁ בְּדִבְרֵיהֶם **may fittingly be interpreted in their words** הֲגַם שֶׁלֹּא כִּיְּונוּ לָזֶה **even though they did not intend this,** כִּי רוּחַ ה׳ דִּיבֵּר בָּם.[215] **for the spirit of Hashem spoke through them.**

וְהִנֵּה אוֹר פָּנֶיךָ **Now "the light of Your countenance"** מוֹרֶה עַל אוֹר עַתִּיקָא **denotes the light of Atika,** דְּבִסְעוּדָתָא דְּעַתִּיקָא אוֹמְרִים **for the meal of Atika we say** [זֶמֶר הָאֲרִ״י זְכָרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה] **(in the zemer of the Arizal),** נְהוֹרֵיהּ יִשְׁרֵי בַּהּ **"May His light rest upon it";** וּבִסְעוּדָה שְׁלִישִׁית **and at the third meal** הִתְגַּלּוּת מִצְחָא דְּעַתִּיקָא **is the revelation of the Forehead of Atika,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בָּאִדְרָא[216] **as they said in the Idra** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֶלֶק ג׳ רצג, א]. **(Zohar vol. 3, 293a).** וְאִיתָא (שַׁבָּת קנא, ב) **And it is brought (Shabbos 151b):** הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ וְהָאוֹר **"'The sun and the light' —** זוֹ פַּדַּחַת וְהַחוֹטֶם.[217] **this is the forehead and the nose."** וְזֶהוּ אוֹר פָּנֶיךָ **This is "the light of Your countenance" —** אוֹר עַתִּיקָא עָלֵינוּ **the light of Atika upon us,** שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה כְּכֶתֶר עַל הָרֹאשׁ. **which is above, like a crown upon the head.** וְכֵן מְסַיְּמִים בְּכָל בְּרָכָה **Likewise we conclude every blessing** [בַּפִּיּוּט מוּסָף] **(in the Mussaf piyut)** אֵל רָם וְנִשָּׂא **with "God, high and exalted,"** שֶׁזֶּה מוֹרֶה עַל עַתִּיקָא **which denotes Atika,** שֶׁכָּל הַנֶּעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן[218] **the intellect hidden from all thought;** שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה לְשׁוֹן רָם וְנִשָּׂא **for so the term "high and**

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[213] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 20** — "'He drove out the man': He was expelled and left the Garden of Eden, and settled on Mount Moriah, for the entrance to the Garden of Eden is near Mount Moriah. From there He had taken him, and there He returned him, to the place from which he had been taken. ... From which place had He taken him? From the place of the Temple, as it says, 'To work the earth from which he had been taken.'" This passage explicitly supplies the location that Rav Tzadok reads into the verse: Adam returns to Moriah and the Temple site.

[214] **Rambam, Hilchos Beis HaBechirah 2:2** — "There is a tradition held by all that the place where David and Shlomo built the altar at Aravnah's threshing floor is the place where Avraham built the altar and bound Yitzchak upon it. It is the place where Noach built an altar when he left the ark; it is the altar upon which Kayin and Hevel offered. There Adam offered a sacrifice when he was created, and from there he was created. The Sages said: Adam was created from the place of his atonement."

[215] **Genesis 3:19** — "By the sweat of your face shall you eat bread, until you return to the earth, for from it you were taken: you are dust, and to dust shall you return." Rav Tzadok reasons from the earth of Adam's creation to the place of his burial. The verse itself states the return to earth; the relation between the altar and Machpelah is the argument developed here.

[216] **Bava Basra 58a; Rashbam, s.v. Rabbi Benaah** — "Rabbi Benaah was marking burial caves. ... When he reached Adam's cave, a heavenly voice came forth and said: 'You have looked at the likeness of My image; do not look at My image itself.' He answered, 'But I must mark the cave!' He was told: 'The dimensions of the outer chamber are the same as those of the inner chamber.' ... Rabbi Benaah said: 'I looked at his two heels, and they were like two disks of the sun.' All people beside Sarah are like an ape beside a human; Sarah beside Chavah is like an ape beside a human; Chavah beside Adam is like an ape beside a human; Adam beside the Shechinah is like an ape beside a human." Rashbam explains that Rabbi Benaah measured the caves inside and marked their boundaries outside with lime, so that people carrying ritually pure objects would recognize the place of impurity and avoid passing over a grave. This explains the relevance of the episode to Rav Tzadok's concern about burial impurity.

[217] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 20** — "He sat and reflected in his heart: 'You will return me to death, the appointed house for every living being.' Adam said, 'While I am still in the world, I shall build myself a lodging for my resting place outside Mount Moriah.' He hewed and built himself a resting place. Adam said: 'The tablets will be written by the Holy One's finger, and the Jordan's waters will flee before them. My body He formed with both His hands, and into my nostrils He breathed the spirit of His mouth. After my death, might they take me and my bones and make them an object of idolatry? Rather, I shall deepen my coffin below the cave and within the cave.' It is therefore called the Cave of Machpelah, for it is doubled. There lie Adam and Chavah, Avraham and Sarah, Yitzchak and Rivkah, Yaakov and Leah; it is called Kiryas Arba because four couples were buried there." The Midrash explains concealment of Adam's grave as protection against worship of his body. Rav Tzadok's account of impurity and the cave's sanctity draws on this burial tradition together with the preceding sources.

[218] **Zohar I, Chayei Sarah 127b** — "Moreover, he prayed every day and would go out to that field, from which sublime fragrances arose. He saw light emerging from the cave and prayed there; there the Holy One, blessed be He, spoke with him. For this reason he sought to acquire it: his longing was continually for that place. If you ask why he had not

exalted" indicates אֵצֶל ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּלֹא שִׁיעוּר **regarding Hashem Yisbarach, without measure:** שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה **that He is above** מִתְּפִיסַת כָּל הַבְּרוּאִים **the grasp of all created beings,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. **as explained several times.** וְהַתְּחָלַת הַחֲרוּזִים **The verses of the piyut begin with the pasuk "A cluster of henna, etc."** [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים א, יד]. **(Shir HaShirim 1:14).** [שָׁם פח, ב] וְהוּא עַל פִּי הַגְּמָרָא **This follows the Gemara (there, 88b),** שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ פָּסוּק זֶה **which expounded this verse:** מִי שֶׁהַכֹּל שֶׁלּוֹ **"He to Whom everything belongs** וְהֵיינוּ עֵגֶל הָעֵגֶל — **atones for me for the sin of the kid, etc."** מְכַפֵּר לִי עַל עֵגֶל גְּדִי וְכוּבְּלֵי[219] **that is, the sin of the Golden Calf.** וְהַשְּׁקָלִים בָּאוּ לְכַפֵּר **And the shekalim came to atone for the sin of the Calf,** עַל עֵגֶל הָעֵגֶל **as they said in the Yerushalmi** [שְׁקָלִים פֶּרֶק ב' הֲלָכָה ג' ט, ב] **(Shekalim 2:3, 9b)** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **and the Pesikta (parshah 10, siman 12)** [פְּסִיקְתָּא כִּי תִשָּׂא י] וּפְסִיקְתָא **and Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Sisa 10):** וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (כִּי תִשָּׂא י) **"Since they sinned at midday,** לְפִי שֶׁחָטְאוּ בַּחֲצִי הַיּוֹם **let them give half a shekel; since they sinned at the sixth hour,** יִתְּנוּ מַחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל **let them give six gramisin; and since they transgressed the Ten Commandments,** וּלְפִי שֶׁחָטְאוּ בְּשֵׁשׁ יִתְּנוּ שִׁיתָּא גְּרָמִיסִין **let each one give ten gerah,"** וּלְפִי שֶׁעָבְרוּ עַל עֲשֶׂרֶת הַדְּבָּרוֹת יִתֵּן כָּל אֶחָד עֲשָׂרָה גֵּרָה **as mentioned above (maamar 2, 4).** [מַאֲמָר ב, ד] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּזְכַּר לְמַעְלָה. וְכֵן **So too it is brought in the Tanchuma (there, 2):** אִיתָא בְּתַנְחוּמָא (שָׁם ב) **"What caused the tribes, in Parshas Shekalim, to give?** מִי גָּרַם לַשְּׁבָטִים בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים שֶׁיִּתְּנוּ **The deed of the Calf"** מַעֲשֵׂה הָעֵגֶל (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א'). **(as explained in maamar 1).** וּמַה שֶּׁכִּינּוּ בָּמָקוֹם זֶה **And that they referred here to Hashem Yisbarach by the title "Eshkol," meaning that everything is His,** לַה' יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּתוֹאַר אֶשְׁכּוֹל שֶׁהַכֹּל שֶׁלּוֹ הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת יא, ב) **is based on what they said (Berachos 11b):** כְּתִיב רָע וְקָרֵינַן הַכֹּל[220] **"It is written 'evil' and we read 'everything,' as a euphemism."** לְשׁוֹן נְקִיָּה מְעַלְיָא **Similarly there is expounded** וְכֵן נִדְרַשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ט, ה-יג) **(Bereishis Rabbah 9:5–13)** [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, לא] מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **what is said (Bereishis 1:31),** וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת כָּל עַל כָּל הַהֵיפֶךְ **"And God saw all that He had made, and behold it was very good,"** אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד **as referring to all that is the opposite of good;** בְּיִשּׁוּב קֻשְׁיַת רַבִּי רַבִּי בֶּעֱר וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as we said in resolving the question of the Rebbe, Rabbi Ber,** זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה **may the memory of the righteous and holy be a blessing** [רְמֶזֵי תּוֹרָה בְּרֵאשִׁית דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל יֵשׁ] **(Remazei Torah, Bereishis, s.v. Yesh),** עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה מה, ז] **on what is said (Yeshayah 45:7),** וּבוֹרֵא רָע **"and creates evil":** הֵיכָן נִזְכַּר בְּרִיאַת רָע **where is the creation of evil mentioned** בְּמַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית[221] **in the work of Creation?** וְאָמַרְנוּ עַל פִּי הַגְּמָרָא **And we said, based on the Gemara** (שַׁבָּת קמט, ב) **(Shabbos 149b):** אֵין לֹא טוֹב אֶלָּא רָע[222] **"'Not good' means only evil";** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּבוֹרֵא רָע **and this is what is said, "and creates evil"** — עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **referring to the yetzer hara,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא רָע **which is called "evil."** וּבְמַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן **And in the first utterance** לֹא נֶאֱמַר כִּי טוֹב **"that**

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sought it until now, it was so that they would not take notice of him while he had no need of it. Now that he needed it, he said: 'The time has come to seek it.'"

[219] **Pri Tzaddik, Bo 5** — "'The fragrance of my son is like the fragrance of a field that Hashem has blessed,' for sublime, holy fragrances rose there. Fragrance indicates that the defect has been repaired and that he has attained the quality of tzaddik. ... This is the sublime fragrance that Avraham perceived from the Cave of Machpelah through the light of Adam, who was buried there. There is also a sublime, holy fragrance: the balsam described in the Zohar as the lofty, hidden and concealed chamber." This is the precise internal passage invoked to distinguish Avraham's 'sublime fragrances' from the 'sublime, holy fragrances' associated with Yitzchak. The English renders selected clauses of the original passage; the intervening discussion explains purity through fear of Heaven.

[220] **Zohar I, Chayei Sarah 123b, Tosefta** — "Rabbi Abba said: Come and see what is written: 'Avraham listened to Efron, and Avraham weighed out to Efron the silver.' This is the great longing of those worlds and yearnings. 'Four hundred shekels of silver': four hundred worlds, enjoyments and yearnings. 'Current with the merchant': Rav Nachman said that the soul passes through all the gates of heaven and the heavenly Jerusalem, and no one prevents it." The text plays on kesef, silver, and kisuf, longing. Rav Tzadok interprets its four hundred worlds through the completeness of the four worlds, rather than as worldly material pleasures.

[221] **Psalms 12:7** — "Hashem's words are pure words, silver refined in an earthen crucible, purified sevenfold." The verse supplies the image of sevenfold purification. The numerical comparison of seven times seven with seven times ten is Rav Tzadok's explanation here.

[222] **Zohar I, Bereishis 47b** — "'They were completed': the works above and the works below were completed. 'The heavens and the earth'—above and below. Rabbi Shimon said: The work and craftsmanship of the Written Torah, and the work and craftsmanship of the Oral Torah. 'And all their hosts'—these are the Torah's particulars, its facets: seventy facets of Torah. 'They were completed'—they were established and perfected in one another. Heaven and earth are particular and general; 'all their hosts' are the Torah's mysteries and its laws of purity and impurity." The exact cited folio places Torah's seventy facets within the completion of the Written and Oral Torah in one another. Rav Tzadok further interprets seventy as seven qualities each comprising ten.

it was good" is not said, וְשָׁם נִזְכַּר הַחֹשֶׁךְ **and there darkness is mentioned,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְמַלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת[223] **which alludes to the Angel of Death** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא וַיֵּשֶׁב ד) **(as stated in Midrash Tanchuma, Vayeishev 4),** [בָּבָא בַּתְרָא טז, א] שֶׁהוּא הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע[224], **who is the yetzer hara (Bava Basra 16a),** וְתוֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ **and "tohu va'vohu,"** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים **which alludes to the deeds of the wicked,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, ב, ה; כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 2:5);** שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר בּוֹ כִּי טוֹב **for "that it was good" is not said of it.** וְזֶהוּ לֹא טוֹב **and this is "not good,"** וְכֵן הוּא אֵשׁ שֶׁל גֵּיהִנֹּם **So too the fire of Gehinnom,** שֶׁנִּבְרָא בַּשֵּׁנִי **which was created on the second day,** [פְּסָחִים נד, א][225] וְלֹא נֶאֱמַר כִּי טוֹב. **and "that it was good" is not said (Pesachim 54a).** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּיוֹם שִׁשִּׁי **And afterwards, on the sixth day,** בִּבְרִיאַת הָאָדָם **at the creation of man,** לֹא נֶאֱמַר בּוֹ גַּם כֵּן כִּי טוֹב **"that it was good" is likewise not said of him;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁנִּבְרָא בִּבְחִירָה **that is, he was created with free choice,** שֶׁיּוּכַל הַנָּחָשׁ לִכְנוֹס בּוֹ וּלְפַתּוֹתוֹ **so that the serpent could enter him and seduce him.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּתִיב **And afterwards it is written,** וַיַּרְא אֱלֹהִים אֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה **"And God saw all that He had made,** וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד **and behold it was very good":** שֶׁבְּכְנִיסַת שַׁבָּת **for at the onset of Shabbos** מָצָא עוֹלָמוֹ חֵן בְּעֵינָיו **His world found favor in His eyes,** שֶׁהַכֹּל נִבְרָא **since everything was created** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מִזֶּה טוֹב מְאֹד **so that from it there would come "very good";** וְהַחֹשֶׁךְ נִבְרָא **and darkness was created** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה יִתְרוֹן הָאוֹר מִן הַחֹשֶׁךְ **so that there be the advantage of light over darkness,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **in the manner stated in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב׳ קפד, א) **(vol. 2, 184a):** "אֵין אוֹר אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ חֲשׁוֹכָא דְּנָפִיק **"There is no light except that which emerges from within darkness,** וְלֵית טוֹב אֶלָּא הַהוּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ בִּישָׁא[226] **and there is no good except that which emerges from within evil."** וְלָכֵן נִדְרַשׁ בְּמִדְרָשׁ **Therefore the Midrash expounds** כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה **"all that He had made"** עַל מַלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת וְיֵצֶר הָרָע וְגֵיהִנֹּם[227] **as the Angel of Death, the yetzer hara and Gehinnom,** שֶׁהֵם נִקְרָאִים בְּשֵׁם כֹּ״ל **which are called by the name "kol";** וְזֶה שֶׁכִּינּוּ אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה **and this is why the Men of the Great Assembly euphemized** וּבוֹרֵא רָע **"and creates evil"** וּבוֹרֵא אֶת הַכֹּל[228] **as "and creates everything"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר טו) **(as explained in Bereishis, maamar 15).** וְזֶהוּ מִי שֶׁהַכֹּל שֶׁלּוֹ **And this is "He to Whom everything belongs":** בְּחִינַת כֹּל **the aspect of "kol,"** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל הַהֵיפֶךְ מֵהַטּוֹב **which denotes the opposite of**

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[223] **Uktzin 3:12** — "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will cause every tzaddik to inherit three hundred and ten worlds, as it says: 'To bequeath substance to those who love Me, and I shall fill their treasuries.'" The word yesh has the numerical value 310. The Mishnah cites both halves of the verse; Rav Tzadok distinguishes love and fear within them to account for the additional ninety.

[224] **Pri Tzaddik, Vayigash 12** — "The four hundred worlds are not desires of this world, but the enjoyment of the radiance of the Shechinah, the lofty apprehensions that will be attained in the World to Come. ... 'Their treasuries' means the treasury of fear of Heaven, which is their own treasury. ... The letter tzaddi is the tzaddik, Yosef's quality, the ninth attribute; nine times ten, when it includes the aspect of the Congregation of Israel, is ninety. 'I shall fill their treasuries' thus means ninety worlds attained through fear, Yosef's quality, as he said: 'I fear God.' ... Together with the 310 worlds that Hashem bequeaths in His kindness to those who love Him, these make four hundred worlds." The earlier maamar supplies the otherwise compressed calculation: the reward associated with love is 310, and the treasury of fear contributes ninety. These are Rav Tzadok's distinctions within the Mishnah's proof verse.

[225] **Zohar I, Chayei Sarah 129a** — "When he had grown old and entered the sublime degrees as was fitting, it says, 'Avraham was old'; then he 'came into the days'—those sublime days, the days known in the mystery of faith. 'Hashem blessed Avraham with all': from there issue all blessings and all goodness." The Zohar explains the 'days' as sublime degrees. The specification that the tenth trial integrated all ten qualities is developed by Rav Tzadok, rather than explicitly stated in this quoted Zohar passage.

[226] **Zohar II, Mishpatim 94b** — "When a person is born, he is given a nefesh from the animal aspect, from the side of purity, from those called the holy Ofanim. If he merits more, he is given a ruach from the holy Chayos; if he merits more, a neshamah from the Throne. ... If he merits more, he is given a nefesh in the manner of Atzilus, from the only daughter, called the King's daughter. If he merits more, he is given a ruach of Atzilus from the middle pillar and is called a son of the Holy One. If he merits more, he is given a neshamah from Father and Mother. ... If he merits more, he is given the Divine Name with its letters in full—yod, heh, vav, heh—which is Adam, in the manner of the supernal Atzilus; he is called the image of his Master." The repeated 'if he merits more' describes successive gifts of higher soul levels. Rav Tzadok relates this ascending structure to completeness throughout the four worlds.

[227] **Isaiah 41:8** — "But you, Israel, My servant; Yaakov, whom I have chosen; offspring of Avraham, who loves Me." The verse joins Israel's election with descent from Avraham and calls him one who loves God. It supplies both parts of Rav Tzadok's description: Avraham's quality is love, and his descendants inherit from his root.

[228] **Zohar II, Vayakhel 204a** — "What is Shabbat? If you say it is because of cessation, as it is written, 'For on it He ceased,' that is fitting. But the mystery of the matter is: When this point rises and light shines, then she is crowned with the patriarchs. Once she is crowned with the patriarchs, she joins and unites with them to become one, and all is called Shabbat. Shabbat—shin, bat: shin is the mystery of the three patriarchs, who unite with the only daughter, and she is crowned with them. ... All is one."

good, גַּם כֵּן שֶׁלּוֹ **is also His;** מְכַפֵּר עַל עֲוֹון גְּדִי **He atones for the sin of the kid** שֶׁצָּרַמְתִּי לִי **that I heaped up for myself.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **And in the manner stated in the Gemara** (שַׁבָּת פט, ב) **(Shabbos 89b):** אִם יִהְיוּ חֲטָאֵיכֶם כַּשָּׁנִים הָלָלּו שֶׁסְּדוּרוֹת וּבָאוֹת וְכוּלֵי **"If your sins be like these years, which come in their order, etc.,** כַּשֶּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ[229] שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַכֹּל כִּזְכֻיּוֹת **they shall be made white as snow" — so that everything will become like merits** (וְעַיֵּין חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ה׳). **(as explained several times; see Chanukah, maamar 5).** וּכְשֶׁיִּתּוּקַן עֲוֹון הָעֵגֶל **And when the sin of the Calf is rectified** עַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **through the shekalim,** יוּחְזַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל הַכְּתָרִים שֶׁקָּשְׁרוּ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **the crowns will be returned to Yisrael that were tied on Yisrael at Mattan Torah;** וְזֶהוּ אוֹר פָּנֶיךָ עָלֵינוּ **and this is "the light of Your countenance upon us,** אֲדוֹן נִשָּׂא **exalted Lord" —** שֶׁהוּא כֶּתֶר עַל רֹאשׁ **which is a crown upon the head,** מִקַּרְנֵי אוֹר וְהוֹד. **from the rays of light and splendor.** [מַאֲמָר ב] וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **We have already said (maamar 2** דְּקְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה וְהַחֶשֶׁק **that the reading of the parshah, and the yearning** לְיִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם מִצְוַת שְׁקָלִים **that Yisrael have to fulfill the mitzvah of shekalim,** מַמָּשׁ כִּשְׁקָלִים הֵם. **are like actual shekalim.** וְזֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים **This is why we say,** וְשֶׁקֶל אֶשָּׂא **"And a shekel I will bring** בְּבֵית נָכוֹן וְנִשָּׂא **in a House established and exalted" —** דְּהַיְנוּ בַּבִּנְיָן הַשְּׁלִישִׁי **meaning in the third building,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מֵעַתִּיקָא **which will be from Atika,** שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה לְשׁוֹן נְשָׂא. **as the term "exalted" indicates.** וּמִדַּת עַתִּיקָא נִקְרָא קוֹדֶשׁ הַקָּדָשִׁים **And the attribute of Atika is called the Holy of Holies,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב׳ קכא, א). **as it says in the holy Zohar (vol. 2, 121a).** וְאוֹמְרִים וְשֶׁקֶל אֶשָּׂא **We say "And a shekel I will bring"** כִּי הַחֶשֶׁק הוּא כַּעֲשִׂיָּה **because the yearning is like the deed,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים בַּמּוּסָפִין **as we say in the Mussaf prayers,** נַעֲשֶׂה וְנַקְרִיב בְּאַהֲבָה **"We will prepare and offer with love** כְּמִצְוַת רְצוֹנֶךָ **according to the commandment of Your will."** וְאַף דְּמוּסָף זֶה **And although this Mussaf** אִי אֶיפְשָׁר לְהַקְרִיב בְּיוֹמוֹ **cannot be offered on its day —** כֵּן יוּכַל בִּנְיַן הֶעָתִיד גַּם **for even though on Shabbos and Yom Tov** דְּאַף דְּבְשַׁבָּת וְיוֹם טוֹב לְהָגְלוֹת **the future building could also be revealed,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהוּא בִּידֵי שָׁמַיִם **since it is by the hands of Heaven,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשׁ״י **as Rashi wrote** (ראֹשׁ הַשָּׁנָה ל, א דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל לֹא[230]), **(Rosh Hashanah 30a, s.v. Lo),** מִכָּל מָקוֹם לֹא נוּכַל **nevertheless we could not** לְהַקְרִיב הַמּוּסָף זֶה בְּאוֹתוֹ יוֹם **offer this Mussaf on that same day —** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַפֵּירוּשׁ דְּנַעֲשֶׂה וְנַקְרִיב בְּאַהֲבָה **we said that the meaning of "We will prepare and offer with love"** עַל יְדֵי הַחֶשֶׁק לַעֲשׂוֹת **is through the yearning to do it,** כְּמַעֲשֶׂה שֶׁהוּא כְּיָון שֶׁנֶּאֱנַס וְלֹא עָשָׂה[231] **which is like the deed, since he was prevented and did not do it.** וְזֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים כְּמִצְוַת רְצוֹנֶךָ **This is why we say "the commandment of Your will"** וְלֹא מִצְוַת תּוֹרָתֶךָ **and not "the commandment of Your Torah,"** דְּרְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **for His will, may He be blessed,** הוּא רַק מַה שֶּׁאָמַר **is only that He spoke** וְנַעֲשָׂה רְצוֹנוֹ **and His will was done;** שֶׁזֶּהוּ עִיקַּר נִחוֹחַ **this is the essence of "nicho'ach":** לְשֵׁם הֲנָחַת רוּחַ[232] **for the sake of giving satisfaction** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זְבָחִים מו, ב) **(as**

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[229] **Yevamos 79a** — "Three signs distinguish this nation: they are merciful, bashful, and doers of kindness. Merciful, as it is written, 'He will give you mercy, and have mercy upon you and multiply you'; bashful, as it is written, 'So that His fear may be upon your faces'; doers of kindness, as it is written, 'For I have known him, that he may command his children and his household after him.' Whoever has these three signs is fit to join this nation." The Gemara lists the three traits and their scriptural supports. The assignment of kindness to Avraham, bashfulness and fear to Yitzchak, and mercy to Yaakov is Rav Tzadok's patriarchal interpretation.

[230] **Nedarim 20a** — "It was taught: 'So that His fear may be upon your faces'—this is bashfulness. 'So that you do not sin' teaches that bashfulness leads to fear of sin. From here they said: It is a good sign in a person that he is bashful. Others say: A person who feels shame will not readily sin; one who lacks a sense of shame is known not to have had his ancestors stand at Mount Sinai." The connection between shame and fear of sin explains why Rav Tzadok places bashfulness under Yitzchak's quality of fear.

[231] Parallel: **Zohar, Terumah, section 6, beginning "Patach Rabbi Shimon bereisha"** — "Whoever wishes to engage in a commandment, and through it to attach himself to the Holy One, blessed be He, must not undertake it emptily and without cost. Rather, a person must undertake it properly, according to his strength.... Torah study is available to whoever wishes to attain it; seeking knowledge of the Holy One is available without any payment. But Divine service that is fulfilled through an act may not be obtained emptily and without cost: through that act one draws upon oneself a spirit of holiness only with full payment.... A holy spirit comes through full payment, very great effort, purification of oneself and one's dwelling, and the willingness of one's heart and soul. Would that a person might succeed in having it dwell with him."

Connection: The Zohar joins expenditure for a sacred act to effort and wholehearted desire as the means of drawing holiness into one's life. This sharpens Rav Tzadok's explanation of the remembered merit of Avraham's payment: the silver expresses his eagerness to acquire a place of holiness, rather than serving merely as the price recorded in a transaction.

[232] **Bereishis Rabbah 58:8** — "Rabbi Elazar said: How much ink is poured out, how many pens are broken, to write 'the children of Ches'! 'The children of Ches' is written ten times, corresponding to the Ten Commandments, to teach that

stated in Zevachim 46b, וְרַשִׁ״י שָׁם דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל הֲנָאַת). **and Rashi there, s.v. Hanachas).** וְזֶהוּ הַחֵשֶׁק וְהָאַהֲבָה **And this is the yearning and the love** אַף בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה **even in our times;** וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **and the Holy One, blessed be He,** לָא בָּעֵי מִינַן אֶלָּא לִבָּא[233] **wants nothing from us but the heart,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as it says in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג׳ קס, א) **(vol. 3, 160a)** וּבַגְּמָרָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין קו, ב) **and in the Gemara (Sanhedrin 106b):** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִבָּא בָּעֵי[234] **"The Holy One, blessed be He, wants the heart."** וְכֵן אוֹמְרִים וְשֶׁקֶל אֶשָּׂא **So too we say "And a shekel I will bring,"** מַמָּשׁ בְּמַעֲשֶׂה **literally in deed,** עַל יְדֵי הַחֵשֶׁק וְהָרָצוֹן **through the yearning and the will** שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה מֵהֶם שְׁקָלִים **from which shekalim are made** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב׳) **(as explained in maamar 2),** בְּבַיִת נָכוֹן וְנִשָּׂא **"in a House established and exalted,"** הַמְּשׁוּכָלָל לְמַעְלָה. **perfected above.** וּבְצֶדֶק הָגָה עֵרֶךְ כִּי תִשָּׂא **"With righteousness he uttered the account of Ki Sisa" —** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the manner of the verse,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נָחְשָׁב [הוֹשֵׁעַ יד, ג] וּנְשַׁלְּמָה פָרִים שְׂפָתֵינוּ **"And let our lips take the place of the bulls" (Hoshea 14:3):** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁקּוֹרְאִין קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **that the reading of the parshah be considered** גַּם כֵּן כַּעֲשׂוּיָה **as a deed as well,** בְּפָרָשַׁת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת.[235] **just as we read in Mussaf** בְּמוּסָף **the passage of the offerings.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה אָנוּ מְבַקְּשִׁים **And through this we ask,** אוֹר פָּנֶיךָ עָלֵינוּ אֲדוֹן נִשָּׂא **"The light of Your countenance upon us, exalted Lord" —** שֶׁיִּתְתַּקֵּן עֲוֹון הָעֶגֶל **that the sin of the Calf be rectified** וְיוּחְזַר לָנוּ **and there be returned to us** הַכְּתָרִים דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה: **the crowns of Mattan Torah.**

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whoever establishes a tzaddik's purchase is as though he fulfills the Ten Commandments. Rabbi Yudan said: 'The children of Barzillai' is written five times, corresponding to the five books of Torah, to teach that whoever feeds a morsel to a tzaddik is as though he fulfills the five books of Torah." Both comparisons occur together in the Midrash. Their differing numbers are the question that Rav Tzadok proceeds to explain.

[233] **Yefeh Toar on Bereishis Rabbah 58, s.v. Ke'ilu mekayem aseres hadibros** — "'As though he fulfills the Ten Commandments': This is the Sages' manner in several places: one who assists a Torah scholar is considered as though he fulfilled the entire Torah, because through his help the scholar can occupy himself with Torah. There is therefore no question why the Torah alluded to ten regarding the children of Ches and to five regarding the children of Barzillai, for one does not raise objections against allusions." This is the precise comment summarized in the manuscript. The checked digital edition places its heading under 'As though he fulfills the Ten Commandments'; Rav Tzadok nevertheless seeks meaning in the different numbers.

[234] **Bereishis Rabbah 3:5** — "Rabbi Simon said: Light is written here five times, corresponding to the five books of Torah. 'God said: Let there be light' corresponds to Bereishis, in which the Holy One occupied Himself with creating His world. 'There was light' corresponds to Shemos, in which Israel emerged from darkness into light. 'God saw the light, that it was good' corresponds to Vayikra, filled with many laws. 'God separated the light from the darkness' corresponds to Bamidbar, which distinguishes those who left Egypt from those who entered the Land. 'God called the light day' corresponds to Mishneh Torah, filled with many laws."

[235] **Bereishis Rabbah 14:9; Proverbs 20:27** — "Five names were given to it: nefesh, ruach, neshamah, yechidah, chayah. Nefesh is the blood, as it says, 'The blood is the nefesh.' Ruach ascends and descends, as it says, 'Who knows the ruach of human beings that ascends upward?' Neshamah is the disposition, as people say, 'A good disposition.' Chayah: all the limbs die, yet it lives within the body. Yechidah: the limbs come in pairs, while it is unique within the body." The Midrash supplies the five names; Rav Tzadok arranges them as ascending levels and relates them to the five expressions of light. Proverbs 20:27 reads: 'A person's soul is Hashem's lamp, searching all the chambers of the belly.'

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ו׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Vav

"My Beloved, remember for me דּוֹדִי זְכוֹר לִי **the shekels of Efron** שִׁקְלֵי עֶפְרוֹן **which the Father** אֲשֶׁר שָׁקַל אָב **weighed out** בְּמִכְפַּל חֶבְרוֹן **for the Machpelah of Chevron"** [בְּפִיּוּט לִבְרַכַת אַתָּה קָדוֹשׁ]. **(in the piyut for the blessing Atah Kadosh).** יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **We must understand** מַה זֶּה זְכוּת שִׁקְלֵי עֶפְרוֹן **what this merit of the shekels of Efron is,** שֶׁמְּבַקְּשִׁים זְכוֹר לִי. **about which we plead, "Remember for me."** בִּשְׁלָמָא מַה שֶּׁאוֹמְרִים **It is understandable regarding what we say** אַחַר כָּךְ חֲקֹר שִׁקְלֵי יְבוּסִי וְכוּ׳ **afterward, "Search out the shekels of the Jebusite," etc.;** יִתָּכֵן שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה **it may be that this was** מַה שֶּׁגָּבָה דָּוִד **what David collected,** מִכָּל שֵׁבֶט חֲמִשִּׁים שְׁקָלִים **fifty shekels from each tribe,** לִקְנוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ[236] **to purchase the site of the Mikdash** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זְבָחִים קטז, ב) **(as stated in Zevachim 116b),** וְהֵם מַמָּשׁ כְּמוֹ הַשְּׁקָלִים **and they are exactly like the shekels** שֶׁהָיוּ לְצוֹרֶךְ הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **that were for the needs of the korbanos.** אֲבָל זְכוּת שִׁקְלֵי עֶפְרוֹן **But the merit of the shekels of Efron** — אֵינוֹ מוּבָן מַהוּ. **it is not understood what it is.** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן **But the matter is** עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **according to what they said** (בָּא חָלַק ב לט, ב) **in the holy Zohar (Bo, vol. 2, 39b):** וְכִי מְנַיִן יָדַע יִצְחָק **"And from where did Yitzchak know** ה׳ רֵיחַ שָׂדֶה אֲשֶׁר בֵּרְכוֹ **'the fragrance of a field which Hashem has blessed'?** אֶלָּא תְּרֵי מִילִּין אִינּוּן **Rather, they are two matters,** וְכֻלָּא הוּא חַד **and it is all one.** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כד, סג] דִּכְתִיב **As it is written (Bereishis 24:63),** וַיֵּצֵא יִצְחָק **'And Yitzchak went out** לָשׂוּחַ בַּשָּׂדֶה וְגו׳ **to meditate in the field,' etc. —** אוֹתָהּ הַשָּׂדֶה הָיָה **that field was the one** אֲשֶׁר קָנָה אַבְרָהָם **which Avraham bought** וְכוּלֵי סְמוּךְ לַמְּעָרָה[237] **adjacent to the cave, etc."** עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת. **See there at length.** וְהַיְינוּ דִּבְכָל מָקוֹם **That is, everywhere** קָרֵי לְמָקוֹם הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שָׂדֶה[238] **the site of the Mikdash is called a "field,"** (פְּסָחִים פח, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Pesachim 88a):** יִצְחָק וְכוּלֵי[239] שֶׁכָּתוּב בּוֹ שָׂדֶה **"Yitzchak, about whom 'field' is written," etc.** וְאַף בְּקַיִן דָּרְשׁוּ **And even regarding Kayin they expounded** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה כב, ז) **(Bereishis Rabbah 22:7)** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ד, ח] בִּהְיוֹתָם בַּשָּׂדֶה **"when they were in the field" (Bereishis 4:8)** עַיֵּין שָׁם עַל מְקוֹם בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ[240] **as referring to the site of the Beis HaMikdash; see there.** וּבַזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ מְפָרֵשׁ **And the holy Zohar explains it** עַל מְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה **as referring to the Cave of Machpelah,** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **and about this it said,** תְּרֵי מִילִּין אִינּוּן וְכֻלָּא חַד. **"They are two matters, and it is all one."** וְהוּא דְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן **The point is that Adam HaRishon** נִבְרָא מִמְּקוֹם הַמִּזְבֵּחַ **was created from the place of the Mizbe'ach,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יד, ח) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 14:8):** מִמְּקוֹם

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[236] **Bereishis Rabbah 92:4** — "'They took the gift ... Yosef saw Binyamin with them ... and prepare': Prepare refers only to Shabbos, as it says, 'On the sixth day they shall prepare what they bring.' This shows that Yosef observed Shabbos before it was given." This is the passage supporting the identification of Yosef's meal as a Shabbos meal. The checked digital edition numbers it 92:4; the manuscript cites 92:7.

[237] **Pri Tzaddik, Mikeitz 6** — "'Binyamin's portion increased fivefold beyond the portions of them all': The expression 'increased' suggests that it increased of itself. ... The principal intention of Yosef was to feed them the remnants of his Shabbos meal, which was truly the King's meal; the remnants had the power to bring holiness into all the tribes. ... The Shechinah rested upon Israel in Binyamin's territory in five places. ... Although Yosef introduced holiness into all the tribes, in Binyamin the holiness increased fivefold, for the Shechinah rested in his portion in five places. The number five indicates completeness, for there are five levels of the soul: nefesh, ruach, neshamah, chayah and yechidah." The cited earlier maamar explicitly joins Binyamin's fivefold portion to the five places of the Shechinah and to the five soul levels. It presents alternate ways of counting the places according to the opinions in Zevachim 118b.

[238] **Pri Tzaddik, Vayigash 7** — "Since Binyamin, through his holiness, attained all five holinesses of Shabbos—as it says, 'Binyamin's portion increased,' increasing of itself—there is no place here for jealousy, for he truly possessed what they had not attained. Consequently there is likewise no jealousy over Yosef's giving him five changes of garments and giving the others one, for he had attained what required the tzaddik to shed upon him the encompassing light in the five holinesses of Shabbos. ... Corresponding to these are the five levels of the soul: nefesh, ruach, neshamah, chayah and yechidah." This companion reference explains the fivefold gift as the outer expression of a holiness Binyamin had already attained. It makes explicit why Rav Tzadok treats the five portions as soul nourishment rather than merely a larger meal.

[239] **Proverbs 9:5** — "Come, eat of my bread, and drink of the wine that I have mixed." Wisdom speaks in this chapter, inviting the simple to leave foolishness and live. Rav Tzadok reads the sustaining food through this invitation to Torah and wisdom, alongside the lesson of the manna.

[240] **Deuteronomy 8:3** — "He afflicted you and caused you to hunger, and fed you the manna, which neither you nor your ancestors had known, to make you know that a person does not live by bread alone; rather, a person lives by everything issuing from Hashem's mouth." The verse recounts the lesson of the manna. Rav Tzadok identifies the sustaining divine utterance with the holiness within food.

כַּפָּרָתוֹ נִבְרָא[241] וְכוּלֵי עַיֵּין שָׁם. **"From the place of his atonement he was created," etc.; see there.** וְאַחַר שֶׁנִּתְגָּרֵשׁ מִגַּן עֵדֶן **And after he was banished from Gan Eden,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, כג] כְּתִיב **it is written (Bereishis 3:23),** וַיְשַׁלְּחֵהוּ וְגוֹ' **"And He sent him out," etc.,** לַעֲבֹד אֶת הָאֲדָמָה **"to work the ground** אֲשֶׁר לֻקַּח מִשָּׁם[242] **from which he was taken" —** וְהַמִּזְבֵּחַ שֶׁנִּבְרָא מִשָּׁם[243] **meaning, to the site of the Beis HaMikdash and the Mizbe'ach, from which he was created.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לַעֲבֹד וְגוֹ' **This is why it says "to work," etc.,** דְּשָׁם מְקוֹם הָעֲבוֹדָה **for there is the place of the Avodah** (וְכֵן כָּתוּב בְּפִרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר פֶּרֶק כ) **(and so it is written in Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer, chapter 20).** וְעַיֵּין מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ם (הִלְכוֹת בֵּית הַבְּחִירָה הֲלָכָה ב) **And see what the Rambam wrote (Hilchos Beis HaBechirah 2:2),** דְּשָׁם הִקְרִיב אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן קָרְבָּן.[244] **that there Adam HaRishon offered a korban.** [בְּרֵאשִׁית שָׁם, יט] וּכְתִיב **And it is written (Bereishis ibid. 19),** עַד שׁוּבְךָ אֶל הָאֲדָמָה כִּי מִמֶּנָּה לֻקָּחְתָּ[245] **"Until you return to the ground, for from it you were taken";** וְהָיָה נִצְרָךְ לְהִקָּבֵר שָׁם גַּם כֵּן **so he needed to be buried there as well,** כֵּינָן שֶׁמִּשָּׁם לֻקַּח וְנִבְרָא **since from there he was taken and created,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above;** רַק שָׁם לֹא הָיָה אֶפְשָׁר **only, it was not possible** לְקוֹבְרוֹ מִפְּנֵי הַטּוּמְאָה **to bury him there because of the tumah,** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא נח, א **as they said (Bava Basra 58a):** רַבִּי בְּנָאָה הָוָה מְצַיֵּין כִּי מָטָא לְמַעְרְתָּא **"Rabbi Bena'ah used to mark burial caves, etc.; when he reached the cave** דְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן[246] וְכוּלֵי. **of Adam HaRishon," etc.** וְנִקְבַּר בִּמְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה.[247] **So he was buried in the Cave of**

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[241] **Shabbos 56a** — "Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani said in Rabbi Yonasan's name: Whoever says that David sinned is simply mistaken, for it says, 'David conducted himself wisely in all his ways, and Hashem was with him.' Is it possible that sin came into his hand while the Shechinah was with him? What, then, is the meaning of 'Why have you despised Hashem's word, to do evil'? He sought to do so but did not do it. ... 'You struck Uriah the Chittite with the sword': You should have judged him before the Sanhedrin, but did not. 'You took his wife to be your wife': You had a valid marriage with her." The Gemara's defense of David addresses the legal character of the episode while retaining criticism of his conduct. Rav Tzadok invokes that defense when describing Barzillai's support of David during exile.

[242] **Tikkunei Zohar, Introduction 17a, Patach Eliyahu** — "You brought forth ten arrangements, which we call ten sefiros, through which to govern concealed worlds that are not revealed and worlds that are revealed. ... In this arrangement they are called: Chesed, the right arm; Gevurah, the left arm; Tiferes, the body; Netzach and Hod, the two legs; Yesod, the end of the body, the sign of the holy covenant; Malchus, the mouth, which we call the Oral Torah. Chochmah is the brain, inward thought; Binah is the heart, through which the heart understands. ... The supernal Kesser is the crown of kingship. Of it it is said: 'Declaring the end from the beginning.' It is the skull of the tefillin; within it is the Name spelled Yod, Heh, Vav, Heh, which is the path of emanation." The passage gives the ten sefiros the form of a complete human configuration. That embodied completeness explains why Rav Tzadok associates the purchase of a burial place for the body with ten, rather than the five soul levels nourished through food.

[243] **II Samuel 24:25** — "David built an altar to Hashem there and offered burnt offerings and peace offerings. Hashem accepted entreaty for the land, and the plague was checked from Israel." The verse follows David's purchase of the threshing floor. It directly explains the piyyut's description of the Jebusite shekels as quieting wrath.

[244] **Bereishis Rabbah 49:11** — "Avraham answered: 'Had Amrafel killed me, would I not have been dust? Had Nimrod burned me, would I not have been ashes?' The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: 'By your life! You said, I am dust and ashes; by your life, I shall give your children atonement through them,' as it says, 'They shall take for the impure person some of the dust of the burning of the sin offering,' and 'A pure man shall gather the ashes of the cow.'" The Midrash connects Avraham's humility to rescue both from battle and from the furnace, and makes his words a continuing source of merit for his descendants. Rav Tzadok explains the exceptional self-surrender underlying those two rescues.

[245] **Sanhedrin 74b–75a; Rambam, Hilchos Melachim 10:2** — "They asked Rabbi Ami: Is a descendant of Noach commanded regarding sanctification of the Name, or is he not? Abaye said: Come and hear: The descendants of Noach were commanded seven commandments; if this were so, there would be eight. Rava answered: The seven include their associated requirements. What was the conclusion? Rav Adda bar Ahavah said: They say in Rav's school that Naaman asked forgiveness for bowing in the house of Rimmon while his master leaned on his arm, and Elisha told him: 'Go in peace.'" The ensuing objection distinguishes private from public conduct. Rambam states the conclusion explicitly: 'A descendant of Noach whom a coercer forces to violate one of his commandments is permitted to violate it. Even if forced to serve idols, he may do so, because they are not commanded regarding sanctification of the Name.' Rav Tzadok takes this as the legal background against which to describe Avraham's extraordinary act of love.

[246] **Bereishis Rabbah 34:13; Rashi on Genesis 9:5** — "'But'—this includes one who strangles himself. Could it apply even to one like Shaul? Scripture says 'but,' limiting the rule. Could it apply to those like Chananyah, Mishael and Azaryah? Scripture says 'but,' limiting the rule." Rashi explains 'your blood' as blood shed by a person who kills himself, and 'for your lives' as including even one who strangles himself without shedding blood. The Midrash also states exceptions; Rav Tzadok's discussion concerns how Avraham's pre-Sinai act stands in relation to the ordinary rule. This passage is 34:13 in the checked digital edition, rather than the manuscript's 34:8.

[247] **Rambam, Hilchos Yesodei HaTorah 5:4** — "Anyone of whom it is said, 'Transgress rather than be killed,' who is killed rather than transgresses, is accountable for his own life. Anyone of whom it is said, 'Be killed rather than

Machpelah. וְעַל כֵּן הָיָה בּוֹ **Therefore it too possessed** גַּם כֵּן קְדוּשַׁת הַמִּזְבֵּחַ. **the holiness of the Mizbe'ach.** וְעוֹד גָּדוֹל מִזֶּה **And greater still:** דְּבָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה נִבְרָא הַגּוּף **in this world the body was created** מִמְּקוֹם כַּפָּרָתוֹ **from the place of its atonement,** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְתַקֵּן **meaning, so that he could repair** אִם יְקַלְקֵל **if he should go astray,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה שָׁם) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah there):** הֲרֵי אֲנִי בּוֹרֵא אוֹתוֹ **"Behold, I create him** מִמְּקוֹם כַּפָּרָתוֹ וְהַלְוַאי יַעֲמוֹד. **from the place of his atonement — and would that he endure."** וּבַתְּחִלָּה הָיָה הַגּוּף **At first the body too** גַּם כֵּן בְּגַן עֵדֶן. **was in Gan Eden.** וְאַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל **After the corruption** שׁוּלַּח מִגַּן עֵדֶן **it was sent out of Gan Eden** לִמְקוֹם הַמִּזְבֵּחַ **to the place of the Mizbe'ach,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לוֹ כַּפָּרָה[248] **so that it would have atonement;** וְזֶה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה. **and that is in this world.** וְאַחַר פְּטִירָתוֹ **And after his passing** שֶׁיּוּכַל הַגּוּף לִכָּנוֹס **the body is able to enter** גַּם כֵּן לְגַן עֵדֶן **Gan Eden as well;** מְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה **the Cave of Machpelah** הוּא הַשַּׁעַר לְגַן עֵדֶן. **is the gateway to Gan Eden.** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And so it is found in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק א קכז, ב) **(vol. 1, 127b)** בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **regarding Avraham Avinu, a"h:** וַהֲוָה נָפִיק עַד הַהוּא חֶקְלָ **"And he would go out to that field** דַּהֲוָה סָלִיק רֵיחִין עִלָּאִין[249] וְכוּלֵי **from which supernal fragrances would rise," etc.** וּבְיִצְחָק אִיתָא **And regarding Yitzchak it says** (בְּזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בֹּא שָׁם) **(in the holy Zohar, Bo, there):** וְסָלִיק רֵיחִין **"And there rose fragrances** עִלָּאִין קַדִּישִׁין וְכוּלֵי **supernal and holy," etc. —** וְהַיְנוּ רֵיחַ גַּן עֵדֶן **that is, the fragrance of Gan Eden.** וּמַה שֶּׁלֹּא נִזְכַּר **As for why there is no mention,** בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **regarding Avraham Avinu, a"h,** לְשׁוֹן קָדִישִׁין **of the term "holy,"** כְּבָר נִתְבָּאֵר **it has already been explained** (בְּפָרָשַׁת בֹּא מַאֲמָר ה[250] עַיֵּן שָׁם) **(Parshas Bo, ma'amar 5; see there).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ וְכֻלָּא חַד **And this is what they said, "and it is all one":** קְדוּשַׁת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **the holiness of the Mikdash** וּמְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה. **and that of the Cave of Machpelah.** וְהַקְנִיָּה הָיָה **And the purchase was** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כג, טז] בְּאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שֶׁקֶל כֶּסֶף **for four hundred shekels of silver (Bereishis 23:16),** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and it is found in the holy Zohar** (חַיֵּי שָׂרָה חֵלֶק א קכג, ב) **(Chayei Sarah, vol. 1, 123b)** שֶׁרוֹמֵז אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת עוֹלָמוֹת **that it alludes to four hundred worlds** וְכִסּוּפִין[251] הֲנָאוֹת **of delight and longing.** וְהַיְנוּ דְּמִסְפָּר הַשָּׁלֵם **That is, a complete number** הוּא כְּשֶׁכָּלוּל מִכָּל עֲשָׂר **is one comprised of each of the ten;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ **as we find,** [תְּהִלִּים יב, ז] מְזוּקָּק שִׁבְעָתָיִם[252] **"refined sevenfold" (Tehillim 12:7) —** שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים שֶׁבַע **seven**

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transgress,' who is killed and does not transgress, has sanctified the Name. If this was before ten Israelites, he has sanctified the Name publicly, like Daniel, Chananyah, Mishael, Azaryah, Rabbi Akiva and his companions. These are the martyrs above whose degree there is none." Rambam distinguishes the two legal duties. Rav Tzadok quotes this formulation as background to Avraham's willingness to risk even his spiritual standing; the exceptional interpretation of Avraham's motive is Rav Tzadok's own argument.

[248] **Midrash Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 7** — "Another interpretation: 'The wicked have drawn the sword'—these are the four kings, Amrafel and his companions. There had not yet been war in the world; these came and opened with the sword and made war. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to them: 'You opened with the sword to cast down the poor and needy; their sword shall enter their own hearts.' Avraham arose and killed them." The Midrash identifies the four kings as the initiators of the violence and applies the reversal in Psalms 37:14–15 to their defeat. Rav Tzadok develops this as the object of Avraham's zeal.

[249] **Nedarim 32a** — "'Three hundred and eighteen': Rabbi Ami bar Abba said: Eliezer was equal to them all. Some say: It was Eliezer alone, for the numerical value of his name is that number." The two readings are distinct: in the first Eliezer equals the entire force, while in the second the number 318 itself signifies Eliezer. Rav Tzadok argues that even the literal force was small beside the four kings' armies.

[250] **Bereishis Rabbah 42:8** — "'The fugitive came': Reish Lakish said in Bar Kappara's name: This was Og, the fugitive. Why was he called Og? He came and found Avram occupied with the commandment of cakes. He did not intend for the sake of Heaven, but said: 'This Avraham is a fiery zealot. I shall now tell him that his brother's son has been taken captive; he will go to war and be killed, and I shall take his wife Sarai.'" The characterization occurs in Og's calculating speech, not as the Midrash's unqualified legal ruling. Rav Tzadok draws from it Avraham's readiness to act from burning zeal despite the danger.

[251] **Pri Tzaddik, Vayishlach 6** — "Although he judged them as murderers—and a murderer is liable to death under the laws of the descendants of Noach—according to Torah he was not required or permitted to endanger himself by going alone with Eliezer. ... It was only because of his great ardor and zeal; he knew that, since the wish to pursue the kings had arisen in his will, the will of Hashem was to rescue Lot. In truth this was Hashem's will because of the soul of David and Mashiach that would issue from his descendants. ... Since Hashem performed a miracle for him, he evidently acted fittingly and attained the Divine intention beyond human comprehension." The earlier passage explicitly separates the ordinary legal assessment from Rav Tzadok's explanation of Avraham's exceptional intuition. It also identifies rescue of the future Davidic line as the providential purpose of rescuing Lot.

[252] **Numbers 25:11** — "Pinchas, son of Elazar, son of Aharon the priest, turned My wrath away from the children of Israel when he acted with My zeal among them, so that I did not consume the children of Israel in My zeal." The verse supplies the Divine approval of Pinchas's zeal. The following Gemara quotation sets out the exceptional legal conditions of the act to which Rav Tzadok compares Avraham's action.

times seven; שִׁבְעִים פָּנִים **and elsewhere it is found (Zohar, vol. 1, 47b),** וּבְמָקוֹם אַחֵר אִיתָא [זֹהַר חֵלֶק א מז, ב] **that is, seven times ten,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים עֶשֶׂר **"seventy facets to the Torah,"** שֶׁכָּל מִדָּה כְּלוּל מֵעֶשֶׂר לַתּוֹרָה[253] **since each middah is comprised of ten;** וְעִיקַּר הַשְּׁלֵימוּת **and the essence of completeness** מְסָפָּר מֵאָה **is the number one hundred,** עֶשֶׂר פְּעָמִים עֶשֶׂר. **ten times ten.** וְכֵן יֵשׁ בְּכָל עוֹלָם **And so it is in each world** מֵאֲרְבַּע עוֹלָמוֹת **of the four worlds,** אֲצִילוּת בְּרִיאָה יְצִירָה עֲשִׂיָּה **Atzilus, Beriah, Yetzirah and Asiyah;** וְזֶה מִסְפַּר אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת **and this is the number of the four hundred** עָלְמִין דְּכִיסּוּפִין[254] **worlds of longing,** וְהַיְינוּ מֵרוֹב הָאַהֲבָה. **that is, from an abundance of love.** וְזֶה אֶחָד עִם מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is one with what they said** (עוּקְצִין פֶּרֶק ג מִשְׁנָה יב) **(Uktzin 3:12),** דְּעָתִיד לְהַנְחִיל **that in the future He will bequeath** שע"ש עוֹלָמוֹת[255] **three hundred and ten (shai) worlds,** שֶׁזֶּה שְׂכַר הָאַהֲבָה **which is the reward of love,** [מִשְׁלֵי ח, כא] כְּמוֹ **as it says (Mishlei 8:21),** בְּשָׂכַר וְתִשְׁעִים עוֹלָמוֹת **and ninety worlds** לְהַנְחִיל לְאוֹהֲבַי יֵשׁ **"to cause those who love Me to inherit yesh"** — הַיִּרְאָה[256] **as the reward of fear,** [שָׁם] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (ibid.),** וְאוֹצְרוֹתֵיהֶם אֲמַלֵּא **"and their storehouses I will fill"** — אוֹצָר שֶׁל צַדִּי"ק **the "otzar" of the letter tzaddi, ninety** (וְנִתְבָּאַר בְּפָרָשַׁת וַיִּגַּשׁ סוֹף מַאֲמָר יב) **(as explained in Parshas Vayigash, end of ma'amar 12);** וְזֶהוּ הָאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת עוֹלָמוֹת דְּכִיסּוּפִין. **and these are the four hundred worlds of longing.** וְאָז אַחַר נְסִיּוֹן הָעֲקֵידָה **And then, after the test of the Akeidah,** שֶׁהָיָה נְסִיּוֹן הָעֲשִׂירִי **which was the tenth test,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כד, א] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Bereishis 24:1),** בָּא בַּיָּמִים **"coming into days"** — בְּיוֹמִין עִלָּאִין[257] **into the supernal days,** (חֵלֶק א קכט, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar (vol. 1, 129a);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁנִּתְבָּרֵר בְּמִדָּתוֹ **that is, he was refined in his middah** עַד הַשְּׁוֹרֶשׁ **down to the root** בְּכָל עֶשֶׂר מִדּוֹת[258] **in all ten middos,** וְכָל מִדָּה כְּלוּל מֵעֶשֶׂר **each middah comprised of ten** — הוּא מֵאָה. **which is one hundred.** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And it is found in the holy Zohar** (מִשְׁפָּטִים חֵלֶק ב צד, ב) **(Mishpatim, vol. 2, 94b):** הֲנָיָ"ה זָכָה יַתִּיר וְכוּלֵי **"If he merits more, etc.;** זָכָה יַתִּיר יָהֲבִין לֵיהּ **if he merits still more, they give him**

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[253] **Sanhedrin 82a** — "Rav Chisda said: If a person comes to seek a ruling, he is not instructed to act. ... Moreover, had Zimri withdrawn and Pinchas killed him, Pinchas would have been liable for killing him. Had Zimri turned and killed Pinchas, he would not have been liable, for Pinchas was pursuing him. ... What did Pinchas see? Rav said: He saw the deed and recalled the law. He said to Moshe: 'My father's father's brother, did you not teach me when you came down from Mount Sinai that zealots may strike one who has relations with an Aramean woman?' He answered: 'Let the reader of the letter himself be its messenger.'" The source describes the act as narrowly conditioned and not a course authorized through ordinary consultation. Rav Tzadok compares Avraham's self-endangering zeal to this exceptional category; he does not derive a general duty to take such risks.

[254] **Isaiah 57:15** — "For thus says the high and exalted One, who dwells forever and whose name is holy: I dwell on high and in holiness, and with the crushed and lowly of spirit, to revive the spirit of the lowly and to revive the heart of the crushed." The verse joins Divine exaltedness with dwelling beside the lowly. Rav Tzadok sees in this conjunction the access to the hidden, highest degree attained through Avraham's self-abasement.

[255] **Sotah 5a** — "'And with the crushed and lowly of spirit': Rav Huna and Rav Chisda differed. One said: 'The crushed one is with Me'; the other said: 'I am with the crushed one.' It is more reasonable to follow the one who says 'I am with the crushed one,' for the Holy One, blessed be He, left all the mountains and hills and rested His Shechinah upon Mount Sinai; Mount Sinai did not rise upward." The preferred reading describes the Shechinah descending to the humble, rather than the humble being physically raised. It supplies the specific meaning of 'I am with the crushed one' used here.

[256] **Chullin 89a** — "I granted greatness to Avraham, and he said before Me, 'I am dust and ashes'; to Moshe and Aharon, and they said, 'What are we?'; to David, and he said, 'I am a worm and not a man.'" The Gemara praises Israel for becoming smaller in their own eyes when God grants greatness. Rav Tzadok reads Avraham's humility after his miraculous rescue as participation in this pattern.

[257] **Pri Tzaddik, Toldos 1** — "At the trial of the binding it is written, 'Now I know that you fear God': this is Yitzchak's quality, while Avraham's quality was love, as it says, 'Avraham who loves Me.' ... From his extraordinary fear he was afraid to violate Hashem's word, suspecting himself lest some personal attachment to his son be influencing him. ... This is 'Avraham was crowned through Yitzchak': Avraham's completeness up to the supernal crown came through Yitzchak's quality. ... Avraham was crowned through fear, and Yitzchak through love; as the Zohar says, water was included in fire and fire in water." The selected clauses of the cited maamar directly explain why completion of Avraham's love requires the contrary quality of fear. Its intervening discussion also describes the reciprocal completion of Yitzchak through Avraham.

[258] **Genesis 21:12; 22:12** — "God said to Avraham: 'Do not let the matter of the boy and your maidservant be grievous in your eyes. Whatever Sarah tells you, listen to her voice, for through Yitzchak your offspring will be called.' ... He said: 'Do not stretch out your hand against the lad, and do nothing to him; for now I know that you fear God, since you have not withheld your son, your only one, from Me.'" The first verse states the promise concerning Yitzchak; the second, spoken at the end of the binding, identifies Avraham's fear of God. Rav Tzadok explains the trial as obedience beyond Avraham's own understanding of how the promise and the command would be fulfilled.

בְּאֹרַח אֲצִילוּת דְּעִילָּא וְכוּלֵי[259] בִּשְׁלִימוּ דְּאַתְוָן וְכוּלֵי **the Name Havayah in the completeness of its letters, etc., in the way of the Atzilus above," etc.** וּכְשֶׁזּוֹכֶה לִשְׁלֵימוּת **And when one attains completeness** בְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת **in all the worlds,** הוּא שֶׁהֵם כְּנֶגֶד אַרְבַּע אוֹתִיּוֹת הַוָּיָ"ה כַּיָּדוּעַ **which correspond to the four letters of Havayah, as is known,** אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת עוֹלָמוֹת דְּכִיסּוּפִין **that is the four hundred worlds of longing.** וְזֶה עִיקַּר עֵסֶק **And this was the main occupation** אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Avraham Avinu, a"h,** כְּתִיב [יְשַׁעְיָה מא, ח] אַבְרָהָם אוֹהֲבִי **as it is written (Yeshayahu 41:8), "Avraham, who loves Me";** וְהוּא שׁוֹרֵשׁ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל[260] **and he is the root of all Yisrael,** בְּתוֹלַת אֶבְרָהָם[261] **for on Shabbos the Daughter is crowned with the three Avos** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב רד, א) **(as stated in Zohar, vol. 2, 204a),** זוֹכֶה לִקְדוּשַׁת שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **so that every one of Yisrael merits the holiness of the three Avos.** וְכֵן שָׁלֹשׁ מִידוֹת שֶׁמָּנוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **Likewise, the three traits enumerated in the Gemara (Yevamos 79a)** (יְבָמוֹת עט, א) שֶׁהֵם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **as found in Yisrael — merciful, bashful,** רַחְמָנִים בַּיְישָׁנִים וְגוֹמְלֵי חֲסָדִים[262] **and performers of kindness — come from what they merited from the holiness of the three Avos:** הוּא שֶׁזָּכוּ מִקְּדוּשַׁת שְׁלוֹשָׁה הָאָבוֹת **performers of kindness** גּוֹמְלֵי חֲסָדִים **from Avraham Avinu, a"h;** מֵאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **bashful from Yitzchak Avinu, a"h,** וּבַיְישָׁנִים מִיִּצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **from Avraham Avinu, a"h;** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and it is taught (Nedarim 20a):** וְאִיתָא (נְדָרִים כ, א) **"the Fear of Yitzchak" —** פַּחַד יִצְחָק **whose middah is fear —** שֶׁמִּדָּתוֹ הַיִּרְאָה **"And so that His fear may be upon your faces** [שְׁמוֹת כ, יז] וּבְעֲבוּר תִּהְיֶה יִרְאָתוֹ עַל פְּנֵיכֶם **(Shemos 20:17) — this is bashfulness";** זוֹ בּוּשָׁה **and merciful from Yaakov Avinu, a"h,** וְרַחֲמָנִים מִיַּעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם[263] **whose middah is mercy, as is known.** שֶׁמִּדָּתוֹ רַחֲמִים כַּיָּדוּעַ **And every one of**

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[259] Parallel: **Rabbi Levi Yitzchak of Berditchev, Kedushat Levi, Vayera, paragraph 35** — "There are two kinds of performance: a person may carry out a commandment while knowing its reason, or carry it out without knowing its reason. Doing it without knowing its reason is greater, for when the reason is known, it is not evident that he acts from love of the Creator: perhaps he acts because he knows the reason. When he acts without knowing the reason, it is evident that everything is done from love of Hashem.... After the angel announced, 'Do not stretch out your hand against the lad,' it became clear retroactively that Avraham's desire to offer his son upon the altar came from love of Hashem, rather than from a reason. For if there were a reason requiring Yitzchak to be offered, why did the angel command that he not be offered?... Since there was no such reason, everyone knew Avraham's intention: he had done all this solely from fear of Hashem."

Connection: Kedushat Levi adds a particular way to recognize the obedience beyond understanding that Rav Tzadok describes: the command stopping the sacrifice reveals that Avraham's willingness had not depended on his possessing a rationale for it. His discussion also uses both love and fear for that fidelity, complementing Rav Tzadok's account of Avraham's love becoming complete through the fear expressed at the binding.

[260] **Chullin 89a** — "Rava said, or some say Rabbi Yochanan: What is said of Moshe and Aharon is greater than what is said of Avraham. Concerning Avraham it is written, 'I am dust and ashes'; concerning Moshe and Aharon it is written, 'What are we?' Rava said, or some say Rabbi Yochanan: The world endures only on account of Moshe and Aharon. Here it is written, 'What are we?' and there it is written, 'He suspends the earth upon nothing.'" This is a distinct statement from the earlier list of humble responses. Rav Tzadok makes the contrast between 'dust and ashes' and 'what are we?' the basis of Moshe's association with ayin, nothingness.

[261] **Zohar II, Mishpatim 121a** — "It is written, 'Wisdom—from where is it found?' Torah issues from wisdom, from the place called Holy; wisdom issues from the place called the Holy of Holies. Rabbi Yitzchak said: The Jubilee too is called Holy, for it is written, 'It is a Jubilee; it shall be holy for you.' Israel includes these degrees, as it is written, 'You shall be men of holiness to Me.'" The word me-ayin in Job 28:12 can be heard as 'from ayin,' the hidden source beyond wisdom. Rav Tzadok uses the Zohar's hierarchy of Torah, wisdom and the Holy of Holies to explain Moshe's rootedness above ordinary apprehension.

[262] **Zohar II, Beshalach 64b** — "Rabbi Abba said: What is meant by 'Is the Lord in our midst, or nothing?' Were Israel fools who did not know this matter? Had they not seen the Divine Presence before them and the clouds of glory surrounding them? ... Rather, Rabbi Shimon said this: They wished to know the difference between the Ancient One, concealed beyond all concealment, who is called Nothing, and Zeir Anpin, who is called the Lord. ... Why, then, were they punished? Because they made a separation and put it to a test. They said: If it is this One, we will ask in one manner; if it is this One, we will ask in another manner. Therefore, immediately, 'Amalek came.'" The Zohar interprets Israel's question at Massah as a question about the degree from which Divine governance was being revealed. It explicitly names the concealed Atika as Ayin.

[263] **Shemos Rabbah 27:9** — "A king told his servants: 'Guard these two delicate cups for me; take care with them.' As a servant entered the palace, a calf lying at the entrance gored him and one cup broke. The servant stood trembling before the king. 'Why are you trembling?' the king asked. 'A calf gored me and broke one of the two cups.' The king answered: 'If so, take care with the second.' So the Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'At Sinai you poured Me two cups, We shall do and We shall hear. You broke We shall do, making a calf before Me; take care with We shall hear.' Thus, 'Hear the word of Hashem, house of Yaakov.'" This parable preserves 'We shall hear' as the surviving channel of fidelity after the Calf. Rav Tzadok relates it to Moshe, the inward root of Torah, and to the renewed elevation through reading the shekalim passage.

Yisrael יִשׂ בּוֹ מִקְּדוּשַׁת הָאָבוֹת. **has within him some of the holiness of the Avos.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Avraham Avinu, a"h,** הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן **was the first** שֶׁהִכְנִיס בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **who instilled in Yisrael** הַחֵשֶׁק לְקִנְיוֹת הַקְּדוּשָׁה **the yearning to acquire holiness,** שֶׁנָּתַן קִינְטָרִין **for he paid out heavy talents** מֵרוֹב הַחֵשֶׁק **out of the intensity of his yearning** לִקְנוֹת מָקוֹם הַמְקוּדָּשׁ הַזֶּה.[264] **to acquire this sanctified place.** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה נח, ח) וְאִיתָא **And it is found (Bereishis Rabbah 58:8):** כַּמָּה דְיוֹת מִשְׁתַּפְּכוֹת וְכוּ' **"How much ink is spilled, etc.,** לִכְתּוֹב בְּנֵי חֵת **to write 'the children of Ches'** עֶשֶׂר פְּעָמִים וְכוּ' **ten times, etc.,** שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁמְּבָרֵר **for whoever clarifies** מְקוֹמוֹ שֶׁל צַדִּיק **the purchase of a tzaddik** כְּאִילּוּ מְקַיֵּים עֲשָׂרֶת הַדְּבָּרוֹת **is as if he fulfills the Ten Commandments.** אָמַר רַבִּי יוּדָן **Rabbi Yudan said:** חֲמִשָּׁה פְּעָמִים כְּתִיב **Five times it is written** בְּנֵי בַרְזִלַּי **'the sons of Barzilai,'** כְּנֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה סִפְרֵי תוֹרָה **corresponding to the five books of the Torah,** שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁמַּאֲכִיל **for whoever feeds** פְּרוּסָה לְצַדִּיק **a slice of bread to a tzaddik** כְּאִילּוּ מְקַיֵּים חֲמִשָּׁה סִפְרֵי תוֹרָה **is as if he fulfills the five books of the Torah."** וְכָתַב בִּיפֵה תֹּאַר[265] **And the Yefeh To'ar wrote** [עַל בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה שָׁם סִימָן יב **(on Bereishis Rabbah, ibid., siman 12,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל שֶׁכָּל] **s.v. Shekol)** שֶׁאֵין לְהַקְשׁוֹת **that one should not ask** לָמָּה נִרְמַז בִּבְנֵי חֵת עֶשֶׂר **why ten is alluded to with the children of Ches** וּבִבְרְזִלַּי חָמֵשׁ **and five with Barzilai,** כִּי אֵין מַקְשִׁים עַל רְמָזִים.[266] **for one does not raise questions on allusions.** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **But nevertheless we must understand,** שֶׁלֹּא לְחִנָּם **for not for nothing** נִשְׁתַּנָּה הַמִּסְפָּר בַּכָּתוּב. **did the number differ in Scripture.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר **It may be said** דְּעִנְיַן חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **that regarding the five Chumashim of the Torah,** יֵשׁ כְּנֶגְדָּם **corresponding to them are** חָמֵשׁ פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה **the five times "light"** בְּמַאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר[267] **in the utterance "Let there be light"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ג, ה) **(as stated in Bereishis Rabbah 3:5);** וּכְתִיב [מִשְׁלֵי כ, כז **and it is written (Mishlei 20:27),** נֵר ה' נִשְׁמַת אָדָם **"The soul of man is the lamp of Hashem";** וְחָמֵשׁ פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה **and the five times "light"** כְּנֶגֶד חָמֵשׁ מַדְרֵיגוֹת שֶׁבַּנֶּפֶשׁ **correspond to the five levels of the soul** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יד, ט) שֶׁנִּתְחַשְׁבוּ **enumerated (Bereishis Rabbah 14:9):** נֶפֶשׁ רוּחַ נְשָׁמָה חַיָּה יְחִידָה **nefesh, ruach, neshamah, chayah, yechidah.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ[268] **We have already said** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מג, לד בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **regarding what is stated (Bereishis 43:34),** וַתֵּרַב מַשְׂאַת בִּנְיָמִין **"And**

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[264] **Berachos 33b** — "Is fear of Heaven a small matter? ... Yes, with respect to Moshe it is a small matter. For Rabbi Chanina said: It is like a person asked for a large vessel which he possesses: it seems to him like a small vessel. If asked for a small vessel which he does not possess, it seems to him like a large vessel." The earlier note cited this discussion's teaching about the treasury of fear; here the newly relevant continuation explains 'with respect to Moshe.' Rav Tzadok applies it to the portion of Moshe's Torah present within each Jew, rather than limiting it to Moshe alone.

[265] **Chullin 93a; Rashi, s.v. Moshe** — "Rabbi Abba said in Rav Yehudah's name, in Shmuel's name: The blood vessels in the foreleg are forbidden. Rav Safra said: 'Moshe! Did the Merciful One say, Do not eat meat?' Rava said: 'Moshe! Did the Merciful One say, Eat blood? Cut it and salt it, and it is permitted even for cooking in a pot.' Rashi explains: 'Moshe—a Torah scholar.'" Moshe functions here as an honorific address to a scholar in a halachic debate. Rashi's gloss supplies the specific usage from which Rav Tzadok develops his account of each scholar's Torah share as a part of Moshe.

[266] **Vayikra Rabbah 9:3** — "The guest arose and seized Rabbi Yannai, saying: 'My inheritance is with you, and you are withholding it from me!' He asked: 'What inheritance of yours is with me?' He answered: 'Once I passed a school and heard the children's voices saying, Moshe commanded us the Torah, an inheritance of the congregation of Yaakov. It does not say the congregation of Yannai, but the congregation of Yaakov.' He asked him: 'How did you merit to eat at my table?' He answered: 'In all my days I have never repeated an evil report to the person spoken about, and I have never seen two people fighting without making peace between them.' Rabbi Yannai said: 'You possess all this proper conduct, and I called you a dog!' He applied to him: 'One who orders his way'—one who appraises his conduct is of great worth." Rabbi Yannai had found that his guest lacked learning and had disparaged him. The guest's protest establishes that Torah is the inheritance of every member of Yaakov's congregation, including the unlearned; his conduct then reveals the worth Rabbi Yannai had overlooked.

[267] **Pesikta Rabbasi 10, the passage cited as section 11** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moshe: 'Moshe, exalt this nation as much as you can, for it is as though you exalt Me.' It says, 'When you lift up the head of the children of Israel.' It does not say, 'When you lift up the children of Israel,' but 'the head'; Israel's head is none other than the Holy One, blessed be He, as it says, 'Their king passed before them, and Hashem at their head.' To what is this comparable? To someone fashioning a crown and setting precious stones and pearls in it. A passerby saw him and said: 'Set into it as much as you can, for it is destined to be placed upon the king's head.' ... So the Holy One said to Moshe: 'Take care with this nation: of all the nations I created, it was the first to proclaim Me King, as it says, This is my God, and I will glorify Him.'" The crown parable makes Israel's elevation an adornment of the Divine King. The digital edition presents this within chapter 10 without the manuscript's section number; the exact passage and proof verse were checked.

[268] **Vayikra Rabbah 24:9** — "Likewise: 'You shall be holy.' Could this mean like Me? Scripture therefore says, 'For I am holy': My holiness is above your holiness." The Midrash's plain comparison preserves the distinction between Divine and human holiness. Rav Tzadok next cites a chassidic rereading of the same words: the holiness manifested above is 'from your holiness.' His ensuing argument relates the two readings.

Binyamin's portion was larger מִמַּשְׂאֵת כּוּלָּם חָמֵשׁ יָדוֹת **than the portions of all of them fivefold,"** דְּלִשׁוֹן וַתֵּרַב **that the expression "was larger"** מַשְׁמַע שֶׁרָבְתָה מֵעַצְמָהּ. **implies that it grew of itself.** שֶׁיּוֹסֵף חִילֵּק לְאֶחָיו **For Yosef distributed to his brothers** מִשְּׁיָרֵי סְעוּדַת שַׁבָּת שֶׁלּוֹ **from the remnants of his Shabbos meal —** דְּהָיָה וּבְבִנְיָמִין נִתְרַבָּה הַקְּדוּשָׁה — [בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה צב, ז] סְעוּדַת שַׁבָּת[269] **for it was a Shabbos meal (Bereishis Rabbah 92:7) —** כְּנֶגֶד חָמֵשׁ מַדְרֵיגוֹת שֶׁבַּנֶּפֶשׁ הַנִּזְכָּר **and in Binyamin the holiness multiplied fivefold, corresponding to the five levels of the soul mentioned;** וְכֵן שָׁרְתָה שְׁכִינָה **and likewise the Shechinah rested** בַּחֲמִשָּׁה מְקוֹמוֹת **in five places** בְּחֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל בִּנְיָמִין[270] **in the portion of Binyamin** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מִקֵּץ מַאֲמָר ו **(as explained in Mikeitz, ma'amar 6,** עַיֵּין שָׁם[271] וַיִּגַּשׁ סוֹף מַאֲמָר ז) **and Vayigash, end of ma'amar 7; see there).** וְכָל זֶה פּוֹעֵל **And all this operates** בְּקִיּוּם הַחַיִּים **in the sustaining of life:** לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחְמִי **"Come, partake of My bread" —** שֶׁהוּא הַקְּדוּשָׁה שֶׁבַּמַּאֲכָל[272] **which is the holiness within food,** כִּי לֹא עַל [דְּבָרִים ח, ג] כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Devarim 8:3),** הַלֶּחֶם לְבַדּוֹ **"For not by bread alone** יִחְיֶה הָאָדָם **does man live,** כִּי עַל כָּל מוֹצָא פִי ה׳ **but by all that comes from the mouth of Hashem** יִחְיֶה הָאָדָם[273] **does man live";** וְהַיְינוּ הַקְּדוּשָׁה שֶׁבַּמַּאֲכָל **this is the holiness within food,** שֶׁהוּא קִיּוּם הַחַיִּים **which is the sustenance of life.** וְעַל כֵּן הַמַּאֲכִיל פְּרוֹסָה לְצַדִּיק **Therefore, one who feeds a slice of bread to a tzaddik —** כְּמוֹ בַּרְזִלַּי **like Barzilai,** שֶׁהֶאֱכִיל לְדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **who fed David HaMelech, a"h,** בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁהָיָה גּוֹלֶה **when he was a fugitive in exile,** וְהָיָה מְפַחֵד מִטַּעֲנוֹת **and was afraid of the charges** שֶׁהָיָה עָלָיו **that were against him,** שֶׁפָּגַם חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **that he had blemished, chas v'shalom,** בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם **the middah of "the tzaddik, foundation of the world";** וְהוּא הֶאֱכִיל פְּרוֹסָה לְצַדִּיק **and he fed a slice of bread to a tzaddik,** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת כָּל הָאוֹמֵר **for in truth, "whoever says** דָּוִד חָטָא אֵינוֹ אֶלָּא טוֹעֶה[274] **David sinned is simply mistaken"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת נו, א) **(as stated in Shabbos 56a) —** וְהוּא כְּאִלּוּ מְקַיֵּים **it is as if he fulfills** חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **the five Chumashim of the Torah,** שֶׁכְּנֶגְדָּם חָמֵשׁ פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה **corresponding to which are the five times "light"** וְחָמֵשׁ מַדְרֵיגוֹת **and the five levels:** נֶפֶשׁ רוּחַ נְשָׁמָה חַיָּה יְחִידָה. **nefesh, ruach, neshamah, chayah,**

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[269] **Vayikra Rabbah 24:4** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moshe: 'Go, say to Israel: My children, just as I am separate, so shall you be separate; just as I am holy, so shall you be holy.' Thus it is written: 'You shall be holy.'" This passage commands imitation, while the preceding passage maintains that Divine holiness exceeds human holiness. Rav Tzadok explains how separation from worldly absorption can lead to a continually deeper recognition of that transcendence.

[270] **Yoma 39a** — "The Sages taught: 'Sanctify yourselves and you shall be holy.' If a person sanctifies himself a little, he is sanctified greatly; if he sanctifies himself below, he is sanctified above; if he sanctifies himself in this world, he is sanctified in the World to Come." The response from above exceeds the person's initial act below. Rav Tzadok explains this increasing sanctification as the capacity to perceive a holiness still beyond what one has attained.

[271] **Pri Tzaddik, Yisro 7** — "Hashem is beyond all apprehension, and the description 'holy' does not apply to Him in Himself. It is only because Israel recognizes His holiness—this recognition being that He is holy, separated from every apprehension—that Hashem is called holy. ... 'You are holy, enthroned upon the praises of Israel': through Israel's praises He is called holy, because they recognize His holiness and kingship." The English selects the precise clauses relevant to the present argument. Rav Tzadok's earlier discussion grounds the designation 'holy' in Israel's recognition and praise; it does not suggest a change in God's essence.

[272] Parallel: **Kedushas Levi, Vaera, s.v. Vaera el Avraham** — "In truth, the more a person sanctifies and purifies himself and serves Hashem, the more he knows that he has not yet begun to serve Him at all. A person who thinks he already serves Hashem shows that he is not serving Him; were he serving Him, he would know how far he is from Hashem. This is 'My holiness recedes ever higher above your holiness': the more you add to your sanctification, the more you see that you are far from the Holy One's holiness. ... Alternatively, it may be explained through the Sages' statement that Israel adds strength to the heavenly company. The more Israel sanctifies itself, the more it adds strength and holiness above. This is 'My holiness above is from your holiness': through your holiness My holiness is elevated and exalted ever higher."

Connection: Kedushas Levi states both readings invoked here: growth in holiness reveals greater distance from God, and Israel's sanctification increases the manifestation of holiness above. Rav Tzadok connects them by locating the latter in the deeper recognition that human sanctification makes possible.

[273] **Genesis 41:32** — "As for the dream being repeated to Pharaoh twice: the matter is firmly established by God, and God is hastening to do it." Yosef explains why Pharaoh saw the same decree in two dreams. Rav Tzadok applies the conjunction of confirmation and haste to the doubled sanctity of Shabbos and the shekalim reading.

[274] **Zohar Chadash, beginning of Ki Sisa** — "What does 'everyone who passes over the counted ones' mean? This is one who transgresses his Master's commandments. If he wishes to be repaired before his Master, so that the judgment above will not rule over him: 'This they shall give.' He must give zeh, bringing it near to zot and illuminating it with radiance, so that the world will not burn in its flames. For one who transgresses his Master's commandments separates zeh from zot. He must therefore repair that place and lift his head before judgment, so that judgment will not rule over him." The exposition hears "passes over" as "transgresses" and treats the masculine zeh and feminine zot as the two sides of a union damaged by sin. Rav Tzadok now explains the spiritual meaning of each.

yechidah. וּבְמִקָּחוֹ שֶׁל צַדִּיק **And in the purchase of the tzaddik,** שֶׁהוּא מְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה **which is the Cave of Machpelah,** שֶׁבּוֹ נִקְבַּר אַף הַגּוּף **in which even the body is buried,** בּוֹ נִרְמַז מִסְפַּר קוֹמָה שְׁלֵימָה **there is alluded the number of a complete stature,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּחְשַׁב בִּפְתִיחַת אֵלִיָּהוּ **as enumerated in Pesach Eliyahu** (הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר יז, א) **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar 17a) —** כִּי נִרְמַז עֶשֶׂר פְּעָמִים[275] **all ten sefiros;** כָּל הָעֲשָׂר סְפִירוֹת **therefore it is alluded ten times,** עַל כֵּן שֶׁהֵם אֶחָד **corresponding to the Ten Commandments,** כְּנֶגֶד עֲשֶׂרֶת הַדִּבְּרוֹת **which are one with the ten sefiros,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּזְכַּר (רֵישׁ מַאֲמָר ד) עִם עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **as mentioned (beginning of ma'amar 4)** מֵהַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. **from the holy Zohar.** וְלָכֵן נָתַן אָז **Therefore there gave, at that time,** אַבְרָהָם אֲבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Avraham Avinu, a"h,** אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שְׁקָלִים **four hundred shekels,** שֶׁהוּא אַרְבַּע פְּעָמִים מֵאָה **which is four times one hundred,** שֶׁהוּא עֶשֶׂר פְּעָמִים עֶשֶׂר **that is, ten times ten** כָּאָמוּר בְּכָל אַרְבָּעָה עוֹלָמוֹת. **in each of the four worlds, as stated.** וְהַשְּׁקָלִים דְּמִקְדָּשׁ גַּם כֵּן **And the shekels of the Mikdash, too,** בָּאוּ לְכַפֵּר עֲוֹן הָעֵגֶל **came to atone for the sin of the Golden Calf,** שֶׁכָּפְרוּ בַּעֲשֶׂרֶת הַדִּבְּרוֹת **in which they denied the Ten Commandments,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי וּפְסִיקְתָּא **as they said in the Yerushalmi and Pesikta** וּמִדְרָשׁ שֶׁזָּכַרְנוּ (בְּמַאֲמָר ה) **and the Midrash we cited (in ma'amar 5);** וְזֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים זְכוֹר לִי **and this is why we say, "Remember for me** שִׁקְלֵי עֶפְרוֹן וְכוּלֵי. **the shekels of Efron," etc.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אוֹמְרִים **And afterward we say,** חֲקוֹר **"Search out the shekels of the Jebusite,** מַשְׁבִּיתֵי חָרוֹן **which put an end to wrath";** וְזֶהוּ מְפוֹרָשׁ בַּכָּתוּב **and this is explicit in Scripture:** שֶׁאַחַר שֶׁקָּנָה דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **for after David HaMelech, a"h, purchased** מָקוֹם בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **the site of the Beis HaMikdash,** כְּתִיב [שְׁמוּאֵל ב כד, כה] **it is written (Shmuel II 24:25),** וַיֵּעָתֵר ה' לָאָרֶץ **"And Hashem was entreated for the land,** וְגוֹ' וַתֵּעָצַר הַמַּגֵּפָה[276] **and the plague was stayed," etc. —** וְהַיְינוּ הַמַּגֵּפָה **that is, the plague** שֶׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי **that came about because** שֶׁסִּיפֵּר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **he counted Yisrael.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **We have already said,** בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שְׁמוֹת לב, לד] **regarding what is stated (Shemos 32:34),** הַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה **"And on the day I make account, I will account," etc.,** וּבְיוֹם פָּקְדִי וּפָקַדְתִּי וְגוֹ' **that at the time** שֶׁיִּפָּקְדוּ אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **when Yisrael are counted** וְיִמְנוּ אוֹתָם **and they are numbered,** אָז וּפָקַדְתִּי **then "I will account" —** שֶׁמִּתְעוֹרֵר עֲוֹון הָעֵגֶל **the sin of the Calf is aroused** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וּבְפִסְיקְתָּא עַיֵּין שָׁם) **(as explained in ma'amar 1, beginning "And in the Pesikta"; see there);** וְהַשְּׁקָלִים בָּאִים **and the shekels come** לְכַפֵּר קִלְקוּל הָעֵגֶל. **to atone for the corruption of the Calf.** וְכֵן הוֹעִילוּ שִׁקְלֵי יְבוּסִי **And so the shekels of the Jebusite were effective,** כְּשֶׁגָּבָה דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **when David HaMelech, a"h, collected** חֲמִשִּׁים שְׁקָלִים מִכָּל שֵׁבֶט **fifty shekels from each tribe** לִקְנוֹת מְקוֹם הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. **to purchase the site of the Mikdash.** וְלָכֵן מַזְכִּירִין אוֹתָם **Therefore we mention them** כָּאן גַּם כֵּן **here as well,** כְּדֵי לִזְכּוֹת לְהַכְתָּרִים. **in order to merit the crowns.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אוֹמְרִים **And afterward we say,** אוֹר פָּנֶיךָ עָלֵינוּ **"The light of Your countenance upon us,** שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לְהַכְתָּרִים **that we may merit the crowns** דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **of Matan Torah;** וְזֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים אֵל רָם וְנִשָּׂא **and this is why we say, "God, high and exalted,"** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל מִדַּת עַתִּיקָא: **which points to the middah of Atika.**

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[275] **Taanis 31a, on Yeshayahu 25:9** — "Ulla of Bira said in Rabbi Elazar's name: In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will make a circle for the righteous, and He will sit among them in the Garden of Eden. Each one will point with his finger, as it says: 'It will be said on that day: Behold, this is our God; we hoped for Him and He saved us. This is Hashem, for whom we hoped; let us rejoice and be glad in His salvation.'"

[276] **Mekhilta, Beshalach, Shirah 3; Zohar II, 64b** — "Rabbi Eliezer says: From where do you say that a maidservant saw at the sea what Yeshayahu and Yechezkel did not see? It says: 'Through the prophets I convey likenesses,' and: 'The heavens opened and I saw visions of God.' A human king enters a city surrounded by guards, mighty men to his right and left and soldiers before and behind; people ask which one is the king. But when the Holy One, blessed be He, appeared at the sea, none needed to ask who He was. Once they saw Him, they recognized Him, and all opened their mouths and said: 'This is my God, and I will glorify Him.'" Zohar II, 64b likewise invokes the maidservant's vision when asking how Israel, after seeing the Divine Presence at the sea, could ask whether Hashem was in their midst. The Mekhilta's point is immediate recognition, the aspect of zeh developed here.

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ז׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Zayin

וּמִקּוֹדֶם אוֹמְרִים גַּם כֵּן **Earlier, too, we say** [בְּפִיּוּט לְבִרְכַּת אַתָּה גִּבּוֹר] **(in the piyut for the blessing Atah Gibbor):** אָנֹכִי עָפָר וָאֵפֶר **"And may He remember for you the merit of the one who declared,** וְיִזְכּוֹר לָכֶם זְכוּת נָם **'I am dust and ashes.'"** וְאִיתָא בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה מט, יא) **And it is found in Midrash Rabbah (Bereishis Rabbah 49:11):** אִילּוּ הָרָגַנִי אַמְרָפֶל **"Had Amrafel killed me,** לֹא הָיִיתִי עָפָר **would I not have been dust?** וְאִילּוּ שְׂרָפַנִי נִמְרוֹד **And had Nimrod burned me,** לֹא הָיִיתִי אֵפֶר[277] **would I not have been ash?" etc.** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ דִּבְשָׁנֵי עִנְיָנִים אֵלּוּ **This is as we say, that in these two matters** עָשָׂה אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Avraham Avinu, a"h, acted** וְהַיְינוּ בְּמָסִירוּת נֶפֶשׁ נֶגֶד הַדִּין **with mesiras nefesh beyond the strict law,** שֶׁנָּתַן נַפְשׁוֹ **that is, giving up his life** בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וּבָעוֹלָם הַבָּא. **in this world and in the World to Come.** דִּבְנִסְיוֹן כִּבְשַׁן הָאֵשׁ דְּנִמְרוֹד **For in the test of the fiery furnace of Nimrod** לֹא הָיָה מְצוּוֶּה עַל קִדּוּשׁ הַשֵּׁם **he was not commanded regarding Kiddush Hashem,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁבֶּן נֹחַ אֵינוֹ מְצוּוֶּה עַל זֶה[278] **for a Ben Noach is not commanded about this,** בֶּן נֹחַ מְצוּוֶּה **while not to destroy himself** וְשֶׁלֹּא לְאַבֵּד עַצְמוֹ **as they said (Sanhedrin 74b);** שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סַנְהֶדְרִין עד, ב) **a Ben Noach is commanded,** וְאַךְ אֶת דִּמְכֶם לְנַפְשֹׁתֵיכֶם[279] וְגוֹ׳ **as it says (Bereishis 9:5),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּרֵאשִׁית ט, ה] **"But your blood of your lives I will demand," etc.,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה לד, ח) **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 34:8).** וּלְשִׁיטַת הָרַמְבַּ״ם **And according to the Rambam's view** (פֶּרֶק ה מֵהִלְכוֹת יְסוֹדֵי הַתּוֹרָה הֲלָכָה ד) **(Hilchos Yesodei HaTorah 5:4),** מִי שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בּוֹ **one of whom it is said,** יַעֲבוֹר וְאַל יֵהָרֵג **"Let him transgress and not be killed,"** וְנֶהֱרַג וְלֹא עָבַר **who was killed rather than transgress —** הֲרֵי זֶה מִתְחַיֵּב בְּנַפְשׁוֹ[280] **he is liable for his own life;** וְרַק מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבָּעֲרָה בּוֹ **only because there burned within him** אַהֲבַת ה׳ **the love of Hashem** מָסַר נַפְשׁוֹ **did he give over his life, and his soul as well;** וְאַף שֶׁיַּפְסִיד חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **and even if he would lose, chas v'shalom,** חֶלְקוֹ לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **his share in the World to Come,** מַה בְּכָךְ **what of it,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁרְצוֹנוֹ **since his desire is** שֶׁיִּתְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם עַל יָדוֹ **that the Name of Heaven be sanctified through him** וְיִתְפָּרְסַם אֱלָהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ. **and His Divinity, blessed be His Name, become known.** וְכֵן בְּמִלְחֶמֶת אַרְבָּעָה מְלָכִים **So too in the war of the four kings,** מַה שֶּׁהָיוּ רֹאשׁוֹנִים שֶׁבָּעֲרָה בּוֹ קִנְאַת ה׳ **zeal for Hashem burned within him because they were the first** שֶׁפָּתְחוּ בְּמִלְחָמָה **to open with war,** (תַּנְחוּמָא לֶךְ לְךָ ז) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Tanchuma, Lech Lecha 7):** [תְּהִלִּים לז, יד] חֶרֶב פָּתְחוּ רְשָׁעִים **"The wicked have drawn the sword" (Tehillim 37:14) —** וְכוּלֵי[281] שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה מִלְחָמָה בָּעוֹלָם **for there had been no war in the world, etc.;** וְרוֹצֵחַ חַיָּיב מִיתָה **and a**

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[277] **Zohar II, 37b** — "Thus we have learned: This crown that is called zot is called 'woman,' as it says, 'This one shall be called woman.' Why? 'For from man was this one taken.' Who is the man? The one called zeh. This is the male man, as it says, 'For this Moshe, the man.' He is called 'this man,' and zot is taken from zeh, who is called male." This is the source for the paired demonstratives. The identification of zot with Malchus is part of the passage's symbolic account of the feminine crown.

[278] **Zohar III, 230a** — "The masters of the Mishnah established: Study is not the principal thing, but action. For the Holy One, blessed be He, is concealed in the mysteries of Torah. Through what is He made known? Through the commandments, which are His Shechinah, His image. Just as He is humble, His Shechinah is humility; He is chasid, and she is chasidah; He is mighty, and she rules over all the nations of the world. He is truth, and she is faith; He is king, and she is kingship; He is wise, and she is His wisdom; He is crown, and she is His diadem." The paired attributes belong to an explanation of inward divinity becoming manifest through the Shechinah and mitzvos. Rav Tzadok develops the particular pair "truth" and "faith."

[279] **Pesachim 56a** — "Yaakov sought to reveal the end of days to his sons, but the Shechinah departed from him. He said: Perhaps, Heaven forbid, there is a disqualification among my children, as Avraham had Yishmael and my father Yitzchak had Esav. His sons said to him: 'Hear, Israel, Hashem is our God, Hashem is One.' They said: Just as there is only One in your heart, so there is only One in our hearts. At that moment Yaakov our father began and said: 'Blessed is the name of the glory of His kingdom forever and ever.'" The words are addressed to their father Israel. The sons affirm the same exclusive allegiance to the One whom Yaakov knows; Rav Tzadok explains their unity of faith without assuming an identical degree of revelation.

[280] **Zohar III, 256b** — "The first commandment is called Anochi from the side of Keter, which is the Ayin of 'our God.' Anochi contains kaf—Keter—and contains ayin. Keter is called so from the side of the supernal Mother, in relation to whom the Torah mentions the departure from Egypt fifty times." The source reads the letters of Anochi symbolically. The kaf, whose numerical value is twenty, supplies Rav Tzadok's connection with the twenty gerah of a complete shekel.

[281] **Zohar Chadash, Ki Sisa, opening discussion** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, and Knesses Yisrael are called One; when Knesses Yisrael is in exile, that oneness is not manifest. Therefore the half shekel, ten gerah—the mystery of yud—must be drawn down to illuminate the place that was damaged. This is truly the ransom of his soul: through that half shekel judgment is removed. When good and the soul cleave together as one, it is called the sacred shekel, and

murderer is liable to death בְּדִינֵי בְּנֵי נֹחַ **under the Noahide laws;** מִכָּל מָקוֹם עַל פִּי דִּין **nevertheless, by law** לֹא הָיָה מְחוּיָב **he was not obligated,** וְלֹא הָיָה רַשַּׁאי לְמָסוֹר עַצְמוֹ לְרִדּוּף **nor was he permitted, to endanger himself by pursuing** עִם אֱלִיעֶזֶר לְבַדּוֹ[282] **with Eliezer alone,** (נְדָרִים לב, א) לְפִי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **according to what they said (Nedarim 32a);** וְאַף לְמַאן דְּאָמַר שָׁלֹשׁ מֵאוֹת וּשְׁמוֹנָה עָשָׂר אִישׁ כִּפְשׁוּטוֹ **and even according to the view that there were literally three hundred eighteen men,** מַה זֶּה נֶחְשָׁב **what does that amount to** נֶגֶד חֵילוֹת הָאַרְבָּעָה מְלָכִים **against the armies of the four kings?** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **And about this they said** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה מב, ח) **(Bereishis Rabbah 42:8):** אַבְרָהָם זֶה קוֹנְיָוֹן הוּא **"Avraham — he is a zealot,"** שֶׁהָיָה רַק מִקִּנְאַת ה'[283] **for it was only from the zeal for Hashem** שֶׁבָּעֲרָה בּוֹ **that burned within him** לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹן ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **to do the will of Hashem Yisbarach,** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת וַיִּשְׁלַח מַאֲמָר ו) אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְחוּיָב[284] **even though he was not obligated (as explained in Parshas Vayishlach, ma'amar 6).** וְהוּא כְּעֵין מַה שֶׁמָּצִינוּ **This resembles what we find** בְּפִינְחָס [בְּמִדְבַּר כה, יא] בְּקַנְאוֹ אֶת קִנְאָתִי[285] **with Pinchas, "when he avenged My zeal" (Bamidbar 25:11):** דְּקַנָּאִין פּוֹגְעִין בּוֹ **that zealots may strike him,** וְהַבָּא לְיַמְלֵךְ אֵין מוֹרִין לוֹ **yet one who comes to ask is not instructed so,** שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְחוּיָב לְמָסוֹר עַצְמוֹ **for he is not obligated to endanger himself,** שֶׁאִם נָהְפַּךְ זִמְרִי **since had Zimri turned around** וַהֲרָגוֹ לְפִינְחָס **and killed Pinchas,** אֵין נֶהֱרָג עָלָיו **he would not be executed for him;** רַק מִי שֶׁבּוֹעֵר בְּלִבּוֹ קִנְאַת ה' **only one in whose heart the zeal for Hashem burns** הוּא בִּכְלַל קַנָּאִין **is in the category of zealots** דְּפוֹגְעִין בּוֹ. **who may strike him.** וְלָכֵן אָמַר לוֹ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ לְפִינְחָס **Therefore Moshe Rabbeinu said to Pinchas,** קְרֵיֵנָא דְּאִיגַּרְתָּא[286] אִיהוּ לֶיהֱוֵי פָּרְוָונָקָא **"Let the one who reads the letter be the one to carry it out"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁכֵּיוָן שֶׁבּוֹ בּוֹעֵר הַקִּנְאָה **(as they said all this in Sanhedrin 82a), for since the zeal burns within him,** כָּל זֶה בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין פב, א). הוּא בִּכְלַל קַנָּאִין וְכוּ' **he is in the category of zealots, etc.** וְכֵן הָיָה עִנְיַן אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And so was the case of Avraham Avinu, a"h,** בְּמִלְחֲמוֹת הַמְּלָכִים[287] **in the war of the kings;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **and**

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silver, the King's right side, is aroused toward the offering of Hashem."

[282] **Yerushalmi Shekalim 2:3; Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 10** — "Rabbi Yehudah and Rabbi Nechemiah differed: One said, because they sinned at midday, they shall give half a shekel; the other said, because they sinned in the sixth hour, they shall give a half shekel equal to six small coins. Rabbi Yehoshua son of Rabbi Nechemiah said in Rabban Yochanan ben Zakkai's name: Because they transgressed the Ten Commandments, each shall give ten gerah. Rabbi Pinchas said in Rabbi Levi's name: Because they sold Rachel's firstborn for twenty pieces of silver, and each received a coin, each shall give his shekel as a coin." Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 10, also gives the midday, six-hour, Ten Commandments and sale-of-Yosef explanations. The Yerushalmi additionally relates the twenty silver pieces to redemption of a firstborn. These are distinct formulations, rather than a single undifferentiated statement.

[283] **Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 5; Vayikra Rabbah 8:1** — "Rabbi Yonah interpreted the verse concerning the expression zeh: With zeh they were brought low, and with zeh they were raised. With zeh they were brought low: 'For this Moshe, the man.' With zeh they were raised: 'This they shall give.' This is what Scripture says: 'Righteousness raises a nation.'" Vayikra Rabbah 8:1 preserves the same contrast. Both passages also contrast Aharon's involvement in "this calf" with "this is the offering of Aharon and his sons."

[284] **Zohar Chadash, Ki Sisa, on the sale of Yosef** — "Come and see: This ransom is fit to atone for the ten tribes who sold Yosef, separated zeh from zot, and transgressed their Master's commandments. Therefore the shekel is twenty gerah, corresponding to the one who sojourned in a foreign land, was removed from the Holy Land, and was sold for twenty. From that hour Israel could not lift their heads because of that sin. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moshe: If you wish to lift their heads above, 'This they shall give'—kol."

[285] **Zohar Chadash, Ki Sisa, on Kol and Knesses Yisrael** — "Come and see: that Righteous One is called All, and the Congregation of Israel, the tenth of them all, is included in him. When they draw near to one another, they are called the holy shekel, because he is half a body and the Congregation of Israel is half a body. They join one another, and the body becomes complete. The twelve tribes beneath the sea draw nourishment, each one from its own place. This is what is written, 'This they shall give': 'this' has the numerical value twelve, corresponding to those who cling around the supernal Tabernacle." The half shekel is explained here through mutual completion. Kol, "all," is a title of the tzaddik, the channel of Yesod; the feminine side is Knesses Yisrael.

[286] **Zohar III, 176b** — "The supernal holiness is known. The lower holiness is the wisdom of Shlomo; she too is summoned with all her hosts. All those hosts are ready to be crowned with this lower holiness when the appointed season rests upon the world. As her hosts stand above, so the appointed leaders of the people stand below after her pattern." "The wisdom of Shlomo" is the source's symbolic designation for the lower wisdom. Its contrast with supernal holiness supports Rav Tzadok's distinction between the two aspects of the sacred shekel.

[287] **Zohar III, 297a** — "Rabbi Elazar said: The beginning and ending of everything are included in holiness. Supernal Chochmah is called Holy, and when this supernal Chochmah shines, the wisdom of Shlomo shines, as it says, 'Shlomo's wisdom increased'—the moon stands in its fullness. When she is blessed from Yesod, we call her Holy, for he illuminates her completely. When she is not illuminated and crowned in fullness, we call her 'the spirit of holiness,' but she is not called Holy like the one above." The source ties the lower wisdom's title "Holy" specifically to receiving from Yesod. It therefore clarifies the role assigned here to Yosef, the tzaddik.

this is what they said in the Midrash, אַבְרָהָם זֶה קוֹנְיוֹן הוּא. **"Avraham — he is a zealot."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר **And this is what he said:** דְּאִילּוּ הֲרָגַנִי אַמְרָפֶל **"Had Amrafel killed me,** לֹא הָיִיתִי עָפָר **would I not have been dust,** וְאִילּוּ שְׂרָפַנִי נִמְרוֹד **and had Nimrod burned me,** לֹא הָיִיתִי אֵפֶר **would I not have been ash?"** — רַק שֶׁה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ הִסְכִּים עִם יִשַּׂשכָר בִּלְבַד[288] וְעָשָׂה לוֹ נֵס **only Hashem Yisbarach concurred with him and performed a miracle for him,** עַל יָדוֹ שֶׁנִּתְכַּוֵּין לִרְצוֹן ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **because he intended the will of Hashem Yisbarach** בִּשְׁנֵי עִנְיָנִים אֵלּוּ. **in these two matters.** וְאָז כֵּיוָן שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה שָׁפָל בְּעֵינָיו **Then, since he became lowly in his own eyes,** לִהְיוֹת כָּעָפָר וָאֵפֶר **to be like dust and ashes,** כְּבָר זָכָה לְבְחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **he had already merited the level of Atika,** [יְשַׁעְיָה נז, טו] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Yeshayahu 57:15),** כִּי כֹה אָמַר רָם וְנִשָּׂא וְגוֹ' **"For thus says the High and Exalted One," etc.,** מָרוֹם וְקָדוֹשׁ אֶשְׁכּוֹן וְגוֹ'[289] וְאֶת דַּכָּא וּשְׁפַל רוּחַ **"On high and in holiness I dwell," etc.** **and with the crushed and lowly of spirit,"** רָם וְנִשָּׂא מָרוֹם וְקָדוֹשׁ **"High and Exalted," "on high and in holiness,"** מוֹרֶה עַל עַתִּיקָא **point to Atika,** שֶׁכָּל הַנֶּעְלָם **which is utterly concealed,** שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מֵהַתְפִּיסָה **beyond all grasp;** וּכְתִיב וְאֶת דַּכָּא **and it is written, "and with the crushed,"** (סוֹטָה ה, א) וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (Sotah 5a):** אֲנִי אֶת דַּכָּא **"I am with the crushed."** וְכֵן בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ[290] עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **So too with Avraham Avinu, a"h:** אַחַר שֶׁהִמְעִיט אֶת עַצְמוֹ **after he diminished himself,** אַחַר שֶׁזָּכָה לִגְדוּלָה **after having attained greatness** מֵה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **from Hashem Yisbarach,** עַל שֶׁהִסְכִּים **who concurred with his deeds,** וְאָז אָמַר וְאָנֹכִי עָפָר וָאֵפֶר **and then he said, "I am dust and ashes"** (בְּרֵאשִׁית יח, כז) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (חוּלִּין פט, א) **(this is what they said in Chullin 89a,** נָתַתִּי גְּדוּלָה וְכוּלֵי[291] **"I bestowed greatness," etc.,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר) **as explained elsewhere) —** אָז זָכָה לְמַה שֶׁכָּתוּב **then he merited what is written,** אֲנִי אֶת דַּכָּא **"I am with the crushed,"** שֶׁהוּא רָם וְנִשָּׂא מָרוֹם וְזָכָה לִבְחִינַת עַתִּיקָא[292] **and he merited the level of Atika,** שֶׁהוּא **which is "High and Exalted, on high and in holiness."** וְקָדוֹשׁ. **But to be refined in all the middos,** אַךְ לְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּכָל הַמִּדּוֹת עֶשֶׂר פְּעָמִים עֶשֶׂר **ten times ten —** זֶה זָכָה רַק **this he merited only** אַחַר נִסָּיוֹן הָעֲשִׂירִי **after the tenth test,** דִּכְתִיב אַחַר הָעֲקֵידָה [בְּרֵאשִׁית כד, א] **for it is written after the Akeidah (Bereishis 24:1),** וְאַבְרָהָם זָקֵן בָּא בַּיָּמִים **"And Avraham was old, coming into days"** — שֶׁנִּתְבָּרֵר בִּשְׁלֹשׁ רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת **that he was refined in the three upper levels,** [זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קכט, א] יוֹמִין עִלָּאִין. **the supernal days (Zohar, vol. 1, 129a).** שֶׁאָז מָסַר עַצְמוֹ **For then he gave himself over** לְמַעְלָה מֵהַשָּׂגָתוֹ **beyond his own understanding,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we said,** שֶׁלְּפִי מִדָּתוֹ **that according to his middah** לֹא הָיָה צָרִיךְ לִשְׁמוֹעַ **he would not have had to heed** לְנִסָּיוֹן הָעֲקֵידָה **the test of the Akeidah,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁכָּל עִיקַּר תִּקְוָתוֹ הָיָה **since his entire hope was** שֶׁיִּתְפָּרְסֵם אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ שְׁמוֹ **that His Divinity,**

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[288] **Zohar II, 166b** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, sowed this light in His Garden of Eden, making it row upon row through that righteous one who is the garden's gardener. He takes this light, sows it as a seed of truth, and makes it row upon row in the garden; it gives birth, sprouts, and makes fruit, from which the world is nourished. This is 'Light is sown for the righteous.' ... These are the seeds of the first light, continually sown: now they give birth and make fruit, and now they are being sown. Before the world eats this fruit, that seed already gives birth and yields further fruit, without ceasing." The gardener receives and plants the primordial light, rather than originating it. This is the precise connection with Yosef transmitting illumination to Malchus.

[289] **Shabbos 86b** — "The Rabbis taught: On the sixth of the month the Ten Commandments were given to Israel; Rabbi Yosei says, on its seventh. Rava said: All agree that they came to the wilderness of Sinai on Rosh Chodesh. ... And all agree that the Torah was given to Israel on Shabbos. ... Their dispute concerns the fixing of the month."

[290] **Zohar I, 47b** — "'God completed on the seventh day'—this is the Oral Torah, which is the seventh day. Through it the world was completed, for it is the sustaining foundation of all. 'His work which He had made,' but not 'all His work,' for the Written Torah brought forth everything through the power of the writing that issues from wisdom. Three times 'the seventh day' is mentioned here: 'God completed on the seventh day,' 'He ceased on the seventh day,' and 'God blessed the seventh day.' ... This is the Oral Torah, for with this seventh day the world was completed." The source expressly identifies the seventh day with the Oral Torah and places it beside the Written Torah's emergence from Chochmah. This supports the twofold illumination with which the maamar concludes.

[291] **Shabbos 146a** — "When the serpent came upon Chavah, it cast impurity into her. Israel, who stood at Mount Sinai, had their impurity cease; the nations, who did not stand at Mount Sinai, did not have their impurity cease. Rav Acha son of Rava asked Rav Ashi: What of converts? He answered: Though they themselves were not there, their heavenly counterparts were present, as it is written, 'With those who stand here with us today before Hashem our God, and with those who are not here with us today.'"

[292] **Eruvin 18b** — "Rabbi Yirmiyah ben Elazar said: During all the years that Adam was under a ban he begot spirits, demons and lilin, as it says, 'Adam lived one hundred and thirty years and begot in his likeness, after his image'—implying that until then he had not begotten after his image. Rabbi Meir said: Adam was greatly pious. When he saw that death had been decreed through him, he fasted for one hundred and thirty years, separated from his wife for one hundred and thirty years, and wore a belt of fig branches for one hundred and thirty years." The Gemara reconciles the accounts by explaining that the former refers to involuntary emission. Its description of the 130 years is the background here; the connection with the sale of Yosef is Rav Tzadok's further interpretation.

blessed be His Name, become known עַל יְדֵי יִצְחָק **through Yitzchak;** וְגַם ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ אָמַר לוֹ **and Hashem Yisbarach Himself had told him,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כא, יב] כִּי בְיִצְחָק יִקָּרֵא לְךָ זָרַע **"For through Yitzchak shall offspring be called yours" (Bereishis 21:12);** וְהָיָה לוֹ לַעֲבוֹר **so he should have transgressed** אֶת שֶׁלֹּא לַעֲקוֹד **and not bound Yitzchak,** כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּתְפָּרְסֵם אֱלֹהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ **so that His Divinity, blessed be His Name, become known,** וּלְהַפְקִיר גַּם עוֹלָם הַבָּא שֶׁלּוֹ **even forfeiting his own World to Come,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁעָשָׂה בְּנִסָּיוֹן הַכִּבְשָׁן **as he did in the test of the furnace** וּמִלְחֶמֶת אַרְבַּעַת הַמְּלָכִים **and the war of the four kings,** עַל פִּי מִדַּת אַהֲבָתוֹ **according to the middah of his love** שֶׁבָּעֲרָה בּוֹ. **that burned within him.** אָז הִשְׁתַּמֵּשׁ **But then he employed** בְּמִדַּת הַיִּרְאָה בְּהַפְלָגָה **the middah of fear to an extreme degree,** וְנִתְיָרֵא לַעֲבוֹר עַל רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **and feared to transgress His will, Yisbarach,** וְחָשַׁד אֶת עַצְמוֹ **and suspected himself** פֶּן הוּא נוֹגֵעַ מַה בַּדָּבָר **lest he had some personal bias in the matter** לְאַהֲבַת בְּנוֹ **out of love for his son;** וְאָז נִתְכַּלֵּל בָּאֵשׁ **and then he became integrated into Fire,** מִדַּת יִצְחָק[293] **the middah of Yitzchak.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּנִסָּיוֹן הָעֲקֵידָה **And this is what is said at the test of the Akeidah,** [שָׁם כב, יב] עַתָּה יָדַעְתִּי **(ibid. 22:12): "Now I know** כִּי יְרֵא אֱלֹהִים אַתָּה[294] וְגוֹ׳ **that you fear God," etc.** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת תּוֹלְדוֹת מַאֲמָר א **(as explained in Parshas Toldos, ma'amar 1,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וּמַסִּיק) **beginning "And he concludes");** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאָמַר **that is, he said:** מַה לִּי אִם אֵינִי מֵבִין **"What does it matter if I do not understand?** כֵּיוָן שֶׁכָּךְ צִוּוּיתִי **Since I was so commanded,** אֲנִי מְחוּיָב לִשְׁמוֹעַ.[295] **I am obligated to obey."** וְאָז נִתְבָּרֵר בְּכָל הַמִּדּוֹת **Then he was refined in all the middos,** בִּשְׁלֵימוּת בְּמִדָּתוֹ **completely, in his middah,** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בָּא בַיָּמִים **and this is what is said, "coming into days"** — בְּיוֹמִין עִלָּאִין. **into the supernal days.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ קָנָה **And afterward he bought** אֶת מְעָרַת הַמַּכְפֵּלָה **the Cave of Machpelah** בְּאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שְׁקָלִים **for four hundred shekels,** שֶׁהוּא כְּנֶגֶד אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת עוֹלְמוֹת דְּכִיסּוּפִין **corresponding to the four hundred worlds of longing,** שֶׁהוּא עֶשֶׂר פְּעָמִים עֶשֶׂר **which is ten times ten** בְּכָל אַרְבָּעָה עוֹלָמוֹת **in each of the four worlds,** [בַּמַּאֲמָר הַקּוֹדֵם]. כָּאָמוּר לְמַעְלָה **as stated above (in the previous ma'amar).** וְזֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים אַחַר כָּךְ **And this is why we then say,** זְכוֹר לִי שְׁקָלַי עֶפְרוֹן וְכוּלֵי׳. **"Remember for me the shekels of Efron," etc.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And regarding Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h,** (חוּלִין פט, א) אִיתָא **it is taught (Chullin 89a):** גָּדוֹל בְּמֹשֶׁה יוֹתֵר מִמַּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּאַבְרָהָם וְכוּלֵי׳ **"Greater is what is said of Moshe than what is said of Avraham, etc.;** בְּמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן כְּתִיב **of Moshe and Aharon it is written,** וְנַחְנוּ מָה[296] **'And what are**

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[293] **Avodah Zarah 5a, on Tehillim 82:6–7** — "Rabbi Yosei says: Israel accepted the Torah only so that the Angel of Death would have no dominion over them, as it is written, 'I said: You are divine beings, and all of you sons of the Most High.' You damaged your deeds: 'Indeed, like Adam you shall die.'" This is Rabbi Yosei's position in the Gemara's discussion; the Sages give a different explanation of the Torah's removal of subjection. Rav Tzadok follows the position that relates the calf to the return of death.

[294] Parallel: **Rashi on Shemos 32:34, s.v. Uveyom pokdi** — "'On the day I make an accounting': Now I have listened to you and refrained from destroying them together. Yet whenever I make an accounting of their sins, I will also account against them a little of this sin together with the other sins. No calamity comes upon Israel without some repayment of the sin of the calf."

Connection: Rashi makes explicit the continuing character of the calf's consequence. This clarifies why Rav Tzadok places it beside the sale of Yosef as an injury whose charge reappears in later generations; the two episodes need not have the same historical punishment to share that structural feature.

[295] **Zohar Chadash, end of Midrash HaNe'elam on Eichah, paragraphs 105–116** — "The serpent stood and demanded judgment, invoking 'One who steals a person and sells him.' The Holy One, blessed be He, answered the serpent: Yosef was not yet an adult man, and he was not found in their possession. It returned and cited the other verse, 'If a man is found stealing a person from among his brothers.' For eight hundred years that serpent stood demanding judgment. Then it descended, confounded the world, and put this spirit into the wicked king of Rome, who demanded judgment from the mighty ones of the world. Woe for this, woe for the world: such a distortion of judgment had not been found since the world was created." The ensuing lament describes ten radiant souls departing Gan Eden and explicitly asks why a charge remained after Yosef had forgiven his brothers. It portrays the catastrophe as the serpent's accusation and a grievous distortion during the Mother's exile, rather than a simple legal equation that ignores forgiveness.

[296] Parallel: **Sefas Emes, Pekudei–Shekalim 5649 (1889)** — "Concerning 'The rich shall not increase': The gold and copper donated to the Mishkan followed each individual's generosity, but the counted silver was equal. This shows that the love and desire in Israel's hearts are the power Hashem planted within us at the giving of the Torah, rather than a human power. Awe and the other attributes follow each person's capacity, but love is a gift from the Holy One, blessed be He; therefore everyone is equal in silver, which represents love. The inner point unfolds according to the vessel's preparation: one is clothed in a fine garment, another in a coarse garment, but the essential point is equal in every person of Israel."

Connection: Sefas Emes gives a complementary explanation of why rich and poor contribute the same amount: the inner divine gift is equal even when its manifestation differs. Rav Tzadok's richer and poorer spiritual recipients

we?'" וְהַיְינוּ דְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם That is, Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h, נַעֲשָׂה[297] מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת אַיִן became a chariot for the middah of Ayin, Nothingness, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ as they said in the holy Zohar (חֵלֶק ב קכא, א) (vol. 2, 121a) [עַל פָּסוּק [אִיּוֹב כח, יב עַל on the verse (Iyov 28:12), וְהָחָכְמָה מֵאַיִן תִּמָּצֵא "And wisdom — from where shall it be found": אוֹרַיְיתָא מַהָכְמָה נָפְקַת "The Torah emerged from Chochmah, מֵאָתַר דְּאִקְרֵי קֹדֶשׁ from the place called Kodesh; וְהַחָכְמָה נָפְקַת and Chochmah emerged מֵאָתַר דְּאִקְרֵי קוֹדֶשׁ הַקְּדָשִׁים[298] from the place called Kodesh HaKodashim" — וְהַיְינוּ מִדַּת אַיִן that is, the middah of Ayin, שֶׁהוּא עַתִּיקָא סְתִימָאָה which is Atika, the most concealed דְּכָל סְתִימִין of all concealed, דְּאִקְרֵי אַיִן[299] which is called Ayin, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר (שָׁם סד, ב). הַקָּדוֹשׁ as they said in the holy Zohar (there, 64b). וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם And since Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h, became מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת אַיִן a chariot for the middah of Ayin, זָכָה לִהְיוֹת שׁוֹרֶשׁ he merited to be the root לְכָל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה of all the words of Torah, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר as it says, וְהַחָכְמָה מֵאַיִן תִּמָּצֵא. "And wisdom is found from Ayin." וְעַל כֵּן זָכָה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם Therefore Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h, merited לְכָל הַכְּתָרִים דְּמַתָּן תּוֹרָה all the crowns of Matan Torah מִשִּׁשִּׁים רִיבּוֹא נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל from the six hundred thousand souls of Yisrael (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת פח, א). (as stated in Shabbos 88a). וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרָשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (כִּי תִשָּׂא ג) And this is what they said in Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Sisa 3): חַיֶּיךָ כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאַתָּה עוֹמֵד עַכְשָׁיו "By your life, just as you stand now וְנוֹתֵן לָהֶם פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים and give them Parshas Shekalim וְאַתָּה זוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם and raise up their heads, כָּךְ בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה so in every single year שֶׁקּוֹרְאִין אוֹתָהּ לְפָנַי that they read it before Me, כְּאִלּוּ אַתָּה עוֹמֵד שָׁם it is as if you stand there בְּאוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה at that time וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁן וְכוּלֵי and raise up their heads, etc.; אֶלָּא כִּי תִשָּׂא. but rather 'when you lift up.'" 'Lift up the head' is not said, שָׂא אֶת רֹאשׁ לֹא נֶאֱמַר The point is that in truth וְהוּא שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת עִיקַּר נְשִׂיאַת רֹאשׁ the essential lifting of the head עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם is through Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h, שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה who is the root of the words of Torah; וְאִיתָא (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כז, ט) and it is found (Shemos Rabbah 27:9): שְׁבַרְתֶּם נַעֲשֶׂה "You have broken 'we will do' עֲשִׂיתֶם לְפָנַי עֶגֶל by making a calf before Me; וכוּלֵי[300] הִזָּהֲרוּ בְּנִשְׁמַע be careful with 'we will hear,'" etc. וְהִנֵּה נַעֲשֶׂה Now, "we will do" נֶגֶד קְדוּשַׁת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם corresponds to the holiness of Yaakov

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likewise remain within one complete structure, rather than adding or subtracting a degree according to their personal attainment.

[297] Parallel: **R. Chaim Vital, Etz Chaim, Gate 23, chapter 8** — "Daas therefore completes the ten sefiros in place of Keser. This concerns the external aspect; in the internal aspect, Keser is included among Zeir Anpin's ten sefiros. Thus do not wonder that we sometimes count Daas among the ten sefiros and sometimes Keser, for one concerns the external aspect and the other the internal aspect. The inner aspect of Daas—what it is and whence it is drawn—requires investigation, since it appears to be an additional sefirah. It is possible that this is the meaning of 'not fewer than nine and not more than ten': in the external aspect there are nine sefiros, so Daas is needed to complete them; in the internal aspect Daas would be beyond ten. Therefore it says 'ten and not eleven,' for the inner aspect of Daas consists only of the roots of the inner aspect of the six extremities. But what these roots are still needs to be known and requires investigation."

Connection: The alternating enumeration explains how Daas can "fill the place of Keser" without becoming an eleventh independent light. Etz Chaim distinguishes external and internal aspects, rather than subtracting Keser from reality. Rav Tzadok applies the same numerical boundary to two forms of religious apprehension: achieved knowledge must not be counted as an added light, while the crown's concealment must not reduce the count to nine. Etz Chaim expressly leaves its further account of Daas's inner roots for investigation; that qualification belongs to the cited source.

[298] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 19, 38b; Introduction, 12a; Kesubos 111b** — "The union of Torah scholars is from Shabbos to Shabbos, to inherit that drop, which is Chochmah—the dew of Torah for their children. It was not for nothing that the Sages established: Whoever engages in the dew of Torah, the dew of Torah revives him." The Introduction, 12a, likewise speaks of dew descending on one who guards Shabbos: "Dew to revive the dead," followed by the same teaching about the dew of Torah. Kesubos 111b expounds "Your dew is a dew of lights": "Whoever uses the light of Torah, the light of Torah revives him." The Tikkunim's wording is dew; the retrieved Bavli wording is light.

[299] **Shemos Rabbah 39:1** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moshe: Israel owe Me what they borrowed from Me, as it says, 'Ki sisa,' like the expression, 'When you lend to your fellow.' Tell them to repay what they owe Me: this is ki sisa. Then I will make payment to them, as it says, 'The number of the children of Israel will be like the sand of the sea.'" The Midrash deliberately reads the census word sisa through the language of lending, tasheh. Its closing promise is Hoshea 2:1, the verse to which Rav Tzadok returns at the maamar's end.

[300] **Sefer HaRokeach, Introduction** — "There is no strength like the strength of piety at its beginning." The maxim appears among a sequence praising truthfulness, a good heart, standing firm under trial, remembrance of the Creator, and the flame of awe. The explanation of that initial strength as a loan, and the ensuing application to the first and acquired stages of revelation, are the Chassidic interpretation presented by Rav Tzadok.

Avinu, a"h, (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן יג כט, א) דְּאִיתָא **as it is found (Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 13, 29a):** וְהָא מֹשֶׁה תַּמָּן הֲוָה **"But was not Moshe there?** אֶלָּא מִסִּטְרָא דִּלְגָאו הֲוָה **Rather, he was from the inner side;** דָּא מִגּוּפָא וְדָא מִנִּשְׁמָתָא **this one from the body, and that one from the soul" —** וְהַיְינוּ דְּיַעֲקֹב גּוּפָא **meaning, Yaakov is the body,** וְזֶהוּ כָּל גּוּפֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **of all the bodies of Yisrael,** שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְדוּשַׁת **from whom comes the root of the holiness** וּמֹשֶׁה נִשְׁמָתָא **And Moshe is the soul,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ כָּל הַדִּבְרֵי **and this is the crown of "we will do."** כֶּתֶר נַעֲשֶׂה. תּוֹרָה **who is the root of all the words of Torah,** שֶׁהֵם שׁוֹרֶשׁ שִׁשִּׁים רִיבּוֹא **which are the root of the six hundred thousand** נְפָשׁוֹת דּוֹר הַמִּדְבָּר **souls of the generation of the wilderness;** וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד כֶּתֶר נִשְׁמָע. **and he corresponds to the crown of "we will hear."** וְעִיקַּר נְשִׂיאַת רֹאשׁ **And the essential lifting of the head** עַל יְדֵי כֶּתֶר נִשְׁמָע שֶׁלֹּא בִּטְּלוּ **is through the crown of "we will hear," which they did not annul;** וְלָכֵן בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **therefore, in Parshas Shekalim,** שֶׁהוּא לְתַקֵּן עֲוֹן הָעֵגֶל **which is to rectify the sin of the Calf,** עִיקַּר הַנְּשִׂיאוּת רֹאשׁ **the essential lifting of the head** עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **is through Moshe Rabbeinu.** וְנִתְיָרֵא מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h, feared** שֶׁמָּא פְּטִירָתוֹ אַחַר שָׁלוֹם **that, chas v'shalom, after his passing** יִתְבַּטֵּל הַנְּשִׂיאוּת רֹאשׁ **the lifting of the head would cease** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב) **(as explained in ma'amar 2);** וְאָמַר לוֹ ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **and Hashem Yisbarach told him** שֶׁבְּכָל שָׁנָה בִּקְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **that every year, with the reading of the parsha,** כְּאִלּוּ מֹשֶׁה עוֹמֵד **it is as if Moshe stands** וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁן **and raises up their heads;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל **meaning, in all of Yisrael** יֵשׁ כֹּחַ מִמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **there is a power from Moshe Rabbeinu,** וְהַיְינוּ כֹּחַ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ.[301] **namely, the power of the Torah that each one has.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **And this is what they said in the Gemara** (בְּרָכוֹת לג, ב) **(Berachos 33b):** אֲטוּ יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם מִילְתָא זוּטַרְתָּא הִיא **"Is fear of Heaven, then,** וְכוּ' **a small matter? etc. —** אִין לְגַבֵּי מֹשֶׁה מִילְתָא זוּטַרְתָּא הִיא.[302] **Yes, for Moshe it is a small matter."** וְאַף שֶׁזֶּה אָמַר מָה ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ שׁוֹאֵל מֵעִמָּךְ כִּי אִם לְיִרְאָה וְגוֹ' [דְּבָרִים י, יב] **"What does Hashem your God ask of you but to fear," etc. (Devarim 10:12) —** רַק לְגַבֵּי מֹשֶׁה **it is small only "for Moshe,"** לְגַבֵּי כֹּחַ הַתּוֹרָה **that is, with respect to the power of the Torah,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא מֹשֶׁה **which is called "Moshe,"** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (חוּלִּין צז, א) **in the manner of what they said (Chullin 93a),** מֹשֶׁה וְכוּ' **"Moshe," etc.,** פֵּירֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י תַּלְמִיד חָכָם[303] **which Rashi explains as a talmid**

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[301] Parallel: **R. Kalonymus Kalman Epstein, Maor VaShemesh, Yisro, s.v. Vayesapper Moshe (digital paragraph 5)** — "At a person's first awakening to repentance, the Holy One, blessed be He, gives him an exceedingly great illumination, so that a very great awakening comes upon him. This is 'He gives a hand to transgressors.' But this illumination is immediately forgotten and concealed from him, so that he will search and investigate for himself through Torah, prayer, and good deeds, through choice and will. The further a person advances in service, the more there is revealed to him of what the Creator, blessed be He, illuminated for him at that first glimpse. This is the statement in Sefer Rokeach that there is no strength in piety like its beginning: at the beginning of piety the Holy One shows him a great illumination, but afterward it is concealed from him, until he must seek it out diligently to return to that first piety with which he began. In the writings this is called the first state of greatness: the Holy One illuminates of Himself to clarify His divinity. Afterward the person enters smallness of mind, when that first understanding is concealed, and then great effort is required to attain the former understanding and the yearning he had at the beginning. … Because Israel had possessed great clarity on the first night, whenever they fell they recalled that first great clarity—the strength of piety at the beginning. This sustained them, enabling them to awaken themselves whenever they fell and return to their original faith, until they came to the giving of the Torah."

Connection: Maor VaShemesh explains the same Rokeach maxim through the distinction between an illumination given from above and one recovered through freely chosen service. Its continuing effect is the remembered clarity that sustains the search during concealment; the passage applies this process to Israel's journey from the Exodus to Sinai. This supplies a concrete account of Rav Tzadok's "loan": withdrawal creates the work through which the original gift can become an acquired possession. Rav Tzadok further explains the shekalim as repairing the calf's interruption of that acquisition.

[302] **Shemos Rabbah 43:1** — "A ruler sent a matchmaker to betroth a woman. She went astray with another man. What did the matchmaker do? He took the marriage document he had been given and tore it. He said: Better that she be judged as unmarried than as a married woman. So Moshe acted when Israel did that deed: He took the tablets and broke them. He said: Had they seen the punishment written in them, they would not have sinned. It is better that they be judged as inadvertent sinners rather than deliberate ones." Breaking the tablets is portrayed as the intermediary's defense of Israel after the calf. Rav Tzadok invokes the interrupted marriage to explain why the earlier illumination remained an unpaid loan.

[303] **Mateh Moshe 482, Shabbos Minchah** — "Israel and Shabbos testify concerning the Holy One, blessed be He, that He is One and all was made by His word, and that He sanctifies Israel and Shabbos. The Holy One, blessed be He, and Shabbos testify concerning Israel that they are treasured above all peoples, holy, and one nation on earth. It is fitting for the One God to unite with one nation on one distinguished day. Therefore at Shabbos Minchah one says, 'You are One.'" The original siman 482 is embedded within the digital site's reflowed chapter 99. It explains the

chacham; וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּכָל תַּלְמִיד חָכָם **that is, in every talmid chacham** חֵלֶק הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבּוֹ **the portion of Torah within him** נִקְרָא מֹשֶׁה **is called "Moshe";** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ הִנְחִיל **and Moshe Rabbeinu bequeathed** לְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **to every one of Yisrael** חֵלֶק בַּתּוֹרָה **a portion in the Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [דְּבָרִים לג, ד] תּוֹרָה וְגוֹ׳ **as it says (Devarim 33:4), "Torah," etc.,** קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב **"the congregation of Yaakov";** (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה ט, ג) וְאִיתָא **and it is found (Vayikra Rabbah 9:3):** קְהִלַּת יַנַּאי אֵין כְּתִיב כָּאן **"It is not written here 'the congregation of Yannai,'** אֶלָּא קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב[304] **but 'the congregation of Yaakov.'"** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said:** שֶׁבְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **that every year when Parshas Shekalim is read** כְּאִלּוּ מֹשֶׁה עוֹמֵד **it is as if Moshe stands** וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם **and raises up their heads** עַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ הַתּוֹרָה **through the power of the Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ הִזָּהֲרוּ בְּנִשְׁמָע: **as they said, "Be careful with 'we will hear.'"**

וּבִפְסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתַי **And in Pesikta Rabbasi** (פָּרָשָׁה י סִימָן יא) אִיתָא **(parsha 10, siman 11) it is found:** כִּי תִשָּׂא בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **"'When you lift up the Children of Israel'** אֵין כְּתִיב כָּאן **is not written here,** אֶלָּא אֶת רֹאשׁ **but rather 'the head';** וְאֵין רֹאשָׁם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and the Head of Yisrael is none other** אֶלָּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא[305] **than HaKadosh Baruch Hu,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִיכָה ב, יג] **as it says (Michah 2:13),** וַיַּעֲבֹר מַלְכָּם לִפְנֵיהֶם **'And their King passed before them,** וַה׳ בְּרֹאשָׁם וְגוֹ׳ **with Hashem at their head,' etc."** וְהַמְכוּוָן עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **The intent is according to what they said** (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה כד, ט) **(Vayikra Rabbah 24:9):** קְדוֹשִׁים תִּהְיוּ **"'You shall be holy' —** קְדוּשָׁתִי לְמַעְלָה **could it mean like Me?** תַּלְמוּד לוֹמַר כִּי קָדוֹשׁ אֲנִי **Scripture says, 'For I am holy' —** יָכוֹל כָּמוֹנִי **My holiness is above your holiness."** וּמְפָרְשִׁים בַּסְּפָרִים הַקְּדוֹשִׁים[306] **And the holy sefarim explain** דְּקְדוּשַׁת ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ כִּבְיָכוֹל **that the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach, so to speak,** דְּרָצָה לוֹמַר **that it means** לְמַעְלָה **is above "your holiness"** — מִקְּדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **above the holiness of Yisrael.** וּבָאֱמֶת אָמְרוּ (שָׁם, ד) **And indeed they said (there, 4):** קְדוֹשִׁים תִּהְיוּ פְּרוּשִׁים תִּהְיוּ **"'You shall be holy' — you shall be separate;** שֶׁצָּרִיךְ הַיִּשְׂרָאֵל **just as I am separate,** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאֲנִי פָּרוּשׁ וְכוּלֵי[307] כָּךְ תִּהְיוּ פְּרוּשִׁים **so shall you be separate," etc. —** לְהִיוֹת קָדוֹשׁ נִבְדָּל **for a Jew must be holy, set apart** מִכָּל עִנְיְנֵי עוֹלָם הַזֶּה כְּמוֹנִי **from all matters of this world, like Me.** אַךְ כָּל מַה שֶׁאָדָם **But to the extent that a person** מְקַדֵּשׁ עַצְמוֹ מִלְמַטָּה **sanctifies himself below,** מְקַדְּשִׁין אוֹתוֹ מִלְמַעְלָה[308] **he is sanctified from Above;** מְקַדֵּשׁ עַצְמוֹ מְעַט **if he sanctifies himself a little,**

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unity expressed by the Minchah prayer through the reciprocal testimony of Hashem, Israel and Shabbos. The maamar connects this time with the third meal.

[304] **Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 1; Pesikta Rabbati 10:1** — "They would begin collecting from the first of Adar, and take the contribution on the first of Nisan. Why do they begin in Adar and take it in Nisan? So as not to press Israel. They would warn Israel from the first of the month." Pesikta Rabbati 10:1 gives the same explanation and states that the funds purchased the daily offerings so all Israel would be partners in them. The warning in Adar allows time to prepare the contribution.

[305] **Responsa Rivash 153** — "You assessed the people of Majorca, whose wealthy had houses full of every good thing, stores of silver and merchandise, pearls and gold. But assess the inhabitants of this land, who lack even scant bread and measured water, sleep on the ground or a skin mat, cover themselves at night in their daytime clothing, wear patch upon patch, and mostly go barefoot. In the Sages' time it was so. The Men of the Great Assembly, when they returned from exile, were exceedingly poor, as the account of Nechemiah records. Consider: a woman is betrothed with a perutah, though it is a very small thing; and a court hears a claim for a perutah, since it is not presumed forgiven." The responsum answers an objection to the small monetary value of the statutory kesubah. It bases the standard on the poor and concludes that those who wish may add. Rav Tzadok applies this historical measure of value to the advance notice for the half shekel.

[306] **Shekalim piyyutim: Omen and Mussaf Modim** — "Merciful One, as You had mercy upon those borne by You through the silver of atonement, so regard our lips as repayment in bulls. 'May the pure utterance of our lips repay bulls, for the silver of the atoning shekels is no more.'" The first passage closes Omen in the Shekalim morning liturgy; the second appears in the Modim insertion of the Mussaf piyyut, beginning Ein otzem. Both adapt Hoshea's "we shall repay bulls with our lips" to the loss of the shekel offering. The digital liturgical witnesses read beshillum parim, "as repayment in bulls."

[307] **Zohar III, 7b** — "When sustenance is found below, sustenance is found above. It is like a king who prepared his own feast but had not prepared food for his servants. When he prepared for his servants, he ate his meal and they ate theirs. 'I ate my honeycomb with my honey'—this is the King's meal. 'Eat, friends; drink and become intoxicated, beloved ones'—this is their meal from the fragrance of the offering when its fragrance ascended. Therefore the King's meal waited for the servants' meal. For this reason we learned that Israel sustain their Father in Heaven. Who eats of the King's meal? The souls of the righteous." The source speaks through a royal parable of sacrifice and reciprocal nourishment. Rav Tzadok extends that sacrificial preparation to the shekel funds and then to Shabbos meals.

[308] **Zohar II, 88a** — "Rabbi Abba said: Blessing is prepared for those supernal days, which are blessed from this day. On this day the head of Zeir Anpin is filled with dew descending from Atika Kadisha, the most concealed of all. He pours

he is sanctified greatly (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא לט, א) **(as stated in Yoma 39a);** וְכָל שֶׁהָאָדָם מִתְקַדֵּשׁ יוֹתֵר **and the more a person becomes sanctified,** מַשִּׂיג יוֹתֵר **the more he grasps** מִקְדּוּשַׁת ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **of the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מִזֶּה. **which is above this.** וְזֶהוּ קְדוּשָׁתִי לְמַעְלָה מִקְּדוּשַׁתְכֶם **And this is "My holiness is above your holiness":** קְדוּשָׁתִי לְמַעְלָה **My holiness is higher,** שֶׁכָּל שֶׁמִּתְקַדֵּשׁ יוֹתֵר **for the more he becomes sanctified,** שֶׁכָּל שֶׁמַּשִּׂיג מְקַדְּשִׁין אוֹתוֹ מִלְמַעְלָה **the more he is sanctified from Above,** שֶׁמַּשִּׂיג מִקְּדוּשַׁת ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **so that he grasps that the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach** לְמַעְלָה מִזֶּה. **is above this.** וּבָזֶה יֵשׁ לְבַיֵּן **With this one can also explain** גַּם דִּבְרֵיהֶם שֶׁזֶּה עִיקַּר קְדוּשַׁת ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **their words, that this is the essence of the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach:** מַה שֶּׁמּוּשָׂג לְהָאָדָם **what is grasped by man** מִקְּדוּשַׁת ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **of the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach;** מִמַּצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **for from the side of Hashem Yisbarach Himself** אֵין לְתָאֵר אוֹתוֹ **He cannot be described** בְּתוֹאַר קָדוֹשׁ **with the description "holy,"** דְּלֵית מַחֲשָׁבָה תְּפִיסָא בֵּיהּ כְּלָל **for no thought can grasp Him at all** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר יִתְרוֹ מַאֲמָר ז[309]) **(as explained in Yisro, ma'amar 7).** וְזֶהוּ כִּי תִשָּׂא אֶת רֹאשׁ **And this is "When you lift up the head** בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **of the Children of Israel":** כְּשֶׁנּוֹשְׂאִים רֹאשָׁם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **when one lifts up the heads of Yisrael,** כִּבְיָכוֹל בָּזֶה נוֹשֵׂא **so to speak, one thereby lifts up** רֹאשָׁם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **the Head of Yisrael,** שֶׁהוּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **who is HaKadosh Baruch Hu,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר ה' בְּרֹאשָׁם **as it says, "with Hashem at their head";** [שָׁם] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּפְסִיקְתָּא **as they said in the Pesikta (ibid.):** כָּל שֶׁכָּל שֶׁאַתָּה יָכוֹל **"Whatever you are able** לְרוֹמֵם אֶת הָאוּמָּה הַזּוֹ רוֹמֵם וְכוּלֵי **to exalt this nation — exalt it,** שֶׁכְּאִלּוּ אַתָּה רוֹמֵם אוֹתִי **for it is as if you exalt Me," etc.;** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה קְדוּשָׁתִי לְמַעְלָה **for through this, "My holiness is above,"** שֶׁמַּשִּׂיגִים יוֹתֵר **in that they grasp more** קְדוּשַׁת ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ לְמַעְלָה וְכָאָמוּר.[310] **of the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach above, as stated.**

And regarding Shabbos it is found וּבְשַׁבָּת אִיתָא **in Pri Eitz Chaim** [שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת פֶּרֶק ח] **(Sha'ar HaShabbos, chapter 8)** שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם מַשִּׂיג **that Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h, attains** מַדְרֵיגוֹת אוֹרוֹ דְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **the levels of his light of Matan Torah,** וְעַל זֶה אוֹמְרִים **and about this we say** [תְּפִלַּת שַׁחֲרִית לְשַׁבָּת] **(Shabbos Shacharis prayer),** יִשְׂמַח מֹשֶׁה בְּמַתַּנַת חֶלְקוֹ **"Moshe rejoices in the gift of his portion";** וְאָז מַחֲזִיר הַכְּתָרִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל. **and then he returns the crowns to Yisrael.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **And through the shekels,** שֶׁבָּאוּ לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הָעֶגֶל **which came to repair the blemish of the Calf,** אָז מַחֲזִיר מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h, then returns** כְּתָרִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **to Yisrael the crowns** שֶׁפָּרְקוּם עַל יְדֵי הָעֶגֶל **which they stripped off because of the Calf** וּנְטָלָן מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and which Moshe Rabbeinu, a"h, took;** וְכֵן עַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **and likewise through the reading of the parsha,** [מַאֲמָר א] לְמַעְלָה שְׁנִתְבָּאֵר וּכְמוֹ. **as explained above (ma'amar 1).** **And the reading of the parsha was instituted on Shabbos,** שֶׁהוּא וְנִתְקַן קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה בְּשַׁבָּת **which makes it doubled,** בְּכָפֶל שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה **through which** נִקְבָּע לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד **it is established for all time,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as we have said several times,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מא, לב] עַל דָּבָר מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the manner of what is said (Bereishis 41:32),** כִּי נָכוֹן הַדָּבָר וְגוֹ' וְעַל הִשָּׁנוֹת וְגוֹ' פְּעָמִים **"And as for the dream being repeated twice, it is because the matter is set," etc.,** וְגוֹ'[311] וּמְמַהֵר **"and He hastens," etc. —** שֶׁבְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁיֵּשׁ קְדוּשָׁה כְּפוּלָה **wherever there is doubled holiness,** בָּא מַהֵר **it comes quickly** נִקְבָּע הַדָּבָר גַּם. **and the matter is also**

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it upon the field of holy apples three times from the entrance of Shabbos, so that all will be blessed together." The threefold flow of dew is the specific basis for linking the three Shabbos meals to the upper and lower modes of receiving blessing.

[309] **Zohar I, 26a** — "At that time it was said of Moshe and Israel: 'Then you will delight in Hashem'—with oneg, whose letters signify ayin: Eden; nun: river; gimel: garden. The verse 'Then Moshe will sing' will be fulfilled: it does not say he sang, but he will sing. For the mixed multitude oneg becomes nega, affliction; but for Israel there will be delight." The interpretation treats oneg as the connected sequence Eden–river–garden, through which delight is communicated. Rav Tzadok reads the meals through that ordered flow.

[310] **Mishnah Shekalim 1:3** — "On the fifteenth, money changers would sit in the provinces. On the twenty-fifth they sat in the Temple. Once they sat in the Temple, they began taking pledges." This is the collection schedule behind the maamar's distinction between preparation through reading, the later opportunity to perform the monetary mitzvah, and the original announcement.

[311] Parallel: **Sefas Emes, Pekudei–Shekalim 5643 (1883), final paragraph** — "'They announce in Adar and collect in Nisan.' They gave a month for preparation of the gift, because the purpose is not the shekel, but the desire and generosity of the heart. Therefore preparation for the mitzvah is more beloved than its principal act; this is the joy of a mitzvah. The surplus in Israel's donation alludes to this, showing that the generosity and desire rise beyond the act itself. But the taxes and levies of the wicked, whose purpose is only money, are called 'the path of the lazy.'"

Connection: This passage addresses the same month between announcement and collection, interpreting it as time for the heart's preparation. It sharpens Rav Tzadok's distinction between the court's practical announcement and the Shabbos reading's preparation for participation in the communal offerings.

established. וְנוּכַל לִזְכּוֹת **And we can merit** עַד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִקְבָּע לְעוֹלְמֵי עֲדִ **that it be established for all time,** שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לַכְּתָרִים **that we merit the crowns** דְּנַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע׃ **of "we will do" and "we will hear."**

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ח׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Ches

In the Zohar Chadash (beginning of Parshas Ki Sisa): (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא בְּזֹהַר חָדָשׁ) **What is "everyone who passes among those counted"** [שְׁמוֹת ל, יג] **(Shemos 30:13)?** מַאי כָּל הָעוֹבֵר עַל הַפְּקוּדִים דָּא מַאן דְּעָבַר **This is one who transgresses** עַל פִּקּוּדֵי דְּמָארֵיהּ **the commandments of his Master; if he wishes to be rectified** אִי בָּעֵי לְאִתְתַּקָּנָא קַמֵּי מָארֵיהּ **before his Master —** [שָׁם] זֶה יִתְּנוּ **"this they shall give" (ibid.):** זֶה בָּעֵי לְמֵיתַן **he must give "zeh"** לְקָרְבָא לֵיהּ בְּזוֹאת וְכוּלֵי **to bring it close to "zos," etc.,** בְּגִין דְּמַאן דְּעָבַר **because whoever transgresses** עַל פִּקּוּדֵי דְּמָארֵיהּ **the commandments of his Master** אַפְרִיד זֶה מִזּאת וְכוּלֵי.[312] **separates "zeh" from "zos," etc.** הָעִנְיָן דְּזֶה מוֹרֶה **The matter is that "zeh" indicates** שֶׁמְּפוֹרָשׁ וּמֻרְאֶה בְּאֶצְבַּע **what is explicit and pointed to with the finger,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לָעָתִיד **as it will be in the future,** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מַרְאֶה בְּאֶצְבָּעוֹ[313] **when each one will point with his finger** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּעֲנִית לא, א) **(as written in Taanis 31a);** וְכֵן בְּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **and so too at the Splitting of the Sea,** מְכִילְתָּא בְּשַׁלַּח פָּרָשַׁת הַשִּׁירָה ג **(Mechilta, Beshalach, Parshas HaShirah 3,** וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֵלֶק ב סד, ב**) and the holy Zohar II 64b):** רְאָתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם **a maidservant saw at the Sea** מַה שֶּׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל **what Yechezkel did not see;** וְאָמְרוּ זֶה אֵלִי וְכוּ׳.[314] **they merited to say, "This is my G-d."** וּכְתִיב שָׁאֲמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר **And "zos" alludes to the attribute of Malchus,** וְזֹאת מְרַמֵּז לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב לז, ב) **(II 37b):** הַאי כִּתְרָא דְּאִיקָרֵי זֹאת **this crown that is called "zos"** דְּאִיקָרֵי אִתְקְרֵי אִשָּׁה וְכוּלֵי **is called "ishah," etc.,** וְזֹאת אִתְנְסִיבַת מִזֶּה **and "zos" was taken from "zeh,"** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מְהֵימְנוּתָא שְׁלֵימְתָא **That is, through complete faith** גַּם כֵּן זוֹכִין לִהְיוֹת **which is called "male."** זָכָר[315] **one also merits that it be explicit,** מְפוֹרָשׁ **as though pointing with the finger — "zos"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמַּרְאֶה בְּאֶצְבַּע זֹאת **only that it is in the feminine form.** רַק שֶׁהוּא בִּלְשׁוֹן נְקֵבָה[316] **And about this they said** (רַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא) **(Ra'aya Meheimna, holy Zohar III 230a):** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ אִיהוּ אֱמֶת וְאִיהִי אֱמוּנָה[317] **He is truth and She is faith — that Hashem Yisbarach stands over him and sees his deeds,** שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו **by taking to heart** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁנּוֹתֵן אֶל לִבּוֹ **he too merits** זוֹכֶה גַּם כֵּן **that it be as though explicit before his eyes.** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כְּמְפוֹרָשׁ לְנֶגֶד עֵינָיו. **And then too they recognize the unity,** וְאָז גַּם כֵּן מַכִּירִין הַיִּחוּד הֲוָיָ״ה אֶחָד **"Havayah is One,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ הַשְּׁבָטִים **as the Shevatim said:** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאֵין בְּלִבְּךָ אֶלָּא אֶחָד **just as in your heart**

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[312] **Zohar II, 88a–b** — "A person must delight at these three times, for the supernal faith depends on them: Atika Kadisha, Zeir Anpin, and the field of apples. He must delight and rejoice in them. Rabbi Abba would rejoice in each Shabbos meal and say: 'This is the holy meal of Atika Kadisha, the most concealed of all.' At another meal he would say: 'This is the meal of the Holy One, blessed be He.' When he finished the meals he said: 'The meals of faith have been completed.' When Rabbi Shimon came to a meal he would say: 'Prepare the meal of supernal faith; prepare the King's meal,' and would sit and rejoice." The passage calls the meals both the King's meal and meals of faith. The first description concerns the divine recipient and flow of blessing; the second concerns the complete threefold pattern in which the person participates.

[313] **Yotzer for Parshas Shekalim, El Mitnasse Lechol Lerosh, stanzas beginning Yachid Shokhen Romah and Kol HaOver BeYamah** — "The Unique One who dwells on high stipulated in a perfect Torah for the dove that is pure: all who crossed the sea shall weigh out a shekel without commotion—a half-shekel as an offering." Both the dove and the crossing of the sea occur in the original poem. Rav Tzadok develops the first through fidelity to the covenant and the second through the abiding desire awakened by the revelation at the sea.

[314] **Song of Songs 5:2** — "I was asleep, but my heart was awake. The voice of my beloved knocks: Open for me, my sister, my companion, my dove, my perfect one; for my head is filled with dew, my locks with the drops of the night." The verse joins the two names that Rav Tzadok hears in the liturgical description: the dove and the perfect or whole one.

[315] **Berakhot 53b:19** — "Why specifically a dove? Because the Congregation of Israel is compared to a dove, as it is written, 'The wings of the dove are covered with silver, and her pinions with greenish gold.' Just as a dove is saved only by its wings, so Israel are saved only through the commandments." This supplies the identification of the dove with Israel. Its marital faithfulness is established by the following rabbinic sources.

[316] **Eruvin 100b:29; Rashi, s.v. "ve-arayot mi-yonah"** — "Rabbi Yohanan said: Had the Torah not been given, we would have learned modesty from the cat, avoidance of theft from the ant, and avoidance of forbidden sexual relations from the dove." Rashi explains "forbidden sexual relations from the dove": "It mates only with its own partner." The comparison concerns fidelity to the particular bond, which is central to Rav Tzadok's account of covenantal repair.

[317] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 4:1, "Your eyes are doves"** — "Just as this dove is modest, so Israel are modest. ... Just as this dove, once it recognizes its mate, never exchanges it for another, so Israel, once they recognized the Holy One, blessed be He, did not exchange Him for another." The division cited as 4:2 in the manuscript appears within the exposition of "Your eyes are doves" in the present digital division, 4:1. The same passage appears in 1:15.

there is only One, כֵּךְ אֵין בְּלִבֵּינוּ[318] **so in our heart there is none but He;** אַף שֶׁאֵין אָנוּ מַכִּירִין הַיִּחוּד **even though we do not recognize the unity** בִּבְחִינַת אֱמֶת **in the aspect of truth,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם עַל יְדֵי אֱמוּנָה **nevertheless through faith** אָנוּ מַכִּירִין שֶׁאֵין אֶלָּא אֶחָד **we recognize that there is only One,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as has been explained many times** (פְּסָחִים נו, א). בְּמָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **on what they said (Pesachim 56a).** וְתֵיבַת אֶחָד **And in the word "echad"** מוֹרֶה אוֹת ד׳ **the letter dalet indicates** עַל מִדַּת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **the attribute of Knesses Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (מִשְׁפָּטִים קכג, ב) פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **on this parshah (Mishpatim 123b):** ה׳ ד׳ הֲוָת וְכוּ׳.[319] **the heh was a dalet, etc.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ בְּמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **That is, there shine in the attribute of Malchus** וְאָלֶ״ף שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל פֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן **and the aleph, which indicates the supernal Pele:** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת. **Keser Elyon is Keser Malchus.** וְעַל יְדֵי קִלְקוּל הָעֵגֶל **And through the corruption of the Calf** אַפְרִיד זֶה מִזֹּאת **"zeh" was separated from "zos,"** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה הַיִּחוּד **so that there was no unity** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ. **of Kudsha Brich Hu and His Shechinah.** זֶה בָּעֵי לְמִיתַן וְכוּ׳ **"He must give 'zeh,'" etc.:** דְּעֶשְׂרִים גֵּרָה הַשֶּׁקֶל **for "twenty gerah is the shekel"** — כ׳ מְרַמֵּז לְכֶתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **the kaf alludes to Keser Elyon,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רנו, ב) **as they said (Zohar III 256b):** אָנֹכִי בְּיהּ כ׳ כֶּתֶר.[320] **"Anochi" — in it the kaf is Keser.** וּמַחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל עֲשָׂרָה גֵּרָה **And the half shekel, ten gerah,** רָזָא דְּיוּ״ד **is the secret of the yud,** [שָׁם] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ **as they said in the Zohar Chadash (ibid.);** וְהַיְינוּ יוּ״ד חָכְמָה **that is, the yud is Chochmah,** מַאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **the utterance "Let there be light."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ לְאַמְשָׁכָא וּלְאַנְהָרָא **And this is what they said: to draw down and to illuminate** בְּאַתְרָא דְּפָגִים **in the place that is blemished;** וְהַיְינוּ בְּאוֹר פְּנֵי מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים **that is, "in the light of the King's face is life";** וְדָא הוּא כּוֹפֶר נַפְשׁוֹ **and this is "the ransom of his soul"** — נֶפֶשׁ ו׳. **the nefesh of the vav.** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ [שָׁם] **And it states in the Zohar Chadash (ibid.):** כְּדֵין אִיקְרֵי שֶׁקֶל הַקֹּדֶשׁ **then it is called "the holy shekel,"** וְאִיתְעַר כֶּסֶף **and the silver is awakened,** יְמִינָא דְּמַלְכָּא וְכוּ׳;[321] **the right hand of the King, etc.;** וְהַיְינוּ קוּדֶשׁ עִלָּאָה חָכְמָה **that is, the supernal Kodesh, Chochmah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (מִשְׁפָּטִים חֵלֶק ב קכא, א). **(Mishpatim, II 121a).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמְּפָרֵשׁ שֶׁהַשְּׁקָלִים **That is, it explains that the shekalim** בָּאוּ לְכַפֵּר עֲוֹן הָעֵגֶל **came**

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[318] **Mekhilta DeRabbi Yishmael, Vayehi Beshalach 7:7** — "'The children of Israel walked on dry land within the sea.' The ministering angels were astonished. They said: Master of all worlds! Human beings who worship idols are walking on dry land within the sea! From where do we know that the sea too became filled with anger against them? Above it says 'hemah,' and so it says 'homah.' What caused them to be saved? 'On their right and on their left': on their right, through the merit of Torah, as it is said, 'From His right hand a fiery law for them'; and on their left, prayer." The source contrasts the defective spelling of the word for a wall with the word for anger. In the retrieved tractate division this appears in Vayehi Beshalach 7, rather than chapter 6.

[319] **Zohar II 170b, Terumah 84:4–5** — "When Israel approached the sea and the Holy One, blessed be He, wished to divide the Sea of Reeds for them, Rahab, the prince appointed over Egypt, came and demanded judgment before the Holy One. He said: Master of the world! Why do You wish to execute judgment upon Egypt and divide the sea for Israel? All of them are guilty before You, and all Your ways are justice and truth. These worship the stars and constellations, and those worship the stars and constellations; these commit sexual transgressions, and those commit sexual transgressions; these shed blood, and those shed blood. At that moment it was difficult before Him to pass beyond the way of judgment. ... Had the Holy One not regarded the merit of Abraham, who rose early to perform his Master's command and will, all of them would have been lost in the sea." This is the precise accusation invoked here; the obstacle is the claim of strict judgment, rather than an inability to divide water.

[320] **Zohar II 60a, Beshalach 25:11–13** — "When they finished the words, all of them were filled with delight in their souls and longed to see and contemplate. They did not wish to move from there because of the greatness of their longing. At that hour Moses said to the Holy One, blessed be He: Your children, in their great longing to gaze upon You, do not wish to move away from the sea. ... They did not set out until Moses took hold of them and showed them the radiance of the glory of the Holy One in the wilderness. Then, because of their great longing and desire to contemplate, Moses led them onward. ... What is the wilderness of Shur? The wilderness in which they wished to contemplate the glorious radiance of the Holy King. Therefore it is called the wilderness of Shur: contemplation was there." The source explains their departure through continuing desire for the revelation, the enduring element Rav Tzadok distinguishes from the passing experience.

[321] **Zohar II 60a–b, Beshalach 26:3–4** — "While they were walking in the wilderness, another domain, that of the other nations, was revealed against them—the power that rules in the wilderness—and they encountered it there. Israel saw that their King's glorious radiance was no longer there. ... Why 'for they were bitter'? Their souls were no longer delighted as before; furthermore, it came to accuse them. ... 'The Lord showed him a tree': a tree means Torah, as it is written, 'She is a tree of life to those who hold fast to her.' ... When the radiance of their King's glory was revealed to them, then 'he cast it into the water, and the water became sweet.' What is meant by 'the water became sweet'? The accuser became an advocate." The bitterness and its sweetening continue the account of the hidden and restored radiance.

to atone for the sin of the Calf, דְּעָבְרוּ עַל פִּקּוּדֵי דְּמָארֵיהּ **in which they transgressed the commandments of their Master** וְאַפְרִיד זֶה מִזּאת **and separated "zeh" from "zos,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **as they said in the Yerushalmi** (שְׁקָלִים פֶּרֶק ב הֲלָכָה ג ט, ב) **(Shekalim, chapter 2, halachah 3, 9b)** [322]סִימָן י׳ וְתַנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא. **and the Tanchuma on Ki Sisa (siman 10).** וְאִיתָא בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה ח, א) **And it states in the Midrash Rabbah (Vayikra Rabbah 8:1)** וּבְמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (כִּי תִשָּׂא ה) **and in the Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Sisa 5):** זֶה בִּלְשׁוֹן זֶה הוּשְׁפָּלוּ — **"This one He lowers and this one He raises" (Tehillim 75:8)** [תְּהִלִּים עה, ח] זֶה יָרִים וְזֶה יַשְׁפִּיל **with the word "zeh" they were lowered:** [שְׁמוֹת לב, א] כִּי זֶה מֹשֶׁה **"for this Moshe" (Shemos 32:1);** וּבִלְשׁוֹן זֶה הוּגְבְּהוּ[323] **and with the word "zeh" they were raised:** זֶה יִתְּנוּ וְגוֹמֵר **"This they shall give," etc.** וּבְפִסְקִיתָא מַיְיתֵי (פָּרָשָׁה י סִימָן טו) זֶה שֶׁהִשְׁפִּיל יִשְׂרָאֵל לִבְאֵר שַׁחַת **And in the Pesikta (parshah 10, siman 15) it brings: "this" lowered Yisrael to the pit of destruction —** זֶה אֱלֹהֶיךָ **"This is your god"** (וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר נְחֶמְיָה ט, יח) **(which is what is said in Nechemiah 9:18) —** וְזֶה יָרִים וְכוּלֵי **"and this one He raises," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **That is, through the shekalim** זוֹכִין לְהְיוֹת הַיִּחוּד **they merit that there be the unity —** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ **Keser Elyon is Keser Malchus —** וְשֶׁיִּזְכּוּ לִהְיוֹת מְפוֹרָשׁ לָעַיִן **and that they merit it to be explicit to the eye,** לְהַרְאוֹת זֶה אֵלִי[324] **to point and say, "This is my G-d"** (נְתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ג). **(and this was explained in maamar 3).** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ **Afterward it states in the Zohar Chadash:** תָּא חֲזֵי **Come and see:** הַאי כּוֹפְרָא כְּדֵי הוּא **this ransom is fitting** לְכַפָּרָא עַל עֲשָׂרָה שִׁבְטִין **to atone for the ten tribes** דְּזַבִּינוּ לְיוֹסֵף **who sold Yosef** וְעָבְרוּ עַל פִּקּוּדָא דְּמָארֵיהוֹן וְכוּלֵי **and transgressed the commandment of their Master, etc.** אָמַר לֵיהּ קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא לְמֹשֶׁה **The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moshe:** אִי אַתְּ בָּעֵי לְאַרָמָא רֵישֵׁיהוֹן — **if you wish to raise their heads** זֶה יִתְּנוּ כָּל **"this they shall give, all";** תָּא חֲזֵי הַאי צַדִּיק כָּל אִיקָרֵי וְכוּלֵי **come and see: this Tzaddik is called "kol," etc.** וְנִרְאֶה דְּהַזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ **It appears that the Zohar Chadash** דָּרֵישׁ תַּרְוַיְיהוּ **expounds both,** דִּכְתִיב שְׁתֵּי פְּעָמִים **for it is written twice** כָּל הָעוֹבֵר **"everyone who passes":** דְּתְחִלָּה נָאֲמַר **first it says,** זֶה יִתְּנוּ כָּל הָעוֹבֵר עַל הַפְּקוּדִים וְגוֹמֵר **"This they shall give, everyone who passes among those counted," etc.** [שְׁמוֹת ל, יג] **(Shemos 30:13),** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּתִיב [שָׁם, יד] **and afterward it is written (ibid. 14),** כָּל הָעוֹבֵר עַל הַפְּקוּדִים **"Everyone who passes among those counted,** מִבֶּן וְגוֹמֵר יִתֵּן וְגוֹמֵר **from the age of," etc., "shall give," etc.** וְדָרַשׁ חַד עַל קִלְקוּל הָעֵגֶל **He expounded one on the corruption of the Calf,** דְּאַפְרִידוּ זֶה מִזּאת **in which they separated "zeh" from "zos"** וְעָבְרוּ עַל פִּקּוּדֵי דְּמָארֵיהוֹן **and transgressed the commandments of their Master,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ דָּרַשׁ עַל מְכִירַת יוֹסֵף.[325] **and afterward he expounded on the sale of Yosef.** וּמַסֵּיק כְּדֵין שֶׁקֶל הַקֹּדֶשׁ אִקְרוּן **And it concludes: then they are called "the holy shekel,"** בְּגִין דְּאִיהוּ פְּלַג גּוּפָא **because He is half a body** וּכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל פְּלַג גּוּפָא וְכוּלֵי[326] **and Knesses Yisrael is half a body, etc.** וְהַיְינוּ יו״ד תַּתָּאָה **That is, the lower yud** מִשֵּׁם שַׁדַּי **of the name Shakkai,** דְּקַבִּילַת עוּבָּרָה

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[322] **Mekhilta DeRabbi Yishmael, Vayassa 1:19** — "'There He established for him a statute and a judgment': 'a statute'—this is Shabbat; 'a judgment'—this is honoring father and mother. These are the words of Rabbi Joshua. Rabbi Elazar of Modiin says: 'a statute' means the forbidden sexual relationships ... and 'a judgment' means the laws concerning coercion, penalties, and injuries." Rav Tzadok follows Rabbi Joshua's interpretation of the statute at Marah as Shabbat.

[323] **Deuteronomy 5:4** — "Face to face the Lord spoke with you on the mountain, from within the fire." The verse describes the direct encounter at Sinai toward which Israel's desire leads.

[324] **Shemot Rabbah 46:1; 47:7** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: Do not be distressed over the first tablets, for they contained only the Ten Commandments. With the second tablets I am giving you laws, midrash, and aggadot. This is what is written, 'He would tell you the hidden things of wisdom, for wisdom is doubled.' Moreover, you are thereby informed that I have forgiven your sin, as it is said, 'Know that God has set aside part of your iniquity.'" Shemot Rabbah 47:7 repeats the contrast and specifies that laws, midrash, aggadot, and Talmud are to remain oral. The expansion after the sin is therefore part of the cited Midrash itself.

[325] **Amos 2:6** — "Thus said the Lord: For three transgressions of Israel, and for four, I will not turn it back: for their selling a righteous man for silver, and a needy person for a pair of shoes." Rav Tzadok reads the phrase concerning the righteous one through the sale of Joseph.

[326] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 4:12:1** — "Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said: Sarah went down to Egypt and fenced herself off from sexual transgression, and all the women were protected through her merit. Joseph went down to Egypt and fenced himself off from sexual transgression, and all the males were protected through his merit. Rabbi Phinehas said in the name of Rabbi Hiyya: This protection against sexual transgression was by itself sufficient merit for Israel to be redeemed from Egypt." The manuscript's older section reference 4:25 corresponds to the exposition of "A locked garden," here divided as 4:12:1.

which receives the embryo; וְהַיְינוּ יו״ד תַּתָּאָה **that is, the lower yud,** חָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה קֹדֶשׁ[327] **the lower Chochmah, the lower Kodesh** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג קעו, ב) **(as written, Zohar III 176b).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ שֶׁקֶל הַקֹּדֶשׁ **And this is what they said: "they are called the holy shekel."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּיוֹסֵף מַמְשִׁיךְ לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת אִקְרוּן **That is, Yosef draws down to the attribute of Malchus —** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְכוּלֵי **"the mouth, Torah she'b'al peh," etc.,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שָׁם רצז, א) **(holy Zohar ibid. 297a):** וְכַד אִתְבָּרְכָא מִיסּוֹד **"And when it is blessed from Yesod,** חָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה כַּנִּזְכָּר[328] **then we call it Kodesh," etc. —** וְהַיְינוּ קֹדֶשׁ כִּי קְרִינָן לָהּ קֹדֶשׁ וְכוּלֵי **that is, the lower Kodesh, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן אוֹר **And this too is "light,"** [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] **as it is written (Tehillim 97:11),** אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק **"Light is sown for the tzaddik";** וְהוּא אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן **and this is the primordial light** דְּזָרַע קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא בְּגַן עֵדֶן **which the Holy One, blessed be He, sowed in Gan Eden** וְעָבִיד לֵיהּ שׁוּרִין **and made it into rows** עַל יְדוֹי דְּהַאי צַדִּיק **through this Tzaddik,** דְּאִיהוּ גַּנָּנָא דְּגִנְּתָא[329] **who is the gardener of the garden** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קסו, ב) **(as written, Zohar II 166b);** וּבְשַׁבָּת דְּכוּלֵי עָלְמָא **and on Shabbos — for all agree** בְּשַׁבָּת נִיתְּנָה תּוֹרָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל[330] **that on Shabbos the Torah was given to Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת פו, ב) **(as written, Shabbos 86b) —** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **that is, Torah she'bichsav.** וְיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **And "the seventh day" —** דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּאִיהוּ יוֹם שְׁבִיעִי[331] **which is the seventh day** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א מז, ב) **(as written, Zohar I 47b);** וְהַיְינוּ מַלְכוּת פֶּה **that is, "Malchus is the mouth;** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרִינָן לָהּ. **Torah she'b'al peh we call it."** קוֹרִין פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים בְּשַׁבָּת **Parshas Shekalim is read on Shabbos,** שֶׁבּוֹ הַזְּמַן לִזְכּוֹת **for then is the time to merit** לְחָכְמָה עִלָּאָה **the supernal Chochmah,** מַאֲמַר וּלְחָכְמָה **the utterance "Let there be light,"** אוֹר פְּנֵי מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים **"the light of the King's face is life,"** יְהִי אוֹר **and the lower Chochmah,** תַּתָּאָה אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק: **"Light is sown for the tzaddik."**

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[327] **Zohar III 44a, Tazria 9:6** — "This offering is like the animal offering: this is after eight days, and that is after eight days, as it is written, 'From the eighth day onward it will be accepted.' Through what is it accepted? By one Shabbat having passed over it. Once one Shabbat has passed over it, this one is acceptable as an offering, and that one is acceptable as an offering. Why? Because it has become attached and joined to that Shabbat, the mystery of the holy covenant. Therefore everything is in a supernal mystery." The source links both circumcision on the eighth day and the animal's eligibility for sacrifice with encountering Shabbat.

[328] **Sefer Yetzirah 5, month-letter correspondences** — "He made the letter tzadi rule, bound a crown to it, and formed through it Aquarius in the world, Shevat in the year, and the stomach in the person. He made the letter kuf rule, bound a crown to it, and formed through it Pisces in the world, Adar in the year, and the gizzard in the person." The month-letter correspondences are explicit in the retrieved Warsaw 1884 text, divided as 5:2. Their use as preparation for repairing the quality of the righteous one is Rav Tzadok's exposition.

[329] **Shabbat 104a:7** — "Kuf—holy; resh—wicked. Why does the kuf turn its face away from the resh? The Holy One, blessed be He, says: I cannot look upon a wicked person. Why is the crown of the kuf turned toward the resh? The Holy One says: If he returns, I will bind a crown upon him like Mine. Why does the leg of the kuf hang apart? So that if he returns, he may enter." The alphabetic exposition gives kuf its association with holiness while preserving an entrance for repentance.

[330] **Rosh Hashanah 11a:2** — "Rabbi Joshua says: In Nisan the world was created; in Nisan the patriarchs were born; in Nisan the patriarchs died. ... In Nisan they were redeemed, and in Nisan they will be redeemed in the future." The expectation cited here follows Rabbi Joshua. Rabbi Eliezer, whose view also appears in the discussion, places the future redemption in Tishrei.

[331] **Exodus 30:15–16** — "The wealthy shall not give more, and the poor shall not give less, than half a shekel, when giving the Lord's contribution to atone for your lives. You shall take the atonement money from the children of Israel and assign it to the service of the Tent of Meeting; it shall be a memorial before the Lord for the children of Israel, to atone for your lives." Both the act of giving and the money itself carry the language of atonement. Rav Tzadok distinguishes the donor's completed part from the later purchase and offering of sacrifices.

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ט׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Tes

וּבְמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **In the Yerushalmi (Shekalim, chapter 2, halachah 3, 9b)** (בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי (שְׁקָלִים פֶּרֶק ב הֲלָכָה ג ט, ב) **and in the Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Sisa 10)** (כִּי תִשָּׂא י) יֵשׁ מַחֲלוֹקֶת **there is a dispute:** יֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים **some say** שֶׁמְּכַפְּרִים הַשְּׁקָלִים עַל עֲוֹון הָעֵגֶל **that the shekalim atone for the sin of the Calf,** וְיֵשׁ אוֹמְרִים **and some say** עַל שֶׁמָּכְרוּ בְּכוֹרָה שֶׁל רָחֵל **for their having sold Rachel's firstborn;** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וּשְׁנֵיהֶם אֱמֶת **And both are true,** דְּהַכֹּל אֶחָד **for it is all one:** דְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ פֶּגֶם הַנָּחָשׁ **the root is the blemish of the serpent,**[332] שֶׁהִטִּיל זוּהֲמָא בְּחַוָּה **who cast filth into Chavah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קמו, א) **(as written, Shabbos 146a);** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁנִּתְחַבֵּר לָהּ אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן **and through Adam HaRishon's joining with her** גָּרַם הַזּוהֲמָא בְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן וְזַרְעוֹ **the filth was brought into Adam HaRishon and his seed,** וְגָרַם **and it brought about** פֶּגֶם הַמֵּאָה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה[333] **the blemish of the hundred and thirty years** [עֵרוּבִין יח, ב] **(Eruvin 18b),** שֶׁהוּא הַפֶּגֶם דִּמְכִירַת יוֹסֵף[334] **which is the blemish of the sale of Yosef,** כַּיָּדוּעַ. **as is known.** וּבְשָׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה **And at the time of Matan Torah** הָיָה מְתוּקָּן כָּל קִלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ **the entire corruption of the serpent was rectified,** [תְּהִלִּים פב, ו] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Tehillim 82:6),** אֲנִי אָמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם **"I said, you are angels,"** וְלֹא הֲווּ מֵיְיתֵי **and they would not have died,** כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם קִלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ **as before the corruption of the serpent;** רַק עַל יְדֵי הָעֵגֶל **only through the Calf:** חֲבַלְתֶּם מַעֲשֵׂיכֶם **"you ruined your deeds —** אֲבָל כְּאָדָם וְגוֹמֵר[335] **indeed, like men," etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ה, א). **(as written, Avodah Zarah 5a).** וְכֵן עֲוֹון הָעֵגֶל **So too the sin of the Calf** שָׁמוּר לְדוֹרוֹת **is kept for the generations,** [שְׁמוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לב, לד] **as it says (Shemos 32:34),** וּבְיוֹם פָּקְדִי וּפָקַדְתִּי[336] **"On the day I make account, I will bring to account";** וְכֵן חֵטְא מְכִירַת יוֹסֵף **and so the sin of the sale of Yosef** הָיָה שָׁמוּר עַד עֲשָׂרָה הֲרוּגֵי מַלְכוּת **was kept until the Ten Martyrs,** (סוֹף אֵיכָה[337]) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ. **as they said in the Zohar Chadash (end of Eichah).** וּשְׁנֵיהֶם נִדְרָשׁוּ בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ כִּי תִשָּׂא **Both are expounded in the Zohar Chadash on Ki Sisa** מִשְּׁנֵי פְּסוּקִים **from the two verses** כָּל הָעוֹבֵר עַל הַפְּקוּדִים **"Everyone who passes among those counted"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ח) **(as explained in maamar 8).** וּבְרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא **And in the Ra'aya Meheimna at the start of Parshas Ki Sisa** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ ב קפז, ב אִיתָא **(holy Zohar II 187b) it states:** הָעָשִׁיר לֹא יַרְבֶּה **"The rich shall not give more" —** דָּא עַמּוּדָא דְּאֶמְצָעִיתָא **this is the Middle Pillar;** לֹא יַרְבֶּה עַל עֶשֶׂר וְכוּלֵי **he shall not go beyond ten, etc.;** וְהַדַּל דָּא צַדִּיק **"and the poor" — this is the Tzaddik —** לֹא יַמְעִיט מֵעֶשֶׂר וְכוּלֵי **"shall not give less" than ten, etc.** וְאִינּוֹ מוּבָן **This is not understood,** דְּעַמּוּדָא דְּאֶמְצָעִיתָא **for the Middle Pillar** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא בַּנּוֹדָע

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[332] **Mussaf piyyut for Parshas Shekalim, Modim** — "The One who counts counted them in the five books, and another five in all the books. May the pure utterance of our lips make payment for bulls, for the silver of atonement shekels has ceased. May the light of Your face shine upon us, O Master; I shall bear the shekel in the established and exalted House." The source directly connects the lips' utterance with payment for sacrificial bulls when the shekel contribution is unavailable. Rav Tzadok explains reading the Torah portion as completing Israel's part in atonement.

[333] **Exodus 30:14** — "Everyone who passes among those counted, from twenty years old and upward, shall give the Lord's contribution." Rav Tzadok begins with the original census setting, then asks why its language remains central to the annual reading of Shekalim.

[334] **Bava Metzia 33b:2–3** — "What did they expound? As Rabbi Judah son of Rabbi Ilai expounded: What is meant by 'Declare to My people their transgression, and to the house of Jacob their sin'? 'Declare to My people their transgression'—these are Torah scholars, whose inadvertent errors are reckoned as intentional sins. 'And to the house of Jacob their sin'—these are the unlearned, whose intentional sins are reckoned as inadvertent errors. This is what we learned: Rabbi Judah says, Be careful in study, for an error in study is reckoned as an intentional sin." The distinction concerns responsibility corresponding to knowledge. The same passage supplies Rav Tzadok's later designation of the unlearned as the house of Jacob.

[335] **Zohar II 187b, Ki Tisa 1:2–3** — "A blessing from above does not rest on something that has been counted. If you ask, How then were Israel counted? A ransom was taken from them. ... The reckoning did not take place until all that ransom had been gathered, and it entered the count. First they bless Israel; afterward they count that ransom; afterward they return and bless Israel. Thus Israel are blessed at the beginning and at the end, and death does not arise among them. Why does death arise through counting? Because blessing does not rest upon a count. Once blessing has departed, the other side rests upon it and can cause harm. Therefore they take a ransom and redemption, so that the reckoning may fall upon it." The blessings surround a count of the ransom money, protecting the people whose lives it represents.

[336] **Deuteronomy 33:4** — "Moses commanded us Torah, an inheritance of the congregation of Jacob." The Torah is the inheritance of the entire congregation. Rav Tzadok includes even those whom the Talmud calls the house of Jacob—the unlearned—in this shared inheritance.

[337] **Proverbs 10:22** — "The blessing of the Lord—it makes wealthy, and He adds no sorrow with it." The verse speaks of the wealth of divine blessing; Rav Tzadok applies that wealth here to the individual's portion in Torah.

is Kudsha Brich Hu, as is known, וּמִצְוַת שְׁקָלִים **whereas the mitzvah of shekalim,** הָעָשִׁיר לֹא יַרְבֶּה **"the rich shall not give more,"** נֶאֱמַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל. **was said to Yisrael.** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **But the matter is as we said:** שֶׁיֵּשׁ שֶׁפּוֹגֵם **there is one who blemishes** דְּאַפְרִיד זֶה מִזֹּאת **by separating "zeh" from "zos"** — זֶה אֵלִי **"This is my G-d"** — וְהַיְינוּ בִּבְחִינַת עַמּוּדָא דְּאֶמְצָעִיתָא. **that is, in the aspect of the Middle Pillar.** וְיֵשׁ הָעוֹבֵר עַל הַפְּקוּדִים **And there is "one who passes among those counted,"** שֶׁפּוֹגֵם בְּמִדַּת כָּל **who blemishes the attribute of "kol"** — דָּא צַדִּיק **this is the Tzaddik** — וַאֲפְרִיד זֶה מִזֹּאת **and separates "zeh" from "zos"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאַר מַאֲמָר ח) **(as explained in maamar 8);** וּשְׁנֵיהֶם צְרִיכִין לְתַקֵּן **and both need to rectify,** לְקָרְבָא זֶה בְּזֹאת **to bring "zeh" close to "zos":** זֶה יִתְּנוּ, **"this they shall give,"** וְזֶה יִתְּנוּ כָּל, **"and this they shall give, all,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ **as they said in the Zohar Chadash** [כִּי תִשָּׂא שָׁם]. **(Ki Sisa ibid.).** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר הָעָשִׁיר **And about this it says "the rich"** — שֶׁמְּתַקֵּן הַקִּלְקוּל **who rectifies the corruption** דְּאֶמְצָעִיתָא בִּבְחִינַת עַמּוּדָא **in the aspect of the Middle Pillar,** לְקָרְבָא לֵיהּ בְּזֹאת **to bring it close to "zos"** — לֹא יַרְבֶּה עַל יו״ד. **"shall not give more" than the yud.** וְהַדַּל שֶׁמְּתַקֵּן רַק מִדַּת צַדִּיק **And "the poor," who rectifies only the attribute of Tzaddik,** לְקָרְבָא לֵיהּ בְּזֹאת **to bring it close to "zos,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we said** — לֹא יַמְעִיט מִיו״ד.[338] **"shall not give less" than the yud.** וְהֵבִיא [בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא שָׁם] **And he cites (in the Ra'aya Meheimna ibid.)** מִסֵּפֶר יְצִירָה **from Sefer Yetzirah:** עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא אַחַד עָשָׂר **"ten and not eleven"** — וְלֹא תַּמְעִיט כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר **and "shall not give less," as it is said,** עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא תִּשַׁע **"ten and not nine";** וּפֵירְשׁוּ עַל מִדַּת הַדַּעַת. **and they explained it as referring to the attribute of Daas.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּהָעָשִׁיר **That is, the rich one** — אַף שֶׁמְּתַקֵּן הַכֹּל **although he rectifies everything,** וְגַם הַחֶלְבְּנָה יִתֵּן רֵיחַ טוֹב[339] **so that even the galbanum gives off a good scent,** וְהוּא עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה עִלָּאָה **and that is through supernal teshuvah,** בְּחִינַת בִּינָה **the aspect of Binah,** [עַל דָּרְךָ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מִשְׁלֵי ב, ה] **in the manner of what is said (Mishlei 2:5),** אָז תָּבִין יִרְאַת ה׳ **"Then you will understand the fear of Hashem** וְדַעַת אֱלֹהִים תִּמְצָא **and find the knowledge of G-d"** — וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לְהַשָּׂגַת הַדַּעַת **that is, he merits the attainment of Daas;** [שָׁם, י] וְנֶאֱמַר **and it says (ibid. 10),** כִּי תָבוֹא חָכְמָה בִלְבָבֶךָ **"When wisdom enters your heart** וְדַעַת לְנַפְשְׁךָ יִנְעָם **and knowledge is pleasant to your soul"** — כְּשֶׁיָּבֹא הַחָכְמָה **when Chochmah comes** לְעֹמֶק בִּינַת הַלֵּב **into the depth of the heart's understanding,** זוֹכֶה לְהַדַּעַת **he merits Daas** — וְיִסְבּוֹר שֶׁיֵּשׁ אַחַד עָשָׂר אוֹרוֹת **and he might think that there are eleven lights;** עֶשֶׂר וְלֹא אַחַד עָשָׂר **ten and not eleven;** עַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר הָעָשִׁיר לֹא יַרְבֶּה **about this it says, "the rich shall not give more":** כְּמוֹ דְּכֵינָן שֶׁזְּדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשׂוֹת לוֹ כִּזְכִיּוֹת **for since his willful sins become for him like merits,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עֲלֵיהֶם הוּא יִחְיֶה **as it says, "on account of them he shall live,"** וּכְמוֹ נִכְלָל בְּעֶשֶׂר **it is included in the ten,** שֶׁדַּעַת כָּלוּל בְּעֶשֶׂר מִדּוֹת **just as Daas is included in the ten attributes** וּמְמַלֵּא מְקוֹם הַכֶּתֶר.[340] **and fills the place of Keser.** וְהַדַּל דָּא צַדִּיק כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **And "the poor" is the Tzaddik, as mentioned above,** וְאֵינוֹ זוֹכֶה לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת **who does not merit the aspect of Daas,** וְיִסְבּוֹר כֵּיוָן שֶׁמִּדָּה הָרִאשׁוֹנָה **and he might think that since the first attribute** נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן **is hidden from all thought** וְאֵין לוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה בָּזֶה **and one has no grasp of it whatsoever,** יֵשׁ רַק תֵּשַׁע מִדּוֹת **there are only nine attributes** שֶׁהֶאֱצִיל לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם **which He emanated for the creation of the world** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בָּהֶם תְּפִיסָה **so that they could be grasped;** עַל זֶה אָמַר לֹא יַמְעִיט מֵעָשָׂר **about this it says, "shall not give less" than ten,** כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר עָשָׂר וְלֹא תִּשַׁע **as it is said, "ten and not nine"** — גַּם כֵּן יְכוֹלִים לִזְכּוֹת **one can also merit** לְהַשִּׂיג הֲוָיָ״ה אֶחָד **to** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מְהֵימְנוּתָא שְׁלֵימְתָא **for through complete faith** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֵלֶק ג רל, א] **(holy Zohar III 230a),** אִיהִי אֱמוּנָה,

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[338] **Tikkunei Zohar, Introduction 17a** — "You brought forth ten arrangements, and we call them ten sefirot, through which to direct concealed worlds that are not revealed and worlds that are revealed. ... Malkhut is the mouth: we call it Oral Torah." The specific formula "Malkhut is the mouth, Oral Torah" is found in the introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, in Patach Eliyahu. It complements the preceding Zohar passage about the seventh day.

[339] **Megillah 13b:20–21** — "'Ten thousand talents of silver I will weigh out.' Resh Lakish said: It was revealed and known before the One who spoke and the world came into being that Haman would in the future weigh out shekels against Israel. Therefore He caused their shekels to precede his shekels. This is what we learned: On the first of Adar public announcements are made concerning the shekels and mixed species." Israel's contribution precedes Haman's payment in the order of the year and in the divine preparation for deliverance.

[340] **Midrash Tanchuma, Toldot 8** — "When Esav came from outside, he told his father: Father, is salt liable to the tithe? Yitzchak marveled and said: See how particular my son is in commandments. His father asked him: My son, where were you today? He answered: In the house of study. Is this not the law of such and such? Is this not its prohibition? Is this not its permission? Through these words he hunted him with his mouth, and therefore he loved him. But the holy spirit cries: Though he makes his voice gracious, do not believe him, for seven abominations are in his heart." Esau's performance imitates Torah devotion in speech. This is the precedent for the apparent equivalence Rav Tzadok sees in the offerings of Bilam and the money of Haman.

"She is faith"; כְּתָר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת. **Keser Elyon is Keser Malchus.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And as we said,** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס **that one merits the lower Chochmah,** שֶׁהוּא הָרֹב חָכְמָה **which is "much wisdom," to rectify "much anger";** וְהִיא גַּם כֵּן מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא **and it is also from the dew of Atika —** טַל תּוֹרָה מְחַיֵּיהוּ[341] **the dew of Torah revives them,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **as they said in the Tikkunei Zohar** (תִּקּוּן יט לח, ב **(Tikkun 19, 38b,** וּבְהַקְדָּמָה יב, א. **and in the Introduction, 12a;** וְעַיֵּין כְּתוּבוֹת קיא, ב) **and see Kesubos 111b);** וְנִתְבָּאַר כְּבָר (מַאֲמָר ד) בָּזֶה: **and this was already explained (maamar 4).**

[341] **Midrash Tanchuma, Tzav 2** — "In the world to come, when the Holy One, blessed be He, exacts payment from Esau, what does Esau do? He wraps himself in his tallit like an elder and comes and sits beside Jacob. From where? For it is written, 'Though you place your nest among the stars'; and the stars mean Israel, as it is said, 'Look, please, toward heaven,' and 'So shall your offspring be.' What does Jacob say to him? My brother, you will not be a brother like me. ... Once Esau departs from the world, the Holy One and Israel remain, as it is said, 'One is My dove, My perfect one.'" The tallit is a claim to shared identity; the Midrash ends by distinguishing Israel's particular bond.

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר י׳ Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Yud

In the Midrash Rabbah (Ki Sisa 39:1): בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (כִּי תִשָּׂא לט, א) **The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him:** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **Yisrael owe Me** חַיָּבִין לִי יִשְׂרָאֵל **what they borrowed from Me,** מַה שֶּׁלָּווּ הֵימֶנִּי **as it says, "Ki sisa"** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כִּי תִשָּׂא **— as you would say,** כְּמָה דְּתֵימָא [דְּבָרִים כד, י] **"When you lend to your fellow" (Devarim 24:10);** כִּי תַשֶּׁה בְרֵעֲךָ **tell them to repay, etc.** אֱמוֹר לָהֶם שֶׁיִּפְרְעוּ וְכוּלֵי[342] וְלִכְאוֹרָה אֵין לוֹ פֵּירוּשׁ **Seemingly this has no meaning, for the ransom of the soul** דְּכוֹפֶר נֶפֶשׁ **is not repayment of a debt they borrowed,** אֵינוֹ שִׁילּוּם חוֹב שֶׁלָּווּ **but is for atonement.** רַק לְכַפָּרָה. **The matter is based on what is written** וְהָעִנְיָן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב **in Sefer HaRokeach (Introduction):** בְּסֵפֶר הָרוֹקֵחַ [הַקְדָּמָה] אֵין חוֹזֶק כְּחוֹזֶק הַחֲסִידוּת בִּתְחִלָּתוֹ[343] **there is no strength like the strength of piety at its beginning.** **And they said in the name of the Rebbe, Reb Bunim,** וְאָמְרוּ בְּשֵׁם הָרַבִּי רַבִּי בוּנִים **may the memory of the holy tzaddik be a blessing,** זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה **that about this it says (Koheles 7:10),** שֶׁעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר [קֹהֶלֶת ז, י] **"Do not say," etc.,** אַל תֹּאמַר וְגוֹמֵר **"that the former days were better than these,** הָיוּ טוֹבִים מֵאֵלֶּה שֶׁהַיָּמִים הָרִאשׁוֹנִים **for it is not out of wisdom that you ask about this";** כִּי לֹא מֵחָכְמָה שְׁאֵלְתָּ עַל זֶה **that is, the strength of piety** וְהַיְינוּ דְּחוֹזֶק הַחֲסִידוּת לֹא מֵחָכְמָה **did not come from your own wisdom,** רַק עַל יְדֵי שְׁאֵלָה וְהַלְוָאָה **but through a loan and a borrowing from Hashem Yisbarach,** מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **and afterward He withdraws it** וְאַחַר כָּךְ מְסַלְּקוֹ כְּדֵי שֶׁיַּשִּׂיג בִּיגִיעָתוֹ[344] **so that he attain it through his own toil.** **And our holy Rebbe,** וְאָמַר רַבֵּינוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ **may the memory of the holy tzaddik be a blessing, said** זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה **that a person is shown at his beginning** דְּאִין מַרְאִין לְהָאָדָם בִּתְחִלָּתוֹ **only as much as he will be able to attain afterward as a lasting acquisition.** רַק כְּפִי שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַשִּׂיג אַחַר כָּךְ בְּקִנְיָן[345] **And at the Splitting of the Sea there was the aspect of seeing,** וּבְקִרִיעַת יַם סוּף הָיָה בְּחִינַת הָרְאִיָּה **and about this they said** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ [בְּשַׁלַּח הַשִּׁירָה ג] **in the Mechilta (Beshalach, HaShirah 3)** בְּמְכִילְתָּא **and the holy Zohar (II 64b):** [חֵלֶק ב סד, ב] וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **a maidservant saw at the Sea** רָאָתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם **what Yechezkel did not see — "saw," precisely.** שֶׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל — רָאָתָה דַּיְקָא. **And afterward at Matan Torah,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **as it is written (Devarim 5:4),** כִּדְכְתִיב [דְּבָרִים ה, ד] **"Face to face Hashem spoke with you,"** פָּנִים בְּפָנִים דִּיבֶּר ה׳ עִמָּכֶם **the light was fixed as a lasting acquisition** נִקְבַּע הָאוֹר בְּקִנְיָן (וְנִתְבָּאַר בְּמָקוֹם אַחֵר)[346] **(as explained elsewhere).** **According to what has been said, Matan Torah** וּלְפִי הָאָמוּר הָיָה בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה

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[342] **Zohar III 194a, Balak 12:6** — "He sent to Bilam and said to him: I have in me two letters of Amalek—lamed-kuf, the ending of Amalek. ... Rabbi Shimon said: Say it this way: the beginning of Balak is bet-lamed, and the beginning of Bilam is bet-lamed. The beginning of Balak was in Bilam; the end of Amalek was in Balak; and the end of Bilam was the beginning of Amalek." The names Bilam and Balak jointly contain the letters of Amalek. The source gives a specific symbolic identification rather than merely a general resemblance.

[343] **Bamidbar Rabbah 20:18** — "Why seven altars? Corresponding to seven altars built by seven righteous men from Adam to Moses and accepted: Adam, Abel, Noah, Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, and Moses. He was saying: Why did You accept these? Was it not because of the service they performed before You? Is it not fitting for You to be served by seventy nations rather than one nation? The holy spirit answered him: 'Better a dry morsel'—better a meal offering mixed with oil, and dry—'than a house full of sacrifices of strife,' for you wish to introduce strife between Me and Israel. ... He said, 'The seven altars I have arranged.' ... He answered him: 'Better a meal of vegetables'—better the meal Israel made in Egypt, eating unleavened bread and bitter herbs—than the bulls you offer through hatred." The Midrash explicitly contrasts the intention of the offerings. Rav Tzadok develops its distinction between love and the wish to separate God from Israel.

[344] **Megillah 13b:16–17** — "Rava said: There was no one who knew how to speak maliciously like Haman. He said to him: Come, let us destroy them. He answered: I fear their God, lest He do to me what He did to earlier rulers. Haman said: 'There is'—they have fallen asleep with respect to the commandments. He answered: There are rabbis among them. Haman said: They are one people." Rav Tzadok reads this exchange as Haman's effort to press an accusation against the whole people, including the learned.

[345] **Esther Rabbah 3:10** — "Rabbi Yudan and Rabbi Levi said in the name of Rabbi Yohanan: Every place in this Megillah where 'King Ahasuerus' is said, Scripture speaks of King Ahasuerus; every place where it says simply 'the king,' it serves both the sacred and the ordinary meaning." The rule allows the human king's treasury to be interpreted simultaneously in relation to the divine King. The statement concerns interpretive levels, not an assertion that Haman consciously intended a sacred gift.

[346] **Zohar III 109a, Behar 5:8** — "Rabbi Shimon said: But we find 'courts' in the verse, 'She stood in the inner court of the king's house, opposite the king's house.' In every place, 'the king' without qualification is the Holy One, blessed be He. 'She stood'—standing means prayer. 'Opposite the king's house'—opposite the Temple, for all Israel must direct their prayer there and be opposite the Temple." The Zohar supplies the same sacred reading of the unqualified title in Esther, here in the scene of Esther's prayer.

was כְּעֵין שִׁילּוּם חוֹב **like the repayment of a debt** מַה שֶּׁזָּכוּ בִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף בִּשְׁאֵלָה **for what they had merited at the Splitting of the Sea on loan;** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁאַחַר כָּךְ קִלְקְלוּ **and since afterward they sinned** וְנִתְבַּטֵּל הַחִיתּוּן **and the marriage was annulled,** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה מג, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shemos Rabbah 43:1):** מוּטָב שֶׁתִּדּוֹן כִּפְנוּיָה וְכוּ'[347] **better that she be judged as an unmarried woman, etc. —** מִמֵּילָא חַיְיבִין יִשְׂרָאֵל **consequently Yisrael owe** מַה שֶּׁלָּקְחוּ בִּשְׁאֵלָה וְהַלְוָאָה **what they took as a loan and a borrowing** בְּפֶסַח וּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **at Pesach and the Splitting of the Sea;** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר כִּי תַשָּׁא **and about this it says "Ki sisa,"** כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר **as it is said,** כִּי תַשֶּׁה בְרֵעֲךָ. **"When you lend to your fellow."** וְעַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **And through the shekalim —** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י, ב) כְּדְאִיתָא **as it states (Bava Basra 10b):** בְּמָה תָּרוּם קַרְנָן יִשְׂרָאֵל **"Through what is the horn of Yisrael raised?** כֵּיוָן שֶׁזּוֹכִין **Through 'Ki sisa'" —** זֶה נִקְרָא מְשַׁלְּמִין מַה שֶּׁלָּווּ **this is called repaying what they borrowed,** לְהַרָמַת קַרְנָן **since they merit the raising of the horn** עַד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **up to Keser Elyon,** לִהְיוֹת הַיִּחוּד אֶחָד **that there be the unity of "echad,"** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ אָלֶ"ף חֵי"ת **which indicates that the aleph and ches,** תֵּשַׁע הַמִּדּוֹת **the nine attributes, shine in the dalet —** וְנִקְבַּע הָאוֹר בְּקִנְיָן ה' ד' חֲוַת וְכוּ' **and the light is fixed as a lasting acquisition; the heh was a dalet, etc. —** בְּדָ' **they repay the loan and the borrowing,** מְשַׁלְּמִים הַשְּׁאֵלָה וְהַהַלְוָאָה **since the blemish of the Calf has been rectified.** כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּתְקַן פְּגַם הָעֵגֶל. **And on every Shabbos, at the third meal,** וּבְכָל שַׁבָּת בִּסְעוּדָה שְׁלִישִׁית **they merit the unity,** זוֹכִין לְהַיִּחוּד **as written in Sefer Mateh Moshe** [סִימָן תפב] **(siman 482),** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בְּסֵפֶר מַטֵּה מֹשֶׁה **that for this reason we say at Minchah (in the Amidah prayer)** שֶׁמִּטַּעַם זֶה אוֹמְרִים בְּמִנְחָה [בְּתְפִלַּת הָעֲמִידָה] **"Atah Echad," etc.;**[348] אַתָּה אֶחָד וְכוּ' **and on this Shabbos, when through the shekalim** וּבְשַׁבָּת זוֹ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים **they merit to bring "zeh" close to "zos,"** זוֹכִין לְקָרְבָא זֶה בְּזֹאת **they merit the unity of Kudsha Brich Hu and His Shechinah,** זוֹכִין לְיִחוּד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ **"in the light of the King's face is life."** בְּאוֹר פְּנֵי מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים. **And the Midrash Rabbah concludes:** וּמַסִּיק בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **"and I will repay them,"** [הוֹשֵׁעַ ב, א] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Hoshea 2:1),** וְהָיָה מִסְפַּר בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וְגוֹמֵר וַאֲשַׁלְּמָה לָהֶם **"And the number of Bnei Yisrael shall be," etc.,** יֵאָמֵר לָהֶם בְּנֵי אֵל חָי **"it shall be said to them, children of the living G-d" —** וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה: **that is, as it was at Matan Torah.**

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[347] **Midrash Tanchuma, Mishpatim 14** — "'He who increases his wealth through interest and increase gathers it for one who is gracious to the poor'—this is Esau. Is Esau gracious to the poor? He oppresses the poor! Rather, the government hears that a man is taking interest, brings a charge against him, takes his wealth, and builds public buildings, bathhouses, colonnades in the province, and facilities needed by travelers. Thus, 'he gathers it for one who is gracious to the poor.'" The Midrash's provocative designation refers to the public use of confiscated wealth. Rav Tzadok uses it to distinguish an outward charitable result from the donor's inner intention.

[348] **Kohelet Rabbah 4:6** — "Another interpretation: 'Better one handful of rest'—better one who gives a little charity from his own property than one who robs, takes by force, and oppresses, and then gives great amounts of charity from the property of others. The proverb says: She commits adultery for apples and distributes them to the sick. 'And pursuit of wind'—his desire is to be called a man of good deeds." The exact proverb occurs in the present division at Kohelet Rabbah 4:6, rather than 4:5. The bracketed explanatory gloss in the digital edition is not treated as original Midrash.

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר י״א Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Yud Aleph

In the Tanchuma (Ki Sisa 1) (בְּתַנְחוּמָא (כִּי תִשָּׂא א **and in the Pesikta Rabbasi (parshah 10, siman 1):** (וּבְפִסְיקְתָּא רַבָּתִי (פָּרָשָׁה י סִימָן, א **Why do they begin in Adar** וְלָמָּה מַתְחִילִין בַּאֲדָר **and take up the terumah from Nissan?** וְתוֹרְמִין מִנִּיסָן **So as not to press Yisrael;** וְהָיוּ **and they would remind Yisrael** מַזְהִירִין אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁלֹּא לִדְחוֹק עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **from Rosh Chodesh, etc.**[349] מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ וְכוּלֵי **Now, although a half shekel** הִנֵּה אַף שֶׁחֲצִי שֶׁקֶל **is a small matter in our times,** דָּבָר מוּעָט בִּזְמַנֵּינוּ **and seemingly how does the reason apply to it,** וְלִכְאוֹרָה מַה שַּׁיָּיךְ עַל זֶה הַטַּעַם **"so as not to press Yisrael"?** שֶׁלֹּא לִדְחוֹק אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל (סִימָן קנג) **But the Rivash already wrote (siman 153)** אַךְ כְּבָר כָּתַב הָרִיבַ״שׁ עַל שִׁיעוּר פְּרוּטָה **regarding the measure of a perutah,** שֶׁהוּא דָּבָר מוּעָט **that it is a small matter,** וְהוּא מָמוֹן לְקַדֵּשׁ אִשָּׁה וּכְדוֹמֶה **yet it is money to betroth a woman and the like;** וְהֵשִׁיב דְּאַף **and he answered that even though in our times** דִּבְזַמַּנֵּינוּ יֵשׁ עֲשִׁירֵי עָם **there are the wealthy of the people,** וְהוּא דָּבָר מוּעָט **and it is a small matter;** אָז בִּזְמָנָם **but then, in their time,** שֶׁהָיְתָה הָעֲנִיּוּת בְּהַכְפָּלָגָה **when poverty was extreme,** רַחֲמָנָא לִיצְלַן **Heaven save us,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בִּנְחֶמְיָה סִימָן ה׳ **as it says in Nechemiah chapter 5,** הָיָה **a perutah was then something significant;** אָז פְּרוּטָה דָּבָר חָשׁוּב **see there at length.**[350] עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת. וְזֶה **And this is what they said,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ **that they would remind Yisrael from Rosh Chodesh:** שֶׁהָיוּ מַזְהִירִין אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **this is what we learn in Shekalim** [פֶּרֶק א מִשְׁנָה א] **(chapter 1, mishnah 1):** הַיְינוּ הָא דְּתָנַן בִּשְׁקָלִים **"On the first of Adar** בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר **they announce concerning the shekalim"** — מַשְׁמִיעִין עַל הַשְּׁקָלִים וְהַיְינוּ **that is, by proclamation of the Beis Din,** בְּהַכְרָזַת בֵּית דִּין **as Rashi explains** [מְגִילָּה כט, א דִּבּוּר כְּפֵירוּשׁ רַשִׁ״י **(Megillah 29a, s.v. Mashmi'in);** [הַמַּתְחִיל מַשְׁמִיעִין **and it was not on Shabbos** וְלֹא הָיָה בְּשַׁבָּת **but on Rosh Chodesh,** רַק בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **on whatever day it fell;** בְּאֵיזוֹ יוֹם שֶׁחָל **and its purpose, simply,** וְהָיָה בִּפְשׁוּטוֹ **was that each one of Yisrael prepare his shekel** שֶׁיְּכִין כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל שִׁקְלוֹ **in order to take up the terumah on Rosh Chodesh Nissan** כְּדֵי לִתְרוֹם בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **from the new terumah;** מִתְּרוּמָה חֲדָשָׁה **and they began early, from Rosh Chodesh Adar,** וְהִקְדִּימוּ מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **so as not to press Yisrael.** כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא לִדְחוֹק עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל. אֲבָל מַה **But the reading of Parshas Shekalim** שֶׁקּוֹרִין בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **on the Shabbos before Adar,** בְּשַׁבָּת שֶׁקּוֹדֶם אֲדָר **or on Rosh Chodesh when it falls on Shabbos** — אוֹ בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ בְּחָל בְּשַׁבָּת **it is impossible to say that it is to announce,** אִי אֶפְשָׁר לוֹמַר לְהוֹדִיעַ **since they proclaim from Rosh Chodesh;** שֶׁהֲרֵי מַכְרִיזִין מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **and from the Gemara (Megillah 29b),** וּמֵהַגְּמָרָא (מְגִילָּה כט, ב) **which says, "so that the shekalim will come," etc.,** דְּקָאָמַר כְּדֵי הֵיכִי דְּלֵיתוּ שְׁקָלִים וְכוּלֵי **it is evident that the enactment of reading Parshas Shekalim** מוּכָח שֶׁתַּקָּנַת קְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **existed in the time of the Beis HaMikdash as well.** הָיָה בִּזְמַן הַבַּיִת גַּם כֵּן. וְכֵן לְרַבָּן שִׁמְעוֹן בֶּן **And likewise according to Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel** גַּמְלִיאֵל **it answers that it is because of the money-changers' tables;** מְשַׁנֵּי מִשּׁוּם שׁוּלְחָנוֹת עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְהָעִנְיָן דְּאֵיתָא בַּיּוֹצֵר לְפָרָשָׁה זוֹ **The matter: it states in the Yotzer for this parshah** (סוֹף דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אוֹמֶן) **(at the end of the piece beginning "Omen"):** רַחוּם **"Merciful One, as You had mercy on Your espoused** בְּכֶסֶף כְּפוּרִים **through the silver of atonement,** כֵּן שְׁעֵה שִׁפְתֵינוּ **so turn to our lips** בְּשִׁלּוּם פָּרִים **in place of offering bulls."** וְכֵן בַּמּוּסָף [פִּיּוּט בִּרְכַּת מוֹדִים] **And likewise in Mussaf (the piyut of the Modim blessing):** צַחוּת נִיב שְׂפָתֵינוּ **"May the pure speech of our lips** יְשׁוּלַּם פָּרִים **be paid as bulls,** כִּי אֶפֶס כֶּסֶף שִׁקְלֵי כְּפוּרִים[351] **for there is no silver of the shekels of**

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[349] **Tosafot, Megillah 16a, s.v. "ve-dahi"** — "'And it pushed aside ten thousand talents of silver'—I heard that ten thousand talents of silver amount to half a shekel for each one of Israel, who numbered six hundred thousand when they left Egypt. He said that he would give Ahasuerus the entire price of their redemption. Examine it and you will find it." Tosafot gives the traditional correspondence but leaves the calculation to the reader. Chizkuni, Exodus 30:14, develops a lifetime calculation; the two presentations should not be conflated.

[350] **Chizkuni, Exodus 30:14** — "The total of all of them comes to ten thousand talents of silver. How? Most people live only seventy years; subtract twenty years of exemption ... fifty years remain in which each Israelite gives a common maneh, at a half holy shekel each year. Thus sixty people give sixty maneh in their lifetimes, which is a talent. They were six hundred thousand, so all of them together give ten thousand talents. Therefore the wicked Haman said, 'Ten thousand talents of silver I will weigh out': He said, My shekels are sufficient to cancel their shekels, and I will give the equivalent of the six hundred thousand among them, to do with them as I wish." Chizkuni's comparison uses fifty years of annual contributions, rather than one annual collection.

[351] **Shabbat 10b** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moses: I have a good gift in My treasury, and Shabbat is its name. I wish to give it to Israel; go and inform them." The discussion derives the need to inform the recipient of a gift from "that you may know that I am the Lord who sanctifies you." Rav Tzadok hears this treasury in the phrase "the king's treasuries."

atonement." וְלִכְאוֹרָה יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Seemingly one must understand:** דִּנְשַׁלְּמָה פָּרִים שְׂפָתֵינוּ **"let our lips take the place of bulls"** הוּא עַל קָרְבָּנוֹת **refers to the korbanos,** וּמַה שַּׁיְּיכוּת שִׁלּוּם פָּרִים עַל שְׁקָלִים **so what connection has "in place of bulls" with shekalim?** אֲבָל עִנְיַן קְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **But the reading of Parshas Shekalim** שְׁלֹשִׁים יוֹם קוֹדֶם רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **thirty days before Rosh Chodesh Nissan** הוּא לַעֲשׂוֹת הֲכָנָה לְעִנְיַן הַשְּׁקָלִים **is to make a preparation for the shekalim,** שֶׁיְּקָרִיבוּ מֵהֶם הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **from which they would offer the korbanos,** שֶׁהֵם לֶחֶם ה׳ **which are "the bread of Hashem,"** [בְּמִדְבַּר כח, ב] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Bamidbar 28:2),** לַחְמִי לְאִישַׁי **"My bread for My fire-offerings";** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג ז, ב) וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **and about this they said (Zohar III 7b):** יִשְׂרָאֵל מְפַרְנְסֵי לַאֲבִיהֶן שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **Yisrael sustain their Father in Heaven;** וְזֶה לֹא הָיָה אֶפְשָׁר **and this was not possible** רַק עַל יְדֵי שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל תְּרִמוּ שִׁקְלֵיהֶן.[352] **except through Yisrael contributing their shekels.** וְהוּצְרְכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל הֲכָנָה לָזֶה **And Yisrael needed a preparation for this** שְׁלֹשִׁים יוֹם קוֹדֶם רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **thirty days before Rosh Chodesh Nissan,** שֶׁתְּרְמוּ הַתְּרוּמָה חֲדָשָׁה **when they took up the new terumah;** וְהַהֲכָנָה עַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **and the preparation was through reading the parshah,** וְהוּצְרַךְ לִהְיוֹת בְּשַׁבָּת דַּיְקָא **and it had to be specifically on Shabbos,** (חֵלֶק ב פח, א) דְּאִיתָא **as it states in the holy Zohar (II 88a):** וְהַאי יוֹמָא מַלְיָא רֵישֵׁיהּ דְּזְעֵיר אַנְפִּין **"and on this day the head of Ze'eir Anpin is filled** מִטַּלָּא דְּנָחִית מַעְתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא וְכוּלֵי[353] **with the dew that descends from the holy Atika," etc.;** וְהֵינוּ עַל יְדֵי הַשָּׁלֹשׁ סְעוּדוֹת **that is, through the three meals,** שֶׁהֵם בְּרָזָא דְּעֹנֶג **which are in the secret of "oneg":** כְּמוֹ ע׳ עֵדֶן נ׳ נָהָר ג׳ גַּן[354] **ayin, Eden; nun, river; gimmel, garden,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר (חֵלֶק א כו, א) **as they said in the Zohar (I 26a);** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה מַלְיָא רֵישֵׁיהּ דְּזְעֵיר אַנְפִּין **and through this the head of Ze'eir Anpin is filled** מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **with the dew of the holy Atika;** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **and about this they said** דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְפַרְנְסֵי כְּבָיְכוֹל לַאֲבִיהֶן שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **that Yisrael sustain, as it were, their Father in Heaven,** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא זְעֵיר אַנְפִּין **Kudsha Brich Hu, Ze'eir Anpin;** דְּסְעוּדוֹת שַׁבָּת **for the Shabbos meals** נִקְרְאוּ סְעוּדָתֵי דְּמַלְכָּא **are called the meals of the King** [זֹהַר הַקְּדוֹשׁ חֵלֶק ב פח, ב] **(holy Zohar II 88b),** כְּמוֹ קָרְבָּנוֹת לַחְמִי לְאִישַׁי[355] **like the korbanos, "My bread for My fire-offerings";** וְטַלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא הוּא **and the dew of Atika** גַּם כֵּן טַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is also the dew of Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as has been explained many times** מִזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וְתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (וְנִזְכָּר לְמַעְלָה סוֹף מַאֲמָר ט) **from the holy Zohar and the Tikkunei Zohar (and mentioned above, end of maamar 9).** וְהוּצְרְכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לַעֲשׂוֹת הֲכָנָה בְּשַׁבָּת **And Yisrael needed to make the preparation on Shabbos,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה שְׁלֹשִׁים יוֹם **that it be thirty days** קוֹדֶם רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **before Rosh Chodesh Nissan;** וְזֶה הוֹעִיל **and this was effective** אַף לְמִי שֶׁתָּרַם שִׁקְלוֹ **even for one who contributed his shekel** עֶרֶב רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן. **on the eve of Rosh Chodesh Nissan.** וּבַחֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בַּאֲדָר **And on the fifteenth of**

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[352] **Bava Batra 10b:3–4; Rashi, s.v. "amar lo be-khi tissa"** — "Rabbi Abbahu also said: They asked Solomon son of David, How far does the power of charity extend? He said to them: Go and see what my father David explained: 'He distributed, he gave to the poor; his righteousness endures forever; his horn will be raised in honor.'" Rashi explains the first answer: "If you come to raise their heads in elevation, take from them a ransom for charity." Thus the Talmudic sequence itself links lifting the head with charity.

[353] **Vayikra Rabbah 25:2** — "Rabbi Huna and Rabbi Jeremiah said in the name of Rabbi Hiyya bar Abba: In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will make shelter and canopies for those who perform commandments beside those devoted to Torah in the Garden of Eden. There are three verses for this: 'For in the shelter of wisdom is the shelter of money'; 'Happy is the person who does this'; and 'She is a tree of life to those who uphold her.' ... Because Azariah engaged in business and placed food in Shimon's mouth, the teaching was called by his name." The accompanying example concerns material support for Torah study. The promised proximity to scholars explains Rav Tzadok's reading of elevation "in honor."

[354] **Pirkei Avot 6:3** — "There is no honor except Torah, as it is said, 'The wise shall inherit honor,' and 'The wholehearted shall inherit good'; and there is no good except Torah, as it is said, 'For I have given you good teaching; do not forsake My Torah.'" This explicit formulation is found in Avot 6:3. The cited Chullin 133a passage speaks of teaching an unfit student through "one who gives honor to a fool," but does not print this exact formula in the retrieved text.

[355] **Zohar II 128a–b, Terumah 6:5–6** — "'From every man'—from one who is called a man, who has prevailed over his inclination. Everyone who prevails over his inclination is called a man. 'Whose heart moves him willingly'—what is meant by 'whose heart moves him willingly'? One in whom the Holy One, blessed be He, takes pleasure. ... All these expressions speak of the Holy One. So too here, 'whose heart moves him willingly': from him you shall take My contribution, for there it is found, and not elsewhere. How do we know that the Holy One takes pleasure in him and has established His dwelling in him? When we see that this person's desire is to pursue and strive after the Holy One, with his heart, soul, and will, we know with certainty that the Divine Presence dwells in him." The text places the criterion in conquest of the inclination and the direction of the heart. The folio overlay turns to 128b during this paragraph; the quotation begins on 128a.

Adar שׁוּלְחָנוֹת יוֹשְׁבִין בַּמְּדִינָה[356] **the tables were set up in the provinces,** שֶׁמִּי שֶׁהָיָה בְּיָדוֹ **so that whoever had it in hand** הָיָה עוֹשֶׂה מַעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוָה **would perform the act of the mitzvah** שֶׁתָּרַם שִׁקְלוֹ **of contributing his shekel** שְׁתֵּי שַׁבָּתוֹת קוֹדֶם רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **two weeks before Rosh Chodesh Nissan;** וְכָל זֶה הָיָה הֲכָנָה **and all this was a preparation** שֶׁיּוּכַל כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **so that each one of Yisrael would be able** לִהְיוֹת בִּכְלַל יִשְׂרָאֵל[357] **to be included among Yisrael** מְפַרְנְסֵי לַאֲבִיהֶן שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם. **who sustain their Father in Heaven.** וּלְבַד זֶה הָיוּ מַשְׁמִיעִין **Besides this, they would announce** בְּאֶחָד בַּאֲדָר **on the first of Adar,** בְּאֵיזוֹ יוֹם שֶׁחָל **on whatever day it fell,** עַל הַשְּׁקָלִים **concerning the shekalim,** שֶׁיְּכִינוּ הַשְּׁקָלִים **that they should prepare the shekels,** וּכְדֵי שֶׁלֹּא לִדְחוֹק אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **and so as not to press Yisrael,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** (שָׁם סִימָן יא) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּפִסְיקְתָּא **And this is what they said in the Pesikta (ibid., siman 11):** כִּי תִשָּׂא בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **"Ki sisa — Bnei Yisrael"** אֵין כְּתִיב כָּאן **is not written here,** אֶלָּא אֶת רֹאשׁ **but rather "es rosh"** — וְאֵין רֹאשָׁם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and the head of Yisrael is none other** אֶלָּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **than the Holy One, blessed be He,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִיכָה ב, יג] וַה' בְּרֹאשָׁם **as it says (Michah 2:13), "and Hashem at their head";** וְאָמַר כַּמָּה מְשָׁלִים עַל זֶה **and it gives several parables about this;** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְהוּא הַמֻּכָּנָן לְמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is the intent of what they said,** יִשְׂרָאֵל מְפַרְנְסֵי לַאֲבִיהֶן **"Yisrael sustain their Father in Heaven"** — דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה **that is, that through this** יִהְיֶה מַלְיָא מִטַּלָּא דְּנַחִית מֵעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **the head of Ze'eir Anpin will be filled with the dew that descends from the holy Atika;** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כִּי תִשָּׂא אֶת רֹאשׁ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **and this is what it says, "Ki sisa es rosh Bnei Yisrael,"** שֶׁהוּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא. **which is the Holy One, blessed be He.** וְזֶה הָיָה הַהֲכָנָה **And this was the preparation** עַל יְדֵי פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים בִּזְמַן הַבַּיִת. **through Parshas Shekalim in the time of the Beis HaMikdash.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר הַפַּיְטָן **And this is what the paytan says** בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **in the present time,** שֶׁאֵין לָנוּ קָרְבָּנוֹת וְלֹא שְׁקָלִים **when we have neither korbanos nor shekalim:** כְּרַחֲמְתָּ וְכוּלֵי **"As You had mercy," etc.,** כֵּן שֶׁעָה שְׂפָתֵינוּ בְּשִׁילּוּם פָּרִים **"so turn to our lips in place of offering bulls,"** וְכֵן צַחוּת נִיב שְׂפָתֵינוּ **and likewise, "the pure speech of our lips** בְּשִׁלּוּם פָּרִים וְכוּלֵי **in place of bulls," etc.** — דְּאַף שֶׁנֶּחְסַר מַעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוָה **for although the act of the mitzvah is lacking,** שֶׁל הַשְּׁקָלִים **that of the shekalim,** לְהַקְרִיב מֵהֶם פָּרִים **to offer bulls from them,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לַחְמִי לְאִישַׁי **that it be "My bread for My fire-offerings,"** לֶחֶם אֱלֹהֵיהֶם. **"the bread of their G-d"** — וּנְשַׁלְּמָה פָרִים שְׂפָתֵינוּ **"let our lips take the place of bulls":** שֶׁהַקְּרִיאָה בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **that the reading of Parshas Shekalim** יַעֲלֶה כְּמוֹ מַעֲשֵׂה הַשְּׁקָלִים[358] **will count like the act of the shekalim** וְיִהְיֶה הֲכָנָה לְכָל הַשָּׁנָה **and be a preparation for the whole year,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה קְרִיאַת פְּסוּקֵי הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **that the reading of the verses of the korbanos** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמַּקְרִיבִין פָּרִים לֶחֶם **be as though they offer bulls, the bread of Hashem,** ה' וְיִהְיוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל מְפַרְנְסֵי כְּבָיָכוֹל **and all Yisrael will sustain, as it were,** לַאֲבִיהֶן שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **their Father in Heaven, as mentioned above.** וְכֵן סְעוּדוֹת שַׁבָּת **And likewise the Shabbos meals** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל אוֹכֵל לִכְבוֹד שַׁבָּת **that Yisrael eat in honor of Shabbos** נִקְרְאוּ סְעוּדָתֵי דְּמַלְכָּא **are called the meals of the King,** מִטַּלָּא דְּמַלְיָא רֵישֵׁיהּ דִּזְעֵיר אַנְפִּין **for the head of Ze'eir Anpin is filled** דְּנַחֲתִין מֵעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **with the dew that descends from the holy Atika** וְאָטִיל לַחֲקַל תַּפּוּחִין **and drips down to the Field of Apples,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שָׁם [פח, א] **as they said in the holy Zohar there (88a):** וְעַל דָּא

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[356] **Bava Batra 10b:7–10** — "Rabbi Eliezer answered: 'Charity raises a nation'—this means Israel. ... 'The kindness of nations is sin'—all the charity and kindness the nations do is sin for them, for they do it only to make themselves great. ... Is doing so not complete charity? Was it not taught: One who says, 'This sela is for charity so that my children may live,' or 'so that I may merit the world to come,' is completely righteous? There is no difficulty: here the case is an Israelite, and there a gentile. ... Rabban Gamliel answered: They do it only to exalt themselves; and whoever exalts himself falls into Gehinnom." These are particular rabbinic interpretations within a discussion of motive. The same page ends with Rabban Yohanan ben Zakkai's teaching that charity atones for the nations, so its several voices should be preserved.

[357] **Rosh Hashanah 3b–4a** — "'So that they may offer pleasing offerings to the God of heaven, and pray for the life of the king and his sons.' Is acting this way not praiseworthy? Was it not taught: One who says, 'This sela is for charity so that my children may live,' and 'so that through it I may merit life in the world to come,' is completely righteous? There is no difficulty: here the case is an Israelite, and there a gentile." The question raised at the end of Rosh Hashanah 3b is answered on 4a with the king's stated demand for prayers. Rav Tzadok uses this discussion to distinguish an act's appearance from its governing intention.

[358] **Zohar III 129a–b, Idra Rabba 7:1–3** — "The forehead of the skull is the will of wills; the will of Zeir Anpin is directed toward that will. ... When it is revealed, Israel's prayers are accepted. When is it revealed? ... At the time of the Shabbat afternoon prayer. ... During the weekdays judgment depends below in Zeir Anpin; on Shabbat the forehead called Will is revealed. At that hour anger is quieted, will is found, and prayer is accepted. ... Here, when the forehead is revealed, complete love and will are found, and all angers are quieted and subdued before it." The exposition addresses Shabbos afternoon.

and therefore אִתְעַנְּגָא בָּעֵי בַּר נָשׁ לְ**a person must take delight** תְּלַת זִמְנִין אִלֵּין **these three times,** דְּהָא בְּהָא תַּלְיָא **for on this depends** מְהֵימְנוּתָא דִּלְעֵילָּא **the faith of Above —** בְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא וּבְזְעֵיר אַנְפִּין **in the holy Atika, in Ze'eir Anpin,** וּבַחֲקַל תַּפּוּחִין וְכוּלֵי **and in the Field of Apples, etc.** וּסְעוּדוֹת שַׁבָּת **And the Shabbos meals** נְקְרְאוּ סְעוּדָתֵי מְהֵימְנוּתָא וְכוּלֵי **are called the meals of faith, etc.,** מְהֵימְנוּתָא שְׁלֵימְתָא בְּכָל סִטְרוֹי[359] **complete faith in all its aspects,** (שָׁם עַמּוּד ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar (there, side b);** וְהַיְינוּ דְּשָׁלֹשׁ סְעוּדוֹת שַׁבָּת **that is, the three Shabbos meals** נֶגֶד שָׁלֹשׁ קְדֻשּׁוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים **correspond to the three holinesses mentioned,** שֶׁהֵם מְהֵימְנוּתָא שְׁלֵימְתָא כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **which are complete faith, as mentioned above;** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרְאוּ גַּם כֵּן **and therefore they too are called** סְעוּדָתֵי דְּמַלְכָּא כְּקָרְבָּנוֹת: **the meals of the King, like the korbanos.**

[359] **Malachi 1:2** — "I have loved you, said the Lord. Yet you say, In what way have You loved us? Is not Esau Jacob's brother?—declares the Lord—yet I loved Jacob." The verse itself places the love of Jacob beside the apparent equivalence of Esau as his brother.

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר י״ב Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Yud Bais

בַּיּוֹצֵר לְִבִרְכַּת קְרִיאַת שְׁמַע **In the Yotzer for the blessing of Krias Shema** [אַל מִתְנַשֵּׂא] פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **of this parshah (El Misnasei):** לְיוֹנָה שֶׁהִיא תַּמָּה **"To the dove who is perfect,** יָחִיד וְכוּלֵי **"Yachid," etc.:** כָּל הָעוֹבֵר בְּיַמָּהּ **everyone who passed through her sea —** יִשְׁקְלוּ שֶׁקֶל בְּלִי מְהוּמָה **let them weigh out a shekel without confusion,** מַחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל תְּרוּמָה.[360] **a half shekel as terumah."** מַה שֶּׁכִּנָּה כָּאן יִשְׂרָאֵל **That he called Yisrael here** לְיוֹנָה תַּמָּה **a perfect dove** [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ה, ב] עַל שֵׁם הַכָּתוּב **is after the verse (Shir HaShirim 5:2),** יוֹנָתִי תַמָּתִי[361] **"My dove, My perfect one";** גַּם מַה שֶּׁאָמַר כָּל הָעוֹבֵר בְּיַמָּהּ **but also what he says, "everyone who passed through her sea" —** יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **one must understand** מַה שַּׁיְּיכוּת לְהַזְכִּיר כָּאן **what connection there is to mention here** עוֹבְרֵי הַיָּם. **those who crossed the Sea.** וּבֶאֱמֶת גַּם בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ **And indeed in the Zohar Chadash** (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא) אִיתָא **(beginning of Parshas Ki Sisa) too it states:** צַדִּיק אִיקְרֵי כָּל **the Tzaddik is called "kol,"** וּכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵי **and Knesses Yisrael, etc.;** אִתְקָרִבוּ דָּא בְּדָא **they drew close to one another;** כְּדֵין שֶׁקֶל הַקֹּדֶשׁ אִקְרוּן **then they are called "the holy shekel,"** בְּגִין דְּאִיהוּ פְּלַג גּוּפָּא **because He is half a body** וּכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל פְּלַג גּוּפָּא **and Knesses Yisrael is half a body;** אִתְחַבְּרוּ דָּא בְּדָא **they joined one with the other,** גּוּפָּא אִשְׁתְּלִים **the body was completed,** וּתְרֵין עֲשַׂר שִׁבְטִין **and the twelve tribes** דְּתְחוֹת יַמָּא **that are under the sea** יַנְקִין כָּל חַד מֵאֲתַר דִּילֵיהּ וְכוּלֵי **nurse, each one from its own place, etc. —** גַּם כֵּן זֵכֶר הַשְּׁבָטִים **here too there is mention of the tribes** דִּתְחוֹת יַמָּא. **under the sea.** אֲבָל הָעִנְיָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **But the matter is as we said,** שֶׁהַזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ מְפָרֵשׁ **that the Zohar Chadash explains** מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר שְׁתֵּי פְעָמִים **what is said twice,** כָּל הָעוֹבֵר עַל הַפְּקוּדִים **"everyone who passes among those counted,"** דְּעָבַר עַל פִּקּוּדֵי דְּמָארֵיהּ וְכוּלֵי **as one who transgressed the commandments of his Master, etc.,** שֶׁהַשְּׁקָלִים בָּאוּ לְכַפֵּר עֲוֹון הָעֵגֶל **that the shekalim came to atone for the sin of the Calf** גַּם לְכַפֵּר מְכִירַת יוֹסֵף **and also to atone for the sale of Yosef,** שֶׁהוּא הַפְּגָם בְּבְחִינַת צַדִּיק **which is the blemish in the aspect of Tzaddik —** וְכִשְׁתֵּי הַדֵּעוֹת **in line with the two opinions** שֶׁנֶּחְלְקוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **that disagree in the Yerushalmi** [שְׁקָלִים פֶּרֶק ב הֲלָכָה ג ט, ב] **(Shekalim, chapter 2, halachah 3, 9b)** [כִּי תִשָּׂא י] וְתַנְחוּמָא. **and in the Tanchuma (Ki Sisa 10).** וְסִבְירָא לֵיהּ לְהַזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ **And the Zohar Chadash holds** דְּהַשְּׁקָלִים בָּאוּ עַל שְׁנֵיהֶם **that the shekalim came to atone for both,** דִּשְׁנֵי הַקִּלְקוּלִים שְׁמוּרִים לְדוֹרוֹת. **since both corruptions are kept for the generations.** וּשְׁנֵיהֶם אֶחָד **And both are one,** דְּמִפְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **for from the blemish of the serpent** נִצְמַח פְּגַם הַבְּרִית **sprouted the blemish of the bris,** עַל יְדֵי הַזּוּהֲמָא שֶׁהֵטִיל בְּחַוָּה. **through the filth he cast into Chavah.** וְכֵן עַל יְדֵי פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **And likewise through the Calf** נִתְקַלְקֵל מַה שֶּׁנִּתְתַּקֵּן **was undone what had been rectified** הָעֵגֶל **of the serpent's blemish at Matan Torah:** דְּחַבֵּלְתֶּם מַעֲשֵׂיכֶם **"you ruined your deeds —** אֲבָל כְּאָדָם וְגוֹמֵר **indeed, like men," etc.** [עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ה, א] **(Avodah Zarah 5a).** וּבָאוּ הַשְּׁקָלִים לְקָרְבָא זֶה בְּזוֹאת **And the shekalim came to bring "zeh" close to "zos,"** לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַבְּרִית **to rectify the blemish of the bris,** וְיִתּוּקַן גַּם פְּגַם הָעֵגֶל **and so the blemish of the Calf is also rectified,** דְּהַכֹּל אֶחָד כָּאָמוּר **for it is all one, as stated** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ח וּמַאֲמָר ט) **(as explained in maamar 8 and maamar 9).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר לְיוֹנָה שֶׁהִיא תַּמָּה **And this is why he says "to the dove who is perfect,"** דִּמְתִילֵי כְּנֶסֶת עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת נג, ב) **based on what they said (Berachos 53b)** יִשְׂרָאֵל לְיוֹנָה וְכוּלֵי[362] **that Knesses Yisrael is likened to a dove, etc.,** שֶׁאֵינָהּ מַנַּחַת אֶת בַּת זוּגָהּ **for she does not**

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[360] **Bnei Heichala, Shabbat third-meal song; Siddur Ashkenaz, Third Meal, Atkinu 6–10** — "Rejoice now, at this hour, in which there is goodwill and no anger. Draw near to me; see my strength, for there are no harsh judgments. Outside they depart and do not enter, those brazen dogs. Behold, I invite the Ancient of Days to the afternoon meal, until they pass away. His will, which He reveals, is to nullify all the husks." The song itself places the exclusion of the brazen dogs within the afternoon revelation of divine goodwill. Rav Tzadok identifies the excluded force with Amalek through the following Zohar passage.

[361] **Zohar II 65a, Beshalach 32:5** — "'Sending away the foot of the ox and the donkey': These are the two crowns of the left to which the nations attach themselves, called ox and donkey. When Israel are worthy, they send them away and they cannot rule over them. Rabbi Abba said: When they join together, people cannot withstand them. Through a person's acts below, what should not be aroused is aroused. From their combined force emerges what is called dog, the most brazen of them all. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: You said, 'Is Hashem in our midst or not?' I therefore hand you over to the dog. Immediately, 'Amalek came.'" The identification of the brazen dog with Amalek is explicit. Rav Tzadok applies it to the exclusion of Haman and Amalek from the inner Shabbat bond.

[362] Parallel: **R. Yehudah Aryeh Leib Alter, Sefas Emes, Shekalim 5652, s.v. Darshu Chazal** — "Charity has the special power of attaching one to the root, as it says, 'Charity raises a nation, but the kindness of nations is sin.' This means that when the wicked reach their own root, it is sin—as the Sages said, scattering the wicked benefits them and the world, while gathering them harms them and the world. Thus Haman gave ten thousand shekels, and thereby reached the root of Amalek, 'the first of nations'; then 'his end is utter destruction' was fulfilled in him. The Holy

abandon her mate, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עירובין ק, ב) **as they said (Eruvin 100b):** עֲרָיוֹת מְיוֹנָה **marital fidelity from the dove,** כְּפֵירוּשׁ רַשִׁ״י **as Rashi explains** [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל עֲרָיוֹת][363] **(s.v. Arayos)** (וְכֵן הוּא בְּשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ד, ב[364]) **(and so it is in Shir HaShirim Rabbah 4:2);** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ **and as they said in the Zohar Chadash:** וְאָמַר כָּל הָעוֹבֵר בְּיָמָּהּ **they joined one with the other,** אִתְחַבְּרוּ דָּא בְּדָא. **the body was completed.** גּוּפָא אִשְׁתְּלִים **And he says "everyone who passed through her sea,"** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת בִּיצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם **for in truth at Yetzias Mitzrayim,** בְּמַכַּת בְּכוֹרוֹת **at the Plague of the Firstborn,** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **which corresponds to Keser Elyon,** נִתְבָּרְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **Yisrael were shown to be** שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **bound to the root —** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as has been explained many times** שֶׁהָיוּ הַמַּכּוֹת כְּנֶגֶד עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **that the plagues corresponded to the ten sefiros** מִתַּתָּא לְעֵילָּא **from below to above,** בְּבְחִינַת נָגוֹף לְמִצְרַיִם **in the aspect of "smiting for Mitzrayim** וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל. **and healing for Yisrael."** אַךְ הָיָה רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה **But it was only temporary,** שֶׁאַחַר כָּךְ בִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **for afterward, at the Splitting of the Sea,** כְּתִיב [שְׁמוֹת יד, כט] **it is written (Shemos 14:29),** וְהַמַּיִם לָהֶם חוֹמָה חָסֵר **"and the water was a wall for them," spelled defectively,** (וְאִיתָא (מכילתא בְּשַׁלַּח ו **and it states (Mechilta, Beshalach 6):** אַל תִּיקְרֵי חוֹמָה אֶלָּא חֵימָה **do not read "chomah," wall, but "cheimah," wrath,** שֶׁהָיָה קֶצֶף עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל[365] **for there was anger against Yisrael,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁקִּטְרֵג שַׂר מִצְרַיִם **as the angel of Mitzrayim accused:** אִלֵּין פָּלְחֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת וְכוּ' **"these are worshippers of stars and constellations," etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קע, ב[366]). **(as written, Zohar II 170b).** אֲבָל בִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **But at the Splitting of the Sea,** (דְּאִיתָא בְּמְכִילְתָּא בְּשַׁלַּח וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֵלֶק ב סד, ב) **and the holy Zohar II** הַשִּׁירָה ג **as it states (in the Mechilta, Beshalach, HaShirah 3, 64b):** שָׁם רָאֲתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם **a maidservant saw at the Sea** מַה שֶּׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל **what Yechezkel did not see —** לֹא הָיָה לְפִי שָׁעָה **there it was not temporary;** דְּאַף שֶׁנִּסְתַּר מֵהֶם הָאוֹר אַחַר כָּךְ **for although the light was hidden from them afterward,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם זֶה נִשְׁאַר לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד **nevertheless this remained forever:** הַחֲשֵׁק לִרְאוֹת הָאוֹר[367] **the longing to see the light;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב ס, א) **as they said in the holy Zohar (II 60a):** מַאי מִדְבַּר שׁוּר [שְׁמוֹת טו, כב] **What is "the wilderness of Shur" (Shemos 15:22)?** מִדְבְּרָא דַּהֲווֹ בָּעָאן לְאִסְתַּכְּלָא זִיוָא יְקָרָא דְּמַלְכָּא וְכוּ'[368] **The wilderness where they longed to gaze upon the radiance of the King's glory, etc.;**

One therefore caused Israel's shekels to come first, for through them they are raised to attach themselves to their root. This is fulfilled every year, as the Sages said: on the first of Adar they announce the shekels and mixed plantings. For Israel's beginning precedes the world, and there no foreign touch exists at all; only through sins did they become mixed among the nations. Through the shekels they return to attachment to that first root and become separated from the mixture. … The wicked wish to extinguish Israel's attachment to the Holy One, and also wish to intermingle with them. Through the shekels love for Israel is awakened, and all workers of iniquity are separated."

Connection: This passage addresses the apparent equivalence of Haman's money and Israel's money at precisely the level developed here: a gift's power to raise its giver to the root. Sefas Emes argues that the same movement has opposite results, because Haman's root is Amalek, while Israel's prior root is the particular bond in which no foreign claim can enter. This illuminates why matching the amount or outward charitable result cannot purchase the love disclosed at the third Shabbos meal. The emphasis differs from the earlier Sefas Emes note on equal love within Israel: here the issue is the failure of Haman's competing claim.

[363] **Taanis 29a** — "Rav Yehudah, son of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas, said in Rav's name: Just as, when Av enters, we reduce joy, so, when Adar enters, we increase joy." The comparison of the two months is the premise of this maamar: Rav Tzadok asks why a month's distinctive event gives its character to the entire month.

[364] **Rashi, Taanis 29a, s.v. MiShenichnas Adar** — "When Adar enters—these were days of miracles for Israel: Purim and Pesach." Rashi names both festivals. Rav Tzadok therefore examines whether the increase extends to Nisan, then distinguishes the particular quality of Adar.

[365] **Taanis 29b** — "Rav Pappa said: Therefore, a Jewish person who has a lawsuit with a gentile should avoid him in Av, when his mazal is unfavorable, and make himself available in Adar, when his mazal is favorable." The Gemara specifies Adar itself; this gives Rav Tzadok the textual basis for looking for a quality particular to Adar.

[366] **Taanis 29b–30a** — "The one who says that the entire month is forbidden derives it from 'her month'; and the one who says that the entire week is forbidden derives it from 'her week.'" The preceding discussion records Rabbi Meir's restriction from Rosh Chodesh until the fast, Rabbi Yehudah's restriction throughout the month, and Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel's restriction during the week. Rabbi Yochanan says that all three expound Hosea 2:13, 'I shall put an end to all her rejoicing, her festival, her month, and her week.' Rav Tzadok takes the month-long view as his comparison here.

[367] **Esther 9:22** — "As the days on which the Jews rested from their enemies, and the month that was transformed for them from sorrow to joy and from mourning to a festive day—to make them days of feasting and joy, sending portions to one another and gifts to the poor." The verse speaks of the transformation of the month as well as the particular days. That wording supports the maamar's emphasis on Adar's whole-month character.

[368] **Megillah 14a** — "Rav Nachman said: Reading the Megillah is its Hallel. Rava said: There, 'Praise, servants of Hashem' means that they are no longer Pharaoh's servants. But here, could we say 'Praise, servants of Hashem,' and

they said, אָמְרוּ מַאי טַעְמָא **what is the reason?** כִּי מָרִים הֵם [שָׁם] **"for they were bitter" (ibid.):** וְכוּלֵּי לָא אִתְבַּסַּם נַפְשַׁיְיהוּ כְּקַדְמֵיתָא **their souls were not sweetened as before, etc.;** וַיִּמְתְּקוּ הַמָּיִם [שָׁם, כה] **"and the waters became sweet" (ibid. 25)** דְּקַטֵּיגוֹרָא אִתְאֲבִיד סַנֵּיגוֹרָא — **the accuser was turned into a defender;** עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת.[369] **see there at length.** וּכְתִיב [שָׁם] **And it is written there (ibid.),** שָׁם שָׂם לוֹ חֹק **"There He set for it a statute"** — זֶה שַׁבָּת **this is Shabbos,** (בְּשַׁלַּח וַיִּסַּע א[370]) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמְכִילְתָּא **as they said in the Mechilta (Beshalach, Vayisa 1);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ מִצְוָה **that is, there is a mitzvah** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵחָקְקוּ **through which are engraved** הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד. **the words of Torah forever.** וְעַל יְדֵי חֵשֶׁק זֶה **And through this longing** זָכוּ לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **they merited Matan Torah,** כְּדִכְתִיב [דְּבָרִים ה, ד] **as it is written (Devarim 5:4),** פָּנִים בְּפָנִים וְגוֹמֵר[371] **"Face to face," etc.;** וְאַף אַחַר שֶׁבָּהֶם מִדְּרָשׁ הֲלָכוֹת **and even after the corruption** הַקִּלְקוּל זָכוּ לְלוּחוֹת שְׁנִיּוֹת **they merited the second Luchos,** וְאַגָּדוֹת **in which are Midrash, halachos and aggados,** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה מו, א; מז, ז[372]) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shemos Rabbah 46:1; 47:7).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר **And this is what he says:** כָּל הָעוֹבֵר בְּיַמָּהּ **"everyone who passed through her sea** — יִשְׁקְלוּ שֶׁקֶל בְּלִי מְהוּמָה **let them weigh out a shekel without confusion,** מַחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל תְּרוּמָה. **a half shekel as terumah":** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשְּׁקָלִים נִתְקַן שׁוֹרֶשׁ פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **that through the shekalim the root of the serpent's blemish is rectified,** שֶׁגָּרַם פְּגַם הַבְּרִית **which caused the blemish of the bris,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה **and through which came** עַל מְכָרָם בַּכֶּסֶף צַדִּיק[373] **"their selling a tzaddik for silver";** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה בָּאוּ לְמִצְרַיִם **and through this they came to Mitzrayim** וְנִתְבָּרְרוּ כּוּלָּם **and were all refined,** (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ד, כה) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 4:25):** יוֹסֵף יָרַד לְמִצְרַיִם **Yosef went down to Mitzrayim** וְנִגְדְּרוּ כָּל הַזְּכָרִים בִּזְכוּתוֹ.[374] **and all the males were fenced in from immorality in his merit.** וְכֵן נִתְקַן פְּגַם הָעֶגֶל **And**

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not Ahasuerus's servants? We are still Ahasuerus's servants." These are distinct explanations for the absence of a separate Hallel on Purim. Rav Tzadok invokes Rava's explanation to establish that the Exodus was the fuller political liberation, making Adar's special joy require a different explanation.

[369] **Exodus 6:6–7** — "Therefore say to the children of Israel: I am Hashem. I shall bring you out from under Egypt's burdens, rescue you from their service, and redeem you with an outstretched arm and with great judgments. I shall take you to Me as a people, and I shall be your God; you will know that I am Hashem your God, Who brings you out from under Egypt's burdens." The repeated 'I shall' makes Divine initiative explicit. Rav Tzadok contrasts that initiative with the active acceptance and struggle undertaken by Israel in Adar.

[370] **Zohar II 36a, Bo** — "Rabbi Yosi said: In the very act in which judgment was found for the Egyptians, mercy was found for Israel, as it is written: 'I shall see the blood and pass over you.' So too, among all those holy crowns above, wherever judgment was found, mercy was found, all at the same moment. Rabbi Chizkiyah taught: 'Hashem shall strike Egypt, striking and healing'—striking Egypt and healing Israel. What is 'healing'? Since they had been circumcised, they needed healing." The Zohar places judgment and mercy within the same act. The further correspondence of the successive plagues with successive measures of impurity and holiness is Rav Tzadok's development of this principle.

[371] **Vayikra Rabbah 23:2** — "Rabbi Elazar interpreted the verse concerning the redemption from Egypt: Just as a rose lying among thorns is difficult for its owner to pick, so it was difficult, as it were, for the Holy One, blessed be He, to redeem Israel. This is 'to take for Himself a nation from within a nation.' These were uncircumcised, and those were uncircumcised; these grew a forelock, and those grew a forelock; these wore forbidden mixtures, and those wore forbidden mixtures. Thus the attribute of judgment would never have allowed Israel to be redeemed from Egypt. Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani said: Had the Holy One, blessed be He, not bound Himself by an oath, Israel would never have been redeemed." The Midrash explains the redemption as Divine intervention despite the apparent claims of strict judgment. It does not erase the distinction of Israel's identity; it describes the difficulty of their condition in Egypt.

[372] **Exodus 14:14** — "Hashem will fight for you, and you shall be silent." In the setting of the splitting of the sea, the command emphasizes the rescue that comes from God. Rav Tzadok uses its wording to define the Exodus side of his comparison.

[373] **Sefer Yetzirah, Gra recension 5:10** — "He made the letter kuf rule over laughter, bound a crown to it, and combined them with one another. Through them He formed Pisces in the world, Adar in the year, and the spleen in the person, male and female." This is the Gra recension, whose association of kuf, laughter, Adar, and the spleen matches the text used throughout these maamarim. The ordinary Warsaw recension has a different assignment of bodily organs.

[374] **Esther 9:6–10, 16** — "In Shushan the capital the Jews killed and destroyed five hundred men, together with Parshandasa, Dalphon, Aspasa, Porasa, Adalya, Aridasa, Parmashta, Arisai, Aridai, and Vayezasa, the ten sons of Haman son of Hammedasa, the enemy of the Jews. They did not lay their hands on the plunder." Esther 9:16 further reports that the other Jews in the royal provinces defended their lives, rested from their enemies, and killed seventy-five thousand of those who hated them, without taking plunder. The verses identify Haman's sons and the attackers as Israel's enemies; the statement that all these enemies were Amalekites is Rav Tzadok's identification, rather than an explicit genealogical statement in these verses.

likewise the blemish of the Calf is rectified, שֶׁעַל יָדוֹ חָזַר **through which there returned** קִלְקוּל וּפְגַם הַנָּחָשׁ. **the corruption and blemish of the serpent.** וְעַל יְדֵי מַחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל **And through the half shekel** נַעֲשָׂה הַיִּחוּד **the unity is effected,** לְחַבְּרָא בְּזֹאת **to join with "zos,"** וְאִשְׁתְּלִים גּוּפָא.[375] **and the body is completed.** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן הַמְכֻוָּן **And this too is the intent in the Zohar Chadash,** בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ גּוּפָא אִשְׁתְּלִים **in what they said, "the body was completed,** וּתְרֵין עֲשַׂר שִׁבְטִין **and the twelve tribes** דְּתְחוֹת יַמָּא יַנְקִין וְכוּלֵי **under the sea nurse," etc.** — שֶׁמִּאָז נִשְׁאַר הַחֶשֶׁק כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **for from then on the longing remained, as mentioned above.** וְשַׁבָּת בְּרֵזָא **And Shabbos, being in the secret of the bris** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֶלֶק ג מד, א[376]] **(holy Zohar III 44a),** הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן דִּבְרִית **is the time to rectify the blemish of the bris,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as has been explained many times;** וּבְפַרְט בְּשַׁבָּת זוֹ **and especially on this Shabbos,** הַמְיוּחָד לְכָךְ **which is designated for this;** וְזֶה הַהֲכָנָה **and this is the preparation** בִּקְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה דְּשֶׁקָלִים **through the reading of the parshah of Shekalim,** שֶׁחָל בְּשָׁבָט **which falls in Shevat;** [דְּאִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה [פֶּרֶק ה מִשְׁנָה ג] **for it states in Sefer Yetzirah (chapter 5, mishnah 3)** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳ **that it was formed with the letter tzaddi,** שֶׁבּוֹ[377] הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן **in which is the time to rectify the blemish in the aspect of Tzaddik.** הַפְּגָם בִּבְחִינַת צַדִּיק וְאַף בְּחָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר בְּשַׁבָּת **And even when Rosh Chodesh Adar falls on Shabbos,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ **nevertheless we have already said** שֶׁקְּדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת הוּא בְּפִי הַהֲכָנָה מִימֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה **that the holiness of Shabbos is in accordance with the preparation of the weekdays that preceded it** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מִשְׁפָּטִים מַאֲמָר ו) **(as explained in Mishpatim, maamar 6);** וִימֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה שֶׁהוּא מְיוּחָד תָּמִיד בְּשָׁבָט **and the weekdays before Parshas Shekalim are always in Shevat,** שֶׁקּוֹדֶם פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים לְתִיקּוּן מִדַּת צַדִּיק **which is designated for the rectification of the attribute of Tzaddik,** כָּאָמוּר.[378] **as stated.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא אֲדָר **And afterward comes Adar,** [שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ סֵפֶר יְצִירָה שָׁם] **which was formed with the letter kuf (Sefer Yetzirah ibid.),** שֶׁרוֹמֵז קו״ף קָדוֹשׁ **which alludes to "kuf — kadosh"** (כְּמוֹ שַׁבָּת קד, א[379]) **(as written, Shabbos 104a);** וְהוּא מְיוּחָד לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **and it is designated for the eradication of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא הֵיפֶךְ קְדוּשַׁת מִדַּת צַדִּיק **who is the opposite of the holiness of the attribute of Tzaddik,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. **as has been explained many times.** וְהוּא הֲכָנָה לְחֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **And it is the preparation for the month of Nissan,** שֶׁבּוֹ עֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל [רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יא, א[380]]: **in which they are destined to be redeemed (Rosh Hashanah 11a).**

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[375] **Shabbos 88a** — "'They stood at the foot of the mountain'—Rav Avdimi bar Chama bar Chasa said: This teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, held the mountain over them like a tub and said: If you accept the Torah, well and good; if not, there shall be your grave. Rav Acha bar Yaakov said: From here there is a substantial plea concerning the Torah. Rava said: Nevertheless, they accepted it again in the days of Ahasuerus, as it is written: 'The Jews fulfilled and accepted'—they fulfilled what they had already accepted." The renewed acceptance is stated in the Gemara. Its particular application to the Oral Torah is developed through the Midrash cited next.

[376] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3** — "If you say that He held the mountain over them on account of the Written Torah—had they not, as soon as He asked whether they accepted the Torah, all answered, 'We shall do and we shall hear'? For it does not involve such toil and hardship, and its extent is small. Rather, He spoke to them about the Oral Torah, which contains the fine distinctions of lighter and weightier commandments. It is strong as death, its ardor hard as the grave, for only one who loves the Holy One, blessed be He, with all his heart, all his soul, and all his might learns it. 'You shall love Hashem your God with all your heart and all your soul and all your means'; afterward it says, 'These words shall be upon your heart.' Which is this? This is Talmud, which is upon the heart." The contrast concerns the demanding labor of the Oral Torah. Rav Tzadok reads the Purim acceptance as a willing embrace of that labor.

[377] **Rashi, Shabbos 88a, s.v. BiYemei Achashverosh** — "In the days of Ahasuerus—out of love for the miracle that had been performed for them." Rashi supplies the motive of love. The joyous acceptance of Torah is therefore Israel's response to rescue, not merely an external deliverance.

[378] **Shabbos Musaf Amidah, Yismechu VeMalchuscha** — "Those who keep Shabbos and call it a delight shall rejoice in Your kingship. The people who sanctify the seventh day shall all be satisfied and delight in Your goodness. You desired the seventh day and sanctified it; You called it the most cherished of days, a remembrance of the work of Creation." The liturgical wording joins joy to accepting God's kingship and keeping Shabbos, the association that the maamar brings into its account of Purim joy.

[379] **Megillah 16b** — "'The Jews had light, joy, gladness, and honor.' Rav Yehudah said: 'Light' is Torah, as it is said, 'For a commandment is a lamp and Torah is light.' 'Joy' is the festival, as it is said, 'You shall rejoice in your festival.' 'Gladness' is circumcision, as it is said, 'I rejoice over Your word.'" The next line identifies 'honor' with tefillin, specifically the tefillin of the head. The Gemara establishes the Torah meaning of light; the feminine form orah as an allusion to the Oral Torah is Rav Tzadok's reading.

[380] **Zohar III 79b, Acharei Mos** — "Concerning Channah it is written: 'She prayed above Hashem'—'above' precisely, because children depend on the holy mazal, as we have explained. There is no word in the Torah, or even a small letter in the Torah, that is not alluded to in supernal wisdom; from it hang countless mysteries of supernal wisdom." The immediately following discussion reads 'Cast your burden above Hashem' precisely because sustenance depends on mazal, and it connects the added fifteen years of life with the same 'above.' Thus the three needs—children,

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר י״ג Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Yud Gimmel

קוֹרִין פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **Parshas Shekalim is read** קוֹדֶם אֲדָר **before Adar,** כִּי הֵיכִי דְּלֵיתוֹ שְׁקָלִים לַמִּקְדָּשׁ **so that the shekalim would be brought to the Mikdash,** (מְגִילָּה כט, ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Megillah 29b).** וּבַזְּמַן הַזֶּה **And in our time,** שֶׁאֵין לָנוּ מִקְדָּשׁ וּמִזְבֵּחַ **when we have no Mikdash and no mizbeach,** לְכְאוֹרָה אֵין לוֹמַר **seemingly one cannot say** שֶׁהוּא כְּדֵי שֶׁיֶּחָשֵׁב הָאֲמִירָה כְּמַעֲשֶׂה **that it is so that the saying be reckoned like the deed,** כְּמוֹ בִּפְסוּקֵי הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **as with the verses of the korbanos,** דְּהָא עִיקַּר מִצְוַת הַשְּׁקָלִים **for the essence of the mitzvah of shekalim** שֶׁיִּקְנוּ קָרְבָּנוֹת **is that korbanos be bought with them,** וּמָה יּוֹעִילוּ הַשְּׁקָלִים **and what use are the shekalim** כְּשֶׁאֵין מִזְבֵּחַ **when there is no mizbeach?** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן **But the matter is this:** [דִּכְתִיב (שְׁמוֹת ל, טו] לְכַפֵּר עַל נַפְשׁוֹתֵיכֶם **it is written (Shemos 30:15), "to give the offering of Hashem** לָתֵת אֶת תְּרוּמַת ה׳ **to atone for your souls,"** וּלְפִשּׁוּטוֹ מָה כַּפָּרָה **and in its plain sense, what atonement** שַׁיָּיךְ בִּשְׁקָלִים **applies to shekalim?** רַק כֵּיוָן שֶׁהַיִּשְׂרָאֵל **Rather, since the Yisrael** אֵין לוֹ שׁוּם עֵסֶק בְּקָרְבָּנוֹת **has no involvement at all in korbanos** אֶלָּא לִשְׁקוֹל שִׁקְלוֹ **other than giving his shekel,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ הַגִּזְבָּרִים קוֹנִים **and afterward the treasurers buy** תְּמִידִין וּמוּסָפִין **the tamidin and the musafin** וְהַכֹּהֲנִים מַקְרִיבִין **and the kohanim offer them,** עַל כֵּן כֵּיוָן שֶׁהַיִּשְׂרָאֵל **therefore, once the Yisrael** שָׁקַל שִׁקְלוֹ **has given his shekel,** כְּבָר הִשְׁלִים הַמַּעֲשֶׂה מִצִּדּוֹ[381] **he has already completed the deed on his part** וְנִגְמַר הַכַּפָּרָה **and the atonement is complete.** [שָׁם, טז] וְכֵן קָרוּ לֵיהּ כֶּסֶף הַכִּפּוּרִים **And so it is called "the atonement money" (ibid. 16)** מִטַּעַם הָאֲמוּר **for the reason stated:** שֶׁבִּנְתִינַת הַשְּׁקָלִים **that by giving the shekalim** נָמַר הַיִּשְׂרָאֵל הַכַּפָּרָה מִצִּדּוֹ[382] **the Yisrael completed the atonement on his part.** וְזֶה [מוּסָף לְבָרְכַת מוֹדִים] שֶׁאוֹמְרִים בַּפִּיּוּט **And this is what we say in the piyut (Mussaf, at the blessing of Modim):** יְשֻׁלַּם פָּרִים **"May the pure utterance of our lips be offered as bulls,** כִּי אֶפֶס כָּסֶף **for there is no silver** שִׁקְלֵי כִּפּוּרִים[383] **of the atonement shekalim"** — שֶׁבְּקִרְיַאת הַפָּרָשָׁה **meaning that through reading the parsha** יִהְיֶה כְּשׁוֹקֵל שִׁקְלוֹ **it will be as if one gave his shekel,** וְיִהְיֶה נִגְמַר הַכַּפָּרָה **and the atonement will be completed** מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל **on the part of Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ בִּזְמַן הַבַּיִת[384] **as in the time of the Beis HaMikdash** שׁוֹקְלִין הַשְּׁקָלִים **when they would give the shekalim,** וְיִהְיֶה לְכַפֵּר **and it will serve to atone.**

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sustenance, and life—are treated together. Rav Tzadok uses mazal for this supernal root, rather than simply for ordinary astrological prediction.

[381] **Taanis 29b** — "'To give you a future and a hope'—Rav Yehudah, son of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas, said in Rav's name: These are palm trees and linen garments. 'He said: See, my son's fragrance is like the fragrance of a field that Hashem has blessed'—Rav Yehudah, son of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas, said in Rav's name: Like the fragrance of an apple orchard." These are the two statements whose adjacency to the Adar teaching Rav Tzadok explains. The identification of their common inner theme is his interpretation of the sequence.

[382] **Rashi, Taanis 29b, s.v. VeNasati Lachem** — "'I shall give you a future and a hope'—because Rav Yehudah was discussed above, the Gemara proceeds to cite his other teachings." Rashi explains the sequence by shared attribution. Rav Tzadok asks whether the specifically selected teachings also disclose a substantive connection.

[383] **Berachos 17a** — "Master of the universe, it is revealed and known before You that our desire is to do Your will. What prevents us? The leaven in the dough and the subjugation of kingdoms. May it be Your will to save us from their hands, so that we may return to perform the statutes of Your will with a whole heart." Rabbi Alexandri's prayer distinguishes Israel's underlying desire from the internal and external obstacles to its expression. Rav Tzadok uses that distinction in answering Amalek's accusation.

[384] **Bereishis Rabbah 65:15** — "Esav the wicked becomes soiled by sins throughout the year and has no means of atonement; but Yaakov becomes soiled by sins throughout the year, Yom Kippur comes, and he has a means of atonement, as it is said: 'For on this day he shall atone.' Rabbi Yitzchak said: 'The goat shall bear upon itself'—this is Esav, as it is said, 'Esav my brother is a hairy man.' 'All their iniquities'—the iniquities of the wholehearted one, as it is said, 'Yaakov was a wholehearted man.'" The interpretation plays on se'ir, a goat or hairy one, and avonos tam, the sins of the wholehearted Yaakov. Rav Tzadok brings that transfer of accusation into his account of Israel's lasting root in holiness.

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר י״ד Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Yud Daled

"Everyone who passes among the counted, כָּל הָעוֹבֵר עַל הַפְּקוּדִים מִבֶּן עֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה וָמַעְלָה **from twenty years old and up,** [שְׁמוֹת ל, יד[385] יִתֵּן וְגוֹמֵר **shall give," etc. (Shemos 30:14).** יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **We must understand:** דְּהָא הַמִּסְפָּר מִבֶּן עֶשְׂרִים **for the counting from age twenty** הָיָה רַק בִּזְמַן מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **was only in the time of Moshe Rabbeinu,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן אַחַר כָּךְ **which is not so afterward.** וּמִצְוַת שְׁקָלִים הָיָה **And the mitzvah of shekalim applied** לְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **to every one of Yisrael** בְּכָל אֲדָר לַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **every Adar, for the korbanos,** וְלֹא בְּשָׁעַת מִסְפָּר **and not at a time of counting.** וּמָה טִיבוֹ לְפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **So what is the point of Parshas Shekalim,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתַנְחוּמָא [כִּי תִשָּׂא ג] **of which they said in the Tanchuma (Ki Sisa 3)** שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְמֹשֶׁה **that Hakadosh Baruch Hu said to Moshe** שֶׁבְּכָל שָׁנָה שֶׁקּוֹרְאִין פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **that every year that Parshas Shekalim is read** כְּאִלּוּ אַתָּה עוֹמֵד **it is as if you are standing** וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁם **and raising up their heads?** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **But the matter is as we said:** שֶׁבְּשָׁעַת הַמִּנְיָן **that at the time of the count,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **which shows that each one of Yisrael** דָּבָר חָשׁוּב לִפְנֵי ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ[386] **is a significant thing before Hashem Yisbarach,** עַל זֶה נִתְעוֹרֵר קִטְרוּג **an accusation was aroused over this.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַמִּנְיָן מוֹרֶה **That is, the count shows** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ בּוֹ חֵלֶק מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מְיוּחָד **that each one of Yisrael has within him a special portion of the words of Torah,** וּמְקַטְרֵג שֶׁיֵּשׁ כַּמָּה עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ **and the accuser argues that there are many amei ha'aretz** שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם יְדִיעָה כְּלָל בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **who have no knowledge at all of words of Torah,** עַד שֶׁזְּדוֹנוֹת נֶחְשָׁבוֹת לוֹ כִּשְׁגָגוֹת כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא לג, ב[387]) **to the point that their deliberate sins are counted as inadvertent, as they said (Bava Metzia 33b).** וְעַל זֶה הוּצְרְכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לִבְרָכָה **And for this Yisrael needed a blessing** לִפְנֵי הַמִּנְיָן וְאַחַר כָּךְ **before the count and after it,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא ב קפז, ב[388]) **(beginning of Parshas Ki Sisa, II 187b).** וְעִיקַּר הַבְּרָכָה **And the essence of the blessing** הַשְׁפָּעָה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **is an outpouring in words of Torah.** וּכְתִיב [שְׁמוֹת שָׁם, טז] **And it is written (Shemos ibid. 16):** וְלָקַחְתָּ אֶת כֶּסֶף הַכִּפּוּרִים וְגוֹמֵר **"And you shall take the atonement money," etc.,** וְנָתַתָּ אוֹתוֹ **"and you shall give it," etc.:** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that because Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** לָקַח בְּעַצְמוֹ הַשְּׁקָלִים **himself took the shekalim** וְנָתַן בְּעַצְמוֹ **and himself gave them** עַל עֲבוֹדַת אוֹהֶל מוֹעֵד **for the service of the Ohel Moed,** פָּעַל לְדוֹרוֹת לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **he accomplished for Yisrael for all generations** שֶׁיִּזְכּוּ תָּמִיד בְּמַעֲשֵׂה הַשְּׁקָלִים **that they would always merit, through the act of the shekalim,** לִפְעוֹל מֵהַשֹּׁרֶשׁ **to bring about, from the root,** מַדְרֵגַת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of the level of Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּכָל **That is, each time** שֶׁיְּשַׁקְלוּ הַשְּׁקָלִים לַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **that they give the shekalim for the korbanos,** אַף **even though they are not being counted,** אָז ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ מוֹנֶה אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **then Hashem Yisbarach counts Yisrael,** שֶׁכָּל נֶפֶשׁ בִּפְרָט **so that each individual soul** דָּבָר שֶׁבְּמִנְיָן **is a thing that is counted,** דָּבָר חָשׁוּב **a**

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[385] **Megillah 3a** — "Since they did not see, why were they terrified? Although they themselves did not see, their mazal saw." The discussion concerns the men accompanying Daniel when Daniel alone saw the vision. Rav Tzadok reads their mazal's perception as evidence for a root above a person's conscious apprehension.

[386] **Sanhedrin 37a** — "Reish Lakish said: 'Your temples are like a slice of pomegranate'—even the empty ones among you are as full of mitzvos as a pomegranate. Rabbi Zeira said: From here—'He smelled the fragrance of his garments.' Do not read 'his garments,' but 'his traitors.'" The second interpretation finds a pleasing fragrance even in Israel's sinners. Rav Tzadok joins the play on garments and traitors to the clothing of Esav that conceals Yaakov's inner identity.

[387] **Bereishis Rabbah 65:22** — "Another interpretation of 'He smelled the fragrance of his garments and blessed him': such as Yosef Meshisa and Yakum of Tzeroros. When the enemies sought to enter the Temple Mount, they said: Let one of their own enter first. They told Yosef: Enter, and whatever you bring out is yours. He entered and brought out a golden Menorah. They told him: It is not fitting for an ordinary person to use this; enter a second time, and whatever you bring out is yours. He refused. They offered him three years of tax revenue, and he refused. He said: Is it not enough that I angered my God once, that I should anger Him a second time? They put him in a carpenter's frame and sawed him; he cried out: Woe, woe, that I angered my Creator." The retrieved Midrash names him Yosef Meshisa; the manuscript's Yosi Meshisa is a name variant. His refusal to repeat his betrayal, despite coercion and inducement, supplies the concrete example of a concealed holy root becoming manifest.

[388] **Avos DeRabbi Nasan 31:3** — "He fashioned in the human being everything that He created in His world. ... He created fragrance in the world and fragrance in the human being—this is the person's nose. ... Foul water in the world, foul water in the human being—this is the fluid of the person's nose. Salt water in the world, salt water in the human being—these are the tears of the eyes." The source is a catalogue of correspondences between the world and the body. Rav Tzadok selects the nose's seemingly disagreeable fluid while interpreting 'the fragrance of your nose like apples,' showing how a hidden root can yield fragrance.

significant thing, שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ חֵלֶק מְיוּחָד בַּתּוֹרָה[389] **which has a special portion in the Torah.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁזִּכָּה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And just as Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom, granted merit** אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל דִּכְתִיב [דְּבָרִים לג, ד] **to Yisrael, as it is written (Devarim 33:4):** תּוֹרָה צִוָּה לָנוּ מֹשֶׁה **"Moshe commanded us the Torah,** מוֹרָשָׁה קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב[390] **an inheritance of the congregation of Yaakov" — meaning even the amei ha'aretz,** דְּהַיְינוּ אַף עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ בֵּית יַעֲקֹב **who are called "Beis Yaakov,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם) **as they said in the Gemara (there) —** גַּם כֵּן יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק בַּתּוֹרָה **they too have a portion in the Torah.** וְזֶה פּוֹעֵל אַף כְּשֶׁאֵין מִזְבֵּחַ **And this takes effect even when there is no mizbeach,** שֶׁהוּא כְּמַעֲשֶׂה בִּקְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **through reading the parsha,** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **which is like the act of the shekalim;** אָז עַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ **then, through the power of Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁלָּקַח הַשְּׁקָלִים **who took the shekalim** מֵהַנִּמְנִים מִבֶּן עֶשְׂרִים **from those counted from age twenty,** שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ מוֹנֶה וּפוֹקֵד אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **it brings about Above that Hashem Yisbarach counts and remembers Yisrael,** וְזוֹכֶה לְבָרְכָה לְפָנָיו **and one merits a blessing before Him,** הַשְׁפָּעָה בִּדְבָרֵי תוֹרָה **an outpouring in words of Torah,** כְּדִכְתִיב [מִשְׁלֵי י, כב] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Mishlei 10:22):** בִּרְכַּת ה׳ הִיא תַעֲשִׁיר **"The blessing of Hashem, it makes rich" —** עֲשִׁירוּת דְּתוֹרָה[391] **the wealth of Torah.** וּבְרָכָה לְאַחַר הַמִּנְיָן **And there is a blessing after the count,** כְּמוֹ בִּשְׁעַת מִנְיַן **as at the time of the count** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם) **as they said in the holy Zohar (there):** אִשְׁתַּכְּחוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מִתְבָּרְכָאן בְּקַדְמֵיתָא וּבְסוֹפָא **"Yisrael are found to be blessed at the beginning and at the end."** וְזוֹכִין לְהַשְׁפָּעָה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **And they merit an outpouring in words of Torah,** וְשַׁבָּת הַזְּמַן לָזֶה **and Shabbos is the time for this,** דְּכוּלֵי עָלְמָא **for all agree** [שַׁבָּת פו, ב] בְּשַׁבָּת נִתְּנָה תוֹרָה **that the Torah was given on Shabbos (Shabbos 86b).** וְיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **And the seventh day —** דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is the Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א מז, ב) **as they said (Zohar I 47b):** מַלְכוּת פֶּה **"Malchus is the mouth,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְכוּלֵי[392] **the Torah she'b'al peh," etc.**

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[389] **Pesachim 87b–88a** — "Ulla said: So that they should eat dates and occupy themselves with Torah. Ulla came to Pumbedisa, and they brought him a basket of dates. He asked: How many like this can be bought for a zuz? They said: Three for a zuz. He said: A basketful of honey for a zuz, and the Babylonians do not occupy themselves with Torah!" The opening words of Ulla's answer, 'So that they should eat,' are at the end of 87b; 'dates and occupy themselves with Torah' continues on 88a. The statement explains exile to Bavel in terms of the material conditions that enable Torah study.

[390] **Pri Tzaddik, Mishpatim 1** — "In the Babylonian exile the principal establishment of the Oral Torah took place through the Men of the Great Assembly, and likewise in the generations afterward. ... Subsequently, in the days of the Amoraim, came the Babylonian Talmud, which is the principal Oral Torah that we possess. ... This is the good future. As for 'palm trees and linen garments,' it may mean what they said: they were exiled to Bavel so that they might eat dates and engage in Torah. ... Linen garments correspond to 'He showed me the Torah scholars of Bavel resembling ministering angels'; Rashi explains that they wore white. ... Since the place does not have the holiness of the Land, they require the holiness of garments." This is the author's own cross-reference, retrieved from the Lublin 1901 text. It explains exactly why the two concrete gifts—dates and linen—can signify the flourishing of the Oral Torah in exile.

[391] **Megillah 2a** — "The Megillah is read on the eleventh, twelfth, thirteenth, fourteenth, or fifteenth—not earlier and not later. Cities surrounded by a wall since the days of Yehoshua bin Nun read on the fifteenth. Villages and large towns read on the fourteenth, except that the villages advance their reading to the day of gathering." The Gemara explains that the Sages granted this leniency so villagers could supply water and food to their brothers in the cities. The villagers as an image of the unlearned, and their priority in answering Amalek's accusation, are the interpretation transmitted here by Rav Tzadok in the name of his teacher.

[392] **Tanna DeBei Eliyahu Rabbah 1** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: Did I not write for you in My Torah, 'This book of Torah shall not depart from your mouth'? Even though you work through all six days, Shabbos should be made entirely Torah. From here they said: A person should rise early on Shabbos, review his learning, and go to the synagogue and study hall; he should read Torah and study the Prophets. Afterward he should go home, eat, and drink, fulfilling 'Go, eat your bread with joy, and drink your wine with a good heart.'" The instruction specifically addresses those occupied with labor during the week. The same passage includes eating and drinking, so 'entirely Torah' describes Shabbos's governing purpose rather than the exclusion of its meals.

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים, מַאֲמָר ט״ו Parshas Shekalim — Maamar Tes Vav

פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים קוֹרִין **Parshas Shekalim is read** קוֹדֶם פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר **before Parshas Zachor,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said** (מְגִילָּה יג, ב) **(Megillah 13b):** גָּלוּי וְיָדוּעַ לְפָנָי **"It is revealed and known before** מִי שֶׁאָמַר וְהָיָה הָעוֹלָם **the One Who spoke and the world came to be** שֶׁעָתִיד לִשְׁקוֹל שְׁקָלִים **that Haman would in the future weigh out shekalim** עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **against Yisrael;** לְפִיכָךְ הִקְדִּים שִׁקְלֵיהֶן לִשְׁקָלָיו וְכוּ׳[393] **therefore He put their shekalim before his," etc.** וְלִכְאוֹרָה מָה שַּׁיָּיכוּת שִׁקְלֵי **And seemingly, what connection is there** יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁהֵם לַמִּקְדָּשׁ **between the shekalim of Yisrael, which are for the Mikdash,** לִשְׁקְלֵי הָמָן **and the shekalim of Haman,** שֶׁהֵם לַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **which were for Achashveirosh?** אַךְ עִיקַּר קְלִיפַּת עֵשָׂו **But the essence of the kelipah of Esav** שֶׁרוֹצֶה לְהִתְחַפֵּשׂ **is that he wants to disguise himself,** שֶׁהוּא דּוֹמֶה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **as though he resembles Yisrael,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּרֵאשִׁית כה, כח] כִּי צַיִד בְּפִיו **as it is said (Bereishis 25:28), "for there was trapping in his mouth,"** וְאִיתָא (תַּנְחוּמָא תּוֹלְדוֹת ח) **and it is brought (Tanchuma, Toldos 8):** הֵיכָן הָיִיתָ **"'Where were you?'** וְהוּא אוֹמֵר לוֹ בְּבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ **And he would say to him, 'In the beis medrash.** לֹא כָּךְ הֲלָכָה **Is this not the halacha** מִן כָּךְ וְכָךְ **concerning such-and-such,** לֹא כָּךְ אִיסּוּרוֹ **is this not its prohibition,** וְלֹא כָּךְ הֶתֵּירוֹ[394] **and is this not its permission?'"** וְכֵן לֶעָתִיד אִיתָא **And so regarding the future it is brought** (תַּנְחוּמָא צַו, ב) **(Tanchuma, Tzav 2):** וּלְעוֹלָם הַבָּא **"And in the World to Come,** מָה עֵשָׂו עוֹשֶׂה **what does Esav do?** מִתְעַטֵּף בְּטַלִּיתוֹ כְּזָקֵן **He wraps himself in his tallis like an elder** וּבָא וְיוֹשֵׁב לוֹ אֵצֶל יַעֲקֹב **and comes and sits beside Yaakov,** שֶׁכֵּן כְּתִיב [עוֹבַדְיָה א, ד] **for so it is written (Ovadyah 1:4):** אִם בֵּין כּוֹכָבִים שִׂים קִנֶּךָ **'Though you set your nest among the stars'** — וְאֵין כּוֹכָבִים אֶלָּא יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּ׳[395] **and 'stars' means none other than Yisrael," etc.** וּבָזֶה עֲמָלֵק מְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **And with this Amalek accuses Yisrael,** שֶׁהֵם שָׁוִים חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **claiming they are equal, chas v'shalom.** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ בְּבִלְעָם **And so we find with Bilam,** שֶׁהָיָה גַּם כֵּן כַּעֲמָלֵק כַּיָּדוּעַ **who was also like Amalek, as is known** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֶלֶק ג קצד, א][396] **(Zohar III 194a),** וְאָמַר אֶת שִׁבְעַת הַמִּזְבְּחֹת עָרַכְתִּי **and he said, "I have arranged the seven altars"** [בַּמִּדְבָּר כג, ד] **(Bamidbar 23:4) —** כְּנֶגֶד שִׁבְעָה מִזְבְּחוֹת **corresponding to the seven altars** שֶׁבָּנוּ שִׁבְעָה צַדִּיקִים **that seven tzaddikim built,** מֵאָדָם עַד מֹשֶׁה וְכוּ׳ **from Adam until Moshe, etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה כ, יח) **(as it says in Bamidbar Rabbah 20:18).** וְהֵיכִינוּ שֶׁאָמַר **That is, he said** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן יָכוֹל **that he too is able** לַעֲבוֹד אֶת ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ **to serve Hashem Yisbarach,** וְאִדְרַבָּה הוּא מַקְרִיב כְּנֶגֶד כּוּלָּם **and on the contrary, he offers corresponding to them all.** וּמָה הֵשִׁיבוֹ ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ **And what did Hashem Yisbarach answer him?** טוֹב פַּת חֲרֵבָה **"Better a dry morsel" —** מִנְחָה בְּלוּלָה בַּשֶּׁמֶן וַחֲרֵבָה **a minchah mixed with oil, or dry —** מִבַּיִת מָלֵא זִבְחֵי רִיב **"than a house full of feasts of strife" —** שֶׁאַתָּה רוֹצֶה לְהַכְנִיס מְרִיבָה

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[393] **Ein Yaakov, Sanhedrin 96b** — "Descendants of Sisera learned Torah in Jerusalem. Descendants of Sancheriv taught Torah in public—and who were they? Shemayah and Avtalyon. Descendants of Haman learned Torah in Bnei Brak—and who was it? Rav Shmuel bar Shilas." The final identification with Rav Shmuel bar Shilas is present in the retrieved Ein Yaakov text. The standard Sanhedrin text retrieved for comparison reports Haman's descendants learning in Bnei Brak without naming him. Rav Tzadok explicitly relies on the Ein Yaakov reading.

[394] **Sanhedrin 39b** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said: Let Ovadiah, who lived between two wicked people and did not learn from their deeds, come and prophesy against Esav the wicked, who lived between two righteous people and did not learn from their deeds. Ephraim Maksha'ah, Rabbi Meir's student, said in Rabbi Meir's name: Ovadiah was an Edomite convert. This is the popular saying: From the forest itself comes the wood for the axe that enters it." The source explains why Ovadiah is appointed to prophesy against Edom. Rav Tzadok applies its pattern to a teaching transmitted through a descendant of Haman that overturns Amalek's accusation.

[395] **Zohar II 152a, Terumah** — "Come and see: Tes is the illumination of life in every place. Therefore the verse begins with it in 'that it was good,' as it is written: 'God saw the light, that it was good.' From this letter the destroying angel flees—or rather, he is not given permission to enter there. This letter differs from kuf: kuf is not established in any settled place in the world; its sign is 'A man of evil speech shall not be established in the land.' Tes is established in every place and is properly fitted to settle there; wherever tes is, kuf has no settled place. ... Just as this letter rules in this place, so another letter rules in the place of Gehinnom. Which is it? Qof." The source contrasts tes with kuf in the account of a place protected from death. The retrieved text also preserves a variant reading of ches for kuf. Rav Tzadok's argument follows the kuf reading quoted in his manuscript.

[396] **Zohar II 148b, Terumah** — "Everywhere, this serpent follows the mystery of the woman of valor. The woman of harlotry seeks to fashion herself in her likeness, but cannot. The mark and letter of the woman of valor is heh, and so it befits her. The mark and letter of the woman of harlotry is kuf; her letter is fashioned after the shape of heh, like an ape beside human beings: it follows human beings, yet cannot become like them." The comparison describes imitation of holiness by its opposite. Rav Tzadok later distinguishes that counterfeit from the holy imitation of God's ways that he associates with kuf.

for you want to bring strife בֵּינִי וּבֵין יִשְׂרָאֵל **between Me and Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם) **(as they said there).** וְכֵן הֱשִׁיבוֹ **And so He answered him:** טוֹב אֲרוּחַת יָרָק **"Better a meal of greens** וְגוֹמֵר[397] **where there is love," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ אוֹמֵר **That is, Hashem Yisbarach says** לֵב שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל עוֹשִׂין מִנְּדִיבוּת **that Yisrael act from generosity of heart** וּמֵאַהֲבַת ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **and from love of Hashem Yisbarach** הַנָּטוּעַ בְּעוֹמֶק לִבָּם **that is planted in the depth of their heart,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן קָרְבְּנוֹת בִּלְעָם **which is not so with the offerings of Bilam,** שֶׁהֵם בָּאִים לְשַׁנּוֹת **which come to alter,** חַס וְשָׁלוֹם רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרֵךְ **chas v'shalom, His will, may He be blessed,** וּלְהַכְנִיס מְרִיבָה **and to bring strife** בֵּינוֹ וּבֵין יִשְׂרָאֵל **between Him and Yisrael.** וְכֵן הָיָה עִנְיַן הָמָן **And so was the matter of Haman,** (מְגִילָּה שָׁם) דְּאָמְרִינַן בַּגְּמָרָא **as we say in the Gemara (Megillah ibid.):** לֵיכָּא דְּיָדַע לְישַׁנָּא בִּישָׁא כְּהָמָן **"There was none who knew how to slander like Haman"** — וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהָיָה אוּמָּן וּבָקִי **meaning he was skilled and expert** שֶׁכָּל קְטָרוּגוֹ לְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **at accusing Yisrael** לִפְנֵי ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **before Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ [מְגִילָּה שָׁם] יְשֵׁנוּ מִן הַמִּצְוֹת **as they said (Megillah ibid.): "They sleep from the mitzvos";** אִית בְּהוּ רַבָּנַן **"There are Rabbanan among them";** עַם אֶחָד הֵן[398] **"They are one nation."** וְכֵן הָיָה עִנְיַן הַשְּׁקָלִים **And such was the matter of the shekalim,** שֶׁאָמַר וַעֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים כִּכַּר כָּסֶף **as he said, "And ten thousand talents of silver** וְגוֹמֵר אֶשְׁקוֹל **I will weigh out," etc.,** לְהָבִיא אֶל גִּנְזֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **"to bring into the king's treasuries."** (אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ג, י) וְאִיתָא **And it is brought (Esther Rabbah 3:10)** דְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בִּמְגִילָּה זוֹ מֶלֶךְ סְתָם **that wherever it says in this Megillah "the king" without qualification,** מְשַׁמֵּשׁ קוֹדֶשׁ וְחוֹל **it serves both the holy and the mundane;** וְכֵן כָּאן הַמֶּלֶךְ **and so here, "the king" is** מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים **the King of kings of kings,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא[399] **Hakadosh Baruch Hu** (וְעַיֵּין זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג תַּנְחוּמָא, קטְ א[400]) **(and see Zohar III 109a).** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is according to what they said** (תַּנְחוּמָא מִשְׁפָּטִים יד) **(Tanchuma, Mishpatim 14):** וְעֵשָׂו חוֹנֵן דַּלִּים הוּא וְכוּלֵי **"And Esav, he is gracious to the poor," etc.;** נוֹטֶלֶת מָמוֹנוֹ וּבוֹנָה מִמֶּנּוּ דְּמוֹסְיוֹת וְכוּלֵי **"it takes his money and builds public bathhouses from it," etc.,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לְצָרְכֵי הָעֲנִיִּים[401] **so that it should be for the needs of the poor,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה [קֹהֶלֶת רַבָּה ד, ה] **and as they said in Midrash Rabbah (Koheles Rabbah 4:5):** וּכְמָשָׁל גַּיְיפָא בְּחַזְרִין **"and as the parable goes: she whores for apples** וּמְחַלֶּקֶת לְבִישַׁיָּא[402] **and distributes them to the sick."** וְכֵן בְּרַבַּאי כְּשֶׁהָיָה אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **And so**

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[397] **Bereishis Rabbah 20:1** — "Another interpretation: 'A man of evil speech'—this is the serpent, which spoke evil of its Creator. 'Shall not be established in the land'—'upon your belly.' 'A violent man, evil shall hunt him to repeated falls': it does not say one fall, but repeated falls—Adam was cursed, Chavah was cursed, and the serpent was cursed." The Midrash explicitly identifies the evil speaker of Psalms 140:12 with the primordial serpent, linking the Zohar's proof-text to the serpent's counterfeit likeness.

[398] **Berachos 31a** — "Rabbi Yochanan said in the name of Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai: A person may not fill his mouth with laughter in this world, as it is said: 'Then our mouth shall be filled with laughter and our tongue with song.' When? At the time when 'they shall say among the nations: Hashem has done great things with these.' They said of Reish Lakish that he never filled his mouth with laughter in this world from the time he heard this from Rabbi Yochanan his teacher." The Gemara itself specifies the future recognition of God's great deeds by the nations. The distinction between inward joy and laughter's full outward disclosure is developed in the following maamarim.

[399] **Berachos 61b** — "The lung draws in all kinds of liquids; the liver becomes angry; the gall casts a drop into it and quiets it; the spleen laughs; the gizzard grinds; the stomach sleeps; the nose keeps awake. If the sleeper awakens and the wakeful one sleeps, the person wastes away." Within the Gemara's account of bodily functions, 'the spleen laughs' is the particular clause used here. Sefer Yetzirah's Gra recension likewise assigns the spleen and laughter to Adar.

[400] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 48, 85a** — "Happy is the person who keeps a dwelling for Shabbos—namely the heart—so that the spleen's sadness and the gall's anger, the fire of Gehinnom, do not approach there. Concerning this it is said: 'You shall not kindle fire in any of your dwellings on Shabbos.' Indeed, anyone who becomes angry is as though he kindled the fire of Gehinnom." The source associates the spleen with sadness. Rav Tzadok brings it alongside the Gemara's 'the spleen laughs' to distinguish unstable indulgence from the holy joy developed in Adar.

[401] **Zohar I 202a, Mikeitz** — "A person should recall the day of death, for this breaks the human heart. The evil inclination dwells only where there is the joy of wine and arrogance of spirit. Where a broken spirit is found, it departs and does not dwell with him. ... Come and see: the good inclination seeks the joy of Torah; the evil inclination seeks the joy of wine, adultery, and arrogance of spirit. Therefore a person should continually confront it with that great day, the day of judgment and accounting." The source itself distinguishes two kinds of joy. Rav Tzadok therefore does not identify all joy with the spleen's unstable laughter.

[402] **Yerushalmi, Rosh Hashanah 1:3; Vayikra Rabbah 35:3** — "Rabbi Elazar said: In ordinary practice a mortal king makes a decree; if he wishes, he observes it, while others observe it. But the Holy One, blessed be He, is not so: He decrees a decree and first observes it Himself. What is the basis? 'They shall keep My charge; I am Hashem'—I am the One Who first kept the Torah's commandments. Rabbi Simon said: It is written, 'Rise before the aged and honor the elder ... I am Hashem'—I am the One Who first fulfilled standing before an elder." The parallel Midrash in Vayikra Rabbah 35:3, also retrieved, gives the same principle. Rav Tzadok makes it the basis of 'walking in His

certainly, when Achashveirosh מְקַבֵּל הַכֶּסֶף **would receive the money,** לֹא הָיָה מַהֲנִימוּס **it would not have been proper** לְהַכְנִיס לָאוֹצָר מָמוֹן **to put into the treasury money** שֶׁקִּיבֵּל בְּמָחִיר אוּמָּה שְׁלֵימָה **that he received as the price of an entire nation;** וּמִן הַסְּתָם **and presumably** הָיָה מְחַלֵּק לָעֲנִיִּים **he would distribute it to the poor** אוֹ הָיָה עוֹשֶׂה צָרְכֵי רַבִּים **or would provide for public needs,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לְצָרְכֵי הָעֲנִיִּים **so that it be for the needs of the poor,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וְזֶה הָיָה כַּוָּנַת הָמָן **And this was Haman's intent** לִשְׁקוֹל עֲשֶׂרֶת אֲלָפִים כִּכַּר כֶּסֶף **in weighing out ten thousand talents of silver,** שֶׁהוּא כְּמִסְפַּר שִׁקְלֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **which matches the number of the shekalim of Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תּוֹסָפוֹת מְגִילָּה טז, א, דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וּדְחִי, **s.v. Ud'chi,** יד, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּחִזְקוּנִי שְׁמוֹת ל, יג[403]) **(as Tosafos writes, Megillah 16a, and as the Chizkuni writes, Shemos 30:14):** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאָמַר **that is, he claimed** כְּנֶגֶד כָּל שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ נְדִיבוּת כָּזֶה **that he had such generosity** שֶׁיּוּכַל לִיתֵּן צְדָקָה **that he could give charity** יִשְׂרָאֵל[404] **equal to all of Yisrael,** כְּעֵין מִזְבְּחוֹת דִּבְלְעָם **like the altars of Bilam.** וְהוּא הָיָה נוֹתֵן לַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **And he would give it to Achashveirosh,** וַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ יְחַלְּקֵם לָעֲנִיִּים **and Achashveirosh would distribute it to the poor;** וְזֶהוּ לְהָבִיא אֶל גִּנְזֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **and this is "to bring into the king's treasuries,"** וּמְשַׁמֵּשׁ קוֹדֶשׁ וְחוֹל **serving both holy and mundane:** שֶׁהוּא יִתֵּן לַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **that he would give to Achashveirosh** וַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ יִתֵּן לְצְדָקָה **and Achashveirosh would give it to charity.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּמִרְמֵז **And one may say that it alludes,** אֶל גִּנְזֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **with "into the king's treasuries,"** עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת י, ב) **to what they said (Shabbos 10b):** מַתָּנָה טוֹבָה יֵשׁ לִי **"I have a good gift** בְּבֵית גְּנָזַי **in My treasure house,** וְשַׁבָּת שְׁמָהּ[405] **and Shabbos is its name."** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י, וְאִיתָא **And it is brought (Bava Basra 10b):** בַּמֶּה תָּרוּם קַרְנָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **"Through what will the horn of Yisrael be raised?** בְּכִי תִשָּׂא אֶת רֹאשׁ **Through 'When you raise up the head.'"** וְהַיְינוּ דְּבִשְׁקָלִים **That is, through the shekalim** תָּרוּם קַרְנָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל עַד הָרֹאשׁ שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **the horn of Yisrael is raised up to the head, for they are bound to the root.** וְכֵן בִּצְדָקָה **And so too through charity,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בְּרַשִׁ"י [שָׁם דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אָמַר] **as Rashi writes (ibid., s.v. Amar),** אַחַר כָּךְ [שָׁם] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and as they said (ibid.) afterward:** בְּכֹחָהּ שֶׁל צְדָקָה קַרְנוֹ תָּרוּם בְּכָבוֹד[406] **"Through the power of charity — 'his horn shall be raised in honor.'"** וְהַיְינוּ עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה כה, ב) **That is, according to what they said (Vayikra Rabbah 25:2):** עָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לַעֲשׂוֹת צֵל וְחוּפּוֹת לְבַעֲלֵי מִצְוֹת **"In the future Hakadosh Baruch Hu will make shade and canopies for the**

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ways': the commanded deed follows a Divine pattern.

[403] **Midrash Tanchuma, Bereishis 2, opening Sheilta** — "The house of Israel is obligated to rest on Shabbos. When the Holy One, blessed be He, created the world, He created it in six days and rested on Shabbos, blessing and sanctifying it, like one who builds a house, finishes its work, and makes a festive day. ... The Merciful One says: Rest on Shabbos just as I rested on it, as it is written: 'He rested on the seventh day; therefore Hashem blessed' it." This Aramaic opening, explicitly a Sheilta, gives the direct formulation of imitating Divine rest that Rav Tzadok quotes.

[404] **Berachos 6a** — "Rabbi Avin bar Rav Adda said in Rabbi Yitzchak's name: From where do we know that the Holy One, blessed be He, wears tefillin? For it is said: 'Hashem swore by His right hand and by the arm of His strength.'" The following explanation identifies His right hand with Torah and the arm of His strength with tefillin; it then asks what is written in the Master of the world's tefillin and answers: 'Who is like Your people Israel, one nation in the land?' The anthropomorphic image is the Gemara's expression of the reciprocal bond that underlies Rav Tzadok's account of imitation.

[405] Parallel: **Malbim, commentary to Tehillim 97:10–11 and Beur HaMilos to 97:11** — "'Light is sown for the righteous': divine light is found sown within them, like a seed planted in their souls, ready to bear fruit and multiply if they water it, tend it, and cultivate it, like a seed ready to bear fruit and multiply. For one who guards his soul and performs its service, the sown light will grow and bear fruit until it becomes sevenfold light, as it says, 'The path of the righteous is like shining light.' The great prophetic light will penetrate him. Through this, 'for the upright of heart, joy': they will rejoice with spiritual joy through the divine light shining within their souls, when His lamp shines above their heads, as it says, 'The light of the righteous gives joy.' In Beur HaMilos he explains: 'For the righteous, for the upright of heart': the righteous person conquers his inclination; the upright of heart has a nature that inclines toward good. He rejoices because he has no inward war."

Connection: Malbim supplies both elements of Rav Tzadok's reading of this verse: light begins as something planted that grows through the person's work, and uprightness describes a heart whose inclination toward good has ended the inner conflict. This clarifies the transition from the tzaddik's conquest of the leftward heart to the yashar lev's revealed joy. It does not identify the two stages merely because both people act correctly; the decisive difference is what has happened within the heart.

[406] **Megillah 13b** — "When the lot fell in the month of Adar, Haman rejoiced greatly. He said: The lot has fallen for me in the month in which Moshe died. He did not know that Moshe died on the seventh of Adar and was born on the seventh of Adar." The Gemara supplies the coincidence of death and birth. Rav Tzadok reads it as the concealment of one light becoming the condition for a new flowering of the Oral Torah.

masters of mitzvos אֲצֶל בְּנֵי תוֹרָה וְכוּ׳[407] **beside the sons of Torah," etc.** וְזֶהוּ קַרְנוֹ תָּרוּם **And this is "his horn shall be raised":** מוֹרֶה בְּלֹא שִׁיעוּר **it indicates without limit,** עַד עַתִּיקָא **up to Atika;** בְּכָבוֹד אֵצֶל בְּנֵי תוֹרָה **"in honor" — beside the sons of Torah,** (חולין קלג, א) וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said (Chullin 133a):** אֵין כָּבוֹד אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה[408] **"Honor means none other than Torah."** וְזֶהוּ קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת **And this is the holiness of Shabbos,** שֶׁהוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **which is the revelation of Atika** שֶׁזּוֹכִין בְּשַׁבָּת **that one merits on Shabbos,** וְזֶהוּ בְּבֵית גְּנָזַי **and this is "in My treasure house."** וְאָמַר הָמָן שֶׁגַּם הוּא יָכוֹל **And Haman said that he too could** לְהָבִיא אֶל גִּנְזֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **"bring into the king's treasuries,"** שֶׁיַּעֲשֶׂה צְדָקָה מוּפְלָגֶת כָּזוֹ **by doing such extraordinary charity,** וְיָרוּם קַרְנוֹ בָּזֶה חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **and his horn would be raised by it, chas v'shalom.** אַךְ ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ הִקְדִּים **But Hashem Yisbarach put** שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ מְבָרֵר **the shekalim of Yisrael before his,** שִׁקְלֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לִשְׁקָלָיו **for Hashem Yisbarach makes clear** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל עוֹשִׂים בְּנְדִיבוּת[409] **that Yisrael act with generosity,** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קכח, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Zohar II 128a):** דְּאִתְגַּבַּר עַל יְצִרֵיהּ וְכוּלֵי **who overcomes his inclination, etc.;** מֵאֵת כָּל אִישׁ **"'From every man' —** אֲשֶׁר יִדְּבֶנּוּ לִבּוֹ **'whose heart moves him'** — דְּיִתְרְעֵי בֵּיהּ קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵי[410] **in whom Hakadosh Baruch Hu takes delight," etc.** וְעֲלֵיהֶם נֶאֱמַר **And about them it is said,** כִּי תִשָּׂא אֶת רֹאשׁ **"When you raise up the head,"** שֶׁתָּרוּם קֶרֶן יִשְׂרָאֵל **that the horn of Yisrael is raised** בְּהַשְׁקָלִים כְּמַשְׁמָעוֹ **through the shekalim, in its literal sense,** אוֹ בִּצְדָקָה כְּפֵירוּשׁ רַשִׁ״י **or through charity, as Rashi explains,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּרְאֶה מִסֵּדֶר לְפָנָיו וּלְאַחֲרָיו **and as is evident from the sequence of the topic** שֶׁמְּדַבֵּר בַּגְּמָרָא **discussed in the Gemara before it and after it,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר **and as it says:** בְּכֹחָהּ שֶׁל צְדָקָה **"Through the power of charity,** קַרְנוֹ תָּרוּם בְּכָבוֹד **'his horn shall be raised in honor,'"** וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁמְּבָרֵר **That is, He makes clear:** צְדָקָה תְּרוֹמֵם גּוֹי **"Righteousness exalts a nation"** — אֵלּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **these are Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בָּבָא בְּתְרָא שָׁם) **(as they said in Bava Basra there),** שֶׁהֵם נוֹתְנִים מִנְּדִיבוּת הַלֵּב **for they give from generosity of heart** וּמֵאַהֲבַת ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **and from love of Hashem Yisbarach,** וְיָרוּם קַרְנָם בְּכָבוֹד **and their horn is raised in honor.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן וְחֶסֶד וְגוֹמֵר **Which is not so with "but the kindness of the nations," etc.,** שֶׁאֵין עוֹשִׂין אֶלָּא **which they do only** לְהִתְגַּדֵּל וּלְהִתְיַהֵר וְכַדּוֹמֶה **to aggrandize themselves and to boast and the like,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא[411] **as they said in the Gemara (Bava Basra ibid.).** וְאַף בְּכוֹרֶשׁ **And even with Koresh,** דְּאָמַר דִּי לֶהֱוֹן מְקָרְבִין נִיחוֹחִין לֵאלָהָא שְׁמַיָּא **who said, "that they may offer pleasing sacrifices to the God of Heaven** וּמְצַלִּין וְגוֹמֵר [עֶזְרָא ו, י] **and pray," etc. (Ezra 6:10),** וְהָיָה לוֹ אֱמוּנָה בַּה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **and he had faith in Hashem Yisbarach** — וּכְהַאי גַּוְנָא בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **and in such a case with a Jew,** הֲרֵי זֶה צַדִּיק גָּמוּר **"he is a complete tzaddik"** — מִכָּל מָקוֹם ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **nevertheless Hashem Yisbarach** בּוֹחֵן לְבָבוֹת **examines hearts,** שֶׁכּוֹרֵשׁ לֹא נִתְכַּוֵּן כְּלָל **for**

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[407] **Sotah 12a** — "'She saw that he was good.' Rabbi Meir said: His name was Tov. Rabbi Yehudah said: His name was Toviyah. Rabbi Nechemyah said: He was fit for prophecy. Others said: He was born circumcised." The verbal link 'good' connects Moshe's birth with the first light of Creation, the connection on which Rav Tzadok builds his account of Moshe's Written Torah light.

[408] **Temurah 16a** — "Rav Judah said in the name of Samuel: Three thousand laws were forgotten during the mourning for Moses. They said to Joshua: Ask! He answered them: 'It is not in heaven.' ... It was taught: One thousand seven hundred a-fortiori inferences, analogous-word derivations, and details of scribal law were forgotten during the mourning for Moses. Rabbi Avahu said: Nevertheless, Osniel ben Kenaz restored them through his dialectical analysis, as it is said: 'Osniel ben Kenaz, Kalev's brother, captured it, and he gave him Achsah his daughter as a wife.'" The preceding teaching specifies that seventeen hundred inferences, analogies, and fine points of the Scribes were forgotten during the mourning for Moshe. Later the Gemara identifies Osniel with Yaavetz and interprets Yaavetz as one who advised and disseminated Torah in Israel. Rav Tzadok sees the restoration through analysis as a birth of Oral Torah precisely at the time of loss.

[409] **Berachos 12b–13a** — "They said to him: The Exodus from Egypt will not be uprooted from its place. Rather, deliverance from the subjugation of kingdoms will become the principal subject, and the Exodus from Egypt will be secondary to it." The Sages respond to Ben Zoma's citation of Jeremiah's promise of a future ingathering from the northern land and all the lands of exile. Rav Tzadok uses the future redemption's greater prominence when asking why unreserved laughter is reserved for then.

[410] **Berachos 31a** — "One should not stand to pray from sadness, laziness, laughter, conversation, frivolity, or idle matters, but from the joy of a mitzvah." The stated contrast between laughter and mitzvah joy enables Rav Tzadok to distinguish the two expressions even when their subject is holy.

[411] **Shabbos 30b** — "'I praised joy'—this is the joy of a mitzvah. 'And of joy, what does it accomplish?'—this is joy unconnected to a mitzvah. This teaches that the Divine Presence rests neither from sadness, laziness, laughter, frivolity, conversation, nor idle matters, but from the joy of a mitzvah, as it is said: 'Now bring me a musician'; and when the musician played, the hand of Hashem came upon him." The verse about the musician is II Kings 3:15. The passage recognizes holy joy as the setting for inspiration while distinguishing it from laughter.

Koresh intended nothing at all רַק לַהֲנָאַת עַצְמוֹ **but his own benefit,** (ב ,ג ,רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה) וְקָרֵי לֵיהּ בַּגְמָרָא **and the Gemara calls him (Rosh Hashanah 3b),** בְּשִׁבּוּל זֶה לְאַחַר שֶׁהֶחְמִיץ[412] **on account of this, "after he soured."** וְזֶהוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁהֻשְׁווּ **And this is like what was answered** רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ לְבִלְעָם **to Bilam by Ruach HaKodesh.** וּבִשְׁקָלִים לַמִּשְׁכָּן מְפוֹרָשׁ **And regarding the shekalim for the Mishkan it is explicit:** מֵאֵת כָּל אִישׁ **"From every man** אֲשֶׁר יִדְּבֶנּוּ לִבּוֹ **whose heart moves him" —** שֶׁיִּתְגַּבֵּר עַל יִצְרוֹ **that he overcome his inclination,** וְיִדְּבֶנּוּ לִבּוֹ **and "his heart moves him,"** שֶׁשּׁוֹכֵן בְּלִבּוֹ אַהֲבַת ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **that the love of Hashem Yisbarach dwells in his heart,** שֶׁהוּא לִבּוֹ שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **for He is the heart of Yisrael,** (שָׁם) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar (there).** וְזֶהוּ עִנְיַן שֶׁהִקְדִּים **And this is the meaning of His putting** שִׁקְלֵיהֶן לִשְׁקָלָיו **their shekalim before his:** אַף שֶׁגַּם שְׁקָלָיו הָיוּ לִצְדָקָה **even though his shekalim too were for charity,** בֵּירֵר ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **Hashem Yisbarach made clear** שֶׁכַּוָּנָתוֹ לִמְרוֹת רְצוֹן ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **that his intent was to defy the will of Hashem Yisbarach,** וְלַעֲמוֹד בְּחוּצְפָּה כְּבִלְעָם **to stand in brazenness like Bilam,** וּלְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and to accuse Yisrael** נֶגֶד רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **against His will, may He be blessed.** וְכֵן בִּסְעוּדָה שְׁלִישִׁית דְּשַׁבָּת **And so at the third meal of Shabbos,** שֶׁהוּא רַעֲוָא דְּרַעֲוִין **which is Ra'ava d'Ra'avin,** רְצוֹן הָרְצוֹנוֹת **the Will of all wills,** דְּאִתְגַּלְיָא מִצְּחָא **when the Forehead is revealed** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּאִדְּרָא חֲלָק ג קכט, א–ב][413] דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **of Atika Kadisha (Zohar, Idra, III 129a–b) —** אָז ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ בּוֹחֵר בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **then Hashem Yisbarach chooses Yisrael** דֻּגְמָתָן סְגוּלָה בְּלֹא שׁוּם טַעַם **as His treasure, without any reason,** רַק שֶׁמַּעִיד עַל לֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל[414] **only that He testifies to the heart of Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מַלְאָכִי א, ב] וָאֹהַב אֶת יַעֲקֹב **as it is said (Malachi 1:2), "And I loved Yaakov."** [זֶמֶר] וְעַל כֵּן אוֹמְרִים בְּנֵי הֵיכָלָא **And therefore we say (in the zemer Bnei Heichala):** לְבַר נַטְלִין וְלָא עָאלִין **"They are cast outside and do not enter,** הָנֵי כַּלְבִּין דַּחֲצִיפִין[416] **these brazen dogs" —** שֶׁלֹּא יוּכְלוּ כְּלָל לִכְנוֹס **that they cannot enter at all:** עֲמָלֵק וְהָמָן **Amalek and Haman,** שֶׁהֵם קְלִיפַּת כֶּלֶב[417] **who are the kelipah of the dog,** וְהַכְּלָבִים עַזֵּי נָפֶשׁ **and the dogs are brazen of soul,** חֲצִיפָא מִכֻּלְּהוּ **"more brazen than all of them"** (א ,סה ,חֵלֶק ב זֹהַר כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב[418]) **(as**

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[412] **Rashi, Shabbos 30b, s.v. Sechok** — "Laughter—actual laughter, for the mind of one who laughs is not settled. Even if it is not mockery, it still lacks settled composure." Rashi explicitly includes laughter free of mockery. This supplies the narrower sense of laughter that Rav Tzadok uses in his apparent difficulty about Rav Bruna.

[413] **Berachos 9b** — "Rabbi Ela said to Ulla: When you go there, inquire after the welfare of my brother Rav Bruna in the presence of the whole fellowship, for he is a great man who rejoices in mitzvos. Once he joined redemption directly to prayer, and laughter did not leave his mouth for the entire day." Rav Bruna's sustained laughter after this particular mitzvah is the concrete case that Rav Tzadok reconciles with the restriction on filling one's mouth with laughter.

[414] **Zohar II 156a, Terumah** — "'And I'—this is King David, the place called redemption. 'My prayer'—this is prayer, and here it is joined to redemption, for they are one. When he joins redemption to prayer, then it is a time of favor. 'A time of favor' is also one inclusive whole: time is one and favor is one, they are included in one another and become one. ... On Shabbos all wrath is removed and everything is included together; even when judgment awakens, it is sweetened. ... When there is union, judgment joins and is included in mercy; everything is sweetened, and then 'a time of favor' is written." The Zohar explains both the union of redemption and prayer and the recitation of Psalms 69:14 at Shabbos Minchah. Rav Tzadok sees Rav Bruna's joy as a realization of this union.

[415] **Shabbos 31b** — "Rav Yehudah said: The Holy One, blessed be He, created His world only so that people should stand in awe before Him, as it is said: 'God has done it so that they should stand in awe before Him.'" The proof-text is Ecclesiastes 3:14. Rav Tzadok joins this account of creation's purpose to the complementary purpose of giving Divine honor.

[416] **Avos 6:11** — "Everything the Holy One, blessed be He, created in His world, He created only for His honor, as it is said: 'Everyone called by My Name, whom I created for My honor, whom I formed and also made'; and it says: 'Hashem shall reign for ever and ever.'" The saying is numbered 6:11 in this edition; some divisions number it 6:12, as in the manuscript. Rav Tzadok connects honor with praise, alongside awe expressed in prayer.

[417] **Midrash Tehillim 148** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, created the human being only for His honor. So it says: 'Hashem made everything for His purpose'—He created them to offer praise, and they praised Him, as it is said: 'The heavens tell the glory of God.' Just as the heavens and all within them praise Him, so the earth and all within it praise Him, as it is said: 'Praise Hashem from the earth.'" The source makes explicit the movement from creation for God's honor to praise by creation. Rav Tzadok places this praise before the act of prayer.

[418] **Berachos 9b** — "The devoted ones would finish the Shema with sunrise, so that they could join redemption to prayer and be found praying in daylight. Rabbi Zeira said: What is the verse? 'They shall fear You with the sun, and before the moon, throughout the generations.'" The first sentence is the immediately preceding teaching, Berachos 9b:14. The verse is Psalms 72:5. Rav Tzadok notes that prayer itself is expressed here through the language of awe.

it says, Zohar II 65a); כִּי מִי יוּכַל לָבוֹא אֶל הַמֶּלֶךְ **for who can come before the King** לְעוֹרֵר מְדָנִים וְשִׂנְאָה עַל בָּנָיו[419] **to stir up strife and hatred against His children?**

[419] **Berachos 10b** — "Rabbi Chanan said: Even if the master of dreams tells a person that he will die tomorrow, he must not withhold himself from seeking mercy, as it is said: 'For with many dreams, vanities, and many words—rather, fear God.'" The Gemara reads Ecclesiastes 5:6 as a call to continue prayer. Rav Tzadok uses the association of fear of God with asking for mercy.

רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר

Rosh Chodesh Adar

ראש חדש אדר, מאמר א׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Aleph

בגמרא (תענית כט, א) **In the Gemara (Taanis 29a):** אמר רב יהודה בריה **Rav Yehudah, son of** דרב שמואל בר שילת **Rav Shmuel bar Sheilas, said** משמיה דרב **in the name of Rav:** כשם שמשנכנס אב **"Just as when Av enters** ממעטין בשמחה **we diminish in joy,** כך משנכנס אדר **so when Adar enters** מרבין בשמחה[420] **we increase in joy."** [דבור המתחיל משנכנס אדר] ופרש״י רש״י **And Rashi explained (s.v. Mishenichnas Adar):** ימי נסים היו לישראל **"They were days of miracles for Yisrael,** פורים ופסח[421] **Purim and Pesach."** ומשמע לכאורה **This seemingly implies** דמשנכנס אדר מרבין **that from when Adar enters we increase,** וכן בניסן **and likewise in Nissan.** אבל מלשון הגמרא אחר כך [כט, ב] **But from the Gemara's wording afterward (29b),** ולימצי נפשיה באדר **"let him make himself available in Adar,** דכריא מזליה **for its mazal is healthy,"**[422] **it implies that it refers to Adar specifically.** והענין דהלימוד הוא מאב **The matter is that the derivation is from Av:** דכמו שבחדש אב **just as in the month of Av,** שהיה יום אחד בו **in which there was one day** שאירע בו אבל ובכי **on which mourning and weeping occurred,** ממעטין בשמחה מראש חדש **we diminish in joy from Rosh Chodesh,** וכמו שלמדו בגמרא (שם ל, א) **as they derived in the Gemara (there, 30a):** מאן דאמר כל החדש **the one who holds that the entire month,** כולו אסור מחדשה[423] **all of it, is forbidden derives it from "her new moon"** — כן באדר **so in Adar,** שאירע בו יום שמחה **in which a day of joy occurred,** השמחה מראש חדש **the joy is from Rosh Chodesh** וכל החדש **and the whole month.** [אסתר ט, כב] וכן נזכר גם בפסוק **And so it is also mentioned in the pasuk (Esther 9:22):** והחדש אשר נהפך להם **"and the month which was turned for them** וגומר[424] מיגון לשמחה **from sorrow to joy," etc.** אך להבין **But we must understand** למה באמת רק באדר **why indeed only in Adar** החדש נהפך לשמחה **the whole month was turned to joy,** ולא נזכר כן בחדש ניסן **and this is not mentioned of the month of Nissan,** ובאמת גאולת ניסן עדיפא **when in truth the redemption of Nissan is greater,** כמו שאמרו (מגילה יד, א) **as they said (Megillah 14a)** לענין הלל **regarding Hallel:** התם הללו עבדי ה׳ **"There, 'Praise, servants of Hashem' —** ולא עבדי פרעה **and not servants of Pharaoh;** הכא וכו׳ **here, etc.,** אכתי עבדי אחשורוש **we are still servants of Achashveirosh."**[425] **The matter is that the redemption of Nissan** היה מצד השם יתברך **came from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** כמו שנאמר [שמות ו, ו-ז] והוצאתי אתכם

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[420] **Zohar II 54a, Beshalach** — "Rabbi Abba said: I considered all the praises with which they praised the Holy One, blessed be He, and all began with 'Then': 'Then Solomon said'; 'Then Joshua spoke'; 'Then Israel sang.' Why? All the miracles and mighty deeds done for Israel occur when the light of the Holy Ancient One shines in His crowns, engraved and marked in az—in the alef. The alef pierces the darkness and illumines every side. When the alef's illumination joins and reaches the zayin—what is the zayin? 'Hashem's sword is filled with blood'—then He performs miracles and mighty deeds, because alef has joined with zayin. This is song, song on every side; this is 'Then Moshe sang.'" The Zohar reads az, 'then,' through its letters, alef and zayin. Rav Tzadok applies the same joining of supernal illumination with the lower levels to the future 'Then our mouth shall be filled with laughter.'

[421] **Shemos Rabbah 22:3** — "One who reads the Shema must mention the splitting of the sea and the smiting of the firstborn in Emes VeYatziv. ... Why must one mention the splitting of the sea? Because when He split the sea for them, they believed in Him, as it is said: 'They believed in Hashem and in Moshe His servant.' Through their belief they merited to sing, and the Divine Presence rested upon them, for immediately afterward it is written: 'Then Moshe sang.' Therefore a person must join redemption to prayer, just as they joined song to faith and the splitting of the sea. Just as they purified their hearts and sang, so a person must purify his heart before praying." The Midrash directly connects the sea's faith and song with the prayer order and the worshipper's purification of heart, the sequence that Rav Tzadok seeks to realize inwardly.

[422] **Zohar II 88b, Yisro** — "Come and see: During the six weekdays, when the time of Minchah prayer arrives, severe judgment rules and all judgments awaken. But on Shabbos, when Minchah prayer's time arrives, the favor of all favors is found; the Holy Ancient One reveals His will, all judgments are subdued, and favor and joy are found in everything." This is the precise Shabbos Minchah context invoked here. Rav Tzadok reads it as a foretaste of the future disclosure that allows complete joy.

[423] **Tosafos, Berachos 9b, s.v. Kol HaSomech** — "But do not all people join redemption to prayer? What, then, was Rav Bruna's distinction, that laughter did not leave his mouth? We may answer: The statement means one who joins redemption to prayer like the devoted ones, who read Shema before sunrise and pray after sunrise." Tosafos answers through precise timing. Rav Tzadok retains the question and develops an additional inner account: Rav Bruna's experience brought the praise and prayer into their supernal unity.

[424] **Tanna DeBei Eliyahu Rabbah 3** — "King David further said: I stood in awe through my joy, and rejoiced through my awe; my love rose above them all. Therefore the Holy One, blessed be He, made a covenant with me that I should be proficient in Scripture, Mishnah, laws, and aggados, as it is said: 'An everlasting covenant He has appointed for me, ordered in everything and guarded.'" The source explicitly treats awe and joy as mutually productive. Rav Tzadok uses this sentence to explain how Adar's holy laughter can grow from the preceding work of restraint.

וְגוֹמֵר **as it is said (Shemos 6:6–7), "And I will take you out," etc.,** וְלָקַחְתִּי אֶתְכֶם לִי לְעָם **"and I will take you to Me as a nation,** וְהָיִיתִי לָכֶם לֵאלֹהִים[426] **and I will be your God."** וְכֵן הָיוּ כָּל הַנִּסִּים **And so all the miracles were** מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁהִכָּה בְּפַרְעֹה וּבְכָל מִצְרַיִם **Who struck Pharaoh and all of Egypt** בְּעֶשֶׂר מַכּוֹת **with ten plagues,** וְהָיוּ נָגוֹף לְמִצְרַיִם **and they were a blow to Egypt** וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **and healing for Yisrael,** עַל פֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **in the manner expounded in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב בֹּא, לו א) **(II, Bo 36a):** שֶׁבְּכָל מַכָּה הוֹצִיא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **that with each plague Hashem Yisbarach took** אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמַּדָּה אַחַת דְּקְלִיפָּה **Yisrael out of one attribute of kelipah** וְהֶכְנִיסָם בְּזֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה **and brought them, correspondingly,** בְּמִדָּה אַחַת בִּקְדוּשָּׁה[427] **into one attribute of holiness** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(as has been explained many times);** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [דְּבָרִים ד, לד] גּוֹי מִקֶּרֶב גּוֹי **and as it is said (Devarim 4:34), "a nation from the midst of a nation,"** וְנִדְרַשׁ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה כג, ב) **and it is expounded (Vayikra Rabbah 23:2):** אֵלּוּ וָאֵלּוּ **"These and those were uncircumcised," etc.;** לֹא הָיְתָה נוֹתֶנֶת מִדַּת הַדִּין **"the attribute of justice would not have allowed** וְכוּלֵי[428] לְיִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁיִּגָּאֲלוּ **Yisrael to be redeemed," etc.** רַק הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ הוֹצִיאָם מֵהֶם **Only Hashem Yisbarach took them out from among them,** אַף שֶׁהָיוּ מְשׁוּקָעִים **even though they were immersed like a fetus in its mother's womb.** כְּעוּבָּר בְּמֵעֵי אִמּוֹ [שְׁמוֹת יד, יד] וְכֵן בְּקִרְיַעַת יַם סוּף כְּתִיב **And so at the splitting of the Yam Suf it is written (Shemos 14:14):** ה' יִלָּחֶם לָכֶם **"Hashem will fight for you,** וְאַתֶּם תַּחֲרִישׁוּן[429] **and you shall be silent"** — מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן חֹדֶשׁ הַכֹּל מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ[430] **all of it from the side of Hashem Yisbarach.**

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[425] **Zohar I 137a, 138a, Midrash HaNeelam** — "At first, when it was sullied with sins in this world, it was called Lot. In the future, when it will no longer be sullied as at first, like one who bathes and immerses from impurity, they call it Lavan. In any event, the inclination is not abolished from the world. ... The inclination is needed by the world like rain is needed by the world: without it there would be no joy in learning a Torah teaching. But it will no longer be sullied as at first so as to sin through it, as it is written: 'They shall neither harm nor destroy on all My holy mountain.' Rabbi Shimon said: This is the heart, in which the inclination dwells." The passage distinguishes desire's continuing life-giving energy from its sinful distortion. This distinction is essential to Rav Tzadok's account of the transformed inclination and the joy of Torah.

[426] **Midrash Tanchuma, Bereishis 7** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, Who is called righteous and upright, created the human being in His image only so that the person should be righteous and upright like Him. If you ask: Why did He create an evil inclination, of which it is written, 'The inclination of man's heart is evil from his youth'? You say that it is evil; who can make it good? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: You make it evil." The Midrash locates responsibility for the inclination's evil in the person's development of it. Rav Tzadok accordingly distinguishes the original power of desire from its direction toward bodily indulgence.

[427] Parallel: **R. Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Tanya, Likkutei Amarim, chapter 27** — "There are two kinds of satisfaction before Him, blessed be He, above. One comes from the complete nullification of the Other Side and the transformation of bitterness into sweetness and darkness into light through the righteous. The second comes when the Other Side is subdued while it is still in its strength and might, raising itself like an eagle; from there Hashem brings it down through an awakening from below by the beinonim, those of intermediate spiritual standing. This is what Scripture says: 'Make me delicacies as I love'—'delicacies' in the plural: two kinds of satisfaction. It is the Shechinah's address to her children, the community of Israel, as explained in the Tikkunim. In the analogy of bodily delicacies, there are two kinds of choice foods: one consists of pleasant, sweet foods, and the other of pungent or sour things, which are well seasoned and prepared until they become delicacies that restore the spirit."

Connection: Tanya distinguishes divine delight in a transformed inclination from divine delight in overcoming an inclination that remains powerful. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's present account of the divine "laughter" produced by battle: the successful resistance itself gives satisfaction above, even before the future purification symbolized by the feast of Leviathan and the wild ox. It also preserves the distinction from the preceding paragraph's straightened heart, where the conflict has been transformed into goodness.

[428] **Vayikra Rabbah 13:3** — "Rabbi Yudan son of Rabbi Shimon said: Behemos and Leviathan will be the righteous people's spectacle in the future. Whoever has not watched the nations' spectacles in this world will merit to see it in the World to Come. How are they slaughtered? Behemos strikes Leviathan with its horns and tears it; Leviathan strikes Behemos with its fins and pierces it. The Sages asked: Is this valid slaughter? ... Rabbi Avin bar Kahana said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said, 'A new Torah shall go forth from Me'—a new disclosure of Torah shall go forth from Me." The Midrash supplies the contest of the two creatures. Their identification with the roots of desire and anger, and the righteous person's purification of both, is Rav Tzadok's interpretation of that contest.

[429] **Avodah Zarah 18b** — "One may not attend the stadium because it is 'the company of scoffers.' Rabbi Nasan permits it for two reasons: first, because one may cry out and save someone; second, because one may give testimony enabling a woman to marry." The surrounding discussion treats public spectacles as a distraction from Torah and distinguishes the exceptional purpose of saving life or supplying testimony. Rav Tzadok cites this setting to explain the term kenigya for a contest or spectacle.

[430] **Bava Basra 74b** — "Why not likewise castrate the male and cool the female? Fish are unrestrained. Why not do the reverse? One answer: a salted female is preferable. Another answer: since it is written, 'Leviathan, which You formed to play with,' it would not be fitting to play with a female." The discussion concerns why the male and female

אָדָר **Which is not so with the month of Adar,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **which was formed with the letter Kuf,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה[431] **as is said in Sefer Yetzirah;** (שַׁבָּת קד, א) וְאוֹת ק׳ אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא **and of the letter Kuf it is brought in the Gemara (Shabbos 104a):** קוֹף קָדוֹשׁ **"Kuf — kadosh, holy,"** מְרַמֵּז לִקְדוּשָׁה מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל **alluding to holiness from the side of Yisrael.** וְכֵן נַעֲשָׂה אָז מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **And so the eradication of Amalek was then carried out** עַל יְדֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **through Yisrael,** וְכֵן נַעֲשָׂה הַנֵּס **and so the miracle was done** עַל יְדֵי מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **through Mordechai and Esther,** וְהַיְּהוּדִים הָרְגוּ בְּשׁוּשַׁן הַצּוֹרְרִים וַעֲשֶׂרֶת בְּנֵי הָמָן **and the Jews killed in Shushan and the enemies and the ten sons of Haman (see Esther 9:6–10),** וּבִשְׁאָר מְדִינוֹת הַמֶּלֶךְ [רְאֵה אֶסְתֵּר ט, ו-י] **and in the other provinces of the king** [שָׁם, טז] שִׁבְעִים וַחֲמִשָּׁה אֶלֶף [שָׁם] **seventy-five thousand (ibid. 16) —** הַכֹּל הָיוּ מֵעֲמָלֵקִים[432] **all of them were Amalekites.** וְכֵן הָיָה אָז **And so there was then** קַבָּלַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the acceptance of the Torah she'b'al peh,** (שַׁבָּת פח, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shabbos 88a):** הֶדַר קַבְּלוּהָ בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ[433] **"They accepted it anew in the days of Achashveirosh" —** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **meaning the Torah she'b'al peh,** (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Tanchuma, Noach 3)** שֶׁעַל זֶה הָיָה כְּפִיַּית הָהָר כְּגִיגִית **that it was for this that the mountain was held over them like a barrel:** שֶׁעַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **for regarding the Torah she'b'chsav** אָמְרוּ נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע **they said "Naaseh v'nishma,"** שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ צַעַר כָּל כָּךְ **since it involves not so much hardship;** רַק עַל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **only regarding the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהִיא עַזָּה כַּמָּוֶת[434] וְכוּ׳ **which is "strong as death," etc. —** עַל זֶה הָיָה כְּפִיַּית הַר כְּגִיגִית **for that the mountain was held over them like a barrel.** וּבִימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ מֵאַהֲבַת הַנֵּס קִבְּלוּהָ **And in the days of Achashveirosh, out of love for the miracle, they accepted it with joy, out of love (Rashi, Shabbos ibid.),** כְּמוֹ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב[435] [רַשׁ״י שַׁבָּת שָׁם] בְּשִׂמְחָה מֵאַהֲבָה **like the Torah she'b'chsav.** וּמִזֶּה בָּא[436] הַשִּׂמְחָה **And from this comes the joy,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא [שָׁם] **as they said in the Gemara (ibid.):** דִּבְשָׁעָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע **"When they said Naaseh v'nishma,** קָשְׁרוּ לְכָל אֶחָד שְׁנֵי כְתָרִים וְכוּ׳ **they tied two crowns onto each one," etc.,** וְעָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"and in the future Hakadosh**

Leviathan were prevented from reproducing together. Rav Tzadok takes the description of fish as sexually unrestrained into his symbolic account of Leviathan as the root of desire.

[431] **Berachos 61a** — "Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak challenged: If so, does an animal, concerning which 'formed' is not written with two yuds, have no inclination? Yet we see that it injures, bites, and kicks! Rather, it is as Rabbi Shimon ben Pazi taught: Woe to me from my Creator, and woe to me from my inclination." The objection points to aggression in animals. Rav Tzadok associates the beast's root here with anger and violence, distinguishing it from Leviathan's desire.

[432] **Bava Basra 74b–75a** — "Rav Dimi said in Rabbi Yonasan's name: In the future Gavriel will conduct a contest with Leviathan, as it is said: 'Can you draw Leviathan with a hook, or sink its tongue with a rope?' If the Holy One, blessed be He, did not help him, he could not prevail over it, as it is said: 'Its Maker shall bring near His sword.'" The opening words naming Gavriel occur at the end of 74b, with the rest on 75a. Rav Tzadok joins this Divine assistance to the parallel teaching about the person's daily struggle with the inclination.

[433] **Sukkah 52b** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: A person's inclination overpowers him every day and seeks to kill him, as it is said: 'The wicked watches for the righteous and seeks to kill him.' Were the Holy One, blessed be He, not to help him, he could not prevail over it, as it is said: 'Hashem will not leave him in its hand, and will not condemn him when he is judged.'" The matching formulation 'were God not to help him' permits Rav Tzadok to read Gavriel's contest with Leviathan as a pattern for the human struggle.

[434] **Shabbos 119b** — "Rabbi Yosi bar Yehudah said: Two ministering angels accompany a person on Friday evening from the synagogue to his house, one good and one bad. When he enters his house and finds a lamp lit, the table prepared, and the bed arranged, the good angel says: May it be so on another Shabbos, and the bad angel answers Amen against its will. If not, the bad angel says: May it be so on another Shabbos, and the good angel answers Amen against its will." The Gemara gives two accompanying angels. Their relation here to the wise heart on the right and foolish heart on the left is Rav Tzadok's interpretation of the opposing forces.

[435] **Avodah Zarah 3b** — "In the third quarter He sits and nourishes the whole world, from the horns of the wild oxen to the eggs of lice. In the fourth quarter He sits and plays with Leviathan, as it is said: 'Leviathan, which You formed to play with.' Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: He plays with His creatures, but He laughs at His creatures only on that day." The discussion then asks how this stands with the statement that, since the Temple's destruction, God has no laughter. It answers that in the fourth quarter He sits and teaches Torah to schoolchildren, applying 'Whom shall He teach knowledge? ... Those weaned from milk.' This change of activity is the textual basis for Rav Tzadok's contrast between mastery of the inclination and the children's sinless Torah.

[436] **Shabbos 119b** — "Reish Lakish said in Rabbi Yehudah Nesia's name: The world endures only on account of the breath of schoolchildren. Rav Pappa asked Abaye: What of my Torah study and yours? He replied: Breath that contains sin cannot be compared to breath that contains no sin. Reish Lakish further said: We do not interrupt schoolchildren's study even for building the Temple." The source distinguishes the children's sinless breath from the Torah study of adults. Rav Tzadok uses it to explain the special Divine delight in their learning during exile.

Baruch Hu לְהַחֲזִירָן לָנוּ וְכוּ׳ **will return them to us," etc.:** וְשִׂמְחַת עוֹלָם עַל רֹאשָׁם **"'and everlasting joy upon their heads' — שִׂמְחָה שֶׁמֵּעוֹלָם עַל רֹאשָׁם the joy of old upon their heads."** דְּהַשִּׂמְחָה בָּא **For the joy comes** מִמַּה שֶּׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל מְקַבְּלִין **from Yisrael accepting** עוֹל מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ מִצִּדָּם[437] **the yoke of His kingship, may He be blessed, on their own part,** [תְּפִלּוֹת שַׁבָּת] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים **as we say (Shabbos prayers),** יִשְׂמְחוּ בְמַלְכוּתְךָ **"They shall rejoice in Your kingship,** שׁוֹמְרֵי שַׁבָּת[438] וְכוּ׳ **those who keep Shabbos," etc.** וְכֵן כְּתִיב בַּמְּגִילָּה **And so it is written in the Megillah,** [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] אַחַר מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **after the eradication of Amalek (Esther 8:16):** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה וְשִׂמְחָה **"The Jews had light and joy,"** (מְגִילָּה טז, ב) וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (Megillah 16b):** אוֹרָה זוֹ תּוֹרָה **"'Light' — this is Torah,** וְתוֹרָה אוֹר [מִשְׁלֵי ו, כג][439] וְכֵן הוּא אוֹמֵר **and so it says (Mishlei 6:23), 'and Torah is light'" —** וְהֵיינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **meaning the Torah she'b'al peh.** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב נִקְרָא אוֹר **For the Torah she'b'chsav is called "or,"** וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **which receives from the Torah she'b'chsav,** בְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא **is in the aspect of the moon** דְּמְקַבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **that receives from the sun,** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרֵאת אוֹרָה **and therefore it is called "orah,"** לְשׁוֹן נְקֵיבָה **in the feminine form.** וּכְתִיב אַחַר כָּךְ וְשִׂמְחָה **And afterward it is written "and joy,"** שֶׁהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שִׂמְחָה שֶׁמֵּעוֹלָם **which is like the crown of the joy of old.** וְיֵקָר הוּא גַּם כֵּן **And "honor," too,** כָּתֶר עַל הָרֹאשׁ **is a crown upon the head,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אִיּוֹב כח, י] וְכָל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ **as it is said (Iyov 28:10), "and every precious thing his eye beheld,"** וְאָמְרוּ (בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה יט, ו, תַּנְחוּמָא חֻקַּת ח) **and they said (Bamidbar Rabbah 19:6, Tanchuma Chukas 8):** זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **"This is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues:** רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ שֶׁל רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **the eye of Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues beheld** מַה שֶּׁלֹּא רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה[440] **what the eye of Moshe did not behold."** וְזֶהוּ שִׂמְחָה שֶׁמֵּעוֹלָם עַל רֹאשָׁם **And this is "the joy of old upon their heads,"** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and this is what they said:** דְּמִשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אֲדָר מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה **"When Adar enters we increase in joy."** אַחַר כָּךְ וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said afterward:** הִלְכָךְ וְכוּ׳ **"Therefore, etc.,** וְלִימְצֵי נַפְשֵׁיהּ בַּאֲדָר **let him make himself available in Adar,** דְּבְרִיא מַזָּלֵיהּ **for its mazal is healthy" —** דְּאַחַר מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **for after the eradication of Amalek** זוֹכִין לְכָתָרִים **one merits the crowns.** מַזָּל **"Mazal" indicates** שֶׁהוּא קְשׁוּר בַּשּׁוֹרֶשׁ **that it is bound to the root,** דְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה **at the beginning of Thought,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג אַחֲרֵי עט, ב) **(III, Acharei 79b):** בְּהָנֵי תְּלַת דְּתַלְיָין בְּמַזָּלָא **"in these three that depend on mazal,"** דְּהֵיינוּ עַתִּיקָא **that is, Atika,** עַל ה׳ דְּיֵיקָא **"upon Hashem" specifically;** עַיֵּין שָׁם[441] **see there.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ אַחַר כָּךְ בַּגְּמָרָא **And this is why**

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[437] **Zohar III 160a, Shelach** — "Furthermore, 'Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev.' If a person says that despite all this he will attain it: 'Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev'—this is the evil inclination, the accuser, who accuses a person and is constantly found in the body. 'The Hittite and the Amorite'—how many accusers are found there, so that a person cannot enter that world at all. Who will merit it, and who will enter it? With these words 'they disheartened the children of Israel,' for they brought out an evil report about it." The Zohar first portrays the discouraging accusation, then answers it with sincere will and guarding the covenant. This exact context supports Rav Tzadok's identification of Amalek as the accusing root of the inclination.

[438] **Gloss to Zohar II 121b, preserved in Mikdash Melekh** — "'You shall throw it to the dog'—note: The female aspect of the Other Side is called kelev, dog, the reversal of bakol, 'in everything.'" The exact marginal wording is preserved here in the Zholkva 1864 edition. Rav Tzadok explicitly attributes it to R. Chaim Vital also in Pri Tzaddik, Mishpatim 9; that passage was retrieved as a witness to his attribution. The gloss's own digital text is marked 'note' without naming its author.

[439] **Sanhedrin 109a** — "Rabbi Yirmeyah bar Elazar said: They divided into three groups. One said: Let us ascend and dwell there; one said: Let us ascend and worship idols; and one said: Let us ascend and wage war. Those who said, 'Let us ascend and dwell there'—Hashem dispersed them. Those who said, 'Let us ascend and wage war' became apes, spirits, demons, and night spirits. Those who said, 'Let us ascend and worship idols'—'there Hashem confused the language of the whole earth.'" The Gemara lists the four forms resulting from the rebellious war against Heaven. Their correspondence to the middle line of holiness is developed at length in the author's cross-reference, Pri Tzaddik, Mishpatim 9.

[440] **Vayikra Rabbah 35:4** — "Statutes through which I engraved the heavens and the earth, as it is said: 'If not for My covenant by day and night, I would not have appointed the statutes of heaven and earth.' Statutes through which I engraved the sun and moon, as it is said: 'Who gives the sun for light by day, the statutes of the moon and stars for light by night.' Statutes through which I engraved the sea, as it is said: 'When He set the sea its statute.'" The Midrash reads the Torah's statutes together with the ordered laws of Creation. It develops the previous section's principle that the Divine order precedes Israel's observance.

[441] **Midrash Tanchuma, Kedoshim 2** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: Since you were sanctified to My Name before I created the world, be holy as I am holy. ... To what may this be compared? To a king who betrothed a woman. He said to her: Since you have been betrothed to my name, I am king and you are queen. As is my honor, so is your honor, because you are my wife. So the Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moshe: Go and sanctify the people."

the Gemara says afterward שְׁתֵּי מֵימְרוֹת **two statements** דְּרַב יְהוּדָה בְּרֵיהּ **of Rav Yehudah son of** דְּרַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **Rav Shmuel bar Sheilas:** [לָתֵת לָכֶם אַחֲרִית וְתִקְוָה יִרְמְיָה כט, יא] **"'To give you a future and hope' (Yirmeyah 29:11) —** אִלּוּ תְּקָלִים וּכְלֵי פִּשְׁתָּן **these are date palms and linen garments";** כְּרֵיחַ שָׂדֶה אֲשֶׁר בֵּרְכוֹ ה׳ [בְּרֵאשִׁית כז, כז] **"'like the fragrance of a field which Hashem has blessed' (Bereishis 27:27) —** כְּרֵיחַ שָׂדֶה שֶׁל תַּפּוּחִים[442] **like the fragrance of a field of apples."** וְרַשִׁ״י [שָׁם דְּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וְנָתַתִּי] פֵּרֵשׁ **And Rashi (ibid., s.v. V'nasati) explained** דְּאַיְידֵי דְּאַיְירֵי רַב יְהוּדָה לְעֵיל **that since Rav Yehudah was quoted above,** נָקִיט וְאָזֵיל[443] **it continues with his statements.** וַעֲדַיִין יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Yet we must still understand** לָמָּה נִסְמְכוּ שְׁתֵּי מֵימְרוֹת אֵלּוּ דְּיַיקָא **why specifically these two statements were placed together,** דְּהָא יֵשׁ מִמֶּנּוּ עוֹד מֵימְרוֹת **since there are other statements of his** בְּשִׁשָּׁה סְדָרִים **in the Shas.** וּלְפִי הָאָמוּר **And according to what was said,** יֵשׁ לָהֶם שַׁיְיכוּת **they are connected:** דְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר שֶׁהָיָה בּוֹ מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **for the month of Adar, in which the eradication of Amalek took place —** שֶׁהוּא מְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **Amalek, who accuses Yisrael** שֶׁאֵין כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים **that they are not all tzaddikim,** שֶׁגַּם בָּהֶם אַף שֶׁנִּימּוֹלוּ **that among them too, even though they are circumcised,** יֵשׁ כַּמָּה שֶׁפּוֹגְמִים **there are many who blemish** בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק **the attribute of Tzaddik —** וּבְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **and in this month,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר **formed with the letter Kuf,** בְּאוֹת ק׳ שֶׁמְּוֹרֶה קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **which indicates the holiness of Yisrael,** שֶׁבָּאֱמֶת רְצוֹנֵנוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹנֶךָ **that in truth "our will is to do Your will,** וּמִי מְעַכֵּב[444] וְכוּ׳ **and who holds us back," etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת יז, א) **(as it says, Berachos 17a);** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן **and through this,** וְנָשָׂא הַשָּׂעִיר **"and the goat shall carry" —** עֲוֹנֹתֵיהֶם **Esav — "all their iniquities,"** עֲוֹנוֹת תָּם[445] **the iniquities of the "tam,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סה, טו) **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 65:15).** וְזֶהוּ דְּבָרִיא מַזָּלֵיהּ **And this is "its mazal is healthy,"** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **meaning they are bound at the root** בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **to Hashem Yisbarach,** וְעַל (מְגִילָּה ג, א) דָּרְכָּךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said (Megillah 3a):** אַף עַל גַּב דְּאִינְהוּ לָא חָזוּ **"Even though they did not see,** חָזוּ מַזָּלַיְיהוּ[446] **their mazal saw" —** דְּמַזָּל הוּא מַה שֶּׁהוּא **for mazal is that which is** לְמַעְלָה מַחָכְמָה וּבִינָה **above Chochmah and Binah,** וְהַיְינוּ לְמַעְלָה **that is, above** מִכָּל תְּפִיסַת הַבְּרוּאִים **any grasp of created beings.** וְעַל זֶה הֵבִיא דְּרָשַׁת כְּרֵיחַ שָׂדֶה וְגוֹמֵר **And on this it brought the exposition "like the fragrance of a field," etc.,** דִּכְתִיב [בְּרֵאשִׁית כז, כז] וַיָּרַח אֶת רֵיחַ בְּגָדָיו **for it is written (Bereishis 27:27), "And he smelled**

The Midrash presents holiness as the consequence of Israel's prior bond with God's Name. Rav Tzadok reads 'as I am holy' as the human task of becoming distinct from mundane attachment.

[442] **Vayikra Rabbah 24:8** — "Rabbi Avin offered another interpretation: It is like the people of a province who made three crowns for the king. What did the king do? He placed one on his head and two on his children's heads. So each day the beings above crown the Holy One, blessed be He, with three sanctifications. What does He do? He places one on His head and two on Israel's heads, as it is written: 'You shall be holy,' and 'Sanctify yourselves and be holy.'" The two sanctifications given to Israel make the crowns an image of its bestowed vocation. The same section explains their double portion through their struggle against the inclination, which the upper beings do not face.

[443] **Vayikra Rabbah 24:6** — "Rabbi Yehudah ben Pazi said: Why is the section of forbidden relations adjacent to the section 'You shall be holy'? To teach that wherever you find a boundary against forbidden relations, you find holiness. Rabbi Yehudah ben Pazi likewise said: Anyone who sets a boundary against forbidden relations is called holy." This explicit connection between restraint and holiness supports the maamar's sequence from Shevat's repair of appetite and the covenant to Adar's kuf, 'holy.'

[444] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 9** — "Rabbi Yudan bar Gadya said: Remember what he did to us concerning circumcision, which is situated in a person's lap. ... What did the house of Amalek do? They cut off the circumcisions of Israel and threw them upward, saying: Is this what You chose? Take what You chose. This is 'Their insult, with which they insulted You, Hashem.'" The Midrash makes Amalek's assault an insult against God's choice expressed through the covenant. Rav Tzadok treats the physical desecration as the form of its accusation against Israel's covenantal holiness.

[445] **Zohar II 23a, Vaera** — "'I also established My covenant with them, to give them the land of Canaan'—because they were circumcised. Whoever is circumcised inherits the Land, for only a righteous person inherits the Land, and whoever is circumcised is called righteous, as it is written: 'Your people are all righteous; they shall inherit the land forever.' Whoever is circumcised and guards this covenantal sign is called righteous. Come and see from Yosef: throughout his days he was not called righteous until he guarded that covenant, the holy covenantal sign. Once he guarded it, he was called Yosef the righteous." The passage includes both the covenantal sign and its guarding. Rav Tzadok quotes its initial statement in explaining the ground of Amalek's accusation and the holiness Israel must bring into expression.

[446] **Sefer Yetzirah, Gra recension 5:7, 10** — "He made the letter heh rule over speech, bound a crown to it, and combined them with one another. Through them He formed Aries in the world, Nisan in the year, and the right foot in the person, male and female." The same recension assigns tzadi, eating, and Shevat together, and kuf, laughter, and Adar together. Rav Tzadok interprets this sequence of letters and months as a movement from disciplined appetite, through Israel's holiness, to the revelation symbolized by heh in Nisan.

the fragrance of his garments," (סַנְהֶדְרִין לז, א) וְאִיתָא **and it is brought (Sanhedrin 37a):** אַל תִּיקְרֵי בְּגָדָיו **"Do not read 'his garments'** אֶלָּא בּוֹגְדָיו[447] **but 'his traitors,'"** (שָׁם, כב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה **and as they said in Bereishis Rabbah (ibid. 22):** כְּגוֹן יוֹסֵי מְשִׁיתָא[448] וְכוּלֵי **such as Yosei Meshisa, etc.:** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים **that in truth they are all tzaddikim,** וְאַף הַבּוֹגְדִים **and even the traitors** הֵם רַק מַלְבּוּשֵׁי וּבְגְדֵי עֵשָׂו **are only the clothing and garments of Esav,** אֲבָל בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **but at the root** נוֹתְנִין רֵיחַ טוֹב[449] **they give off a good fragrance,** כְּרֵיחַ שָׂדֶה שֶׁזֵּהוּ סוֹד מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים **like the fragrance of a field of apples.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And as we said,** ז, ט] **this is the secret of what is said (Shir HaShirim 7:9):** וְרֵיחַ אַפֵּךְ כַּתַּפּוּחִים **"and the fragrance of your nose like apples":** דְּרֵיחַ אַף מְרַמֵּז לַבּוֹגְדִים **for the fragrance of the nose alludes to the traitors,** (בְּאָבוֹת דְּרַבִּי נָתָן פֶּרֶק לא, ג) **for it lists (Avos d'Rabbi Nosson 31:3)** זֶהוּ מֵימֵי חוֹטְמוֹ[450] שֶׁל אָדָם **these are the waters of a person's nose"** — עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there** — וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם נוֹתֵן רֵיחַ טוֹב **and nevertheless it gives off a good fragrance,** כְּתַפּוּחִים כְּשָׂדֶה שֶׁל תַּפּוּחִים **like apples, like a field of apples.** וְכֵן הֵבִיאוּ הַמַּיְמָרָא שֶׁאָמַר **And so they brought the statement he said,** לָתֵת לָכֶם אַחֲרִית וְתִקְוָה **"'To give you a future and hope'** — עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (פְּסָחִים פז, ב) **along the lines of what they said (Pesachim 87b):** אֵלּוּ דְּקָלִים וּכְלֵי פִשְׁתָּן **these are date palms and linen garments,"** לֹא הִגְלָה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"Hakadosh Baruch Hu exiled** אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל לְבָבֶל וְכוּלֵי **Yisrael to Bavel," etc.,** כְּדֵי שֶׁיֹּאכְלוּ תְּמָרִים **"only so that they eat dates** וְיַעַסְקוּ[451] בַּתּוֹרָה **and occupy themselves with Torah"** — דְּעִיקַּר הִתְיַסְּדוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for the main founding of the Torah she'b'al peh** הָיָה בְּבָבֶל **was in Bavel** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מִשְׁפָּטִים מַאֲמָר א **(as explained in Mishpatim, maamar 1,** עַיֵּין שָׁם בִּדְבָרֵינוּ בַּאֲרִיכוּת[452]) **see our words there at length);** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז **and to this alludes** דְּקָלִים וּכְלֵי פִשְׁתָּן **"date palms and linen garments,"** לְבוּשֵׁי תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **the garments of talmidei chachamim** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר שָׁם מִכַּמָּה מְקוֹמוֹת) **(as explained there from several places).** [יִרְמְיָה כט, יא וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what is said (Yirmeyah 29:11):** כִּי אָנֹכִי יָדַעְתִּי אֶת הַמַּחֲשָׁבוֹת **"For I know the thoughts** אֲשֶׁר אָנֹכִי חוֹשֵׁב עֲלֵיכֶם וְגוֹמֵר **that I think concerning you," etc.,** מַחְשְׁבוֹת שָׁלוֹם וְגוֹמֵר **"thoughts of peace," etc.** וְזֶהוּ הַשַּׁיָּיכוּת **And this is the connection** לְמַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **to what they said,** דְּבַאֲדָר בָּרִיא מַזָּלֵיהּ **that in Adar its mazal is healthy,** שֶׁהָעֵסֶק בִּקְדוּשָּׁה

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[447] **Bamidbar Rabbah 10:1; Pesikta Rabbasi 23** — "Rabbi Tanchum son of Rabbi Chiya said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: It is written, 'Sanctify My Shabbosos.' Through what do you sanctify it? Through food, drink, and clean clothing. What is written with it? 'They shall be a sign between Me and you, to know that I am Hashem your God.' I am Hashem, faithful to pay you your reward." The retrieved Pesikta likewise reads 'to sanctify it' as food, drink, and clean clothing. These concrete actions are Israel's active participation in Shabbos holiness.

[448] **Megillah 6b** — "Rabbi Tavi said: The reason of Rabbi Shimon ben Gamliel is that bringing one redemption close to another is preferable. Rabbi Elazar said: His reason is from here: To confirm this second letter of Purim." The discussion explains why Purim is observed in the second Adar of a leap year, adjacent to Nisan and the Exodus. Rav Tzadok reads that liturgical-calendar adjacency as the movement from Adar's work toward Nisan's redemption.

[449] **Ein Yaakov, Avodah Zarah 3b** — "Rav Acha of Galilee said to Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak: According to the view that, since the Temple was destroyed, there is no laughter before the Holy One, blessed be He, what does He do in the fourth quarter? He sits and teaches Torah to schoolchildren. From where do we know that there is no laughter before Him? ... Perhaps it is forgetting that does not occur, but joy still occurs! Rather, from here: 'I have kept silent from of old; I shall be still and restrain Myself.'" This retrieved Ein Yaakov text reads 'joy' at the critical question, where the standard Avodah Zarah 3b text reads 'laughter.' The actual variant is therefore verified. Rav Tzadok uses it as evidence that joy and laughter name the same inner content at different degrees of disclosure.

[450] **Megillah 12b** — "'On the seventh day, when the king's heart was merry with wine'—was his heart not merry with wine until now? Rava said: The seventh day was Shabbos. When Israel eat and drink, they begin with words of Torah and praise; when the nations eat and drink, they begin with frivolous matters." Rav Tzadok raises a concrete difficulty from the Gemara's praise of Shabbos song: if outward joy is reserved for the future, how is present song possible? His answer turns on Shabbos as a disclosure of the future light.

[451] **Zohar, Idra Zuta, III 290a** — "Because in Atika there is neither beginning nor end, it is not called 'You'; because it is concealed and not revealed, it is called 'He.' From the place where a beginning is found it is called 'You' and is called Father, as it is written: 'For You are our Father.' In the teaching of the school of Rav Yeiva the Elder: In the inclusive account, Zeir Anpin is called 'You,' while the concealed Holy Ancient One is called 'He.'" The distinction of 'You' from the concealed 'He' is explicit in the retrieved original. Rav Tzadok interprets the future 'that day' as the day on which this concealed level will be illumined. The traditional III 290a locator follows the manuscript; this particular Idra extract has no embedded page overlay.

[452] **Megillah 16b** — "'And honor'—these are tefillin, as it is said: 'All the peoples of the earth shall see that the Name of Hashem is called upon you, and they shall fear you.' Rabbi Eliezer the Great says: These are the tefillin of the head." The maamar now develops the 'honor' clause, beyond its earlier treatment of light and joy. The head-tefillin image permits Rav Tzadok's association with the supernal crown.

וְעַל זֶה הֲבִיא מַאֲמַר מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּאָמוּר[453] **for the engagement in holiness is from the side of Yisrael, as stated;** **and on this it brought the statement** דְּדָקָלִים וּכְלֵי פִּשְׁתָּן **about date palms and linen garments,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל **which alludes to the Torah she'b'al peh** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that they accepted in Adar;** וְרֵיחַ שָׂדֶה **and "the fragrance of a field"** לְעִנְיַן רֵיחַ בּוֹגְדָיו **regarding "the fragrance of his traitors,"** שֶׁלְּעִנְיָן זֶה **that in this respect** נֶגֶד עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת **compared to the idolaters;** כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לוֹ קְדוּשָׁה **every one of Yisrael has holiness** וְעַל כֵּן בּוֹ מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **and therefore the eradication of Amalek is in it.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר רַבֵּינוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And as our holy Rebbe said —** זָכֹר צַדִּיק וָקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה **may the memory of the holy tzaddik be for a blessing** לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **for the life of the World to Come —** [מְגִילָה ב, א] לְעִנְיַן מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **regarding what they said (Megillah 2a),** שֶׁהַכְּפָרִים מַקְדִּימִין לְיוֹם הַכְּנִיסָה[454] **that the villages read early, on the day of assembly:** דִּבְנֵי כְּפָרִים נִקְרְאוּ עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ **villagers are called amei ha'aretz,** שֶׁעוֹסְקִים בַּעֲבוֹדַת הָאֲדָמָה **since they engage in working the land;** וְאַף שֶׁעִיקַּר מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **and although the main eradication of Amalek** עַל יְדֵי תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **is through talmidei chachamim,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם גַּם עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ בְּנֵי הַכְּפָרִים **nevertheless the amei ha'aretz too, the villagers,** מְבָרְרִין אֶת עַצְמָן לְגַבֵּיהוּ **prove themselves alongside them,** שֶׁהֵם כְּרֵיחַ שָׂדֶה שֶׁל תַּפּוּחִים **that they are like the fragrance of a field of apples.** וְאַדְרַבָּה הֵם מַקְדִּימִין **And on the contrary, they come first,** לְיוֹם הַכְּנִיסָה **on the day of assembly,** דְּעִיקַּר הַבֵּירוּר **for the main clarification** נֶגֶד קִטְרוּג הוּא עֲמָלֵק בָּהֶם **against Amalek's accusation is through them,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ טְעָנוֹת עֲלֵיהֶם[455] **since he has claims against them,** וְהֵם מִתְבָּרְרִין **and they are shown** שֶׁהֵם קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **to be bound at the root to Hashem Yisbarach,** דִּרְצוֹנֵנוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹנֶךָ **that "our will is to do Your will,** וּמִי מְעַכֵּב וְכוּ' **and who holds us back," etc.** וְכָל אֶחָד **And every one of Yisrael** מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לוֹ חֵלֶק בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **has a portion in the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁעַל זֶה **about which we say,** אוֹמְרִים וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה **"and grant our portion in Your Torah,"** וְתֵן חֶלְקֵנוּ בְּתוֹרָתֶךָ **and as we have said many times** פְּעָמִים מִמַּה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה ט, ג) **based on what they said (Vayikra Rabbah 9:3):** **"'The congregation of Yannai' is not written here,** קְהִלַּת יַנַּאי אֵין כְּתִיב כָּאן **but 'the congregation of Yaakov'" —** אֶלָּא קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב **meaning even the amei ha'aretz,** וְהֵיינוּ אַף עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ **as is expounded (Bava Metzia 33b):** שָׁנוּ דְּרַשׁ (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא לג, ב) **"and to the house of Yaakov" (Yeshayah 58:1) —** וּלְבֵית יַעֲקֹב [יְשַׁעְיָה נח, א] **this refers to the amei ha'aretz.** עַל עַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ **And this was the portion of** וְזֶה הָיָה חֶלְקוֹ שֶׁל **that am ha'aretz who expounded** אוֹתוֹ עַם הָאָרֶץ שֶׁדָּרַשׁ **in the Torah she'b'al peh.** בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that everyone has a portion** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד יֵשׁ לוֹ חֵלֶק **And even the laborers,** וְאַף הַפּוֹעֲלִים **at least on Shabbos,** עַל כָּל פָּנִים בְּשַׁבָּת עוֹסְקִין **occupy themselves with Torah,** בַּתּוֹרָה **as they said** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּנָּא דְּבֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ רַבָּה, א) **(Tanna d'Vei Eliyahu, beginning of Seder Eliyahu Rabbah 1)** דְּשַׁבָּת יַעֲשֶׂה כּוּלּוֹ תּוֹרָה[456] **that Shabbos should be made entirely Torah.** וְאָמְרוּ **And these three statements were said** מִשְּׁמֵיהּ דְּרַב יְהוּדָה בְּרֵיהּ **in the name of Rav Yehudah son of** דְּרַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **Rav Shmuel bar Sheilas,** (סַנְהֶדְרִין צו, ב) דְּאִיתָא **for it is brought (Sanhedrin 96b):** לָמְדוּ תּוֹרָה בִּבְנֵי בְרַק וְגוֹמֵר מִבְּנֵי בָּנָיו שֶׁל הָמָן **"Of the descendants of Haman,** **some**

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[453] **Zohar III 61a, Acharei Mos** — "What is Holy? The perfection of everything, called supernal Wisdom. From that place holy anointing flows through known paths to the place called supernal Understanding. From there springs and streams issue on every side until they reach this zot.... When this zot is blessed ... it is called the Holy Spirit: that is, a spirit from that higher Holy. When mysteries of Torah issue and awaken from it, it is called the Holy Tongue." The source itself explains the compound expression ruach hakodesh as a spirit flowing from supernal holiness, and immediately relates it to the emergence of Torah mysteries.

[454] **Ramban, Chiddushim, Bava Basra 12a** — "This is what it means: Although the prophecy of the prophets, which is the appearance and vision, was taken away, the prophecy of the sages, which comes through the path of wisdom, was not taken away. Rather, they know the truth through the Divine inspiration within them. For on occasion He rests His Divine Presence even upon the pious who are not sages." Ramban distinguishes visionary prophecy from the sages' apprehension of truth through wisdom and inner Divine inspiration. The Gemara immediately adds, 'A sage is greater than a prophet.' Rav Tzadok draws on this distinction for the inspired quality of Oral Torah.

[455] **Megillah 14b** — "Esther—for it is written, 'On the third day Esther clothed herself in royalty.' Should it not have said 'royal garments'? Rather, Divine inspiration clothed her. Here it is written 'clothed,' and there it is written 'A spirit clothed Amasai.'" The source makes malchus, royalty, a manifestation of ruach hakodesh in Esther's action. It thus gives Rav Tzadok a direct Purim example for the link among Malchus, inspired apprehension, and its expression.

[456] **Berachos 33a** — "Rabbi Elazar said: Every person who possesses understanding is as though the Temple had been built in his days. Understanding was placed between two Divine Names, and the Temple was placed between two Divine Names." The preceding discussion cites 'For Hashem is a God of understandings' and 'The sanctuary, my Lord, which Your hands established.' Rav Tzadok interprets this equivalence inwardly, as the heart becoming a holy dwelling.

studied Torah in Bnei Brak," etc. — וּמַנּוּ - עֵין יַעֲקֹב **Ein Yaakov: "and who was it? —** רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת[457] **Rav Shmuel bar Sheilas.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר **And therefore he said** שָׁלֹשׁ מֵימָרוֹת אֵלּוּ **these three statements,** שֶׁהֵם עִנְיַן בְּקִדּוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית **which concern the eradication of Amalek,** שֶׁמְּקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **who accuses Yisrael** מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **concerning the holiness of the bris;** וּבַאֲדָר הַבֵּירוּר **and in Adar comes the clarification** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְדוֹשִׁים הֵן **that Yisrael are holy** וְכוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **and all are tzaddikim, as mentioned above;** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁגָּלוּ לְבָבֶל **and through being exiled to Bavel** זָכוּ לְאַחֲרִית וְתִקְוָה טוֹבָה **they merited a good future and hope,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **which is the root of the Torah she'b'al peh;** וְכוּלָּם נוֹתְנִים רֵיחַ טוֹב **and they all give off a good fragrance,** כְּרֵיחַ שָׂדֶה שֶׁל תַּפּוּחִים **like the fragrance of a field of apples,** וַאֲפִילּוּ הַבּוֹגְדִים **even the traitors,** וְהֵם רַק מַלְבּוּשֵׁי עֵשָׂו **for they are only the garments of Esav.** (שָׁם לט, ב) וְעַל דָּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **And along the lines of what they said in the Gemara (there, 39b):** עוֹבַדְיָהוּ גֵּר אֱדוֹמִי הָיָה **"Ovadyahu was an Edomite convert,** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאָמְרֵי אִינָשֵׁי **and this is what people say:** מִינַּיהּ וּבֵיהּ אַבָּא **'From the forest itself** נַיְזִיל בֵּיהּ נַרְגָּא[458] **comes the axe that goes into it'" —** וְכֵן רַב יְהוּדָה בְּרֵיהּ **so too Rav Yehudah son of** דְּרַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **Rav Shmuel bar Sheilas,** שֶׁהָיָה מִזֶּרַע הָמָן וַעֲמָלֵק **who was of the seed of Haman and Amalek,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** אָמַר מַאֲמָרִים אֵלּוּ **said these statements,** שֶׁהֵם מֵעִנְיַן מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק שֶׁבַּאֲדָר **which concern the eradication of Amalek in Adar,** וְשָׁעַל כֵּן בּוֹ מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה **on account of which we increase in joy in it.**

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[457] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 48, 85a** — "These are two Shabbosos, corresponding to the upper and lower Divine Presence. 'To make Shabbos for their generations'—what is 'for their generations'? Happy is the person who makes them a dwelling on Shabbos in the two chambers of the heart, and from there the evil inclination, which is the profanation of Shabbos, is cleared away. 'An everlasting covenant'—this is the righteous one, upon whom both dwell, one to fill him and one to be filled from him."

[458] **Zohar II 123a, Mishpatim** — "What is the mouth? Knowledge is hidden in the King's mouth, which is called Tiferes, the extension of Tiferes in which all treasures and all colors are united, as it is written: 'Through knowledge the chambers are filled.' That knowledge is hidden in the King's mouth and fills all chambers and porticoes. When its illumination awakens and comes forth, it is called 'the mouth of Hashem.' The lips, the two lights from Father and Mother, when they meet in that illumination of knowledge, join together, and words are decreed in truth, with wisdom, understanding, and knowledge." The source explicitly links concealed knowledge with its emergence as true speech. Rav Tzadok uses that movement in explaining 'My Lord, open my lips.'

ראש חדש אדר, מאמר ב׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Bais

In the Gemara (Taanis 29a): בִּגְמָרָא [תַּעֲנִית כט, א] **just as from when Av enters** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁמִּשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אָב מְמַעֲטִין **we diminish in joy,** בְּשִׂמְחָה מֵרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה **so from when Adar enters we increase in joy.** כָּךְ מִשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אֲדָר וּבְסֵפֶר **And in Sefer Yetzirah it is stated** יְצִירָה אִיתָא **that the month of Adar was formed** דְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **with the letter Kuf, and the month of Av with the letter Tes.** וְחֹדֶשׁ אָב בְּאוֹת ט׳ וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And it is stated in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב קנב, א) **(II 152a):** טֵית נְהִירוּ דְּחַיִּין **Tes is the light of life** בְּכָל אֲתַר **in every place,** ק׳ לָא מִתְיַישְׁבָא כְּלָל **and with it the verse opened:** וְעַל דָּא פָּתַח בָּהּ קְרָא **"that it was good," etc.** כִּי טוֹב וְכוּלֵי **Kuf does not settle at all** בְּדוּכְתָּא בְּעָלְמָא **in any place in the world,** וְסִימָנָךְ **and your sign is:** אִישׁ לָשׁוֹן בַּל יִכּוֹן בָּאָרֶץ[459] **"A man of slanderous tongue shall not be established in the land"** [תְּהִלִּים קמ, יב] **(Tehillim 140:12).** וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is as they said** (שָׁם קמח, ב) **(ibid. 148b):** אֵשֶׁת זְנוּנִים כּוּלֵי **"The harlotrous woman," etc.,** וְאָת דִּילָהּ ק׳ **and her letter is Kuf,** אִתְתַּקָּנָא בְּתִקּוּנָא **which is fashioned in the form** דְּאָת ה׳ **of the letter Hei,** כְּגַוְונָא דְּקוֹפָא **like an ape** כּוּלֵי אַצָּל בְּנֵי נָשָׁא[460] **beside human beings, etc.;** וְנִתְפַּשֵּׁט הָרֶגֶל עַד לְמַטָּה **and its leg extends downward** וְאֵין לָהּ קִיּוּם **and it has no permanence.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ וְסִימָנָךְ **And this is what they said, "and your sign is:** אִישׁ לָשׁוֹן בַּל יִכּוֹן **a man of tongue shall not be established,"** שֶׁפָּסוּק זֶה נִדְרָשׁ **for this verse is expounded** עַל הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁאָמַר **about the serpent, who spoke** לָשׁוֹן הָרַע עַל בּוֹרְאוֹ[461] **slander about his Creator** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה כ, א) **(as stated in Bereishis Rabbah 20:1).** וְגַם אִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה **It is also stated in Sefer Yetzirah:** הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בְּשְׂחוֹק **"He crowned the letter Kuf with laughter."** וּשְׂחוֹק הוּא גַּם כֵּן **And laughter, too, is** דָּבָר שֶׁאֵין לוֹ קִיּוּם **something that has no permanence,** כְּעִנְיַן אָמְרָם **as in their saying** (בְּרָכוֹת ז, ב) **(Berachos 7b)** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּצַדִּיקִים בָּרְשָׁע שֶׁהַשָּׁעָה מְשַׂחֶקֶת לוֹ **about a wicked man for whom the hour smiles; which is not so with tzaddikim,** (תַּעֲנִית כא, א) **of whom it is stated (Taanis 21a)** אִיתָא דְּקַיְימָא לֵיהּ שַׁעְתָּא **that the hour stands firm for him.** כִּי בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **For in this world** אֵין מָקוֹם לְהַשְׂחוֹק **there is no place for laughter,** (בְּרָכוֹת לא, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Berachos 31a):** אָסוּר לְאָדָם **It is forbidden for a person** שֶׁיְּמַלֵּא **to fill his mouth with laughter** פִּיו שְׂחוֹק בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **in this world,** [תְּהִלִּים קכו, ב] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 126:2),** אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **"Then our mouth will be filled with laughter."** וְלֹא הֵבִיא **And it did not cite** תְּחִלַּת **the beginning of the verse,** [שָׁם, א] **(ibid. 1),** בְּשׁוּב ה׳ אֶת שִׁיבַת צִיּוֹן **"When Hashem returns the captivity of Zion,"** כִּי גַּם בִּזְמַן הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **because even in the time of the Beis HaMikdash** לֹא הָיָה עוֹד מָקוֹם **there was not yet a place for laughter,** עַד לֶעָתִיד **until the future,** [שָׁם, ב][462] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (ibid. 2),** אָז יֹאמְרוּ בַגּוֹיִם **"Then they will say among the nations,** הִגְדִּיל ה׳ לַעֲשׂוֹת עִם אֵלֶּה **Hashem has done great things with these,"** שֶׁאָז הָיָה הַשִּׂמְחָה **for then the joy will be** בְּתַכְלִית הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשְּׁלֵימוּת **in the ultimate revelation of perfection;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **which is not so in this world,** (בְּרָכוֹת סא, ב) דְּאִיתָא **as it is**

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[459] **Yerushalmi, Berachos 1:6** — "One who reads the Shema in the morning must mention the Exodus from Egypt in Emes VeYatziv. Rabbi says: One must mention kingship in it. Others say: One must mention in it the splitting of the sea and the smiting of the firstborn. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi says: One must mention them all, and must say, 'Rock of Israel and its Redeemer.'" The Yerushalmi lists the specific redemptive events that the blessing should recall. Rav Tzadok identifies the inner disclosure of those events as what must be carried into the prayer that follows.

[460] **Zohar II 52b, Beshalach** — "Then it is written: 'Hashem said to Moshe: Why do you cry to Me?' In the Book of Concealment it was taught: 'To Me' precisely—everything depends on Atika. At that moment the Holy Ancient One was revealed, favor was found in all the upper worlds, and the illumination of everything shone." The source explicitly locates the sea's rescue in the revelation of Atika. Rav Tzadok takes remembrance of that disclosure into the joining of redemption with prayer.

[461] **Mechilta, Beshalach, Shirah 3, on Exodus 15:2** — "Rabbi Eliezer says: From where do you say that a maidservant saw at the sea what Yeshayahu and Yechezkel did not see? ... It is like a mortal king entering a province, surrounded by his guard, mighty men to his right and left, and armies before and behind him. Everyone asks, 'Which one is the king?' because he is flesh and blood like them. But when the Holy One, blessed be He, was revealed at the sea, none needed to ask, 'Which is He?' As soon as they saw Him, they recognized Him, and all opened their mouths and said: 'This is my God, and I shall glorify Him.'" The distinctive point is immediate recognition that issues in song. The corresponding Zohar passage, Beshalach 31:434, within the II 64b overlay, repeats that a maidservant saw what Yechezkel did not see; its exact original has also been retrieved.

[462] **Berachos 7a** — "Rabbi Yochanan said in Rabbi Yosi's name: From where do we know that the Holy One, blessed be He, prays? For it is said: 'I shall bring them to My holy mountain and make them rejoice in the house of My prayer.' It does not say 'their prayer,' but 'My prayer'; from here we learn that the Holy One, blessed be He, prays." The Gemara's expression is the basis of the interpretation transmitted in R. Elimelech's name. Rav Tzadok applies it to the Divine origin of the words that emerge in Israel's prayer.

stated (Berachos 61b): טְחוֹל שׂוֹחֵק **"The spleen laughs."** וְכֵן בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה[463] **And likewise in Sefer Yetzirah** מְיֻחָס הַטְּחוֹל בְּנֶפֶשׁ **the spleen in the soul is attributed** לְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **to the month of Adar.** וְאִיתָא **And it is stated** (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן מח פה, א) **(Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 48, 85a):** עֲצִיבוּ דְּטָחוֹל כּוּלֵי[464] **"The sadness of the spleen," etc.,** שֶׁהָעֲצָבוֹן מִסְּטָרָא דְּטָחוֹל **that sadness comes from the side of the spleen.** וְהַכֹּל אֶחָד **And it is all one,** שֶׁהַשִּׂמְחָה וְהוֹלֵלוּת **for the joy and revelry** שֶׁל יֵצֶר הָרַע **of the yetzer hara** חֶדְוָה דְּחַמְרָא וְנִיאוּפִין[465] **is "the joy of wine and immorality"** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א רב, א) **(Zohar I 202a),** וְיָדוּעַ דְּיֵין **and it is known that wine** תְּחִלָּתוֹ שִׂמְחָה **begins in joy** וְסוֹפוֹ עֶצֶב וְתוּגָה **and ends in sadness and grief.** וּלְפִי הַגְּמָרָא בַּאֲדָר דַּיְיקָא **And according to the Gemara, specifically in Adar** מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה שֶׁל מִצְוָה **we increase in the joy of a mitzvah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] **as it says (Esther 8:16),** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה וְשִׂמְחָה **"The Jews had light and gladness,** וְהַהֵיפֶךְ בְּחֹדֶשׁ אָב **and the opposite in the month of Av.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה **And one may say regarding this** דְּהִנֵּה בֶּאֱמֶת הַחֹדֶשׁ אָב **that in truth the month of Av,** שֶׁנִּוצַר בְּאוֹת ט׳ **which was formed with the letter Tes,** הוּא מִבְּחִינַת אוֹר כִּי טוֹב **is from the aspect of the light "that it was good"** שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּשֵׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית **which was created in the six days of Creation,** שֶׁהוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב **which is the revelation of the light "that it was good"** בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **in the Written Torah,** שֶׁעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז חֲמִשָּׁה פְּעָמִים אוֹר **to which allude the five times "light" is said** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ג, ה) **(as stated in Bereishis Rabbah 3:5).** רַק מִפְּנֵי שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה הָעוֹלָם כְּדַאי **But because the world was not worthy,** נִגְנַז אוֹתוֹ הָאוֹר **that light was hidden.** וְכֵן חֹדֶשׁ אָב **And likewise the month of Av** הָיָה מוּכָן **was intrinsically prepared** לְהִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר הַזֶּה **for the revelation of this light,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כְּבָר **as we have already said** מֵאַן דְּאָמַר כָּל הַחֹדֶשׁ **regarding the period of diminished joy in Av,** עַל זְמַן מִיעוּט הַשִּׂמְחָה בְּאָב **that there is an opinion: the whole month;** וְאִיכָּא לְמֵאן דְּאָמַר **and there is an opinion:** מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ עַד הַתַּעֲנִית **from Rosh Chodesh until the fast;** וְאִיכָּא לְמֵאן דְּאָמַר כָּל הַשַּׁבָּת **and there is an opinion: the whole week;** וּשְׁלָשְׁתָּן מִקְרָא אֶחָד דָּרְשׁוּ **and all three expounded one verse:** וְהִשְׁבַּתִּי כָּל מְשׂוֹשָׂהּ **"And I will put an end to all her rejoicing,** חַגָּהּ חָדְשָׁהּ וְשַׁבַּתָּהּ **her festival, her new moon and her Sabbath"** [הוֹשֵׁעַ ב, יג] **(Hoshea 2:13),** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּגְמָרָא **as they said in the Gemara** (תַּעֲנִית כט, ב) **(Taanis 29b).** וְעַל כָּל פָּנִים **In any event,** הֵיכָן נִרְמָז **where is it hinted** שֶׁהֶחָג וְהַחֹדֶשׁ וְהַשַּׁבָּת **that the festival, the new moon and the Sabbath** קָאֵי עַל אָב דַּיְיקָא **refer specifically to Av?** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהָעִיקָּר **And we said that the main point** מִמַּה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר כָּל מְשׂוֹשָׂהּ **is from what it says, "all her rejoicing,"** שֶׁהוּא מְרַמֵּז דַּיְיקָא **which alludes specifically** עַל חֹדֶשׁ אָב **to the month of Av,** שֶׁהָיָה מוּכָן בְּעֶצֶם **which was intrinsically prepared** לִבְחִינַת הַמָּשׂוֹשׂ **for the aspect of rejoicing** וְהִתְגַּלּוּת הָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב **and the revelation of the light "that it was good"** בְּרֵאשִׁית הַבְּרִיאָה **at the beginning of Creation.** אָמְנָם לְאַחַר **However, after the corruption,** נַעֲשָׂה טוּבִיהּ גְּנִיז בְּגַוֵּיהּ **"its good became hidden within it,"** וְזֶהוּ הָעִנְיָן הַקִּלְקוּל **and this is why we diminish in joy:** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא בְּהֶסְתֵּר וּבְהִתְכַּסּוּת **because it is in hiddenness and concealment** עַד עֵת קֵץ לְעָתִיד לָבוֹא **until the time of the End, in the future to come.** וְעִנְיַן חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **And the matter of the month of Adar** הוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת הָאֲרַת **is the revelation of the illumination** שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה תּוֹרָה **of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **to which alludes what it says,** הָיְתָה אוֹרָה זוֹ תּוֹרָה **"There was light" — this is Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִילָּה טז, ב) **(as stated in Megillah 16b),** בְּלְשׁוֹן נְקֵבָה **in the feminine form,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל שֶׁמִּקַּבֶּלֶת מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **which receives from the Written Torah;** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of the Oral Torah,** הָאֲרַת **which alludes to the illumination** בִּימֵי דַּהֲדַר קִבְּלוּהָ עֲלֵיהֶם **for they accepted it upon themselves anew** אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ מֵאַהֲבַת הַנֵּס **in the days of Achashverosh out of love for the miracle** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א) **(as explained in Maamar 1).** שֶׁעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז **To this alludes** בְּרֹב חָכְמָה רָב כָּעַס **"In much wisdom is much**

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[463] **R. Elimelech of Lizhensk, as quoted in Pri Tzaddik, Vayeishev 3** — "Our master R. Elimelech explained 'if my prayer is fluent' as an expression of sending: God sent the prayer into his mouth. This is what the Gemara says: 'In the house of My prayer'—from here we learn that the Holy One, blessed be He, prays; namely, within the mouths of Israel, for He sends the prayer into their mouths. These are his holy words." This earlier passage preserves Rav Tzadok's explicit report of the teaching and supplies the verbal interpretation of shegurah as 'sent.' It is a documented transmission in R. Elimelech's name; no unsupported chapter reference in Noam Elimelech is assigned.

[464] **Berachos 4b** — "Rabbi Yochanan said: Who is a person of the World to Come? One who joins redemption to the evening prayer. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi says: They instituted the prayers between the two recitations of Shema."

[465] **Tosafos, Kesubos 103b, s.v. Mezuman** — "'Destined for life in the World to Come'—this is difficult: do not all Israel have a share in the World to Come? Rabbi Meir explained that wherever it says 'destined for life in the World to Come,' it means without judgment and without suffering." Tosafos distinguishes this special assurance from the general promise of a share. Rav Tzadok notes that its answer concerns 'destined,' then explains the different expression 'a person of the World to Come' as a present apprehension of future light.

vexation" [קֹהֶלֶת א, יח] **(Koheles 1:18):** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָרוֹב כַּעַס **that through the great vexation** שֶׁל הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע דְּיֵיקָא **specifically of the yetzer hara** בָּאוּ לְרוֹב חָכְמָה **they came to abundant wisdom** פֶּה שֶׁל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל **of the Oral Torah.** וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן **And this is the matter** שֶׁנּוֹצַר הַחֹדֶשׁ בְּאוֹת ק׳ **of the month being formed with the letter Kuf,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **in the manner of what they said** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא נח, א) **(Bava Basra 58a):** אָדָם בִּפְנֵי שְׁכִינָה **Adam before the Shechinah** כְּקוֹף בִּבְנֵי אָדָם **was like an ape before human beings.** וְהוּא שֶׁעַל זֶה נִבְרָא הָאָדָם דְּיֵיקָא **And this is the very purpose for which man was created:** לַעֲשׂוֹת מַעֲשָׂיו כְּקוֹף **to do his deeds like an ape,** לִהְיוֹתָם דּוֹמִים כְּבָיכוֹל **so that they resemble, as it were,** לְמַעֲשֵׂה הַשְּׁכִינָה **the deeds of the Shechinah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה בְּחוּקֹתַי לה, ג; יְרוּשַׁלְמִי רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה פֶּרֶק א הֲלָכָה ג ז, ב) **(Yerushalmi Rosh Hashanah 1:3, 7b; Vayikra Rabbah, Bechukosai 35:3)** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְקַיֵּים וּמְשַׁמֵּר **that the Holy One, blessed be He, fulfills and keeps** מִצְוֹתָיו שֶׁל תּוֹרָה תְּחִלָּה[466] **the mitzvos of the Torah first,** וְכִמְפוֹרָשׁ בְּטַעַם מִצְוַת שַׁבָּת **and as is explicit in the reason for the mitzvah of Shabbos:** כִּי שֵׁשֶׁת יָמִים וְגוֹמֵר **"For in six days," etc.,** וַיָּנַח וְגוֹמֵר **"and He rested," etc.,** עַל כֵּן בֵּרַךְ וְגוֹמֵר **"therefore He blessed," etc.** [שְׁמוֹת כ, יא] **(Shemos 20:11).** וְאִיתָא **And it is stated** (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא בְּרֵאשִׁית ב מִשְּׁאִילְתּוֹת) **(Midrash Tanchuma, Bereishis 2, from the She'iltos):** נוּחוּ מִמְּלַאכְתְּכֶם בְּיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **"Rest on the day of Shabbos,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנַּחְתִּי אֲנִי[467] **just as I rested on it."** [דְּבָרִים כח, ט] וּכְתִיב **And it is written (Devarim 28:9),** וְהָלַכְתָּ בִּדְרָכָיו וְגוֹמֵר **"And you shall walk in His ways," etc.,** וְאִיתָא (בְּרָכוֹת ו, א) **and it is stated (Berachos 6a):** מִנַּיִן שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מֵנִיחַ תְּפִילִּין[468] כּוּלֵי **"From where do we know that the Holy One, blessed be He, puts on tefillin," etc.** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת קד, א) **And about this they said (Shabbos 104a):** קוֹף קָדוֹשׁ[469] **"Kuf — holy."** וְהִנֵּה זֶה הָיָה גַּם כֵּן **Now this was also** עֲצַת הַנָּחָשׁ **the serpent's counsel:** וִהְיִיתֶם כֵּאלֹהִים **"And you will be like God,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, ה] יוֹדְעֵי טוֹב וָרָע **knowing good and evil" (Bereishis 3:5) —** שֶׁדַּיְיקָא עַל יְדֵי שֶׁיֹּאכְלוּ **that specifically by eating** מֵעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע **from the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil** יוּכְלוּ לְהִתְדַּמּוֹת יוֹתֵר לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **they could resemble Hashem Yisbarach more,** לְהַגִּיעַ עַל יְדֵי זֶה **to reach thereby** לְמַדְרֵגָה גְּדוֹלָה **a great level:** לִהְיוֹת בּוֹחֵר בַּטּוֹב **to be choosing the good** וּמוֹאֵס בָּרָע לְדַעְתּוֹ **and rejecting the evil by his own understanding.** וּבֶאֱמֶת יֵשׁ בָּזֶה עֵסֶק גָּדוֹל **And in truth there is great substance in this,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as is stated in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב קפד, א) **(II 184a):** דְּלֵית נְהוֹרָא **There is no light** אֶלָּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא **except that which emerges from within darkness.** וְהוּא דַּיְיקָא הִתְגַּלּוּת **And this is precisely the revelation** אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of the light of the Oral Torah** עַל יְדֵי הַחֲשֵׁכוּת **through the darkness,** [יְשַׁעְיָה ט, א] וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **and about this it says (Yeshayahu 9:1),** הָעָם הַהֹלְכִים בַּחֹשֶׁךְ **"The people that walk in darkness** רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל **have seen a great light,"** (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as**

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[466] **Berachos 17a** — "May you see your world in your lifetime, and may your end be life in the World to Come, your hope for every generation. May your heart meditate understanding, your mouth speak wisdom, and your tongue utter songs. ... May your eyes shine with the light of Torah and your face radiate like the brightness of the firmament; may your lips express knowledge, your innermost parts rejoice in uprightness, and your steps run to hear the words of the Ancient of Days." This blessing distinguishes seeing one's world during life from one's final life in the World to Come. Its conjunction of understanding, speech, song, and the Ancient of Days particularly illuminates Rav Tzadok's present interpretation.

[467] **Zohar III 118a, Bamidbar** — "Rejoice with Jerusalem: for joy is found only when Israel stand in the Holy Land. There the wife is joined with her husband, and then there is the joy of all, joy above and below. When Israel are not in the Holy Land, a person is forbidden to rejoice and display joy, for it is written, Rejoice with Jerusalem and exult in her—in her, specifically. Rabbi Abba saw a man rejoicing in a place of festivity in Bavel and rebuked him: It is written, Rejoice with Jerusalem; when Jerusalem is in joy, a person should rejoice. Rabbi Elazar explained 'Rejoice with Jerusalem' as 'Serve Hashem with joy.'" The Zohar speaks of the complete joy of restored union. Rav Tzadok reads the attained inward knowledge that is 'as though the Temple were built' as a present participation in that restoration.

[468] **Zohar I 123a, Chayei Sarah** — "'One hundred years' is the inclusion of everything: the Holy One, blessed be He, included from the supernal place, concealed beyond all concealment, in one hundred, in the mystery of the hundred blessings of every day. Likewise 'twenty years'; therefore it is written 'year,' the mystery of union, for Thought and Jubilee never separate." The numerical completeness of one hundred, which is also kuf's value, is explicit in the source. Rav Tzadok relates that completeness to the concealed crown's disclosure and to the letter governing Adar's laughter.

[469] **Zohar I 132a, Chayei Sarah** — "'Hear my prayer, Hashem'—because this is the level that receives all the prayers of the world. We have learned that it makes from them a crown and places it upon the head of the righteous one, the life of the worlds, as it is written: 'Blessings are upon the head of the righteous.' Therefore: 'Hear my prayer, Hashem.'" The source explicitly joins the gathering of prayers, a crown, and the head of the righteous one. Its further identification with Atika is Rav Tzadok's reading of that image.

they said (Tanchuma Noach 3) דְּקָאֵי עַל חַכְמֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that it refers to the sages of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁלָּהֶם נִגְלָה **to whom was revealed** אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּגְנַז **the primordial light that was hidden.** וְהוּא בֵּירוּר בְּחִינַת **And this is the refinement of the aspect** עֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע כַּיָּדוּעַ **of the Tree of Knowledge of Good and Evil, as is known,** וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **while the Written Torah** הוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת עֵץ הַחַיִּים **is the revelation of the Tree of Life.** וְעַל זֶה רָמְזוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **And to this our Sages, of blessed memory, alluded:** מְשֻׁנְּכָנָס אֲדָר מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה **"From when Adar enters we increase in joy,"** הַיְינוּ שֶׁבָּא הִתְרַבּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה בַּלֵּב **meaning that an increase of joy comes into the heart** מִבְּחִינַת אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק **from the aspect of "Light is sown for the tzaddik,** וּלְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **and for the upright in heart, gladness"** [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] **(Tehillim 97:11).** וְצַדִּיק יְסוּד עוֹלָם **And a tzaddik, as is known,** שֶׁהוּא גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ **is the mighty one who conquers his inclination;** דַּיְיקָא מִזֶּה הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ בַּלֵּב **specifically from this the light is sown in the heart,** עַד שֶׁבָּא לְהִתְרַבּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **until it comes to an increase of joy,** [שָׁם, יב] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (ibid. 12),** שִׂמְחוּ צַדִּיקִים בַּה׳ **"Rejoice, tzaddikim, in Hashem."** וְאָמְרוּ **(**תַּעֲנִית טו, א**) And they said (Taanis 15a):** צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה **"Tzaddikim to light,** וְיִשָּׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה **and the upright to joy";** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁמַּכְנִיעִין **meaning that by subduing** הַלֵּב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ **the foolish heart on his left,** נִתְרַבֶּה וְנִזְרָע הָאָרָה בַּלֵּב **illumination increases and is sown in the heart,** עַד שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה הַלֵּב יָשָׁר **until the heart becomes upright,** שֶׁגַּם הַלֵּב כְּסִיל **so that even the foolish heart** נִתְהַפֵּךְ לְטוֹב **is transformed to good,** וְאָז בָּאִים לְהִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **and then they come to the revelation of joy:** לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה[470] **"for the upright in heart, gladness."** וְזֶה עִנְיַן חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **And this is the matter of the month of Adar,** הַבָּא אַחַר חֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט **which comes after the month of Shevat,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳ **which was formed with the letter Tzadi;** וְהַיְינוּ גְּמַר הַתִּיקּוּן **and this is the completion of the rectification** שֶׁל שׁוֹבָבִי״ם **of Shovavim,** הַבָּא מִבְּחִינַת צַדִּיק **which comes from the aspect of the tzaddik** הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ כַּיָּדוּעַ **who conquers his inclination, as is known,** שֶׁזֶּהוּ שְׁלֵימוּת הַתִּיקּוּן **for this is the completion of the rectification** שֶׁל קְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית **of the holiness of the covenant;** וּמִזֶּה בָּאִים לְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **and from this they come to the month of Adar,** שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **which becomes "for the upright in heart, gladness."** וְזֶהוּ מַרְבִּין **And this is "we increase":** שֶׁנִּתְרַבֶּה הַשִּׂמְחָה **that joy increases** עַל יְדֵי הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק **through the light sown for the tzaddik,** שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה מֵהִתְגַּלּוּת כֹּחַ **which comes from the revelation of the power** פֶּה הָאֲרַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of the illumination of the Oral Torah,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וְעַל זֶה יֵשׁ לִרְמֹז **And to this one can relate** עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (מְגִילָּה יג, ב) **what they said (Megillah 13b):** כֵּיוָן שֶׁנָּפַל פּוּר בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **When the lot fell on the month of Adar,** שָׂמַח שִׂמְחָה גְּדוֹלָה[471] **he rejoiced greatly.** אָמַר נָפַל לִי פּוּר **He said: The lot fell for me** בַּיֶּרַח שֶׁמֵּת מֹשֶׁה **in the month in which Moshe died.** וְלֹא הָיָה יוֹדֵעַ כּוּלֵי **But he did not know, etc.,** וּבְשִׁבְעָה בַּאֲדָר נוֹלַד **that on the seventh of Adar he was born.** וְהַיְינוּ כִּי בְּחִינַת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **That is, the aspect of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** הוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר כִּי טוֹב **is the revelation of the light "that it was good"** מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **from the Written Torah,** [שְׁמוֹת ב, ב] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Shemos 2:2),** וַתֵּרֶא אוֹתוֹ כִּי טוֹב הוּא **"And she saw him that he was good,"** (סוֹטָה יב, א) וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (Sotah 12a)** שֶׁכְּשֶׁנּוֹלַד **that when he was born** נִתְמַלֵּא הַבַּיִת כּוּלּוֹ אוֹר[472] **the whole house filled with light.** וּכְשֶׁרָאָה הָמָן **And when Haman saw** שֶׁמֵּת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בַּאֲדָר **that Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, died in Adar,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁנִּגְנַז הָאוֹר **meaning that the light** שֶׁבִּכְתָב תּוֹרָה שֶׁל **of the Written Torah was**

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[470] **Otiyos DeRabbi Akiva, version I, letter kuf** — "Kuf—this is Moshe, father of the sages, father of all the prophets. Father of all the sages, who set before Pharaoh every matter of wisdom, understanding, counsel, knowledge, and discernment in seventy languages. Seventy scribes wrote in seventy languages, and every document stood before Pharaoh the wicked. When they saw Moshe and Aharon, resembling ministering angels, ... with the staff of God in their hand and the explicit Name engraved upon it, ... fear and trembling immediately fell upon them." The original alphabet Midrash is preserved in Otzar Midrashim, New York 1915. Rav Tzadok attends to the play between kuf and hikif, surrounding or encompassing, and reads Moshe's wisdom as encompassing Pharaoh's.

[471] **Zohar II 34a, Bo** — "Rabbi Shimon said: Now mysteries must be revealed, bound above and below. Why is it written, 'Come to Pharaoh'? It should have said, 'Go to Pharaoh.' What is 'come'? The Holy One, blessed be He, brought him, chamber after chamber, to one powerful supernal serpent from which many levels extend. What is it? The mystery of the great serpent." The source presents the encounter as entering successive chambers toward the great serpent. The marginal identification of that serpent with Arich of the kelippah, quoted alongside it, is the background to Rav Tzadok's description of Moshe's encompassing wisdom.

[472] **Gloss to Zohar II 34a, preserved in Mikdash Melekh** — "'One supernal serpent'—note: Arich of the kelippah." The exact short gloss is preserved in the Zholkva 1864 text, marked as a marginal note. Rav Tzadok attributes it to R. Chaim Vital. It identifies the level assigned to the great serpent; the maamar develops its opposition to Moshe's encompassing wisdom.

hidden, חָשַׁב בְּדַעְתּוֹ **he thought to himself** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִהְיֶה בְּכֹחוֹ לְהִתְגַּבֵּר **that through this he would have the power to prevail.** וְלֹא יָדַע שֶׁזֶּה דַּיְקָא **But he did not know that this precisely** הָיָה סִיבָּה לְהִתְגַּלּוּת **was the cause for the revelation** הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק **of the light sown for the tzaddik** מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **from the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בֶּאֱמֶת בִּפּוֹעַל **as indeed actually happened:** בְּעֵת פְּטִירַת מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **at the time of the passing of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** הִתְנוֹצֵץ תֵּיכֶף **there immediately sparkled forth** הִתְגַּלּוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the revelation of the Oral Torah** עַל יְדֵי עָתְנִיאֵל בֶּן קְנַז[473] **through Osniel ben Kenaz,** הוּא יַעְבֵּץ **who is Yaavetz,** שֶׁהֶחֱזִיר הַהֲלָכוֹת שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּכְּחוּ **who restored the halachos that had been forgotten** מִתּוֹךְ פִּילְפּוּלוֹ[474] **through his dialectic reasoning** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תְּמוּרָה טז, א) **(as stated in Temurah 16a).** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁבִּשְׁבִיעָה בַּאֲדָר נוֹלַד **And this is "on the seventh of Adar he was born":** הֵינוּ אָז דַּיְקָא נוֹלַד **precisely then was born** הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק **the light sown for the tzaddik,** לָבוֹא מִזֶּה **to come from it** לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **to "for the upright in heart, gladness," as mentioned above.** וּכְדְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **As stated in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב קסו, ב) **(II 166b):** דְּהַאי אוֹר וְכוּ' **"This light," etc.,** וְאוֹלִיד וְאַצְמַח וְכוּ' **"and it bore and sprouted," etc.,** וְעָבִיד אִיבִּין וְכוּ' **"and produced fruit," etc.** וְהֵינוּ עִנְיַן כֹּחַ הִתְרַבּוּת **And this is the power of the increase** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of the Oral Torah** בִּנְפָשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל עַד אֵין שִׁעוּר **in the souls of Yisrael without limit,** מִכֹּחַ הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ **by force of the sown light;** וְנַעֲשֶׂה מִזֶּה יַשְׁרוּת לֵב **and from this comes uprightness of heart,** לְהוֹלִיד מִזֶּה הַשִּׂמְחָה וְהַשְּׂחוֹק **to give birth from it to joy and laughter.** וְעַל זֶה דַּיְקָא מְסוּגָּל הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה **And for this precisely is this month suited,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בִּשְׂחוֹק **which was formed with laughter,** לִהְיוֹת נִתְרַבֶּה הַשִּׂמְחָה **that joy should increase** בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **all the more, as mentioned above.**

And what they said (Berachos 31a): וּמַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת לא, א) **It is forbidden for a person to fill his mouth with laughter** אָסוּר לְאָדָם שֶׁיְּמַלֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו **in this world,** בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **from the verse** מִקְּרָא דְּאָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **"Then our mouth will be filled with laughter" —** מַשְׁמַע **this implies even in the joy of a mitzvah,** אֲפִילּוּ בְּשִׂמְחָה שֶׁל מִצְוָה **for this verse** בְּשׁוּב ה' אֶת שִׁיבַת צִיּוֹן כְּתִיב **is written about "When Hashem returns the captivity of Zion";** וְכָל הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת שֶׁנִּתְקַבְּעוּ לְשִׂמְחָה **and all the festivals that were established for joy** הָיוּ זֵכֶר לִיצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם **were a remembrance of the Exodus from Egypt,** וּגְאוּלָּה הָעֲתִידָה **while the future redemption** וְיִהְיֶה אָז שִׂמְחָה רַבָּה שֶׁל מִצְוָה[475] **is much greater,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שָׁם יג, א) **as they said (ibid. 13a),** מַשְׁמַע **and then there will be great joy of mitzvah,** וְרַק אָז יִמָּלֵא וְגוֹמֵר **and only then "will be filled," etc.** וְכֵן מַשְׁמַע **This implies that in this world,** דְּבָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אֲפִילּוּ בְּשִׂמְחַת מִצְוָה לֹא **even in the joy of a mitzvah, no.**

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[473] **Midrash Tehillim 107:4** — "Rabbi Abahu son of Rabbi Acha said in the name of our master: Thus Israel were placed within Egypt like a fetus placed within the innards of an animal. Just as the shepherd puts his hand into its innards and draws it out, so did the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is said, 'to take for Himself a nation from the midst of a nation.'" The same simile appears in Midrash Tehillim 114:3, in Rabbi Abba bar Acha's name in Rabbi Chanin's name: "Like a person who draws the fetus out from an animal's womb." Rav Tzadok himself cites this simile elsewhere from Shocher Tov 107 (Resisei Layla; Divrei Soferim). Pesikta Rabbasi 15 (HaChodesh), like Pesikta deRav Kahana 5:11, expounds the same verse: "these were uncircumcised and those were uncircumcised; these grew forelocks and those grew forelocks." It does not contain the fetal comparison. The Pesikta reference therefore supports the exposition of "a nation from the midst of a nation," and the simile itself comes from Midrash Tehillim.

[474] **Chullin 91a** — "Rav Shmuel bar Acha said before Rav Pappa in Rava bar Ulla's name: He appeared to him as a Torah scholar, for the Master said: One who walks at his teacher's right is an uncultivated person." The discussion asks how Yaakov's assailant stood relative to him. One view says he appeared as a gentile; this view says he appeared as a Torah scholar. Rav Tzadok applies that disguise to evil counsel that presents itself as religious instruction.

[475] Parallel: **R. Shmuel Bornsztain, Shem MiShmuel, Purim, "Shushan Purim," s.v. Inyan perazim umukkafim (digital 4:2–4)** — "My revered father and teacher explained that there are two kinds of evil inclination. One incites a person toward what is forbidden: even though he knows that he has been warned against it, it incites him to transgress Hashem's command. This is 'he appeared to him as a gentile.' Another evil inclination presents reasons that this is permitted, and perhaps even a mitzvah. This is 'he appeared to him as a Torah scholar.' Thus far his words. … It is written, 'A breached city without a wall is a person who has no restraint over his spirit.' A walled place therefore alludes to a person who has restraint over his spirit. This counters the first husk. But against the second husk, which presents reasons that the impure is pure, the wall has no advantage."

Connection: Shem MiShmuel applies the same disguise as a Torah scholar to Purim and Amalek, distinguishing weakness of restraint from a corrupted judgment that represents sin as a mitzvah. His wall image shows why stronger restraint alone cannot answer the latter: a person may be disciplined while obeying a false religious guide. This clarifies the particular need Rav Tzadok identifies for a deeper disclosure that unmasks a concealed root of evil. The parallel illustrates that need without equating Shem MiShmuel's explanation with Rav Tzadok's specific account of Atika.

And so it is implied from what they said in the Gemara מִמַּה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בִּגְמָרָא **afterward (on 31a):** אַחַר כָּךְ [בְּדַף לא, א] **"One may not stand to pray," etc.,** אֵין עוֹמְדִין לְהִתְפַּלֵּל וְכוּ׳ **"amid laughter," etc.,** מִתּוֹךְ שְׂחוֹק וְכוּ׳ **but only amid the joy of a mitzvah" —** אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שִׂמְחָה שֶׁל מִצְוָה[476] **which also implies** מַשְׁמַע גַּם כֵּן דְּשְׂחוֹק אֲפִילּוּ שֶׁל מִצְוָה **that laughter, even of a mitzvah, no. And in this language it is stated** וְכַלְשׁוֹן הַזֶּה אִיתָא (שַׁבָּת ל, ב) **(Shabbos 30b):** **"The Shechinah does not rest," etc.,** שֶׁאֵין שְׁכִינָה שׁוֹרָה כו׳[477] **"not amid laughter," etc.,** לֹא מִתּוֹךְ שְׂחוֹק כו׳ **"but amid a matter of joy of a mitzvah";** אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ דָּבָר שִׂמְחָה שֶׁל מִצְוָה **and there Rashi explains** וְשָׁם פֵּירֵשׁ רַשִׁ״י [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל שְׂחוֹק] **(s.v. Sechok)** דַּאֲפִילּוּ אֵינוֹ שְׂחוֹק שֶׁל לֵיצָנוּת **that even if it is not laughter of frivolity, because the mind of one who laughs** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵין דַּעַת שׂוֹחֵק מְיוּשֶּׁבֶת עָלָיו[478] **is not settled upon him. And it appears that he explained this in Shabbos** וְנִרְאֶה מַה שֶּׁפֵּירֵשׁ זֶה בְּשַׁבָּת וְלֹא בִּבְרָכוֹת שָׁם **and not in Berachos there because there we would know it on our own** מִשּׁוּם דְּשָׁם נֵדַע מֵעַצְמֵינוּ מִמַּה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם **from what they said there just before that statement:** מֵימָרָא הָךְ דְּאָסוּר שֶׁיְּמַלֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **that it is forbidden to fill one's mouth with laughter in this world from the verse cited above,** מִקְּרָא הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **which implies that even of a mitzvah** דְּמַשְׁמַע אֲפִילּוּ שֶׁל מִצְוָה **it is forbidden to fill one's mouth with laughter in this world, even in the joy of the festivals** אָסוּר לְמַלֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְאַף בְּשִׂמְחַת הַמּוֹעֲדִים שֶׁעַל הַנִּסִּים **which commemorate the miracles, until the future, when "our mouth will be filled with laughter"** עַד לֶעָתִיד שֶׁאָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ עַל הַנִּסִּים שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אָז[479] **over the miracles that will happen then.** וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא (בְּרָכוֹת ט, ב) **Now it is stated (Berachos 9b)** וְשָׁמַעְתָּ בְּרַב בְּרוּנָא **about Rav Bruna** דְּאָדָם גָּדוֹל הוּא **that he was a great man and one who rejoiced in mitzvos;** בְּמִצְוֹת זִימְנָא חָדָא **once** סָמַךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִתְפִלָּה **he juxtaposed Geulah to Tefillah, and laughter did not cease from his mouth** וְלֹא פָסִיק חוּכָא מִפּוּמֵיהּ כּוּלָּא יוֹמָא[480] **the entire day.** וְחוּכָא הוּא שְׂחוֹק **And "chuka" is laughter, and the expression "laughter did not cease from his mouth"** וּלְשׁוֹן לֹא פָסִיק חוּכָא מִפּוּמֵיהּ מַשְׁמַע דְּמִילֵּא פִּיו שְׂחוֹק **implies that he filled his mouth with laughter, and this contradicts what we said.** וְזֶה נֶגֶד מַה שֶּׁאָמַרְנוּ **But see there** אֲבָל עַיֵּין שָׁם **that it says he was one who rejoiced in mitzvos, and it related only this.** דְּקָאָמַר דְּשָׂמֵחַ בְּמִצְוֹת הוּא וְלֹא סִיֵּיפִי אֶלָּא זֶה **And why specifically at the time of juxtaposing Geulah to Tefillah?** וּמַהוּ דַּוְקָא בְּעֵת סְמִיכַת גְּאוּלָּה לִתְפִלָּה **One may say regarding this, based on what they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב קנו, א) **(II 156a)** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **on the verse "And as for me, my prayer," etc.** [תְּהִלִּים סט, יד] **(Tehillim 69:14):** **"And I" — this is King David,** וַאֲנִי דָּא דָּוִד מַלְכָּא **the place that is called Geulah;** אֲתַר דְּאִקְרֵי גְּאוּלָּה **"my prayer" — this is prayer, etc.;** תְּפִלָּתִי דָּא תְּפִלָּה כו׳ **when he juxtaposes Geulah to Tefillah,** כַּד אִיהוּ סָמֵךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִתְפִלָּה כְּדֵין אִיהוּ עֵת רָצוֹן[481] כו׳ **then it is a time of favor, etc. And this is along the lines of what they said** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת לא,

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[476] **Deuteronomy 32:6** — "Is this how you repay the Lord, foolish and unwise people? Is He not your Father who acquired you? He made you and established you."

[477] **Psalms 149:2** — "Let Israel rejoice in its Maker; let the children of Zion exult in their King."

[478] Parallel: **R. Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Tanya, Likkutei Amarim 33:4–6** — "When a person considers this deeply, his heart rejoices and his soul exults, even singing out with all his heart, soul and strength in this faith, for it is actual closeness to God. This is the whole purpose of man and of the creation of all the upper and lower worlds: that He should have this dwelling below. How great is the joy of an ordinary person of low station when a flesh-and-blood king draws near and comes to lodge and live with him in his house! How infinitely more so when the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed be He, draws near and dwells with him. This is why we praise and thank Him every morning: 'Fortunate are we; how good is our portion … and how beautiful our inheritance.' As one rejoices over an enormous inheritance for which he did not toil, so, infinitely more, should we rejoice over our forefathers' bequest: God's true unity, that even here below there is nothing besides Him."

Connection: Tanya makes the transition from accepting kingship to joy concrete: recognizing the King's nearness is itself a privilege that gives joy, even before measuring one's accomplishments. Rav Tzadok locates this joy in Israel's bond to its divine root. The analogy and the inherited character of this bond explain why the heavenly yoke can produce exultation rather than the burden associated here with human rule.

[479] **Berakhot 30b** — "Abaye was sitting before Rabbah, who saw that he was very cheerful. He said, 'But it is written, 'Rejoice with trembling'!' He answered, 'I am wearing tefillin.' Rabbi Yirmeyah was sitting before Rabbi Zeira, who saw that he was very cheerful. He said, 'But it is written, 'In all toil there is gain'!' He answered, 'I am wearing tefillin.'" The Gemara gives two encounters. Rav Tzadok reads the shared reply as recognition of the divine sovereignty and attachment represented by tefillin.

[480] **Psalms 100:2-3** — "Serve the Lord with joy; come before Him with song. Know that the Lord is God: He made us, and we are His—His people and the flock of His pasture." The written consonants in verse 3 give ve-lo with aleph, "and not we"; the traditional reading gives ve-lo with vav, "and we are His." Rav Tzadok develops the two spellings together.

ב) **(Shabbos 31b):** לֹא בָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֶת עוֹלָמוֹ **The Holy One, blessed be He, created His world** אֶלָּא כְּדֵי וְהָאֱלֹהִים עָשָׂה[482] שֶׁיִּירְאוּ מִלְּפָנָיו **only so that they should fear Him,** [קֹהֶלֶת ג, יד] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Koheles 3:14),** **"And God has made it** שֶׁיִּירְאוּ מִלְּפָנָיו **so that they should fear Him."** וּבְמָקוֹם אַחֵר **And elsewhere** (אָבוֹת ו, יב) **(Avos 6:12):** כָּל מַה שֶּׁבָּרָא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּעוֹלָמוֹ **Everything the Holy One, blessed be He, created in His world** לֹא בְרָאוֹ אֶלָּא לִכְבוֹדוֹ[483] **He created only for His glory,** [יְשַׁעְיָה מג, ז] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Yeshayahu 43:7),** וְלִכְבוֹדִי בְּרָאתִיו וְגוֹמֵר **"And for My glory I created him," etc.** (שׁוֹחֵר טוֹב תְּהִלִּים קמח) וְגַם אָמְרוּ **And they also said (Shocher Tov, Tehillim 148):** כֹּל בַּעֲבוּר ה׳ לְמַעֲנֵהוּ **"Hashem made everything for His sake"** [מִשְׁלֵי טז, ד] **(Mishlei 16:4) —** וְכוּלֵי[484] בָּרָא לִהְיוֹת מְקַלְסִין לְפָנָיו **He created them to be singing praise before Him, etc.** וְהֵם שְׁנֵי עִנְיָנִים הָאֵלּוּ **And these are the two matters of** סְמִיכַת גְּאוּלָה לִתְפִלָּה **juxtaposing Geulah to Tefillah:** כִּי גְּאוּלָה הִיא עִנְיַן **for Geulah is the matter of** הַקִּילּוּס וְהַשֶּׁבַח **the praise and acclaim** שֶׁנּוֹתֵן הָאָדָם לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **that a person gives to Hashem Yisbarach** עַל כָּל מַעֲשָׂיו וְנִפְלְאוֹתָיו **for all His works and wonders,** וְהוּא עִנְיַן סִידּוּר וְהַיְינוּ **and it is the arranging of the praise of the Omnipresent** קוֹדֶם הַתְּפִלָּה **before prayer,** שִׁבְחוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם **that is, in the praises of King David,** בְּשִׁבְחֵי דָּוִד מַלְכָּא דְּהוּא אֲתַר דְּאִקְרֵי גְּאוּלָה **who is the place called Geulah;** שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה כָּל עִנְיָנוֹ **for this was his whole matter** בְּסֵפֶר תְּהִלִּים **in Sefer Tehillim,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא נְעִים זְמִירוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל **for he is called "the sweet singer of Israel"** [שְׁמוּאֵל ב כג, א] **(II Shmuel 23:1),** שֶׁהוּא הָיָה הַשָּׁלִיחַ צִבּוּר **since he was the shliach tzibbur** מִכְּלַל יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּזֶה **of Klal Yisrael in this.** וּמִזֶּה בָּאִים לִתְפִלָּה **And from this they come to prayer,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת הַיִּרְאָה מִלְּפָנָיו **which is the aspect of fear before Him,** (בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם) כְּמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ **as they expounded (Berachos ibid.):** [תְּהִלִּים עב, ה] יִירָאוּךָ עִם שֶׁמֶשׁ[485] **"They shall fear You with the sun" (Tehillim 72:5) —** עַל תְּפִלָּה עִם הָנֵץ הַחַמָּה **about praying at sunrise;** (שָׁם י, ב) וְכֵן **and likewise (ibid. 10b):** אַל יִמְנַע עַצְמוֹ מִן הָרַחֲמִים[486] **"One should not hold himself back from pleading for mercy,"** [קֹהֶלֶת ה, ו] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Koheles 5:6),** כִּי אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים יְרָא **"But fear God" —** דָּרְשׁוּ יְרָא עַל תְּפִלָּה **they expounded "fear" as referring to prayer.** וּסְמִיכַת שְׁנֵי הָעִנְיָנִים **And the juxtaposition of the two matters** הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל **mentioned above** הֲמָה עִיקַּר תַּכְלִית **are the essential purpose** מְכוּוָּן הַבְּרִיאָה **intended in Creation,** שֶׁהָיָה לִכְבוֹדוֹ **which was for His glory** וְלַיִרְאָה מִלְּפָנָיו **and for fear before Him.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמִּזֶּה זוֹכִים לָבֹא **And through this one merits to come** עַד רֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה שֶׁל הַבְּרִיאָה **up to the first thought of Creation,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **which is the aspect of Atika,** וְהוּא מֵעֵין הִתְגַּלּוּת שֶׁל לְעָתִיד **and it is a semblance of the revelation of the future,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא רַעֲוָא דְּרַעֲוִין **called "the Will of Wills";** אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **about which it says,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בּוֹ **"Then our mouth will be filled with laughter."** כִּי תֵּיבַת אָ״ז מְרַמֵּז **For the word "Az" alludes to this:** כַּד אִתְנְהִיר נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **when the**

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[481] **Zohar III, 290a (Idra Zuta)** — "In the teaching of the school of Rav Yeiva the Elder, the totality of everything, Ze'ir Anpin, is called 'You'; Atika Kadisha, which is concealed, is called 'He.' This is fitting. Now we call the place where a beginning is found 'You': although it is concealed, from it there is a beginning, and it is called Father.... This Father issues from Atika Kadisha, as it is written, 'Wisdom—from Ayin shall it be found.' Therefore He is not apprehended."

[482] **Zohar I, 120b (Vayera)** — "Whenever troubles befall Israel, 'lo' is written with aleph but read with vav, because the Holy One, blessed be He, is with them in their distress. 'Lo' with aleph signifies a still higher place. Although anger and distress do not exist in that place, Israel's distress reaches there above. 'Lo' with aleph is as in, 'He made us, ve-lo anachnu': it is written with aleph and read with vav." The passage begins from Isaiah 63:9 and then explicitly compares Psalm 100:3. Rav Tzadok applies that higher, concealed level to the joy of belonging to God.

[483] **Sifrei Bamidbar, Behaalotekha, piska 77** — "'On the day of your joy'—these are the Sabbaths. Rabbi Natan says: these are the daily offerings. 'And on your appointed festivals'—these are the three pilgrimage festivals; 'and at your new moons'—as its plain meaning."

[484] **Zohar III, 79b (Achrei Mot)** — "'The Sabbath burnt offering on its Sabbath, above the continual burnt offering': one must direct the heart higher and higher, more than on other days. Therefore it says precisely 'above the continual burnt offering.' It was taught: of Hannah it is written, 'She prayed above the Lord'—'above' precisely, because children depend upon the holy mazal, as we have explained."

[485] **Zohar III, 65b (Achrei Mot)** — "Come and see: Yud at the beginning includes all, concealed on every side; the paths have not opened. It includes male and female. The upper tip of yud alludes to Ayin. Afterward comes yud, which brings forth the river that flows and goes out from it, so that heh may become pregnant from it. Concerning this it is written, 'A river goes out from Eden'—'goes out,' rather than 'went out.'"

[486] **Shabbat 156a** — "'Rabbi Chanina says: mazal makes a person wise, mazal makes a person wealthy, and Israel is subject to mazal. Rabbi Yochanan says: Israel is not subject to mazal.' Rabbi Yochanan derives this from Jeremiah: ''Do not be frightened by the signs of heaven, for the nations are frightened by them'—they should be frightened, but Israel should not.'" The plain Talmudic expression ein mazal denies Israel's subjection to astrological necessity. Rav Tzadok also reads ein as Ayin, the concealed divine source, using the Zohar cited next.

light of the Holy Ancient One shines, רְשִׁימִין בְּא׳[487] **it is inscribed in Alef,** וְא׳ אִנְקִיב בַּחֲשׁוֹכִי **and Alef pierces through the darkness** וְנָהִיר לְכָל עִיבְרָ **and shines to every side,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ב נד, א) **(II 54a).** וְהַיְינוּ עִנְיַן הִתְגַּלּוּת **And this is the revelation** רֵאשִׁית הַמַּחְשָׁבָה **of the first thought, the aspect of Keser Elyon,** בְּחִינַת כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **in all the worlds.** בְּכָל הָעוֹלְמוֹת **And likewise** וְכֵן הָיָה מַעֵין הִתְגַּלּוּת הַזֶּה **there was a semblance of this revelation at the splitting of the Sea,** בְּקִרְיעַת יַם סוּף דְּבָעֵתִיקָא תַּלְיָא **which depends on Atika,** [שְׁמוֹת טו, א] **and it says (Shemos 15:1),** וְנֶאֱמַר אָז יָשִׁיר מֹשֶׁה וְגוֹמֵר **"Then Moshe sang," etc.,** וְכִמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar.** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כב, ג) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said (Shemos Rabbah 22:3):** צָרִיךְ לְהַזְכִּיר קְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **One must mention the splitting of the Sea** וּמַכַּת בְּכוֹרוֹת בָּאֱמֶת וְיַצִּיב וְכוּלֵי **and the plague of the firstborn in Emes Veyatziv, etc.;** לְכָךְ צָרִיךְ אָדָם **therefore a person must** לְסָמוֹךְ גְּאוּלָה לִתְפִלָּה **juxtapose Geulah to Tefillah,** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁהֵם הִסְמִיכוּ שִׁירָה וְכוּלֵי **just as they juxtaposed song, etc.,** וּכְשֵׁם שֶׁהֵם טִיהֲרוּ לִבָּם[488] וְכוּלֵי **and just as they purified their hearts, etc.** וְהוּא כְּעִנְיָן הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **And this is like the matter above.** וְכֵן עַל רָמְז זֶה אוֹמְרִים **And likewise on this allusion we say** וַאֲנִי תְּפִלָּתִי **"And as for me, my prayer," etc.** בְּמִנְחַת שַׁבָּת **at Minchah of Shabbos,** שֶׁאָז הוּא עֵת רָצוֹן הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **for then is the time of favor mentioned above,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ב פח, ב) **(II 88b),** דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **that the Holy Ancient One** גַּלְיָא רָצוֹן דִּילֵיהּ[489] **reveals His will;** שֶׁאָז הוּא גַּם כֵּן סְמִיכַת גְּאוּלָה **for then too is the juxtaposing of Geulah** שֶׁל כָּל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **of the whole day of Shabbos,** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל עָסְקוּ **in which Yisrael have been engaged** בְּשִׁירוֹת וְתִשְׁבָּחוֹת **in songs and praises,** וּמִזֶּה בָּאִים לִתְפִלַּת הַמִּנְחָה **and from this they come to the Minchah prayer,** לְהִתְגַּלּוּת הָעֵת רָצוֹן **to the revelation of the time of favor** דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **of the Holy Ancient One,** מַעֵין הִתְגַּלּוּת דִּלְעָתִיד לָבֹא **a semblance of the revelation of the future to come,** שֶׁאָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **when "our mouth will be filled with laughter."** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן הָעִנְיָן דְּרַב בְּרוּנָא **And this too is the matter of Rav Bruna,** שֶׁפַּעַם אַחַת סָמַךְ גְּאוּלָה לִתְפִלָּה **who once juxtaposed Geulah to Tefillah** וְלֹא פָּסִיק חוּכָא מִפּוּמֵיהּ כּוּלֵּיהּ יוֹמָא **and laughter did not cease from his mouth the entire day.** [שָׁם דִּבּוּר וְהַתּוֹסָפוֹת **And Tosafos (ibid., s.v. Kol HaSomech) asked:** מַאי רְבוּתָא דְּרַב בְּרוּנָא **What is the novelty of Rav Bruna?** וַהֲלֹא כָּל הָעוֹלָם **Surely everyone** סוֹמְכִין גְּאוּלָה לִתְפִלָּה[490] **juxtaposes Geulah to Tefillah!** אֶלָּא בְּוַדַּאי אֵין הַמְכוּוָן בְּדִיבּוּר בִּלְבַד **Indeed, certainly what is meant is not the speech alone;** רַק שֶׁאָז הוֹפִיעַ הָאָרָה לְכַוִּין בְּלִבּוֹ שֶׁל רַב בְּרוּנָא **rather, at that time a great illumination shone in the heart of Rav Bruna** גְּדוֹלָה **to direct the aspect of praise and redemption** בְּחִינַת הַתְּהִלָּה וְהַגְּאוּלָה **in all the worlds.** בְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת **And likewise** וּכְמוֹ כֵן **his prayer made an impression in all the worlds,** שֶׁתְּפִלָּה שֶׁלּוֹ עָשָׂה רוֹשֶׁם בְּכָל הָעוֹלָמוֹת **until through this he reached the time of favor,** עַד שֶׁהִגִּיעַ לְהָעֵת רָצוֹן **in the revelation of the light of the Holy Ancient One,** בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **as mentioned above.** בְּגִנְזָךְ לְעֵיל **And since he merited** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁזָּכָה **a semblance of the revelation of the future to come,** מַעֵין הִתְגַּלּוּת דִּלְעָתִיד לָבֹא **therefore he filled his mouth with laughter,** עַל כֵּן מִילֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיהוּ **in the manner of what it says,** עַל דָּרְכָּךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **"Then our mouth will be filled with laughter,"** אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **in accordance with our words.** וְכִדְבָרֵינוּ וּבָזֶה נוּכַל לְרַמֵּז גַּם כֵּן **And with this we can also allude to the matter of the month of Adar,** עִנְיַן חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **which was formed with laughter,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּשְׂחוֹק **and it comes precisely after the sadness** וְהוּא דַּיְיקָא אַחַר הָעֶצֶב **of the past month of Shevat.** שֶׁל חֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט הָעָבַר **And this is the essential laughter of holiness,** וְזֶהוּ עִיקַּר הַשְּׂחוֹק שֶׁל הַקְּדוּשָׁה הַבָּא אַחַר הָעֶצֶב

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[487] **Asarah Maamarot, Maamar Chikur HaDin I:1** — "Contemplation of His attributes is the ultimate good, and 'Your splendor upon their children' is like the merit of fathers becoming the mazal of their children.... 'May the pleasantness of the Lord our God be upon us' is our primal mazal, which does not depend on merit at all. He prepared for the house of Israel abundant goodness and mighty kindness, with the generous hand of the supreme King who benefits all. 'The work of our hands' is the merit renewed day by day: 'Establish it upon us,' to add strength to our mazal in every generation." The chapter says that ancestral merit becomes the children's mazal. Rav Tzadok formulates this relationship as the father's soul being the son's mazal; that exact formula was not found verbatim in the retrieved chapter.

[488] **Psalms 73:4** — "For there are no fetters at their death, and their body is robust." The verse supplies the word bari, "robust" or "strong." Rav Tzadok uses it to explain the Talmudic expression bari mazaleih, a strong and enduring mazal.

[489] **Sefer Yetzirah, Gra recension 5:10** — "He made the letter qof reign over laughter, bound a crown to it, and combined them with one another. Through them He formed Pisces in the world, Adar in the year, and the spleen in the person, male and female."

[490] **Malachi 3:22** — "Remember the Torah of Moses My servant, whom I commanded at Horeb for all Israel—statutes and ordinances."

which comes after sadness; וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן מַעְנְיָן **and it too is of the matter of** סְמִיכַת גְּאוּלָה לִתְפִלָּה **juxtaposing Geulah to Tefillah:** כִּי חֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט הוּא בְּחִינַת גְּאוּלָה **for the month of Shevat is the aspect of Geulah,** שֶׁנּוֹתֵן הוֹדָאָה לְשֶׁעָבַר **in which one gives thanks for the past,** שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לְהַתְּיקוּן **that he merits the rectification** לִהְיוֹת נִגְאָל מֵעוֹמֶק הָרַע **to be redeemed from the depths of evil;** וְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר הוּא בְּחִינַת תְּפִלָּה **and the month of Adar is the aspect of prayer** עַל לְהַבָּא **for the future,** וְהַיְינוּ הַיִרְאָה הַמּוֹפִיעַ **meaning the fear that shines forth** בְּלֵב נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל **in the heart of the souls of Yisrael;** וּמִזֶּה נוֹלַד הַשְּׂחוֹק וְהַשִּׂמְחָה בַּלֵּב[491] **and from this are born laughter and joy in the heart,** כְּעִנְיַן מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as in what they said** (תָּנָא דְּבֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ רַבָּה ג) **(Tanna Devei Eliyahu Rabbah 3):** שִׂמְחָתִי מִתּוֹךְ יִרְאָתִי[492] **"My joy is from amid my fear."** וּמִשֶּׁנִּכְנָס אֲדָר מַרְבִּין **And from when Adar enters we increase** מֵהַאי טַעְמָא בְּשִׂמְחָה כְּנִזְכָּר לְעֵיל **in joy for this reason, as mentioned above.**

Now the term "laughter" is also found, וְהִנֵּה לְשׁוֹן שְׂחוֹק נִמְצָא גַּם כֵּן **which our Sages, of blessed memory, applied** כְּבִיכוֹל אֵצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **as it were, to Hashem Yisbarach,** (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ג, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **(Avodah Zarah 3b) as they said:** רְבִיעִיּוֹת יוֹשֵׁב וּמְשַׂחֵק עִם לִוְיָתָן **In the last quarter of the day He sits and plays with the Leviathan,** [תְּהִלִּים קד, כו] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 104:26),** לִוְיָתָן זֶה יָצַרְתָּ **"This Leviathan You formed to play with."** וְלִוְיָתָן מְרַמֵּז עַל יֵצֶר הָרַע **And the Leviathan alludes to the yetzer hara** שֶׁל תַּאֲוָה דְּמִסְטְרָא דְּנָחָשׁ **of desire, which is from the side of the serpent,** [יְשַׁעְיָה כז, א] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Yeshayahu 27:1),** עַל לִוְיָתָן נָחָשׁ עֲקַלָּתוֹן **"Leviathan the slant serpent,** לִוְיָתָן נָחָשׁ בָּרִיחַ **upon Leviathan the twisting serpent."** וְתֵבַת יָצַרְתָּ **And the word "You formed"** מְרַמֵּז עַל הַיֵּצֶר **alludes to the yetzer,** וּמִלַּת יֵצֶר הוֹרָאָתוֹ **and the word yetzer denotes** עַל הַחֵשֶׁק שֶׁבַּלֵּב **the desire in the heart,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם **as they said in Midrash HaNe'elam** (זֹהַר חָלֵק א קלז, א קלח, א) **(Zohar I 137a, 138a)** דְּיֵצֶר דְּתַאֲוָה **that the inclination of desire** לֹא יִתְבַּטֵּל גַּם לֶעָתִיד[493] **will not be nullified even in the future,** דְּאִלְמָלֵא יֵצֶר הָרַע **for were it not for the evil inclination,** לָא מִשְׁתַּכַּח חֶדְוָותָא דְּשָׁמַעְתָּא **the joy of Torah learning would not be found;** רַק דְּאִיקְרֵי לָבָן **only it will be called "white,"** דְּאִתְלַבַּן כְּמַאן דְּסָחֵי **for it has been whitened like one who bathes** וּמִטְבִּיל מְסָאֲבוּתֵיהּ **and immerses from his impurity.** וְעַל יְדֵי חֵטְא אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן **And through the sin of Adam HaRishon,** בְּעִרְבּוּב טוֹב וָרָע **in the mixing of good and evil,** נַעֲשָׂה בְּלֵב הָאָדָם **there came to be in man's heart** שְׁנֵי חֲשָׁקוֹת **two desires:** יֵצֶר טוֹב וְיֵצֶר רָע **a good inclination and an evil inclination.** [דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א כט, יח] וְנֶאֱמַר **And it says (I Divrei HaYamim 29:18),** לְיֵצֶר מַחְשְׁבוֹת לְבַב עַמֶּךָ **"in the inclination of the thoughts of the heart of Your people";** וּכְשֶׁהוּא לְטוֹב **and when it is directed to good,** נִקְרָא יֵצֶר טוֹב **it is called the good inclination.** וּכְשֶׁרָאָה דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And when King David, peace be upon him, saw** שֶׁהִתְנַדְּבוּ לַמִּקְדָּשׁ **that they donated to the Mikdash** בְּתִשּׁוּקָה וְחֶשֶׁק גָּדוֹל **with longing and great desire,** בִּיקֵּשׁ מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **he asked of Hashem Yisbarach** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִשְׁמָר זֹאת לְעוֹלָם בַּלֵּב **that this be preserved forever in the heart.** רַק הָאָדָם בְּעַצְמוֹ עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רָע **Only man himself makes it evil,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא כַּאֲשֶׁר פּוֹנָה **(Midrash Tanchuma, Bereishis 7):** אַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רָע[494] וְכוּלֵי **"You make it evil," etc.,** בְּרֵאשִׁית ז) וּכְשֶׁהָאָדָם מִתְגַּבֵּר עַל יִצְרוֹ **And when a person overcomes his inclination** לְתַאֲוַת הַגּוּף **to the desire of the body.** וְלוֹחֵם מִלְחֶמֶת ה׳ תַּחְתָּיו **and fights the battle of Hashem** לְהַכְנִיעוֹ **to subdue** בִּתְשׁוּקָתוֹ **when he turns his longing**

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[491] **Exodus 19:6** — "You shall be to Me a kingdom of priests and a holy nation. These are the words that you shall speak to the children of Israel."

[492] **Zohar II, 64b (Beshalach)** — "Were Israel so foolish that they did not know this matter? They had seen the Shekhinah before them and the clouds of glory surrounding them! People who had seen the radiance of their King's glory at the sea—for we have learned that a maidservant at the sea saw what Ezekiel did not see—would they be found foolish, asking, 'Is the Lord among us or Ayin?'"

[493] **Ritva on Yoma 54b** — "When gentiles entered the Sanctuary, they found the cherubim intertwined. Rabbi ben Maush raised the difficulty that Bava Batra says their faces were toward one another only when Israel performed God's will. Some answer that the latter refers to Moses' cherubim, while here it refers to the cherubim depicted upon the walls, which were always intertwined. But this is difficult: how, then, did they display the depicted cherubim to demonstrate Israel's belovedness before God? The correct explanation, as Rabbi Eliyahu Mizrachi explained, is that these too were now intertwined by a miracle; but it was a miracle for harm, in order to expose their nakedness." Rav Tzadok accepts the question and develops a different explanation: Israel's repentance at the destruction renewed their attachment to God.

[494] **Bava Batra 99a** — "How did they stand? Rabbi Yochanan and Rabbi Elazar disagree: one says, 'Their faces were toward one another'; the other says, 'Their faces were toward the house.' According to the view that their faces were toward one another, does Scripture not say, 'Their faces were toward the house'? There is no difficulty: one case is when Israel performs the Omnipresent's will; the other is when Israel does not perform His will."

it beneath him, מִזֶּה נוֹלַד הַשְּׂחוֹק **from this laughter is born,** כִּבְיָכוֹל אֵצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ[495] **as it were, with Hashem Yisbarach;** כִּי לְשׁוֹן שְׂחוֹק הוּנַח **for the term "laughter" is applied** אֵצֶל נִיצּוּחַ מִלְחָמָה **to victory in battle,** כְּדָרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּאַבְנֵר [שְׁמוּאֵל ב ב, יד] **as it says regarding Avner (II Shmuel 2:14):** יָקוּמוּ נָא הַנְּעָרִים **"Let the young men arise** וִישַׂחֲקוּ לְפָנֵינוּ **and play before us."** וְגַם אָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **And our Sages, of blessed memory, also said** (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה יג, ג) **(Vayikra Rabbah 13:3)** שֶׁמִּי שֶׁלֹּא רָאָה **that one who did not watch** קְנִיגִין שֶׁל עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים **the hunting-games of the idolaters** וּמַזָּלוֹת **in this world** בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה[496] **merits to see, in the World to Come,** זוֹכֶה לִרְאוֹת בָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא **the sport and combat** בִּשְׂחוֹק וּקְנִיגוֹן **of the Leviathan and the wild ox.** שֶׁל הַלִּוְיָתָן וְשׁוֹר הַבָּר **And hunting-games are likewise** וְעִנְיַן קְנִיגִין הוּא גַּם כֵּן **the sport of victory in battle** שְׂחוֹק שֶׁל נִיצּוּחַ מִלְחָמָה **of beasts and wild animals** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה יח, ב[497]) **(as stated in Avodah Zarah 18b).** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ מֵעִנְיַן **And we have already spoken about** מִלְחֶמֶת הַלִּוְיָתָן וְשׁוֹר הַבָּר **the battle of the Leviathan and the wild ox** כִּי הַלִּוְיָתָן שׁוֹרֶשׁ יֵצֶר **in the Midrash Rabbah** [שָׁם בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה] **(Vayikra Rabbah ibid.):** הָרַע דְּתַאֲוָה **that the Leviathan is the root of the yetzer hara of desire,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא עד, ב) **as they said (Bava Basra 74b)** עַל הַלִּוְיָתָן דָּגִים פְּרִיצֵי[498] **about the Leviathan: "brazen fish";** וְהַשּׁוֹר הַבָּר הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ **and the wild ox is the root** יֵצֶר הָרַע דְּבַהֲמָה[499] **of the yetzer hara of anger and murder,** וְהוּא יֵצֶר הָרַע דְּבַהֲמָה **and it is the yetzer hara of an animal,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת סא, א) **as they said (Berachos 61a):** וְהָא קָא חָזֵינַן **"But we see** דִּמְזַקְא וְנָשְׁכָא וּבָעֲטָא[500] **that it does damage, bites and kicks."** וְהֵמָּה מִתְנַגְּדִים זֶה לָזֶה **And they oppose one another** בְּטִבְעָם כַּיָּדוּעַ **by their nature, as is known,** וְזֶה עִנְיַן הַמִּלְחָמָה שֶׁבֵּינֵיהֶם **and this is the battle between them.** וּמִזֶּה יִהְיֶה הַסְּעוּדָה לַצַּדִּיקִים **And from this will come the feast for the tzaddikim** לְעָתִיד לָבֹא **in the future to come;** הַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּתְבָּרְרוּ בִּשְׁלֵימוּת **meaning they will be completely refined** בִּשְׁנֵי הַפְּגָמִים הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל **of the two flaws mentioned above,** שֶׁיִּתְבַּטְּלוּ מֵהַנֶּפֶשׁ **which will be nullified from the soul,** וְזֶה יִהְיֶה תַּכְלִית הַשִּׂמְחָה **and this will be the ultimate joy** בִּשְׁלֵימוּת לְעָתִיד לָבֹא[501] **in perfection in the future to come.** וְגַם אָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא שָׁם) **They also said (Bava Basra ibid.)** שֶׁעָתִיד גַּבְרִיאֵל **that Gavriel is destined** לַעֲשׂוֹת קְנִיגְיָא עִם לִוְיָתָן **to make a hunt with the Leviathan,** וְאִלְמָלֵא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹזְרוֹ **and were it not that the Holy One, blessed be He, helps him,** אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ[502] **he could not overcome it,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אִיּוֹב מ, יט] **as it says (Iyov 40:19),** הָעֹשׂוֹ יַגֵּשׁ חַרְבּוֹ **"He Who made him can bring near His sword."** וְהוּא עִנְיָן אֶחָד עִם מַאֲמָרָם **And this is one matter with their statement** (סוּכָּה נב, ב) **(Sukkah 52b):** יִצְרוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם **A person's inclination** מִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו בְּכָל

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[495] **Jerusalem Talmud, Berachos 2:4; cf. Eikhah Rabbah 1:51** — "There was a Jew who stood plowing. His ox lowed before him. An Arab passed and heard its voice. He said, 'Jew, Jew! Unharness your ox and unfasten your plow, for the Temple has been destroyed.' It lowed a second time. He said, 'Jew, Jew! Harness your ox and fasten your plow, for the King Messiah has been born.' He asked, 'What is his name?' He answered, 'Menachem.'" The same story is present in Eikhah Rabbah 1:51, after its opening Doeg narrative and subsequent expositions. Both original witnesses place the birth of consolation beside the very announcement of destruction.

[496] **Shemot Rabbah 7:4** — "Just as the Holy One, blessed be He, receives praise from the righteous in the Garden of Eden, so praise ascends to Him from the wicked in Gehinnom.... They shed tears like springs until they cool Gehinnom with their tears, and from there praise rises.... What do they say? Rabbi Yochanan said: 'You have spoken rightly; You have judged rightly; You have declared pure rightly; You have declared impure rightly; You have found guilty rightly; You have taught rightly; You have instructed rightly.'"

[497] **Eruvin 19a** — "That verse, 'Those who pass through the valley of weeping,' refers to those who are liable at that moment in Gehinnom. Our father Abraham comes, brings them up, and receives them—except for an Israelite who had relations with a gentile woman: his foreskin is drawn over, and Abraham does not recognize him." The stated exception belongs to the Talmudic passage and is retained here; Rav Tzadok is drawing upon its principal image of Abraham receiving Israel after judgment.

[498] **Zohar III, 34b (Tzav)** — "Rabbi Chizkiyah was sitting before Rabbi Elazar. He asked: 'How many lights were created before the world was created?' He answered: 'Seven. These are: the light of Torah, the light of Gehinnom, the light of the Garden of Eden, the light of the Throne of Glory, the light of the Temple, the light of repentance, and the light of Messiah. These were created before the world was created.'"

[499] **Megillah 11a** — "Rabbi Yochanan opened his exposition of this scroll from here: 'He remembered His kindness and faithfulness to the house of Israel; all the ends of the earth saw the salvation of our God.' When did 'all the ends of the earth see the salvation of our God'? In the days of Mordechai and Esther."

[500] **Ecclesiastes 2:2** — "Of laughter I said, 'It is madness,' and of joy, 'What does this accomplish?'"

[501] **Genesis 3:16-17** — "To the woman He said: 'I will greatly increase your pain and your pregnancy; in pain you shall bear children....' To Adam He said: 'Because you listened to your wife and ate from the tree of which I commanded you not to eat, cursed is the ground on your account; in painful toil you shall eat of it all the days of your life.'"

[502] **Psalms 105:3** — "Glory in His holy name; let the heart of those who seek the Lord rejoice."

וְכוֹפֵלִי יוֹם[503] **overpowers him every day, etc.,** וְאִלְמָלֵא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁעוֹזֵר לוֹ **and were it not that the Holy One, blessed be He, helps him,** אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ **he could not overcome it.** כִּי גַּבְרִיאֵל הוּא הַמַּלְאָךְ שֶׁל גְּבוּרָה **For Gavriel is the angel of gevurah,** וְהוּא הַיֵּצֶר טוֹב שֶׁל הָאָדָם **and it is the good inclination of man,** לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר כְּאָמְרָם זְכרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (שַׁבָּת קיט, ב) **to be a mighty one who conquers his inclination, as our Sages, of blessed memory, said (Shabbos 119b):** שְׁנֵי מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת מְלַוִּין לוֹ לְאָדָם כּוּפֵלִי **Two ministering angels accompany a person, etc.,** אֶחָד טוֹב וְאֶחָד רַע[504] **one good and one evil;** וְהֵיינוּ הַלֵּב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ **and this is "the heart of the wise is on his right,** וְלֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ **and the heart of the fool on his left."** וְהִנֵּה עַל זֶה רָמְזוּ בְּדִבְרֵיהֶם **Now to this they alluded in their words,** שֶׁבְּשָׁלֹשׁ שָׁעוֹת אַחֲרוֹנוֹת שֶׁל יוֹם דְּיֵיקָא **that specifically in the last three hours of the day** הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְשַׂחֵק עִם הַלִּוְיָתָן **Hashem Yisbarach plays with the Leviathan,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁתִּיקֵּן יִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **which Yitzchak Avinu, peace be upon him, instituted** מִסִּטְרָא דִּגְבוּרָה **from the side of gevurah,** לִהְיוֹת כּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ **to conquer one's inclination and subdue it;** וּמִזֶּה נוֹלַד הַשְּׂחוֹק **and from this laughter is born,** כְּבָיְכוֹל לְהַכְנִיעוֹ **as it were, with Hashem Yisbarach,** אֵצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מִצַּד נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל **on account of the souls of Yisrael who triumph over and overcome their inclination.** וּלְאַחַר בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **And after the Beis HaMikdash was destroyed,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְלַמֵּד **the Holy One, blessed be He, teaches schoolchildren Torah** תִּינוֹקוֹת שֶׁל בֵּית רַבָּן תּוֹרָה בְּשָׁלֹשׁ שָׁעוֹת הַלָּלוּ **in these three hours,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה שָׁם) **as they said (Avodah Zarah ibid.);** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל הֵמָּה בַּגָּלוּת **because Yisrael are in exile** וְאֵין בְּכֹחָם לְהִתְגַּבֵּר **and do not have the strength to prevail** וּלְהַכְנִיעַ אֶת הַהֵיפֶךְ **and to subdue the opposite,** כְּבָיְכוֹל נִתְבַּטֵּל לְפָנָיו **there ceased, as it were, before Him, may He be blessed,** הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל[505] הַשְּׂחוֹק שֶׁל הַלִּוְיָתָן **the play with the Leviathan mentioned above,** וְהַשַּׁעֲשׁוּעַ שֶׁלּוֹ **and His delight** עַל יְדֵי תִּינוֹקוֹת שֶׁל בֵּית רַבָּן **is through schoolchildren,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת קיט, ב) **as they said (Shabbos 119b)** שֶׁאֵין הָעוֹלָם מִתְקַיֵּים **that the world endures** אֶלָּא בִּשְׁבִיל הֶבֶל **only in the merit of the breath** תִּינוֹקוֹת שֶׁל בֵּית רַבָּן **of schoolchildren,** הֶבֶל פִּיהֶם שֶׁאֵין בָּהֶם חֵטְא[506] **the breath of their mouths, in which there is no sin.** וְהִנֵּה חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר דְּמַזָּלוֹ דָּגִים **Now the month of Adar, whose sign is Fish,** שֶׁהוּא זְמַן הִתְגַּבְּרוּת הַתַּאֲוָה[507] **is a time when desire grows strong,** כְּדָגִים דִּפְרִיצֵי **like "brazen fish";** וְלָזֶה הָיָה אָז הַכֹּחַ **and therefore at that time there was the power** לְהִתְגַּבְּרוּת כֹּחַ קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **for the strengthening of the force of the kelipah of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא הַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ שֶׁל יֵצֶר הָרַע[508] **which is the root of the yetzer hara,** כִּדְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as stated in the holy Zohar** [חֵלֶק ג קסְ, א] **(III 160a)** [בְּמִדְבַּר יג, כט] עַל פָּסוּק **on the verse (Bamidbar 13:29),** עֲמָלֵק יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב **"Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev."** וְכַאֲשֶׁר זָכִינוּ דְּיֵיקָא בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **And when we merited, precisely in this month,** לְהַכְנִיעוֹ וְלִמְחוֹת אֶת זִכְרוֹ **to subdue him and blot out his memory —** נַעֲשָׂה בָּזֶה רְשִׁימָה לְדוֹרֵי דוֹרוֹת **this made an imprint for all generations,** לִהְיוֹת הַחֹדֶשׁ

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[503] Parallel: **Resisei Layla 53:1** — "Joy is only in the blessed God, in a person's attachment to Him. Even if he is not yet attached, even if he is completely distant, nevertheless, if he seeks Him and desires to attach himself to Him, it is said, 'Let the heart of those who seek the Lord rejoice.' Through the light of Torah and the lamp of the commandment he can merit this joy as well.... The straightness of the heart is simply wholeheartedness with the Lord his God: knowing that there is a Creator and Governor and that nothing exists apart from Him. This straightens every crookedness of the heart."

Connection: This explains why the maamar locates joy already in seeking God, before attainment is complete: seeking is rooted in an existing faith that can straighten the heart. The parallel distinguishes that inward joy from the full illuminating clarity attained through righteous action.

[504] **Ketubot 111b** — "I expound another verse: 'For Your dew is a dew of lights, and the earth shall cast down the shades.' Whoever makes use of the light of Torah, the light of Torah revives him; whoever does not make use of the light of Torah, the light of Torah does not revive him."

[505] **Tikkunei Zohar, Introduction, 12a** — "Whoever guards her from those lashes, dew descends upon him—the name Yod He Vav, the dew with which the dead are revived. Concerning it the masters of the Mishnah established: 'Whoever engages in the dew of Torah, the dew of Torah revives him.'"

[506] **Shabbat 88b** — "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: With every utterance that came from the mouth of the Holy One, blessed be He, the souls of Israel departed, as it is said, 'My soul departed when He spoke.' If their souls departed at the first utterance, how did they receive the second? He brought down the dew with which He will revive the dead in the future and revived them, as it is said, 'You showered abundant rain, O God; when Your inheritance was weary, You sustained it.'"

[507] **Psalms 119:162** — "I rejoice over Your utterance like one who finds abundant spoil."

[508] **Midrash Tanchuma, Vayechi 15** — "'All these are the tribes of Israel, twelve.'... These tribes correspond to the order of the world: twelve hours in the day and twelve hours in the night; likewise the constellations and the months, and the twelve stones of the ephod. Therefore: 'All these are the tribes of Israel, twelve.'"

הַזֶּה מְסוּגָּל **that this month should be suited** לִבְחִינַת הַשְּׂחוֹק **to the aspect of laughter** מִצַּד הַכְנָעַת הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע **by virtue of subduing the yetzer hara** מִנֶּפֶשׁ הָאָדָם **from the soul of man.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן אָמְרָם **And this is the meaning of their saying,** מִשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אֲדָר מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה **"From when Adar enters we increase in joy."**

ראש חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר, מַאֲמָר ג׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Gimmel

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ וְכוּפֵי וַאֲדָר בַּשָּׁנָה **In Sefer Yetzirah: "He crowned the letter Kuf etc., and Adar in the year."** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב תְּרוּמָה קמח, ב) **In the holy Zohar (II, Terumah 148b):** הַאי נָחָשׁ אָזְלָא **"This serpent goes** בָּתַר רָזָא דְּאֵשֶׁת חַיִל **after the secret of the Eishes Chayil,** וּבָעְיָא אֶשֶׁת זְנוּנִים **and the harlotrous woman seeks** לְאִתְתַּקָּנָא גַּרְמָהּ **to adorn herself** כְּגַוְונָא דִּילָהּ וְלָא יְכִילַת **in her likeness, but she cannot.** אֵשֶׁת חַיִל אֶת דִּילָהּ **The Eishes Chayil — her letter** אוֹת ה׳ וְכוּפֵי **is the letter Hei, etc.;** אֶשֶׁת זְנוּנִים וְכוּפֵי **the harlotrous woman, etc. —** כְּגַוְונָא דְּקוֹפָא אֲצַל בְּנֵי נָשָׁא וְכוּפֵי **like a monkey beside human beings, etc."** וְאֶת דִּילָהּ ק׳ וְכוּפֵי **and her letter is Kuf, etc.,** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאוֹת ה׳ דּוֹמָה לְאוֹת ק׳ **That is, the letter Kuf resembles the letter Hei,** רַק שֶׁהֶרֶגֶל שָׂלָה עָקֹם וְנִמְשָׁךְ לְמַטָּה **except that its leg is crooked and extends downward.** וְזֶהוּ דְּאִתְתַּקָּנָא בְּתִקּוּנָא דְּאָת ה׳ **And this is "adorning herself with the adornment of the letter Hei" —** לְהִדָּמוֹת חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **to make herself resemble it, Heaven forbid,** כְּמוֹ הַקּוֹף **like the monkey** שֶׁרוֹצֶה לְהִתְדַּמּוֹת לִבְנֵי אָדָם **that wants to imitate human beings.** וְעִסְקָא דְּהַאי יַרְחָא לְמִחְיֵית עֲמָלֵק **And the task of this month is the obliteration of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ וְרֹאשִׁית דְּקִלְיפָּה **who is the root and beginning of the kelipah,** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן נוּקְבָא דְּקִלְיפָּה **and he is also the feminine aspect of the kelipah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ דְּמִסַּעַם זָה אִיתָא **as we have said, that for this reason it is stated** עַל עֲמָלֵק [חֵלֶק ב סה, א] בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **in the holy Zohar (II 65a) regarding Amalek** שֶׁהוּא קְלִיפַּת כֶּלֶב[509] **that he is the kelipah of the dog;** וְרַבֵּנוּ חַיִּים וִיטָאל זְכוּרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה כָּתַב **and Rabbeinu Chaim Vital, of blessed memory, wrote** [בַּהַגָּהוֹת עַל הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֵלֶק ב קכא, ב] **(in his glosses on the holy Zohar II 121b)** דִּנוּקְבָא דְּקִלְיפָּה נִקְרָא כֶּלֶב **that the feminine aspect of the kelipah is called kelev, dog,** הֵיפֶךְ בַּכֹּל[510] **the letters of bakol, "everything," reversed.** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאִיתָא בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **This is along the lines of what is stated regarding holiness** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפָתַח אֲלִיָּהוּ] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pasach Eliyahu):** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **"Keser Elyon is the crown of Malchus";** כֵּן בְּזֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה בִּקְלִיפָּה **so too, correspondingly, in the kelipah:** וְהָרֹאשִׁית דִּקְלִיפָּה נִקְרָא קוֹף **the beginning of the kelipah is called kof, monkey,** מַהֲגָמָרָא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we said from the Gemara** (דְּסַנְהֶדְרִין קט, א[511]) **(Sanhedrin 109a,** וְנִתְבָּאֵר בַּאֲרוּכָּה מִשְׁפָּטִים **and it was explained at length in Mishpatim,** שָׁם [ט] (י) עַיֵּין מַאֲמָר). **maamar 9; see there).** וְזֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **And correspondingly, in holiness,** אָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא נח, א) **they said (Bava Basra 58a):** אָדָם בִּפְנֵי שְׁכִינָה **"Man before the Shechinah** כְּקוֹף בִּפְנֵי אָדָם **is like a monkey before a man."** שֶׁעִיקַּר שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַמִּצְוֹת **For the essential root of the mitzvos** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ הֶאֱצִיל [דְּבָרִים כח, ט] וְהָלַכְתָּ בִּדְרָכָיו **is that Hashem Yisbarach emanated,** לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם **for the creation of the world,** דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת **words of Torah and mitzvos** שֶׁבָּהֶם מַנְהִיג עוֹלָמוֹ **through which He conducts His world,** וְצִוָּה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **and He commanded Yisrael** לָלֶכֶת בִּדְרָכָיו **to walk in His ways** וּלְקַיֵּים הַמִּצְוֹת **and to fulfill the mitzvos** שֶׁהוּא מְקַיֵּים תְּחִלָּה **which He Himself fulfills first,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **as they said in the Yerushalmi** (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה פֶּרֶק א הֲלָכָה ג ז, ב) **(Rosh Hashanah 1:3, 7b)** וּבְמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (בְּחֻקֹּתַי לה, ג) **and in Midrash Rabbah (Bechukosai 35:3);** וְאִיתָא [שָׁם, ד] **and it is stated (ibid. 4):** אִם בְּחֻקֹּתַי תֵּלֵכוּ [וַיִּקְרָא כו, ג] **"If you walk in My statutes" (Vayikra 26:3) —** חֻקִּים שֶׁבָּהֶם **the statutes with which I engraved** אֶת הַשָּׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ[512] וְכוּפֵי **the heavens and earth, etc.** וּבְמִצְוַת שַׁבָּת **And regarding the mitzvah of Shabbos,** שֶׁהִיא כְּלָלָא דְּכָל אוֹרַיְיתָא **which is the sum of the entire Torah,** כְּתִיב [תַּנְחוּמָא בְּפֵירוּשׁ טַעֲמָא] **its reason is written explicitly:** לָנוּחַ כִּי הֵיכִי דְּנָחֵי בֵּיהּ אֲנָא **to rest, just as I rested on it** וְכֵן כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת **And so all the mitzvos** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ לְהִתְדַּמּוֹת לְדַרְכֵי **are meant** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ב] **(Tanchuma Bereishis 2).**

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[509] **Kohelet Rabbah 1:13** — "Rabbi Yudan said in Rabbi Ayvu's name: A person does not leave the world with even half his desire in his possession. If he has a hundred, he wants to turn it into two hundred; if he has two hundred, he wants to turn it into four hundred."

[510] **Sifrei Devarim, Vezot HaBerakhah, piska 355** — "'Naphtali, satisfied with favor': this teaches that Naphtali rejoiced in his portion—in seas, fish, and ships."

[511] **Rashi on Shabbat 25b, s.v. nachat ruach be-oshro** — "'Contentment in his wealth': he rejoices in his portion, whether it is small or large."

[512] **Zohar II, 62a (Beshalach)** — "All the inhabitants of the world look expectantly and lift their eyes to the Holy One, blessed be He. Therefore all people of faith must ask Him for their sustenance and pray for it each and every day.... Even one who has food with him must ask and pray for sustenance every day, so that blessings may be found above through him.... What is 'favor'? The favor that issues from Atika Kadisha: favor comes forth from Him so that sustenance may be found for all. One who asks for sustenance every day is called a faithful son, because on his account blessings are found above."

to resemble the ways of Hashem Yisbarach, וְזֶהוּ כְּקוֹף בְּפָנֵי שְׁכִינָה **and this is "like a monkey before the Shechinah"** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב׳) **(as explained in maamar 2).** וּבְיִשְׂרָאֵל מְרַמֵּז אוֹת קוֹף **And regarding Yisrael, the letter Kuf alludes to** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קד, א) קָדוֹשׁ **Kadosh, holy (as stated in Shabbos 104a),** וּכְתִיב [וַיִּקְרָא יט, ב] קְדוֹשִׁים תִּהְיוּ **and it is written (Vayikra 19:2): "You shall be holy,** כִּי קָדוֹשׁ אֲנִי **for I am holy";** (תַּנְחוּמָא קְדוֹשִׁים ב) וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (Tanchuma Kedoshim 2):** הוֹאִיל וְנִקְדַּשְׁתֶּם לְשְׁמִי **"Since you have been sanctified to My Name,** הֱיוּ קְדוֹשִׁים **be holy,** וְכוּלֵי[513] כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאֲנִי קָדוֹשׁ **just as I am holy, etc."** דְּעִיקָּר קְדוּשָּׁה הוּא לְמַעְלָה **For the essence of holiness is Above,** שֶׁהַמַּלְאָכִים אוֹמְרִים **where the angels say** קָדוֹשׁ קָדוֹשׁ קָדוֹשׁ וְגוֹמֵר [יְשַׁעְיָה ו, ג] **"Holy, holy, holy, etc." (Yeshayahu 6:3),** שֶׁאֵין שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **for there is no grasp whatsoever of Hashem Yisbarach,** רַק שֶׁיֵּשׁ קָדוֹשׁ נִבְדָּל מִכֹּל **only that there is a Holy One, separate from all.** וְכָךְ קְדוֹשִׁים תִּהְיוּ **And so, "You shall be holy":** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאֲנִי פָּרוּשׁ **"Just as I am separate,** כָּךְ תִּהְיוּ פְּרוּשִׁים **so shall you be separate"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה כד, ד) **(as stated in Vayikra Rabbah 24:4).** [וְאָמְרוּ שָׁם [כד, ח] שֶׁהָעֶלְיוֹנִים מַכְתִּירִין לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **And they said there (24:8) that the celestial beings crown the Holy One, blessed be He,** שָׁלֹשׁ קְדוּשׁוֹת[514] **with three sanctifications,** וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא נוֹתֵן שְׁתַּיִם **and the Holy One, blessed be He, places two** בְּרֹאשָׁן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **upon the heads of Yisrael** (וְיִתְבָּאֵר בִּמְקוֹמוֹ) **(and it will be explained in its place),** כְּדֵי לְהִתְדַּמּוֹת לְהַשְּׁכִינָה **in order that they resemble the Shechinah,** כְּבָיְכוֹל לִהְיוֹת פְּרוּשִׁים **as it were — to be separate** וְנִבְדָּלִים מִכָּל עִנְיְנֵי הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **and set apart from all matters of this world.** וְזֶה עֶסֶק חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **And this is the task of the month of Adar,** שֶׁנִּוצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **which was formed with the letter Kuf — Kadosh.** שֶׁבָּא אַחַר חֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט **It comes after the month of Shevat,** שֶׁנִּוצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳ בִּלְעִיטָה **which was formed with the letter Tzadi, with eating,** לְתַקֵּן הָאֲכִילָה **to rectify eating,** שֶׁתִּתְהֶיהָ בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **that it be in holiness,** שֶׁזֶּה תִּיקּוּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הֶסַּתַּת הַנָּחָשׁ **for this is the rectification of the root of the serpent's enticement.** וּמִמֵּילָא נִתְתַּקֵּן עִנְיַן קְדוּשַּׁת הַבְּרִית בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק **And consequently there is rectified the holiness of the bris, the aspect of Tzaddik,** שֶׁהוּא הַמּוּגְדָּר בְּתַאֲוָה **who is fenced off from desire;** בָּא אַחַר כָּךְ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **afterward comes the month of Adar,** שֶׁנִּוצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **formed with the letter Kuf — Kadosh,** שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁגּוֹדֵר עַצְמוֹ מִן הָעֶרְוָה **for whoever fences himself off from immorality** נִקְרָא קָדוֹשׁ[515] **is called holy,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה שָׁם, ו **as they said (Vayikra Rabbah ibid. 6).** וְעַל כֵּן בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **Therefore in this month** הָיָה מְחַיֵּית עֲמָלֵק[516] **was the obliteration of Amalek,** שֶׁכָּל עִיקַּר קִטְרוּגוֹ **whose entire accusation** עַל קְדוּשַּׁת הַבְּרִית **concerns the holiness of the bris,** שֶׁאוֹמֵר שֶׁאֵין כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים **for he says that not all of them are righteous,** וּמְבַזֶּה אוֹת בְּרִית **and he disgraces the sign of the bris** וְאוֹמֵר טוֹל מַה שֶּׁבָּחַרְתָּ[517] **and says, "Take what You have chosen"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא ט) **(as stated in Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 9),** שֶׁמְּקַטְרֵג עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **for he accuses against what they said,** דְּכָל מַאן דְּאִתְגְּזַר **that "whoever is circumcised** (זֹהַר חֻלָּק ב כג, א) אִיקְרֵי צַדִּיק[518] **is called a tzaddik" (Zohar II 23a).** וְאַחַר זֶה בָּא נִיסָן **After this comes Nissan,** שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּאוֹת ה׳ **created with the letter Hei,** רָזָא דְּאֶשֶׁת חַיִל **the secret of the Eishes Chayil.** דְּנִיסָן רֹאשׁוֹן לְחָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה דִּלְבָנָה **For Nissan is the first of the lunar months of the year,** דְּתִשְׁרֵי רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לִשְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה **whereas Tishrei is the New Year for solar years;**

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[513] **Moed Katan 28a** — "Rava said: Life, children and sustenance do not depend upon merit; they depend upon mazal. For Rabbah and Rav Chisda were both righteous Sages: one prayed and rain came; the other prayed and rain came."

[514] **Bereshit Rabbah 11:1** — "'The blessing of the Lord makes rich, and He adds no sorrow with it.' 'The blessing of the Lord makes rich'—this is the Sabbath, as it is said, 'God blessed the seventh day.' 'He adds no sorrow with it'—this is mourning, as it is said, 'The king grieves over his son.'" The Midrash identifies the added sorrow with mourning. Rav Tzadok extends the verse to the primordial sorrow introduced through the serpent.

[515] **Shabbat 25b** — "Who is wealthy? Whoever has contentment in his wealth—these are Rabbi Meir's words. Rabbi Tarfon says: whoever has a hundred vineyards, a hundred fields, and a hundred servants working in them. Rabbi Akiva says: whoever has a wife whose deeds are beautiful. Rabbi Yose says: whoever has a privy close to his table."

[516] **Zohar I, 161a (Vayetzei)** — "Laban performed many spells and kinds of sorcery, and examined his fortune on Jacob's account. Because of Jacob, every month he found himself with a hundred additional sheep, a hundred lambs and a hundred goats beyond his flock."

[517] **Shaar HaKavanot, Discourses on the Morning Prayer, s.v. pasuk poteach et yadekha** — "The initials of 'Poteach et yadekha' are PAI, which is one of the seventy-two names of 'Vayissa, Vayavo, Vayet.' Its mystery is also the joining of the two names, YHWH and Adonai, as YAHDWNHY. You already know what the Zohar and the Tikkunim say: 'Poteach et yadekha'—do not read 'Your hands,' but 'Your yods.' They are the two yods of YAHDWNHY, the first and the last, with six letters between them."

[518] **Daniel 7:9** — "I continued looking until thrones were set in place and the Ancient of Days sat. His garment was white as snow, and the hair of His head like pure wool; His throne was flames of fire, its wheels blazing fire."

וְזֶה נִקְרָא שָׁנָה מִלְּשׁוֹן שׁוֹנֶה **and that is called shanah, from shoneh, repeating,** שֶׁהוּא חוֹזֵר וּמַקִּיף כְּמִקֶּדֶם **for it returns and circles around as before** וְאֵין בּוֹ הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת **and has no renewal.** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל מוֹנִין לַלְּבָנָה **But Yisrael count by the moon,** וְאוֹרָהּ בְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא דְּמִקַּבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **the aspect of the moon that receives from the sun,** מִתְחַדֵּשֶׁת בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ **and its light renews every month.** וְנִיסָן רֹאשׁוֹן לְחָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה דִּלְבָנָה **And Nissan is the first of the lunar months of the year,** וְאָז הוֹצִיא הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **and then Hashem Yisbarach brought** אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרַיִם **Yisrael out of Egypt,** וְנַעֲשׂוּ כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **and they became Knesses Yisrael;** עַל כֵּן נוֹצַר הַחֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **therefore the month of Nissan was formed** רָזָא דְּאֵשֶׁת חַיִל[519] **with the letter Hei, the secret of the Eishes Chayil.** וְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר הָאַחֲרוֹן שֶׁבַּחֳדָשִׁים **And the month of Adar, the last of the months,** נִבְרָא בְּאוֹת ק׳ **was created with the letter Kuf,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז קָדוֹשׁ **which alludes to Kadosh,** שֶׁהָעֵסֶק וְהִתְקַדִּשְׁתֶּם **for its task is "Sanctify yourselves** וִהְיִיתֶם קְדוֹשִׁים כִּי קָדוֹשׁ אֲנִי **and be holy, for I am holy";** וְהוּא בְּחִינַת קוֹף **and this is the aspect of the monkey —** לְהִתְדַּמּוֹת כְּבָיְכוֹל לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **to resemble, as it were, Hashem Yisbarach.**[520] וְזֶהוּ הַקְּדוּשָׁה מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל **And this is holiness from the side of Yisrael —** אִשָּׁה יִרְאַת ה׳ **"a woman who fears Hashem."** וְשַׁבָּת יֵשׁ בּוֹ קְדוּשָׁה **And Shabbos has a holiness** דְּקָבְיָא וְקַיְימָא מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **that is fixed and established by Hashem Yisbarach,** לָדַעַת [שְׁמוֹת לא, יג] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Shemos 31:13): "to know** כִּי אֲנִי ה׳ מְקַדִּשְׁכֶם **that I am Hashem who sanctifies you";** וְהִיא מַתָּנָה טוֹבָה בְּבֵית גְּנָזַי **and it is "a good gift from My treasure house"** שֶׁנָּתַן לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **that He gave to Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת י, ב) **(as stated in Shabbos 10b).** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל מִצִּדָּם גַּם כֵּן **And Yisrael, from their side, as well —** כְּתִיב זָכוֹר לְקַדְּשׁוֹ [שְׁמוֹת כ, ח] **it is written "Remember it, to sanctify it" (Shemos 20:8),** שָׁמוֹר לְקַדְּשׁוֹ [דְּבָרִים ה, יב] **"Guard it, to sanctify it" (Devarim 5:12) —**[521] שֶׁמַּכְנִיסִין קְדוּשָׁה לְשַׁבָּת **for they bring holiness into Shabbos,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **as they said in the Pesikta** ([פָּרָשָׁה כג] וּבְמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה נָשֹׂא י, א) **(Parashah 23; and in Midrash Rabbah, Naso 10:1):** בַּמָּה מְקַדְּשׁוֹ **"With what does one sanctify it?** בְּמַאֲכָל וּבְמִשְׁתֶּה[522] וְכוּלֵי **With food and with drink, etc."** וּכְשֶׁחָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **And when Rosh Chodesh Adar,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ בְּשַׁבָּת **formed with the letter Kuf — Kadosh — falls on Shabbos,** שֶׁבּוֹ גַּם כֵּן הָעֵסֶק **on which too the task is** בְּחִינַת הַקְּדוּשָׁה **the aspect of holiness,** אָז בְּנָקֵל לְהַשִּׂיג **then it is easy to attain holiness,** וְכִבְחִינַת קוֹף בִּפְנֵי שְׁכִינָה **in the manner of "a monkey before the Shechinah":** קְדוֹשִׁים תִּהְיוּ כִּי קָדוֹשׁ אֲנִי וְגוֹמֵר **"You shall be holy, for I am holy, etc."** וְאַחַר כָּךְ מְסַמֵּךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִגְאוּלָּה[523] **And afterward one joins redemption to redemption** (מְגִילָּה ו, ב) **(Megillah 6b),** שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לְזְכוּת בְּחֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **so that we may merit, in the month of Nissan,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ה׳ **formed with the letter Hei —** [רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יא, א] בְּנִיסָן עֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל **"in Nissan they are destined to be redeemed" (Rosh Hashanah 11a) —** שֶׁהוּא הַקְּדוּשָׁה מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **which is holiness from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִיכָה ז, טו] **in the manner of what is said (Michah 7:15):** כִּימֵי צֵאתְךָ מֵאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם אַרְאֶנּוּ נִפְלָאוֹת **"As in the days of your going out of the land of Egypt, I will show him wonders" —** מִפֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן: **from the supernal Wonder.**

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[519] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 11** — "Rabbi Levi said in the name of Rabbi Acha bar Chanina: As long as Amalek's seed is in the world, neither the Name nor the throne is whole. When Amalek's seed perishes, the Name is whole and the throne is whole. What is the reason? 'The enemy—the ruins are ended forever....' What is written afterward? 'But the Lord sits forever; He has established His throne for judgment.' Thus the Name is whole and the throne is whole."

[520] **Psalms 4:8** — "You have placed joy in my heart, more than at the time when their grain and new wine increased."

[521] **Proverbs 23:15** — "My son, if your heart becomes wise, my heart too shall rejoice."

[522] **Berakhot 11a** — "A mourner is obligated in all the commandments stated in the Torah except tefillin, for they are called an adornment, as it is said, 'Bind your adornment upon yourself.'"

[523] **Shemot Rabbah 23:1** — "Although You have existed forever, Your throne was not established and You were not known in Your world until Your children sang.... A king fought a war and won, and they made him Augustus. They said: 'Before the war you were a king; now we have made you Augustus.' What difference in honor is there? The king stands upon the platform, while Augustus sits. Thus Israel said: 'Before You created Your world You existed; since You created it You exist, but, as it were, standing.... When You stood at the sea and we sang before You with az, Your sovereignty became settled and Your throne established.'"

ראש חדש אדר, מאמר ד׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Daled

וכוולי ואדר בשנה בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק **In Sefer Yetzirah: "He crowned the letter Kuf with laughter, etc., and Adar in the year."** דְּבָאֱמֶת אֵיתָא אֲמַר שְׂחוֹק וְלֹא לְשׁוֹן שִׂמְחָה **It says "laughter" and not a term of joy,** שֶׁיְּמַלֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו בָּעוֹלָם (בְּרָכוֹת לא, א) **for indeed it is stated (Berachos 31a): "A person is forbidden** אָסוּר לְאָדָם **to fill his mouth with laughter in this world."** וּלְהָבִין לָמָּה נִבְרָא הַשְׂחוֹק **And we must understand why laughter was created,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהוּא אָסוּר בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **since it is forbidden in this world.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ דְּמַשְׁמַע **We have already said that it implies** שֶׁאַף לִדְבַר מִצְוָה **that even for the sake of a mitzvah** אָסוּר לְמַלֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו **it is forbidden to fill one's mouth with laughter,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדִּקְדְּקוּ שָׁם בַּבָּרַיְיתָא **as they inferred there from the Baraisa:** שִׂמְחָה שֶׁל מִצְוָה **it says "the joy of a mitzvah,"** וְלֹא אָמְרוּ שְׂחוֹק שֶׁל מִצְוָה **and they did not say "the laughter of a mitzvah,"** דְּאַיְירֵי בָּהּ **though that is the subject under discussion;** מִכָּלָל דִּשְׂחוֹק אַף דְּמִצְוָה אָסוּר **this implies that laughter, even of a mitzvah, is forbidden.** וּלְפִי זֶה דִּקְדְּקוּ **Accordingly we raised a difficulty** בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (שָׁם ט, ב) **with what is related (ibid. 9b)** בְּרַב בְּרוּנָא דְּשָׁמַח בְּמִצְוֹת **about Rav Bruna, who rejoiced in mitzvos:** זִימְנָא חֲדָא סָמַךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִתְפִלָּה **once he joined Geulah to Tefillah,** וְלָא פְּסִיק חוּכָא מִפּוּמֵיהּ כּוּלֵּי יוֹמָא **and laughter did not leave his mouth all day.** וְאֵיךְ הוּתַּר לוֹ הַשְׂחוֹק **How then was laughter permitted to him,** לְפִי הָאָמוּר דְּאַף שְׂחוֹק דְּמִצְוָה אָסוּר **according to what was said, that even laughter of a mitzvah is forbidden?** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַבְנוּ מַאֲמָר ב) **(as we wrote in maamar 2).** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת נִרְאֶה **But in truth it appears** דְּשְׂחוֹק וְשִׂמְחָה הוּא עִנְיָן אֶחָד **that laughter and joy are one matter,** רַק דְּשִׂמְחָה בַּלֵּב **only that joy is in the heart,** וּשְׂחוֹק הוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב **and laughter is the revealing of the joy in the heart.** וְיֵשׁ סַעַד לָזֶה מֵהַגְּמָרָא **And there is support for this from the Gemara** (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ג, ב) **(Avodah Zarah 3b): "From the day the Beis HaMikdash was destroyed** מִיּוֹם שֶׁחָרַב בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **there is no laughter for the Holy One, blessed be He.** אֵין שְׂחוֹק לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **And from where do we know there is no laughter?** וּמִנַּלַן דְּלֵיכָּא שְׂחוֹק **Shall we say from what is written, etc.?** אִילֵימָא מִדִּכְתִיב וְכוּלֵּי **Perhaps it is forgetting that there is not,** דִּלְמָא שִׂכְחָה הוּא דְּלֵיכָּא **but laughter, at least, there is."** וְגִירְסַת עֵין יַעֲקֹב **And the reading of the Ein Yaakov is** אֲבָל שְׂחוֹק מִיהָא אִיכָּא **"but joy, at least, there is,"**[524] וְכֵן נִרְאֶה דְּגִירְסָתוֹ דַּוְוקָא **and it appears that his reading is the precise one,** שֶׁהַשִּׂמְחָה הֵיפֶךְ הַבֶּכִי וּמִסְפֵּד **for joy is the opposite of weeping and lament.** וּמָה רְאָיָה מִשִּׂמְחָה לִשְׂחוֹק **And what proof is there from joy to laughter?** אֶלָּא עַל כָּרְחָךְ **Rather, perforce** דִּשְׂחוֹק וְשִׂמְחָה אֶחָד הֵם **laughter and joy are one,** רַק דְּשִׂמְחָה בַּלֵּב **only that joy is in the heart** וּשְׂחוֹק הוּא שִׂמְחָה בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת **and laughter is joy in revelation.** וְהִנֵּה הַשִּׂמְחָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **Now, joy in this world** טוֹב לִדְבַר מִצְוָה **is good,** [כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים קה, ג **as it says (Tehillim 105:3):** יִשְׂמַח לֵב מְבַקְשֵׁי ה׳ **"Let the heart of those who seek Hashem rejoice,"** וְנֶאֱמַר (זְכַרְיָה י, ז) **and it says (Zechariah 10:7):** וּבְנֵיהֶם יִרְאוּ וְשָׂמְחוּ **"And their children shall see and rejoice,** גָּגַל לִבָּם בַּה׳ **their heart shall exult in Hashem."** אֲבָל הַשְׂחוֹק הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **But laughter, the revealing of joy —** זֶה יִהְיֶה רַק לֶעָתִיד **that will be only in the future,** [כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים קכו, ב **as it says (Tehillim 126:2):** אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **"Then our mouth will be filled with laughter** וּלְשׁוֹנֵנוּ רִנָּה **and our tongue with song";** וְרִנָּה הוּא גַּם כֵּן הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **and song too is a revealing of joy.** אַךְ מִכָּל מָקוֹם מָצִינוּ **Yet nevertheless we find,** גַּם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה שִׁירוֹת וְתִשְׁבָּחוֹת **even in this world, songs and praises,** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל מְשׁוּבָּחִים בָּזֶה **and Yisrael are praised for this:** בְּמַה שֶׁבְּשַׁבָּת **that on Shabbos,** כְּשֶׁאוֹכְלִין וְשׁוֹתִין **when they eat and drink,** מַתְחִילִין בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **they begin with words of Torah**[525] **and with words of praise** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִילָּה יב, ב) **(as stated in Megillah 12b).** וַהֲלֹא גַּם הָרִנָּה כְּתִיב אָז וְגוֹמֵר **Yet regarding song too it is written, "Then, etc.,** וּלְשׁוֹנֵנוּ רִנָּה **and our tongue with song,"** וּמִינָּהּ יָלֵיף **and from this verse he derives**

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[524] **Commentary attributed to Raavad on Sefer Yetzirah 5:1** — "Laughter is assigned to Naphtali, as it is said, 'Of Naphtali he said: Naphtali, satisfied with favor and full...'; thought is assigned to Issachar.... Sleep is assigned to Benjamin, as it is said, 'He dwells between his shoulders.'... By all these twelve qualities we describe the activity of the blessed God: seeing—'The Lord saw'; hearing—'The Lord heard'; smelling—'The Lord smelled'; speech—'The Lord spoke'.... Laughter—'He who sits in heaven laughs'; thought—'The Lord planned to destroy'; sleep—'Awake! Why do You sleep, Lord?'"

[525] **Avodah Zarah 3b** — "When they see the war of Gog and Magog, he asks them, 'Against whom have you come?' They answer, 'Against the Lord and His anointed,' as it is said, 'Why do the nations rage, and the peoples meditate emptiness?' Each one tears off his commandment and departs, as it is said, 'Let us tear off their bonds.' The Holy One, blessed be He, sits and laughs, as it is said, 'He who sits in heaven laughs.' Rabbi Yitzchak said: The Holy One, blessed be He, has no laughter except on that day alone."

וְאִם כֵּן הוּא **that it is forbidden to fill one's mouth with laughter in this world;** דְּאָסוּר לְמַלֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **if so, the same applies to song,** דְּצָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת אָסוּר בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **that it ought to be forbidden in this world,** וּלְפִי הָאָמוּר אַף דְּמִצְוָה **and according to the above, even song of a mitzvah.** אֲמָנָם בֶּאֱמֶת עִיקַּר הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **However, in truth, the essential revealing of joy** יִהְיֶה רַק לֶעָתִיד **will be only in the future,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא יוֹם כְּאוֹר יוֹם הַהוּא **which is called "that day,"** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁיָּאִיר וְיִתְגַּלֶּה **meaning that there will shine and be revealed,** וְהַיְנוּ עַתִּיקָא דְּאִתְכַּסְיָא **that is, Atika, the Concealed One,** מִדַּת הוּא דְּאֶקְרֵי הוּא[526] **like the light of day, the attribute of Hu, who is called Hu** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רצ, א) **(as stated in Zohar III 290a).** וּבָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה בְּחִינַת זוֹ **And in this world this aspect** נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן **is hidden from all thought,** וְיִתְגַּלֶּה רַק לֶעָתִיד **and it will be revealed only in the future.** וְזֶהוּ נִקְרָא אָז **And this is called Az, "then,"** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב נד, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Zohar II 54a):** אָז כַּד אִתְנְהִיר **"Az — when there shines** נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **the light of the Holy Ancient One** אִתְחֲבִיר נְהִירוּ בְּעָטְרוֹי גְּלִיפִין רְשִׁימִין **in His engraved, inscribed crowns,** בְּאָלֶף וְכוּלֵי **in Aleph, etc.,** דְּאָלֶף **the light of Aleph joins** וּמָטוּ לְזַיִן וְכוּלֵי **and reaches Zayin, etc."** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **And this is what it says: "Then our mouth will be filled with laughter** וּלְשׁוֹנֵנוּ רִנָּה אָז דְּיֵיקָא **and our tongue with song" — "then," Az, specifically.** וְכֵן בְּשַׁבָּת שֶׁיֵּשׁ הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **So too on Shabbos, when there is a revelation of Atika,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (סוֹף פָּרָשַׁת אַחֲרֵי חֵלֶק ג עט, ב) **(end of Parshas Acharei, III 79b,** וְיִתְרוֹ חֵלֶק ב פח, א) **and Yisro, II 88a),** דְּמַלְיָא רֵישֵׁיהּ דְּזֵעִיר אַנְפִּין **that the head of Zeir Anpin is filled** מִטַּלָּא דְּנָחִית מֵעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **with the dew that descends from the Holy Ancient One** וְאַטִּיל לַחֲקַלָּא דְּתַפּוּחִין קַדִּישִׁין **and drips into the Field of Holy Apples —** אֲזַי נִפְתָּח גַּם כֵּן הַפֶּה **then the mouth too is opened** לוֹמַר שִׁירוֹת וְתִשְׁבָּחוֹת **to say songs and praises,** וּלְשׁוֹנֵנוּ רִנָּה **"and our tongue with song."** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן בִּכְלָל **And this too is included in** מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר אָז יִמָּלֵא וְגוֹמֵר **what it says, "Then will be filled, etc.,"** דְּכְשֶׁיֵּשׁ הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **for when there is a revelation of Atika** נִקְרָא אָז כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **it is called Az, as mentioned above.** (מִשְׁלֵי) וּכְתִיב **And it is written (Mishlei 20:15):** (כ, טו) וּכְלִי יְקָר שִׂפְתֵי דָעַת **"But lips of knowledge are a precious vessel,"** (שָׁם כד, ד) **and it says (ibid. 24:4):** וְנֶאֱמַר וּבְדַעַת חֲדָרִים יִמָּלְאוּ **"And by knowledge the chambers are filled** כָּל הוֹן יָקָר וְנָעִים **with all precious and pleasant wealth."** וְהַיְנוּ דְּדַעַת **That is, Da'as** פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר בַּנּוֹדָע **is the inner dimension of Keser, as is known.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **And we have already said many times** שֶׁבְּחִבּוּר הַחָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ לַבִּינָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב **that through joining the wisdom in the mind to the understanding in the heart,** זוֹכִין לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת **one merits the aspect of Da'as,** [שָׁם ב, י] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (ibid. 2:10):** כִּי תָבוֹא חָכְמָה בְלִבֶּךָ **"For wisdom shall enter your heart,** וְדַעַת לְנַפְשְׁךָ יִנְעָם **and knowledge shall be pleasant to your soul."** וְזֶה נִקְרָא יְקָר **And this is the aspect of the revelation of Atika,** וְזֶהוּ בְּחִינַת הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **and this is called "precious,"** (מְגִילָּה טז, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ **as they alluded (Megillah 16b):** "'וְיִקָר אֵלּוּ תְּפִילִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ[527] **"'And honor' — these are the tefillin of the head,"** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **which alludes to Keser Elyon,** קַרְקַפְתָּא דְּתְפִילִּין **the head on which the tefillin rest** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(and this was explained many times).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מַלְאָכִי ב, ז] **And this is what it says (Malachi 2:7):** כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת **"For the lips of the Kohen guard knowledge,** וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ **and they seek Torah from his mouth."** וְהַיְנוּ דְּבְחִינַת דַּעַת **That is, the aspect of Da'as** נִקְרָא גַּם רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **is also called Ruach HaKodesh,** (פָּרָשַׁת תְּשָׂא לא, ג) כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשִׁ"י **as Rashi writes (Parshas Ki Sisa 31:3);** וְהַיְנוּ הַהַשָּׂגָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ[528] **meaning the perception beyond the**

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[526] **Genesis 1:5** — "God called the light Day, and the darkness He called Night. There was evening and there was morning: one day." The letter qof first occurs in the Torah in vayikra, "He called." This is the textual basis for Rav Tzadok's association of qof with the first light.

[527] **Bava Kamma 55a** — "Rabbi Yehoshua said: One who sees tet in his dream has a favorable sign.... Rather, it is because Scripture first opened with it for good: from 'In the beginning' until 'God saw the light,' tet is not written." The Gemara discusses tet's first occurrence in tov. Rav Tzadok applies that principle to qof's first occurrence in vayikra in Genesis 1:5.

[528] **Zohar III, 169b (Shelach)** — "'On the third day Esther clothed herself in royalty'—she clothed herself in that likeness of the other world. Royalty is the holy spirit, for the kingdom of heaven sends forth a spirit from the air of that world, and Esther clothed herself in it. When she entered before King Achashverosh and he saw that garment of light, her appearance seemed like an angel of God, and his soul departed from him for a moment. Mordechai was likewise, as it is written, 'Mordechai went out from before the king in royal clothing': royal clothing indeed, the likeness of that world. Therefore it is written, 'The fear of Mordechai fell upon them'—the fear of Mordechai, and not the fear of Achashverosh."

bounds of the wisdom in one's mind. רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ כְּלוֹמַר **Ruach HaKodesh — that is,** רוּחַ[529] מֵהַהוּא קֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא **a spirit from that Holy One Above,** (חֵלֶק ג סא, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar (III 61a).** וְאָז תּוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ **And then "they seek Torah from his mouth":** מַלְכוּת פֶּה **Malchus is the mouth,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפָתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pasach Eliyahu);** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן **as the Ramban writes** (חִידּוּשֵׁי בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב, א) **(Chiddushim, Bava Basra 12a)** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **that Torah she'b'al peh** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ[530] **comes through Ruach HaKodesh,** וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ [שָׁם] **and about this they said (ibid.):** חָכָם עָדִיף מִנָּבִיא **"A sage is greater than a prophet."** [מְגִלָּה יד, ב] **And so they expounded (Megillah 14b):** וַתִּלְבַּשׁ אֶסְתֵּר מַלְכוּת [אֶסְתֵּר ה, א] **"And Esther clothed herself in royalty" (Esther 5:1) —** שֶׁלְּבָשַׁתָּה רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ[531] **that Ruach HaKodesh clothed her.** וְהִנֵּה אָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת לג, א) **Now, they said (Berachos 33a):** כָּל אָדָם שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ דֵּעָה **"Any person who has knowledge,** כְּאִלּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו[532] **it is as though the Beis HaMikdash was built in his days."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּמִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לְבְחִינַת דַּעַת **That is, whoever merits the aspect of Da'as,** נַעֲשָׂה הַלֵּב שֶׁלּוֹ הַר קָדְשִׁי **his heart becomes "My holy mountain,"** כִּיוָן דְּאִתְפַּנֵּי יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלִּבּוֹ[533] **since the yetzer hara has been cleared from his heart,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **as they said in Tikkunei Zohar** (תִּקּוּן מח פה, א) **(Tikkun 48, 85a);** וּכְתִיב [יְשַׁעְיָה יא, ט] **and it is written (Yeshayahu 11:9):** לֹא יָרֵעוּ וְלֹא יַשְׁחִיתוּ **"They shall not harm nor destroy** בְּכָל הַר קָדְשִׁי **in all My holy mountain";** וְאִיתָא (מִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם, זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קלח, א) **and it is stated (Midrash HaNe'lam, Zohar I 138a):** הוּא לִבָּא **"It is the heart,** דְּמָדוֹרֵיהּ דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע בֵּיהּ **in which the yetzer hara has its dwelling";** וְהַר קָדְשִׁי נִקְרָא בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **and "My holy mountain" denotes the Beis HaMikdash.** וְהוּא כְּאִילּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו **So it is as though the Beis HaMikdash was built in his days —** וְהַיְינוּ בְּלִבּוֹ[534] **that is, in his heart.** וְאָז נִפְתָּח הַפֶּה **And then the mouth is opened** לוֹמַר שִׁירוֹת וּלְרַנֵּן **to say songs and to sing,** דְּנִקְרָא בְּשׁוּב ה' **which is called "When Hashem returns** אֶת

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[529] **Genesis 2:3** — "God blessed the seventh day and sanctified it, because on it He ceased from all His work which God created to do."

[530] **Machberet HaKodesh, Shaar HaShabbos, Likkutim, 34a, column 2** — "Know that of all a person eats during the week, the greater part goes to the external forces, and it contains no spirituality except in the portion necessary to nourish the soul so that it does not separate. Whoever adds beyond this adds strength to the evil inclination. What he eats on Shabbos, however, is entirely spiritual: even if he eats more than necessary, it is absorbed into his limbs." The checked passage is in the original collection's Shabbos gate, under Likkutim, in the discussion of eating. Rav Tzadok uses its contrast between ordinary and Shabbos eating to explain how bodily enjoyment can be sanctified and the serpent's damage repaired on Shabbos.

[531] Parallel: **Resisei Layla 55:8** — "Together with blessing there must also be holiness, so that the illumination of the face remains bounded and distinct and does not become frivolous joy.... Among Israel, on the contrary, it produces holiness in the heart. The light of the face that testifies to strength within the heart comes from no frivolous tranquility, but from tranquility filled with holiness.... Sabbath's blessing is received through prayer.... Holiness is through Kiddush over wine, which gladdens the heart and produces frivolous joy in those who stray through it; but wine of a commandment, on the contrary, produces holiness in the heart and restraint from worldly frivolity."

Connection: The maamar says that even bodily enjoyment on Sabbath can repair the serpent's corruption of eating. This parallel gives the controlling distinction: the same physical wine can produce frivolity or, when received through the mitzvah of Kiddush, a joy governed by holiness.

[532] **Mekhilta deRabbi Yishmael, Vayassa, on Exodus 16:28 (current chapter 6; cited as 5)** — "Rabbi Yehoshua says: The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moses: 'Moses, tell Israel: I brought you out of Egypt, split the sea for you, brought down the manna for you, brought up the well for you, brought you quails, fought Amalek for you, and performed miracles and mighty deeds for you. Until when will you refuse to keep My commandments and My teachings? Perhaps you say that I imposed many commandments upon you? I imposed this Sabbath upon you at Marah to keep it, and you did not keep it! Perhaps you ask what reward one who keeps the Sabbath receives? Scripture says: 'Happy is the person who does this... who keeps the Sabbath from desecrating it and guards his hand from doing any evil.' Thus we learn that whoever keeps the Sabbath despite hardship is saved from transgression.'" The Beeri edition reads "keeps the Sabbath despite hardship, is saved from transgression." The manuscript quotes the related reading "whoever keeps the Sabbath is distanced from transgression."

[533] **Pri Etz Chaim, Gate of the Sabbath 1** — "There is no person who does not receive an additional nefesh, ruach and neshamah, according to his allotted share. A person must direct his intention so that some of this addition remains with him for the weekdays. Through this his ways will be set right, if he directs his intention properly; he is assured that he will not sin, that sins will not come about through him, and that the evil inclination will not accuse him. Everything depends upon the intention."

[534] **Temurah 16a** — "'If You will indeed bless me'—in Torah; 'and enlarge my border'—with students; 'and Your hand will be with me'—so that my learning will not be forgotten from my heart; 'and act against my harm'—so that companions like me will be provided for me; 'that it may not grieve me'—so that the evil inclination will not overpower me and prevent me from studying."

שְׁבִית צִיּוֹן וְגוֹמֵר **the captivity of Zion, etc.,** אָז יִמָּלֵא וְגוֹמֵר **then will be filled, etc."** וְכֵן נִקְרָא אָז **And so it is called Az,** דְּאִתְחַבַּר אָלֶף עִם זַיִן **for Aleph joins with Zayin,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד **as it will be in the future.** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And it is stated in the holy Zohar** (מִשְׁפָּטִים חֶלֶק ב קכג, א) **(Mishpatim, II 123a):** מַאי פּוּמָא **"What is 'mouth'?** וְכוּלֵי[535] אֶלָּא דַּעַת גָּנִיז בְּפוּמָא דְּמַלְכָּא **Rather, Da'as is hidden in the mouth of the King, etc.;** וּבְדַעַת חֲדָרִים יִמָּלְאוּ וְכוּלֵי **'And by knowledge the chambers are filled,' etc.** וְכַד אִתְעַר נְהִירוּ דְּבֵיהּ **And when the light within it is awakened** וְנָפִיק בְּדֵין אִקְרֵי פֻּמֵּהּ דְּ' וְכוּלֵי עַיֵּין שָׁם **and goes forth, then it is called 'the mouth of Hashem,' etc." See there.** [תְּהִלִּים נא, יז] וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what it says (Tehillim 51:17):** אֲדֹנָי שְׂפָתַי תִּפְתָּח לְפִי הָאָמוּר שֶׁלְּפִתּוֹחַ **"My Lord, open my lips,** וּפִי יַגִּיד תְּהִלָּתֶךָ **and my mouth will declare Your praise" —** צָרִיךְ שֶׁיִּזְכֶּה לוֹמַר תְּהִלָּה וְרִנָּה **according to the above, that to open the mouth to say praise and song,**[536] הַפֶּה לְבָחִינַת הַדַּעַת **one must merit the aspect of Da'as,** דְּאָז אִקְרֵי פֻּמֵּהּ דְּ' **for then it is called "the mouth of Hashem,"** וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **that is, as they said** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר מַאֲמַר פָּתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, maamar Pasach Eliyahu),** וְזֶה ה' שְׂפָתַי תִּפְתָּח וּפִי וְגוֹמֵר **and this is "My Lord, open my lips, and my mouth, etc."** מַלְכוּת פֶּה **"Malchus is the mouth";** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן עִנְיַן סְמִיכַת גְּאוּלָּה **And this too is the meaning of joining Geulah to Tefillah,** לִתְפִלָּה שֶׁאֵין הַפֵּירוּשׁ הַסְמִיכָה בְּדִבּוּר לְבַד[537] **for the joining does not mean in speech alone,** שֶׁכְּבָר הִקְשׁוּ תּוֹסָפוֹת **since Tosafos already asked** (בְּרָכוֹת הַנִּזְקָק דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל כָּל הַסּוֹמֵךְ) **(Berachos, cited above, s.v. Kol HaSomech):** וַהֲלֹא כָּל הָעוֹלָם **"But does not everyone** סוֹמְכִין גְּאוּלָּה לִתְפִלָּה **join Geulah to Tefillah?** וּמַאי רְבוּתֵיהּ דְּרַב בְּרוּנָא **So what is so special about Rav Bruna,** דְּלָא פְּסִיק חוּכָא מִפּוּמֵּיהּ **that laughter did not leave his mouth?"** רַק הָעִנְיָן עַל פִּי **Rather, the matter is according to** מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **what they said in the Yerushalmi** (בְּרָכוֹת פֶּרֶק א הֲלָכָה ו יא, ב) **(Berachos 1:6, 11b),** דְּצָרִיךְ לְהַזְכִּיר בֶּאֱמֶת וְיַצִּיב **that one must mention in "Emes VeYatziv"** קְרִיעַת יַם סוּף וּמַכַּת בְּכוֹרִים[538] **the splitting of the Yam Suf and the plague of the firstborn;** שֶׁנִּצְטַוִּינוּ לְזָכוֹר תָּמִיד בְּכָל יוֹם **that is, regarding the Exodus from Egypt, which we were commanded to remember constantly, every day;** הָעִקָּר הִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר עַתִּיקָא **the main point is the revelation of the light of Atika** שֶׁהָיָה בְּמַכַּת בְּכוֹרִים **that occurred in the plague of the firstborn,** שֶׁהָיָה מַכָּה עֲשִׂירִית **which was the tenth plague.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **We have already said many times** שֶׁהָעֶשֶׂר מַכּוֹת הָיוּ נֶגֶד עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת מִתַּתָּא לְעֵילָּא **that the ten plagues were corresponding to the ten Sefiros, from below to above,** בְּסוֹד נָגוּף לְמִצְרַיִם **in the secret of "smiting Egypt** וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל [רְאֵה זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֶלֶק ב לוֹ, א] **and healing Yisrael" (see the holy Zohar II 36a);** וּבְמַכַּת בְּכוֹרִים **and in the plague of the firstborn** יָצָא יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵרֵאשִׁית דְּקִלִּיפָּה **Yisrael went out from the beginning of the kelipah** וְזָכוּ לִכְנוֹס בַּמַּדָּה שֶׁכְּנֶגְדָּהּ **and merited to enter the corresponding attribute in holiness,** וְהַיְינוּ אוֹר כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **namely the light of Keser Elyon.** וְכֵן בִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **And so too with the splitting of the Yam Suf,** (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ב נב, ב) דְּאִיתָא **as it is stated (Zohar II**

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[535] **Rashi on Deuteronomy 25:18** — "Another interpretation: it is the language of cold and heat. He cooled you and made you lukewarm after your boiling heat. All the nations feared to fight against you; he came and began, showing the way to others. This is comparable to a boiling bath into which no creature could descend. A reckless person came and jumped into it: although he was scalded, he cooled it for others."

[536] **Sanhedrin 106a** — "What is the meaning of the name Rephidim? Rabbi Eliezer says: Rephidim was its name. Rabbi Yehoshua says: they weakened themselves in words of Torah, as it is said, 'Fathers did not turn toward children because of the weakness of their hands.'"

[537] Parallel: **Resisei Layla 29:1** — "Although a person is drowsy, and in drowsiness has no heart, for a person cannot remain firmly at his station and the heart's first powerful awakening weakens with time, the counsel is: 'Commit your works to the Lord, and your thoughts will be established.' For the blessed God does not become drowsy. This is the meaning of 'I sleep, but my heart is awake,' which our Sages explained: the Holy One, blessed be He, is called Israel's heart.... He is awake to give life to the deeds a person performs as though drowsy."

Connection: This identifies the "awake heart" with God's continuing support when human spiritual attention weakens. It clarifies why the maamar treats sleep as concealment of an enduring bond rather than the disappearance of that bond.

[538] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2** — "The congregation of Israel said before the Holy One, blessed be He: 'Master of the world, I sleep from the commandments, but my heart is awake to acts of kindness. I sleep from acts of charity, but my heart is awake to perform them. I sleep from the sacrifices, but my heart is awake to the recitation of Shema and prayer. I sleep from the Temple, but my heart is awake to synagogues and houses of study. I sleep from the end, but my heart is awake to redemption. I sleep from redemption, but the heart of the Holy One, blessed be He, is awake to redeem me.' Rabbi Chiyya bar Abba said: 'Where do we find that the Holy One, blessed be He, is called the heart of Israel? From the verse, 'God is the rock of my heart and my portion forever.'"

52b) דְּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף בָּעַתִּיקָא תַּלְיָא[539] **that the splitting of the Yam Suf depends on Atika;** וְאִיתָא בְּמְכִילְתָּא [פָּרָשַׁת הַשִּׁירָה ג] **and it is stated in the Mechilta (Parshas HaShirah 3)** וְזֹהַר קָדוֹשׁ [חֶלֶק ב סד, ב] **and the holy Zohar (II 64b):** רָאֲתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם מַה שֶּׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל[540] **what Yechezkel did not see" —** וְהַיְינוּ לְהָיוֹת צוֹפִין בַּמֶּרְכָּבָה **that is, to gaze upon the Merkavah,** הִתְגַּלּוּת מֵעַתִּיקָא **a revelation from Atika,** שֶׁהוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן **which is hidden from all thought.** וְזֶה צָרִיךְ לְסָמוֹךְ לִתְפִלָּה **And this must be joined to Tefillah,** וְהַתְּפִלָּה מְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת שֶׁהוּא עוֹמֵד לְפָנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **in which one stands before the King,** וְאָז וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אֲדֹנָי שְׂפָתַי תִּפְתָּח וְגוֹמֵר **and Tefillah is of the attribute of Malchus, as it says, "My Lord, open my lips, etc."** כְּשֶׁיִּזְכֶּה לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת אִתְּעַר נְהִירוּ דְּבֵיהּ **And then, when he merits the aspect of Da'as, the light within it is awakened,** כְּדֵין אִקְרֵי פֻּמֵּהּ ה׳ וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מֵהַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and then it is called "the mouth of Hashem," as we cited from the holy Zohar;** וְאָז תִּהְיֶה שְׁכִינָה מְדַבֶּרֶת מִתּוֹךְ גְּרוֹנוֹ דִּבְרֵי הַתְּפִלָּה **and then the Shechinah will speak the words of prayer from within his throat,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים מַרְבֵּנוּ רַבִּי אֱלִימֶלֶךְ זְכָר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה **as we have said many times in the name of our master, Rabbi Elimelech, may the memory of the holy tzaddik be a blessing,** שֶׁזֶּה עִנְיַן שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מִתְפַּלֵּל[541] **that this is the meaning of "the Holy One, blessed be He, prays" —** [בְּרָכוֹת ז, א] הַיְינוּ בְּתוֹךְ פִּיפְיוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל[542] **(Berachos 7a) — namely, within the mouths of Yisrael.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (בְּרָכוֹת ד, ב) **And this is what they said in the Gemara (Berachos 4b):** אֵיזֶהוּ בֶּן עוֹלָם הַבָּא **"Who is a ben Olam Haba?** זֶה הַסּוֹמֵךְ גְּאוּלָּה שֶׁל עַרְבִית לִתְפִלָּה[543] וְכוּלֵי **One who joins the Geulah of Maariv to Tefillah, etc."** וְהִנֵּה כְּבָר דִּקְדְּקוּ הַתּוֹסָפוֹת **Now Tosafos already raised a difficulty** (כְּתוּבוֹת קג, ב דְּבוּר מְזוּמָּן לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם **on what was said there,** הַמַּתְחִיל מְזוּמָּן) **(Kesubos 103b, s.v. Mezuman) "destined for the life of the World to Come" —** דְּהָא כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל[544] יֵשׁ לָהֶן חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **for surely all Yisrael have a share in the World to Come** [סַנְהֶדְרִין צ, א] **(Sanhedrin 90a);** וְתֵירוּץ הַתּוֹסָפוֹת **and Tosafos' answer is** אָמְנָם לְפִי הָאָמוּר לֹא שַׁיָּיךְ עַל לְשׁוֹן בֶּן עוֹלָם הַבָּא **that this does not apply to the expression "ben Olam Haba."** **However, according to the above,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בַּהוֹוֶה יִתְפָּרֵשׁ בֶּן עוֹלָם הַבָּא **"ben Olam Haba" is to be explained**

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[539] **Esther 3:8** — "Haman said to King Ahasuerus: There is one people, scattered and dispersed among the peoples in all the provinces of your kingdom; their laws differ from those of every people, and they do not perform the king's laws. It does not benefit the king to leave them."

[540] **Midrash Tanchuma, Toldot 1** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai said: Great is peace, for the Torah spoke untrue words for the sake of peace. Which words? 'Thus shall you say to Joseph: Please forgive your brothers' transgression and sin.' We do not find that Jacob commanded any of these things; rather, he knew Joseph's piety and would not suspect him or regard him as a shedder of blood." Rav Tzadok refers to an inference developed elsewhere from this exceptional treatment of an untrue report for the sake of peace. The Midrash does not state his general principle in those exact words.

[541] **Esther Rabbah 7:13** — "Moses said: 'Is there a worthy man in that generation?' Elijah answered, 'There is, and his name is Mordechai.' Moses said: 'Go and inform him, so that he will stand in prayer there and I here, and we will seek mercy for them before the Holy One, blessed be He.' Elijah said: 'Faithful shepherd, a decree of destruction has already been written against Israel.' Moses said: 'If it is sealed with clay, our prayer is heard; if it is sealed with blood, what has happened has happened.' He answered: 'It is sealed with clay.' Moses our teacher said: 'Go and inform Mordechai.'"

[542] Parallel: **R. Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Tanya, Likkutei Amarim 19:10–12** — "This exile of the soul's wisdom affects only the influence extending from it throughout the soul to give it life. The root and essence of this wisdom in the divine soul, however, is in the mind. It is not actually clothed in exile within the sackcloth of the kelippah in the heart's left chamber; rather, in the wicked it is asleep and does not act upon them while their thought and understanding are occupied with worldly desires. But when they face a trial in faith, which is above knowledge, and it touches the soul's wisdom, this wisdom awakens from sleep and acts through God's power clothed within it, as it says, 'Hashem awoke as one asleep.' They then withstand the test without any reason, knowledge or intellectual explanation they can grasp. … Although the kelippos have overpowered them throughout their lives, when the test concerns faith in the one God, all the kelippos are nullified before the divine light clothed in the soul's wisdom."

Connection: Tanya distinguishes the soul's outward influence, which can be captive to wrongdoing, from its essential wisdom, which remains only dormant. This supplies a precise model for Rav Tzadok's conjunction of a valid charge against Israel's conduct and an untouched holy root. Tanya also identifies a test that reaches faith beyond reason as the trigger for sudden awakening even after lifelong failure—a further dimension of the existential decree described here. The two authors locate the recovery in a root deeper than the conduct exposed to accusation, without denying the reality of that conduct.

[543] **Deuteronomy 33:12** — "Of Benjamin he said: Beloved of the Lord, he shall dwell securely beside Him; He shelters him all day long, and between his shoulders He dwells."

[544] **II Samuel 12:25** — "He sent through Nathan the prophet, and he called his name Yedidyah, on account of the Lord."

תֵּיכָף[545] **that he will be, in the present, right away,** בֶּן עוֹלָם הַבָּא **a ben Olam Haba,** שֶׁיַּשִּׂיג מֵאוֹר הֶעָתִיד **who attains of the light of the future,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא יוֹם הַהוּא **which is called "that day":** שֶׁנֶּאֱיר לוֹ בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה בְּחִינַת הוּא **that the aspect of Hu shine for him in this world,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּזְכֶּה לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת **that is, that he merit the aspect of Da'as.** (בְּרָכוֹת יז, א) וְהוּא כְּעֵין מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **It is akin to what they said (Berachos 17a):** עוֹלָמְךָ תִּרְאֶה בְּחַיֶּיךָ[546] **"May you see your world in your lifetime,"** שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁבֵּרְכוּהוּ **which we explained means that they blessed him** שֶׁיִּזְכֶּה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **that he merit, in this world,** מַעֵין הִתְגַּלּוּת עוֹלָם הַבָּא **a semblance of the revelation of the World to Come.** וְזֶה זוֹכֶה כְּשֶׁסּוֹמֵךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִתְפִלָּה **And one merits this when he joins Geulah to Tefillah,** שֶׁהוּא קְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **which is the splitting of the Yam Suf** וּמַכּוֹת בְּכוֹרִים **and the plague of the firstborn,** שֶׁהֵם מֵאוֹר עַתִּיקָא **which come from the light of Atika;** וְזוֹכֶה לְהִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר הַדַּעַת **and he merits the revelation of the light of Da'as,** לִהְיוֹת אֲדֹנָי שְׂפָתַי תִּפְתָּח כָּאָמוּר **to be "My Lord, open my lips," as said** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לַ"ג בָּעוֹמֶר מַאֲמָר ג-ד) **(and explained in Lag BaOmer, maamarim 3–4).** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לָזֶה **And since he merits this,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כְּמוֹ בָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא **to be as in the World to Come,** הוּתַּר לוֹ הַשִּׂמְחָה בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת **joy in revealed form is permitted to him.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרַב בְּרוּנָא **And this is what they said about Rav Bruna,** דְּסָמַךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִתְפִלָּה **that he joined Geulah to Tefillah:** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁזָּכָה לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת **meaning that he merited the aspect of Da'as** וּלְהִתְגַּלּוּת מֵאוֹר עַתִּיקָא **and the revelation of the light of Atika,** וְהוּא כְּאִלּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו **and it was as though the Beis HaMikdash was built in his days,** וּכְבָר הוּא בֶּן עוֹלָם הַבָּא בַּהווֹ **and he was already a ben Olam Haba in the present.** וְעַל כֵּן הוּתַּר לוֹ הַשִּׂמְחָה בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת[547] **Therefore revealed joy was permitted to him,** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ דְּלָא פְּסִיק חוּכָא **and this is what they said: laughter did not leave** מִפּוּמֵיהּ כּוּלֵּיהּ יוֹמָא **his mouth all day.** (בַּמִּדְבָּר חֵלֶק ג קיח, א) וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And in the holy Zohar (Bamidbar, III 118a):** [יְשַׁעְיָה סו, י] שִׂמְחוּ אֶת יְרוּשָׁלַיִם **"'Rejoice with Yerushalayim' (Yeshayahu 66:10) —** בְּגִין דְּחֶדְוָה לָא אִשְׁתְּכַח **because joy is not found** דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל אֶלָּא בְּזִמְנָא **except at the time when Yisrael** וְכוּלֵי קַיְימֵי בְּאַרְעָא קַדִּישָׁא[548] **dwell in the Holy Land, etc."** אֲבָל לְפִי הָאָמוּר **But according to the above,** דְּהַמְכוּנָן שֶׁזָּכָה לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת **the point is that he merited the aspect of Da'as,** וּכְאִלּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו **and it is as though the Beis HaMikdash was built in his days —** וְקַל וָחוֹמֶר שֶׁהוּא כְּמוֹ **all the more so is it like** בְּזִמְנָא דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל שְׁרוּיִים בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **the time when Yisrael dwell in Eretz Yisrael,** וְשִׂמְחוּ אֶת יְרוּשָׁלַיִם **and "Rejoice with Yerushalayim";** [תְּהִלִּים ק, ב] וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **and of this it says (Tehillim 100:2),** עִבְדוּ אֶת ה' בְּשִׂמְחָה **"Serve Hashem with joy,"** [שָׁם] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar (ibid.).** וְאָז הוּתַּר גַּם הַשִּׂמְחָה **And then joy too is permitted** בְּהִתְגַּלּוּת בְּרָנָּה וּשְׁחוֹק **in revealed form, with song and laughter.** וְזֶהוּ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said:** הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק' בִּשְׂחוֹק **"He crowned the letter Kuf with laughter."** דְּאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **For it is stated in the holy Zohar** (חַיֵּי שָׂרָה חֵלֶק א קכג, א) **(Chayei Sarah, I 123a):** מֵאָה שָׁנָה כֻּלָּא **"A hundred years — the sum of all,** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא דְּאִתְכְּלִיל **the Holy One, blessed be He, who is comprised** מֵאֲתַר עִלָּאָה סְתִימָא דְּכָל סְתִימִין **from the supernal place, most hidden of all hidden,** בְּמֵאָה בְּרָזָא **in a hundred, in the secret** דְּמֵאָה בִּרְכָאן דְּכָל יוֹמָא[549] **of the hundred blessings of each day."** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַמְכוּנָן עַל עַתִּיקָא **And we said that this refers to Atika,** [חֵלֶק ב פט, א] שֶׁנִּקְרָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **which is called in the holy Zohar (II 89a)** סְתִימָא דְּכָל סְתִימִין **"the most hidden of all hidden."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּמִסְפַּר מֵאָה **That is, the number one hundred**

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[545] **Psalms 127:2** — "It is vain for you to rise early and sit up late, eating the bread of painful toil; He gives thus to His beloved in sleep."

[546] **Zohar I, 149b–150a (Vayetzei)** — "It is written, 'The Lord appeared to Solomon in a dream of the night, and God said: Ask what I should give you.'... Here one level was included within another, a higher level within a lower level, because Solomon had not yet attained completeness. Once he attained completeness, it is written, 'The Lord gave wisdom to Solomon,' and, 'Solomon's wisdom increased.' The moon stood in its fullness and the Temple was built. Then Solomon saw wisdom eye to eye and did not need a dream."

[547] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2, s.v. pitchi li** — "Rabbi Yassa said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: 'My children, open for Me one opening of repentance like the point of a needle, and I will open for you openings through which wagons and carriages can enter.'"

[548] **Peri Tzadik, Rosh Chodesh Shvat 4:1** — "The verse alludes: 'Return, wayward children,' which they explained: 'You were wayward from the outset.' Repentance is a cure retroactively, unlike a person whose blemish has merely healed. After deliberate sins have become like inadvertent sins through repentance from fear, arising from the person below, the blessed God arouses from above: 'Return, wayward children—you were wayward from the outset,' to bring about repentance from love.... He becomes repaired from his very beginning."

[549] **Yoma 86a** — "Rabbi Chama bar Chanina raised a contradiction: It is written, 'Return, wayward children'—which implies that you were wayward from the outset—and it is written, 'I will heal your backslidings.' There is no difficulty: one refers to repentance from love, the other to repentance from fear."

עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת כְּשֶׁכָּל אֶחָד כָּלוּל מֵעֶשֶׂר **the ten Sefiros, when each one is comprised of ten.** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And so it is stated in the holy Zohar** (שָׁם חֵלֶק א קלב, א) **(ibid., I 132a)** דְּעָבְדָא מִנַּיְיהוּ עֲטָרָה **that she makes from them a crown** וְשַׂוִּי לָהּ בְּרֵישָׁא **and places it on the head** דְּצַדִּיק חַי הָעוֹלָמִים[550] **of the Tzaddik, Life of the Worlds,** [מִשְׁלֵי י, ו] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Mishlei 10:6):** בְּרָכוֹת לְרֹאשׁ צַדִּיק **"Blessings upon the head of the tzaddik";** וְהַמְכוּוָן גַּם כֵּן לְמִדַּת עַתִּיקָא **and this too refers to the attribute of Atika —** רֹאשׁ צַדִּיק רוֹמֵז לְעַתִּיקָא **"the head of the tzaddik" alludes to Atika.** וְאָז הַזְּמַן יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ כָּאָמוּר **And then is the time when "our mouth will be filled with laughter," as said;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק **and this is what they said: "He crowned the letter Kuf with laughter."** וּבְאוֹתִיּוֹת דְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא אוֹת ק׳ **And in the Osiyos of Rabbi Akiva, on the letter Kuf,** אִיתָא קוֹף זֶה מֹשֶׁה **it says: "Kuf — this is Moshe,** אֲבִי הַחֲכָמִים וְכוּלֵי **the father of the sages, etc.,** שֶׁהִקִּיף לִפְנֵי פַּרְעֹה **who encompassed before Pharaoh** וְכוּלֵי[551] כָּל דִּבְרֵי חָכְמָה **all words of wisdom, etc."** דָּרֵשׁ קוֹף לְשׁוֹן הִקִּיף **He expounds Kuf as from hikif, "encompassed."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּפַרְעֹה הָיָה **That is, Pharaoh was** אֲרִיךְ דִּקְלִיפָּה **the Arich of the kelipah,** [בַּהַגָּהוֹת לַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ] זְכרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַבֵּנוּ חַיִּים וִיטָאל **as Rabbeinu Chaim Vital wrote, of blessed memory (in his glosses on the holy Zohar),** עַל מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **on what they said in the holy Zohar** (בֹּא חֵלֶק ב לד, א) **(Bo, II 34a):** תַּנְינָא חַדָּא עַלָּאָה וְכוּלֵי **"One supernal serpent, etc."** —[552] דָּא הִיא דְּתַנְּין הַגָּדוֹל **the secret of the Great Serpent,** שֶׁהוּא אֲרִיךְ דִּקְלִיפָּה[553] **which is the Arich of the kelipah.** וְאָז הָיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִצְרַיִם **And then Yisrael were in Egypt** כְּעוּבָּר בִּמְעֵי אִמּוֹ **like a fetus in its mother's womb,** [פָּרָשָׁה] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא [טו[554]] **as they said in the Pesikta (Parashah 15)** עַל מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [דְּבָרִים ד, לד] **on what is said (Devarim 4:34),** גּוֹי מִקֶּרֶב גּוֹי **"a nation from the midst of a nation";** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַקְּלִיפָּה הָיְתָה מַקֶּפֶת לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **that is, the kelipah surrounded Yisrael.** וְזֶה הָיָה עַל יְדֵי **And this came about because** שֶׁהָיָה אָז חָכְמַת מִצְרַיִם שׁוֹלֶטֶת **the wisdom of Egypt then held sway,** וְחָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה הָיָה שָׁם **and the wisdom of the Torah was there** בְּבְחִינַת גָּלוּת **in a state of exile.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה אוֹר מַקִּיף **was an encompassing light** שֶׁהָיָה מַקִּיף לְפַרְעֹה בְּחָכְמָתוֹ **who encompassed Pharaoh with his wisdom,** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן הוֹצִיא **and thereby he brought out** חָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה מִשָּׁם מִתּוֹכָם **the wisdom of the Torah from there, from their midst.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** הוּא בְּסוֹד הַדַּעַת כַּיָּדוּעַ **is in the secret of Da'as, as is known;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ הִמְלִיךְ **and this is what they said, "He crowned** אוֹת קוֹף בִּשְׂחוֹק כָּאָמוּר **the letter Kuf with laughter," as said.** וְכֵן בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר מְחֻיֶּית עֲמָלֵק **And so in the month of Adar is the obliteration of Amalek,** דְּקְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק רֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִים **for the kelipah of Amalek is "first of the nations,"** רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה כְּמוֹ פַּרְעֹה **the beginning of the kelipah, like Pharaoh;** רַק פַּרְעֹה אֲרִיךְ דִּקְלִיפַּת הַתַּאֲוָה **only Pharaoh is the Arich of the kelipah of desire,** וַעֲמָלֵק אֲרִיךְ דִּקְלִיפַּת הַקִּנְאָה **and Amalek the Arich of the kelipah of jealousy,** וְעֵסֶק עֲמָלֵק כַּעַס וּרְצִיחָה (וְנִתְבָּאֵר יִתְרוֹ מַאֲמָר ג) **anger and murder (and this was explained in Yisro, maamar 3).** וְדַרְכּוֹ שֶׁיְּכוֹל לְהִסְתַּתֵּר כָּל כָּךְ עַד שֶׁיַּטְעֶה לְאָדָם **And Amalek's way is that he can conceal himself so thoroughly that he misleads a person** לוֹמַר לָרַע טוֹב **into calling evil good,** וְיִתְחַפֵּשׂ כְּמוֹרֶה אוֹתוֹ לְטוֹב **and he disguises himself as**

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[550] **Taanit 8b** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: Sunshine on the Sabbath is charity for the poor, as it is said, 'For you who fear My name, a sun of charity shall rise, with healing.'" The Gemara applies Malachi's words "you who fear My name" to those who benefit from Sabbath sunshine. Rav Tzadok draws out the Sabbath's awakening of reverence within every Jew.

[551] **Jerusalem Talmud Demai 4:1** — "The colleagues said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: They permitted it out of honor for the Sabbath.... Rabbi Bibi said in Rabbi Chanina's name: The awe of the Sabbath rests upon him, and he speaks the truth. If the awe of the Sabbath rests upon him, why does the Mishnah teach that after nightfall at the Sabbath's conclusion one may not eat until tithing? Because of the person upon whom the awe of the Sabbath does not rest." The legal case concerns produce purchased from a person who is not generally trusted about tithing. His Sabbath answer is trusted in the circumstances specified by the Mishnah; the passage also records a qualification to the Sabbath-awe explanation.

[552] **Psalms 92:2** — "It is good to give thanks to the Lord and to sing to Your name, Most High." In its immediate setting, lehodot means "to give thanks." Rav Tzadok also hears the root of hodaah, acknowledgment or confession, and links the Sabbath psalm with repentance and Proverbs 28:13.

[553] **Proverbs 28:13** — "One who conceals his transgressions will not prosper; one who confesses and abandons them will be shown mercy."

[554] **Megillah 7b** — "Rava said: A person is obligated to become mellow with wine on Purim until he does not know the difference between Cursed is Haman and Blessed is Mordechai." Rav Tzadok is interpreting the state beyond ordinary awareness as a spiritual level. The following narrative in the Gemara records the danger at Rabbah and Rabbi Zeira's feast; the passage is not an unrestricted endorsement of intoxication.

one guiding him to good, עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (חולין צא, א) **in the manner of what they said (Chullin 91a):** כְּתַלְמִיד שֶׁהִתְחַפֵּשׂ כְּרַב מוֹרֶה דֶּרֶךְ[555] **for he disguised himself as a rabbi showing the way** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בֹּא מַאֲמָר א) **(and this was explained in Bo, maamar 1).** וּלְעוּמַּת זֶה נִצְטָרֵךְ **Against this it is necessary** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ יְגַלֶּה **that Hashem Yisbarach reveal** מִבְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **from the aspect of Atika,** שֶׁהוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן **which is hidden from all thought,** וְאָז יוּכְלוּ לְכַבּוֹשׁ **and then they will be able to conquer** רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה **the beginning of the kelipah,** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן נֶעְלָם **which is likewise hidden and concealed, as its counterpart.**[556] וְלָכֵן בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **Therefore in this month,** שֶׁנִּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת קוֹף **formed with the letter Kuf,** שֶׁהַמְלִיךְ בִּשְׂחוֹק **which He crowned with laughter —** וְהַיְינוּ דְּעַל יְדֵי קוֹף **that is, through Kuf,** שֶׁרוֹמֵז קָדוֹשׁ **which alludes to Kadosh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא [שַׁבָּת קד, א] **as they said in the Gemara (Shabbos 104a),** זוֹכִין יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **Yisrael merit the revelation of Atika,** סְתִימָא דְּכָל סְתִימִין **the most hidden of all hidden,** בְּרָזָא דְּמֵאָה כָּאֲמוּר **in the secret of one hundred, as said;** וְאָז הַזְּמַן לְמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **and then it is the time for obliterating Amalek,** שֶׁהַקְּלִיפָּה גַּם כֵּן **for the kelipah too —** אֶת דִּילָהּ ק׳ **her letter is Kuf,** כְּקוֹפָא לִבְנֵי נָשָׁא **like a monkey beside human beings** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ג) **(as explained in maamar 3);** וְנַעֲשָׂה הַלֵּב הַר קָדְשִׁי **and the heart becomes "My holy mountain,"**[557] וְאָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **and then "our mouth will be filled with laughter,"** וְכָאָמוּר: **as said.**

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[555] Parallel: **Rav Tzadok HaKohen, Resisei Layla 20** — "This holiness is revealed with all its force on Purim, when they said that one must become mellow until he does not know. Its plain meaning is the revelation that Israel's hearts are truly attached to the blessed God even when they cannot distinguish their right from their left. ... Then what lies in the depths of the heart is revealed. Israel's hearts are attached to the blessed God without deliberation or compulsion of the heart's will: the point of true will is of itself truly attached to Him."

Connection: Resisei Layla explains what the loss of ordinary calculation discloses: an enduring inner will attached to God. It clarifies why Rav Tzadok relates Purim's joy to the root of Israel's holiness rather than to a new intellectual achievement.

[556] Parallel: **R. Yehudah Aryeh Leib Alter, Sefat Emet, Purim 5634 (1874), s.v. Teshuasam Hayisa LaNetzach** — "'You were their salvation forever, and their hope in every generation.' The salvation of Purim was for all generations. Just as the decree was to destroy all the Jews, so the miracle concerned every generation: the continued existence of all Israel's descendants rests on this miracle. It is taught that the decree also existed in Heaven against Israel. The Holy One, blessed be He, performed the miracle without Israel's merit, solely because we are His people and always take refuge in Him; therefore He must save us in a time of distress. This festival thus gives Israel strength and hope in exile to trust Him because we belong uniquely to Him. It seems that for this reason they instituted becoming intoxicated 'until one does not know': to show that the festival does not rest on Israel's merit. It is called Purim after the lot because the lot signifies what the natural circumstances and the power the other side acquired through our sins would have brought about; only through His kindness did Hashem save us."

Connection: Sefat Emet connects this particular Purim practice to the ground of the salvation: Israel's enduring belonging to Hashem reaches beyond the account of its conduct that supported the decree. This gives a precise counterpart to Rav Tzadok's argument that Amalek challenges a holiness conferred before conscious choice, and that the mitzvah performed beyond ordinary awareness answers that challenge. Sefat Emet does not discuss circumcision here; his contribution is the distinction between belonging and the merit being judged.

[557] **Taanit 30b** — "The Sages say: Whoever works on Tishah B'Av and does not mourn for Jerusalem does not see her joy, as it is said, Rejoice with Jerusalem and exult in her, all who love her; rejoice with her in gladness, all who mourn over her. From here they said: Whoever mourns for Jerusalem merits and sees her joy; whoever does not mourn for Jerusalem does not see her joy." The wording is merits and sees, in the present tense. Rav Tzadok reads this as an inward participation in Jerusalem's joy even before the final rebuilding.

ראש חדש אדר, מאמר ה׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Hei

כָּךְ מִשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אָדָר מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה כְּשֵׁם שֶׁמִּשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אָב מְמַעֲטִין בְּשִׂמְחָה **Just as when Av enters we diminish in joy, so when Adar enters we increase in joy** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּעֲנִית כט, א) **(as stated in Taanis 29a).** לְהָבִין עִנְיַן רִיבּוּי הַשִּׂמְחָה בַּאֲדָר **We must understand the matter of the increased joy in Adar,** וַהֲלֹא חֹדֶשׁ אָדָר מוּתָּר בְּהֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **for is not the month of Adar permitted for eulogy and fasting,** וְאוֹמְרִים בּוֹ תַּחֲנוּן. **and we say Tachanun in it?** אַךְ עִיקַּר שִׂמְחָה כְּשֶׁמְּקַבֵּל עָלָיו הַיִּשְׂרָאֵל עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם **But the essence of joy is when the Jew accepts upon himself the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven,** וּכְשֶׁקָּשׁוּר בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **and when he is bound to the root, in Hashem Yisbarach;** מִזֶּה בָּא הַשִּׂמְחָה **from this comes joy.** [תְּהִלִּים קמט, ב] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **As it says (Tehillim 149:2),** יִשְׂמַח יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעוֹשָׂיו **"Let Yisrael rejoice in its Maker" —** הוּא כְּשֶׁמַּכִּיר שֶׁהַ׳ עָשָׂאנוּ **that is, when he recognizes that Hashem made us,** [דְּבָרִים לב, ו] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Devarim 32:6),** הוּא אָבִיךָ וְגוֹמֵר **"He is your Father...,** הוּא עָשְׂךָ וְגוֹמֵר[558] **He made you...";** [תְּהִלִּים שָׁם] בְּנֵי צִיּוֹן יָגִילוּ בְמַלְכָּם **"The children of Tziyon will exult in their King" (Tehillim ibid.):** כְּשֶׁמְּקַבְּלִין עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם יָגִילוּ **when they accept the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven they exult,** הֶפֶךְ עֹל בָּשָׂר וָדָם שֶׁהוּא לְעֹל.[559] **the opposite of the yoke of flesh and blood, which is a burden.** (בְּרָכוֹת ל, ב) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **This is what they said (Berachos 30b):** חַזְיֵיהּ דְּהַנָּה קָא בַּדַּח טוּבָא **He saw that he was very merry,** וְכוּ׳ [תְּהִלִּים ב, יא] וְגִילוּ בִּרְעָדָה כְּתִיב וְאָמַר **and said, "It is written, 'Rejoice with trembling' (Tehillim 2:11)..."** אָמַר לֵיהּ בְּכָל עֶצֶב יִהְיֶה מוֹתָר **He said to him, "'In all sadness there is profit'** [מִשְׁלֵי יד, כג] כְּתִיב **is written (Mishlei 14:23)."** אָמַר לֵיהּ אֲנָא תְּפִילִּין מְנַחְנָא **He said to him, "I am wearing tefillin."** וְלִכְאוֹרָה אֵינוֹ מוּבָן הַתְּשׁוּבָה. **Seemingly the answer is not understood.** רַק לְפִי שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁמַּנִּיחַ תְּפִילִּין **But it is because at the time he puts on tefillin** נוֹשֵׂא עָלָיו עֹל מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם **he bears upon himself the yoke of the Kingdom of Heaven,** גַּם תְּפִילִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז **and also the tefillin of the head, which allude** לִבְחִינַת כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **to the aspect of Keser Elyon,** שֶׁהוּא קַרְקַפְתָּא דִּתְפִילִּין **which is the "skull of the tefillin,"** וּמוֹרֶה שֶׁהַיִּשְׂרָאֵל קָשׁוּר בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **and indicates that the Jew is bound to the root;** וְאָז בָּא הַשִּׂמְחָה[560] **and then comes joy,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר יִשְׂמַח יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעוֹשָׂיו וְגוֹמֵר בְּמַלְכָּם.[561] **as it says, "Let Yisrael rejoice in its Maker... in their King."** [תְּהִלִּים ק, ב] וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **This is what is said (Tehillim 100:2),** עִבְדוּ אֶת ה׳ בְּשִׂמְחָה **"Serve Hashem with joy,** בֹּואוּ לְפָנָיו בִּרְנָנָה **come before Him with song,"** [שָׁם, ג] וּכְתִיב בַּתְרֵיהּ **and after it is written (ibid. 3),** הוּא עָשָׂנוּ וְלוֹ **"He made us and we are His...";** (חֵלֶק א קכ, ב) וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and it is brought in the holy Zohar (I, 120b):** וְהַיְינוּ כְּתִיב בְּאָלֶ״ף וְקָרֵי בְּוָא״ו וְכוּ׳ **"It is written with an aleph and read with a vav..."**

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[558] **ZoharIII 124b, Nasso 6:93** — "When the tree of good and evil rules—ordinary things of purity and ordinary things of impurity—the sages, who resemble Shabbosos and festivals, have only what those ordinary people give them, just as Shabbos has only what is prepared for it during the weekdays." The Zohar compares Torah sages with Shabbos in its discussion of their sustenance. Rav Tzadok develops the comparison as continual participation in Shabbos holiness.

[559] **Shelah, Torah Shebikhtav, Shemos, Introduction §§2–6** — "I include all these portions under one heading, because they are joined in a leap year, when Israel are accustomed to awaken more strongly to the ways of repentance. Most earlier writers mentioned only the portions of Shovavim; later writers added Terumah and Tetzaveh. ... Had there been no diminution of the moon, there would never have been any intercalation, for if they had used one crown, their circuits and courses would have been equal. Now that they are separated, their courses and circuits are unequal, and seven intercalations must be made in the cycle to equalize the lunar years with the solar year, so that Pesach falls in spring and Sukkos at harvest-time. The intercalations arose through the accusation, which caused the accusation below that brings sin. Therefore a leap year is especially fitting for repentance." The intervening paragraphs explain that the moon's accusation and diminution correspond above to the emergence below of the evil inclination and the accuser. Rav Tzadok first presents this explanation, then offers its complementary inversion: the very equalizing of moon and sun also anticipates the future restoration and therefore makes these days suitable for repentance.

[560] **Chullin 60b** — "Seeing that the moon was not comforted, the Holy One, blessed be He, said: Bring an atonement for Me because I diminished the moon. This is what Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: Why is the Rosh Chodesh goat different, that Scripture calls it For Hashem? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: Let this goat be an atonement because I diminished the moon."

[561] **ZoharI 138a, Midrash HaNeelam, Toldos** — "Rabbi Shimon said: This is the heart, in which the evil inclination dwells. Rabbi Eliezer says: A good heart is the building of the body and soul; therefore it is written, You shall love Hashem your God with all your heart, for this is the root of everything."

[562] **Berakhot 30a** — "If he is standing in the Temple, he should direct his heart toward the Holy of Holies, as it is said, They shall pray toward this place. If he is standing in the Holy of Holies, he should direct his heart toward the place of the Ark-cover."

דְּפֵירְשׁוּ הוּ״א עָשָׂנוּ **That is, what they interpreted, "Hu made us,"** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל עַתִּיקָא דְּאִתְכַּסְיָא **is that it alludes to the Hidden Atika,** דְּאִקְרֵי הוּ״א[563] **which is called "Hu"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רצ, א) **(as stated in Zohar III, 290a).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּלְאָלֶ״ף אֲנַחְנוּ **And this is what is said, "and to the Aleph are we,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar:** לֹא בְּאָלֶ״ף אַתַּר עִלָּאָה יַתִּיר **"Lo with an aleph — a higher place still."** וְהַיְינוּ אָלֶף פֶּלֶ״א עֶלְיוֹן **That is, Aleph, the supernal Pele,** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **meaning that Yisrael are bound to the root,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה בָּא הַשִּׂמְחָה וּרְנָנָה.[564] **and through this come joy and song.** (בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ יט) וּמֵהַאי טַעְמָא דְּרָשׁוּ בְּסִפְרֵי [בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ יִ, י] **For this reason they expounded in the Sifrei (Behaaloscha 19):** וּבְיוֹם שִׂמְחַתְכֶם [בְּמִדְבַּר י, י] **"And on the day of your rejoicing" (Bamidbar 10:10)** אֵלּוּ הַשַּׁבָּתוֹת **— these are the Shabbosos.** דְּבְיוֹם טוֹב יֵשׁ מִצְוַת שִׂמְחָה **For on Yom Tov there is a mitzvah of joy,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּשַׁבָּת **which is not so on Shabbos,** שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ מִצְוַת וְשָׂמַחְתָּ **which has no mitzvah of "and you shall rejoice";** רַק הַיִּשְׂרָאֵל כְּשֶׁמְּקַבֵּל עֹל מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **rather, when the Jew accepts the yoke of His Kingship, Yisbarach,** עַל יְדֵי זֶה יִשְׂמְחוּ בְּמַלְכוּתְךָ **through this "they rejoice in Your Kingship...";** בִּשְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת **by keeping Shabbos,** וְכוּלֵי.[565] וְזֶהוּ שִׂמְחַתְכֶם דַּיְיקָא **and this is precisely "your rejoicing."** גַּם בְּשַׁבָּת יֵשׁ בּוֹ הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **Also, on Shabbos there is the revelation of Atika,** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **that Yisrael are bound to the root,** בִּרְצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן בְּרֵאשִׁית וְכוּלֵי **in the Supernal Will, "Bereishis...,"** וְאָז בָּא הַשִּׂמְחָה מֵמֵילָא.[566] **and then joy comes of itself.** (תַּעֲנִית שָׁם) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּגְמָרָא **This is what they said in the Gemara (Taanis ibid.):** הִלְכָךְ וְכוּלֵי וְלִימְצֵי נַפְשֵׁיהּ בַּאֲדָר **"Therefore... let him present himself in Adar,** דְּבָרִיא מַזָּלֵיהּ **whose mazal is strong"** — מַזָּלָא קַדִּישָׁא הַיְינוּ עַתִּיקָא **the holy Mazla, that is, Atika,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג עט, ב) **as they said in the holy Zohar (III, 79b):** וַתִּתְפַּלֵּל עַל ה׳ [שְׁמוּאֵל א א, י] **"And she prayed upon Hashem" (I Shmuel 1:10)** — עַל דַּיְיקָא **precisely "upon,"** בְּגִין דִּבְנִין בְּמַזָּלָא קַדִּישָׁא תַּלְיָין **because children depend on the holy Mazla;** וְכֵן הַשְׁלֵךְ עַל ה׳ יְהָבָךְ [תְּהִלִּים נה, כג] **and likewise "Cast your burden upon Hashem" (Tehillim 55:23);** עַיֵּין שָׁם.[567] **see there.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּקוֹצָא דְּיוּד דְּלְעֵילָּא **That is, the upper tip of the yud** רְמִיזָא לְאַיִן **alludes to Ayin** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג סה, ב) **(as stated in Zohar III, 65b),** וְזֶהוּ עַל הֲנֵי״ה דַּיְיקָא[568] **and**

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[563] Parallel: **R. Chaim of Volozhin, Nefesh HaChayim I, chapter 4, main text, paragraphs 7 and 10** — "The heart of a person, at the center of the body, gathers everything into itself, corresponding to the Holy of Holies at the center of the inhabited world, the Foundation Stone. Like it, the heart includes all the roots and sources of holiness. Our Sages alluded to this in the Mishnah in the chapter Tefillas HaShachar: 'He should direct his heart toward the Holy of Holies.' … Likewise, every sin and transgression through which a Jew brings foreign fire into his heart, through anger or other evil desires, is literally comparable to the verse, 'Our holy and beautiful house … has been burned with fire.' May the Merciful One save us."

Connection: Nefesh HaChayim gives the inner sanctuary a precise structure: the heart corresponds specifically to the Holy of Holies, and destructive desires are its foreign fire. He draws the same inward implication from the direction of the heart in prayer that Rav Tzadok invokes here. This explains why repentance during Terumah and Tetzaveh must rebuild the heart's holiness, rather than merely recall the construction of a separate sacred building.

[564] **Kedushas Levi, Shekalim, s.v. Taam al Adar** — "The reason that Adar sometimes comprises two months, as the intercalated month, is that the twelve months of the year correspond to the twelve tribes of God. Adar, whose constellation is fish, corresponds to Yosef, who is compared to fish over which the evil eye has no power, as Scripture says, Yosef is a fruitful son, a fruitful son above the eye. Yosef fathered two tribes, Menashe and Ephraim; therefore there are two Adars."

[565] **Bereshit Rabbah 73:7** — "When Yosef was born, Esav's adversary was born. ... Rabbi Pinchas said in Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman's name: It is a tradition that Esav falls only into the hands of Rachel's children, as it is written, Surely the youngest of the flock shall drag them away. Why does he call them the youngest of the flock? Because they are the youngest of the tribes."

[566] **Bereshit Rabbah 59:6** — "Avraham is the foremost of the patriarchs; Yehoshua is the foremost in kingship from the tribe of Ephraim, as it is said, From Ephraim, their root against Amalek: this is Yehoshua. David is the foremost in kingship from the tribe of Yehudah." The manuscript cites 59:7. This passage appears at 59:6 in the retrieved Midrash Rabbah text;59:7 discusses Avraham's blessing in all things.

[567] **Zohar II 166b–167a, Terumah** — "In the same way, 'Torah is light': the Torah, given from the side of that primordial light, is continually sown in the world, producing offspring and fruit without ever ceasing; from its fruit the world is nourished." The passage explicitly joins the gardener's primordial light to Torah's continuing fruitfulness. Rav Tzadok applies this to Ephraim, whose name expresses fruitfulness, and to the growth of Oral Torah after overcoming evil. The intervening discussion qualifies the garden's fruitfulness during exile.

[568] **Zohar II 137b, alternate text; Addenda II §8** — "In the mystery of 'Guard,' speech, night: this is 'the Torah of Hashem,' the Oral Torah. 'Moshe received Torah from Sinai and handed it to Yehoshua'—they explained this concerning the Oral Torah, for regarding the Written Torah it is written, 'Moshe commanded the Levites who bear the ark of Hashem's covenant ... Take this Torah scroll.' This was fitting for the Levites, for that which is bound to the sun. Moshe shone upon Israel for forty years, the sun in the daytime; 'the Torah of Hashem' is the entrance of

this is precisely "upon" Havayah. (שַׁבָּת קנו, א) וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בִּגְמָרָא **And it is what they said in the Gemara (Shabbos 156a):** אֵין מַזָּל לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **"Ein mazal l'Yisrael" —** דְּמִדַּת אֵין עַתִּיקָא דְּאִתְכַּסְיָא **for the attribute of Ayin, the Hidden Atika,** דְּאִקְרֵי אַיִן **which is called Ayin,** (חֶלֶק ב סד, ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar (II, 64b),** הוּא מַזָּל לְיִשְׂרָאֵל[569] **is the mazal of Yisrael;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ[570] **that is, that they are bound to the root,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמַ"ע **as the Rema MiPano wrote** [עֲשָׂרָה מַאֲמָרוֹת מַאֲמַר חִקּוּר הַדִּין **(Asarah Maamaros, Maamar Chikur HaDin,** חֶלֶק א פֶּרֶק א**) part 1, chapter 1):** נֶפֶשׁ הָאָב מַזַּל לַבֵּן[571] **the soul of the father is the mazal of the son.** וְזֶהוּ הוּ"א עָשָׂנוּ וּלְאֵל"ף אֲנַחְנוּ **And this is "Hu made us, and to the Aleph are we,"** וְאָז מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה. **and then we increase in joy.** וְעִנְיַן בְּרִיא מַזְלֵיהּ **The meaning of "his mazal is strong"** מוֹרֶה שֶׁהוּא חָזָק וְדָבָר קַיָּם לָעַד **indicates that it is strong, a thing enduring forever,** שֶׁלֹּא יִבָּטֵל **that will not be nullified,** [תְּהִלִּים עג, ד[572]] מִלְּשׁוֹן בָּרִיא אוּלָם **from the expression "their strength is firm (bari ulam)" (Tehillim 73:4).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה הַזְּמַן **That is, this month is the time** לִזְכּוֹת לִבְחִינָה זוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לְעוֹלָם **to merit this aspect, that it be forever:** שְׂפַת אֱמֶת תִּכּוֹן לָעַד. **"The lip of truth shall be established forever."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה **This is what it says in Sefer Yetzirah,** שֶׁחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק.[573] **that the month of Adar was formed with the letter kuf, with laughter.** (שַׁבָּת קד, א) וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בִּגְמָרָא **This is according to what they said in the Gemara (Shabbos 104a):** קו"ף קָדוֹשׁ **"Kuf — kadosh,"** שֶׁרוֹמֵז שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **which alludes that Yisrael are bound to the root in Hashem Yisbarach.** יוד רוֹמֵז לְחָכְמָה **The yud alludes to Chochmah,** שֶׁהוּא קוֹדֶשׁ עִלָּאָה **which is the Supernal Holiness,** וְתָגוֹ שֶׁל יוד **and the crown of the yud** רוֹמֵז לְמַזָּלָא דְּאַיִן **alludes to the Mazla of Ayin,** שֶׁהוּא כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן וְכָאָמוּר. **which is Keser Elyon, as was said.** וּבְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה נוֹלַד מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And in this month Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, was born,** (סוֹטָה יב, א) שֶׁאִיתָא **of whom it is stated (Sotah 12a)** שֶׁכְּשֶׁנּוֹלַד נִתְמַלְּאָה הַבַּיִת כּוּלּוֹ אוֹר **that when he was born the whole house was filled with light;** שֶׁהוּא הוֹרִיד הַתּוֹרָה **for he brought down the Torah,** וְאוֹרַיְיתָא נָפְקַת מֵחָכְמָה **and the Torah emerged from Chochmah,** מֵאֲתַר דְּאִקְרֵי קוֹדֶשׁ **from the place called Kodesh** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קכא, א) **(as stated in Zohar II, 121a),** מַאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **the utterance "Let there be light";**

Shabbos, in one mystery." The original is preserved both in the alternate reading embedded in Terumah 16 and in the second volume's Addenda §8. The expanded Addenda wording explicitly includes the handing to Yehoshua. Rav Tzadok's identification of Yehoshua's book with the hidden roots of Oral Torah develops this precise distinction.

[569] **Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah §25, s.v. UvaGemara** — "We have already said that 'Had Israel not sinned, only the five books of Torah and the book of Yehoshua would have been given to them, because it contains the apportioning of the Land of Israel' means that the book of Yehoshua is the secret of Oral Torah. 'Moshe received Torah from Sinai and handed it to Yehoshua' refers to Oral Torah, as the Zohar explains; he handed Written Torah to the Levites. Had they not sinned, they would have seen how everything is included in the five books of Torah, for nothing is absent from an allusion in the Torah. 'Its apportioning' means each Israelite's portion in Oral Torah, which is the Land, the aspect of the Congregation of Israel. Although the book of Yehoshua consists only of town names, the secrets of Oral Torah's roots are hidden in it, as it is the first book after Moshe's Torah." This is the exact earlier authorial explanation to which the present maamar directs the reader. It clarifies how the geographical allotments can signify each soul's distinct portion in Oral Torah.

[570] **Midrash Tanchuma, Beshalach 2** — "With Yosef's ark went the Shechinah, the Ark, the priests, the Levites, and seven clouds of glory. Yosef's ark traveled with the Ark of the Testimony in the wilderness. The nations asked: What are these two arks? They answered: This is the ark of a dead man, and this is the Ark of the living One of the worlds. Does a dead man travel with the Ark of the living One of the worlds? They answered: This one fulfilled all that is written in that one."

[571] **Rosh Hashanah 25b** — "Scripture weighed three lesser figures like three greater figures, to teach you that Yerubaal in his generation is like Moshe in his generation; Bedan in his generation is like Aharon in his generation; Yiftach in his generation is like Shmuel in his generation. This teaches that even the least of the least, once appointed a leader over the public, is like the mightiest of the mighty." The Gemara identifies Yerubaal with Gideon. Its direct subject is the authority of the appointed leaders of each generation; Rav Tzadok develops the spiritual meaning of the comparison.

[572] **Vayikra Rabbah 22:9** — "Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said: Seven transgressions were committed in Gideon's bull: wood of an asherah, disqualified stones, an animal designated for idolatry, a bull that had been worshipped, a non-priest, night, and an animal not yet of the required age." The Midrash first establishes that a prophet can authorize an exceptional offering. Rav Tzadok contrasts this commanded episode with the unauthorized Golden Calf.

[573] **Temurah 28b** — "Rava said: Indeed, they had worshipped it, and this was an exceptional ruling, as Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said: Eight things were permitted that night: offering outside the Sanctuary, night, a non-priest ..." The list continues on 29a: a service vessel, a vessel of an asherah, wood of an asherah, an animal designated for idolatry, and an animal that had been worshipped. The Bavli's eight permissions and the Midrash's seven transgressions have different enumerations; neither should be silently changed to match the other.

כְּנֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תּוֹרָה **and the five times "light" in this utterance** וַחֲמִשָּׁה פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה שֶׁבְּמַאֲמַר זֶה **correspond to the five Chumashim of the Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ג, ה) **(as stated in Bereishis Rabbah 3:5),** וְנִקְרָא תּוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה [מַלְאָכִי ג, כב][574]. **and it is called "the Torah of Moshe" (Malachi 3:22).** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁנִּזְכַּר בּוֹ קְדוּשָּׁה בְּמָקוֹם בַּסְּנֶה **And Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, is the first in connection with whom holiness of place is mentioned, at the Bush.** רָאשׁוֹן וְאַחַר כָּךְ הוֹרִיד הַקְּדוּשָּׁה **Afterward he brought down holiness** בְּכָל נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **into all the souls of Yisrael at Matan Torah,** [שְׁמוֹת יט, ו] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Shemos 19:6),** וְאַתֶּם תִּהְיוּ לִי מַמְלֶכֶת כֹּהֲנִים וְגוֹי קָדוֹשׁ.[575] **"And you... and a holy nation."** וּבְנִיסָן דְּאָמְרוּ **And in Nissan, as they said** (מְכִילְתָּא פָּרָשַׁת הַשִּׁירָה ג **(Mechilta, Parshas HaShirah 3,** וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּשַׁלַּח סד, ב) **and the holy Zohar, Beshalach 64b):** מַה שֶּׁלֹּא רָאָה יְחֶזְקֵאל **what Yechezkel did not see;** רָאָתָה שִׁפְחָה עַל הַיָּם **a maidservant saw at the Sea** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁזָּכוּ לְהִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא.[576] **that is, they merited the revelation of Atika.** וְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר הֻכָּנָה לָזֶה **And the month of Adar is the preparation for this.** [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּאֲדָר **This is what is said regarding Adar (Esther 8:16):** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה וְשִׂמְחָה וְגוֹמֵר דִּכְתִיב **"The Jews had light and joy...,"** דְּעִיקַּר הַשִּׂמְחָה כְּשֶׁזּוֹכִין **for the essence of joy is when we** שִׂמְחָה אַחַר אוֹרָה **where "joy" is written after "light,"** וְקוֹצֵא דִּלְעֵילָּא כְּתָר **merit** לְאוֹר ׳ חָכְמָה מִיהֵי אוֹר **the light of the yud, Chochmah, from "Let there be light,"** עֶלְיוֹן כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and the upper tip, Keser Elyon, as mentioned above.** וּבְגְמָרָא (מְגִילָּה טז, ב) דָּרְשׁוּ **And in the Gemara (Megillah 16b) they expounded:** אוֹרָה זוֹ תּוֹרָה **"Light — this is Torah;** שִׂמְחָה זֶה יוֹם טוֹב **joy — this is Yom Tov";** דְּכְשֶׁזּוֹכִין לַתּוֹרָה זוֹכִין לָאוֹר כִּי טוֹב **for when we merit Torah we merit the light "that it was good,"** שֶׁעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה יוֹם טוֹב **which Yom Tov indicates,** שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ בּוֹ אוֹר כִּי טוֹב **for the light "that it was good" shines forth in it.** וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ **Therefore they said** דִּכְשֵׁם שֶׁבְּאָב מְמַעֲטִין בְּשִׂמְחָה **that just as in Av we diminish joy,** שֶׁנִּתְמַעֵט הָאוֹר **since the light was diminished,** כָּךְ כְּשֶׁנִּכְנָס אֲדָר מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה. **so when Adar enters we increase in joy.** **Now in the holy Zohar (Terumah 152a)** אִיתָא **it states:** טֵית אָת דָּא מְשַׁנְיָא מַאֲת ק׳ **this letter differs from the letter kuf:** ק׳ לָא מִתְיַשְּׁבָא כָּלָל בְּדוּכְתָּא **kuf does not settle at all in its place,** וְסִימָנָיךְ אִישׁ לָשׁוֹן [תְּהִלִּים קמ, יב] בַּל יִכּוֹן בָּאָרֶץ **and your sign is, 'A slanderous man shall not be established in the land' (Tehillim 140:12);** אָת ט׳ אִתְיַשְּׁבָא בְּכָל דּוּכְתָּא וְכוּלֵּי **the letter tes settles in every place...;** כְּמָה דָּאָת דָּא שָׁלְטָא בַּאֲתַר דָּא **just as this letter rules in this place,** הָכִי נַמִּי שָׁלְטָא אָת אַחֲרָא בַּאֲתַר דְּגֵיהִנֹּם **so too another letter rules in the place of Gehinnom:** אָת ק׳ עַיֵּין שָׁם. **the letter kuf"; see there.** וּבְסֵפֶר יְצִירָה אִיתָא **And in Sefer Yetzirah it states** דְּאָב נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ט׳ **that Av was formed with the letter tes** וַאֲדָר בְּאוֹת ק׳ וְהָעִנְיָן בָּזֶה עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **and Adar with the letter kuf.** **The matter is according to what we said** בְּיִשּׁוּב קוּשְׁיַת הָרִיטְבָ"א זְכוּרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **in resolving the question of the Ritva, of blessed memory,** עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (יוֹמָא נד, ב) **on what they said (Yoma 54b):** בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁנִּכְנְסוּ אוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם לַהֵיכָל רָאוּ כְּרוּבִין הַמְעוֹרִין זֶה בָּזֶה וְכוּלֵּי **"When the nations entered the Heichal, they saw the Keruvim intertwined with one another..."** וְהִקְשָׁה מִדְּאָמְרִינַן (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא צט, א) **He asked from what we say (Bava Basra 99a),** שֶׁכְּשֶׁאֵין עוֹשִׂין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם **that when they do not do the will of the Omnipresent,** פְּנֵיהֶם לַבַּיִת **"their faces are toward the House";** וְהוּא הַדִּין בִּכְרוּבִים דְּצוּרְתָּא **and the same applies to the ornamental Keruvim,** [נד, א] כִּדְמוֹכַח בְּיוֹמָא **as is evident in Yoma (54a),** דְּמַרְאִין לָהֶם כְּרוּבִים דְּצוּרְתָּא **that they would show them the ornamental Keruvim:** וְאִם כֵּן בִּזְמַן הַחוּרְבָּן רְאוּ חִבָּתְכֶם וְכוּלֵּי **"See your belovedness..."** **If so, at the time of the Destruction,** שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ עוֹשִׂין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם **when they were not doing the will of the Omnipresent,** אֵיךְ רָאוּ אוֹתָם מְעוֹרִין זֶה בָּזֶה.[577] **how did they see them intertwined with one another?** וְאָמַרְנוּ כְּשֶׁרָאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּכְנְסוּ אוֹיְבִים **And we said that immediately at the time of the Destruction,** שֶׁתֵּיכֶף בִּשְׁעַת הַחוּרְבָּן

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[574] **ZoharIII 79b, Achrei Mos 74, s.v. Uf hachi** — "So too at the renewal of the moon, for the sun shines upon her with the joy of the light of the Ancient One above. Therefore this offering is directed above, so that everything may be sweetened and joy be found in the world. Hence the words Bring an atonement for Me are exact." The Zohar connects the renewed moon, the Rosh Chodesh offering, and supernal joy. This supplies Rav Tzadok's reason for finding an element of joy in Rosh Chodesh.

[575] **Arakhin 10b** — "Rosh Chodesh is called an appointed occasion, so let Hallel be recited! It is not sanctified through a prohibition of work, as it is written, The song shall be yours as on the night a festival is sanctified: a night sanctified as a festival requires song; one not sanctified as a festival does not require song." This discussion concerns obligatory complete Hallel. It does not deny the separate custom of reciting an abridged Hallel on Rosh Chodesh.

[576] **Taanit 28b** — "Rav came to Bavel and saw that they recited Hallel on Rosh Chodesh. He thought to stop them. When he saw that they skipped passages, he said: This shows that the custom of their ancestors is in their hands. A Sage taught: An individual should not begin; but if he began, he completes it."

לַהֵיכָל **when Yisrael saw that enemies had entered the Heichal,** אֲשֶׁר לֹא הֶאֱמִינוּ מִקּוֹדֶם **which they had not believed beforehand,** מִיָּד עָשׂוּ כּוּלָּם תְּשׁוּבָה **they all immediately did teshuvah,** וְנַעֲשׂוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל תֵּיכֶף **and Yisrael immediately came to be** בְּגֶדֶר עוֹשִׂין רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **in the category of those who do His will, Yisbarach;** וְנַעֲשׂוּ הַכְּרוּבִין מְעוֹרְרִין זֶה בָּזֶה **and the Keruvim became intertwined with one another,** פְּנֵיהֶם אִישׁ אֶל אָחִיו **"their faces each toward his brother."** (בְּרָכוֹת פֶּרֶק ב הֲלָכָה ד יז, ב)[578] וּבִירוּשַׁלְמִי **And in the Yerushalmi (Berachos 2:4, 17b)** (אֵיכָה א, נא) וּבְמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **and in Midrash Rabbah (Eichah 1:51)** אִיתָא שֶׁבְּתִשְׁעָה בְּאָב בְּיוֹם הַחוּרְבָּן **it states that on Tishah b'Av, on the day of the Destruction,** נוֹלַד תֵּיכֶף מָשִׁיחַ[579] **Mashiach was immediately born;** וְהוּא מִטַּעַם הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל.[580] **and this is for the reason mentioned above.** רַק לֹא הָיָה עֲדַיִן הַזְּמַן **Only, it was not yet the time** לִהְיוֹת הַתִּיקּוּן כָּהוֹגֶן **for the rectification to be complete,** אֲבָל עַל כָּל פָּנִים הָיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **but at any rate Yisrael were** בְּגֶדֶר עוֹשִׂין רְצוֹנוֹ שֶׁל מָקוֹם. **in the category of doing the will of the Omnipresent.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנּוֹצַר חֹדֶשׁ אָב בְּאוֹת ט׳ **This is why the month of Av was formed with the letter tes,** שֶׁהוּא נְהִירוּ דְּחַיִּין בְּכָל אֲתַר **which is "the light of life in every place,"** מֵאוֹר כִּי טוֹב **from the light "that it was good,"** שֶׁאָז בָּאֱמֶת זָרַח הָאוֹר. **for then the light truly shone.** וְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **And the month of Adar was formed with the letter kuf,** שֶׁשּׁוֹלֵט בַּאֲתַר דְּגֵיהִנֹּם **which rules in the place of Gehinnom,** שֶׁהוּא חוֹשֶׁךְ וְצַלְמָוֶת **which is darkness and the shadow of death;** אֲבָל הוּא רַק חֹשֶׁךְ לִפּוֹשְׁעֵי עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת **but it is darkness only for the sinners of the idolatrous nations,** הַפּוֹשְׁעִים בִּי [יְשַׁעְיָה סו, כד] **"who sinned against Me" (Yeshayah 66:24),** דְּפָשְׁעֵי וְאָזְלֵי **who go on sinning,** וַאֲפִילּוּ עַל פִּתְחוֹ שֶׁל גֵּיהִנֹּם **and even at the entrance of Gehinnom** אֵינָם חוֹזְרִין בִּתְשׁוּבָה **do not return in teshuvah;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן פּוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **which is not so for the sinners of Yisrael,** שֶׁמִּיָּד שֶׁבָּאִין לְגֵיהִנֹּם כְּרֶגַע **who, as soon as they come to Gehinnom, instantly** מוֹרִידִין דְּמָעוֹת כְּמַעְיָן **shed tears like a spring** וּמְכַבִּין אֵשׁ דְּגֵיהִנֹּם **and extinguish the fire of Gehinnom** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ז, ד) **(as stated in Shemos Rabbah 7:4),** וּמַצְדִּיקִין הַדִּין[581] וּמְקַלְּסִין לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **and they justify the judgment** וּמִיָּד אָתָא **and praise Hashem Yisbarach;** וּמַסִּיק לְהוּ[582] אַבְרָהָם אֲבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and immediately Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him, comes** וְלָהֶם נִקְרָא אוּר דְּגֵיהִנֹּם **and brings them up** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֵירוּבִין יט, א) **(as stated in Eruvin 19a); and for them it is called "the fire of Gehinnom,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּגְמָרָא (פְּסָחִים נד, א) **as they said in the Gemara (Pesachim 54a)** וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג לד, ב[583]) **and the holy Zohar (III, 34b);** שֶׁבְּיִשְׂרָאֵל אוֹת ק׳ מוֹרֶה קָדוֹשׁ **for with Yisrael the**

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[577] **Megillah 31a** — "Rav Huna said in Rav's name: On a Shabbos occurring during Chol HaMoed, whether Pesach or Sukkos, we read See, You say to me. For the haftarah, on Pesach we read The dry bones; on Sukkos, On the day Gog comes." The Gemara establishes the haftarah reading. Rav Tzadok connects its resurrection vision with Nisan; the quoted ruling does not itself state the date of the resurrection.

[578] **Deuteronomy 33:23** — "Of Naftali he said: Naftali, satisfied with favor and full of the blessing of Hashem, inherit the sea and the south."

[579] **Temurah 16a** — "When a student goes to his teacher and says, Teach me Torah, if he teaches him, Hashem enlightens the eyes of them both. If not, The rich and the poor meet; Hashem makes them all: He who made this one wise makes him ignorant, and the one who made this one ignorant makes him wise. This is Rabbi Nasan's teaching."

[580] **Eruvin 54a** — "Rava said: The desire of his heart You have given him, and the utterance of his lips You have not withheld. When do You give him his heart's desire? When he does not withhold the utterance of his lips." The surrounding discussion teaches the value of learning aloud. Rav Tzadok relates the words on the lips to the Divine gift of Oral Torah.

[581] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:3** — "God said, Let there be light: this is Avraham, of whom it is written, Who awakened righteousness from the east? God called the light day: this is Yaakov; and the darkness He called night: this is Esav."

[582] **Bereshit Rabbah 61:1** — "Rabbi Shimon said: His father did not teach him, and he had no teacher. From where did Avraham learn Torah? The Holy One, blessed be He, provided his two kidneys as two teachers, and they flowed and taught him Torah and wisdom, as it is written, I shall bless Hashem, who counseled me; even at night my kidneys instructed me." The Midrash offers several accounts of Avraham's Torah knowledge. This teaching emphasizes inward Divine instruction rather than an inherited human teaching chain.

[583] Parallel: **R. Yehudah Aryeh Leib Alter, Sefat Emet, Nasso 5637 (1877), s.v. BeAvos Moshe Kibel Torah** — "Although Torah was given to all Israel, there are two aspects of Torah. One is the toil through which every Jew can find something in Torah, each according to his grasp. There is also a special property of Torah through which the sages who lead the generations attain what does not follow from human reasoning. This is the inheritance given us, as it says, 'Moshe commanded us Torah, an inheritance of the congregation of Yaakov.' … The Gemara says: 'Do not read morashah, inheritance, but me'orasah, betrothed.' The distinction is that an inheritance comes without toil, an inheritance that has no interruption; betrothal is a closeness attained through a person's actions and toil in Torah. It is to each individual that the instruction applies: 'Prepare yourself to study Torah, for it is not an inheritance to you.' Of Israel collectively it says, 'an inheritance of the congregation of Yaakov.' Nevertheless, by meriting to include himself within the whole of Israel, a person also merits a share in the inheritance."

letter kuf signifies kadosh, [קד, א] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּשַׁבָּת. **as they said in Shabbos (104a).** וְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה וְנַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא **And this month is "v'nahafoch hu,"** שֶׁנֶּהְפַּךְ הַקּ׳ אֲתַר דְּגֵיהִנֹּם לְקּ׳ קָדוֹשׁ. **in which the kuf of the place of Gehinnom was turned into the kuf of kadosh.** (מְגִילָּה יא, א) וּבְגְמָרָא **And in the Gemara (Megillah 11a):** אֵימָתַי רָאוּ כָּל [תְּהִלִּים צח, ג] אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ אֵת יְשׁוּעַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ **"When did all the ends of the earth see the salvation of our G-d" (Tehillim 98:3)?** בִּימֵי מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **In the days of Mordechai and Esther."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאַף הָרְחוֹקִים מֵה׳ **That is, even those far from Hashem,** שֶׁהֵם מְכוּנִים כָּל אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ **who are called "all the ends of the earth,"** רָאוּ אָז [584]וְהֵכִּירוּ הַנֵּס **saw then and recognized the miracle,** [585]שֶׁנֶּהְפַּךְ ה׳ שֶׁהוּא יְשׁוּעַת **that it was the salvation of Hashem, which was reversed:** זָכוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַגְּזֵירָה דַּיְיקָא **that precisely through the decree they merited to carry out the obliteration of Amalek,** מַה שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה אֶפְשָׁר בִּלְעֲדֵי הַגְּזֵירָה **which would not have been possible without the decree —** לְבַקֵּשׁ לְהַשְׁמִיד וְלַהֲרוֹג הָעֲמָלֵקִים כַּמּוּבָן. **to seek to destroy and kill the Amalekites, as is understood.** וְכֵן הָיָה שֶׁנֶּהְפַּךְ ק׳ אַתְרָא דְּגֵיהִנֹּם **And so it was that the kuf of the place of Gehinnom,** שֶׁהוּא חֹשֶׁךְ **which is darkness,** לְקּ׳ קָדוֹשׁ שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל בְּחִינַת חָכְמָה **was turned into the kuf of kadosh, which indicates the aspect of Chochmah,** כָּאָמוּר [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, ג] יְהִי אוֹר מֵאֲמַר. **the utterance "Let there be light" (Bereishis 1:3), as was said.** וּבְנִיסָן גַּם כֵּן הָיוּ נִסִּים **In Nissan, too, there were miracles** שֶׁלֹּא כְּדֶרֶךְ הַטֶּבַע **beyond the way of nature,** וְאַדְרַבָּא נִסִּים גְּדוֹלִים **and on the contrary, great miracles;** רַק אָז לֹא נֶהְפַּךְ הַגְּזֵירָה לִישׁוּעָה **only then the decree was not turned into salvation,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בַּאֲדָר **which is not so in Adar,** שֶׁהַגְּזֵירָה עַצְמָהּ נֶהְפַּךְ לִישׁוּעָה וְהַחֹשֶׁךְ לְאוֹר **where the decree itself was turned into salvation and the darkness into light;** וְזֶה הוֹרָאַת אוֹת קו״ף כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and this is the meaning of the letter kuf, as mentioned above.** וְהָמָן שָׂמַח כְּשֶׁנָּפַל הַפּוּר בַּאֲדָר **Haman rejoiced when the lot fell on Adar,** בַּיָּרֵחַ שֶׁמֵּת בּוֹ מֹשֶׁה **the month in which Moshe died,** וְהָיָה סָבוּר שֶׁבּוֹ הַזְּמַן **and he thought that it was the time** לְכִבְיַית הָאוֹר חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **for the extinguishing of the light, chas v'shalom;** [586]וְלֹא יָדַע שֶׁבּוֹ נוֹלַד מֹשֶׁה **but he did not know that in it Moshe was born** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִילָּה יג, ב) **(as stated in Megillah 13b),** [סוֹטָה יב, א] שֶׁכְּשֶׁנּוֹלַד נִתְמַלֵּא הַבַּיִת אוֹר **that when he was born the house was filled with light (Sotah 12a),** וְהוּא הוֹרִיד הַתּוֹרָה אוֹר **and he brought down the Torah, which is light,** וְהַקְּדוּשָׁה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **and holiness to Yisrael,** שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ גּוֹי קָדוֹשׁ בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **who were called "a holy nation" at Matan Torah;** וְעַל זֶה בָּא הוֹרָאַת הַקּ׳. **and to this the kuf points.** וְעַל כֵּן מַרְבִּין בּוֹ בְּשִׂמְחָה **Therefore we increase joy in it,** וְלִימְצֵי נַפְשֵׁיהּ בַּאֲדָר דְּבָרִיא מַזְלֵיהּ **and "let him present himself in Adar, whose mazal is strong,"** שֶׁהוּא חָזָק שֶׁלֹּא יִבָּטֵל לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד **for it is strong and will not be nullified forever and ever:** הוּ״א עָשָׂנוּ וּלְאָלֶ״ף אֲנַחְנוּ **"Hu made us, and to the Aleph are we";** וּמִזֶּה בָּא הַשִּׂמְחָה **and from this comes joy,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עִבְדוּ אֶת ה׳ בְּשִׂמְחָה: **as it says, "Serve Hashem with joy."**

Connection: This distinction qualifies the meaning of a share available to every Jew. The inheritance belongs enduringly to Israel as a whole, while the individual's developed grasp still calls for toil and differs from person to person. Sefat Emet thus explains how a universal, uninterrupted inheritance can coexist with the Mishnah's warning that Torah is not simply inherited by an individual. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's express qualification that not every member of the tribe was a scholar, although each has a portion.

[584] **Bava Batra 129b** — "Rav Acha son of Rav Avya sent: According to Rabbi Yochanan ben Berokah, if one says, My property is yours, and after you, so-and-so's, and the first recipient is fit to inherit him, the second has nothing in place of the first. This is not the language of a gift but the language of inheritance, and inheritance has no interruption." The legal rule concerns inherited property. Rav Tzadok uses its language to illuminate Torah as the enduring inheritance of Israel.

[585] **ZoharI 234b, Vayechi 53, s.v. Vayomer** — "And he said: what is meant by And he said? We have established it, as Scripture says, You shall say in your heart: saying in silence. Gather yourselves: it should have said Gather! Rather, Gather yourselves comes from above: gather in a complete bond, in a single unity. And I shall tell you is the mystery of wisdom." Rav Tzadok draws specifically on saying in silence to explain Oral Torah appearing within the sages' hearts.

[586] **Eruvin 54a** — "Rabbi Zeira said from here: A person has joy in the answer of his mouth, and a word in its time, how good. When does a person have joy? When the answer is in his mouth. Another version: When is there joy in the answer of his mouth? When a word in its time is good."

ראֹשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר, מַאֲמָר ו׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Vav

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ הַלָּשׁוֹן **In Sefer Yetzirah, for each month the wording is:** הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת פְּלוֹנִי בְּכֹחַ פְּלוֹנִי **"He made such-and-such letter king over such-and-such power."** וְהַמְכֻנָּן בָּזֶה **The intent of this is** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַכֹּחַ **that the power be on the side of the good mode,** בְּצַד אוֹפָן הַטּוֹב שֶׁכָּל הַכֹּחוֹת יֵשׁ בְּטוֹב וּבְהֶפְךָ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. **for every power exists both in good and in the opposite, chas v'shalom.** וְכֵן בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר אָמַר **So too regarding the month of Adar he said:** אֲדָר בַּשָּׁנָה **"He made the letter kuf king over laughter...,** הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק וְכוּלֵי **Adar in the year."** הַיְינוּ דְּיֵשׁ שִׂמְחָה וּשְׂחוֹק **That is, there is a kind of joy and laughter** [קֹהֶלֶת ב, ב] דִּכְתִיב **of which it is written (Koheles 2:2),** לִשְׂחוֹק אָמַרְתִּי מְהוֹלָל **"Of laughter I said, it is madness,** וּלְשִׂמְחָה מַה זּוֹ עוֹשָׂה **and of joy, what does it accomplish?"** וְהִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ **And He made the kuf king** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה שִׂמְחָה וּשְׂחוֹק טוֹבָה[587] **so that it be good joy and laughter.** [בְּמַאֲמָר הַקּוֹדֵם] וְכֵן אָת ק׳ דְּאָמַרְנוּ **Likewise the letter kuf that we cited (in the previous maamar)** (תִּרוּמָה קנב, א) מֵהַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **from the holy Zohar (Terumah 152a),** דְּאָמַר דְּאָת ק׳ לָא מִתְיַישְׁבָא בְּדוּכְתָּא **which says that the letter kuf does not settle in its place,** [תְּהִלִּים קמ, יב] וְסִימָנָיךְ **"and your sign is (Tehillim 140:12):** אִישׁ לָשׁוֹן בַּל יִכּוֹן בָּאָרֶץ **'A slanderous man shall not be established in the land'"** — וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁרוֹמֵז עַל הַנָּחָשׁ **that is, it alludes to the serpent,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה כ, א) שֶׁכֵּן דָּרְשׁוּ **for so they expounded (Bereishis Rabbah 20:1)** פָּסוּק זֶה עַל הַנָּחָשׁ. **this verse regarding the serpent.** (חֵלֶק ב קנב, א) וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And it states in the holy Zohar (II, 152a)** דְּאָת ק׳ שָׁלְטָא בַּאֲתַר דְּגֵיהִנֹּם. **that the letter kuf rules in the place of Gehinnom.** וְהַנָּחָשׁ הוּא הֵבִיא עָצֶב לָעוֹלָם **And the serpent is the one that brought sadness into the world:** בְּעִצָּבוֹן תֵּאכְלֶנָּה [שָׁם, בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, טז] **"In sadness you shall bear children" (Bereishis 3:16),** וְהַיְינוּ שִׂמְחָה הֶפֶךְ הָעֶצֶב **And joy is the opposite of sadness,** וְהַשִּׂמְחָה הֶפֶךְ הָעֶצֶב **"in sadness you shall eat of it" (ibid. 17).**[588] יז. **as it says (Tehillim 97:12),** כְּדִכְתִיב שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים צז, יב] כְּדֶרֶךְ **"Rejoice, tzaddikim, in Hashem";** שִׂמְחוּ צַדִּיקִים בַּה׳ **"Let Yisrael rejoice in its Maker..." (ibid. 149:2);** יִשְׂמַח יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּעוֹשָׂיו וְגוֹמֵר [שָׁם קמט, ב] **"Let the heart of those who seek Hashem rejoice" (ibid. 105:3):** יִשְׂמַח לֵב מְבַקְשֵׁי ה׳[589] [שָׁם קה, ג] **when he merely seeks to attain** כְּשֶׁהוּא אַךְ מְבַקֵּשׁ לְהַשִּׂיג אוֹר וּקְדוּשַׁת ה׳ **the light and holiness of Hashem,** אַף שֶׁלֹּא זָכָה לְהַשִּׂיג עֲדַיִן **even though he has not yet merited to attain it,**[590] מִכָּל מָקוֹם זוֹכֶה לִבְחִינַת שִׂמְחָה **nevertheless he merits the aspect of joy.** וְעִיקַּר הַשִּׂמְחָה לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **But the essence of joy is "for the upright of heart, joy":** כְּשֶׁזּוֹכִין לְיַישֵׁר הַלֵּב **when one merits to straighten the heart,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֵב אֶחָד לְאָבִיו שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם. **that it be one heart to his Father in Heaven;** וּכְשֶׁזּוֹכִין לְהִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **and when one merits the revelation of Atika,** כְּשֶׁקָּשׁוּר בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **when he is bound to the root,** (בְּרָכוֹת ל, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמַר **as we said on what they said (Berachos 30b):** אֲנָא תְּפִילִּין מְנַחְנָא **"I am wearing tefillin"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ה) **(and it was explained in maamar 5).** וּבְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה כְּתִיב [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] **And regarding this month it is written (Esther 8:16),** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light...,"** (מְגִילָּה טז, ב) וְדָרְשׁוּ **and they expounded (Megillah 16b):** אוֹרָה זוֹ תּוֹרָה **"Light — this is Torah";** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת אוֹרָה

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[587] Parallel: **Rav Tzadok HaKohen, Resisei Layla 6:2** — "Prayer's essence is a broken heart. ... A broken heart is the opposite of joy: when a person considers his particular deficiencies and the great salvation and mercy he needs, reason would say that sadness and worry should fill him. But God's commandments work oppositely: they give birth to joy, and this is the sign that prayer is complete and accepted. Words of Torah in themselves gladden the heart. ... When study is for its own sake, the sign is that it gives birth instead to reverence and care, as they said: Great is study, for it leads to action."

Connection: The parallel explains how the joy of Torah is tested by its result. The gladness associated here with Naftali and Oral Torah becomes reverence and action, clarifying the difference between holy joy and mere levity.

[588] **Sotah 13a** — "They said: Who shall go? Let Naftali go, for he is as swift as a hind, as it is written, Naftali is a hind sent forth, who gives beautiful words. Rabbi Abahu said: Do not read beautiful words, but beautiful documents." The documents concern Esav's sale of his share in the burial place. The narrative is the concrete background for Naftali's speed and the words/documents wordplay.

[589] **Berakhot 64a** — "Rabbi Chiyya bar Ashi said in Rav's name: Torah scholars have no rest, neither in this world nor in the World to Come, as it is said, They go from strength to strength; they appear before God in Tziyon."

[590] **Shulchan Aruch and Rema, Orach Chaim 697:1** — "On the fourteenth and fifteenth of AdarI one does not fall on one's face in supplication and does not recite May Hashem answer you in the day of distress. They are forbidden for eulogy and fasting, but the other observances do not apply. Some permit even eulogy and fasting. Rema: The custom follows the first opinion. Some say one must increase feasting and joy on the fourteenth of AdarI; this is not the custom. Nevertheless, one should add a little to the meal to satisfy those who are stringent. One of good heart has a continual feast."

לְשׁוֹן נְקֵיבָה **which is called orah, in the feminine form,** שֶׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת הָאוֹר מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב.[591] **for it receives the light from Torah she'b'ksav.** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **This is what they said** (ב תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר יט לח, **(Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 19, 38b,** וּבְהַקְדָּמָה יב, א**) and in the Introduction, 12a):** כָּל הָעוֹסֵק בְּטַל תּוֹרָה **"Whoever engages in the dew of Torah,** טַל תּוֹרָה מְחַיֵּיהוּ **the dew of Torah revives him";** (כְּתוּבוֹת קיא, ב) וּבִגְמָרָא **and in the Gemara (Kesubos 111b):** אוֹר תּוֹרָה מְחַיֵּיהוּ[592] **"the light of Torah revives him";** וְהַמְכֻוָּן אֶחָד **and the intent of both is one:** עַל טַלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא[593] **the dew of Atika,** שֶׁהוּא טַל שֶׁעָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **which is the dew with which HaKadosh Baruch Hu will in the future** לְהַחֲיוֹת בּוֹ הַמֵּתִים **revive the dead;** וְהֵיינוּ טַל תּוֹרָה דְּבָעַל פֶּה **and this is the dew of Torah she'b'al peh,** כִּדְמוֹכַח בִּגְמָרָא (שַׁבָּת פח, ב) **as is evident in the Gemara (Shabbos 88b),** שֶׁיְּצִיאַת נִשְׁמָתָן מֵאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **that their souls departed at the light of Torah she'b'ksav,** וּבְטַל הֶחֱיָה אוֹתָם עַיֵּין שָׁם.[594] **and with dew He revived them; see there.** וְכֵן שִׂמְחָה זֶה יוֹם טוֹב **Likewise, "joy — this is Yom Tov,"** וּמוֹרָה גַּם כֵּן עַל אוֹר שֶׁבּוֹ הוֹפָעָה מֵאוֹר כִּי טוֹב **in which there is a shining forth of the light "that it was good,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ [בְּמַאֲמָר הַגְּנוּז **and it also indicates the hidden light,** קוֹצָא דְּיוּד דְּלְעֵילָּא **the upper tip of the yud,** וְשִׂמְחָה הֶפֶךְ עֶצֶב הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **and joy is the opposite of the sadness of the yetzer hara.** הַקּוֹדֵם] **as we said (in the previous maamar);** גַּם כֵּן מוֹרָה שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **"And gladness — this is milah,"** וְשָׂשׂוֹן זוֹ מִילָה **which also indicates that Yisrael are bound to the root,** שֶׁמָּלִין תִּינוֹק בֶּן שְׁמוֹנָה יָמִים **for we circumcise an infant eight days old,** וְשֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעְתּוֹ וְנַעֲשֶׂה יִשְׂרָאֵל **without his own knowledge, and he becomes a Jew** וְנִכְלָל בִּכְלַל וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם וְגוֹמֵר [יְשַׁעְיָה ס, כא] **and is included among "And Your people are all..." (Yeshayah 60:21),** דְּכָל מַאן דְּאִתְגְּזַר אִיקְרֵי צַדִּיק **for whoever is circumcised is called a tzaddik** [זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב כג, א]. **(Zohar II, 23a).** וְזֶה שָׂשׂ אָנֹכִי עַל אִמְרָתֶךָ [תְּהִלִּים קיט, קסב] **This is what is said (Tehillim 119:162), "I rejoice over Your word** כְּמוֹצֵא שָׁלָל רָב **like one who finds great spoil";** וְזֶה מוֹרֶה עַל קְדוּשַׁת הַמִּילָה **and this indicates the holiness of milah,** שֶׁבָּא דֶּרֶךְ מְצִיאָה[595] **which comes by way of a find,** שֶׁלֹּא בִּיגִיעָה וְסֵדֶר הַנָּהוּג.[596] **not through toil and the customary order.** וְיֵקָר אֵלּוּ תְּפִילִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ **"And honor — these are the tefillin of the head,"** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה גַּם כֵּן עַל שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **which also indicates that they are bound to the root** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ה) **(as explained in maamar 5).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק **This is what it says, "He made the kuf king over laughter":** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה ק׳ הַטּוֹב **that it be the good kuf,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה קְדוּשָׁה וְאוֹר **which signifies holiness and light,** בִּשְׂחוֹק וְשִׂמְחָה **in laughter and joy,** וְלֹא ק׳ שֶׁל אִישׁ לָשׁוֹן וְגוֹמֵר **and not the kuf of "a slanderous man...,"** הַשּׁוֹלֵט בְּגֵיהִנֹּם. **which rules in Gehinnom —** שֶׁהוּא הַנָּחָשׁ שֶׁהֵבִיא עֶצֶב וְעַצָּבוֹן. **that is, the serpent, which brought sadness and grief.** וְאָמַר בִּשְׂחוֹק **And it says "laughter,"** [עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים קכו, ב **in the manner of the verse (Tehillim 126:2),** אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **"Then our mouth will be filled with laughter":** שֶׁכְּשֶׁזּוֹכִין לְהִתְגַּלּוּת בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **when one merits the revelation of the aspect of Atika,** שֶׁרוֹמֵז א״ז **to which "az" alludes,** הֲתַּר גַּם לְמַלֵּא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו **it is**

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[591] **Rashi, Mishlei 15:15** — "One of good heart: one whose heart is content with his wealth. A continual feast: all his years seem to him like days of feasting, teaching you that a person should rejoice in his own portion. Our Sages expounded what they expounded in Chelek."

[592] **Gittin 68a** — "When he came, he inspected the seal, opened the vessel, and found wine. He said: It is written, Wine is a scoffer, strong drink is tumultuous, and whoever strays through it will not become wise; and it is written, Harlotry, wine, and fresh wine take away the heart. He did not drink. When he became thirsty and could no longer bear it, he drank, became intoxicated, and slept." Ashmedai cites these verses when he initially refuses the wine prepared by Benayahu. Rav Tzadok draws on the verses' negative portrayal of wine before explaining the spiritual meaning of a continual feast.

[593] **Pesachim 50a** — "Rabbi Acha bar Chanina said: The World to Come is unlike this world. In this world, over good tidings one says, Blessed is the Good and Beneficent, and over bad tidings one says, Blessed is the true Judge. In the World to Come it is all The Good and Beneficent." Rav Tzadok understands the future unity as the recognition of the good within what now appears adverse.

[594] **Rashi, Pesachim 50a, s.v. Kulo** — "It is all The Good and Beneficent: for there are no bad tidings there."

[595] **Berakhot 60b** — "Rav Huna said in Rav's name, in Rabbi Meir's name, and it was also taught in Rabbi Akiva's name: A person should always be accustomed to say, Whatever the Merciful One does, He does for the good. Rabbi Akiva was traveling and reached a town, but they gave him no lodging. He said: Whatever the Merciful One does is for the good. He slept in the field, with a rooster, a donkey, and a lamp. Wind extinguished the lamp, a cat ate the rooster, and a lion ate the donkey. He said: Whatever the Merciful One does is for the good. That night an armed troop came and captured the town." The losses protected Rabbi Akiva from discovery. Rav Tzadok distinguishes recognition of an event's actual good from the separate obligation to accept suffering joyfully.

[596] **Berakhot 60b** — "What does it mean that a person must bless over adversity as he blesses over good? If it means saying The Good and Beneficent over adversity too, did we not learn that over bad tidings one says Blessed is the true Judge? Rava said: The teaching is needed only to require accepting them with joy."

permitted even to fill one's mouth with laughter (יט וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר **(as explained in Chanukah, maamar 19,** וּלְמַעְלָה מַאֲמָר ב וּמַאֲמָר ד**). and above, maamar 2 and maamar 4).** שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר חָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה **The twelve months of the year** [תַּנְחוּמָא וַיְחִי טו][597] מְיוּחָסִים לִשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים **are associated with the twelve tribes (Tanchuma, Vayechi 15),** וְהָאֲרִיזַ״ל חָשָׁבָם כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים **and the Arizal counted them in the order of the banners** וְחָשַׁב אֲדָר לְנַפְתָּלִי[598] **and assigned Adar to Naftali,** וּמוֹלֵךְ עַל הַשְּׂחוֹק. **and it reigns over laughter.** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **This is as it says,** נַפְתָּלִי שְׂבַע רָצוֹן וְגוֹמֵר **"Naftali, sated with favor..."**; וּבָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אֵין שְׂבִיעָה[599] **and in this world there is no satiation,** דִּכְתִיב [קֹהֶלֶת ה, ט] **as it is written (Koheles 5:9),** אוֹהֵב כֶּסֶף לֹא יִשְׂבַּע כֶּסֶף **"One who loves money will not be sated with money,"** (קֹהֶלֶת רַבָּה, א, יג) וְאִיתָא **and it states (Koheles Rabbah 1:13):** אֵין אָדָם יוֹצֵא מִן הָעוֹלָם **"No person leaves the world** וַחֲצִי תַּאֲוָתוֹ בְּיָדוֹ וְכוּ׳[600] **with half his desire in his hand..."**; וּשְׂבַע רָצוֹן הַיְינוּ **"sated with favor" means** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַשְׁפִּיעַ בּוֹ רָצוֹן **that Hashem Yisbarach bestows will upon him,** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן הוּא שָׂבֵעַ **and through this he is sated;** וְכֵן אִיתָא (סִפְרֵי בְּרָכָה יד) **and so it states (Sifrei, V'Zos HaBerachah 14):** שֶׁהָיָה נַפְתָּלִי שָׂמֵחַ בְּחֶלְקוֹ וְכוּ׳.[601] **"This teaches that Naftali was happy with his portion..."** וּבִגְמָרָא (שַׁבָּת כה, ב) **And in the Gemara (Shabbos 25b):** אֵיזֶהוּ עָשִׁיר **"Who is wealthy?** כָּל שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ נַחַת רוּחַ בְּעָשְׁרוֹ **Whoever has contentment in his wealth";** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשׁ״י שָׂמֵחַ בְּחֶלְקוֹ וְכוּ׳[602] **and Rashi explained: happy with his portion...;** [דְּ, א] וְכִלְשׁוֹן הַמִּשְׁנָה דְּאָבוֹת **as in the wording of the Mishnah in Avos (4:1):** אֵיזֶהוּ עָשִׁיר הַשָּׂמֵחַ בְּחֶלְקוֹ. **"Who is wealthy? One who is happy with his portion."** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב סב, א) **And in the holy Zohar (II, 62a),** עַל פָּסוּק [תְּהִלִּים קמה, טז] **on the verse (Tehillim 145:16),** וּמַשְׂבִּיעַ לְכָל חַי רָצוֹן **"And satisfies every living thing with will":** מַאי רָצוֹן **"What is 'will'?** הַהוּא רָצוֹן

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[597] **Berakhot 7b** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Avishalom said: To what may this be compared? To a person against whom a debt document was issued. Before he paid it, he was sad; after he paid it, he rejoiced." The Gemara applies this to David's response to punishment involving Avshalom: once his feared punishment had taken a form, he could sing. Rav Tzadok distinguishes this relief from perceiving that the event itself was good.

[598] Parallel: **Rav Tzadok HaKohen, Resisei Layla 9** — "The blessed God is always called the One who bestows good kindnesses, for all His actions and the emanation of all His attributes were only to benefit Israel. ... When it sometimes appears otherwise to the eye, this is, on the contrary, to bestow an even greater goodness beyond human reason. Thus Bereishis Rabbah calls the evil inclination, death, and sleep very good: all appear not good to the eye, yet Scripture says very good, because in them there is a depth of goodness."

Connection: This passage supplies the distinction behind the present discourse: the event may look adverse to ordinary sight while its deeper purpose exceeds that sight. It develops Rav Tzadok's claim that Rabbi Akiva recognized actual good, beyond merely accepting a painful decree.

[599] **ZoharIII 271b, Raaya Mehemna, Eikev 1, s.v. Adehachi** — "The elder appeared and said: Faithful Shepherd, prepare a table for your Master and the Matron with every kind of delicacy, to fulfill This is the table before Hashem. All delight in the King's table: Come, eat My bread. This is the bread of Written Torah and the wine of Oral Torah. There are many delicacies there, the tastes of Torah, sweeter than all the foods and delights of the world and of kings." This is the source of the wine imagery. Rav Tzadok identifies the continual feast with a heart sustained by Oral Torah.

[600] **Asher Heini, preserved in Machzor Vitry §248** — "All the world's inhabitants opened their mouths, for Haman's lot was transformed into our lot. The righteous one was rescued from the wicked one's hand; the enemy was given in place of his life. They undertook to observe Purim and rejoice each year." The liturgical wording is independently preserved in Machzor Vitry's text of Asher Heini. Rav Tzadok uses the transformation of the lot itself to explain how the original decree becomes the means for the rescue.

[601] Parallel: **R. Moshe Chaim Luzzatto, Da'at Tevunot, section 48, paragraphs 3–4** — "Certainly the Holy One, blessed be He, does not intend to hold to the course of good and evil for a period of time and then abandon it, taking up the course of sovereignty and unity in a single moment like someone who regrets and changes his mind. Rather, in the depth of His counsel He directs events with such profound wisdom that, through good and evil themselves, we finally reach the point where everything is perfected and He reveals His unity. … The conduct of reward and punishment is open and always visible to everyone. But the course through which He turns everything toward the good is exceedingly deep, and becomes manifest only at the end. Yet it is certainly unfolding at every moment and every hour, without ceasing."

Connection: Ramchal describes two modes operating simultaneously: visible judgment and the hidden direction of those very events toward the revelation of unity. This clarifies why Rav Tzadok treats the decree of Haman as the means of the deliverance itself. Its reversal reveals what the decree accomplished within the one divine purpose; it is more than a later benefit added after an unrelated calamity. Purim, in Rav Tzadok's account, allows that hidden connection to be recognized within history.

[602] **Megillah 5b** — "Rav Yosef taught: Joy, feasting, and a festival day. Joy teaches that they are forbidden for eulogy; feasting teaches that fasting is forbidden; a festival day teaches that work is forbidden." The ensuing discussion explains that the prohibition of work was not accepted. Rav Tzadok's question uses the derivation of eulogy and fasting from joy and feasting.

דְּמִדָּה רִאשׁוֹנָה עַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **For the first attribute, Atika Kaddisha,** רְצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן **is the Supernal Will;** וּכְנֶגֶד זֶה מַאֲמַר בְּרֵאשִׁית **and corresponding to it is the utterance "Bereishis,"** דְּלָא כְּתִיב בֵּיהּ וַיֹּאמֶר **in which "And He said" is not written,** שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ שׁוּם תְּפִיסָה **for there is no grasp of it at all,** וְהוּא נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן **and it is hidden from all thought;** וְהוּא רְצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן **and it is the Supernal Will.** דְּהַתְחָלַת הִתְגַּלּוּת הַבְּרִיאָה[603] **For the beginning of the revelation of Creation** מִמַּאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **is from the utterance "Let there be light,"** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד חָכְמָה **which corresponds to Chochmah,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה תְּפִיסָה מָה **so that there be some grasp** מִבְּחִינַת חָכְמָה כֹּחַ מָ"ה. **from the aspect of Chochmah, ko'ach mah.** וְזֶהוּ שְׂבַע רָצוֹן. **And this is "sated with will."** וּמָלֵא בִּרְכַּת ה' **"And full of Hashem's blessing":** חַיֵּי בָּנֵי וּמְזוֹנֵי **life, children and sustenance —** דְּכָל הַבְּרָכוֹת כְּלוּלִים בְּהָנֵי שְׁלֹשׁ **for all blessings are included in these three —** דְּלָאו בִּזְכוּתָא תַּלְיָין אֶלָּא בְּמַזָּלָא[604] **which depend not on merit but on mazal** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מוֹעֵד קָטָן כח, א) **(as stated in Moed Katan 28a);** וּמַזָּלָא קַדִּישָׁא הַיְינוּ עַתִּיקָא **and the holy Mazla is Atika** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג עט, ב) **(as stated in Zohar III, 79b,** וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ה**) and explained in maamar 5);** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁהוּא שְׂבַע רָצוֹן מֵעַתִּיקָא **and since he is sated with will from Atika,** הוּא מְלֵא בִּרְכַּת ה'. **he is full of Hashem's blessing.** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יא, א) וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ **Likewise it is expounded (Bereishis Rabbah 11:1)** בִּרְכַּת ה' [מִשְׁלֵי י, כב] הִיא תַּעֲשִׁיר **that "The blessing of Hashem, it makes rich" (Mishlei 10:22)** עַל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **refers to the day of Shabbos,** מַהַאי טַעְמָא **for this reason:** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ בְּשַׁבָּת **that on Shabbos there is** הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא. **the revelation of Atika Kaddisha.** וּכְתִיב [שָׁם] וְלֹא יוֹסִף עֶצֶב עִמָּהּ **And it is written (ibid.), "And He adds no sadness with it":** שֶׁאֵין שִׁלְטוֹן בְּיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת לְהַנָּחָשׁ **for on the day of Shabbos there is no dominion for the serpent,** שֶׁהֵבִיא עֶצֶב לָעוֹלָם.[605] **which brought sadness into the world.** (שַׁבָּת שָׁם) וְאִיתָא **And it states (Shabbos ibid.):** רַבִּי טַרְפוֹן אוֹמֵר **"Rabbi Tarfon says:** כָּל שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ מֵאָה כְּרָמִים **Whoever has a hundred vineyards** וּמֵאָה שָׂדוֹת וּמֵאָה עֲבָדִים וְכוּלֵי **and a hundred fields and a hundred servants...,** זֶהוּ עָשִׁיר.[606] **he is wealthy."** וּמִסְפַּר מֵאָה **The number one hundred that he said** שֶׁאָמַר **is according to what they said** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **in the holy Zohar (I, 161a),** דַּהֲוָה לָבָן מַשְׁכַּח בְּגִינֵיהּ דְּיַעֲקֹב **that Lavan would find, on account of Yaakov,** בְּכָל יַרְחָא מְאָה עָאנִין **every month a hundred sheep,** וּמְאָה אִמְּרִין וּמְאָה עִזִּין עַיֵּין שָׁם **a hundred lambs and a hundred goats; see there.** (חֶלֶק א קסא, א) וּסְבִירָא לֵיהּ דִּבְרַכַּת ה' מֵאָה.[607] **And he**

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[603] **Ran on the Rif, Megillah 3b, s.v. Ela mikra Megillah** — "It appears to me that the Mishnah did not also say The Purim feast because the Gemara concludes that the two Adars are alike regarding eulogy and fasting: both are forbidden. The prohibition of eulogy and fasting is derived from joy and feasting, as the Gemara says: Joy teaches that eulogy is forbidden; feasting teaches that fasting is forbidden. This is the basic obligation of the additional meal. ... It is also close to certain that one should increase the meal on the fourteenth of the first Adar. But as to sending portions, since these resemble gifts to the poor, which apply only in the second Adar, it appears that sending portions likewise applies only in the second."

[604] **Tosafos, Megillah 6b, s.v. VeRabbi Eliezer** — "Some customarily make the fourteenth and fifteenth of the first Adar days of feasting and joy, and the Mishnah's wording seems to imply this. ... This does not appear correct, for the Gemara says that the two are alike regarding eulogy and fasting, implying that joy and feasting do not apply. The one cannot depend upon the other; otherwise it should have taught that feasting and joy apply, from which the prohibition of eulogy would follow automatically. ... The law is that one need not be stringent by making a feast and rejoicing in the first Adar." Tosafos disagrees with the inference from the prohibition of eulogy and fasting to a positive feast obligation. Rav Tzadok preserves this disagreement and explains a shared inward root.

[605] **Targum Sheni, Esther 9:29** — "Queen Esther, daughter of Avichayil, and Mordechai the Jew wrote with all authority to confirm this second letter of Purim. For if the year is intercalated, they shall not read the Megillah in the first Adar; rather, they shall read it in the latter Adar."

[606] **Zohar I 48a–b, Bereishis** — "Rabbi Shimon further said: We learned that Shabbos is an image of the World to Come; certainly it is so. Therefore the sabbatical year and the Jubilee correspond to one another, and so do Shabbos and the World to Come. The addition to the soul comes from the mystery of Zachor to this Shelter of Peace, which receives from the World to Come and gives this addition to the holy world. Through that addition they rejoice, and all weekday concerns, pains and troubles are forgotten, as it says, 'On the day Hashem grants you rest from your pain, your turmoil and the hard labor.'" The original in the cited first volume is now matched, including its Isaiah 14:3 proof. It describes Shabbos's addition of soul and release from inner distress. Rav Tzadok applies this rest of the heart to recognizing the good concealed within the Purim decree.

[607] **Mekhilta, Yisro, BaChodesh 1:23** — "'Israel encamped there'—wherever it says 'they journeyed' and 'they encamped,' they journeyed in dispute and encamped in dispute. But here it says, 'Israel encamped there': they all made their hearts equal as one." The checked Mekhilta original says 'they all made one heart.' Rav Tzadok expresses the same unity through the familiar 'one man, one heart' wording. Its contrast with earlier disputed encampments supplies the particular unity through which Israel became ready to receive the Torah.

holds that Hashem's blessing is a hundred. וְכֵן עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת כְּשֶׁכָּל אֶחָד כָּלוּל מֵעֶשֶׂר **So too the ten sefiros, when each one is comprised of ten,** עַד עַתִּיקָא הוּא מֵאָה **up to Atika, make a hundred** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר סוֹף מַאֲמָר ד) **(as explained at the end of maamar 4).** וּכְשֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ מֵאָה מִכָּל מִין **And when he has a hundred of every kind** וּמֵאָה עֲבָדִים לַעֲבוֹד בָּהֶן **and a hundred servants to work them,** וְהוּא יִהְיֶה פָּנוּי לַעֲמָלָהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה **and he is free for the toil of Torah,** הוּא עָשִׁיר מְלֵא בִּרְכַּת ה׳. **he is wealthy, full of Hashem's blessing.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמַר וּמוֹלֵךְ עַל הַשְּׂחוֹק **This is what he said, "and it reigns over laughter":** כֵּיוָן שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לְרָצוֹן מֵעַתִּיקָא **since he merits will from Atika,** הוּא בְּבָאֱמֶת בְּבְחִינַת אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ.[608] **he is in the aspect of "Then our mouth will be filled with laughter."** פְּסוּק פּוֹתֵחַ אֶת יָדֶךָ **In truth, the verse "You open Your hand" requires explanation,** שֶׁמַּתְחִיל בְּנֹסְתָּר פּוֹתֵחַ. **for it begins in the third person, "opens";** אֶת יָדֶךָ לְנֹכַח. **"Your hand" is in the second person;** וּמַשְׂבִּיעַ נִסְתָּר. **and "satisfies" is in the third person.** וְהָיָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר **It should have said,** תִּפְתַּח יָדְךָ וְתַשְׂבִּיעַ לְכָל וְגוֹמַר. **"You open Your hand and You satisfy every...."** אַךְ נִרְאֶה דְּקָאֵי עַל מַה **But it seems that it refers back** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים שָׁם, טו] **to what is said (Tehillim ibid. 15),** עֵינֵי כֹל אֵלֶיךָ יְשַׂבֵּרוּ וְגוֹמַר **"The eyes of all look hopefully to You...";** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **and on this it says** שֶׁהַבּוֹטֵחַ בַּה׳ וּמְקַוֶּה לְךָ **that the one who trusts in Hashem and hopes to You —** הוּא פּוֹתֵחַ. **he "opens":** אֶת יָדֶךָ וּמַשְׂבִּיעַ וְגוֹמַר **"Your hand, and satisfies...."** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן עֶסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה **This too is the work of this month:** לְהִיוֹת מִסְתַּכֵּל לְהַנּוֹתֵן **to look to the Giver** וְלִבְטוֹחַ בַּה׳. **and to trust in Hashem.** וְהָאֲרִיזַ״ל כָּתַב **The Arizal wrote** [שַׁעַר הַכַּוָּנוֹת דְּרוּשֵׁי תְּפִלַּת הַשַּׁחַר דְּרוּשׁ א] **(Shaar HaKavanos, Derushei Tefillas HaShachar, Derush 1)** דְּרָאשֵׁי תֵּיבוֹת פּוֹתֵחַ אֶת יָדֶךָ פַּא״י **that the first letters of "Posei'ach es yadecha," Pai,** גִּימַטְרִיָּא הֲוָיָ״ה אֲדֹנָ״י.[609] **equal in gematria Havayah and Adnus.** וְזֶה נֶגֶד וּלְהֶפֶךְ מִקְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **And this stands against and opposite the kelipah of Amalek,** דְּאִיתָא (תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא יא וְשׁוֹחֵר טוֹב תְּהִלִּים ט) **as it states (Midrash Tanchuma, Teitzei 11, and Shocher Tov, Tehillim 9),** שֶׁכָּל זְמַן שֶׁעֲמָלֵק בָּעוֹלָם **that as long as Amalek is in the world** אֵין הַשֵּׁם שָׁלֵם וְאֵין הַכִּסֵּא שָׁלֵם **the Name is not whole and the Throne is not whole.** וְהַיְינוּ דִּבְכִסֵּא חָסֵר אָלֶ״ף פֶּלֶ״א עֶלְיוֹן **That is, in the Throne the aleph, the supernal Pele, is lacking;** וּכְתִיב [דָּנִיֵּאל ז, ט] **and it is written (Daniel 7:9),** עַד דִּי כָרְסָוָן רְמִיו **"Until thrones were set up,** וְעַתִּיק יוֹמִין יְתִיב **and the Ancient of Days sat";** וּכְשֶׁנֶּעֱלָם הָאָלֶ״ף פֶּלֶ״א עֶלְיוֹן **and when the aleph, the supernal Pele, is hidden,** כְּבְיָכוֹל אֵין יוֹשֵׁב עַל הַכִּסֵּא.[610] **as it were, there is none sitting on the Throne.** וְאֵין הַשֵּׁם שָׁלֵם **And the Name is not whole,** שֶׁחָסֵר הַיִּחוּד דְּיָ״ה בְּוָ״ה.[611] **for the union of Yud-Heh with Vav-Heh is lacking.** וְהַבּוֹטֵחַ בַּה׳ גּוֹרֵם הַיִּחוּד **And one who trusts in Hashem brings about the union** וְהִתְגַּלּוּת רָצוֹן מֵעַתִּיקָא כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **and the revelation of will from Atika, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר נִתַּן לְנַפְתָּלִי **This is why it says that Adar was given to Naftali —** וּמִטַּעַם שֶׁהוּא שְׂבַע רָצוֹן **for the reason that he is "sated with will"** דְּאִשְׁתְּכַח מֵעַתִּיקָא **which is found from Atika;** וְעַל כֵּן מוֹלֵךְ עַל הַשְּׂחוֹק כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and therefore it reigns over laughter, as mentioned above.** וְהוּא מָלֵא בִּרְכַּת ה׳ **And he is "full of Hashem's blessing,"** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **which alludes to the day of Shabbos,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה **as they said in Bereishis Rabbah;** וּבְשַׁבָּת הַזְּמַן לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק[612] **and**

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[608] **Rema, Orach Chaim 1:1** — "I have set Hashem before me continually: this is a great principle in Torah and in the virtues of the righteous who walk before God. A person's sitting, movements, and dealings alone in his house are unlike his sitting, movements, and dealings before a great king. ... When he takes to heart that the great King, the Holy One, blessed be He, whose glory fills the whole earth, stands over him and sees his deeds, fear, submission, and shame before God will immediately reach him."

[609] **Shaarei Teshuvah 697:2, quoting Birkei Yosef** — "See Birkei Yosef, who wrote that our master Rema, of blessed memory, wisely established a conclusion corresponding to his opening: two continual offerings in their order. He began his glosses with I have set Hashem before me continually, and concluded with One of good heart has a continual feast." This verifies the Birkei Yosef observation through Shaarei Teshuvah, the intermediary explicitly cited by Rav Tzadok; it does not claim independent collation of Birkei Yosef's printed page.

[610] **Sotah 21a** — "Torah is compared to light, to tell you: just as light protects continually, so Torah protects continually. It says, When you walk, it shall guide you: this is this world. When you lie down, it shall guard you: this is death. When you awaken, it shall converse with you: in the future to come."

[611] **Berakhot 16b** — "May it be Your will, Hashem our God, to make love, brotherhood, peace, and friendship dwell in our lot. ... Set our portion in Gan Eden and establish for us a good companion and a good inclination in Your world. May we rise early and find our hearts' hope directed to fearing Your Name; may the satisfaction of our souls come before You for good." These are part of Rabbi Elazar's words after prayer. Rav Tzadok interprets the heart's readiness at waking as an initial Divine gift.

[612] **Eruvin 41a** — "After Rabban Gamliel died, Rabbi Yehoshua entered to overturn his ruling. Rabbi Yochanan ben Nuri stood and said: I see that the body follows the head! Throughout Rabban Gamliel's life we established the law according to him; now you wish to overturn his words? Yehoshua, we do not heed you, for the law has already been

Shabbos is the time for the obliteration of Amalek, וְאוֹמְרִים [שַׁחֲרִית לְשַׁבָּת בִּרְכַּת יוֹצֵר] **and we say (Shacharis of Shabbos, Birkas Yotzer),** בְּיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי נִתְעַלָּה **"On the seventh day He ascended** וְיָשַׁב עַל כִּסֵּא כְבוֹדוֹ **and sat on His Throne of Glory,"** דְּאָז הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא. **for then is the revelation of Atika.** וְעַל כֵּן אוֹמְרִים בְּמוֹצָאֵי שַׁבָּת **Therefore we say on Motzaei Shabbos** [בַּפְּסוּקִים קוֹדֶם הַבְדָּלָה] **(in the verses before Havdalah),** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה וְגוֹמֵר וְיֵקָר. **"The Jews had light... and honor,"** שֶׁכֻּלָּם מוֹרֶה עַל הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **all of which indicate the revelation of Atika,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **as we said.** כֵּן תִּהְיֶה לָּנוּ: **"So may it be for us."**

established according to Rabban Gamliel, and no one disputed the matter." The proverb occurs in a dispute about maintaining an established ruling after a leader's death. Rav Tzadok applies its image to Rosh Chodesh as the head that directs the month.

ראש חדש אדר, מאמר ז׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Zayin

בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה **In Sefer Yetzirah:** הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק וְכוּלֵי **"He made the letter Kuf king over laughter, etc.,** וַאֲדָר בְּשָׁנָה וּטְחוֹל בְּנָפֶשׁ. **and Adar in the year, and the spleen in the soul."** אוֹת ק׳ מְרַמֵּז **The letter Kuf alludes to** ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **"Kuf — kadosh, holy"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קד, א) **(as stated in Shabbos 104a),** וְזֶה הִמְלִיךְ בִּשְׂחוֹק **and this He made king over laughter;** וְעַל כֵּן יֵחַס לוֹ **and therefore he ascribed to it** טְחוֹל בַּנֶּפֶשׁ **the spleen in the soul,** עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **based on what they said** (בְּרָכוֹת סא, ב) **(Berachos 61b):** טְחוֹל שׂוֹחֵק. **"The spleen laughs."** וְשַׁיָּכוּת שְׂחוֹק לַאֲדָר **The connection of laughter to Adar** פֵּירְשׁוּ הַמְפָרְשִׁים **the commentators explained** מִטַּעַם שֶׁבּוֹ **on the grounds that in it are** יְמֵי מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה. **days of feasting and joy.** וּלְפִי זֶה הָוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר **But according to this, he should have said** בְּשִׂמְחָה. **"over joy."** אֶלָּא דְּכָבָר אָמַרְנוּ **However, we have already said** [מַאֲמָר ד] **(Maamar 4)** דְּהַהֶבְדֵּל בֵּין שִׂמְחָה לִשְׂחוֹק **that the difference between joy and laughter is that joy is in the heart,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says** [תְּהִלִּים קה, ג] **(Tehillim 105:3),** יִשְׂמַח לֵב מְבַקְשֵׁי ה׳. **"Let the heart of those who seek Hashem rejoice";** וְכֵן בְּנִי אִם חָכַם לִבְּךָ **and likewise, "My son, if your heart is wise,** יִשְׂמַח לִבִּי גַּם אָנִי **my heart too shall rejoice"** [מִשְׁלֵי כג, טו][614], **(Mishlei 23:15);** וְכֵן טוֹבֵי לֵב **and likewise "glad of heart";** וְהַשָּׂחוֹק הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **whereas laughter is the revelation of the joy,** וְזֶה לֹא הֻתַּר **and this was not permitted** כִּי אִם לֶעָתִיד לָבוֹא[615] **except in the future,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says** [תְּהִלִּים קכו, ב] **(Tehillim 126:2),** אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ. **"Then our mouth will be filled with laughter."** וְכֵן לְשׁוֹן הַגְּמָרָא **And likewise the wording of the Gemara** (בְּרָכוֹת ל, ב) **(Berachos 30b):** חֲזָיֵיהּ דַּהֲוָה קָא בְּדַח טוּבָא **"He saw him being exceedingly merry";** לְשׁוֹן חֲזָיֵיהּ מוֹרֶה **the expression "he saw him" indicates** שֶׁנִּרְאֶה לָעַיִן הַשִּׂמְחָה **that the joy was visible to the eye,** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר לוֹ **and therefore he said to him,** וְגִילוּ בִּרְעָדָה כְּתִיב **"'And rejoice with trembling' is written,"** אוֹ בְּכָל עֶצֶב וְגוֹמֵר **or "In all sorrow, etc.,"** שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אָסוּר **for in this world it is forbidden** שֶׁיִּמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּיו. **for one to fill his mouth with laughter.** וְעַל זֶה הֵשִׁיבוֹ **And to this he answered him,** תְּפִילִּין מַנִּיחָנָא **"I am wearing tefillin";** דִּתְפִילִּין נִקְרָא פְּאֵר[616] **for tefillin are called "pe'er," splendor** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם יא, א) **(as stated there, 11a),** וְהַיְינוּ כֶּתֶר **which is Keser,** וְאָז מוּתָּר הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה[617] **and then the revelation of joy is permitted,** וּמוֹרֶה שֶׁקִּשּׁוּר בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **and it indicates that he is bound to the root,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says** [תְּהִלִּים קכו, ב] **(Tehillim 126:2),** אָז יִמָּלֵא. **"Then shall be filled."** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this accords with what they said** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כג, א) **(Shemos Rabbah 23:1)** עַל פָּסוּק נָכוֹן כִּסְאֲךָ מֵאָז **on the verse "Your throne is established from then"** [תְּהִלִּים צג, ב] **(Tehillim 93:2):** הַמֶּלֶךְ עוֹמֵד **the king stands** וְאַגּוּסְטוּס יוֹשֵׁב וְכוּלֵי **and Augustus sits, etc.;** מִשֶּׁבָּרָאתָ וְכוּלֵי **from when You created, etc.,** כְּבָיְכוֹל עוֹמֵד **You were, as it were, standing,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עָמַד וְגוֹמֵר **as it says, "He stood, etc.";** אֲבָל מִשֶּׁאָמַרְנוּ שִׁירָה לְפָנֶיךָ **but once we said song before You** בְּאָז נִתְיַשְּׁבָה מַלְכוּתְךָ **with "Az," Your kingship became settled** וְכִסְאֲךָ נָכוֹן **and Your throne established.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is**

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[613] **Kiddushin 49b** — "Ten measures of wisdom descended to the world: the Land of Israel took nine, and the whole world took one. Ten measures of beauty descended to the world: Jerusalem took nine, and the whole world took one." The first statement grounds Rav Tzadok's association of the Land with Torah wisdom. The measure is the Gemara's figurative language, not a numerical survey.

[614] **Yoma 76b** — "Rava raised a contradiction: it is written yeshammach and read yesammach. If he merits, wine gladdens him; if he does not merit, it devastates him. This is what Rava said: Wine and spices have made me perceptive." The wordplay distinguishes beneficial joy from wine's ruinous effect. Rav Tzadok applies the requirement of merit to the spiritual wine of Oral Torah.

[615] **Pesachim 68b** — "Mar son of Ravina fasted throughout the year, except for Shavuos, Purim, and the eve of Yom Kippur. Shavuos is the day on which Torah was given. Concerning Purim it is written, Days of feasting and joy. Concerning the eve of Yom Kippur, Chiyya bar Rav of Difti taught: Whoever eats and drinks on the ninth, Scripture accounts it to him as if he had fasted on the ninth and tenth."

[616] **Tosafos, Berachos 49b, s.v. I bai achil** — "That which is said in Pesachim, that Mar son of Ravina fasted throughout the year, implies that he fasted on festivals. Ri explains that the passage concerns a fast over a dream; other fasts are forbidden."

[617] **Ruth Rabbah 5:15** — "'Boaz ate and drank, and his heart was good.' Why was his heart good? He blessed over his food. Another interpretation: His heart was good because he ate sweet foods after the meal, which accustom the tongue to Torah. Another interpretation: His heart was good because he engaged in words of Torah, as it is said, 'The Torah of Your mouth is better for me.' Another interpretation: His heart was good because he sought a wife, as it is said, 'One who has found a wife has found good.'" The Midrash gives several explanations of Boaz's glad heart. Rav Tzadok follows the explanation that identifies the gladness with Torah.

according to what they said [בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ [חֶלֶק ב נד, א[618] **in the holy Zohar (II 54a),** דְּאָז מְרַמֵּז **that "Az" alludes** דְּאָלֶף פָּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן **that the Aleph, the supernal wonder,** אַנְקִיב בְּחֻשׁוֹכִי **bores through in the darkness** וּמָטוּ לְזַיִן **and reaches the Zayin;** וְהַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁיֵּשׁ הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **that is, when there is a revelation of Atika,** וּכְתִיב **and it is written** [דָּנִיֵּאל ז, ט] **(Daniel 7:9),** עַד דִּי כָרְסָוָן רְמִיו **"Until thrones were set up,** וְעַתִּיק יוֹמִין יְתִיב **and the Ancient of Days sat";** וְזֶהוּ נָכוֹן כִּסְאֲךָ מֵאָז. **and this is "Your throne is established from Az."** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what it says,** אָ״ז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ **"Az (Aleph-Zayin) our mouth will be filled with laughter":** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מוּתָּר הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **that the revelation of joy will be permitted;** וְכֵן בִּשְׁעַת הֲנָחַת תְּפִילִּין **and likewise at the time of putting on tefillin** (וְנִתְבָּאַר לְמַעְלָה בַּמַּאֲמָרִים הַקּוֹדְמִים). **(as was explained above in the previous maamarim).** וְהָרַאֲבַ״ד זְכרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **And the Ra'avad, of blessed memory** [בְּפֵירוּשׁ סֵפֶר יְצִירָה רֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ה] **(in his commentary on Sefer Yetzirah, beginning of chapter 5),** חָשַׁב כָּל הַשְּׁנַיִם עָשָׂר כֹּחוֹת **enumerated all twelve** הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁנִּמְצְאוּ בַּכָּתוּב גַּם אֲצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ כְּבְיָכוֹל **powers of the soul found in Scripture with regard to Hashem Yisbarach too, as it were;** חָשַׁב שְׂחוֹק **he counted laughter,** דִּכְתִיב **as it is written** [תְּהִלִּים ב, ד] **(Tehillim 2:4),** יוֹשֵׁב בַּשָּׁמַיִם יִשְׂחָק[619] **"He Who sits in Heaven laughs"** — וְהַיְינוּ בְּמִלְחֶמֶת גּוֹג וּמָגוֹג **that is, in the war of Gog and Magog** [עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ג, ב], **(Avodah Zarah 3b),** שֶׁאָז ה' בָּדָד יַנְחֶנּוּ וְגוֹמֵר **when "Hashem alone will lead him, etc."** [דְּבָרִים לב, יב] **(Devarim 32:12),** וְלֹא יִהְיֶה שָׂרִיד וְגוֹמֵר **and "there shall be no survivor, etc."** [עוֹבַדְיָה א, יח], **(Ovadyah 1:18),** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק מִכֹּל וָכֹל[620] **for Amalek will be eradicated completely;** אָז הוּא בְּחִינַת שְׂחוֹק **then it is the aspect of laughter,** הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **the revelation of joy,** וְאָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ. **and then "our mouth will be filled with laughter."** וְאוֹת ק' רִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁנִּזְכַּר בַּתּוֹרָה **And the first Kuf mentioned in the Torah** הוּא בְּתֵיבַת וַיִּקְרָא **is in the word "vayikra":** אֱלֹהִים לָאוֹר יוֹם[621] **"And Elokim called the light day"** [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, ה]. **(Bereishis 1:5).** וְיָדוּעַ דְּכָל אוֹת **And it is known that every letter,** בַּמָּקוֹם שֶׁנִּזְכַּר רִאשׁוֹנָה בַּתּוֹרָה **in the place where it is first mentioned in the Torah,** שָׁם מְרוּמָּז **there is alluded** הָאוֹת שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְדוּשַׁת הָאוֹת[622] **the root of that letter's holiness,** כִּדְמוּכָח בַּגְּמָרָא **as is evident in the Gemara** (בָּבָא קַמָּא נה, א) **(Bava Kamma 55a)** גַּבֵּי אוֹת טֵית.[623] **regarding the letter Tes.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאוֹת קוּף קָדוֹשׁ **That is, the letter Kuf is "kadosh,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **as they said in the Gemara** [שַׁבָּת קד, א]; **(Shabbos 104a);** וְחָכְמָה עִלָּאָה קוֹדֶשׁ עִלָּאָה **and supernal wisdom is supernal holiness;** חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה **the wisdom of Shlomo** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג קעו, ב) **(as stated in Zohar III 176b).** וְהַיְינוּ דְּחָכְמָה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **That is, Chochmah is the Written Torah,** וּנְגַד מִדָּה זוֹ **and corresponding to this attribute** מַאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **is the**

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[618] **Shabbat 63b** — "Reish Lakish said: Up to here the verse concerns words of Torah; from here onward it concerns good deeds." The verse begins, Rejoice, young man, in your youth, and let your heart gladden you. Reish Lakish reads its first portion as encouragement in Torah and its latter portion as a demand for action.

[619] **Berakhot 5a** — "Rabbi Yochanan said: ... Whoever can occupy himself with Torah but does not do so, the Holy One, blessed be He, brings ugly sufferings upon him and troubles him, as it is said, I became mute in silence; I was silent from good, and my pain was stirred up. Good means nothing other than Torah, as it is said, For I have given you a good teaching; do not abandon My Torah." Rav Tzadok draws on the identification of good with Torah when reading a good heart as a heart shaped by Torah.

[620] **Bava Batra 145b** — "Rabbi Zeira said in Rav's name: What is meant by All the days of a poor man are bad? This is the master of Talmud. One of good heart has a continual feast: this is the master of Mishnah. Rava said the opposite. Rav Mesharshiya said in Rava's name: One who moves stones is pained by them refers to masters of Mishnah; one who splits wood benefits through it refers to masters of Talmud." Rav and Rava assign the glad heart differently. Rav Tzadok preserves both: settled rulings guide practice, while successful Talmudic analysis discloses fresh Torah.

[621] **Sefer Chachmoni, Sefer Yetzirah, chapter 5, pp. 75–76, 78** — "He made qof rule and tied a crown to it, engraving it at the beginning of speech. ... He formed with it the constellation Pisces in the world, the month Adar in the year, and the left leg in the soul. ... The opposite of sleep is wakefulness, namely being awake. ... With qof were formed Pisces, Adar, the left leg, sleep, and wakefulness." The actual original chapter gives the full correspondence explicitly in its concluding table, and the commentary on page 78 again associates qof and the left leg with sleep and wakefulness. This independently verifies the sleep–Adar reading cited here through Sefer Chachmoni. Its wording is fuller than Rav Tzadok's compressed formula 'He made qof rule over sleep'; it should be distinguished from the laughter recension quoted elsewhere.

[622] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:5** — "Hashem God caused a deep sleep to fall. Rabbi Yehoshua of Sikhnin said in Rabbi Levi's name: The beginning of a fall is sleep: he sleeps and does not labor in Torah or do work. Rav said: There are three deep sleeps: the deep sleep of ordinary sleep, the deep sleep of prophecy, and the deep sleep of stupor."

[623] **Midrash Tanchuma, Beshalach 25** — "Others say: Rephidim means only that their hands had grown slack in Torah; therefore Amalek came upon them. Likewise you find that the enemy comes only because of slackness in Torah, as it is said, When Rechavam's kingdom was established and he had become strong, he abandoned the Torah of Hashem, and all Israel with him."

utterance "Let there be light," כְּנֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה חֻמְשֵׁי תּוֹרָה **corresponding to the five Chumashim of the Torah,** וּכְתִיב בּוֹ חֲמִשָּׁה פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה **and "light" is written in it five times,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה [ג, ה]. **as they said in Bereishis Rabbah (3:5).** וְכֵן מַלְכוּת פֶּה **And likewise, "Malchus is the mouth" —** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh,** כָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ"ן בְּחִדּוּשָׁיו **which the Ramban wrote in his novellae** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב, א) **(Bava Basra 12a)** שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **comes through ruach hakodesh;** וְכֵן נִדְרַשׁ בַּגְּמָרָא **and so it is expounded in the Gemara** (מְגִילָּה יד, ב) **(Megillah 14b)** וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג קסט, ב) **and in the holy Zohar (III 169b):** מַלְכוּת רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ[624] **Malchus is ruach hakodesh;** כְּלוֹמַר רוּחַ מֵהַהוּא קוֹדֶשׁ (שָׁם סא, א) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (ibid. 61a):** דְּלְעֵילָּא **that is, a spirit from that holiness above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק **And this is what he said, "He made Kuf king over laughter":** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הִתְגַּלּוּת[625] אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁנִּגְנַז **that there will be a revelation of the primordial light that was hidden,** שֶׁעַל זֶה מוֹרָה אוֹת ק׳ **which is what the letter Kuf indicates,** שֶׁנִּזְכַּר רִאשׁוֹנָה בְּתֵיבַת וַיִּקְרָא לָאוֹר יוֹם **being first mentioned in the word "vayikra": "He called the light day."** וְהַיְינוּ קוֹצוֹ שֶׁל יוּד **That is, the tip of the Yud** דְּלְעֵילָּא דְּרָמִיז **above, which alludes** לְאֵין כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **to Ayin, Keser Elyon,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם סה, ב) **as they said in the holy Zohar** (ibid. 65b); וְהוּא כּוֹלֵל קוֹדֶשׁ עִלָּאָה וְתַתָּאָה **and it includes the upper and lower holiness,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the Written Torah and Torah she'b'al peh,** וְאָז זְמַן הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה. **and then is the time for the revelation of joy.** וְזֶה עֵסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה **And this is the work of this month,** שֶׁהוּא רֹאשִׁית שְׁמְסוּגָל לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **which is propitious for the eradication of Amalek,** דְּקִלִּיפָּה זוֹכִין לְרֹאשִׁית דְּקְדוּשָׁה **who is the "first" of the kelipah;** וּכְשֶׁנִּמְחֶה **and when he is wiped out, we merit the "first" of holiness.** וְזֶה שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ וּבְשְׂחוֹק **And this is why it was formed with Kuf and with laughter,** שָׁאָז מוּתָּר הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה. **for then the revelation of joy is permitted.** וְהָרַאֲבַ"ד זְכוּרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **And the Ra'avad, of blessed memory,** דְּהָשַׁב שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר כֹּחוֹת הַנֶּפֶשׁ **who matched the twelve powers of the soul** לִשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים **to the twelve tribes,** חָשַׁב שְׂחוֹק לְנַפְתָּלִי **assigned laughter to Naftali,** דִּכְתִיב **as it is written** [דְּבָרִים (לוֹג, כג] **(Devarim 33:23),** נַפְתָּלִי שְׂבַע רָצוֹן **"Naftali, satisfied with favor** וּמָלֵא וְגוֹמֵר **and full, etc."** וְהָאֲרִ"י זְכוּרוֹנוֹ **And the Arizal,** כְּסֵדֶר דְּהָשַׁב הֶחָדָשִׁים לִשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים **who matched the months to the twelve tribes** לִבְרָכָה **in the order of the banners,** הַדְּגָלִים חָשַׁב אָדָר לְנַפְתָּלִי[626] **assigned Adar to Naftali,** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן מִטַּעַם זֶה **and this too is for the same reason.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **And we have already said** דְּשְׂבַע רָצוֹן הַיְינוּ **that "satisfied with favor" means** שֶׁזָּכָה לְהִתְגַּלּוּת רָצוֹן מֵעַתִּיקָא **that he merited a revelation of will from Atika** (וְנִתְבָּאַר מַאֲמָר ו) **(as explained in maamar 6);** וּמָלֵא בִּרְכַת ה׳ הַיְינוּ **and "full of Hashem's blessing" means** דְּקְדוּשָׁה רִאשׁוֹנָה שֶׁהוּזְכַּר בַּתּוֹרָה **that the first holiness mentioned in the Torah** דְּהוּא[627] שַׁבָּת **is that of Shabbos,** דִּכְתִיב **as it is written** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ב, ג] **(Bereishis 2:3),** וַיְקַדֵּשׁ אוֹתוֹ **"And He sanctified it,"** [שָׁם] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (ibid.),** וַיְבָרֶךְ אֶלֹהִים אֶת יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **"And Elokim blessed the seventh day."** וְזֶה שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ **And this is what they expounded** בִּרְכַּת ה׳ הִיא תַּעֲשִׁיר (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יא, א) **(Bereishis Rabbah 11:1): "The blessing of Hashem, it makes rich"**

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[624] **Midrash Tanchuma, Re'eh 13** — "Chizkiyah said: The judgment of the wicked in Gehinnom is twelve months: six months in heat and six months in cold. ... Where do they complete their punishment? Rabbi Yehudah bar Rabbi says: In snow, as it is written, When the Almighty scattered kings in it, it snowed in Tzalmon. The snow is their shadow of death." Rav Tzadok associates the cold punishment with spiritual coldness and laziness, in contrast to the fire associated with inflamed desire.

[625] **Bereshit Rabbah 54:1** — "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: This is the evil inclination. Ordinarily a person who grows up with his fellow for two or three years in a town binds himself to him in love. This one grows up with a person from youth to old age: if it finds him at seventy, it makes him fall; if at eighty, it makes him fall. ... Shlomo said: If your enemy is hungry, feed him bread; if he is thirsty, give him water: from the bread of Torah and the water of Torah." The Midrash interprets the enemy in Mishlei 16:7 as the evil inclination and explains its mastery through Torah. This supports Rav Tzadok's inward reading of victory over enemies.

[626] **Bereshit Rabbah 9:6** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar said: Behold, very good—behold, sleep is good. Is sleep very good? Is it not taught that wine and sleep are fitting for the wicked and fitting for the world? Rather, because a person sleeps a little, he rises and labors greatly in Torah." The distinction is purposeful sleep that renews Torah labor, rather than sleep as abandonment of labor.

[627] **Zohar I 129a–b, Chayei Sarah** — "Avraham drew near to Him, and this was his yearning all his days. Avraham did not draw near in one day or at one time; his deeds brought him near each day, from level to level, until he rose through his levels. When he grew old and entered the higher levels fittingly, it says, 'Avraham was old'; then he 'came into the days'—those supernal days, those days known in the mystery of faith. ... Fortunate are the masters of repentance, for in one hour, one day, one moment, they draw near to the Holy One, blessed be He, as even completely righteous people did not over many years." The source explicitly interprets Avraham's age through entry into supernal days, reached through his life's deeds. The maamar reads that attainment as purification of his attribute up to its highest root; its discussion of renewed Torah exertion draws on the same ascent.

[מִשְׁלֵי י, כב] **(Mishlei 10:22) —** זוֹ הַשַּׁבָּת **this is Shabbos;** [שָׁם] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (ibid.),** וְלֹא יוֹסִיף עֶצֶב עִמָּהּ **"and He adds no sorrow with it."** דְּעִיקַּר הֶסַּתַּת הַנָּחָשׁ **For the essence of the serpent's enticement** הָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה לַהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף **was in eating for bodily pleasure,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה גָּרַם וְהֵבִיא הָעֶצֶב **and through this he caused and brought sorrow,** דִּכְתִיב **as it is written** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, יז] **(Bereishis 3:17),** בְּעִצָּבוֹן תֹּאכְלֶנָּה **"In sorrow shall you eat of it";** וּבְשַׁבָּת שֶׁאָז הָאֲכִילָה **and on Shabbos, when even eating** לַהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף הוּא בְּקִדּוּשָׁה **for bodily pleasure is in holiness,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר הָאֲרִ״י זְכרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **as the Arizal said** [מַחְבֶּרֶת הַקֹּדֶשׁ שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת **(Machberes HaKodesh, Shaar HaShabbos,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל לִיקוּטִים בְּסוֹד הָאֲכִילָה[628]**], s.v. Likkutim BeSod HaAchilah),** בּוֹ הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ.[629] **is the time to repair the serpent's damage.** וְאִיתָא בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן מח פה, א) **And it is stated in the Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 48, 85a):** "וְשָׁמְרוּ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת **"And Bnei Yisrael shall keep the Shabbos,** לַעֲשׂוֹת אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת **to make the Shabbos"** [שְׁמוֹת לא, טז] **(Shemos 31:16) —** שֶׁרוֹמֵז לְשַׁבָּת עִלָּאָה וְתַתָּאָה **which alludes to the upper and lower Shabbos,** שֶׁהוּא שְׁכִינְתָּא עִלָּאָה וְתַתָּאָה **which is the upper and lower Shechinah;** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר לְדֹרֹתָם חָסֵר **and about this "ledorosam" is written defective,** לְרַמֵּז מָאן דְּעָבִיד **to allude: fortunate is he who makes** לוֹן דִּירָה בְּשַׁבָּת **a dwelling for them on Shabbos** בִּתְרֵי בָּתֵּי לִבָּא **in the two chambers of the heart,** וְאִתְפַּנֵּי יֵצֶר הָרָע מִן תַּמָּן **and the evil inclination is cleared out from there.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what it says,** וְלֹא יוֹסִיף עֶצֶב עִמָּהּ **"and He adds no sorrow with it":** דְּאִתְפַּנֵּי הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **that the evil inclination is cleared out,** שֶׁגָּרַם וְהֵבִיא הָעֶצָּבוֹן **which is the serpent** שֶׁהוּא הַנָּחָשׁ.[630] **that caused and brought the sorrow.** וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ **And so they expounded** (מְכִילְתָּא בְּשַׁלַּח פָּרָשַׁת וַיַּסַּע ה) **(Mechilta, Beshalach, Parshas Vayisa 5):** "שׁוֹמֵר שַׁבָּת וְגוֹמֵר **"Who keeps Shabbos, etc.,** וְשׁוֹמֵר יָדוֹ מֵעֲשׂוֹת כָּל רָע **and guards his hand from doing any evil"** [יְשַׁעְיָה נו, ב] **(Yeshayah 56:2) —** מִי שֶׁמְּשַׁמֵּר אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת **whoever guards the Shabbos** מְרוּחָק מִן הָעֲבֵירָה[631] **is kept far from sin.** וּמִזֶּה שׁוֹרֶשׁ מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב **And from this is the root of what is written** בְּפִרְי עֵץ חַיִּים (רֵישׁ שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת) **in Pri Etz Chaim (beginning of Shaar HaShabbos):** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשַּׁבָּת יִהְיֶה מוּבְטָח **that through Shabbos one will be assured** שֶׁלֹּא יֶחֱטָא **that he will not sin,** וְלֹא יְקַטְרֵג בּוֹ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **and the evil inclination will not accuse him** כָּל יְמֵי הַשָּׁבוּעַ **all the days of the week.** וְזֶהוּ[632] וְלֹא יוֹסִיף עֶצֶב עִמָּהּ **And this is "and He adds no sorrow with it":** הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁנִּקְרָא עֶצֶב. **the evil inclination, which is called sorrow.** וְכֵן נִדְרַשׁ (תְּמוּרָה טז, א) **And so it is expounded (Temurah 16a):** "לִבְלְתִּי עָצְבִּי **"that it may not grieve me"** [דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א ד, י] **(Divrei**

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[628] **Bereshit Rabbah 58:9** — "Rabbi Shmuel bar Yitzchak said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Avraham: My occupation is performing kindness. You have adopted My occupation; come, wear My garment. And Avraham was old, advanced in days."

[629] **Chullin 16a** — "Rabbi was teaching: From where do we know that slaughter must be with a detached object? For it is said, He took the knife to slaughter. ... But that verse teaches us Avraham's eagerness." The Gemara questions whether taking the knife proves a rule about slaughtering implements or simply displays Avraham's eagerness to fulfill the command.

[630] Parallel: **Rambam, Mishneh Torah, Hilchos Deos 3:3** — "He should intend that his body be sound and strong so that his soul will be properly directed to know Hashem; one cannot understand and contemplate the disciplines while hungry or ill or when one of his limbs is in pain. … Even when he is sleeping, if he deliberately sleeps so that his mind may rest and his body recover, lest he become ill and be unable to serve Hashem, his sleep itself becomes service of the Omnipresent, blessed be He. Concerning this our Sages commanded, 'Let all your actions be for the sake of Heaven.' This is what Shlomo said in his wisdom: 'In all your ways know Him, and He will straighten your paths.'"

Connection: Rambam gives a practical halachic form to the conversion of sleep from downfall into service: the rest must be deliberately directed toward restoring the capacity to know and serve Hashem. It is not only the subsequent learning that acquires value; the sleep itself becomes avodah. This sharpens Rav Tzadok's statement that sleep can generate renewed alacrity and abundant Torah toil, without treating unqualified inactivity as holy.

[631] **Esther Rabbah 7:12** — "There is one people: the One of whom it is said, Hashem is One, has fallen asleep from His people. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: There is no sleep before Me, as it is written, Behold, the Guardian of Israel neither slumbers nor sleeps. Yet you said that there is sleep before Me! By your life, from sleep I shall awaken against that man and destroy him from the world, as it is written, Hashem awakened as one who sleeps and struck His enemies backward." That man refers to Haman. The Midrash presents his charge of Divine sleep as the point from which the reversal will emerge.

[632] **Makkot 7b** — "The Sages taught: Or he cast upon him includes a descent undertaken for an ascent. Rabbi Abahu asked Rabbi Yochanan: If a person was ascending a ladder and a rung slipped from beneath him, fell, and killed someone, what is the law? Is this ascent or descent? He answered: You have encountered a descent undertaken for an ascent." The phrase belongs to the laws of accidental killing and exile. Rav Tzadok borrows it to describe a spiritual descent that becomes the means to renewed ascent.

HaYamim I 4:10) — שֶׁלֹּא יְשַׁגְּבֵנִי יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלִּשְׁנוֹת[633] **that the evil inclination not overpower me from reviewing.** וְזֶהוּ שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **And this is the root of the kelipah of Amalek,** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ **"who happened upon you"** [דְּבָרִים כה, יח] **(Devarim 25:18):** הִצְנִינְךָ וְהִפְשִׁירְךָ **he cooled you and made you lukewarm** [רַשִׁ״י שָׁם[634]], **(Rashi there),** וּמַשְׁלִיךְ עֶצֶב וְעַצְלוּת **and he casts sorrow, laziness** וְרִיפּוּי יָדַיִם מִן הַתּוֹרָה[635] **and slackness of hands from Torah,** (סַנְהֶדְרִין קו, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ **as is expounded (Sanhedrin 106a)** לְשׁוֹן רְפִידִים.[636] **on the name "Refidim."** וּכְשֶׁזּוֹכִין לְרָצוֹן מֵעַתִּיקָא **And when we merit the will from Atika —** דְּמַאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **for the utterance "Let there be light,"** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד חָכְמָה **which corresponds to Chochmah,** הוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת הָרָצוֹן **is the revelation of the will** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בּוֹ תְּפִיסָה מָה **such that there is some grasp of it,** וְעַתִּיקָא רָצוֹן פָּשׁוּט **whereas Atika is simple will** הַנַּעֲלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן. **hidden from all thought —** זוֹכִין לְקֻ׳ קֹדֶשׁ עִלָּאָה וְתַתָּאָה **we merit Kuf, the upper and lower holiness,** וּכְמוֹ בְּשַׁבָּת **just as on Shabbos,** שֶׁהוּא זְמַן שֶׁנִּיתְּנָה **which is the time when there was given** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **the Written Torah to Yisrael,** [פו, ב] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּשַׁבָּת; **as they said in Shabbos (86b);** (זֹהַר חֲלָק א מז, ב) וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (Zohar I 47b):** בְּיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **"On the seventh day"** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ב, ב] **(Bereishis 2:2) —** דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּאִיהוּ יוֹם שְׁבִיעִי **which is the seventh day;** וְהַיְינוּ מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and this is what they said** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar,** בְּפָתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] **in Pasach Eliyahu):** מַלְכוּת פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה וְכוּלֵי **"Malchus is the mouth, Torah she'b'al peh, etc."** וְעַל כֵּן גַּם בְּשַׁבָּת **And therefore on Shabbos too** מוּתָּר הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **the revelation of joy is permitted,** שֶׁהוּא רִנָּה **which is "rinah," song;** אַף דִּכְתִיב אָז דַּיְקָא **for it is written "Az" precisely,** וּלְשׁוֹנֵנוּ רִנָּה **"and our tongue with song"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ד) **(as explained in maamar 4).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what it says,** נַפְתָּלִי שְׂבַע רָצוֹן **"Naftali, satisfied with favor" —** וּמָלֵא בִּרְכַּת ה׳ **the will from Atika — "and full of Hashem's blessing,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: **as mentioned above.**

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[633] **Berakhot 53b** — "Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name, and it was taught likewise: You shall sanctify yourselves refers to the first washing of the hands; and you shall be holy refers to the final washing; for holy refers to oil; I am Hashem your God refers to the blessing." The teaching expounds Vayikra 20:7. Rav Tzadok develops the first washing as the removal of the personal bias introduced through bodily desire.

[634] **Bereshit Rabbah 17:6** — "Rabbi Chanina son of Rav Idi said: From the beginning of the book until here the letter samech is not written. When she was created, Satan was created with her. If someone tells you, It says He is the one that surrounds, tell him: Scripture there is speaking of rivers." The Midrash makes a textual play on the first samech in the human narrative. Rav Tzadok applies it to the moral struggle surrounding desire; it should not be converted into a claim that women themselves are evil.

[635] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 11** — "It was taught in Rabbi Ilai's name: The Holy One, blessed be He, swore: My right hand, My right hand; My throne, My throne! If converts come from all the nations of the world, I accept them; but the offspring of Amalek I do not accept forever." This is the Midrashic teaching Rav Tzadok cites in his distinction between extracting holy sparks from Egypt and the eradication of Amalek. It is presented here as a source for his discourse, not as a practical determination of anyone's ancestry or conversion status.

[636] **Taanit 5b** — "Rabbi Yochanan said: Our father Yaakov did not die. They asked: Was it for nothing that the eulogizers eulogized, the embalmers embalmed, and the buriers buried him? He answered: I am expounding a verse: Do not fear, My servant Yaakov ... for I shall save you from afar and your offspring from the land of their captivity. It compares him to his offspring: just as his offspring are alive, so he is alive."

ראש חודש אדר, מאמר ח׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Ches

וּלְגִרְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים **And according to the version of the Geonim,** בְּחֶשְׁבּוֹן הַשְּׁנֵים עָשָׂר כֹּחוֹת **in the count of the twelve powers** (רֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ה) בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה **in Sefer Yetzirah (beginning of chapter 5),** כֹּחַ שֵׁינָה הַשְּׁנֵים עָשָׂר **the power of sleep is the twelfth,** הַגִּרְסָא הַמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בְּשֵׁינָה **and the reading is: "He made Kuf king over sleep,** וַאֲדָר בְּשָׁנָה **and Adar in the year";** וְאֵלּוּ וָאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים. **and these and these are the words of the living G-d.** שֶׁעַסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה **For the work of this month is** שֶׁאַף בְּשֵׁינָה יִשְׂרָאֵל ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **that even in sleep Yisrael are Kuf, holy,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשּׁוֹרֶשׁ **since they are bound at the root** בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ[637] **to Hashem Yisbarach.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is according to what they said** (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה, ב) **(Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2):** אֲנִי יְשֵׁנָה מִן הַמִּצְוֹת וְכוּ׳ **"I am asleep from the mitzvos, etc.,** וְלִבִּי עֵר לַעֲשׂוֹתָן וְכוּ׳ **but my heart is awake to do them, etc.** אֵיכָן מָצִינוּ **Where do we find** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that HaKadosh Baruch Hu is the heart of Yisrael?** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **As it says** [תְּהִלִּים עג, כו] **(Tehillim 73:26),** צוּר לִבָּבִי **'The Rock of my heart** וְחֶלְקִי אֱלֹהִים לְעוֹלָם. **and my portion is Elokim forever.'"** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמִּצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **That is, from the side of Hashem Yisbarach:** קוֹל דּוֹדִי דוֹפֵק **"The voice of my Beloved knocks:** פִּתְחִי לִי וְגוֹמֵר **open for Me, etc."** [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ה, ב] **(Shir HaShirim 5:2) —** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְעוֹרֵר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **Hashem Yisbarach arouses Yisrael** לַעֲשׂוֹתָן[638] **to do them.** וּבְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **And in this month —** (מְגִילָּה יג, ב) דְּאִיתָא **as it is stated (Megillah 13b):** לֵיכָּא דְּיָדַע לִישָׁנָא בִּישָׁא כְּהָמָן **"There is none who knows how to slander like Haman,"** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהוּא שָׁיָדַע **and we said this means that he knew** לְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **how to accuse Yisrael** לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **before Hashem Yisbarach;** וְאָמַר יָשְׁנוּ מִן הַמִּצְוֹת **and he said, "They are asleep from the mitzvos;** אִית בְּהוּ רַבָּנָן **there are Rabbanan among them;** עַם אֶחָד הֵן וְכוּ׳[639] **they are one people, etc.,"** וְאָמַר וְאֶת דָּתֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **and he said, "And the laws of the King** אֵינָם עוֹשִׂים[640] **they do not observe"** [אֶסְתֵּר ג, ח]; **(Esther 3:8);** וְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בִּמְגִילָּה זוֹ **and wherever this Megillah says** הַמֶּלֶךְ סְתָם **"the King" without qualification,** מְשַׁמֵּשׁ קוֹדֶשׁ וְחוֹל **it serves for both the holy and the mundane** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּאֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ג, י) **(as stated in Esther Rabbah 3:10);** וְכָאן גַּם כֵּן שֶׁאֵינָם עוֹשִׂים מִצְוֹת **and here too he intended** לְקַטְרֵג לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **to accuse before Hashem Yisbarach** נִתְכַּוְּנוּ **that they do not perform the commandment** מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים[641] **of the King of kings** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג קט, א) **(Zohar III 109a):** בְּכָל אֲתַר הַמֶּלֶךְ סְתָם **"And everywhere, 'the King' unqualified —** דָּא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא. **this is Kudsha Brich Hu."** וְיָשְׁנוּ מִן הַמִּצְוֹת **And "they are asleep from the mitzvos"** — וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בְּפָסוּק **since it was written in a verse,** מִן הַסְּתָם הָיָה מָקוֹם לְקַטְרוּגוֹ[642] **presumably there was some basis**

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[637] **Ketubot 103a** — "Let the lamp be lit in its place, the table set in its place, and the bed spread in its place. Why? Every Friday evening he would come to his house." The passage follows Rabbi's instructions before his death and describes his continued Friday-evening presence in the home.

[638] **Sefer Chassidim 1129** — "Our holy master would appear in the fine garments that he wore on Shabbos, not in shrouds, to show that he remained in his full strength. He discharged the obligation of the many in the sanctification of the day, unlike other dead people who are free from the commandments: he was as a living person in the clothes he wore in his life. The righteous are called living even in death, and he discharged his household's obligation in Kiddush." This is the explicit source for Kiddush, a detail not stated in the quoted sentence from Kesubos 103a.

[639] **Ketubot 104a** — "As Rabbi was dying, he raised his ten fingers upward and said: Master of the world, it is revealed and known before You that I labored in Torah with my ten fingers and did not take pleasure even with my little finger. May it be Your will that there be peace in my rest. A heavenly voice went forth and said: Let peace come; they shall rest on their beds."

[640] **Likkutei HaShas of the Ari, Avos 2:1** — "Rabbi says, 'Whatever brings honor to the one who does it,' etc. Know that Rabbeinu HaKadosh is Yaakov Avinu himself. This is the meaning of 'whatever brings honor to the one who does it.' Understand this." The original Lurianic passage identifies Rebbi with Yaakov directly. Its immediate context is Rebbi's teaching about tiferes, the attribute associated with Yaakov; Rav Tzadok invokes the soul connection in explaining their shared holiness.

[641] **Rosh Hashanah 29a** — "Similarly it says: Make yourself a fiery serpent and place it on a pole; anyone bitten shall see it and live. Does a serpent kill or give life? Rather, when Israel looked upward and subjected their hearts to their Father in Heaven, they were healed; otherwise they wasted away." The Mishnah places this immediately after the teaching about Moshe's raised hands in the war with Amalek. Rav Tzadok explains both through direction of the heart.

[642] **Berakhot 33a** — "Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa took the dead arvad on his shoulder and brought it to the study hall. He told them: See, my children: the arvad does not kill; sin kills. At that time they said: Woe to the person met by an arvad, and woe to the arvad met by Rabbi Chanina ben Dosa." Arvad is the dangerous creature described in the preceding narrative. Rav Tzadok invokes the episode to identify the moral root beneath the serpent image.

for his accusation, שֶׁאֵין הַכְּתוּבִים כּוֹתְבִים דִּבְרֵי בַּדַּאי **for Scripture does not record words of falsehood** שֶׁאוֹמֵר מִי **merely stating who said them,** אַף שֶׁאֱמֶת שֶׁאָמַר[643] **even though it is true that he said them,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהוֹכַחְנוּ מֵהַמִּדְרָשׁ **as we demonstrated from the Midrash** (תַּנְחוּמָא תּוֹלְדוֹת א). **(Tanchuma, Toldos 1).** וְכֵן רָאִינוּ שֶׁהוֹעִיל קִטְרוּגוֹ **And so we have seen that his accusation was effective,** עַד שֶׁהִסְכִּימוּ מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם **until Heaven concurred** וְנֶחְתַּם הַגְּזֵרָה דִּין **and the decree was sealed;** רַק הָיָה חוֹתָם שֶׁל טִיט[644] **only it was a seal of clay** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ז, יג). **(as stated in Esther Rabbah 7:13).** רַק בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **But in this month** הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בְּשֵׁינָה **He made Kuf king over sleep,** שֶׁאַף בְּשֵׁינָה **for even in sleep** יִשְׂרָאֵל קְדוֹשִׁים הֵם **Yisrael are holy,** וְלִבִּי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **and "my heart" — HaKadosh Baruch Hu,** שֶׁהוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **who is the heart of Yisrael —** עֵר לַעֲשׂוֹתָן. **"is awake to do them,"** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהֵם קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ[645] **since they are bound at the root;** וְעַל כֵּן בּוֹ הַזְּמַן **and therefore it is the time** לְמִחְיַת רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה **for eradicating the "first" of the kelipah,** רֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִם עֲמָלֵק. **"Amalek, the first of the nations."** וּכְתִיב [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים שָׁם] **And it is written (Shir HaShirim, ibid.),** קוֹל דּוֹדִי וְהַיְינוּ עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבַּעַל שֶׁרֹּאשִׁי נִמְלָא טָל **for My head is filled with dew" —** וְגוֹמֵר **"The voice of my Beloved, etc.,** טַל שֶׁעָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **which is the dew of Atika,** שֶׁהוּא טַלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא **this refers to Torah she'b'al peh,** פֶּה **the dew with which HaKadosh Baruch Hu is destined** לְהַחֲיוֹת הַמֵּתִים **to revive the dead** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ו) **(as explained in maamar 6).** וְזֶהוּ וְלִבִּי עֵר **And this is "and my heart is awake":** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְעוֹרֵר יִשְׂרָאֵל מִשֵּׁינָה **Hashem Yisbarach rouses Yisrael from sleep** לַעֲשׂוֹת הַמִּצְוֹת. **to do the mitzvos.** וְהָרַאֲבַ״ד זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה כְּשֶׁחָשַׁב הַשְּׁנֵים עָשָׂר כֹּחוֹת **And the Ra'avad, of blessed memory, when he matched the twelve powers** לִשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר שְׁבָטִים **to the twelve tribes,** חָשַׁב שֵׁינָה לְבִנְיָמִין **assigned sleep to Binyamin,** דִּכְתִיב **as it is written** [דְּבָרִים לג, יב] **(Devarim 33:12),** בֵּין כְּתֵפָיו שָׁכֵן **"and He dwells between his shoulders"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלֵו מַאֲמָר ד עַיֵּין שָׁם) **(as explained for Rosh Chodesh Kislev, maamar 4, see there);** [שָׁם] וּבִנְיָמִין נִקְרָא **and Binyamin is called (ibid.)** יְדִיד ה׳[646] **"beloved of Hashem,"** וְכֵן שְׁלֹמֹה עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and likewise Shlomo, peace be upon him,** [שְׁמוּאֵל ב יב, כה] נִקְרָא **is called (Shmuel II 12:25)** יְדִידְיָהּ[647] **"Yedidyah,"** [תְּהִלִּים קכז, ב] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Tehillim 127:2),** כֵּן יִתֵּן לִידִידוֹ שֵׁנָה[648] **"So He gives His beloved sleep";** שֶׁמָּצִינוּ [זֹהַר ח״א קמט, ב] **for we find (Zohar I 149b)** דִּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that King Shlomo, peace be upon him,** זָכָה לְכָל חָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה **attained all the lower wisdom,** חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה **the wisdom of Shlomo,** בַּחֲלוֹם בְּשֵׁינָה **in a dream, in sleep;** וְזֶהוּ ק׳

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[643] **Bartenura, Rosh Hashanah 3:8** — "Because the Mishnah was discussing directing the heart, it also taught this: when Israel direct their hearts to their Father in Heaven, they prevail."

[644] **Rambam, Hilchos Teshuvah 3:4** — "Although sounding the shofar on Rosh HaShanah is a decree of Scripture, it contains a hint: Awaken, sleepers, from your sleep; slumberers, arise from your slumber. Examine your deeds, return in repentance, and remember your Creator. Those who forget truth in the vanities of time and spend their whole year in emptiness and nothingness that neither benefits nor saves: look to your souls and improve your ways and deeds."

[645] **Sukkah 52b** — "Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani said in Rabbi Yonasan's name: The evil inclination incites a person in this world and testifies against him in the World to Come, as it is said, One who pampers his servant from youth will in the end have him as a manon. In Rabbi Chiyya's atbach cipher, a witness is called manon." The Gemara identifies the servant with the evil inclination. Rav Tzadok develops the image further: the inclination was created to serve the person's Torah and Divine service.

[646] **Sanhedrin 59b** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Menasya says: Alas for the great attendant lost from the world! Had the serpent not been cursed, each Jew would have had two good serpents: he could send one north and one south to bring fine precious stones and pearls. Moreover, he could sling a strap beneath its tail, and it would carry earth for his garden and ruin."

[647] **Sefer HaLikkutim, Shoftim, s.v. U'mah Shekasuv Ve'Inakmah (Jerusalem 5748, p. 364)** — "Regarding 'Let me exact vengeance for one of my two eyes': these are aspects of Netzach and Hod, which become hair. Since he had damaged them, he now wished to repair them through his death, and he put the external forces to death with him, since he had supplied them with a flow of holiness and vitality by joining with them. ... When our father Yaakov saw this, he said, 'For Your salvation I hope, Hashem'—not through this one, whom I had thought to be Mashiach; he has turned into nachash, for they have the same numerical value." The passage concerns Shimshon and explicitly supplies the equality of nachash and Mashiach. Its account moves from failed messianic promise to the serpent; Rav Tzadok develops the possibility of taking eternal life from the serpent through repentance and turning the heart toward Heaven.

[648] **Tosafos, Rosh Hashanah 16b, s.v. Kedei learbev** — "The Aruch explains, as in the Yerushalmi: It is written, He shall swallow death forever, and On that day a great shofar shall be sounded. When he hears the shofar once, he is alarmed but not fully alarmed. When he hears it a second time, he says: Surely this is the shofar that shall be sounded as the great shofar, and my time has come to be swallowed up. He becomes confused and has no time to prosecute." This verifies the teaching through Tosafos quoting the Aruch in the Yerushalmi's name, the intermediary identified in Rav Tzadok's citation. It is not presented as an independently located passage in the extant Yerushalmi.

וְזֶהוּ מִצַּד חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה בְּשֵׁינָה.[649] **the wisdom of Shlomo, in sleep.** וְזֶה קוֹדֶשׁ תַּתָּאָה **and this is Kuf, the lower holiness,** הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **And this comes from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the manner that it says,** קוֹל דּוֹדִי דוֹפֵק פִּתְחִי לִי **"The voice of my Beloved knocks: open for Me"** — פֶּתַח אֶחָד שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה וְכוּ'.[650] **one opening of teshuvah, etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה שָׁם, ג). **(as stated in Shir HaShirim Rabbah, ibid. 3);** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **and as it says** [יִרְמְיָה ג, כב] **(Yirmeyah 3:22),** שׁוּבוּ בָנִים שׁוֹבָבִים **"Return, wayward children."** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **And we have already said** [פְּרִי צַדִּיק לְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט מַאֲמָר ד] **(Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Shevat, Maamar 4)** דְּמִתְּחִלָּה נִצְטָרֵךְ **that at first there is needed** אִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְתַתָּא עַל כָּל פָּנִים **an arousal from below, at least,** לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה מִיִּרְאָה[651] **to do teshuvah out of fear,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה **and through this** זְדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשׂוֹת לוֹ כִּשְׁגָגוֹת **willful sins become for him like unintentional ones;** וְאָז הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְצִדּוֹ **and then Hashem Yisbarach, on His part,** מְעוֹרֵר יְשֵׁנִים **rouses the sleepers:** שׁוּבוּ בָנִים שׁוֹבָבִים **"Return, wayward children,"** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה דְּמַעִיקָּרָא שׁוֹבָבִים אַתֶּם **which indicates, "From the outset you were merely wayward"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ יוֹמָא פו, א). **(as stated in Yoma 86a).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מְעוֹרֵר אוֹתָנוּ **That is, Hashem Yisbarach rouses us** לַעֲשׂוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה **to do teshuvah out of love,** שֶׁנַּעֲקַר הַחֵטְא מֵעִיקָּרוֹ[652] **whereby the sin is uprooted at its root,** דְּמַעִיקָּרָא שׁוֹבָבִים אַתֶּם **for "from the outset you were merely wayward";** וְאַדְרַבָּא עוֹד נַעֲשׂית לוֹ כְּזְכִיּוֹת **and on the contrary, they even become for him like merits,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם **as they said there** מִקְרָא דַּעֲלֵיהֶם הוּא יִחְיֶה **from the verse "because of them he shall live"** [יְחֶזְקֵאל לג, יט]. **(Yechezkel 33:19).** וְעַל כֵּן בְּשַׁבָּת **And therefore on Shabbos,** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **when every one of Yisrael** נִקְרָא יִרְאֵי שְׁמִי[653] **is called "those who fear My Name"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּעֲנִית ח, ב), **(as stated in Taanis 8b),** וַאֲפִילּוּ עַם הָאָרֶץ **and even an am ha'aretz** זוֹכֶה גַּם כֵּן לְיִרְאָה **also attains fear of Heaven,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (יְרוּשַׁלְמִי דְּמַאי פֶּרֶק ד הֲלָכָה א טז, ב): **(Yerushalmi Demai 4:1, 16b):** אֵימַת שַׁבָּת עַל עַם הָאָרֶץ.[654] **"The awe of Shabbos is upon the am ha'aretz"** — שַׁבָּת זְמַן תְּשׁוּבָה **Shabbos is a time of teshuvah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says** [תְּהִלִּים צב, ב] **(Tehillim 92:2),** טוֹב לְהוֹדוֹת וּלְזַמֵּר[655] **"It is good to give thanks, etc.,"** [מִשְׁלֵי כח, יג] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Mishlei 28:13),** וּמוֹדֶה וְעוֹזֵב

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[649] **Eruvin 65a** — "Rav Yehudah said: Night was created only for sleep. Rabbi Shimon ben Lakish said: Moonlight was created only for study. They told Rabbi Zeira: Your teachings are sharp. He answered: They belong to the daytime." The juxtaposition allows Rav Tzadok to distinguish restorative sleep and nighttime review from the clarity bestowed in the light of day.

[650] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tisa 36** — "How did Moshe know when it was day? When the Holy One, blessed be He, taught him Written Torah, he knew it was day. When He taught him orally, Mishnah and Talmud, he knew it was night. For day and night are alike before the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is said, Light dwells with Him; and Even darkness does not darken for You; night shines like day, darkness is like light."

[651] **Avodah Zarah 19a** — "Rava said: A person should always review, even though he forgets and even though he does not know what he is saying, as it is written, My soul breaks for longing. It is written breaks, not grinds." Rav Tzadok reads review as the person's necessary effort even before he receives clear inward understanding.

[652] **Sanhedrin 13b** — "Rav Shmuel bar Rav Yitzchak said: Acherim are speaking about the Nisan season, for it is written, Guard the month of spring: guard the spring season so that it falls within the month of Nisan." The surrounding discussion gives differing thresholds for intercalation. Rav Tzadok uses its basic requirement that the lunar month and solar spring remain aligned.

[653] **Isaiah 30:26** — "The light of the moon shall be like the light of the sun, and the light of the sun shall be sevenfold, like the light of the seven days, on the day Hashem binds up His people's fracture and heals the wound of their blow."

[654] **Bereshit Rabbah 1:1** — "The Torah says: I was the instrument of the Holy One, blessed be He, in His craft. Ordinarily a human king who builds a palace does not build it by his own knowledge but by the knowledge of an architect. The architect does not build it by his own knowledge, but has plans and tablets to know how to make rooms and small doors. So the Holy One, blessed be He, looked into Torah and created the world." Torah as the plan of Creation is the premise for Rav Tzadok's identification of primordial light with the Torah's light.

[655] **Bereshit Rabbah 12:6** — "Rabbi Levi said in Rabbi Nezira's name: That light served for thirty-six hours: twelve on Friday, twelve on Shabbos night, and twelve on Shabbos day. When Adam sinned, God wished to hide it, but honored Shabbos. ... When the sun set at the departure of Shabbos, darkness began to serve, and Adam became afraid." The Midrash distinguishes the light's thirty-six hours of service for Adam from the first-day light's original creation. Rav Tzadok relates the verse's light of seven days to the primordial light throughout Creation.

יְרֻחָם.[656] **"but he who confesses and forsakes them will be shown mercy."** וְאָז הַזְּמַן לִזְכּוֹת **And then is the time to merit,** מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** לִתְשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה׃ **teshuvah out of love.**

[656] **Rambam, Hilchos Kiddush HaChodesh 6:10** — "Every nineteen-year period containing seven intercalated years and twelve ordinary years is called a cycle. Why do we rely on this count? When you collect the days, hours, and parts of twelve ordinary years and seven intercalated years ... the total comes to nineteen solar years of 365 days and six hours each, with a remaining difference of only one hour and 485 parts in nineteen years." The Rambam describes an approximation, explicitly retaining the small remainder. Rav Tzadok's spiritual interpretation of the nineteen-year cycle should not be read as mathematical identity between lunar and solar time.

ראש חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר, מַאֲמָר ט׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Tes

בַּגְּמָרָא (תַּעֲנִית כט, א) **In the Gemara (Taanis 29a):** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁמִּשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אָב מְמַעֲטִין בְּשִׂמְחָה **"Just as when Av enters we diminish joy,** כָּךְ מִשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אֲדָר מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה. **so when Adar enters we increase joy."** וְהַיְינוּ דִּכְמוֹ בְּאָב **That is: just as in Av,** מְמַעֲטִין בְּשִׂמְחָה מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **we diminish joy from Rosh Chodesh,** מִפְּנֵי יוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁאֵירַע בּוֹ **because of one day that befell in it,** כָּךְ בַּאֲדָר מִפְּנֵי יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים **so in Adar, because of the days of Purim,** יְמֵי מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **days of feasting and joy,** מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ. **we increase joy from Rosh Chodesh.** וְאִיתָא (מְגִילָּה ז, ב) **And it is stated (Megillah 7b):** מִיחַיַּיב אִינַשׁ לְבַסּוּמֵי בְּפוּרְיָא **"A person is obligated to become intoxicated on Purim** עַד וְכוּלֵי[657] **until, etc."** וְלֹא מָצִינוּ בְּשׁוּם זְמַן **And we do not find at any time** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מִצְוָה **that there is a mitzvah in drunkenness** רַק בְּפוּרִים **except on Purim,** זְמַן מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **the time of Amalek's eradication.** וְהַטַּעַם לְהוֹרוֹת **And the reason is to show** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים שֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעַת **that Yisrael are bound, beyond awareness,** בְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ בְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה[658] **at the root, in the very beginning of the Thought;** וְהוּא לְנֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **and this stands against the kelipah of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה **who is the "first" of the kelipah,** וְהוּא מְנַגֵּד לִקְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית **and he opposes the holiness of the bris** (כְּשֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(as explained many times);** דְּתִינוֹק נִימוֹל שֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעַת **for an infant is circumcised without awareness** וְנִכְנָס לְכְלַל וְעַמֵּךְ וְגוֹמֵר **and enters the category of "And your people, etc.,** לְעוֹלָם יִרְשׁוּ אָרֶץ **shall inherit the land forever"** [יְשַׁעְיָה ס, כא], **(Yeshayah 60:21),** דְּיֵשׁ לוֹ חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **so that he has a share in Olam HaBa;** וַעֲמָלֵק מְקַטְרֵג עַל זֶה **and Amalek accuses about this,** דְּאֵין כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים **that they are not all righteous.** וּבָא הַמִּצְוָה עַל זֶה **And the mitzvah comes against this** בְּשִׂכְרוּת וְשִׂמְחָה שֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעַת[659] **with drunkenness and joy beyond awareness;** וְעַל יְדֵי שִׂכְרוּת מְרַקְּדִין **and through drunkenness people dance,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says** [תְּהִלִּים קז, כז] **(Tehillim 107:27),** יָחוֹגּוּ וְיָנוּעוּ כַּשִּׁכּוֹר **"They reel and stagger like a drunkard";** וְזֶה הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **and this is the revelation of joy,** שֶׁזֶּה אָסוּר בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה. **which is forbidden in this world.** אֲבָל הֶעָנְיָן **But the point is** כְּשֶׁיִּהְיֶה הִתְגַּלּוּת דְּהִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה יִהְיֶה רַק לֶעָתִיד **that the revelation of joy will be only in the future,** עַתִּיקָא. **when there will be a revelation of Atika.** וּבִזְמַן מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **And at the time of Amalek's eradication** הוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **there is a revelation of Atika,** וְהוּתַּר הִתְגַּלּוּת הַשִּׂמְחָה **and the revelation of joy was permitted,** וְאַדְרַבָּא יֵשׁ בּוֹ מִצְוָה **and on the contrary, there is a mitzvah in it.** וְזֶה מַרְבִּין מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **And this is why we increase from Rosh Chodesh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we said** בְּמַה שֶׁאָמַר בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה **regarding what he said in Sefer Yetzirah,** הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק **"He made Kuf king over laughter,** וַאֲדָר בְּשָׁנָה **and Adar in the year":** שֶׁעֵסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה **that the work of this month is** שֶׁאַף הַשְּׂחוֹק בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **that even laughter is in holiness,** כִּרְמָז קו״ף קָדוֹשׁ **as hinted by "Kuf — kadosh"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בַּמַּאֲמָרִים הַקּוֹדְמִים) **(as explained in the preceding maamarim).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה **And this is what they said, "we increase joy,"** כְּלָשׁוֹן חָזְיֵיהּ **like the expression "he saw him** דְּהָוָה קָא בָּדַח טוּבָא **being exceedingly merry"** שֶׁבְּרֵישׁ פֶּרֶק אֵין עוֹמְדִין **at the beginning of the chapter Ein Omdin** [בְּרָכוֹת ל, ב], **(Berachos 30b),** וְאָמַר תְּפִילִּין מַנַּחְנָא **where he said, "I am wearing tefillin,"** וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה **as explained above** [מַאֲמָר ה]. **(Maamar 5).** וּגְרִסַת עֵין יַעֲקֹב **And the version of the Ein**

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[657] **Zohar II 175b, Terumah** — "Rabbi Shimon said: I see that wisdom includes everything. Supernal lovingkindness issues from wisdom; might, which is powerful judgment, issues from understanding. Yaakov completes the two sides. The patriarchs include everything, and Yaakov includes the patriarchs." The original expressly gives the two derivations used here: chesed from chochmah and gevurah from binah. Rav Tzadok applies them to the flow through Yitzchak's attribute and then to Avraham's light and lovingkindness. The later repetition in this maamar is covered by this same original passage.

[658] **Ramban, Devarim 33:23, citing Sefer HaBahir** — "In the Midrash of Rabbi Nechunya ben HaKanah they said: Moshe said, If you walk in My statutes, you will inherit the World to Come, which is compared to the sea ... and this world, compared to the south. Why does Scripture say yerashah rather than yerash? Because even the Holy One, blessed be He, is included: rash Yah, inherit God. ... Everything is given to you; would that you keep His ways. They also said: Sea means none other than Torah, as it is said, Broader than the sea." Ramban gives the plain meaning before the Bahir's interpretation. Rav Tzadok draws on the mystical inheritance of sea and south as Torah and the World to Come.

[659] **Zohar III 236b, Pinchas** — "Rabbi Shimon opened: 'Hear, Israel, Hashem our God, Hashem is One.' The ayin is large, and so is the dalet; together they signify ed, witness. ... The letters shin-mem remain, with an open mem. Why is it not closed? Because the closed mem is the upper King—the alternate reading says 'upper world'; the open mem is the lower King—the alternate reading says 'lower world.'" The original expressly preserves 'world' as an alternate reading alongside 'King.' Rav Tzadok follows that reading when interpreting the closed mem through the upper world, binah. This is a textual variant, rather than a substitution of a general teaching about the sefiros.

Yaakov is: מִשֶּׁנִּכְנַס אֲדָר מְמַעֲטִין בְּאֵבֶל **"When Adar enters we diminish mourning** וּמַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה.[660] **and increase joy."** וּבֶאֱמֶת לֹא מָצִינוּ **But in truth we do not find** שׁוּם הֶבְדֵּל בְּדִין אֲבֵילוּת **any difference in the laws of mourning** מִי שֶׁנִּתְחַיֵּב בָּהּ רַחֲמָנָא לִצְּלַן **for one obligated in it, Heaven spare us,** בַּאֲדָר לְכָל הַשָּׁנָה. **in Adar as against the rest of the year.** אֶלָּא נִרְאֶה פֵּירוּשׁוֹ **Rather, its meaning appears to be** דְּמְמַעֲטִין בְּאֵבֶל הַיָּדוּעַ **that we diminish the well-known mourning,** שֶׁהוּא אֲבֵלוּת צִיּוֹן וִירוּשָׁלַיִם **which is the mourning for Tziyon and Yerushalayim.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is according to what they said** (תַּעֲנִית ל, ב): **(Taanis 30b):** כָּל הַמִּתְאַבֵּל עַל יְרוּשָׁלַיִם **"Whoever mourns for Yerushalayim** וְכוּ'[661] זוֹכֶה וְרוֹאֶה בְּשִׂמְחָתָהּ **merits to see its joy, etc."** וּכְבָר שְׁאַלְנוּ **And we have already asked:** שֶׁהֲרֵי כַּמָּה דּוֹרוֹת **surely so many generations** שֶׁהִתְאַבְּלוּ עַל יְרוּשָׁלַיִם **mourned for Yerushalayim** וְלֹא זָכוּ לִרְאוֹת בְּשִׂמְחָתָהּ. **and did not merit to see its joy!** וְאִי קָאֵי עַל תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים **And if it refers to Techiyas HaMeisim,** שֶׁיַּעֲמְדוּ וְיִרְאוּ בְּשִׂמְחָתָהּ **that they will rise and see its joy** — כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **all Yisrael have a share in Olam HaBa** לְבַד הַנִּמְנִין בְּחֵלֶק [סַנְהֶדְרִין צ, א], **except those listed in Perek Chelek (Sanhedrin 90a),** וּתְחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים וְעוֹלָם הַבָּא **and Techiyas HaMeisim and Olam HaBa** אֶחָד הוּא **are one,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם **as they said there,** הַכּוֹפֵר בִּתְחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים וְכוּ' **"He denied Techiyas HaMeisim, etc."** — עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַמְכוּוָן **And we said that the intent is** שֶׁזּוֹכֶה וְרוֹאֶה בְּשִׂמְחָתָהּ **that he merits to see its joy** בַּהֲווֹיָה בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה[662] **in the present, in our time,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת לג, א) **along the lines of what they said (Berachos 33a):** כָּל אָדָם שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ דֵּיעָה **"Any person who has understanding,** כְּאִילּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו. **it is as if the Beis HaMikdash was built in his days."** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג קיח, א) **And in the holy Zohar (III 118a):** שִׂמְחוּ אֶת יְרוּשָׁלַיִם **"Rejoice with Yerushalayim"** [יְשַׁעְיָה סו, י] **(Yeshayah 66:10)** — בְּגִין דְּחֶדְוָה לָא אִשְׁתְּכַח **because joy is not found** אֶלָּא בְּזִמְנָא דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **except at the time when Yisrael are in the Holy Land, etc.;** כְּתִיב אֶחָד אוֹמֵר **one verse says,** עִבְדוּ אֶת ה' בְּשִׂמְחָה וְכוּ' **"Serve Hashem with joy, etc."** — כָּאן בִּזְמָנָא דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **here, at the time when Yisrael dwell in the Holy Land, etc.** קַיְימֵי בְּאַרְעָא קַדִּישָׁא וְכוּ'. **And in this month He made Kuf king,** וּבְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק' שֶׁמִּרַמֵּז לְקוֹדֶשׁ עִלָּאָה **which alludes to the upper and lower holiness,** וְתַתָּאָה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **the Written Torah and Torah she'b'al peh.** וְכֵן בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **And likewise in this month** הָדַר קַבְּלוּהָ בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **they accepted it anew in the days of Achashverosh** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת פח, א) **(as stated in Shabbos 88a);** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh;** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **for the Written Torah** לֹא הָיָה עַל יְדֵי כְּפִיַּת הַר כְּגִיגִית **was not through the mountain held over them like a barrel,** דְּאָמְרוּ בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **for at Matan Torah they said,** נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע **"We will do and we will hear,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and as they said** (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג עַיֵּין שָׁם בִּדְבָרָיו). **(Tanchuma, Noach 3, see his words there).** וּכְתִיב בְּחָכְמָה יִבָּנֶה וגו' **And it is written, "Through wisdom a house is built, etc.,** וּבְדַעַת חֲדָרִים יִמָּלְאוּ **and through knowledge the chambers are filled** כָּל הוֹן יָקָר וְנָעִים **with all precious wealth, etc."** יָקָר רוֹמֵז לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **"Precious" alludes to Torah she'b'al peh,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **as they expounded in the Midrash** (בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה יט, ו; תַּנְחוּמָא חֻקַּת ח) **(Bamidbar Rabbah 19:6 and Tanchuma, Chukas 8):** כָּל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ **"His eye saw every precious thing"** [אִיּוֹב כח, י] **(Iyov 28:10)** — זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו. **this is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהֵם זוֹכִין **That is, they attain** לִבְחִינַת הַדַּעַת **the aspect**

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[660] **Berakhot 34b** — "Rabbi Abahu said: The place where penitents stand cannot be occupied by wholly righteous people, as it is said, Peace, peace to the far and to the near: first to the far, and afterward to the near." Rabbi Abahu and Rabbi Yochanan interpret the verse differently. Rav Tzadok follows Rabbi Abahu's elevation of repentance in this passage.

[661] **Deuteronomy 25:17–19** — "Remember what Amalek did to you on the way when you came out of Egypt: how he encountered you on the way and struck at your rear, all the stragglers behind you, while you were weary and exhausted; he did not fear God. When Hashem your God grants you rest from all your enemies around you, in the land that Hashem your God gives you as an inheritance to possess, you shall blot out Amalek's remembrance from beneath the heavens. Do not forget." Rav Tzadok's opening questions concern the two occurrences of 'on the way,' the need to remember an event known to its witnesses, and the distinction between remembering and blotting out.

[662] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 9; Targum Yonasan on Nachum 3:16** — "What is Amalek? A people that licks, flying like a locust. Amalek: a people that came to lick up Israel's blood like a dog. ... It was taught in Rabbi Nassan's name: Amalek traversed four hundred parasangs and came to make war against Israel at Refidim, as it says, 'Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev.'" The checked text reads am lak, 'a people that licks'; Rav Tzadok also hears am yelek, a people likened to a locust. He treats the locust's reach and the dog's licking as two different spiritual dangers, rather than merely two descriptions of the same attack. Targum Yonasan on Nachum 3:16 renders the verse's yelek as zachala: 'You increased your merchants beyond the stars of heaven; behold, like a locust that casts off its covering and flies.' This is a precise example of the gloss Rav Tzadok supplies.

of Daas, שֶׁבָּא בְּחִיבּוּר חָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ **which comes from joining the wisdom in the mind** לְבִינָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב[663] **to the understanding in the heart,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **along the lines of what it says** [מִשְׁלֵי ב, י] **(Mishlei 2:10),** כִּי תָבוֹא חָכְמָה בְלִבֶּךָ **"When wisdom enters your heart,** וְדַעַת לְנַפְשְׁךָ יִנְעָם **and knowledge is pleasant to your soul"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ד) **(as explained in maamar 4).** וְהַזְּמַן לִזְכּוֹת **And it is the time to merit** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כְּאִילּוּ נִבְנָה **that it be as if there were built** בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו **the Beis HaMikdash in one's days,** וְזוֹכִין וְרוֹאִים בְּשִׂמְחָתָהּ **and we merit to see its joy** בַּהוֹוֶה אַף בַּגָּלוּת **in the present, even in exile;** וּמְמַעֲטִין בָּאֲבֵלוּת דְּצִיּוֹן וִירוּשָׁלַיִם **and we diminish the mourning for Tziyon and Yerushalayim** וּמַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה. **and increase joy.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said,** הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק. **"He made Kuf king over laughter."** וּבְשַׁבָּת כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכִין **And on Shabbos all Yisrael merit** לִפְרִיסַת סוּכַּת שָׁלוֹם **the spreading of the shelter of peace** וּקְדוּשַּׁת יְרוּשָׁלַיִם וּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. **and the holiness of Yerushalayim and the Beis HaMikdash.** וְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים דְּדַמְיָין לְשַׁבָּתוֹת[664] **And talmidei chachamim, who are likened to Shabbosos** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג קכד, ב), **(Zohar III 124b),** זוֹכִין תָּמִיד לִקְדוּשָּׁה **always merit holiness,** קֹדֶשׁ עֶלְיוֹנָה וְתַחְתּוֹנָה **the upper and lower holiness,** וְזוֹכִין לְדַעְתָּה **and they attain understanding,** וּכְאִילּוּ נִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּיָמָיו. **and it is as if the Beis HaMikdash was built in their days.** וּמֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **And from Rosh Chodesh Adar** כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכִין לָזֶה **all Yisrael merit this,** וּמַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה: **and we increase joy.**

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[663] **Kiddushin 81a** — "Rabbi Meir would mock transgressors. One day Satan appeared to him as a woman on the other bank of a river. There was no ferry; he seized a rope and began crossing. When he reached the middle of the rope, Satan left him and said: 'Were it not that they proclaim in Heaven, Beware of Rabbi Meir and his Torah, I would have made your blood worth two ma'ah.'" The episode makes protection from temptation dependent on help from above even for a great sage.

[664] **Eruvin 13b** — "It was taught: His name was not Rabbi Meir, but Rabbi Nehorai. Why was he called Rabbi Meir? Because he illuminated the eyes of the Sages in halachah. And his name was not Nehorai, but Rabbi Nechemyah—or, some say, Rabbi Elazar ben Arach. Why was he called Nehorai? Because he enlightened the eyes of the Sages in halachah." The statement establishes Rabbi Meir's extraordinary illuminating power in Torah. Rav Tzadok emphasizes that this greatness did not make vigilance unnecessary.

ראשׁ חדֶשׁ אֲדָר, מַאֲמָר י׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Yud

לְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן For Rosh Chodesh Adar Rishon

The holy Shelah (רֵישׁ דְּרוּשׁ שׁוֹבְבִי״ם תְּרוּמָה תְּצַוֶּה) **(beginning of Derush Shovevim Terumah Tetzaveh)** כָּתַב שֶׁבִּשְׁנַת הָעִיבּוּר **writes that in a leap year** מוֹסִיפִין פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת תְּרוּמָה תְּצַוֶּה **we add the parshiyos Terumah and Tetzaveh** עַל שׁוֹבְבִי״ם **to Shovevim;** וְכָתַב הַטַּעַם **and he writes the reason:** דְּהָעִיבּוּר הֵם **that the intercalations are** לְהַשְׁווֹת שְׁנוֹת הַלְּבָנָה **to equalize the years of the moon** עִם שְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה **with the years of the sun,** וְזֶה בָּא עַל יְדֵי מִיעוּט הַיָּרֵחַ **and this comes about through the diminishing of the moon,** שֶׁמִּזֶּה בָּא הַקְּטָרוּג **from which comes the accusation below,** קְטָרוּג הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע וְהַקְּלִיפּוֹת **the accusation of the yetzer hara and the kelipos.** נִמְצָאוּ הָעִיבּוּרִין **It emerges that the intercalations,** שֶׁבָּאוּ מִכֹּחַ הַקְּטָרוּג **which came by force of the accusation,** הֵם גָּרְמוּ שֶׁנִּתְהַווּ **are what caused there to come into being** קְטָרוּג שֶׁלְּמַטָּה **the accusation below** הַמֵּבִיא לִידֵי חֵטְא **that brings one to sin;** עַל כֵּן בִּשְׁנַת הָעִיבּוּר **therefore a leap year** רָאוּי לְתְשׁוּבָה[665] **is especially fitting for teshuvah.** עַד כָּאן דְּבָרָיו, עַיֵּן שָׁם. **Thus far his words; see there.** וְהַמְכוּוָן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **The intent is based on what they said** (חולין ס, ב) **(Chullin 60b):** "הָבִיאוּ כַּפָּרָה עָלַי **"Bring an atonement for Me** שֶׁמִּעַטְתִּי אֶת הַיָּרֵחַ[666] **for having diminished the moon"** — שֶׁמִּכֹּחַ קְטָרוּג הַלְּבָנָה **that by force of the moon's accusation** נִתְהַווּ הַקְּלִיפּוֹת. **the kelipos came into being.** אַךְ צָרִיךְ לְהָבִין **But we need to understand** מַה שַּׁיָּיכוּת מִיעוּט הַיָּרֵחַ **what connection the diminishing of the moon has** לְיָמִים אֵלּוּ **to these days** שֶׁבָּאִים לְהַשְׁווֹת **which come to equalize** שְׁנוֹת הַלְּבָנָה לִשְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה. **the lunar years with the solar years.** וּבְוַדַּאי דִּבְרֵיהֶן אֱמֶת **And certainly his words are true.** אַךְ לְדַעְתִּי אֶפְשָׁר לוֹמַר **But in my view one can say** כֵּן לְהֵיפֶךְ גַּם **the reverse as well:** שֶׁיְּמֵי הָעִיבּוּר מְסוּגָּלִים יוֹתֵר לִתְשׁוּבָה **that the days of intercalation are more auspicious for teshuvah** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבָּאִים לְהַשְׁווֹת **because they come to equalize** שְׁנוֹת הַלְּבָנָה לִשְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה **the lunar years with the solar years,** וּמַעֲיִן עוֹלָם הַבָּא **a semblance of the World to Come,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אוֹר הַלְּבָנָה כְּאוֹר הַחַמָּה **when "the light of the moon will be like the light of the sun"** [יְשַׁעְיָה ל, כו] **(Yeshayahu 30:26),** וְיִתְבַּטְּלוּ אָז הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **and the kelipos will then be nullified,** וְהַיֵּצֶר הָרַע מִכֹּל וָכֹל. **together with the yetzer hara, entirely.** וְנִבְחֲרוּ לָזֶה **And for this were chosen** פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת תְּרוּמָה תְּצַוֶּה **the parshiyos Terumah and Tetzaveh,** שֶׁמְּדַבֵּר מִבִּנְיַן הַמִּשְׁכָּן וְכֵלָיו **which speak of building the Mishkan and its vessels,** שֶׁהוּא שֶׁיִּשְׁכּוֹן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **which means that Hashem Yisbarach should dwell** בְּתוֹךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל **in the midst of Yisrael;** וְעִיקַּר הַמְכוּוָן **and the main intent** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה. **is that the heart of Yisrael be a Mishkan for the Shechinah.** וְלוּלֵי הַקִּלְקוּל **Were it not for the corruption,** הָיָה כָּל מַחֲנֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל **the entire camp of Yisrael would have been** מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **a Mishkan for the Shechinah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שָׁם סו, א] **as it says (ibid. 66:1),** וְהָאָרֶץ הֲדוֹם רַגְלָי **"And the earth is My footstool";** וְהַיְינוּ לְבָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that is, the heart of Yisrael** מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **being a Mishkan for the Shechinah.** וְאָז לֹא יִהְיֶה **And then there will be no** שׁוּם קְטָרוּג יֵצֶר הָרַע **accusation of the yetzer hara at all,** [שָׁם יא, ט] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (ibid. 11:9),** לֹא יָרֵעוּ וְלֹא יַשְׁחִיתוּ **"They shall not harm nor destroy** בְּכָל הַר קָדְשִׁי **in all My holy mountain";** וְאָמְרוּ (מִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קלח, א) **and they said (Midrash HaNe'lam, Zohar I 138a):** הוּא לִבָּא דְּמִדּוֹרֵיהּ דְּיֵצֶר הָרַע בֵּיהּ.[667] **"This is the heart, in which the dwelling** וְנִקְרָא הַר קָדְשִׁי **of the yetzer hara is." And**

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[665] **Kiddushin 81a** — "Rabbi Akiva would mock transgressors. One day Satan appeared to him as a woman at the top of a palm tree. He took hold of the tree and began climbing. When he reached halfway up, Satan left him and said: 'Were it not that they proclaim in Heaven, Beware of Rabbi Akiva and his Torah, I would have made your blood worth two ma'ah.'" This is the companion episode to Rabbi Meir's, with a different obstacle and the same heavenly protection. Rav Tzadok cites both as evidence that no level of learning makes a person independent of Divine aid.

[666] **Kiddushin 81b** — "Rabbi Meir said: 'Be careful with me because of my daughter.' Rabbi Tarfon said: 'Be careful with me because of my daughter-in-law.' A student mocked him. Rabbi Abbahu said in the name of Rabbi Chanina ben Gamliel: Before many days had passed, that student stumbled with his mother-in-law." The passage follows a discussion of seclusion with close relatives. Rav Tzadok reads the sages' caution as refusing to presume immunity, and the student's failure as the danger of scoffing at such caution. The suggestion that Rabbi Meir's warning followed the earlier episode is Rav Tzadok's inference; the Gemara does not date the two incidents.

[667] **Temurah 16a** — "She said: 'Give me a blessing, for you have given me the land of the Negev'—a house dried out of every good thing. 'Give me springs of water'—a man who possesses nothing but Torah. 'Kalev gave her upper springs and lower springs.' He said to her: 'Would one in whom the upper and lower worlds dwell ask me for sustenance?'" The Gemara expounds Achsah's request to Kalev after her marriage to Osniel. Rav Tzadok takes its wordplay on Negev and menuggav, 'dried out,' as a model for describing a heart emptied of worldly desire, even though the original narrative concerns material provision.

it is called "My holy mountain" כְּמוֹ **like the Beis HaMikdash,** [יְשַׁעְיָה נו, ז] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Yeshayahu 56:7),** מְפָנֵי שֶׁהַלֵּב מִשְׁכָּן **"I will bring them to My holy mountain...,"** וַהֲבִיאוֹתִים אֶל הַר קָדְשִׁי וְגוֹמֵר **because the heart is a Mishkan for the Shechinah,** (בְּרָכוֹת ל, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Berachos 30a):** יְכַוֵּין אֶת לִבּוֹ **"He should direct his heart** כְּנֶגֶד בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ כּוּלֵי **toward the Beis HaMikdash...;** יְכַוֵּין אֶת לִבּוֹ **he should direct his heart** כְּנֶגֶד קָדְשֵׁי הַקָּדָשִׁים.[668] **toward the Holy of Holies."** רַק לְאַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל **Only after the corruption** נִבְחַר מִשְׁכָּן **was a Mishkan chosen** לִהְיוֹת מָקוֹם לְהַשְׁרָאַת הַשְּׁכִינָה **to be a place for the resting of the Shechinah;** וְעַל כֵּן בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **and therefore in the month of Adar,** בְּפָרָשִׁיוֹת תְּרוּמָה תְּצַוֶּה **at the parshiyos Terumah and Tetzaveh,** זְמַן לְתִשׁוּבָה **is a time for teshuvah,** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקִּלְקוּל.[669] **to rectify the root of the corruption.** וּבָא אַחַר חֹדֶשׁ שְׁבָט **And it comes after the month of Shevat,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צַדִּי״ק **which was formed with the letter Tzaddik,** לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ.[670] **to be a mighty one who conquers his inclination.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אֲדָר **And afterward Adar,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **which was formed with the letter Kuf,** וּבוֹ זְמַן מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **and in it is the time of the eradication of Amalek;** זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב) דְּאוֹת ק׳ אִיתָא **for regarding the letter Kuf it is stated** (קמח, ב) **(Zohar II 148b):** אֵשֶׁת זְנוּנִים כּוּלֵי **"The woman of harlotry...,** וְאֶת דִּילָהּ ק׳ כּוּלֵי **and her letter is Kuf...,** אֲצַל בְּנֵי נָשָׁא כּוּלֵי **beside human beings...";** וּבְיִשְׂרָאֵל אוֹת ק׳ **but in Yisrael** כְּגַוְונָא דְּקוֹפָא **in the manner of an ape** מְרַמֵּז קו״ף קָדוֹשׁ **the letter Kuf alludes to "Kuf — Kadosh,"** (שַׁבָּת קד, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shabbos 104a),** (מַאֲמָר ג׳ וּמַאֲמָר ו׳) וְנִתְבָּאֵר **and it was explained (maamarim 3 and 6).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַזְּמַן בּוֹ לְתַקֵּן **That is, it is the time to rectify** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַלֵּב הַר קָדְשִׁי **that the heart be "My holy mountain,"** וְלֹא יָרֵעוּ וְלֹא יַשְׁחִיתוּ **and "they shall not harm nor destroy** בְּכָל הַר קָדְשִׁי. **in all My holy mountain,"** שֶׁיִּתְבַּטֵּל קִטְרוּג הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע **so that the accusation of the yetzer hara be nullified.** וְאִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר קְדוּשַׁת לֵוִי **And it is stated in the sefer Kedushas Levi** שֶׁחָשַׁב הַחֳדָשִׁים לַשְּׁבָטִים **that he counted the months against the tribes,** וְחָשַׁב אֲדָר לְיוֹסֵף **and counted Adar for Yosef;** וְעַל כֵּן נֶחֱלַק אֲדָר לִפְעָמִים לִשְׁנַיִם **and therefore Adar is sometimes divided in two,** כְּמוֹ יוֹסֵף **like Yosef, who is sometimes counted as one tribe** וְלִפְעָמִים נֶחְלָק לִשְׁנַיִם **and sometimes divided into two,** מְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶפְרַיִם[671] **Menasheh and Efrayim;** וְחָשַׁב לֵוִי **and he counted Levi** בְּחֶשְׁבּוֹן הַשָּׁנִים עֶשֶׂר חֳדָשִׁים. **in the reckoning of the twelve months.** וְהִנֵּה עִיקַּר קְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָּה **Now, the main reading of the Megillah** וּמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **and the eradication of Amalek** [מְגִילָּה ו, ב] הוּא בַּאֲדָר הַשֵּׁנִי **is in the second Adar (Megillah 6b),** וּמִסְתָּמָא אֲדָר שֵׁנִי לְאֶפְרַיִם **and presumably the second Adar is for Efrayim;** וְכֵן יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **and likewise Yehoshua,** שֶׁהָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **who was the first to eradicate Amalek,** בָּא מֵאֶפְרַיִם. **came from Efrayim.** וַאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן לִמְנַשֶּׁה **And the first Adar is for Menasheh,** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת כָּל שִׁלֹּשֶׁת הַשְּׁבָטִים **for in truth all three tribes,** מְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶפְרַיִם וּבִנְיָמִן **Menasheh, Efrayim and Binyamin,** הֵם לְכִיבּוּשׁ הָעַכּו״ם **are for the conquest of the idolaters,** [תְּהִלִּים פ, ג] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 80:3),** לִפְנֵי אֶפְרַיִם וּבִנְיָמִן וּמְנַשֶּׁה **"Before Efrayim and Binyamin and Menasheh** עוֹרְרָה אֶת גְּבוּרָתֶךָ וּלְכָה לִישׁוּעָתָה לָנוּ **stir up Your might and come to save us";** מָסוֹרֶת הִיא **and in the manner of what they said (Bereishis Rabbah 73:7):** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה עג, ז) וְעַל דָּרְךָ שֶׁאָמְרוּ

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[668] **Pri Tzaddik, Tetzaveh 6** — "Amalek 'dwells in the land of the Negev.' The Gemara says of 'You have given me the land of the Negev': 'A house dried out of every good thing ... a person who possesses nothing but Torah.' Amalek dwells there: he enters the heart of a holy person emptied of all the delights of this world, possessing nothing but Torah. It is like the serpent coming to entice Adam, who was emptied of worldly desires, as it says, 'They were not ashamed,' for he knew nothing of desire. He was in the Garden of Eden, the place of His Divine Presence, yet the serpent entered and enticed him. This is Amalek's kelipah, the beginning and root of the kelipos, opposing the holy beginning." The cited earlier maamar spells out the Negev analogy and connects the possibility of temptation in an otherwise pure heart to Adam's original situation.

[669] **Avos 2:4** — "Hillel says: Do not separate yourself from the community. Do not trust yourself until the day of your death. Do not judge your fellow until you have reached his situation. Do not say of something that cannot be heard that it will in the end be heard. Do not say, When I have time I shall study, for perhaps you will never have time." The warning against self-assurance stands beside restraint in judging another person's situation, a fitting context for the preceding accounts of sages who had mocked transgressors.

[670] **Ecclesiastes 12:5** — "They will also fear what is high, and terrors will be on the way; the almond tree will blossom, the locust will drag itself along, and desire will fail, for a person goes to his eternal home, while the mourners go about the street." In the chapter's portrayal of old age and death, the person 'goes to his eternal home.' Rav Tzadok reads the continuing motion of 'goes' as the work of refinement that lasts throughout life.

[671] **Deuteronomy 31:2** — "He said to them: I am one hundred and twenty years old today. I can no longer go out and come in, and Hashem has told me: You shall not cross this Jordan." Rav Tzadok reads Moshe's statement of completed movement as the completion of the individual's appointed work, contrasting it with the lifelong movement described in Koheles.

"It is a tradition שֶׁאֵין עֵשָׂו נוֹפֵל **that Esav falls** אֶלָּא בְּיַד בָּנֶיהָ שֶׁל רָחֵל.[672] **only by the hand of the children of Rachel."** גַּם כֵּן נִצְטַוָּה עַל מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **And Shaul, who was from the tribe of Binyamin,** וְשָׁאוּל שֶׁהָיָה מִשֵּׁבֶט בִּנְיָמִין **was also commanded to eradicate Amalek;** רַק יְהוֹשֻׁעַ רֹאשׁ לַמַּלְכוּת **but Yehoshua, the first to rule,** מִשֵּׁבֶט אֶפְרַיִם **was from the tribe of Efrayim,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שופטים ה, יד] **as it says (Shoftim 5:14),** מִנִּי אֶפְרַיִם **"From Efrayim,** שָׁרְשָׁם בַּעֲמָלֵק **whose root is against Amalek"** — זֶה יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **this is Yehoshua,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית[673] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ רַבָּה נט, ז) **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 59:7);** וְכֵן אֶדֶר שֵׁנִי כְּנֶגֶד אֶפְרַיִם. **and so the second Adar corresponds to Efrayim.** וַאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן נֶגֶד מְנַשֶּׁה **And the first Adar corresponds to Menasheh,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא עַל שֵׁם **who was named for** כִּי נַשַּׁנִי אֱלֹהִים **"For God has made me forget** אֶת כָּל עֲמָלִי וְגוֹמֵר **all my toil..."** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מא, נא] **(Bereishis 41:51);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעִסְקוֹ הָיָה **that is, his occupation was** לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ **to be a mighty one who conquers his inclination,** בְּחִינַת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם **the aspect of "the tzaddik is the foundation of the world";** וּלְעֶבֶד נִמְכַּר יוֹסֵף **"As a slave was Yosef sold"** [תְּהִלִּים קה, יז] **(Tehillim 105:17),** שֶׁהָיָה נִצְרָךְ עוֹד לְהִתְבָּרֵר **for he still needed to be refined** עַל יְדֵי הַנִּסָּיוֹן בְּמִצְרַיִם **through the trial in Mitzrayim** בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק. **in the attribute of tzaddik.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר **And afterward he said,** כִּי נַשַּׁנִי אֱלֹהִים אֶת כָּל עֲמָלִי **"For God has made me forget all my toil";** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁכָּבַשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ מִכֹּל וָכֹל **that is, he conquered his inclination entirely,** וְנִשְׁכַּח מִמֶּנּוּ כָּל הֶעָמָל. **and all the toil was forgotten from him.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ שֵׁם הַשֵּׁנִי קָרָא אֶפְרַיִם **And afterward, "the name of the second he called Efrayim,** כִּי הִפְרַנִי אֱלֹהִים וְגוֹמֵר **for God has made me fruitful..."** [בְּרֵאשִׁית שָׁם, נב] **(Bereishis ibid. 52);** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **this accords with what it says** [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] **(Tehillim 97:11),** אוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק **"Light is sown for the tzaddik,"** דְּקָאֵי עַל אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן **which refers to the primordial light** שֶׁנִּגְנַז וְנִזְרַע בְּגַן עֵדֶן **and sown in Gan Eden,** וְעָבִיד פֵּירִין וְאִבִּין **and it produces fruits and produce** עַל יְדֵי הַאי צַדִּיק **through this tzaddik,** גַּנְּנָא דְּגִנְּתָא[674] **the gardener of the garden** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קסו, ב) **(as stated in Zohar II 166b);** וְאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן נִגְנַז **and the primordial light was hidden away** לַעֲמָלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for those who toil in Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג) **as they said (Tanchuma, Noach 3)** עַל פְּסוּק [יְשַׁעְיָה ט, א] **on the verse (Yeshayahu 9:1),** הָעָם הַהֹלְכִים בַּחֹשֶׁךְ **"The people who walk in darkness** רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל **have seen a great light";** וְזֶהוּ כִּי הִפְרַנִי וְגוֹמֵר **and this is "for God has made me fruitful...":** שֶׁזָּכָה לְאוֹרָה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **that he merited the light of Torah she'b'al peh.** וְכֵן בְּפוּרִים אַחַר מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **And likewise on Purim, after the eradication of Amalek,** כְּתִיב [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] **it is written (Esther 8:16),** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light"** — זוֹ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **(as explained in maamar 1 and elsewhere);** וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ מִשֵּׁבֶט אֶפְרַיִם **and Yehoshua, of the tribe of Efrayim,** הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן **was the first** שֶׁזָּכָה לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **to merit Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב קלז, ב בְּסָפָרִים אֲחֵרִים) **(II 137b, in other editions)** עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ [אָבוֹת א, א] **on what they said (Avos 1:1),** מֹשֶׁה וְכוּ' **"Moshe...** וּמְסָרָהּ לִיהוֹשֻׁעַ **and handed it to Yehoshua,"** דְּעַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קָאֵי **that this refers to Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב מָסַר לְהַלְוִיִּים[675] **for he handed the Written Torah to the Levi'im;** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְיהוֹשֻׁעַ הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁכָּתַב סֵפֶר **And**

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[672] **Yerushalmi, Shabbos 1:3** — "There we learned: 'Do not trust yourself until the day of your death.' A pious man was sitting and teaching: 'Do not trust yourself until the day of your old age—such as myself.' A spirit came and tempted him, and he began to be troubled. She said to him: 'Do not be distressed; I am a spirit. Go and make yourself equal to your fellows.'" The final instruction corrects his claim to exemption from the rule that applies to others. Rav Tzadok takes it as the direction to retain 'until the day of your death,' rather than substitute old age. The source was checked at its digital chapter and halachah; the manuscript's printed 8alocator was not independently collated.

[673] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10** — "Another interpretation: 'All the stragglers behind you.' Rabbi Yehudah said: Whoever had been scorched was cast out. Rabbi Nechemyah said: Whoever the cloud expelled was cast out." The Midrash identifies those exposed outside the cloud with a spiritual failing. Rav Tzadok's further claim is that Amalek exploited that failure by inducing despair of repentance. The exact Dan passage was checked in Tanchuma; the additional Pesikta 12§13reference has not yet been independently located in the checked digital edition.

[674] **Chagigah 15a** — "He said: 'Since that man has been driven out of that world, let him go out and enjoy this world.' Acher went out to a life of wrongdoing. He found a prostitute and propositioned her. She said to him: 'Are you not Elisha ben Avuyah?' He uprooted a radish from its bed on Shabbos and gave it to her. She said: 'He is someone else.'" The self-reference 'that man' is Acher speaking about himself. The story shows perceived exclusion producing further transgression; Rav Tzadok identifies this inference of hopelessness as a second attack of the inclination.

[675] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10** — "Israel did not know the nature of the zemorah until Amalek came and taught it to them, as it says, 'They put forth the zemorah to their nose.' From whom did he learn it? From Esav his grandfather, as it says, 'He said: Is he not rightly named Yaakov?' He cleared his throat and put forth the zemorah." The Midrash links an obscure gesture of contempt to Amalek and Esav without defining it here. Rav Tzadok

Yehoshua was the first to write a sefer אַחַר חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **after the Five Books of the Torah;** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **and we have already said,** (נְדָרִים כב, ב) בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **regarding what they said (Nedarim 22b),** אִילְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ שֶׁעֲרָכָהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא וְסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בִּלְבַד וְכוּלֵי **"Had they not sinned..., and the Book of Yehoshua alone,** שֶׁהַמְכוּוָן שֶׁבְּסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **for it is the arrangement of Eretz Yisrael" — that the meaning is that in the Book of Yehoshua** צְפוּנִים שֹׁרֶשׁ סוֹדוֹת **is hidden the root of the secrets** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[676] **of Torah she'b'al peh;** וְזֶהוּ **and this is "its arrangement":** חֵלֶק שֶׁל כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **the portion of each one of Yisrael** בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **in Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא אֶרֶץ **which is "land,"** בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **the aspect of Knesses Yisrael** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר כה דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וּבַגְּמָרָא) **(as explained in Chanukah, maamar 25, beginning "Uvagemara").** שֶׁהָיָה עַל שֵׁם כִּי נַשַּׁנִי וְגוֹמֵר **And to Yosef, Menasheh was dear,** וְאֶצְל יוֹסֵף הָיָה חָבִיב מְנַשֶּׁה **being named for "For God has made me forget...,"** בְּחִינַת סוּר מֵרָע **the aspect of "turn from evil,"** שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה עִיקַּר עֲבוֹדָתוֹ וַעֲמָלוֹ **for this was the essence of his service and toil:** לַעֲקוֹר שֹׁרֶשׁ הָרַע **to uproot the root of evil,** לְמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם. **for the attribute of "the tzaddik is the foundation of the world."** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מֶרְכָּבָה וְאַחַר כָּךְ אֶפְרַיִם **so that he be a chariot And afterward Efrayim,** עַל שֵׁם כִּי הִפְרַנִי וְגוֹמֵר **named for "For God has made me fruitful...":** שֶׁזָּכָה לְאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן הַגָּנוּז מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **that he merited the hidden primordial light from the side of Hashem Yisbarach;** וְעַל כֵּן הִקְדִּים יוֹסֵף מְנַשֶּׁה לְאֶפְרַיִם. **and therefore Yosef put Menasheh before Efrayim.** וְכֵן נוֹלַד מְנַשֶּׁה קוֹדֶם **And so too Menasheh was born first,** שֶׁכֵּן הַסֵּדֶר מִצַּד הָאָדָם **for such is the order from the side of man:** סוּר מֵרָע וַאֲחַר כָּךְ וַעֲשֵׂה טוֹב. **"turn from evil," and afterward "and do good."** וְכֵן מִצַּד הָאָדָם כְּתִיב [יְשַׁעְיָה סו, כג] מִדֵּי חָדֶשׁ בְּחָדְשׁוֹ **And likewise from the side of man it is written (Yeshayahu 66:23),** שֶׁמַּקְדִּים קְדוּשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ וּמִדֵּי שַׁבָּת וְגוֹמֵר **"from one new moon to another and from one Shabbos...," putting first the holiness of the month,** שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי עֲמַל הָאָדָם. **which comes through the toil of man.** וְרַק יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Only Yaakov Avinu, alav hashalom,** הִקְדִּים אֶפְרַיִם לִמְנַשֶּׁה **put Efrayim before Menasheh,** שֶׁאָמַר שֶׁהָעִיקָּר **for he held that the main thing is** דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְהַקְּדוּשָׁה **the words of Torah and the holiness** שֶׁזּוֹכֶה מִי שֶׁלִּבּוֹ מְזוּכָּךְ וְזֶה זוֹכֶה מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ[677] **that one merits as light from the side of Hashem Yisbarach;** וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה שָׁם, עַיֵּין שָׁם) וְהוּא צַדִּיק **and this is merited by one whose heart is refined, and he is a tzaddik** (בַּאֲרִיכוּת) **(as explained in Chanukah, ibid.; see there at length).** אֲבָל מִכָּל מָקוֹם **But nevertheless** הַסֵּדֶר מִצַּד הָאָדָם וַדַּאי **the order from the side of man is certainly** סוּר מֵרָע וַאֲחַר כָּךְ טוֹב **"turn from evil" and afterward "good,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנּוֹלַד מְנַשֶּׁה לִפְנֵי אֶפְרַיִם. **just as Menasheh was born before Efrayim.** וְעַל כֵּן בִּשְׁאָר הַשָּׁנִים **Therefore in other years,** אַחַר שְׁבָט שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת צ׳ **after Shevat, which was formed with the letter Tzaddik,** שֶׁהַעֵסֶק בּוֹ לְתַקֵּן הַפְּגָם **whose work is to repair the blemish** וּלְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם **and to be refined in the attribute of "the tzaddik is the foundation of the world,"** לִהְיוֹת גִּבּוֹר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ **to be a mighty one who conquers his inclination,** בָּא אֲדָר שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **comes Adar, which was formed with the letter Kuf,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה קְדוֹשׁ **which indicates "Kadosh,"** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **when we merit the eradication of Amalek,** לִהְיוֹת הַלֵּב מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **for the heart to be a Mishkan for the Shechinah,** וְלֹא יָרֵעוּ וְלֹא יַשְׁחִיתוּ **and "they shall not harm nor destroy** בְּכָל הַר קָדְשִׁי כָּאָמוּר. **in all My holy mountain," as was said.** וְהַחֹדֶשׁ נֶגֶד יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק **And the month corresponds to Yosef HaTzaddik,** (תַּנְחוּמָא בְּשַׁלַּח ב) דְּאִיתָא **as it is stated (Tanchuma, Beshalach 2):** מַהֲלַךְ עִם אָרוֹן וְכִי דַּרְכּוֹ שֶׁל מֵת וַאֲרוֹנוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף וְכוּלֵי **"And the coffin of Yosef...; is it then the way of a dead man** הַמֵּת הַמּוּנָּח בָּאָרוֹן חַי הָעוֹלָמִים כּוּלֵי **to walk with the Ark of the Life of the worlds?... The dead one lying in the**

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explicitly notes that obscurity and turns to Yechezkel and its commentators to explain the kind of defiance intended.

[676] **Rashi on Ezekiel 8:17; Targum Yonasan on Ezekiel 8:17** — "'They put forth the zemorah to their nose': They send to their own nostrils the bad smell of this zemorah, making music with the wind issuing from the anus. That is, this shame of theirs will return upon their faces. Menachem explains the expression as a matter of disgrace and dishonor. ... Their backs being turned to Hashem's sanctuary indicates the matter." Rashi connects the verse to a deliberately contemptuous bodily gesture. The Targum renders the conclusion more generally: 'They bring shame upon their faces.' Thus the Targum supports the language of disgrace, while the explicit bodily explanation is Rashi's.

[677] **Shemos Rabbah 27:6** — "'Yisro heard': This is what is written, 'Strike the scoffer, and the simple will become prudent'; likewise, 'When the scoffer is punished, the simple becomes wise.' Amalek and Yisro had been in counsel with Pharaoh. When Yisro saw that the Holy One had destroyed Amalek from this world and the World to Come, he reflected and repented. First it says, 'I shall surely blot out Amalek's remembrance,' and afterward, 'Yisro heard.' He said: 'I have nowhere to go except to the God of Israel.'" The Midrash explicitly identifies Amalek with the scoffer and contrasts his defiance with Yisro's repentance. Rav Tzadok uses that contrast to describe the contempt that can follow despair.

coffin קִיֵּים כָּל מַה שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּזֶה[678] **fulfilled all that is written in this";** דְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם **for the attribute of "the tzaddik is the foundation of the world"** נִקְרָא חַי עָלְמִין **is called "Life of the worlds,"** וְקוּרְבָא דִּילֵיהּ לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָמִים **and its closeness is to the Life of the worlds,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א רז, ב) **as they said (Zohar I 207b).** וְכֵן מוֹרֶה ק׳ **And likewise Kuf indicates** מִסְפָּר שָׁלֵם עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **a complete number, the ten sefiros,** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד כָּלוּל מֵעֶשֶׂר **each one comprising ten,** עַד בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **up to the aspect of Atika;** (שָׁם קכג, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (ibid. 123a):** מֵאָה כּוּלֵי **"One hundred..., the most hidden of all hidden ones,** סְתִימָא דְּכָל סְתִימִין בְּמֵאָה בְּרָזָא דְּמֵאָה בִּרְכָאן כּוּלֵי **in one hundred, in the secret of the hundred blessings...";** (שָׁם קלב, א) וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (ibid. 132a)** דְּעָבְדָא מִנַּיְיהוּ עֲטָרָה **that from them is made a crown** וְשַׂוִּי לָהּ בְּרֵישָׁא דְּצַדִּיק **and it is placed on the head of the tzaddik,** חַי הָעוֹלָמִים **the Life of the worlds,** [מִשְׁלֵי י, ו] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Mishlei 10:6),** בְּרָכוֹת לְרֹאשׁ צַדִּיק **"Blessings are upon the head of the tzaddik"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה סוֹף מַאֲמָר ד) **(as explained above, end of maamar 4).** אַךְ בִּשְׁנַת הָעִיבּוּר **But in a leap year,** שֶׁהוּא לְהַשְׁווֹת שְׁנַת הַלְּבָנָה **which serves to equalize the year of the moon** עִם שְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה **with the years of the sun,** מֵעֵין הָעָתִיד **a semblance of the future,** דִּכְתִיב וְהָיָה אוֹר הַלְּבָנָה **as it is written, "And the light of the moon will be** כְּאוֹר הַחַמָּה. **like the light of the sun"** — בָּא מִקּוֹדֶם אֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן **first comes the first Adar,** נֶגֶד מְנַשֶּׁה **corresponding to Menasheh,** לְתַקֵּן כָּל הָרַע **to rectify all the evil:** כִּי נַשַּׁנִי וְגוֹמֵר **"For God has made me forget...,"** לְשַׁכֵּחַ כָּל הָרַע **to forget all the evil.** וּמִשֵּׁבֶט מְנַשֶּׁה יָצָא גִּדְעוֹן **And from the tribe of Menasheh came Gidon,** (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כה, ב) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Rosh Hashanah 25b):** שְׁקַל הַכָּתוּב **"Scripture weighed** שְׁלֹשָׁה קַלֵּי עוֹלָם **three of the lightest of the world** כְּנֶגֶד שְׁלֹשָׁה חֲמוּרֵי עוֹלָם **against three of the weightiest of the world,** לוֹמַר לָךְ יְרוּבַּעַל בְּדוֹרוֹ **to tell you: Yerubaal in his generation** כְּמשֶׁה בְּדוֹרוֹ[679] כּוּלֵי **is like Moshe in his generation...";** חָשַׁב גִּדְעוֹן כְּנֶגֶד **it reckoned Gidon against** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom;** שָׁפְמוֹ שֶׁמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּנוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **for just as Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** שִׁיבֵּר הַלּוּחוֹת **broke the Tablets** וְנִתְבַּטֵּל הַחִיתּוּן **and the wedding was annulled** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה מג, א) **(as stated in Shemos Rabbah 43:1),** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיָה בְּכֹחוֹ **and nevertheless it was in his power** לְהוֹרִיד הַלּוּחוֹת שְׁנִיִּים **to bring down the second Tablets** וּלְתַקֵּן הַכֹּל **and to rectify everything,** כֵּן גִּדְעוֹן מָצִינוּ **so too with Gidon we find** (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה כב, ט) **(Vayikra Rabbah 22:9):** שֶׁבַע עֲבֵירוֹת נַעֲשׂוּ **"Seven transgressions were committed** בְּפָרוֹ שֶׁל גִּדְעוֹן[680] כּוּלֵי **with the bull of Gidon...";** וּבַגְּמָרָא (תְּמוּרָה כח, ב) **and in the Gemara (Temurah 28b):** שְׁמוֹנָה דְּבָרִים הִתִּירוּ **"Eight things they permitted** בְּאוֹתוֹ לַיְלָה[681] כּוּלֵי **on that night...";** וְהָיָה כֹּחוֹ לְתַקֵּן כָּל הָרַע **and he had the power to rectify all the evil,** וּלְהַקְרִיב פַּר מוּקְצֶה **and to offer a bull set aside** לַעֲבוֹדָה זָרָה **for idol worship,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה קָדוֹשׁ **so that it become holy** לְהַקְרִיבוֹ לַשָּׁמַיִם **to offer to Heaven,** וּכְמוֹ כֹּחַ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **like the power of Moshe Rabbeinu, alav**

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[678] Parallel: **Tzidkas HaTzaddik 154** — "Just as a person must believe in Hashem, so afterward he must believe in himself. This means that Hashem has dealings with him, and that he is not a useless worker who exists for a night, nor like a wild animal that is lost and gone after its death. Rather, he must believe that his soul comes from the Source of life, blessed be His Name, and that Hashem takes delight and pleasure in it when it does His will."

Connection: This defines the confidence that defeats despair: belief in the soul's Divine origin and continuing purpose. It complements the earlier warning against trusting oneself to be immune from temptation; awareness of vulnerability does not justify abandoning the possibility of return.

[679] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 4** — "Israel said: 'Master of the world, we cannot overcome him.' The Holy One, blessed be He, tells them: 'You shall mention his name below, and I shall erase his name above, as it says, Let them be continually before Hashem—all that he did against Me—and let Him cut off their remembrance from the earth.' Thus, 'Remember what Amalek did.'" The Midrash makes human remembrance the beginning of an act completed from above. Rav Tzadok applies the same pattern to overcoming an inclination stronger than the individual.

[680] **Kiddushin 30b** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: 'My children, I created the evil inclination and I created Torah as its remedy. If you occupy yourselves with Torah, you will not be delivered into its hand, as it says, If you do well, shall it not be lifted up? But if you do not occupy yourselves with Torah, you are delivered into its hand, as it says, Sin couches at the door. Moreover, all its occupation is with you, as it says, Its desire is toward you. If you wish, you can rule over it, as it says, You shall rule over it.'" The source couples the reality of the inclination with a divinely provided means of resistance. Rav Tzadok further explains the energy of desire as capable of being directed toward yearning for Torah.

[681] **Sukkah 52a** — "Rabbi Avira expounded—or some say Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi: The evil inclination has seven names. The Holy One, blessed be He, called it Evil, as it says, 'The inclination of a person's heart is evil from his youth.' Moshe called it Uncircumcised, as it says, 'Circumcise the foreskin of your hearts.' David called it Impure, as it says, 'Create a pure heart for me, God,' implying that an impure heart exists." Rav Tzadok singles out the Divine name 'Evil' and relates it to the desire described in the Flood generation. The Gemara itself supplies the citation of Genesis 8:21.

hashalom, לְתַקֵּן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נַעֲשֶׂה **to rectify, so that there be made** מֵהָרַע טוֹב מְאֹד **out of the evil "very good";** וְעַל כֵּן נֶחְשָׁב גִּדְעוֹן **and therefore Gidon is reckoned** כְּנֶגֶד מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **against Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְהָעֵסֶק בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **And the work of this month** לְתַקֵּן כָּל הָרַע וְהַקְּלִיפּוֹת **is to rectify all the evil and the kelipos,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזּוֹהַר שֶׁהֵם גַּם כֵּן בְּאוֹת ק׳ **which are also in the letter Kuf,** כְּקוֹפָא אֵצֶל בְּנֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ שֶׁזָּכַרְנוּ (חֵלֶק ב קמח, ב) **as they said in the holy Zohar (II 148b), which we mentioned:** נָשָׁא. **"like an ape beside human beings."** וּלְתַקֵּן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַלֵּב הַר קָדְשִׁי **And to rectify that the heart be "My holy mountain,"** מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **a Mishkan for the Shechinah,** וְלֹא יָרֵעוּ וְגוֹמֵר בְּכָל הַר קָדְשִׁי **and "they shall not harm... in all My holy mountain" —** דָּא לִבָּא **this is the heart** דְּמְדוֹרֵיהּ דְּיֵצֶר הָרַע בֵּיהּ **in which the yetzer hara has its dwelling,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as they said in the Midrash HaNe'lam cited above.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בַּאֲדָר הַשֵּׁנִי **And afterward, in the second Adar,** מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **is the eradication of Amalek,** וּבְאוֹת ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **and in the letter Kuf, "Kadosh";** וְהַיְינוּ הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק **that is, the "light sown for the tzaddik,"** אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁגְּנָזוֹ **the primordial light that was hidden away** לַעֲמֵלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for those who toil in Torah she'b'al peh,** קוֹדֶשׁ תַּתָּאָה **the lower holiness** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ז) **(as explained in maamar 7).** וְאָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית טו, א) **And they said (Taanis 15a):** צַדִּיקִים לְאוֹרָה **"Tzaddikim for light,** וְיִשָּׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה **and the upright for joy,"** [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Tehillim 97:11),** וּלְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **"And for the upright of heart, joy";** דִּכְשֶׁמִּתְיַישֵּׁר הַלֵּב מִכָּל וָכָל **for when the heart is made entirely upright,** זוֹכִין לְשִׂמְחָה:[682] **one merits joy.**

וּבַתּוֹרָה לֹא מָצִינוּ שִׂמְחָה **In the Torah we do not find joy** רַק שֶׁיֵּשׁ מִצְוָה **except where there is a mitzvah of it;** וּבְשַׁבָּת אִיתָא (סִפְרֵי בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ יט) **and regarding Shabbos it is stated (Sifrei, Behaaloscha 19):** וּבְיוֹם שִׂמְחַתְכֶם [בְּמִדְבַּר י, י] **"'And on the day of your joy' (Bamidbar 10:10) —** אֵלּוּ הַשַּׁבָּתוֹת **these are the Shabbosos";** דְּאַף שֶׁאֵין מִצְוַת שִׂמְחָה בְּשַׁבָּת **for though there is no mitzvah of joy on Shabbos,** הַיִּשְׂרָאֵל שָׂמֵחַ **the Jew rejoices** בְּקַבָּלַת עוֹל מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **in accepting the yoke of His Kingship, may He be blessed,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים [תְּפִלּוֹת שַׁבָּת] **as we say (Shabbos prayers),** יִשְׂמְחוּ בְמַלְכוּתְךָ וְכוּ׳ **"They shall rejoice in Your Kingship..."** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ה) **(as explained in maamar 5);** אֲבָל בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **but regarding Rosh Chodesh** לֹא מָצִינוּ שִׂמְחָה. **we do not find joy.** וּכְתִיב [הוֹשֵׁעַ ב, יג] **And it is written (Hoshea 2:13),** וְהִשְׁבַּתִּי כָּל מְשׂוֹשָׂהּ חַגָּהּ חָדְשָׁהּ וְשַׁבַּתָּהּ וְגוֹמֵר **"I will put an end to all her rejoicing, her festival, her new month and her Shabbos...";** נִרְמָז שֶׁגַּם בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **it is hinted that on Rosh Chodesh too** יֵשׁ בּוֹ שִׂמְחָה **there is joy,** כְּמוֹ שַׁבָּת וְיוֹם טוֹב **like Shabbos and Yom Tov;** וְצָרִיךְ לְהָבִין מַה מָּקוֹם בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ לְשִׂמְחָה. **and we need to understand what place there is on Rosh Chodesh for joy.** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן **But the matter is** דְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁיֵּשׁ הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **that wherever there is a revelation of Atika,** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ בְּהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **meaning that Yisrael are bound to the root in Hashem Yisbarach,** זוֹכִין לְיַישֵּׁר הַלֵּב **they merit to make the heart upright,** וּלְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **and "for the upright of heart, joy."** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב נד, א) **And so it is stated in the holy Zohar (II 54a)** דְּכָל תּוּשְׁבְּחָן **that all the praises** דְּשַׁבְּחוּ לְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **with which they praised the Holy One, blessed be He,** כּוּלָּם פָּתְחוּ בְּאָז כּוּלֵי **all opened with "Az"...:** כַּד אִתְנְהִיר **when there shines** נְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא וְכוּלֵי **the light of Atika Kadisha...;** אָלֶ״ף אִתְנְקִיב בַּחֲשׁוֹכֵי כּוּלֵי **Alef was engraved in the darkness...,** וּמָטוּ לְזַיִן. **and reached to Zayin.** וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (עֲרָכִין יא, א) **And it is stated in the Gemara (Arachin 11a):** אֵיזֶהוּ עֲבוֹדָה **"What is the service** שֶׁבְּשִׂמְחָה וּבְטוּב לֵבָב **that is with joy and gladness of heart?** הֱוֵי אוֹמֵר זֶה שִׁירָה **Say, this is song";** וְהַשִּׂמְחָה עַל יְדֵי הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **and the joy comes through the revelation of Atika,** שֶׁהוּא בְּאָ״ז כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **which is in "Az," as mentioned above.** וְשַׁבָּת יֵשׁ בּוֹ הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **Shabbos has in it a revelation of Atika,** וְכֵן בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ גַּם כֵּן **and so too Rosh Chodesh,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ג עט, ב) **as they said in the holy Zohar (III 79b):** אוּף הָכִי בְּחַדְתּוֹתֵי דְּהָא נָהִיר לָהּ שִׁמְשָׁא **"So too at the renewals of the moon, for the sun shines on it** בְּחֶדְוָותָא **in joy,** סִיהֲרָא[683]

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[682] **Zohar I, Vayechi 219b** — "Come and see: Concerning the other sinners of the world it is not written, 'It was evil in Hashem's eyes'; here it is written, 'What he did was evil in Hashem's eyes.' Why? Because it says, 'He wasted it upon the ground.'" The passage explains the language used of Onan's wasting of seed. Rav Tzadok cites this specific use of 'evil' when describing the defect of sexual desire; the following Niddah source applies the same language to deliberate thought.

[683] **Niddah 13b** — "Some report Rabbi Ami as saying: Anyone who brings himself to sinful thoughts is not admitted into the precinct of the Holy One, blessed be He. Here it is written, 'It was evil in Hashem's eyes,' and there it is written, 'For You are not a God who desires wickedness; evil shall not dwell with You.'" The Gemara joins the language used of Onan's act with the exclusion of deliberate erotic thought from the Divine precinct. Rav Tzadok draws on this

we say the Kedushah of Keser אוֹמְרִים קְדוּשַׁת כֶּתֶר **and for this reason** וּמִטַּעַם זֶה **through the light of Atika above";** דְּנְהִירוּ דְּעַתִּיקָא לְעֵילָּא
but the illumination is only temporary, אַךְ הַהֶאָרָה הוּא רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה **in the Mussaf of Rosh Chodesh;** בְּמוּסָף דְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ
as the Arizal said. וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר הָאֲרִ״י זַ״ל.[684] **at the time of Mussaf,** בְּשָׁעַת מוּסָף
regarding Hallel on Rosh Chodesh: לְעִנְיַן הַלֵּל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **And it is stated (Arachin 10b)** (עֲרָכִין י, ב) וְאִיתָא
a night sanctified for a festival לַיְלָה הַמְקוּדָּשׁ לְחַג **"Since it is called a festival, let him say it...;** דְּאִיקְרִי מוֹעֵד לֵימָא כּוּלֵּי
requires song, טָעוּן שִׁירָה **and one that is not...";** וְשֶׁאֵין כּוּלֵּי[685] וְאָנוּ אוֹמְרִים הַלֵּל בְּרֹאשׁ
yet we say Hallel on Rosh Chodesh, חֹדֶשׁ **"Learn from this:** שְׁמַע מִינַּהּ **and they said (Taanis 28b):** (תַּעֲנִית כח, ב) וְאָמְרוּ
the custom of their fathers is in their hands"; מִנְהַג אֲבוֹתֵיהֶם בִּידֵיהֶם[686] **that is, in Bavel they instituted** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּבָבֶל הִנְהִיגוּ
saying Hallel on Rosh Chodesh, לוֹמַר הַלֵּל בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **and this is because Bavel was the place of** וְהוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבְּבָבֶל הָיָה
the main spread and establishment עִיקַּר הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת וְהִתְיַסְּדוּת **of the Torah she'b'al peh** הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה
(as explained in Mishpatim, maamar 1, and elsewhere); (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מִשְׁפָּטִים מַאֲמָר א וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת)
and therefore they sensed the hint וְעַל כֵּן הִרְגִּישׁוּ הֶרֶמֶז **that joy is hinted** שֶׁנִּרְמַז שִׂמְחָה אַף
even on Rosh Chodesh, as mentioned above. בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל.[687] **Since** כֵּיוָן דְּעַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה
which is the "light sown for the tzaddik," שֶׁהוּא הָאוֹר זָרוּעַ לַצַּדִּיק **through Torah she'b'al peh,** וְהָרֹב חָכְמָה
that rectifies the "much anger," לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס **one merits** זוֹכִין לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה
as mentioned above, כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **it emerges that on every Rosh Chodesh** וְנִמְצָא בְּכָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ
there is a hint of joy, יֵשׁ רֶמֶז שִׂמְחָה **in that we say song.** שֶׁאוֹמְרִים שִׁירָה.
"In Adar, whose fortune is healthy"; בַּאֲדָר דְּבְרִיא מַזָּלֵיהּ **And regarding the month of Adar we find (ibid. 29b):** (שָׁם כט, ב) וּבְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר מָצִינוּ
that is, they are bound to the root דְּהַשְׁתָּא יִתְבָּרֵךְ **in Hashem Yisbarach** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ
for mazal is that which is above דְּמַזָּל הוּא מַה שֶׁלְּמַעְלָה **(as explained in maamar 5);** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ה)
the grasp and intellect of man, מִתְפִּיסַת וְשֵׂכֶל אָדָם[688] **in the manner of what they said (Megillah 3a):** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (מְגִילָּה ג, א)
"Even though they do not see, their mazal sees"; אַף עַל גַּב דְּאִינְהוּ לָא חָזוּ מַזָּלַיְיהוּ חָזֵי
"When Adar enters we increase in joy," וּכְמוֹ **and therefore they said,** מְשֻׁנְּכְנָס אֲדָר מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ

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usage of 'evil in Hashem's eyes' in his account of the defect of desire. The separate ZoharI 219b locator requires its own verification.

[684] **Sukkah 52a** — "Abaye heard a man say to a woman: 'Let us rise early and go on the road.' He said: 'I shall go and separate them from a prohibition.' He followed them for three parasangs through the marsh. When they parted, he heard them say: 'The road is long, but our company was pleasant.' Abaye said: 'Had it been me, I could not have restrained myself.' He went and leaned upon the doorpost, distressed. An elder came and taught him: 'Whoever is greater than his fellow has an inclination greater than his fellow's.'" The story supplies the setting of Abaye's admission: the couple separated innocently, while he recognized the danger he himself might have faced. The elder's answer explains why greatness and strong temptation can coexist.

[685] **Pri Tzaddik, Terumah 8** — "Yetzer means yearning: Hashem created the person with desire and longing rooted within him, and the choice is given to him to direct that longing toward holiness or, Heaven forbid, its opposite. ... This is the purpose for which the inclination was created: that there should be desire and yearning for Torah. 'If this repulsive one encounters you, draw him to the study hall' means drawing the longing so that it becomes yearning for Torah. Therefore, one greater than his fellow, because yearning for Torah is rooted more strongly within him, encounters a stronger opposite longing as well, for God made the one corresponding to the other." The earlier passage explains the causal connection in the Sukkah saying: stronger spiritual longing carries an opposing possibility. It does not identify the intensity of temptation by itself as a proof of spiritual attainment.

[686] **I Samuel 15:2** — "Thus says Hashem of hosts: I have taken account of what Amalek did to Israel, how he set himself against him on the way when he came up from Egypt." The haftarah repeats the emphasis on 'the way.' Rav Tzadok asks why this particular assault is remembered more than other persecution and answers through its continuing spiritual effect.

[687] **Shabbos 118b** — "Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: Had Israel observed the first Shabbos, no nation or tongue would have ruled over them, as it says, 'On the seventh day some of the people went out to gather,' followed by 'Amalek came.' Rabbi Yochanan said in Rabbi Shimon ben Yochai's name: If Israel observed two Shabbosos according to their laws, they would be redeemed immediately, as it says, 'Thus says Hashem to the eunuchs who keep My Shabbosos,' followed by 'I shall bring them to My holy mountain.'" The first statement supplies the connection between Shabbos and Amalek; the second explains why Shabbos can also be presented as the route to immediate redemption. Rav Tzadok understands the lasting subjugation as the later fruit of the inward damage Amalek introduced.

[688] **Joshua 2:11** — "We heard, and our hearts melted; no spirit remained in anyone because of you, for Hashem your God is God in the heavens above and on the earth below." Rachav reports the continuing terror of Israel's God. Rav Tzadok uses her words to show that Amalek's attack did not immediately remove Israel's manifest military and spiritual power; the subjugation described by the Gemara therefore calls for a deeper explanation.

שֶׁיִּשָּׂרָאֵל מַרְגִּישִׁין **just as joy and gladness are hinted** גַּם בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **also on Rosh Chodesh,** שְׁנִרְמַז שִׂמְחָה וּמָשׂוֹשׂ בּוֹ **that Yisrael feel joy in it,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וּכְשֶׁזּוֹכִין בַּאֲדָר **And when one merits, in Adar,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **which was formed with the letter Kuf, "Kadosh,"** לִהְיוֹת הַלֵּב הַר קָדְשִׁי **for the heart to be "My holy mountain,"** שֶׁנַּעֲשֶׂה הַלֵּב מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **so that the heart becomes a Mishkan for the Shechinah,** וְלֹא יָרֵעוּ וְגוֹמֵר בְּכָל הַר קָדְשִׁי **and "they shall not harm... in all My holy mountain,"** וְיִכַּוֵּן אֶת לִבּוֹ **and one directs his heart** כְּנֶגֶד בֵּית קָדְשֵׁי הַקָּדָשִׁים **toward the house of the Holy of Holies,** אָז אַחַר כָּךְ בְּנִיסָן **then afterward, in Nissan,** עֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל **they are destined to be redeemed,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (ר"ה יא, א) **as they said (Rosh Hashanah 11a);** וּבְשַׁבָּת חוֹל הַמּוֹעֵד פֶּסַח **and on Shabbos Chol HaMoed Pesach** מַפְטִירִין הָעֲצָמוֹת שֶׁבְּפֶסַח יִהְיֶה הַיְבֵשׁוֹת[689] **the Haftarah is the dry bones,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (מְגִילָּה לא, א) **as they said (Megillah 31a),** תְּחִיַּת הַמֵּתִים **for on Pesach there will be the revival of the dead,** אַחַר שֶׁיִּתּוּקַן כָּל הַפְּגָם וְהַקְּטָרוּג **after all the blemish and the accusation are rectified,** וְהָיָה אוֹר הַלְּבָנָה **and "the light of the moon will be** כְּאוֹר הַחַמָּה: **like the light of the sun."**

[689] **Eruvin 54a** — "Rav Acha bar Yaakov said: No nation or tongue would have ruled over them, for it says, 'Engraved'—do not read charus, engraved, but cheirus, freedom." The Gemara discusses what would have followed had the first tablets not been broken. Rav Tzadok relates this freedom from foreign domination to the state Israel could have retained at the giving of the Torah.

ראש חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר, מַאֲמָר י״א Rosh Chodesh Adar — Maamar Yud Aleph

The holy Arizal הָאַרִ״י הַקָּדוֹשׁ זַ״ל **counted the twelve months** חָשַׁב שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר חֳדָשִׁים **against the twelve tribes** לִשְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הַשְּׁבָטִים **in the order of the banners,** כְּסֵדֶר הַדְּגָלִים וְנִמְצָא אֲדָר לְנַפְתָּלִי[690] **and it emerges that Adar is for Naftali.** **And this is what it says in Sefer Yetzirah:** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה **"He crowned the letter Kuf in laughter";** הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בִּשְׂחוֹק **for of Naftali it is written (Devarim 33:23),** דִּכְתִיב [דְּבָרִים לג, כג] לְנַפְתָּלִי כְּתִיב **"Naftali, satisfied with favor..."; and as the Raavad also wrote,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב גַּם הָרַאֲבַ״ד **that laughter is for Naftali for this reason** דִּשְׂחוֹק לְנַפְתָּלִי מֵהַאי טַעְמָא (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ו) **(as explained in maamar 6).** [דְּבָרִים שָׁם] וּכְתִיב **And it is written (Devarim ibid.),** וּמָלֵא בִּרְכַּת ה׳ **"and full of the blessing of Hashem";** בִּרְכַּת ה׳ הִיא תַּעֲשִׁיר **"The blessing of Hashem, it makes rich,"** הוּא[691] וְעִיקַּר הַבְּרָכָה **and the main blessing is** וְהַיְינוּ עֲשִׁירוּת דְּתוֹרָה **meaning the wealth of Torah,** (תְּמוּרָה טז, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ **as is expounded (Temurah 16a):** עַל חָכָם וְטִיפֵּשׁ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה — עָשִׁיר וָרָשׁ **"rich and poor"**.[692] **of the wise and the foolish in words of Torah.** וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ **And so they expounded** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יא, א) **(Bereishis Rabbah 11:1):** בִּרְכַּת ה׳ הִיא תַּעֲשִׁיר **"The blessing of Hashem, it makes rich"** — זוֹ הַשַּׁבָּת **this is Shabbos;** שֶׁשַּׁבָּת הַזְּמַן **for Shabbos is the time** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֶלֶק א מז, ב) לִזְכּוֹת לַעֲשִׁירוּת דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **to merit the wealth of Torah she'b'al peh,** **as they said (Zohar I 47b):** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ב, ב] בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **"On the seventh day" (Bereishis 2:2)** — דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כּוּלֵי. **this is Torah she'b'al peh...."** **And this is what it says (Devarim ibid.),** [דְּבָרִים שָׁם] וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the manner of what it says (Tehillim 21:3),** [תְּהִלִּים כא, ג] עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **"satisfied with favor,"** שְׂבַע רָצוֹן **"The desire of his heart You have given him,** תַּאֲוַת לִבּוֹ נָתַתָּ לוֹ וַאֲרֶשֶׁת שְׂפָתָיו בַּל מָנַעְתָּ סֶלָה **and the request of his lips You have not withheld, Selah";** (עירובין נד, א) וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (Eruvin 54a):** אֵימָתַי תַּאֲוַת לִבּוֹ נָתַתָּ לוֹ **"When have You given him the desire of his heart?** בְּזְמַן שֶׁאֲרֶשֶׁת שְׂפָתָיו **When the request of his lips** בַּל מָנַעְתָּ[693] סֶלָה. **You have not withheld, Selah."** [דְּבָרִים שָׁם] וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what it says (Devarim ibid.),** יָם וְדָרוֹם יְרָשָׁה. **"Possess the sea and the south."** יָם רוּחַ מַעֲרָב **"Sea" is the west side,** שֶׁהוּא כְּנֶגֶד דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **which corresponds to David HaMelech, alav hashalom,** כִּידוּעַ **as is known,** וְהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **and he is a chariot for the attribute of Malchus,** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **"mouth," Torah she'b'al peh;** וְדָרוֹם כְּנֶגֶד אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and "south" corresponds to Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁהָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן **who was the first** שֶׁהוֹרִיד הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה **to bring down the light of Torah,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, ב, ג) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 2:3):** יְהִי אוֹר זֶה אַבְרָהָם[694] **"'Let there be light' — this is Avraham";** וַחֲמִשָּׁה פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה

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[690] **Yoma 38b** — "Reish Lakish said: What is meant by 'If it concerns scoffers, He scoffs; to the humble He gives grace'? One who comes to become impure is given an opening; one who comes to become pure is given assistance." This is the precise rabbinic wording behind the final assurance of assistance. The person's beginning toward purity matters even where the complete overcoming of Amalek requires help from above.

[691] Parallel: **R. Yehudah Aryeh Leib Alter, Sefas Emes, Shabbos Zachor 5638, s.v. Od yisba'er** — "The Sages established this at the end of the year, and Haman's fall likewise occurred in Adar, on the basis of 'When He gives you rest from all your enemies round about.' After the surrounding forces of impurity have been burned away, Amalek's name can be erased. What occurred in the course of Israel's history also occurs every year; therefore, at the year's end, 'when He gives you rest from all your enemies,' there is an erasure of Amalek."

Connection: Sefas Emes reads the same condition as an inward sequence: release from the surrounding forces prepares the attack on Amalek itself. He then applies that sequence to the annual calendar, explaining how the Torah's national condition can also inform the present observance of Zachor.

[692] **Zohar III, Vayikra 4b** — "'The time of pruning has arrived'—the time to uproot the dominion of the rulers of the nations, so that they should not rule over Israel, when the Mishkan was established. 'The voice of the turtledove is heard in our land'—this is the lower land that Israel inherited through Yehoshua. What is the voice of the turtledove? It is the supernal guide who joined her when Shlomo built the Temple below. ... In the Book of Aggadah it says: 'The voice of the tor' is the Oral Torah. The Written Torah is called Torah without qualification; the Oral Torah is called tor, as with vayiker and vayikra: one is complete and the other is not so." The Zohar supplies both the literal inheritance through Yehoshua and the interpretation of tor as Oral Torah. Rav Tzadok develops their conjunction into the meaning of the land as each Jew's share in Oral Torah.

[693] **Zohar I, Mikeitz 202a** — "We learned: A person should always rouse the good inclination against the evil inclination and strive against it. If it departs from him, well; if not, he should occupy himself with Torah, for there is nothing that breaks the evil inclination except Torah. If it departs, good; if not, let him remind it of the day of death in order to break it." The Zohar gives a sequence of active resistance, Torah and remembrance of death. Rav Tzadok emphasizes the Oral Torah's lived study as the means of transforming the inward enemy.

[694] **Sukkah 52b** — "The school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: If this repulsive one encounters you, draw him to the study hall. If he is stone, he will dissolve; if iron, he will shatter. If stone, he dissolves, for it says, 'All who are thirsty, go to

and the five times "light" כְּנֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **in the utterance "Let there be light"** שֶׁבְּמַאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **correspond to the Five Books of the Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם ג, ה) **(as stated ibid. 3:5);** וְאֶצֶל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and with Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** הָיָה[695] הַכֹּל בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **everything was in the aspect of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהֲרֵי רַב לֹא הָיָה לוֹ **for he had no teacher,** וְאָבִיו לֹא לִמְּדוֹ **and his father did not teach him;** רַק שֶׁהַזְּמִין לוֹ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **rather Hashem Yisbarach provided him** שְׁתֵּי כְלָיוֹתָיו **his two kidneys,** שֶׁהָיוּ נוֹבְעוֹת תּוֹרָה[696] **which would well forth Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם סא, א) **(as stated ibid. 61:1);** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and this is like Torah she'b'al peh:** דְּבָרַי אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּפִיךָ **"My words which I have placed in your mouth"** [יְשַׁעְיָה נט, כא] **(Yeshayahu 59:21),** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ מַשְׁפִּיעַ **which Hashem Yisbarach bestows** בְּלֵב הַחֲכָמִים. **in the heart of the sages.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר יְרָשָׁה **And this is what he said, "yerashah":** יְרַשׁ ה׳ **"inherit the Hei,"** הַמְרַמֵּז לְמַלְכוּת פֶּה **which alludes to Malchus, "mouth,"** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **Torah she'b'al peh.** וְאָמַר יְרָשָׁה **And it says "yerashah,"** שֶׁלֹּא כָּל הַשֵּׁבֶט תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **for not all the tribe were talmidei chachamim,** אַךְ עַל כָּל פָּנִים **but in any case** הַכֹּל זוֹכִין לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **all merit words of Torah,** [דְּבָרִים לג, ד] עַל דָּרָךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **in the manner of what they said (Devarim 33:4),** מוֹרָשָׁה קְהִלַּת יַעֲקֹב **"an inheritance of the congregation of Yaakov,"** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד יֵשׁ לוֹ **that each one has** חֵלֶק בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה.[697] **a portion in words of Torah.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר יְרָשָׁה **And this is what it says, "yerashah":** כִּירוּשָׁה שֶׁאֵין לָהּ הֶפְסֵק[698] **like an inheritance, which has no interruption** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּבָא בַּתְרָא קכט, ב) **(as stated in Bava Basra 129b).** וּבִרְכַת נַפְתָּלִי מִיַּעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Naftali's blessing from Yaakov Avinu, alav hashalom:** נַפְתָּלִי אַיָּלָה שְׁלוּחָה **"Naftali is a hind let loose,** אִמְרֵי מְרַמֵּז לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הַנּוֹתֵן אִמְרֵי שָׁפֶר **who gives beautiful words"** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מט, כא] **(Bereishis 49:21).** אֲמִירָה **"Words" alludes to Torah she'b'al peh** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זֹהַר חֵלֶק א רלד, ב) **as they said (Zohar I 234b):** בַּחֲשַׁאי[699] **"saying" is in silence,** [יְשַׁעְיָה מט, כא] כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר **as you say (Yeshayahu 49:21),** וְאָמַרְתְּ בִּלְבָבֶךָ **"and you shall say in your heart";** וְהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and the Torah she'b'al peh** מוֹפִיעַ הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **Hashem**

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water,' and 'Water wears away stones.' If iron, he shatters, for it says, 'Is not My word like fire, says Hashem, and like a hammer that shatters rock?'" The source's remedy is study in the beis midrash. Rav Tzadok identifies this setting particularly with the active development of Oral Torah, rather than treating knowledge as merely an intellectual possession.

[695] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 5** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Israel: 'Be careful concerning those two remembrances I wrote for you in Torah: Blot out Amalek's remembrance; remember what Amalek did to you.' 'Proverbs of ashes': If you merit, you are the children of Avraham, who compared himself to ashes, saying, 'I am dust and ashes.' If not, 'your defenses are defenses of clay': prepare yourselves for the servitude of Egypt, as it says, 'They embittered their lives with hard labor.' Another reading: for the servitude of kingdoms, as it says, 'Plowers plowed upon my back.'" The Midrash links both remembering and erasure to Avraham's ashes and to deliverance from servitude. Rav Tzadok explains that humility counters Amalek's pride and that the two commands address the two dangers distinguished in Maamar 1. The same formulation was not independently located in the checked Pesikta 12transcription.

[696] **Parallel: Sefer Sod HaNachash, attributed to Rabbi Yosef Gikatilla, opening, pp.30–32** — "Avraham, the mystery of the right arm, has thirty-five princes attached through Yishmael; beside him is Egypt, second to the Land of Israel. ... Know that on the left is Yitzchak, and thirty-five princes attach to him through Esav. All those princes are generally called nations, and the first of them all is Amalek, descendant of Esav." The edition attributes this treatise to Gikatilla. That attribution has not been independently established from a manuscript. Its Hebrew reads ben Esav in the broad sense of Esav's descendant; Amalek is his grandson. This passage explicitly gives the thirty-five princes on each side and their attachment through Yishmael and Esav. It corroborates the division. Megaleh Amukot on Lech Lecha, as reported by Shem MiShmuel, Mattos, gives the same scheme in the Lurianic school: "The prince of Yishmael has under him thirty-five princes on the right, and the prince of Esav thirty-five princes on the left; these are the seventy princes of the nations." A passage in the Arizal's own transmitted writings stating the division has not been located.

[697] **Bamidbar Rabbah 13:3** — "'A person's pride will bring him low'—this is Amalek, who exalted himself against the Holy One with insults and blasphemies. He directed the zemorah toward Him, taking Israel's circumcised members and throwing them upward, insulting and blaspheming and saying, 'Is this what You desired?' Thus, 'He struck at your rear'—a blow at the tail. 'The lowly of spirit will attain honor'—this is Yehoshua, who killed him, as it says, 'Yehoshua weakened Amalek and his people.'" The source explicitly identifies the spiritual fault as pride and contrasts it with Yehoshua's lowliness. Rav Tzadok relates Avraham's self-description as ashes to the same opposing quality of humility.

[698] **Bava Metzia 87a** — "Until Avraham there was no old age. One wishing to speak with Avraham would speak with Yitzchak; one wishing to speak with Yitzchak would speak with Avraham. Avraham came and asked for mercy, and old age came to be, as it says, 'Avraham was old, advanced in days.'" The Gemara explains the visible distinction of old age between father and son. Rav Tzadok reads this manifestation as the outward sign of Avraham's attainment of Atika; that mystical identification is his further interpretation.

Yisbarach causes to shine forth יִשְׂבָּרְךָ הַחֲכָמִים בְּלֵב. **in the heart of the sages.** שֶׁפֶר עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **"Beautiful," in the manner of what they said** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא נח, א) **(Bava Basra 58a):** בִּשׁוּפְרֵיהּ דְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן **"in the beauty of Adam HaRishon,"** דִּשְׁנֵי עֲקֵבָיו **whose two heels** דּוֹמִין לִשְׁנֵי גַּלְגַּלֵּי חַמָּה **resembled two orbs of the sun;** וְהֵיינוּ לְאַחַר פְּטִירָתוֹ **that is, after his passing,** שֶׁנִּתְתַּקֵּן **when he was rectified,** שֶׁהוּא כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל **so that he is as before the corruption** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּשַׁלַּח רֵישׁ מַאֲמָר ד) **(as stated in Beshalach, beginning of maamar 4);** וְזֶהוּ דִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל הַנּוֹתֵן אִמְרֵי שֶׁפֶר **and this is "who gives beautiful words":** שֶׁיָּכוֹל לְהַשְׁפִּיעַ **that he can bestow** פֶּה. **words of Torah she'b'al peh.** וְזֶהוּ גַּם כֵּן שִׂמְחָה **And this is also joy,** [מִשְׁלֵי טו, כג] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Mishlei 15:23),** שִׂמְחָה לָאִישׁ בְּמַעֲנֵה פִיו וְגוֹמֵר **"A man has joy in the answer of his mouth...";** (עֵירוּבִין נד, וְדָרְשׁוּ אֵימָתַי שִׂמְחָה לָאִישׁ[700] בִּזְמַן שֶׁמַּעֲנֶה בְּפִיו **(א and they expounded (Eruvin 54a): "When does a man have joy? When the answer is in his mouth."** וּכְתִיב לְאִי״שׁ **And it is written "la'ish,"** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז אֶל״ף פֶּל״א עֶלְיוֹן **which alludes to Alef, the supernal Wonder,** יו״ד שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ מֵהַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ **Yud, which shines forth from the root** לְכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **to Knesses Yisrael,** דְּה׳ ד׳ הֲוָות **for the Hei was a Dalet,** וּמִדְּאִתְעַבְּרַת בְּי׳ כַּיָּדוּעַ **and once it became impregnated with the Yud, as is known;** שׁ׳ רָזָא דְּתִלְתָּא אֲבָהָן **Shin is the secret of the three Avos** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֲלָק ב רד, א) **(as stated in Zohar II 204a);** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לִקְדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת **that is, he merits the holiness of Shabbos,** שׁ׳ בַּת **Shin–Bas,** דְּבַת מִתְעַטְּרָא בַּאֲבָהָן **for the daughter is crowned with the Avos;** שֶׁאָז הַזְּמַן לִזְכּוֹת **for then is the time to merit** לִבְרָכָה בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[701] **blessing in Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **as we said.** וּכְתִיב **And it is written, "Naftali is a hind let loose";** וּבְפִשּׁוּטוֹ שֶׁהָיָה רָץ כְּאַיָּלָה **in its plain sense, that he ran like a hind,** (סוֹטָה יג, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Sotah 13a),** שֶׁשְּׁלָחוּהוּ לְמִצְרַיִם **that they sent him to Mitzrayim** לְהָבִיא הַשְׁטַר מְכִירָה מִמִּצְרַיִם.[702] **to bring the deed of sale from Mitzrayim.** אֲבָל בַּתּוֹרָה לֹא **But the Torah does not mention as praise** שֶׁיָּכוֹל לָרוּץ **that one can run;** רַק הָעִיקָר הַשֶּׁבַח בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **rather the main praise is in words of Torah,** [תְּהִלִּים קיט, א] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 119:1),** אַשְׁרֵי תְמִימֵי דָרֶךְ **"Fortunate are those whose way is perfect,** הַהוֹלְכִים בְּתוֹרַת ה׳ **who walk in the Torah of Hashem";** וּבָזֶה תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים אֵין לָהֶם מְנוּחָה **and in this, talmidei chachamim have no rest,** לֹא בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וְלֹא בָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא[703] **neither in this world nor in the World to Come** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת סד, א) **(as stated in Berachos**

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[699] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 18, 34a** — "There are three prayers on Shabbos, with Musaf as a fourth. The evening prayer, 'You sanctified,' is the lower Shechinah, from the left side, where the Leviim are, of whom it says, 'Sanctify the Leviim.' The morning prayer, 'Moshe rejoices in the gift of his portion,' is the soul of every living being, the supernal Mother. ... The third prayer, 'You are One and Your name is One,' is the Divine Name, the middle pillar, which unites with both." The checked passage assigns the Shabbos prayers to distinct supernal aspects. It expressly calls Shacharis the supernal Mother; it does not explicitly name Atika in these lines. Rav Tzadok's identification of prayer with the corresponding meal and Avraham's holiness is the further interpretation developed in the manuscript.

[700] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 7** — "Here it says Remember, and of Shabbos it says Remember: are the two equal? Shlomo said, 'The fate of the fool will befall me too,' and then, 'The wise person has no remembrance together with the fool forever.' ... A king made a feast and invited guests. A bowl full of every good thing was brought before him; he said, 'Remember my friend so-and-so.' After he had emptied the bowl, he said, 'Remember my enemy so-and-so.' His friends asked: 'You mentioned this one and that one!' He answered: 'I mentioned this one over a bowl full of every good thing, and that one over an empty bowl.' So of Shabbos it says, 'Remember the Shabbos day to sanctify it,' honoring it with food, drink and clean clothing. Of Amalek it says Remember; over what do you remember him? Over an empty table, as it says, 'Blot out Amalek's remembrance from beneath the heavens.'" Rav Tzadok accepts the Midrash's distinction but asks why the shared word Remember creates a difficulty when the Torah already states different purposes. He explains the full bowl as holiness granted from above and the empty bowl as the person's work of removing evil.

[701] Parallel: **Beitzah 17a** — "A reciter taught before Ravina: 'Who sanctifies Israel, Shabbos and the appointed times.' He said to him: 'Does Israel sanctify Shabbos? Shabbos is already sanctified and established. Rather, say: Who sanctifies Shabbos, Israel and the appointed times.' Rav Yosef said: The halachah follows Rebbi, with Ravina's correction."
Connection: The order of the blessing preserves the distinction Rav Tzadok needs: Shabbos's holiness is already established, while Israel participates in sanctifying the festivals. This gives precise talmudic content to the full bowl's preexisting gift of holiness.

[702] **Exodus 31:13** — "You shall speak to the children of Israel, saying: You must keep My Shabbosos, for it is a sign between Me and you throughout your generations, that you may know that I am Hashem who sanctifies you." The verse expressly attributes Israel's sanctification to Hashem. Rav Tzadok distinguishes this divinely given holiness from the person's labor of removing evil.

[703] Parallel: **R. Yehudah Aryeh Leib Alter, Sefas Emes, Pesach 5635, s.v. Va'afilu kulanu chachamim** — "The final redemption will also come when all that is concealed within the Exodus has been clarified, for that redemption contains all the redemptions. 'To bring the days of Mashiach': remembering and recounting the Exodus brings those days. At the Exodus the intention was a complete repair, as in the future, when Hashem and His name will be one.

64a); וְהָאָדָם הָיָה רוֹצֶה לָרוּץ and a person would want to run מֵחַיִל אֶל חָיִל "from strength to strength," רַק הַשְּׂאוֹר שֶׁבָּעִיסָּה מְעַכֵּב the leaven in the dough holds him back [שָׁם יז, א] בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה only in this world (ibid. 17a); וְלֶעָתִיד לָבוֹא מֵחַיִל אֶל חָיִל[704] and in the future they will go from strength to strength; וְנַפְתָּלִי אַיָּלָה שְׁלוּחָה and "Naftali is a hind let loose": שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לֵילֵךְ מֵחַיִל אֶל חָיִל that he merits to go from strength to strength, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד. as it will be in the future. וְעַל כֵּן זוֹכֶה לִשְׂחוֹק Therefore he merits laughter, כְּמוֹ לֶעָתִיד as in the future; וְזֶה קְדוּשַׁת חֹדֶשׁ זֶה and this is the holiness of this month: לִזְכּוֹת לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה to merit the light of Torah she'b'al peh, שֶׁהוּא כְּנֶגֶד קְדוּשַׁת נַפְתָּלִי which corresponds to the holiness of Naftali, כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. as mentioned above. וּבְסֵפֶר קְדוּשַׁת לֵוִי And in the sefer Kedushas Levi חָשַׁב חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר כְּנֶגֶד יוֹסֵף he counted the month of Adar against Yosef, וְעַל כֵּן מִתְחַלֵּק בְּשָׁנַת הָעִיבּוּר לִשְׁנַיִם and therefore it divides in two in a leap year, כְּמוֹ יוֹסֵף שֶׁמִּתְחַלֵּק לְפָעָמִים like Yosef, who sometimes divides לִמְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶפְרַיִם into Menasheh and Efrayim (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר י, עַיֵּן שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת) (as explained in maamar 10; see there at length); וּמִיּוֹסֵף יָצָא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ and from Yosef came Yehoshua, שֶׁהִכְנִיס יִשְׂרָאֵל לְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל who brought Yisrael into Eretz Yisrael, שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה which is the root of Torah she'b'al peh, [כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בַּמַּאֲמָר הַקּוֹדֵם] as we said (in the previous maamar) בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ regarding what they said (נְדָרִים כב, ב) (Nedarim 22b): וְסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ "and the Book of Yehoshua, שֶׁעָרְכָה שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא. for it is the arrangement of Eretz Yisrael." וְאַחַר כָּךְ יִהְיֶה מִזַּרְעוֹ And afterward from his seed will come מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף Mashiach ben Yosef, שֶׁיְקַבֵּץ נִדְחֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל who will gather the dispersed of Yisrael וְיתַקֵּן הַכֹּל and rectify everything עַל יְדֵי אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[705] through the light of Torah she'b'al peh שֶׁיִּתְגַּלֶּה אָז: that will then be revealed.

But wicked Amalek confused Israel, as it says, 'who encountered you on the way.' … Through recounting the Exodus every year the repair is awakened, and his name is erased little by little."

Connection: This gives a precise model for Rav Tzadok's answer to the apparent failure of repeated erasure: an annual act can advance a cumulative repair whose completion is still future. Sefas Emes applies the principle to the Seder's narration; Rav Tzadok applies it here to the yearly remembrance of Amalek.

[704] **Mechilta DeRabbi Yishmael, Beshalach, Vayassa 6 (on Shemos 16:28)** — "Lest you say: Whoever keeps Shabbos, what reward does he receive? Scripture teaches: 'Fortunate is the man who does this... who keeps Shabbos from profaning it and guards his hand from doing any evil.' We have thus learned that whoever keeps Shabbos is kept distant from transgression." The Yalkut Shimoni (Beshalach 261) quotes the Mechilta in Rav Tzadok's wording, מרוחק מן העבירה. The critical text reads "whoever keeps Shabbos under duress is saved from transgression" (מְדֻחָק נֵצֵל). The passage opens parashah 6 of Vayassa. Rav Tzadok uses the teaching to affirm Shabbos's protective effect while retaining the person's duty of vigilance.

[705] **Shemos Rabbah 26:2** — "What does it say there? 'Is Hashem among us or not?' and 'Amalek came.' What is the connection? It is like a child riding on his father's shoulder who saw his father's friend and asked, 'Have you seen my father?' His father said: 'You are riding on my shoulder and asking about me? I shall put you down, and the enemy will come and rule over you.' So the Holy One said to Israel: 'I carried you upon clouds of glory, yet you say, Is Hashem among us? Therefore the enemy will come and rule over you.' Thus, 'Amalek came.'" The parable describes failure to recognize a sustaining presence already carrying the people. Rav Tzadok joins that loss of recognition to weakened Torah and Shabbos through the unifying quality of daas.

לְאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר אֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן

For the Fourteenth of Adar Rishon

לְאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר אֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן, מַאֲמָר א׳ For the Fourteenth of Adar Rishon — Maamar Aleph

הֵבִיא שְׁתֵּי **In the Shulchan Aruch, Orach Chaim** (סוֹף סִימָן תרצז) **(end of siman 697),** בְּשֻׁלְחָנוֹ עָרוּךְ אוֹרַח חַיִּים **he brought two opinions** דֵּעוֹת בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר **regarding feasting and rejoicing** לְעִנְיַן מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה[706] **on the fourteenth of Adar Rishon,** רִאשׁוֹן **and the Rema concluded:** וְסֵיֵם הָרַמָ״א [מִשְׁלֵי טו, טו] **"And one of good heart has a constant feast" (Mishlei 15:15).** וּכְבָר כָּתַב בְּסֵפֶר אוּרִים וְתֻמִּים **It was already written in the sefer Urim VeTumim** [קִיצּוּר תּוֹקְפּוֹ כֹּהֵן אוֹת קכג קכד בְּסוֹפוֹ] **(Kitzur Tokfo Kohen, os 123–124, at the end)** שֶׁנּוּכַל לְפָרֵשׁ בִּלְשׁוֹן הַשֻּׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ **that we may interpret the wording of the Shulchan Aruch** אַף אִם לֹא נִתְכַּוְּנוּ לָזֶה **even if they did not intend this,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הָעִנְיָן הָאֲמִתִּי **for in any case the true matter** נִכְלָל בְּדִבְרֵיהֶן **is included in their words,** הַנִּכְתָּב בְּרוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ.[707] **which were written with ruach hakodesh.** וְכֵן כָּאן שֶׁסִּיֵּם בְּפָסוּק זֶה **So too here, where he concluded with this pasuk,** אַף דְּלְכְאוֹרָה אֵין לוֹ שַׁיָּכוּת לְכָאן **even though it seemingly has no connection to this place** רַק לְסַיֵּם בְּדָבָר טוֹב. **but only serves to conclude with something good.** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה **One may say regarding this** דְּבִפְשׁוּטוֹ אֵינוֹ מוּבָן **that in its plain sense it is not understood** מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר וְטוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **what is said, "And one of good heart has a constant feast" — does then one whose heart is good** שׁוֹתֶה תָּמִיד **drink constantly?** וְרַשִׁ״י וְכִי מִי שֶׁטּוֹב לִבּוֹ [מִשְׁלֵי שָׁם] פֵּירֵשׁ **And Rashi (Mishlei ibid.) explained it** עַל הַשָּׂמֵחַ בְּחֶלְקוֹ[708] **as referring to one who is happy with his lot,** וּכְאִלּוּ נִכְתַּב וְטוֹב לֵב כְּמִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **as if it were written, "one of good heart is like a constant feast,"** וְאֵינוֹ דָּבָר וְהִפּוּכוֹ **and it is not a statement and its opposite** [שָׁם] נֶגֶד מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **against what is said (ibid.),** כָּל יְמֵי עָנִי רָעִים **"All the days of the poor man are bad,"** רַק קָאֵי עַל הֶעָנִי **rather it refers to the poor man himself:** דְּכְשֶׁהוּא שָׂמֵחַ בְּחֶלְקוֹ **when he is happy with his lot** הוּא כְּמִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד. **he is like a constant feast.** אֲבָל גַּם זֶה יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **But this too needs to be understood:** וְכִי מַעֲלְיוּתָא הִיא מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **is a constant feast then a virtue?** וְכַמָּה פְּסוּקִים בְּמִשְׁלֵי **There are many pesukim in Mishlei** בְּגִנּוּת שׁוֹתֵי יַיִן **in disparagement of wine drinkers,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (גִּיטִּין סח, א) **as they said (Gittin 68a):** כְּתִיב [מִשְׁלֵי כ, א] **"It is written (Mishlei 20:1),** לֵץ הַיַּיִן וְגוֹמֵר **'Wine is a mocker...,'** וּכְתִיב וְגוֹמֵר.[709] **and it is written..."** וְאַף אִם נֹאמַר **And even if we say** דְּמִשְׁתֶּה **that the "feast" intended** שֶׁהוּא שָׂמֵחַ תָּמִיד **is that he is always joyful,** גַּם זֶה אֵינוֹ מַעֲלָה **this too is no virtue,** דְּמָצִינוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ל, ב) **for we find (Berachos 30b):** חֲזָיֵיהּ דַּהֲוָה קָא בָּדַח טוּבָא **He saw that he was very merry,** אֲמַר לֵיהּ בְּכָל עָצְבָּ **and said to him, "In all sorrow** יִהְיֶה מוֹתָר וְכוּ׳. **there will be profit...."** אַךְ יֵשׁ לוֹמַר

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[706] **Mechilta DeRabbi Yishmael, Amalek 1** — "Others say: Refidim means only slackening of the hands. Because they slackened their hands from words of Torah, the enemy came upon them; the enemy comes only because of slackening from Torah. For it says, 'When Rechavam's kingdom was established and he had grown strong, he abandoned Hashem's Torah, and all Israel with him.' What was the punishment? In Rechavam's fifth year, Shishak king of Egypt came up against Jerusalem, because they had acted unfaithfully against Hashem." The Mechilta supports its reading of Refidim with another episode where loss of Torah commitment preceded foreign domination. Rav Tzadok focuses on the inward lack of vitality signified by 'slackening.'

[707] **Zohar II, Pekudei 221a** — "All three are alluded to in this verse: 'In the beginning'—'with wisdom'; 'God created'—'with understanding'; 'the heavens'—'with knowledge.' All three are written in the work of the Mishkan. In this mystery it says: 'These are the accounts of the Mishkan'—the mystery of wisdom; 'the Mishkan of testimony'—the mystery of understanding; 'which was reckoned by Moshe's command'—the mystery of knowledge. Everything corresponds, for whatever the Holy One created in this world He created in the likeness of what is above, and everything is inscribed in the Mishkan's construction." The Zohar places Moshe at daas within the threefold structure of wisdom, understanding and knowledge. Rav Tzadok explains daas here as the living bond between mental apprehension and the heart's will.

[708] **Zohar III, Ki Seitzei 281b** — "Who is Amalek above? We have seen that the souls of Bilam and Balak came from there; therefore they hated Israel more than any nation or tongue. For this reason Amalek is inscribed in their names: am from Bilam and lak from Balak. They are the male and female Amalekites; of them it is said, 'He has not beheld iniquity in Yaakov, nor seen trouble in Israel.'" The source explicitly relates Bilam and Balak to Amalek's root through their names and hostility. Rav Tzadok identifies their shared inward opposition as the distortion of daas.

[709] **Sifrei, VeZos HaBerachah, 357:40** — "'No prophet arose again in Israel like Moshe': In Israel none arose, but among the nations one did arise. Who was it? Bilam son of Beor. Yet there is a difference between Moshe's prophecy and Bilam's: Moshe did not know who was speaking with him, while Bilam knew, as it says, 'Who hears God's sayings.' Moshe did not know when He would speak with him until He spoke, while Bilam knew when, as it says, 'Who knows the knowledge of the Most High.' Moshe spoke with Him only standing, as it says, 'Stand here with Me'; Bilam spoke while fallen, as it says, 'Who beholds a vision of the Almighty, fallen and with eyes uncovered.'" The comparison does not erase the differences in prophetic station. The Sifrei continues with the parable of a king's cook who knows the expenses of the royal table; Rav Tzadok uses the comparison as the background for two opposed forms of daas.

But one may say דְּטוֹב לֵב הוּא מִי שֶׁלִּבּוֹ טוֹב **that "good of heart" is one whose heart is good,** שֶׁהוֹרִיק הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **who has emptied out the yetzer hara** מֵהַלֵּב כְּסִיל לְשְׂמֹאלוֹ **from "the heart of the fool, at his left,"** וְיֵשׁ לוֹ רַק לֵב טוֹב **and he has only a good heart,** שֶׁגַּם הַלֵּב לְאָבִיו שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **one heart to his Father in Heaven,** וְהוּא תָּמִיד בְּשִׂמְחָה. **and he is always in joy.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (פְּסָחִים נ, א) **As they said (Pesachim 50a):** בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא יִהְיֶה ה' אֶחָד **"On that day Hashem will be One"** אַטוּ הָאִידָּנָא לָאו אֶחָד הוּא **— is He then not One nowadays?** וְכוּלֵי עָלְמָא הַבָּא **... In the World to Come** כּוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב[711] **it is all "Who is good and does good,"** [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל כּוּלּוֹ] וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י **and Rashi explained (s.v. Kulo)** שֶׁאֵין שָׁם בְּשׂוֹרָה רָעָה[712] **that there are no bad tidings there;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **that is, in this world** יֵשׁ הֵיפֶךְ הַטּוֹב **there is the opposite of good,** וְאָז לֹא יִהְיֶה זֶה **and then this will not be,** שֶׁיַּכִּירוּ הַטּוֹבָה. **for they will recognize the good.** וּבֶאֱמֶת גַּם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **In truth, even in this world** אוֹמְרִים פַּעֲמַיִם בְּכָל יוֹם **we say twice every day** בִּקְרִיאַת שְׁמַע ה' אֶחָד. **in Krias Shema, "Hashem is One."** אֲבָל מִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לָזֶה **But one who merits this** מַרְגִּישׁ בֶּאֱמֶת בִּשְׁעַת קְרִיאַת שְׁמַע **truly feels at the time of Krias Shema** שֶׁה' אֶחָד **that Hashem is One,** דְּכוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב **that it is all "Who is good and does good,"** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַכֹּל לְטוֹבָה **meaning that everything is for the good,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא (בְּרָכוֹת ס, ב) **as Rabbi Akiva said (Berachos 60b):** לְעוֹלָם יְהֵא אָדָם רָגִיל לוֹמַר **A person should always be accustomed to say,** כָּל מָה דְּעָבִיד רַחֲמָנָא **"Whatever the Merciful One does,** לְטַב עָבֵיד[713] **He does for the good."** וְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא הֶרְאָה לָהֶם תֵּיכָף **And Rabbi Akiva showed them immediately** שֶׁכָּל הַנַּעֲשֶׂה הוּא לְטוֹבָה **that all that is done is for the good,** וְאָמַר לְהוּ לָאו אֲמָרִי לְכוּ **and said to them, "Did I not tell you** שֶׁכָּל מַה שֶּׁעוֹשֶׂה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **that all that the Holy One, blessed is He, does** הַכֹּל לְטוֹבָה. **is all for the good?"** וְלֹא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר מִקּוֹדֶם [בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם] **This is unlike what he said earlier (Berachos ibid.),** חַיָּיב אָדָם לְבָרֵךְ לְקַבּוּלֵינְהוּ בְּשִׂמְחָה[714] **to accept them with joy,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאַף שֶׁיּוֹדֵעַ שֶׁאֵינוֹ טוֹב **meaning that even though he knows it is not good,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יְבָרֵךְ בְּשִׂמְחָה **he nonetheless blesses with joy,** וְעַל דָּרָךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שָׁם ז, ב) **in the manner they said (ibid. 7b):** לְאָדָם שֶׁיָּצָא עָלָיו שְׁטַר חוֹב וְכוּלֵי **"Like a man against whom a promissory note came out...** אֲבָל מִדַּת רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא הָיָה לְאַחַר שֶׁפָּרָעוֹ שָׂמַח.[715] **after he paid it, he rejoiced."** **But the attribute of Rabbi Akiva was** שֶׁהִכִּיר שֶׁהַמַּעֲשֶׂה הוּא לְטוֹבָה מַמָּשׁ **that he recognized that the**

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[710] **Zohar III, Balak 193b** — "Rabbi Shimon said: Elazar, all the words of wicked Bilam are powerful. The companions explained, 'No prophet arose again in Israel like Moshe': In Israel none arose, but among the nations one arose—Bilam. We have explained the matter: Moshe had no equal among the supernal crowns; Bilam had no equal among the lower crowns. This one belonged to the side of holiness, and that one to the side of the left." The Zohar expressly makes Moshe and Bilam counterparts in opposing orders. Rav Tzadok explains the contrast ethically as the bond—or refusal to bind—wisdom to the heart's will.

[711] **Numbers 23:10** — "Who can count Yaakov's dust, or number a fourth part of Israel? May my soul die the death of the upright, and may my end be like theirs." Bilam's own blessing recognizes Israel's worth and expresses a wish for the end of the upright. Rav Tzadok contrasts that recognition with Bilam's subsequent counsel to corrupt Israel, illustrating wisdom that was not joined to the heart's will.

[712] **Sanhedrin 106a** — "He said to them: 'Their God hates sexual immorality, and they desire linen garments. Come, I shall advise you: Set up enclosures for them, seat prostitutes in them—an old woman outside and a young woman inside—and let them sell linen garments to them.'" This is Bilam's counsel to lead Israel into sin through a staged commercial encounter. Rav Tzadok contrasts the counsel with Bilam's expressed wish to die the death of the upright: intellectual recognition of Israel's value did not govern his will.

[713] **Berachos 63a** — "Rabbi Tavi said in Rabbi Yoshiyah's name: Whoever slackens himself from words of Torah lacks the strength to stand in a time of trouble, as it says, 'If you slacken on the day of trouble, your strength is narrow.' Rav Ami bar Masna said in Shmuel's name: Even regarding a single commandment, for it says 'You slackened'—in any matter." The Gemara broadens the danger from Torah to even one mitzvah. Rav Tzadok relates this weakening to action without the inward bond and vitality of daas.

[714] **Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Berachos 63a, s.v. Kol hamerappeh** — "'Whoever slackens himself from words of Torah': Even one who studies and fulfills it—if he does so weakly and as an occasional pursuit, the statement says that he lacks the strength to stand on the day of trouble. As is said in the chapter Ein Omdin: These require strengthening—Torah, good deeds, and so forth; see there." Maharsha's precision is that the person has not abandoned study and observance; what is deficient is the sustained vigor with which they are pursued. This is the exact distinction Rav Tzadok uses in defining the absence of daas.

[715] **Berachos 32b** — "The Rabbis taught: Four require strengthening: Torah, good deeds, prayer, and worldly occupation. From where do we learn Torah and good deeds? Only be strong and very courageous, to observe and do according to all the Torah: be strong in Torah, and courageous in good deeds. From where prayer? Hope to Hashem; be strong, and let your heart be courageous, and hope to Hashem." The source names ongoing strengthening as a requirement even for pursuits that are already being practiced. Rav Tzadok treats this vitality as the inward quality whose absence is called slackening.

event is truly for the good וְאֵינוֹ בִּכְלַל רָע[716] **and is not in the category of bad at all,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיַּכִּירוּ לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **just as they will recognize in the World to Come** דְּכוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב. **that it is all "Who is good and does good."** וְזֶהוּ וְטוֹב לֵב **This is "and one of good heart":** מִי שֶׁלִּבּוֹ טוֹב **one whose heart is good,** שֶׁמְּבַעֵר הָרָע מִלֵּב **who eradicates the evil from the heart of the fool** — מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **"has a constant feast,"** שֶׁהוּא תָּמִיד בְּשִׂמְחָה. **for he is always in joy.** וּמִשְׁתֶּה הַיְינוּ **And "feast" means,** כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִשְׁלֵי ט, ה] **as it says (Mishlei 9:5),** וּשְׁתוּ בְּיַיִן מָסָכְתִּי **"and drink of the wine I have mixed"** — דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דְּבַעַל פֶּה[717] **the wine of the Oral Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא **as they said in the Ra'aya Mehemna** (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג רעא, ב) **(Zohar III 271b);** כֵּיוָן שֶׁמְּתַקֵּן עַל יְדֵי **and he recognizes** שֶׁכּוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב **that it is all "Who is good and does good,"** וְהוּא מַכִּיר הָרוֹב חָכְמָה **since through the abundance of wisdom he rectifies** הָרוֹב כַּעַס **the abundance of anger** וּמְבַעֵר הָרָע **and eradicates the evil** מֵהַלֵּב כְּסִיל לְשׂמֹאלוֹ. **from "the heart of the fool, at his left."** וְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא זָכָה לָזֶה **Rabbi Akiva merited this attribute,** דְּאִיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **for it is found in the Midrash** (מִדְרַשׁ חֻקַּת רַבָּה יט, ו **(Midrash on Chukas: Rabbah 19:6** וְתַנְחוּמָא ח) **and Tanchuma 8):** כָּל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ [אִיּוֹב כח, י] **"His eye has seen every precious thing" (Iyov 28:10)** — זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **this is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues;** דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא נִגְלוּ לְמֹשֶׁה נִגְלוּ לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **things that were not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues,** שֶׁהָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for he was the root of Torah she'b'al peh** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים). **(as explained many times).** וְכָל אָדָם יָכוֹל לִזְכּוֹת **And every person can merit** לְהַשָּׂגָה זוֹ בְּשָׁעַת קְרִיאַת שְׁמַע **this perception at the time of Krias Shema,** שֶׁמַּשִּׂיג הַיִּחוּד **when he perceives the Unity,** דְּכוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב **that it is all "Who is good and does good,"** וְאָז הוּא בְּשִׂמְחָה בַּלֵּב. **and then he is joyful in the heart.** וְעַל כֵּן **Therefore when he said to him,** בְּכָל עֶצֶב יִהְיֶה מוֹתָר כְּתִיב **"It is written, 'In all sorrow there will be profit,'"** כְּשֶׁאָמַר לוֹ אֲמַר לֵיהּ אֲנָא תְּפִילִּין מַנַּחְנָא **he answered him, "I am wearing tefillin"** — דְּעִיקַּר מִצְוַת תְּפִילִּין **for the essence of the mitzvah of tefillin** לְהַשִּׂיג הַיִּחוּד דַּהּ' אֶחָד **is to perceive the Unity of "Hashem is One,"** דְּכוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב **that it is all "Who is good and does good."** וְכֵן הוֹלְכִין בִּתְפִילִּין **Likewise one goes in tefillin** בְּשָׁעַת קְרִיאַת שְׁמַע תָּמִיד **at the time of Krias Shema always,** וּכְשֶׁזּוֹכֶה לְהַשִּׂיג הַיִּחוּד **and when he merits perceiving the Unity,** אָז הוּא בְּשִׂמְחָה **then he is in joy,** שֶׁמַּכִּיר דְּהַכֹּל לְטוֹבָה. **for he recognizes that everything is for the good.** וְזֶה הָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ נֵס פּוּרִים **This was the root of the miracle of Purim,** שֶׁהוּא זְמַן מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **which is the time of the eradication of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **who is the root of the evil inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ג קסז, א). **(III 160a).** וְאָז הִכִּירוּ הַכֹּל הַטּוֹבָה **Then all recognized the good** דְּלוּלֵי הַגְּזֵרָה לֹא הָיָה אוֹפֶן **that came through Haman's decree,** שֶׁהָיָה עַל יְדֵי גְּזֵרַת הָמָן **for were it not for the decree there would have been no way** שֶׁיְּבַקְּשׁוּ מֵאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **that they would ask Achashverosh** לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **to carry out the eradication of Amalek** וְלַהֲרוֹג מֵעַמּוֹ **and to kill from among his people;** וְרַק עַל יְדֵי גְּזֵרַת הָמָן **only through Haman's decree** נֶהְפּוֹךְ הוּא **"it was turned about,** אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁלְטוּ הַיְּהוּדִים **that the Jews ruled,** הַמָּה בְּשׂוֹנְאֵיהֶם.[718] **they, over those who hated them."** וְאָז הִכִּירוּ הַכֹּל הַטּוֹבָה **Then all recognized the good,** וְלֹא הָיָה גְּזֵרָה רָעָה **and it was not an evil decree** מֵעִיקָּרָהּ כָּלָל **from the outset at all,** רַק סִיבָּה לְטוֹבָה[719] **but only a cause for good,** שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק. **so that they could carry out the eradication of Amalek.**

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[716] Parallel: **R. Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Tanya, Likkutei Amarim, ch. 3, concluding paragraphs** — "Daas denotes attachment and joining: one binds his awareness with a very strong bond and fixes his thought firmly on the greatness of the Infinite One, without turning his attention away. Even someone who wisely understands that greatness will not generate true awe and love in his soul unless he binds his awareness and fixes his thought firmly and continually; otherwise these are empty imaginings. Therefore daas sustains the emotional attributes and gives them life; it embraces kindness and might—that is, love and its branches, and awe and its branches."

Connection: Tanya explains the exact missing link diagnosed here: intellectual understanding becomes living love and awe only through sustained attachment. This clarifies why Rav Tzadok describes Torah performed weakly, despite its correct intellectual content, as lacking daas and therefore lacking vitality.

[717] **I Chronicles 22:9** — "Behold, a son will be born to you; he will be a man of rest. I will grant him rest from all his enemies around him, for Solomon will be his name, and I will grant peace and quiet to Israel in his days." David's account of Solomon supplies the language of rest against which Rav Tzadok raises his question.

[718] **I Samuel 15:24** — "Saul said to Samuel: I have sinned, for I have transgressed the command of the Lord and your words, because I feared the people and listened to their voice." Rav Tzadok emphasizes "your words" as the prophetic command in that particular hour. This is his interpretive argument within the maamar; the verse itself joins the Lord's command and Samuel's words.

[719] **Jerusalem Talmud, Berakhot 9:5:8** — "Our father Abraham made the evil inclination good, as it is written, 'You found his heart faithful before You.' ... But David could not withstand it and killed it in his heart. What is the reason? 'My heart is slain within me.'" The contrast between transforming and slaying the inclination is explicit.

וְלֹא כְּמוֹ גְּאוּלַּת מִצְרַיִם **This is unlike the redemption from Egypt,** שֶׁבִּשְׁעַת הַצָּרָה הָיָה צָרָה בֶּאֱמֶת **where at the time of the trouble it was truly trouble,** רַק אַחַר כָּךְ נִגְאֲלוּ הַיְמֵנָה **and only afterward were they redeemed from it and went out to relief;** וְיָצְאוּ לִרְוָחָה מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן כָּאן **whereas here** שֶׁהִכִּירוּ מֵעִיקָּרוֹ לְטוֹבָה **they recognized that it was for the good from the outset,** [פִּיּוּט אֲשֶׁר הֵנִיא] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים **as we say (Piyut Asher Heni),** כִּי פוּר הָמָן **"For the lot of Haman** נֶהְפַּךְ לְפוּרֵנוּ[720] **was turned into our lot":** שֶׁהַגּוֹרָל הָיָה לְטוֹבָתֵינוּ **the lot was for our benefit,** מַה שֶּׁלֹּא הָיָה אֶפְשָׁר שֶׁנּוּכַל לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **so that we could carry out the eradication of Amalek,** בְּלָאו הָכִי.[721] **which would not have been possible otherwise.** וְהִנֵּה שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַמַּחֲלוֹקֶת **Now the root of the dispute** לְעִנְיַן מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **regarding feasting and rejoicing** בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר בַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן **on the fourteenth of Adar Rishon** אִיתָא (מְגִילָה ו, ב) הוּא דְּבַגְּמָרָא **is that in the Gemara (Megillah 6b) it states:** אֵין בֵּין אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן לְאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר הַשֵּׁנִי **There is no difference between the fourteenth of Adar Rishon and the fourteenth of Adar Sheni** אֶלָּא מִקְרָא מְגִילָּה **except the reading of the Megillah** וּמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **and gifts to the poor;** אֶלָּא לְעִנְיַן הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **but regarding eulogy and fasting** זֶה וָזֶה שָׁוִין **both are the same.** וְלֹא הוּזְכַּר מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **Feasting and rejoicing are not mentioned,** רַק שֶׁהָרַ"ן **but the Ran** (לְרִי"ף שָׁם ג, ב מִדַּפֵּי הָרִי"ף) **(on the Rif there, 3b in the Rif's pages, s.v. Ela) wrote** כָּתַב (דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אֶלָּא) דְּכֵיוָן דְּאִיסּוּר הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **that since the prohibition of eulogy and fasting** יָלִיף בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם ה, ב) **is derived in the Gemara (ibid. 5b):** שִׂמְחָה **"rejoicing" — that they are forbidden in eulogy;** מִשְׁתֶּה[722] **"feasting" — that it is forbidden to fast;** נִכְלָל חִיּוּב מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר **the obligation of feasting and rejoicing** רִאשׁוֹן[723] **on the fourteenth of Adar Rishon is included** בִּכְלַל אִיסּוּר הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **within the prohibition of eulogy and fasting** שֶׁבַּגְּמָרָא. **stated in the Gemara.** וְהַתּוֹסָפוֹת **And Tosafos** (מְגִילָה ו, ב דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וְרַבִּי כָּתְבוּ **(Megillah 6b, s.v. VeRabbi) wrote** דְּכֵיוָן דְּאָמְרוּ הָא לְעִנְיַן הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **that since they said, "but regarding eulogy and fasting** שָׁוִין **they are the same,"** מִכְּלָל דְּמִשְׁתֶּה וּמִשְׁתֶּה לֵיכָּא בְּרִאשׁוֹן[724] **this implies that rejoicing and feasting do not apply in the first,** דְּעַל כָּרְחָךְ לָא תֵּלְיָא הָא בְּהָא **for perforce the one does not depend on the other,** דְּאִם לֹא כֵּן לְאַשְׁמְעִינַן **for otherwise it should have taught us** דְּמִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה נָהֲגוּ בְּהוּ **that feasting and rejoicing are practiced in it,** וְכָל שֶׁכֵּן שֶׁנֶּאֱסַר בְּהֶסְפֵּד **and all the more so that it is forbidden in eulogy;** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** וּלְשִׁיטַת הַתּוֹסָפוֹת יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **And according to the view of Tosafos one must understand:** מְנָא לְהוּ כֵּיוָן דְּאִיסּוּר לְמֵיסַר הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית בְּרִאשׁוֹן **from where do they derive to forbid eulogy and fasting in the first,** נִלְמַד מִמַּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **since the prohibition of eulogy and fasting is learned from what** הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **is said, "feasting and rejoicing,"** וְזֶה גּוּפֵיהּ אֵינוֹ נוֹהֵג בַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן **and that itself does not apply in Adar Rishon?** וּבַמְּגִילָּה לֹא כָּתוּב **And in the Megillah it is written only** רַק לַעֲשׂוֹת אוֹתָם יְמֵי מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **"to make them days of feasting and rejoicing** וּמִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת וְגוֹמֵר [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כב] **and sending portions... and gifts to the poor" (Esther 9:22),** וּמִצְוֹת אֵלּוּ אֵינָם נוֹהֲגוֹת **and these mitzvos do not apply** בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר

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[720] **Bava Batra 17a:6** — "The Sages taught: Four died through the serpent's counsel: Benjamin son of Jacob, Amram father of Moses, Jesse father of David, and Chileab son of David. All are known through received tradition except Jesse father of David, concerning whom Scripture explains it. ... Was Abigail a daughter of Nahash? Was she not a daughter of Jesse? Rather, she was the daughter of one who died through the serpent's counsel." The expression attributes their mortality to the original serpent rather than to personal transgression. Rav Tzadok examines what remains of that primordial damage even in a righteous ancestry.

[721] **Temurah 16a:14–16** — "It was taught: He is Othniel, he is Jabez. What was his name? Judah, the brother of Shimon, was his name. 'Othniel'—God answered him; 'Jabez'—he counseled and spread Torah in Israel." The final phrase of the prayer is explicitly interpreted as protection against the inclination's interference with Torah study.

[722] **Bava Batra 12b:2** — "Rav Ashi said: Know that this is so, for a great man says a teaching, and a law received by Moses at Sinai is stated in accordance with him. Perhaps he is like a blind man finding an opening? But does he not give a reason?" The sage's reasoned understanding can coincide with a received Sinaitic law. Rav Tzadok reads this concurrence as reaching the root beyond ordinary apprehension.

[723] **Proverbs 3:8** — "It will be healing for your navel, and refreshment for your bones." The preceding verse calls for fearing the Lord and turning from evil. Rav Tzadok records his teacher's oral interpretation of the navel as the point of formation and of Torah as healing an inherited deficiency; no separate written attribution is supplied here.

[724] **Pesikta Rabbati 12, parable of the orchard and dog** — "Rabbi Berekhiah said: To what may this be compared? To a king who had an orchard and a dog sitting and guarding the orchard. The son of the king's beloved friend came to steal from the orchard. That dog stood up and bit him. When the king wished to remind the son of his beloved friend, without mentioning that he had wished to steal from his orchard, he would say to him: Remember what that dog did to you. So Israel sinned at Rephidim and said, 'Is the Lord in our midst?' Immediately the dog came and bit them—this was Amalek." The parable allows the offense to be recalled through its consequence. Rav Tzadok develops why this form of remembrance is appropriate to a subtle inward failure.

שֶׁבַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן **on the fourteenth of Adar Rishon;** וּמְנָא לֵיהּ לְמֵיסַר הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית. **so from where does he derive to forbid eulogy and fasting?** גַּם יִקְשֶׁה לְשׁוֹן אֵין בֵּין וְכוּלֵי **Also the wording "there is no difference..." is difficult** עַל אִיסּוּר הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **regarding the prohibition of eulogy and fasting** שֶׁשָּׁוִין בּוֹ **in which they are the same,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁכָּל הַמִּצְוֹת הַמְפוֹרָשׁוֹת בַּמְּגִילָּה אֵינָם נוֹהֲגוֹת **since all the mitzvos explicitly stated in the Megillah do not apply** בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן **on the fourteenth of Adar Rishon;** וְאֵיךְ שַׁיָּיךְ לוֹמַר אֵין בֵּין וְכוּלֵי **so how can one say "there is no difference..."** עַל אִיסּוּר הֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **about the prohibition of eulogy and fasting,** שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְפוֹרָשׁ כְּלָל בַּמְּגִילָּה. **which is not stated explicitly in the Megillah at all?** אֲמְנָם הַטַּעַם **Now the reason** דְּמִסְּמָךְ הוּא אוֹ מִטַּעַם **is either because of the reason** שֶׁאֵין נוֹהֲגוֹת אֶלָּא בַּשֵּׁנִי **that they apply only in the second** גְּאוּלָּה לִגְאוּלָּה עָדִיף [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כט] אוֹ מִדִּכְתִיב **that juxtaposing redemption to redemption is preferable,** לְקַיֵּים **or because it is written (Esther 9:29), "to establish** אֶת אִגֶּרֶת הַפּוּרִים הַזֹּאת הַשֵּׁנִית **this second letter of Purim,"** וְהַיְינוּ בַּאֲדָר הַשֵּׁנִי **meaning in Adar Sheni,** [מְגִילָּה ו, ב] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **as they said in the Gemara (Megillah 6b);** וְכֵן כָּתַב בְּתַרְגּוּם שֵׁנִי **and so wrote the Targum Sheni** עַל פָּסוּק זֶה **on this pasuk:** דְּאִין הֲוֵי שַׁתָּא עִיבּוּרָא **If the year is a leap year,** לָא יִקְרוֹן מְגִילְּתָא **they shall not read the Megillah** וכוּלֵי[725] בַּאֲדָר קַדְמָאָה. **in the first Adar....** וְהִנֵּה בְּכָל הַמְּגִילָּה **Now throughout the Megillah** כְּתִיב לְשׁוֹן עֲשִׂיָּה **the language of "doing" is written:** עוֹשִׂים אֶת יוֹם וְגוֹמֵר [אֶסְתֵּר שָׁם יט] **"they make the day..." (Esther ibid. 19);** לְקַיֵּים עֲלֵיהֶם לִהְיוֹת עוֹשִׂים **"to establish upon them that they make** אֶת יוֹם וְגוֹמֵר [שָׁם, כא] **the day..." (ibid. 21);** לַעֲשׂוֹת אוֹתָם יְמֵי מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **"to make them days of feasting and rejoicing** וּמִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת וְגוֹמֵר **and sending portions...** [שָׁם, כב] וּמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **and gifts to the poor" (ibid. 22);** וְכֵן קִיְּמוּ וְקִבְּלוּ וְגוֹמֵר **and likewise, "they established and accepted...** לִהְיוֹת עוֹשִׂים אֶת שְׁנֵי הַיָּמִים וְגוֹמֵר [שָׁם, כז]. **to make these two days...." (ibid. 27).** וְעַל זֶה כָּתוּב **And regarding this it is written,** לְקַיֵּים בְּמַעֲשֶׂה קְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָּה אֵת אִגֶּרֶת הַפּוּרִים הַזֹּאת הַשֵּׁנִית **"to establish this second letter of Purim":** שֶׁלְּקַיֵּים **that to fulfill in deed the reading of the Megillah,** וּמִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת וּמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **sending portions and gifts to the poor,** תִּקְנוּ רַק בַּאֲדָר הַשֵּׁנִי **they instituted only in Adar Sheni** בְּשָׁנָה הָעִיבּוּר **in a leap year;** וְעַל זֶה שַׁיָּיךְ טַעַם **and to this the reason applies** מִסְּמָךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִגְאוּלָּה עָדִיף **that juxtaposing redemption to redemption is preferable,** לְעִנְיַן הַתַּקָּנָה בְּמַעֲשֶׂה. **with regard to the enactment in deed.** וּמִקְרָא מְגִילָּה וּמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **Reading the Megillah and gifts to the poor** הוּא בְּמַעֲשֶׂה הִתְגַּלּוּת הַנֵּס שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה **are in deed, the revelation of the miracle that was performed for our forefathers at this season,** לַאֲבוֹתֵינוּ בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה וְזֶהוּ נוֹהֵג רַק בַּשֵּׁנִי. **and this applies only in the second.** אֲבָל שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַמִּצְוֹת בַּלֵּב **But the root of the mitzvos in the heart —** כֵּיוָן שֶׁשְּׁנֵיהֶם **since both of them** וּכְשֶׁבָּא הַזְּמַן הַזֶּה בַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן **and when this season comes in Adar Rishon** בְּשֵׁם חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר נִקְרְאוּ **are called by the name "the month of Adar,"** גַּם כֵּן זְמַן מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **it too is a time of the eradication of Amalek** בְּחִינַת מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה וְטוֹב לֵב **the aspect of feasting and rejoicing** מַרְגִּישׁ הָאָדָם בַּלֵּב **— a person feels in the heart** שֶׁיְּכוֹלִים לְתַקֵּן הַלֵּב כְּסִיל לְשְׂמֹאלוֹ **that they can rectify "the heart of the fool, at his left,"** שֶׁזֶּהוּ עִיקַּר מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **for this is the essence of the eradication of Amalek,** כְּמוֹ יִצְרָא בִישָׁא **the evil inclination,** שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מֵהַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. **as we cited from the holy Zohar.** וּמִמֵּילָא נֶאֱסָר בְּהֶסְפֵּד וְתַעֲנִית **Consequently it is forbidden in eulogy and fasting,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהוּא זְמַן מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה בַּלֵּב **since it is a time of feasting and rejoicing in the heart;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן **that is, it too is** זְמַן הִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **a time of the revelation of the light of Torah she'b'al peh.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] **Of this it says (Esther 8:16),** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light,"** וְדָרְשׁוּ (מְגִילָּה טז, ב) זוֹ תּוֹרָה **and they expounded (Megillah 16b): this is Torah,** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה דִּמְקַבָּלָא שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **meaning Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת אוֹרָה לְשׁוֹן נְקֵיבָה **which is called orah, in the feminine,** מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **since it receives from the Written Torah,** תּוֹרָה אוֹר **"Torah is light"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים). **(as explained many times).** וְעַל יְדֵי הָרוֹב חָכְמָה **And through the abundance of wisdom** זוֹכִין לְתַקֵּן הָרוֹב כַּעַס **one merits to rectify the abundance of anger,** וְהַיְינוּ לַעֲקוֹר וּלְשָׁרֵשׁ אֶת הָרָע **that is, to uproot and extirpate**

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[725] Parallel: **R. Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Tanya, Likkutei Amarim, ch. 26, concluding paragraphs** — "If sadness and anxiety about spiritual matters fall upon a person in the midst of his business, this is recognizably a device of the inclination, intended to cast him afterward into desires. Even concern about grave sins requires appointed times and a fitting occasion, with a settled mind, to contemplate the greatness of Hashem against whom he sinned and attain true contrition. Immediately after his heart has been broken at those appointed times, he should remove sadness completely and believe fully that Hashem has removed his sin and abundantly forgives."

Connection: This distinguishes repentance from the disabling sadness that can imitate it. Rav Tzadok's indirect reminder of the sin prevents the recollection itself from strengthening Amalek; Tanya supplies the practical distinction between such intrusive guilt and deliberate, restorative repentance.

the evil מִלֵּב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ **from "the heart of the fool, at his left,"** וְלִהְיוֹת לוֹ רַק לֵב אֶחָד לֵב טוֹב **and to have only one heart, a good heart;** וּמַרְגִּישׁ **"and one of good heart has a constant feast,"** וְטוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **and he feels the joy in the heart** שֶׁכָּל מַה שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹשֶׂה **that all that the Holy One, blessed is He, does** הוּא לְטוֹבָה **is for the good,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיַּכִּירוּ לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **just as they will recognize in the World to Come** דְּכוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב. **that it is all "Who is good and does good."** [אֶסְתֵּר ט, טז] שֶׁעַל זֶה נִזְכַּר בַּמְּגִילָּה **For regarding this the Megillah mentions (Esther 9:16)** וְנוֹחַ וְגוֹמֵר **"and they rested...,"** כַּיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר נָחוּ בָהֶם **"as the days on which the Jews rested** מֵאוֹיְבֵיהֶם **from their enemies":** וְהֵינוּ הַנִּיָּחָא בַּלֵּב **meaning the rest in the heart,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **in the manner they said in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק א מח, ב) **(I 48b and elsewhere)** וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) עַל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **about the day of Shabbos:** בְּיוֹם הָנִיחַ ה׳ לְךָ וְגוֹמֵר **"On the day Hashem gives you rest...** [יְשַׁעְיָה יד, ג] וּמִן הָעֲבוֹדָה הַקָּשָׁה **and from the hard labor" (Yeshayah 14:3)** — שֶׁהוּא דְּאַף כְּשֶׁהוּא בָּעֲבוֹדָה הַקָּשָׁה **that even when he is in hard labor** יֵשׁ[726] לוֹ נַיְחָא בַּלֵּב **he has rest in the heart,** וְהֵינוּ עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמַּכִּיר **that is, through recognizing** שֶׁהַכֹּל לְטוֹבָה. **that everything is for the good.** וְכֵן הִכִּירוּ אָז **So too they recognized then** שֶׁהַגְּזֵרָה הָיְתָה לְטוֹבָה **that the decree was for the good,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְכֵן מִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת אִישׁ לְרֵעֵהוּ **So too "sending portions one to another"** שֶׁהוּא לְהָיוֹת הַכֹּל **is so that all should be** כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד.[727] **as one man with one heart.** וּלְקַיֵּם בְּמַעֲשֶׂה **To fulfill it in deed** תִּקְנוּ רַק בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר **but in the heart one must,** אַף אֲבָל בַּלֵּב צָרִיךְ **they instituted only on the fourteenth of Adar Sheni,** הַשֵּׁנִי **even in Adar Rishon,** בַּאֲדָר הָרִאשׁוֹן **so that all of Yisrael be unite the hearts,** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל לְיַחֵד הַלְּבָבוֹת **as one man with one heart,** כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד **and through this one merits** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זוֹכִין **the revelation of the light of Torah.** לְהִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר תּוֹרָה. **As at the Giving of the Torah,** [יִתְרוֹ] דְּאִיתָא בַּמְּכִילְתָּא **as found in the Mechilta (Yisro, Parashas BaChodesh 1):** [פָּרָשַׁת בַּחֹדֶשׁ א] **"And Yisrael encamped"** — [שְׁמוֹת יט, ב] וַיִּחַן יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד **as one man (Shemos 19:2)** בְּלֵב אֶחָד **with one heart;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכוּ לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה[728] **and through this they merited the Giving of the Torah.** [זְכַרְיָה ח, יט] וּכְתִיב **And it is written (Zechariah 8:19),** מְבַקֵּשׁ **"Love truth and peace":** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד **for through each one** וְהָאֱמֶת וְהַשָּׁלוֹם אֲהֵבוּ **seeking the word of truth** דְּבַר אֱמֶת **they become as one man with one heart,** נַעֲשִׂים כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד וְנַעֲשָׂה **and peace is made,** שָׁלוֹם **and they love one another.** וְאוֹהֲבִים זֶה אֶת זֶה **And this applies in the heart** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן זְמַן הִתְגַּלּוּת **which is also a time of the revelation** אַף בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן **even on the fourteenth of Adar Rishon,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **of Torah she'b'al peh, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה הַטַּעַם **This is the reason** דְּלֹא נִזְכַּר בַּמִּשְׁנָה **that the Mishnah mentions** רַק קְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָּה וּמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **only the reading of the Megillah and gifts to the poor,** וְלֹא נִזְכַּר בַּמִּשְׁנָה מִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת **and the Mishnah does not mention sending portions** שֶׁנּוֹהֵג רַק בַּשֵּׁנִי. **as applying only in the second.** וְהָרַ״ן לֹא כָּתַב טַעַם עַל זֶה **The Ran did not write a reason for this,** וְכָתַב דְּכֵיוָן דְּדָמוּ לְמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **and wrote that since they resemble gifts to the poor,** דְּלֵיתָנְיהוּ אֶלָּא בַּשֵּׁנִי **which apply only in the second,** לֹא נָהוּג מִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת **sending portions is not practiced** אֶלָּא בַּשֵּׁנִי. **except in the second.** וּלְפִי זֶה לָמָּה לֹא חָשְׁבוּ בַּמִּשְׁנָה. **But according to this, why did they not list it in the Mishnah?** וּלְפִי הָאָמוּר **According to what we have said,** מַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **gifts to the poor,** שֶׁהוּא רַק צְדָקָה בְּמַעֲשֶׂה **which are only charity in deed,** זֶה הוּא רַק בַּשֵּׁנִי **apply only in the second;** אֲבָל מִשְׁלוֹחַ

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[726] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 44:8** — "Rabbi Phinehas says: After forty years Moses wished to remind Israel: Do you remember saying in this wilderness, 'Is the Lord in our midst or not?' But Moses said: If I say this to them, I will expose their shame; and one who exposes another person's shame has no share in the world to come. Rather, I will tell them the episode of Amalek, and they will understand what is written before it." The retrieved wording is "expose their faces," where the manuscript cites "whiten their faces." The source's concern is the public shame caused by direct accusation.

[727] **Sukkah 5a:1–4** — "Rabbi Yose says: The Divine Presence never descended below, and Moses and Elijah never ascended to the height, as it is said, 'The heavens are the Lord's heavens, but the earth He gave to human beings.' ... Is it not written, 'Moses ascended to God'? Below ten handbreadths. Is it not written, 'Elijah ascended in the storm to heaven'? Below ten handbreadths. ... Nevertheless, does it not say, 'He holds the face of the throne'? The throne extended downward to ten, and he took hold of it." The Talmud discusses the boundary between the heavenly and earthly domains. Rav Tzadok applies that boundary to the limit of attainable spiritual apprehension.

[728] **Zohar I 27a, Bereshit 24:3** — "With regard to the holy limbs of the body, which are from the side of good, it is said, 'They came to Marah and could not drink water from Marah.' In this manner the masters of the Mishnah said: 'They embittered their lives with hard labor'—with a difficulty; 'with mortar'—with an a-fortiori inference; 'with bricks'—with clarification of the law; 'with every labor in the field'—this is baraita; 'all their labor'—this is Mishnah." The terms of Egyptian labor are read as forms of effort in Oral Torah. Rav Tzadok uses this original wordplay to explain another mode of overcoming Amalek.

מָנוֹת **but sending portions,** שֶׁעִיקָּרוֹ הַמְּכוּוָּן **whose essential intent** לִהְיוֹת כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד **is to be as one man with one heart —** וְהַמְּכוּוָּן נוֹהֵג **its intent applies** אַף בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן **even on the fourteenth of Adar Rishon:** לִהְיוֹת כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל חֲבֵרִים[729] **that all of Yisrael be companions** בְּלֵב אֶחָד. **with one heart.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **And through this "the Jews had light":** זוֹ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא מִשְׁתֶּה דְּרוֹמֵז בְּיֵין מָסָכְתִּי תָּמִיד **which is the "constant feast,"** שְׁתוּ בְּיֵין מָסָכְתִּי. **alluding to "drink of the wine I have mixed."** וְשִׂמְחָה שֶׁיַּרְגִּישׁ וְיַשִּׂיג הָאוֹר **And "gladness" — that he feel and perceive the light,** ה' אֶחָד וְהַכֹּל לְטוֹבָה **"Hashem is One," and all is for the good.** וְזֶהוּ וְטוֹב לֵב **This is "and one of good heart":** שֶׁלִּבּוֹ טוֹב **that his heart is good** וְאֵין לוֹ רַק לֵב אֶחָד טוֹב **and he has only one good heart —** מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **"has a constant feast,"** שֶׁמַּרְגִּישׁ הַיְחוּד ה' אֶחָד **for he feels the Unity, "Hashem is One,"** שֶׁכּוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב. **that it is all "Who is good and does good."** וּבְשַׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא מֵעֵין עוֹלָם הַבָּא **And on Shabbos, which is a semblance of the World to Come** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת נז, ב) **(as stated in Berachos 57b),** אַף כְּשֶׁהוּא מַרְגִּישׁ[730] כָּל אָדָם הַנִּיְחָא **every person feels the rest even when he is in hard labor,** בָּעֲבוֹדָה הַקָּשָׁה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ מֵהַזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. **as we said from the holy Zohar.** וְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים דְּדָמְיָין לְשַׁבָּתוֹת **And talmidei chachamim, who resemble Shabbosos,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג קכד, ב) **(III 124b),** שֶׁזּוֹכִין תָּמִיד **who constantly merit** לְהִתְגַּלּוּת אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the revelation of the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** יְכוֹלִים לְהַשִּׂיג תָּמִיד הַיְחוּד **can constantly perceive the Unity,** שֶׁכּוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב **that it is all "Who is good and does good,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהֶרְאָה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא. **as Rabbi Akiva showed.** וְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **And every Jew,** בְּשָׁעַת קְרִיאַת שְׁמַע וּכְשֶׁמַּנִּיחַ תְּפִילִּין **at the time of Krias Shema and when he puts on tefillin,** יוּכַל לְהַשִּׂיג הַיְחוּד לְפִי שָׁעָה **can perceive the Unity for the moment,** ה' אֶחָד **"Hashem is One,"** שֶׁכּוּלּוֹ הַטּוֹב וְהַמֵּטִיב. **that it is all "Who is good and does good."** וּבְיוֹם זֶה שֶׁהוּא זְמַן מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **And on this day, which is the time of the eradication of Amalek,** וְיכוֹלִים לְבַעֵר הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל **when they can eradicate the evil from the heart of the fool** וְלִהְיוֹת אַךְ לֵב טוֹב **and have only a good heart,** יְכוֹלִים לְהַרְגִּישׁ הַיְחוּד **they can feel the Unity** וְהַשִּׂמְחָה בַּלֵּב. **and the joy in the heart.** וּבָזֶה שָׁוִין **In this they are equal,** לְאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר הַשֵּׁנִי **the fourteenth of Adar Rishon and the fourteenth of Adar Sheni,** וְזֶה שֶׁסַּיִּים הָרַמ"א עַל זֶה: וְטוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד. **and this is why the Rema concluded on this: "And one of good heart has a constant feast."**

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[729] **Shemot Rabbah 26:1** — "'I was not at ease'—from the first decree Pharaoh decreed against me: 'They embittered their lives'; the Holy One raised up a redeemer—Miriam, named for the bitterness. 'I was not quiet'—from the second decree, 'If it is a son, kill him'; the Holy One raised up a redeemer—Aaron, named for pregnancy. 'I did not rest'—from the third decree, 'Every son who is born, cast into the river'; the Holy One raised up a redeemer named for the water—Moses, as it is said, 'For from the water I drew him.' 'And agitation came'—this is Amalek." The three decrees and three redeemers are explicitly paired in the Midrash; their correspondence to three crowns is Rav Tzadok's next interpretive step.

[730] **Sotah 11b:22** — "'Because the midwives feared God, He made houses for them.' Rav and Samuel: one said, houses of priesthood and Levite service; the other said, royal houses. According to the one who says houses of priesthood and Levite service: Aaron and Moses. According to the one who says royal houses: David too descended from Miriam, as it is written, 'Azubah died, and Caleb took Ephrath, and she bore him Hur'; and it is written, 'David was the son of that Ephrathite man.'" The teaching establishes Miriam's place in the ancestry of kingship, supporting the third crown in Rav Tzadok's sequence.

לְאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר אֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן, מַאֲמָר ב׳ For the Fourteenth of Adar Rishon — Maamar Bais

יֵשׁ **In the Shulchan Aruch at the end of Orach Chaim** [סִימָן תרצז] **(siman 697):** בַּשֻּׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ בְּסוֹף אוֹרַח חַיִּים אוֹמְרִים שֶׁחַיָּיב לְהַרְבּוֹת **Some say that one is obligated to increase** בְּמִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **in feasting and rejoicing** וְאֵין נוֹהֲגִין כֵּן **but the practice is not so;** וּמִכָּל **on the fourteenth of Adar Rishon,** בְּאַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר שֶׁבַּאֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן מָקוֹם יֵרָבֶּה קְצָת בִּסְעוּדָה וְכוּ׳ **nevertheless one should increase somewhat in the meal...** וְטוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **"and one of good heart has a constant feast."** וּבְסֵפֶר בִּרְכֵי יוֹסֵף [סְעִיף קָטָן ב] **And in the sefer Birkei Yosef** (se'if katan 2), נִתְעוֹרֵר שֶׁהָרַמָ״א הוּבָא בְּשַׁעֲרֵי תְּשׁוּבָה [סְעִיף קָטָן ב] **cited in the Shaarei Teshuvah (se'if katan 2),** זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה פָּתַח בְּרֵישׁ הַגָּהָה[731] **he noted that the Rema, of blessed memory, opened at the head of his glosses** [אוֹרַח חַיִּים סִימָן א סְעִיף א] **(Orach Chaim, siman 1, se'if 1)** שִׁוִּיתִי וְגוֹמֵר תָּמִיד **with "I have set... always,"** וְחָתַם וְטוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד[732] **and sealed with "and one of good heart has a constant feast,"** וְכָתַב רֶמְז עַל זֶה. **and he wrote an allusion on this.** הָעִנְיָן דְּאוֹרַח חַיִּים **The matter is that "Orach Chaim," the path of life,** הַיְינוּ הַדֶּרֶךְ לִקְנוֹת חַיֵּי עוֹלָם **means the way to acquire eternal life,** שֶׁכְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ **for we have already said** שֶׁבְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְשׁוֹן חַיִּים מוֹרֶה עַל חַיֵּי עוֹלָם **that in the words of Torah the term "life" denotes eternal life;** וּבֶאֱמֶת כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לוֹ עוֹלָם בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ **and in truth every Jew has a world of his own,** דְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם חֵלֶק לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא [סַנְהֶדְרִין צ, א] **for "all of Yisrael have a share in the World to Come" (Sanhedrin 90a);** וְהַשֻּׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ אוֹרַח חַיִּים הַדֶּרֶךְ לִזְכּוֹת לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם הוּא. **and the Shulchan Aruch Orach Chaim is the way to merit eternal life.** שֶׁכֵּן נִקְרָא הַמִּיתָה כְּשֵׁינָה **For thus death is called like sleep,** וְיָקִיצוּ אַחַר כָּךְ **and afterward they will awaken,** כָּרָגִיל בִּלְשׁוֹן חֲזַ״ל כַּד דְּמַךְ. **as is usual in the language of Chazal: "when he slept."** וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ (סוֹטָה כא, א) **And so it is expounded (Sotah 21a):** וַהֲקִיצוֹתָ הִיא תְּשִׂיחֶךָ[733] [מִשְׁלֵי ו, כב] **"And when you awaken, it will converse with you" (Mishlei 6:22) —** לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא **in the time to come;** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה יוּעִיל **that through words of Torah it will help,** שֶׁמֵּכֵיוָן שֶׁיִּסְבּוֹל רַק כְּרֶגַע צַעַר הַמִּיתָה **that since he will suffer only for a moment** מִפְּנֵי פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **the pain of death because of the blemish of the serpent,** אָז יִזְכֶּה תֵּיכֶף לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם **he will then immediately merit eternal life,** וְיִהְיֶה רַק כְּהוֹלֵךְ לִישׁוֹן וּמֵקִיץ מִשְׁנָתוֹ.[734] **and it will be only like one who goes to sleep and awakens from his sleep.** וּפָתַח בַּשֻּׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ [סִימָן א סְעִיף א] **The Shulchan Aruch (siman 1, se'if 1) opens with** שֶׁהָעִיקָּר לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **"One should strengthen himself like a lion...," for the main thing is to overcome the yetzer hara** יִתְגַּבֵּר כַּאֲרִי וְכוּ׳ לַעֲמוֹד בַּבּוֹקֶר לַעֲבוֹדַת בּוֹרְאוֹ **to rise in the morning for the service of his Creator;** וְהוּא כְּעֵין מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת טז, ב) **and this resembles what they said (Berachos 16b):**

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[731] **Yalkut Shimoni on Torah 763:18** — "When this rock was small, you struck it, as it is said, 'Strike the rock.' But now, 'Speak to the rock': recite one chapter over it, and it will bring out water from the rock." The parable compares the change from striking to speaking with the education of a child as he grows. The passage is numbered 763:18 in the retrieved Yalkut, rather than 764.

[732] **Shaar HaPesukim, Shemot, opening exposition and paragraph 47** — "All those spirits ... were lofty, holy souls from the aspect of knowledge, which became mixed among the husks and required many reincarnations to refine and whiten them until their contamination was ended. ... The beginning of their reincarnation was in the generation of the Flood. ... Afterward they reincarnated a second time in the generation of the dispersion. ... Afterward they reincarnated a third time among the people of Sodom. ... Although the wilderness generation had been repaired and the good separated from the evil, their original contamination had not wholly ceased until they stood at Mount Sinai. ... Even though they had received their punishment in the exile of Egypt, they needed actively to return and fulfill those commandments they had transgressed." This verifies the three generations and their Egyptian purification. The same work separately marks a speculative reconstruction with "I am uncertain"; that qualification is retained in the full provenance rather than being turned into an unqualified statement by the Ari.

[733] **Zohar III 216b, Pinchas 10:16** — "Furthermore, the rabbis established another mystery: the generation that goes is the generation that comes. If one departed lame, one came lame; if one departed blind, one came blind. The rabbis further established that Moses was destined to receive the Torah in the generation of the Flood, but because they were wicked, this is what is written: 'For he too is flesh'—be-shagam is Moses. Why is he called be-shagam? ... Kohelet removed the bet from be-shagam to conceal the matter: 'I said that this too is vanity.'" The equivalence of be-shagam and Moshe is numerical. Chullin 139b likewise asks "Where is Moses in the Torah?" and answers with this verse.

[734] **Shemot Rabbah 30:13** — "Rabbi Aha said: The Holy One, blessed be He, wished to give them four things—Torah, afflictions, sacrificial service, and prayer—and they did not wish for them. 'They said to God: Depart from us'—these are afflictions. 'We do not desire knowledge of Your ways'—this is Torah. 'What is the Almighty that we should serve Him?'—these are sacrifices. 'What benefit will we have if we entreat Him?'—this is prayer. The Holy One said to them: What caused you to be lost from the evening of this world and the morning of the world to come? Because you did not accept the Torah, which contains justice." The passage specifically discusses the generation of the Flood and its rejection of divine instruction.

וְנַשְׁכִּים וְנִמְצָא יְחוּל לְבָבֵנוּ **"May we rise early and find our hearts longing** לְיִרְאָה אֶת שְׁמֶךָ[735] **to fear Your Name"** — וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּלֹא שׁוּם הֶכָנָה וּפְעוּלּוֹת **meaning that without any preparation or effort** יְהֶיֶה חֶשֶׁק לְבָבֵנוּ **our heart's desire will be** לְיִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם וַעֲבוֹדָתוֹ. **for the fear of Heaven and His service.** רַק הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **But the yetzer hara** יָכוֹל לְהִתְגַּבֵּר אַחַר כָּךְ **can gain strength afterward;** עַל זֶה פָּתַח הָרַמַ"א זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **therefore the Rema, of blessed memory, opened with** [שָׁם] שִׁוִּיתִי ה' לְנֶגְדִּי תָּמִיד **(ibid.) "I have set Hashem before me always":** שֶׁיַּעֲמוֹד תָּמִיד לְנֶגֶד עֵינָיו **that there should always stand before his eyes** פַּחַד ה' **the dread of Hashem,** שֶׁיְצַיֵּיר שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים **that he picture that the King of the kings of kings,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **the Holy One, blessed is He,** עוֹמֵד עָלָיו וְרוֹאֶה בְּמַעֲשָׂיו **stands over him and sees his deeds,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִזְכֶּה לְיִרְאַת ה' **and through this he will merit fear of Hashem** וּבוּשְׁתּוֹ מִמֶּנּוּ תָּמִיד. **and constant shame before Him.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ **Afterward comes the order of the day,** בָּא סֵדֶר הַיּוֹם [סִימָן ח – כד] **with the mitzvos of tzitzis (simanim 8–24),** בְּמִצְוַת צִיצִית [סִימָן כה – מה] **tefillin (simanim 25–45),** וּתְפִילִין [סִימָן נח – פח] **Krias Shema (simanim 58–88)** וּקְרִיאַת שְׁמַע [סִימָן פט – קכז] **and tefillah (simanim 89–127),** וּתְפִלָּה [סִימָן קנז – רלא]. **and the sanctity of foods** וּקְדוּשַׁת הַמַּאֲכָלוֹת **through washing the hands and berachos** עַל יְדֵי נְטִילַת יָדַיִם וּבְרָכוֹת **(simanim 157–231).** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא סֵדֶר זְמַנִּים **Afterward comes the order of the seasons,** [סִימָן רמב – שצה] **and it opens with the laws of Shabbos (simanim 242–395)** וּפָתַח בְּהִלְכוֹת שַׁבָּת [סִימָן תיז – תכח] **and Rosh Chodesh (simanim 417–428),** וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֶׁהֵם שְׁנֵי שָׁרְשֵׁי קְדֻשּׁוֹת הַזְּמַנִּים **which are the two roots of the sanctities of the times;** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה בְּשֵׁשֶׁת יְמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה **for the sanctity of Shabbos serves to bring holiness into the six weekdays,** דִּקְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת מוֹעִיל שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַכֹּל בִּקְדוּשָׁה. **so that everything be in holiness.** וְכֵן רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִקְרָא רֹאשׁ **Likewise Rosh Chodesh is called "head"** שֶׁהוּא הָרֹאשׁ שֶׁל כָּל הַחֹדֶשׁ **for it is the head of the entire month,** וְלֹא רִאשׁוֹן דְּחֹדֶשׁ **and not "first" of the month,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֵירוּבִין מא, א) דְּבָתַר רֵישָׁא גּוּפָא אָזֵיל[736] **for "the body follows the head" (as stated in Eruvin 41a);** שֶׁבְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ כָּלוּל **so in Rosh Chodesh are contained** כָּל הַקְּדוּשׁוֹת שֶׁבַּחֹדֶשׁ **all the sanctities of the month,** וּמִמֶּנּוּ מוֹפִיעַ לְכָל יְמֵי הַחֹדֶשׁ.[737] **and from it they radiate to all the days of the month.** וּפָתַח אַחַר כָּךְ בַּמּוֹעֲדִים בְּפֶסַח **Afterward it opens the festivals with Pesach,** שֶׁבַּחֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן רִאשׁוֹן לְחָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה **for in the month of Nissan, first of the months of the year** [סִימָן תכט – תצא] **(simanim 429–491),** שֶׁאָז זָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **Yisrael then merited all the light,** בְּמַכַּת בְּכוֹרוֹת **at the plague of the firstborn,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **and afterward at the splitting of the Yam Suf;** רַק דְּאַחַר כָּךְ נִסְתַּר הָאוֹר מֵהֶם **only that afterward the light was hidden from them,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ שָׁבוּעוֹת **and afterward Shavuos,** [סִימָן תצד] זְמַן מַתַּן תּוֹרָתֵנוּ **the time of the giving of our Torah (siman 494),** דִּכְתִיב [תְּהִלִּים פב, ו] **as it is written (Tehillim 82:6),** אֲנִי אָמַרְתִּי אֱלֹהִים אַתֶּם **"I said: You are godly beings"** — רַק דְּאִירַע הַקִּלְקוּל. **only that the corruption occurred.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא הַזְּמַנִּים **Afterward come all the seasons:** [סִימָן תקפא – תרב] רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה **Rosh Hashanah (simanim 581–602)** וְיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים [סִימָן תרד – תרכד] **and Yom HaKippurim (simanim 604–624)** וְסוּכּוֹת זְמַן שִׂמְחָתֵנוּ **and Sukkos, the time of our rejoicing** [סִימָן תרכה – תרסט] **(simanim 625–669),** שֶׁאָז הַזְּמַן לִזְכּוֹת לְכָל הַתִּיקּוּן **which is the time to merit the complete rectification** ([מַאֲמָר לב] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בִּשְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת **(as explained in Shemini Atzeres, maamar 32,** וּבְפָרָשַׁת בְּרֵאשִׁית מַאֲמָר ה) **and in Parashas Bereishis, maamar 5);** וּמְסַיֵּם הַשַּׁלְתָּן עָרוּךְ בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **and**

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[735] **Shemot Rabbah 30:9** — "The measure of the Holy One, blessed be He, is unlike that of flesh and blood. Flesh and blood instructs others to act while doing nothing himself; the Holy One is not so. Rather, what He does, He tells Israel to do and to observe." Rav Tzadok therefore understands Torah as God's own ways, not merely as instructions detached from the divine conduct.

[736] Parallel: **R. Menachem Nachum of Chernobyl, Meor Einayim, Miketz, s.v. Kidivreichem ken hu** — "The generations of Enosh, the Flood, and the Dispersion acted wickedly in a way that reached the highest levels: they separated the world and the Torah from Hashem, so to speak, and the Torah fell into Egypt's forces of impurity. This was heard from the holy teacher R. Dov Ber and is also explained in the Ari's writings. Thus their labor was 'with mortar and bricks': as explained in the Zohar, 'mortar' signifies inference from minor to major and 'bricks' the clarification of halachah. Through their labor in treading mortar they extracted from Egypt's forces of impurity the kal vachomer, one of the thirteen methods by which Torah is expounded; similarly with the bricks."

Connection: Meor Einayim explains the repair enacted by the Zohar's wordplay: the bodily labor releases powers of Torah reasoning held in exile after the earlier generations' damage. This develops Rav Tzadok's association of the Dispersion, Egyptian mortar and bricks, and the clarification of Oral Torah. Meor Einayim's list includes Enosh; Rav Tzadok's threefold arrangement here includes Sodom.

[737] **Sukkah 20a:11** — "When Torah was first forgotten from Israel, Ezra came up from Babylonia and established it. It was forgotten again; Hillel the Babylonian came up and established it. It was forgotten again; Rabbi Hiyya and his sons came up and established it." The recurring Babylonian restoration of Torah supplies Rav Tzadok's historical basis for linking Oral Torah with the place of the dispersion.

the Shulchan Aruch concludes with the month of Adar [סִימָן תרפו – תרצז]. **(simanim 686–697).** שֶׁכְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ מִסֵּפֶר קְדוּשַׁת לֵוִי **We have already said, from the sefer Kedushas Levi** [לְפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל טַעַם] **(on Parashas Shekalim, s.v. Ta'am),** דְּחָשַׁב חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר נֶגֶד שֵׁבֶט יוֹסֵף **that he counted the month of Adar as corresponding to the tribe of Yosef,** וְעַל כֵּן מִתְחַלֵּק בִּשְׁנַת הָעִיבּוּר לִשְׁנַיִם **and therefore it divides in a leap year into two,** נֶגֶד מְנַשֶּׁה וְאֶפְרַיִם. **corresponding to Menasheh and Ephraim.** מְנַשֶּׁה עַל שֵׁם כִּי נַשַּׁנִי וגוֹמֵר [בְּרֵאשִׁית מא, נא] **Menasheh, named for "For God has made me forget..." (Bereishis 41:51),** שֶׁהוּא זְמַן מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **which is the time of the eradication of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **who is the evil inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג קס, א) **(III 160a);** וְאֶפְרַיִם שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ יָצָא יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **and Ephraim, from whom came Yehoshua,** שֶׁהִנְחִיל לְיִשְׂרָאֵל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **who gave Eretz Yisrael to Yisrael as an inheritance,** שֶׁהִיא שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְדוּשַׁת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **which is the root of the holiness of Torah she'b'al peh;** (נְדָרִים כב, ב) וְזֶהוּ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **and this is what they said (Nedarim 22b)** עַל סֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **about the book of Yehoshua,** שֶׁעֶרְכָּהּ שֶׁל אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא **that it is the inventory of Eretz Yisrael;** וְהַיְינוּ דְּשֵׁם מְרוּמָּז **meaning that there is alluded** חֵלֶק כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **the portion of every Jew** בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **in Torah she'b'al peh —** תִּשְׁעָה קַבִּין חָכְמָה **the nine kav of wisdom** שֶׁנָּטְלָה אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל[738] **that Eretz Yisrael took** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב קִידּוּשִׁין מט, ב) **(as stated in Kiddushin 49b);** וְאַחַר כָּךְ יֵצֵא מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף מִזַּרְעוֹ **and afterward Mashiach ben Yosef will come from his seed,** שֶׁהוּא יְתַקֵּן כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **who will rectify all of Yisrael** עַל יְדֵי הִתְגַּלּוּת הָעוֹמֶק שֶׁבְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **through the revelation of the depth within Torah she'b'al peh,** הָרוֹב חָכְמָה שֶׁיְּתַקֵּן הָרוֹב כַּעַס **the abundance of wisdom that will rectify the abundance of anger,** פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **the blemish of the serpent.** וְזֶה שֶׁסִּיֵּם הָרַמָּ"א **And this is why the Rema concluded,** מֵעַיִן הַפְּתִיחָה **in the manner of the opening,** "וְטוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד" **"and one of good heart has a constant feast,"** לְרַמֵּז טוֹב לֵב וְלֹא לֵבָב **to allude: "good of lev," not levav,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה רַק לֵב אֶחָד **meaning that there should be only one heart** לְאָבִיו שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **to his Father in Heaven,** וְיִהְיֶה רַק לֵב טוֹב **and only a good heart;** מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **"has a constant feast" —** דִּבְיַין אִיתָא (יוֹמָא עו, ב) **for regarding wine it states (Yoma 76b):** "זָכָה מְשַׂמְּחוֹ"[739] **if he is worthy, it gladdens him;** שֶׁנִּצְטָרֵךְ זְכוּת לָזֶה **for merit is needed for this,** שֶׁיְּשַׂמַּח לְבַב אֱנוֹשׁ **that it "gladden the heart of man."** וּבְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר הַזְּמַן **And the month of Adar is the time** לְזְכּוֹת לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **to merit the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** [מִשְׁלֵי ט, ה] שֶׁהוּא שְׁתוּ בְיֵינִי מָסָכְתִּי **which is "drink of the wine I have mixed" (Mishlei 9:5),** יֵינָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דְּבַעַל פֶּה **the wine of the Oral Torah** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רעא, ב) **(Zohar III 271b),** וְיִהְיֶה טוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **and he will be "of good heart, a constant feast" —** יֵינָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דְּבַעַל פֶּה. **the wine of the Oral Torah.** שֶׁבַּאֲדָר הֵדַד קַבָּלוּהָ **For in Adar "they accepted it anew** בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **in the days of Achashverosh"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת פח, א) **(as stated in Shabbos 88a),** וְהַיְינוּ לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **meaning Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **as they said in Midrash Tanchuma** (נֹחַ ג עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת) **(Noach 3, see there at length).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (פְּסָחִים סח, ב) **And this is what they said (Pesachim 68b):** דְּמָר בְּרֵיהּ דְּרָבִינָא **Mar the son of Ravina** כּוּלֵּי שַׁתָּא הֲוָה יָתֵיב בְּתַעֲנִיתָא[740] וְכוּלֵּי לְבַר מַעֲצָרְתָא וּפוּרְיָא **would sit fasting the whole year except for Atzeres and Purim...;** וּפֵירְשׁוּ הַתּוֹסָפוֹת **and Tosafos explained** (בְּרָכוֹת מט, ב דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אי) **(Berachos 49b, s.v. Ee)** בְּשֵׁם רַבִּי יִצְחָק קָאָמַר **in the name of the Ri** דְּבַתַּעֲנִית חֲלוֹם.[741] **that it speaks of a dream fast,** אַף דְּבְשַׁבָּת הוּתַּר **even though on Shabbos it is permitted.** וְהַטַּעַם דְּהַתַּעֲנִית חֲלוֹם **The reason is that the dream fast** הוּא לְקָרוֹעַ גְּזַר דִּינוֹ **is to tear up his decree,** וּבְפוּרִים הַמְּשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **and on Purim the feasting and**

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[738] **Pirkei Avot 1:12** — "Hillel says: Be among the disciples of Aaron—loving peace and pursuing peace, loving people and bringing them near to Torah." Aaron's loving and peace-making character supplies the positive counterpart to Sodom's refusal of kindness.

[739] **Mekhilta DeRabbi Yishmael, Bachodesh 7:9** — "Rabbi Isaac says: Do not count in the manner in which others count; rather, count for the sake of Shabbat." The days of the week are numbered in relation to Shabbat. Rav Tzadok reads this habitual naming as preparation of thought and speech before the day arrives.

[740] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 9** — "Rabbi Judah says: 'He encountered you'—he made you impure, as it says, 'who is not pure because of an occurrence at night.' Rabbi Nehemiah says: He actually called you. ... He stood outside the cloud and called to them: Reuben, Shimon, and Levi, come out, for I am your brother and wish to do business with you. When they came out, they killed them." The Midrash records distinct interpretations of the same word. Rav Tzadok develops the interpretation of impurity as an inward attack on thought.

[741] **Mekhilta DeRabbi Yishmael, Amalek 1:2** — "Rabbi Elazar of Modiin says: 'Amalek came'—because Amalek would enter beneath the wings of the cloud, steal souls from Israel, and kill them, as it is said, 'He encountered you on the way and struck all your stragglers behind you, when you were weary and exhausted, and did not fear God.'" The unusual phrase "steal souls" is in the original Mekhilta. Rav Tzadok interprets it as corrupting thought in a way that removes a person from the cloud's protection.

rejoicing מוֹעִיל כְּמוֹ הַתַּעֲנִית **accomplishes like the fast,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאָז הִתְחִיל לִצְמוֹחַ **because then there began to sprout** הִתְרַחֲבוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the expansion of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא יַיִן מָסָכְתִּי **which is "the wine I have mixed,"** יֵינָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דְּבַעַל פֶּה **the wine of the Oral Torah,** מִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לָזֶה[742] **for one who merits it.** וְנִרְמָז וְטוֹב לֵב עַל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **And "good of heart" alludes to words of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (רות רבה ה, טו) **as they expounded (Rus Rabbah 5:15):** [רות ג, ז] וַיִּיטַב לִבּוֹ **"And his heart was merry" (Rus 3:7)** — שֶׁעָסַק בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **that he occupied himself with words of Torah;** (שַׁבָּת סג, ב)[743] וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ **and likewise they expounded (Shabbos 63b):** [קוֹהֶלֶת יא, ט] וִיטִיבְךָ לִבֶּךָ **"And let your heart cheer you" (Koheles 11:9)** — עַד כָּאן לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה[744] **up to here, regarding words of Torah;** (בְּרָכוֹת ה, א) וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and in the manner they said (Berachos 5a):** אֵין טוֹב אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה[745] **"Good" means nothing but Torah,** [מִשְׁלֵי ד, ב] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Mishlei 4:2),** כִּי לֶקַח טוֹב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם **"For I have given you good teaching...,"** וְהֵיינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **meaning the Written Torah;** [תְּהִלִּים קיט, כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר] וְכֵן תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִקְרָא טוֹב **and likewise Torah she'b'al peh is called "good,"** [עב] **as it says (Tehillim 119:72),** טוֹב לִי תוֹרַת פִּיךָ וְגוֹמֵר **"The Torah of Your mouth is good for me...,"** וְזֶה הַחִיּוּב תָּמִיד. **and this is the obligation constantly.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא קמה, ב) **And in the Gemara (Bava Basra 145b):** וְטוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **"and one of good heart has a constant feast"** — זֶה בַּעַל מִשְׁנָה **this is the master of Mishnah;** וְרָבָא אָמַר אִיפְּכָא[746] **and Rava said the reverse,** דְּזֶה בַּעַל גְּמָרָא. **that this is the master of Gemara.** מִשְׁנָה הֵיינוּ הֲלָכוֹת פְּסוּקוֹת **Mishnah means decided halachos,** כְּמוֹ הַשֻּׁלְחָן עָרוּךְ **like the Shulchan Aruch,** וְעַל כֵּן דָּרַשׁ עַל זֶה וְטוֹב לֵב **and therefore he expounded "good of heart" about it,** שֶׁזֶּה הָעִיקָּר בְּהַלִּימּוּד **for this is the main thing in learning,** לִשְׁמוֹר וְלַעֲשׂוֹת **to keep and to do;** (סַנְהֶדְרִין כד, א) וְעַל הַפִּלְפּוּל אָמְרוּ **and of pilpul they said (Sanhedrin 24a):** [אֵיכָה ג, ו] בְּמַחֲשַׁכִּים הוֹשִׁיבַנִי **"He has set me in dark places" (Eichah 3:6)** — זֶה תַּלְמוּדָהּ שֶׁל בָּבֶל. **this is the Talmud of Bavel.** וְרָבָא אָמַר אִיפְּכָא **And Rava said the reverse,** דְּעַל יְדֵי הַפִּלְפּוּל מִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה **for through pilpul, one who merits** מוֹצִיא צִיצִין וּפְרָחִים לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **brings forth buds and blossoms for the words of Torah,** (שַׁבָּת קמה, ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shabbos 145b):** [יְשַׁעְיָה כז, ו] יָצִיץ וּפָרַח יִשְׂרָאֵל **"Yisrael shall bud and blossom" (Yeshayah 27:6)** — אֵלּוּ תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁבְּבָבֶל **these are the talmidei chachamim in Bavel,** שֶׁעוֹשִׂין צִיצִין וּפְרָחִים לַתּוֹרָה **who make buds and blossoms for the Torah;** וְאַדְרַבָּה עַל יְדֵי כֵן **and on the contrary, through this** זוֹכִין לְאוֹר הַגָּנוּז[747] **they merit the hidden light,** לַעֲמֵלֵי תוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **those who toil in**

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[742] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 44:3** — "The pillar of cloud surrounded Israel's camp like a walled city, and no adversary or enemy could reach them. But anyone who needed immersion was expelled by the cloud outside Israel's camp, which was holy; Amalek would strike and kill those behind the cloud." This gives the stated condition under which Amalek could reach those separated from the protected camp.

[743] **Chullin 37b:6** — "'Behold, my soul has not been defiled'—I did not entertain thoughts by day that would bring me to impurity by night. 'I have not eaten carrion or torn flesh from my youth'—I never ate the flesh of an animal hurried to slaughter because it was dying. 'No rejected meat entered my mouth'—I did not eat from an animal concerning which a sage had to issue a ruling." The first interpretation directly links thought by day with the nocturnal impurity used in Rav Tzadok's account.

[744] **Sukkah 52a:10** — "'For he has done greatly'—Abaye said: Against Torah scholars more than against everyone else." The preceding interpretation identifies the passage as the activity of the evil inclination: it set its eyes on the Temples and destroyed them and their scholars. Superior attainment does not remove the need for vigilance.

[745] **Chagigah 16a:15–16** — "Rabbi Judah son of Rabbi Nahmani, the interpreter of Resh Lakish, expounded: What is meant by 'Do not trust a companion; do not rely on an intimate'? If the evil inclination says to you, Sin and the Holy One, blessed be He, will forgive, do not believe it. ... 'Companion' means the evil inclination, as it is said, 'The inclination of the human heart is evil'; and 'intimate' means the Holy One, as it is said, 'You are the intimate of my youth.' If you say, Who testifies against me? The stones and beams of a person's house testify against him." Rav Tzadok explains the temptation as falsely treating divine warnings as threats that will never be acted upon.

[746] **Zohar II 123b, Mishpatim 23:1** — "'In everything I said to you, take care.' What is meant by tishameru? Should it not say tishmoru? Rather, tishameru certainly. What is 'that I said to you'? That is: that I warned you concerning the word of My service. You will be guarded, so that no evil reaches you. You will be guarded through that keeping and protection of Mine alone." The original distinguishes the active command to observe from the passive promise of being protected. Rav Tzadok explains how the warnings themselves awaken the fear that protects.

[747] Parallel: **R. Moshe Chaim Luzzatto, Mesillas Yesharim, ch. 4, discussion of justice and mercy** — "To remove from the hearts of those who wish to be deceived the thought that the blessed Master will not bring small matters into His judgments or reckon with them, the rule is: 'Whoever says that the Holy One overlooks wrongdoing—let his innards be forfeit.' They likewise said: 'If the evil inclination tells you, 'Sin, and the Holy One will forgive you,' do not listen.' … The measure of mercy sustains the world, which could not stand at all without it; nevertheless, the measure of justice is not impaired. … But the measure of mercy grants the opposite of the three things we mentioned: the sinner is given time rather than being cut off immediately when he sins; the punishment itself does not utterly

Torah she'b'al peh, (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Tanchuma, Noach 3)** עַל פָּסוּק הָעָם הַהוֹלְכִים בַּחֹשֶׁךְ **on the pasuk, "The people who walk in darkness** [יְשַׁעְיָה ט, א] רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל **have seen a great light" (Yeshayah 9:1) —** וְעַל כֵּן סִיֵּם הָרַמָּ״א אוֹר שֶׁנִּבְרָא בַּיּוֹם רִאשׁוֹן וְכוּלֵי. **the light that was created on the first day.... Therefore the Rema concluded,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה **"and one of good heart has a constant feast,"** וְטוֹב לֵב מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **that words of Torah should be absorbed in him,** נִבְלָע בּוֹ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **for this is the constant obligation,** שֶׁזֶּה הַחִיּוּב תָּמִיד **as it says (Yehoshua 1:8),** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְהוֹשֻׁעַ א, ח] וְהָגִיתָ בּוֹ יוֹמָם וָלָיְלָה **"and you shall meditate in it day and night";** וְהִתְחִיל הַגָּהוֹתָיו בְּיִרְאַת ה׳ **and he began his glosses with the fear of Hashem,** [תְּהִלִּים קיא, י] **as it is written (Tehillim 111:10),** רֵאשִׁית חָכְמָה יִרְאַת ה׳ **"The beginning of wisdom is the fear of Hashem,"** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן חִיּוּבָהּ תָּמִיד **and this too is an obligation constantly,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שָׁם טז, ח] **as it says (ibid. 16:8),** שִׁוִּיתִי ה׳ לְנֶגְדִּי תָּמִיד: **"I have set Hashem before me always."**

consume him; and repentance is granted to sinners as a complete kindness, so that uprooting the will is reckoned as uprooting the deed. … This is certainly a kindness beyond strict justice, yet it does not wholly contradict justice, since there is a basis upon which it can rest."

Connection: Ramchal specifies what divine mercy actually changes: time, the measure of punishment, and the availability of repentance. This sharpens Rav Tzadok's distinction between warnings that preserve a person through fear and the inclination's false inference that those warnings are empty and may safely be ignored.

רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר שֵׁנִי

Rosh Chodesh Adar Sheni

ראש חדש אדר שני, מאמר א׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar Sheni — Maamar Aleph

In Sefer Yetzirah, He crowned the letter Kuf בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה הִמְלִיךְ אוֹת ק׳ בְּשֵׁינָה וַאֲדָר בְּשָׁנָה **over sleep, and Adar in the year, according to the version of the Geonim,** לְגִירְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים **cited in Sefer Chachmoni** [רַיִּשׁ פֶּרֶק ה]. (בְּרֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ה) **And such is the reading** וְכָךְ הוּא הַגִּירְסָא **(at the beginning of chapter 5) according to the Geonim,** לְהַגְּאוֹנִים **who counted the faculty of sleep as the twelfth faculty** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּזְכָּר רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר מַאֲמָר ח) **(as was mentioned in Rosh Chodesh Adar, ma'amar 8);** דְּחָשַׁב כֹּחַ שֵׁינָה כְּנֶגֶד כֹּחַ הַשְּׂנַיִם עָשָׂר **and according to the version of the Arizal,** וּלְגִרְסַת הָאֲרִ״י ז״ל[749] אוֹת ק׳ בְּשְׂחוֹק **the letter Kuf is over laughter. And certainly both these and those are the words of the living God,** וּבְוַדַּאי אֵלּוּ וָאֵלּוּ דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים **and regarding the version of the Geonim too, has an explanation.** יֵשׁ לוֹ פֵּירוּשׁ. וְגַם גִּירְסַת הַגְּאוֹנִים הָעִנְיָן, **The matter is:** דִּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **for we have already said** [רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר מַאֲמָר ד] **(Rosh Chodesh Adar, ma'amar 4) that of the number one hundred** דְּמִסְפַּר ק׳ אִיתָא **it is brought (Zohar I, 123a):** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קכג, א) **"From the supernal place,** מֵאֲתַר עִלָּאָה **the most hidden of all hidden, through one hundred,** סְתִימָא דְּכָל סְתִימִין בְּמַאָה **in the secret of the hundred blessings, etc.";** בְּרָזָא דְּמַאָה בִּרְכָאן כּוּלֵי; וְאִיתָא **and it is brought (ibid. 132a) that she made of them a crown** דְּעָבְדָה מִנַּיְיהוּ עֲטָרָה וְשַׂוְיָה לֵיהּ בְּרֵישָׁא **and placed it upon the head of the Tzaddik, Life of the Worlds,** דְּצַדִּיק חֵי הָעוֹלָמִים (שָׁם קלב, א) **as it is written (Mishlei 10:6),** דִּכְתִיב [מִשְׁלֵי י, ו] **"Blessings are upon the head of the righteous."** בְּרָכוֹת לְרֹאשׁ צַדִּיק וְהַיְינוּ מִסְפַּר מַאָה מוֹרֶה **That is, the number one hundred indicates** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **"Kesser Elyon is Kesser Malchus"** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּיקּוּנֵי זֹהַר, בְּפֶתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] **Pesach Eliyahu),** כְּשֶׁהִיא כָּלוּל מִכָּל הַמִּדּוֹת **when it is comprised of all the middos,** שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד כָּלוּל מֵעֲשָׂר. וּמִכָּל **each one of them comprised of ten. Nevertheless, it is brought** מָקוֹם אִיתָא **in the holy Zohar (II, 148b)** בְּזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב קמח, ב) דְּאָת קוּף דָּנָחָשׁ **that the letter Kuf is the letter of the serpent, the harlotrous woman,** דְּאָזְלָא בָּתַר רָזָא דְּאֵשֶׁת חַיִל אֵשֶׁת זְנוּנִים **who goes after the secret of the Woman of Valor,** שָׁרוֹצָה לְהִדָּמוֹת לְאוֹת ה׳ **wishing to resemble the letter Hei; and so they wrote (ibid. 152a)** (שָׁם קנב, א) וְכָךְ כָּתְבוּ **that the letter Kuf does not settle at all in its place, etc.,** דְּאוֹת ק׳ לָא מִתְיַישְׁבָא כְּלָל בְּדוּכְתָּא וְכוּלֵי; **and it rules in the place of Gehinnom;** וְשַׁלְטָא בַּאֲתַר דְּגֵיהִנָּם עַיֵּן שָׁם. **see there.** (שַׁבָּת קד, א) **And in the Gemara (Shabbos 104a)** וּבִגְמָרָא אָמְרוּ קו״ף קָדוֹשׁ. **they said: Kuf stands for Kadosh.** **Certainly the letter indicates good:** וּבְוַדַּאי הָאוֹת מוֹרֶה לְטוֹב קוּף קָדוֹשׁ **Kuf for Kadosh in the holy letters of the alef-beis;** בְּאוֹתִיּוֹת אָלֶף בֵּית הַקְּדוֹשִׁים **and so too it is the complete number,** וְכֵן הוּא מִסְפַּר הַשָּׁלֵם **Kesser Elyon is Kesser Malchus,** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **as mentioned above.** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. רַק דְּזֶה **Only, "one opposite the other has God made,"** לְעֻמַּת זֶה עָשָׂה אֱלֹהִים **and in the kelipah there is a "beginning" of the kelipah, and it too is the letter Kuf** וְיֵשׁ בַּקְּלִיפָּה רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן אוֹת ק׳ (וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר מַאֲמָר ג **(as explained in Rosh Chodesh Adar, ma'amar 3;** עַיֵּן שָׁם) **see there),** וְהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקְּלִיפָּה **and it is the root of the kelipah that accuses Klal Yisrael.** לְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יז, ה) וְאָמְרוּ **And they said (Bereishis Rabbah 17:5):** **"The beginning of downfall is sleep:** תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה שֵׁינָה **he dozes off** דְּמִיךְ לֵיהּ וְלָא **and does not toil in Torah, etc.";** [מִשְׁלֵי יט, טו] וְכֵן נֶאֱמַר **and so it is said (Mishlei 19:15),** כּוּלֵי בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא לָעֵי[750]

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[748] **Pirkei DeRabbi Eliezer 44:10** — "Israel said to him: Moses our teacher, one verse says, 'Remember what Amalek did to you,' and another verse says, 'Remember the Shabbat day to sanctify it.' How can both stand? He answered them: A cup of spiced wine is not like a cup of vinegar. This is a cup and that is a cup. This is remembering in order to observe and sanctify the Shabbat day; that is remembering in order to destroy and cut off all the seed of Amalek." The analogy compares identical vessels with opposite contents. Rav Tzadok draws from it the power of fulfilling both commands in simplicity.

[749] **Zohar II 65b, Beshalach 32:18,21–22** — "'Amalek came.' Rabbi Shimon said: A mystery of wisdom is here. This war came from a decree of harsh judgment, and this war existed above and below. ... Moses saw and knew the root of the matter. Moses said: I will prepare myself for that war above, and you, Joshua, prepare yourself for the war below. This is what is written, 'When Moses raised his hand, Israel prevailed'—Israel above. Therefore Moses withdrew from the war below, to exert himself in the war above, so that victory would be achieved through him." The division of labor between Moses and Joshua is explicit, supplying the structure of Rav Tzadok's exposition of two kinds of inward attack.

[750] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 10** — "What would the house of Amalek do? They would cut off Israel's circumcisions and throw them upward, saying: This is what You chose? Here is what You chose." The act is presented as a deliberate taunt against the divine choice expressed by the covenant. Rav Tzadok reads its spiritual meaning as an accusation against Israel's faithfulness.

עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה **"Laziness casts a deep sleep";** (תַּנְחוּמָא בְּשַׁלַּח כה) וְאִיתָא **and it is brought (Tanchuma, Beshalach 25):** אֵין רְפִידִים **"Refidim means nothing other than** אֶלָּא שֶׁרָפוּ יְדֵיהֶם מִן הַתּוֹרָה[751] **that they slackened their hands from the Torah,** וּלְפִיכָךְ עֲמָלֵק בָּא עֲלֵיהֶם. **and therefore Amalek came upon them."** וַעֲמָלֵק הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **And Amalek is the root of the yetzer hara,** (זֹהַר חֻלָּק ג קס, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Zohar III, 160a):** קַטֵּיגוֹרָא שֶׁבְּיִשָּׂא עֲמָלֵק וְגוֹמֵר הוּא יִצְרָא **"'Amalek, etc.' — he is the evil inclination,** מְקַטְרְגָא דְּבַר נָשׁ כּוּלֵּי **the accuser who prosecutes man, etc."** וְהוּא מַשְׁלִיךְ רִיפּוּי יָדַיִם **And he casts slackness of hands** מִן הַתּוֹרָה **away from the Torah —** עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה **"laziness casts a deep sleep";** [דְּבָרִים כה, יח] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Devarim 25:18),** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ **"who happened upon you,"** שֶׁמַּשְׁלִיךְ קְרִירוּת עַל הָאָדָם **for he casts coldness upon a person** וְעַצְלוּת מִלַּעֲמוֹל בַּתּוֹרָה **and laziness against toiling in Torah,** וְזֶה רֵאשִׁית דְּקִלְקָפָּה. **and this is the "beginning" of the kelipah.** וְכֵן יֵשׁ גֵּיהִנֹּם דְּאֵשׁ **Likewise there is a Gehinnom of fire** נֶגֶד הַתַּאֲוָה הַסָּתַת הַנָּחָשׁ **corresponding to desire, the serpent's enticement,** וְנִקְרָא גֵּיהִנֹּם **and it is called Gehinnom** שֶׁהַכֹּל יוֹרֵד לָהּ **because all descend into it** עַל עִסְקֵי הִנֹּם **on account of matters of hinom** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֵירוּבִין יט א **(as stated in Eruvin 19a** וּפֵירוּשׁ רַשִׁ״י**) and Rashi's commentary),** שֶׁהוּא תַּאֲוָה. **which is desire.** וְיֵשׁ גֵּיהִנֹּם שֶׁל שֶׁלֶג **And there is a Gehinnom of snow** נֶגֶד הַקְּרִירוּת שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקְּלִיפָּה[752] **corresponding to coldness, the root of the kelipah,** רֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִם עֲמָלֵק **"the first of nations, Amalek,"** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ וְהִצְנִינְךָ **who "happened upon you" and chilled you;** (תַּנְחוּמָא רְאֵה יג) וְאִיתָא **and it is brought (Tanchuma, Re'eh 13):** וְהֵיכָן מַשְׁלִימִין עֲצָמָן **"And where do they complete their punishment?** בַּשֶּׁלֶג כּוּלֵּי **In the snow, etc.:** [תְּהִלִּים סח, טו] **'It snowed in Tzalmon' (Tehillim 68:15) —** הַשֶּׁלֶג צַלְמָוֶת שֶׁלָּהֶם[753] **the snow is their shadow of death."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And this is what they said in the holy Zohar,** דְּאוֹת קו״ף שֶׁלְּטָא בַּאֲתַר גֵּיהִנֹּם **that the letter Kuf rules in the place of Gehinnom,** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן נֶגֶד **which also corresponds to** הָרֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִם עֲמָלֵק **"the first of nations, Amalek,"** בְּחִינַת קוּף כָּאָמוּר. **the aspect of Kuf, as stated.** וּבִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **And regarding the eradication of Amalek** [דְּבָרִים שָׁם, יט] כְּתִיב **it is written (Devarim ibid. 19),** בְּהָנִיחַ וְגוֹמֵר **"When He gives rest, etc.** מִכָּל אוֹיְבֶיךָ מִסָּבִיב **from all your enemies round about";** וְהַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁיִּזָּכֶה לְתַקֵּן **that is, when one merits to rectify** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **the root of the yetzer hara,** וְיִהְיֶה נַיָּחָא **and there will be rest** מִכָּל קְטָרוּגֵי הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **from all the accusations of the yetzer hara,** שֶׁהוּא סָתָם אוֹיֵב **who is "the enemy" without qualification,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה נד, א) **as is expounded (Bereishis Rabbah 54:1):** גַּם אוֹיְבָיו יַשְׁלֵם אִתּוֹ **"'Even his enemies He makes at peace with him'** [מִשְׁלֵי טז, ז] **(Mishlei 16:7) —** זֶה יֵצֶר הָרָע. **this is the yetzer hara."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים[754] מֹרֵנוּ רַבִּי בּוּנִם **And as is said in the name of our master Rebbe Bunim,** זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה **may**

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[751] **Zohar II 194b–195a, Vayakhel 1:1–4** — "Amalek's war was on every side, above and below, for at that time the evil serpent grew strong above and below. Just as the evil serpent lies in wait at a crossroads, so Amalek was an evil serpent toward Israel, lying in wait for them at a crossroads. ... He lay in wait above to defile the sanctuary, and lay in wait below to defile Israel. ... Had Moses not strengthened himself above and Joshua below, Israel could not have withstood him. Therefore the Holy One, blessed be He, preserves that hostility from generation to generation. Why? Because he intended to uproot the covenant from its place." The original passage explicitly names the covenant as the object of the attack. The discussion continues across the folio boundary.

[752] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 10; compare Pesikta Rabbati 12** — "Rabbi Yohanan said: All the princes of the tribes stand to contend with Esau's prince, but he does not fall into their hands, because he answers each of them. To Reuben he says: You were suspected concerning your father's concubine. To Shimon and Levi: You killed Shechem. To the other tribes: You sold your brother and sought to kill him. To Judah: You were suspected concerning Tamar your daughter-in-law. To Benjamin: You were suspected concerning the concubine at Gibeah. When [Joseph's] prince comes to contend with him, he immediately falls before him, because he has no answer to give him: 'The house of Jacob shall be fire, the house of Joseph flame, and the house of Esau straw.'" The received digital wording has "Esau's prince" at the second encounter, although the argument and the quoted verse require Joseph's prince. This apparent textual slip is flagged rather than hidden; the parallel Pesikta Rabbati 12 explicitly reads Joseph's prince.

[753] **Mikdash Melekh on Zohar, II, 65a:1** — "'Which is called a dog': note that the middle letters of 'ox' and 'donkey'—the vav of shor and the mem-vav of chamor—have the numerical value of kelev, 'dog.' Or Yisrael writes that they are called choshekh, 'darkness': chamor, shor, kelev—donkey, ox, dog." This unsigned gloss independently verifies the letter calculation and explicitly names Or Yisrael for the acronym. It does not identify R. Chaim Vital as its author. Mikdash Melekh on Zohar I 193a quotes the same calculation in the name of the RaMaZ, R. Moshe Zacut: "Donkey, ox, dog—the dog emerges from between the ox and the donkey, whose inner letters, vav and mem-vav, equal kelev." The Mikdash Melekh marks this as a marginal note (נ״ב) without naming its author. The Matok MiDvash page for this daf does not print the gloss, and no source located names R. Chaim Vital as its author.

[754] **Zohar III 236a, Pinchas 71:2** — "'Moses took the bones of Joseph with him'—the bones of the Righteous One, the foundation of the worlds, the degree of Joseph the righteous. Concerning them it is said, 'My offering, My bread for

the memory of the holy tzaddik be a blessing, דְּפְשַׁט הַכָּתוּב [דְּבָרִים כא, י] **that the plain sense of the verse (Devarim 21:10)** הוּא עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **"When you go out to war against your enemies"** כִּי תֵצֵא לַמִּלְחָמָה עַל אוֹיְבֶיךָ **is about the yetzer hara,** וְאֵין זֶה דֶּרֶךְ רֶמֶז.[755] **and this is not merely by way of hint.** וּבֶאֱמֶת הַכֹּל אֶחָד **In truth it is all one,** וְתָלוּי זֶה בָּזֶה **and each depends on the other,** כִּי כָּל שְׁלִיטַת הָאוֹיְבִים **for all the dominion of the enemies** הוּא עַל יְדֵי יֵצֶר הָרָע **comes through the yetzer hara;** וּבְהָנִיחַ ה׳ מִכָּל אוֹיְבֶיךָ **and when Hashem gives rest "from all your enemies,"** מִכָּל קִטְרוּגֵי יֵצֶר הָרָע **from all the accusations of the yetzer hara,** מִמֵּילָא וְהָיָה **then as a matter of course "the house of Esav shall be** לְקַשׁ וְגוֹמֵר [עובדיה א, יח]. **straw, etc." (Ovadiah 1:18).** וְהִנֵּה בְּמַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן בְּרֵאשִׁית **Now in the first utterance, "In the beginning,"** הוּזְכַּר חֹשֶׁךְ תֹּוהוּ וָבֹהוּ **darkness, tohu and vohu are mentioned,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל מַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים **which alludes to the deeds of the wicked;** דְּהַחֹשֶׁךְ הַיְינוּ **the darkness is** לֵיל מוֹצָאֵי שַׁבַּת קֹדֶשׁ **the night following the holy Shabbos,** שֶׁהָיָה הַחֹשֶׁךְ **when there was the darkness,** וְלַחֹשֶׁךְ קָרָא **and afterward by day, "Let there be light";** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בַּיּוֹם יְהִי אוֹר **And it is brought (Eruvin 65a):** וְאִיתָא (עֵירוּבִין סה, א) **"and the darkness He called night."** לָא אִיבְּרִי לַיְלָה **"The night was created** לְשֵׁנָה אֶלָּא **only for sleep."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **That is, Hashem Yisbarach created the darkness;** בָּרָא הַחֹשֶׁךְ [בְּרֵאשִׁית ב, כא] וְאַף דִּכְתִיב **and although it is written (Bereishis 2:21),** וַיַּפֵּל תַּרְדֵּמָה **"He cast a deep sleep,"** מִכָּל מָקוֹם אִיתָא תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה שֵׁינָה **and "the beginning of downfall is sleep,"** **nevertheless it is brought** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ט, ו) **(Bereishis Rabbah 9:6):** וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד הַשֵּׁינָה **"'And behold, it was very good' — this is sleep.** וְכִי שֵׁינָה טוֹבָה מְאֹד כּוּלֵּי **Is sleep then very good? etc.** אֶלָּא מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁאָדָם יָשֵׁן קְמָעָא **Rather, because a person sleeps a little,** הוּא עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה[756] **he rises and toils greatly in Torah."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּרָא הַחֹשֶׁךְ **That is, Hashem Yisbarach created the darkness** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה טוֹב מְאֹד **so that it should be very good,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קפד, א) **along the lines of what is said (Zohar II, 184a):** דְּלֵית נְהוֹרָא **"There is no light** אֶלָּא הַהוּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא **except that which comes forth from within darkness,** וְלֵית טוֹב **and there is no good** אֶלָּא הַהוּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ בִּישָׁא **except that which comes forth from within evil."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשֵּׁינָה **That is, through sleep** יִהְיֶה עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה **he will rise and toil greatly in Torah,** וְיָאִיר הָאוֹר מִתּוֹךְ הַחֹשֶׁךְ.[757] **and the light will shine forth from within the darkness.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁזָּכָה **was the first who merited** לְהִתְגַּלּוּת מִדַּת עַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **the revelation of the attribute of Atika Kadisha,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּרֵאשִׁית כד, א] **as it is said (Bereishis 24:1),** וְאַבְרָהָם זָקֵן וְגוֹמֵר **"And Avraham was old, etc.";** וְאִיתָא עַל זֶה בְּזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and it is brought on this in the holy Zohar** [חֵלֶק א קכט א] **(I, 129a)** דָּבָא בְּיוֹמִין עִלָּאִין[758] **that he "came into the supernal days."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁזָּכָה לְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּמִדָּתוֹ **That is, he merited to be clarified in his attribute** עַד הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ **all the way to the root,** אַף בִּשְׁלֹשׁ רִאשׁוֹנוֹת **even in the first three sefiros;** וְזֶה רוֹמֵז זָקֵן **and this is what "old" alludes to:** בְּחִינַת עַתִּיק יוֹמִין **the**

My fires.' There is no bread except Torah: 'Come, eat of My bread.' They are the clusters of the Righteous One, and the Righteous One is a fruit-bearing tree." The text directly identifies Joseph's degree with the righteous foundation. The canonical source coordinate is preserved alongside the manuscript's folio reference.

[755] **Pesikta Rabbati 12, exposition of "asher karekha"** — "Our rabbis said: 'He encountered you'—he made you lukewarm, he made you cold like water, as it is said, 'Cold water upon a weary soul.' Rabbi Huna said: To what may it be compared? To a boiling bath from which everyone fled. One person came, jumped into it, and cooled it; immediately everyone came and bathed in it. So Israel: when they came out of Egypt, all fled from them. ... Amalek came and cooled them." The source contains both the comparison with refreshing cold water and the bath parable. Rav Tzadok distinguishes the apparent kindness of the temptation from its weakening effect.

[756] **Berakhot 61a:27–28** — "Rav said: The evil inclination resembles a fly and sits between the two openings of the heart, as it is said, 'Dead flies make the perfumer's oil putrid.' ... The Sages taught: A person has two kidneys; one counsels him for good and one counsels him for evil. It is reasonable that the good one is to his right and the evil one to his left, as it is written, 'A wise person's heart is to his right, and a fool's heart to his left.'" The two openings and two sides underlie Rav Tzadok's distinction between direct enticement and evil presenting itself as good.

[757] **Pirkei Avot 6:4** — "This is the way of Torah: Eat bread with salt, drink water by measure, sleep on the earth, live a life of hardship, and labor in Torah. If you do so, happy are you, and it is good for you: happy are you in this world, and it is good for you in the world to come." Rav Tzadok distinguishes the difficult road of acquisition from the joy of Torah after its light is attained.

[758] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3:2–3,7** — "The Oral Torah is not found with one who seeks this world's pleasure, desire, honor, and greatness, but with one who gives his life for it. ... The Oral Torah is difficult to learn and contains great hardship; it is compared to darkness: 'The people walking in darkness saw a great light'—these are the masters of Talmud whose eyes the Holy One illuminates in what is prohibited and permitted, impure and pure. ... It involves great hardship and lost sleep; a person wears himself out for it. Therefore its reward is in the world to come." The Midrash gives the transition from demanding labor to illumination that the deceptive voice seeks to bypass.

aspect of Atik Yomin, [נח, ט] כְּמוֹ שֶׁרָמַז בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה **as is hinted in Bereishis Rabbah (58:9):** לְבוּשׁ לְבוּשִׁי[759] **"wearing My own garment."** וְזֶהוּ בְּחִינַת ק׳ **And this is the aspect of Kuf,** רָזָא דְּמַאָה בִּרְכָאן **the secret of the hundred blessings,** דְּהַיְינוּ כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **that is, Kesser Elyon is Kesser Malchus,** כְּשֶׁהוּא כָּלוּל מִכֻּל וּמִכֻּלָּא אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם. **when it is comprised of all the middos,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** **And the attribute of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ הָאַהֲבָה וְהַזְּרִיזוּת **is love and alacrity,** (חוּלִּין טז, א) **as they said (Chullin 16a):** קְרָא זְרִיזוּתֵיהּ דְּאַבְרָהָם קָא מַשְׁמַע לָן[760] **"The verse is teaching us Avraham's alacrity."** וְהַזְּרִיזוּת הֵיפֶךְ עַצְלוּת **Alacrity is the opposite of laziness,** וְהַשֵּׁנָה מְבִיאָה הַזְּרִיזוּת **and sleep brings on alacrity,** שֶׁיְּהֵא עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ הַרְבֵּה בַּתּוֹרָה.[761] **so that he rises and toils greatly in Torah.** וְהִנֵּה הַמְקַטְרֵג הַגָּדוֹל **Now the great accuser** (מְגִילָּה יג, ב) הָיָה הָמָן דְּאָמְרוּ **was Haman, as they said (Megillah 13b):** לֵית דְּיָדַע לְשַׁנָּא בִּישָׁא כְּהָמָן **"There is none who knows how to slander like Haman."** וְאֵין הַמְכוּוָּן **And the intent is not** עַל מַה שֶּׁהִלְשִׁין **regarding his slandering** וּבִיזָּה אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **and disparaging Klal Yisrael** לִפְנֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **before Achashverosh,** רַק הַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁזֶּה יֵשׁ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְבַזּוֹת יוֹתֵר **for in that there are those who could disparage more; rather the intent is** מַה שֶּׁקִּטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **how he accused Klal Yisrael** לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **before Hashem Yisbarach;** וּפְתִחַת קִטְרוּגוֹ **and the opening of his accusation was** שֶׁנִּמְצְאוּ מִן הַמִּצְוֹת **"they have slumbered from the mitzvos,"** וְהַיְינוּ עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה **which is "laziness casts a deep sleep";** וְרַבָּנָן גַּם כֵּן עַם אֶחָד הֵן **and "the Rabbis too are one people with them"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם) **(as they said there),** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהֵם גַּם כֵּן **meaning that they too** רָפוּ יְדֵיהֶם מִן הַתּוֹרָה. **slackened their hands from the Torah.** **And in Midrash Rabbah (Esther 7:12)** [אֶסְתֵּר ז, יב] וּבְמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **it is brought on this:** אוֹתוֹ "עַם אֶחָד שֶׁנִּשְׁנוּ עַל זֶה אֵיתָא **"'There is one people' — He of whom it is said, 'Hashem is One,'** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בּוֹ ה׳ אֶחָד אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **HaKadosh Baruch Hu said to him:** אֲנִי אֵין לְפָנַי שֵׁנָה וְכוּלֵי **Before Me there is no sleep, etc.,** חַיֶּיךָ שֶׁמִּתּוֹךְ שֵׁנָה וְאַתָּה אָמַרְתָּ יֵשׁ לְפָנַי שֵׁנָה **by your life, from within sleep yet you said there is sleep before Me —** אֲנִי מִתְעוֹרֵר עַל אוֹתוֹ הָאִישׁ הֲדָא הוּא דִכְתִיב[762] **I will rouse Myself against that man** וּמְאַבְּדוֹ **and destroy him; thus it is written** [תְּהִלִּים עח, סה] **(Tehillim 78:65),** וַיִּקַץ כְּיָשֵׁן ה׳ כְּגִבּוֹר **'Then Hashem awoke as one asleep, etc.'"** הָעִנְיָן בָּזֶה **The matter here is** שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי כֵּיוָן שֶׁקִּטְרֵג הָמָן **that certainly, since Haman accused** וְהוֹעִילָה חֲצָפָּה שֶׁלּוֹ **and his audacity was effective,** עַד שֶׁנֶּחְתַּם גְּזַר דִּינָם **to the point that their decree was sealed** בְּחוֹתָם שֶׁל טִיט **with a seal of clay,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **as they said in Midrash Rabbah** [אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ז, יג], **(Esther Rabbah 7:13),** שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם רִיפּוּי יָדַיִם מִן הַסְּתָם הָיָה מָקוֹם לְקַטְרֵג **presumably there was room to accuse, for they had slackness of hands** מִן הַתּוֹרָה. **from the Torah.** **But afterward, in that** רַק אַחַר כָּךְ בְּאוֹתוֹ חֹדֶשׁ

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[759] **Rosh Hashanah 29a:6** — "'When Moses raised his hand, Israel prevailed.' Do Moses' hands make war or break war? Rather, it tells you: Whenever Israel looked upward and subjected their hearts to their Father in heaven, they grew strong; when not, they fell. ... Does the serpent kill, or does the serpent give life? Rather, whenever Israel looked upward and subjected their hearts to their Father in heaven, they were healed; when not, they wasted away." The Mishnah places the hands of Moses and the bronze serpent under the same principle: the decisive act is directing and submitting the heart to God.

[760] **Zohar II 82a, Yitro 19:17–18** — "Rabbi Yose son of Rabbi Judah said: Israel saw here what Ezekiel son of Buzi did not see, and all cleaved to precious supernal wisdom. Israel saw five degrees of voices at Mount Sinai, and through these five degrees Torah was given. ... Rabbi Elazar said: Concerning Israel it is written, 'Face to face the Lord spoke'; concerning Ezekiel it is written 'like the appearance' and 'a likeness,' like one looking through many walls. What Israel saw no other prophet saw; all the more so what Moses saw, no other prophet saw." The passage distinguishes the directness of Sinai from Ezekiel's mediated vision. This sharpens Rav Tzadok's warning that even great revelation does not justify self-confidence.

[761] **Sanhedrin 107a:2–3** — "Rav Judah said in the name of Rav: A person should never bring himself to a test, for David king of Israel brought himself to a test and stumbled. He said before Him: Master of the world, why do they say, 'God of Abraham, God of Isaac, and God of Jacob,' but not 'God of David'? He said: They were tested by Me, and you were not tested by Me. He said before Him: Master of the world, examine me and test me, as it is said, 'Examine me, Lord, and test me.' He said: I will test you, and I will tell you something I did not tell them: I will test you in a matter of sexual transgression." The Talmud makes David's request an explicit warning against deliberately seeking a test. The manuscript's further allusion to "I resolved that my mouth not transgress" belongs to its account of his regret.

[762] **Chagigah 13a:2** — "Until here you have permission to speak; from here onward you have no permission to speak. For it is written in the book of Ben Sira: Do not investigate what is beyond you, and do not search out what is concealed from you. Contemplate what you have been permitted; you have no business with the hidden things." The limitation concerns what one has been authorized and equipped to contemplate. Rav Tzadok describes overreaching that portion through the orchard's image of theft.

very month, הָיָה מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **came the eradication of Amalek,** [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Esther 8:16),** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light"** — זוֹ תּוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **"this is Torah," as they said in the Gemara** [מְגִילָּה טז, ב]; **(Megillah 16b);** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh,** שְׁנִּקְרֵאת אוֹרָה לְשׁוֹן נְקֵבָה **which is called orah, a feminine term,** שֶׁאָז זָכוּ לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for then they merited Torah she'b'al peh,** (שַׁבָּת פח, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shabbos 88a):** "הֶדַר קִבְּלוּהָ בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **"They accepted it anew in the days of Achashverosh";** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁעַל זֶה הָיָה **for it was regarding this that there was** כְּפִיַּת הַר כְּגִיגִית **the holding of the mountain over them like a barrel** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרָשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג). **(as stated in Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 3).** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהָמָן הָיָה סָבוּר **That is, Haman thought** שֶׁיָּכוֹל לִשְׁלוֹט עֲלֵיהֶם בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **that he could dominate them in this month,** שְׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **which was formed with the letter Kuf,** הַמּוֹרֶה בְּחִינַת נָחָשׁ וְשֵׁינָה **which indicates the aspect of serpent and sleep;** וְנַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא **"but it was turned about,"** שֶׁהוּא שֶׁעָשׂוּ מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **for they carried out the eradication of Amalek,** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **who is the root of the yetzer hara,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** וְזָכוּ לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and they merited the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא אוֹר הַגָּדוֹל **which is the great light** שֶׁנִּבְרָא בְּיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן **that was created on the first day;** [יְשַׁעְיָה ט, א] וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **and about this it is said (Yeshayah 9:1),** הָעָם **"The people that walked in darkness** הַהֹלְכִים בַּחֹשֶׁךְ רָאוּ אוֹר גָּדוֹל **have seen a great light"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם בְּתַנְחוּמָא). **(as stated there in the Tanchuma).** וְהַשֵּׁינָה מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁהוּא יָשֵׁן קְמָעָא **And as for sleep: because he sleeps a little,** יָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה **he toils greatly in Torah,** וְהוּא נֶהֱנֶה דָּבָר וְכוּלֵי **and this is "the light that comes forth, etc."** דְּוַדַּאי תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה שֵׁינָה **For certainly "the beginning of downfall is sleep,"** אַךְ כְּתִיב [מִשְׁלֵי כד, טז] **but it is written (Mishlei 24:16),** כִּי שֶׁבַע יִפּוֹל צַדִּיק וָקָם **"For the righteous one falls seven times and rises,"** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָעַצְלוּת **so that through the laziness** יָבֹא לִזְרִיזוּת בְּיוֹתֵר[763] **he comes to even greater alacrity;** וְכֵן וְרִיפּוּי יָדַיִם מִן **and likewise, through their having** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהָיוּ נָשְׁנוּ מִן הַמִּצְוֹת **"slumbered from the mitzvos"** הַתּוֹרָה **and slackness of hands from the Torah,** זָכוּ לְרֹב חָכְמָה **they merited abundant wisdom,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh;** (מַכּוֹת ז, ב) וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and this is along the lines of what they said (Makkos 7b):** יְרִידָה שֶׁהִיא צוֹרֶךְ עֲלִיָּה.[764] **"a descent that is for the sake of an ascent."** וְאוֹת קוּף מוֹרֶה קָדוֹשׁ **And the letter Kuf indicates "Kadosh,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **as they said in the Gemara;** וְהַיְינוּ לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **that is, to rectify the root of the serpent's blemish:** לְהַרְגִּישׁ הַנָּאַת הַגּוּף בַּאֲכִילָה **feeling bodily pleasure in eating.** וְאִיתָא (בְּרָכוֹת נג, ב) **And it is brought (Berachos 53b):** "וְהִתְקַדִּשְׁתֶּם [וַיִּקְרָא כ, ז] **"'And you shall sanctify yourselves' (Vayikra 20:7)** — וּנְטִילַת יָדַיִם **and the washing of the hands** מְרַמֵּז אֵלּוּ מַיִם רִאשׁוֹנִים[765] **this is the first waters";** עַל הָסָרַת הַנְּגִיעָה **alludes to the removal of self-interest;** וְהַיְינוּ לְהָסִיר פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **that is, to remove the serpent's blemish** בַּהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף בַּאֲכִילָה **in bodily pleasure in eating** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר קוּנְטְרֵס עֵת הָאוֹכֶל) **(as explained in Kuntres Es HaOchel).** וְכֵן מוֹרֶה קָדוֹשׁ **Likewise "Kadosh" indicates** עַל קְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית **the holiness of the bris,** שֶׁהַזְּמַן בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **for the time in this month** לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **is for the eradication of Amalek,** שֶׁאֵינוֹ נוֹפֵל **who falls only** אֶלָּא בְּיַד זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף **by the hand of Yosef's descendants,** שֶׁהוּא הֵיפֶךְ עֵשָׂו **he being the opposite of Esav,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁחָשַׁב בְּמִדְרָשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (תֵּצֵא י) **as enumerated in Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei 10);** וְכֵן עֲמָלֵק מְקַטְרֵג **and likewise Amalek accuses** עַל קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּזֶה **against the holiness of Klal Yisrael in this,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם **as they said there,** שֶׁהָיָה חוֹתֵךְ וְכוּלֵי **that he would cut off, etc.** וְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה כָּתַב **And this month, writes** בְּסֵפֶר קְדוּשַׁת **the Kedushas Levi,** לֵוִי שֶׁהוּא נֶגֶד יוֹסֵף **corresponds to Yosef;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְחַלֵּק לִשְׁנֵי שְׁבָטִים **and just as he was**

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[763] **Numbers 12:6-8** — "If there is a prophet among you, I, the Lord, make Myself known to him in a vision; in a dream I speak with him. Not so My servant Moses: in all My house he is faithful. Mouth to mouth I speak with him, in a clear appearance and not in riddles, and he beholds the form of the Lord." The contrast between ordinary prophetic disclosure and Moses' faithful standing in the divine house supplies Rav Tzadok's language of an allotted share.

[764] **Shemot Rabbah 1:28** — "'He saw their burdens': He saw that they had no rest. He went and said to Pharaoh: A person who owns a slave—if the slave does not rest one day in the week, he dies. These are your slaves; if you do not allow them one day in the week, they will die. He said to him: Go and do for them as you say. Moses went and established Shabbat for them to rest." The Midrash gives the account of Moses choosing a day of rest while Israel were in Egypt.

[765] **Tur, Orach Chayim 281:1** — "The explanation of 'Moses shall rejoice': When our ancestors were in Egypt and Moses saw the heavy servitude imposed on them, he asked Pharaoh to give them one day in the week on which to rest. Pharaoh granted it to him, and he chose the seventh day. When they were commanded concerning Shabbat, Moses rejoiced that he had chosen it. This is 'Moses shall rejoice in the gift of his portion.'" This identifies one of the earlier written explanations to which Rav Tzadok refers. The Tur also records a second explanation based on Shabbat as God's good gift.

divided into two tribes, כֵּן מִתְחַלֵּק אָדָר לִשְׁנַיִם **so Adar is divided into two** בִּשְׁנַת הָעִבּוּר. **in a leap year.** וְכָל מִי שֶׁגּוֹדֵר עַצְמוֹ מִן הָעֲרָוָה נִקְרָא קָדוֹשׁ **And whoever fences himself off from immorality is called holy** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה כד, ו). **(as stated in Vayikra Rabbah 24:6).** וְכֵן וַיַּפֵּל תַּרְדֵּמָה **Likewise, "He cast a deep sleep" —** תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה שֵׁינָה **"the beginning of downfall is sleep" —** וְאָז נִבְרֵאת הָאִשָּׁה **and then the woman was created;** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יז, ו) וְאִיתָא **and it is brought (Bereishis Rabbah 17:6):** כֵּינָן שֶׁנִּבְרֵאת **"Once she was created,** נִבְרָא שָׂטָן עִמָּהּ[766] עַיֵּן שָׁם **the Satan was created with her"; see there.** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁבָּזֶה הָעִסָּק **That is, in this matter** יֵשׁ קִטְרוּג הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **there is the accusation of the yetzer hara** מִזֻּהֲמַת הַנָּחָשׁ **from the contamination of the serpent;** אַךְ הַחֹדֶשׁ נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **but the month was formed with the letter Kuf** שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְתַקֵּן **so that they can rectify it,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **that the Kuf be Kadosh,** וְלַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **and carry out the eradication of Amalek,** שֹׁרֶשׁ הַנָּחָשׁ. **the root of the serpent,** וְלִזְכּוֹת לִזְרִיזוּת **and merit alacrity,** בְּחִינַת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **the aspect of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁזָּכָה לִבְחִינַת ק׳ **who merited the aspect of Kuf,** רָזָא דְּמַאָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **the secret of the hundred, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **And this is what they said in Midrash Rabbah** [אֶסְתֵּר שָׁם] **(Esther, ibid.):** אֲנִי אֵין שֵׁינָה לְפָנַי וְכוּלֵי **"Before Me there is no sleep, etc.,"** וַיִּקַץ כְּיָשֵׁן ה׳ **"Then Hashem awoke as one asleep."** דִּכְתִיב [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, כו] **For it is written (Bereishis 1:26),** בְּצַלְמֵנוּ כִּדְמוּתֵנוּ **"In Our image, after Our likeness,"** וְהַכֹּחוֹת שֶׁבָּרָא בָּאָדָם **and the faculties He created in man** הֵם הַמִּדּוֹת **are the attributes** שֶׁהֶאֱצִיל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **that Hashem Yisbarach emanated** לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם כַּיִּדּוּעַ **for the creation of the world, as is known;** וּכְמוֹ דְּשֵׁינָה עַל יָדֶיהָ **and just as through sleep** עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה יְתֵרָה **one rises and toils greatly in Torah** וּבָא לִידֵי זְרִיזוּת יְתֵרָה **and comes to extra alacrity,** כֵּן כִּבְיָכוֹל **so too, as it were,** אֵצֶל הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **with Hashem Yisbarach:** עַל יְדֵי מַה שֶּׁנִּרְאֶה **through His appearing** כְּיָשֵׁן לוֹ מֵעַמּוֹ **as though asleep, away from His people,** וְנִגְזְרָה הַגְּזֵרָה **and the decree was issued** וְנֶחְתַּם בְּחוֹתָם שֶׁל טִיט **and sealed with a seal of clay —** עַל יְדֵי זֶה דַּיְיקָא **precisely through this,** וַיִּקַץ כְּיָשֵׁן ה׳ **"Hashem awoke as one asleep,"** שֶׁנִּגְאַבֵּד הָמָן מִן הָעוֹלָם **for from this it came about** שֶׁמִּתּוֹךְ שֵׁינָה **that Haman was destroyed from the world.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר **And this is what He said: "From within sleep** אֲנִי מִתְעוֹרֵר וכוּלֵי. **I will rouse Myself, etc."** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **We have already said** שֶׁבְּפוּרִים זָכוּ לְהַשִּׂיג **that on Purim they merited to grasp** דְּכָל (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ס,) מַאי דְּעָבִיד רַחֲמָנָא **that "whatever the Merciful One does,** לְטַב עָבִיד **He does for the good"** (ב **(as stated in Berachos 60b),** שֶׁהוּא וְלֹא רַק לְקַבּוֹלֵינְהוּ בְּשִׂמְחָה **and not only to accept sufferings with joy,** כְּמוֹ לְכַפָּרָה **as being for atonement,** רַק לְהַכִּיר **but to recognize** שֶׁהוּא בֶּאֱמֶת לְטוֹבָה **that it is truly for the good,** שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְבַקֵּשׁ **that they could ask** לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **to carry out the eradication of Amalek,** מַה שֶּׁלֹּא הָיָה אֶפְשָׁר **which would have been impossible** בְּלִעְדָּהּ לְבַקֵּשׁ **to ask for without it;** רַק עַל יְדֵי הַגְּזֵרָה **only through the decree —** נַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא **"it was turned about":** שֶׁכֵּיוָן שֶׁגָּזַר לְהַשְׁמִיד וְגוֹמֵר **since he decreed "to destroy, etc.,"** הָיָה מָקוֹם לְבַקֵּשׁ **there was room to ask** שֶׁיֵּהָפֵךְ הַגְּזֵרָה **that the decree be reversed,** וְיֹאמַר שֶׁכָּךְ הָיָה הַכַּוָּנָה **and to say that this was the intent** (מַאֲמָר א), **ma'amar 1),** וְעַל יְדֵי (**as explained at the fourteenth of Adar Rishon,** וְנִתְבָּאֵר אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר אֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן) כֵּן נַעֲשָׂה מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק. **and thereby the eradication of Amalek was accomplished.** וְזָכוּ לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And they merited Torah she'b'al peh** עַל יְדֵי הֶעָצְלוּת בַּתּוֹרָה **through the laziness in Torah,** וְהוּא בְּחִינַת נְהוֹרָא **and this is the aspect of "the light** דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֶשׁוֹכָא **that comes forth from within darkness":** מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁיָּשֵׁן **because he sleeps,** עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה: **he rises and toils greatly in Torah.**

וְאַחַר כָּךְ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **And afterward comes the month of Nissan,** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד שֵׁבֶט יְהוּדָה **which corresponds to the tribe of Yehudah,** שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ יָצָא מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד **from whom Mashiach ben David issues,** שֶׁיְּתַקֵּן הַכֹּל **who will rectify everything.** וְזֶהוּ עוֹמֶק מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is the depth of what they said** (מְגִלָּה ו, ב) **(Megillah 6b):** מִסְמָךְ גְּאֻלָּה לִגְאֻלָּה עָדִיף **"Juxtaposing redemption to redemption is preferable";** דְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר נָגֶד יוֹסֵף **for the month of Adar corresponds to Yosef,** שֶׁכֹּחוֹ הַנִּצּוּחַ **whose power is victory** בְּעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת **over the idolaters,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִיסָן נֶגֶד יְהוּדָה **and afterward Nissan corresponds to Yehudah,** שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ מָשִׁיחַ הַגּוֹאֵל **from whom comes Mashiach the redeemer.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּעֲנִית כט, ב) **And this is what they said (Taanis 29b):**

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[766] **Isaac Luria, Asader li-Seudata, stanzas 3–4,8** — "May He send us His beauty, and may we behold His glory; may He show us His secrets, which are spoken in a whisper. May He reveal to us the meanings within the twelve loaves, which are a letter in His name, doubled and subtle. ... To crown the table with a precious mystery, deep and hidden, and not a noisy utterance." The song's own language makes disclosure of secrets part of the morning Shabbat meal. The original Aramaic was checked in a digital transcription of the poem; no printed siddur edition is claimed.

הִלְכָךְ וכו׳ **"Therefore, etc.,** וְלִימְצֵי נַפְשֵׁיהּ בַּאֲדָר **let him make himself available in Adar,** דְּבָרִיא מַזָּלֵיהּ **when his fortune is healthy."** וְלִכְאוֹרָה יִתָּכֵן יוֹתֵר בְּנִיסָן **Seemingly it would fit better in Nissan,** שֶׁהָיָה גְּאוּלָּה יוֹתֵר **which was more of a redemption,** (מְגִילָּה יד, א) שֶׁבַּאֲדָר אִיתָא **for regarding Adar it is brought (Megillah 14a):** אַכַּתִּי עַבְדֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ אֲנַן. **"We are still servants of Achashverosh."** אַךְ הַטַּעַם **But the reason is** שֶׁבְּנִיסָן הָיָה עִיקַּר הַגְּאוּלָּה **that in Nissan the essence of the redemption was** לְהֵטִיב לְיִשְׂרָאֵל וּלְגַדְּלָם **to benefit Klal Yisrael and elevate them;** וְאִם הָיָה פַּרְעֹה מִתְרַצֶּה תֵּכֶף לְשַׁלְּחָם **and had Pharaoh agreed to send them out immediately,** לֹא הָיוּ מַכִּין בּוֹ **they would not have struck him;** וְהִתְרוּ בּוֹ בְּמַכּוֹת **and they warned him of the plagues,** וְרַק מֵאֲשֶׁר מָרַד הִכּוּ בּוֹ **and only because he rebelled did they strike him;** וְכֵאֲשֶׁר רָדַף אַחֲרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **and when he pursued Klal Yisrael** טוּבְּעוּ בַּיָּם **they were drowned in the sea;** וַיְנַצְּלוּ אֶת מִצְרַיִם **and "they emptied out Egypt"** [שְׁמוֹת יב, לו] **(Shemos 12:36),** לְהוֹצִיא מֵהֶם **to extract from them** הַנִּיצוֹצִין קְדִישִׁין **the holy sparks,** וְהַרְבֵּה מֵעֵרֶב רַב **and many of the eirev rav** שֶׁקִּיבֵּל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **whom Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, accepted,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ גַּם הֵם **for they said that they too** בְּשֵׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל יִכָּנֶה. **would be called by the name of Yisrael.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בַּאֲדָר **This is not so in Adar,** שֶׁהָיָה עִיקַּר הַמְּכוּוָּן **where the main intent was** [אֶסְתֵּר ט, טז] וְהָרוֹג בְּשׂוֹנְאֵיהֶם **"and killing among their enemies" (Esther 9:16),** לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **to carry out the eradication of Amalek,** וּבַבִּזָּה לֹא שָׁלְחוּ אֶת יָדָם **"but on the spoil they laid not their hand"** [שָׁם, י] **(ibid. 10),** וְלֹא רָצוּ כְּלָל **and they did not want at all** לְהוֹצִיא הַנִּיצוֹצִין קְדִישִׁין מֵהֶם **to extract the holy sparks from them;** וְאִיתָא (תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא יא) **and it is brought (Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 11,** וּמְכִילְתָּא פָּרָשַׁת עֲמָלֵק ב**) and Mechilta, Parshas Amalek 2)** שֶׁאֵין מְקַבְּלִין גֵּרִים מֵעֲמָלֵק.[767] **that converts are not accepted from Amalek.** וְעַל כֵּן לִימְצֵי נַפְשֵׁיהּ בַּאֲדָר **Therefore "let him make himself available in Adar,"** שֶׁאָז זְמַן הַנִּצּוּחַ נֶגְדָּם. **for that is the time of victory over them.** וְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה שֶׁנּוֹצַר **And this month, which was formed** בְּאוֹת ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **with the letter Kuf for Kadosh,** הַזְּמַן לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **is the time to rectify the serpent's blemish,** שֶׁהִכְנִיס הַתַּאֲוָה **who brought in desire.** וְעִיקַּר קְדוּשָּׁה **And the essence of holiness** מִדַּת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **is the attribute of Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה כט, כג] **as it is said (Yeshayah 29:23),** וְהִקְדִּישׁוּ אֶת קְדוֹשׁ יַעֲקֹב **"They shall sanctify the Holy One of Yaakov";** דְּיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **for Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה כְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן **was like Adam HaRishon** קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל **before the corruption,** וְלֹא יָדַע מֵעֲטָיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ **and knew nothing of the serpent's counsel,** [תַּעֲנִית ה, ב] וְעַל כֵּן לֹא מֵת.[768] **and therefore he did not die (Taanis 5b).** וְכֵן רַבִּי כָּל בֵּי שַׁמְּשֵׁי **And likewise Rebbi, every Shabbos-eve twilight,** [כְּתוּבוֹת קג, א] [769] הֲוָה אָתֵי לְבֵיתֵיהּ. **would come to his home (Kesubos 103a).** וְאִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר חֲסִידִים **And it is brought in Sefer Chassidim** [סִימָן תתשכט] **(siman 1129)** שֶׁהָיָה מוֹצִיא בְּנֵי בֵיתוֹ בְּקִידּוּשׁ[770] **that he would discharge his household's obligation of Kiddush;** וְהוּא מִטַּעַם **and this**

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[767] **Chagigah 14b:8–9; 15b:16** — "The Sages taught: Four entered the orchard: Ben Azzai, Ben Zoma, Aher, and Rabbi Akiva. ... Ben Azzai looked and died. ... Ben Zoma looked and was harmed. ... Aher cut the plantings. Rabbi Akiva emerged in peace." Chagigah 15b adds: "Rabbi Akiva ascended in peace and descended in peace. ... Even Rabbi Akiva—the ministering angels sought to thrust him away. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: Leave this elder, for he is fit to make use of My glory." The distinction turns on fitness for the encounter.

[768] **Bereshit Rabbah 49:2** — "At first, 'the secret of the Lord' was 'for those who fear Him'; afterward, for the upright: 'His secret is with the upright'; afterward, for the prophets: 'He does nothing unless He has revealed His secret to His servants the prophets.' The Holy One said: This Abraham fears God, as it is said, 'Now I know that you fear God.' This Abraham is upright among the upright. ... This Abraham is a prophet, as it is said, 'Return the man's wife, for he is a prophet.' Shall I not reveal it to him?" The Midrash combines fear, uprightness, and prophecy in Abraham. Rav Tzadok develops the restraint appropriate to each as the condition for receiving a secret.

[769] Parallel: **R. Moshe ben Maimon, Moreh Nevuchim I:5** — "A person should not rush into this great and sublime matter at his first encounter, before training himself in the sciences and knowledge, thoroughly refining his character, and subduing his appetites and imagined longings. After attaining true premises and learning the rules of inference and protection against errors of thought, he may begin the inquiry. He should not decide by his first impression or initially let his thoughts range toward apprehending the Deity; he should hold back in reverence until he advances gradually. This is the meaning of 'Moshe hid his face, for he feared to gaze toward God.' … That restraint was praised, and afterward he merited, 'He beholds the likeness of Hashem.'"

Connection: Rambam connects restraint in divine inquiry to prior moral and intellectual preparation, and uses the same sequence from Moshe's hidden face to his later vision. This explains why Rav Tzadok links fear of God and an upright heart with receiving secrets without taking what has not yet been allotted. Rambam describes readiness through training; Rav Tzadok speaks here of each soul's allotted portion.

[770] **Shemot Rabbah 3:1** — "Rabbi Joshua of Sikhnin said in the name of Rabbi Levi: Nevertheless, He showed him. In reward for 'Moses hid his face,' 'The Lord spoke to Moses face to face.' In reward for 'for he feared,' 'They feared to approach him.' In reward for 'from looking,' 'He beholds the form of the Lord.' ... Rabbi Hoshaya the elder said: He

is for the reason שֶׁלֹּא יָדַע כְּלָל מֵהַנָּאַת הַגּוּף **that he knew nothing at all of bodily pleasure,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר גָּלוּי וְיָדוּעַ **as he said, "It is revealed and known, etc.,** וְכוּלֵי[771] **and I did not derive benefit** אֲפִילּוּ בְּאֶצְבַּע קְטַנָּה **even with my little finger"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּתוֹסְפוֹת קד, א) **(as stated in Kesubos 104a);** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא מֵת **and therefore he did not die,** כְּמוֹ יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **like Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר סְעוּדַת **(as explained in Seudas Pidyon HaBen,** פִּדְיוֹן הַבֵּן (מַאֲמָר א עַיִן שָׁם) **ma'amar 1; see there);** וְנִקְרָא רַבֵּינוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and he was called Rabbeinu HaKadosh** גַּם כֵּן מִטַּעַם זֶה **also for this reason,** דְּעִיקַּר קְדוּשָּׁה **for the essence of holiness** בְּחִינַת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **is the aspect of Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** וְהוּא הָיָה נִיצוֹץ מִנִּשְׁמָתוֹ **and he was a spark of his soul,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מֵהָאֲרִי הַקָּדוֹשׁ.[772] **as is cited from the holy Arizal.** וְיַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף תַּרְוַיְיהוּ כַּחֲדָא אָזְלִי **"And Yaakov and Yosef both go together as one,** וְדָא הוּא רָזָא דְּאוֹת וָאו כּוּלֵי **and this is the secret of the letter Vav, etc.,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק א קפב, ב). **(I, 182b).** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַּׁת יוֹסֵף **For through the holiness of Yosef** יְכוֹלִים לְתַקֵּן **one can rectify** שׁוֹרֶשׁ פִּגַּם הַנָּחָשׁ **the root of the serpent's blemish,** לִהְיוֹת כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם הַפְּגָם **to be as before the blemish;** וְזֶה שׁוֹרֶשׁ עֵסֶק חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **and this is the root of the work of the month of Adar,** שֶׁנּוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **which was formed with the letter Kuf** וְנִתַּן לְיוֹסֵף כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and given to Yosef, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כט, א) **And this is what they said (Rosh Hashanah 29a):** עֲשֵׂה לְךָ שָׂרָף וְגוֹמֵר **"'Make yourself a fiery serpent, etc.'** [בְּמִדְבַּר כא, ח] **(Bamidbar 21:8) —** וְכִי נָחָשׁ מֵמִית כּוּלֵי[773] **does a serpent kill? etc.** אֶלָּא בִּזְמַן **Rather, when Klal Yisrael** מְסִתַּכְּלִין כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה **look upward** וּמְשַׁעְבְּדִין אֶת לִבָּם **and subjugate their hearts** לַאֲבִיהֶם שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **to their Father in Heaven,** הָיוּ מִתְרַפְּאִין כּוּלֵי **they were healed, etc."** וּבְוַדַּאי הַנָּחָשׁ הָיָה מֵמִית **Certainly the serpent did kill** כְּפִשּׁוּטוֹ **in the literal sense;** רַק הַמְכוּוָן עַל דָּרְךָ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **but the intent is** (בְּרָכוֹת לג, א) **along the lines of what they said (Berachos 33a):** אֵין הָעָרוֹד מֵמִית **"It is not the arod that kills;** אֶלָּא הַחֹטֵא מֵמִית[774] **rather it is sin that kills."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּהַנָּחָשׁ **That is, the serpent** הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **is the root of the yetzer hara,** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן בְּרָזָא דְּאָת ק׳ **and it too is in the secret of the letter Kuf,** שֶׁהִכְנִיס הַתַּאֲוָה לַלֵּב **which brought desire into the heart,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** שֶׁהוּא זֶה לְעֻמַּת זֶה **which is "one opposite the other,"** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה **and it too is the "beginning" of the kelipah;** וּכְשֶׁמְּשַׁעְבְּדִין אֶת לִבָּם **and when they subjugate their hearts** לַאֲבִיהֶם שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **to their Father in Heaven,** וְהִבִּיט אֶל נְחַשׁ הַנְּחֹשֶׁת וָחָי **"he would look at the copper serpent and live"** [בְּמִדְבַּר שָׁם]; **(Bamidbar ibid.);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבָּזֶה עַצְמוֹ **that is, in this itself** יְכוֹל לִמְצוֹא חַיִּים **one can find life,** עַל דָּרְךָ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **along the lines of what is said in the holy Zohar:** אֶלָּא הַהוּא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא. **except that which comes forth from within** דְּלֵית נְהוֹרָא **"There is no light**

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did well to hide his face. The Holy One said to him: I came to show you My face, and you honored Me and hid your face. By your life, you will be with Me on the mountain forty days and forty nights, without eating or drinking, and you will delight in the radiance of the Divine Presence." The Midrash preserves a debate over Moses' initial concealment and then articulates the positive relation between restraint and later disclosure.

[771] **Pri Etz Chaim, Gate of Shabbat 17:3** — "Before the Shabbos evening meal one says: This is the meal of the field of holy apples; Zeir Anpin and the Holy Ancient One come to dine with her. This meal belongs to Yitzchak, who is its master and directs it; one who delights in it is saved from the birth pangs of Mashiach. At the morning meal ... he says: This is the meal of the Holy Ancient One; Zeir Anpin and the field of holy apples come to dine with Him. It corresponds to Avraham, the pious elder, and through his merit one is saved from the judgment of Gehinnom." The cited Lurianic text explicitly associates the morning meal with Abraham and the Holy Ancient One.

[772] **Zohar II 60b, Beshalach 26:1–2** — "'They went three days in the wilderness and found no water.' Water means Torah. Who gave them Torah here? For the Torah had not yet been given to them. Rabbi Elazar said: They went out into the wilderness to contemplate, and the Holy One took the radiance of His glory from there; they went to contemplate Him but did not find Him. We have learned that the Holy One is called Torah, and water means Torah; Torah means the Holy One." The original question explicitly addresses the fact that this episode precedes Sinai. Rav Tzadok follows its reading of the search for water as a search for the hidden radiance.

[773] **Sotah 21b:3** — "Rabbi Yose son of Rabbi Hanina said: Words of Torah endure only in one who makes himself bare for them, as it is said, 'I, wisdom, dwell with nakedness.' Rabbi Yohanan said: Words of Torah endure only in one who makes himself as though he were nothing, as it is said, 'Wisdom—from nothing is it found.'" The passage joins surrender for Torah with the humility expressed through the word "nothing." Rav Tzadok connects this to Moses' "What are we?"

[774] **Taanit 7a:15–16** — "Rabbi Hanina bar Idi said: Why are words of Torah compared to water? ... Just as water leaves a high place and goes to a low place, so words of Torah endure only in one whose mind is humble. Rabbi Oshaya said: Why are words of Torah compared to these three liquids—water, wine, and milk? ... Just as these three liquids are preserved only in the lowliest vessels, so words of Torah endure only in one whose mind is humble." The images describe humility as the vessel that can retain Torah, rather than as an absence of understanding.

darkness." וְיָכוֹל לְהַכְנִיס הַתַּאֲוָה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה And one can bring desire into holiness, (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קלז, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ as they said (Zohar I, 137a), כְּדִבְקַדְמִיתָא דְּלְעָתִיד לֹא יִהְיֶה מְנוּוָל that in the future it will not be repulsive כְּמַאן דְּסָחֵי like one who bathes וּמַטְבִּיל מִסְּאֲבוּתֵיהּ and immerses himself from his impurity; חֶדְוָתָא דְּשַׁמְעָתָא לָא לֵיהֱוֵי for were it not for it, דְּאִלְמָלֵא הוּא and the yetzer is necessary, וְנִצְרָךְ הַיֵּצֶר the joy of Torah study would not exist (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם קלח, א). (as stated there, 138a). וְהַתְחָלַת הַמִּשְׁנָה And the opening of the Mishnah [רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה שָׁם] (Rosh Hashanah, ibid.): וְהָיָה כַּאֲשֶׁר יָרִים מֹשֶׁה יָדוֹ "'And it was, when Moshe raised his hand, וְגָבַר יִשְׂרָאֵל [שְׁמוֹת יז, יא] Yisrael prevailed' (Shemos 17:11) — וְכִי יָדָיו שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה do the hands of Moshe מִסְתַּכְּלִין כְּלַפֵּי עוֹשׂוֹת מִלְחָמָה כּוּלֵי wage war? etc. אֶלָּא כָּל זְמַן שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל Rather, whenever Klal Yisrael מַעֲלָה looked upward וּמְשַׁעְבְּדִין לִבָּם כּוּלֵי and subjugated their hearts, etc., הָיוּ מִתְגַּבְּרִין they prevailed." וְאֵין לוֹ שַׁיָּיכוּת לְשָׁם And it has no connection to that place, רַק מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב except for what was written by רַבֵּנוּ עוֹבַדְיָה מִשּׁוּם דְּאַיְירֵי בְּכַוָּונַת הַלֵּב since it is dealing with intention of the heart, שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁמְּכַוְּונִים לִבָּם לַשָּׁמַיִם [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וְהָיָה] Rabbeinu Ovadiah Bartenura (s.v. VeHayah): תָּנָא נַמִּי לְהָךְ[775] it also taught this one, שֶׁכְּשָׁעָה שֶׁמְּכַוְּונִים לִבָּם לַשָּׁמַיִם. that at the time they direct their hearts to Heaven. [שָׁם כז, ב] וְהֵיינוּ הָא דְּתָנַן And this is what we learned (ibid. 27b): וְשָׁמַע קוֹל שׁוֹפָר "And he heard the sound of the shofar אוֹ קוֹל מְגִילָּה or the sound of the Megillah — אִם כִּיוֵּן לִבּוֹ יָצָא כּוּלֵי if he directed his heart, he has fulfilled his obligation, etc., אַף עַל פִּי כּוּלֵי even though, etc." וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין And this needs to be understood: הָא כְּבָר תָּנֵי רַבִּי Rebbi has already taught דִּין כַּוָּנַת הַלֵּב the law of intention of the heart לְעִנְיַן קְרִיאַת שְׁמַע regarding Krias Shema [יג, א בְּרֵישׁ פֶּרֶק ב דְּבְרָכוֹת] at the beginning of the second chapter of Berachos (13a), וְשָׁם הָוֶה לֵיהּ לְמִתְנֵי and there he should have taught הָךְ מַתְנִיתִין this Mishnah דְּוְהָיָה כַּאֲשֶׁר יָרִים וְגוֹמֵר. of "And it was, when he raised, etc." אַךְ לְפִי הָאֲמוּר But according to what has been said, יָתְכֵן דְּמִקְרָא מְגִילָּה it fits well: the reading of the Megillah הֵיינוּ מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק is the eradication of Amalek, לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרְשׁוֹ to rectify its root, אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ וְהִצְנִינְךָ who "happened upon you" and chilled you, וְהִשְׁלִיךְ עַצְלוּת and cast laziness וְרִיפּוּי יָדַיִם מֵהַתּוֹרָה and slackness of hands from the Torah — עַצְלָה תַּפִּיל תַּרְדֵּמָה. "laziness casts a deep sleep." וְכֵן עִנְיַן הַשּׁוֹפָר בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה Likewise the matter of the shofar on Rosh Hashanah: אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהוּא גְּזֵרַת הַכָּתוּב although it is a decree of Scripture, רָמְזוּ יֵשׁ בּוֹ there is a hint in it: עוּרוּ יְשֵׁנִים מִשְּׁנַתְכֶם "Awake, you sleepers, from your sleep, וְנִרְדָּמִים הָקִיצוּ מִתַּרְדֵּמַתְכֶם[776] and you slumberers, rouse yourselves from your slumber" (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַמְב״ם (as the Rambam wrote, פֶּרֶק ג מֵהִלְכוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה הֲלָכָה ד). Hilchos Teshuvah 3:4). וְעַל זֶה הֵבִיא אַחַר כָּךְ And on this he then brought שְׁנֵי הָעִנְיָנִים the two matters, דְּכְשֶׁמְּכַוְּונִין אֶת לִבָּם לַשָּׁמַיִם that when they directed their hearts to Heaven הָיוּ מִתְגַּבְּרִין וְחַיִּים. they prevailed and lived. וְנָגֶד מְגִילָּה הֵבִיא Corresponding to the Megillah he brought מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ what they said, שֶׁהוּא "And it was, when Moshe raised his hand, וְגָבַר יִשְׂרָאֵל Yisrael prevailed," וְהָיָה כַּאֲשֶׁר יָרִים מֹשֶׁה יָדוֹ which is the prevailing הַהִתְגַּבְּרוּת בְּמִחְיַת עֲמָלֵק. in the eradication of Amalek. וְאַחַר כָּךְ הֵבִיא And afterward he brought, נֶגֶד קוֹל שׁוֹפָר corresponding to the sound of the shofar, כַּיּוֹצֵא בַּדָּבָר "Similarly: עֲשֵׂה לְךָ שָׂרָף וְגוֹמֵר 'Make yourself a fiery serpent, etc.'" וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ And as we said בָּמֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר regarding what is said, וְהִבִּיט אֶל נְחַשׁ נְחשֶׁת וָחָי "he would look at the copper serpent and live," שֶׁיּוּכַל לְמָצוֹא בָּזֶה חַיִּים that one can find life in this; וְהֵיינוּ דְּהַנָּחָשׁ that is, the serpent, יֵצֶר הָרָע שֶׁל תַּאֲוָה the yetzer hara of desire, אֵשֶׁת זְנוּנִים the harlotrous woman — זֶה נִבְרָא לְשַׁמֵּשׁ לָאָדָם this was created to serve man לַעֲבוֹדַת הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ[777] for the service of Hashem Yisbarach, שֶׁהוּא לְהִיּוֹת לוֹ which is that he should have חֵשֶׁק וַחֲמִידוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא yearning and

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[775] **Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 11** — "'From generation to generation.' The Holy One, blessed be He, said: I pursue him through every generation. Rabbi Eliezer says: From the generation of Moshe until that of Shmuel. Rabbi Yehoshua says: From the generation of Shmuel until that of Mordechai and Esther. Rabbi Yosei says: From the generation of Mordechai and Esther until the King Mashiach, which is three generations. From where is the generation of Mashiach three generations? 'They will fear You with the sun, and before the moon, generation of generations': dor is one, dorim are two, making three." The text's count is a derashah on Tehillim 72:5, rather than a conventional three-generation chronology. Rav Tzadok explains how the messianic generation contains the three stages of confrontation with Amalek.

[776] **Shemos Rabbah 41:7** — "'Engraved upon the tablets'—what is charus? Rabbi Yehudah says: Do not read charus, engraved, but cheirus, freedom from exile. Rabbi Nechemiah says: Freedom from the Angel of Death. The Sages say: Freedom from suffering. Rabbi Elazar son of Rabbi Yosei HaGelili said: If the Angel of Death says before the Holy One, blessed be He, 'You created me in the world for nothing,' He answers: I gave you dominion over every nation in the world, except this nation, to which I gave freedom." Freedom from death is one of the Midrash's interpretations of the tablets. Rav Tzadok explains why Amalek's opposition to Torah therefore threatens the persistence of the evil inclination itself.

longing for Torah, דְּאִלְמָלֵא יֵצֶר הָרָע **for were it not for the yetzer hara,** לָא לֶיהֱוֵי חֶדְוָתָא דְּשִׁמְעָתָא **the joy of Torah study would not exist,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ. **as they said in the holy Zohar.** (סוּפָּה נב, ב) וְזֶה שֶׁאִיתָא **And this is what is brought (Sukkah 52b),** דְּדָרַשׁ מְפַנֵּק עַבְדּוֹ מִנֹּעַר **expounding "He who pampers his servant from youth"** [מִשְׁלֵי כט, כא] **(Mishlei 29:21)** עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **as referring to the yetzer hara,** שֶׁהוּא נִבְרָא לִהְיוֹת עֶבֶד לָאָדָם[778] **which was created to be a servant to man,** שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה לְסַיְּעוֹ לַתּוֹרָה **to assist him in Torah,** תַּכְלִית בְּרִיאַת הָאָדָם **for this was the purpose of man's creation:** לַעֲמֹל תּוֹרָה. **toil in Torah.** וְהַנָּחָשׁ כְּפִשׁוּטוֹ **And the serpent, in the literal sense,** הָיָה שַׁמָּשׁ גָּדוֹל[779] לְסַיְּעוֹ **was meant to be a great attendant to assist him** וְלַעֲשׂוֹת מְלַאכְתּוֹ **and to do his work** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין נט, ב). **(as stated in Sanhedrin 59b).** וְכֵן לֶעָתִיד **And so in the future** לֹא יִתְבַּטֵּל יֵצֶר דְּתַאֲוָה **the yetzer of desire will not be abolished;** רַק יִשָּׁאֵר הַחֵשֶׁק לַתּוֹרָה[780] **rather the yearning for Torah will remain,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וְאִיתָא מֵרַבֵּנוּ חַיִּים וִיטָאל זַ״ל **And it is brought from our master Rabbi Chaim Vital, of blessed memory** [רְאֵה סֵפֶר הַלִּיקּוּטִים **(see Sefer HaLikkutim,** שׁוֹפְטִים פֶּרֶק ה **Shoftim, chapter 5,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וּמַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב וְאַנְקָמָה] **s.v. "U'mah shekasuv ve'Ankamah"),** נָחָשׁ גִּימַטְרִיָּא מָשִׁיחַ[781] **that nachash has the numerical value of Mashiach;** וְזֶהוּ וְהִבִּיט אֶל נְחַשׁ שֶׁיְּקַח מִמֶּנּוּ חַיֵּי עוֹלָם **and this is "he would look at the copper serpent and live":** נְחֹשֶׁת וָחָי **that he take eternal life from it,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וּבַשּׁוֹפָר מָצִינוּ בַּיְרוּשַׁלְמִי **And regarding the shofar we find in the Yerushalmi** הוּבָא בְּתוֹסָפוֹת רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה טז ב **(cited in Tosafos, Rosh Hashanah 16b,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל כְּדֵי) **s.v. Kedei):** וְכַד שָׁמַע תִּנְיָין **"And when he hears it a second time,** אָמַר וַדַּאי זֶהוּ שֶׁיִּפּוֹצְרָא **he says: Surely this is the shofar** כּוֹפְלֵי[782] דְּיִתְקַע בְּשׁוֹפָר גָּדוֹל **of 'a great shofar shall be sounded,' etc."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּזֶה יְעוֹרֵר **That is, this will awaken** אַף לֵב הָאוֹבְדִים בְּאֶרֶץ אַשּׁוּר **even the heart of "those lost in the land of Ashur** וְהַנִּדָּחִים בְּאֶרֶץ מִצְרָיִם **and those cast away in the land of Egypt";** הַיְינוּ אַף שֶׁמְּשׁוּקָעִים בְּתוֹךְ **that is, even though they are sunk within the kelipah,** הַקְּלִיפָּה עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה עִלָּאָה **through supernal teshuvah** יִתּוּקַן הַכֹּל **everything will be rectified,** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כְּזַכְיוֹת **so that their sins become like merits —** נְהוֹרָא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא. **the light that comes forth from within darkness.** וְזֶהוּ עֵסֶק חֹדֶשׁ זֶה **And this is the work of this month:** לְתַקֵּן שֶׁהַשֵּׁינָה **to rectify things so that sleep** רַק כְּדֵי לָבֹא לִידֵי זְרִיזוּת **is only in order to come to alacrity,** לִהְיוֹת יָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה **to toil greatly in Torah,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְסָמוּךְ לְמַאֲמַר **And adjacent to the statement** לָא אִיבְּרֵי לֵילְיָא אֶלָּא לְשֵׁינְתָּא **"The night was created only for sleep"** (עֵירוּבִין סה, א) אִיתָא **(Eruvin 65a) it is brought:** לָא אִיבְּרֵי סִיהֲרָא אֶלָּא לְגִירְסָא[783] **"The moon was created only for study."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּמִדַּת לַיְלָה **That is, the attribute of**

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[777] **Pesikta Rabbati 13:4** — "What is 'After you, Binyamin'? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: Forever after you, Binyamin, to exact payment from Amalek's offspring. Know that a man from Amalek's offspring arose against Israel, and none stood against him except one from Binyamin's offspring. Who was this? Haman the wicked. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: By your life, a man from Binyamin's offspring is prepared to uproot your roots. Who was this? Mordechai, as it says, 'A Jewish man was in Shushan the capital, named Mordechai ... a Benjaminite.'" The preceding exposition also cites Yehoshua, of Ephraim, as a descendant of Rachel who fought Amalek. Thus the source supplies the Rachel–Yosef–Binyamin pattern developed here.

[778] **Kohelet Rabbah 11:8** — "'If a person lives many years'—let him rejoice in the joy of Torah. 'Let him remember the days of darkness'—these are the days of adversity. 'For they will be many': The Torah a person learns in this world is vapor before the Torah of Mashiach." The comparison expresses the vastness of the future disclosure. Rav Tzadok connects that new light in both modes of Torah with the final removal of Amalek.

[779] **Bnei Heichala, zemer for the third Shabbos meal** — "Rejoice now, at this hour, in which there is favor and no anger. Outside they go and do not enter, those brazen dogs. He will place them in their holes, and they will hide among the rocks." The stanza describes the removal of accusing forces during the hour of divine favor. Rav Tzadok's identification of those forces with Amalek explains the zemer through the Zohar passage that follows.

[780] **Yevamot 62a** — "Rav said: All agree that a slave has no recognized paternal lineage, for it is written, 'Stay here with the donkey'—a people likened to the donkey." The Gemara is addressing the legal recognition of lineage in slavery through the wordplay im/am. Rav Tzadok applies the traditional animal image to an inner trait; the source's immediate legal context should remain clear.

[781] **Vayikra Rabbah 26:7** — "Rabbi Aivu said: Two people practiced proper conduct, Avraham and Shaul. Of Avraham it says, 'Avraham rose early in the morning and took his two young men with him.' Who were they? Yishmael and Eliezer. Of Shaul it says, 'He went, and two men with him.' Who were they? Avner and Amasa." The Midrash's topic is taking companions on a journey. It identifies the two men left with the donkey in the Akedah account.

[782] **Pesachim 113b** — "Canaan commanded his sons five things: Love one another; love robbery; love sexual immorality; hate your masters; and do not speak truth." This list is the cited rabbinic portrait of Canaan's instruction, from which Rav Tzadok takes the particular connection with unrestrained desire.

[783] **Bamidbar Rabbah, Balak 20:14** — "This teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, cares for the honor of creatures and knows their needs, and therefore closed the animal's mouth. Had it spoken, people could neither subdue it nor

night תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is Torah she'b'al peh,** סִיהֲרָא דִּמְקַבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **the moon that receives from the sun,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **the Written Torah,** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **HaKadosh Baruch Hu,** [תְּהִלִּים פד, יב] כְּדִכְתִיב שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Tehillim 84:12),** כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן ה׳ **"For Hashem is a sun and a shield";** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ **and so we find** (תַּנְחוּמָא תְּשָׂא לו) **(Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 36):** וּכְשֶׁהָיָה מְלַמְּדוֹ עַל פֶּה **"And when He would teach him the Oral Law,** מִשְׁנָה וְאָמַר לָשׁוֹן לְגִירְסָא **Mishnah and Talmud,** כּוּלֵּי[784] הָיָה יוֹדֵעַ שֶׁהוּא לַיְלָה **he knew that it was night, etc."** **And it uses the term "for girsa,"** (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה יט, א) עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said (Avodah Zarah 19a):** לִגְרֹס אִינִישׁ **"A person should keep reciting his learning,** דְּלָא יָדַע מַאי וְאַף עַל גַּב **even though he does not know what he is saying."**[785] קָאָמַר. **And this alludes to good sleep:** וְזֶה מְרַמֵּז שֵׁינָה טוֹבָה שֶׁמִּתּוֹךְ **that because he sleeps a little,** שֶׁהוּא יָשֵׁן קְמָעָא **he rises and toils greatly in Torah;** עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה **and the toil is from the side of man,** וְהַיְגִיעָה הוּא מִצַּד הָאָדָם **even though he forgets.** אַף עַל גַּב דְּמִשְׁכַּח. **But to merit illumination in the heart,** אֲבָל לְזַכּוֹת לְהָאִיר בַּלֵּב [בִּרְכַּת אַהֲבַת עוֹלָם] כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים **as we say (in the blessing Ahavas Olam),** וְהָאֵר עֵינֵינוּ בְּתוֹרָתֶךָ **"And illuminate our eyes in Your Torah"** — זֶהוּ רַק מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **this is only from the side of Hashem Yisbarach.** (עירובין שם) וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **And about this they said:** אָמַר לְהוּ דִּימָמֵי נִינְהוּ **he said to them, "They are from the daytime."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said:** לָא אִיבְּרֵי סִיהֲרָא אֶלָּא לְגִירְסָא **"The moon was created only for study,"**[786] שֶׁזֶּהוּ מִצַּד הָאָדָם. **for this is from the side of man.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם אַף בַּלַּיְלָה **Nevertheless, even at night** יֵשׁ בְּחִינַת חֲלוֹם **there is the aspect of dreaming,** שֶׁהוּא אֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לִנְבוּאָה **which is one-sixtieth of prophecy** (ברכות נז, ב כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת); **(as stated in Berachos 57b);** וּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and Shlomo HaMelech, peace be upon him,** זָכָה בַּחֲלוֹם אֶחָד **merited, in a single dream,** לְכָל חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה **all the wisdom of Shlomo,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **Torah she'b'al peh.** וְאָמַרְנוּ דְּכֶתֶר מַלְכוּת **And we said that the crown of kingship** שֶׁזָּכָה שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that Shlomo HaMelech, peace be upon him, merited** — מַלְכוּת פֶּה **"Malchus is the mouth,"** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh** — הוּא אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is the light of Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁנּוֹתֵן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּמַתָּנָה **that Hashem Yisbarach gives as a gift,** וְהוּא עוֹשֶׁר הַדַּעַת **and it is the wealth of knowledge** מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **from the side of Hashem Yisbarach;** וְהַמְּנוֹרָה שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן **while the Menorah, which is also** בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the aspect of Torah she'b'al peh** — בֹּא וְהָאֵר לְפָנַי — **"come and give light before Me"** — הוּא מַה שֶּׁזּוֹכֶה הָאָדָם בִּיגִיעוֹ **is what a person merits through his toil,** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים **and it too is the words of the living God;** וְעַל זֶה יִתָּכֵן **and about this it fits:** מִתּוֹךְ שֶׁהוּא יָשֵׁן קְמָעָא **because he sleeps a little,** עוֹמֵד וְיָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה. **he rises and toils greatly in Torah.** וְזֶהוּ עִיקַּר הָעִסָּק בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **And this is the main work of this month:** לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע וְהַנָּחָשׁ **to rectify the blemish of the yetzer hara and the serpent,** שֶׁמַּשְׁלִיךְ קְרִירוּת וַעֲצָלוּת עַל הָאָדָם **which casts coldness and laziness upon a person** — תְּחִלַּת מַפָּלָה שֵׁינָה. **"the beginning of downfall is sleep."** וְעַל יְדֵי תִּקּוּן זוֹכֶה **And by rectifying it, one merits** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשֵּׁינָה **that through sleep** יַשִּׂיג זְרִיזוּת וְחֵשֶׁק **he attains alacrity and yearning,** וְיִהְיֶה יָגֵעַ בַּתּוֹרָה הַרְבֵּה **and toils greatly in Torah;** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן בְּרָזָא דְּמַאָה. **and this too is in the secret of the hundred.** וְזֶהוּ מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **And this is the eradication of Amalek:** לְשָׁרֵשׁ אַחַר פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **to uproot the serpent's blemish,** שֶׁהִכְנִיס הַתַּאֲוָה בַּאֲכִילָה **who brought desire into eating,** וְהַתַּאֲוָה שֶׁהֵטִיל זֶהֱמָא **and the desire through which he cast contamination;** וְעַל זֶה נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ קָדוֹשׁ **and therefore it was formed with the letter Kuf for Kadosh:** [וַיִּקְרָא יט, ב] קְדוֹשִׁים תִּהְיוּ [סִפְרָא קְדוֹשִׁים א] פְּרוּשִׁים תִּהְיוּ **"You shall be holy" (Vayikra 19:2) — be separate (Sifra, Kedoshim 1) —**

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stand against it: this was the most foolish of animals and he the wisest of the wise, yet once it spoke he could not stand against it." The Midrash contrasts Bilam's pretended mastery with the humiliation of being answered by his donkey. Rav Tzadok selects the animal's description as an image of foolishness.

[784] **Rashbam on Bava Basra 74a, s.v. Kol Abba and Chamra** — "'Every Abba is a donkey': Rabbah bar bar Chanah is Rabbi Abba bar Chanah, just as Ravina is Rav Avina. 'A donkey'—that is, a fool like a donkey." In the narrative a traveling companion rebukes Rabbah bar bar Chanah after he fails to count the tzitzis before returning a garment. Rashbam explains the pun on his name.

[785] **Nedarim 81a** — "Why is it not common for Torah scholars' sons to become Torah scholars? Rav Yosef said: So that they should not say Torah is an inheritance for them. Rav Sheshes son of Rav Idi said: So that they should not elevate themselves above the community. Mar Zutra said: Because they lord themselves over the community. Rav Ashi said: Because they call people 'donkeys.'" The passage criticizes arrogance toward the public. It is not an endorsement of using the animal term to degrade other people.

[786] **Sanhedrin 106a** — "What is the meaning of 'Shittim'? Rabbi Eliezer says: Shittim was its name. Rabbi Yehoshua says: They engaged in acts of foolishness." This is the wordplay on the setting of Israel's transgression with Moav. It stands beside the Gemara's interpretation of Rephidim as slackening in Torah, already cited in the preceding maamar.

וְנִקְרָא קָדוֹשׁ **and one is called holy;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זוֹכִין **and through this one merits** לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above:** [דָּנִיֵּאל ב, כב] נְהוֹרָא עִמֵּהּ שְׁרֵא **"and light dwells with Him" (Daniel 2:22),** נְהוֹרָא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֶשׁוֹכָא **the light that comes forth from within darkness;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִיכָה ז, ח] כִּי אֵשֵׁב בַּחֹשֶׁךְ **as it is said (Michah 7:8),** כִּי נָפַלְתִּי קַמְתִּי **"Though I fell, I rose;** **though I sit in darkness,** ה׳ אוֹר לִי: **Hashem is a light for me."**

ראשׁ חדֶשׁ אֲדָר שֵׁנִי, מַאֲמָר ב׳ Rosh Chodesh Adar Sheni — Maamar Bais

חֹדֶשׁ הָעִבּוּר מוֹסִיפִין **The leap month is added** כְּדֵי לְהַשְׁווֹת שְׁנוֹת הַלְּבָנָה **in order to equalize the years of the moon** עִם שְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה **with the years of the sun,** כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה תְּקוּפַת נִיסָן בְּנִיסָן[787] **so that the season of Nissan should fall in Nissan** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין יג, ב). **(as stated in Sanhedrin 13b).** וְהָעִנְיָן דְּהַקְפִּידָה תּוֹרָה לְהַשְׁווֹתָם **The reason the Torah insisted on equalizing them** הוּא דִּכְתִיב [יְשַׁעְיָה ל, כו] **is that it is written (Yeshayahu 30:26),** "וְהָיָה אוֹר הַלְּבָנָה כְּאוֹר הַחַמָּה וְאוֹר הַחַמָּה יִהְיֶה שִׁבְעָתַיִם[788] **and the light of the sun shall be sevenfold,** כְּאוֹר שִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים. **like the light of the seven days."** שֶׁהָעוֹלָם נִבְרָא **For the world was created** [בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה א, א][789] בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה, **through the words of Torah (Bereishis Rabbah 1:1),** וּבְיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן כָּתִיב יְהִי אוֹר **and on the first day it is written, "Let there be light,"** וַחֲמִשָּׁה פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה כְּתִיב בּוֹ **and "light" is written five times in it,** כְּנֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **corresponding to the five Chumashim of the Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם ג, ה) **(as stated there, 3:5);** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה אוֹר[790] **that is, "Torah is light."** וּכְשֶׁנִּתְלוּ הַמְּאוֹרוֹת **And when the luminaries were hung in place,** הָיוּ מֵאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן **they were from the primordial light,** נִגְנַז הָאוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן בְּמוֹצָאֵי שַׁבָּת[791] **was the primordial light hidden away on Motza'ei Shabbos** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם יב, ו) **(as stated there, 12:6),** וְרַק אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל **and only after the corruption** וְנִגְנַז **and it was stored away for the tzaddikim for the future to come.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כְּאוֹר שִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים **This is what it says, "like the light of the seven days,"** שֶׁבְּכָל שִׁבְעַת יְמֵי בְּרֵאשִׁית **for throughout all seven days of Creation** שִׁמֵּשׁ אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן. **the primordial light served.** וּבְכָל תְּשַׁע עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה **And every nineteen years** מִשְׁתַּוִּים שְׁנוֹת הַלְּבָנָה עִם שְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה **the years of the moon become equal with the years of the sun;** הַיְינוּ דְּאָז הַזְּמַן לִזְכּוֹת **that is, then is the time to merit** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אוֹר הַלְּבָנָה כְּאוֹר הַחַמָּה **that the light of the moon be like the light of the sun,** וְאוֹר הַחַמָּה יִהְיֶה שִׁבְעָתַיִם, **and the light of the sun be sevenfold,** וְכֵן לְעוֹלָם **and so forever,** עַד שֶׁיִּתָּקֵן הַכֹּל **until everything is rectified** כְּאוֹר שִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים. **like the light of the seven days.** וְנִרְמָז בַּכָּתוּב [תְּהִלִּים קכח, ה] **And it is hinted in the verse (Tehillim 128:5),** "יְבָרֶכְךָ ה׳ מִצִּיּוֹן **"May Hashem bless you from Tziyon,** וּרְאֵה בְּטוּב יְרוּשָׁלָיִם **and may you see the good of Yerushalayim":** בְּטוּ״ב גִּימַטְרִיָּא תְּשַׁע עֶשְׂרֵה **the letters of "BeTuv" have the numerical value of nineteen,** לִרְמֹז שֶׁבְּכָל תְּשַׁע עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה **to hint that every nineteen years** הֲכָנָה לִזְכּוֹת לְאוֹר כִּי טוֹב **there is a preparation to merit the light that "was good,"** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה אוֹר הַלְּבָנָה כְּאוֹר הַחַמָּה.[792] **so that the light of the moon be like the light of the sun.** וּבְכָל תְּשַׁע עֶשְׂרֵה שָׁנָה **And every**

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[787] **Sotah 3a** — "Reish Lakish said: A person does not commit a transgression unless a spirit of foolishness has entered him, as it says, 'If a man's wife turns astray'—tisteh is written." The derashah relates turning astray to foolishness. Rav Tzadok explains desire as a distortion in judgment that sacrifices enduring good for a passing moment.

[788] **Shabbos 152a** — "Rav Kahana said: What is meant by 'For He spoke and it was'? This is a wife. 'He commanded and it stood'—these are children. It was taught: A woman is a skin-bag filled with excrement, and her opening filled with blood, yet all pursue her." The teaching occurs in a discussion of aging and the divinely implanted force of sexual attraction. Rav Tzadok invokes its bodily image against the illusion that desire's momentary object is worth losing one's spiritual world.

[789] **Bereishis Rabbah 75:12** — "'I have an ox and a donkey.' The ox is Yosef, as it says, 'His firstborn ox has majesty.' The donkey is Yissachar, as it says, 'Yissachar is a strong-boned donkey.' Yosef's descendant will arise to destroy Amalek, as it says, 'Yehoshua weakened Amalek and his people by the sword.' Yissachar's sons know what the Holy One, blessed be He, does in His world, as it says, 'Of the sons of Yissachar, those who understand the times, to know what Israel should do.'" The Midrash already pairs Yosef's victory over Amalek with Yissachar's understanding. Rav Tzadok shows how both images can be redirected into holiness.

[790] **Avodah Zarah 5b** — "Rabbi Yochanan said in Rabbi Benaah's name: What does 'Fortunate are you who sow beside all waters, sending away the foot of the ox and donkey' mean? Fortunate are Israel: When they engage in Torah and acts of kindness, their inclination is delivered into their hands, rather than they being delivered into its hands. Sowing means charity, as it says, 'Sow righteousness for yourselves and reap according to kindness.' Water means Torah, as it says, 'All who are thirsty, go to water.'" Torah and kindness are the paired practices through which the forces represented by ox and donkey become subject to the person.

[791] **Bava Kamma 17a** — "One merits the inheritance of two tribes: The enclosure of Yosef, as it says, 'Yosef is a fruitful son; daughters tread upon the wall,' and Yissachar's inheritance, as it says, 'Yissachar is a strong-boned donkey.' Some say: His enemies fall before him as before Yosef, as it says, 'With them he shall gore peoples together to the ends of the earth'; and he merits understanding like Yissachar, as it says, 'Of the sons of Yissachar, those who understand the times, to know what Israel should do.'" The two versions attach different outcomes to the same tribes. Rav Tzadok specifically uses the second: victory over enemies and discriminating understanding.

[792] **Bereishis Rabbah 63:13** — "'I will make you blood, and blood will pursue you; because you hated blood, blood will pursue you.' Did Esav hate blood? Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman said: This is the blood of the birthright and sacrifices.

nineteen years, כְּשֶׁעוֹשִׁין שִׁבְעָה עִבּוּרִים[793] **when seven leap months are made,** מִשְׁתַּוִּים שְׁנוֹת הַלְּבָנָה **the years of the moon are equalized** עִם שְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה בְּקֵירוּב **with the years of the sun approximately,** וְנִקְרָא מַחְזוֹר **and this is called a cycle,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ״ם **as the Rambam wrote** (הִלְכוֹת קִדּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ פֶּרֶק ו הֲלָכָה י). **(Hilchos Kiddush HaChodesh 6:10).** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁמְּעַבְּרִין אֶדָר **And this is why it is Adar that is doubled:** לִהְיוֹת הֲכָנָה שֶׁיִּהְיוּ נִגְאָלִין בְּנִיסָן. **to be a preparation for being redeemed in Nissan.** וְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר נוֹצַר בְּאוֹת ק׳ **The month of Adar was formed with the letter Kuf,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה, **as it says in Sefer Yetzirah.** וְאִיתָא בְּהָאֲרַ״י ז״ל **And it is found in the Arizal,** בְּפֵרוּשׁ סֵפֶר יְצִירָה[794] **in his commentary on Sefer Yetzirah:** וְהוֹלֵךְ בְּצִינּוֹר מִבִּינָה לְחֶסֶד וְנִתַּן לְנַפְתָּלִי ק׳ וְכוּלֵי **"Kuf, etc., and it goes through the channel from Binah to Chesed, and it was given to Naftali,** וּמוֹלֵךְ עַל הַשְּׂחוֹק וּבָרָא וְכוּלֵי עַד כָּאן לְשׁוֹנוֹ **and it reigns over laughter, and He created, etc." End quote.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאוֹת קוֹף [שַׁבָּת קד, א], קָדוֹשׁ, **That is, the letter Kuf stands for "kadosh" (Shabbos 104a),** וְשׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקְּדוּשָּׁה **the root of holiness,** וְהַחֹדֶשׁ מְיֻחָד לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **to repair the blemish of the serpent; and the month is designated for the eradication of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא שֹׁרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **who is the root of the evil inclination,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הוּא הֲכָנָה **and through this it is a preparation** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ נִגְאָלִין בְּנִיסָן **for being redeemed in Nissan** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה) **(as explained above).** וְהַסֵּדֶר שֶׁיִּכָּנֵס הַקְּדוּשָּׁה לְלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל **As for the order by which holiness enters the heart of Yisrael,** אָמַר וְהוֹלֵךְ בְּצִינּוֹר מִבִּינָה לְחֶסֶד **he said, "it goes through the channel from Binah to Chesed."** בִּינָה מְרַמֵּז לִתְשׁוּבָה **Binah hints at teshuvah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה ו, י] **as it says (Yeshayahu 6:10),** וְיִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **"and his heart will understand, and he will return";** וּלְבָבוֹ יָבִין וְשָׁב **and Yitzchak Avinu, peace be upon him,** מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת גְּבוּרָה **is a chariot for the attribute of Gevurah,**[795] שֶׁהִיא נַפָּקָא מִבִּינָה **which issues from Binah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קעה, ב) **(as stated in Zohar II 175b);** וְאַחַר כָּךְ זוֹכִין לְאוֹר **and afterwards one merits the light:** יְהִי אוֹר זֶה אַבְרָהָם **"'Let there be light' — this is Avraham"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, ב, ג) **(as stated in Bereishis Rabbah 2:3),** שֶׁמִּדָּתוֹ חֶסֶד **whose attribute is Chesed,** חֶסֶד לְאַבְרָהָם. **as in "kindness to Avraham."** וְנִתַּן לְנַפְתָּלִי **"And it was given to Naftali":** [דְּבָרִים לג, כג] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Devarim 33:23),** נַפְתָּלִי שְׂבַע רָצוֹן **"Naftali, sated with favor** וּמָלֵא בִּרְכַּת ה׳ וְגוֹמֵר **and full with the blessing of Hashem, etc."** וְכָתַב הָרַמְבַּ״ן **And the Ramban wrote** [דְּבָרִים שָׁם דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל נַפְתָּלִי] **(Devarim there, s.v. Naftali),** מִסֵּפֶר הַבָּהִיר **citing Sefer HaBahir:** מַאי דִּכְתִיב וּמָלֵא בִּרְכַּת ה׳ **"What is meant by 'and full with the blessing of Hashem,** אָמַר מֹשֶׁה **Moshe said:** אִם תֵּלֵךְ בְּחֻקּוֹתַי **If you walk in My statutes,** שֶׁהוּא נְמָשָׁל לַיָּם וְכוּלֵי **which is likened to the sea, etc.** תִּירַשׁ הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **you will inherit the World to Come,** וּמַאי דִּכְתִיב יְרָשָׁה וְכוּלֵי **And why is it written 'yerashah,' etc.?** אֶלָּא אֲפִילּוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בַּכְלָל **Rather, even the Holy One, blessed be He, is included,** וְהַיְינוּ רֵישׁ יָהּ[796] וְכוּלֵי **and this is 'rash Yah,' etc.**

Rabbi Levi said: This is the blood of circumcision. The Sages said: You hated a person's blood within his body." The last explanation means that Esav did not let his victim's blood remain within the body. It is the particular interpretation Rav Tzadok contrasts with Yosef's sustaining other people.

[793] **Bava Batra 123b** — "Rabbi Chelbo asked Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani: 'When Rachel had borne Yosef'—what changed when Yosef was born? He answered: Yaakov our father saw that Esav's offspring are delivered only into the hands of Yosef's offspring, as it says, 'The house of Yaakov will be fire, the house of Yosef a flame, and the house of Esav straw.'" The Gemara explains Yaakov's readiness to leave Lavan after Yosef's birth. Rav Tzadok describes the moral reversal that makes Yosef the opposing force to Esav.

[794] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:3; Tanchuma, Chukas 6** — "'Chalkol'—this is Yosef, as it says, 'Yosef sustained' his household. The Egyptians said: Did this slave reign over us through anything other than his wisdom? They brought seventy slips with seventy languages written on them, placed them before him, and he read each in its own language. Moreover, he spoke the holy language, which they could not understand." The name Chalkol in I Melachim 5:11 is interpreted through Yosef's provision of food. This passage is 19:3 in the retrieved Bamidbar Rabbah division; Tanchuma, Chukas 6, also preserves it.

[795] **Yoma 26a** — "Rava said: You do not find a Torah scholar who renders authoritative instruction unless he comes from the tribe of Levi or Yissachar. Levi: 'They will teach Your judgments to Yaakov.' Yissachar: 'Those who understand the times, to know what Israel should do.' But why not Yehudah, since it says, 'Yehudah is My lawgiver'? I am speaking of bringing a teaching to its conclusion according to the halachah." The final answer identifies the special capacity at issue: reaching the correct halachic conclusion, rather than excluding the Torah learning of other tribes.

[796] **Tanchuma, Vayechi 11; Bereishis Rabbah 99:10** — "'Yissachar is a strong-boned donkey': Yissachar gives himself to Torah like a donkey to a burden, while Zevulun brings merchandise in ships. 'Crouching between the boundaries'—these are his students, who spread Torah in Eretz Yisrael before the Sages. 'He saw rest'—this is Torah. 'That it was good'—this is Torah, as it says, 'For I have given you good teaching.' 'He inclined his shoulder to bear'—the yoke of Torah." Bereishis Rabbah gives the same burden-bearing comparison in the following paragraph after Zevulun, numbered 99:10 in the retrieved edition, rather than 99:9. The burden here is the chosen

וְעוֹד אָמְרוּ אֵין יָם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה **And they further said: 'Sea' means nothing other than Torah,** [שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר (אִיּוֹב יא, ט] **as it says (Iyov 11:9),** וּרְחָבָה מִנִּי יָם וְכוּ' **'and broader than the sea,' etc.** אִם כֵּן יִהְיֶה סוֹד הַכָּתוּב **If so, the secret of the verse will be:** נַפְתָּלִי שְׂבַע רָצוֹן הַמְמֻלָּא בִּרְכַּת ה' **Naftali is sated with the Favor that fills the blessing of Hashem,** שֶׁהוּא הַיָּם וְכוּ' **which is the sea, etc."** וְסִיֵּם וְהַמַּשְׂכִּיל יָבִין **And he concluded, "and the wise will understand";** עַיֵּן שָׁם. **see there.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה מְיוּחָד **That is, this month is designated** לִזְכּוֹת לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for meriting the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** [שֶׁעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר (אִיּוֹב יא, ט] **of which it says (Iyov 11:9),** וּרְחָבָה מִנִּי יָם **"and broader than the sea";** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כְּבָר **and as we have already said,** תְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **in Torah she'bichsav** אוֹתִיּוֹתֶיהָ מְנוּמִים וּסְפוּרִים. **the letters are numbered and counted.** וּבְחֹדֶשׁ זֶה הֶדַר קִבְּלוּהָ **And in this month "they accepted it anew"** [שַׁבָּת פח, א בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ], **in the days of Achashverosh (Shabbos 88a),** וְהַיְינוּ לַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **meaning the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁעַל זֶה הָיָה הַכְּפִיַּת הַר כְּגִיגִית **for which the mountain had been held over them like a barrel,** (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ. **as they said (Tanchuma, Noach 3).** וְעַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה יְכוֹלִין לִזְכּוֹת **And through the Torah she'b'al peh one can merit** לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ מְשׁוֹרְשׁוֹ. **to repair the blemish of the serpent from its root.** יָם וְדָרוֹם. **"West and south":** יָם רוֹמֵז לְיוּד **"Yam" hints at the Yud** שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ לְכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **that shines forth upon Knesses Yisrael,** דְּהֵ' דָּלֶת הֲרֵיָת, **for the Hei is the Dalet of the Name Havayah,** וּמֵ"ם סְתוּמָה עָלְמָא עִלָּאָה בִּינָה[797] **and the closed Mem is the Upper World, Binah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רלו, ב) **(as stated in Zohar III 236b),** שֶׁרוֹמֵז שֶׁיּוּשְׁאַר הַקְּדוּשָׁה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד. **which hints that the holiness will remain forever.** יָ"ם גִּימַטְרִיָּא חֲמִשִּׁים, **"Yam" has the numerical value of fifty,** שֶׁהַבַּעַל תְּשׁוּבָה זוֹכֶה לְשַׁעַר הַחֲמִשִּׁים[798] **for the baal teshuvah merits the fiftieth gate,** שֶׁהוּא[799] מָקוֹם שֶׁבַּעֲלֵי תְּשׁוּבָה עוֹמְדִין **which is the place where baalei teshuvah stand** [בְּרָכוֹת לד, ב] **(Berachos 34b),** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. **as we have said several times.** וְדָרוֹם מִדַּת הַחֶסֶד כַּיָּדוּעַ **"And south" is the attribute of Chesed, as is known.** יְרָשָׁה רַשׁ יָהּ **"Yerashah" is "rash Yah":** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לִקְדוּשַׁת שֵׁם זֶה **one merits the holiness of this Name,** דְּחֶסֶד עִלָּאָה נִפְקָא מֵחָכְמָה **for supernal Chesed issues from Chochmah,** וּגְבוּרָה מִבִּינָה **and Gevurah from Binah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קעה, ב), **(as stated in Zohar II 175b):** יוּד חָכְמָה ה' בִּינָה. **Yud is Chochmah, and Hei is Binah.** וּמוֹלֵךְ עַל שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַשְּׂחוֹק בִּקְדוּשָׁה **"And it reigns over laughter":** **that laughter should be in holiness** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(as explained several times),** שֶׁהוּא כְּשֶׁזּוֹכֶה לִהְיוֹת שְׂבַע רָצוֹן הַשֵּׁם **which is when one merits to be sated with the favor of Hashem Yisbarach,** יִתְבָּרַךְ וְהוּא כְּשֶׁמַּאִיר מֵהַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ **and that is when it shines from the root,** מֵאָלֶ"ף פֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן. **from the Aleph, the supernal Wonder.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים קכו, ב] **Of this it says (Tehillim 126:2),** וְזֶה שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְדוּשַׁת חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **"Then our mouth will be filled with laughter."** אָז יִמָּלֵא שְׂחוֹק פִּינוּ. **This is the root of the holiness of the month of Adar:** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that one merits the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא מִטַּל דְּעַתִּיקָא **which is from the dew of Atika,** אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן **the primordial light** שֶׁנִּגְנַז לַעֲמֵלֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that was stored away for those who toil in Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּנְחוּמָא שָׁם), **as they said (Tanchuma, there);** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זוֹכִין **and through this one merits** לְתַקֵּן פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **to repair**

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labor of Torah.

[797] **Avodah Zarah 5b** — "'Sending away the foot of the ox and the donkey': The school of Eliyahu taught: A person should always set himself to the words of Torah like an ox to the yoke and a donkey to the burden." The two animals now express chosen submission and labor. Rav Tzadok relates the yoke to the restraint of aggression and the burden to the discipline of desire.

[798] Parallel: **R. Meir Leibush Weisser, Malbim on I Shmuel 15:2** — "His war had none of the reasons for which wars are ordinarily provoked. Its own cause was denial of God: after the peoples heard and trembled at the signs and wonders performed at the sea and in Egypt, he wished to fight Israel and demonstrate that Hashem could not save them. The main object of his war was thus opposition to Hashem. His hatred of Israel also arose from their ancestors, from Esav's enmity toward Yaakov, since Amalek descended from Esav."

Connection: Malbim reaches this conclusion after excluding conquest, defense of borders, an existing quarrel, military reputation, and religious devotion as ordinary motives for the attack. That analysis clarifies Rav Tzadok's precise claim that Amalek acted against reason despite the universal fear produced by the miracles; the issue is deliberate defiance of their divine source.

[799] **Rashi on Koheles 4:13** — "'A poor and wise child'—this is the good inclination, called a child because it enters a person only at thirteen. 'Poor'—because the limbs do not obey it as they obey the evil inclination. 'Wise'—because it instructs a person in a good path. 'Than an old and foolish king'—this is the evil inclination, which rules all the limbs. 'Old'—because it is present from birth. 'Foolish'—because it misleads him into a bad path. 'Who no longer knows to take warning'—having grown old, he accepts no rebuke." Rav Tzadok applies the verse's three descriptions —king, old and foolish—to Amalek as the root of inner opposition.

the blemish of the serpent, וְהוּא הֲכָנָה לִהְיוֹת בְּנִיסָן נִגְאָלִין: **and it is a preparation for being redeemed in Nissan.**

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר

Parshas Zachor

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר א׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Aleph

אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדֶּרֶךְ וְגוֹמֵר זָכוֹר אֵת אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְךָ עֲמָלֵק **"Remember what Amalek did to you on the way, etc.;** מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּדֶּרֶךְ שְׁתֵּי וְגוֹמֵר צְרִיךְ לְהָבִין[800] **we must understand how he happened upon you on the way, etc."** פְּעָמִים. גַּם מַהוּ עִנְיַן הַזְּכִירָה **why "on the way" is said twice. Also, what is the meaning of the remembering,** וּמַה סִּפֵּר לָהֶם **and what did he tell them?** וַהֲלֹא דּוֹר הַמִּדְבָּר יָדְעוּ מֵעַצְמָם **Did not the generation of the wilderness know it on their own,** שֶׁהָיוּ בְּנֵי דּוֹר שֶׁנִּלְחַם בָּהֶם. **being members of the very generation he fought against?** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן **But the matter is** עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **according to what they said** (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא ט) **(Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 9):** מַהוּ עֲמָלֵק **What is "Amalek"?** עַם יֶלֶק **A people of "yelek":** פָּרַח כְּזוֹחֵל **he flew like a creeping locust** (וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁתַּרְגּוּם יֶלֶק זוֹחֵל) **(that is, the Targum of "yelek" is "zochel");** עֲמָלֵק שֶׁבָּא לְלוֹק **Amalek, who came to lick up** דָּמָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּכֶלֶב. **the blood of Yisrael like a dog.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁנִּקְרָא עֲמָלֵק **That is, he is called Amalek** עַל שְׁנֵי הָעִנְיָנִים הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל **on account of the two matters mentioned above.** שֶׁפָּרַח כְּיֶלֶק **That he flew like a locust** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ אַחַר כָּךְ [שָׁם] בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **is what they said afterwards in the Midrash (there):** אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת פַּרְסָה עָמַד עֲמָלֵק **"Four hundred parsa did Amalek stride,** וּבָא לַעֲשׂוֹת מִלְחָמָה עִם יִשְׂרָאֵל[801] וְכוּ׳ **and he came to make war with Yisrael, etc."** וּבְפְשׁוּטוֹ שֶׁיָּשַׁב לִפְנִים מֵאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **In its plain sense, he lived far away from Eretz Yisrael,** שֶׁהָיָה אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת פַּרְסָה **a distance of four hundred parsa.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר הַמְכוּוָן **But it may be said that the intent is** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל הַקְּלִיפָּה דַּעֲמָלֵק **that it alludes to the kelipah of Amalek,** הַיְינוּ יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **namely the evil inclination,** (זֹהַר שְׁלַח חֶלֶק ג קס, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ. **as they said (Zohar, Shelach, III 160a).** וְהוּא (קִידּוּשִׁין פא, א) מַה שֶּׁמָּצִינוּ **This is what we find (Kiddushin 81a)** בְּרַבִּי מֵאִיר שֶׁהָיָה מִתְלוֹצֵץ בְּעוֹבְרֵי עֲבֵירָה וְכוּ׳ **regarding Rabbi Meir, who would mock transgressors, etc.:** לָא הֲוָה מַבְרָא וְכוּ׳ **"there was no ferry," etc. —** אִי לָאו דְּמַכְרִיזֵי בִּרְקִיעָא **"were it not that they proclaim in Heaven,** הִזָּהֲרוּ בְּרַבִּי מֵאִיר וְתוֹרָתוֹ[802] וְכוּ׳ **'Be careful with Rabbi Meir and his Torah,' etc."** וְהָיָה יָכוֹל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע לָבֹא **So the evil inclination was able to come** וּלְהָסִית לְרַבִּי מֵאִיר בְּדָבָר עֲבֵירָה **and entice Rabbi Meir to a matter of sin,** אַף דְּאִיתָא (עֵירוּבִין יג, ב) **even though it is stated (Eruvin 13b)** שֶׁהָיָה מֵאִיר עֵינֵי חֲכָמִים בַּהֲלָכָה.[803] **that he would illuminate the eyes of the Sages in halachah.** וְכֵן מִיתִּי שָׁם **Likewise it brings there,** בְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא שֶׁהָיָה מִתְלוֹצֵץ בְּעוֹבְרֵי עֲבֵירָה **regarding Rabbi Akiva, that he would mock transgressors,** וְרָצָה גַּם כֵּן לְהַכְשִׁילוֹ **and it sought to make him stumble as well,** וְאָמַר אִי לָאו דְּמַכְרִיזֵי בִּרְקִיעָא **and it said, "Were it not that they proclaim in Heaven,** הִזָּהֲרוּ בְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא

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[800] **Shemos Rabbah 26:3; Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10** — "Why did Moshe send Yehoshua? He said to him: Your ancestor said, 'I fear God,' whereas of this one it says, 'He did not fear God.' Let the descendant of the one who said 'I fear God' come and exact payment from the one of whom it says 'He did not fear God.'" Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10, likewise contrasts Yosef's fear with Esav's lack of fear; Pesikta Rabbati 12 develops the inherited confrontation. The maamar's reading of the phrase as Amalek's fearlessness follows this strand of the Midrash.

[801] **Bereishis Rabbah 68:2** — "'I lift my eyes to the mountains'—to the parents who taught and formed me. 'From where will my help come?' When Eliezer went to bring Rivkah, he took ten camels, whereas I have neither a ring nor a bracelet. Yaakov then said: Shall I lose my hope in my Creator? Heaven forbid! I will not lose my hope in my Creator. Rather, 'My help is from Hashem.'" In the Midrash Yaakov's lack of material resources becomes the occasion for reliance on Hashem. The maamar brings out its inner humility.

[802] **Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos 17, "From the companions"** — "At Minchah he arranges four loaves and says: 'This is the meal of Zeir Anpin, and the field of holy apples and Atika Kadisha come to dine with him.' It corresponds to Yaakov, the father of seventy souls, and through his merit one is saved from the wars of Gog and Magog." This is in the section headed "From the companions," which assigns the evening meal to Yitzchak, the morning meal to Avraham, and the afternoon meal to Yaakov. The text later gives additional mystical configurations; the maamar cites this patriarchal correspondence.

[803] Parallel: **R. Chaim of Volozhin, Nefesh HaChaim III:12** — "There is a great matter and wondrous means of removing and nullifying judgments and other wills, so that they cannot rule over a person or leave any impression. He establishes in his heart that Hashem is the true God, that no power exists anywhere in all the worlds apart from Him, and that everything is filled only with His simple unity. He inwardly nullifies all other powers, pays them no regard, and subjects and attaches the purity of his thought only to the one Master. He will then be enabled from above: the powers and wills of the world will fall away and be unable to act upon him."

Connection: Nefesh HaChaim describes the operative inward act in Rav Tzadok's account of Yaakov: recognizing that all power belongs to Hashem entails relinquishing the imagined independence of other forces. It explains why Rav Tzadok treats humility and recognition that everything comes from Hashem as the means by which Amalek's brazen opposing claim is excluded.

וְכוּלֵי[804] וְתוֹרָתוֹ **'Be careful with Rabbi Akiva and his Torah,' etc."** וְאַף שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this, even though they said** (מִדְרָשׁ חֲזִית רַבָּה יט, ו; תַּנְחוּמָא ח) **(Midrash Chukas Rabbah 19:6; Tanchuma 8):** כָּל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ [אִיּוֹב כח, י] **"'His eye has seen every precious thing' (Iyov 28:10) —** זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **this is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues;** דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא נִגְלוּ לְמֹשֶׁה **things that were not revealed to Moshe** נִגְלוּ לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו. **were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues."** וְהָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And he was the root of Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים מַהָאֲרִ״י זַ״ל.[805] **as we have said several times in the name of the Arizal.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם לֹא הָיָה מִתְבַּיֵּישׁ **Nonetheless, it was not ashamed** לְהַסִּיתוֹ לִדְבַר עֲבֵירָה **to entice him to a matter of sin,** אִי לָאו שֶׁנִּשְׁמְרוּ מִלְּמַעְלָה **had they not been guarded from Above.** וְעַל זֶה רוֹמֵז אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדֶּרֶךְ **And to this alludes "how he happened upon you on the way":** שֶׁהָיָה כְּעִנְיַן מִקְרֶה **that it was like a chance occurrence,** דָּבָר אֲשֶׁר לֹא יַעֲלֶה עַל לֵב[806] **a thing that would not enter one's mind.** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהָיוּ מִתְלוֹצְצִים בְּעוֹבְרֵי עֲבֵירָה **Since they would mock transgressors,** בְּוַדַּאי הָיוּ רְחוֹקִים מַעְנְיָן זֶה **they were certainly far removed from this matter,** מְאֹד מְאֹד **very, very far,** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם לֹא נִתְבַּיֵּישׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **and nonetheless the evil inclination was not ashamed** לְכָנוֹס לָהֶם לְפַתּוֹת. **to come at them to seduce them.** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ (קִידּוּשִׁין פא, ב) **Likewise we find (Kiddushin 81b)** בְּרַבִּי מֵאִיר שֶׁאָמַר **regarding Rabbi Meir, who said,** הִזָּהֲרוּ בִּי מִפְּנֵי בִּתִּי **"Be careful of me on account of my daughter,"** אַף שֶׁמּוּתָּר הַיִּחוּד עִמָּהּ **even though seclusion with her is permitted.** וְנִרְאֶה דְּזֶה הָיָה **And it seems that this was** דְּמִקּוֹדָם הָיָה מִתְלוֹצֵץ בְּעוֹבְרֵי אַחַר מַעֲשֶׂה הַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **after the incident mentioned above,** שֶׁלִּגְלֵג עַל רַבִּי עֲבֵירָה. **for beforehand he would mock transgressors.** וְכֵן זֶה הַתַּלְמִיד **And likewise that student** מִסְתָּמָא הָיָה רָחוֹק מֵעִנְיַן תַּאֲוָה **was** טַרְפוֹן [קִידּוּשִׁין שָׁם] **who scoffed at Rabbi Tarfon (Kiddushin there) presumably far from any matter of desire,** לֹא הָיוּ יָמִים מוּעָטִים **and nonetheless they said:** עַד שֶׁנִּכְשְׁלוּ אוֹתוֹ תַּלְמִיד בַּחֲמוֹתוֹ[807] **"Only a few days passed before that student stumbled with his mother-in-law";** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **And to this alludes what it says,** עֲמָלֵק יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב [בַּמִּדְבָּר יג, כט], **"Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev" (Bamidbar 13:29),** שֶׁפֵּרֵשׁ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ [שָׁם] **which the Zohar HaKadosh (there) explains:** הָא יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא וְכוּלֵי **"This is the evil inclination, etc."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב **That is, it dwells in the "land of the Negev,"** וּמְרַמֵּז שֶׁנִּכְנָס אַף לְלֵב קָדוֹשׁ כָּזֶה **alluding that it enters even such a holy heart** שֶׁמְּנוּוָּג מִכָּל חֶמְדָּה וְתַאֲוָה **that is dried out of all craving and desire,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁפֵּרְשׁוּ (תְּמוּרָה טז, א) **in the manner they expounded (Temurah 16a):** [יְהוֹשֻׁעַ טו, יט] אֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב נְתַתָּנִי **"'You have given me the**

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[804] **Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 11** — "Rabbi Berechyah said in Rabbi Abba bar Kahana's name: As long as Amalek's offspring exist, it is as though a covering-wing conceals the face. When his offspring are gone from the world, 'Your Teacher will no longer be concealed.'" The first image concerns the hidden Teacher; the second concerns the incomplete Name and throne. Rav Tzadok explains the former through the light of the Oral Torah.

[805] **Menachot 29b** — "Moshe returned before the Holy One, blessed be He, and said: Master of the world, You have such a person, and You give the Torah through me? He said: Be silent; so it arose in thought before Me. Moshe said: You have shown me his Torah; show me his reward. He said: Turn around. Moshe turned and saw Rabbi Akiva's flesh being weighed in the market. He said: Master of the world, this is Torah and this its reward? He said: Be silent; so it arose in thought before Me." The passage follows Moshe's vision of Rabbi Akiva expounding the crowns of letters. Rav Tzadok's reading of "before Me" as a level beyond thought is the maamar's mystical interpretation of the divine response.

[806] **Parallel: Shaar HaGilgulim, Introduction 35, paragraph 9** — "The severities of Atik Yomin, which are within Arich Anpin and from which the supernal Mother emerged, become revealed long before the kindnesses. One who is of this second aspect of the root of Kayin can ascend from degree to degree, from severity to severity, until the severity of Atik Yomin, and draw from there. This is why the Midrash says, 'Every precious thing his eye saw'—Rabbi Akiva: things not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva. The root of Hevel can attain the crowns of the letters, the tags, while this aspect of Kayin can attain the cantillation, or higher still. Nevertheless, Moshe our teacher subsequently attained everything through his immense deeds." The Ari's transmitted teaching links the very Midrash cited here to Rabbi Akiva's capacity to ascend to Atik Yomin. It gives a precise background for Rav Tzadok's explanation of Akiva's soul-root and attainment, while retaining the source's qualification that Moshe ultimately attained all through his deeds. Rav Tzadok states outright in Pri Tzaddik, Lag BaOmer 1, that Rabbi Akiva was the root of Torah she'b'al peh, "as is stated in the writings of the Arizal."

[807] **Berakhot 61b** — "When they took Rabbi Akiva out to be killed, it was the time for the Shema. They combed his flesh with iron combs, and he accepted the yoke of the kingdom of Heaven. His students asked: Our master, even to this point? He answered: All my days I was troubled over 'with all your soul'—even if He takes your soul. I said: When will it come to my hand and I fulfill it? Now that it has come to my hand, shall I not fulfill it? He prolonged 'One' until his soul departed with 'One.' A heavenly voice proclaimed: Fortunate are you, Rabbi Akiva, that your soul departed with One." The disciples' question and Rabbi Akiva's answer are essential to Rav Tzadok's interpretation: his final declaration completes a lifelong aspiration to cleave to Hashem.

land of the Negev' (Yehoshua 15:19) — בַּיִת שָׁמְנוּגָב מְכָל טוֹבָה וְכוּלֵי a house dried out of all good, etc., אָדָם שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה בִּלְבַד[808] a man in whom there is nothing but Torah alone" (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר תְּצַוֶּה מַאֲמָר ו[809] (as explained in Tetzaveh, maamar 6; עַיֵּין שָׁם) see there). וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר And of this it says, זָכוֹר אֵת אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְךָ עֲמָלֵק "Remember what Amalek did to you בַּדֶּרֶךְ בְּצֵאתְכֶם מִמִּצְרָיִם on the way, when you went out of Egypt": וְהַיְינוּ אַחַר שֶׁיָּצְאוּ that is, after they had gone out מִכָּל עֶשֶׂר כִּתְרִין דִּמְסָאֲבוּתָא from all ten crowns of impurity נָגוֹף לְמִצְרַיִם וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל through the ten plagues that corresponded to them, בְּעֶשֶׂר מַכּוֹת שֶׁכְּנֶגְדָּם striking Egypt and healing Yisrael, וְנִכְנְסוּ בְּעֶשֶׂר קְדוּשׁוֹת עֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת and they entered into the ten holinesses, the ten Sefiros, וְזָכוּ בְּמַכַּת בְּכוֹרוֹת and they merited, through the plague of the firstborn, לִהְיוֹת קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ to be bound to the root, בְּחִינַת כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן the aspect of Keser Elyon, וְנִקְרְאוּ אָז בְּנִי בְכוֹרִי יִשְׂרָאֵל and they were then called "My son, My firstborn, Yisrael" (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) (as explained several times); וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם יָכוֹל עֲמָלֵק לְהִתְעָרֵב בָּהֶם and nonetheless Amalek was able to attach himself to them. וְאָמַר אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדֶּרֶךְ And it says, "how he happened upon you on the way" — הַיְינוּ בַּדֶּרֶךְ that is, on the way שֶׁהָלְכוּ לְקַבֵּל תּוֹרָה מִסִּינַי. on which they were going to receive the Torah from Sinai. וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם לֹא נִתְבַּיֵּישׁ And nonetheless he was not ashamed to attach himself to you, אַף שֶׁהָיָה דֶּרֶךְ מִקְרֶה though it was a chance occurrence אֲשֶׁר לֹא יְאוּמַן כִּי יְסוּפַּר. that would not be believed if told. וּבָא לְלַמֵּד It comes to teach שֶׁיִּזָּהֵר הָאָדָם מִפִּיתּוּיֵי הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע that a person should beware of the seductions of the evil inclination וְלֹא יִסְמוֹךְ עַל גְּדוּלָּתוֹ and not rely on his greatness, וּקְדוּשָּׁתוֹ וּפְרִישָׁתוֹ his holiness and his separateness; וּכְמָה דְּתָנֵן [אָבוֹת פֶּרֶק ב מִשְׁנָה ד] as we learned in the Mishnah (Avos 2:4): אַל תַּאֲמִין בְּעַצְמְךָ עַד יוֹם מוֹתֶךָ[810] "Do not trust yourself until the day of your death," שֶׁאָז בְּוַדַּאי נִשְׁלְמוּ בֶּאֱמֶת for then they are certainly truly complete; וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [קֹהֶלֶת יב, ה] as it says (Koheles 12:5), כִּי הוֹלֵךְ הָאָדָם וְגוֹמֵר[811] "For man goes, etc.," שֶׁכָּל יְמֵי הָאָדָם for all the days of a man הוּא בְּחִינַת הוֹלֵךְ he is in the aspect of "going," לְהִתְבָּרֵר בְּמִדָּתוֹ to be refined in his attribute, שֶׁהוּא בֵּית עוֹלָמוֹ הַמְיוּחָד לוֹ which is his "eternal home" designated for him, עַד יוֹם מוֹתוֹ until the day of his death, שֶׁאָז when he is completed, שֶׁלֹּא יוּכַל לְקַלְקֵל עוֹד so that he can no longer spoil it, וְאֵין לוֹ עֵסֶק עוֹד בָּזֶה הָעוֹלָם and he has no more business in this world, וְאָז נָח[812] and then he rests. וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמַר [דְּבָרִים לא, מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם This is in the manner of what Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, said: לֹא אוּכַל עוֹד לָצֵאת וְלָבֹא [ב.[813] (Devarim 31:2) "I can no longer go out and come in." וּבִירוּשַׁלְמִי (שַׁבָּת פֶּרֶק א

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[808] **Sotah 36b** — "At that moment the image of his father appeared to him in the window. He said: Yosef, your brothers are destined to be inscribed upon the stones of the ephod, and you among them. Do you wish your name to be erased from among them? Immediately his bow returned to its strength. 'His arms became agile': He planted his hands in the ground, and his seed issued from between his fingernails. It was taught: Twelve tribes should have issued from Yosef as from his father Yaakov, but because of this emission they did not; nevertheless they issued from his brother Binyamin, and all were named in relation to Yosef." The Bavli describes the fingernails and the loss of ten potential tribes. The ten sparks and their relation to the martyrs are explained in Tikkunei Zohar, quoted next.

[809] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 69, 110a–b** — "In this yud Yosef sinned: 'His bow remained firm, and his arms became agile.' What is 'became agile'? A drop, which is yud, was cast between the ten fingers and divided into ten sparks cast from the bow, which is the covenant. Where were they cast? Into the ten martyrs. He asked: Have we not heard that the ten martyrs were Yaakov's sons? He answered: Heaven forbid; rather, they were in their image. Yosef received his consequence through these ten martyrs, corresponding to the ten tribes that should have issued from him." This account distinguishes the martyrs from a literal identification as Yaakov's sons and explains the number through Yosef's unrealized ten tribes. It is the specific kabbalistic interpretation used in this maamar.

[810] **Kesubos 103b** — "On the day of Rabbi's funeral a heavenly voice proclaimed: Everyone present at Rabbi's funeral is prepared for the life of the world to come. A certain launderer used to come before him every day, but that day he did not come. When he heard this he went up to the roof, fell to the ground, and died. A heavenly voice proclaimed: That launderer too is prepared for the life of the world to come." Rav Tzadok cites the repeated formula "prepared for the life of the world to come" in order to ask what specific addition that formula conveys in Rabbi Akiva's case.

[811] **Avodah Zarah 10b** — "A heavenly voice went out and said: Ketiya bar Shalom is prepared for the life of the world to come. Rabbi wept and said: One acquires his world in a single hour, and another acquires his world over many years." The narrative concerns Ketiya's defense of Israel before the emperor and his subsequent death. Its use of the same formula sharpens the question about Rabbi Akiva's announcement.

[812] **Pesachim 50a** — "I heard that those killed by the kingdom are of such a level that no person can stand in their enclosure. Who are they? If you say Rabbi Akiva and his companions—is it only because they were killed by the kingdom, and nothing more? Rather, it refers to those killed at Lod." The Gemara itself rejects making Rabbi Akiva's stature depend solely on the manner of his death. That is the force of Rav Tzadok's comparison.

[813] **Avodah Zarah 18a** — "Rabbi Yosei ben Kisma said: I speak to you with reason, and you answer me, 'Heaven will have mercy'? I would be surprised if they do not burn you and the Torah scroll in fire. Rabbi Chanina ben Teradyon

(הֲלָכָה ג, ח, א) **And in the Yerushalmi (Shabbos 1:3, 8a),** בְּחָסִיד שֶׁהָיָה שׁוֹנֶה **regarding a pious man who would teach:** כְּגוֹן אֲנִי **"Do not trust yourself** אַל תַּאֲמִן בְּעַצְמְךָ עַד יוֹם זִקְנוּתְךָ **until the day of your old age," such as myself,** וּמַה שֶׁאֵירַע לוֹ **and what happened to him;** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** וְאָמְרָה אִשְׁתּוֹ לְחַבְרָךְ **And she said, "Change it for your fellows,** לְשַׁנּוֹת[814] עַד יוֹם מוֹתְךָ **to teach 'until the day of your death,'"** וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְעַל זֶה בָּא הַמִּצְוָה לְזָכוֹר **And for this comes the mitzvah to remember** מַה שֶׁהָיָה כֹּחַ לַעֲמָלֵק **that Amalek had the power** לְהִזְדַּוֵּג לָהֶם בַּדֶּרֶךְ **to attach himself to them on the way** שֶׁיָּצְאוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם **on which they left Egypt,** שֶׁכּוֹלֵל כָּל הָרָע **which includes all evil,** בְּבְחִינַת סוּר מֵרָע **in the aspect of "turn from evil,"** וּבַדֶּרֶךְ שֶׁהָלְכוּ לְקַבֵּל הַתּוֹרָה **and on the way on which they went to receive the Torah,** בְּחִינַת עֲשֵׂה טוֹב **the aspect of "do good";** וְלִהְיוֹת הָאָדָם אַף כְּשֶׁהוּא **so that a person, even when he is** בְּמַעֲלָה עֶלְיוֹנָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה וְטָהֳרָה **at a supreme level of holiness and purity,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יִהְיֶה נִזְהָר **should nonetheless be careful** מִפִּיתּוּיֵי הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **of the seductions of the evil inclination,** עֲמָלֵק יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא. **Amalek, the evil inclination.** וְעַל שֵׁם זֶה נִקְרָא עַם יֶלֶק **And on account of this he is called "a people of yelek,"** שֶׁפָּרַח כְּיֶלֶק מֵאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת פַּרְסָה **who flew like a locust from four hundred parsa,** רוֹמֵז אַף לְמִי שֶׁמְּרוּחָק מִקְּלִיפָּתוֹ **alluding that even one who is distant from his kelipah** עַד הַתַּכְלִית **to the utmost,** וּמְנוּגָב מִכָּל חֶמְדָּה וְתַאֲוָה **and dried out of all craving and desire,** וּמְרוּחָק מֵהֶם **and as distant from them** כְּשִׁעוּר אַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת פַּרְסָה **as the measure of four hundred parsa,** מִדַּת כָּל הָאָרֶץ **the measure of the entire land —** מִכָּל מָקוֹם פּוֹרֵחַ כְּיֶלֶק. **he nonetheless flies to him like a locust.** וְעוֹד נִקְרָא עֲמָלֵק שֶׁבָּא לָלוֹק דָּמָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּכֶלֶב **He is further called Amalek because he came to lick up the blood of Yisrael like a dog,** עַל שֵׁם **and this is what it says,** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **"And he struck at your rear, all the stragglers, etc."** [דְּבָרִים כה, יח]; **(Devarim 25:18);** וְאִיתָא בִּפְסִיקְתָא רַבְּתִי (וְתַנְחוּמָא שָׁם י) **and it is stated (in Pesikta Rabbasi for Parshas Zachor, parsha 12, siman 13,** לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן יג **and Tanchuma there, 10):** זֶה שֵׁבֶט דָּן **"This is the tribe of Dan,** וְכוּלֵי[815] שֶׁפִּלָּטוֹ הֶעָנָן **whom the cloud expelled, etc."** וְלָהֶם הִכְנִיס הַיְאוּשׁ **And into them he brought despair** מִלְּשׁוּב בִּתְשׁוּבָה **of returning in teshuvah,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה פִּיתָּה אוֹתָם **and through this he seduced them,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמַר אַחֵר (חֲגִיגָה טו, א) **in the manner of what Acher said (Chagigah 15a):** הוֹאִיל וְאִטְרִיד הַהוּא גַּבְרָא **"Since that man has been driven out** מֵהַהוּא עָלְמָא **from that World,** לִיפּוֹק לִיתְהֲנֵי בְּהַאי עָלְמָא.[816] **let him go out and enjoy this world."** וְכָל כָּךְ גּוֹרֵר אוֹתָם הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **The evil**

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asked: My master, what is my portion in the world to come? He asked: Has any deed come to your hand? He answered: Money for Purim became mixed with charity money, and I distributed it to the poor. He said: If so, may my portion be from your portion and my lot from your lot." The exchange concerns Rabbi Chanina's continued public teaching under persecution. Rav Tzadok considers why a further deed is asked about despite his manifest devotion to Torah.

[814] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 7:8** — "Chananyah, Mishael and Azaryah went to Yechezkel and asked whether they should bow to the image. He answered: I have received from Yeshayahu my teacher, 'Hide for a little moment until the wrath passes.' They said: Do you wish that people should say every nation bowed to this image? He asked what they proposed. They answered: We wish to expose its defect by being there and refusing to bow, so that people will say all the nations bow to this image except Israel. He said: If that is your intention, wait until I consult the divine Power." The Midrash distinguishes hiding from deliberately appearing at the idolatrous ceremony. Rav Tzadok invokes that distinction in his speculative explanation of the exceptional public sanctification undertaken by the sages.

[815] Parallel: **Cf. R. Avraham de Boton, Lechem Mishneh, Hilchos Yesodei HaTorah 5:4** — "The Ran found no resolution for Elisha's self-sacrifice except that it was an act of piety. But our master holds that one who is not required to die and nevertheless does so incurs liability for his own life. How, then, did Elisha act? One may answer that our master holds that Elisha was required to surrender his life. … Rabbi Chanina ben Teradyon surrendered his life to engage in Torah. … Although the Ran can resolve all these cases as he resolved Elisha's, our master does not accept that approach: for him there is no special measure of piety here; all these figures surrendered their lives because they were obligated."

Connection: This is a differing reading of the legal premise Rav Tzadok here raises tentatively. Lechem Mishneh expressly includes Rabbi Chanina ben Teradyon and interprets Rambam as treating his self-sacrifice as obligatory, rather than as optional piety. Rav Tzadok's proposed explanation of the uncertainty about reward therefore follows one analysis of the legal situation, not an uncontested inference from Rambam.

[816] **Berakhot 61b** — "Pappus found Rabbi Akiva gathering assemblies publicly and teaching Torah. He asked: Are you not afraid of the kingdom? Akiva answered with a parable: A fox saw fish fleeing from the nets people cast upon them. He invited them to leave the river and live with him on dry land. They answered: You are called clever, yet you are foolish! If we fear in the place of our life, how much more in the place of our death. So too, if we fear while studying Torah, of which it says, 'It is your life and the length of your days,' how much more if we abandon it." The parable explains why withdrawing from Torah is not a safer form of life. Rav Tzadok reads Akiva's answer together with his lifelong wish to fulfill "with all your soul."

inclination drags them so far עַד שֶׁמְּבִיאָם לִידֵי חוּצְפָּה יְתֵירָה **that it brings them to extreme brazenness.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּפִסְיקְתָא (לַחֲנוּכָּה פָּרָשָׁה ז) **This is what they said in the Pesikta (for Chanukah, parsha 7)** וּבְתַנְחוּמָא (כִּי תֵצֵא שָׁם) **and in Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei, there):** לְפִי שֶׁלֹּא הָיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל יוֹדְעִין **"Because Yisrael did not know** מַה טִּיבָהּ שֶׁל זְמוֹרָה **what the nature of the 'zemorah' was,** עַד שֶׁבָּא עֲמָלֵק וְלִמְּדָה לָהֶם **until Amalek came and taught it to them,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְחֶזְקֵאל ח, יז] **as it says (Yechezkel 8:17),** וְהִנָּם שֹׁלְחִים אֶת הַזְּמוֹרָה וְגוֹמֵר **'And behold, they put forth the zemorah, etc.'** וּמִמִּי לָמְדָה **And from whom did he learn it?** מֵעֵשָׂו זְקֵנוֹ וְכוּלֵי **From Esav his grandfather, etc.:** וְאֵין חֵיכֵךְ בִּגְרוֹנוֹ וְהוֹצִיא אֶת הַזְּמוֹרָה **he cleared his throat and put forth the zemorah" —** לוֹ פֵּירוּשׁ.[817] **and this has no clear explanation.** וּבֶאֱמֶת בִּיחֶזְקֵאל ח׳ **In truth, in Yechezkel 8** הַפָּסוּק נֶאֱמַר עַל מַה שֶׁעָמְדוּ **the verse is said about their standing** אֲחוֹרֵיהֶם אֶל הֵיכַל ה׳ **"with their backs toward the Sanctuary of Hashem,"** וְרַשִׁ״י [יְחֶזְקֵאל שָׁם] פֵּירֵשׁ הַזְּמוֹרָה **and Rashi (Yechezkel there) explained "the zemorah"** עַל יָמָּ֫ הַיּוֹצֵא מֵאֲחוֹרֵיהֶם **as a sound coming out from their rear** וְרֵיחַ רַע **and a foul odor,** וְכֵן נִרְאֶה מִתַּרְגּוּם.[818] **and so it appears from the Targum.** אֲבָל בְּוַדַּאי זֶה הַחוּצְפָּה **But surely this brazenness** לֹא הָיָה אוֹפֶן שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִמְצָא בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **was not something that could be found in Yisrael;** רַק שֶׁחוּצְפָּה זוֹ הִכְנִיס עֲמָלֵק[819] **rather, it was Amalek who brought in this brazenness,** שֶׁהָיָה מְחוּצָף **for he was brazen:** [שְׁמוֹת טו, יד] דְּשָׁמְעוּ עַמִּים יִרְגָּזוּן **"Nations heard and trembled" (Shemos 15:14),** וְהוּא אַף שֶׁשָּׁמַע וְיָדַע הַכֹּל **and he, though he heard and knew everything,** נִכְנַס וְעָמַד בְּחוּצְפָּה **entered and stood in brazenness** וְנִזְדַּוֵּג לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **and attached himself to Yisrael.** וְזֶה לָמַד מֵעֵשָׂו זְקֵנוֹ **And this he learned from Esav his grandfather,** שֶׁאַף שֶׁחָשַׁשׁ מְאֹד עַל הַבְּרָכוֹת **who, even though he was very troubled about the blessings** שֶׁנִּתְבָּרֵךְ יַעֲקֹב מֵאָבִיו **with which Yaakov was blessed by his father,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הִתְלוֹצֵץ מִכֹּל וָכֹל **nonetheless scoffed at it all entirely,** וְחִיכֵּךְ בִּגְרוֹנוֹ וְהוֹצִיא אֶת הַזְּמוֹרָה. **cleared his throat and put forth the zemorah.** וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כז, ו) **Likewise it is expounded (Shemos Rabbah 27:6)** וְכֵן מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [שָׁם כא, יא] לֵץ תַּכֶּה וְגוֹמֵר [מִשְׁלֵי יט, כה] **that "Strike the scoffer, etc." (Mishlei 19:25),** וְכֵן מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב לְמַעְלָה **and likewise what it says (there 21:11),** בְּעָנְשׁ לֵץ וְגוֹמֵר **"When the scoffer is punished, etc.,"** עַל עֲמָלֵק שֶׁהָיָה לֵץ.[820] **refer to Amalek, who was a scoffer.** וְזֶה הִכְנִיס בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל. **And this is the matter of heresy.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן אֶפִּיקוֹרְסוּת **And this he brought into Yisrael,** בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְהִנָּם **so that they came to this brazenness,** שׁוֹלְחִים אֶת הַזְּמוֹרָה וְגוֹמֵר. **as it says, "And behold, they put forth the zemorah, etc."** וְזֶה דֶּרֶךְ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **This is the way of the evil inclination:** כְּשֶׁרוֹאֶה שֶׁהָאָדָם נִכְשָׁל בְּאֵיזֶה עָוֹן **when it sees that a person has stumbled in some sin** וּבְפִיתוּיוֹ בְּעֵצָתוֹ. **through its counsel and its seduction,** אַחַר כָּךְ מַשְׁלִיכוֹ בְּיֵאוּשׁ **it afterwards casts him into despair,** לוֹמַר מַה יּוֹעִיל לְךָ תְּשׁוּבָתְךָ **saying, "What will your teshuvah help you,** אַחַר כִּי גָּדוֹל עֲוֹנְךָ עַד לַשָּׁמַיִם **since your sin is so great, reaching to the heavens?** וְהוֹאִיל וְאִיטְרִיד הַהוּא גַּבְרָא **And since that man has been driven out** מֵעוֹלָם הַבָּא **from the World to Come,** לִיפּוֹק לְיִתְהֲנֵי בְּהַאי עָלְמָא **let him go out and enjoy this world."** וְעַל שֵׁם זֶה נִקְרָא עֲמָלֵק עַם לָק **And on account of this he is called Amalek, "am lak,"** שֶׁבָּא לָלוֹק דָּמָן שֶׁל

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[817] **Nazir 23b** — "Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: A transgression for the sake of Heaven is greater than a mitzvah performed not for its own sake. But Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: A person should always engage in Torah and mitzvos even not for their own sake, because from not for their own sake he comes to act for their own sake. Rather, say: It is like a mitzvah performed not for its own sake. For it is written, 'Blessed among women is Yael, wife of Chever the Kenite; among women in the tent she shall be blessed.'" The Gemara corrects "greater than" to "like." Rav Tzadok preserves that correction in comparing the special act here with a mitzvah not performed for its own sake.

[818] **Shabbos 63a; Rashi, s.v. Lamayminin and Lamasme'ilin** — "'Length of days is in her right hand; in her left, wealth and honor.' Does the right have length of days but not wealth and honor? Rather: For those who take the right side in Torah, there is length of days, and certainly wealth and honor. For those who take the left side, there is wealth and honor, but no length of days." Rashi first explains the right side as scrutinizing Torah's reasons carefully and selecting them skillfully, while the left neglects sufficient effort. He then gives an alternative: the right studies for its own sake, the left not for its own sake. Rav Tzadok uses this second explanation.

[819] **Berakhot 61b** — "The ministering angels said before the Holy One, blessed be He: This is Torah, and this its reward? 'From men, by Your hand, Hashem; from men ...'! He answered: 'Their portion is in life.' A heavenly voice proclaimed: Fortunate are you, Rabbi Akiva, that you are prepared for the life of the world to come." The maamar returns to these concluding words after asking what the promise adds to Akiva's already assured stature. It reads "their portion" as the spiritual attainment effected through this very act.

[820] **Zohar II 65b, Beshalach** — "Rabbi Shimon said that the accusation was against the Holy One above, and below too it was against Him: They took men, cut away the sacred sign, lifted it and threw it upward, saying, 'Take what You desired.' The whole confrontation was directed against the Holy One." The mockery attacks the sign of the covenant. The Zohar calls this a confrontation directed against the Holy One both above and below.

יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּכֶלֶב **who came to lick up the blood of Yisrael like a dog,** שֶׁבָּא לִמְצוֹץ שְׁאֵרִית דָּמָם וְחִיּוּתָם **who came to suck out the remnant of their blood and vitality** עַד תַּכְלִיתוֹ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **to the very end, as mentioned above.** וּבָא הַמִּצְוָה תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **And the mitzvah "You shall erase the memory of Amalek" comes** עַל שְׁנֵי הָעִנְיָנִים. **regarding both matters:** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאַף הַגָּדוֹל בְּמַעֲלָה **namely, that even one who is great in stature** וּקְדוּשָּׁה יְתֵירָה **and of exceptional holiness** לֹא יִסְמוֹךְ עַל קְדוּשָּׁתוֹ **should not rely on his holiness,** וְיִזָּהֵר מִפִּיתּוּיֵי הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. **and should beware of the seductions of the evil inclination;** וְאַף מִי שֶׁנִּכְשַׁל חַס וְשָׁלוֹם מַה **and even one who has stumbled in something, Heaven forbid,** לֹא יִתְיָאֵשׁ מִן הַתְּשׁוּבָה[821] **should not despair of teshuvah,** וְיָשׁוּב אֶל ה׳ וִירַחֲמֵהוּ. **but should return to Hashem, and He will have mercy on him.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **And regarding this it says** (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא ד) וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **And regarding this they said (Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 4):** אָמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל רִבּוֹנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **"Yisrael said: Master of the World,** אֵין אָנוּ יְכוֹלִין בּוֹ **we cannot prevail over him.** אָמַר לָהֶם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **The Holy One, blessed be He, said to them:** תִּהְיוּ אַתֶּם מַזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַטָּה **You mention his name below,** וַאֲנִי מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַעְלָה[822] וְכוּ׳ **and I will erase his name above, etc."** וְהַיְינוּ מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what it says,** [תְּהִלִּים לז, לג] הוּא מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **is what it says (Tehillim 37:33),** ה׳ לֹא יַעַזְבֶנּוּ בְיָדוֹ **"Hashem will not leave him in his hand,"** שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ (סוּכָּה נב, ב) עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **which is expounded (Sukkah 52b) about the evil inclination:** שֶׁאִלְמָלֵא הָקָדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עוֹזְרוֹ **were it not that the Holy One, blessed be He, helps him,** אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ **he could not overcome it,** וַה׳ לֹא יַעַזְבֶנּוּ בְיָדוֹ. **"and Hashem will not leave him in his hand."** וְאָמַר אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ **And it says "asher karcha,"** וְנִדְרָשׁ בְּפֶסִיקְתָא **which is expounded in the Pesikta** (לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן יג) **(for Parshas Zachor, parsha 12, siman 13)** וְתַנְחוּמָא (שָׁם ט) **and Tanchuma (there, 9):** קָרְךָ טִמְּאֲךָ וְכוּ׳. **"Karcha — he defiled you, etc.,"** מִקְרֶה לַיְלָה **with a nocturnal emission;** שֶׁזֶּהוּ עִיקַּר שֹׁרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **for this is the main root of the evil inclination,** שֶׁעָלָיו אָמְרוּ (קִידּוּשִׁין ל, ב) **about which they said (Kiddushin 30b):** בָּרָאתִי יֵצֶר הָרָע **"I created the evil inclination,** וּבָרָאתִי לוֹ תּוֹרָה תַּבְלִין[823] **and I created Torah as its antidote";** שֶׁזֶּה הַיֵּצֶר בָּרָא ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **for Hashem Yisbarach created this inclination** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לְטוֹב **to be for good,** חֵשֶׁק לְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **a longing for words of Torah,** וְאַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רַע **and you make it evil,** לְעִנְיְנֵי תַּאֲוָה **for matters of lust,** שֶׁהָיָה בְּתַאֲוָה בַּאֲכִילָה **which was through desire in eating,** עַל יְדֵי פִּיתּוּי הַנָּחָשׁ **through the seduction of the serpent,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ הִטִּיל זוהֲמָא בְּחַוָּה **and afterwards he injected filth into Chavah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קמו, א) **(as stated in Shabbos 146a),** וְנִדְבַּק הַזּוהֲמָא בְּאָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן וְזַרְעוֹ. **and the filth clung to Adam HaRishon and his offspring.** וְעַל יֵצֶר הָרָע זֶה **And about this evil inclination** אָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה נב, א) **they said (Sukkah 52a):** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא קְרָאוֹ רָע[824] **"The Holy One, blessed be He, called it 'evil'";** וְהַיְינוּ יֵצֶר תַּאֲוָה **that is, the inclination of lust** שֶׁל דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל **of the generation of the Flood,** שֶׁהַפּוֹגֵם נִקְרָא רַע בְּעֵינֵי ה׳[825] **for one**

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[821] **Tanchuma, Mishpatim 5; Shemos Rabbah 30:12** — "Hadrian said: You should have learned Torah without becoming circumcised. Akylas answered: Have you ever given a soldier his allowance unless he took his weapon? So too, if a person is not circumcised, he cannot learn Torah, as it says, 'He declares His words to Yaakov'—to one circumcised like Yaakov. 'He has not done so for any nation,' because they are uncircumcised." Shemos Rabbah 30:12 preserves the same exchange and Akylas's praise of the truth of Israel's Torah. Rav Tzadok uses the dialogue to explain why Amalek targeted the covenant before the giving of Torah.

[822] **Nedarim 31b** — "If one vows, 'I may not benefit from the uncircumcised,' he may benefit from uncircumcised Israelites but may not benefit from circumcised members of the nations. If he vows, 'I may not benefit from the circumcised,' he may not benefit from uncircumcised Israelites but may benefit from circumcised members of the nations. For uncircumcision is used as the designation of the nations, as it says, 'All the nations are uncircumcised, and all the house of Israel are uncircumcised of heart.'" The Mishnah is interpreting the communal language of a vow. Rav Tzadok draws from it the distinction between the physical operation alone and entry into Israel's covenant.

[823] **Shabbos 138b** — "'The word of Hashem'—this is halachah. 'The word of Hashem'—this is the end of exile. 'The word of Hashem'—this is prophecy." The sugya interprets the hunger to hear Hashem's word in Amos 8. Rav Tzadok takes its first identification, halachah, when reading "the word of Hashem from Jerusalem."

[824] **Sanhedrin 86b** — "If they have not heard a ruling, both groups come to the Great Court in the Chamber of Hewn Stone, from which Torah goes forth to all Israel, as it says, 'From that place which Hashem will choose.' If the elder returns to his city and teaches as he formerly taught, he is exempt; if he instructs people to act, he is liable. He is not liable until he instructs them to act." The Mishnah locates final public legal authority in the Temple court. That concrete institution supplies the maamar's association between Jerusalem and the unfolding of Oral Torah.

[825] **Tanchuma, Chukas 18; Bamidbar Rabbah 19:20** — "When Aharon died, the clouds of glory departed and Israel appeared like a woman whose hair was uncovered. Who was the king of Arad? This was Amalek, as it says, 'Amalek dwells in the land of the south.' He sat at the breach. When he heard that Aharon had died and the clouds of glory had departed, he immediately attacked them." Bamidbar Rabbah 19:20 gives the same identification and explains why Scripture calls him a Canaanite. Rav Tzadok places this renewed attack at the threshold of Eretz Yisrael and the Oral

who blemishes in this is called "evil in the eyes of Hashem," כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the Zohar HaKadosh** (חֶלֶק א רִיט, ב וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **(I 219b, and elsewhere)** ([826]נִדָּה יג, ב). וּבְגְמָרָא **and in the Gemara (Niddah 13b).** וּבָזֶה מָצִינוּ **And in this we find** שֶׁכָּל הַגָּדוֹל מֵחֲבֵירוֹ **that whoever is greater than his fellow,** [סוּכָּה שָׁם][827] יִצְרוֹ גָּדוֹל הֵימֶנּוּ; **his inclination is greater than he (Sukkah there);** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר אַבָּיֵי **as Abaye said,** אִי מָאן דְּסָנֵי לִי הֲוָה לָא הֲוָה מָצֵי לְאוֹקְמֵי נַפְשֵׁיהּ **"Had it been one who hates me, he would not have been able to restrain himself"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּסוּכָּה שָׁם **(as they said in Sukkah there,** [828]וְנִתְבָּאֵר תְּרוּמָה מַאֲמָר ח) **and explained in Terumah, maamar 8).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדֶּרֶךְ. **And this is what it says, "how he happened upon you on the way."** וּבַהַפְטָרָה **And in the Haftarah** [לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר שְׁמוּאֵל א טו, ב] **(for Parshas Zachor, Shmuel I 15:2):** פָּקַדְתִּי אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה עֲמָלֵק לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **"I have remembered what Amalek did to Yisrael,** אֲשֶׁר שָׂם לוֹ בַּדֶּרֶךְ וְגוֹמֵר[829] **how he set upon him on the way, etc."** וְאִם קָאֵי עַל הַמִּלְחָמָה **Now if it refers to the war,** הֲלֹא רַבִּים צָרְרוּנוּ תָּמִיד **have not many always oppressed us?** וְהַיְוָנִים גָּזְרוּ גְּזֵרַת שְׁמָד **And the Greeks decreed religious persecution** בִּימֵי הַחַשְׁמוֹנָאִים יוֹתֵר מֵעֲמָלֵק **in the days of the Chashmona'im, more than Amalek did.** אַךְ הָעִיקָּר מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר אַחַר כָּךְ **But the main thing is what is said afterwards,** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדֶּרֶךְ **"how he happened upon you on the way":** שֶׁטִּמְּאָךְ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **that he defiled you, as mentioned above;** וַיְזַנֵּב בְּךָ כָּל הַנֶּחֱשָׁלִים **"and he struck at your rear, all the stragglers":** שֶׁהִכְנִיס הַיֵּאוּשׁ בַּנֶּחֱשָׁלִים **that he brought despair into the stragglers,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ. **as we have said.** (שַׁבָּת קיח, ב וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is the meaning of what they said (Shabbos 118b):** לֹא אִלְמָלֵא שָׁמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל שַׁבָּת רִאשׁוֹנָה **"Had Yisrael kept the first Shabbos,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר[830] לֹא שָׁלְטָה בָּהֶן אוּמָּה וְלָשׁוֹן **no nation or tongue would have ruled over them,** [שְׁמוֹת טז, כז] **as it says (Shemos 16:27),** וַיְהִי בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי יָצְאוּ וְגוֹמֵר **'And it was on the seventh day, they went out, etc.,'** וּכְתִיב בַּתְרֵיהּ [שָׁם יז, ח] **and right after it is written (there 17:8),** וַיָּבֹא עֲמָלֵק. **'And Amalek came.'"** וְלִכְאוֹרָה אֵינוֹ מוּבָן **At first glance this is not understood,** דְּהָא עֲמָלֵק לֹא שָׁלַט בָּהֶם כְּלָל, **for Amalek did not rule over them at all,** שֶׁיְּהוֹשֻׁעַ הֶחֱלִישׁ אוֹתָם. **Yehoshua weakened them.** וְאַחַר הַמִּלְחָמוֹת הֵעִידָה רָחָב **And after the wars Rachav**

Torah.

[826] **Eruvin 21b** — "'New as well as old, my beloved, I have stored away for you': The congregation of Israel said before the Holy One, blessed be He: Master of the world, I have imposed many decrees upon myself beyond what You decreed upon me, and I have fulfilled them." The additional decrees are presented as Israel's loving offering. The maamar contrasts that motive with Haman's accusation that separation comes from pride or hatred.

[827] **Avodah Zarah 36a** — "Rav said: Scripture says, 'Daniel resolved in his heart not to defile himself with the king's food and the wine of his drinkings.' It speaks of two drinkings: wine and oil. Rav held that he resolved in his own heart and instructed all Israel; Shmuel held that he resolved in his heart but did not instruct all Israel. The Gemara then explains Rav's account: Daniel decreed against oil in the city, and the later Sages extended the decree even to the field." The source distinguishes Daniel's initiating restriction from the broader enactment attributed to the students of Hillel and Shammai. Rav Tzadok focuses on the emergence of these protective practices.

[828] **Avodah Zarah 36b** — "They decreed against their bread and oil because of their wine; against their wine because of their daughters; and against their daughters because of another matter. But is the prohibition concerning their daughters not biblical, 'You shall not intermarry with them'? The biblical prohibition concerns the seven nations; the Sages came and extended the decree to the other nations." The Gemara describes safeguards against intermarriage and idolatry. On 36a Rav derives a decree from Daniel's abstention, while Shmuel reads it as personal resolve. The maamar follows the tradition assigning Daniel an initiating role.

[829] **Megillah 13b** — "'Their laws differ from every people': They do not eat of ours; they do not marry our women, nor give their women in marriage to us. 'They do not observe the king's laws': They pass the year with their excuses and holidays. 'It is not worthwhile for the king to leave them': They eat and drink and disparage the king. Even if a fly falls into one of their cups, he throws it out and drinks; but if my lord the king touches the cup, he dashes it to the ground and will not drink." These are the malicious allegations attributed to Haman. Rav Tzadok reads the earthly accusation as also challenging the intention behind Israel's safeguards, not as the Gemara's own judgment about their motive.

[830] Parallel: **Tanya, Likkutei Amarim 41** — "With tefillin in particular, one should annul and include the wisdom and understanding of his divine soul within the wisdom and understanding of the Infinite One, blessed be He, clothed particularly in the passages 'Sanctify' and 'When He will bring you.' He should use his soul's wisdom and understanding for Hashem alone. So too, he should annul and include his soul's knowledge, embracing the love and fear in his heart, within the supernal Knowledge clothed in 'Hear' and 'If you will listen'—as stated in Shulchan Aruch, to subject the heart and the mind."

Connection: Tanya spells out the inward service signified by tefillin: the intellect and heart themselves enter divine service. This clarifies Rav Tzadok's distinction between tefillin merely resting on the head and an attachment that reaches into the mind. It is a parallel to that idea, rather than an identification of the unnamed teacher quoted in the

testified, וְנִשְׁמַע וַיִּמַּס לְבָבֵנוּ **"We heard, and our hearts melted,** וְלֹא קָמָה עוֹד רוּחַ בְּאִישׁ מִפְּנֵיכֶם[831] **and no spirit remained any longer in any man because of you"** [יְהוֹשֻׁעַ ב, יא]. **(Yehoshua 2:11).** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִכְנְסוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְאֶרֶץ **And afterwards Yisrael entered Eretz Yisrael,** וְנִבְנָה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **and the Beis HaMikdash was built,** יִשְׂרָאֵל **and there were the days of Shlomo,** וְהָיוּ יְמֵי שְׁלֹמֹה וְכָל יְמֵי בֵּית רִאשׁוֹן **and all the days of the First Temple,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בַּיִת שֵׁנִי. **and afterwards the Second Temple.** אַךְ הָעִיקָּר אֲשֶׁר שָׁם לוֹ בַּדֶּרֶךְ **But the main thing is "how he set upon him on the way":** וְהִכְנִיס עֲמָלֵק הַיֵּאוּשׁ בַּנִּכְשָׁלִים[832] **Amalek brought despair into those who stumbled,** עַד שֶׁבָּא לָלוֹק שְׁאֵרִית דָּמָם וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה גִּירַר אוֹתָם **and through this he dragged them along until he came to lick up the remnant of their blood** וְהַחִיּוּת שֶׁבָּהֶם **and the vitality within them;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה גָּרַם לָהֶם **and through this Amalek caused them the subjugation** עֲמָלֵק הַשִּׁעְבּוּד שֶׁבָּא אַחַר כָּךְ לִזְמַן רָחוֹק **that came afterwards, a long time later.** דְּלוּלֵי מִלְחֶמֶת עֲמָלֵק **For were it not for the war of Amalek** וּמַה שֶּׁהִכְנִיס בְּלִבָּם **and the despair he brought into their hearts,** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** הָיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל נִשְׁאָרִים בְּאוֹתוֹ הַיֵּאוּשׁ **Yisrael would have remained in the same state** מַצָּב שֶׁהָיוּ בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **they were in at Matan Torah,** חֵרוּת מִשִּׁעְבּוּד[833] [רְאֵה עֵירוּבִין נד, א] **freedom from subjugation (see Eruvin 54a),** וְלֹא הָיוּ מִתְקַלְקְלִים לְעוֹלָם. **and they would never have been spoiled.** רַק עֲמָלֵק גָּרַם לָהֶם **Only Amalek caused it for them,** עַל יְדֵי הַפִּיתּוּי **through the seduction** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל וְאַחַר כָּךְ הַיֵּאוּשׁ. **and afterwards the despair, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה גָּרַם מַה שֶּׁלֹּא שָׁמְרוּ שַׁבָּת רִאשׁוֹנָה. **And this is what caused them not to keep the first Shabbos.** וְעַל כֵּן בָּא הַמִּצְוָה **Therefore the mitzvah comes:** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **"You shall erase the memory of Amalek,"** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמַּזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַטָּה **through our mentioning his name below,** וַה' יִתְבָּרַךְ מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַעְלָה **and Hashem Yisbarach erases his name above** וּמְבַטֵּל כָּל כֹּחוֹ **and nullifies all his power;** שֶׁמַּבְאִים לְטַהֵר מְסַיְּעִין אוֹתוֹ.[834] **for one who comes to purify himself is given help.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **And this is the meaning of reading the parsha** קֹדֶם פּוּרִים בְּכָל שָׁנָה **before Purim every year:** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִזְכֶּה לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק כָּרָאוּי **that through this we will merit to carry out the eradication of Amalek properly.** וּמַזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ בַּשַּׁבָּת שֶׁקֹּדֶם לוֹ **And we mention his name on the Shabbos before it** כְּדֵי שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לִמְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק בְּפוּרִים **so that we will merit the eradication of Amalek on Purim,** וּמִיָּד נִגְאָלִין בְּנִיסָן **and immediately be redeemed in Nissan** [רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יא, א]: **(Rosh Hashanah 11a).**

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maamar.

[831] Parallel: **R. Levi Yitzchak of Berditchev, Kedushas Levi, Derush lePurim, s.v. Od yevo'ar: shalchah lahem Esther** — "Oral Torah varies according to the sages of the generations: one says one thing and another says another, and the conduct of halachah follows the generations. … In truth Israel loved to receive Torah, saying, 'We will do and we will hear'; but initially they did not wish to receive Oral Torah. … They found it difficult that Oral Torah should vary according to the will of the righteous sage of each generation, who draws down the attribute through which the world is governed. This is why the Sages said, 'They accepted it again in the days of Achashverosh': through love of the miracle they accepted this too. Mordechai and Esther brought about that acceptance."

Connection: Kedushas Levi locates the difficulty of accepting Oral Torah specifically in its continuing realization through the sages of successive generations. This clarifies why Rav Tzadok says the accusation against Oral Torah must be overcome afresh: acceptance embraces living Torah authority as it continues to unfold, beyond a single historical giving of Torah. Kedushas Levi explains this through changing divine attributes, a formulation distinct from Rav Tzadok's present account of accusation.

[832] **Megillah 30a** — "Rav says to advance the reading, so that performance should not precede remembrance. Shmuel says to postpone it: Since the walled cities perform Purim on the fifteenth, performance and remembrance occur together." The discussion concerns Purim falling on Friday and the scheduling of Parshas Zachor. Rav Tzadok adopts Rav's ordering of remembrance before the act of Purim.

[833] **Havdalah, introductory verses** — "'The Jews had light, joy, gladness and honor.' So may it be for us. 'I shall lift the cup of salvations and call upon the name of Hashem.'" The addition "So may it be for us" turns the verse into a prayer at the passage from Shabbos into the working week. Rav Tzadok explains that prayer through the continuing removal of Amalek's inner accusation.

[834] **Turei Even, Megillah 2a, s.v. Megillah nikreis** — "Why did the Mishnah not teach, 'They read the Megillah on the eleventh,' as it teaches later in the second chapter, 'They do not read the Megillah'? One can answer that the times differ for different people: those of walled cities, towns and villages. One group's time is not another's, and not everyone reads on all these days. It therefore teaches, 'The Megillah is read,' since its reading does occur on all these days among different people. Still, perhaps the wording is not so exacting." Turei Even offers the practical distinction between communities as an answer, while leaving room to question the precision of the formulation. Rav Tzadok instead develops its passive wording as an allusion to the light imparted from above.

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר ב׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Bais

וְהָיָה בְּהָנִיחַ ה׳ אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְךָ מִכָּל אוֹיְבֶיךָ מִסָּבִיב **"And it shall be, when Hashem your God gives you rest from all your enemies round about,** בָּאָרֶץ וְגוֹמֵר **in the land, etc.,** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק וְגוֹמֵר **you shall erase the memory of Amalek, etc."** זֵכֶר שְׁנֵי תְּנָאִים **It mentions two conditions.** בְּהָנִיחַ לְךָ מִכָּל אוֹיְבֶיךָ **"When He gives you rest from all your enemies":** שֶׁעִיקַּר הָאוֹיֵב הוּא הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **for the chief enemy is the evil inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה נד, א): גַּם אוֹיְבָיו יַשְׁלִים אִתּוֹ [מִשְׁלֵי טז, ז] **as it is expounded (Bereishis Rabbah 54:1):** **"'Even his enemies He will make at peace with him' (Mishlei 16:7) —** זֶה יֵצֶר הָרָע וְכוּלֵּי **this is the evil inclination, etc.";** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה נב, א): שְׁלֹמֹה קְרָאוֹ שׂוֹנֵא **and as they said (Sukkah 52a):** **"Shlomo called it 'enemy.'"** וּמִכָּל אוֹיְבֶיךָ **"And from all your enemies":** הֵיינוּ כָּל שִׁבְעִים הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **that is, all seventy kelipos** הַמִּסְתָּעֲפִים מֵעֲמָלֵק **that branch out from Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה **who is the beginning of kelipah,** יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא. **the evil inclination.** וּכְשֶׁמִּתְגַּבְּרִין עַל כָּל הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **And when one overcomes all the kelipos,** מְמֵילָא נִיצּוֹלִים שֶׁכֻּלָּם רַק עַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **one is automatically saved from all the enemies,** מִכָּל הָאוֹיְבִים[835] **whose power comes only through the power of the kelipos** שֶׁנִּכְנָס מֵהֶם גַּם לְלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל **that enters from them even into the heart of Yisrael,** הַשְּׂאוֹר שֶׁבָּעִיסָה **the "leaven in the dough"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר תְּצַוֶּה מַאֲמָר ו) **(as explained in Tetzaveh, maamar 6).** וְהַתְּנַאי הַשֵּׁנִי **And the second condition:** בָּאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר ה׳ אֱלֹהֶיךָ **"in the land which Hashem your God** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ נֹתֵן לְךָ נַחֲלָה וְגוֹמֵר **gives you as an inheritance, etc."** **This is according to what they said in the Zohar HaKadosh** (חֵלֶק ג וַיִּקְרָא ד, ב): **(III, Vayikra 4b):** עֵת הַזָּמִיר הִגִּיעַ **"'The time of song has arrived' —** עִידָּן לְאֶעְקָרָא שָׁלְטָנוּתָא וְכוּלֵּי **the time to uproot the dominion, etc.;** וְקוֹל הַתּוֹר נִשְׁמַע בְּאַרְצֵנוּ **'and the voice of the turtledove is heard in our land' —** דָּא אֶרֶץ דִּלְתַתָּא **this is the lower land** דְּאַחְסָנוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל יְדָא דִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ וְכוּלֵּי **that Yisrael inherited through Yehoshua, etc."** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ אַחַר כָּךְ **And it is as they say in the Zohar HaKadosh afterwards:** קוֹל הַתּוֹר **"'The voice of the turtledove' —** דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב אִקְרֵי תּוֹרָה סְתָם[836] וְכוּלֵּי **for Torah she'bichsav is called simply 'Torah,' etc."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And as we have said,** דְּאַף דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **even though Torah she'b'al peh** נִקְרָא אוֹרָה לְשׁוֹן נְקֵיבָה **is called "orah," in the feminine,** וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב תּוֹרָה אוֹר **and Torah she'bichsav "Torah or,"** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מְקַבֵּל מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **since Torah she'b'al peh receives from Torah she'bichsav —** אַךְ כְּמוֹ דְּה׳ בַּתְרָאָה פֶּה **still, just as the final Hei,** מַלְכוּת פֶּה **Malchus, the mouth —** שֶׁרוֹמֵז לְתַפְאֶרֶת שֵׁם וְהוּא אַחַר הַוּ׳ **comes after the Vav,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קָרִינַן לָהּ **"we call it Torah she'b'al peh" —** כֵּן תּוֹרָ״ה הַיְינוּ תּוֹר ה׳ **so too "Torah," that is "Tor"** הֲוָ״י **which alludes to Tiferes, in the Name Havayah,** followed by Hei, מְרַמֵּז לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **alludes to Torah she'bichsav,** שֶׁכָּלוּל בָּהּ גַּם הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **in which Torah she'b'al peh is also included.** וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה נִקְרָא הַתּוֹר **And Torah she'b'al peh is called "HaTor,"** ה׳ מִקּוֹדֶם **with the Hei first,** וּמְקַבְּלָא מֵאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **and it receives from the light of Torah she'bichsav.** וְזֶה שֶׁדִּקְדֵּק בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And this is why the Zohar HaKadosh was precise to say,** אֶרֶץ דִּלְתַתָּא **"the lower land** דְּאַחְסָנוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל יְדָא דִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ **that Yisrael inherited through Yehoshua":** שֶׁיְּהוֹשֻׁעַ הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן **for Yehoshua was the first** שֶׁעָשָׂה סֵפֶר אַחַר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **to compose a book after Torah she'bichsav.** וְסֵפֶר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And Sefer Yehoshua comprises** חֵלֶק כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **the portion of each one of Yisrael** כּוֹלֵל **in Torah she'b'al peh,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בְּפֵירוּשׁ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **as we said in explaining what they said** (נְדָרִים כב, ב): **(Nedarim 22b):** **"and Sefer Yehoshua, for it is the record of Eretz Yisrael"** וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר כה **(this was explained in Chanukah, maamar 25,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וּבְגֶמָרָא **in the passage beginning "U'vaGemara";** עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת). **see there at length).** וּבְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל עִיקַּר הַמָּקוֹם **And**

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[835] **Midrash Mishlei 9:2** — "What good name did Esther acquire for herself in this world and the world to come? All festivals are destined to cease, but the days of Purim never cease, as it says, 'These days of Purim shall not pass from among the Jews.' Rabbi Elazar said: The Day of Atonement too never ceases, as it says, 'This shall be for you an everlasting statute, to atone for the children of Israel from all their sins once a year.'" The Midrash is expounding Esther's enduring achievement through "She also set her table." The maamar next asks how this can be reconciled with the permanence of every Torah commandment.

[836] **Shevuos 13a** — "Could Yom Kippur atone only if one fasted on it, proclaimed it a holy convocation, and refrained from labor? From where do we know the case in which he did not fast, did not proclaim it a holy convocation, and performed labor? Scripture says, 'It is a Day of Atonement'—in any case." The sugya distinguishes the atoning force of the day from a person's observance, while examining the different tannaitic positions. The maamar explicitly follows the opinion invoked by Rashba.

Eretz Yisrael is the principal place פֶּה שֶׁבְּעַל תּוֹרָה לְאוֹר **for the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זוֹכִין **and through this one merits victory over the evil inclination,** לְנִיצּוּחַ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע[837] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א רב, א): **as they said (Zohar I 202a):** דְּהָא לֵית לָךְ מִלָּה **"For there is nothing** אוֹרַיְיתָא אֶלָּא יֵצֶר הָרָע[838] **to break the evil inclination except Torah";** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה נב, ב): **and as they said (Sukkah 52b):** אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנַוֵּול זֶה **"If this repulsive one encounters you,** מְשָׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ[839] **drag him to the Beis HaMidrash,"** וְשָׁם מְקוֹם חִידּוּשׁ הֲלָכוֹת **and there is the place where halachos are newly brought forth** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **in Torah she'b'al peh.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בָּאָרֶץ וְגוֹמֵר **And this is what it says, "in the land, etc.":** בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה הוּא בְּאֶרֶץ **for "land" is the aspect of Torah she'b'al peh —** מַלְכוּת פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **"Malchus, the mouth, Torah she'b'al peh."** וְשַׁבָּת הוּא יוֹם **And Shabbos is the day of** הָנִיחַ ה' לְךָ מֵעִצָּבְךָ וְרִגְזֶךָ **"Hashem gives you rest from your sorrow and your agitation"** [יְשַׁעְיָה יד, ג], **(Yeshayahu 14:3),** שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **which is expounded in the Zohar HaKadosh** (חֵלֶק א מח, ב) **(I 48b)** עַל יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **about the Shabbos day:** שֶׁאָז שׁוֹלֵחַ ה' נַיְיחָא **that then Hashem sends rest** מֵרוֹגֶז הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **from the agitation of the evil inclination,** שֶׁגּוֹרֵם הָעֶצֶב וְעִצָּבוֹן. **which causes the sorrow and grief.** וְאָז גַּם כֵּן זְמַן הַשְׁפָּעָה **And then too is a time of bestowal** בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **in Torah she'b'al peh,** (שָׁם מז, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ: **as they said (there, 47b):** בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **"'On the seventh day'** — דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּאִיהוּ יוֹם שְׁבִיעִי **which is the seventh day";** וְהַיְינוּ מַלְכוּת פֶּה **that is, "Malchus, the mouth** — תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרֵינַן לָהּ **we call it Torah she'b'al peh";** וְעַל כֵּן שַׁבָּת מְיוּחָד לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **and therefore Shabbos is designated for the eradication of Amalek.** וְאִיתָא בִּפְסִיקְתָּא **And it is found in the Pesikta** [לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן ב] **(for Parshas Zachor, parsha 12, siman 2)** וּמִדְרָשׁ **and the Midrash** (תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא ה) **(Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 5):** שְׁתֵּי זְכִירוֹת שֶׁכָּתַבְתִּי **Those two rememberings** אוֹתָן אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"The Holy One, blessed be He, said:** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק [דְּבָרִים כה, יט] **'You shall erase the memory of Amalek' (Devarim 25:19),** זָכוֹר אֵת אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְךָ עֲמָלֵק **'Remember what Amalek did to you'** [שָׁם, יז]. **(there, 17)."** וְהַיְינוּ שְׁנֵי הָעִנְיָנִים שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק **These are the two matters of Amalek** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א) שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **that we spoke of (as explained in maamar 1):** הַזְּהִירוּת לַגְּדוֹלִים **the warning to the great,** וְיִזָּהֲרוּ מִפִּיתּוּיֵי הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **and should beware of the seductions of the evil inclination,** שֶׁלֹּא יִסְמְכוּ עַל קְדוּשָׁתָם **that they not rely on their holiness** שֶׁיּוּכַל לִכְנוֹס אַף לְלֵב קָדוֹשׁ **which can enter even a holy heart,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁעָשָׂה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **as it did to Yisrael** כְּשֶׁיָּצְאוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם לְקַבֵּל תּוֹרָה **when they went out of Egypt to receive the Torah,** שֶׁהָיוּ בְּמַעֲלָה עֶלְיוֹנָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **when they were at a supreme level, as mentioned above;** וְגַם לִמְחוֹת זִכְרוֹ **and also to erase his memory,** מַה שֶׁהִכְנִיס יֵאוּשׁ בְּלֵב הַנֶּחֱשָׁלִים. **the despair he brought into the heart of the stragglers.** וּמַסִּיק מָשְׁלֵי אֵפֶר **And it concludes: "My parable is ashes:** אִם זְכִיתֶם **if you merit,** אַתֶּם בָּנָיו שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם **you are the children of Avraham,** וְכוּלֵי[840] שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל עַצְמוֹ כְּאֵפֶר **who likened himself to ashes,**

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[837] **Responsa Rashba I:93** — "It appears to me that this means: Concerning all the festivals, He did not promise that sin would never cause their cessation at some time, as it says, 'Hashem caused festival and Shabbos to be forgotten in Tzion.' But concerning Purim He promised, 'They shall not pass from among the Jews, and their remembrance shall not cease from their descendants.' So too, 'This shall be for you' concerning Yom Kippur is a promise that it will be an everlasting statute: The day will atone even if they do not observe it. Rabbi's view here follows his view in the Gemara that Yom Kippur atones for those who repent and those who do not. The 'everlasting statute' stated about Pesach, however, is a command rather than a promise: 'You shall celebrate it as an everlasting statute,' and, 'You shall observe it throughout your generations.'" Rav Tzadok accepts Rashba's distinction between promise and command, then asks what remains of Purim's promise when coercion prevents its specific observances. His answer locates the promise in the enduring spiritual action of the days.

[838] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 21, 57b** — "It is called Purim after Yom HaKippurim, for in the future they will delight in it and change it from affliction into delight." The text actually names Purim after Yom HaKippurim and speaks of affliction transformed into delight. Rav Tzadok also brings the chassidic reading of Yom Kippur as "a day like Purim"; that reversal is his reported interpretation, rather than the literal wording of this passage.

[839] **Megillah 18a** — "If one read the Megillah by heart, he has not fulfilled his obligation. Rava said: This is learned through 'remembrance' and 'remembrance.' Here it says, 'These days are remembered'; there, 'Write this as a remembrance in a book.' Just as there it is in a book, so here it must be in a book. Perhaps remembrance means merely inward reflection? 'Remember' could mean in the heart, but 'Do not forget' already addresses the heart. Thus 'Remember' means with the mouth." The shared language joins the Megillah's public oral reading from a written scroll with remembrance of Amalek. The maamar is attentive to the additional passive form "are remembered."

[840] **Megillah 17a** — "Is reading written here? It is performance that is written: 'To perform these two days.' Rather, the source is, 'These days are remembered and performed': remembrance is compared to performance. Just as performance cannot be in reverse order, so remembrance cannot be in reverse order." Megillah 2b uses the same

etc." וְהֵינוּ דְּקְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק הוּא הַגַּאֲוָה **That is, the kelipah of Amalek is arrogance;** דְּשָׁרְשֵׁי הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **for the roots of the kelipos are** עֵשָׂו הַקִּנְאָה וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל הַתַּאֲוָה **Esav, jealousy, and Yishmael, lust,** וּמֵהֶם נִסְתָּעֲפוּ הַשִּׁבְעִים קְלִיפּוֹת **and from them branched out the seventy kelipos,** וּשְׁלֹשִׁים וְחָמֵשׁ שְׁלֹשִׁים וְחָמֵשׁ מִימִינָא **thirty-five on the right and thirty-five on the left,** מִשְּׁמָאלָא[841] כַּיָּדוּעַ מִכְּתְבֵי הָאֲרִ״י זַ״ל; **as is known from the writings of the Arizal;** וּמִזֶּה בָּא הָעֲבוֹדָה **and from this comes idolatry,** אֲשֶׁר עַל בָּמֳתֵי [יְשַׁעְיָה יד, יד] **in the manner of what it says:** עָב **(Yeshayahu 14:14) "I will ascend above the heights of the clouds;** אֶדַּמֶּה לְעֶלְיוֹן **I will be like the Most High."** (בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה יג, ג) וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ **Likewise it is expounded (Bamidbar Rabbah 13:3):** גַּאֲוַת אָדָם תַּשְׁפִּילֶנּוּ [מִשְׁלֵי כט, כג] **"'A man's pride will bring him low' (Mishlei 29:23) —** זֶה עֲמָלֵק **this is Amalek,** שֶׁנִּתְגָּאָה עַל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא[842] וְכוּלֵי **who exalted himself over the Holy One, blessed be He, etc."** שֶׁזֶּה הָיָה מִגַּאֲוָתוֹ **For this came from his arrogance:** שֶׁלֹּא נִתְפַּעֵל מִגְּדוּלַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל **that he was not impressed by the greatness of Yisrael** וּמֵהַנִּסִּים נִגְלִים שֶׁהָיָה אָז **and by the open miracles that occurred then,** עַד דְּשָׁמְעוּ עַמִּים יִרְגָּזוּן **to the point that "nations heard and trembled,"** וְהוּא מִגַּאֲוָתוֹ **yet he, out of his arrogance,** לֹא הִשְׁגִּיחַ עַל זֶה. **paid no attention to this.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁזָּכָה **was the first to merit** לְהִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **the revelation of Atika,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּרְמָז בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּרֵאשִׁית כד, א] **as is hinted in what it says (Bereishis 24:1),** וְאַבְרָהָם זָקֵן **"And Avraham was old";** (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא פז, א) וְזֶה סוֹד מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ: **and this is the secret of what they said (Bava Metzia 87a):** עַד אַבְרָהָם לֹא הָיָה זִקְנָה[843] **"Until Avraham there was no old age"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(as explained several times).** וְזֶה זָכָה עַל יְדֵי הֶעָנָוָה **And this he merited through humility,** שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל עַצְמוֹ כְּאֵפֶר **for he likened himself to ashes;** דְּמִי שֶׁהוּא עָנִיו **for whoever is humble** זוֹכֶה לִהְיוֹת עַתִּיקָא סְתִימָאָה **Atika Setima'ah,** דְּכָל סְתִימִין מֶרְכָּבָה **merits to be a chariot** לְבָחִינַת אַיִן, **for the aspect of Ayin,** דְּאִקְרֵי אַיִן **"hidden of all hidden, which is called Ayin"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב סד, ב). **(as stated in Zohar II 64b).** וְעַל כֵּן בַּשַּׁבָּת **Therefore, on Shabbos,** וּבִתְפִלַּת שַׁחֲרִית **and at the Shacharis prayer,** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד קְדוּשַׁת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **which corresponds to the holiness of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** וּבְחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **and to the aspect of Atika** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן יח לד, א), **(as stated in Tikkunei Zohar, tikkun 18, 34a),** דְּקְדוּשַׁת הַתְּפִלּוֹת דְּשַׁבָּת **for the holiness of the Shabbos prayers** כְּמוֹ קְדוּשַׁת הַסְּעוּדוֹת.[844] **is like the holiness**

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comparison to extend the distinction between the fourteenth and fifteenth from performance to reading. Rav Tzadok notes that these sugyos understand remembrance as the Megillah reading.

[841] **Megillah 20a** — "From where do we learn the time for reading? Scripture says, 'These days are remembered and performed': by day, yes; at night, no. Does this refute Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi, who said one must read the Megillah at night and repeat it by day? The Mishnah is speaking about the daytime reading." Megillah 20b again derives the validity of the entire day for the reading from this verse. The verse therefore governs the concrete act of reading as well as the meaning the maamar finds in the days themselves.

[842] **Megillah 29a** — "'I have been for them a small sanctuary': Rabbi Yitzchak said: These are the synagogues and study halls in Bavel. Rabbi Elazar said: This is the house of our master in Bavel. Rabbi Elazar HaKappar taught: The synagogues and study halls in Bavel are destined to be fixed in Eretz Yisrael. If Tavor and Carmel, which came only for a time to learn Torah, were fixed in Eretz Yisrael, how much more these houses, in which Torah is read and spread." The Gemara supplies the sanctuary status and future planting of diaspora Torah institutions. Rav Tzadok develops their present participation in the holiness of Eretz Yisrael through the Oral Torah.

[843] Parallel: **Rabbi Moshe Chaim Luzzatto, Derekh Hashem IV, ch. 7 §6; ch. 8 §3** — "The root of all these matters is the order established by the supreme Wisdom: whenever a repair was accomplished and a great light shone at a particular time, then, when the cycle of that time returns, a light resembling the first light shines, and the result of that repair is renewed in those who received it. ... The purpose of Chanukah and Purim is to make shine the light that shines on those days, according to the repairs accomplished in them. ... Purim concerns Israel's rescue in the Babylonian exile and the renewed acceptance of the Torah, which they accepted upon themselves again forever, as our Sages said: 'They accepted it again in the days of Achashverosh.' The details of these matters correspond to the details of the repair."

Connection: Ramchal describes the annual renewal of an accomplished spiritual change, and identifies Purim's renewed light specifically with Israel's rescue and acceptance of Torah. This clarifies Rav Tzadok's claim that "the Jews had light" becomes active again each Purim. Rav Tzadok further develops that renewed Torah light as the holiness of Eretz Yisrael and the eradication of Amalek; those additional identifications are his own argument.

[844] **Bereishis Rabbah 11:7** — "Rabbi Yochanan said in Rabbi Yosei bar Chalafta's name: Avraham, of whom Shabbos observance is not written, inherited the world with a measure: 'Arise, walk through the land, its length and breadth.' But Yaakov, of whom Shabbos observance is written, 'He encamped before the city'—he entered at the sun's fading and set boundaries before day's end—inherited the world without measure, as it says, 'Your offspring will be like the dust of the earth.'" The contrast is expressly between what is recorded about the two patriarchs. The maamar later explains that explicit recording as a sign of holiness fixed for all generations.

of the meals — קוֹרְאִין אָז פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר **we then read Parshas Zachor,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁמַּזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַטָּה **so that through mentioning his name below** נִזְכֶּה לִמְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **we will merit the eradication of Amalek,** וְלִזְכּוֹת לִקְדוּשַׁת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and merit the holiness of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא מְנֻגָּד לוֹ,[845] **who is his opposite,** שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל עַצְמוֹ כְּאֵפֶר כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **for he likened himself to ashes, as mentioned above.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִגְאָלִין: **And through this we are redeemed.**

[845] **Berakhot 8a** — "Rav Chisda said: 'Hashem loves the gates of Tzion more than all Yaakov's dwellings'—Hashem loves gates distinguished in halachah more than synagogues and study halls. Rabbi Chiya bar Ami said in Ulla's name: Since the Temple was destroyed, the Holy One, blessed be He, has in His world only the four cubits of halachah." Rav Tzadok takes the halachic place's relation to the lost Temple as the basis for its participation in Eretz Yisrael's holiness.

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר ג׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Gimmel

בַּתַּנְחוּמָא (כִּי תֵצֵא ז) **In the Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei 7):** כָּאן כְּתִיב זָכוֹר **"Here it is written 'Remember,'** וּבַשַּׁבָּת כְּתִיב זָכוֹר **and regarding Shabbos it is written 'Remember';** שְׁנֵיהֶם שָׁוִין כּוּלֵי **the two are equal, etc.** אָמַר שְׁלֹמֹה [קֹהֶלֶת ב, טו] **Shlomo said (Koheles 2:15),** כְּמִקְרֶה הַכְּסִיל **'As it happens to the fool,** גַּם אֲנִי יִקְרֵנִי **so will it happen to me too.'** מָשָׁל לָמָּה הַדָּבָר דּוֹמֶה כּוּלֵי **To what may the matter be compared? etc.** לָזֶה הִזְכַּרְתִּי עַל קְעָרָה **This one I mentioned over a dish full of every good thing,** וְלָזֶה הִזְכַּרְתִּי עַל קְעָרָה רֵיקָם **and that one I mentioned over an empty dish.** כָּךְ הַשַּׁבָּת כְּתִיב זָכוֹר וְגוֹמֵר **So too, regarding Shabbos it is written 'Remember' etc.,** וּלְכַבְּדוֹ בְּמַאֲכָל וְכוּלֵי **and to honor it with food, etc.;** וּבַעֲמָלֵק כְּתִיב זָכוֹר וְגוֹמֵר **and regarding Amalek it is written 'Remember' etc.** עַל מָה אַתָּה זוֹכְרוֹ **Over what do you remember him?** עַל שׁוּלְחָן רֵיקָה[846] **Over an empty table," etc.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Now we must understand:** בְּשִׁלְמָא בַּמָּשָׁל **granted, in the parable** יִתָּכֵן שֶׁאָמַר בִּשְׁנֵיהֶם **it is plausible that he used for both** לְשׁוֹן זְכִירָה סְתָם **a plain expression of mentioning,** שְׁאָלוּהוּ זֶה הִזְכַּרְתָּ **for they asked him, "You mentioned this one** וְזֶה הִזְכַּרְתָּ **and you mentioned that one";** אֲבָל בְּכָאן הֲלֹא מְפוֹרָשׁ **but here, is it not explicit—** בַּשַּׁבָּת זָכוֹר לְקַדְּשׁוֹ **regarding Shabbos, "Remember... to sanctify it,"** וּבַעֲמָלֵק תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **and regarding Amalek, "You shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek"?** וְאֵיךְ אָמַר דִּשְׁנֵיהֶם שָׁוִין. **So how could he say that the two are equal?** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן **But the matter is this:** תְּמִחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **the blotting out of Amalek** הוּא לְעָשְׁרֵשׁ וְלַעֲקוֹר **is to uproot and to tear out** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הָרָע וְהַיֵּצֶר **the root of evil and the yetzer hara,** וְהַמִּצְוָה בְּכָל שָׁנָה **and the mitzvah applies every year;** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם רוֹאִים שֶׁלֹּא הוֹעִיל **and nevertheless we see that it has not helped,** שֶׁעֲדַיִן מִתְגָּרֶה **for he still provokes,** וְאַף כְּמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּרַבִּי מֵאִיר וְרַבִּי **even with talmidei chachamim and even with the great,** בְּתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים וְאַף בִּגְדוֹלִים **as we find with Rabbi Meir and Rabbi Akiva** (קִידּוּשִׁין פא, א) **(Kiddushin 81a);** וְנִרְאֶה שֶׁלֹּא הוֹעִיל חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **and it seems that it has not helped, chas v'shalom.** וְיֹאמַר הָאָדָם מַה יּוֹעִיל **And a person might say: What will it help** מַה שֶּׁנִּצְטַוִּינוּ זָכוֹר אֶת יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת לְקַדְּשׁוֹ **that we were commanded, "Remember the Shabbos day to sanctify it,"** וּקְדוּשַׁת סְעוּדַת שַׁבָּת **and the holiness of the Shabbos meal—** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה עַל יְדֵי הָעֹנֶג **to bring in holiness through the delight** פֶּן זֶה גַּם כֵּן לֹא יוֹעִיל **perhaps this too will not help;** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **and about this he said,** כְּמִקְרֶה הַכְּסִיל גַּם אֲנִי יִקְרֵנִי. **"As it happens to the fool, so will it happen to me too."** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר מָשָׁל הַנִּזְכָּר **And to this he answered, from the aforementioned parable,** דְּשַׁבָּת אַתָּה מַזְכִּירוֹ **that Shabbos you mention** עַל קְעָרָה מְלֵאָה כָּל טוּב **over a dish full of every good thing;** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת הַקְּדוּשָׁה דְּשַׁבָּת **for in truth the holiness of Shabbos** קְבִיעָא וְקַיְימָא מֵה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ[847] **is fixed and established by Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שְׁמוֹת לא, יג] **as it says (Shemos 31:13),** לָדַעַת[848] כִּי אֲנִי ה' מְקַדִּשְׁכֶם **"To know that I am Hashem Who sanctifies you";** וּבְוַדַּאי מוֹעִיל **and it certainly helps,** שֶׁהוּא יוֹם הֲנִיחַ ה' לָךְ **for it is the day on which "Hashem gives you rest** מֵעָצְבְּךָ וְרִגְזֶךָ **from your sorrow and your trouble,"** הַיְינוּ הַנַּ"ל מִכָּל הָאוֹיְבִים וְהַקְּלִיפּוֹת **that is, rest from all the enemies and the kelipos;** אַךְ אַחַר כָּךְ חוֹזֵר יֵצֶר הָרָע לִמְקוֹמוֹ **but afterward the yetzer hara returns to its place,** כְּמוֹ אַחַר מַתַּן תּוֹרָה. **as happened after Mattan Torah.** וּמִי שֶׁמְּשַׁמֵּר שַׁבָּת כְּהִילְכָתָהּ **And one who keeps Shabbos according to its laws** נִגְאָל בֶּאֱמֶת מִיָּד לְעוֹלָם. **is truly redeemed at once, forever.** וּבָא מִצְוַת הַזְּכִירָה **And the mitzvah of remembrance comes** לְהַכְנִיס הַקְּדוּשָׁה עַל יְדֵי עֹנֶג **to bring in the holiness through**

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[846] **Zohar III, 243a** — "The Name comprises ten sefiros from above to below in this way: Yud is Chochmah; Heh is Binah; Vav embraces six sefiros, from Chesed to Yesod; the final Heh is Malchus. The kaf in 'Like Hashem our God' is a crown upon its head. This is the additional soul bestowed on Shabbos." This explicitly supplies the letter-to-sefirah correspondences on which the maamar's reading of the four Purim blessings depends.

[847] **Pesachim 50a** — "'And His name One'—is His name not One now? Rav Nachman bar Yitzchak said: The world to come is unlike this world. In this world it is written with Yud–Heh and read with Alef–Dalet; in the world to come all is one: It is read with Yud–Heh and written with Yud–Heh." The Gemara contrasts the written four-letter Name with its substituted pronunciation. Rav Tzadok asks why the shorter Name can be pronounced while the complete Name is withheld, and answers through the unification represented by the letters.

[848] **Zohar III, 4a** — "Rabbi Shimon said: 'Eat, friends' refers above; 'Drink and become intoxicated, beloved ones' refers below. The higher place is where they are in unity and joy, never separating; these are called friends. Eden and the river that flows from it never separate, but are forever in will, unity and joy. The beloved ones below unite at known times. Those who yearn for one another and are not always together are called beloved ones; those always present and never separating are called friends. Through this completeness the congregation of Israel is blessed and there is joy in all worlds." The distinction is precisely between abiding union above and union at particular times below. Rav Tzadok applies it to Yud–Heh and their union with Vav–Heh.

delight, דְּגַם הַגּוּף בַּשַּׁבָּת הִיא בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **for even the body on Shabbos is in holiness;** וְזֶהוּ עַל קְעָרָה מְלֵאָה כָּל טוּב. **and this is "over a dish full of every good thing."** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן זְכִירַת עֲמָלֵק **Not so the remembrance of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא לְהוֹצִיא הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל **which is to remove the evil from the heart of the fool,** וְזֶהוּ עִיקָּר עַל יְדֵי הָעֲבוֹדָה **and this is mainly through avodah** מִצַּד הָאָדָם **on the part of man;** וְזֶהוּ עַל שׁוּלְחָן רֵיקָם.[849] **and this is "over an empty table."** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם גַּם הוּא מוֹעִיל **Nevertheless it too helps,** שֶׁבְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה **for each and every year** נַעֲשָׂה מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק יוֹתֵר **more of the blotting out of Amalek is accomplished,** עַד שֶׁנִּזְכֶּה לַעֲשׂוֹת **until we merit to bring about** וְלִזְכּוֹת לִמְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **and to attain the blotting out of Amalek** מִכֹּל וְכֹל.[850] **completely, from Above.** אֲבָל כָּל זְמַן שֶׁלֹּא נִמְחָה זִכְרוֹ מִכֹּל וָכֹל **But as long as his remembrance has not been completely blotted out,** יִצְרוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם מִתְגַּבֵּר. **a person's yetzer overpowers him.** אֲבָל מִצְוַת שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת **However, the mitzvah of keeping Shabbos** מוֹעִיל בְּוַדַּאי **certainly helps,** שֶׁה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ מַכְנִיס בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **for Hashem Yisbarach brings into Yisrael** קְדוּשָּׁה דְּקִבְיָעָא וְקַיְימָא **a holiness that is fixed and established,** וְהַיִּשְׂרָאֵל מְקַדֵּשׁ הַשַּׁבָּת עַל יְדֵי הָעֹנֶג **and the Jew sanctifies Shabbos through delight,** דְּגַם הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף בִּקְדוּשָּׁה. **for even the body's pleasure is in holiness.** וְעַל יְדֵי שְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת **And through keeping Shabbos** נִיצּוֹלִין גַּם מֵהָעֲבֵירָה **one is saved from sin as well,** (מְכִילְתָּא בְּשַׁלַּח וַיַּסַּע ו) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Mechilta, Beshalach, Vayisa 6)** מִקְרָא דְּשׁוֹמֵר יָדוֹ וְגוֹמֵר [יְשַׁעְיָה נו, ב] **from the verse "who keeps Shabbos from profaning it and guards his hand" etc. (Yeshayah 56:2),** שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁמְּשַׁמֵּר אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת **that whoever keeps Shabbos** מְרוּחָק מִן הָעֲבֵירָה[851] **is distanced from sin;** (רֵישׁ שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת) וּבְפְרִי עֵץ חַיִּים **and in Pri Etz Chaim (beginning of Shaar HaShabbos),** שֶׁנִּיצּוֹל מִקְּטֵרוּג הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **that one is saved from the accusation of the yetzer hara** כָּל יְמֵי הַשָּׁבוּעַ.[852] **all the days of the week.** רַק הָאָדָם מִצִּידּוֹ צָרִיךְ שְׁמִירָה **Only, a person on his part must take care** שֶׁלֹּא יִכָּנֵס הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **that the yetzer hara not enter, chas v'shalom,** לְקַלְקְלוֹ בִּשְׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת **to spoil him in his keeping of Shabbos;** וּמִי שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לִהְיוֹת מְשַׁמֵּר שַׁבָּת כְּהִילְכָתָהּ **and one who merits to keep Shabbos according to its laws** הוּא בְּפֶרְט נַפְשׁוֹ נִגְאָל מִכֹּל וָכֹל **is, as regards his own soul, completely redeemed** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(as has been explained many times).** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר [קֹהֶלֶת שָׁם, טז] **And on this he said (Koheles ibid. 16),** כִּי אֵין זִכָּרוֹן לֶחָכָם וְגוֹמֵר **"For there is no remembrance of the wise" etc.,** שֶׁזִּכְרוֹן הַשַּׁבָּת **for the remembrance of Shabbos** עַל קְעָרָה מְלֵאָה קְדוּשָּׁה: **is over a dish full of holiness.**

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[849] **Zohar III, 123b** — "Heh and Vav never rest upon a person without fear and love, which are Yud–Heh. From there are given Torah and mitzvah, the son and daughter; because Israel fulfill Torah and mitzvah they are called children of the Holy One. 'The hidden things' are fear and love, within the brain and heart; 'the revealed things' are Torah and mitzvah, outwardly in the body and head. Whether a person fears or loves the Holy One is known only between him and his Creator. But a person's Torah study and performance of positive commandments are visible to others." The source distinguishes concealed intention from visible action and joins both in the four letters. The maamar insists that their union must reach actual Torah and mitzvos.

[850] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 10, 25b** — "Chochmah and Binah are hidden in the brain and heart, in love and fear. Torah without fear and love does not fly upward. The small Heh, the likeness of man, completes the Name; it is holy Malchus, mitzvah, the performance of commandments residing in the 248 limbs. 'The revealed things belong to us' refers to Torah and mitzvah. Without fear and love, Torah and mitzvah cannot ascend and stand before Yud–Heh." The metaphor of flight makes intention the power by which visible Torah and mitzvos are joined to their higher source.

[851] **Zohar I, 26a** — "When Israel leave exile as the holy people alone, the river that had been dry and desolate is immediately described, 'A river goes forth from Eden'—this is Vav—'to water the garden.' The river is the central pillar; 'goes forth from Eden' refers to the supernal Mother; 'to water the garden' refers to the lower Shechinah." The river joins the source of divine understanding to the receiving garden. Rav Tzadok places gladness, the water-drawing verse and the covenant within that continuous flow.

[852] **Yerushalmi, Sukkah 5:1; Tosafos, Sukkah 50b** — "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: Why is it called the House of Drawing? Because from there they draw the Holy Spirit, as it says, 'You shall draw water with gladness from the springs of salvation.' Rabbi Yonah said: Yonah son of Amitai was among the festival pilgrims; he entered the rejoicing of the House of Drawing, and the Holy Spirit rested upon him. This teaches that the Holy Spirit rests only upon a joyful heart, as it says, 'When the musician played, the spirit of God came upon him.'" Tosafos on Sukkah 50b, s.v. Chad tanei sho'evah, cites this Yerushalmi and its example of Yonah. The maamar treats the holy spirit as the inward content of the joyous drawing of water.

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר ד׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Daled

It is stated in the Gemara (Shabbos 118b): אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (שַׁבָּת קיח, ב) **"Had Yisrael kept the first Shabbos," etc.** אִלְמָלֵא שָׁמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל שַׁבָּת רִאשׁוֹנָה כּוּלֵי **"And it was on the seventh day" etc.,** וְכָתִיב וַיְהִי בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי וְגוֹמֵר **implying that Amalek came** מַשְׁמַע דַּעֲמָלֵק בָּא **and it is written after it, "And Amalek came";** בָּתְרֵיהּ וַיָּבֹא עֲמָלֵק **because of the sin concerning keeping Shabbos.** עַל עֲוֹון דְּשָׁמִירַת שַׁבָּת. **And in the Midrash (Shemos Rabbah 26:2)** וּבַמִּדְרָשׁ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כו, ב) **it is stated that because they said,** אִיתָא שֶׁמִּפְּנֵי שֶׁאָמְרוּ אִם הֲיֵשׁ ה׳ בְּקִרְבֵּנוּ אִם אֵין [שְׁמוֹת יז, ז] **"Is Hashem among us or not?" (Shemos 17:7)— "therefore let the enemy come," etc.,** לְפִיכָךְ יָבֹא הַשּׂוֹנֵא כּוּלֵי [שָׁם, ח][853] **"and Amalek came" (ibid. 8);** וַיָּבֹא עֲמָלֵק **and so it is in the holy Zohar** וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב סה, א). **And in the Mechilta (Beshalach, Amalek 1) it is stated:** וּבַמְּכִילְתָּא (בְּשַׁלַּח עֲמָלֵק א) אִיתָא **"Because they slackened their hands from words of Torah,** לְפִי שֶׁרָפוּ יְדֵיהֶם מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לָכֵן **therefore an enemy came upon them";**[854] בָּא שׂוֹנֵא עֲלֵיהֶם שָׁם. **see there.** עַיֵּין שָׁם **And it can be said that all the reasons** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁכָּל הַטְּעָמִים **amount to one.** דְּהֵנָּה יָדוּעַ **For it is known** דִּמֹּשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** הוּא בְּסוֹד הַדַּעַת[855] **is in the secret of Daas** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֵלֶק ב רכא, א] **(Zohar II 221a),** עַל יְדֵי חִיבּוּר חָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ **that is, the recognition of His Divinity, Yisbarach,** וְהַיְינוּ הַכָּרַת אֱלָהוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמֵהּ **through joining the wisdom in the mind** מַה שֶּׁמְּקַשֵּׁר חָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ **with the understanding in the heart,** עִם הַבִּינָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב **binding what one grasps with his wisdom** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה שֶׁמַּשִּׂיג בְּחָכְמָתוֹ **with the will in the heart;** עִם הָרָצוֹן שֶׁבַּלֵּב **and through this the illumination of Divinity comes to the soul,** וְהַחִיּוּת בְּכָל הָעִנְיָנִים בָּא הָאָרַת אֱלָהוּת לְהַנֶּפֶשׁ **and vitality in all matters,** הַמַּקִּיף עַל **from the root, which is the aspect of Keser** מֵהַשֹּׁרֶשׁ שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת כֶּתֶר **that surrounds the mochin;** הַמּוֹחִין **and Daas is the inwardness of Keser** וְדַעַת הוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים רֵישׁ מַאֲמָר א) **(as explained in Parshas Shekalim, beginning of maamar 1);** **and the time of the holiness of Shabbos corresponds to it,** וּבְזְמַן קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת נָגְדּוֹ וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שְׁמוֹת לא, יג] **as it says (Shemos 31:13),** לָדַעַת כִּי אֲנִי וְגוֹמֵר **"To know that I" etc.** **And Amalek is the opposite,** וַעֲמָלֵק הוּא הַהֵיפֶךְ הַמְנַגֵּד לִבְחִינַת דַּעַת **opposing the aspect of Daas in holiness;** שֶׁבִּקְדוּשָּׁה **and he is of one root with Bilam** וְהוּא מִשֹּׁרֶשׁ אֶחָד עִם בִּלְעָם[856] **(as stated in Zohar III 281b).** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג רפא, ב) **And they said (Sifri, Vezos HaBerachah 16)** וְאָמְרוּ (סִפְרֵי וְזֹאת הַבְּרָכָה טז) **on the verse (Devarim 34:10)** עַל פָּסוּק [דְּבָרִים לד, י] וְלֹא קָם נָבִיא עוֹד בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **"And there arose no other prophet in Yisrael like Moshe":** כְּמֹשֶׁה **"but among the nations one did arise;** אֲבָל בָּאוּמּוֹת קָם **and who is this? Bilam," etc.;** וְכוּלֵי[857] וְאֵיזֶה זֶה בִּלְעָם **and so it is in the holy Zohar (Balak, III 193b).** (בָּלָק חֶלֶק ג קצג, ב) וְכֵן הוּא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **That is, Bilam was the opposite** וְהַיְינוּ דְּבִלְעָם הָיָה הַהֵיפֶךְ מִבְּחִינַת **of the aspect of Daas of holiness,** דַּעַת דִּקְדוּשָּׁה **"this opposite that":** בְּזֶה לְעוּמַת זֶה שֶׁלֹּא רָצָה לְקַשֵּׁר הַחָכְמָה שֶׁבְּמוֹחוֹ **he did not want to bind the wisdom in his mind** עִם רְצוֹנוֹת לִבּוֹ[858] **with the desires of his heart;** שֶׁהֲגַם שֶׁהִשִּׂיג

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[853] **Zohar III, 242b** — "The holy lamp said: Faithful Shepherd, concerning you it says, 'Moshe took Yosef's bones with him,' because body and covenant are counted as one. Concerning you it says, 'My sheaf arose and stood'—thus prayer is standing. Everyone who straightens does so at the Name; with the righteous one, everyone who bows does so at 'Blessed.'" The initial statement expressly joins body and covenant. Rav Tzadok uses their unity to relate the river's Vav to circumcision, the sign of the covenant.

[854] **Zohar I, 176b** — "The Shechinah is bound with Avraham, Yitzchak, Yaakov and Yosef. They are as one, and one likeness belongs to them, as it says, 'These are the generations of Yaakov: Yosef.' For from the place of the river that flows and goes forth, everything is watered and all faces shine." This statement includes Yosef in the patriarchal configuration of the Shechinah. The shared likeness of Yaakov and Yosef is made explicit in the next Zohar passage.

[855] **Zohar III, 2a** — "'Ask for yourself a sign'—an actual letter, for all was carried through the mystery of letters. Of Rachav it says, 'Give me a true sign': This is the letter Vav, which is called the letter of truth. Are the other letters not truth? They are, but this letter is called the letter of truth." The maamar joins the designation of Vav with "Give truth to Yaakov," identifying the patriarchal quality within the letter.

[856] **Zohar III, 11a** — "The eighth is 'Living God,' as it says, 'For there Hashem commanded the blessing, life forever.' This is the righteous one, for all life comes from there; it is called by the Name, as it says, 'Hashem tests the righteous.' This is the small Vav of the holy Name. Therefore Vav is two vavs." The small Vav represents the righteous, covenantal channel through which life proceeds. Rav Tzadok identifies this with Yosef.

[857] **Zohar I, 194a** — "'From the river rose seven cows, fine in appearance and robust in flesh, and they grazed in the marsh.' All the lower degrees are blessed from this river, for the river that flows and goes forth waters and sustains everything. Yosef is the river through whose merit all the land of Egypt was blessed." The explicit image of Yosef as the sustaining river completes the connection between the two vavs and the flow to the lower world.

[858] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 24, 69b** — "One must fulfill delight in her: This is the righteous one who goes forth from Eden, which is Binah, the world to come, to water the garden, the lower Shechinah. The river is Vav going forth from

בְּמוֹחוֹ **for although he grasped in his mind** אֶת יְקָרוּת יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **the preciousness of Yisrael in holiness,** [בַּמִּדְבָּר כג, י] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר **as he said (Bamidbar 23:10),** תָּמֹת נַפְשִׁי מוֹת יְשָׁרִים[859] **"Let my soul die the death of the upright,"** וְעִם כָּל זֶה הִשִּׂיא עֵצָה לְהַכְשִׁילָם[860] **nevertheless he gave counsel to make them stumble** [סַנְהֶדְרִין קו, א] **(Sanhedrin 106a),** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיָה לִבּוֹ קָשׁוּר בְּכָל הַתַּאֲוֹת. **because his heart was bound up in all the lusts.** וְזֶהוּ גַּם כֵּן קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק[861] **And this too is the kelipah of Amalek,** שֶׁרָצָה לְהַכְנִיס זֹאת בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל. **who wanted to bring this into Yisrael;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵשׁ שִׁלִּיטָה לְהַקְּלִיפּוֹת. **and through this the kelipos have dominion.** וּמִזֶּה הַטַּעַם **And for this reason,** אִם שָׁמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל שַׁבָּת רִאשׁוֹנָה **had Yisrael kept the first Shabbos,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת דַּעַת שֶׁבִּקְדוּשָּׁה **which is the aspect of Daas in holiness,** לֹא הָיָה שִׁלִּיטָה שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק **Amalek would have had no dominion,** שֶׁהוּא הַמְנַגֵּד לִקְדוּשָּׁה זוֹ. **for he is the opponent of this holiness.** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן עִנְיַן מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this too is the meaning of what they said,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב סד, ב) **(II 64b), as they said in the holy Zohar** הֲיֵשׁ ה׳ בְּקִרְבֵּנוּ אִם אָיִן **"Is Hashem among us or not?"—** דְּבָעוּ לְמִינְדַּע **that they wished to know the difference** בֵּין עַתִּיקָא סְתִימָאָה דְּכָל סְתִימִין **between Atika, the most Concealed of all concealed,** וּבֵין דְּאִקְרֵי אַיִן **which is called Ayin,** וְזֵעִיר אַנְפִּין דְּאִקְרֵי ה׳ **and Zeir Anpin, which is called Hashem.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהָיוּ מְסוּפָּקִים **That is, they were in doubt** אִם יֵשׁ ה׳ בְּקִרְבֵּנוּ **whether "Hashem is among us"—** שֶׁהַשָּׂגַת אֱלֹהוּת הוּא בִּבְחִינַת יֵשׁ **whether the grasp of Divinity is in the aspect of Yesh,** שֶׁהוּא לְפִי שֵׂכֶל הַשָּׂגַת אָדָם **which accords with the intellect of human comprehension,** אוֹ בִּבְחִינַת אַיִן **or in the aspect of Ayin,** שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מִן הַמּוֹחִין. **which is above the mochin.** וּמִמֵּילָא לֹא הָיוּ מְקוּשָּׁרִים בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **And consequently they were not bound in holiness** בִּבְחִינַת דַּעַת **in the aspect of Daas,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת אַיִן וְעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **which is the aspect of Ayin and Atika Kadisha,** שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מִן הַמּוֹחִין. **which is above the mochin.** וְזֶה גַּם כֵּן הַמְכוּוָן **And this too is what is meant** בְּטַעַם שֶׁרָפוּ יְדֵיהֶם מִן הַתּוֹרָה **by the reason that they slackened their hands from the Torah:** שֶׁהוּא שֶׁכָּל מַעֲשֵׂי הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוֹת שֶׁלָּהֶם **namely, that all their deeds of Torah and mitzvos** הָיָה בְּרִפְיוֹן וְעַצְלוּת[862] **were done with slackness and laziness,** בְּלֹא חִיּוּת **without vitality,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁלֹּא קָשְׁרוּ הַחָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ **because they did not bind the wisdom in the mind** עִם הָרָצוֹן שֶׁבַּלֵּב **with the will in the heart.** (בְּרָכוֹת סג, א) וְעַל דָּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **It is along the lines of what they said (Berachos 63a):** אֵין בּוֹ כֹּחַ לַעֲמוֹד אֵין בּוֹ כֹּחַ לַעֲמוֹד כָּל הַמְרַפֶּה עַצְמוֹ מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **"Whoever slackens himself from words of Torah has no strength to stand on the day of trouble";**[863] וְכָתַב בְּחִדּוּשֵׁי אַגָּדוֹת מַהַרְשָׁ״א **and the Maharsha wrote in Chiddushei Aggados** [שָׁם דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל כָּל] **(there, s.v. Kol)** שֶׁגַּם שֶׁלּוֹמֵד וּמְקַיְּמָהּ **that even if he learns and fulfills it,** רַק הוּא בְּרִיפּוּי וְרָפְיָא[864] **but does so with slackness and in a casual way,** אֵין בּוֹ כֹּחַ כּוּלֵי

Yud–Heh. It travels five hundred years, the five sefiros, until it reaches the righteous one, to water from there the garden, which is Heh. Therefore ‘a man leaves his father and mother and cleaves to his wife.’” The source explicitly traces the flow through Vav to the righteous one and the receiving Heh. The maamar cites this passage by its tikkun division.

[859] **Megillah 16b** — “‘Words of peace and truth.’ Rabbi Tanchum said, and some say Rabbi Assi: This teaches that the Megillah requires ruled lines, like the truth of Torah.” The physical ruling of the scroll expresses its affinity with a Torah text. The maamar develops the deeper permanence signified by its being granted a written form.

[860] **Yoma 29a** — “Rabbi Assi said: Why is Esther compared to dawn? Just as dawn ends the night, Esther ends all the miracles. But there is Chanukah! We mean miracles that were given to be written. This fits the view that Esther was given to be written; what can be said according to the view that Esther was not given to be written?” The sugya qualifies “last miracle” through canonical writing, rather than denying later miracles. Rav Tzadok reads that written status as light permanently fixed in Israel’s heart.

[861] **Yerushalmi, Megillah 1:5** — “Rabbi Yochanan said: The Prophets and the Writings are destined to cease, but the five books of Torah are not, as it says, ‘A great voice, and it did not cease.’ Reish Lakish said: The Megillah of Esther and halachos too are not destined to cease. Here it says, ‘A great voice, and it did not cease’; there, ‘Their remembrance shall not cease from their descendants.’ As for halachos, ‘The ways of the world are His.’” The maamar distinguishes the Megillah’s enduring light from the prophetic instruction occasioned by sin and anger.

[862] **Yoma 74b–75a** — “‘When he sets his eye upon the cup, he walks on level ground.’ Rabbi Ami and Rabbi Assi differed: One said that whoever sets his eye upon his cup finds all forbidden sexual relations like level ground; the other said that the whole world appears to him like level ground.” The image describes wine removing a person’s sense of moral obstacles. The maamar’s joy is the opposite: wine discloses an upright heart.

[863] **Yoma 76b** — “Rav Kahana contrasted the written tirash with the pronounced tirosh: If one merits, he becomes a head; if he does not, he becomes impoverished. Rava similarly contrasted the written form of ‘it makes glad’ with its pronunciation: If one merits, wine makes him glad; if not, it makes him desolate. Thus Rava said: Wine and fragrant spices sharpen understanding.” Wine has contrasting outcomes, dependent on the person who receives it. Rav Tzadok interprets Purim’s feast as the gladness of a heart made upright.

[864] **Zohar I, 197b** — “‘All her paths are peace.’ These are the paths that emerge from above, all gathered by the single covenant called peace, the peace of the house. It brings them into the great sea and gives it peace. Yosef was the

he has no strength, etc.; (שָׁם לב, ב) שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (ibid. 32b)** דְּאַרְבָּעָה צְרִיכִין חִיזּוּק **that four things need strengthening:** וְכוּלֵי[865] תּוֹרָה **Torah, etc.** וּכְשֶׁהוּא עוֹשֶׂה בְּרִפְיוֹן וּבְלֹא חִיזּוּק **And when one acts with slackness and without strengthening,** הוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁחָסֵר מִמֶּנּוּ בְּחִינַת הַדַּעַת **it is because he lacks the aspect of Daas,** שֶׁהוּא הַחִיזּוּק וְהַחַיּוּת **which is the strength and the vitality** שֶׁל הַתּוֹרָה וְהַמִּצְוֹת קְדוּשָּׁה.[866] **and the holiness of the Torah and the mitzvos.**

covenant of peace. He was king in Egypt and ruled over the land. Yaakov did not know, because the Shechinah had departed from him." The source expressly calls Yosef the covenant of peace and describes its gathering of the upper paths into the receiving sea. This is the precise mystical contribution to the maamar's understanding of shared portions.

[865] **Zohar III, 12b** — "'Dominion and fear are with Him; He makes peace in His heights.' Dominion is Avraham; fear is Yitzchak. 'He makes peace in His heights' is Yaakov, as it says, 'Give truth to Yaakov,' and, 'Love truth and peace.' Truth and peace are bound to one another. Therefore he is the perfection of all." Truth does not remain detached from relationship. Yaakov's truth is the harmonizing middle that unites both sides, clarifying why the maamar joins Yaakov's truth with Yosef's peace in the exchange of gifts.

[866] **Tikkunei Zohar, Patach Eliyahu, 17b** — "Judgment is Gevurah; justice is the central pillar; righteousness is holy Malchus. 'Just scales' are the two supports of truth; 'a just hin' is the sign of the covenant. All this shows how the world is governed." The receiving divine kingship is called tzedek. The following passage explains its transformation into tzedakah when filled by the flow from above.

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר ה׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Hei

"And it shall be, when Hashem your God gives you rest" etc., וְהָיָה בְּהָנִיחַ ה׳ אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְךָ וְגוֹמֵר תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר **"you shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under the heavens" etc.** עֲמָלֵק מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמַיִם וְגוֹמֵר **From the plain sense of the wording "And it shall be, when He gives rest" etc., it appears that the mitzvah of actually blotting out Amalek** נִרְאֶה דְּמִצְוַת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק בְּפוֹעַל הוּא רַק לֶעָתִיד **applies only in the future to come;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָנוּ רוֹאִים בָּאֱמֶת **and as we indeed see,** שֶׁגַּם בִּימֵי שְׁלֹמֹה **that even in the days of Shlomo,** שֶׁהָיָה אִישׁ מְנוּחָה **who was a man of rest** [רְאֵה דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א כב, ט][867] **(see Divrei HaYamim I 22:9),** וּכְתִיב [מְלָכִים א ד, כ] **and it is written (Melachim I 4:20),** יְהוּדָה וְיִשְׂרָאֵל רַבִּים וְגוֹמֵר **"Yehudah and Yisrael were many" etc., "and rejoicing"—and nevertheless** וּשְׂמֵחִים וְעִם כָּל זֶה לֹא הָיָה הַצִּיווּי **there was no command** לִמְחוֹת אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק בְּפוֹעַל. **to actually blot out the remembrance of Amalek.** וְגַם [שְׁמוּאֵל א טו, ב] בְּשָׁאוּל כְּתִיב **And with Shaul too, it is written (Shmuel I 15:2),** פָּקַדְתִּי וְגוֹמֵר **"I have remembered" etc.,** שֶׁהָיָה רַק מִצְוָה לְשָׁעָה **which was only a command for that time,** וְלֹא מִכְּלַל מִצְוַת הַתּוֹרָה **and not part of the mitzvah of the Torah;** [שָׁם, כד] וְכֵן אָמַר שָׁאוּל **and so Shaul said (ibid. 24),** חָטָאתִי כִּי עָבַרְתִּי שֶׁעָבַר עַל מִצְוַת הַנָּבִיא בְּשֵׁם **"I have sinned, for I have transgressed" etc.** וְגוֹמֵר וְאֶת דְּבָרֶיךָ **"and your words,"** ה׳.[868] **for he transgressed the command of the prophet given in Hashem's name.** וְאִם כֵּן מַהוּ מִצְוַת הַזְּכִירָה בָּזֶה **If so, what is the mitzvah of remembrance in this** בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **in our time,** וְגַם דְּיֵיקָא בְּשַׁבָּת זֶה. **and specifically on this Shabbos?** וְעַל כָּל פָּנִים הָיָה דַּי בִּקְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה בְּפָרָשַׁת תֵּצֵא **At any rate it would have been enough to read the passage in Parshas Teitzei,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהַמִּצְוָה פַּעַם אַחַת בַּשָּׁנָה **since the mitzvah is once a year;** וְאִם כְּדַי הָיָה צָרִיךְ לִקְרוֹת בִּשְׁלֹשָׁה עָשָׂר **it should have been read on the thirteenth of Adar,** שֶׁהוּא קָרוֹב לְפוּרִים **which is close to Purim;** וְלָמָּה דְּיֵיקָא בְּשַׁבָּת **so why specifically on Shabbos,** שֶׁיֶּאֱרַע לִפְעָמִים אֵיזוֹ יָמִים קוֹדֶם. **which sometimes falls several days before?** וְגַם יֵשׁ לְהָבִין הַלָּשׁוֹן מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמַיִם **We must also understand the phrase "from under the heavens":** וְכִי אוּמַּת עֲמָלֵק דָּר תַּחַת הַשָּׁמַיִם **does the nation of Amalek dwell under the heavens** וְלֹא בָּאָרֶץ כִּשְׁאָרֵי אוּמּוֹת. **and not on the earth like the other nations?** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And it can be said, as we have said,** דַּעֲמָלֵק רֵאשִׁית דְּקִלִּיפָּה **that Amalek is the beginning of the kelipah** שֶׁל הַנָּחָשׁ הַקַּדְמוֹנִי **of the primordial serpent,** וְהוּא הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ **and he is the root;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן שְׁאָר הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **unlike the other kelipos,** שֶׁהֵם עַל חֲטָאִים מְיוּחָדִים בְּמַעֲשֶׂה בְּפוֹעַל **which are over specific sins in actual deed.** וְעַל כֵּן אִיתָא בַּזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ [חֶלֶק ג קס, א] **Therefore it is stated in the holy Zohar (III 160a)** עַל פָּסוּק עֲמָלֵק יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב [בַּמִּדְבָּר יג, כט] **on the verse "Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev" (Bamidbar 13:29):** הָא יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא קַטֵּיגוֹרָא כְּווֹתֵי **"This is the evil inclination, the accuser," etc.,** דְּאִשְׁתַּכַּח תָּדִיר בְּגוּפָא **"which is found constantly in the body";** וְעַל זֶה רוֹמֵז בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב **and to this alludes "in the land of the Negev,"** הַיְינוּ אַף בְּמִי שֶׁהוּא מְנוּגָּב **that is, even in one who is dried out** מִכָּל חֶמְדּוֹת **of all desires and lusts,** הוּא גַּם כֵּן נִכְנָס לְלִבּוֹ לְפַתּוֹתוֹ **he too enters his heart to entice him;** וּכְעֵין שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (תְּמוּרָה טז, א) **similar to what they expounded (Temurah 16a):** אֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב נְתַתָּנִי [יְהוֹשֻׁעַ טו, יט] **"You have given me the land of the Negev" (Yehoshua 15:19)—** שֶׁמְּנוּגָּב מִכָּל טוֹבָה כְּווֹתֵי **that he is dried out of all good, etc.,** אָדָם שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה בִּלְבַד. **a man who has nothing in him but Torah alone** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א) **(as explained in maamar 1).** וְלָכֵן נֶאֱמַר בְּאַבְרָהָם [בְּרֵאשִׁית יב, ט] **Therefore it says regarding Avraham (Bereishis 12:9),** הָלוֹךְ וְנָסוֹעַ הַנֶּגְבָּה **"going on and journeying toward the Negev,"** שֶׁכָּל עִסְקוֹ וּמַגָּמָתוֹ הָיָה **for all his occupation and aim was** לָבֹא לִבְחִינָה זוֹ **to come to this level,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְנוּגָּב מִכָּל חֶמְדָּה זָרָה **to be dried out of**

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[867] **Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 21, 58a–b** — "The Shechinah is called charity, and the Holy One, blessed be He, the Master of charity. In exile she is poor, and her children poor. Everyone who gives charity to a poor person causes the river to flow from Eden, the supernal Mother, to water the garden, the dalet, poor and needy. When she descends filled to her husband, Vav enters dalet and it becomes Heh. What was tzedek becomes tzedakah. Concerning that river it says, 'Charity raises a nation'; what was tzedek, judgment, becomes mercy." The addition of Heh to tzedek is described through giving, filling and mercy. Rav Tzadok reads the raising of a nation as ascent to the highest source, the preciousness signified by yekar.

[868] **Vayikra Rabbah 35:3** — "Rabbi Elazar said: A flesh-and-blood king decrees a decree; if he wishes he keeps it, and if not he eventually causes others to keep it. The Holy One, blessed be He, is different: He decrees a decree and fulfills it first. Thus, 'Rise before the aged and honor an elder ... I am Hashem'—I am the One who first fulfilled the mitzvah of standing before an elder." Rav Tzadok applies this pattern to Purim's gifts: the human mitzvah reflects a divine bestowal already active in these days.

every foreign desire, וּלְהַחֲזִירָם לִקְדוּשָׁה **and to return them to holiness;** [שָׁם כד, סב] וּבְיִצְחָק נֶאֱמַר **and regarding Yitzchak it says (ibid. 24:62),** וְהוּא יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב **"and he dwelt in the land of the Negev,"** שֶׁהָיָה נַפְשׁוֹ כְּבָר מְזוּפָּךְ **for his soul was already refined** וּמְנוּגָּב מִכָּל ח�ֶמְדּוֹת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה **and dried out of all the desires of this world,** וְהָיָה לוֹ נַיָּיחָא בִּבְחִינָה זוֹ. **and he had repose in this level.** וּקְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק הוּא לְהַכְשִׁיל בְּדַקּוּת **And the kelipah of Amalek is to make one stumble in subtle ways,** גַּם הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁמְּזַכֵּךְ אֶת עַצְמוֹ **even the soul that refines itself** מִכָּל נִדְנוּד אִיסּוּר **of every trace of prohibition;** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **as we find with David HaMelech, alav hashalom,** שֶׁאָמַר עַל נַפְשׁוֹ **who said of his soul,** [תְּהִלִּים קט, כב] וְלִבִּי חָלַל בְּקִרְבִּי **"And my heart is slain within me" (Tehillim 109:22),** שֶׁהָרַג לַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **for he had slain the yetzer hara** [869]יְרוּשַׁלְמִי בְּרָכוֹת פֶּרֶק ט הֲלָכָה ה סז, ב] **(Yerushalmi Berachos 9:5, 67b);** וְהִתְנַצֵּל הֵן בְּעָוֹן חוֹלָלְתִּי [תְּהִלִּים נא, ז **and he pleaded, "Behold, I was brought forth in iniquity" (Tehillim 51:7)—** בַּעֲוֹן מָלֵא **"in iniquity," fully,** הַיְינוּ הַחֵטְא מַהֲתוֹלָדָה **meaning the sin from birth,** שֶׁהָיָה בִּישַׁי שֶׁמֵּת בְּעֶטְיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ **which was in Yishai, who died only through the counsel of the serpent** [870]בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יז, א] **(Bava Basra 17a);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁנִּתְכַּוֵּין מָה **that is, that he had some intention** לְהֶנָּאַת עַצְמוֹ בְּהֶיתֵּר **for his own pleasure in a permitted act,** שֶׁזֶּה נִצְמָח מִפְּגַם הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁל הַנָּחָשׁ. **which grows out of the first blemish of the serpent.** [תְּהִלִּים שָׁם] וּבְחֵטְא יֶחֱמַתְנִי אִמִּי **"And in sin did my mother conceive me" (Tehillim ibid.)—** וְהַיְינוּ הַחֵטְא שֶׁל טוּמְאַת נִדָּה **meaning the sin of the impurity of niddah** וְטוּמְאַת לֵידָה **and the impurity of childbirth,** שֶׁגַּם פְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **which is also the blemish of the serpent,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לָהּ [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, טז] **as was said to her (Bereishis 3:16),** בְּעֶצֶב תֵּלְדִי בָנִים **"In sorrow you shall bear children";** וְזֶה עִיקַּר כֹּחַ עֲמָלֵק **and this is the main power of Amalek** בְּכָל נֶפֶשׁ בְּפִנִימִיּוּת.[871] **within every soul.** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ בְּיַעְבֵּץ **And so we find with Yaavetz,** [דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א ד, ט] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Divrei HaYamim I 4:9),** וְאִמּוֹ קָרְאָה שְׁמוֹ יַעְבֵּץ לֵאמֹר כִּי יָלַדְתִּי בְּעֹצֶב **"And his mother called his name Yaavetz, saying, 'For I bore him in sorrow'";** שֶׁהָיְתָה מַרְגֶּשֶׁת שֶׁהָיָה לָהּ הָעֶצֶב בְּהַפְלָגָה **for she felt that she had the sorrow to an extraordinary degree,** וּמִזֶּה הִרְגִּישָׁה שֶׁיִּוָּלֵד נֶפֶשׁ יְקָרָה כָּזוֹ **and from this she sensed that so precious a soul would be born,** שֶׁהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּת הַנָּחָשׁ לְהַכְשִׁילוֹ בְּהָעֶצֶבוֹן **that the serpent was striving to trip him up through sadness;** וְעַל זֶה קָרָאתוּ שָׁעַל שֵׁם זֶה נִקְרָא לְהַפֵּךְ הָעֶצֶב לְטוֹב **and therefore she called him Yaavetz, to turn the sorrow into good;** יַעְבֵּץ שֶׁיָּעַץ וְרִיבֵּץ תּוֹרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **for on account of this he was called Yaavetz, because he counseled and spread Torah in Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ תְּמוּרָה שָׁם[872]) **(as they said in Temurah there);** וְהוּא הֶחֱזִיר עַל יְדֵי פִּילְפּוּלוֹ **and he restored through his pilpul** הַהֲלָכוֹת שֶׁנִּשְׁתַּכְּחוּ בִּימֵי אֲבֵלוּ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה **the halachos that were forgotten in**

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[869] **Tanchuma, Naso 29; Pesikta Rabbati 3** — "A person should not say: I will not fulfill the elders' commandments, since they are not from the Torah. The Holy One, blessed be He, said to them: My children, you may not speak so. Rather, fulfill everything they decree for you, as it says, 'You shall act according to the instruction they teach you.' For I too agree with their words, as it says, 'You will decree a matter, and it will be established for you.' Yaakov placed Ephraim before Menasheh, and the Holy One fulfilled his decree in the princes' offerings: Ephraim offered first, then Menasheh." Pesikta Rabbati 3 likewise concludes that Yaakov's placing Ephraim first was honored in the offerings. The maamar extends this concurrence with the elders to the rabbinic mitzvos of Purim.

[870] **Tanchuma, Yisro 5** — "'Your friend and your father's friend do not abandon.' Your friend is the Holy One, blessed be He, who called Israel brothers and friends, as it says, 'For the sake of my brothers and friends.' Your father's friend is Avraham, as it says, 'The seed of Avraham, My beloved.' Do not abandon Him; if you have abandoned Him, take it to heart." The source explicitly makes friendship a description of the bond between Hashem and Israel. That bond is the basis of Rav Tzadok's reading of divine sending of portions.

[871] **Rashi, Shabbos 31a, s.v. De'alach sani** — "'What is hateful to you, do not do to your fellow': 'Your friend and your father's friend do not abandon'—this is the Holy One, blessed be He. Do not transgress His words, for you too dislike it when your friend transgresses your words. Another explanation: Your actual fellow, as in robbery, theft, adultery and most mitzvos." Rashi presents both readings. Rav Tzadok selects the first to develop the reciprocity of divine and human friendship.

[872] Parallel: **Sefas Emes, Purim 5631 (1871), s.v. Umitzvas mishloach manos** — "The mitzvah of sending portions appears intended to bring one to love of Israel. 'Love your fellow as yourself' is a great principle in Torah. When a person cleaves to the inward point of life, where all Israel are one, he naturally loves his fellow too. This is itself what Rashi says, 'Your friend is the Holy One,' for all is one. Mordechai comprised all Israel: Through the love that makes them one, he could bring the merit of his deeds upon all Israel. He cleaved to the point of life where unity resides. My grandfather likewise explained 'Israel encamped before the mountain': Unity prepares for receiving Torah; here too, in Purim, there was acceptance of Torah."

Connection: Sefas Emes links the same three elements joined here: sending portions, Rashi's identification of the divine Friend, and the one-hearted encampment that prepares for Torah. It explains the social mitzvah as an expression of the inward unity of Israel, clarifying why human friendship can reveal the higher union described by Rav Tzadok.

the days of mourning for Moshe; וְהוּא עִיקַּר כֹּחַ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and this is the essential power of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהּ הִתְקַשְּׁרוּת בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ בְּעַתִּיקָא **which is bound at the root, in Atika;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב, ב) **as they said (Bava Basra 12b):** תֵּדַע דְּאָמַר גַּבְרָא רַבָּה מִילְּתָא **"Know it, for a great man states a matter** וּמִתְאַמְרָא הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי כְּוָותֵיהּ כּוּלֵּי **and a halachah given to Moshe at Sinai is stated in accordance with him," etc.,** וְלָאו טַעַם יָהֵיב.[873] **"even though he gave no reason."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי טַעֲמֵי תּוֹרָה **That is, through the reasons of Torah** מַגִּיעִין עַד הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ **one reaches up to the root,** מַה שֶּׁלְּמַעְלָה מֵהַשָּׂגָה **to what is beyond comprehension;** וְזֶה דְּיֵיקָא הוּא הַכֹּחַ **and this specifically is the power** לְהַכְנִיעַ רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **to subdue the beginning of the kelipah of Amalek,** הַמְנַגֵּד לָזֶה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **which opposes this, as mentioned above.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁמַעְנוּ מֵרַבֵּנוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And as we heard from our holy Rebbe,** זֶכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **may the memory of the righteous and holy one be for a blessing, for the life of the World to Come,** עַל פָּסוּק רִפְאוּת שֹׁרֶךָ תְּהִי לְשָׁרֶךָ [מִשְׁלֵי ג, ח][874] **on the verse "It shall be healing to your navel" (Mishlei 3:8):** שֶׁדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה הֵם רְפוּאָה לְהַחֲסָרוֹן שֶׁל הַתּוֹלָדָה **that words of Torah are a healing for the deficiency of birth,** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז הַשֹּׁרֶר **and this is alluded to by the navel,** שֶׁהָאָדָם נוֹצָר מִמֶּנּוּ. **from which a person is formed.** וּבְיַעְבֵּץ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עָלָיו **And regarding Yaavetz, about whom it says,** אֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב נְתַתָּנִי וְגוֹמֵר **"You have given me the land of the Negev" etc.—** אָדָם שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה בִּלְבַד **a man who has nothing in him but Torah alone—** (תְּמוּרָה שָׁם) אָמְרוּ **they said (Temurah there)** [דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א ד, י] שֶׁהִתְפַּלֵּל לְבִלְתִּי עָצְבִּי **that he prayed "that it not grieve me" (Divrei HaYamim I 4:10):** שֶׁלֹּא יְשַׁגְּבֵנִי יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלִּשְׁנוֹת **that the yetzer hara not overpower me and keep me from reviewing;** כִּי זֶהוּ דְּיֵיקָא כֹּחוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק **for this precisely is the power of Amalek,** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַנָּחָשׁ **the root of the serpent:** לְהַשְׁלִיךְ אֶת הָאָדָם בְּעַצְבוּת **to cast a person into sadness;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [דְּבָרִים שָׁם, יח] **as it says (Devarim ibid. 18),** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ **"who happened upon you"—** שֶׁהִפְשִׁירְךָ וְהִצְנִינְךָ.[875] **that he cooled you and chilled you.**

With this we can understand what they said in Pesikta Rabbasi (לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן יב) וּבָזֶה יוּבַן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בְּפִסְיקְתָא רַבָּתִי **(for Parshas Zachor, section 12, siman 12):** מָשָׁל לְמֶלֶךְ שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ פַּרְדֵּס כּוּלֵּי **"A parable of a king who had an orchard," etc.;** בָּא בְּנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ **"his friend's son came** לִגְנוֹב מִתּוֹךְ הַפַּרְדֵּס **to steal from within the orchard;** עָמַד הַכֶּלֶב וּנְשָׁכוֹ **the dog rose up and bit him.** כְּשֶׁהָיָה הַמֶּלֶךְ מְבַקֵּשׁ לְהַזְכִּיר **When the king wished to remind** לִבְנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ **his friend's son** שֶׁרָצָה לִגְנוֹב כּוּלֵּי **that he had wanted to steal," etc.,** אוֹמֵר לוֹ זְכוֹר מַה שֶּׁעָשָׂה לְךָ אוֹתוֹ הַכֶּלֶב[876] **"he would say to him, 'Remember what was done to you by that dog.'** כָּךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל חָטְאוּ בְּרְפִידִים **So too, Yisrael sinned at Refidim** וְאָמְרוּ הֲיֵשׁ ה' בְּקִרְבֵּנוּ **and said, 'Is Hashem among us?'** וּמִיָּד בָּא הַכֶּלֶב וּנְשָׁכָם **and immediately the dog came and bit them—** זֶה הָיָה עֲמָלֵק כּוּלֵּי **this was Amalek," etc.;** לְהַזְכִּיר יִשְׂרָאֵל הַחֵטְא וּכְשֶׁהָיָה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְבַקֵּשׁ **"and when HaKadosh Baruch Hu wished to remind Yisrael of the sin** שֶׁחָטְאוּ בִּרְפִידִים **they sinned at Refidim,** אוֹמֵר זְכוּרִים אַתֶּם לְאוֹתוֹ עֲמָלֵק כּוּלֵּי. **He says,**

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[873] **Yerushalmi, Megillah 1:4** — "Purim collections are for Purim. Rabbi Elazar said: The poor person may not divert the funds even for a strap for his shoe. We do not scrutinize Purim giving; rather, whoever extends his hand to receive is given. Purim funds are not diverted." The Yerushalmi states the openhanded rule for Purim distribution. The maamar applies its spiritual counterpart to all who seek Hashem's salvation.

[874] Parallel: **Rambam, Hilchos Megillah VeChanukah 2:17** — "It is better for a person to increase his gifts to the poor than to increase his own feast or the portions he sends to his friends. For there is no greater or more splendid joy than gladdening the hearts of the poor, orphans, widows, and converts. One who gladdens the hearts of these afflicted people resembles the Divine Presence, as it says: 'To revive the spirit of the lowly and to revive the heart of the crushed.'"

Connection: Rambam explicitly places resemblance to the Shechinah within the mitzvah of Purim gifts: bringing life and gladness to the lowly is itself a divine action. This illuminates Rav Tzadok's conclusion that God fulfills these gifts by giving to those who seek His rescue. The same mitzvah links human relief of poverty with the divine bestowal described in the maamar.

[875] **Chullin 139b** — "Where is Moshe alluded to in the Torah? 'Inasmuch as he is flesh.' Where is Haman alluded to in the Torah? 'Have you eaten from the tree?' Where is Esther alluded to in the Torah? 'I will surely hide.' Where is Mordechai alluded to in the Torah? As it is written, 'Pure myrrh,' which we translate as 'mira dakhya.'" The Gemara places the four questions together. Rav Tzadok asks why these particular figures are selected and interprets the sequence through their relation to the Written and Oral Torah.

[876] **Bava Kamma 17a** — "Rabbi Yochanan said in Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai's name: What is meant by 'Happy are you who sow beside all waters, sending forth the foot of the ox and the donkey'? Whoever engages in Torah and acts of kindness merits the inheritance of two tribes. ... 'Sowing' means charity, as it is written, 'Sow for yourselves in righteousness and reap according to kindness'; 'water' means Torah, as it is written, 'All who are thirsty, come to the water.'" The identification of water with Torah supplies the basis for Rav Tzadok's further distinction between the visibly descending rain and the less apparent arrival of dew.

'Remember that Amalek,'" etc. וְעָמַדְנוּ עַל זֶה **And we raised a difficulty on this:** הֲלֹא יֵשׁ חֵטְא גָּדוֹל מִזֶּה **is there not a greater sin than this,** שֶׁמַּזְכִּירוֹ הַכָּתוּב בְּפֵירוּשׁ זְכוֹר וְגוֹמֵר **which the verse mentions explicitly, "Remember" etc.,** אֵת אֲשֶׁר הִקְצַפְתָּ אֶת ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ בַּמִּדְבָּר **"how you angered Hashem your God in the wilderness"** [דְּבָרִים ט, ז] **(Devarim 9:7)?** אָמְנָם **However, since this is the power of Amalek,** לְהַכְנִיס אֶת הָאָדָם בְּעִצָּבוֹן **to bring a person into sadness,** עַל כֵּן אֵין לְהַזְכִּיר הַחֵטְא בְּפֵירוּשׁ **therefore the sin is not to be mentioned explicitly,** כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא יִפּוֹל בְּעִצָּבוּת מִזֶּה עַצְמוֹ.[877] **so that he not fall into sadness from this very thing.** וְגַם כִּי כֹּחוֹ לְהַכְשִׁיל **And also because his power is to make stumble** גַּם מִי שֶׁלִּבּוֹ מְזוּקָּךְ מִכֹּל וָכֹל **even one whose heart is completely refined,** וְזֶה בּוּשָׁה גְּדוֹלָה **and this is a great shame,** כְּבוֹשֶׁת גַּנָּב כִּי יִמָּצֵא **"as the shame of a thief when he is found";** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ הַלָּשׁוֹן (פִּרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר פֶּרֶק מד) **and this is the wording they used (Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer, ch. 44):** הֲרֵי אֲנִי מַלְבִּין אֶת פְּנֵיהֶם **"Behold, I am shaming them,** וְהַמַּלְבִּין כּוּלֵי.[878] **and one who shames," etc.** וּמֵאַחַר שֶׁזֶּהוּ עִיקַּר קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **And since this is the essence of the kelipah of Amalek—** הַפְּגַם מֵהַתּוֹלָדָה **the blemish from birth,** מֵה שֶׁנִּמְצָא בְּכָל נֶפֶשׁ **which is found in every soul** מִכֹּחַ פְּגַם הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁל הַנָּחָשׁ **by force of the first blemish of the serpent—** וְזֶה בֶּאֱמֶת אֵין אוֹפֶן לִמְחוֹק מִכֹּל וָכֹל **and this in truth there is no way to erase completely** בָּהָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **in this world** עַד לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא **until the future to come,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה גְּמַר הַתִּיקּוּן לִפְגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **when the rectification of the serpent's blemish will be complete;** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר תִּמְחֶה וְגוֹמֵר **and about this it says, "And it shall be, when He gives rest" etc.,** וְהָיָה בְּהָנִיחַ וְגוֹמֵר **"you shall blot out" etc.** וְזֶהוּ לֶעָתִיד לָבֹא תִּזָּכֶה **That is, in the future to come you will merit** לִמְחוֹת זִכְרוֹ מִכֹּל וָכֹל. **to blot out his remembrance completely.** אָמְנָם **However, in this world too** גַּם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **every** נִצְרָךְ כָּל נֶפֶשׁ לִזְכּוֹר **soul needs to remember** לִמְחוֹת מִלִּבּוֹ אֶת מַה שֶּׁבְּיָכְלְתּוֹ[879] **to blot out from his heart whatever is within his ability,** כִּי זֶהוּ עִיקַּר עֵסֶק הָאָדָם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה. **for this is a person's main occupation in this world.** וְהָעֵת הַמּוּכְשָׁר לָזֶה **And the time suited for this** הוּא דַּיְיקָא בְּשַׁבָּת זֶה הַסָּמוּךְ לְפוּרִים **is specifically this Shabbos, close to Purim;** וּבְשַׁחֲרִית בִּשְׁעַת הִתְגַּלּוּת בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **and at Shacharis, at the time of the revelation of the aspect of Atika,** יֵשׁ כֹּחַ לְהַכְנִיעַ **there is power to subdue** סִטְרָא דְּקִלְפַּת עֲמָלֵק **the side of the kelipah of Amalek,** הַמְנַגֵּד לְרֵאשִׁית דְּקֻדּוּשָׁה. **which opposes the beginning of holiness.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is why it says,** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמָיִם **"You shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under the heavens,"** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה ה, א) **along the lines of what they said (Sukkah 5a):** וְלֹא עָלוּ מֹשֶׁה וְאֵלִיָּהוּ לַמָּרוֹם כּוּלֵי מֵעוֹלָם כּוּלֵי **"Never," etc., "did Moshe and Eliyahu ascend on high," etc.;**[880] וְהָכְתִיב כּוּלֵי לְמַטָּה מֵעֲשָׂרָה **"but is it not written," etc. —"below ten";** דִּכְתִיב [תְּהִלִּים קטו, טז] הַשָּׁמַיִם שָׁמַיִם לַה' **as it is written (Tehillim 115:16), "The heavens are the heavens of Hashem,** וְהָאָרֶץ וְגוֹמֵר **and the earth" etc.** רַק הָאֲוִיר שֶׁבֵּין שָׁמַיִם לָאָרֶץ **Only the air between heaven and earth,** עַד לְמַטָּה מֵעֲשָׂרָה **down to below ten,** יֵשׁ כֹּחַ בְּנֶפֶשׁ הָאָדָם לְהַגִּיעַ. **is within the power of the**

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[877] **Zohar I 117a, Vayera** — "In the six-hundredth year of the sixth millennium, the gates of wisdom above and the springs of wisdom below will open, and the world will be prepared to enter the seventh, like a person who prepares on the sixth day, as the sun approaches evening, to enter Shabbos. So it is here. Your sign is: 'In the six-hundredth year of Noach's life ... all the springs of the great deep burst forth.'" The source uses the Flood verse as a sign for the future opening of wisdom. Rav Tzadok also sees in it the possibility of revelation that the Flood generation itself failed to realize.

[878] **Rashi on Chullin 139b** — "They also asked him this: Where is there a hint to Moshe, before he came, that he would ultimately come? 'Beshagam'—beshagam has the same numerical value as Moshe, and it is written there, 'His days shall be one hundred and twenty years'; so were the years of Moshe's life. That is, Moshe, beshagam, would ultimately come from those who would be born, and this would also be his lifespan." Rashi explains why a hint is sought even though Moshe is explicitly named throughout the Torah: the question concerns a prior allusion. Rav Tzadok develops an additional account of Moshe as the root of Torah.

[879] **Zohar III 98a–b, Emor, Raaya Meheimna** — "Masters of Kabbalah and masters of the attributes are from the side of the Tree of Life. The rest of the people are from the side of the tree of good and evil, of forbidden and permitted. Therefore their food is from the animal level: the omer is barley bread—'He measured six measures of barley and placed it upon her'—the Oral Torah, which has six orders of Mishnah. But those of the Tree of Life, who are called 'man,' have as their Torah the bread of the Holy One, blessed be He, as it is written, 'Come, eat of My bread.' These are the two loaves." This passage distinguishes levels of Torah through the two trees and names the six orders of Mishnah. Rav Tzadok applies that distinction to the interaction of Written and Oral Torah; the Zohar's own categories also distinguish masters of inward wisdom from the rest of the people.

[880] **Eruvin 3a** — "Rabbah said: Scripture states, 'So that your generations shall know that I settled the children of Israel in sukkos.' Up to twenty cubits a person knows that he is dwelling in a sukkah; above twenty cubits a person does not know, because the eye does not take it in." The Gemara is explaining awareness of the sukkah's roof. Rav Tzadok invokes its statement about visual awareness in asking why Haman built a gallows fifty cubits high.

human soul to reach. וּבְזֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה **And correspondingly, on the opposing side,** יֵשׁ כַּמָּה קְלִיפּוֹת **there are several kelipos** הַמּוֹנְעִים אֶת הָאָדָם **that prevent a person** מִלְּכָנוֹס לְהַקְדוּשָּׁה **from entering into holiness,** וְהַכֹּחַ הָרִאשׁוֹן **and the first power** הוּא מִבְּחִינַת עֲמָלֵק **is from the aspect of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה. **which is the beginning of kelipah.** וְעַל כֵּן מוֹשָׁבוֹ תַּחַת הַשָּׁמַיִם **Therefore his dwelling is under the heavens,** לְמִנְוַע רֵאשִׁית הִתְקַשְּׁרוּת בְּהַשֹּׁרֶשׁ **to prevent the beginning of the bond with the root;** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **and about this it says,** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמַיִם דַּיְיקָא: **"You shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek from under the heavens"—specifically.**

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר ו׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Vav

Rabbi Tanchuma opened: רַבִּי תַּנְחוּמָא פָּתַח **"Your remembrances are likened to ashes;** זִכְרוֹנֵיכֶם מְשָׁלֵי אֵפֶר **your bodies are bodies of clay" (Iyov 13:12).** לְגַבֵּי חוֹמֶר גַּבֵּיכֶם [אִיּוֹב יג, יב] **HaKadosh Baruch Hu said to Yisrael:** אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **"Those two remembrances," etc.,** אוֹתָן שְׁתֵּי זְכִירוֹת כּוּבְלֵי **"be careful with them:** הֱווּ זְהִירִין בָּהֶן תִּמְחֶה **'You shall blot out the remembrance of Amalek,'** מְשׁוּלֵי אֵפֶר זָכוֹר וְגוֹמֵר **'Remember' etc.** אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **'Likened to ashes'—** אִם זְכִיתֶם אַתֶּם בָּנָיו שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם **if you are worthy, you are the children of Avraham,** שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל עַצְמוֹ כְּאֵפֶר כּוּבְלֵי **who likened himself to ashes, etc.;** וְאִם לָאו **and if not—** לְגַבֵּי חוֹמֶר גַּבֵּיכֶם **'your bodies are bodies of clay':** הַתְקִינוּ עַצְמֵיכֶם לְשִׁעְבּוּדָהּ שֶׁל מִצְרַיִם **prepare yourselves for the bondage of Egypt,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שְׁמוֹת א, יד] וַיְמָרְרוּ וְגוֹמֵר. **as it says (Shemos 1:14), 'And they embittered' etc."** הָעִנְיָן כִּדְבָרֵינוּ הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל **The matter is as we said above,** דְּקִלִּיפַּת עֲמָלֵק הוּא מְנַגֵּד **that the kelipah of Amalek stands opposed** בֶּגֶד קְדוּשַּׁת הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ **against the holiness of the root,** בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **the aspect of Atika;** וְזֶהוּ אִם זְכִיתֶם **and this is "if you are worthy,** אַתֶּם בָּנָיו שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם **you are the children of Avraham,"** שֶׁזָּכָה לְבְחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **who attained the aspect of Atika** (וְנִתְבָּאַר מַאֲמָר ב) **(as explained in maamar 2),** וְדַיְיקָא עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל עַצְמוֹ כְּאֵפֶר **and specifically through likening himself to ashes,** עַל יְדֵי הַשְׁפָּלוּת **through lowliness;** [יְשַׁעְיָה נז, טו] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Yeshayah 57:15),** מָרוֹם וְקָדוֹשׁ אֶשְׁכּוֹן וְאֶת דַּכָּא וְגוֹמֵר **"I dwell on high and in holiness, and with the contrite" etc.;** מָרוֹם וְקָדוֹשׁ מוֹרֶה עַל בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא. **"on high and in holiness" denotes the aspect of Atika.** וְאִם הַתְקִינוּ מִרְמֵז שֶׁעַל יְדֵי עֵסֶק **"And if not, prepare yourselves** לְשִׁעְבּוּדָהּ שֶׁל מִצְרַיִם **for the bondage of Egypt"** עַצְמְכֶם יְכוֹלִים לְהַכְנִיעוֹ **alludes that through occupation** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה גַּם כֵּן **in Torah she'b'al peh as well one can subdue him,** וְכִמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ (וְנִתְבָּאַר שָׁם) **as we said (and it was explained there);** וְזֶהוּ רוֹמֵז שִׁעְבּוּד מִצְרַיִם **and this is what the bondage of Egypt alludes to,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיְמָרְרוּ אֶת חַיֵּיהֶם **as it says, "And they embittered their lives** בַּעֲבֹדָה קָשָׁה **with hard labor";** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א כז, א וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **and it is stated (Zohar I 27a and elsewhere):** קָשָׁה בְּקוּשְׁיָא **"'Hard'—with kushya;** בְּחוֹמֶר בְּקַל וָחוֹמֶר **'with clay'—with kal vachomer;** וּבִלְבֵנִים בְּלִבּוּן הִלְכְתָא **'and with bricks'—with clarifying the halachah;** וּבְכָל עֲבוֹדָה בַּשָּׂדֶה דָּא בָּרַיְיתָא **'and with all labor in the field'—this is Baraisa;** אֶת כָּל עֲבוֹדָתָם דָּא מִשְׁנָה.[881] **'all their labor'—this is Mishnah."** עוֹד אָמְרוּ **They further said in the Midrash:** בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **"your bodies are bodies of clay" (Iyov ibid.)—** לְגַבֵּי חוֹמֶר גַּבֵּיכֶם [אִיּוֹב שָׁם] **like the Generation of the Dispersion,** כְּדוֹר הַפַּלָּגָה **of whom it is written,** שֶׁכְּתִיב בָּהֶן **"and the slime served them as mortar"** וְהַחֵמָר הָיָה לָהֶם לַחוֹמֶר [בְּרֵאשִׁית יא, ג] **(Bereishis 11:3);** עַיֵּין שָׁם וּבְפִסְיקְתָא רַבָּתִי **see there, and in Pesikta Rabbasi** (לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן ב). **(for Parshas Zachor, section 12, siman 2).** וְיֵשׁ לְרַמֵּז גַּם כֵּן **And one can also find an allusion** לְעִנְיַן דְּרַשׁ זִכְרוֹנֵיכֶם **for the matter of the exposition of "your remembrances"** עַל זִכְרוֹנוֹת דַּעֲמָלֵק. **as referring to the remembrances of Amalek,** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כו, א) **based on what they said (Shemos Rabbah 26:1):** לֹא שָׁלַוְתִּי מִגְּזֵירָה רִאשׁוֹנָה **"I was not at ease from the first decree** שֶׁגָּזַר פַּרְעֹה עָלַי **that Pharaoh decreed upon me,** וַיְמָרְרוּ וְגוֹמֵר **'And they embittered' etc.,** וְהֶעֱמִיד לִי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גּוֹאֵל **and HaKadosh Baruch Hu set up for me a redeemer—** זֶה מִרְיָם עַל שֵׁם הַמָּרוֹר **this is Miriam, named for the bitterness;** וְלֹא שָׁקַטְתִּי מִגְּזֵירָה שְׁנִיָּה **and I had no quiet from the second decree,** אִם בֵּן הוּא הַמַּתֶּם אוֹתוֹ **'If it is a son, you shall kill him,'** וְהֶעֱמִיד לִי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גּוֹאֵל **and HaKadosh Baruch Hu set up for me a redeemer—** זֶה אַהֲרֹן עַל שֵׁם הַהֵרָיוֹן **this is Aharon, named for the pregnancy;** וְלֹא נַחְתִּי מִגְּזֵירָה שְׁלִישִׁית **and I had no rest from the third decree,** שֶׁגָּזַר כָּל הַבֵּן הַיִּלּוֹד הַיְאוֹרָה וְגוֹמֵר **which he decreed: 'Every son that is born, into the river' etc.,** וְהֶעֱמִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גּוֹאֵל **and HaKadosh Baruch Hu set up a redeemer** עַל שֵׁם הַמַּיִם זֶה מֹשֶׁה כּוּבְלֵי **named for the water—this is Moshe," etc.;** וַיָּבֹא רֹגֶז זֶה עֲמָלֵק.[882] **"and**

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[881] **Tikkunei Zohar 58a, Tikkun 21** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, gave them into her hand and into the hand of her people, and they hanged him and his sons upon the tree. He made a tree fifty cubits high, and the Holy One, blessed be He, took vengeance upon him and upon his sons through the upper Shechinah, which struck the Egyptians with fifty blows." The fifty-cubit tree and the fifty blows are explicit in the original. Rav Tzadok interprets them through the fifty gates of Binah and the attempted suppression of Oral Torah.

[882] **Zohar III 124b, Nasso, Raaya Meheimna** — "'The wise will understand'—from the side of Binah, which is the tree of life. Concerning them it is said, 'The wise will shine like the radiance of the firmament,' through this composition of yours, which is the Book of the Zohar, from the radiance of the supernal Mother, repentance. ... Because Israel are destined to taste from the tree of life, which is this Book of the Zohar, through it they will leave exile with mercy. ... The tree of good and evil, which is prohibition and permission, impurity and purity, will no longer rule over Israel,

trouble came—this is Amalek." וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁשָּׁלֹשׁ גְּזֵירוֹת הַלָּלוּ **And it can be said that these three decrees** הָיוּ עַל יְדֵי הַשָּׁלֹשָׁה גּוֹאֲלִים **were in order to refine in Egypt** כְּדֵי לְבָרֵר בְּמִצְרַיִם **the three crowns** הַשְּׁלֹשָׁה כְּתָרִים **through the three redeemers:** וְכֶתֶר כְּהוּנָּה עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה כֶּתֶר תּוֹרָה עַל יְדֵי אַהֲרֹן **the crown of Torah through Moshe, the crown of priesthood through Aharon, and the crown of kingship through Miriam;** (סוטה יא, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Sotah 11b):** בָּתֵּי מַלְכוּת דָּוִד נַמֵּי מִמִּרְיָם קָאָתֵי.[884] **"Royal houses—David too descends from Miriam."** וּמַלְכוּת פֶּה **And Malchus is "mouth"—we call it Torah she'b'al peh** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפָתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pesach Eliyahu);** וְהוּא בְּחִינַת בְּאֵרָה שֶׁל מִרְיָם **and it is the aspect of Miriam's well,** שֶׁרוֹמֵז לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **which alludes to Torah she'b'al peh,** (ילקוט שמעוני חקת רמז תשסד) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Yalkut Shimoni, Chukas, remez 764)** [בַּמִּדְבָּר כ, ח] עַל פָּסוּק וְדַבַּרְתֶּם אֶל הַסֶּלַע **on the verse "And you shall speak to the rock" (Bamidbar 20:8):** שְׁנֵה עָלָיו פֶּרֶק אֶחָד **"Recite over it one chapter,** וְהוּא מוֹצִיא מַיִם מִן הַסֶּלַע[885] **and it will bring forth water from the rock"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר תְּרוּמָה מַאֲמָר יא) **(and it was explained in Terumah, maamar 11,** וַחֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר כה **and Chanukah, maamar 25,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וּבַגְּמָרָא עַיֵּין שָׁם). **in the passage beginning "And in the Gemara"; see there).** וְאִיתָא בִּכְתָבֵי הָאֲרִ״י זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **And it is stated in the writings of the Arizal** שֶׁשִּׁעְבּוּד מִצְרַיִם הָיָה **that the bondage of Egypt was** לְבָרֵר נִשְׁמוֹת שֶׁל דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל **to refine the souls of the Generation of the Flood,** וְדוֹר הַפְּלָגָה וְאַנְשֵׁי סְדוֹם[886] **the Generation of the Dispersion, and the people of Sodom;** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁשְּׁלֹשָׁה בֵּירוּרִים שֶׁל הַשָּׁלֹשָׁה גּוֹאֲלִים הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל **and it can be said that these too correspond to the three refinements of the three aforementioned redeemers.** גְּזֵירַת הַיְאוֹרָה תַּשְׁלִיכוּהוּ **The decree "Into the river you shall cast him,"** הוּא בֵּירוּר שֶׁל הַבֵּירוּר שֶׁל דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל **the refinement of the Generation of the Flood,**

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for our sustenance will be only from the side of the tree of life, where there is neither a difficulty from the side of evil nor dispute from the spirit of impurity, as it is written, 'I will remove the spirit of impurity from the earth.'" The passage explicitly identifies the tree of good and evil with the legal distinctions named in the manuscript. Here the tree of life is identified with the Book of the Zohar. Rav Tzadok applies this vocabulary within his account of Written and Oral Torah; the source should retain its own stated context.

[883] **Tikkunei Zohar 58a, Tikkun 21** — "Because of this jealousy, the Holy One, blessed be He, covered Esther with His sign, for she is His holiness. ... For holiness is not fewer than ten. The ten lower crowns clothed themselves in the ten sons of Haman, where there is an alien god. Haman said, 'I shall weigh out ten thousand talents of silver.' All was to take vengeance upon Esther and her nation, concerning whom it is said, 'Esther clothed herself in royalty.'" This is the passage describing Esther as God's holiness. It underlies Rav Tzadok's connection between her sanctity, protective concealment and royal clothing.

[884] **Berakhot 32b** — "She said before Him: Master of the world, since there is forgetfulness before Your throne of glory, perhaps You will forget the event at Sinai for me? He said to her: 'But I, Anochi, will not forget you.' This is what Rabbi Elazar said in Rav Oshaya's name: 'Even these [eileh] may forget'—this is the event of the calf; 'But I, Anochi, will not forget you'—this is the event at Sinai." The contrast turns on the words used at the calf and at Sinai. Rav Tzadok reads "Anochi" in Esther's Torah allusion as pointing to the root of Torah.

[885] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:2:4** — "Rabbi Yehudah said: When Israel heard 'I am Hashem your God,' Torah study became fixed in their hearts; they would learn and would not forget. They came to Moshe and said: Moshe our teacher, become an intermediary, a messenger between us. ... They again began learning and forgetting. They said: Just as Moshe is mortal and passes away, so does what he teaches pass away. They immediately returned to Moshe and said: If only He would reveal Himself to us a second time; if only He would kiss us with the kisses of His mouth; if only Torah study would become fixed in our hearts as before. He said to them: This is not for now, but for the future, as it is said, 'I shall place My Torah within them and write it upon their hearts.'" The manuscript's traditional locator 1:15 corresponds here to the digital subdivision 1:2:4. The exact passage describes direct hearing as permanently fixing Torah within the heart.

[886] Parallel: **Cf. Ramban on Devarim 31:17–18** — "'Because my God is not within me' is not a complete confession, like 'They shall confess their sin'; it is reflection and regret, in which they regret their betrayal and recognize that they are guilty. ... Since Israel reflected in their hearts that they had sinned against God, and that these evils had found them because their God was not within them, God's abundant kindness would fittingly help and deliver them, for they had already rejected idolatry. ... The concealment is not like the first concealment, when He hid His merciful countenance and many evils and troubles befell them. Rather, the face of redemption remains concealed, while they stand within the promise of His merciful countenance: 'Even so, when they are in their enemies' land, I have not rejected or abhorred them'—until they add complete confession and complete repentance to that regret."
Connection: Ramban addresses the same textual difficulty: why does concealment follow Israel's recognition of its fault? He distinguishes the continuing delay of redemption from the earlier hiding of mercy; recognition has already changed the relationship. Rav Tzadok offers a different explanation of the concealment: the divine "Anochi" is present within the apparently human innovations of Oral Torah. The comparison marks their different explanations while clarifying why the second concealment need not mean renewed abandonment.

תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **is the refinement of the Written Torah** עַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **through Moshe Rabbeinu;** שֶׁהֵם פָּגְמוּ בָּזֶה **for they blemished this,** שֶׁהָיָה רָאוּי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **since Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom, was fit** לִיתֵּן לָהֶם הַתּוֹרָה בְּדוֹר הַמַּבּוּל[887] **to give them the Torah in the Generation of the Flood,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּרַעְיָא מְהֵימְנָא **as they said in the Raaya Mehemna** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רטז, ב) **(Zohar III 216b);** וְכֵן אִיתָא בְּמִדְרָשׁ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ל, יג) **and so it is stated in the Midrash (Shemos Rabbah 30:13)** שֶׁהֵם אָמְרוּ וְדַעַת דְּרָכֶיךָ **that they said, "And knowledge of Your ways** זֶה תּוֹרָה [אִיּוֹב כא, יד] לֹא חָפָצְנוּ.[888] **we do not desire" (Iyov 21:14)—this is Torah.** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **That is, the Written Torah,** שֶׁהִיא דְּרָכָיו שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **which is the ways of HaKadosh Baruch Hu,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה שָׁם, ט) שֶׁגּוֹזֵר גְּזֵרָה וּמְקַיְּימָהּ תְּחִלָּה **Who decrees a decree and fulfills it first,** וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) שֶׁמַּה שֶׁהוּא עוֹשֶׂה **as they said (Shemos Rabbah ibid. 9, and elsewhere),** אוֹמֵר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל לַעֲשׂוֹת כּוּבְּלֵי[889] **that what He Himself does** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּרֵאשִׁית ו, ג] **He tells Yisrael to do, etc.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁמִּרְמֵז עַל מֹשֶׁה **And this is what it says (Bereishis 6:3),** בְּשַׁגַּם הוּא בָשָׂר **which alludes to Moshe, "Inasmuch as he too is flesh,"** וּגְמָרָא (חוּלִּין קלט, ב) שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם) **and the Gemara as they said in the holy Zohar (there) (Chullin 139b),** לְרַמֵּז שֶׁהוּא עָתִיד לְבָרְרָם. **to allude that he is destined to refine them.** וּגְזֵרַת וַיְמָרְרוּ וְגוֹמֵר בְּחוֹמֶר וּבִלְבֵנִים **And the decree "And they embittered" etc., "with clay and with bricks,"** שֶׁבָּא עַל חֵטְא דּוֹר הַפְּלָגָה **which came for the sin of the Generation of the Dispersion,** הוּא נֶגֶד בֵּירוּר בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **corresponds to the refinement of the aspect of Torah she'b'al peh** עַל יְדֵי מִרְיָם שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת עַל שֵׁם הַמָּרוֹר **through Miriam, who is named for the bitterness;** וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **and as mentioned above:** בְּחוֹמֶר דָּא קַל וָחוֹמֶר **"with clay"—this is kal vachomer,** וּלְבֵנִים לִיבּוּן הִלְכָתָא[890] **"bricks"—clarifying the halachah.** וְעִיקַּר הִתְיַסְּדוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And the main founding of Torah she'b'al peh** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים מִגְּמָרָא הָיָה בְּבָבֶל **was in Bavel, as has been explained many times from the Gemara** (סוּכָּה כ, א וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת[891]) **(Sukkah 20a and elsewhere);** וְשָׁם מָצְאוּ הַבִּקְעָה בְּאֶרֶץ שִׁנְעָר [בְּרֵאשִׁית יא, ב] וְעַל יְדֵי הַחָכְמָה זוֹ רָצוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת לָהֶם שֵׁם **and there they found the valley in the land of Shinar (Bereishis 11:2), and by means of this wisdom they wanted to make a name for themselves,** וְהִצְלִיחוּ בָּזֶה בְּכֹחַ הַהֵיפֶךְ כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּרֵאשִׁית יא, ו] **and they succeeded in this with the opposing power, as it says (Bereishis 11:6),** וְעַתָּה לֹא יִבָּצֵר מֵהֶם וְגוֹמֵר[892] **"And now nothing will be withheld from them" etc.**

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[887] **Tikkunei Zohar 58a, Tikkun 21, alternate reading** — "And as with Esther: He concealed her from Ahasuerus, who was uncircumcised and impure, and placed a female demon in her place, in her likeness. This is what is written, 'Whatever she would say ...'; 'In the evening she came, and in the morning she returned to the second house of the women.' He protected her from the wicked Haman, as it is written, 'From an adversary You guard me,' for he is an adversary and an enemy." The words translated "a female demon" follow the alternate reading recorded in the vocalized text. The consulted digital transcription of Constantinople 1740 reads "a second one" at this point.

[888] **Zohar I 8a, Introduction** — "'The glory of God'—this is the glory of the bride, who is called El, as it is written, 'God is indignant every day.' During all the days of the year she is called El; now that she has entered the bridal canopy, she is called glory and is called El: honor upon honor, light upon light, and dominion upon dominion." The bridal glory supplies Rav Tzadok's language for Malchus and for the sanctity protected in Esther.

[889] **Megillah 10b** — "'Instead of the thorn shall come up the cypress'—instead of the wicked Haman, who made himself an object of worship. ... 'Shall come up the cypress'—this is Mordechai, who was called chief of all the spices, as it is said, 'Take for yourself chief spices, pure myrrh,' which we translate as 'mar dakhi.'" The Gemara reads the verse's replacement of the thorn as Mordechai's emergence in Haman's place. Rav Tzadok develops the spice imagery in relation to the corrective work of Oral Torah.

[890] **Horayot 11b** — "Rabbi Yehudah says: How many miracles were performed with the anointing oil that Moshe made in the wilderness, from beginning to end! At first there were only twelve log. Consider how much the pot absorbs, how much the roots absorb, and how much the fire consumes. Yet with it the Tabernacle and its vessels, Aharon and his sons, were anointed throughout all seven days of inauguration; and with it high priests and kings were anointed." The passage enumerates the uses of the oil. The Gemara subsequently distinguishes Davidic kings from kings of Israel; Rav Tzadok's account here concerns the spiritual symbolism of priesthood and kingship.

[891] **Megillah 10b:28** — "Rabbi Abba bar Kahana opened his exposition of this passage from here: 'To a person who is good before Him, He has given wisdom, knowledge, and joy'—this is Mordechai the righteous. 'But to the sinner He has given the occupation of gathering and collecting'—this is Haman. 'To give to one who is good before God'—this is Mordechai and Esther, as it is written, 'Esther appointed Mordechai over Haman's house.'" The Talmud makes the transfer from Haman to Mordechai and Esther the starting point for its exposition. Rav Tzadok asks what spiritual transfer corresponds to that movement of wealth.

[892] **Mekhilta DeRabbi Yishmael, Amalek 2:50** — "Rabbi Eliezer says: The Omnipresent swore by the throne: If someone from any of the nations of the world comes to convert, Israel shall accept him; but from the house of Amalek they shall not accept him. For it is said: 'David said to the young man who told him: Where are you from? He said: I am the son of an Amalekite convert.' At that hour David remembered what had been said to Moses: If someone from any nation comes to convert, Israel shall accept him, but from the house of Amalek they shall not

(וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת נֹחַ מַאֲמָר א). **(as explained in Parshas Noach, maamar 1).** וּגְזֵירַת אִם בֵּן הוּא וַהֲמִיתֶן אוֹתוֹ **And the decree "If it is a son, you shall kill him"** הוּא לְבָרֵר פְּגַם אַנְשֵׁי סְדוֹם **is to refine the blemish of the people of Sodom,** שֶׁהָיָה בָּהֶן צְרוּת עַיִן עַל הָעֲנִיִּים **who were stingy toward the poor** [יְחֶזְקֵאל טז, מט וְלֹא גָּמְלוּ חֶסֶד כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **and did not do kindness, as it says (Yechezkel 16:49),** יַד עָנִי וְאֶבְיוֹן לֹא הֶחֱזִיקָה. **"And the hand of the poor and needy she did not strengthen."** וּבָזֶה הָיָה הַבֵּירוּר עַל יְדֵי אַהֲרֹן **And here the refinement was through Aharon,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא אִישׁ חֲסִידֶךָ [דְּבָרִים לג, ח **who is called "Your pious one" (Devarim 33:8),** שֶׁהָיָה אוֹהֵב שָׁלוֹם וְרוֹדֵף שָׁלוֹם **for he loved peace and pursued peace,** [אָבוֹת פֶּרֶק א מִשְׁנָה יב[893] אוֹהֵב אֶת הַבְּרִיּוֹת כּוּלַּי. **loved people, etc. (Avos 1:12).** וְלֵאֲשֶׁר שְׁנֵי הַפְּגָמִים **And since the two blemishes** שֶׁל דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל וְדוֹר הַפְּלָגָה **of the Generation of the Flood and the Generation of the Dispersion** הָיוּ מֵעֲוונוֹת חֲמוּרִים **came from grave sins,** לָכֵן נִצְרָךְ לִסְבוֹל קוֹשִׁי הַגְּזֵירָה זְמַן רַב **therefore it was necessary to bear the hardship of the decree for a long time,** כְּדֵי לְבָרֵר וּלְלַבֵּן הַנְּפָשׁוֹת **in order to refine and purify the souls** מֵהַפְּגָמִים הַגְּדוֹלִים **from the great blemishes;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן פְּגַם דְּאַנְשֵׁי סְדוֹם **whereas the blemish of the people of Sodom,** שֶׁהָיָה רַק מִצָּרוּת עַיִן **which was only from stinginess** שֶׁבֵּין אָדָם לַחֲבֵירוֹ **between man and his fellow—** לָכֵן לֹא הִתְמִיד גַּם כֵּן **therefore there also did not persist** רַק הָיָה דַּי לָהֶם בְּצַעַר לְפִי שָׁעָה **rather, a passing distress sufficed for them,** שֶׁגָּזַר פַּרְעֹה לַמְיַלְּדוֹת **when Pharaoh decreed to the midwives,** וְלֹא נִתְקַיְּמָה גְּזֵירָתוֹ **and his decree was not carried out,** [שְׁמוֹת א, יז כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Shemos 1:17),** וְלֹא עָשׂוּ וְגוֹמֵר **"And they did not do" etc.,** וַתְּחַיֶּיןָ אֶת הַיְלָדִים: **"and they let the children live."**

accept him." This is the specific Midrashic teaching presupposed by Rav Tzadok's ensuing genealogical problem. His proposed reconciliation is an interpretation of that problem.

[893] **Ein Yaakov, Sanhedrin 11:39; compare Sanhedrin 96b** — "Descendants of Sisera learned Torah in Jerusalem. Descendants of Sennacherib taught Torah publicly—and who were they? Shemaiah and Avtalyon. Descendants of Haman learned Torah in Bnei Brak—and who was it? Rav Shmuel bar Shilat." The consulted Ein Yaakov, Glick edition, includes Rav Shmuel bar Shilat's name. The retrieved standard text of Sanhedrin 96b says only that Haman's descendants learned Torah in Bnei Brak and does not supply the name. The identification is therefore retained as a specified textual reading.

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר ז׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Zayin

בְּתַנְחוּמָא (כִּי תֵצֵא ז) **In Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei 7):** כָּאן כְּתִיב זָכוֹר **"Here it is written 'Remember,'** וּבְשַׁבָּת זָכוֹר **and regarding Shabbos, 'Remember';** שְׁנֵיהֶם שָׁוִין וְכוּלֵי **the two are equal, etc.** מָשָׁל לְמָה הַדָּבָר דּוֹמֶה וְכוּלֵי **To what may the matter be compared? etc.** זֶה הַזָּכַרְתָּ וְזֶה הַזָּכַרְתָּ **This one you mentioned and that one you mentioned;** זֶה הִזְכַּרְתִּי **this one I mentioned** עַל קְעָרָה מָלֵא כָּל טוּב **over a bowl full of every good thing,** וְזֶה עַל קְעָרָה רֵיקָם **and that one over an empty bowl.** כָּךְ בְּשַׁבָּת כְּתִיב **So too, regarding Shabbos it is written,** זָכוֹר וְגוֹמֵר לְקַדְּשׁוֹ **'Remember… to sanctify it,'** וּבַעֲמָלֵק כְּתִיב זָכוֹר וְגוֹמֵר **and regarding Amalek it is written, 'Remember…** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר וְגוֹמֵר. **you shall erase the memory….'"** (פֶּרֶק מד) וּבְפִרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר **And in Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer (chapter 44)** אִיתָא עַל זֶה **it is stated about this** שֶׁאָמְרוּ לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **that they said to Moshe Rabbeinu,** הֵיאַךְ יִתְקַיְּימוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם **"How can both be fulfilled** — זֶה זָכוֹר וְזֶה זָכוֹר **this is 'Remember' and that is 'Remember'?"** נִרְאֶה מַהַלָּשׁוֹן **It appears from the wording** שֶׁשְּׁנֵי הַזְּכִירוֹת **that the two rememberings** מִתְנַגְּדִים זֶה לָזֶה. **are opposed to one another.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר **And it may be explained:** דְּאִיתָא בְּמְכִילְתָּא **it is stated in the Mechilta** (יִתְרוֹ בַּחֹדֶשׁ ז) **(Yisro, BaChodesh 7):** זָכוֹר אֶת יוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **"'Remember the day of Shabbos' —** אֶלָּא תְּהֵא מוֹנֶה[894] לֹא תְּהֵא מוֹנֶה לְשֵׁם שַׁבָּת כְּדַרְכָּךְ שֶׁאַחֵרִים מוֹנִים **you shall not count the way others count,** **but you shall count in the name of Shabbos."** הַיְינוּ אֶחָד בְּשַׁבָּת **That is, "the first day toward Shabbos,"** שֵׁנִי בְּשַׁבָּת **"second day toward Shabbos," and the like.** וְכַדּוֹמֶה וְעִיקַּר קְדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת **And the essence of the holiness of Shabbos** נִשְׁפָּע לְהַנֶּפֶשׁ **flows into the soul** רַק מִצַּד הַזְּכִירָה **only by virtue of the remembering** בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה וּבְפֶה **in thought and in speech beforehand.** מִלְּפָנָיו. וְהִנֵּה גַּם זְכִירַת עֲמָלֵק **Now the remembering of Amalek too** הוּא רַק בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה וּבְפֶה לְבַד **only in thought and in speech alone,** כִּי גַּם כֵּן לְעֵת עַתָּה **is likewise, for the present,** אָז תִּמְחֶה וְגוֹמֵר בְּפוֹעַל. **for only "when Hashem grants rest…" will "you shall erase…" be in actual deed.** וְלָכֵן אָמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **Therefore Yisrael said:** מֵאַחַר שֶׁשְּׁנֵי הַזְּכִירוֹת שָׁוִים **since both rememberings are equal,** שֶׁמָּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַזְּכִירָה רַק לְהַעֲלוֹת בְּזִכָּרוֹן הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה **only to bring up into the memory of the mind,** שֶׁל קְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לְבַד **perhaps, just as through the remembering of the holiness of Shabbos in thought alone** עַל יְדֵי כֵן נִמְשָׁךְ וְנִשְׁפָּע **there is thereby drawn and poured forth** הַקְּדוּשָׁה לְהַנֶּפֶשׁ **holiness into the soul,** כְּמוֹ כֵן עַל יְדֵי הַזְּכִירָה **so too through the remembering** דְּמַעֲשֵׂה עֲמָלֵק בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה **of the deed of Amalek in thought** יוּכַל לִהְיוֹת נִמְשָׁךְ לְהַנֶּפֶשׁ **there could be drawn into the soul** כֹּחַ הַטּוּמְאָה **the power of impurity,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדָּרֶךְ **as it says, "who happened upon you on the way";** [תֵּצֵא ט] וְאִיתָא בְּתַנְחוּמָא **and it is stated in Tanchuma (Teitzei 9)** וּבְפִסִיקְתָּא **and in the Pesikta** (לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן יג) **(for Parshas Zachor, parsha 12, siman 13):** קָרְךָ טִמְּאָךְ **"'Karcha' — he defiled you,** [דְּבָרִים כג, יא] כְּעִנְיָן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as in the matter of which it says (Devarim 23:11),** אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִהְיֶה טָהוֹר מִקְרֵה לָיְלָה[895] **'who will not be pure because of a nocturnal occurrence';** וְרַבּוֹתֵינוּ אָמְרוּ **and our Rabbis said:** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ הִפְשִׁירְךָ **'karcha' — he cooled you,** עָשָׂה אוֹתְךָ קַר כַּמַּיִם **he made you cold as water,** [מִשְׁלֵי כה, כה] כְּעִנְיָן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as in the matter of which it says (Mishlei 25:25),** מַיִם קָרִים עַל נֶפֶשׁ עֲיֵפָה. **'Cold water upon a weary soul.'"** וְאִיתָא בְּמְכִילְתָּא **And it is stated in the Mechilta** (בְּשַׁלַּח וַיָּבוֹא עֲמָלֵק א) **(Beshalach, Vayavo Amalek 1)** שֶׁהָיָה עֲמָלֵק נִכְנָס **that Amalek would enter** תַּחַת כַּנְפֵי הֶעָנָן **beneath the wings of the Cloud** וְגוֹנֵב נְפָשׁוֹת מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **and steal souls from Yisrael** עֵיין וְהוֹרְגָן[896]

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[894] **Sefer Yuchasin, second discourse, Shilat, p.190 (London, 1857)** — "This is not Shilat, the father of Rav Shmuel bar Shilat, who taught children, for he was a convert. The Geonim, however, wrote that this woman named Shilat was the mother of Rav Shmuel and was Rabbi Hiyya's sister; it is stated that his father was a convert. This is puzzling, for they were very particular about lineage: how, then, was she married to a convert?" The original Yuchasin questions the Geonic genealogy. In this London witness, the wording is "This is puzzling"; the categorical rejection reported in the manuscript is stronger than this formulation. Rav Tzadok resolves the difficulty through a Jewish mother. A separate entry on Rav Shmuel bar Shilat, p.193, again records the Geonic report.

[895] **Yoma 22b:17** — "'Saul was a year old when he became king.' Rav Huna said: Like a one-year-old who had never tasted the taste of sin." Rav Huna reads the anomalous age as a description of Saul's innocence. Rav Tzadok sets that innocence beside Saul's failure concerning Agag, seeking an inward reason for his compassion.

[896] **Pri Etz Chaim, Gate of the New Month, Chanukah and Purim 6:59** — "Hashem commanded King Shaul to cut off Amalek's offspring, but he brought King Agag back alive. When Shmuel came, he said to Agag: 'As your sword has bereaved women.' For the Sages said that on that night they brought him a slave-woman in the prison; she conceived by him, and Haman descended from him. Therefore, although Shmuel was killing Agag, he said, 'As you have bereaved ... so shall [your mother] be bereaved,' in the future tense, concerning his offspring that remained. He said 'from women'—through women, for the miracle occurred through Esther." This historical Lurianic compilation

שָׁם **and kill them; see there.** (שָׁם) וּפְסִיקְתָּא [תֵּצֵא י] וּבְתַנְחוּמָא **And in Tanchuma (Teitzei 10) and the Pesikta (ibid.)** אִיתָא שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה לַעֲמָלֵק שְׁלִיטָה רַק עַל מִי שֶׁפָּלָטוֹ הֶעָנָן **it is stated that Amalek had no dominion except over one whom the Cloud had expelled.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Now we must understand** מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בְּמְכִילְתָּא **what they said in the Mechilta,** שֶׁהָיָה גּוֹנֵב נְפָשׁוֹת **that he would steal souls** מִתַּחַת כַּנְפֵי הֶעָנָן **from beneath the wings of the Cloud:** מִמָּה נַפְשָׁךְ **whichever way you take it —** אִם הָיָה לוֹ כֹּחַ לִכָּנוֹס לְשָׁם **if he had the power to enter there,** הָיָה יָכוֹל לְהוֹרְגָם שָׁם **he could have killed them there;** וְאִם לָאו **and if not,** הֵיאַךְ הָיָה גּוֹנְבָם. **how could he steal them?** גַּם דִּקְדּוּק לְשׁוֹנוֹ **Also, the precision of its wording:** שֶׁהָיָה גּוֹנֵב נְפָשׁוֹת **that he would steal "souls"** וְלֹא גּוֹנֵב אֲנָשִׁים מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל. **"steal people from Yisrael."** וְהָוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר **it should have said,** הַגּוּפִים **and not the bodies;** וְיוּבַן עַל פִּי **It will be understood according to** מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **what our Sages of blessed memory said** (פִּרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר פֶּרֶק מד) **(Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer, chapter 44),** שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁהָיָה צָרִיךְ טְבִילָה **that anyone who required immersion,** הָיָה הֶעָנָן מַפְלִיטוֹ **the Cloud would expel him** חוּץ מִמַּחֲנֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל **outside the camp of Yisrael,**[897] וְכוּלֵי שֶׁהָיָה קָדוֹשׁ **which was holy, etc.** וְזֶהוּ הָעִנְיָן **And this is the matter** שֶׁהָיָה גּוֹנֵב נְפָשׁוֹת דַּיְיקָא **that he would steal specifically "souls":** כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת לֹא הָיָה לוֹ כֹּחַ **for in truth he had no power** לִכָּנוֹס תַּחַת הֶעָנָן **to enter beneath the Cloud;** עַל יְדֵי עֵצָה זוֹ **by means of this scheme,** רַק עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהִכְנִיס בְּמַחֲשַׁבְתָּם הִירְהוּרֵי תַּאֲוָה **but by introducing into their thoughts lustful musings,** עַל יְדֵי זֶה הָיָה גּוֹנֵב הַנְּפָשׁוֹת **thereby he would steal the souls,** לְהִיּוֹת נִטְמָאִים בְּמִקְרֶה לַיְלָה[898] **so that they became defiled by a nocturnal occurrence.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ נְפָשׁוֹת דַּיְיקָא **And this is why they said specifically "souls,"** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (חולין לז, ב) **in the manner they expounded (Chullin 37b):** [יְחֶזְקֵאל ד, יד] נַפְשִׁי לֹא מְטוּמְּאָה **"'My soul has not been defiled' (Yechezkel 4:14) —** שֶׁלֹּא הִרְהַרְתִּי בַּיּוֹם **for I did not muse by day** לָבֹא לִידֵי טוּמְאָה בַּלַּיְלָה.[899] **so as to come to impurity at night."** וּמִמֵּילָא פָּלְטָם הֶעָנָן כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **And so automatically the Cloud expelled them, as mentioned above,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הָיָה לוֹ כֹּחַ לְהוֹרְגָם **and thereby he had the power to kill them.** וְזֶהוּ גַּם כֵּן הָרֶמֶז **And this too is the allusion:** בְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the manner it says,** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ טִמְאֶךָ **"karcha — he defiled you,"** אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִהְיֶה טָהוֹר מִקְרֵה לָיְלָה. **"who will not be pure because of a nocturnal occurrence."** וְהַכֹּחַ הַזֶּה הָיָה לוֹ **And this power he had:** לְטַמֵּא הַנְּפָשׁוֹת בְּמַחֲשַׁבְתָּם **to defile the souls through their thoughts** גַּם בְּהְיוֹתָם תּוֹךְ הַקְּדוּשָּׁה **even while they were within the holiness** תַּחַת כַּנְפֵי הֶעָנָן **beneath the wings of the Cloud,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we have said,** שֶׁעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר [בְּמִדְבַּר יג, כט] עֲמָלֵק יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב **that about this it says (Bamidbar 13:29), "Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev":** שֶׁהוּא כֹּחַ הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע **that is the power of the evil inclination** מִסִּטְרָא דְּנָחָשׁ **from the side of the serpent;** בְּנֶפֶשׁ שֶׁהוּא מְנוּגָּב **in a soul that is dried out** וְהוּא יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב **and he dwells in "the land of the Negev" —** מִכָּל חֲמֻדּוֹת וְתַאֲוֹת עוֹלָם הַזֶּה. **from all the desires and lusts of this world.** וְדַיְיקָא עַל נֶפֶשׁ כָּזֹאת **And specifically against such a soul** הוּא מִתְגָּרֶה בְּיוֹתֵר **he provokes most of all,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה נב, א) **as they said**

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explicitly supplies the night detail. The separately quoted Megillah 13a establishes the Agag–Haman lineage, but does not itself state the night. The earlier rabbinic source invoked by this compilation is not independently identified here.

[897] **Megillah 13a:1** — "What did the Benjaminite repay me? Saul did not kill Agag, and Haman, who afflicted Israel, was born from him." The Talmud traces Haman's survival to Agag being spared. Rav Tzadok's account of Saul perceiving the future holy soul within Agag is his interpretation, rather than a statement made in this Talmudic passage.

[898] **Megillah 15b:12–13** — "The Sages taught: What did Esther see that led her to invite Haman? Rabbi Elazar says: She laid traps for him, as it is written, 'May their table before them become a trap.' Rabbi Yehoshua says: She learned from her father's house, as it is said, 'If your enemy is hungry, feed him bread.' Rabbi Meir says: So that he would not form a plan and rebel." The passage presents several explanations. Rav Tzadok develops Rabbi Yehoshua's explanation in particular; the view that Esther hoped for Haman's repentance is not stated here as the Talmud's unanimous account. The Ein Yaakov texts consulted (the standard text and the Glick edition) read here like the Vilna Bavli: they end Rabbi Yehoshua's proof with "feed him bread," etc. The reading Rav Tzadok attributes to the Ein Yaakov continues the verse: "and Hashem will repay you (יְשַׁלֵּם לָךְ). Do not read 'will repay you' but 'will make him at peace with you' (יַשְׁלִימֶנּוּ לָךְ)." This reading was not found in those texts. It appears on this same baraisa in Yalkut Shimoni, Esther 1056, and in the Midrash on Esther collected in Otzar Midrashim. Rav Tzadok's Ein Yaakov printing may have had it.

[899] **Sukkah 52a:8; Rashi, s.v. "haakhilehu lehem," "hashkehu mayim," and "yashlimennu lakh"** — "Solomon called it 'an enemy,' as it is said: 'If your enemy is hungry, feed him bread; if he is thirsty, give him water to drink. For you heap coals upon his head, and the Lord will repay you.' Do not read 'will repay you,' but 'will make it at peace with you.'" Rashi explains: "Feed it bread"—"Make it toil in the battle of Torah." "Give it water"—Torah, of which it says, "All who are thirsty, go to water." "Will make it at peace with you"—"Your inclination will be whole with you and love you, and will not entice you to sin and be lost from the world."

(Sukkah 52a): וּבְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים יוֹתֵר מִכּוּלָּם[900] **"and against Torah scholars more than all."** וְזֶהוּ כֹּחַ הַנָּחָשׁ הַקַּדְמוֹנִי **And this is the power of the primordial serpent,** שֶׁנִּכְנַס לְגַן עֵדֶן **which entered Gan Eden** לְהַכְנִיס בְּלִבָּם מַחְשֶׁבֶת הַתַּאֲוָה **to put the thought of lust into their hearts,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, ו] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Bereishis 3:6),** וַתֵּרֶא הָאִשָּׁה וְגוֹמֵר **"And the woman saw…** וְכִי תַאֲוָה הוּא לָעֵינַיִם. **and that it was a delight to the eyes."** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א). **(This was explained in maamar 1.)** וְגַם לְמַאן דְּאָמַר **And also according to the one who says** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ הִפְשִׁירָךְ **"karcha — he cooled you** וְעָשָׂה אוֹתְךָ קַר כַּמַּיִם **and made you cold as water,"** הוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ אָמְרָם זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **it is along the lines of the statement of our Sages of blessed memory** (חֲגִיגָה טז, א) **(Chagigah 16a)** עַל פָּסוּק אַל תַּאֲמִינוּ בְּרֵיעַ **on the verse "Do not trust a companion,** [מִיכָה ז, ה] אַל תִּבְטְחוּ בְּאַלּוּף **do not rely on a friend" (Michah 7:5):** אִם יֹאמַר לְךָ יֵצֶר הָרַע **"If the evil inclination says to you,** חֲטוֹא וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מוֹחֵל **'Sin, and the Holy One, Blessed is He, will forgive,'** אַל תַּאֲמִין **do not believe it,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר אַל תַּאֲמִינוּ בְּרֵעַ **as it says, 'Do not trust a companion'** — וְאֵין רֵעַ וְכוּלֵי **and 'companion' means none other, etc.;** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יִרְמְיָה ג, ד] אַלּוּף נְעוּרַי אָתָּה. **as it says (Yirmiyah 3:4), 'You are the guide of my youth.'"** וּמַה שֶּׁכִּינּוּ בְּכָאן **And that they here called** רָמְזוּ בָּזֶה **they hinted thereby** לְהַכְנִיס בְּעָצָם הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע שֶׁהוּא עֶצֶת **that this is the essential scheme of the evil inclination:** כְּאָב הַמַּדְרִיךְ אֶת בְּנוֹ מִנְּעוּרָיו **like a father who trains his son from his youth,** וּמְפַחִיד אוֹתוֹ בְּעוֹנְשִׁין **who frightens him and threatens him with punishments** כְּדֵי שֶׁיֵּלֵךְ בַּדֶּרֶךְ הַיָּשָׁר **so that he will walk on the straight path,** אֲבָל בְּרַחֲמֵי לֹא יַעֲנִישׁ בְּנוֹ חֲבִיבוֹ **but certainly will not punish his beloved son** אַף אִם יַעֲבוֹר עַל צִיווּיוֹ **even if he transgresses his command.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁכִּינּוּהוּ בְּשֵׁם אַלּוּף **And this is why they called Him by the name "aluf,"** כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר אַלּוּף נְעוּרַי אָתָּה **as it says, "You are the guide of my youth,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר אַל תַּאֲמִינוּ וְגוֹמֵר **And about this it says, "Do not trust…,** אַל תִּבְטְחוּ בְּאַלּוּף. **do not rely on a friend."** וְזֶהוּ גַּם כֵּן כֹּחַ עֲמָלֵק **And this too is the power of Amalek:** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ הִפְשִׁירָךְ **"karcha — he cooled you,** עָשָׂה אוֹתְךָ קַר כַּמַּיִם **he made you cold as water":** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מַחֲשָׁבָה זוֹ **through this thought** מַכְנִיס עֲמָלֵק יְצִרָא בִּישָׁא **Amalek, the evil inclination, puts** קְרִירוּת בְּלֵב הָאָדָם **coldness into a person's heart:** שֶׁאֵין מֵהַצּוֹרֶךְ לִהְיוֹת נִזְהָר **that there is no need to be** כָּל כָּךְ מֵהָעֲבֵירָה **so careful about sin,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָעוֹנְשִׁין **because the punishments** הֵם רַק לְגִיזּוּם בְּעָלְמָא **are merely a threat.** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן מִפִּיתּוּיֵי הַנָּחָשׁ **This too is among the enticements of the serpent,** שֶׁאָמַר לָהֶם **who said to them,** אַף כִּי אָמַר אֱלֹהִים **"Did God really say,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, א] לֹא תֹאכְלוּ וְגוֹמֵר **'You shall not eat…'?" (Bereishis 3:1)** — אֵין בְּכָךְ כְּלוּם **it means nothing,** שֶׁהָיָה רַק לְגַזֵּם וּלְהַפְחִיד אֶתְכֶם **for it was only to threaten and frighten you;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר אַחַר כָּךְ **and as he said afterward,** [שָׁם, ד] לֹא מוֹת תְּמֻתוּן **(ibid. 4) "You will not surely die":** שֶׁכָּל כַּוָּנַת ה' לְהַפְחִיד אֶתְכֶם **Hashem's whole intent is to frighten you** שֶׁלֹּא תֵּדְעוּ מְטוֹב וָרָע **so that you not know of good and evil,** אֲבָל גַּם אִם תֹּאכְלוּ **but even if you eat,** לֹא יַעֲנִישׁ אֶתְכֶם מִיתָה.[902] **He will not punish you with**

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[900] Parallel: **Avot DeRabbi Natan 16:3** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Elazar says: I will give you a comparison. What does the evil inclination resemble? Iron that has been put into the fire. As long as it is in the fire, any utensils one wishes can be made from it. So too the evil inclination has no repair except through words of Torah alone, as it is said, 'If your enemy is hungry, feed him bread; if he is thirsty, give him water to drink, for you heap coals upon his head, and the Lord will repay you.' Do not read 'will repay you,' but 'will make peace for you.'"

Connection: The iron is reshaped through fire. This supplies a specific model for Rav Tzadok's suggestion that Torah could bring a hidden good element into expression and change the inclination's direction. The parallel concerns the transformation of the inclination; it does not independently report that Haman repented.

[901] **Midrash Mishlei 9:1** — "'Wisdom has built her house'—this is the Torah, which acquired all the worlds. ... 'She slaughtered her slaughtering, mixed her wine'—Rabbi Abbahu said: This is Queen Esther. When distress reached Israel in the days of Mordechai, what did she do? She prepared a feast for Ahasuerus and the wicked Haman, and made him exceedingly drunk with wine. The wicked man thought she had honored him, but he did not know that she had spread a trap for him. Through making him drunk with wine, she acquired her people for herself forever. 'She also arranged her table'—she arranged a table for herself in this world and the world to come." The same exposition joins Torah's cosmic house with Esther's feast. The consulted source reads "acquired all the worlds," where the manuscript cites "built all the worlds." Rav Tzadok interprets the banquet through its Torah imagery.

[902] **Esther Rabbah 3:11** — "'When the king's heart was good with wine': Rabbi Yitzhak said, Idolaters have no goodness, as it is written, 'It will not be good for the wicked.' They objected: But is it not written, 'When the king's heart was good with wine'? He answered: It is not written 'with the king's heart good,' but 'as the king's heart was good'—goodness that is not goodness. Israel's goodness, however, is complete goodness, as it is said, 'They went to

death. בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And on this matter we have indeed spoken,** וְעַל עִנְיָן זֶה אָמַרְנוּ בֶּאֱמֶת **regarding what they said in the holy Zohar** (ב קכג, ב״ח) עַל פָּסוּק **(II 123b) on the verse** וּבְכֹל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי **"And in all that I have said** [שְׁמוֹת כג, יג] תִּשָּׁמֹרוּ מִיבָּעֵי לֵיהּ אֲלֵיכֶם **to you, take heed" (Shemos 23:13):** **"It should have said 'tishmoru' (you shall keep);** כְּלוֹמַר אֶלָּא תִּשָּׁמְרוּ וַדַּאי **but rather 'tishamru' (take heed) indeed —** דְּאַגְזֵימִית לְכוֹן **that is to say: I have warned you sternly** עַל מֵימַר פּוּלְחָנִי **concerning the word of My service;** תִּשָּׁמְרוּ דְּלָא יִמְטֵי עֲלֵיכוֹן **take heed, so that there not come upon you** שׁוּם בִּישׁ[903] **any evil."** וּלְפִי זֶה הָיָה צָרִיךְ לוֹמַר **But according to this it should have said,** וּמִכֹּל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם תִּשָּׁמֵרוּ **"And from all that I have said to you, take heed" —** שֶׁתִּהְיוּ נִשְׁמָרִים **that you be guarded** מִכָּל הַגִּיזּוּמִים וְהָעוֹנְשִׁין **from all the threats and punishments,** שֶׁלֹּא יָבֹא עֲלֵיכֶם. **that they not come upon you.** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁרוֹמֵז **And we said that it hints** עַל דְּדַיְיקָא **that specifically through the threats and the punishments,** יְדֵי הַגִּיזּוּמוֹת וְהָעוֹנְשִׁין בְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר אָמַרְתִּי אֲלֵיכֶם. **"in all that I have said to you" —** עַל יְדֵי כֵן תִּהְיוּ נִשְׁמָרִים **through that you will be guarded.** וְזֶהוּ נִסְמָךְ אַחַר שַׁבָּת דְּשְׁמִטָּה **And this is juxtaposed to the Shabbos of Shemittah,** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה דַּיְיקָא **for specifically through this** יִהְיֶה יִרְאַת ה׳ עַל פְּנֵיכֶם **the fear of Hashem will be upon your faces,** וּמִמֵּילָא יִהְיוּ נִשְׁמָרִים מִכָּל רָע **and automatically they will be guarded from all evil** וְיִהְיוּ יוֹצְאִים בְּכַפַּחַד הַגִּיזּוּם **and will fulfill their duty through the fear of the threat** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מִשְׁפָּטִים מַאֲמָר ב **(this was explained in Mishpatim, maamar 2** וּמַאֲמָר ו עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּאָרִיכוּת) **and maamar 6; see there at length).** אֲבָל חָלִילָה לְסָמוֹךְ עַל זֶה **But Heaven forbid to rely on this** וּלְהָקֵל בְּעֵינָיו הָעוֹנָשִׁים **and to make the punishments light in one's eyes,** כְּעֵצַת הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע[904] וַעֲמָלֵק **as is the counsel of the evil inclination and Amalek,** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַנָּחָשׁ **the root of the serpent,** שֶׁעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר אַל תַּאֲמִינוּ בְּרֵעַ. **about which it says, "Do not trust a companion;** אַל תִּבְטְחוּ בְּאַלּוּף כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **do not rely on a friend," as mentioned above.** וְלַאֲשֶׁר כֹּחַ עֲמָלֵק גָּדוֹל כָּל כָּךְ **Now since the power of Amalek is so great** לְטַמֵּא וּלְבַלְבֵּל הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה **to defile and confuse the thought** בִּשְׁתֵּי בְּחִינוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל **in the two aspects mentioned above,** חָשְׁשׁוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **Yisrael feared** אוּלַי עַל יְדֵי זְכִירָה שֶׁלּוֹ בַּמַּחֲשָׁבָה **that perhaps through remembering him in thought** יִהְיֶה נִדְבָּק חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **there would cling to them, Heaven forbid,** אֵיזֶהוּ שֶׁמֶץ הִרְהוּר מִסְּטָרָא דִּילֵיהּ **some trace of musing from his side,** וְשָׁמָּא יְקַלְקֵל עוֹד **and perhaps it would further spoil** אֶת כֹּחַ הַזְּכִירָה דִּקְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **the power of the remembering of the holiness of Shabbos, as mentioned above.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **And about this he said,** הֵיאַךְ יִתְקַיְּימוּ שְׁנֵיהֶם. **"How can both be fulfilled?"** וְעַל זֶה הֵשִׁיב לָהֶם **And to this replied to them** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁאֵינָם שָׁוִים **that they are not equal,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָעִיקָּר נִתְלֶה **because the main thing depends** בְּכַוָּנַת הַזְּכִירָה שֶׁל הָאָדָם **on the intent of the person's remembering,** כְּמָשָׁל **as in the parable: "This one I mentioned** לָזֶה הִזְכַּרְתִּי עַל קְעָרָה מָלֵא כָּל טוּב **over a bowl full of every good thing" —** כְּדֵי הַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי כַּוָּנַת הַזְּכִירָה שֶׁל שַׁבָּת **that is, through the intent of the remembering of Shabbos,** לְקַדְּשׁוֹ **in order to sanctify it,** נִפְעָל זֹאת בְּעֶצֶם **this is in essence brought about:** לְהַמְשִׁיךְ קְדוּשָׁה. **to draw down holiness.** וְעַל יְדֵי זְכִירַת עֲמָלֵק **And through the remembering of Amalek,** עַל שׁוּלְחָן רֵיקָם **"over an empty table,"** שֶׁיִּמָּחֶה זִכְרוֹ מֵהַנְּפָשׁ. **that he be erased,** נִפְעָל עַל יְדֵי זֶה **there is brought about thereby** **that his memory is erased from the soul.** וּבְפִרְקֵי דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר [שָׁם] הַלָּשׁוֹן **And in Pirkei d'Rabbi Eliezer (ibid.)**

A :si gnidrow eht אֵין מַשְׁמִיעִין אֶלָּא לְכוֹס שֶׁטִּיבְּנוֹק לוֹשֶׁ סוֹכ הַמָּוֶת[905] **,emeht ot dias ehs** מָוֹת ל **ekil ton si eniw decips fo puc**

a cup of vinegar; זֶה כּוֹס וְזֶה כּוֹס[905] **this is a cup and that is a cup;** זֶה זָכוֹר לִשְׁמוֹר וּלְקַדֵּשׁ וְכוּלֵי **this is**

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their tents glad and good of heart for all the goodness.'" The Midrash turns on the qualifying letter kaf in ke-tov, "as though good." Rav Tzadok uses that contrast to ask why Haman is called unqualifiedly "good of heart" on leaving Esther's banquet.

[903] **Rashi, Megillah 15b, s.v. "mi-bet aviha lamdah"** — "'She learned from her father's house'—she heard the children saying this." Rashi explains the phrase through the scriptural words heard in childhood. Rav Tzadok then offers a further ancestral reading through Esther's descent from Saul. The two explanations should not be merged into one attribution to Rashi.

[904] **Shemot Rabbah 21:5; compare Tanchuma, Beshalach 8:2** — "What is meant by 'Pharaoh drew near'? He brought Israel near to the repentance they performed. Rabbi Berekhiah said: Pharaoh's bringing Israel near was better than a hundred fasts and prayers. For when he pursued them and they saw the Egyptians, they became very afraid, lifted their eyes upward, repented, and prayed, as it is said, 'The children of Israel cried out to the Lord.'" This is the stated precedent for an enemy becoming the unintended cause of Israel's return. It supports Rav Tzadok's distinction between Haman's own intention and the Torah growth occasioned by his decree.

[905] Parallel: **Bava Batra 8b:14** — "'Those who bring the many to righteousness are like the stars forever and ever'—these are teachers of children. Like whom? Rav said: Like Rav Shmuel bar Shilat. Rav found Rav Shmuel bar Shilat standing in a garden. He said to him: Have you left your trust? He answered: It has been thirteen years since I saw it,

'Remember' to keep and to sanctify, etc., וְזֶה זָכוֹר לְהַשְׁמִיד וְכוּלֵי **and that is 'Remember' to destroy, etc."** נִרְאֶה שֶׁאֵין צָרִיךְ שׁוּם כַּוָּנָה **It appears that no special intent at all is needed** בִּשְׁתֵּי הַזְּכִירוֹת **in the two rememberings,** כְּעִנְיַן הַמָּשָׁל בִּשְׁנֵי כּוֹסוֹת **as in the parable of the two cups,** שֶׁאֵין בָּהֶם הַבְחָנָה **between which there is no distinction** לְמַרְאֵה עֵין הָאָדָם **to the sight of the human eye;** וּכְמוֹ כֵן בְּעִנְיַן שְׁתֵּי הַזְּכִירוֹת **and likewise regarding the two rememberings,** נִצְטָרֵךְ לְקַיֵּים בִּתְמִימוּת בִּשְׁנֵיהֶם **one need only fulfill both with simplicity according to His command, may He be blessed,** וַה' יִגְמוֹר בַּעֲדֵנוּ **and Hashem will complete it on our behalf:** יִהְיֶה נִשְׁפָּע קְדוּשָּׁה לְהַנֶּפֶשׁ **that through the remembering of Shabbos** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַזְּכִירָה שֶׁל שַׁבָּת **holiness will flow into the soul,** וְעַל יְדֵי זְכִירַת עֲמָלֵק **and through the remembering of Amalek** יִהְיֶה נִמְחֶה זִכְרוֹ **his memory will be erased from the soul completely,** מִכֹּל וָכֹל **as it says,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמָיִם: **"You shall erase the memory of Amalek from beneath the heavens."**

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and even now my mind is on them."

Connection: The Talmud singles out Rav Shmuel bar Shilat as an exemplary educator whose attention remains with his pupils. This gives a concrete Torah role to the soul that Rav Tzadok interprets as the hidden spiritual wealth within Haman. The genealogical identification remains the specified Ein Yaakov reading.

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר ח׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Ches

בָּא הַמַּצָּוָה **"Remember what Amalek did to you… do not forget."** זָכוֹר אֵת אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְךָ עֲמָלֵק וְגוֹמֵר לֹא תִּשְׁכָּח **The mitzvah comes to remember this war;** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and in the holy Zohar** (ח״ב בְּשַׁלַּח לִזְכּוֹר מִלְחָמָה זוֹ **(II, Beshalach 65b; Vayakhel 194b):** דְּלָא הֲוָה כְּהַאי קְרָבָא **"There was never a battle like this one** מִיּוֹמָא דְּאִתְבְּרֵי עָלְמָא וְכוּלֵי **since the day the world was created, etc.;** וּקְרָבָא דַּעֲמָלֵק **and the battle of Amalek** הֲוָה לְעֵילָּא וְתַתָּא **was above and below."** וְעַל כֵּן בָּחַר מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בִּיהוֹשֻׁעַ **Therefore Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, chose Yehoshua** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הוּא הַנִּלְחָם **to be the one who fights,** לְנַצַּח קְרָבָא דִּלְתַתָּא **to win the battle below,** וּמֹשֶׁה אִתְתַּקַּן לִקְרָבָא דִּלְעֵילָּא **while Moshe readied himself for the battle above;** וְאִלְמָלֵא דְּאִתְתַּקַּף מֹשֶׁה לְעֵילָּא וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ לְתַתָּא **"and had Moshe not strengthened himself above and Yehoshua below,** לָא יָכְלֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל לֵיהּ **Yisrael would not have prevailed against him";** עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּאוֹרֶךְ.[906] **see there at length.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁלְּבַד הַמִּלְחָמָה לְתַתָּא **That is, besides the war below,** הָיָה עֲמָלֵק מְקַטְרֵג לְעֵילָּא **Amalek was prosecuting above,** שֶׁקְּלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק כֶּלֶב נוֹבֵחַ **for the kelipah of Amalek is a barking dog,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (בְּשַׁלַּח סה, א) **as they said in the holy Zohar (Beshalach 65a).** וְכֵן הָמָן מִזַּרְעוֹ **And likewise Haman, of his seed —** אָמְרוּ (מְגִילָּה יג, ב) **they said (Megillah 13b):** לֵיכָּא דְּיָדַע לְיַשָּׁנָא בִּישָׁא כְּהָמָן **"There is none who knows how to speak slander like Haman";** וְאָמַרְנוּ שֶׁאֵין הַפֵּירוּשׁ **and we said that the meaning is not** בְּמַה רַק שֶׁיָּדַע **that he slandered and disgraced Yisrael** שֶׁהִלְשִׁין וּבִיזָּה אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל לִפְנֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **before Achashverosh,** לְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל לְמַעְלָה **but that he knew how to prosecute against Yisrael above:** שֶׁהֵם יְשֵׁנוּ מִן הַמִּצְוֹת **that they have slumbered from the mitzvos,** וְרַבָּנָן עִם אֶחָד הֵם **and the Rabbis — "they are one people,"** וְדָתֶיךָ הַמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים **and "the laws of the King," the King of kings,** אֵינָם עוֹשִׂים וְכַדּוֹמֶה **"they do not keep,"** וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר מַאֲמָר ח **and the like (this was explained in Rosh Chodesh Adar, maamar 8,** וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת**) and elsewhere).** וְכֵן אִיתָא בַּעֲמָלֵק **And likewise it is stated regarding Amalek** (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא י **(Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10,** וּבְפִסְיקְתָא לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר **and Pesikta for Parshas Zachor,** פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן יג וְזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שָׁם**) parsha 12, siman 13, and the holy Zohar there)** שֶׁהָיָה חוֹתֵךְ מִילוֹתֵיהֶם **that he would cut off their circumcised flesh** וְזוֹרְקָן כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה **and fling it upward,** וְאוֹמְרִים בָּזֶה בָּחַרְתָּ **saying, "Is it this You chose?** הֲרֵי לָךְ מַה שֶּׁבָּחַרְתָּ[907] **Here, take what You chose!"** שֶׁאָמַר שֶׁאַף שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל מוּלִים **Meaning: even though Yisrael are circumcised,** אֵין כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים **not all of them are righteous,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ שֶׁפּוֹגְמִין **for there are some who blemish** בְּמִדַּת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם **the attribute of "the tzaddik, foundation of the world."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And this is what they said in the holy Zohar** [שָׁם] רֵישׁ וַיַּקְהֵל **at the beginning of Vayakhel (ibid.):** בְּגִין דְּחָשִׁיב **"Because he intended** לְאַעְקָרָא אֶת קְיָימָא מֵאַתְרֵיהּ וְכוּלֵי[908] **to uproot the covenant from its place, etc."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁקִּטְרֵג **That is, he prosecuted** עַל קְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וְשׁוֹרְשָׁהּ **against the holiness of Yisrael's covenant and its root.** וְלָזֶה נִבְחַר יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **And for this Yehoshua was chosen** לְנַצַּח קְרָבָא דִּלְתַתָּא **to win the battle below,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּפְסִיקְתָא (שָׁם סִימָן ה, ו) **as they said in the Pesikta (ibid., siman 5–6)** (שָׁם) וְתַנְחוּמָא **and Tanchuma (ibid.),** שֶׁאֵין עֲמָלֵק נוֹפֵל אֶלָּא בְּיַד זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף **that Amalek falls only by the hand of the seed of Yosef,** שֶׁלְּכוּלָּם מְסַלֵּק בְּטָעֲנוֹת **for all the others he repels with claims:** לִרְאוּבֵן אוֹמֵר וְכוּלֵי **to Reuven he says, etc.;** וּלְשִׁמְעוֹן וּלְוִי **and to Shimon and Levi:** אַף אַתֶּם הָרַגְתֶּם אֶת שְׁכֶם **"You too killed Shechem";** וּלְכָל הַשְּׁבָטִים **and to all the tribes:** אַתֶּם מְכַרְתֶּם אֲחִיכֶם **"You sold your brother";** וּבְמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא מַסִּיק **and Midrash Tanchuma**

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[906] **Rashi, Bava Metzia 73b, s.v. "Rav Mari bar Rachel"** — "Rav Mari bar Rachel—she was Samuel's daughter. She was taken captive, and a gentile married her; he converted, and his name was Issur the convert. Rav Mari was conceived outside holiness and born within holiness. Out of respect for him, they associated him with his mother's name." Rashi explicitly distinguishes the time of conception from the time of birth. Rav Tzadok cites the maternal designation as an analogy for his proposed genealogy of Rav Shmuel bar Shilat.

[907] **Midrash Abba Guryon 3:3, on Esther 3:1** — "The sages say: The Holy One, blessed be He, considered: This Mordechai is completely righteous. If he is to receive advancement, Haman will come and accumulate wealth, and Mordechai will come to take it from him and build the Temple." The passage gives the Temple as the intended destination of the wealth gathered by Haman. Rav Tzadok develops its significance for the Second Temple's institutions of Oral Torah.

[908] **Pirkei Avot 1:1** — "Moses received Torah from Sinai and transmitted it to Joshua; Joshua to the elders; the elders to the prophets; and the prophets transmitted it to the Men of the Great Assembly. They said three things: Be deliberate in judgment, raise up many students, and make a fence for Torah." The transmission culminates in the assembly whose program Rav Tzadok invokes: the expansion of students and the protection of Torah through a fence.

concludes: וּלְבִנְיָמִין אַתָּה נָחְשַׁדְתָּ **"and to Binyamin: 'You were suspect** עַל פִּלֶגֶשׁ בַּגִּבְעָה.[909] **over the concubine in Givah.'"** וְהוּא דְּעֲמָלֵק קְלִיפַּת כֶּלֶב **The point is that Amalek is the kelipah of the dog,** שֶׁהוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת מְשׁוֹר וַחֲמוֹר **which is the inner core of the ox and the donkey,** שֶׁהֵם קְלִיפַּת עֵשָׂו וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל **which are the kelipos of Esav and Yishmael;** וּפְנִימִיּוּת שו״ר חֲמו״ר **and the inner letters of shor and chamor,** ר׳ מ״ו גִּימַטְרִיָּא כל״ב[910] **vav and mem-vav, equal in numerical value to kelev** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בְּשַׁלַּח **(as written in the holy Zohar, Beshalach,** שָׁם עַמּוּד א **there, side a,** וּבְהַגָּהוֹת רַבִּי חַיִּים וִיטַאל **and the glosses of Rabbi Chaim Vital,** זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה שָׁם אות א**) of blessed memory, there, os 1).** וְעֵשָׂו שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְלִיפַּת רְצִיחָה **And Esav is the root of the kelipah of murder,** קְלִיפַּת שׁוֹר **the kelipah of the ox,** דִּמְזַקְקָא נָשְׁכָא וּבָעֲטָא **which gores, bites and kicks** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת סא, א**) (as stated in Berachos 61a);** וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל קְלִיפַּת הַתַּאֲוָה חֲמוֹר. **and Yishmael is the kelipah of lust, the donkey.** וַעֲמָלֵק פְּנִימִיּוּת שְׁנֵיהֶם מְקַטְרֵג **And Amalek, the inner core of both, prosecutes,** שֶׁגַּם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל רְאוּבֵן יְהוּדָה וּבִנְיָמִין **for in Yisrael too claims are found** מִשְּׁנֵי עִנְיָנִים אֵלּוּ **from these two matters:** בְּטָעֲנוֹת מַעֲנְיַן תַּאֲוָה. **Reuven, Yehudah and Binyamin with claims concerning lust;** וּשְׁאָר שְׁבָטִים בְּטָעֲנַת מְכִירַת יוֹסֵף **and the other tribes with the claim of the sale of Yosef,** מֵעֵין קְלִיפַּת קִנְאָה וּרְצִיחָה. **akin to the kelipah of jealousy and murder.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן לְיוֹסֵף **That is not so for Yosef,** שֶׁאֵין עָלָיו שׁוּם טַעֲנָה **against whom there is no claim at all,** שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת **for he is a chariot for the attribute of** צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם כַּיָּדוּעַ [זוה״ק ח״ג רלו, א][911] **"the tzaddik, foundation of the world," as is known (Zohar III 236a);** וְעַל כֵּן יְהוֹשֻׁעַ מִזַּרְעוֹ נִבְחַר **therefore Yehoshua, of his seed, was chosen** לְנַצֵּחַ קְרָבָא דִּלְתַתָּא. **to win the battle below.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** אִתְתַּקַּן לְנַצֵּחַ קְרָבָא דִּלְעֵילָּא **readied himself to win the battle above —** הַקְטָרוּג שֶׁלּוֹ לְמַעְלָה. **his prosecution on high.** אִיתָא [שָׁם] בְּזֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וַיַּקְהֵל **And in the holy Zohar, Vayakhel (ibid.), it is stated,** אַחַר שֶׁאָמַר **after it said,** כָּמִין הֲוָה לְעֵילָּא לְסָאֲבָא מַקְדָּשָׁא **"He lay in ambush above to defile the Sanctuary,** וְכָמִין הֲוָה לְתַתָּא לְסָאֲבָא יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּלֵי **and lay in ambush below to defile Yisrael, etc." —** אָמַר אַזְמִין לְגַבָּךְ **he said, "There is set against you** הַהוּא חִוְיָא בִּישָׁא לְעֵילָּא **that evil serpent above,** לְסָאֲבָא לָךְ בְּכָל סְטָרִין **to defile you on all sides,** וְאִלְמָלֵא וְכוּלֵי עַיֵּין שָׁם **and were it not, etc."; see there.** וּמַשְׁמַע דִּלְעֵילָּא גַּם כֵּן **This implies that above, too,** לְסָאֲבָא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **it was to defile Yisrael,** מַקְדָּשָׁא וְזֶהוּ נִקְרָא **and this is what is called "the Sanctuary":** שֶׁהוּא לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ **that is, "the heart of the wise man at his right,"** מָקוֹם מִשְׁכַּן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **the place where Hashem Yisbarach dwells,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה, ב) **as they said (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2):** וְאֵיכָן מָצִינוּ **"And where do we find** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that the Holy One, Blessed is He, is the heart of Yisrael?** דִּכְתִיב [תְּהִלִּים עג, כו] צוּר לְבָבִי **For it is written (Tehillim 73:26), 'The Rock of my heart** וְחֶלְקִי אֱלֹהִים לְעוֹלָם **and my portion is God forever'";** וְכֵן כָּתַב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and so it is written in the holy Zohar** (ח״ב תְּרוּמָה קכח, ב)**. (II, Terumah 128b).** וְיִתָּכֵן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ לְעֵילָּא וּלְתַתָּא **And it may be that what they said, "above and below,"** עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [דְּבָרִים כה, יח] **follows the dispute about what is said (Devarim 25:18),** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ **"who happened upon you";** וְאִיתָא (תַּנְחוּמָא שָׁם ט) **for it is stated (Tanchuma, ibid. 9):** רַבִּי יְהוּדָה אָמַר **"Rabbi Yehudah said:** קָרְךָ טִמְּאָךְ וְכוּלֵי **'karcha' — he defiled you, etc.;** רַבָּנָן אָמְרֵי **the Rabbis say:** הִקְרָךְ לִפְנֵי אֲחֵרִים **he cooled you off before others.** מָשָׁל לְמָה הַדָּבָר דּוֹמֶה **To what may this be compared?** לְאַמְבַּטִי רוֹתַחַת וְכוּלֵי **To a boiling bath, etc."** וּבְפִסְיקְתָא (לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרְשָׁה יב סִימָן יג) **And in the Pesikta (for Parshas Zachor, parsha 12, siman 13)** אִיתָא גַּם כֵּן הַמַּחֲלוֹקֶת הַנִּזְכֶּרֶת **the dispute mentioned is also stated,** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ הִפְשִׁירְךָ **'karcha' — he** וְאָמְרוּ רַבָּנָן אָמְרוּ **and they said: "The Rabbis said:**

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[909] **Midrash Tehillim 22:1–2** — "'For the conductor, upon the hind of dawn'—this is Esther. ... 'The light of Israel shall become a fire, and his Holy One a flame': 'The light of Israel'—this is Mordechai; 'and his Holy One a flame'—this is Esther; 'and it shall burn and consume'—this is Haman. ... Esther is called the light of Israel because she illuminated Israel like the light of dawn." The Midrash identifies Esther with the dawn and then assigns fire, flame and consumption to Mordechai, Esther and Haman. Rav Tzadok interprets the paired flames through Torah and conquest of the inclination.

[910] **Taanit 4a** — "Rava said: A young Torah scholar who becomes heated—it is the Torah that makes him heated, as it is said, 'Is not My word like fire, says Hashem?' Rav Ashi said: Any Torah scholar who is not hard as iron is not a Torah scholar, as it is said, 'Like a hammer that shatters rock.' ... Ravina said: Even so, a person must train himself in gentleness, as it is said, 'Remove anger from your heart.'" The fire describes Torah's force. The Gemara's concluding qualification requires gentleness; its teaching does not make ordinary anger a virtue.

[911] **Megillah 13a** — "It calls her Hadassah and it calls her Esther. It was taught: Rabbi Meir says: Her name was Esther, and why was she called Hadassah? After the righteous, who are called myrtles, as it is said, 'He stood among the myrtles.'" This is Rabbi Meir's explanation; the following opinions offer other explanations of her two names. Rav Tzadok develops the myrtle's fragrance as a sign of righteousness.

cooled you, עָשָׂה אוֹתְךָ קַר כַּמַּיִם[912] **he made you cold as water,** [מִשְׁלֵי כה, כה] כְּעִנְיָן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as in the matter of which it says (Mishlei 25:25),** מַיִם קָרִים עַל נֶפֶשׁ עֲיֵפָה **'Cold water upon a weary soul'";** וְהֵבִיא גַּם כֵּן הַמָּשָׁל עַיֵּין שָׁם **and it also brings the parable; see there.** אַךְ מִמַּה שֶׁהֵבִיא מִפָּסוּק **But from the fact that it brings the verse** נִרְאֶה שֶׁעָשָׂה לָהֶם נִיחָא **it appears that he gave them a sense of relief,** מַיִם קָרִים וְגוֹמֵר **"Cold water…,"** כְּדִמְיוֹן מַיִם קָרִים עַל נֶפֶשׁ עֲיֵפָה. **like cold water upon a weary soul.** וְנִרְאֶה כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And it appears, as we said** [ח"ג קס, א] מֵהַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שְׁלַח **from the holy Zohar, Shelach (III 160a),** דַּעֲמָלֵק יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **that Amalek is the evil inclination** דְּיִשְׁתַּכַּח תָּדִיר בְּגוּפָא. **that is constantly found in the body.** וּמְשׁוּם הָכִי קָרֵי לֵיהּ **And therefore it calls him,** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ כָּאן **in the holy Zohar here,** עֲמָלֵק חִוְיָא בִּישָׁא **"Amalek, the evil serpent,** דְּכָמִין לוֹן וְכוּבְלֵי שֶׁהוּא נָחָשׁ הַקַּדְמוֹנִי הָרִאשׁוֹן **who lay in ambush for them, etc.,"** **for he is the primordial serpent, the first serpent.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **And we have already spoken** (בְּרָכוֹת סא, א) בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **about what they said (Berachos 61a):** יֵצֶר הָרַע דּוֹמֶה לִזְבוּב[913] וְיוֹשֵׁב בֵּין שְׁנֵי מִפְתְּחֵי הַלֵּב וְכוּבְלֵי **"The evil inclination resembles a fly and sits between the two openings of the heart, etc." —** דִּשְׁנֵי חֲלָלֵי הַלֵּב **for the two chambers of the heart are** לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ **"the heart of the wise man at his right** וְלֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ **and the heart of the fool at his left,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם בִּכְלָיוֹת **as they said there regarding the kidneys,** דְּטוֹבָה לִימִינוֹ וְכוּבְלֵי **that the good one is at his right, etc.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע **Nevertheless, the evil inclination** אֵינוֹ שׁוֹמֵר אֶת מְקוֹמוֹ **does not keep to its place,** וְלִפְעָמִים מַטְעֶה אֶת הָאָדָם **and at times it misleads a person** וּמַרְאֶה עַצְמוֹ כְּעוֹמֵד לִימִינוֹ **and presents itself as standing at his right,** וּמְלַמְּדוֹ לְהוֹעִיל לְטוֹבָה **teaching him what will benefit him for good —** וּכְעֵין מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (חוּלִין צא, א) כְּתַלְמִיד חָכָם נִדְמֶה לוֹ **similar to what they said (Chullin 91a): "He appeared to him as a Torah scholar,"** שֶׁהֶחֱזִיקוֹ כְּרַב **so that he regarded him as a rav** וְלֹא רָצָה לֵילֵךְ לִימִינוֹ **and did not want to walk at his right;** רַק לְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **but Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁמִּדָּתוֹ אֱמֶת **whose attribute is truth,** לֹא יוּכַל לְהַטְעוֹת.[914] **he could not mislead.** [דְּבָרִים כה, יח] וְכֵן עֲמָלֵק דִּכְתִיב **And so with Amalek, as it is written (Devarim 25:18):** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדָּרֶךְ וְגוֹמֵר **"what he did to you on the way…,** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדָּרֶךְ **who happened upon you on the way";** [שָׁם] וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ וַיַּקְהֵל **and the holy Zohar, Vayakhel (ibid.),** מֵבִיא הַפָּסוּק מִשְׁמוּאֵל **brings the verse from Shmuel,** [שְׁמוּאֵל-א טו, ב] אֲשֶׁר שָׂם לוֹ בַּדָּרֶךְ וְגוֹמֵר **(I Shmuel 15:2) "how he set upon him on the way…":** חִוְיָא בִּישָׁא הֲוָה לְגַבַּייהוּ דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **"He was an evil serpent toward Yisrael,** דְּכָמִין לוֹן עַל פָּרְשַׁת אָרְחִין **lying in ambush for them at the crossroads."** [אָבוֹת פ״ו מ״ד] וְהַיְינוּ דְּאִיתָא **And this is what is stated (Avos 6:4):** כָּךְ דַּרְכָּהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה וְכוּבְלֵי תְּחַיֶּי צַעַר[915] **"This is the way of Torah, etc., and you shall live a life of hardship";** דְּאַף שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת **for although in truth** [תְּהִלִּים יט, ט] פִּקּוּדֵי ה׳ יְשָׁרִים מְשַׂמְּחֵי לֵב **"the precepts of Hashem are upright, gladdening the heart" (Tehillim 19:9),** זֶהוּ אַחַר שֶׁזּוֹכֶה לְאוֹר הַתּוֹרָה **that is after one merits the light of Torah;** אָז מַכְנִיס שִׂמְחָה בְּלִבּוֹ **then it brings joy into his heart.** אֲבָל דַּרְכָּהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה **But the way of Torah,** קוֹדֶם שֶׁזָּכָה לָהּ **before one has merited it,** יֵשׁ לוֹ חַיֵּי צַעַר **is that he has a life of hardship —** בִּיגִיעָה רַבָּה **with great exertion,** וּבְמִיעוּט שֵׁינָה וְתַעֲנוּג **with little** וּבַתּוֹרָה אַתָּה עָמֵל **"and in Torah you toil" —**

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[912] **Eruvin 21b** — "Rava expounded: What is meant by 'The mandrakes have given fragrance'? These are the young men of Israel who have not tasted the taste of sin." The Gemara's preceding statement that both the righteous and the wicked will ultimately give fragrance is quoted earlier in this volume. This further interpretation identifies the fragrance of the young who have not sinned; Rav Tzadok reads it specifically in relation to purity of the covenant.

[913] **Bereshit Rabbah 53:10** — "'The child grew and was weaned'—Rabbi Hoshaya the elder said: He was weaned from the evil inclination. The Rabbis said: He was weaned from his milk. 'Avraham made a great feast'—Rabbi Yehudah son of Rabbi Simon said: The Great One of the worlds was there." The Midrash also records other readings of the feast's greatness. Rav Tzadok selects the presence of the Great One as the basis for distinguishing this revealed feast from the concealed divine source of Oral Torah at Purim.

[914] **Pesachim 119b** — "Rav Avira expounded: What is meant by 'The child grew and was weaned'? In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will make a feast for the righteous on the day that He bestows His kindness upon the descendants of Yitzchak. After they eat and drink, they give Avraham our father a cup of blessing with which to recite the blessing. ... They say to David: Take it and bless. He says to them: I shall bless, and it is fitting for me to bless, as it is said, 'I shall raise the cup of salvations and call in the name of Hashem.'" The Gemara's account contains both eating and drinking and a cup of blessing. That concrete imagery is relevant to the Rambam–Raavad discussion that follows.

[915] **Mishneh Torah, Repentance 8:4** — "Many names have been given to it by way of analogy: the mountain of Hashem, His holy place, the holy way, the courts of Hashem, the pleasantness of Hashem, the tent of Hashem, the sanctuary of Hashem, the house of Hashem, and the gate of Hashem. The Sages called this good that is prepared for the righteous a 'feast,' by way of analogy. Everywhere they call it the world to come." Rambam explicitly identifies "feast" as a metaphor for the future good. Rav Tzadok connects this with the revelation of Torah's secrets.

sleep and pleasure, וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **as they said in Midrash Tanchuma** (נֹחַ ג בְּאוֹרֶךָ[916]) **(Noach 3, at length).** וּבָא עֲלֵיהֶם עֲמָלֵק **And Amalek came upon them** בְּטַעֲנָה מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **with an argument from the words of Torah,** שֶׁמָּצִינוּ **for we find:** אוֹכְלֵי לֶחֶם, שֶׁוְא לָכֶם מַשְׁכִּימֵי קוּם וְגוֹמֵר **"It is vain for you who rise early…,** לֶחֶם הַיינוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **"bread" means words of Torah,** [תְּהִלִּים קכז, ב] הָעֲצָבִים **who eat the bread of toil" (Tehillim 127:2) —** [מִשְׁלֵי ט, ה] כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Mishlei 9:5),** לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחְמִי **"Come, eat of my bread";** וְזֶהוּ לֶחֶם הָעֲצָבִים **and this is "the bread of toil,"** שֶׁבָּא בְּעֶצֶב וִיגִיעָה רַבָּה **which comes with sorrow and great exertion** וְנִדְנוּד שֵׁינָה. **and loss of sleep.** [תְּהִלִּים שָׁם] כֵּן יִתֵּן לִידִידוֹ שֵׁנָה **"So He gives His beloved sleep" (Tehillim ibid.) —** וִידִידוֹ הַיינוּ שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and "His beloved" is King Shlomo, peace be upon him,** שֶׁזָּכָה לְחָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה **who attained the lower wisdom** כּוּלָּהּ בְּשֵׁינָה בַּחֲלוֹם **entirely in sleep, in a dream,** וְנִקְרָא יְדִידְיָה [שְׁמוּאֵל-ב יב, כה] **and was called Yedidyah (II Shmuel 12:25),** וּכְתִיב [שָׁם, כד] וַה' אֲהֵבוֹ. **and it is written (ibid. 24), "and Hashem loved him."** וְזֶהוּ כְּמַאן דְּאָמַר **And this accords with the one who says,** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ עָשָׂה אוֹתָךְ קַר בַּמָּיִם **"karcha — he made you cold as water":** שֶׁבָּא בְּטַעֲנוֹת מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **he came with arguments from the words of Torah** שֶׁאֵין צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת עָמֵל **that one need not toil** בַּעֲמָלָהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה **in the toil of Torah** וְלִחְיוֹת חַיֵּי צַעַר **and live a life of hardship** אַף בְּדַרְכָּהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה. **even in the way of Torah.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ כְּעִנְיָן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is why they said, "as in the matter of which it says,** מַיִם קָרִים עַל נֶפֶשׁ עֲיֵפָה **'Cold water upon a weary soul'":** שֶׁנִּדְמֶה כְּמְלַמְּדוֹ **for he appears like one teaching him** לְהוֹעִיל לְטוֹבָתוֹ עַל פִּי הַתּוֹרָה. **what benefits him for his good according to the Torah.** וְזֶהוּ הַקְּרָבָא לְעֵילָּא **And this is the battle above,** לְסָאֲבָא מַקְדְּשָׁא **"to defile the Sanctuary,"** שֶׁהוּא לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ **which is "the heart of the wise man at his right,"** מְקוֹם מִשְׁכַּן הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **the place where Hashem Yisbarach dwells.** וְכָמִין הָוֵה לְתַתָּא **"And he lay in ambush below** לְסָאֲבָא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **to defile Yisrael" —** בְּלֹא הִשְׁתַּנּוּת וְהֶסְתֵּר פָּנִים **without disguise or concealment of his face,** רַק עוֹמֵד עַל מְקוֹמוֹ **but standing in his own place,** בְּלֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ **in "the heart of the fool at his left,"** לְסָאֲבָא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **to defile Yisrael** מִן הַתּוֹרָה וּמִן הַמִּצְוֹת **in Torah and in the mitzvos;** וּלְפַתּוֹתָם בְּרִיפּוּי יָדַיִם **and to entice them into slackness** וְזֶהוּ כְּמַאן דְּאָמַר **and this accords with the one who says,** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ טִמְאֲךָ וְכוּ' **"karcha — he defiled you, etc."** וְזֶהוּ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said,** דַּהֲוָה כָּמִין לוֹן עַל פָּרָשַׁת אָרְחִין **that he lay in ambush for them at the crossroads,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above —** עַל שְׁנֵי מִפְתְּחֵי הַלֵּב **at the two openings of the heart.** וְעַל זֶה נִצְטָרַךְ מֹשֶׁה וִיהוֹשֻׁעַ **And for this both Moshe and Yehoshua were needed:** יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לְתַתָּא **Yehoshua below,** שֶׁבָּא מִזַּרְעוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף **for he came from the seed of Yosef,** בְּחִינַת גְּבוּר הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ **the aspect of "the mighty one who conquers his inclination";** יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הַמַּכְנִיס יִשְׂרָאֵל לָאָרֶץ[917] **and Yehoshua, who brings Yisrael into the Land,** בְּחִינַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is the aspect of Torah she'b'al peh,** וְהִיא הָרֹב חָכְמָה **which is the "abundance of wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס **that rectifies the "abundance of anger"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(as has been explained many times).** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** נִצַּח קְרָבָא לְעֵילָּא **won the battle above,** עַל דְּרָךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כט, א) **along the lines of what they said (Rosh Hashanah 29a):** וְכִי יָדָיו שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה **"Do the hands of Moshe** עוֹשׂוֹת אוֹ שׁוֹבְרוֹת מִלְחָמָה **make war or break it?** אֶלָּא כָּל זְמַן שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל מִסְתַּכְּלִין כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה **Rather, as long as Yisrael looked upward** וּמְשַׁעְבְּדִין אֶת לִבָּם **and subjugated their hearts** לַאֲבִיהֶם שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם וְכוּ'[918] **to their Father in Heaven, etc."** וְהַיינוּ לְמָסוֹר אֶת עַצְמוֹ **That is, to give**

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[916] **Hasagot HaRaavad on Mishneh Torah, Repentance 8:4** — "'The Sages called this good that is prepared for the righteous a feast by way of analogy.' Avraham says: If this is the feast, there is no cup of blessing here. Silence would have been better for him." Raavad objects to Rambam's account by invoking the cup of blessing. Rav Tzadok acknowledges this objection and then appeals to the following Midrash HaNeelam passage.

[917] **Zohar I 135b, Toldos, Midrash HaNeelam** — "Rabbi Elazar said: In one place we learned that they 'enjoy,' and in another that they 'are nourished.' What is the difference? His father explained: The righteous who have not merited so much enjoy that radiance, which they do not apprehend so fully; but the righteous who have merited are nourished until they attain complete apprehension. There is no eating and drinking except this; this is the feast and the eating. From where do we know it? From Moshe, of whom it is written that he was there with Hashem for forty days and forty nights; he ate no bread and drank no water, because he was nourished from another feast, from the radiance above. So is the feast of the righteous in the future. ... Rabbi Yosi said: Wine preserved in its grapes from the six days of Creation—these are ancient matters that have not been revealed to a person since the world was created, and that are destined to be revealed to the righteous in the future. This is the drinking and eating; this it certainly is." The translated excerpt begins after the 135b folio marker in the first preserved record. It explicitly interprets the nourishment and preserved wine through apprehension of divine radiance and previously hidden matters, supporting the comparison Rav Tzadok makes without erasing Raavad's objection.

[918] **Esther Rabbah 7:12** — "Haman said: Their teeth are large: they eat and drink and say, 'Shabbos delight, festival delight,' reducing the world's wealth. One day in seven is Shabbos; one in thirty is Rosh Chodesh; in Nisan, Pesach;

oneself over לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **to Hashem Yisbarach** וּלְשַׁעְבֵּד לִבּוֹ אֵלָיו **and to subjugate one's heart to Him;** וְאָז לֹא יוּכַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרַע **and then the evil inclination cannot** לְהַטְעוֹת אֶת הָאָדָם **mislead a person** וּלְהִתְלַבֵּשׁ בִּלְבוּשׁ מוֹרֶה לְטוֹבָה. **and clothe itself in the garb of one who guides toward good.** וְזֶה הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **The first to do this was Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁאָמַר הָאֱלֹהִים הָרֹעֶה אֹתִי **who said, "The God who has shepherded me** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מח, טו] מֵעוֹדִי וְגוֹמֵר **all my life…" (Bereishis 48:15):** שֶׁמָּסַר כָּל כֹּחוֹתָיו לְהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **he gave over all his faculties to Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁהוּא מַנְהִיג אוֹתוֹ **that He guide him;** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא יָכוֹל הַס״מ לְהַטְעוֹתוֹ **therefore Samael could not mislead him.** וְיַעֲקֹב מְלָבֵר וּמֹשֶׁה מְלָבְאו **"Yaakov is on the outside and Moshe on the inside"** (תִּקּוּן יג) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **as they said in Tikkunei Zohar (tikkun 13);** וְהוּא פָּעַל בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **and he brought it about in Yisrael** לְשַׁעְבֵּד לִבָּם לַאֲבִיהֶם שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **that they subjugate their hearts to their Father in Heaven;** וְזֶה הָיָה נִיצּוּחַ מֹשֶׁה לְעֵילָּא **and this was Moshe's victory above:** כַּאֲשֶׁר יָרִים יָדוֹ וְגָבַר יִשְׂרָאֵל: **"when he would raise his hand, Yisrael prevailed."**

in Sivan, Shavuos; in Tishrei, Rosh Hashanah, the great fast, and Sukkos. ... The Holy One, blessed be He, said to him: Wicked one, you cast an evil eye upon their festivals! I shall cast you down before them, and they shall add another festival over your downfall—the days of Purim." The Midrash's response makes Haman's attack upon holy festivity the very occasion for an additional holy festival. Rav Tzadok explains why eating and drinking, the objects of Haman's accusation, become the form of its celebration.

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר ט׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Tes

In the Pesikta (for Parshas Zachor, Parsha 12, siman 12): לְמָה הַדָּבָר דּוֹמֶה **To what may the matter be compared?** לְמֶלֶךְ שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ פַּרְדֵּס **To a king who had an orchard** וְהָיָה לוֹ כֶּלֶב אֶחָד וְכוּ׳ **and he had a certain dog, etc.** בָּא בְּנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ **The son of the king's beloved friend came** לִגְנֹב מִתּוֹךְ הַפַּרְדֵּס **to steal from within the orchard;** כְּשֶׁרָצָה הַמֶּלֶךְ **whenever the king wished to remind** לְהַזְכִּיר לְבְנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ **the son of his beloved friend** שֶׁרָצָה לִגְנֹב **that he had wanted to steal,** הָיָה אוֹמֵר לוֹ **he would say to him,** זְכוֹר מַה שֶּׁעָשָׂה לְךָ **"Remember what was done to you** אוֹתוֹ הַכֶּלֶב **by that dog."** כָּךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּ׳ **So too Yisrael, etc.** וּכְשֶׁהָיָה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְבַקֵּשׁ **And when HaKadosh Baruch Hu wished** לְהַזְכִּיר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל הַחֵטְא **to remind Yisrael of the sin** שֶׁחָטְאוּ בִּרְפִידִים **that they sinned at Refidim,** הָיָה אוֹמֵר **He would say,** זְכוּרִים אַתֶּם לְאוֹתוֹ עֲמָלֵק וְכוּ׳ **"Do you remember that Amalek?" etc.** וְהַמִּצְוָה שֶׁגָּרַם שָׁבָא לְפִי זֶה **According to this, the mitzvah** לִזְכּוֹר הַחֵטְא וְהַסִּבָּה **is to remember the sin and the cause** עֲמָלֵק. **that brought about Amalek's coming.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Now we must understand:** לָמָּה לֹא רָצָה לְהַזְכִּיר **why did He not wish to mention** זְכוֹר הַחֵטְא בְּפֵירוּשׁ **"Remember the sin" explicitly,** רַק שֶׁיִּזָּכְרוּ הַחֵטְא **but only that they should remember the sin** עַל יְדֵי הָעוֹנֶשׁ **by way of the punishment?** וְאִם שֶׁלֹּא לְהַזְכִּיר גְּנוּתָם **And if it is in order not to mention their disgrace,** הֲלֹא נֶאֱמַר **is it not said,** זְכוֹר אַל תִּשְׁכַּח **"Remember, do not forget** אֵת אֲשֶׁר הִקְצַפְתָּ **how you provoked** אֶת ה׳ אֱלֹהֶיךָ בַּמִּדְבָּר וְגוֹמֵר [דְּבָרִים ט, ז] **Hashem your God in the wilderness," etc. (Devarim 9:7),** וְחָשַׁב בְּפֵירוּשׁ הָעֵגֶל **and He enumerated explicitly the Golden Calf** וּשְׁאָר חֲטָאִים גְּדוֹלִים **and other great sins?** וּמַאי שְׁנָא הָכָא **So why is it different here,** שֶׁחָס וְלֹא רָצָה **that He was sparing and did not wish** לְהַזְכִּיר הַחֵטְא **to mention the sin** רַק עַל יְדֵי הָעוֹנֶשׁ. **except through the punishment?** גַּם צָרִיךְ לְהָבִין **We must also understand** עִנְיַן הַצִּיווּי לִזְכּוֹר **the matter of the command to remember** חֶטְאֵי הַמִּדְבָּר **the sins of the wilderness** יוֹתֵר מִשְּׁאָר חֶטְאֵי הַדּוֹרוֹת. **more than the sins of the other generations.** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן **But the explanation is** דְּשָׂם הַמִּצְוָה לִזְכּוֹר **that there the mitzvah is to remember** מַעֲשֵׂה הָעֵגֶל שֶׁאֵירַע לָהֶם **the episode of the Calf, which befell them** אַחַר הִתְגַּלּוּת שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם **after the revelation they had** עַל הַיָּם **at the Sea,** דְּרָאָתָה מְכִילְתָא (וְאַחַר כָּךְ שָׁמְעוּ כּוּלָּם קוֹל אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים מְדַבֵּר מִתּוֹךְ הָאֵשׁ [דְּבָרִים ד, לג] וּכְתִיב [שָׁם ה, ד] פָּנִים בְּפָנִים **and afterwards they all heard the voice of the living God speaking from within the fire (Devarim 4:33), and it is written (ibid. 5:4), "Face to face** דִּבֶּר ה׳ וְגוֹמֵר **Hashem spoke," etc.,** דַּחֲמוֹ מַה דְּלָא חָמָא יְחֶזְקֵאל **for they saw what Yechezkel did not see** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר **(as stated in the Zohar,** חֶלֶק ב פב, א[919]**) vol. 2, 82a);** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הָיָה בְּכֹחַ **and nevertheless it was in the power** הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע לִכְנוֹס בְּלִבָּם **of the yetzer hara to enter their hearts** לְפַתּוֹתָם לָבוֹא **and entice them to come** לִידֵי עֲבֵירָה חֲמוּרָה כָּזוֹ **to so grave a transgression as this.** וְעַל יְדֵי זְכִירָה זוֹ **And through this remembrance** יִזְדָּרֵז הָאָדָם לְהִשָּׁמֵר **a person will be spurred to guard himself** מִפִּיתּוּיֵי הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **from the enticements of the yetzer hara,** וְלֹא יִבְטַח בְּמַעֲשָׂיו **and he will not trust in his deeds** וְלֹא יַאֲמִין בְּעַצְמוֹ **nor believe in himself** עַד יוֹם מוֹתוֹ **until the day of his death;** וְזֶה צָרִיךְ לִזְכּוֹר תָּמִיד **and this one must remember always.** וּכְהַהוּא עוּבְדָּא בְּחָסִיד **This is like that incident with the chassid** שֶׁהָיָה שׁוֹנֶה **who used to teach,** אַל תַּאֲמִין בְּעַצְמְךָ עַד יוֹם זְקנוּתְךָ **"Do not believe in yourself until the day of your old age,** כְּגוֹן אֲנִי **such as I,** וְאֵירַע לוֹ מַעֲשֶׂה **and an incident befell him** שֶׁיּוֹדֶה וְיִלְמַד **so that he would admit and teach,** עַד יוֹם מוֹתְךָ **"until the day of your death"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יְרוּשַׁלְמִי (פֶּרֶק ה דְּשַׁבָּת הֲלָכָה ג, ח, א **(as stated in the Yerushalmi, Shabbos, chapter 5, halacha 3, 8a);** אַף שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי יָדַע בְּעַצְמוֹ **even though he certainly knew of himself** שֶׁלִּבּוֹ חָלָל בְּקִרְבּוֹ **that his heart was slain within him** וְרָחוֹק מֵהָאֱוָה. **and far from desire.** וְכֵן דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And so too David HaMelech, alav hashalom,** שֶׁאָמַר וְלִבִּי חָלַל בְּקִרְבִּי [תְּהִלִּים קט, כב] **who said, "And my heart is slain within me" (Tehillim 109:22),** וְאָמַר בְּחָנֵנִי ה׳ וְגוֹמֵר [שָׁם כו, ב] **and said, "Test me, Hashem," etc. (ibid.**

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[919] **Niddah 31a** — "Because of this, the eye of Bilaam the wicked was blinded. He said: Can One Who is pure and holy, and Whose servants are pure and holy, look upon such a matter? His eye was immediately blinded, as it is written: 'The utterance of the man whose eye is closed.'" The preceding statement interprets 'Who has counted the dust of Yaakov and numbered Israel's couplings?' as God awaiting the drop from which a righteous person will be formed. Bilaam refuses to recognize Divine concern and holiness within marital bodily life; this is the precise analogy Rav Tzadok draws to Haman's attitude toward eating.

26:2), וְאַחַר כָּךְ הִתְנַחֵם **and afterwards he regretted it** וְצָוַח זַמּוֹתַי בַּל יַעֲבָר פִּי[920] **and cried out, "Would that my mouth had not uttered it"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין קז, א) **(as stated in Sanhedrin 107a).** [בְּמִדְבָּר יג, כט] וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And regarding this it is said (Bamidbar 13:29),** עֲמָלֵק יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב **"Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev,"** (חֵלֶק ג קס, א) שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **about which they said in the holy Zohar (vol. 3, 160a)** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע **that it alludes to the yetzer hara;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוֹשֵׁב **that is, that he dwells** אַף בְּנֶפֶשׁ הָאָדָם **even in the soul of a person** שֶׁהוּא מְנוּגָּב **who is dried out** מִכָּל חֶמְדָּה וְתַאֲוָה **of all craving and desire** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א) **(as explained in Maamar 1).** וְעַל כֵּן בָּא הַצִּיווּי **Therefore the command came** לְזָכוֹר מַעֲשֵׂה הָעֶגֶל **to remember the episode of the Calf,** שֶׁלֹּא יַסִּיחַ הָאָדָם דַּעְתּוֹ **so that a person should not divert his mind** מִלְּהִשָּׁמֵר מִפִּיתּוּיֵי הַיֵּצֶר אַף כְּשֶׁהוּא בְּמַעֲלָה הָעֶלְיוֹנָה **from guarding himself against the enticements of the yetzer hara even when he is at the highest level,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּעִנְיַן חֵטְא **This is not so regarding the sin** שֶׁגָּרַם בִּיאַת עֲמָלֵק **that caused the coming of Amalek,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **about which they said in the holy Zohar** (בְּשַׁלַּח סד, ב) **(Beshalach 64b),** עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמְרוּ **on what they said,** [שְׁמוֹת יז, ז] הֲיֵשׁ ה׳ בְּקִרְבֵּנוּ **"Is Hashem in our midst" (Shemos 17:7):** וְכִי טַפְּשִׁין הֲווּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **"Were Yisrael then fools,** דְּלָא יָדְעֵי מִלָּה דָּא וְכוּלֵי **that they did not know this thing? etc.** אֶלָּא הָכִי קָאָמַר רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן **Rather, thus said Rabbi Shimon:** בָּעוּ לְמִנְדַּע **they wished to know the difference** בֵּין עַתִּיקָא סְתִימָאָה **between the Concealed Ancient One,** דְּכָל סְתִימִין **most hidden of all hidden,** וּבֵין זְעֵיר אַנְפִּין **and Ze'eir Anpin,** דְּאִקְרֵי אַיִן **who is called Ayin,** דְּאִקְרֵי ה׳ וְכוּלֵי **who is called Hashem," etc.** וְעִנְיַן חֶטְאָם **The matter of their sin** לֹא הָיָה בִּפְשָׁטוּת **was not something plain;** רַק בְּדָבָר שֶׁהָיָה עִנְיָן שֶׁהִסְתַּכְּלוּ **rather it lay in matters of secrets, in that they gazed** בְּעִנְיְנֵי סוֹדוֹת **at something higher than their grasp,** (חֲגִיגָה יג, א) שֶׁעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **regarding which they said (Chagigah 13a),** בְּמוּפְלָא מִמְּךָ אַל תִּדְרוֹשׁ וְכוּלֵי **"Into what is too wondrous for you do not inquire, etc.;** אֵין לְךָ עֵסֶק בְּנִסְתָּרוֹת.[921] **you have no business with hidden things."** וְזֶה מְכוּוָּנָה בְּשֵׁם **And this is referred to by the name** נִקְרָא בְּשֵׁם קוֹצֵץ בִּנְטִיעוֹת **is called "one who cut down the saplings"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם יד, ב) **(as stated there, 14b).** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And regarding this it is said** עַל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** לֹא כֵן עַבְדִּי מֹשֶׁה **"Not so My servant Moshe;** [בַּמִּדְבָּר יב, ז[922]] בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן הוּא **in all My house he is trusted" (Bamidbar 12:7).** וּמַה שָּׁיָּךְ נֶאֱמָנוּת לְמַעְלָה **But what relevance has trustworthiness Above,** וְאֵין מָקוֹם לִגְנֵבָה **when there is no possibility of stealing** מִבֵּית ה׳. **from the house of Hashem?** רַק דְּהַמִּסְתַּכֵּל בְּדָבָר **Rather, one who gazes at something** שֶׁאֵינוֹ שַׁיָּךְ לוֹ **that does not belong to him** מְכוּוָּנָה בְּשֵׁם **is referred to as** גּוֹנֵב מִבֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ **stealing from the house of the King,** [חֲגִיגָה יג, א] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and as they said (Chagigah 13a),** בְּמַה שֶׁהוּרְשֵׁיתָ הִתְבּוֹנֵן **"Contemplate what you have been permitted,"** וְזֶה שֶׁאוֹמְרִים [תְּפִלַּת שַׁחֲרִית לְשַׁבָּת] שֶׁלֹּא לִיקַּח יוֹתֵר מֵחֶלְקוֹ. **not to take more than one's portion.** **And this is what we say (Shabbos morning prayer),** יִשְׂמַח מֹשֶׁה בְּמַתְּנַת חֶלְקוֹ **"Moshe rejoiced in the gift of his portion,"** שֶׁהוּא הַשַּׁבָּת **which is Shabbos,** שֶׁבֵּירֵר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמִצְרַיִם[923] **which he chose for**

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[920] **Sanhedrin 38a** — "He said to them: My sons, are you putting thorns into my eyes? Rabbi Chiya said to him: Rabbi, do not be distressed. Yayin, wine, has the numerical value seventy, and sod, secret, has the numerical value seventy. Wine entered; the secret emerged." Rabbi had urged that Rabbi Chiya's sons be given more wine so that they would speak. Their ensuing statement about the ending of the patriarchal and exilarchic houses pained him; Rabbi Chiya explained that the wine had brought a hidden teaching into speech. Rav Tzadok applies the principle of disclosed inwardness, rather than the specific political content of their statement.

[921] **Eruvin 65b** — "Rabbi Ilai said: A person is recognized through three things: his cup, his purse, and his anger. Some add: also through his laughter." The saying treats drinking as a disclosure of character. Rav Tzadok joins it to the preceding emergence of a secret, explaining how the Purim feast may reveal the inward direction of the participant.

[922] Parallel: **Keter Shem Tov I, §55** — "'I shall surely hide My face' means that He hides so that they will not know that the Holy One, blessed be He, is present there in concealment. ... Once a person knows this great principle—that no barrier separates him from his God during Torah and prayer—even if many alien thoughts arise, these are garments and coverings in which God is concealed. Once the person knows that God is concealed there, it is no longer concealment." This is an exact earlier formulation of the twofold concealment invoked here under 'the holy books.' Connection: The earlier teaching distinguishes concealment from unawareness of concealment. Rav Tzadok applies the same distinction to Purim and to the individual: recognizing one's low condition already allows the hidden Divine rescue to be perceived.

[923] **Sanhedrin 105a** — "Rav Nachman said: Audacity is effective even toward Heaven. At first it is written, 'Do not go with them,' but afterward it is written, 'Rise, go with them.' Rav Sheshes said: Audacity is kingship without a crown." The first statement concerns Bilaam's persistence despite God's initial prohibition. Rav Tzadok contrasts this self-serving audacity with persistent intercession undertaken for Israel's good.

Yisrael in Egypt, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה, א, כח) **as they said (Shemos Rabbah 1:28),** וְכֵן פֵּירְשׁוּ הַקַּדְמוֹנִים[924] **and so the early authorities explained.** מַה שֶּׁאוֹמְרִים כִּי וּלְפִי זֶה יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **According to this we must understand what we say, "For a trusted servant," etc.,** דְּמַשְׁמַע כְּנוֹתֵן טַעַם עֶבֶד נֶאֱמָן וְכוּלֵי **which implies that it gives a reason.** אַךְ הַמְכוּוָן כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר לֹא כֵן עַבְדִּי וְגוֹמֵר **But the intent is as above, what is said, "Not so My servant," etc.,** בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן הוּא וּמִכָּל פֶּה אֶל פֶּה וְגוֹמֵר **"in all My house he is trusted;" mouth to mouth," etc.,** מָקוֹם לֹא הִסְתַּכֵּל בְּמַה שֶּׁלֹּא הָיָה שַׁיָּיךְ לְחֶלְקוֹ **and nevertheless he did not gaze at what did not belong to his portion,** שֶׁזֶּה עִנְיַן נֶאֱמָן הוּא[925] **for this is the meaning of "he is trusted,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְשַׁבָּת זְמַן הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **And Shabbos is the time of the revelation of Atika,** וּבַבּוֹקֶר זְמַן **and the morning is the time** סְעוּדְתָא דְעַתִּיקָא **of the meal of Atika,** וְאָז זְמַן הִתְגַּלּוּת סוֹדוֹת **and then is the time of revelation of secrets,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּסַּד הָאֲרִ״י זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **as composed by the Arizal, zichrono livrachah,** בְּפִזְמוֹן [זֶמֶר אַסַּדֵּר לִסְעוּדְתָא] **in the song (the zemer Asader LiSeudasa):** יְשַׁדֵּר לָן שׁוּפְרֵיהּ וְכוּלֵי **"May He send us His splendor, etc.;** יְגַלֵּה לָן טַעֲמֵי וְכוּלֵי **may He show us His hidden things,** יְחֲזֵי לָן סִתְרֵיהּ **may He reveal to us the reasons," etc.;** לְעַטָּרָא פָּתוֹרָא **"to adorn the table** בְּרָזָא יַקִּירָא וְכוּלֵי[926] **with a precious secret," etc.** וְזֶהוּ כֹּחַ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁמַּכְנִיס בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **And this is the power of Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom, which he instills in Yisrael:** שֶׁלֹּא יִסְתַּכְּלוּ **that they should gaze** רַק בְּמַה שֶּׁהוּרְשָׁיתָ **only at what one has been permitted,** הַמּוּכָן לְחֶלֶק שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַנֶּפֶשׁ **what is fitting for the portion of the soul's root.** וְעַל כֵּן אוֹמְרִים בִּתְפִלַּת שַׁחֲרִית **And therefore we say in the morning prayer** יִשְׂמַח מֹשֶׁה בְּמַתְּנַת חֶלְקוֹ **"Moshe rejoiced in the gift of his portion,"** שֶׁהוּא הַשַּׁבָּת **which is Shabbos,** וְהוּא זְמַן הִתְגַּלּוּת סוֹדוֹת **and it is the time of the revelation of secrets,** וְהוּא עֶבֶד נֶאֱמָן **and he is a trusted servant,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** (חֲגִיגָה יד, ב) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said (Chagigah 14b)** בְּאַרְבָּעָה שֶׁנִּכְנְסוּ לַפַּרְדֵּס **regarding the four who entered the Pardes:** בֶּן עַזַּאי הִצִּיץ וּמֵת **Ben Azzai gazed and died,** בֶּן זוֹמָא הִצִּיץ וְנִפְגַּע **Ben Zoma gazed and was harmed,** רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא יָצָא בְּשָׁלוֹם **Rabbi Akiva emerged in peace;** (שָׁם טו, ב) וְאָמְרוּ **and they said (ibid. 15b)** וְאַף רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **that even Rabbi Akiva** בִּקְּשׁוּ מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת לְדוֹחֲפוֹ **the ministering angels sought to push away;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **that is, they said** שֶׁמַּה שֶׁהִשִּׂיג **that what he grasped** אֵינוֹ בְּמַה שֶּׁהוּרְשָׁיתָ **was not within what is permitted** וְהוּא בִּנְסָתָרוֹת **and it is in hidden matters;** וְאָמַר לָהֶם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא הַנִּיחוּ לְזָקֵן זֶה וְכוּלֵי[927] **and HaKadosh Baruch Hu said to them, "Leave this elder alone," etc.;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁזֶּהוּ בְּמַה שֶּׁהוּרְשָׁיתָ **that is, that this was within what he was permitted,** כְּעִנְיַן בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן הוּא **like the matter of "in all My house he is trusted,"** שֶׁלֹּא יִקַּח יוֹתֵר מִחֶלְקוֹ שׁוֹרְשׁוֹ. **that he would not take more than the portion of his root.** וְזֶהוּ מְדוּקְדָּק בַּמָּשָׁל **And this is precisely indicated in the parable,** שֶׁבָּא בְּנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ לִגְנֹב מִתּוֹךְ הַפַּרְדֵּס **that the son of the king's beloved friend came to steal from within the orchard;** וְהַיְינוּ מַה שֶּׁהִסְתַּכְּלוּ בָּזֶה שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה שַׁיָּיךְ לָהֶם **that is, that they gazed at this, which did not belong to them,** בִּנְסָתָרוֹת גּוֹנֵב מַמָּשׁ שֶׁזֶּהוּ **in hidden matters, for this is literally stealing**

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[924] **Pesachim 119a** — "Come and see: The Holy One, blessed be He, is unlike a mortal. A mortal is defeated and is distressed; the Holy One, blessed be He, is defeated and rejoices, as it is said: 'He said to destroy them, had not Moshe His chosen one stood in the breach before Him.'" The preceding teaching reads 'For the Conductor' as 'Sing to the One Whom they overcome and Who rejoices.' Its example is Moshe's successful intercession, establishing the holy form of 'victory' that the maamar contrasts with Amalek's opposition.

[925] **Bava Metzia 59b** — "Rabbi Yehoshua stood and said: 'It is not in Heaven.' Rabbi Yirmeyah explained: The Torah has already been given at Mount Sinai; we do not heed a heavenly voice, for You already wrote in the Torah at Sinai, 'Incline after the majority.' Rabbi Nasan met Eliyahu and asked: What was the Holy One, blessed be He, doing at that time? He replied: He smiled and said, 'My children have overcome Me; My children have overcome Me.'" The victory in this source is fidelity to the Torah's authorized human process of decision. It is the Divine will expressed through the children's response, the principle Rav Tzadok draws from the smile.

[926] **Taanis 25a** — "Levi decreed a fast, but rain did not come. He said before Him: Master of the universe, You have ascended and sat on high, and You do not have mercy on Your children! Rain came, and Levi became lame. Rabbi Elazar said: A person must never cast words at Heaven, for a great man cast words at Heaven and became lame—and who was it? Levi." The next discussion says both this incident and his demonstration of a difficult bow contributed to his injury. The story thus records the cost of his audacity together with the public benefit of the rain, both of which the maamar acknowledges.

[927] **Esther 9:24–26** — "Haman son of Hammedasa the Agagite, enemy of all the Jews, had plotted against the Jews to destroy them, casting pur—that is, the lot—to confound and destroy them. But when it came before the king, he said by letter that the evil plot Haman had plotted against the Jews should return upon his own head; they hanged him and his sons on the tree. Therefore they called these days Purim, after the pur." The verses themselves place the reversal of the plot between the original lot and the naming of the days. Rav Tzadok's question asks how the instrument of danger can itself become the name of salvation.

מִתּוֹךְ הַפַּרְדֵּס כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **from within the Pardes, as mentioned above;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִשְׁכָּם הַכֶּלֶב **and through this the dog bit them,** וַיָּבֹא עֲמָלֵק. **"and Amalek came."** וְלָכֵן לֹא יִתָּכֵן לְצַוּוֹת **Therefore it is not fitting to command** לְזָכוֹר הַחֵטְא **to remember the sin,** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה חֵטְא פָּשׁוּט כָּל כָּךְ **for it was not so simple a sin,** וּכְשֶׁאֵלַת רַק צִוָּה ה' אֲמַאי אִתְעַנָּשׁוּ. **"Why were they punished?"** הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as in the question of the holy Zohar,** יִתְבָּרַךְ **Rather, Hashem Yisbarach commanded** לְזָכוֹר מַעֲשֵׂה עֲמָלֵק שֶׁגָּרַם. **to remember the deed of Amalek, which it caused.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה לֹא יֶהֱרְסוּ **And through this they will not break through** לִרְאוֹת וּלְהִתְבּוֹנֵן **to look and contemplate** בְּמַה שֶׁהוּרְשֵׁיתָ **as they said,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ יוֹתֵר מִמַּה שֶׁרָאוּי לָהֶם **more than is fitting for them,** הִתְבּוֹנֵן. **"Contemplate what you have been permitted."** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁזֶּה שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בַּמָּשָׁל **And it can be said that this is why the parable mentions** בְּנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ דַּיְקָא **specifically "the son of the king's beloved friend,"** וְכֵן לְהַזְכִּיר לְבֶנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ. **and likewise "to remind the son of the king's beloved friend."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמַּה שֶׁחָמְדוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְהִסְתַּכֵּל בְּסוֹדוֹת **That is, the reason Yisrael craved to gaze into secrets** הוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם **is because they are** בְּנֵי אַבְרָהָם אֲבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **the children of Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא אַבְרָהָם אוֹהֲבִי [יְשַׁעְיָה מא, ח] **who is called "Avraham My beloved" (Yeshayah 41:8),** דְּתְחִלַּת הִתְגַּלּוּת סוֹדוֹת **for the beginning of the revelation of secrets** הָיָה לְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **was to Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּרֵאשִׁית יח, יז] **as it is said (Bereishis 18:17),** הַמְכַסֶּה אֲנִי מֵאַבְרָהָם **"Shall I conceal from Avraham?"** וְאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה מט, ב) **And it is found (Bereishis Rabbah 49:2):** מִתְּחִלָּה הָיָה סוֹד ה' לִירֵאָיו **At first, "the secret of Hashem is for those who fear Him";** וְאַחַר כָּךְ לַיְשָׁרִים **afterwards, to the upright,** דִּכְתִיב [מִשְׁלֵי ג, לב] **as it is written (Mishlei 3:32),** וְאֶת יְשָׁרִים סוֹדוֹ **"And with the upright is His secret";** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אֶל עֲבָדָיו הַנְּבִיאִים **and afterwards to the prophets:** כִּי אִם גָּלָה סוֹדוֹ **"Unless He has revealed His secret** [עָמוֹס ג, ז] **to His servants the prophets" (Amos 3:7).** אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **HaKadosh Baruch Hu said,** אַבְרָהָם זֶה וְכוּ'[928] **"This Avraham," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּמִי שֶׁהוּא יְרֵא ה' **That is, one who fears Hashem** לֹא יְסַתֵּכֵּל **will not gaze** בְּמַה שֶׁאֵינוֹ שַׁיָּיךְ לוֹ **at what does not belong to him,** וּמְגַלֶּה לוֹ ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ סוֹדוֹ[929] **and Hashem Yisbarach reveals His secret to him;** וְכֵן אִיתָא בְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and so it is found regarding Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ג, א) **(Shemos Rabbah 3:1):** בְּשָׂכָר כִּי יָרֵא מֵהַבִּיט [שְׁמוֹת ג, ו] **in reward for "for he was afraid to look" (Shemos 3:6),** [בַּמִּדְבָּר יב, ח][930] וּתְמוּנַת ה' יַבִּיט. **"and the image of Hashem does he behold" (Bamidbar 12:8).** וְהַיְינוּ **And "to the upright" refers to** מִי שֶׁלִּבּוֹ מְיוּשָׁר **one whose heart is straightened,** שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ יֵצֶר הָרָע **who has no yetzer hara in him,** שֶׁכְּבָר נִתְיַישֵּׁר לִבּוֹ **for his heart has already been made straight,** וְאֵין לוֹ רַק לֵב אֶחָד **and he has only one heart** לְאָבִיו שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **for his Father in Heaven;** זֶהוּ וַדַּאי לֹא יַחְמוֹד לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן בְּמַה שֶׁלֹּא הוּרְשָׁה **such a one certainly will not crave to contemplate what he was not permitted,** וְאִתּוֹ סוֹד ה' **and with him is the secret of Hashem,** שֶׁמְּגַלֶּה לוֹ כָּל הַסּוֹדוֹת. **that He reveals to him all the secrets.** וְלִנָּבִיא מְגַלֶּה ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ סוֹדוֹת **And to a prophet Hashem Yisbarach reveals secrets** רַק מַה שֶּׁשַּׁיָּיךְ לוֹ **only what belongs to him,** וְאֵינוֹ בְּמוּפְלָא מִמֶּנּוּ **and not what is too wondrous for him,** [שָׁם, ו] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (ibid. 6),** בַּמַּרְאָה אֵלָיו אֶתְוַדָּע וְגוֹמֵר אִם יִהְיֶה נְבִיאֲכֶם ה' **"If there be a prophet among you, I Hashem make Myself known to him in a vision," etc.;** וְהַיְינוּ בַּמַּדְרֵגָה שֶׁרָאוּי לְהַשִּׂיג **that is, at the level that he is fit to grasp,** בִּבְחִינַת מַרְאָה אוֹ חֲלוֹם. **in the aspect of vision or dream.** לֹא כֵן עַבְדִּי מֹשֶׁה **"Not so My servant Moshe;**

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[928] **Pesachim 116b** — "Passover—because the Omnipresent passed over our ancestors' houses in Egypt, as it is said: 'You shall say: It is a Passover offering to Hashem, Who passed over the houses of the children of Israel in Egypt.'" The name here commemorates the act of rescue itself. This is the contrast on which the maamar's question about the name Purim rests.

[929] **Pesach Haggadah, explanation of matzah** — "This matzah that we eat—why? Because our ancestors' dough did not have time to become leavened before the King of kings, the Holy One, blessed be He, was revealed to them and redeemed them, as it is said: 'They baked the dough they brought out of Egypt into unleavened cakes, for it had not leavened, because they were driven out of Egypt and could not delay, and had not prepared provisions for themselves.'" Like Passover's name, the matzah is explained through the moment of deliverance. Purim's apparent reference to the prior decree therefore requires a different account.

[930] **Megillah 10b** — "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi opened his exposition from: 'As Hashem rejoiced over you to do you good, so He will cause rejoicing ... in doing you harm.' But does the Holy One, blessed be He, rejoice at the downfall of the wicked? ... Rabbi Yochanan said: The ministering angels wished to sing; the Holy One, blessed be He, said: My handiwork is drowning in the sea, and you sing? Rabbi Elazar said: He Himself does not rejoice, but He causes others to rejoice. This is precise: it says yasis, 'He will cause rejoicing,' and not yasus, 'He will rejoice.'" The proof about the omitted 'for He is good' is taken from Yehoshafat's thanksgiving in II Chronicles 20:21. The maamar's questions concern why this teaching opens the exposition of Esther and who 'others' are in that context.

[שָׁם, ז] בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן הוּא **in all My house he is trusted" (ibid. 7),** שֶׁלֹּא יִסְתַּכֵּל **for he would not gaze** בְּמַה שֶּׁאֵינוֹ שַׁיָּיךְ לוֹ. **at what does not belong to him.** וְהוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁכָּתוּב עָלָיו מִקּוֹדֶם **And this is because it is written of him beforehand,** [שָׁם, ג] וְהָאִישׁ מֹשֶׁה עָנָיו מְאֹד וְגוֹמֵר **"And the man Moshe was very humble," etc. (ibid. 3),** וְהָיָה כָּל דָּבָר גָּדוֹל בְּעֵינָיו **and every matter was great in his eyes** לְעָרְכוֹ לְפִי עַנְוָתָנוּתוֹ **relative to himself, in accordance with his humility;** וְלָכֵן גִּילָה לוֹ ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **and therefore Hashem Yisbarach revealed to him** כָּל הַסּוֹדוֹת **all the secrets,** [שָׁם, ח] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (ibid. 8),** פֶּה אֶל פֶּה אֲדַבֶּר וְגוֹמֵר **"Mouth to mouth do I speak," etc.,** וּתְמוּנַת ה' יַבִּיט. **"and the image of Hashem does he behold."** וּלְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And to Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁהָיָה יְרֵא אֱלֹהִים **who was God-fearing,** וְיָשָׁר מִן הַיְשָׁרִים וְנָבִיא **upright among the upright, and a prophet,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁחָשַׁב בִּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה **as enumerated in Bereishis Rabbah,** וְעַל כֵּן נֶאֱמַר **and therefore it is said,** הַמְכַסֶּה אֲנִי וְגוֹמֵר **"Shall I conceal," etc.,** שֶׁגִּילָה לוֹ ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ סוֹדוֹת **for Hashem Yisbarach revealed secrets to him,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְכֵן בְּסָעוּדַת שַׁחֲרִית דְּשַׁבָּת **And likewise at the morning meal of Shabbos,** סְעוּדְתָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא **the meal of Atika,** וְהַסְּעוּדָה כְּנֶגֶד קְדוּשַׁת **and the meal corresponds to the holiness** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִ״י **of Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם זְכרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **as the Arizal, zichrono livrachah, wrote** [פְּרִי עֵץ חַיִּים שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת פֶּרֶק יז][931] **(Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos, chapter 17),** וְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכִין לְהִתְעַטֵּר **and all Yisrael merit to be crowned** בְּקְדוּשַׁת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **with the holiness of Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** הוּא זְמַן הִתְגַּלּוּת סוֹדוֹת **it is the time of the revelation of secrets,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְזָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **And Yisrael merited at the Splitting of the Sea** לְהִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **the revelation of Atika,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ רָאֲתָה וְכוּ׳ **as they said, "A maidservant saw," etc.,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם זֶרַע אַבְרָהָם אוֹהֲבִי. **because they are "the seed of Avraham My beloved."** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִכְסָה מֵהֶם הָאוֹר **And afterwards the light was concealed from them,** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה הַהִתְגַּלּוּת **for the revelation was only** רַק לְפִי שָׁעָה **for the time being,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ב ס, א) **(vol. 2, 60a):** מִדְבַּר שׁוּר **"The wilderness of Shur,"** דַּהֲווּ בָּעָאן לְאִסְתַּכְּלָא בֵּיהּ **for they were seeking to gaze upon it,** זִיוָא יְקָרָא **the radiance of the glory** דְּמַלְכָּא קַדִּישָׁא. **of the Holy King.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ אַחַר כָּךְ **And as they said afterwards,** [שְׁמוֹת טו, כב] עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **on what is said (Shemos 15:22),** וְלֹא מָצְאוּ מָיִם **"And they did not find water":** וְאֵין מַיִם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה **"and water means nothing but Torah,"** אַף שֶׁהָיָה קוֹדֶם מַתַּן תּוֹרָה **even though it was before the giving of the Torah;** וְאוֹלִיפְנָא דְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **"and we have learned that Kudsha Brich Hu** אִקְרֵי תּוֹרָה[932] **is called Torah";** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁחִפְּשׂוּ הַהִתְגַּלּוּת **that is, they sought the revelation** שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם וְנֶעְלַם מֵהֶם. **which they had had and which was hidden from them.** וְזֶה הַחֵשֶׁק הָיָה לָהֶם **And this yearning they had** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם בְּנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ **because they are the son of the king's beloved friend,** רָצָה לוֹמַר **meaning** בְּנֵי אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **the children of Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא אוֹהֲבִי **who is called "My beloved,"** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכוּ לְסוֹדוֹת **through which they merited secrets,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above;** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנֶּעְלַם מֵהֶם **and since it was hidden from them,** חָשְׁקוּ לָזֶה.[933] **they yearned for it.** וְזֶה גָּרַם אַחַר כָּךְ **And this later caused** שֶׁחָשְׁקוּ לְהִסְתַּכֵּל **that they yearned to gaze into** בְּעִנְיָן גָּבוֹהַּ **in a matter higher** מֵחֶלְקָ שֶׁנִּיתַּן לָהֶם לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן **than the portion given them to contemplate;** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and this is what** הֲיֵשׁ ה' בְּקִרְבֵּנוּ אִם אַיִן **"Is Hashem in our midst or not (Ayin)"**

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[931] **Rashi, Megillah 10b, s.v. Acherim Meisis** — "He causes others to rejoice—when they became liable to destruction in Haman's days, their enemies were rejoicing over them." Rashi identifies the rejoicing others as Israel's enemies. Rav Tzadok first raises difficulties with that reading, then proposes that the others are Israel rejoicing at the reversal of the decree onto its enemies.

[932] **Midrash Tanchuma, Acharei Mos 12** — "Rabbi Berchyah the priest said: See what is written: 'Rejoice greatly, daughter of Zion ... behold, your King comes to you, righteous and saved.' It does not say 'righteous and a savior,' but 'righteous and saved.' ... As it were, He is saved. Rabbi Meir said: 'Hashem saved Israel on that day'—as it were, He is redeemed with Israel. Whenever Israel are redeemed, it is as though He is redeemed." The Midrash explicitly reads Israel's salvation as the Divine salvation. Rav Tzadok cites it to show why rejoicing in Israel's destruction would be impossible, even before the Gemara's proof from the drowning Egyptians.

[933] **Megillah 29a** — "Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai says: Come and see how beloved Israel are before the Holy One, blessed be He: wherever they were exiled, the Divine Presence was with them. They were exiled to Egypt, and the Divine Presence was with them; they were exiled to Bavel, and the Divine Presence was with them. When they are destined to be redeemed, the Divine Presence is with them, as it is said: 'Hashem your God shall return with your captivity.' It does not say 'He shall bring back,' but 'He shall return'—the Holy One, blessed be He, returns with them from the exiles." The textual contrast between veshev and veheshiv makes the Divine Presence a participant in exile and return. It supplies the direct rabbinic premise for the maamar's argument about Divine grief and joy.

they said, לְגִנְּבּ שֶׁבָּא בְּנוֹ שֶׁל אוֹהֲבוֹ שֶׁל מֶלֶךְ דַּיְיקָא **that specifically the son of the king's beloved friend came** מִתּוֹךְ הַפַּרְדֵּס דַּיְיקָא **to steal specifically from within the orchard,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְלֹא רָצָה **And HaKadosh Baruch Hu did not wish** לְהַזְכִּיר הַחֵטְא וּלְצַוּוֹת **to mention the sin and to command** זָכוֹר אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתָ **"Remember what you did,"** שֶׁזֶּהוּ אֵינוֹ חֵטְא מְפוֹרָשׁ **for this is not an explicit sin,** וּמִי יָדַע שֶׁזֶּהוּ חֵטְא **and who would know that this is a sin?** רַק זָכַר הָעוֹנֶשׁ **Rather, He mentioned the punishment,** שֶׁבָּא הַכֶּלֶב וּנְשָׁכָם **that the dog came and bit them,** וּמִזֶּה תֵּדְעוּ הַחֵטְא. **and from this you will know the sin,** וְתִזָּהֲרוּ שֶׁלֹּא לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן **and you will take care not to contemplate** רַק בְּמַה שֶׁהוּרְשֵׁיתָ: **anything but what you have been permitted.**

אָכֵן לְפִי מְשַׁל הַפְּסִיקְתָּא **However, according to the parable of the Pesikta,** יֵשׁ לְהָבִין מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר אַחַר כָּךְ **we must understand what is said afterwards,** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **"You shall erase the memory of Amalek,"** כֵּיוָן שֶׁעִיקַּר הַזְּכִירָה **since the main remembrance** לְזְכּוֹר הַחֵטְא **is to remember the sin** שֶׁגָּרַם בִּיאַת עֲמָלֵק. **that caused the coming of Amalek.** אַךְ בָּא לְבָאֵר **But it comes to explain** מַה יּוֹעִיל הַזְּכִירָה **what use the remembrance will be,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁאֵינוֹ יָדוּעַ **since it is not known** כַּמָּה הוּא הַשָּׂגָה הָרְאוּיָה לוֹ **how much is the grasp fitting for him** וּמַה הוּא לְמַעְלָה מֵחֶלְקוֹ **and what is above his portion** שֶׁהוּרְשָׁה לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן **that he is permitted to contemplate.** עַל זֶה אָמַר תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **"You shall erase the memory of Amalek":** שֶׁמַּה שֶּׁיֵּשׁ הָעֵצָה **On this it gives the advice,** בְּמַה שֶׁלֹּא הוּרְשָׁה **at what one is not permitted** לְהִסְתַּכֵּל חֶשֶׁק **for the yearning to gaze** בָּא גַּם כֵּן עַל יְדֵי קְלִיפַּת וְהַסְּתַת עֲמָלֵק **also comes through the kelipah and the incitement of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **who is the evil inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar,** [חֵלֶק ג קס, א שְׁלַח **Shelach (vol. 3, 160a);** וּכְשֶׁתִּמְחֶה זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **and when you erase the memory of Amalek,** לֹא יִהְיֶה לְךָ חֶשֶׁק **you will have no yearning** לְהִסְתַּכֵּל וּלְהִתְבּוֹנֵן **to gaze and contemplate** בְּיוֹתֵר מִמַּה שֶׁהוּרְשֵׁיתָ **beyond what you have been permitted,** שֶׁאָז תַּשִּׂיג הַיִּרְאָה **for then you will attain fear of Heaven,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the way that it is said,** כִּי יָרֵא מֵהַבִּיט **"for he was afraid to look,"** וְיִהְיֶה לְךָ יַשְׁרוּת לֵב **and you will have uprightness of heart,** וְלֹא יִהְיֶה לְךָ חֶשֶׁק **and you will have no yearning** לְמַה שֶׁלֹּא הוּרְשֵׁיתָ. **for what you have not been permitted.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said** (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא ה) **(Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 5):** זִכְרוֹנֵיכֶם מְשָׁלֵי אֵפֶר **"Your remembrances are parables of ash":** אוֹתָן שְׁתֵּי זְכִירוֹת **those two remembrances,** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק וְכוּבְלֵי **"You shall erase the memory of Amalek," etc.,** אִם זְכִיתֶם **if you are worthy,** אַתֶּם בָּנָיו שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם **you are the children of Avraham,** שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל עַצְמוֹ כְּאֵפֶר **who likened himself to ash.** (וּכְעֵין זֶה בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא שָׁם סִימָן, ב) **(and similarly in the Pesikta, ibid., siman 2).** שֶׁעִנְיַן שֶׁזָּכָה אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **For the reason that Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom, merited** לִהְיוֹת יָרֵא וְיָשָׁר **to be God-fearing and upright** שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל עַצְמוֹ כְּאֵפֶר. **that he likened himself to ash.** וּכְתִיב [מִשְׁלֵי כב, ד] עֵקֶב עֲנָוָה **And it is written (Mishlei 22:4), "The result of humility** יִרְאַת ה׳ **is the fear of Hashem,"** וּכְתִיב [תְּהִלִּים יט, ט] פִּקּוּדֵי ה׳ יְשָׁרִים **and it is written (Tehillim 19:9), "The precepts of Hashem are upright,** מְשַׂמְּחֵי לֵב **gladdening the heart,"** וְאֵין דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה מִתְקַיְּימִים **and words of Torah endure** אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁמַּשִׁים עַצְמוֹ כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ[934] **only in one who makes himself as if he does not exist** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סוֹטָה כא, ב) **(as stated in Sotah 21b).** וְכֵן נִמְשְׁלוּ דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה כְּמַיִם **So too words of Torah are likened to water,** שֶׁמַּנִּיחִים מָקוֹם גָּבוֹהַּ **which leave a high place** וְהוֹלְכִים לְמָקוֹם נָמוּךְ. **and go to a low place;** וְנִמְשְׁלוּ לְמַיִם יַיִן וְחָלָב **and they are likened to water, wine and milk,** שֶׁאֵין מִתְקַיְּימִין **which keep** אֶלָּא בְּפָחוּת שֶׁבַּכֵּלִים **only in the humblest of vessels;** וְכֵן דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה אֵין מִתְקַיְּימִין **so too words of Torah endure** אֶלָּא בְּמִי שֶׁדַּעְתּוֹ שְׁפָלָה **only in one whose mind is lowly** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּעֲנִית ז, א[935]) **(as stated in Taanis 7a).** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁהֵם יְשָׁרִים וּמְשַׂמְּחֵי לֵב **And through humility one merits words of Torah, which are upright and gladden the heart,** (שָׁם טו, א כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ) **as they said (ibid. 15a),** יְשָׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה **the upright are for joy,** [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Tehillim 97:11),** וּלְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה. **"And for the upright of**

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[934] **Rashi, Genesis 1:1, s.v. Bereishis Bara** — "As our Sages expounded: For the sake of the Torah, which is called 'the beginning of His way,' and for the sake of Israel, who are called 'the beginning of His produce.'" Rashi's two readings of bereishis underlie the claim that Creation's purpose is bound to Torah and Israel. The Sinai condition discussed in Shabbos 88a then gives that purpose its explicit covenantal form.

[935] **Rashi, Genesis 27:40, s.v. Tarid** — "Tarid is an expression of distress, as in 'I am restless in my complaint.' That is: When Israel transgress the Torah, and you have grounds to be distressed about the blessings he took, then 'you shall break his yoke' from your neck." Rashi connects Esav's release with Israel's failing. The teaching Rav Tzadok reports from his master reads tarid additionally through Esav's own descent: its final assault precedes its fall. The two readings should be distinguished.

heart, joy." וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁתִּמְחֶה זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **And by erasing the memory of Amalek** תִּזְכֶּה לָזֶה לִהְיוֹת עָנָיו **you will merit this, to be humble,** וְאַתֶּם בָּנָיו **and you are the children** שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁנִּמְשַׁל כְּאֵפֶר **who likened himself to ash,** וְתִזְכֶּה לִהְיוֹת יָשָׁר וְיָרֵא **and you will merit to be upright and God-fearing,** וְלֹא תִרְצֶה לְהִתְבּוֹנֵן **and you will not wish to contemplate** רַק בְּמַה שֶׁהוּרְשֵׁיתָ **anything but what you have been permitted,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ (חולין פט, א) **about whom they said (Chullin 89a)** דְּגָדוֹל [מַ]מַּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **that it is greater than what is said** בְּאַבְרָהָם **of Avraham,** שֶׁאָמַר וְנַחְנוּ מָה **for he said, "And what are we,"** כְּמִי שֶׁאֵינוֹ מַמָּשׁ **as one who literally does not exist,** יוֹתֵר מִמָּשָׁל עָפָר וָאֵפֶר **more than the image of "dust and ash,"** וְזָכָה לִהְיוֹת מֶרְכָּבָה **merited to be a chariot** לְמִדַּת אַיִן **for the attribute of Ayin;** וְעַל כֵּן הוֹרִיד **and therefore he brought down** כָּל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **all the words of Torah,** כַּנִּכְתָּב [אִיּוֹב כח, יב] **as it is written (Iyov 28:12),** וְהַחָכְמָה מֵאַיִן תִּמָּצֵא **"And wisdom, from Ayin is it found";** לוֹ גִּילָה ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **to him Hashem Yisbarach revealed** כָּל הַסּוֹדוֹת **all the secrets,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said,** בְּכָל בֵּיתִי נֶאֱמָן הוּא **"In all My house he is trusted;** פֶּה אֶל פֶּה אֲדַבֶּר בּוֹ וְגוֹמֵר **mouth to mouth do I speak with him," etc.** וּבִסְעוּדַת שַׁחֲרִית דְּשַׁבָּת **And at the morning meal of Shabbos,** דְּבַת מְעַטְּרָא בְּאַבְהָן **when she is crowned with the Avos,** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֶלֶק ב רד, א] **(Zohar HaKadosh, vol. 2, 204a),** וְזוֹכִין לִקְדוּשַׁת **and we merit the holiness** אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Avraham Avinu, alav hashalom,** מְבַקְּשִׁים עַל סוֹדוֹת **we pray for secrets,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: **as mentioned above.**

וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר עוֹד **And it can further be said** דְּזִכְירַת עֲמָלֵק הוּא עִנְיָן **that the remembrance of Amalek means** שֶׁלֹּא יֵקַל הָאָדָם לְעַצְמוֹ **that a person should not be lenient with himself** בְּדָבָר שֶׁנִּרְאֶה קַל בְּעֵינָיו אֲפִילּוּ. **even in a matter that seems light in his eyes.** שֶׁהֲרֵי רוֹאִים **For we see** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי חֵטְא דַּק **that through a subtle sin,** שֶׁהָיוּ מִסְתַּכְּלִין **that they were gazing into** בְּבְחִינַת הַהַכָּרָה וְהַדַּעַת. **in the realm of recognition and knowledge,** נִסְתָּעֵף בִּיאַת עֲמָלֵק **there branched out the coming of Amalek,** שֶׁגָּרַם שְׁלִיטַת הָרֹאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָה **which brought about the dominion of the "first" of the kelipah,** וּמִזֶּה נִסְתָּעֵף שְׁלִיטַת **and from this branched out the dominion** כָּל הַשִּׁבְעִים קְלִיפּוֹת **of all the seventy kelipos** הַמִּסְתָּעְפִים מִסְּטָרָא דִּילֵיהּ **that branch out from his side;** וְאִלְמָלֵא הוּא **and were it not for him,** לֹא שָׁלְטוּ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **no nation or tongue** כָּל אוּמָּה וְלָשׁוֹן **would have ruled over Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מִגְּמָרָא **as we said from the Gemara** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר לְמַעְלָה סוֹף מַאֲמָר א) **(Shabbos 118b, and explained above at the end of Maamar 1),** כִּי כֹּחוֹ שֶׁבָּת קיח, ב כּוֹלֵל כָּל שִׁבְעִים הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **for his power includes all seventy kelipos.** וּמִזֶּה יִשְׁפּוֹט הָאָדָם בְּשִׂכְלוֹ **And from this a person will judge with his intellect** שֶׁלֹּא יֵקַל חָלִילָה בְּשׁוּם דָּבָר[936] **not to be lenient, chas v'shalom, in anything;** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא הִזְכִּיר כָּאן הַחֵטְא **and therefore it did not mention the sin here** כִּי אִם עַל יְדֵי הָעוֹנֶשׁ. **except through the punishment.** כִּי אַדְרַבָּא עִיקַּר הַזְּכִירָה **For on the contrary, the essence of the remembrance is** שֶׁהָעוֹנֶשׁ בָּא עַל יְדֵי חֵטְא דַּק **that the punishment came through a subtle sin,** וְנִסְתָּעֵף מִזֶּה בִּיאַת עֲמָלֵק **and from it branched out the coming of Amalek;** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן יִהְיֶה בּוֹרֵחַ מִן הָעֲבֵירָה **and through this one will flee from transgression** וְלִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק מִן הַלֵּב **and erases the memory of Amalek from the heart,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: **as mentioned above.**

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[936] **Bereishis Rabbah 42:3** — "Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman made the distinction: Wherever vayehi is said, it denotes distress; vehayah denotes joy. They challenged him: But it is written, 'And there was light'! He replied: That too was not complete joy, for the world did not merit to use that light." The Midrash proceeds through objections and answers to this rule. Rav Tzadok uses the proposed association of vehayah with joy when interpreting 'When you descend, you shall break his yoke.'

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר י׳ Parshas Zachor — Maamar Yud

מִלְחָמָה לַה׳ בַּעֲמָלֵק מִדּוֹר דּוֹר **"Hashem maintains a war against Amalek from generation to generation."**
(כִּי תֵצֵא יא) בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **In Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei 11):** רַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר אוֹמֵר **Rabbi Eliezer says,** מִדּוֹרוֹ
שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה **from the generation of Moshe** עַד דּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל שְׁמוּאֵל **until the generation of Shmuel;** וְרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אוֹמֵר **and Rabbi Yehoshua says,** מִדּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל שְׁמוּאֵל **from the generation of Shmuel** עַד דּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **until the generation of Mordechai and Esther;** וְרַבִּי יוֹסֵי אוֹמֵר **and Rabbi Yose says,** מִדּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **from the generation of Mordechai and Esther** עַד מֶלֶךְ הַמָּשִׁיחַ וְכוּלֵי **until the King Mashiach, etc.,** שֶׁהוּא שְׁלֹשָׁה דּוֹרוֹת **which is three generations:** דּוֹר חַד דּוֹרִים שְׁנַיִם **"dor" is one, "dorim" is two,** הֲרֵי תְּלָת.[937] **making three.** עִנְיַן מַחֲלוֹקְתָּם **The point of their dispute** עִנְיַן מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **the matter of the eradication of Amalek:** דְּשָׁלֹשׁ פְּעָמִים מָצִינוּ **is that three times we find** בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה **in the generation of Moshe,** שֶׁאָז נִזְדַּוֵּג לָהֶם עֲמָלֵק **when Amalek attached himself to them** וְנִלְחֲמוּ בּוֹ **and they fought him,** [שְׁמוֹת יז, יג] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Shemos 17:13),** **"And Yehoshua weakened Amalek,"** וַיַּחֲלֹושׁ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת עֲמָלֵק. **for he only weakened his strength.** גַּם כֵּן הָמָן הִתְגָּרָה בָּהֶם **And in the generation of Mordechai and Esther** וּבְדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **Haman too provoked them** וּבִיקֵּשׁ לְהַשְׁמִיד לַהֲרוֹג וּלְאַבֵּד **and sought to destroy, to kill and to annihilate,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא **and afterwards "it was turned about,** אֲשֶׁר יִשְׁלְטוּ הַיְּהוּדִים **that the Jews ruled,** הֵמָּה בְּשׂוֹנְאֵיהֶם [אֶסְתֵּר ט, א]. **they over those who hated them" (Esther 9:1).** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל שְׁמוּאֵל **This was not so in the generation of Shmuel,** שֶׁהִתְגָּרָה עֲמָלֵק בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **that Amalek provoked Yisrael;** שֶׁאָז לֹא מָצִינוּ כְּלָל **when we do not find at all** רַק ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ צִיָּוָה **rather, Hashem Yisbarach commanded** אֶת שְׁמוּאֵל וְשָׁאוּל **Shmuel and Shaul** לְהַחֲרִים אֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר לַעֲמָלֵק **to utterly destroy all that belonged to Amalek** [רְאֵה שְׁמוּאֵל א פֶּרֶק טו]. **(see I Shmuel, chapter 15).** וְהָעִנְיָן דְּבַמִּדְבָּר **The explanation is that in the wilderness,** שֶׁאָז הִגִּיעַ זְמַן **when the time had arrived** וְאָז הִתְגָּרָה עֲמָלֵק בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **then Amalek provoked Yisrael** הִתְנַגְּלוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **for the revelation of the Written Torah,** לְבַטֵּל מֵהֶם שֶׁבִּכְתָב קַבָּלַת תּוֹרָה. **to prevent them from receiving the Written Torah.** וְזֶה הָיָה בִּרְפִידִים **And this was at Refidim,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא עַל שֵׁם שֶׁרִיפוּ עַצְמָם מִדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **which is so called because they slackened themselves from words of Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין קו, א) **(as stated in Sanhedrin 106a);** וְזֶה הָיָה עַל יְדֵי עֲמָלֵק **and this came about through Amalek,** שֶׁהִשְׁלִיךְ עֲלֵיהֶם רִפְיוֹן יָדַיִם מִדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **who cast upon them slackness of hands from words of Torah,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁיָּדַע **because he knew** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מַתַּן תּוֹרָה **that through the giving of the Torah** יִתְבַּטֵּל כּוּלּוֹ **he would be entirely nullified,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה מא, ז) **as they said (Shemos Rabbah 41:7):** חֵירוּת מִמַּלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת[938] **"freedom from the Angel of Death";** וְזֶהוּ עַל יְדֵי בִּיטּוּל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **and this is through the nullification of the yetzer hara,** שֶׁגָּרַם הַפְּגָם **which caused the blemish,** וְהוּא מַלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת הוּא יֵצֶר הָרָע **and the Angel of Death is the yetzer hara** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּבָא בַּתְרָא טז, א) **(as stated in Bava Basra 16a),** וַעֲמָלֵק יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **and Amalek is the evil inclination,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ג קסז, א). **(vol. 3, 160a).** וְכֵן בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **And so too in the generation of Mordechai and Esther,** שֶׁאָז הָיָה זְמַן אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה **which was the time of the Men of the Great Assembly,** שֶׁיִּסְּדוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **who established Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה כ, א) **as they said (Sukkah 20a),** עָלָה עֶזְרָא מִבָּבֶל וְיִסְּדָהּ **"Ezra came up from Bavel and established it";** וְהָרֹב הָכְמָה מוֹעִיל **and abundance of wisdom serves** לְבַטֵּל הָרֹב כַּעַס [נְדָרִים כב, ב] **to nullify abundance of anger (Nedarim 22b);** וְעַל כֵּן הִתְגָּרָה עֲמָלֵק גַּם כֵּן **therefore Amalek again provoked** בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל לְבַטֵּל מֵהֶם **Yisrael, to deprive them of** הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **Torah she'b'al peh.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא **And afterwards "it was turned about,"** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִתְיַסֵּד אָז **for through this there was then established** הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שַׁבָּת פח, א) **as**

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[937] **Midrash Tanchuma, Korach 12** — "Gog and Magog have the numerical value seventy, corresponding to the seventy nations." This explicit numerical interpretation is the cited basis for treating the final war as a gathering of the full range of opposing national powers. Its placement before the fullest revelation of Israel's holiness is developed by Rav Tzadok.

[938] **Yoma 10a** — "Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: The son of David does not come until the wicked kingdom of Rome spreads over the entire world for nine months, as it is said: 'Therefore He shall give them over until the time when she who gives birth has given birth; the rest of his brothers shall return to the children of Israel.'" The verse is Micah 5:2 in the Hebrew numbering. The nine-month image gives the maamar its comparison of the preceding distress to the pains of birth.

they said (Shabbos 88a), הָדַר קִבְּלוּהָ בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ[939] **"they accepted it anew in the days of Achashverosh";** וְהַיְינוּ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁעַל זֶה הָיָה **for it was about this that there was** כְּפִיַּת הַר כְּגִיגִית **the holding of the mountain over them like a barrel,** דְּעַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **whereas about the Written Torah** אָמְרוּ נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע **they said, "We will do and we will hear"** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג) **(as stated in Tanchuma, Noach 3).** וְכֵן כָּתוּב אַחַר מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **And so it is written after the eradication of Amalek,** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] **"The Jews had light" (Esther 8:16),** (מְגִילָה טז, ב) וְדָרְשׁוּ **and they expounded (Megillah 16b),** זוֹ תּוֹרָה **"This is Torah";** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא אוֹרָה בִּלְשׁוֹן נְקֵיבָה **which is called "orah" in the feminine,** שֶׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **for it receives from the Written Torah,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא תּוֹרָה אוֹר. **which is called "Torah is light."** וּבְדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה שֶׁהָיוּ בַּמִּדְבָּר **And in the generation of Moshe, when they were in the wilderness** וְלֹא הָיָה לָהֶם עֲדַיִן **and did not yet have** זְכוּת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **the merit of Eretz Yisrael,** לֹא הָיָה הַזְּמַן **it was not the time** לְמְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק מִכֹּל וָכֹל **for the complete eradication of Amalek,** [דְּבָרִים כה, יט] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Devarim 25:19),** וְהָיָה בְּהָנִיחַ וְגוֹמֵר **"And it shall be, when Hashem gives rest," etc.,** בָּאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר ה' אֱלֹהֶיךָ נוֹתֵן לְךָ נַחֲלָה לְרִשְׁתָּהּ **"in the land that Hashem your God gives you as an inheritance to possess,** תִּמְחֶה וְגוֹמֵר. **you shall erase," etc.** אֲבָל בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל שְׁמוּאֵל **However, in the generation of Shmuel,** אָז לֹא נִתְגָּרָה עֲמָלֵק בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **Amalek did not then provoke Yisrael,** רַק כֵּיוָן שֶׁהָיוּ בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **but since they were in Eretz Yisrael,** צִוָּה ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ לְשָׁאוּל **Hashem Yisbarach commanded Shaul** לְהַחֲרִים אֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר לַעֲמָלֵק. **to utterly destroy all that belonged to Amalek.** וְאִם הָיָה מְקַיֵּים **And had he fulfilled** כַּאֲשֶׁר נִצְטַוָּה **what he was commanded,** הָיָה אָז מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק מִכֹּל וָכֹל **there would then have been the complete eradication of Amalek** עַל יְדֵי שָׁאוּל **through Shaul,** שֶׁהוּא מִזַּרְעוֹ שֶׁל בִּנְיָמִין **who is of the seed of Binyamin,** וְגַם כְּמוֹ מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **the eradication of Amalek,** עַל יָדוֹ רָאוּי לִהְיוֹת **and through him too it was fitting there be** [שׁוֹפְטִים ה, יד] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Shoftim 5:14),** וְאָמְרוּ עַל זֶה בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **"After you, Binyamin,"** אַחֲרֶיךָ בִנְיָמִין **and they said on this in the Pesikta** (פָּרָשָׁה יג סִימָן ד) **(Parsha 13, siman 4):** לְעוֹלָם אַחֲרֶיךָ בִנְיָמִין[940] **"Forever 'after you, Binyamin,'** לִתְבּוֹעַ מִן זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק. **to exact retribution from the seed of Amalek."** וְאָז הָיָה דָּוִד וְשָׁאוּל הָיָה רָאוּי לִהְיוֹת **and Shaul was fit to be** מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף **Mashiach ben Yosef,** [שְׁמוּאֵל א כג, יז] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר יְהוֹנָתָן **as Yehonasan said (I Shmuel 23:17),** וְאָנֹכִי אֶהְיֶה לְךָ לְמִשְׁנֶה.[941] **"And I shall be second to you."** רַק עַל יְדֵי שֶׁהִשְׁאִיר שָׁאוּל אֶת אֲגַג **But because Shaul left Agag alive,** יָצָא מֶמֶּנּוּ הָמָן **Haman descended from him,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הִתְגָּרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **and through this he provoked Yisrael** בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **in the generation of Mordechai and Esther,** שֶׁבָּא כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above;** זְמַן הִתְגַּלּוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **when the time came for the revelation of Torah she'b'al peh,** וְאָז הָיָה מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **and then there was the eradication of Amalek** עַל יְדֵי מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **through Mordechai and Esther,** מִזֶּרַע בִּנְיָמִין. **of the seed of Binyamin.** וְנִתְיַיסֵּד הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And Torah she'b'al peh was established,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ הָדַר קִבְּלוּהָ וְכוּ' **as they said, "they accepted it anew," etc.,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְעִיקַּר הִתְגַּלּוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה יִהְיֶה **But the main revelation of Torah she'b'al peh** בִּזְמַן מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד **will be in the time of Mashiach ben David,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (קֹהֶלֶת רַבָּה יא, ח) **as they said (Koheles Rabbah 11:8):** תּוֹרָה שֶׁאָדָם לָמַד בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **"The Torah that a person learns in this world** הֶבֶל הִיא **is**

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[939] **Proverbs 16:33** — "The lot is cast into the lap, but its whole decision is from Hashem." Rav Tzadok reads the result of Haman's lot through this verse: the month selected by the enemy serves the Divine purpose of bringing about the enemy's defeat.

[940] **Esther 8:8** — "You may write concerning the Jews as seems good to you, in the king's name, and seal it with the king's signet; for a document written in the king's name and sealed with the king's signet cannot be revoked." The first letters could not simply be withdrawn. The resulting new authorization, in which the Jews defend themselves against their enemies, is the narrative form of the maamar's claim that Haman's decree itself created the opening for its reversal.

[941] **Zohar Chadash, Ki Savo, on Deuteronomy 28:61** — "'Until you are destroyed'—something that will never be, for ever and ever. For the Holy One, blessed be He, has sworn never to destroy Israel for ever and ever, and their remembrance shall endure continually, as it is written: 'So shall your offspring and your name endure'; and 'If the heavens above can be measured ... .' Since He has sworn that Israel will not be destroyed, all those blows and illnesses are destined to remain hidden and covered, not emerging to harm them until the time they cease from the world—which shall never be, for ever and ever." The original exposition reads the threat in Deuteronomy 28:61 through the oath that Israel will endure. Rav Tzadok applies the same premise to the language 'to destroy you' in 28:63. The manuscript's traditional 73b folio has not been independently collated against a scan; the digital section and exact text are verified.

vanity לְפָנַי תּוֹרָתוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ.[942] **compared to the Torah of Mashiach."** וְאָז יִהְיֶה עִיקַּר הַמְּחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **And then will be the main eradication of Amalek,** מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **on the part of Hashem Yisbarach.** וְזֶהוּ שׁוֹרֶשׁ מַחֲלוֹקְתָּם **And this is the root of their dispute:** דְּרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר אוֹמֵר **that Rabbi Eliezer says,** מִדּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה **from the generation of Moshe** עַד דּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל שְׁמוּאֵל **until the generation of Shmuel,** שֶׁאָז הָיָה רָאוּי לִהְיוֹת **for then it was fitting that there be** מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק מִכֹּל וָכֹל **the complete eradication of Amalek,** אִם הָיָה שָׁאוּל מְקַיֵּים **had Shaul fulfilled** כְּמִצְוַת שְׁמוּאֵל מִפִּי ה' **the command of Shmuel from the mouth of Hashem,** וְכָאָמוּר. **as has been said.** וְרַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ סָבַר **And Rabbi Yehoshua held** כֵּיוָן דִּפְסוּק **that since the pasuk** מִלְחָמָה לַה' בַּעֲמָלֵק מִדּוֹר דּוֹר **"Hashem maintains a war against Amalek from generation to generation"** נֶאֱמַר אַחַר מִלְחֶמֶת עֲמָלֵק. **was said after the war with Amalek,** לֹא נֶחְשַׁב דּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה **the generation of Moshe is not counted** מַה בְּכָלַל שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מִדּוֹר דּוֹר **within what is said, "from generation to generation,"** רַק מִדּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל שְׁמוּאֵל **but only from the generation of Shmuel** עַד דּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **until the generation of Mordechai and Esther,** שֶׁאָז גַּם כֵּן הִתְעוֹרֵר עֲמָלֵק **when Amalek likewise awoke** וְהִתְגָּרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **and provoked Yisrael,** כְּשֶׁהִגִּיעַ זְמַן קַבָּלַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **when the time arrived for receiving Torah she'b'al peh.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁגִּילָה ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **That is, Hashem Yisbarach revealed** לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **to Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom,** שֶׁמַּעַתָּה יִהְיֶה דּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל שְׁמוּאֵל **that from now there will be the generation of Shmuel,** שֶׁה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ יַתְחִיל מִצִּדּוֹ **in which Hashem Yisbarach will begin, on His part,** לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **to carry out the eradication of Amalek,** וְלֹא יִגָּמֵר **and it will not be completed,** שֶׁאַחַר כָּךְ יִתְעוֹרֵר עֲמָלֵק עוֹד **for afterwards Amalek will awaken again** לְהִתְגָּרוֹת בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **to provoke Yisrael** בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר. **in the generation of Mordechai and Esther.** וְרַבִּי יוֹסֵי אוֹמֵר **And Rabbi Yose says,** שֶׁדּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מִדּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר וְכוּלֵי **from the generation of Mordechai and Esther, etc.,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה מְחָיֶה כַּהוֹגֶן. **since there was no proper eradication.** שְׁמוּאֵל לֹא חָשַׁב **for he did not count the generation of Shmuel,** שֶׁשָּׁאוּל קִלְקֵל שֶׁהִנִּיחַ אֲגַג **For Shaul spoiled it by leaving Agag,** וְחָשַׁב הַהַתְחָלָה **and he counted as the beginning** לְבַטֵּל הִתְגַּלּוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל מַה שֶׁהִתְגָּרָה עֲמָלֵק בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **when Amalek provoked Yisrael** פֶּה **to nullify the revelation of Torah she'b'al peh** בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָרְדֳּכַי **in the generation of Mordechai;** וְאָז הָיָה מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **and then there was the eradication of Amalek,** וְקִבְּלוּהָ לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and they accepted Torah she'b'al peh,** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** רַק לֹא נִגְמַר **But it was not completed,** עַד דּוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ **until the generation of Mashiach,** שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה עִיקַּר הִתְגַּלּוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **when there will be the main revelation of Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ מֵהַמִּדְרָשׁ **as we said from the Midrash,** וְאָז יִהְיֶה עִיקַּר מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **and then will be the main eradication of Amalek;** וְעַל זֶה מֵיתֵי הַדְּרָשָׁא דִּפְקִתִיב וְלִפְנֵי יָרֵחַ דּוֹר דּוֹרִים **and on this he brings the exposition that the generation of Mashiach is three generations, as it is written, "And before the moon, dor dorim":** דּוֹר חַד דּוֹרִים שְׁנַיִם **"dor" is one, "dorim" is two,** הֲרֵי תְּלָת **making three;** מְרַמֵּז שֶׁדּוֹר שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ הוּא כּוֹלֵל כָּל הַשְּׁלֹשָׁה דּוֹרוֹת **alluding that the generation of Mashiach includes all three generations** שֶׁהָיָה בָּהֶן מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **in which there was eradication of Amalek:** שְׁנֵי דּוֹרוֹת **two generations** שֶׁהִתְגָּרָה הוּא בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל. **in which he provoked Yisrael,** וְדוֹר אֶחָד **and one generation** שֶׁהָיָה מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **in which it came from Hashem Yisbarach's side,** שֶׁצִּוּוּ לְהַחֲרִים זִכְרוֹ. **who commanded to destroy his memory.** וְהוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאָז **And this is because then** יַרְגִּישׁוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל טַעַם מְחוּדָּשׁ **Yisrael will sense a renewed taste** בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **in the Written Torah** וּבַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and in Torah she'b'al peh,** וְאָז יִהְיֶה מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק בְּכֶפֶל **and then the eradication of Amalek will be twofold:** מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל. **from the side of Yisrael** וְגַם מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **and also from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּמוֹ בִּשְׁלֹשָׁה דּוֹרוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל. **as in the three generations mentioned above.** וְעַל זֶה נִצְטַוּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **And regarding this Yisrael were commanded,** זָכוֹר וְגוֹמֵר **"Remember," etc.,** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **"You shall erase the memory of Amalek."** (תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא ד) וְאִיתָא **And it is found (Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 4):** אָמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל רִבּוֹנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **Yisrael said, "Master of the World,** אֵין אָנוּ יְכוֹלִים בּוֹ **we are not able to overcome him."** אָמַר לָהֶם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **HaKadosh Baruch Hu said to them,** תְּהִיוּ אַתֶּם מַזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַעְלָה וְכוּלֵי **"You mention his name below,** וַאֲנִי מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַעְלָה **and I will erase his name from Above," etc.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לֹא תִשְׁכָּח **And this is what is said, "Do not forget":** שֶׁעַל כָּל פָּנִים לֹא

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[942] **Megillah 14a** — "Rabbi Abba bar Kahana said: The removal of the signet was greater than the forty-eight prophets and seven prophetesses who prophesied to Israel. They did not return Israel to proper conduct, whereas removal of the signet returned them to proper conduct." The king's transfer of his signet to Haman made the decree effective. The Gemara identifies that moment of danger as the cause of repentance; Rav Tzadok sees the enemy's apparent success itself bringing Israel closer to God.

תִּשְׁכַּח **that at the very least you must not forget** מִלְּהִתְפַּלֵּל לַה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **to pray to Hashem Yisbarach** לִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **to erase the memory of Amalek,** וְאָז ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ מוֹחֶה שְׁמוֹ **and then Hashem Yisbarach erases his name** מִלְּמַעְלָה **from Above.** וְעַל זֶה בָּא קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **And for this purpose comes the reading of the parsha:** מַזְכִּירִין שֶׁיִּמְחֶה שְׁמוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק מִלְּמַעְלָה **that we mention his name** וּמְבַקְּשִׁים מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **and ask of Hashem Yisbarach** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נִזְכֶּה לִמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **that He erase the name of Amalek from Above; and through this we will merit the eradication of Amalek** בְּדוֹרוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ **in the generation of Mashiach** עַל יְדֵי ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **by Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁיַּחֲרִים זִכְרוֹ מִכֹּל וָכֹל **who will destroy his memory completely,** בִּמְהֵרָה בְיָמֵינוּ אָמֵן סֶלָה׃ **speedily in our days, amen selah.**

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר י״א Parshas Zachor — Maamar Yud Aleph

these brazen dogs" (the hymn Bnei Heichala). הָנֵי כַּלְבִּין דַּחֲצִיפִין [זַמָּר בְּנֵי הֵיכָלָא][943] **"Outside they wander and do not enter,** לְבַר נָטְלִין וְלָא עָאלִין

In the holy Zohar (vol. 2, Beshalach 64b): בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב בְּשַׁלַּח סד, ב) **"Fortunate are you who sow beside all waters,** אַשְׁרֵיכֶם זוֹרְעֵי עַל כָּל מָיִם **who send forth the foot of the ox and the donkey" — these are two crowns of the left side** מְשַׁלְּחֵי רֶגֶל הַשּׁוֹר וְהַחֲמוֹר אִינּוּן תְּרֵין כְּתָרִין שְׂמָאלָא דַּאֲחִידָן בְּהוּ עַמִּין עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת **to which the idolatrous nations hold fast, which are called ox and donkey;** דְּאִקְרוֹן שׁוֹר וַחֲמוֹר **and this is what is written (Bereishis 32:6):** [וְהַיְינוּ דִּכְתִיב [בְּרֵאשִׁית לב, ו] וַיְהִי לִי שׁוֹר

And when Yisrael are meritorious, they send them away, וּכְשֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל זַכָּאִין מְשַׁלְּחֵי לְהוּ **and they cannot rule over them;** וְלָא יְכִלֵי לְשַׁלְטָאָה עֲלַיְיהוּ **this is what is written, "who send forth...."** הָדָא הוּא דִּכְתִיב מְשַׁלְּחֵי וְגוֹמֵר **"I have ox and donkey," etc.** וַחֲמוֹר וְגוֹמֵר

And when they couple together, from between their sides וְכַד מִזְדַּוְּוגֵי כַּחֲדָא מִבֵּין סִטְרָא דִּלְהוֹן **there emerges from their strength** נָפִיק מִתְּקִיפוּתָא דִּלְהוֹן **that which is called "dog," etc.** דְּאִיקְרֵי כֶּלֶב וְכוּלֵי

For ox and donkey are the two kelipos of Esav and Yishmael, דִּשְׁוֹר וַחֲמוֹר הֵם הַשְּׁתֵּי קְלִיפוֹת דְּעֵשָׂו וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל **from which the seventy kelipos branched out,** שֶׁמֵּהֶם נִסְתַּעֲפוּ שִׁבְעִים הַקְּלִיפוֹת **thirty-five from the right and thirty-five from the left,** שְׁלוֹשִׁים וְחָמֵשׁ מִימִינָא וּשְׁלוֹשִׁים וְחָמֵשׁ מִשְּׂמָאלָא כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִ״י זְכוֹרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה. **as the Arizal wrote.**

The kelipah of Yishmael is lusts and evil cravings, וּקְלִיפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל הוּא הַתַּאֲוֹת וַחֲמָדוֹת רָעוֹת **and to this "donkey" alludes,** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז חֲמוֹר **for so it is written of the Egyptians, "whose flesh is the flesh of donkeys," etc.** אֲשֶׁר בְּשַׂר חֲמוֹרִים בְּשָׂרָם וְגוֹמֵר [יְחֶזְקֵאל כג, כ] שֶׁכֵּן כְּתִיב בְּמִצְרַיִים **(Yechezkel 23:20),** כִּי הָיוּ שְׁטוּפֵי זִימָּה **for they were steeped in lewdness.** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כב, ה] וְכֵן כְּתִיב **And so it is written (Bereishis 22:5),** שְׁבוּ לָכֶם פֹּה **"Stay here with the donkey,"** עִם הַחֲמוֹר **and they expounded (Yevamos 62a):** (יְבָמוֹת סב, א) וְדָרְשׁוּ **"with a people that resembles a donkey";** עִם הַדּוֹמֶה לַחֲמוֹר[944] וְהֵם הָיוּ אֱלִיעֶזֶר וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל[945] **and these were Eliezer and Yishmael (as stated in Vayikra Rabbah 26:7).** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה כו, ז)

And slaves are steeped in lewdness, as they said (Pesachim 113b) וַעֲבָדִים שְׁטוּפֵי זִימָּה (פְּסָחִים קיג, ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **that Canaan commanded his sons,** שֶׁצִּוָּה כְּנַעַן אֶת בָּנָיו[946] אֶהֱבוּ אֶת הַזִּימָּה **"Love lewdness";** וְיִשְׁמָעֵאל בֶּן שִׁפְחָה מִמִּצְרִים **and Yishmael was the son of a maidservant from Egypt, whom HaKadosh Baruch Hu called** שֶׁקְּרָאוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"the son of the handmaid" (Bereishis 21:13),** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כא, יג] בֶּן הָאָמָה וְעַל כֵּן

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[943] **Shemos Rabbah 5:18** — "'Let the labor become heavy upon the men'—this teaches that they possessed scrolls with which they delighted themselves from Shabbos to Shabbos, saying that the Holy One, blessed be He, would redeem them, for they rested on Shabbos. Pharaoh said: Let the work become heavy upon the men, so that they do it and do not turn to false words—let them not delight themselves and let them not rest on Shabbos." The Midrash explicitly connects Pharaoh's intensified labor with suppressing Shabbos rest and the sustaining scrolls of redemption. Rav Tzadok therefore reads 'he has done evil to this people' as an assault on their holiness as well as on their physical condition.

[944] **Pri Tzaddik, Va'eira §7** — "Although it was first written, 'The people believed,' that came through the power of Shabbos, which placed faith in their hearts. Shabbos is the aspect of complete faith, and through the scrolls with which they would delight from Shabbos to Shabbos, they knew that Hashem would redeem them. Once Pharaoh said, 'Let the work be heavy ... and let them not turn aside'—let them not delight and let them not rest on Shabbos—then, although Moshe Rabbeinu told them all the expressions of redemption, 'I shall take you out, save you, redeem you, and take you,' it did not enter Israel's hearts, because they lacked Shabbos and the scrolls that had brought complete faith into their hearts." The earlier maamar explains how abolishing their Shabbos rest undermined the people's receptivity to the promised redemption. Shemos §3, also cited here and checked in its original, describes the same loss of complete faith and compares the darkening immediately before rescue to the birth-pangs of Mashiach. These are the precise background teachings for the present interpretation of Pharaoh's harm.

[945] **Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaPurim, chapter 6** — "On this great day, when there is that great illumination, we wish life from this illumination to reach even that spark itself, but not to such a degree that it illumines the kelippah. Therefore a person becomes intoxicated on this day until he does not distinguish 'cursed is Haman' from 'blessed is Mordechai'; perhaps he will err and give a blessing to that spark within the kelippah, so that it too is blessed. But it must not be a blessing with complete intention, for then too much would reach it and the kelippah would also be blessed." The preceding paragraph states that every kelippah lives through a holy spark, and would immediately cease if that spark were removed. The distinction here is between sustaining the spark and sustaining the opposing shell; the maamar's subsequent account of Israel's power to overcome it depends on that distinction.

[946] **Sanhedrin 59a** — "Rabbi Yochanan said: A gentile who occupies himself with Torah is liable to death, as it is said: 'Moshe commanded us the Torah, an inheritance'—it is our inheritance, not theirs." The same discussion cites Rabbi Meir: a gentile who studies Torah is like a High Priest, and explains that statement as referring to the seven commandments incumbent upon them. The passage therefore distinguishes Israel's covenantal Torah inheritance from the study appropriate to the nations' own obligations; it does not exclude that study.

נִמְשַׁל לַחֲמוֹר. **and therefore he is likened to a donkey.** וְגַם כָּל בַּעַל תַּאֲוָה **Moreover, every man of lust** עוֹשֶׂה מַעֲשֶׂה שְׁטוּת **commits an act of folly;** (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה בָּלָק כ, יד) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Midrash Rabbah, Balak 20:14)** עַל אֲתוֹנוֹ שֶׁל בִּלְעָם **regarding Bilam's she-donkey** שֶׁשִּׁוּוּ[947] הַטִּפְּשׁוּת שֶׁבַּבְּהֵמָה וְכוּלֵי **that this is the most foolish of animals...;** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא עד, א) וְכֵן הַלָּשׁוֹן בַּגְּמָרָא **And so is the expression in the Gemara (Bava Basra 74a):** כָּל אַבָּא חַמְרָא **"Every Abba is a donkey,"** [ד״ה כָּל] וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשְׁבַּ״ם **and the Rashbam explained (s.v. Kol):** שׁוֹטֶה כַּחֲמוֹר.[948] **a fool like a donkey.** (נְדָרִים פא, א) וְכֵן אִיתָא **And so it is stated (Nedarim 81a)** שֶׁאֵין מְצוּיִין לָצֵאת **that it is not common for there to emerge** תַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים מִבְּנֵיהֶן **Torah scholars from their sons,** מִשּׁוּם דְּקָרוּ לֶאֱינָשֵׁי חַמְרֵי[949] **because they call people donkeys —** הַיְינוּ שֶׁמִּתְגָּאִים עַל לְהַחְשִׁיב הַכֹּל כְּטִפְּשִׁים. **that is, they are haughty toward the public in their wisdom, regarding everyone as fools.** וַחֲמוֹר הַטִּיפֵּשׁ שֶׁבַּבְּהֵמָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **And the donkey is the most foolish of animals, as mentioned above.** וְתַאֲוָה מַעֲשֶׂה שְׁטוּת **And lust is an act of folly,** (סַנְהֶדְרִין קו, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Sanhedrin 106a):** שִׁטִּים שֶׁנִּתְעַסְּקוּ בְּדִבְרֵי שְׁטוּת[950] **"Shittim — for they engaged in matters of folly";** וְכֵן אִיתָא (סוֹטָה ג, א) **and so it is stated (Sotah 3a):** אֵין אָדָם עוֹבֵר עֲבֵירָה **"A person does not commit a transgression** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּמִדְבַּר ה, יב] **as it says (Bamidbar 5:12),** אֶלָּא אִם כֵּן נִכְנַס בּוֹ רוּחַ שְׁטוּת[951] **unless a spirit of folly has entered him,** כִּי תִשְׂטֶה אִשְׁתּוֹ. **'If his wife goes astray.'"** כִּי אֵין שְׁטוּת גָּדוֹל מִזֶּה **For there is no folly greater than this,** כִּי הוּא דָּבָר מָאוּס **for it is a loathsome thing,** (שַׁבָּת קנב, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shabbos 152a):** אִשָּׁה חֲמַת מָלֵא צוֹאָה וְכוּלֵי[952] **"A woman is a skin-bag full of filth...";** וְשׁוֹטֶה זֶה מְאַבֵּד עוֹלָמוֹ **and this fool loses his world** בִּשְׁבִיל רֶגַע אֶחָד דְּתַאֲוָה מְנוּוָּל **for one moment of repulsive lust.** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא קְלִיפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל דְּתַאֲוָה **Therefore the kelipah of Yishmael, the kelipah of lust, is called** חֲמוֹר. **"donkey."** וּקְלִיפַּת עֵשָׂו הַקְּנָאָה וּרְצִיחָה **And the kelipah of Esav — envy and murder —** נִקְרָא שׁוֹר **is called "ox,"** (בְּרָכוֹת סא, א) עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **according to what they said (Berachos 61a)** דִּבְהֵמָה אִית בָּהּ יֵצֶר הָרָע **that an animal has an evil inclination,** דְּקָא חָזֵינַן דְּמַזְקָא **for we see that it does damage,** וְנָשְׁכָא וּבָעֲטָא **bites and kicks.** וּכְנֶגְדָּן אָמַר יַעֲקֹב **And corresponding to them Yaakov said,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית לב, ו] וַיְהִי לִי שׁוֹר וַחֲמוֹר **"I have ox and donkey" (Bereishis 32:6),** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה עה, יב) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Bereishis Rabbah 75:12):** שׁוֹר זֶה יוֹסֵף וְכוּלֵי **"'Ox' — this is**

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[947] **Sanhedrin 58b** — "Reish Lakish said: A gentile who establishes a cessation of labor is liable to death, as it is said: 'Day and night shall not cease.' ... Ravina said: Even on Monday." The Gemara is discussing the creation of a religious day of cessation, extending its statement even beyond the seventh day. Rav Tzadok cites it as a sign of Shabbos's particular covenantal relation to Israel, alongside Torah and circumcision.

[948] **Rashi, Megillah 13b, s.v. DeMafki LeShata** — "They spend the year with shehi and pehi—'Today is Shabbos,' 'Today is Pesach,' and we are forbidden to work." Rashi expands the Gemara's compressed expressions. The speech is Haman's hostile account of Israel's holy calendar, which Rav Tzadok interprets as an accusation against the sincerity of its festival service.

[949] **Megillah 5b** — "Rabbah, Rava's son, said: Even if you say that it was on Purim itself, they accepted upon themselves the prohibitions of eulogy and fasting, but did not accept a prohibition of labor." The discussion distinguishes Purim's festivity from the Torah festivals' prohibition of work. Rav Tzadok nevertheless sees its fixed date, rejoicing, and mitzvos as a revelation of the holiness of Israel's calendar.

[950] **Pesachim 117b** — "Shabbos is fixed and established; therefore, in both prayer and Kiddush, one says 'Who sanctifies Shabbos.' A festival, however, is fixed by Israel, for they intercalate the months and establish the years; therefore one says 'Who sanctifies Israel and the seasons.'" The source distinguishes the independently fixed seventh day from the calendar sanctity established through Israel. Rav Tzadok places Purim's dated observances on the latter side while treating the Divine sanctity of Shabbos as the third root.

[951] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10** — "Rabbi Pinchas said in Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman's name: It is a received aggadic tradition that Esav falls through Rachel's children, as it is said: 'Surely the youngest of the flock shall drag them away.' Why call them the youngest of the flock? Because they are the youngest of the tribes. Therefore Moshe said to Yehoshua, 'Choose men for us,' for he was of Yosef's tribe, concerning whom it is said, 'I fear God,' while concerning Esav it is written, 'He did not fear God.'" The continuation contrasts Yosef's restraint in forbidden relations and bloodshed with Esav's corruption in both. This provides the precise covenantal ground of the maamar's appeal to Rachel's sons.

[952] **Zohar I 153b, Vayeitzei** — "Rachel gave birth to two righteous ones. ... Yosef and Binyamin are two righteous ones. Yosef merited to be the righteous one above because he guarded the covenantal sign; Binyamin is the righteous one below, so that the Shemittah is crowned between two righteous ones, Yosef the righteous and Binyamin the righteous. Was Binyamin righteous? Yes: all his days he did not sin against this covenantal sign, although he did not encounter an ordeal like Yosef's." The Zohar explicitly grounds the status of both Rachel's sons in guarding the covenant. This is the specific contribution required by the maamar's explanation of why their descendants overcome Amalek.

Yosef, etc.; וַחֲמוֹר זֶה יִשָּׂשכָר וְכוּלֵי[953] **'donkey' — this is Yissachar...."** (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ה, ב) וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא **And it is stated in the Gemara (Avodah Zarah 5b):** בִּזְמַן שֶׁעוֹסְקִים בַּתּוֹרָה **"When they engage in Torah** וּבִגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים **and in acts of kindness,** יִצְרָם מָסוּר בְּיָדָם **their inclination is given over into their hands,** [יְשַׁעְיָה לב, כ] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Yeshayah 32:20),** אַשְׁרֵיכֶם זֹרְעֵי עַל כָּל מָיִם **'Fortunate are you who sow beside all waters';** וְאֵין זְרִיעָה אֶלָּא צְדָקָה וְכוּלֵי **and 'sowing' means nothing other than charity, etc.,** וְאֵין מַיִם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵי[954] **and 'water' means nothing other than Torah, etc."** (בָּבָא קַמָּא יז, א) וְאִיתָא **And it is stated (Bava Kamma 17a)** עַל פָּסוּק זֶה **on this verse,** מְשַׁלְּחֵי רֶגֶל הַשּׁוֹר וְהַחֲמוֹר **"who send forth the foot of the ox and the donkey":** כָּל זוֹכֶה לְבִנְחָלַת שְׁנֵי שְׁבָטִים וְכוּלֵי **"Whoever engages in Torah and acts of kindness** הָעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה וּבִגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים **merits the inheritance of two tribes, etc.:** אוֹיְבָיו נוֹפְלִים לְפָנָיו כְּיוֹסֵף וְכוּלֵי **his enemies fall before him, like Yosef, etc.,** וְזוֹכֶה לְבִינָה כְּיִשָּׂשכָר[955] **and he merits understanding, like Yissachar";** שָׁם. עַיֵּין **see there.** כִּי יוֹסֵף הַיְינוּ גְּמִילוּת חֲסָדִים וּצְדָקָה **For Yosef is kindness and charity** וְטוֹב לַבְּרִיּוֹת **and goodness to people,** הֵיפֶךְ קְלִיפַּת עֵשָׂו **the opposite of the kelipah of Esav,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סג, יג) **of whom they said (Bereishis Rabbah 63:13),** עַל פָּסוּק דָּם שָׂנֵאתָ [יְחֶזְקֵאל לה, ו] **on the verse "you hated blood" (Yechezkel 35:6):** שָׂנֵאתָ דָּמוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם בְּגוּפוֹ[956] **"You hated the blood of a man in his body";** וְהוּא רַע לַבְּרִיּוֹת. **and he is evil to people.** וּבְעֵשָׂו וַעֲמָלֵק כְּתִיב [דְּבָרִים כה, יח] **Regarding Esav and Amalek it is written (Devarim 25:18),** וְלֹא יָרֵא אֱלֹהִים **"and he did not fear G-d,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מב, יח] וּבְיוֹסֵף כְּתִיב **while regarding Yosef it is written (Bereishis 42:18),** אֶת הָאֱלֹהִים **"I fear G-d."** שֶׁאֵין זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא קכג, ב) וְעַל כֵּן אָמְרוּ **Therefore they said (Bava Basra 123b)** אֲנִי יָרֵא **that the offspring of Esav is delivered** נִמְסָר אֶלָּא בְּיַד זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף.[957] **only into the hand of the offspring of Yosef.** וְעֵשָׂו הוּא רוֹצֵחַ וְגוֹזֵל[958] **Esav is a murderer and a robber,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מז, יב] וּבְיוֹסֵף כְּתִיב **while regarding Yosef it is written (Bereishis 47:12),** וַיְכַלְכֵּל יוֹסֵף **"And Yosef sustained,"** וְנִקְרָא עַל שֵׁם זֶה כַּלְכֹּל **and on account of this he is called Kalkol** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרָשׁ חֻקַּת רַבָּה ט, א; תַּנְחוּמָא ו) **(as stated in Midrash Chukas Rabbah 9:1; Tanchuma 6),** שֶׁזָּן וְכִלְכֵּל הַבְּרִיּוֹת[959] **for he fed and sustained people.** וְהוּא בִּקְדוּשָׁה נָגֶד קְלִיפַּת עֵשָׂו

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[953] **Beitzah 20b** — "Abba Shaul expressed it another way: If, where your hearth is closed, your Master's hearth is open, then where your hearth is open, is it not right that your Master's hearth should be open? It is indeed fitting that your table should not be full while your Master's table is empty." The discussion concerns festival offerings: when the person may prepare festival food, offerings for the Divine altar should likewise be possible. Rav Tzadok uses the table image to relate the royal wine feasts to the remembered merit of the altar's offerings and libations.

[954] **Megillah 10b** — "Rabbi Yonasan opened his exposition from: 'I shall rise against them ... and cut off from Bavel name, remnant, offspring, and descendant, says Hashem.' 'Name' is its script; 'remnant' is its language; 'offspring' is its kingship; and 'descendant' is Vashti." The Gemara explicitly connects Vashti's removal with the ending of Bavel's dynasty. Rav Tzadok reads that beginning of Esther's story as the first concealed preparation for rebuilding the Temple that Bavel had destroyed.

[955] **Midrash Abba Guryon, chapter 1, on Esther 1:10** — "Rabbi Yudan and Rabbi Levi said in Rabbi Yochanan's name: Wherever the Megillah says 'King Ahasuerus,' the verse speaks of Ahasuerus. Wherever it says simply 'the king,' it speaks of the King of kings. 'When the king's heart was merry with wine'—when the Holy One's heart was merry with the wine of Torah." The precise original passage, in Buber's Sifrei DeAggadeta edition, includes 'the wine of Torah.' Rav Tzadok develops the sacred wine image here through the merit of Temple offerings and libations; that development should be distinguished from the Midrash's own wording.

[956] **Megillah 12b** — "The ministering angels said before the Holy One, blessed be He: Master of the universe, did they ever offer You year-old lambs as Israel offered You? Did they offer You two turtledoves? Did they build You an earthen altar? Did they serve before You in priestly garments containing 'beryl, onyx, and jasper'? Did they stir the blood before You, or mix meal-offerings before You? Did they prepare a table before You?" Rabbi Levi introduces this interpretation by saying that the entire verse naming the seven advisers is expounded through offerings. The angels' appeal to Israel's service is the explicit textual basis for the maamar's claim that sacrificial merit awakens the concealed rescue.

[957] **Megillah 11b** — "After the reckoning of seventy years, he said: Now they will certainly no longer be redeemed. He brought out the Temple vessels and used them." The discussion first identifies Belshazzar's mistaken reckoning and then Ahasuerus's different but likewise mistaken reckoning. At 11b:12 the latter similarly brings out the vessels; the Satan then dances among them, and Vashti is killed. Rav Tzadok's claim that Israel's merit could have made an earlier time effective is his interpretation of the potential hidden within that period.

[958] **Sanhedrin 98a** — "Rabbi Alexandri said: Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi posed a contradiction: It is written, 'in its time,' and it is written, 'I shall hasten it.' If they merit, 'I shall hasten it'; if they do not merit, 'in its time.'" Both expressions are in Isaiah 60:22. The distinction permits Rav Tzadok's account of a possible earlier redemption while preserving an appointed ultimate time.

[959] **Megillah 15b** — "'What is your request? Up to half the kingdom, and it shall be done'—half the kingdom, not the whole kingdom, and not something that creates a division in the kingdom. What was that? The rebuilding of the

He, in holiness, stands against the kelipah of Esav, וְנִקְרָא גַּם כֵּן שׁוֹר **and he too is called "ox,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא. **as they said in the Gemara.** וְיִשָּׂשכָר בִּקְדוּשָּׁה נֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל **And Yissachar, in holiness, stands against the kelipah of Yishmael,** שֶׁיִּשְׁמָעֵאל עוֹשֶׂה מַעֲשֵׂה שְׁטוּת כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **for Yishmael commits acts of folly, as mentioned above.** [דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א יב, לג] וּבְיִשָּׂשכָר כְּתִיב **Regarding Yissachar it is written (I Divrei HaYamim 12:33),** יוֹדְעֵי בִינָה וְגוֹמֵר **"men who had understanding," etc.,** (יוֹמָא כו, א) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Yoma 26a):** לָא מַשְׂכַּחְתְּ צוּרְבָא מֵרַבָּנַן דְּמוֹרֵי אֶלָּא דְּאָתֵי **"You will not find a young scholar who issues rulings** וְזֶהוּ הָעֵסֶק בַּתּוֹרָה **unless he comes, etc., from the tribe of Yissachar."**[960] **And this is engagement in Torah,** שֶׁזֶּה חֵלֶק יִשָּׂשכָר **for this is the portion of Yissachar,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה צט, ט) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 99:9):** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מט, יד] יִשָּׂשכָר חֲמוֹר גָּרֶם **"'Yissachar is a strong-boned donkey' (Bereishis 49:14):** כָּךְ יִשָּׂשכָר טוֹעֵן אֶת הַתּוֹרָה **so Yissachar carries the Torah";** (וּבְמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא וַיְחִי יא) **(and in Midrash Tanchuma, Vayechi 11):** וַיֵּט שִׁכְמוֹ לְסְבֹל **"He bent his shoulder to bear"** — עֻלָּהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה[961] **the yoke of Torah.** וְהוּא הֵיפֶךְ הַחֲמוֹר דְּקִלִיפָּה. **This is the opposite of the donkey of the kelipah.** שֶׁהוּא כַּחֲמוֹר לְמַשָּׂאוֹי **For he is like a donkey for the load,** וְהַמַּשָּׂא מְבַטֵּל רְצוֹן הַתַּאֲוָה **and the burden nullifies the desire of lust;** (סוּכָּה נב, ב) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Sukkah 52b):** אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנוּוָּל זֶה **"If this repulsive one encounters you,** מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ **drag him to the beis midrash"** — הַיְנוּ יֵצֶר הָרָע דְּתַאֲוָה **that is, the evil inclination of lust,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא מְנוּוָּל כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **which is called "repulsive," as mentioned above;** מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ **"drag him to the beis midrash,"** לְהְיוֹת חָשֵׁק וַחֲמִידוּ לְאוֹרַיְיתָא **so that it becomes desire and longing for Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד **as it will remain in the future** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א קלח, א בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם) **(as stated in Zohar vol. 1, 138a, in the Midrash HaNe'lam).** וְהָעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה וּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים **And those who engage in Torah and acts of kindness** — יִצְרָם מָסוּר בְּיָדָם **their inclination is given over into their hands,** שְׁנֵי הַיְצָרִים כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל.[962] **both inclinations, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה שָׁם) **And this is what they said (Avodah Zarah, ibid.),** בָּתַר הָךְ דְּמְשַׁלְּחֵי רַגְלָ הַשּׁוֹר וְהַחֲמוֹר **right after that teaching of "who send forth the foot of the ox and the donkey":** תָּנָא דְּבֵי אֵלִיָּהוּ **The school of Eliyahu taught:** עַל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה כְּשׁוֹר לְעוֹל וְכַחֲמוֹר לְמַשָּׂאוֹי[963] לְעוֹלָם יָשִׂים אָדָם עַצְמוֹ **"A person should always place himself upon words of Torah like an ox to the yoke and like a donkey to the load"** — הַיְנוּ לְהַכְנִיס שְׁנֵי הַכֹּחוֹת אֵלּוּ לִקְדוּשָּׁה **that is, to bring these two forces into holiness.** וּלְמַשָּׂאוֹי הַיְנוּ **"To the load" means** הַיְגִיעָה בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **toil in words of Torah;** וּכְשׁוֹר לְעוֹל **and "like an ox to the yoke,"** כִּי הָעוֹל נִיתָּן עַל הַשּׁוֹר **for the yoke is placed on the ox** לָכוֹף רֹאשׁוֹ **to bend its head,** שֶׁלֹּא יוּכַל לִנְגּוֹחַ בְּרֹאשׁוֹ. **so that it cannot gore with its head.** וְאָמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And the holy Zohar says** דְּכַד מִזְדַּוְּגֵי כַּחֲדָא **that when they couple together,** נָפִיק מִתְּקִיפוּתָא דִּלְהוֹן **there emerges from their strength** דְּאִיקְרֵי כֶּלֶב וְכוּבְּיָ **that which is called "dog," etc.:** הֲרֵי אֲנִי מוֹסֵר אֶתְכֶם לַכֶּלֶב **"Behold, I deliver you to the dog"** — מִיָּד וַיָּבוֹא עֲמָלֵק **immediately, "And Amalek came."** וְכָתַב רַבִּי חַיִּים וִיטַאל **And Rabbi Chaim Vital wrote** [הַגָּהוֹת עַל הַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ שָׁם אוֹת א] **(Haggahos on the holy**

Temple." The Gemara makes the Temple the excluded request. Rav Tzadok therefore distinguishes the concealed preparation achieved through Esther from an immediate, openly authorized rebuilding.

[960] **Megillah 15a** — "'I shall come to the king, not according to the law'—Rabbi Abba said: It was not according to the established rule, for until now each day was under compulsion, but now it was voluntary. 'As I am lost, I am lost'—just as I was lost to my father's house, so I shall be lost to you." The source distinguishes Esther's compelled position from the voluntary approach undertaken to rescue Israel. The maamar places that act within its account of hidden preparation for the Temple's future restoration.

[961] **Vayikra Rabbah 13:5; Ezra 6:14–15** — "Rabbi Yehudah bar Simon said: The last Darius was Esther's son, pure from his mother and impure from his father." This is the Midrashic genealogy used by the maamar. Ezra 6:14–15 separately records the Temple's building under the Persian royal decrees and its completion on the third of Adar in Darius's sixth regnal year. Both originals were retrieved; the genealogy is presented as the Midrash's tradition.

[962] **Rema MiPano, Asarah Maamaros, Im Kol Chai I:7** — "When Artaxerxes said to Nechemyah, 'Why is your face sad?' it is written, 'I prayed to the God of heaven.' Is it possible that between the king's question and Nechemyah's answer there was time to pray, even a short prayer? What, then, was his prayer? The very words he was saying before the king, with his heart directed to Heaven. And so too with Esther. This plainly teaches the people of Yehudah to take counsel within ourselves so that Hashem is always before us, and our words flow before Him in appeasement, request, and all our needs." The original expressly includes Esther as well as Nechemyah. Rav Tzadok is therefore applying the Rema MiPano's own stated example, interpreting the court's spoken requests as inward prayer at the same moment.

[963] **Esther 8:15** — "Mordechai went out from the king's presence in royal clothing of blue and white, with a great golden crown and a wrap of fine linen and purple; and the city of Shushan shouted and rejoiced."

Zohar, ibid., os 1) דִּפְנִימִיּוּת דְּשׁוֹר וַחֲמוֹר **that the inner letters of shor and chamor —** ו׳ דְּשׁוֹר מ״ו דַּחֲמוֹר **the vav of shor and the mem-vav of chamor — equal in gematria the word kelev, dog.** גִּימַטְרִיָּא כֶּלֶב. וְזֶהוּ קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **And this is the kelipah of Amalek,** וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד קְדוּשַׁת עַתִּיקָא שֶׁנּוֹבֵחַ בְּלֹא טַעַם **which barks without reason; it stands against the holiness of Atika:** שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מֵהַשָּׂגַת שִׂכְלָ אֱנוֹשִׁי **just as that is above the grasp of human intellect,** כְּמוֹ שָׁם אַחַר קְרִיעַת יַם **so the kelipah of Amalek is against reason,** כָּךְ קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק נֶגֶד הַשֵּׂכֶל **as there, after the splitting of the Sea,** שָׁמְעוּ עַמִּים יִרְגָּזוּן [שְׁמוֹת טו, יד] דִּכְתִיב **where it is written (Shemos 15:14), "Nations heard and trembled,"** וְלֹא קָמָה עוֹד רוּחַ בְּאִישׁ **and "no spirit remained any longer in any man,"** [יְהוֹשֻׁעַ ב, יא] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרָה רָחָב **as Rachav said (Yehoshua 2:11) —** וְהוּא לֹא חָשׂ לָזֶה.[964] **yet he paid no heed to this.** וְאָמְנָם בְּשַׁבָּת יֵשׁ הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **Now on Shabbos there is a revelation of Atika.** וּבְיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת הַהִתְגַּלּוּת עוֹד בָּהֶעְלֵם **On the day of Shabbos the revelation is still concealed,** וּבִסְעוּדָה שְׁלִישִׁית **but at the third meal,** שֶׁמִּתְגַּלֶּה מִצָּחָא דְּעַתִּיקָא **when the Forehead of Atika is revealed** [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֵלֶק ג קכט, א] **(holy Zohar vol. 3, 129a),** הַיְינוּ הָאוֹר פָּנִים **when the aspect of Atika comes into revelation —** שֶׁבָּאָה בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא אֶל הַגִּילּוּי **that is, the light of the Countenance —** כִּי אָז נִתְבַּטֵּל קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **then the kelipah of Amalek is nullified,** וְאָז נִתְבָּרֵר שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקְּדוּשָׁה **for it becomes clear that Yisrael are bound to the root of holiness.** וְאָז לְבַר נָטְלִין וְלָא עָאלִין **And then "Outside they wander and do not enter,** הָנֵי כַּלְבִּין דַּחֲצִיפִין **these brazen dogs":** שֶׁמִּתְבַּטֵּל קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **the kelipah of Amalek is nullified,** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכִין שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **for Yisrael merit to be bound to the root** וּבְאוֹר פְּנֵי מֶלֶךְ חַיִּים: **and to "the light of the King's Countenance, which is life."**

And the holy Zohar says (there): וְאָמַר בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם) **"which is called 'dog,'** דְּאִיקְרֵי כֶּלֶב **and this is the most brazen of all."** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁמִּזֶּה **One may say that it alludes** דַּעֲמָלֵק שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **to Amalek being the root of the evil inclination,** וְזֶהוּ הַחוּצְפָּה שֶׁלּוֹ **and this is his brazenness:** שֶׁמִּתְגָּרֶה בְּתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **that he provokes Torah scholars** וְיָכוֹל לִכְנוֹס אַף לְנֶפֶשׁ קְדוֹשׁ **and can enter even a holy soul,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהֵעִיז לְרַבִּי מֵאִיר וּלְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **just as he dared to test and entice Rabbi Meir and Rabbi Akiva** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א) **(as explained in Maamar 1);** וְהוּא רֵאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה **and he is the beginning of the kelipah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בַּמִּדְבָּר כד, כ] רֵאשִׁית גּוֹיִם עֲמָלֵק. **as it says (Bamidbar 24:20), "Amalek is the first of the nations."** וְנִקְרָא הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **The evil inclination is called** מֶלֶךְ זָקֵן וּכְסִיל[965] **"an old and foolish king"** [קֹהֶלֶת ד, יג וּבְרַשׁ״י שָׁם] **(Koheles 4:13 and Rashi there);** וּכְמוֹ בִּקְדוּשָׁה **and just as in holiness** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **Keser Elyon is the Crown of Kingship** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּיקוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפָתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pesach Eliyahu),** כֵּן זֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה בִּקְלִיפָּה **so correspondingly, in the kelipah,** עֲמָלֵק הָרִאשִׁית נִקְרָא מֶלֶךְ.[966] **Amalek, "the first," is called king.** וְנִקְרָא זָקֵן בְּזֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה **And he is called "old," correspondingly,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּקְרָא אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **just as Avraham Avinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם זָקֵן בָּא בַּיָּמִים **peace be upon him, is called "old" in holiness,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כד, א] **as it says (Bereishis 24:1),** וְאַבְרָהָם זָקֵן בָּא בַּיָּמִים **"And Avraham was old, advanced in days" —** בְּיוֹמִין עִלָּאִין [זֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ חֵלֶק א קכט, א] **in the supernal days (holy Zohar vol. 1, 129a) —** וְזָכָה שֶׁנִּקְרָא זָקֵן **and he merited to be called "old"** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ב) **(as explained in Maamar 2).** כֵּן עֲמָלֵק נִקְרָא מֶלֶךְ זָקֵן וּכְסִיל **So Amalek is called "an old and foolish king** אֲשֶׁר לֹא יָדַע לְהִזָּהֵר עוֹד **who no longer knows how to take heed,"** שֶׁנִּכְנָס בְּחוּצְפָּה לִגְדוֹלֵי עוֹלָם **for he brazenly enters upon the greatest of the world,** אַף שֶׁהִכְרִיזוּ **even though they proclaimed,** הִזָּהֲרוּ בְּרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וְתוֹרָתוֹ **"Beware of Rabbi Meir and his Torah;** הִזָּהֲרוּ בְּרַבִּי מֵאִיר וְתוֹרָתוֹ **beware of Rabbi Akiva and his Torah"** (כָּאָמוּר (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב קִידּוּשִׁין פא, א. **(as stated in Kiddushin 81a), as was said.** [שְׁמוּאֵל א טו, ב] וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what is said (I Shmuel 15:2):** אֲשֶׁר שָׂם לוֹ בַּדָּרֶךְ **"how he set**

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[964] **Pri Etz Chaim, Gate of Rosh Chodesh, Chanukah and Purim, chapter 6** — "Esther has the numerical value of shoshanah. Esther also equals 671 less ten. This is the mystery of the inward point itself that is concealed, the mystery of the yod of Adonai; for Adonai, when spelled out in full, has the numerical value 671." Both names have the numerical value 661. The identification of the rose with the congregation of Israel is developed in the opening of the Zohar, quoted next.

[965] **Zohar I, 1a (Introduction)** — "Rabbi Chizkiyah opened: 'Like a rose among thorns.' What is the rose? The congregation of Israel. Just as a rose among thorns has red and white, so the congregation of Israel has judgment and mercy. Just as a rose has thirteen petals, so the congregation of Israel has thirteen attributes of mercy surrounding it on every side. So, from the first mention of God, He brought forth thirteen words to surround and guard the congregation of Israel."

[966] **Bereshit Rabbah 2:4** — "'And the spirit of God hovered'—this is the spirit of the King Messiah, as it says, 'The spirit of the Lord shall rest upon him.' Through what merit does it approach and come? Through repentance, which is compared to water: 'Pour out your heart like water.'"

upon him on the way בַּעֲלֹתוֹ מִמִּצְרַיִם **when he came up from Egypt" —** בַּדֶּרֶךְ הַיְדוּעַ **"On the way" — the known way** שֶׁהָלְכוּ לְקַבֵּל תּוֹרָה **on which they went to receive the Torah;** וְזֶהוּ בַּעֲלוֹתוֹ מִמִּצְרַיִם **and this is "when he came up from Egypt":** דְּלַבַּד שֶׁיָּצְאוּ מֵהַקְלִיפּוֹת **for besides having left the kelipos** בִּיצִיאַת מִצְרַיִם **at the Exodus from Egypt,** שֶׁיָּצְאוּ מִכָּל עֶשֶׂר כִּתְרִין דְּמָסְאֲבוּתָא **leaving all ten crowns of impurity —** לְבַד זֶה הָיוּ עוֹלִין מַעְלָה מַעְלָה **besides this, they were ascending higher and higher;** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם נִזְדַּוֵּג לָהֶם **and nevertheless he attached himself to them,** אַף שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי הִכְרִיזוּ בָּרָקִיעַ **even though they surely proclaimed in heaven,** הִזָּהֲרוּ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל וְתוֹרָתָן **"Beware of Yisrael and their Torah";** אַךְ הוּא לֹא יָדַע לְהִנָּהֵר **but he did not know how to take heed,** וְזֶהוּ חֻצְפָּתוֹ שֶׁלּוֹ. **and this is his brazenness.** **Now in the Pesikta** (לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן יג) **(on Parshas Zachor, section 12, siman 13),** וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (כִּי תֵצֵא י) **in Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei 10),** וּמִדְרַשׁ רַבָּה (בְּשַׁלַּח כו, ג) **and in Midrash Rabbah (Beshalach 26:3)** דָּרְשׁוּ[967] וְלֹא יָרֵא אֱלֹהִים עַל עֲמָלֵק **they expounded "and he did not fear G-d" as referring to Amalek.** וְלִכְאוֹרָה מַה זֶּה רִבּוּתָא עַל עֲמָלֵק **Seemingly, what novelty is this regarding Amalek,** דְּלֹא יָרֵא אֱלֹהִים. **that he did not fear G-d?** רַק בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הַיִּרְאָה מֻהֶשֶּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **But in Yisrael the fear of Hashem Yisbarach is** בְּגִין דְּאִיהוּ רַב וְשַׁלִּיט **"because He is great and ruling,"** וּבְאוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם יֵשׁ יִרְאַת הָעוֹנֶשׁ **and among the nations of the world there is fear of punishment** עַל כָּל פָּנִים **at least;** וּבִקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **and at the splitting of the Sea,** שָׁמְעוּ עַמִּים יִרְגָּזוּן [שְׁמוֹת טו, יד] דִּכְתִיב **where it is written (Shemos 15:14), "Nations heard and trembled,** חִיל אָחַז וְגוֹמֵר **terror seized...,"** עַל כָּל פָּנִים יִרְאַת הָעוֹנֶשׁ **there was at least fear of punishment.** **But Amalek "did not fear G-d,"** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה וַעֲמָלֵק לֹא יָרֵא אֱלֹהִים **for he did not have even fear of punishment;** וְזֶהוּ חֻצְפָּתוֹ שֶׁלּוֹ וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and this is his brazenness, as mentioned above.** **Now the holiness of the three Avos** נֶגֶד שָׁלֹשׁ אִבָּרָהָם נֶגֶד קִלִּיפַּת עֵשָׂו **stands against three kelipos —** דְּקִנְאָה וְתַאֲוָה וְכָבוֹד **of envy, lust and honor.** **Avraham stands against the kelipah of Esav,** שֶׁהוּא הַקִּנְאָה וְשִׂנְאַת הַבְּרִיּוֹת **which is envy and hatred of people;** כְּנֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל הַתַּאֲוָה וְיִצְחָק אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and Yitzchak Avinu, peace be upon him, against the kelipah of Yishmael, lust** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(as explained many times);** וּקְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק הוּא הַגַּאֲוָה וְהַכָּבוֹד **and the kelipah of Amalek is arrogance and honor,** (בְּמִדְבָּר רַבָּה יג, ג) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ **as expounded (Bamidbar Rabbah 13:3):** [מִשְׁלֵי כט, כג] גַּאֲוַת אָדָם תַּשְׁפִּילֶנּוּ **"A man's pride will bring him low" (Mishlei 29:23) —** זֶה עֲמָלֵק שֶׁנִּתְגָּאָה עַל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּלֵי **this is Amalek, who exalted himself against HaKadosh Baruch Hu, etc.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַגַּאֲוָה **And through arrogance** בָּא לִידֵי חוּצְפָּה יְתֵירָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **he comes to excessive brazenness, as mentioned above.** **Opposite him in holiness is Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** וּלְעוּמָּתוֹ בִּקְדוּשָּׁה יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **who said, "From where will my help come?"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סח, ב) **(as stated in Bereishis Rabbah 68:2).** שֶׁאָמַר מֵאַיִן יָבֹא עֶזְרִי[968] **Amalek stood brazenly against Hashem Yisbarach,** וַעֲמָלֵק עָמַד בְּחוּצְפָּה נֶגֶד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **for he did not believe at all** שֶׁלֹּא הֶאֱמִין כְּלָל **that Hashem Yisbarach fights the war of Yisrael;** שֶׁהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ נִלְחָם מִלְחֶמֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **whereas Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him, said,** וְיַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אָמַר **"The G-d who has shepherded me all my life," etc.** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מח, טו] הָאֱלֹהִים הָרוֹעֶה אוֹתִי מֵעוֹדִי וְגוֹמֵר **(Bereishis 48:15),** שֶׁלֹּא הִכִּיר כְּלָל **for he did not perceive at all** שֶׁעוֹשֶׂה מַה בְּהִשְׁתַּדְּלוּתוֹ **that he accomplished anything by his own effort,** רַק אָמַר שֶׁהַכֹּל מֻהֶשֶּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **but said that everything is from Hashem Yisbarach.** **And it says (Amos 7:2), "How will Yaakov stand,** כִּי קָטֹן הוּא. **for he is small?"** [עָמוֹס ז, ב] מִי יָקוּם יַעֲקֹב וְנֶאֱמַר **Therefore at the third meal,** וְעַל כֵּן בִּסְעוּדָה שְׁלִישִׁית **which corresponds to Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם[969] **as the Arizal wrote** [פְּרִי עֵץ חַיִּים שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת פֶּרֶק יז] כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִי״ז זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **(Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos, chapter 17) —** וְשַׁבָּת ש׳ רָזָא דְּתִלַּת אֲבָהָן **and "Shabbos: the shin is the secret of the three Avos,** וּבַת מְתַעְטְרָא בְּהוּ **and the bas is crowned with them"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב רד, א) **(as stated in Zohar II 204a),** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לִקְדוּשַׁת הָאָבוֹת **for we merit the holiness of the Avos** בִּשְׁלֹשׁ הַסְּעוּדוֹת **in the three meals —** וּכְשֶׁזּוֹכִין בִּסְעוּדָה שְׁלִישִׁית **when at the third meal we merit**

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[967] **Zohar I, 1a (Introduction)** — "Afterward it is mentioned a second time. Why a second time? To bring forth five strong leaves that surround the rose. These five are called salvations; they are five gates. Of this mystery it is written, 'I shall raise the cup of salvations.' This is the cup of blessing. The cup of blessing must rest upon five fingers and no more, just as the rose rests upon five strong leaves, the image of five fingers."

[968] **Megillah 12b** — "Who are 'the wise men'? The Rabbis, 'who know the times'—who know how to intercalate years and establish months."

[969] **Megillah 15a** — "'Esther called Hatach.' Rav said: Hatach is Daniel. Why was he called Hatach? Because he had been cut down from his greatness. Shmuel said: Because all affairs of the kingdom were decided by his word."

לִקְדוּשַׁת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **the holiness of Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא הַשִּׁפְלוּת וְהָעֲנָוָה **which is lowliness and humility** וְהַהַכָּרָה שֶׁהַכֹּל מֵהַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ[970] **and the recognition that everything is from Hashem Yisbarach,** אוֹמְרִים לְבַר נָטְלִין וְלָא עָאלִין **we say, "Outside they wander and do not enter,** הָנֵי כַּלְבִין דַּחֲצִיפִין **these brazen dogs,"** שֶׁמִּתְבַּטֵּל קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **for the kelipah of Amalek is nullified,** שֶׁהוּא חֲצִיפָא מִכֻּלְּהוּ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: **which is "the most brazen of all," as mentioned above.**

[970] **Megillah 16b** — "Rabbi Binyamin bar Yefet said: He gave him a hint that a descendant would issue from him who would go out from the king's presence in five royal garments, as it says, 'Mordechai went out in royal clothing of blue....'"

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר י״ב Parshas Zachor — Maamar Yud Bais

In Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei 11): בְּתַנְחוּמָא (כִּי תֵצֵא יא) **"As long as the offspring of Amalek exists,** כָּל זְמַן שֶׁזִּרְעוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק קַיָּים **it is as though a wing covers the Face;** אֲבַד זִרְעוֹ מִן הָעוֹלָם **once his offspring is lost from the world,** כְּאִלּוּ כָּנָף מְכַסֶּה אֶת הַפָּנִים **your Teacher shall no longer be hidden,** לֹא יִכָּנֵף עוֹד מוֹרֶיךָ[971] וְהָיָה עֵינֶיךָ רוֹאוֹת אֶת מוֹרֶיךָ **and your eyes shall see your Teacher'"** [יְשַׁעְיָה ל, כ]. **(Yeshayah 30:20).** הָעִנְיָן דְּכֹחַ זֶה **The matter is that this power,** הוּא עַל יְדֵי טַל תּוֹרָה **that no wing should cover the Face,** שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה כָּנָף מְכַסֶּה אֶת הַפָּנִים **which derives from the Dew of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא מִטַּל דְּעַתִּיקָא **comes through the dew of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **which derives from the Dew of Atika,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as we have said many times** [דְּבָרִים לב, ב] עַל פָּסוּק תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי **on the verse "My word shall flow like dew" (Devarim 32:2),** הַמְרַמֵּז עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **which alludes to Torah she'b'al peh.** **Therefore they said** (מִדְרָשׁ חֻקַּת רַבָּה יט, ו; תַּנְחוּמָא ח) וְלָכֵן אָמְרוּ **(Midrash Chukas Rabbah 19:6; Tanchuma 8):** [אִיּוֹב כח, י] כָּל יְקָר רָאָתָה עֵינוֹ **"'His eye beheld every precious thing' (Iyov 28:10) —** זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **this is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues;** דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא נִגְלוּ לְמֹשֶׁה **things that were not revealed to Moshe** נִגְלוּ לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues"** — מִפְּנֵי שֶׁרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא הָיָה **because Rabbi Akiva was** שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the root of Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֲרִ״י זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **as the Arizal wrote** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) **(and as explained many times).** וְזֶהוּ עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (מְנָחוֹת כט, ב) **And this is the meaning of what they said (Menachos 29b):** שֶׁכְּשֶׁרָאָה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that when Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, saw** שֶׁשּׁוֹקְלִין בְּשָׂרוֹ בְּמַקּוּלִין **that they were weighing his flesh in the meat market,** אָמַר רִבּוֹנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **he said, "Master of the World,** זוֹ תּוֹרָה וְזוֹ שְׂכָרָהּ **this is Torah and this its reward?!"** אָמַר לוֹ שְׁתוֹק **He said to him, "Be silent;** כָּךְ עָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לְפָנַי[972] **so it arose in thought before Me."** הַיְינוּ שֶׁדַּיְיקָא עַל יְדֵי כָּךְ **That is, precisely through this** יִתְעַלֶּה עַד הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ עַתִּיקָא **he would ascend to the root, Atika,** שֶׁהוּא לְמַעְלָה מִבְּחִינַת מַחֲשָׁבָה[973] **which is above the level of thought;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לְפָנַי דַּיְיקָא **and this is why they said specifically "in thought before Me,"** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל עַתִּיקָא[974] **which indicates Atika** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר וַיְחִי מַאֲמָר י). **(as explained in Vayechi, Maamar 10).** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז רֹאשׁ הַפָּסוּק [יְשַׁעְיָה שָׁם] **And to this alludes the beginning of the verse (Yeshayah, ibid.):** וְנָתַן לָכֶם אֲדֹנָי **"The Lord will give you** לֶחֶם צָר וּמַיִם לַחַץ **bread of distress and water of oppression"** — הַיְינוּ בְּהַשָּׂגַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, in the attainment of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי צַעַר וְיגִיעָה **which comes through suffering, toil** וּמִיעוּט תַּעֲנוּג **and minimal pleasure** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּנְחוּמָא פָּרָשַׁת נֹחַ ג) **(as stated in Tanchuma, Parshas Noach 3);** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה וְלֹא יִכָּנֵף עוֹד מוֹרֶיךָ וְגוֹמֵר **and through this, "your Teacher shall no longer be hidden...":** שֶׁתִּזְכֶּה לְבְחִינַת טַלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא **you will merit the level of the Dew of Atika,** שֶׁהוּא אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **which is the light of Torah she'b'al peh.** **And they said (Berachos 61b):** וְאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת סא, ב) זְמַן קְרִיאַת שְׁמַע הָיָה וְכוּלֵי **"It was the time for reciting Shema, etc.;** אָמְרוּ לוֹ תַּלְמִידָיו רַבֵּינוּ עַד כָּאן **his students said to him, 'Our master, this far?'** אָמַר לָהֶם כָּל יָמַי וְכוּלֵי **He said to them, 'All my days,' etc.,** עַד שֶׁיְּצָאָה נִשְׁמָתוֹ בְּאֶחָד[975] **until his soul departed with 'Echad,'**

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[971] **Peri Tzadik, Vayigash 7:1** — "Blue signifies awe.... White is expounded from chivvar, as they said: white wool. This alludes to love: the aspect of Jacob and Joseph—Joseph, who said, 'I fear God,' and Jacob, mercy.... Blue and white are judgment and mercy.... The two crowns correspond to Wisdom and Understanding: the crown corresponds to Wisdom, and the wrap to Understanding.... Through the union of Wisdom and Understanding, brain and heart—when the wisdom in the brain enters Understanding in the heart—one attains Knowledge, which is the inward aspect of the Crown.... These are the crowns Israel attained at the giving of the Torah."

[972] **Esther 9:12-13** — "The king said to Queen Esther: 'In Shushan the capital the Jews have killed and destroyed five hundred men and Haman's ten sons.... What further request have you? It shall be done.' Esther said: 'If it is good to the king, let it be granted tomorrow also to the Jews in Shushan to act according to today's law, and let Haman's ten sons be hung upon the tree.'"

[973] **Megillah 11a** — "Resh Lakish opened his exposition of this scroll from here: 'A roaring lion and a ravenous bear—a wicked ruler over a poor people.' 'A roaring lion' is Nebuchadnezzar.... 'A ravenous bear' is Ahasuerus.... 'A wicked ruler' is Haman. 'Over a poor people'—these are Israel, who were poor in commandments."

[974] **Megillah 11a** — "Rabbi Elazar opened his exposition from here: 'Through laziness the ceiling sags.' Because of Israel's laziness in not engaging in Torah, the Holy One's enemy became impoverished. 'Impoverished' means poor, as it says, 'If he is too poor for the valuation.' 'Ceiling' refers only to the Holy One, blessed be He, as it says, 'Who roofs His upper chambers with water.'" The expression "the Holy One's enemy" is the Talmud's reverential euphemism. Rav Tzadok later develops the image of Torah as a roof blocking accusation.

[975] **Rashi on Avodah Zarah 5b** — "'Who send away the foot'—they cast away the evil inclination, which is called a traveler, as it is written, 'A traveler came to the wealthy man.'"

etc." וְהוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁ בְּנַפְשׁוֹ **This was because he sensed in his soul** שֶׁדַּיְקָא עַל יְדֵי כֵן **that precisely through this** יִתְעַלֶּה נִשְׁמָתוֹ בְּתַכְלִית הַיִּחוּד **his soul would ascend to the ultimate unity,** עִם הִתְקַשְּׁרוּת דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **with attachment to the holy Atika,** בְּחִינַת מַחֲשָׁבָה לְפָנַי כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **the level of "in thought before Me," as mentioned above.** וְכַיָּדוּעַ שֶׁהָיָה מֵעֲשָׂרָה הֲרוּגֵי מַלְכוּת **And as is known, he was one of the Ten Martyrs,** שָׂרוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק לְהַשְׁקִיט קְטֶרוּג שֶׁל הַסָּמֶ"ךְ מֵ"ם **who served to silence the accusation of the Samech-Mem, the angelic prince of Amalek,** הַמְקַטְרֵג עַל קְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית **who accuses regarding the holiness of the covenant:** טוֹל מַה שֶּׁבָּחַרְתָּ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל [מַאֲמָר ח] **"Take what You have chosen," as mentioned above (Maamar 8).** וְעַל כֵּן אֵינוֹ נוֹפֵל עֲמָלֵק **Therefore Amalek falls** אֶלָּא בְּיַד זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף **only into the hand of the offspring of Yosef,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁאֵין עָלָיו טַעֲנָה בְּעִנְיָן זֶה **because there is no claim against him in this matter,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתַנְחוּמָא (כִּי תֵצֵא י). **as they said in Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei 10).** וּמַה שֶּׁהָיָה עָלָיו אֵיזֶה נִדְנוּד **And the slight taint there was upon him** מֵהָעֲשָׂרָה[976] טִיפִּין שֶׁיָּצְאוּ וְכוּלֵי **from the ten drops that came forth, etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ סוֹטָה לו, ב) **(as they said in Sotah 36b) —** עַל זֶה הִשְׁלִימוּ הַתִּיקוּן **this was fully rectified by** עֲשָׂרָה הֲרוּגֵי מַלְכוּת[977] **the Ten Martyrs** [תִּיקוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּיקוּן סט קִי, ב] **(Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 69, 110b),** וּבְיִחוּד רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **and especially by Rabbi Akiva,** שֶׁיָּצְאָה נִשְׁמָתוֹ בְּאֶחָד **whose soul departed with "Echad,"** שֶׁהוּא תַּכְלִית הַיִּחוּד **which is the ultimate unity,** בְּהִתְעַלּוּת הִתְקַשְּׁרוּת נִשְׁמָתוֹ בְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **in the elevation of his soul's attachment to the holy Atika.** וּבָזֶה נִכְנַע כֹּחַ עֲמָלֵק מִכֹּל וָכֹל[978] **Through this the power of Amalek was utterly subdued,** כְּדִבַּרְנוּ לְמַעְלָה **as we said above,** שֶׁזֶּה עִיקַּר הַכְנָעַת כֹּחַ עֲמָלֵק. **that this is the essence of subduing the power of Amalek.** (בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם) וְאָמְרוּ **And they said (Berachos, ibid.):** מַלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת אָמְרוּ **The ministering angels said,** זוֹ תּוֹרָה וְזוֹ שְׂכָרָהּ **"This is Torah and this its reward?!"** [תְּהִלִּים יז, יד] אָמַר לָהֶם חֶלְקָם בַּחַיִּים **He said to them, "Their portion is in life" (Tehillim 17:14).** בַּת קוֹל יָצְתָה **A heavenly voice went forth:** אַשְׁרֶיךָ רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **"Fortunate are you, Rabbi Akiva,** שֶׁאַתָּה מְזוּמָּן לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא. **for you are destined for the life of the World to Come."** וְהַדָּבָר נִפְלָא **The matter is astonishing:** וְכִי זֶה תַּכְלִית שְׂכָרוֹ שֶׁל רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **is this, then, the ultimate reward of Rabbi Akiva,** שֶׁמְּזוּמָּן לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם הַבָּא **that he is destined for the life of the World to Come —** מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ גַּם עַל הַהוּא כּוֹבֵס[979] **something they said even about that launderer** (כְּתוּבּוֹת קג, ב) **(Kesubos 103b)** וְעַל קִטְיָעָה בַּר שָׁלוֹם[980] (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה י, ב) **and about Ketia bar Shalom (Avodah Zarah 10b)?** וּכְעֵין שֶׁהִקְשׁוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (פְּסָחִים נ, א) **It is like what they asked in the Gemara (Pesachim 50a)** עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ הֲרוּגֵי מַלְכוּת **on what they said, "The martyrs of the kingdom —** אֵין אָדָם יָכוֹל לַעֲמוֹד בִּמְחִיצָתָן **no person can stand in their compartment":** אִלְּיָמָא רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבִירָיו **"If you say Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues,** מִשּׁוּם הֲרוּגֵי מַלְכוּת וְתוּ לָא וְכוּלֵי[981] **is it because they were martyrs of the kingdom and nothing more?" etc.** וּכְעֵין זֶה יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Similarly one must understand** בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה יח, א) **what they said (Avodah Zarah 18a)** בְּרַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן תְּרַדְיוֹן **regarding Rabbi Chanina ben Teradyon,** שֶׁהָיָה עוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה **who was engaged in Torah** וּמַקְהִיל קְהִילּוֹת בָּרַבִּים **and gathering assemblies in public,** וְאָמַר לוֹ רַבִּי יוֹסֵי בֶּן קִסְמָא **and Rabbi Yosei ben Kisma said to him,** תָּמַהּ אֲנִי אִם לֹא יִשְׁרְפוּ וְכוּלֵי **"I wonder if they will**

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[976] **Tosafot on Avodah Zarah 5b** — "'Their inclination is delivered into their hand'—this is inferred from 'the foot,' for the evil inclination is called a traveler, as it says, 'A traveler came to the wealthy man.'" The interpretation of that traveler as the initial coldness and sluggishness of Amalek is Rav Tzadok's development of the commentators' linguistic observation.

[977] **Ketubot 5a** — "The work of the righteous is greater than the making of heaven and earth. Concerning heaven and earth it is written, 'My hand founded the earth, and My right hand spread out the heavens'; but concerning the work of the righteous it is written, 'The place You made for Your dwelling, Lord—the Sanctuary, Lord, which Your hands established.'"

[978] **Shemot Rabbah 33:8** — "When the Holy One, blessed be He, spoke to Moses about the Tabernacle, he said before Him: 'Master of the world, can Israel make it?' The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'Even one Israelite can make it, as it is said, 'From every person whose heart moves him.'"

[979] **Bava Batra 146a** — "'All the days of the poor are bad.' But are there not Sabbaths and festivals? This accords with Shmuel, for Shmuel said: 'A change of habitual eating is the beginning of intestinal illness.'" The Gemara explains how even festive eating can trouble the materially poor person. Rav Tzadok rereads "poor" through Nedarim as poverty of understanding, so that even a day intended for Torah fails to gladden him.

[980] **Jerusalem Talmud Shabbat 15:3** — "Rabbi Chaggai said in the name of Rabbi Shemuel bar Nachman: Sabbaths and festivals were given only for eating and drinking.... Rabbi Berakhyah said in the name of Rabbi Chiyya bar Ba: Sabbaths and festivals were given only for engaging in words of Torah.... How, then, is this fulfilled? Give a portion to Torah study and a portion to eating and drinking."

[981] **Zohar II, 65b (Beshalach)** — "Moshe said: 'I shall prepare myself for that battle above; you, Yehoshua, prepare yourself for the battle below.'"

not burn," etc.; אָמַר לוֹ רַבִּי **he said to him, "My master,** מָה אֲנִי לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם הַבָּא **what am I regarding the life of the World to Come?"** אָמַר לוֹ כְּלוּם מַעֲשֶׂה בָּא לְיָדְךָ וְכוּ׳[982] **He said to him, "Has any deed come to your hand?" etc.** וְהַפֶּלֶא שֶׁהָיָה מְסוּפָּק **The wonder is that he was in doubt** אִם מְזוּמָּן לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם הַבָּא. **whether he was destined for the life of the World to Come.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר בָּזֶה **One may say regarding this** דְּעַל פִּי הַדִּין אֶפְשָׁר **that according to the halachah it is possible** דְּלֹא הָיוּ צְרִיכִין לִמְסוֹר נַפְשָׁם **that they were not required to give up their lives,** דְּגַם עַל שְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים **for even regarding the three cardinal sins,** אִם יְכוֹלִים לְהִמָּלֵט **if they can escape,** (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ז, ח) אָמְרוּ **they said (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 7:8)** דְּאָמַר לָהֶם יְחֶזְקֵאל **that Yechezkel said to them,** כָּךְ מְקוּבָּלַנִי מִישַׁעְיָה רַבִּי **"Thus I have received from Yeshayah my teacher:** חֲבִי כִמְעַט רֶגַע וְגוֹמֵר רַק חֲנַנְיָה מִישָׁאֵל וַעֲזַרְיָה **only Chananyah, Mishael and Azaryah** רָצוּ לְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם[983] **wished to sanctify the Name of Heaven;** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁהוּא כְּעִנְיַן אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בְּכִבְשַׁן הָאֵשׁ **One may say that it is like the case of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him, in the fiery furnace:** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה מְצוּוֶּה עַל קִדּוּשַׁת הַשֵּׁם **he was not commanded concerning sanctification of the Name,** וְשֶׁלֹּא לְאַבֵּד עַצְמוֹ **and not to destroy himself —** בֶּן נֹחַ מְצוּוֶּה **this a Noahide is commanded;** רַק דְּרָצָה לְקַדֵּשׁ שֵׁם שָׁמַיִם **only he wished to sanctify the Name of Heaven** לְצוֹרֶךְ הַשָּׁעָה **for the need of the hour,** אַף שֶׁמִּי שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְחוּיָּב בַּדָּבָר וְנֶהֱרָג **even though one who is not obligated in the matter and is killed** מִתְחַיֵּיב בְּנַפְשׁוֹ לְהָרַמְבַּ״ם **is liable for his life according to the Rambam** (הִלְכוֹת יְסוֹדֵי הַתּוֹרָה פֶּרֶק ה הֲלָכָה ד) **(Hilchos Yesodei HaTorah 5:4)** וַעֲבֵירָה בְּיָדוֹ **and has committed a sin** (וְכִמְבֹאָר פָּרָשַׁת נֹחַ מַאֲמָר ט) **(as explained in Parshas Noach, Maamar 9;** עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת**) see there at length).** וּכְמוֹ כֵן יֵשׁ לוֹמַר **Likewise one may say** בְּעִנְיַן רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וְרַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן תְּרַדְיוֹן **regarding Rabbi Akiva and Rabbi Chanina ben Teradyon,** שֶׁהָיוּ מַקְהִילִין קְהִילּוֹת בָּרַבִּים **who gathered assemblies in public** וְעוֹסְקִין בַּתּוֹרָה **and engaged in Torah,** דְּאִיפְשָׁר דְּלֹא הָיוּ רַשָּׁאִין **that possibly they were not permitted to,** מִדִּין מְאַבֵּד עַצְמוֹ לְדַעַת **by the law against taking one's own life,** וְהָיוּ צְרִיכִין לְהִטָּמֵין עַצְמָם[984] **and they should have hidden themselves,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁאַל רַבִּי יוֹסֵי בֶּן קִסְמָא **just as Rabbi Yosei ben Kisma asked** לְרַבִּי חֲנִינָא בֶּן תְּרַדְיוֹן [עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה שָׁם] **of Rabbi Chanina ben Teradyon (Avodah Zarah, ibid.),** וּפַפּוּס לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא [בְּרָכוֹת שָׁם]. **and Pappus of Rabbi Akiva (Berachos, ibid.).** רַק רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא הֲשִׁיבוֹ **But Rabbi Akiva answered him,** וּמַה בִּמְקוֹם חִיּוּתֵנוּ וְכוּ׳[985] אָנוּ מִתְיָרְאִין **"If in the place of our life** [שָׁם] **we are afraid," etc. (ibid.),** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁ בְּנַפְשׁוֹ **because he sensed in his soul** שֶׁנִּצְרָךְ שֶׁיָּבֹא לְיָדוֹ **that it was necessary for it to come to his hand** שֶׁתֵּצֵא נִשְׁמָתוֹ בְּאֶחָד **that his soul depart with "Echad,"** וְזֶהוּ עִיקַּר חִיּוּתוֹ **and this is the essence of his life** וְהִתְעַלּוּת נַפְשׁוֹ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and the elevation of his soul, as mentioned above.** וְהוּא מֵעֵין עֲבֵירָה לִשְׁמָהּ **This is akin to a transgression for the sake of Heaven,** (נָזִיר כג, ב) שֶׁאָמְרוּ **of**

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[982] **Megillah 12a** — "Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai's disciples asked him: 'Why did the enemies of Israel in that generation deserve destruction?' ... They said: 'Because they enjoyed that wicked man's banquet.' 'If so, those in Shushan should be killed; why those throughout the world?' They said: 'Then you tell us.' He said: 'Because they bowed down to the image.' ... 'They acted only outwardly; the Holy One, blessed be He, likewise acted toward them only outwardly.'"

[983] **Megillah 12a** — "'To do according to the wish of each man'—Rava said: To do according to the wish of Mordechai and Haman. Mordechai is called 'a man': 'There was a Jewish man'; Haman is called 'a man': 'A man, an adversary and enemy.'" The Gemara identifies the two "men." The detailed claim here about kosher provisions and the distinction between eating and enjoying the banquet belong to Rav Tzadok's explanation.

[984] Parallel: **Rabbi Moshe Chaim Luzzatto, Mesillas Yesharim, ch. 26, §§7, 10–13** — "The person who sanctifies himself with his Creator's holiness finds even his bodily deeds becoming actual matters of holiness. ... Such a person is himself reckoned as a Tabernacle, a Temple, and an altar. ... The Divine Presence rests upon them as it rested in the Temple; hence the food they eat is like an offering ascending upon the altar's fires. ... The food and drink consumed by the holy person are elevated, as though actually offered upon the altar. ... This does not mean that Torah scholars should be inflamed with desire for food and drink, Heaven forbid, filling their throats as one stuffs a glutton. Rather, Torah scholars whose ways and deeds are holy are literally like a Temple and an altar, because the Divine Presence rests upon them as it literally rested in the Temple, and what is offered to them is as though offered upon the altar."

Connection: Ramchal supplies a precise distinction behind Rav Tzadok's account of the scholars' banquet: bodily consumption can become actual sacred service, while appetite for one's own pleasure remains a different motive. His description concerns an attained state of holiness. It clarifies how Torah bound within the heart could transform a permitted meal, and why Rav Tzadok locates the failure in enjoying the wicked king's banquet rather than in its food being forbidden.

[985] **Shabbat 88a** — "Rabbi Simai expounded: When Israel put 'we shall do' before 'we shall hear,' six hundred thousand ministering angels came, and each bound two crowns upon every Israelite—one corresponding to 'we shall do,' and one to 'we shall hear.' Once Israel sinned, twelve hundred thousand destroying angels descended and removed them."

which they said (Nazir 23b) שֶׁהוּא כְּמִצְוָה שֶׁלֹּא לִשְׁמָהּ[986] **that it is like a mitzvah not for its own sake;** וְנֶאֱמַר [מִשְׁלֵי ג, טז] **and it says (Mishlei 3:16),** אֹרֶךְ יָמִים בִּימִינָהּ **"Length of days is in its right hand,** בִּשְׂמֹאלָהּ עוֹשֶׁר וְכָבוֹד **in its left, riches and honor":** דְּלַמַּיְמִינִים **for those who go to the right,** שֶׁעוֹסְקִים בַּתּוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת לִשְׁמָהּ **who engage in Torah and mitzvos for their own sake —** אֹרֶךְ יָמִים לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **length of days, in the World to Come,** שֶׁכּוּלּוֹ אָרוֹךְ **which is entirely long;** וְלַמַּשְׂמְאִילִים **and for those who go to the left,** שֶׁעוֹסְקִין שֶׁלֹּא לִשְׁמָהּ **who engage not for its own sake —** עוֹשֶׁר וְכָבוֹד בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה אִיכָּא **riches and honor in this world there are,** וְלֹא אֹרֶךְ יָמִים לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **but not length of days in the World to Come** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת סג, א וְעַיֵּין רַשִׁ"י שָׁם[987]) **(as stated in Shabbos 63a; see Rashi there).** וּמִמֵּילָא גַּם בְּמַעֲשֶׂה זוֹ **Consequently in this deed too,** דְּהָיָה כְּעֵין עֲבֵירָה לִשְׁמָהּ **which was akin to a transgression for the sake of Heaven,** הָיָה הַסָּפֵק **there was the doubt** אִם עַל זֶה בְּעַצְמוֹ יַגִּיעַ שָׂכָר לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא. **whether for this itself a reward would come in the World to Come.** וְעַל זֶה הֵשִׁיב הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **And to this HaKadosh Baruch Hu answered,** שֶׁמַּחֲלָק חֶלְקָם בַּחַיִּים **"Their portion is in life":** מֵעֲשֶׂה זוֹ יַגִּיעוּ לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם **that from the portion of this very deed they would attain eternal life,** לְתַכְלִית הַשְּׁלֵימוּת **the ultimate perfection,** לְהִתְעַלּוֹת בִּבְחִינַת מַחֲשָׁבָה לְפָנַי **to ascend to the level of "in thought before Me."** וְעַל זֶה יָצְתָה בַּת קוֹל **And regarding this the heavenly voice went forth:** אַשְׁרֶיךָ רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **"Fortunate are you, Rabbi Akiva,** שֶׁאַתָּה מְזוּמָּן לְחַיֵּי עוֹלָם הַבָּא **for you are destined for the life of the World to Come"** — שֶׁזֶּהוּ תַּכְלִית הָאוֹשֶׁר[988] **for this is his ultimate bliss** וְהַשְּׁלֵימוּת שֶׁלּוֹ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: **and perfection, as mentioned above.**

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[986] **Esther 9:26** — "Therefore they called these days Purim, after the name of the pur. Therefore, because of all the words of this letter, and what they had seen concerning this matter and what had happened to them...."

[987] **Sanhedrin 43b** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Joshua: 'Am I an informer? Go and cast lots.' He went and cast lots, and the lot fell upon Achan. Achan said: 'Joshua, are you accusing me on the strength of a lot? You and Eleazar the priest are the two great men of the generation. If I cast lots over you, it must fall upon one of you!' Joshua said: 'I ask you: do not cast aspersions upon the lots, for the land of Israel will eventually be divided by lot.'"

[988] **Joshua 7:14** — "In the morning you shall approach by your tribes. The tribe which the Lord takes shall approach by families; the family which the Lord takes shall approach by households; and the household which the Lord takes shall approach man by man."

פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר, מַאֲמָר י״ג Parshas Zachor — Maamar Yud Gimmel

אַחַר הַבְדָּלָה After Havdalah

פָּסוּק זֶה **"For the Jews there was light** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה וְשִׂמְחָה וְשָׂשׂוֹן וְיִקָר. **and gladness, joy and honor."** **This verse was said** נֶאֱמַר **after the obliteration of Amalek,** אַחַר מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **for it** שֶׁהוּא כּוֹלֵל כָּל **includes all the matters** שֶׁהֵם לְנֶגֶד קְלִיפָּתוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק. **that stand against the kelipah of Amalek.** דְּעִיקַר קְלִיפָּתוֹ **For the essence of his kelipah** הָיָה לְבַטֵּל תּוֹרָה. **was to nullify Torah.** וּבַתְּחִלָּה שֶׁבָּא זְמַן **At first, when the time came** קַבָּלַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **for receiving the Written Torah,** בָּא וְהִתְגָּרָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **he came and provoked Yisrael** וְרָצָה לְבַטֵּל קַבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה. **and wished to nullify the receiving of the Torah.** וְעַל כֵּן בִּיזֶּה הַמִּילָה **Therefore he scorned the milah,** [דְּבָרִים כה, יח] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Devarim 25:18),** וַיְזַנֵּב בְּךָ וְגוֹמֵר **"and he cut down among you," etc.,** וְזֹהַר [תַּצְוֶה י] וְאִיתָא בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **and it is stated in Midrash Tanchuma (Teitzei 10)** [חֵלֶק ב סה, ב] הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and the holy Zohar (vol. 2, 65b)** שֶׁהָיָה חוֹתֵךְ מִילוֹתֵיהֶם וְכוּ׳ **that he would cut off their milos, etc.:** וְכַוָּנָתוֹ הָיָה **And his intention was** עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **based on what they said** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ל, יב; תַּנְחוּמָא מִשְׁפָּטִים ה) **(Shemos Rabbah 30:12; Tanchuma, Mishpatim 5)** לְמַד תּוֹרָתָן וְאַל תָּמוֹל **"Learn their Torah but do not circumcise yourself,"** בְּעֲקִילַס שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ אַדְרְיָינוּס **regarding Akilas, to whom Hadrian said,** וְאָמַר לוֹ אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לִלְמוֹד תּוֹרָתָן **and he said to him, "One cannot learn their Torah** אִם אֵינוֹ מָל **unless he is circumcised:** [תְּהִלִּים קמז, יט] מַגִּיד דְּבָרָיו לְיַעֲקֹב **'He declares His words to Yaakov' (Tehillim 147:19) —** שֶׁהוּא מָל וְכוּ׳[990] **to one who is circumcised, etc."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאִם יָמוֹל **That is, if he circumcises but does not convert,** לֹא יוֹעִיל הַמִּילָה **the milah does not avail,** שֶׁהוּא בִּכְלַל עֲרֵלִים[991] **for he is in the category of the uncircumcised** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב נְדָרִים לא, ב) **(as stated in Nedarim 31b).** וְזֶה שֶׁבָּא לְקַטְרֵג **And this is why he came to accuse** עַל מַה שֶׁרוֹצֶה הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרֵךְ **regarding Hashem Yisbarach's wish** לִיתֵּן תּוֹרָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **to give the Torah to Yisrael** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם מוּלִים **because they are circumcised,** וְאָמַר שֶׁהֵם גַּם כֵּן פּוֹגְמִין **and he said that they too blemish it —** וְטוֹל מַה שֶׁבָּחַרְתָּ. **"Take what You have chosen."** וְלֹא הוֹעִיל קִטְרוּגוֹ **But his accusation did not avail,** וְקִבְּלוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **and they received the Written Torah.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּשֶׁבָּא הַזְּמַן **Afterwards, when the time came** לִכְנוֹס לְאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **to enter Eretz Yisrael —** דְּשָׁם עִיקַּר מְקוֹם תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for there is the principal place of Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה ב, ג] כִּי מִצִּיּוֹן תֵּצֵא תּוֹרָה **as it says (Yeshayah 2:3),** וּדְבַר ה׳ **"For from Tziyon shall go forth Torah,**

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[989] **Yoma 62a** — "The two goats of Yom Kippur should ideally be alike in appearance, height and value, and should be bought together. Even if they are not alike, they are valid; if one was bought today and the other tomorrow, they are valid." Their initial equivalence makes the lot's designation conspicuous: their two different ritual destinies are not determined by an outward distinction between them.

[990] Parallel: **Rabbi Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Torah Ohr, Hosafos, Megillas Esther, "Al ken kar'u," §3; digital 4:6** — "Haman therefore cast the lot, for a lot belongs to a level above understanding. Through understanding one chooses according to a reason and an intellectual consideration, with the ability to select. With a lot, however, one sets aside choice based on understanding and makes the matter depend solely upon how the lot falls, even against one's understanding and choice. One therefore necessarily makes it depend upon a level above understanding: the will above understanding. This is also the meaning of the sacred lots: 'Aharon shall place lots upon the two goats.' As the lot falls, so it shall be; this too is the will above understanding. Thus, 'He shall stand the two goats before Hashem'—specifically before Hashem, where sins do not separate and deliberate sins become merits."

Connection: Torah Ohr makes explicit the inference underlying Rav Tzadok's contrast between prophecy and a lot: prophecy enters the prophet's understanding, whereas submitting to a lot sets aside the selector's reasoning and preference. Its application to the Yom Kippur goats explains why their outward equality calls for a designation from a higher will. The act of accepting a decision beyond one's own reasoning gives concrete content to the higher will identified here.

[991] Parallel: **Tzidkat HaTzadik 40:1** — "The essence of repentance is that God illuminates a person's eyes until deliberate sins become merits: he recognizes and understands that everything through which he sinned was also within the blessed God's will.... Both divine knowledge and human choice are true, each in its own place: in the place of choice there is no place for knowledge, and in the place of knowledge there is truly no place for choice. When he attains this immense light, all his deliberate sins return, never having left the depth of God's knowledge.... This is the mystery of the goat sent to Azazel: if a person did it on his own, he would be an outright idolater; but because the goat is sent by God's will, which commands that it be sent, it becomes a commandment rather than a transgression."

Connection: This passage explains both elements brought together in the maamar: the Yom Kippur goat and the retrospective transformation attained through repentance. It explicitly preserves human choice in its own domain; recognition of the deeper divine will is an illumination reached through repentance, rather than an instruction to choose sin.

מירוּשָׁלָיִם **and the word of Hashem from Yerushalayim";** דְּבַר ה׳ זוֹ הֲלָכָה[992] **"the word of Hashem — this is halachah"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קלח, ב) **(as stated in Shabbos 138b);** וְלִשְׁכַּת הַגָּזִית **and the Chamber of Hewn Stone —** מִשָּׁם יוֹצְאָה תּוֹרָה לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל[993] **"from there Torah goes forth to all Yisrael"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין פו, ב) **(as stated in Sanhedrin 86b),** וְזֶה הָיָה בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם. **and this was in Yerushalayim —** שׁוּב בָּא עֲמָלֵק **Amalek came again,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (בַּמִּדְבָּר רַבָּה יט, כ; תַּנְחוּמָא חֻקַּת יח) **(Bamidbar Rabbah 19:20; Tanchuma, Chukas 18):** וּמִי הָיָה מֶלֶךְ עֶרָד זֶה עֲמָלֵק וְכוּלֵי[994] **"And who was the king of Arad? This is Amalek," etc.** לְבַטֵּל מֵהֶם אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבָּא לְקַטְרֵג **That is, he came to accuse, to nullify from them the light of Torah she'b'al peh.** דַּעֲמָלֵק יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **For Amalek is the evil inclination,** [כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ בַּמַּאֲמָרִים הַקּוֹדְמִים] **as we said (in the previous maamarim)** [חֵלֶק ג קס, א] מֵהַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **from the holy Zohar (vol. 3, 160a),** וְיָדַע שֶׁכְּשֶׁיְּקַבְּלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל הַתּוֹרָה **and he knew that when Yisrael receive the Torah** יְבַטֵּל הוּא מִכֹּל וָכֹל. **he will be nullified entirely.** וְכֵן אַחַר כָּךְ בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Likewise afterwards, through Torah she'b'al peh,** לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס **to rectify the "much anger,"** יוּכְלוּ לִזְכּוֹת כְּמוֹ בְּמַתַּן שֶׁהוּא הָרֹב חָכְמָה **which is the "much wisdom"** לִהְיוֹת חֵירוּת מִמַּלְאַךְ הַמָּוֶת וְיֵצֶר הָרָע **they would be able to merit, as at the Giving of the Torah, freedom from the Angel of Death and the evil inclination;** וְלָכֵן רָצָה לְעַכְּבָם. **therefore he wished to hold them back.** וְכֵן קִטְרוּג הָמָן מְזַרְעוֹ **So too the accusation of Haman, of his offspring,** הָיָה גַּם כֵּן כְּשֶׁהִגִּיעַ זְמַן **likewise came when the time arrived** הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for the spread of Torah she'b'al peh** עַל יְדֵי אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה **through the Men of the Great Assembly,** שֶׁגָּזְרוּ גְּזֵירוֹת וּסְיָיגִים **who enacted decrees and safeguards,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (עירובין כא, ב) **as they said (Eruvin 21b):** הַרְבֵּה גְּזֵירוֹת גָּזַרְתִּי עַל עַצְמִי **"Many decrees have I decreed upon myself** יוֹתֵר מִמַּה שֶׁגָּזְרָתְךָ עָלַי.[995] **beyond what You decreed upon me."** וְדָנִיֵּאל הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן **And Daniel was the first,** דִּכְתִיב [דָּנִיֵּאל א, ח] וַיָּשֶׂם דָּנִיֵּאל **as it is written (Daniel 1:8), "And Daniel resolved** אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִתְגָּאַל **that he would not defile himself** בְּפַת בַּג הַמֶּלֶךְ וּבְיֵין מִשְׁתָּיו **with the king's food or with the wine he drank" —** וְהַיְינוּ גְּזֵירַת יַיִן וְשֶׁמֶן **that is, the decree against their wine and their oil** מְשׁוּם בְּנוֹתֵיהֶן[996] **on account of their daughters,** וּבְנוֹתֵיהֶן גַּם כֵּן גְּזֵירָה[997] **and their daughters too are a decree** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה לו, ב) **(as stated in Avodah Zarah 36b).** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁזֶּה הָמָן **We have already said that Haman's accusation,** וְדָתֵיהֶם שׁוֹנוֹת מִכָּל עָם **"and their laws differ from every people" —** דְּלָא אָכְלֵי מִינַן **that they do not eat of ours** וְלָא נָסְבֵי מִינַן **and do not marry of ours** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִילָּה יג, ב) **(as stated in Megillah 13b) —** הָיָה כַּוָּנָתוֹ לְקַטְרֵג לְמַעְלָה[998] **was intended as an accusation above,** לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ עַל גְּזֵירָה זוֹ **before Hashem Yisbarach, about this decree:** שֶׁאֵין הַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁלָּהֶם לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם **that their intent is not for the sake of Heaven**

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[992] **Sanhedrin 44a** — "'Israel has sinned.' Rabbi Abba bar Zavda said: Although he has sinned, he is still Israel. Rabbi Abba said: As people say, 'A myrtle standing among reeds is called a myrtle, and people call it a myrtle.'"

[993] **Sanhedrin 43b** — "How do we know that his confession atoned for him? For it is said, 'Joshua said: Why have you troubled us? The Lord shall trouble you this day'—this day you are troubled, but you are not troubled in the World to Come."

[994] **Esther Rabbah 8:5** — "'Mordechai told him everything that had befallen him.' He said to Hatach: 'Go and tell her: A descendant of 'he who encountered you' has come upon you.' This is what is written, 'Who encountered you on the way.'" The Midrash connects karahu, "had befallen him," with Amalek's karekha, "encountered you," and identifies Haman as Amalek's descendant.

[995] **Ibn Ezra on Esther 3:7** — "'Pur' is a Persian word; its interpretation is 'lot.' ... The lot's judgment is from the Lord. He deferred their time so that they would repent and He would deliver them." Ibn Ezra already places the Persian term beside the providential delay. Rav Tzadok develops a further distinction between Haman's intention in casting it and the divine will that actually governs it.

[996] **Shabbat 148b** — "One may cast lots over sacred offerings on a festival, but not over the portions."

[997] **Shabbat 149b** — "How do we know that chalashim is a term for a lot? For it is written, 'How you have fallen from heaven, shining one, son of the dawn; you have been cut down to the earth, you who cast lots over nations.' Rabbah bar Rav Huna said: This teaches that he would cast lots over the great men of the kingdom, to know whose turn it was for intercourse." The Gemara's degrading description concerns Nebuchadnezzar. Rav Tzadok therefore prefers the Mishnah's sacred setting when explaining Joshua's lot.

[998] **Yalkut Shimoni on Torah 265** — "Our Rabbis say: He cast lots over them, as it says, 'When they cast lots over the portions.' Four names are applied to a lot: chalash, pur, goral and chevel; through all of them Esau's descendants were struck. Through chalash Amalek was struck, as it says, 'Joshua weakened'; through pur Haman was struck, as it says, 'He cast pur'; through goral Haman was struck, as it says, 'the lot.' Through chevel the fourth kingdom will be struck, as it says, 'The pangs of a woman in childbirth shall come upon him.'" The extant text reads "portions." Rav Tzadok proposes correcting its proof to the Mishnah's "sacred offerings," quoted next. That proposal is his textual correction, rather than the wording of the retrieved Yalkut.

רַק מִפְּנֵי הַגַּאֲוָה וְשִׂנְאַת הַבְּרִיּוֹת **but out of arrogance and hatred of people.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **About this he said,** וְאֶת [אֶסְתֵּר ג, ח] דָּתֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ אֵינָם עוֹשִׂים **"and the king's laws they do not keep" (Esther 3:8);** וּבְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ סְתָם **and wherever "the king" is said unspecified,** מְשַׁמֵּשׁ קוֹדֶשׁ וְחוֹל **it serves for both sacred and profane** (אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ג, י עַל פָּסוּק גַּם וַשְׁתִּי) **(Esther Rabbah 3:10, on the verse "Also Vashti")** — וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאֵין כַּוָּנָתָם **that is, their intention is not** לְקַיֵּים דָּתֵי מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים בָּזֶה **to fulfill thereby the laws of the King of kings** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר תְּצַוֶּה סוֹף מַאֲמָר ב). **(as explained in Tetzaveh, end of Maamar 2).** וְכֵן קִטְרוּג יְשָׁנוּ מִן הַמִּצְוֹת **So too the accusation "they are asleep regarding the mitzvos,"** וְרַבָּנָן עִם אֶחָד הֵן **and, according to the Rabbis, "they are one people"** — הַכֹּל הָיָה כַּוָּנָתוֹ **in all of it his intention was** לְקַטְרֵג לִפְנֵי הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ. **to accuse before Hashem Yisbarach.** וּמִן הַסְּתָם הָיָה קְצָת מְקוֹם קִטְרוּג **And presumably there was some ground for the accusation,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁפָּעַל שְׁנָחְתַם גְּזַר דִּין שֶׁל טִיט **since he brought about the sealing of a decree in clay,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ [אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ז, יג] בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **as they said in the Midrash Rabbah (Esther Rabbah 7:13).** וְאַחַר שֶׁעָשׂוּ תְּשׁוּבָה **And after they repented** וְעָשׂוּ מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **and carried out the obliteration of Amalek,** [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] כְּתִיב **it is written (Esther 8:16), "For the Jews there was light,"** (מְגִילָּה טז, ב) וְדָרְשׁוּ **and they expounded (Megillah 16b):** אוֹרָה זוֹ תּוֹרָה **"'Light' — this is Torah,** [מִשְׁלֵי ו, כג] וְתוֹרָה אוֹר וְכֵן הוּא אוֹמֵר **and so it says (Mishlei 6:23), 'and Torah is light'"** — וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת אוֹרָה לְשׁוֹן נְקֵיבָה[999] **which is called orah, in the feminine form,** שֶׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **for it receives from the Written Torah,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא תּוֹרָה אוֹר. **which is called "Torah ohr."** וְכֵן כְּתִיב (שַׁבָּת פח, א) **And so it is written (Shabbos 88a):** וְהַיְינוּ **"They accepted it anew in the days of Achashverosh"** — הֶחְדֵּר קִבְּלוּהָ בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ שֶׁעָלֶיהָ הָיָה הַכְּפִיַּית הַר כְּגִיגִית **regarding which there was the overturning of the mountain upon them like a barrel;** דְּעַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב אָמְרוּ נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע **for about the Written Torah they said, "We will do and we will hear,"** (תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ. **as they said (Tanchuma, Noach 3).** כֵּן הוּא גַּם [אֶסְתֵּר שָׁם] שִׂמְחָה **Simchah (Esther, ibid.) too is** הֵיפֶךְ קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק יְצִרָא בִּישָׁא **the opposite of the kelipah of Amalek, the evil inclination,** (תַּעֲנִית טו, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Taanis 15a):** וְלִישָׁרִים שִׂמְחָה **"'And gladness for the upright,'** [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] וּלְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Tehillim 97:11), 'and for the upright of heart, gladness'"; that is, when the heart is** וְהַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁמִּתְיַישֵּׁר הַלֵּב **made upright,** וּמוֹרִיק כָּל הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל **and empties all the evil from the heart of the fool,** וְנַעֲשֶׂה לֵב אֶחָד לַאֲבִיו שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם. **and becomes one heart to his Father in Heaven.** עֲמָלֵק שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַנָּחָשׁ וְהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **Amalek is the root of the serpent and the evil inclination,** שֶׁגָּרַם עֶצֶב וְעִצָּבוֹן **which caused sorrow and pain,** וְהוּא הֵיפֶךְ הַשִּׂמְחָה **and it is the opposite of joy;** וּכְשֶׁמְּבַטְּלִין קְלִיפָּתוֹ לְגַמְרֵי מִכֹּל וְכֹל **and when his kelipah is nullified completely and entirely,** זוֹכִין לְשִׂמְחָה. **we merit simchah.** [מְגִילָּה שָׁם] שָׁשׁוֹן זוֹ מִילָה **"Sasson — this is milah" (Megillah, ibid.):** הוּא בְּוַדַּאי נֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **this certainly stands against the kelipah of Amalek,** שֶׁבִּיזָּה הַמִּילָה **who scorned the milah** וְקִטְרֵג עַל קְדוּשַּׁת הַבְּרִית שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and accused regarding the holiness of Yisrael's covenant,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** [מְגִילָּה שָׁם] יְקָר אֵלּוּ תְּפִילִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ **"Yekar — this is the tefillin of the head" (Megillah, ibid.),** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **which indicates that Yisrael are bound to the root,** לְמַעְלָה מִתְּפִיסַת שֵׂכֶל בְּנֵי אָדָם. **beyond the grasp of human intellect.** וְעַל זֶה דִּקְדְּקוּ **On this they were precise** וְאָמְרוּ תְּפִילִּין שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ **in saying "the tefillin that are in the head"** וְלֹא אָמְרוּ שֶׁעַל הָרֹאשׁ **and not "that are on the head,"** שֶׁהַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בָּרֹאשׁ בַּמּוֹחַ[1000] **for the intent is that they are bound in the head, in the mind,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר הָרַב זָצַ"ל וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה. **as the Rav, of saintly and holy memory, said.** וְעַל זֶה קִטְרֵג עֲמָלֵק **And against this Amalek accused** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר יב וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **(as explained in Maamar 12 and elsewhere);** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁזָּכוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **and since they merited to carry out the obliteration of Amalek,** זָכוּ לִבְחִינַת יְקָר **they merited the level of yekar,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל הִתְקַשְּׁרוּת בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **which indicates attachment to the root,** בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **the level of Atika.** וְעַל כֵּן תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Therefore Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁבָּא מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא **which comes from the Dew of Atika,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ נִקְרָא כָּל יְקָר **is called "every precious thing," as**

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[999] **Sanhedrin 38b** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: Adam drew out his foreskin. Here it is written, 'They, like Adam, transgressed the covenant,' and there it is written, 'He has annulled My covenant.'"

[1000] **Zohar I, 93a (Lech Lecha)** — "Happy are Israel, who offer a pleasing sacrifice to the Holy One, blessed be He: they bring their sons as an offering at eight days old. Once circumcised, they enter this good portion of the Holy One, of whom it is written, 'The righteous one is the foundation of the world.' Because they have entered this portion of the righteous one, they are called righteous—certainly, all of them are righteous."

expounded (מִדְרָשׁ חֲזֵקֻת רַבָּה יט, ו; תַּנְחוּמָא ח) **(Midrash Chukas Rabbah 19:6; Tanchuma 8):** וְכָל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ [אִיּוֹב כח, י] **"'And his eye beheld every precious thing' (Iyov 28:10) —** זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבִירָיו. **this is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues."** וְהִנֵּה קִטְרוּג עֲמָלֵק **Now, the accusation of Amalek** עַל קַבָּלַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב נִתְבַּטֵּל **against receiving the Written Torah was nullified,** שֶׁהָרֵי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הֶחֱלִישׁ כֹּחוֹ **for Yehoshua weakened his power** וְזָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל לְקַבֵּל הַתּוֹרָה **and Yisrael merited to receive the Torah;** אֲבָל הַקִּטְרוּג עַל קַבָּלַת **but the accusation against the receiving** פֶּה שֶׁבְּעַל וְהִתְפַּשְּׁטוּת תּוֹרָה **and spread of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא מִתְפַּשֵּׁט בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר **which spreads in every generation** בְּלִבּוֹת חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **in the hearts of the Sages of Yisrael —** וְעַל זֶה יֵשׁ קִטְרוּג תָּמִיד מִקְּלִיפַּת הָמָן[1001] **against this there is constant accusation from the kelipah of Haman.** **Regarding this it is said,** [שְׁמוֹת יז, טז] מִלְחָמָה לַה' בַּעֲמָלֵק מִדּוֹר דּוֹר **"Hashem has a war against Amalek from generation to generation" (Shemos 17:16),** וְצָרִיךְ בְּכָל פּוּרִים **and every Purim one must** לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק מֵחָדָשׁ. **carry out the obliteration of Amalek anew.** וְקוֹרִין קוֹדֶם לוֹ בְּשַׁבָּת **We read before it, on Shabbos,** פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר **Parshas Zachor,** לְהַקְדִּים זְכִירָה לַעֲשׂיָה[1002] **to put remembering before the doing** דִּמְחִיַּית שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַטָּה: **of the obliteration of Amalek (as stated in Megillah 30a):** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִילָּה ל, א) עֲמָלֵק **we mention his name below,** וְזוֹכִין לִמְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **and we merit the obliteration of Amalek** מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ בְּפוּרִים **on the part of Hashem Yisbarach on Purim,** [תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא ד] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **as they said in the Midrash (Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 4):** וַאֲנִי מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַעְלָה וְכוּ' **"And I erase his name from above," etc.** וּבְכָל שַׁבָּת יֵשׁ מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק לְשָׁעָתוֹ **And every Shabbos there is an obliteration of Amalek for its time,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר יא וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **as we have said (as explained in Maamar 11 and elsewhere).** וְעַל כֵּן אוֹמְרִים בְּמוֹצָאֵי שַׁבָּת קֹדֶשׁ **Therefore we say on Motzaei Shabbos Kodesh,** קוֹדֶם הַבְדָּלָה **before Havdalah,** שֶׁמְּבַקְּשִׁים שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כֵּן תִּהְיֶה לָנוּ[1003] **so may it be for us":** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה וְגוֹמֵר **"For the Jews there was light...;** וְאַף בִּימֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה **we ask that even in the weekdays** נִהְיֶה נִיצּוֹלִים מִקִּטְרוּג עֲמָלֵק **we be saved from the accusation of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **which is the evil inclination,** וְנִזְכֶּה לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and that we merit the light of Torah she'b'al peh** וְשִׂמְחָה שָׂשׂוֹן וִיקָר: **and gladness, joy and honor.**

[1001] **Kohelet Rabbah 9:7** — "On Yom Kippur everyone fasts, and the Holy One, blessed be He, releases another third of their sins.... He forgives them everything and says: 'What has passed has passed; from here onward begins the accounting.' A heavenly voice goes forth and says to them: 'Go, eat your bread with joy; your prayer has already been heard.'"

[1002] **Shabbat 118b–119a** — "Abaye said: May I receive my reward, for when I see a young scholar who has completed his tractate, I make a festive day for the Rabbis."

[1003] **Shabbat 117b** — "Our Rabbis taught: How many meals must a person eat on the Sabbath? Three. Rabbi Chidka says four. Rabbi Yochanan said: Both expound the same verse: 'Moses said: Eat it today, for today is a Sabbath to the Lord; today you shall not find it in the field.' Rabbi Chidka holds that these three occurrences of 'today' exclude the evening; the Rabbis hold that they include the evening."

[1004] **Pesachim 114b** — "What are the two cooked dishes? Rav Huna said: beets and rice. Rava would seek out beets and rice, since this had issued from Rav Huna's mouth."

פּוּרִים

Purim

פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר א׳ Purim — Maamar Aleph

[מְגִילָּה ב, א] מְגִילָּה נִקְרֵאת וְכוּ׳ **"The Megillah is read," etc. (Megillah 2a).** (בְּטוּרֵי אֶבֶן שָׁם ד״ה מְגִילָּה) **And (the Turei Even, ibid., s.v. Megillah) asked:** אַמַּאי לֹא תָּנֵי **Why did it not teach,** קוֹרִין אֶת הַמְּגִילָּה בְּאַחַד עָשָׂר וְכוּ׳ **"We read the Megillah on the eleventh," etc.,** [כ, א] כְּהָא דְּתָנַן בְּפֶרֶק שֵׁנִי **as we learned in the second perek (20a),** אֵין קוֹרִין אֶת הַמְּגִילָּה.[1005] **"We do not read the Megillah," etc.?** וּבֶאֱמֶת מָצִינוּ גַּם כֵּן **And indeed we also find this** בִּלְשׁוֹן הַכָּתוּב [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כח] וְהַיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה נִזְכָּרִים וְנַעֲשִׂים **in the wording of the verse (Esther 9:28): "And these days are remembered and kept** בְּכָל דּוֹר וְדוֹר **in every generation," etc.** וַהֲוָה לֵיהּ לְכָתוּב יִזָּכְרוּ וְיֵעָשׂוּ **It should have written "will be remembered and will be kept,"** כֵּינָן דְּקָאֵי לֶעָתִיד. **since it refers to the future.** אֶלָּא הָעִנְיָן **But the matter is this:** דְּאִיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (מִשְׁלֵי סִימָן ט) **It is stated in the Midrash (Mishlei, siman 9)** שֶׁכָּל הַמּוֹעֲדִים יִהְיוּ בְּטֵלִין **that all the festivals will be nullified,** וִימֵי הַפּוּרִים לֹא **but the days of Purim** יִהְיוּ נִבְטָלִין לְעוֹלָם **will never be nullified,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כח] וִימֵי הַפּוּרִים הָאֵלֶּה **as it says (Esther 9:28), "And these days of Purim** לֹא יַעַבְרוּ מִתּוֹךְ הַיְּהוּדִים **shall not pass from among the Jews,** וְזִכְרָם לֹא יָסוּף מִזַּרְעָם **nor shall their remembrance cease from their seed."** אַף יְמֵי הַכִּפּוּרִים **Also Yom Kippur**[1006] אֵינָן בְּטֵלִין לְעוֹלָם **will never be nullified,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [וַיִּקְרָא טז, לד] וְהָיְתָה זֹאת לָכֶם **as it says (Vayikra 16:34), "And this shall be for you** לְחֻקַּת עוֹלָם. **an everlasting statute."** וּכְבָר נִשְׁאַל עַל זֶה **And already asked about this was** הָרַשְׁבָּ״א זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **the Rashba, of blessed memory** (בְּתְשׁוּבוֹת חֵלֶק א סִימָן צג) **(in his Teshuvos, vol. 1, siman 93):** שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי אַף קוֹצָהּ שֶׁל יוּד **for certainly even the thorn of a yud** מִן הַתּוֹרָה לֹא יִבָּטֵל לָעֲתִיד **of the Torah will not be nullified in the future,** וְאֵיךְ יִבָּטְלוּ הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת. **so how can the festivals be nullified?** גַּם לְבַד זֶה קָשֶׁה **Besides this, it is also difficult:** אֲפִילּוּ אִם יְצוּיַר **even if one could imagine** שֶׁיִּתְבַּטְּלוּ הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת **that the festivals would be nullified,** אַף שֶׁהֵם מִצְוֹת עֲשֵׂה מִן הַתּוֹרָה **though they are positive mitzvos from the Torah,** אֵיךְ יִתָּכֵן שֶׁאָז לֹא יִבָּטֵל פּוּרִים **how is it possible that then Purim would not be nullified,** שֶׁהוּא מִדִּבְרֵי קַבָּלָה **which is from Divrei Kabbalah** וְתַקָּנַת אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה. **and an enactment of the Men of the Great Assembly?** גַּם הָרַשְׁבָּ״א זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה הִקְשָׁה עַל מַה שֶּׁהֵבִיאוּ הָרְאָיָה לְיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים שֶׁלֹּא יִבָּטֵל **The Rashba, of blessed memory, also asked on what they brought as the proof for Yom Kippur, that it will not be nullified,** מִדִּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ חֻקַּת עוֹלָם **since "an everlasting statute" is written regarding it:** חֻקַּת עוֹלָם תְּחָגֲגוּהוּ הָא גַּם בְּפֶסַח כְּתִיב **but regarding Pesach too it is written,** וְכֵן וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם וְגוֹמֵר [שְׁמוֹת יב, יד] **"You shall celebrate it as an everlasting statute" (Shemos 12:14), and likewise, "And you shall observe," etc.,** לְדוֹרוֹתֵיכֶם חֻקַּת עוֹלָם [שָׁם, יז]. **"throughout your generations, an everlasting statute" (ibid. 17).** וּמְפָרֵשׁ הָרַשְׁבָּ״א **And the Rashba explains** שֶׁהוּא הַבְטָחָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **that it is a promise to Yisrael:** שֶׁאַף בִּזְמַן הַגְּזֵירָה **that even at a time of persecution,** שֶׁיְּבַטְּלוּ הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת **when they will abolish the festivals,** כְּעֵין מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [אֵיכָה ב, ו] שִׁכַּח ה׳ בְּצִיּוֹן מוֹעֵד וְשַׁבָּת **similar to what is said (Eichah 2:6), "Hashem has caused festival and Shabbos to be forgotten in Tziyon,"** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים **nevertheless the days of Purim** לֹא יִבָּטְלוּ וְהוּא הַבְטָחָה. **will not be nullified—and this is a promise.** וְכֵן יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **And likewise Yom Kippur:** וְהָיְתָה וְגוֹמֵר הַבְטָחָה **"And this shall be," etc., is a promise** שֶׁתִּהְיֶה לְחֻקַּת עוֹלָם **that it will be an everlasting statute,** שֶׁהַיּוֹם יְכַפֵּר **that the day itself will atone** אֲפִילּוּ לֹא יִשְׁמְרוּהוּ **even if they do not observe it.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּוַדַּאי **That is to say, certainly,** שֶׁבְּשָׁעָה שֶׁהִכְרִיחוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **at a time when they forced Yisrael** לְבַטֵּל מוֹעֵד וְשַׁבָּת **to abandon festival and Shabbos,** לֹא נִיחָא לְקַיֵּים **they would not allow them to fulfill** גַּם מִצְוַת יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **the mitzvah of Yom Kippur either;** רַק דְּאָתֵי כְּמַאן דְּאָמַר **rather, it follows the opinion** דְּעִצּוּמוֹ שֶׁל יוֹם מְכַפֵּר **that the essence of the day atones** אֲפִילּוּ לֹא הִתְעַנָּה **even if one did not fast** וְלֹא קָרָאוֹ מִקְרָא קוֹדֶשׁ[1007]

[1005] **Sukkah 32b** — "Rav Yehudah said: [A myrtle is valid] if three leaves grow together from one base. Rav Kahana said: Even two opposite each other, with one rising above them. Rav Acha son of Rava would seek out two opposite each other with one rising above them, since this had issued from Rav Kahana's mouth." The following opinion rejects that configuration as an inferior myrtle. Rav Tzadok's analogy concerns the positive significance of seeking a form praised by a teacher, rather than resolving that dispute here.

[1006] **Pesachim 120a** — "Just as the seventh day is optional, so the six days are optional. Might the first night also be optional? Scripture says, 'Together with unleavened bread and bitter herbs they shall eat it.' ... Scripture says, 'In the evening you shall eat unleavened bread': the verse established it as an obligation." The source distinguishes an obligatory first night from the remaining days. Rav Tzadok proposes that "optional," relative to that obligation, still leaves a positive value in eating matzah throughout the festival.

[1007] **Megillah 10b** — "'A cypress shall rise'—this is Mordechai, who is called the chief of all spices, as it says, 'And you, take choice spices, flowing myrrh'; its translation is mira dakhya."

and did not proclaim it a holy convocation כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יג.) **(as stated in Shevuos 13a).** וְגִירְסָת הָרַשְׁבָּ"א בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **And the Rashba's reading in the Midrash is:** אָמַר רַבִּי אַף יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים וְכוּ' **"Rebbi said: Also Yom Kippur," etc.;** וְכָתַב דְּאָתֵי רַבִּי כְּדַעְתֵּיהּ דְּיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים (שָׁם) **and he wrote that Rebbi follows his own view (ibid.) that Yom Kippur atones** מְכַפֵּר אַף עַל שֶׁאֵינָן שָׁבִים **even for those who do not repent;** אֲבָל חֻקַּת עוֹלָם **but the "everlasting statute" of Pesach** דְּפֶסַח הוּא אַזְהָרָה **is an admonition,** כְּלָשׁוֹן תְּחָגֵּהוּ **as in the wording "you shall celebrate it"** וּשְׁמַרְתֶּם לְדוֹרוֹתֵיכֶם **and "you shall observe throughout your generations,"** וְלֹא הַבְטָחָה עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1008] **and not a promise; see there.** אֲבָל עֲדַיִן קָשֶׁה **But it is still difficult,** שֶׁבְּפוּרִים גַּם כֵּן **for regarding Purim as well,** לֹא הִנִּיחוּ לְקַיֵּים מִצְוֹתֶיהָ בִּשְׁעַת הַגְּזֵירָה בְּוַדַּאי **at a time of persecution they certainly did not allow its mitzvos to be fulfilled—** בִּקְרִיאַת מְגִילָה וּמִשְׁתֶּה **the reading of the Megillah, the feast,** וּמִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת וּמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **sending portions and gifts to the poor—** וּמַה זֶּה הַהַבְטָחָה **so what is this promise that they will never be nullified?** שֶׁלֹּא יִבָּטְלוּ לְעוֹלָם. אֲבָל הָעִנְיָן הוּא **But the matter is** לִהְיוֹת דִּכְתִיב [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כא] **that it is written (Esther 9:21), "to make** עוֹשִׂים אֵת יוֹם אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר וְגוֹמֵר **the fourteenth day," etc.,** וְאֵת יוֹם חֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר בּוֹ וְגוֹמֵר **"and the fifteenth day of it," etc.,** כַּיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר נָחוּ וְגוֹמֵר **"as the days on which they rested," etc.** וְכֵן לְמַעְלָה כְּתִיב [שָׁם, יט] **And likewise above it is written (ibid. 19),** עוֹשִׂים אֶת יוֹם אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר וְגוֹמֵר **"making the fourteenth day," etc.,** שִׂמְחָה וְגוֹמֵר. **"gladness," etc.** וְאִם הַמְכוּוָּן **Now if the intent were** עַל מִצְוֹת הַנּוֹהָגוֹת בְּפוּרִים **the mitzvos practiced on Purim,** הָוָה לֵיהּ לְכָתוֹב **it should have written,** עוֹשִׂים בְּיוֹם אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר **"making, on the fourteenth day,** שִׂמְחָה וְגוֹמֵר. **gladness," etc.** אֶלָּא כֵּן פֵּירוּשׁ הַכָּתוּב **Rather, the meaning of the verse is:** דִּבְזְמַן הַנֵּס כְּתִיב **regarding the time of the miracle it is written,** [אֶסְתֵּר ט, טז] וְנוֹחַ מֵאוֹיְבֵיהֶם וְגוֹמֵר **"and they had rest from their enemies," etc. (Esther 9:16),** וְעִיקַּר הַנְּיָחָא **and the essence of the rest** הוּא מֵאוֹיֵב כְּמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה נד, א) **is from the well-known enemy,** שֶׁהוּא הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **which is the yetzer hara,** הַיָּדוּעַ **as they expounded (Bereishis Rabbah 54:1):** בִּרְצוֹת ה' דַּרְכֵי אִישׁ **"When Hashem favors a man's ways,** גַּם אוֹיְבָיו יַשְׁלִים אִתּוֹ [מִשְׁלֵי טז, ז] **He makes even his enemies be at peace with him" (Mishlei 16:7)—** זֶה יֵצֶר הָרָע **this is the yetzer hara;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא (סוּכָּה נב.) **and as they said in the Gemara (Sukkah 52a),** שְׁלֹמֹה קְרָאוֹ שׂוֹנֵא. **Shlomo called it "enemy."** וְזֶה עִיקַּר מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **And this is the essence of the eradication of Amalek:** הוּא לְשָׁרֵשׁ אֶחָד הָרָע שֶׁבַּלֵּב **to uproot the evil in the heart,** יְצָרָא בִּישָׁא **the evil inclination,** קַטֵּיגוֹרָא דִּבְנֵי נָשָׁא **the accuser of mankind,** דְּנִקְרָא עֲמָלֵק **which is called Amalek,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג' קס, א) **as they said (Zohar III 160a);** וְזוֹכִין לְהַנַּיְיחָא **and they merit the rest** מֵהַמְּנוּחָה מֵהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. **and repose from the yetzer hara.** וְהִנֵּה בִּמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **Now regarding the eradication of Amalek,** אִיתָא (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תֵצֵא ד) **it is stated (Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 4):** אָמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל רִבּוֹנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **Yisrael said, "Master of the World,** אֵין אָנוּ יְכוֹלִין בּוֹ **we cannot prevail over him."** אָמַר לָהֶם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **HaKadosh Baruch Hu said to them,** תְּהֵיוּ אַתֶּם מַזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַעְלָה וַאֲנִי מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַעְלָה וְכוּ' **"You mention his name below, and I will erase his name from above," etc.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַהַזְכָּרָה דִּלְמַטָּה **And through the mention below** נַעֲשֶׂה הַמְּחִיָּה **the eradication is accomplished** עַל יְדֵי ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **by Hashem Yisbarach.** וְכֵן הַמְּנוּחָה מֵהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **Likewise the rest from the yetzer hara,** כֹּחַ עֲמָלֵק **the force of Amalek,** נַעֲשֶׂה גַּם כֵּן עַל יְדֵי ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **is also accomplished by Hashem Yisbarach,** [תְּהִלִּים לז, לג] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 37:33),** ה' לֹא יַעַזְבֶנּוּ בְיָדוֹ **"Hashem will not abandon him into his hand";** דְּאִלְמָלֵא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שֶׁעוֹזֵר לוֹ **for were it not that HaKadosh Baruch Hu helps him,** אֵינוֹ יָכוֹל לוֹ **he could not overcome it** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סוּכָּה שָׁם) **(as stated in Sukkah, ibid.);** רַק הָאָדָם צָרִיךְ לְהִשְׁתַּדֵּל בְּכָל כֹּחוֹ. **only, a person must exert himself with all his strength.** וְכֵן בְּכָל שָׁנָה נַעֲשֶׂה **And likewise every year there is accomplished,** בְּיָמִים אֵלּוּ מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק לְמַעְלָה **in these days, the eradication of Amalek above,** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁמַּזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַטָּה. **through mentioning his name below.** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל עוֹשִׂים בְּכָל שָׁנָה **And Yisrael "make" every year** הַיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה **these days,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בָּהֶם מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **so that there be in them the eradication of Amalek;** וּמַמָּשׁ דְּהַיְינוּ כֹּחַ הַיָּמִים כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. הֵם עוֹשִׂים אֶת הַיָּמִים **and they literally "make" the days—** **meaning, the power of the days, as mentioned above.** (ב וְאִיתָא בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן כא נז, **And it is stated in Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 21, 57b):** פּוּרִים אִתְקְרִיאַת עַל שֵׁם יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **"Purim is so called after Yom HaKippurim,** דַּעֲתִידִין לְאִתְעַנָּגָא בֵּיהּ וְכוּ'[1009] **for in the future they will delight on it," etc.** וְכֵן אוֹמְרִים בְּשֵׁם **And likewise they say in the name of**

[1008] **Numbers 19:2** — "This is the statute of the Torah which the Lord commanded, saying: Speak to the children of Israel, that they take for you a completely red cow, in which there is no blemish, upon which no yoke has come."

[1009] **Exodus 12:43** — "The Lord said to Moses and Aaron: This is the statute of the Passover offering: no foreigner shall eat of it." The contrast is between naming a particular rite, "the statute of the Passover offering," and calling the red

זֵכֶר צַדִּיקִים וּקְדוֹשִׁים לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **may the memory of the righteous and holy be a blessing for the life of the World to Come,** הָרַבָּנִים הַקְּדוֹשִׁים **the holy Rebbes,** דְּפוּרִים בְּחִינַת יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **that Purim is in the aspect of Yom HaKippurim,** הַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ פּוּרִים **meaning,** וְנִקְרָא יוֹם כִּפּוּרִים **and it is called Yom Kippurim, "like Purim";** וּבֶאֱמֶת נִרְמָז בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and indeed this is hinted in Tikkunei Zohar, as mentioned above.** וּכְמוֹ בְּיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **And just as on Yom Kippur** עִיצּוּמוֹ שֶׁל יוֹם מְכַפֵּר **the essence of the day atones,** כֵּן יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים **so on the days of Purim** עִיצּוּמוֹ שֶׁל יוֹם עוֹשֶׂה מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק. **the essence of the day accomplishes the eradication of Amalek.** רַק הָאָדָם צָרִיךְ שֶׁיִּזְכּוֹר **Only, a person must remember** שֶׁהַיּוֹם יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **that today is Yom Kippur,** וְכֵן שֶׁהַיּוֹם פּוּרִים. **and likewise that today is Purim.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And about this it says,** וְהַיָּמִים דְּהֵיְינוּ בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר **in every generation";** הָאֵלֶּה נִזְכָּרִים וְנַעֲשִׂים **"And these days are remembered and kept** שֶׁהַיָּמִים נַעֲשִׂים **that is, the days are made** לִהְיוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **to be the eradication of Amalek** עַל יְדֵי ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **by Hashem Yisbarach,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **as we said.** וְאָמַר נִזְכָּרִים **And it says "are remembered,"** שֶׁאַף הַזְּכִירָה **for even the remembrance,** שֶׁמַּזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַטָּה **that they mention his name below,** גַּם כֵּן מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ מְמֻיָּלָא. **also comes from Hashem Yisbarach of itself,** שֶׁשּׁוֹלֵחַ בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל הַהַזְכָּרָה **for He sends into the heart of Yisrael the remembrance** שֶׁיַּזְכִּירוּ שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַטָּה. **that they should mention his name below.** וּמִמֵּילָא נַעֲשִׂים הַיָּמִים **And consequently the days are made** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בָּהֶם מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **such that the eradication of Amalek is in them,** כָּאָמוּר וּבָא הַהַבְטָחָה **as stated. And then comes the promise:** וִימֵי הַפּוּרִים הָאֵלֶּה **"And these days of Purim** לֹא יַעֲבְרוּ מִתּוֹךְ הַיְּהוּדִים וְגוֹמֵר **shall not pass from among the Jews," etc.:** שֶׁאַף בִּשְׁעַת הַגְּזֵרָה **that even at a time of persecution,** לְבַטֵּל מוֹעֵד **when they will force Yisrael, Heaven forbid,** שֶׁיַּכְרִיחוּ חַס וְשָׁלוֹם אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **to abandon festival and Shabbos,** וּבְוַדַּאי לֹא יַנִּיחוּ אוֹתָם לְקַיֵּים מִצְוֹת **and will certainly not let them** וְשַׁבָּת **fulfill the mitzvos practiced on Purim,** הַנּוֹהֶגוֹת בְּפוּרִים מִכָּל מָקוֹם יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים לֹא יַעֲבְרוּ **nevertheless "the days of Purim shall not pass"—** וְהַיְינוּ כֹּחַ הַיָּמִים **meaning, the power of the days** לִהְיוֹת בָּהֶם מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק מִלְמַעְלָה **to have in them the eradication of Amalek from above;** וְהוּא לֹא יִתְבַּטֵּל גַּם אָז.[1010] **this will not be nullified even then.** וּמַמָּשׁ כְּמוֹ יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **Exactly like Yom Kippur,** שֶׁעִיצּוּמוֹ שֶׁל יוֹם מְכַפֵּר **where the essence of the day atones** אַף אִם לֹא הִתְעַנּוּ בוֹ **even if they did not fast on it** וְלֹא קָרְאוּ מִקְרָא קוֹדֶשׁ **and did not proclaim a holy convocation,** וְכֵן יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים עַצְמָם עוֹשִׂים הַמְּחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק לְמַעְלָה. **so too the days of Purim themselves accomplish the eradication of Amalek above.** אַךְ דְּצָרִיךְ עַל כָּל פָּנִים לֵידַע **But one must at least know** שֶׁהַיּוֹם הַזֶּה הוּא פּוּרִים **that this day is Purim,** וְעַל זֶה הִבְטִיחַ הַכָּתוּב **and about this the verse promised:** וְזִכְרָם לֹא יָסוּף מִזַּרְעָם **"nor shall their remembrance cease from their seed"—** שֶׁאַף אָז לֹא יִשָּׁכְחוּ הַיָּמִים **that even then they will not forget the days,** וְיִהְיוּ הַיָּמִים נִזְכָּרִים וְנַעֲשִׂים **and the days will be remembered and made** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ יְמֵי מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק. **to be days of the eradication of Amalek.** וְהִנֵּה יֵשׁ שִׁינּוּי בַּכְּתוּבִים **Now there is a change of order in the verses:** דִּמְקוֹדָם כְּתִיב נִזְכָּרִים **first it writes "remembered"** וְאַחַר כָּךְ וְנַעֲשִׂים **and afterwards "and kept,"** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בְּאוֹתוֹ פָּסוּק כְּתִיב **and afterwards in that same verse it is written,** וִימֵי הַפּוּרִים הָאֵלֶּה לֹא יַעֲבְרוּ וְגוֹמֵר **"And these days of Purim shall not pass," etc.,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ וְזִכְרָם לֹא יָסוּף וְגוֹמֵר. **and afterwards "nor shall their remembrance cease," etc.** אָמְרוּ בְּפוּרִים שֶׁחָל לִהְיוֹת **Now in the Gemara (Megillah 30a)** דְּרַב אָמַר מַקְדִּימִין פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר **they said, regarding Purim that falls** עֶרֶב שַׁבָּת **on Erev Shabbos,** כְּדֵי שֶׁלֹּא תִּקְדּוֹם **that Rav said we read Parshas Zachor earlier,** כִּי הֵיכִי דְּלָא תִּיקְדּוֹם עֲשִׂיָּה לִזְכִירָה **so that the doing should not precede the remembering;** נִרְאֶה דִּדְרָשֵׁי נִזְכָּרִים **it appears that they expound "remembered"** עַל קְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר. **as referring to the reading of Parshas Zachor.** אֲבָל פְּשָׁטֵיהּ דִּקְרָא **But the plain meaning of the verse** דְּקָאֵי עַל יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים **is that it refers to the days of Purim,** וְאִם נִזְכָּרִים קָאֵי **and if so "remembered" refers** עַל קְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָּה **to the reading of the Megillah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ (שָׁם יח.) **as they expounded (ibid. 18a)** דְּמַקִּישׁ זְכִירָה זְכִירָה[1011] **"remembrance"—"remembrance,"** וְכֵן (שָׁם ב: וְשָׁם יז.) **and likewise (ibid. 2b and ibid. 17a)** וְכֵן (שָׁם כ' עַמּוּד א' וְעַמּוּד ב') דִּמְגִילָּה לַעֲשִׂיָּיה[1012] **that it compares the remembrance of the Megillah to the doing,**

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heifer's rite "the statute of the Torah."

[1010] **Pesikta Rabbati 14** — "Rabbi Yochanan ben Pazi said: The Torah is expounded in forty-nine aspects, and this passage too is 'refined sevenfold': it contains forty-nine purifications.... Why is this so? Just as the Torah is expounded in forty-nine aspects, so this passage has forty-nine aspects, for it is equal in weight to the entire Torah."

[1011] **Shemot Rabbah 25:12** — "Rabbi Levi said: If Israel would guard even one Sabbath properly, the son of David would come. Why? Because it is equal in weight to all the commandments.... Rabbi Elazar bar Avina said: We find it written in Torah, Prophets and Writings that Sabbath is equal in weight to all the commandments."

and likewise (ibid. 20a and 20b) לָמְדוּ מֵהַאי קְרָא **they learned from this verse** לִקְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָה.[1013] **regarding the reading of the Megillah.** וְכֵיוָן דְּנִזְכָּרִים עַל הַקְּרִיאָה קָאֵי **And since "remembered" refers to the reading,** קָשֶׁה לְשׁוֹן נִזְכָּרִים. **the wording "are remembered" is difficult.** וְיִתָּכֵן לְפָרֵשׁ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **And it is possible to explain what is said,** לִהְיוֹת עוֹשִׂים אֶת יוֹם אַרְבָּעָה עָשָׂר וְגוֹמֵר **"to make the fourteenth day," etc.,** כַּיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר נָחוּ בָּהֶם וְגוֹמֵר **"as the days on which they rested," etc.:** דְּהִנֵּה בְּמִצְוַת מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **for behold, regarding the mitzvah of eradicating Amalek,** כָּתוּב שְׁנֵי תְּנָאִים **two conditions are written:** בְּהָנִיחַ ה׳ אֱלֹהֶיךָ לְךָ **"When Hashem your God gives you rest** מִכָּל אוֹיְבֶיךָ [דְּבָרִים כה, יט] **from all your enemies" (Devarim 25:19);** הַשֵּׁנִי **the second, "in the land which Hashem your God** בָּאָרֶץ אֲשֶׁר ה׳ אֱלֹהֶיךָ [שָׁם] נוֹתֵן לְךָ וְגוֹמֵר **gives you," etc. (ibid.).** וּבְדוֹר מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **And in the generation of Mordechai and Esther,** אַף שֶׁהָיוּ בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ **though they were outside Eretz Yisrael,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם נַעֲשָׂה מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **nevertheless the eradication of Amalek was accomplished,** מִטַּעַם דִּכְתִיב [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] **for the reason that it is written (Esther 8:16),** לַיְהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light,"**— וְהַיְינוּ דְּאִיתָא (מְגִילָה טז:) זוֹ תוֹרָה **and it is stated (Megillah 16b): "This is Torah"** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר מַאֲמָר יג) **meaning Torah she'b'al peh (as explained in Parshas Zachor, maamar 13).** וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (שָׁם כט.) **And it is stated in the Gemara (ibid. 29a):** וַאֲהִי לָהֶם לְמִקְדָּשׁ מְעַט [יְחֶזְקֵאל יא, טז] **"And I have been to them a small sanctuary" (Yechezkel 11:16)**— אֵלּוּ בָּתֵּי כְנֵסִיּוֹת וּבָתֵּי מִדְרָשׁוֹת שֶׁבְּבָבֶל **these are the shuls and batei midrash in Bavel;** וְרַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר אָמַר **and Rabbi Elazar said,** זֶה בֵּית רַבֵּינוּ שֶׁבְּבָבֶל **this is the house of our master in Bavel;** וְאָמְרוּ שֶׁעֲתִידִין שֶׁיִּקָּבְעוּ **and they said that in the future they will be established** בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1014] **in Eretz Yisrael; see there.** וְעַל כֵּן כֵּיוָן שֶׁזָּכוּ **Therefore, since they merited** לְאוֹרָה דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** זָכוּ לִקְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **they merited the holiness of Eretz Yisrael,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכוּ **and through this they merited** לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק. **to carry out the eradication of Amalek.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And about this it says,** לִהְיוֹת עוֹשִׂים אֶת יוֹם וְגוֹמֵר **"to make the day," etc.,** בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה **"every single year,** כַּיָּמִים אֲשֶׁר נָחוּ וְגוֹמֵר **"as the days on which they rested," etc.:** שֶׁיַּעֲשׂוּ בְּכָל שָׁנָה הַמְּחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **that every year they will accomplish the eradication of Amalek;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּכָל שָׁנָה **that is, every year there is awakened** בְּיָמִים אֵלּוּ עִנְיַן **in these days the matter of** כִּבְיֵמֵי מָרְדְּכַי **as in the days of Mordechai,** לַיְהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה זוֹ תוֹרָה **"The Jews had light"—this is Torah—** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן יִשְׂרָאֵל כְּשֶׁרוּיִים וְיוֹשְׁבִים בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **and thereby Yisrael are as though dwelling and settled in Eretz Yisrael,** וְנַעֲשֶׂה בְּיָמִים אֵלּוּ מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק.[1015] **and in these days the eradication of Amalek is accomplished.** וְזֶה כֹּחַ קְדוּשַׁת יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And this is the power of the holiness of Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּבְטַח וּפָרַצְתָּ יָמָּה וָקֵדְמָה וְגוֹמֵר [בְּרֵאשִׁית כח, יד] **who was promised, "And you shall spread out westward and eastward," etc. (Bereishis 28:14);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁיֵּלֵךְ **that is, wherever he goes,** תֵּלֵךְ עִמּוֹ קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל[1016] **the holiness of Eretz Yisrael goes with him;** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יא, ז) **and about this they said (Bereishis Rabbah 11:7),** יָרַשׁ אֶת הָעוֹלָם שֶׁלֹּא בְּמִדָּה[1017] עַיֵּין שָׁם **"He inherited the**

[1012] **Zohar II, 89a (Yitro)** — "Therefore the Sabbath is equal in weight to the Torah. Whoever guards the Sabbath is as though he guarded the entire Torah."

[1013] **Zohar III, 180b (Chukat)** — "'This is the statute of the Torah'—it should have said 'the law of the Torah'; what is 'statute'? We have explained that heh was dalet, but tav is dalet and nun joined as one. Why is nun called by this name? As it says, 'You shall not deceive one another': now she has a shining face and deceives people; afterward she strikes like a serpent, destroys and kills, and says, 'I have done no wrong.' ... Tav is all joined together: dalet, nun." The Zohar develops the letters of chukat through dalet, nun and tav, and then expounds nun in connection with deception and the serpent. Rav Tzadok reads that conjunction through the fifty gates of understanding and the Oral Torah. The wordplay should not be reduced to a literal rule of Hebrew spelling.

[1014] **Jerusalem Talmud Megillah 3:5** — "Rabbi Levi said in the name of Rabbi Chama bar Chanina: It would be proper for HaChodesh to precede Parah, for the Tabernacle was erected on the first of Nisan, and the heifer was burned on the second. Why, then, does Parah precede it? Because it is the purification of all Israel."

[1015] **Rashi on Megillah 29a** — "'The red heifer'—to warn Israel to make their Passover offerings in purity."

[1016] **Pesikta Rabbati 14** — "Rabbi Acha said in the name of Rabbi Yose bar Chanina: When Moses ascended on high, he found the Holy One, blessed be He, occupied with His book in His hand, engaged in reading this passage, the passage of the red heifer: 'This is the statute of the Torah.' Why? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'I am engaged only in the purification of Israel.' Whence? 'The mouth of the righteous meditates wisdom, and his tongue speaks judgment': the mouth of the Righteous One of the world meditates wisdom, occupying Himself with Torah. With which Torah? 'This is the statute of the Torah.'"

[1017] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:7** — "Rabbi Acha said in the name of Rabbi Chanina: When Moses ascended on high, he heard the voice of the Holy One, blessed be He, sitting and studying the passage of the red heifer, stating a law in the

world without measure"; see there. וְזֶהוּ עַל יְדֵי כֹּחַ הַתּוֹרָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **And this is through the power of the Torah, as mentioned above.** וּכְתִיב [בַּמִּדְבָּר כד, ה] מַה טֹּבוּ אׇהָלֶיךָ יַעֲקֹב **And it is written (Bamidbar 24:5), "How goodly are your tents, Yaakov,** מִשְׁכְּנוֹתֶיךָ יִשְׂרָאֵל **your dwellings, Yisrael,"** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהֶם קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **which possess the holiness of Eretz Yisrael;** וְאִיתָא (בְּרָכוֹת ח.) **and it is stated (Berachos 8a):** אוֹהֵב ה' שְׁעָרִים **Hashem loves the gates** הַמְצוּיָנִים בַּהֲלָכָה **distinguished in halachah** יוֹתֵר מִבָּתֵּי כְּנֵסִיּוֹת וּבָתֵּי מִדְרָשׁוֹת **more than the shuls and batei midrash,** מִכָּל מִשְׁכְּנוֹת יַעֲקֹב **"more than all the dwellings of Yaakov";** וְיֵשׁ לְאַרְבַּע אַמּוֹת שֶׁל הֲלָכָה **and the four amos of halachah possess** קְדוּשַׁת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם **the holiness of the Mikdash, as they said there,** וְכָל שֶׁכֵּן קְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל.[1018] **and all the more so the holiness of Eretz Yisrael.** וְאִיתָא (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא ה) **And it is stated (Midrash Tanchuma, Teitzei 5):** אוֹתָן שְׁתֵּי זְכִירוֹת וְכוּלֵי **"Those two remembrances," etc.,** הֱוִי זְהִירִין בָּהֶן **"be careful with them:** תִּמְחֶה אֶת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **'You shall erase the memory of Amalek';** זָכוֹר אֵת אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְךָ עֲמָלֵק **'Remember what Amalek did to you.'"** וְאָמַרְנוּ דְּקָאֵי **And we said that this refers** עַל ב' עִנְיָנֵי עֲמָלֵק **to two aspects of Amalek:** זָכוֹר אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְךָ **"Remember what he did to you"—** שֶׁמִּתְגָּרֶה בַּגְּדוֹלִים **that he provokes the great ones,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִזְדַּהֲרוּ הַגְּדוֹלִים **and through this the great ones will take care** שֶׁלֹּא יִסְמְכוּ עַל קְדוּשָׁתָם **not to rely on their holiness** וְיִזְדַּהֲרוּ מִפִּיתּוּיֵי הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **and will guard against the enticements of the yetzer hara;** וְלָזֶה דַּי הַזְּכִירָה לְבַד. **and for this, remembrance alone suffices.** הַשֵּׁנִי תִּמְחֶה זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **The second: "You shall erase the memory of Amalek"—** לְשָׁרֵשׁ אַחַר קְלִיפָּתוֹ **to uproot his kelipah,** וְזֶה עֵסֶק שֶׁהִשְׁלִיךְ יֵאוּשׁ בְּלֵב הַנֶּחְשָׁלִים **which casts despair into the hearts of the weak stragglers;** מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק בְּפוֹעַל. **and this is the work of eradicating Amalek in actuality.** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר מַאֲמָר ב) **(This was explained in Parshas Zachor, maamar 2.)** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And one may say that about this it says,** נִזְכָּרִים עַל הַזְּכִירָה רִאשׁוֹנָה וְהַיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה נִזְכָּרִים וְנַעֲשִׂים **"And these days are remembered and kept":** **"remembered" refers to the first remembrance,** דְּצָרִיךְ רַק לְזָכוֹר **where one need only remember,** זָכוֹר אֵת אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה לְךָ. **"Remember what he did to you";** וְנַעֲשִׂים עַל הַמְּחִיָּה בְּפוֹעַל כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and "kept" refers to the actual eradication, as mentioned above.** וּשְׁנֵיהֶם הֵם מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **And both of them come from Hashem Yisbarach:** שֶׁנּוֹתֵן הַזְּכִירָה בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל **He places the remembrance in the heart of Yisrael,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נַעֲשָׂה הַמְּחִיָּה **and afterwards the eradication is accomplished above,** גַּם כֵּן מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **also from Hashem Yisbarach,** וּפוֹעֵל לְמַטָּה. **and it takes effect below.** וְהַזְּכִירָה בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכִין **And the remembrance, Yisrael merit it** בִּקְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר **through the reading of Parshas Zachor** אוֹ בִּקְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָּה. **or through the reading of the Megillah.** וְזֶהוּ בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר **And this is "in every generation,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בִּימֵי מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **as was done in the days of Mordechai and Esther.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא בַּכָּתוּב הַהַבְטָחָה **And afterwards the verse brings the promise** לְאוֹתוֹ דּוֹר שֶׁזּוֹכְרִים **to that generation which remembers** מַעֲשֵׂה מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **the act of eradicating Amalek** שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה בְּיָמִים אֵלּוּ **that was done in these days,** וְהִבְטִיחָם וִימֵי הַפּוּרִים הָאֵלֶּה **and it promised them, "And these days of Purim** לֹא יַעֲבְרוּ מִתּוֹךְ הַיְּהוּדִים **shall not pass from among the Jews"—** וְהַיְנוּ עַל כֹּחַ יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים **that is, regarding the power of the days of Purim,** שֶׁבְּכָל שָׁנָה יִתְעוֹרֵר בָּהֶם **that every year there will be awakened in them** אוֹרָה זוֹ תּוֹרָה **"light—this is Torah,"** וְיִזְכּוּ לִקְדוּשַׁת אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **and they will merit the holiness of Eretz Yisrael,** וִימֵי הַפּוּרִים הָאֵלֶּה יַעֲשׂוּ **and these days of Purim will accomplish** מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק עַל יְדֵי ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **the eradication of Amalek through Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּעִיצּוּמוֹ שֶׁל יוֹם הַכִּיפּוּרִים שֶׁמְּכַפֵּר **like the essence of Yom Kippur, which atones,** כְּעִנְיַן מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **in the manner of what they said in Midrash Tanchuma:** אַתָּה מַזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַטָּה **"You mention his name below,** וַאֲנִי מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ מִלְּמַעְלָה. **and I erase his name from above."** וְכֵן הַמְּחִיָּה דְּיִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **And likewise the eradication of the evil inclination,** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן עַל יְדֵי ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **is also through Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא עֲמָלֵק כָּאָמוּר **which is called Amalek, as stated,** וְתָלוּי זֶה בָּזֶה. **and the one depends on the other.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר הַכָּתוּב הַבְטָחָה לְדוֹרוֹת **And afterwards the verse stated a promise for all generations:** שֶׁיְּצוּיַיר חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **that should it come about, Heaven**

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name of its author: 'Rabbi Eliezer says: A calf is in its first year, and a cow in its second.' He said before Him: 'Master of the worlds, may it be Your will that he come from my descendants.' He said to him: 'By your life, he comes from your descendants,' as it is written, 'The name of the one was Eliezer'—the name of that distinguished one." The parallel is also transmitted in Tanchuma, Chukat 8. Rav Tzadok distinguishes the book held in the first account from the spoken teaching bearing the name of a future Sage in this account.

[1018] **Mishnah Parah 1:1** — "Rabbi Eliezer says: A calf is in its first year, and a cow in its second. The Sages say: A calf is in its second year, and a cow in its third or fourth. Rabbi Meir says: Even one five years old. An old cow is valid, but we do not wait for it, lest it blacken and become invalid."

forbid, שֶׁיִּהְיֶה זְמַן כָּזֶה **that there be such a time,** כְּמוֹ דִּכְתִיב שִׁכַּח ה׳ בְּצִיּוֹן מוֹעֵד וְשַׁבָּת **as it is written, "Hashem has caused festival and Shabbos to be forgotten in Tziyon,"** לֹא שֶׁעַל יְדֵי אוֹנֶס **that through compulsion** מִצְוֹת הַנּוֹהָגוֹת בְּפוּרִים **the mitzvos practiced on Purim,** מִכָּל יַנִּיחוּם לְקַיֵּים כְּלָל **they will not let them fulfill at all** מִקּוֹם זִכְרָם לֹא יָסוּף מִזַּרְעָם **nevertheless "their remembrance shall not cease from their seed"—** שֶׁיִּזְכְּרוּ שֶׁהַיּוֹם הַזֶּה פּוּרִים **that they will remember that this day is Purim,** וּמִמֵּילָא כֹּחַ יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים **and consequently the power of the days of Purim** יִהְיוּ נַעֲשִׂים **will take effect,** וְלֹא יַעַבְרוּ מִתּוֹךְ הַיְּהוּדִים **and "they shall not pass from among the Jews,"** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בָּהֶם מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **so that there will be in them the eradication of Amalek,** כְּמוֹ בְּדוֹר מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר: **as in the generation of Mordechai and Esther.**

וּכְתִיב בַּמְּגִילָה **And it is written in the Megillah,** אַחַר שֶׁנִּכְתְּבוּ הָאִיגְּרוֹת **after the letters were written** לַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] **to carry out the eradication of Amalek (Esther 8:16):** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light** וְשִׂמְחָה וְשָׂשׂוֹן וְיִקָר **and gladness, and joy, and honor."** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And this is according to what they said in the Pesikta** (לְפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר פָּרָשָׁה יב סִימָן ט) **(on Parshas Zachor, parsha 12, siman 9)** (כִּי תֵצֵא יא) וּבְמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **and in Midrash Tanchuma (Ki Seitzei 11):** כָּל זְמַן שֶׁזִּרְעוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק קַיָּים **"As long as the seed of Amalek exists,** לֹא הַשֵּׁם שָׁלֵם וְכוּלְיֹ **the Name is not complete," etc.;** וְהוּא מִדִּכְתִיב [שְׁמוֹת יז, טז] **and this is derived from what is written (Shemos 17:16),** כִּי יָד עַל כֵּס יָהּ. **"For a hand is upon the throne of Kah."** וְהִנֵּה שֵׁם הָוָי״ה אֵינוֹ נֶהֱגֶה [פְּסָחִים נ, א] **Now the Name Havayah is not pronounced (Pesachim 50a),** וְשֵׁם יָהּ **while the Name Kah,** [זוה״ק ח״ג רמג, א] אַף שֶׁמִּרֶמֶז לְחָכְמָה וּבִינָה **although it alludes to Chochmah and Binah (Zohar III 243a),** מִכָּל מָקוֹם נֶהֱגֶה **is nevertheless pronounced;** וְעִם ו״ה שֶׁרוֹמְזִים לְשֶׁבַע תַּחְתּוֹנוֹת [שָׁם][1019] **but together with the vav-hei, which allude to the seven lower sefiros (ibid.),** אֵינוֹ נֶהֱגֶה.[1020] **it is not pronounced.** אַךְ עִיקַּר הַיִּחוּד **But the essence of the union** י״ה בְּו״ה **is yud-hei with vav-hei,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים בְּכָל מִצְוָה **as we say before every mitzvah,** לְיַחֵדָא שְׁמָא דְּי״ה בְּו״ה **"to unify the Name of yud-hei with vav-hei";** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ג׳ **and this is according to what they said in the holy Zohar** (ד, א) **(III 4a):** אִכְלוּ רֵעִים [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ה, א] וְכוּלְיֹ **"'Eat, friends' (Shir HaShirim 5:1), etc.—** דָּא אֲתַר עִלָּאָה **this is the supernal place,** דְּלָא מִתְפָּרְשִׁין לְעָלְמִין **who are in unity, in joy, never separating;** דְּאִינּוּן בְּאַחְדּוּתָא בְּחֶדְוָותָא **these are called 'friends.'** [שָׁם] שְׁתוּ וְשִׁכְרוּ דּוֹדִים **'Drink and be drunk, beloved ones' (ibid.)** — אִלֵּין אִקְרוּן רֵעִים. **these are those below,** דְּאִקְרוּן דּוֹדִים **who are called 'beloved,'**[1021] לְזִמְנִין יְדִיעָן **who are joined only at set times."** וַהֲיֵינוּ דְּיִחוּד י״ה תְּדִיר **That is, the union of yud-hei is constant,** דְּלָא מִתְפָּרְשִׁין לְעָלְמִין. **never separating.** וְאוֹתִיּוֹת י״ה הוּא שֵׁם בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ **And the letters yud-hei are a Name in themselves,** שֶׁרוֹמְזִים לְחָכְמָה וּבִינָה **alluding to Chochmah and Binah,** מוֹחָא וְלִבָּא. **the mind and the heart.** וְזֶה הַיִּחוּד יְכוֹלִים לִזְכּוֹת **And this union one is able to merit:** שֶׁיִּתְחַבֵּר הַחָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ עִם הַבִּינָה **that the wisdom in the mind be joined with the understanding and the will in the heart.** וְהָרָצוֹן שֶׁבַּלֵּב. אֲבָל הָעִיקָּר לְיַחֵד שֵׁם י״ה בְּו״ה **But the main thing is to unify the Name yud-hei with vav-hei,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַיִּחוּד עִם כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **so that the union be with Knesses Yisrael.** וְאוֹתִיּוֹת ו״ה רוֹמְזִים לְתוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת **And the letters vav-hei allude to Torah and mitzvos,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ[1022] בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ג׳ קכג, ב) **(III 123b);** וְעַל כֵּן אוֹתִיּוֹת ו״ה בְּעַצְמָם **and therefore the letters vav-hei by themselves** אֵינוֹ שֵׁם **are not a Name,** דְּחָכְמָה וּבִינָה אִינּוּן נִסְתָּרוֹת **for Chochmah**

[1019] **Zohar II, 3a (Shemot)** — "The voice comes to speech, and brings her forth with it. Voice is the general principle; speech is the particular articulation. Each needs the other; their separation is not fitting."

[1020] **Zohar I, 32a (Bereshit)** — "Speech is called Sabbath, and Sabbath is called speech. Therefore it is forbidden to speak ordinary speech on the Sabbath, because this speech must rule, and no other. This speech, which comes from the side of darkness, reveals depths from within it."

[1021] **Isaiah 59:21** — "As for Me, this is My covenant with them, says the Lord: My spirit which is upon you, and My words which I have put in your mouth, shall not depart from your mouth, nor from the mouth of your offspring, nor from the mouth of your offspring's offspring, says the Lord, from now and forever."

[1022] Parallel: **Tzidkat HaTzadik 221:1** — "Voice is general and speech is particular, as the Zohar says at the beginning of Shemot. Therefore the Written Torah is called 'voice,' and the Oral Torah 'speech.' Likewise, what is made heard in the heart is only general: to know His divinity and seek Him.... Through the understanding in a person's heart it becomes particular in every detail, according to what he needs.... 'With a voice' means God's will for that day in general, for the angels know no more: the Oral Torah is below, in the hands of the Sages of Israel, and the particulars are clarified by human beings on that day."

Connection: The maamar distinguishes the divine voice that gives life from the specific halakhah spoken by a Sage. This parallel explains the distinction's human side: the general divine call becomes particular Torah through the understanding and daily work of Israel's Sages.

and Binah are hidden בְּמוֹחָא וְלִבָּא **in the mind and the heart,** בִּרְחִימוּ וּדְחִילוּ **in love and in fear,** וְאוֹרַיְתָא בְּלָא דְּחִילוּ וּרְחִימוּ **and Torah without fear and love** לָא פָּרְחַת לְעֵילָּא[1023] **does not fly upward,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן י כה, ב). **as they said in Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 10, 25b).** וְעִיקַּר הַיִּחוּד לְזָכּוֹת **And the essence of the union is to merit** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה יִחוּד שֵׁם י״ה בְּוָ״ו ה״ **that there be a union of the Name yud-hei with vav-hei,** שֶׁאֵינוֹ תָּדִיר **which is not constant;** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַיִּחוּד **that is, that there be the union** דְּחָכְמָה וּבִינָה מוֹחָא וְלִבָּא **of Chochmah and Binah, mind and heart,** עִם הַמַּעֲשֶׂה דְּתוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת **with the deed of Torah and mitzvos.** וְזֶה הַיִּחוּד לֹא יוּכַל לִהְיוֹת בִּשְׁלֵימוּת **And this union cannot be complete** כָּל זְמַן שֶׁזַּרְעוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק קַיָּים **as long as the seed of Amalek exists;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיֵּשׁ מְציאוּת לַעֲמָלֵק[1024] **that is, as long as Amalek has existence,** שֶׁהוּא יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **which is the evil inclination,** (ח״ג קס, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar (III 160a)** עַל פָּסוּק [בַּמִּדְבָּר יג, כט] עֲמָלֵק יוֹשֵׁב בְּאֶרֶץ הַנֶּגֶב, **on the verse (Bamidbar 13:29), "Amalek dwells in the land of the Negev,"** וְיוּכַל לִכְנוֹס **and it is able to enter** אַף בְּלֵב גְּדוֹלִים וּקְדוֹשִׁים **even into the hearts of great and holy people** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר) **(as explained in Parshas Zachor,** מַאֲמָר א וְעַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת) **maamar 1; and see there at length).** וְעַל כֵּן אַחַר מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **Therefore, after the eradication of Amalek,** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light," etc.:** אַרְבָּעָה דְּבָרִים כְּנֶגֶד אַרְבַּע אוֹתִיּוֹת[1025] **four things corresponding to the four letters** מִשֵּׁם הַוָ״ה. **of the Name Havayah.** אוֹרָה כְּנֶגֶד יוּ״ד מֵהַשֵּׁם **"Light" corresponds to the yud of the Name,** שֶׁהוּא חָכְמָה **which is Chochmah;** וּכְנֶגֶד מִדָּה זוֹ **and corresponding to this attribute** [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, ג] מַאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **is the utterance "Let there be light" (Bereishis 1:3),** וְחָמֵשׁ פְּעָמִים אוֹר כָּתוּב בּוֹ **and "light" is written there five times,** נֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תּוֹרָה **corresponding to the five Chumashim of the Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ג, ה) **(as stated in Bereishis Rabbah 3:5).** וְשִׂמְחָה כְּנֶגֶד ה׳ עִלָּאָה **"Gladness" corresponds to the upper hei,** שֶׁהוּא בִּינָה לִבָּא **which is Binah, the heart,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה ו, י] וּלְבָבוֹ יָבִין **as it says (Yeshayah 6:10), "and his heart will understand,"** וּכְתִיב [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] וּלְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **and it is written (Tehillim 97:11), "and gladness for the upright of heart";** דְּהַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁמְּתַיְישֵׁר הַלֵּב **that is, when the heart is made upright,** שֶׁמּוֹרִיק הָרָע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל **when one empties the evil from the heart of the fool** וְנַעֲשֶׂה הַכֹּל טוֹב **and everything becomes good,** אָז יִשְׂרִים לְשִׂמְחָה[1026] **then "the upright to gladness"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּעֲנִית טו.) **(as stated in Taanis 15a).** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ בַּפְּסוּקִים **And likewise we find in the verses** שֶׁמְּתַיְיחֵס הַשִּׂמְחָה לַלֵּב **that gladness is attributed to the heart:** [תְּהִלִּים קה, ג] יִשְׂמַח לֵב מְבַקְשֵׁי ה׳ **"Let the heart of those who seek Hashem be glad" (Tehillim 105:3);** [שָׁם ד, ח] וְכֵן נָתַתָּ שִׂמְחָה בְלִבִּי **and likewise, "You have put gladness in my heart" (ibid. 4:8);** [מִשְׁלֵי כג, טו] יִשְׂמַח לִבִּי גַּם אָנִי **"my heart too will be glad, even mine" (Mishlei 23:15);** וְכֵן בְּכַמָּה פְּסוּקִים. **and so in several verses.** **"Joy" corresponds to the vav in the Name Havayah,** וְשָׂשׂוֹן נֶגֶד ו׳ שֶׁבְּשֵׁם הַוָ״ה שֶׁהוּא הַנָּהָר הַיּוֹצֵא מֵעֵדֶן **which is "the river going out of Eden** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ כו, א) לְהַשְׁקוֹת אֶת הַגָּן[1027] **to water the garden,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Zohar I 26a);** וּכְתִיב [יְשַׁעְיָה יב, ג] וּשְׁאַבְתֶּם מַיִם בְּשָׂשׂוֹן[1028] **and it is written (Yeshayah 12:3), "And you shall draw water with joy** מִמַּעַיְנֵי הַיְשׁוּעָה **from the wellsprings of salvation";** וְהַיְינוּ נָהָר דְּנָגִיד וְנָפִיק **that is, the river that flows and goes forth** וְלָא פָּסִיק מִימוֹי לְעָלְמִין **and whose waters never cease.** וְאִיתָא בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **And it is stated in the Yerushalmi (Sukkah 5:1, 22b),** (סוּכָּה נ, ב ד״ה חַד) הוּבָא בְּתוֹסָפוֹת (סוּכָּה פ״ה ה״א כב, ב)

[1023] **Zohar III, 31b (Tzav)** — "An action below awakens an action above. If a person performs a holy action below, a holiness above is awakened and rests upon him. If he performs a deed of impurity below, a spirit of impurity is awakened above and rests upon him.... Action depends upon action, and speech upon speech."

[1024] **Psalms 37:30** — "The mouth of the righteous meditates wisdom, and his tongue speaks judgment."

[1025] **Sefer Yetzirah 4, letter tav** — "He made the letter tav reign, bound a crown to it, and through it formed the moon in the world, the Sabbath day in the year, and the mouth in the person." This is the recension that assigns the moon to tav. The Gra recension also associates tav with Sabbath and the mouth, but assigns Jupiter rather than the moon. Rav Tzadok's point here concerns Sabbath and speech.

[1026] **Zohar III, 201b (Balak)** — "These three mouths were created on the eve of the Sabbath at twilight. When the day became holy, the mouth appointed over all the other mouths ascended. Which is it? That day which ascended and became holy in everything, which is called 'the mouth of the Lord.' ... When the day became holy, the mouth that rules over everything ascended: the mouth of the Lord."

[1027] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:6** — "Rabbi Yose son of Rabbi Chanina said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said to Moses: 'To you I reveal the reason for the heifer; for another, it is a statute.' ... Things concealed from you in this world will become visible in the World to Come, like a blind person who sees, as it is written, 'I shall lead the blind upon a road they did not know.'"

[1028] **Sotah 13b** — "Some say: Moses did not die. Here it is written, 'Moses died there,' and there it is written, 'He was there with the Lord.' Just as there he stood and served, so here he stands and serves."

cited in Tosafos (Sukkah 50b, s.v. Chad), שֶׁמִּשָּׁם שׁוֹאֲבִין רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ[1029] **that from there they drew ruach hakodesh;** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and it is stated in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג׳ סא, א) **(III 61a):** רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ כְּלוֹמַר **"Ruach hakodesh—that is,** רוּחַ מֵהַהוּא קוֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא **a spirit from that holy one above";** וְהַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי עַמּוּדָא **that is, through the central pillar,** דְּאָמְצָעִיתָא שֶׁיּוֹצֵא מֵעֵדֶן לְהַשְׁקוֹת אֶת הַגָּן **which goes out of Eden to water the garden,** בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **the aspect of Knesses Yisrael,** שְׁכִינְתָּא תַּתָּאָה **the lower Shechinah.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (מְגִילָּה טז:) **And in the Gemara (Megillah 16b)** נֶדֶרֶשׁ וְשָׂשׂוֹן זוֹ מִילָה וְכוּ׳ **"and joy" is expounded: "This is milah," etc.** וְהַכֹּל אֶחָד דְּגוּף וּבְרִית **And it is all one, for body and covenant** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ חָד[1030] **are counted as one, as they said** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג׳ רמב ב וְשָׁאַר מְקוֹמוֹת) **(Zohar III 242b and elsewhere);** וְאִיתָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א׳ קעו, ב) **and it is stated (Zohar I 176b):** וְיַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף אִינּוּן[1031] **"Yaakov and Yosef are as one";** וְאִיתָא (שָׁם קפב, ב) **and it is stated (ibid. 182b):** וְתַרְוַויְיהוּ כַּחֲדָא אָזְלִי **"And the two of them go together,** וְדָא הוּא רָזָא דְּאַת ו״ו **and this is the secret of the letter vav-vav,** דְּאָזְלִי תַּרְוַויְיהוּ כַּחֲדָא וְכוּ׳ **that both of them go together," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּיַעֲקֹב כְּתִיב [מִיכָה ז, כ] **That is, regarding Yaakov it is written (Michah 7:20),** תִּתֵּן אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב **"You will give truth to Yaakov"—** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ אוֹת ו׳ דָּא אִיקְרֵי אוֹת אֱמֶת[1032] **the letter vav, for this is called "the letter of truth,"** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (ח״ג ב, א) **as they said in the holy Zohar (III 2a);** וְיוֹסֵף אוֹת ו׳ זְעִירָא[1033] **and Yosef is the small letter vav,** ו׳ הַמְּילּוּי **the vav of the spelled-out letter,** וְכֵן כָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (שָׁם יא, א) **and so it is written in the holy Zohar (ibid. 11a).** וְעַל כֵּן אִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **Therefore it is stated in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק א׳ קצד, א) **(I 194a)** דְּנָהָר דָּא יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק[1034] **that "the river" is Yosef HaTzaddik,** וְאִיתָא (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן כד) **and it is stated (Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 24)** דְּאִיהוּ צַדִּיק דְּנָפִיק מֵעֵדֶן וְכוּ׳[1035] **that he is "the tzaddik who goes forth from Eden," etc.;** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וִיקָר אֲחָרוֹנָה שֶׁבַּשֵּׁם **"Honor" corresponds to the final hei of the Name;** וּבַגְּמָרָא [מְגִילָּה שָׁם] אָמְרוּ **and in the Gemara (Megillah, ibid.) they said,** אֵלּוּ תְּפִילִּין וְכוּ׳ שֶׁבָּרֹאשׁ **"These are tefillin," etc., "of the head";** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and this is in the manner of what they said** (הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפֶסַח אֵלִיָּהוּ) **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pesach Eliyahu):** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **"Keser Elyon**

[1029] **Zohar II, 89a (Yitro)** — "Through the will of Atika Kadisha his soul went forth and was concealed in Him. Therefore it is written, 'No man knows his burial place.' Just as Atika Kadisha is concealed from all that is concealed, and neither upper nor lower beings know Him, so this soul, concealed in this will—which is revealed at the time of the Sabbath afternoon prayer—is hidden from all that is hidden in the world, and judgment has no dominion over it. Happy is the portion of Moses!"

[1030] **Isaiah 25:8** — "He shall swallow up death forever; the Lord God shall wipe the tear from every face, and remove His people's reproach from all the earth, for the Lord has spoken."

[1031] Parallel: **Mei HaShiloach, Volume I, Exodus, Beshalach 13** — "For this purpose they were given the commandments of Sabbath and the red heifer there at Marah, and were commanded concerning judgments. Sabbath teaches: See, the blessed God gives you a commandment through which you serve Him by ceasing from activity; why, then, complain? The red heifer points toward the future, for in the future the Lord will be One and His name One; then service will cease, and there will be no anger. Judgments teach order: do not constantly think of forcing the hour in order to attain all this goodness. Everything must proceed in an order that becomes fixed in the heart without alteration."

Connection: The Ishbitzer explicitly joins the red heifer with the future abolition of anger, and places it beside Sabbath's sanctification of cessation. This clarifies the maamar's link between Parah, the repair of the primordial damage, and Sabbath as a present anticipation of that future.

[1032] **Shaar Maamarei Razal, Shabbat, passage beginning "Let us return to Rabbi Akiva"** — "Rabbi Akiva attained what Moses our teacher did not attain, for Moses our teacher attained only forty-nine gates, while he attained the fiftieth.... Our Sages said that the Holy One showed Moses each generation and its leaders, and showed him Rabbi Akiva expounding the crowns of the letters.... 'Be silent; thus he ascended in thought'—that is, be silent, for through such a death he ascended in thought and to the place of the eyes." The specific statement about the fiftieth gate appears in the comment introduced "Shmuel said," identifying Rabbi Shmuel Vital's annotation within the Lurianic collection. Rav Tzadok develops its relation to repentance here; the annotation itself explains Rabbi Akiva's attainment through his martyrdom. Rav Tzadok states outright in Pri Tzaddik, Lag BaOmer 1, that Rabbi Akiva was the root of Torah she'b'al peh, "as is stated in the writings of the Arizal."

[1033] **Pesikta Rabbati 14** — "Solomon said: 'In every passage of Torah and in all the depths of wisdom I entered and grasped them'—'All this I tested through wisdom.' Why does he return and say, 'I said: Let me become wise'? Concerning this passage he cried, 'Let me become wise!'"

[1034] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:3** — "Solomon said: 'I understood all these things, but the passage of the red heifer I investigated, questioned, and searched out: 'I said: Let me become wise, but it is distant from me.'"

[1035] **Proverbs 2:6** — "For the Lord gives wisdom; from His mouth come knowledge and understanding." Rav Tzadok reads the verse's two clauses as the Written Torah given by God, and the Oral Torah that articulates further understanding from it.

is Keser Malchus," קַרְקַפְתָּא דִּתְפִילִּין **the head-tefillin,** בְּחִינַת כֶּתֶר עַל הַמּוֹחַ שֶׁבְּרֹאשָׁם **the aspect of a crown upon the mind in their head;** וְכֵן יָקָר בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **and likewise "honor" is the aspect of Atika,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as has been explained many times,** וְאִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת. **and it is Keser Malchus.** וּכְנֶגֶד ה׳ שְׁכִינְתָּא תַּתָּאָה **And it corresponds to the hei, the lower Shechinah,** בְּסוֹד נָעוּץ סוֹפוֹ בְּתְחִלָּתוֹ. **in the secret of "its end is embedded in its beginning."** וּכְנֶגֶד אַרְבָּעָה דְּבָרִים הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל **And corresponding to the four things mentioned above,** יֵשׁ אַרְבַּע מִצְוֹת בְּפוּרִים **there are four mitzvos on Purim:** מִקְרָא מְגִילָּה. **reading the Megillah;** מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה. **feasting and rejoicing;** מִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת. **sending portions;** וּמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים. **and gifts to the poor.** מִקְרָא מְגִילָּה נֶגֶד אוֹרָה **Reading the Megillah corresponds to "light,"** שֶׁהוּא יו״ד חָכְמָה **which is the yud, Chochmah—** תּוֹרָה אוֹר **"Torah is light"—** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **that is, the Written Torah;** וּכְעֵין מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ כַּאֲמִיתָּהּ שֶׁל מְגִילָּה שָׁם) **similar to what they said (Megillah, ibid.)** שֶׁצְּרִיכָה שִׂרְטוּט **that it requires ruled lines** תּוֹרָה.[1036] **like the Torah scroll itself.** וְאַף דִּמְגִילָּה מִדְּרַבָּנָן **And although the Megillah is rabbinic,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם אָמְרוּ (יוֹמָא כט.) **nevertheless they said (Yoma 29a),** נִיתְּנָה לִכְתּוֹב קָא אָמְרִינַן[1037] **"We say that it was given to be written";** וְהַיְינוּ דִּמְגִילַּת אֶסְתֵּר **that is, Megillas Esther** יֵשׁ בָּהּ הָאוֹר **contains the light** שֶׁנִּקְבַּע בַּלֵּב לְדוֹרוֹת **that is fixed in the heart for all generations,** לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד **forever and ever,** שֶׁעַל זֶה מוֹרֶה מַה שֶּׁנִּיתַּן לִכְתּוֹב **which is indicated by its having been given to be written;** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָנוּ מְפָרְשִׁים **as we explain** מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה יא, ז) **what they said (Bereishis Rabbah 11:7):** יַעֲקֹב שֶׁכָּתוּב בּוֹ שָׁמְרָה שַׁבָּת וְכוּלֵּי **"Yaakov, regarding whom Shabbos observance is written," etc.:** אַף שֶׁגַּם אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **although Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him, also** קִיֵּים מִצְוַת שַׁבָּת **kept the mitzvah of Shabbos,** בִּכְלַל כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת שֶׁקִּיֵּים **as part of all the mitzvos that he kept,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם אָמַר **nevertheless it says** שֶׁאֵין כָּתוּב בּוֹ וְכוּלֵּי **that "it is not written regarding him," etc.;** אֲבָל בְּיַעֲקֹב שֶׁכָּתוּב בּוֹ מְפוֹרָשׁ **but regarding Yaakov, of whom it is written explicitly,** הוּא לְאוֹת **it is a sign** שֶׁנִּנְקְבַּע בּוֹ הַקְּדוּשָּׁה לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד **that the holiness was fixed in him forever** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר וַיִּשְׁלַח מַאֲמָר ז׳) **(as explained in Vayishlach, maamar 7).** וְזֶה עִנְיַן אוֹרָה **And this is the matter of "light"** נֶגֶד קְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָּה **corresponding to the reading of the Megillah,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ הָאוֹר שֶׁנִּיתַּן לִכְתּוֹב. **which contains the light that was given to be written.** וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד י׳ שֶׁבְּשֵׁם הַוָיָ״ה. **And it corresponds to the yud in the Name Havayah.** וּבִירוּשַׁלְמִי (מְגִילָּה פֶּרֶק א׳ הֲלָכָה ה) **And in the Yerushalmi (Megillah, perek 1, halachah 5)** אִיתָא אַף מְגִילַּת אֶסְתֵּר וְהַלָּכוֹת **it is stated: "Also Megillas Esther and the halachos** אֵינָן עֲתִידִין לְיבָטֵל[1038] **will not in the future be nullified;** וְנֶאֱמַר לְהַלָּן [אֶסְתֵּר ט, לב] וְלֹא יָסָף [דְּבָרִים ה, יט] נֶאֱמַר כָּאן **it says here (Devarim 5:19), 'and did not add,'** וְזִכְרָם לֹא יָסוּף מִזַּרְעָם. [כח] **and it says there (Esther 9:28), 'nor shall their remembrance cease from their seed.'"** וּמַיְירֵי שָׁם **And it speaks there** אַף בִּזְמַן שֶׁיִּבָּטְלוּ שְׁאָר הַנְּבִיאִים עַיֵּין שָׁם. **even of the time when the rest of the Prophets will be nullified; see there.** וְהַיְינוּ דִּשְׁאָר נְבִיאִים **That is, the other Prophets** נֶאֶמְרוּ רַק לְבַטֵּל הָרַב כַּעַס **were said only to undo the "much anger,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (נְדָרִים כב:) **as they said (Nedarim 22b):** אִלְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **"Had Yisrael not sinned,** לֹא נִיתַּן לָהֶם **they would have been given only** אֶלָּא חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תּוֹרָה **the five Chumashim of the Torah," etc.,** וְכוּלֵּי כִּי בְּרֹב חָכְמָה רָב [קֹהֶלֶת א, יח] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Koheles 1:18),** כָּעַס **"For in much wisdom is much anger."** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן הַמְּגִילָּה **This is not so of the Megillah,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ הָאוֹר **which contains the light** שֶׁיָּאִיר בַּלֵּב **that will shine in the heart,** וְיוּקְבַּע הָאוֹר בַּלֵּב לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד **and the light will be fixed in the heart forever,** וְזֶה לֹא יִתָּבֵטֵל **and this will not be nullified.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ מְגִילָּה נִקְרֵאת **And this is what they said, "The Megillah is read":** שֶׁזּוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָּה **regarding this light** שֶׁאוֹר זֶה **that is merited through reading the Megillah,** אָמַר נִקְרֵאת **it says "is read,"** שֶׁהָאוֹר בָּא מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **for the light comes from Hashem Yisbarach,** רַק עַל יְדֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל קוֹרִין לְמַטָּה **only through Yisrael reading below;** וְעַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בִּמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **similar to what they said about the eradication of Amalek,** אַתָּם מַזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַטָּה וַאֲנִי מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַעְלָה. **"You mention his name below, and I erase his name from above."** וּבָא רֶמֶז זֶה בְּרֵישׁ

[1036] **Rashi on Exodus 31:3** — "'Wisdom'—what a person hears from others and learns. 'Understanding'—he understands a matter in his own heart from things he has learned. 'Knowledge'—the Holy Spirit."

[1037] **I Kings 5:9** — "God gave Solomon wisdom and exceedingly great understanding, and breadth of heart like the sand upon the seashore."

[1038] **Midrash Tanchuma, Chukat 6** — "Rabbi Levi says: Just as the sand makes a boundary and a fence for the sea, so that it does not go forth and flood the world, so Solomon's wisdom stood against his inclination, that he should not sin. The proverb says: If you lack understanding, what have you acquired? If you have acquired understanding, what do you lack?" Bamidbar Rabbah 19:3 transmits the shorter image of wisdom as Solomon's boundary. Tanchuma gives the fuller wording quoted by Rav Tzadok.

And this hint comes at the beginning of the tractate, הַמַּסֶּכְתָּא **for this is the whole essence** שֶׁזֶּה כָּל עִיקַּר עֵסֶק **of the matter** לִהְיוֹת **of the mitzvah of Purim and the reading of the Megillah:** מִצְוַת פּוּרִים וּקְרִיאַת הַמְּגִילָּה **that it be "read,"** נִקְרֵאת **and the light be fixed forever** וְיוּקְבַּע הָאוֹר לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **by Hashem Yisbarach.** **And it teaches the power of the words of the Sofrim,** וְתָנֵי כֹּחַ דִּבְרֵי סוֹפְרִים שֶׁנָּתְנוּ כֹּחַ לְגַבֵּי הַכְּפָרִים **who granted power with regard to the villages:** שֶׁאַף שֶׁקּוֹרִין בְּאַחַד עָשָׂר **that although they read on the eleventh,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יִהְיוּ לָהֶם כֹּחַ זֶה **nevertheless they will have this power,** לִהְיוֹת נִקְרֵאת מִלְמַעְלָה **for it to be "read" from above,** וְיִזְכּוּ לָאוֹר. **and they will merit the light.** 2 (ב) **The mitzvah of feasting and rejoicing** הוּא נֶגֶד מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר וְשִׂמְחָה **corresponds to what is said, "and gladness,"** שֶׁהוּא נֶגֶד ה׳ עִלָּאָה **which corresponds to the upper hei,** בִּינָה **Binah, the heart, as we said.** לִבָּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And it is written "feasting and gladness,"** וּכְתִיב מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **for Yisrael merit gladness** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכִין לְשִׂמְחָה עַל יְדֵי הַמִּשְׁתֶּה דְּיֵינָא **through the feast of wine;** אַף שֶׁהַיַּיִן גּוֹרֵם **although wine causes the opposite,** הַהֶפֶךְ רַחֲמָנָא לִצְלַן **Heaven save us,** שֶׁכָּל הָעֲרָיוֹת דּוֹמוֹת עָלָיו כְּמִישׁוֹר[1039] **that all forbidden relations seem to him like level ground** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא עה, א) **(as stated in Yoma 75a),** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יִשְׂרָאֵל זוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי הַיַּיִן לְיִשְׂרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **nevertheless Yisrael merit through wine** **"gladness for the upright of heart,"** לְיַשֵּׁר הַלֵּב **to straighten the heart** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כּוּלּוֹ טוֹב **so that it be entirely good,** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ שְׂמֵחִים וְטוֹבֵי לֵב **that they be joyous and good-hearted;** (שָׁם עו:) וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **and this is what they said (ibid. 76b),** זָכָה מְשַׂמְּחוֹ[1040] **"If he merits, it gladdens him"—** וְהַיְינוּ יְשָׁרִים לְשִׂמְחָה **that is, "the upright to gladness,"** לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **"gladness for the upright of heart," as mentioned above.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (מְגִילָּה יב:) **And similar to what they said (Megillah 12b):** יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי שַׁבָּת הָיָה **"The seventh day was Shabbos,** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל אוֹכְלִין וְשׁוֹתִין **when Yisrael eat and drink** מַתְחִילִין בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **they begin with words of Torah** וּבְדִבְרֵי תִּשְׁבָּחוֹת אֲבָל וְכוּלֵּי **and words of praise; but," etc.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁרָאִינוּ בְּסִעוּדָתוֹ **And as we saw at his feast,** שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה נַבְלוּת לִבּוֹ **where the vileness of his heart was revealed** עַל יְדֵי הַיַּיִן **through the wine,** שֶׁדָּרַשׁ דָּבָר הַמְגוּנֶּה **for he demanded something disgraceful** אַף לְעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת. **even by the standards of idolaters.** וְזֶהוּ לֹא זָכָה **And this is "If he does not merit, it desolates him":** מְשַׂמְּמוֹ שֶׁעֲרָיוֹת כּוּלָּם דּוֹמוֹת עָלָיו כְּמִישׁוֹר **that all forbidden relations seem to him like level ground,** יִתְהַלֵּךְ בְּמֵישָׁרִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִשְׁלֵי כג, לא] **as it says (Mishlei 23:31),** שָׁם [יוֹמָא עה] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא. **"it goes down smoothly," as they said in the Gemara there (Yoma 75).** (ג 3) **Sending portions one to another** הוּא נֶגֶד מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר וְשָׁשׂוֹן מִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת אִישׁ לְרֵעֵהוּ **corresponds to what is said, "and joy,"** שֶׁהוּא נֶגֶד ו׳ שֶׁבַּשֵּׁם **which corresponds to the vav in the Name,** עִם ו׳ הַמִּילּוּי כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ. **together with the vav of the spelled-out letter, as we said.** **And the root of the mitzvah is to unite the hearts,** וְשׁוֹרֶשׁ הַמִּצְוָה לְיַחֵד הַלְּבָבוֹת **that they be like one man with one heart;** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד וְזֶה הֲכָנָה **and this is a preparation to receive the words of Torah,** לְקַבֵּל דִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **as we find at Matan Torah,** דִּכְתִיב [שְׁמוֹת יט, ב] וַיִּחַן יִשְׂרָאֵל **where it is written (Shemos 19:2), "And Yisrael encamped"—** כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד **"like one man with one heart,"** [יִתְרוֹ בַּחֹדֶשׁ א] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמְּכִילְתָּא **as they said in the Mechilta (Yisro, BaChodesh 1);** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה זָכוּ לְמַתַּן תּוֹרָה. **and through this they merited Matan Torah.** **And the drawing-down from Chochmah** וְהַהַמְשָׁכָה מֵחָכְמָה **is through the river that flows and goes forth;** עַל יְדֵי הַנָּהָר דְּנָגִיד וְנָפִיק **that is, when they merit the attribute of peace,** וְהַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁזּוֹכִין לְמִדַּת שָׁלוֹם שֶׁיִּהְיוּ **to be like one man with one heart,** כְּאִישׁ אֶחָד בְּלֵב אֶחָד עַל יְדֵי זֶה מַמְשִׁיכִין הָאוֹר **through this they draw down the light,** שֶׁהוּא חָכְמָה **which is Chochmah,** שֶׁיּוּקְבַּע לְעוֹלְמֵי עַד **that it be fixed forever** בִּכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **in Knesses Yisrael,** שֶׁהוּא הַגָּן שְׁכִינְתָּא תַּתָּאָה. **which is the garden, the lower Shechinah.** **And this is the holiness of Yaakov and Yosef:** וְהוּא קְדוּשַׁת יַעֲקֹב וְיוֹסֵף מִדַּת אֱמֶת לְיַעֲקֹב **the attribute of truth for Yaakov,** וְיוֹסֵף שָׁמְּדָתוֹ שָׁלוֹם[1041]

[1039] **Rosh Hashanah 21b** — "One said: 'Among prophets there arose none, but among kings there did arise [one like Moses].' How, then, do I explain, 'Kohelet sought to find desirable words'? Kohelet sought to adjudicate matters of the heart without witnesses or warning. A heavenly voice went forth and said: 'Words of truth written uprightly'—'By the testimony of two witnesses....'" The comparison concerns Solomon's wisdom. The same passage nonetheless limits judgment to the Torah's rules of evidence.

[1040] **Avodah Zarah 5a** — "Rabbi Shemuel bar Nachmani said in Rabbi Yonatan's name: What is meant by 'The utterance of David son of Jesse, the utterance of the man raised on high'? The utterance of David son of Jesse, who raised the yoke of repentance."

[1041] **Sanhedrin 104b** — "Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: They sought to count one more. The image of his father came and prostrated itself before them, but they paid it no heed. Fire came from heaven and singed their benches, but they paid it no heed. A heavenly voice went forth: 'One who placed My house before his own—and moreover built My

[זוה"ק ח"א קצז, ב] **and Yosef, whose attribute is peace (Zohar I 197b);** וּכְתִיב [זְכַרְיָה ח, יט] וְהָאֱמֶת וְהַשָּׁלוֹם אֱהָבוּ **and it is written (Zechariah 8:19), "Love truth and peace,"** דְּאֱמֶת וְשָׁלוֹם קְשִׁיר דָּא בְּדָא[1042] **for truth and peace are bound one to the other** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג' יב, ב). **(as stated in Zohar III 12b).** (ד מַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **4) Gifts to the poor,** מִצְוַת צְדָקָה **the mitzvah of tzedakah,** נֶגֶד ה' תַּתָּאָה **corresponds to the lower hei,** וְנֶגֶד מַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וִיקָר **and to what is said, "and honor";** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and this is according to what they said** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפָתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] צֶדֶק מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישָׁא.[1043] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pesach Eliyahu): "Tzedek is the holy Malchus."** וּכְשֶׁהוּא בְּשִׁלֵּימוּת עִם ה' צְדָקָה **And when it is complete, with the hei, it is tzedakah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **as they said in Tikkunei Zohar** (תִּקּוּן כא נח, א הַנְּזִנְקָר) **(Tikkun 21, 58a, mentioned above):** וְעוֹד שְׁכִינְתָּא אִתְקְרִיאַת צְדָקָה **"Furthermore, the Shechinah is called tzedakah,** וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא בַּעַל צְדָקָה וְכוּ' **and HaKadosh Baruch Hu the master of tzedakah, etc.;** וּמַה דַּהֲוַות צְדָק **and what was tzedek** אִתְעֲבִידַת צְדָקָה וְכוּ' **became tzedakah," etc.;** עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת. **see there at length.** דְּצֶדֶק שְׁכִינְתָּא תַּתָּאָה **For tzedek is the lower Shechinah,** וּכְשֶׁנִּמְשָׁךְ מֵעֵדֶן **and when it is drawn from Eden,** שְׁכִינְתָּא עִלָּאָה צְדָקָה **the upper Shechinah, it is tzedakah;** (שָׁם) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **and this is what they said in Tikkunei Zohar (ibid.):** וַעֲלֵיהּ אִתְּמַר [מִשְׁלֵי יד, לד][1044] **"And about it is said, 'Tzedakah exalts a nation' (Mishlei 14:34)";** שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה לְשׁוֹן תְּרוֹמֵם **that is, up to Atika,** וְהַיְינוּ עַד עַתִּיקָא **for so the term "exalts" indicates** בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְאֵין שִׁיעוּר **in the words of Torah—without limit;** וְכֵן כְּתִיב [תְּהִלִּים קיב, ט] קַרְנוֹ תָּרוּם בְּכָבוֹד **and likewise it is written (Tehillim 112:9), "His horn shall be exalted with honor,"** וְהַיְינוּ עַד עַתִּיקָא **that is, up to Atika** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים מַאֲמָר טו) **(as explained in Parshas Shekalim, maamar 15).** וְעַל כֵּן שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל עַתִּיקָא וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **Therefore it corresponds to what is said, "and honor,"** הוּא נֶגֶד מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר וִיקָר **which indicates Atika, as mentioned above,** שֶׁמַּהֲאי טַעְמָא **that for this reason** נִדְרָשׁ עַל תְּפִילִּין שֶׁל רֹאשׁ. **it is expounded as the tefillin of the head.** וּכְתִיב וְהַיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה **And it is written, "And these days** נִזְכָּרִים וְנַעֲשִׂים בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר **are remembered and kept in every generation":** שֶׁאַף שֶׁיְּצוּיִיר חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **that even should it come about, Heaven forbid,** שֶׁיְּבָטְלוּ הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת **that the festivals be nullified,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם יִהְיֶה נַעֲשֶׂה **nevertheless there will be accomplished** מַעֲשֵׂה כֹּחַ הַיָּמִים **the working of the power of the days,** הַמְּחַיֶּית עֲמָלֵק **the eradication of Amalek,** וְיִזְכּוּ לְיִחוּד שֵׁם הֳוָי"ה **and they will merit the union of the Name Havayah,** אַרְבַּע הָאוֹתִיּוֹת **its four letters,** עַל יְדֵי הַיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **through these days, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה יִהְיֶה עַל יָדֵי **And this will be through the remembrance** שֶׁתּוּקְדַּם לוֹ **that will precede it,** גַּם כֵּן מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **which also comes from Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהִבְטִיחַ **as He promised,** וְזִכְרָם לֹא יָסוּף מִזַּרְעָם **"nor shall their remembrance cease from their seed."** וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְקַיֵּים מִצְוֹתָיו תְּחִלָּה[1045] **And HaKadosh Baruch Hu fulfills His mitzvos first,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה לה, ג) **(Vayikra Rabbah 35:3);** וְאַף מִצְוֹת זְקֵנִים **and even the mitzvos of the Elders** גַּם כֵּן ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ מְקַיֵּים **Hashem Yisbarach likewise fulfills,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said in the Pesikta** (לַחֲנוּכָּה פָּרָשָׁה ג סִימָן, א) **(for Chanukah, parsha 3, siman 1)** וּמִדְרָשׁ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אִיּוֹב כב, כח] וְתִגְזַר אוֹמֶר וְיָקָם לָךְ **and the Midrash (Tanchuma, Naso 29), as it says** (תַּנְחוּמָא נָשֹׂא כט) **(Iyov 22:28), "You will decree a matter and it will be fulfilled for you."** וּמְקַיֵּים ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **And Hashem**

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house in seven years, but his own in thirteen—shall stand before kings, not before the obscure.' ... A heavenly voice went forth: 'Is it from you that He should repay, because you reject it? For you must choose, and not I?'" The builder of the Temple is Solomon. The debate concerns adding him to the Mishnah's list of kings lacking a share in the World to Come; the heavenly intervention rejects that human judgment.

[1042] **Shabbat 56b** — "Rabbi Shemuel bar Nachmani said in Rabbi Yonatan's name: Whoever says that Solomon sinned is mistaken, for it is said, 'His heart was not whole with the Lord his God like the heart of David his father': it was not like David his father's heart, but he did not sin.... Because he ought to have protested against his wives and did not protest, Scripture accounts it to him as though he sinned."

[1043] **Job 14:4** — "Who can bring a pure thing from an impure one? Not one." The Midrash turns the question into an affirmation: Is it not the One—the Unique One of the world—who can bring purity from impurity?

[1044] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:1** — "'Who can bring a pure thing from an impure one? Is it not the One?' Such as Abraham from Terach, Hezekiah from Ahaz, Josiah from Amon, Mordechai from Shimei, Israel from the nations, and the World to Come from this world. Who did this? Who commanded this? Who decreed this? Is it not the Unique One of the world?"

[1045] **Shabbat 77b** — "He said to him: 'Why do the goats go first, and afterward the sheep?' He answered: 'Like the creation of the world: first darkness, and afterward light.'" Rabbi Zeira's question to Rav Yehudah supplies the expression quoted here. Rav Tzadok applies the sequence of darkness and light to the purification that brings the future world out of the present one.

Yisbarach fulfills מִצְוַת מִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת אִישׁ לְרֵעֵהוּ[1046] **the mitzvah of sending portions one to another,** שֶׁבְּיָמִים אֵלּוּ **for in these days,** שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה הַיִּחוּד י״ה בְּשֵׁם ו״ה **when the union of yud-hei with the Name vav-hei is made,** נִקְרְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל רֵעִים לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא[1047] **Yisrael are called friends of HaKadosh Baruch Hu:** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים קכב, ח] לְמַעַן אַחַי וְרֵעָי[1048] **as it says (Tehillim 122:8), "For the sake of my brothers and my friends";** וְכֵן כָּתַב בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא (יִתְרוֹ ה׳). **and so it is written in Midrash Tanchuma (Yisro 5).** וְרַשִׁ״י (שַׁבָּת לא. ד״ה דַּעֲלָךְ) פֵּירֵשׁ **And Rashi (Shabbos 31a, s.v. Da'alach) explained** מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ דַּעֲלָךְ סָנֵי **what they said, "What is hateful to you,** לְחַבְרָךְ לָא תַּעֲבֵיד **do not do to your fellow,"** עַל ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ[1049] **as referring to Hashem Yisbarach,** עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִשְׁלֵי כז, י] **based on what is said (Mishlei 27:10),** רֵעֲךָ וְרֵעַ אָבִיךָ אַל תַּעֲזוֹב עַיִן שָׁם.[1050] **"Your friend and your father's friend do not forsake"; see there.** וְכֵן מַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **And likewise gifts to the poor,** דְּאִיתָא (יְרוּשַׁלְמִי מְגִילָּה פ״א ה״ד ה, א) **as it is stated (Yerushalmi Megillah 1:4, 5a):** אֵין מְדַקְדְּקִין בְּמִצְוַת פּוּרִים **"We are not exacting with the Purim mitzvah of giving;** אֶלָּא כָּל מִי שֶׁפּוֹשֵׁט יָדוֹ לִיטּוֹל **rather, whoever stretches out his hand to take** נוֹתְנִין לוֹ.[1051] **is given."** וְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְקַיֵּים מִצְוַת זְקֵנִים **And HaKadosh Baruch Hu fulfills the mitzvah of the Elders** וְנוֹתֵן צְדָקָה לְכָל דּוֹרְשֵׁי יְשׁוּעָתוֹ **and gives tzedakah to all who seek His salvation,** בְּכָל הָעִנְיָנִים:[1052] **in all matters.**

[1046] **Pesachim 87b** — "Rabbi Elazar said: The Holy One, blessed be He, exiled Israel among the nations only so that converts might be added to them, as it says, 'I shall sow her for Myself in the land.' Does a person sow a se'ah except to bring in many kor?" The Gemara expressly speaks of converts and compares exile with sowing. The extension to holy sparks within the nations belongs to the mystical explanation cited by Rav Tzadok.

[1047] **Shaar HaPesukim, Shemot, opening account of the Egyptian exile** — "The reason for the exile in which Israel was exiled among the nations has already been explained in the passage of Re'eh, concerning the commandment to remember the Exodus. We said that Adam contained all the souls and all the worlds. When he sinned, all those souls fell from him into the husks, which are divided among the seventy nations. Israel must be exiled there, among each and every nation, to gather the roses of the holy souls scattered among those thorns. As our Sages said in Midrash Rabbah: Why was Israel exiled among the nations? So that converts might be added to them. Understand this well." The Lurianic text explicitly applies the teaching about added converts to gathering holy souls dispersed among the seventy nations. Rav Tzadok expresses that gathering here in the language of holy sparks and their divine life.

[1048] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 2:8** — "'The voice of my beloved—behold, he comes': this is the King Messiah. When he says to Israel, 'In this month you will be redeemed,' they say: 'How can we be redeemed? Has not the Holy One sworn that He will subject us to seventy nations?' He says: 'One of you goes into exile to Barbaria, and one to Samatria; it is as though all of you had gone into exile.'" This is the passage cited in the manuscript as Shir HaShirim Rabbah 2:22; the retrieved edition places it within 2:8. The interpretation of these dispersed exiles as the collection of holy sparks is Rav Tzadok's development.

[1049] **Zohar III, 79b (Achrei Mot)** — "'From new moon to new moon and from Sabbath to Sabbath': why is one equated with the other? ... Their joy in one another is found only when Atika Kadisha is revealed, and then there is joy for all.... Of 'A psalm, a song for the Sabbath day,' we learned: for the Sabbath day itself—the praise with which the Holy One, blessed be He, praises it. Then joy is found, and the soul is increased, for Atika is revealed and union is made ready." The quoted passage establishes the revelation of Atika and the additional soul on Sabbath. Rav Tzadok specifies the morning meal here in applying that revelation to the reading of Parah.

[1050] **Bava Batra 14b** — "Who wrote them? Moshe wrote his book, the section of Bilam, and Iyov. Yehoshua wrote his book and eight verses of the Torah. Shmuel wrote his book, Shoftim, and Rus."

[1051] **Pesikta Rabbasi 14:11, Parah** — "We have heard of Moshe that Torah was written in his name: Remember the Torah of My servant Moshe. Of Shmuel a book was written: He wrote it in a book and placed it before Hashem. But we have heard nothing of this concerning Aharon. Rather, it teaches that this section was given to him, never to depart from him, his children, or his children's children until the end of all generations." The Midrash expounds They kept His testimonies and a statute He gave them. Rav Tzadok asks how the heifer's teaching remains active after the Temple's destruction.

[1052] **Bamidbar Rabbah 15:6** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, told Moshe: Go, tell Aharon, Do not fear; you are destined for a greatness beyond this. ... The offerings are practiced while the Temple stands, but the lamps are forever: The seven lamps shall give light toward the face of the Menorah. All the blessings I gave you to bless My children will never cease." The Midrash speaks of both the lamps and the priestly blessing as enduring. Rav Tzadok examines how that language applies when the Temple lamps are no longer lit.

פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר ב׳ Purim — Maamar Bais

לַעֲשׂוֹת אוֹתָם **"To make them** [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כב] יְמֵי מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה. **days of feasting and gladness" (Esther 9:22).** הָעִיקָּר בַּיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה הַמִּשְׁתֶּה **The main thing in these days is the drinking-feast,** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and it is in line with what they said** (זֹהַר ח״ג רעא, ב) **(Zohar III 271b):** [מִשְׁלֵי ט, ה] לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחֲמִי **"Come, eat of my bread" (Mishlei 9:5) —** דָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא דִּבְכְתָב **this is the Written Torah;** [שָׁם] וּשְׁתוּ בְּיַיִן מָסָכְתִּי **"and drink of the wine I have mixed" (ibid.) —** דָּא יֵינָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא **this is the wine of the Torah** דִּבְעַל פֶּה. **that is Oral.** וְעִיקַּר קִטְרוּג הָמָן **And the essence of Haman's accusation** שֶׁהִגִּיעַ אָז זְמַן **was aroused because** נִתְעוֹרֵר עַל יְדֵי **the time had then arrived** הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **for the spreading forth of Torah she'b'al peh.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁזָּכוּ אַחַר כָּךְ **And so they merited afterward** לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת אוֹרָה **which is called "orah," light,** (שַׁבָּת פח, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shabbos 88a):** הֶדַר קִבְּלוּהָ **"They accepted it anew** בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **in the days of Achashverosh" —** וְהַיְינוּ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁעַל זֶה הָיָה **for it was regarding this that there was** הַכְּפִיַּת הָהָר כְּגִיגִית **the overturning of the mountain over them like a barrel** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר מַאֲמָר יג). **(as was explained in Parshas Zachor, maamar 13).** וְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא **And it is stated in the Gemara** (חוּלִין קלט, ב) **(Chullin 139b):** מֵאַיִן לְמשֶׁה מִן הַתּוֹרָה **"Where is Moshe alluded to in the Torah?" etc.** לְהָמָן מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן וְכוּלֵי **"Where is Haman alluded to in the Torah?" etc.** וְצָרִיךְ לְהָבִין **And we need to understand** לָמָּה נִצְרַךְ לְחַפֵּשׂ רֶמֶז **why it was necessary to search for an allusion** עַל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בַּתּוֹרָה **to Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, in the Torah,** וְכָל הַתּוֹרָה מָלֵא מִשְׁמוֹ **when the whole Torah is full of his name** וְנִקְרֵאת עַל שְׁמוֹ **and is called by his name** תּוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה. **"Toras Moshe."** גַּם מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **Also, what they said:** לְהָמָן מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן **"Where is Haman alluded to in the Torah?"** וְלָמָּה לֹא **"where are they alluded to in the Torah?"** מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן **— "Mordechai"** אֶסְתֵּר מָרְדְּכַי **"Esther,"** וְלָמָּה לֹא דָּרְשׁוּ **And why did they not expound** דָּוִד וּשְׁלֹמֹה **"David and Shlomo —** מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן וְכַדּוֹמֶה. **where are they alluded to in the Torah?" and the like?** גַּם לָמָּה רָמְזוּ **Also, why did they allude to** הָמָן בַּתּוֹרָה **Haman in the Torah** וְלֹא נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר וְסַנְחֵרִיב.[1053] **and not Nevuchadnetzar and Sancheriv?** אָכֵן יֵשׁ לוֹמַר **However, it may be said** שֶׁהָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ **that the intent of "Moshe from the Torah"** הַמְכוּוָּן מֹשֶׁה מִן הַתּוֹרָה **is that he was the root** הַדְּבָרִי תּוֹרָה **of the words of Torah,** שֶׁנִּקְרֵאת תּוֹרַת מֹשֶׁה **which is called Toras Moshe;** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **and about this it says** מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן **"where is it from the Torah,"** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַתּוֹרָה[1054] **meaning that he is the root of the Torah,** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **and about this it says** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ו, ג] בְּשַׁגַּם וְגוֹמֵר **"B'shagam," etc. (Bereishis 6:3) —** וְהַיְינוּ עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and this is in line with what they said** (זֹהַר ח״ג רטז, ב) **(Zohar III 216b):** דַּעֲתִיד הֲוָה מֹשֶׁה **that Moshe was destined** לְקַבְּלָא אוֹרַיְיתָא **to receive the Torah** בְּדָרָא דְּטוֹפָנָא וְכוּלֵי **in the generation of the Flood, etc.** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ל, יג) וְכֵן אָמְרוּ **And so they said (Shemos Rabbah 30:13)** שֶׁבִּיקֵּשׁ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **that Hakadosh Baruch Hu wished** לִיתֵּן לָהֶם אַרְבָּעָה דְּבָרִים **to give them four things,** תּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵי **Torah, etc.;** וְדַעַת דְּרָכֶיךָ לֹא חָפָצְנוּ **"and knowledge of Your ways we do not desire" —** זֶה תּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵי **this is Torah, etc.** דְּמַיִם **For water alludes to Torah,** (בָּבָא קַמָּא יז, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Bava Kamma 17a):** אֵין מַיִם רוֹמֵז לַתּוֹרָה **"Water means nothing but Torah."**[1055] וּכְתִיב [דְּבָרִים לב, ב] יַעֲרֹף כַּמָּטָר לִקְחִי **And it is written (Devarim 32:2), "My teaching shall drop as the rain" —** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **that is, the Written Torah,** שֶׁנִּיתְּנָה מִשָּׁמַיִם **given from Heaven,** וְהוּא מְפוֹרָשׁ לַכֹּל **and it is evident to all** שֶׁהוּא הַלֶּקַח טוֹב **which is the "good teaching"** שֶׁהוּא מֵהַשָּׁמַיִם כַּמָּטָר **that it is from Heaven, like the rain;** וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and the Torah**

[1053] **Ramban, Bamidbar 8:2** — "It is well known that when the Temple does not stand and the offerings cease because of its destruction, the lamps also cease. Rather, the Sages alluded only to the lamps of the Chanukah of the Chashmonaim, which are observed even after the destruction, during our exile. Likewise the priestly blessing, adjacent to the princes' dedication, is observed forever."

[1054] **Alshich, Bamidbar 8, Behaaloscha** — "It is difficult: the Midrash says the lamps endure forever, but the Menorah too ceased at the destruction. If this means the Chanukah lamps, there are eight of them: how can it identify them with The seven lamps shall give light? Moreover, they are not performed by priests alone, and they are only a memorial and of rabbinic origin: how are they mentioned in Torah? ... When the sanctuary below was established, a sanctuary above was established. When the lamps were kindled below, those above were kindled and remained burning forever from that kindling." Alshich raises explicit objections to the Chanukah reading and explains the lasting supernal effect of Aharon's kindling. Rav Tzadok offers the enduring light of Oral Torah as his interpretation.

[1055] **Shabbat 31a** — "Reish Lakish said: What is meant by Faithfulness of your times, strength, salvations, wisdom, and knowledge? Faithfulness is Zeraim; your times is Moed; strength is Nashim; salvations is Nezikin; wisdom is Kodashim; knowledge is Taharos. Even so, The fear of Hashem is His treasure."

she'b'al peh, שֶׁחַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל מְחַדְּשִׁים **which the Sages of Yisrael originate,** וְהֵם בֶּאֱמֶת **and they are in truth** דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים **the words of the Living God,** מַה שֶּׁה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ נוֹזֵל **what Hashem Yisbarach causes to flow** וּמַשְׁפִּיעַ בְּלִבָּם **and bestows into their hearts —** עַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר [שָׁם] תִּזַּל כַּטַּל **about this it says (ibid.), "shall distill as the dew,"** שֶׁאֵינוֹ נִיכָּר הַמַּשְׁפָּעָה **for the bestowal is not recognizable** מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם **as from Heaven** רַק אַחַר שֶׁיּוֹרַד **except after it has descended;** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר אִמְרָתִי **and about this it says "imrasi," my utterance,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר ח״א רלד, ב) **along the lines of what they said (Zohar I 234b):** אֲמִירָה בַּלֵּב **"amirah" is in the heart,** כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר **as you say,** [דְּבָרִים ח, יז] וְאָמַרְתָּ בִּלְבָבֶךָ **"and you shall say in your heart" (Devarim 8:17) —** אֲמִירָה בַּחֲשַׁאי. **"amirah" is in secret.** וְהוּא מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא **And it is from the dew of Atika** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת וַיְחִי רֵישׁ מַאֲמָר י) **(and it was explained in Parshas Vayechi, beginning of maamar 10).** וְהָיָה אָז **And at that time there was** נֶפֶשׁ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **the soul of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהָיָה מְקַבֵּל גַּם הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **who was the receiver of the Written Torah,** שֶׁהָיָה כָּלוּל בּוֹ **in which was included** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **also the Torah she'b'al peh,** בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה **at Matan Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה קוֹדֶם הַקִּלְקוּל **just as it was before the damage** (נְדָרִים כב, ב) **as they said (Nedarim 22b):** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **"Had Yisrael not sinned,** דְּאִלְמָלֵא חָטְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **they would have been given only** לֹא נִיתְּנוּ לָהֶם **the five books of the Torah," etc.;** אֶלָּא חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תּוֹרָה וְכוּלֵי. **all the light of Torah she'b'al peh.** כָּל אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and included in this would have been** וְהָיָה כָּלוּל בָּזֶה **And it would have been evident** וְהָיָה מְפוֹרָשׁ **that it is from Heaven,** שֶׁהוּא מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם **like a halachah l'Moshe miSinai,** כְּמוֹ הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי **the Torah she'b'al peh** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him.** שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם. **And so it is alluded to in the Flood,** וְכֵן נִרְמָז בַּמַּבּוּל נִבְקְעוּ [בְּרֵאשִׁית ז, יא] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Bereishis 7:11): "were broken up** מַעְיְנוֹת תְּהוֹם רַבָּה **all the fountains of the great deep,** וַאֲרֻבּוֹת הַשָּׁמַיִם נִפְתָּחוּ **and the windows of heaven were opened,"** שֶׁרוֹמֵז תַּרְעֵי דְּחָכְמְתָא לְעֵילָּא **which alludes to the gates of wisdom above** וּמַבּוּעֵי דְּחָכְמְתָא לְתַתָּא[1056] **and the springs of wisdom below** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר ח״א קיז, א). **(as it says in Zohar I 117a).** רַק מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיוּ **Only, because** דּוֹר הַמַּבּוּל רְשָׁעִים **the generation of the Flood were wicked,** נַעֲשׂוּ מֵי הַמַּבּוּל **it became the waters of the Flood,** וְנִשְׁטְפוּ בַּמַּיִם הַזְּדוֹנִים **and they were swept away in the raging waters** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת נֹחַ מַאֲמָר ב וּמַאֲמָר ג) **(and it was explained in Parshas Noach, maamar 2 and maamar 3).** וְזֶהוּ מֹשֶׁה מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנִין **And this is "Where is Moshe alluded to in the Torah,"** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **for he is the root of the Written Torah** שֶׁכָּלוּל בּוֹ **in which is included** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **the Torah she'b'al peh:** בְּשַׁגַּם הוּא וְגוֹמֵר **"B'shagam hu," etc.,** וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above:** וְהָיוּ יָמָיו **"and his days shall be** מֵאָה וְעֶשְׂרִים שָׁנָה **a hundred and twenty years,"** וּכְפֵרוּשׁ רַשִׁ״י.[1057] **as in Rashi's commentary.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ שָׁאֲלוּ **And afterward they asked about Haman,** וְכֵן מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **and likewise Mordechai and Esther,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהֵם הָיוּ שׁוֹרֶשׁ **that is, they were the root** הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁאָז הִתְחִיל **of the time when there began the spreading forth of Torah she'b'al peh.** וְאָמְרוּ הָמָן **And they said: "Haman —** מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנִין **where is he alluded to in the Torah?** הֲמִן הָעֵץ [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, יא] **'Hamin ha'etz' — Is it from the tree?" (Bereishis 3:11)** דְּהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָמָן **meaning that through Haman** זָכוּ לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **they merited the light of Torah she'b'al peh.** וְזֶה נִרְמָז **And this is alluded to** בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הֲמִן הָעֵץ **in what it says, "Hamin ha'etz,"** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **in line with what they said** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (ח״ג צח, א; קכד, ב וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **in the holy Zohar (III 98a; 124b, and elsewhere)** שֶׁיֵּשׁ תּוֹרָה **that there is Torah** מִסִּטְרָא דְּעֵץ הַחַיִּים **from the side of the Tree of Life,** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **that is, the Written Torah,** וְיֵשׁ מִסִּטְרָא **and there is Torah from the side** דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת טוֹב וָרָע **of the Tree of Knowledge of Good**

[1056] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:2:4, Rabbi Nechemyah** — "Rabbi Nechemyah said: When Israel heard You shall have no other, the evil inclination was uprooted from their hearts. They came to Moshe and said: Moshe our teacher, become an intermediary, a messenger between us, as it is said, You speak with us, and we shall hear; and, Now why should we die? What benefit is there in our being lost? Immediately the evil inclination returned to its place. They came back to Moshe and said: If only He would reveal Himself to us a second time! If only He would kiss me with the kisses of His mouth! He told them: This is not for now, but for the future to come, as it is written, I shall remove the heart of stone from your flesh." This is the distinct Rabbi Nechemyah teaching concerning Lo yihyeh. The preceding Rabbi Yehudah teaching concerns Torah becoming fixed in the heart at Anochi. The manuscript's 1:15 numbering differs from this digital division,1:2:4.

[1057] **Jerusalem Talmud Shekalim 3:3** — "Purity leads to holiness, as it is written, He shall purify it and sanctify it. Holiness leads to humility, as it is written, High and holy is His Name ... and with the contrite and humble of spirit." The chain describes a path of human preparation. Rav Tzadok distinguishes it from Divine bestowal, where holiness precedes purification.

and Evil, דְּאִיהוּ אִיסּוּר וְהֶיתֵּר **which is prohibition and permission,** טוּמְאָה וְטָהֳרָה.[1058] **impurity and purity.** וְהִנֵּה **Now, Haman made the gallows** הָמָן עָשָׂה הָעֵץ **fifty amos high,** גָּבוֹהַּ חֲמִשִּׁים אַמָּה **and we must understand** לְתָלוֹת אָדָם אֶחָד לְדַעְתּוֹ גָּבוֹהַּ כָּל כָּךְ **so very high** לָמָּה הוּצְרַךְ עֵץ **why he needed a gallows to hang one man, as he saw it;** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה גָּבוֹהַּ עֲשֶׂר אַמּוֹת. **it would have been enough** וְהָיָה דַּי **for it to be ten amos high.** וְאִם רָצָה שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נִרְאֶה **And if he wanted it to be visible,** אַדְרַבָּה מָצִינוּ **on the contrary, we find** (עֵירוּבִין ג, א) **(Eruvin 3a):** לְמַעְלָה מֵעֲשָׂרִים אַמָּה **"Above twenty amos** לֹא שָׁלְטָא בֵּיהּ עֵינָא[1059] **the eye does not catch it."** אַךְ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **But in the Tikkunei Zohar** (תִּקּוּן כא נח, א) **(Tikkun 21, 58a)** אִיתָא וְאִיהוּ עָבִיד עֵץ **it is stated: "And he made a gallows** גָּבוֹהַּ חֲמִשִּׁים אַמָּה **fifty amos high,** וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **and Hakadosh Baruch Hu** נָטִיל נוּקְמָא מִינֵּיהּ וּמִבְּנוֹי **took vengeance on him and on his sons** בְּשָׁכִינְתָּא עִלָּאָה **through the Supernal Shechinah,** דְּמָחֵאת לְמִצְרָאֵי **which struck the Egyptians** חֲמִשִּׁים מַכּוֹת[1060] **with fifty plagues" —** שָׁם. **see there.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהָמָן **That is, Haman** שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁ שֶׁבָּא זְמַן **sensed that the time had come** הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for the spreading forth of Torah she'b'al peh,** וְהַיְינוּ חֲמִשִּׁים שַׁעֲרֵי בִינָה **which is the fifty gates of Binah,** דְּבִינָה מַבִּין דָּבָר מֵהַהֶכְמָה. **for Binah is understanding one thing out of the wisdom.** וְהוּא שֶׁאָז הָיָה **And this is because it was then** זְמַן אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה **the time of the Men of the Great Assembly,** שֶׁעָשׂוּ גְּזֵירוֹת **who made decrees** וּסְיָיג לַתּוֹרָה **and a fence for the Torah,** וְהוּא קִטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and he accused Yisrael** שֶׁאֵין כַּוָּנָתָם לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם **that their intent was not for the sake of Heaven,** רַק מִגַּאֲוָה וְכַדּוֹמֶה **but rather out of arrogance and the like;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר **and this is what he said:** דְּלָא אָכְלִי מִינַן וְדָתֵיהֶם שׁוֹנוֹת וְגוֹמֵר [אֶסְתֵּר ג, ח] **"and their laws are different," etc. (Esther 3:8) —** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִילָה יג, ב) **(as it says in Megillah 13b);** וְלָא נָסְבִי מִינַן **"they do not eat of ours** וְאֶת דָּתֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **and do not marry from ours"** [אֶסְתֵּר שָׁם] אֵינָם עֹשִׂים **and the laws of the king they do not observe" (Esther ibid.) —** הַיְינוּ שֶׁאֵין כַּוָּנָתָם **meaning that their intent is not** לַעֲשׂוֹת דָּת **to make a law** מִמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים **of the King of kings,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בָּזֶה **Hakadosh Baruch Hu, by this,** רַק שֶׁרוֹצִים לִהְיוֹת **but that they want** דָּתָם שׁוֹנוֹת מִכָּל עָם **their laws to differ from every nation** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר מַאֲמָר יג) **(as was explained in Parshas Zachor, maamar 13).** וְזֶה שֶׁעָשָׂה עֵץ **And this is why he made a gallows** גָּבוֹהַּ חֲמִשִּׁים אַמָּה **fifty amos high:** לְרַמֵּז שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל **to signify that Yisrael** תְּקִיפִים בְּדַעְתָּם **are stubborn in their opinions** מִמַּה שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם עֵץ **from having a tree** גָּבוֹהַּ חֲמִשִּׁים אַמָּה **fifty amos high —** חֲמִשִּׁים שַׁעֲרֵי בִינָה.[1061] **the fifty gates of Binah.** וְזֶה רָצָה

[1058] **Taanit 9a** — "Rabbi Yochanan sat wondering. He said: Is there anything written in the Writings that is not alluded to in Torah? The child answered: Is this not alluded to? It is written, Their hearts went out, and they trembled to one another, saying, What is this that God has done to us?" The exchange concerns a verse in Mishlei. Rav Tzadok draws from it the principle that later revelation is rooted in Torah.

[1059] **Menachot 110a** — "Reish Lakish said: What is meant by 'This is the Torah for the burnt offering, for the meal offering, for the sin offering, and for the guilt offering'? Whoever occupies himself with Torah is as though he offered a burnt offering, a meal offering, a sin offering, and a guilt offering. Rava said: ... Whoever occupies himself with Torah requires neither a burnt offering, nor a meal offering, nor a guilt offering. Rabbi Yitzchak said: What is meant by 'This is the Torah of the sin offering' and 'This is the Torah of the guilt offering'? Whoever occupies himself with the Torah of a sin offering is as though he offered a sin offering; whoever occupies himself with the Torah of a guilt offering is as though he offered a guilt offering." This supplies Rav Tzadok's analogy for reading the heifer's section when the physical rite cannot be performed.

[1060] **Shulchan Aruch and Rema, Orach Chaim 685:7** — "Some say that Parshas Zachor and Parshas Parah Adumah must be read by Torah law. Therefore residents of settlements without a minyan must come to a place with a minyan on these Shabbosos to hear these sections, which are of Torah obligation. Rema: If they cannot come, they should nevertheless take care to read them with their melody and cantillation." Shulchan Aruch records this as some say. Rav Tzadok offers support for that opinion; he does not erase the disagreement implied by that formulation.

[1061] Parallel: **Rabbi Shmuel Bornsztain, Shem MiShmuel, Ki Tisa–Parah 5671** — "Pesach means a leap, as Rashi explains: they attained divine understanding beyond their own level. Consequently this did not come through self-effacement and submission, for self-effacement and submission correspond to one's own level. While they were still in Egypt, they could not reach the self-effacement required for the great understanding they then attained; only at the giving of the Torah did they reach that self-effacement. Perhaps this is why the first festival day of Pesach is called Shabbos in Scripture, for in this respect the two are alike. This explains the Yerushalmi's statement that HaChodesh should properly precede Parah: Pesach does not come through the aspect of Parah. Yet Parah is Israel's purification, since the foundation and root of Israel's service is that they make themselves small. Although the Egyptian Pesach came without the aspect of Parah, when they merit to make themselves small and efface themselves, their understanding on Pesach becomes greater still."

Connection: Rav Tzadok distinguishes the Divine order, in which the gift of Torah precedes purification, from Israel's order, in which Parah must come first. Shem MiShmuel develops the same reversed order through Pesach as a Divine leap beyond Israel's attained level. His explanation makes the role of prior purification precise: freely bestowed illumination can arrive before that preparation, while Israel's own humble preparation enlarges its reception of the

לְבַטֵּל מֵהֶם **And this he wished to abolish from them;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא **and afterward it was turned about,** נָטַל נוּקְמָא מִנֵּיהּ **took vengeance on him** וּמִבְּנוֹי בִּשְׁכִינְתָּא עִלָּאָה. **and on his sons through the Supernal Shechinah.** וְאִדְּרַבָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל זָכוּ **And on the contrary, Yisrael merited** עַל יְדֵי זֶה **through this** דַּהֲדַר קַבְּלוּהָ **that they accepted anew** לַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the Torah she'b'al peh** מֵאַהֲבַת הַנֵּס **out of love for the miracle** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר שָׁם) **(as was explained there).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ הָמָן **And this is what they said: "Haman —** מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן **where is he alluded to in the Torah?"** שֶׁהוּא הָיָה גַּם כֵּן סִיבָּה **for he too was a cause** לְשׁוֹרֶשׁ הִתְפַּשְׁטוּת **of the root of the spreading forth** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh;** וְהִתְפַּשְׁטָה אָז **and there then spread forth** הָרַב חָכְמָה **the "abundance of wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרַב כַּעַס **to repair the "abundance of anger";** וְעַל זֶה רָמַז הָמָן הָעֵץ **and to this "Hamin ha'etz" alludes,** דְּעֵץ שֶׁעָשָׂה הָמָן **for the gallows that Haman made** גָּבוֹהַּ חֲמִשִּׁים אַמָּה **fifty amos high** הָיָה נֶגֶד חֲמִשִּׁים שַׁעֲרֵי בִינָה **corresponded to the fifty gates of Binah** שֶׁבַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that are in the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא מִסִּטְרָא דְּעֵץ הַדַּעַת[1062] **which is from the side of the Tree of Knowledge,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמְרוּ אֶסְתֵּר **And afterward they said: "Esther —** מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן **where is she alluded to in the Torah?** וְאָנֹכִי הַסְתֵּר אַסְתִּיר. **'And I will surely hide.'"** וְהַיְינוּ מִנַּיִן **That is, from where do we know** שֶׁאֶסְתֵּר הָיְתָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ **that Esther was the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּכְתִיב [אֶסְתֵּר ה, א] וַתִּלְבֹּשׁ **as it says (Esther 5:1), "And Esther clothed herself** אֶסְתֵּר מַלְכוּת **in royalty,"** (מְגִילָה יד, ב) וּבְגְמָרָא **and in the Gemara (Megillah 14b):** שֶׁלְּבָשָׁתָה רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **that ruach hakodesh clothed her;** וּבְזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג׳ סא, א) **(III 61a):** רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ כְּלוֹמַר **"Ruach hakodesh, that is to say,** רוּחַ מֵהַהוּא קְדֻשָּׁה דִּלְעֵילָּא **a spirit from that holiness which is above";** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאֶסְתֵּר נַעֲשֵׂית **meaning that Esther became** מֶרְכָּבָה לְמַדַּת מַלְכוּת **a chariot for the attribute of Malchus,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. וְהַיְינוּ **which is Torah she'b'al peh.** (שָׁם) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **And this is what they said in the Tikkunei Zohar (there):** וּבְגִין הַאי קִנְאָה דְּכַסֵּי קוּדְשָׁא **"And because of this jealousy** בָּרִיךְ הוּא **Hakadosh Baruch Hu covered** בְּאוֹת דִּילֵיהּ עַל אֶסְתֵּר **with His sign over Esther,** דְּאִיהִי קְדוּשָּׁה דִּילֵיהּ.[1063] **for she is His holiness."** וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And it is along the lines of what they said** (תַּנְחוּמָא קְדוֹשִׁים ב) **(Tanchuma, Kedoshim 2):** אֲנִי מֶלֶךְ וְאַתְּ מַלְכָּה **"I am King and you are queen;** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁהוּא כְּבוֹדִי **just as it is My honor,** כָּךְ הוּא כְּבוֹדֵךְ וְכוּ׳. **so it is your honor," etc.;** הֱיוּ קְדוֹשִׁים **"be holy,** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאֲנִי קָדוֹשׁ **just as I am holy" —** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and this is what they said,** דְּאִיהִי קְדוּשָּׁה דִּילֵיהּ. **"for she is His holiness."** וְאָמַר שֶׁנִּרְמָז **And it said that it is alluded to** [דְּבָרִים לא, יח] בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **in what is said (Devarim 31:18):** וְאָנֹכִי הַסְתֵּר אַסְתִּיר בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא **"And I will surely hide,"** נֶאֱמַר וְאָמַר [פָּסוּק יז] דְּשָׁם **for there (verse 17) it says: "And he will say** הֲלֹא **on that day, 'Is it not** עַל כִּי אֵין אֱלֹהַי בְּקִרְבִּי **because my God is not in my midst** מְצָאוּנִי הָרָעוֹת הָאֵלֶּה **that these evils have befallen me?'"** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיַּכִּירוּ **meaning that they will recognize** שֶׁהָעוֹנֶשׁ בָּא **that the punishment came** מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **from Hashem Yisbarach** מִפְּנֵי הַחֵטְא וְעָוֹן **because of sin and iniquity;** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **and we must understand why it is written,** וְאָנֹכִי הַסְתֵּר אַסְתִּיר **"And I will surely hide** פָּנַי בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא **my face on that day," etc.,** וְלָמָּה יַעֲנְשׁוּ בְּשָׁבִיל זֶה. **and why they should be punished for this.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר וְגוֹמֵר. **And it may be said that it alludes** וְאָנֹכִי עַל מַאֲמַר אָנֹכִי **with "v'Anochi" to the utterance "Anochi,"** שֶׁרָמַז שֶׁהוּא קַבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה **which is the receiving of the Torah,** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ **along the lines of what they expounded** (בְּרָכוֹת לב, ב) **(Berachos 32b):** וְאָנֹכִי לֹא אֶשְׁכָּחֵךְ [יְשַׁעְיָה מט, טו] **"Yet I will not forget you" (Yeshayah 49:15) —** זֶה מַעֲשֵׂה סִינַי[1064] **this is the event of Sinai;** דְּאָנֹכִי שׁוֹרֶשׁ **for "Anochi" is the root** כָּל הַדִּבְּרֵי

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gift.

[1062] **Zohar III 53b, Metzora 7, s.v. Ta chazi** — "Consider the difference between Moshe and Aharon, and which is higher. Moshe is higher: Moshe is the King's attendant, and Aharon the Queen's attendant. This is compared to a king who had an exalted queen. He gave her an attendant to prepare her and attend to the affairs of the household. Therefore, when this attendant enters before the king, he enters only with the queen: With this Aharon shall enter." Rav Tzadok relates the attendants' complementary tasks to Written Torah brought down through Moshe and Israel's purification through Aharon.

[1063] **Azamer BiShvachin, Shabbos-night zemer** — "Great joy will come, a double portion; light will reach her, and abundant blessings. Come near, bridal attendants; make the preparations, to increase the kinds, fish and other living creatures. To make souls and new spirits, through thirty-two and through three branches." The song directly invites the shushvinin, the bridal attendants. Rav Tzadok identifies them here with Moshe and Aharon in the divine union of Shabbos.

[1064] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Tisa 16** — "Two tablets correspond to heaven and earth, to bridegroom and bride, to two attendants, and to the two worlds. Rabbi Chananya said: Luchos is written deficiently: one is not greater than the other."

תּוֹרָה **of all the words of Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה, א, טו) **(Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:15)** שֶׁבַּדִּיבּוּר אָנֹכִי שֶׁשָּׁמְעוּ **that with the utterance "Anochi" which they heard,** נִתְקַע תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם[1065] **Torah study was implanted in their hearts** — עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְאָנֹכִי בֵּיהּ כ׳ כֶּתֶר **And "Anochi" contains the letter kaf, Keser,** וּבֵיהּ אַיִן **and it contains "Ayin"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר ח״ג רנו, ב) **(as it says in Zohar III 256b);** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר וְאָנֹכִי **and this is what it says, "v'Anochi"** — מַאֲמַר אָנֹכִי **the utterance "Anochi,"** שֶׁהוּא נֶגֶד אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **which corresponds to Keser Elyon, is the crown of Malchus** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפֶסַח אֶלִיָּהוּ] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pesach Eliyahu);** הַסְתֵּר אַסְתִּיר **"I will surely hide"** — יִהְיֶה בְּהֶסְתֵּר **it will be in concealment,** שֶׁנִּרְאֶה הוּא בְּהֶסְתֵּר **is in concealment,** שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for the Torah she'b'al peh** לַחֲכָמִים מִשֻּׁכְלָם **in that it appears to the Sages** שֶׁהֵם מְתַחְדְּשִׁים[1066] **that its teachings originate from their own intellect,** וְהֵם דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים **yet they are the words of the Living God** שֶׁנּוֹטֵף מִטַּלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא **which drip from the dew of Atika** לְלֵב חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל, **into the hearts of the Sages of Yisrael,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יְתַקְּנוּ **and through this they will repair** הָרַב כַּעַס **the "abundance of anger"** שָׁם.[1067] **mentioned there.** וּכְמוֹ כֵן אֵירַע **And likewise it occurred** בְּאֶסְתֵּר גַּם כֵּן **with Esther as well,** שֶׁנִּלְקְחָה לַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **that she was taken to Achashverosh;** (שָׁם) וְאִיתָא בַּתִּקּוּנִים **and it is stated in the Tikkunim (there)** דְּסָתִיר לָהּ מַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **that He hid her from Achashverosh** וְשַׁוֵּי בְּאַתְרָהּ שֵׁדִית **and put a she-demon in her place** בְּדִיוּקְנָא דִּילָהּ[1068] וכו׳ **in her likeness, etc.;** וְאָמַר עַל זֶה שָׁם **and it says about this there:** וּכְבוֹדִי לְאַחֵר לֹא אֶתֵּן **"And My glory I will not give to another"** — וְהַיְינוּ מִדַּת מַלְכוּת **that is, the attribute of Malchus,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא כְּבוֹד אֵל **which is called "the glory of God,"** (זֹהַר ח״א ח, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Zohar I 8a):** כְּבוֹד אֵל **"'The glory of God'** — דָּא כְּבוֹד כַּלָּה **this is the glory of the Bride,** וְכו׳ דְּאִקְרֵי אֵל[1069] **who is called 'El,'" etc.;** כְּבוֹד מַלְכוּתוֹ **"the glory of His kingdom"** — וְזֶה הָיָה בְּאֶסְתֵּר **and this was in Esther.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ לְרַמֵּז **And this is what they said, to allude** דְּאֶסְתֵּר הֲיְתָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ **that Esther was the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת מִדַּת מַלְכוּת **which is the aspect of the attribute of Malchus,** וּבָא עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **and comes through ruach hakodesh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ״ן **as the Ramban wrote** (בְּחִדּוּשָׁיו בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב, א). **(in his Chiddushim, Bava Basra 12a).** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמְרוּ מָרְדְּכַי **And afterward they said: "Mordechai** — מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנַיִן **where is he alluded to in the Torah?"** שֶׁמָּרְדְּכַי הָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ **For Mordechai was the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** דִּכְתִיב [שְׁמוֹת ל, כג] מָר דְּרוֹר **as it is written (Shemos 30:23), "mar dror," pure myrrh,** וּמְתַרְגְּמִינַן מִירָא דָּכְיָא. **which we translate "meira dachya."** וְהַיְינוּ דְּעִיקַּר **That is, the essence of** הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the Torah she'b'al peh** הָרַב חָכְמָה **is the "abundance of wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרַב כַּעַס **to repair the "abundance of anger";** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאַף הַחֶלְבָּנָה **meaning that even the galbanum,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְפוֹשְׁעֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **which alludes to the sinners of Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב כְּרֵיתוֹת ו, ב) **(as it says in Kerisos 6b),** כְּשֶׁהוּא בְּתוֹךְ הַקְּטֹרֶת **when it is within the ketores,** נוֹתֵן רֵיחַ טוֹב **gives a good fragrance;** וּמְרַמֵּז לְמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **and it alludes to what they said** (עֵירוּבִין כא, ב) **(Eruvin 21b):** הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ **"The mandrakes give a fragrance"** — אֵלּוּ וְאֵלּוּ **both these and those** עֲתִידִין שֶׁיִּתְּנוּ רֵיחַ **are destined to give fragrance** — עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there,** וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. **and it has been explained many times.** וְאָמְרוּ (מְגִלָּה י, ב) **And they said (Megillah 10b):** בְּרוֹשׁ זֶה מָרְדְּכַי **"'The cypress' — this is Mordechai,** שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה רֹאשׁ **who**

[1065] **Jerusalem Talmud Megillah 3:5** — "Rabbi Levi said in Rabbi Chama bar Chanina's name: One does not interrupt between Parah and HaChodesh. Rabbi Levi said: Their mnemonic is the cups: between these cups, if one wishes to drink, he may drink; between the third and fourth he may not drink." Rav Tzadok treats the mnemonic as reflecting an inward correspondence between the four readings and four cups.

[1066] **Mishnah Pesachim 10:7** — "They pour him a third cup, over which he recites the blessing for his food. Over the fourth he completes Hallel and recites the blessing of song. Between these cups, if he wishes to drink, he may drink; between the third and fourth he may not drink."

[1067] **Bereshit Rabbah 88:5** — "Rav Huna said in Rabbi Benaya's name: The four cups correspond to the four redemptions stated concerning Egypt: I shall bring out, I shall rescue, I shall redeem, and I shall take. Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman said: They correspond to the four cups mentioned here in the chief cupbearer's account. Rabbi Levi said: They correspond to the four kingdoms." The Midrash preserves several correspondences. Rav Tzadok follows the four expressions of redemption in explaining the sequence of purification.

[1068] **Pirkei Avot 4:21** — "Rabbi Elazar HaKappar says: Jealousy, desire, and honor remove a person from the world." Rav Tzadok maps these three root traits onto the three forms of impurity and the purifying work of the readings.

[1069] **Bereshit Rabbah 84:18** — "Rabbi Yehudah bar Simon said: The Holy One, blessed be He, told the tribes: You sold Rachel's son for twenty silver pieces; therefore each one's share shall be a beka per head, as it is written, A beka per head, half a shekel." The Midrash relates the communal half-shekel to Yosef's sale. Rav Tzadok identifies jealousy as the fault rectified through Shekalim.

became head לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים[1070] **of all the spices,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כִּי מָר דְּרוֹר וְכוּלְיֹ. **as it says, 'pure myrrh,'" etc.** דְּעִיקַּר שֶׁמָּן הַמִּשְׁחָה **For the main purpose of the anointing oil** הוּצְרַךְ לִמְשׁוֹחַ הַמִּשְׁכָּן **was needed to anoint the Mishkan** וְכֵלָיו וּבִגְדֵי כְהוּנָּה **and its vessels and the priestly garments,** וְזֶה נִצְרַךְ **and this was needed** רַק אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל. **only after the damage.** שֶׁמִּקּוֹדֶם הַחֵטְא **For before the sin,** הָיוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **all of Yisrael were** מְשָׁכְּנָן לַשְּׁכִינָה **a dwelling for the Shechinah,** [חֲבַקּוּק ב, כ] וַה׳ בְּהֵיכַל קָדְשׁוֹ **"and Hashem is in His holy sanctuary" (Chavakuk 2:20),** שֶׁשּׁוֹכֵן בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל **who dwells in the heart of Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה, ב) **(Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2)** לְבָבִי צוּר **"the Rock of my heart** וְחֶלְקִי אֱלֹהִים [תְּהִלִּים עג, כו] מִמַּה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **from what it says (Tehillim 73:26),** לְעוֹלָם. **and my portion is God forever."** וְרַק אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל **And only after the damage** נִצְרְכוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת מִשְׁכָּן **did they need to make a Mishkan,** מָקוֹם מְיוּחָד **a designated place** לְהַשְׁרַאת שְׁכִינָה **for the resting of the Shechinah,** וְהוּצְרַךְ הַשֶּׁמֶן הַמִּשְׁחָה **and the anointing oil was needed** לִמְשׁוֹחַ בּוֹ מִשְׁכָּן וְכֵלָיו **to anoint with it the Mishkan and its vessels** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר תְּצַוֶּה מַאֲמָר ג) **(as was explained in Tetzaveh, maamar 3);** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִמְשְׁחוּ בּוֹ **and afterward there were anointed with it** הַכֹּהֲנִים גְּדוֹלִים וּמְלָכִים[1071] **the Kohanim Gedolim and kings** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב הוֹרָיוֹת יא, ב) **(as it says in Horayos 11b).** כֹּהֵן הוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ **The Kohen is the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מַלְאָכִי ב, ז] כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן **as it says (Malachi 2:7), "For the lips of the Kohen** יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת **shall guard knowledge,** וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ דַּיְקָא **and they shall seek Torah from his mouth" — precisely so;** וְדַעַת פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר כַּיָּדוּעַ **and Daas is the inner aspect of Keser, as is known,** וְהַיְינוּ טַלָּא דְּעַתִּיקָא **that is, the dew of Atika,** שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ נוֹבֵעַ **from which flows** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא טַל **for it is the dew of** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh:** תִּזַּל כַּטַּל אִמְרָתִי. **"My utterance shall distill as the dew."** וְרַשִׁ״י פֵּרַשׁ (כִּי תִשָּׂא לא, ג) **And Rashi explained (Ki Sisa 31:3):** וּבְדַעַת - רוּחַ הַקֹּדֶשׁ **"and with knowledge" — ruach hakodesh,** שֶׁהוּא רוּחַ **which is a spirit** מֵהַהוּא קֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא **from that holiness above,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְכֵן מָשְׁחוּ בּוֹ הַמְּלָכִים **And likewise they anointed the kings with it,** דְּדָוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ **for David HaMelech, peace be upon him,** הָיָה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **was a chariot for the attribute of Malchus,** וְהָיָה רַבָּן **and he was the master** שֶׁל בַּעֲלֵי רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **of those who possess ruach hakodesh** וְשׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and the root of Torah she'b'al peh;** וְכֵן כָּל מַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל וִיהוּדָה **and likewise all the kings of Yisrael and Yehudah** הָיוּ מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **were a chariot for the attribute of Malchus —** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **"the mouth: Torah she'b'al peh** קוֹרְאִין לָהּ **we call it** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפֶתַח אֱלִיָּהוּ] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pesach Eliyahu).** וְאָמַר שֶׁמָּרְדְּכַי נַעֲשָׂה רֹאשׁ **And it said that Mordechai became head** לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים **of all the spices,** שֶׁזָּכָה לִהְיוֹת שׁוֹרֶשׁ **for he merited to be the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** וּמָרְדְּכַי יָצָא וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טו] **as it says (Esther 8:15), "And Mordechai went out,"** וְגוֹמֵר בִּלְבוּשׁ מַלְכוּת **etc., "in royal apparel";** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and it is stated in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג׳ קסט, ב) **(III 169b):** מָרְדְּכַי אוּף הָכִי **"Mordechai likewise,** מַלְכוּת דָּא רוּחָא דְקוּדְשָׁא וְכוּלְיֹ **"'Malchus' — this is ruach hakodesh," etc.,** דִּכְתִיב וּמָרְדְּכַי יָצָא **as it is written, 'And Mordechai went out** מִלִּפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **from before the king** בִּלְבוּשׁ מַלְכוּת: **in royal apparel.'"**

And in the Gemara (Megillah 10b): וּבַגְּמָרָא (מְגִילָּה י׳, ב) **Rabbi Abba bar Kahana** רַבִּי אַבָּא בַּר כַּהֲנָא פָּתַח לָהּ **opened this section with an introduction from here:** פִּיתְחָא לְהַאי פָּרְשָׁתָא מֵהָכָא **"To the man who is good before Him** לְאָדָם שֶׁטּוֹב לְפָנָיו [קֹהֶלֶת ב, כו] נָתַן חָכְמָה וְדַעַת וְשִׂמְחָה **He gives wisdom, knowledge and joy" (Koheles 2:26) —** זֶה מָרְדְּכַי הַצַּדִּיק **this is Mordechai the tzaddik;** וְלַחוֹטֶא נָתַן עִנְיָן **"and to the sinner He gives the task** לֶאֱסוֹף וְלִכְנוֹס [שָׁם] **to gather and to amass" (ibid.) —** זֶה הָמָן **this is Haman;** [שָׁם] לָתֵת לְטוֹב לִפְנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים **"to**

[1070] **Midrash Tanchuma, Bereshit 7** — "If you say: Why did He create the evil inclination, of which it is written, The inclination of a person's heart is evil from his youth? You call it evil: who can make it good? The Holy One, blessed be He, said: You make it evil. ... How many things in the world are harsher and more bitter than the evil inclination, yet you sweeten them! Nothing is more bitter than lupines, yet you labor to cook and sweeten them in water seven times, until they become sweet. ... If you sweeten the bitter things I created for your needs, how much more the evil inclination, which is placed in your hands." The source argues that the inclination can be transformed through effort. Rav Tzadok distinguishes redirecting desire toward holiness from traits that must be wholly uprooted.

[1071] **Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Teitzei 9** — "Who encountered you: Rabbi Yehudah, Rabbi Nechemyah, and the Sages disagreed. Rabbi Yehudah says: Encountered you means made you impure, as in One who is not pure through an occurrence by night. Rabbi Nechemyah says: He literally called you. ... The Sages say: Encountered you means cooled you before others." Rav Tzadok follows Rabbi Yehudah's interpretation in linking Amalek with the impurity of a nocturnal emission; the Midrash also preserves other explanations.

give to him who is good before God" (ibid.) — זֶה **this is Mordechai and Esther,** דִּכְתִיב [אֶסְתֵּר
ח, ב] **as it is written (Esther 8:2), "And Esther set** וַתָּשֶׂם אֶסְתֵּר אֶת מָרְדְּכַי עַל בֵּית הָמָן.[1072] **Mordechai over the house of Haman."** וּמֵאַחַר שֶׁעָשָׂה זֶה פְּתִיחָה לְהַמְּגִילָּה **And since he made this the opening to the Megillah,** מַשְׁמַע שֶׁזֶּה
כָּל עִנְיַן **it implies that this is the entire matter** הַמְּכוּוָּן בְּמְגִילַּת אֶסְתֵּר. **intended in Megillas Esther.** וּבֶאֱמֶת יֵשׁ
לְהָבִין **And in truth we must understand** לָמָּה הֵסִיב ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁיִתֵּן **why Hashem Yisbarach brought it about**
אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **that Achashverosh should give** בֵּית הָמָן לְאֶסְתֵּר **the house of Haman to Esther;** וּכְלוּם חָסֵר רְכוּשׁ
לִיתֵּן לְמָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר. **to give to Mordechai and Esther?** אֲבָל הָעִנְיָן **But the matter is**
כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we have said:** דִּבְגָלוּת מִצְרַיִם כְּתִיב **that regarding the exile of Egypt it is written,** וַיְנַצְּלוּ אֶת
מִצְרָיִם [שְׁמוֹת יב, לו] **"And they emptied out Egypt" (Shemos 12:36) —** שֶׁעָשָׂאוּהָ כְּמְצוּדָה **they made it like a**
שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ דָּגִים **deep that has no fish,** כְּמְצוּדָה שֶׁאֵין בָּהּ דָּגָן **like a trap that has no grain** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ט, ב)
(as it says in Berachos 9b); וְכָאן כְּתִיב **whereas here it is written,** [אֶסְתֵּר ט, י] וּבַבִּזָּה לֹא שָׁלְחוּ אֶת יָדָם. **"But on the spoil they did not lay their hand" (Esther 9:10).** דְּשָׁם בְּמִצְרַיִם **For there in Egypt**
הָיְתָה הַתּוֹרָה בְּגָלוּת **the Torah was in exile** בְּחָכְמַת מִצְרַיִם **within the wisdom of Egypt,** וְהָיָה הָעֵסֶק לְהוֹצִיא **and the task was to extract**
הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **the holy sparks** הַדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה. **of the words of Torah;** וְכָמָּה מַהֲעֵרֶב רַב **and many of the eirev**
רַב שָׁהָיוּ רְאוּיִם **were fit** לְהִתְדַּבֵּק בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **to cleave to Yisrael,** וּבְשֵׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל יִכָּנֶה. **"and surname himself by the name of Yisrael."**
מַה שֶׁאֵין כֵּן בַּעֲמָלֵק **This is not so with Amalek,** דְּאִיתָא בַּמְּכִילְתָּא **for it is stated in the**
Mechilta (בְּשַׁלַּח פָּרָשַׁת עֲמָלֵק ב) **(Beshalach, Parshas Amalek 2)** (וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא יא) **and the Midrash**
(Tanchuma, Seitzei 11) שֶׁלֹּא יַקְבִּלוּ גֵּר מֵעֲמָלֵק **that Hashem Yisbarach swore** שֶׁנִּשְׁבַּע ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ.[1073] **that they**
would not accept a convert from Amalek. וְכֵן הָיָה הַמִּצְוָה **And likewise the mitzvah was**
לְהַחֲרִים מִשּׁוֹר עַד שֶׂה **to destroy "from ox to sheep,"** [שְׁמוּאֵל א טו, ג] וְגוֹמֵר **etc. (I Shmuel 15:3);**
וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **and this is what it**
says: וּבַבִּזָּה לֹא שָׁלְחוּ אֶת יָדָם.[1074] **"But on the spoil they did not lay their hand."** אֲבָל לְפִי זֶה **But according to**
this, יֵשׁ לְהָבִין מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ עַל הָמָן **we must understand what they said about Haman:** וְלַחוֹטֶא נָתַן עִנְיָן **"and to**
the sinner He gives the task לֶאֱסוֹף וְלִכְנוֹס **to gather and to amass,** לָתֵת לְטוֹב וְגוֹמֵר **to give to him who is**
good," etc. — זֶה מָרְדְּכַי וְכוּ'. **"this is Mordechai," etc.** אַךְ הוּא מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **But it is as they said** (סַנְהֶדְרִין צו, ב)
(Sanhedrin 96b): מִבְּנֵי בָנָיו שֶׁל הָמָן **"Of the descendants of Haman,** לָמְדוּ תּוֹרָה בִּבְנֵי בְרַק **some studied Torah**
in Bnei Brak"; וְגֹרִים בְּעֵין יַעֲקֹב **and in the Ein Yaakov the reading is "converts,"**[1075] וּמָנוּ רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת
and they counted Rav Shmuel bar Shilas. וְאַף שֶׁאֵין מְקַבְּלִין **And although we do not accept**
גֵּרִים מֵעֲמָלֵק **converts from Amalek,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** נִרְאֶה דְּרַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת
it appears that Rav Shmuel bar Shilas שֶׁבָּא עַל בַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל **who cohabited with a**
Jewish woman, וְיָצָא מֵהָמָן **and he came forth from Haman** שֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעַת **unwittingly.** [וְעַיֵּין בְּיוּחֲסִין אוֹת ש'
And see in Sefer Yuchasin, letter shin, [ד"ה שִׁילַת] **(s.v. Shilas)** שֶׁכָּתַב שֶׁהַגְּאוֹנִים אָמְרוּ **which wrote that the**
Geonim said כִּי שִׁילַת הִיא נְקֵבָה **that Shilas was a woman,** וַאֲחוֹת רַב חִיָּא **the sister of Rav Chiya,** וְאֵינוֹ כֵן **but it**
is not so, דְּאָמְרוּ מִבְּנֵי בָנָיו **for they said, "Of the descendants** שֶׁל הָמָן לָמְדוּ תּוֹרָה **of Haman, some studied**
Torah," וּמָנוּ רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **and they counted Rav Shmuel bar Shilas,** וְלֹא הָיוּ מְעָרְבִין מִשְׁפַּחְתָּם **and they**
would not have mixed their family, שֶׁהֵם מִשִּׁמְעִי אֲחִי דָּוִד **who descend from Shimei, the brother of David,**
עִם גֵּרִים עַד כָּאן לְשׁוֹנוֹ **with converts. Until here are his words.** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And according to what we**

[1072] **Sotah 47b** — "The Master said: One who is arrogant is not accepted even by the members of his household, as it is said, An arrogant man shall not dwell at ease: not even in his own dwelling." Rav Tzadok links the proud person's lack of inward repose with the sadness that follows frustrated self-importance.

[1073] **Sotah 5a** — "Rabbi Elazar said: Any person who possesses haughtiness of spirit, his dust is not awakened, as it is written, Awaken and sing, dwellers in dust. It does not say Those lying in dust, but Dwellers in dust: one who became a neighbor to the dust during his lifetime." Rav Tzadok reads the wording as distinguishing effortless awakening from death, rather than denying every future restoration to anyone with an unrectified trace of pride.

[1074] **Tosafos, Sotah 5a, s.v. Kol adam** — "It is difficult: Why did the Mishnah of Chelek not count this? We also find in the final chapter of Kesubos that the dead outside the Land do not live, that the ignorant do not live unless they benefit Torah scholars, and in Aggadah that those who lend with interest do not live in the World to Come." Tosafos raises the comparison to the Mishnah's list; the quoted comment does not provide Rav Tzadok's proposed resolution.

[1075] **Eruvin 65a** — "Rav Chisda's daughter told him: Does the Master not wish to sleep a little? He answered: Now will come days that are long and short, and we shall sleep much." The Gemara records Rav Chisda's response to the suggestion that he rest from study. Rav Tzadok adduces its idiom for the sleep of death.

have said, אָתַי שַׁפִּיר דִּבְרֵי הַגְּאוֹנִים[1076] **the words of the Geonim work out well.** וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן בְּשָׁאוּל הַמֶּלֶךְ **And this is the matter with Shaul HaMelech,** בְּחִיר ה׳ **the chosen one of Hashem,** וְהָיָה כְּבֶן שָׁנָה **who was like a year-old child** שֶׁלֹּא טָעַם טַעַם חֵטְא **who had not tasted the taste of sin** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁפָּתוּב יוֹמָא כב, ב[1077]) **(as it says in Yoma 22b);** וּמָה רָאָה עַל כָּכָה **and what did he see in this,** דִּכְתִיב [שְׁמוּאֵל א טו, ט] וַיַּחְמֹל שָׁאוּל **that it is written (I Shmuel 15:9), "And Shaul had pity** עַל אֲגַג וְגוֹמֵר **on Agag," etc.,** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן יָצָא מִמֶּנּוּ **and because of this there came forth from him** בְּאוֹתוֹ לַיְלָה **on that night** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הָמָן[1078] **the root of Haman,** (מְגִילָה יג, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Megillah 13a):** וּמַה שִׁילֵּם לִי יְמִינִי **"And what did the Benjamite repay me?** דְּלָא קָטְלֵיהּ שָׁאוּל לַאֲגַג **For Shaul did not kill Agag,** דְּאִתְיְלִיד מִינֵּיהּ הָמָן וְכוּלֵּי.[1079] **from whom Haman was born," etc.** אַךְ לְפִי הָאֲמוּר **But according to what has been said,** רָאָה שָׁאוּל שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ **Shaul saw that there was in him,** בַּאֲגַג שׁוֹרֶשׁ נִשְׁמַת **in Agag, the root of the soul** רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas,** שֶׁלֹּא יָצָא מִמֶּנּוּ עֲדַיִין **which had not yet come forth from him;** וְעַל זֶה הַנִּיצוֹץ כְּתִיב **and about this spark it is written,** וַיַּחְמֹל וְגוֹמֵר עַל אֲגַג.[1080] **"And he had pity," etc., "on Agag."** וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is the matter of what they said** (שָׁם טו, ב) בַּגְּמָרָא **in the Gemara (there, 15b):** מָה רָאֲתָה אֶסְתֵּר **"What did Esther see** שֶׁזִּימְּנָה אֶת הָמָן וְכוּלֵּי **that she invited Haman?" etc.** רַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אוֹמֵר **Rabbi Yehoshua says:** מִבֵּית אָבִיהָ לָמְדָה **"She learned from her father's house:** אִם רָעֵב שׂוֹנַאֲךָ **'If your enemy is hungry,** [מִשְׁלֵי כה, כא][1081] הַאֲכִילֵהוּ לֶחֶם וְגוֹמֵר **feed him bread,'" etc. (Mishlei 25:21)** וּבְעֵין יַעֲקֹב הַגִּירְסָא **And in the Ein Yaakov the reading is:** [שָׁם, כב] וַה׳ יְשַׁלֵּם לָךְ וְגוֹמֵר **"'And**

[1076] **Pesikta Rabbasi 14:16, Parah** — "A pure man shall gather all the ashes of the heifer: this is the Holy One, blessed be He, of whom it is written, He shall raise a banner to the nations and gather Israel's dispersed. A man is the Holy One, blessed be He, for Hashem is a man of war. Pure is the Holy One, blessed be He, pure of eyes from seeing evil. The heifer's ashes are Israel's exiles. He shall place them outside the camp in a pure place: this is Jerusalem, which is pure."

[1077] **Yalkut Shimoni, Yeshayahu, remez 506:1** — "Israel are called bride in ten places. ... Correspondingly the Holy One, blessed be He, wore ten garments. The first, worn when He created the world, was majesty and splendor: You clothed Yourself in majesty and splendor. The second, to exact payment from the generation of the Flood, was exaltation: Hashem reigns; He clothed Himself in exaltation. The third, to give Torah to Israel, was strength: Hashem clothed Himself in strength and girded Himself. The fourth, to exact payment from Bavel, was snow: His garment was white as snow. The fifth, to exact payment from Madai, was vengeance: He wore garments of vengeance as clothing, and wrapped Himself in zeal as a cloak—these are two. The seventh, to exact payment from Yavan, was righteousness: He wore righteousness as a breastplate, and a helmet of salvation upon His head—these are two. The ninth, to exact payment from the fourth kingdom, Edom: Why is Your clothing red? The tenth, to exact payment from Gog and Magog, is glorious: This One, glorious in His clothing. The congregation of Israel said: Master of the world, of all the garments You have worn, none is as beautiful as this." The Yalkut explicitly counts ten. This differs from the seven-garment sequence in Pesikta Rabbasi 37. In this witness the red garment against Edom is ninth, and the glorious garment against Gog and Magog is tenth. Rav Tzadok joins the ten-garment tradition with the ten sefiros; the two Midrashic enumerations should retain their own order.

[1078] **Pesikta Rabbasi 37:2, Sos asis** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, wore seven garments from the creation of the world until He takes judgment upon wicked Edom: when He created the world, majesty and splendor; at the sea, exaltation; when He gave Torah, strength; against the Chaldeans, vengeance; when He forgives Israel, white; when Mashiach appears, righteousness; and a red garment, Why is Your clothing red? This is the judgment upon Edom." This digital witness enumerates seven garments. Rav Tzadok elsewhere explicitly reports a Yalkut reading of ten garments; that reported variant should be distinguished from this witness. The final red garment is present in both discussions.

[1079] **Vayikra Rabbah 13:3** — "Rabbi Avin bar Kahana said: The Holy One, blessed be He, said, A new Torah shall go forth from Me—a renewal of Torah shall go forth from Me. Rabbi Berechyah said in Rabbi Yitzchak's name: The Holy One, blessed be He, will make a feast for His righteous servants in the future." The Midrash discusses the future feast and the question of its mode of slaughter. Rav Tzadok focuses on the words a renewal of Torah.

[1080] **Kohelet Rabbah 2:1** — "Rabbi Chizkiyah said in Rabbi Simon bar Zavdi's name: All the Torah you learn in this world is insubstantial beside the Torah of the World to Come. In this world a person learns Torah and forgets; in the future it is written, I shall place My Torah within them." The Midrash explains its comparison through the disappearance of forgetting. It does not dismiss the present obligation or worth of Torah study.

[1081] Parallel: **Rabbi Mordechai Yosef Leiner, Mei HaShiloachI, Chukas 2** — "In the future the blessed God will reveal His glory to Israel without any garment. Even now this life is found in Israel's depths, but it is not manifest except through garments. The garments are Torah and commandments, for one can reach the depth of God's will only through Torah and commandments. Take for yourself a cow: this is life, as is known; for the present they were commanded that life be within garments, namely Torah and commandments."

Connection: Mei HaShiloach distinguishes the concealed life from the Torah and commandments through which it is presently reached. It sharpens Rav Tzadok's garment language: future disclosure develops a life already present, while its present form remains Torah and mitzvos.

Hashem will repay you,' etc. (ibid. 22) — יַשְׁלִימְנוּ לָךְ **He will make him at peace with you,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהוּא **as is the reading** (נב, א) בְּסוּכָּה **in Sukkah (52a);** וְשָׁם קָאֵי עַל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **and there it refers to the yetzer hara,** שֶׁמְּפַתֶּה לִפְעָמִים **which sometimes entices** לְאָדָם רָשָׁע שֶׁיַּעֲסוֹק בַּתּוֹרָה **a wicked man to engage in Torah,** כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לוֹ יְנִיקָה **so that it may have nourishment** מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁלּוֹ **from his Torah;** וְאָמַר הָעֵצָה **and it says the counsel:** הַאֲכִילֵהוּ לַחְמָהּ שֶׁל תּוֹרָה **feed him the bread of Torah** וְהַשְׁקֵהוּ מַיִם שֶׁל תּוֹרָה **and give him to drink the water of Torah,** שֶׁבַּסּוֹף יַשְׁלִימְנוּ לָךְ **for in the end He will make him at peace with you,** שֶׁלֹּא יַסִּית אוֹתְךָ לַחֲטוֹא **so that it will not entice you to sin** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁפֵּירֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י בְּסוּכָּה שָׁם[1082]) **(as Rashi explained in Sukkah, ibid.).** אֲבָל כָּאן אֵינוֹ מוּבָן **But here it is not understood** מִכּוּוַּן הַסְּעוּדָה **what was intended by the feast** שֶׁעָשְׂתָה לוֹ לְפִי זֶה. **that she made for him, according to this.** וְנִרְאֶה שֶׁלֹּא יָדְעָה אֶסְתֵּר **And it appears that Esther did not know** בְּאֵיזוֹ אוֹפֶן יִהְיֶה הַנֵּס **in what manner the miracle would come,** וְאוּלַי תִּפְעוֹל **and perhaps she would accomplish** עַל יְדֵי הַסְּעוּדָה **through the feast** שֶׁהָמָן יִשְׁלִים אִתָּהּ **that Haman would make peace with her** וִידַבֵּר טוֹב עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and speak well of Yisrael;** וְהָיְינוּ שֶׁסָּבְרָה **that is, she thought** שֶׁיָּשׁוּב הָמָן בִּתְשׁוּבָה.[1083] **that Haman would repent.** וְעַל פִּי זֶה נָבִין **And according to this we will understand** מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **what they said in the Midrash** (מִשְׁלֵי ט) **(Mishlei 9):** "טָבְחָה טִבְחָהּ **"She has slaughtered her meat,** מָסְכָה יֵינָהּ [מִשְׁלֵי ט, ב] **she has mixed her wine" (Mishlei 9:2)** — זוֹ אֶסְתֵּר הַמַּלְכָּה וְכוּלֵי **this is Esther the queen, etc.;** הֵתְקִינָה סְעוּדָה **she prepared a feast** לַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ וּלְהָמָן הָרָשָׁע וְכוּלֵי **for Achashverosh and for Haman the wicked, etc.** וְרֹאשׁ הַפָּרָשָׁה [שָׁם, א] **And the beginning of the passage (ibid. 1) is** חָכְמוֹת בָּנְתָה בֵיתָהּ וְגוֹמֵר **"Wisdom has built her house," etc.,** וּמַשְׁמַע דְּמִדְבֵּר **which implies it is speaking** מֵחָכְמַת הַתּוֹרָה **of the wisdom of the Torah,** וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ (שָׁם) **and so it is expounded in the Midrash (there):** זוֹ הַתּוֹרָה **this is the Torah,** שֶׁבָּנְתָה כָּל הָעוֹלָמוֹת **which built all the worlds** — עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1084] **see there.** רַק הַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁרָצְתָה **Rather, the intent is that she wished** לְעוֹרֵר בּוֹ בָּהָמָן **to awaken in him, in Haman,** שֶׁהָיָה בּוֹ בְּהֶעְלֵם **the root of holiness** הַשֹּׁרֶשׁ קְדוּשָּׁה **that was in him in concealment,** נִיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **the holy sparks** דְּנִשְׁמַת רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **of the soul of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas;** וְזֶהוּ יֵינָהּ מָסְכָה **and this is "she has mixed her wine"** — יֵינָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דִּבְעַל פֶּה **the wine of the Oral Torah,** עַל דְּרָךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said** (זֹהַר ח"ג רעא, ב) **(Zohar III 271b);** וְסָבְרָה שֶׁאוּלַי עַל יְדֵי זֶה **and she thought that perhaps through this** יָשׁוּב בִּתְשׁוּבָה **he would repent** וִידַבֵּר טוֹב עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **and speak well of Yisrael.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אֶסְתֵּר ה, ט] וַיֵּצֵא הָמָן **And this is what it says (Esther 5:9): "And Haman went out** בַּיּוֹם הַהוּא **on that day** שָׂמֵחַ וְטוֹב לֵב **joyful and of good heart";** וּבְכָל מָקוֹם מוֹרֶה טוֹב לֵב **and everywhere "good of heart" indicates** שֶׁנִּתְיַישֵּׁר הַלֵּב לְטוֹב **that the heart has been straightened toward good,** לִהְיוֹת לֵב אֶחָד **to be one heart** לְאָבִיו שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **with one's Father in Heaven;** וְהֵיאַךְ יִתָּכֵן לִכְתּוֹב כֵּן **so how could it be written so** עַל הָמָן הָרָשָׁע. **about Haman the wicked?** וּבְמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **And in the Midrash Rabbah** [אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ג, יא] עַל פָּסוּק **(Esther Rabbah 3:11), on the verse** [אֶסְתֵּר א, י] כְּטוֹב לֵב הַמֶּלֶךְ בַּיָּיִן **"when the heart of the king was merry with wine" (Esther 1:10)** אִיתָא אוּמוֹת הָעוֹלָם **it is stated: "The nations of the world** אֵין לָהֶם טוֹבָה וְכוּלֵי **have no goodness," etc.;** בְּטוֹב לֵב אֵין כְּתִיב כָּאן **"'With good heart' is not written here,** אֶלָּא כְּטוֹב לֵב הַמֶּלֶךְ **but rather 'as the good heart of the king'** — טוֹבָה וְאֵינָהּ טוֹבָה **a goodness that is no goodness";** וְאֵיךְ אָמַר הַכָּתוּב

[1082] **Zohar II 237a–b, Pekudei 37, s.v. Amar lei** — "The cow included the four kingdoms: red is Bavel, perfect is Madai, without blemish is Yavan, and upon which no yoke came is Edom. ... Who can bring pure from impure? Here the pure comes from the impure: at first it was impure, but now judgment was performed upon it, it was given to burning fire and made dust. ... All who work with it become impure. After it becomes ash, it imparts impurity until it is gathered and removed: The gatherer shall wash ... and is impure. Why ash? You shall tread upon the wicked, for they shall be ash beneath the soles of your feet. When water is placed upon that ash, then it is pure from impure." The Zohar connects the heifer, the kingdoms, ash, and purification through judgment. Rav Tzadok develops a further distinction between the residue of the other wicked and Edom's complete disappearance.

[1083] **Bereshit Rabbah 12:15** — "Hashem God: This is compared to a king with empty cups. He said: If I put hot liquid into them, they will split; cold liquid, and they will contract. What did the king do? He mixed hot and cold and put it into them, and they endured. So the Holy One, blessed be He, said: If I create the world with mercy alone, sins will abound; with judgment alone, how can the world endure? Rather, I create it with judgment and mercy; would that it endure." The Midrash explains the combination of Divine Names through the union of judgment and mercy. Rav Tzadok applies it to the Torah's present garment.

[1084] **Zohar II 206b, Vayakhel 17, s.v. Trei zimnei** — "At Shabbos Minchah, at the time when judgment hangs suspended toward evening, one must include the left within the right, for Torah was given from two sides: From His right, a fiery law for them—right and left. Therefore at Minchah ten verses or more suffice for the Torah reading, but not the completion of the section, for the section's completion belongs only to the right." Rav Tzadok cites the union of right and left to explain Torah's present combination of mercy and judgment.

עַל הָמָן **so how does the verse say about Haman,** שָׂמֵחַ וְטוֹב לֵב.[1085] **"joyful and of good heart"?** אַךְ לְפִי הָאֲמוּר יֵשׁ לוֹמַר **But according to what was said, we may say** דְּאָז לְפִי שָׁעָה **that then, for the moment,** יָצָא מִמְּשָׁתֵה אֶסְתֵּר **he went out from Esther's feast** שָׂמֵחַ וְטוֹב לֵב **joyful and of good heart,** כְּרֶגַע שֶׁעוֹרְרָה בּוֹ אֶסְתֵּר **for the moment in which Esther awakened in him** הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **the holy sparks** מִנִּשְׁמַת רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **from the soul of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas,** שֶׁהוּא מִקְּדוּשַׁת **which is from the holiness** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **of Torah she'b'al peh.** רַק כֵּינָן שֶׁיָּצָא **Only, once he went out** וְרָאָה אֶת מָרְדְּכַי **and saw Mordechai,** וְלֹא קָם וְלֹא זָע מִמֶּנּוּ **"and he neither rose nor stirred for him,** וַיִּמָּלֵא הָמָן עַל מָרְדְּכַי **Haman was filled against Mordechai** חֵמָה [שָׁם ה, ט] **with wrath" (ibid. 5:9),** וְאָמַר כָּל זֶה **and he said, "All this** [שָׁם, יג] אֵינֶנּוּ שׁוֶה לִי **is worth nothing to me" (ibid. 13),** וְשָׁב לְרִשְׁעוֹ **and he returned to his wickedness;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ **and afterward** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **Hakadosh Baruch Hu** נָטַל נוֹקָמָא מִינַּיהּ וּמִבָּנוֹי **took vengeance on him and his sons** בִּשְׁכִינְתָּא עִלָּאָה וְכוּלֵּי **through the Supernal Shechinah, etc.,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **as they said in the Tikkunei Zohar,** וְהָיְינוּ חֲמִשִּׁים שַׁעֲרֵי בִינָה **that is, the fifty gates of Binah,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְכָל הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת שֶׁלּוֹ **And all his holy sparks** נָטַל **Mordechai took,** וְנִכְנַס אַחַר כָּךְ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **and it later entered into Yisrael.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא [מְגִילָּה שָׁם] **And this is what they said in the Gemara (Megillah, ibid.):** מִבֵּית אָבִיהָ לָמְדָה **"She learned from her father's house,"** [ד״ה מִבֵּית] וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשִׁ״י **and Rashi explained (s.v. Mibeis):** שָׁמְעָה הַתִּינוֹקוֹת **she heard the children** כֵּן אוֹמְרִים.[1086] **saying so.** וּלְשׁוֹן מִבֵּית אָבִיהָ **But the expression "from her father's house"** מִזֶּרַע שְׁלֹמֹה **of the seed of Shlomo,** מַשְׁמַע מֵאֲבוֹתֶיהָ **implies from her ancestors,** וְהִיא לֹא הָיְתָה **and she was not** שֶׁאָמַר פָּסוּק זֶה. **who said this verse.** וּלְפִי הָאֲמוּר מְיוּשָּׁב **And according to what was said, it is settled:** לְשׁוֹן מִבֵּית אָבִיהָ **the expression "from her father's house"** דְּהַיְינוּ מִשָּׁאוּל **means from Shaul,** שֶׁהָיְתָה מִזַּרְעוֹ **since she was of his seed,** וְהוּא חָמַל עַל אֲגַג **and he had pity on Agag,** שֶׁיָּצָא מִמֶּנּוּ הָמָן **from whom Haman came forth;** וְהַיְינוּ עַל נִיצוֹץ **that is, on account of the spark** שׁוֹרֶשׁ נִשְׁמַת **of the root of the soul** רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas** שֶׁהָיָה כָּלוּל בּוֹ **that was contained in him;** וְהָיְתָה סְבוּרָה שֶׁתּוּכַל **and she thought that she could** לְהַחֲזִירוֹ לְהָמָן לְמוּטָב **bring Haman back to the good,** וַיְשַׁלִּים אִתָּהּ **and he would make peace with her** וִידַבֵּר טוֹב עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and speak well of Yisrael,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** אַךְ אַחַר כָּךְ שֶׁשָּׁב לְרִשְׁעוֹ **But afterward, when he returned to his wickedness,** הָיָה הוּא הַגּוֹרֵם **he was the cause** לְהִתְפַּשְׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of the spreading forth of Torah she'b'al peh,** אַחַר שֶׁעָשׂוּ בּוֹ וְעַל יָדוֹ **after they carried out on him and through him** מֹחִית עֲמָלֵק כָּרָאוּי. **the eradication of Amalek as was fitting.** וּכְעֵין מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And similar to what they said** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כא, ה; תַּנְחוּמָא בְּשַׁלַּח ח) **(Shemos Rabbah 21:5; Tanchuma, Beshalach 8):** וּפַרְעֹה הִקְרִיב [שְׁמוֹת יד, י] **"And Pharaoh drew near" (Shemos 14:10) —** שֶׁהִקְרִיב אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **he drew Yisrael near** לִתְשׁוּבָה שֶׁעָשׂוּ.[1087] **to the teshuvah that they did.** וְכֵן עַל יְדֵי הָמָן נִסְתַּבֵּב **And likewise through Haman it came**

[1085] **Rabbi Shalom Buzaglo, Mikdash Melech, Zohar I 17b:3** — "Alternatively, And it endured means: Every controversy that is for the sake of Heaven is destined to endure. A heavenly voice went forth and said: These and those are the words of the living God, for Shammai's words too have a root above. Although the law does not follow them in this world, they are destined to endure in the future. As the Arizal wrote on this Mishnah, in the future, in Mashiach's time, the law will follow Beis Shammai. The words of both are abiding and true; the Holy One, blessed be He, distinguished between them and agreed to them." Mikdash Melech explicitly transmits the future-law teaching in the Arizal's name. This verifies an early commentary witness to the attribution. Likkutei Torah, Korach, by R. Shneur Zalman of Liadi, repeats it: "The Arizal explained that in the future, in the time of Mashiach, the halachah will follow Beis Shammai." It cites the Mikdash Melech for this, however, and is not an independent witness. Agra DeKala, Korach, also reports it: "as is known to us from the holy writings of the Arizal… in the future the halachah will follow Beis Shammai." The passage in the Arizal's own transmitted writings has not been located. The cited ZoharIII 245a establishes the schools' roots in mercy and judgment separately.

[1086] **Zohar III 245a, Raaya Mehemna, Pinchas 90, s.v. Amar Raaya** — "The Faithful Shepherd said: Hillel and Shammai, you who came, one from the side of mercy and one from the side of judgment, which are kindness and might, the levels of Avraham and Yitzchak—you are of their stock. Gather here, you and the eighty students Hillel had, and likewise the students of Beis Shammai, for the King's feast." The Zohar establishes the schools' roots in kindness and might. It does not itself state here that future law follows Beis Shammai; that separate claim is attributed by Rav Tzadok to the Arizal, and its witnesses are given in the preceding note.

[1087] **Yechezkel 36:25–29, haftarah for Parah** — "I shall sprinkle pure water upon you, and you shall become pure. From all your impurities and all your idols I shall purify you. I shall give you a new heart and place a new spirit within you; I shall remove the heart of stone from your flesh and give you a heart of flesh. I shall place My spirit within you and cause you to walk in My statutes, to keep My judgments and perform them. ... I shall save you from all your impurities." The haftarah explicitly moves from water and impurity to the renewal of the heart and conduct. This is the basis of Rav Tzadok's reading of Parah as purification from the root of sin.

about פֶּה שֶׁבְּעַל **that the Torah she'b'al peh spread forth** שֶׁנִּתְפַּשְּׁטָה הַתּוֹרָה **in Yisrael.** בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל. **And** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **this is what they said:** **"Where is Haman alluded to in the Torah?"** — אֵיפֹה הָמָן מְרֻמָּז בַּתּוֹרָה **for** כִּי **Haman was a cause** הָמָן הָיָה סִבָּה **of the spreading forth of Torah she'b'al peh,** לְהִתְפַּשְּׁטוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **as** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **mentioned above.** **And the holy sparks** וְהַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **came forth from him afterward** יָצָא מִמֶּנּוּ אַחַר כָּךְ **unwittingly,** שֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעַת **as we said,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **since we do not accept** כֵּיוָן שֶׁאֵין מְקַבְּלִין **converts** גֵּרִים מֵעֲמָלֵק **from Amalek.** וְזֶהוּ מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what it says:** **"and to the sinner He gives the task** וְלַחוֹטֶא נָתַן עִנְיָן **to gather and to amass"** — לֶאֱסוֹף וְלִכְנוֹס זֶה הָמָן **this is Haman,** וְהַיְינוּ הָרְכוּשׁ **that is, the wealth** שֶׁהָיָה בּוֹ **in which there was the holiness** הַקְּדוּשָׁה **of the soul of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas.** דְּנִשְׁמַת רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת.[1088] **"To give to him who is good before God"** — לָתֵת לְטוֹב לְפָנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים זֶה מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **this is Mordechai and Esther,** וְזֶה נִכְנַס בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **and this entered into Yisrael** שֶׁלֹּא נִתְגַּיֵּיר **unwittingly,** רַק יָצָא עַל יְדֵי **but rather came forth through** שֶׁבָּא מִזַּרְעוֹ **one of his descendants who** עַל בַּת יִשְׂרָאֵל **cohabited with a Jewish woman,** וְנִקְרָא עַל שֵׁם אִמּוֹ **and he was called by his mother's name** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתְבוּ הַגְּאוֹנִים **(as the Geonim wrote** דְּשִׁילַת נִקְבָה הָיְתָה **that Shilas was a woman,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר לְעֵיל) **as was explained above),** וּכְעֵין שֶׁנִּקְרָא **similar to how there was called** רַב מָרִי בַּר רָחֵל **Rav Mari bar Rachel** עַל שֵׁם אִמּוֹ בַּת שְׁמוּאֵל **by the name of his mother, the daughter of Shmuel** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשִׁ"י **(as Rashi wrote,** בְּבָבָא מְצִיעָא עג, ב ד"ה רַב[1089]). **in Bava Metzia 73b, s.v. Rav).** **And this is what it says:** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **"To the man who is good before Him** נָתַן חָכְמָה לְאָדָם שֶׁטּוֹב לְפָנָיו **He gives wisdom, knowledge and joy"** — זֶה מָרְדְּכַי הַצַּדִּיק **this is Mordechai the tzaddik,** שֶׁהוּא וְדַעַת וְשִׂמְחָה **for he is "good,"** טוֹב **and "good" means nothing but Torah,** וְאֵין טוֹב אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה (בְּרָכוֹת ה, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Berachos 5a);** וְשָׁם מַיְירֵי מִתּוֹרָה **and there it speaks of the Written Torah,** וּמַיְיתֵי קְרָא **and it brings the verse,** כִּי לֶקַח טוֹב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם תּוֹרָתִי אַל תַּעֲזֹבוּ [מִשְׁלֵי ד, ב] **"For I have given you a good teaching," etc. (Mishlei 4:2);** וְכֵן תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and likewise the Torah she'b'al peh** נִקְרָא טוֹב **is called "good,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים קיט, עב] **as it says (Tehillim 119:72), "Better to me** טוֹב לִי תּוֹרַת פִּיךָ **is the Torah of Your mouth," etc.** — וְהַיְינוּ וְכֵן מַיְירֵי קְרָא **and it brings the verse,** כִּי לֶקַח טוֹב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם תּוֹרָתִי אַל תַּעֲזֹבוּ **"For I have given you a good teaching," etc. (Mishlei 4:2);** וְשָׁם מַיְירֵי מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **and there it speaks of the Written Torah,** וּמַיְיתֵי קְרָא **and it brings the verse,** כִּי לֶקַח טוֹב נָתַתִּי לָכֶם תּוֹרָתִי אַל תַּעֲזֹבוּ [מִשְׁלֵי ד, ב] **"For I have given you a good teaching," etc. (Mishlei 4:2);** וְכֵן תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and likewise the Torah she'b'al peh** נִקְרָא טוֹב **is called "good,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים קיט, עב] **as it says (Tehillim 119:72), "Better to me** טוֹב לִי תּוֹרַת פִּיךָ **is the Torah of Your mouth," etc.** — וְהַיְינוּ **that is, the Torah she'b'al peh,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **along the lines of what it says** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִשְׁלֵי ב, ו] **(Mishlei 2:6),** כִּי יְיָ יִתֵּן חָכְמָה מִפִּיו דַּעַת וּתְבוּנָה **"from His mouth come knowledge and understanding"** (וְכֵן מַיְירֵי מִפָּסוּק זֶה **(and likewise this verse is brought** בְּרוּת רַבָּה ה, טו **in Rus Rabbah 5:15,** עַל פָּסוּק וַיִּיטַב לִבּוֹ **on the verse "and his heart was merry"** — עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there).** **"He gives wisdom," etc.,** נָתַן חָכְמָה וְגוֹמֵר [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Esther 8:16), "light and gladness,"** וְהַיְינוּ בְּחִינַת **that is, the aspect of** חָכְמָה וּבִינָה שֶׁהוּא אוֹרָה וְשִׂמְחָה. **Chochmah and Binah, which it is.** **When the heart is made upright** — כְּשֶׁמְּתַיַּשֵּׁר הַלֵּב **"for the upright in heart, gladness"** לְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה **(as was explained in maamar 1);** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר א) **and** וְדַעַת הַבָּא **"knowledge," which comes** לְבִינָה **through the joining of the wisdom in the mind** עַל יְדֵי חִיבּוּר חָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ **with the understanding in the heart;** שֶׁבַּלֵּב **that is, he merited the drawing down** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁזָּכָה לְהַמְשָׁכָה **from Chochmah, the Written Torah,** מֵחָכְמָה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **to the Torah she'b'al peh.** לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **And to the sinner He gives the task** וְלַחוֹטֶא נָתַן עִנְיָן לֶאֱסוֹף וְלִכְנוֹס **"to gather and to amass"** — זֶה הָמָן **this is Haman,** וְהַיְינוּ הָרְכוּשׁ שֶׁבּוֹ **that is, the wealth in which** הָיָה הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **were the holy sparks** דְּנִשְׁמַת רַב שְׁמוּאֵל בַּר שִׁילַת **of the soul of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **and as we said,** שֶׁבְּקִרְבֵי הָאָדָם **in a person's possessions** יֵשׁ רוּחָנִיּוּת **there is spirituality** הַמְחַיֶּה אֶת הָאָדָם **that gives life to the person,** בְּסוֹד וְאַתָּה מְחַיֶּה **in the secret of "And You give life** אֶת כּוּלָּם **to them all"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים סוֹף מַאֲמָר א) **(and it was explained in Parshas Shekalim, end of maamar 1;** עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת **see there at length).** **And this is what** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **they said:** **"to give to him who is good before God"** — לָתֵת לְטוֹב לְפָנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים זֶה מָרְדְּכַי וְכוּ' **this is Mordechai, etc.;** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **and it is in line with what they said** (בַּמִּדְרָשׁ אַבָּא גוּרְיוֹן פָּרָשָׁה ג **in the**

[1088] **Taanit 16a** — "Rav Adda bar Ahavah said: One who has a transgression in his hand, confesses, and does not turn away from it is like a person holding a creeping creature in his hand. Even if he immerses in all the waters of the world, his immersion does not avail. If he throws it from his hand, as soon as he immerses in forty seah, his immersion avails, as it is said, One who confesses and abandons will receive mercy." Confession must accompany abandonment of the sin. Rav Tzadok draws from the image that inner repentance is the root of purification.

[1089] **Yoma 86b** — "Rabbi Meir would say: Great is repentance, for on account of one individual who repents the whole world is forgiven, as it is said, I shall heal their backsliding; I shall love them freely, for My anger has turned away from him. It does not say from them, but from him." The identification of that individual with Mashiach, who awakens repentance in all Israel, is Rav Tzadok's development of this teaching.

Midrash (Abba Gurion, parsha 3, עַל פָּסוּק אַחַר הַדְּבָרִים הָאֵלֶּה **on the verse "After these things** גִּדֵּל וְגוֹמֵר **he promoted," etc.,** הובָא בְּיַלְקוּט אֶסְתֵּר רֶמֶז תתרנג**) cited in Yalkut Esther, remez 1053):** יָבֹא הָמָן וְיִסָּגֵל מָמוֹן **"Let Haman come and amass money,** וְיָבֹא מָרְדְּכַי לִיטּוֹל מִמֶּנּוּ **and let Mordechai come and take it from him** וְיִבְנֶה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ.[1090] **and build the Beis HaMikdash."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמָּרְדְּכַי הִקְדִּישׁ **That is, Mordechai consecrated** רְכוּשׁ הָמָן **Haman's wealth** לִבְנְיַן בֵּית שֵׁנִי **for the building of the Second Temple;** וְזֶהוּ לָתֵת לְטוֹב **and this is "to give to him who is good** לִפְנֵי הָאֱלֹהִים **before God,"** דִּבְבֵית שֵׁנִי הָיוּ **for in the Second Temple era there were** אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה **the Men of the Great Assembly,** שֶׁהֶעֱמִידוּ תַּלְמִידִים הַרְבֵּה **who raised up many students** וְעָשׂוּ סְיָג לַתּוֹרָה[1091] **and made a fence for the Torah,** שֶׁמִּשָּׁם יוֹצְאָה תּוֹרָה **and the Chamber of Hewn Stone, from where Torah goes forth** [סַנְהֶדְרִין פו, ב] לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל **to all Yisrael (Sanhedrin 86b);** וְזֶהוּ עִיקַּר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **and this is the essence of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא טוֹב **which is called "good,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַתָּשֶׂם אֶסְתֵּר **And this is what it says: "And Esther set** אֶת מָרְדְּכַי עַל בֵּית הָמָן **Mordechai over the house of Haman,"** שֶׁמָּרְדְּכַי הָיָה שׁוֹרֶשׁ **for Mordechai was the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as we said regarding what they said,** שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים. **that he is head of all the spices.** וּמִזֶּה שֶׁרָאוּ **And from seeing** שֶׁנִּתְלָה הָמָן עַל עֵץ **that Haman was hanged on a gallows** גָּבוֹהַּ חֲמִשִּׁים אַמָּה **fifty amos high,** נִתְעוֹרְרוּ לְהִתְפַּשְׁטוּת **they were aroused to the spreading forth** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** וּלְתַקֵּן תַּקָּנוֹת וּסְיָיגִים **and to institute ordinances and fences,** וְתִקְּנוּ יְמֵי מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה **and they instituted days of feasting and gladness,** שֶׁהוּא יֵינָא דְאוֹרַיְיתָא **which is the wine of the Torah** דְּבַעַל פֶּה **that is Oral;** וְקִבְּלוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and all Yisrael accepted** הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the Torah she'b'al peh** מֵאַהֲבַת הַנֵּס **out of love for the miracle,** שֶׁעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above, for about this they said,** הֶדֵר קִבְּלוּהָ **"They accepted it anew** בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ.[1092] **in the days of Achashverosh."** וְנִמְצָא שֶׁעַל יְדֵי **It turns out, then, that through** גְּזֵירַת הָמָן **Haman's decree** וּמַה שֶׁנִּתְגַּדֵּל **and his rise to greatness,** זָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **Yisrael merited** לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** אַחַר שֶׁקִּלְטוּ וְלִקְּטוּ **after Mordechai and Esther absorbed and gathered,** מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר בִּקְדוּשָּׁתָם **in their holiness,** הָרְכוּשׁ שֶׁלּוֹ **his wealth,** שֶׁהָיוּ בּוֹ הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **in which were the holy sparks** מֵאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **from the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁנִּרְמָז **And this is what is alluded to** בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הָמָן הָעֵץ **in what it says, "Hamin ha'etz":** הָמָן מִן הַתּוֹרָה **"Haman from the Torah,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above;** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָעֵץ שֶׁל הָמָן **for through Haman's gallows** זָכוּ לְשָׁרֵשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **they merited to root the Torah she'b'al peh,** וְעַל יְדֵי מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **and through Mordechai and Esther;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ אֶסְתֵּר **and this is what they said, "Esther** מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנַיִן **where is she alluded to in the Torah?"** מָרְדְּכַי מִן הַתּוֹרָה מְנַיִן **"Mordechai — where is he alluded to in the Torah?"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: **as mentioned above.**

וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is the matter of what they said** (שׁוֹחֵר טוֹב תְּהִלִּים כב) **(Shocher Tov, Tehillim 22):** עַל אַיֶּלֶת הַשַּׁחַר [תְּהִלִּים כב, א] **"On ayeles hashachar" (Tehillim 22:1) —** זוֹ אֶסְתֵּר **this is Esther;** וְכֵן נִדְרָשׁ מִזְמוֹר זֶה **and so this psalm is expounded** (מְגִילָּה טו, ב) בַּגְּמָרָא **in the Gemara (Megillah 15b)** עַל אֶסְתֵּר **about Esther.** (שָׁם) וְאָמְרוּ בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **And they said in the Midrash (there):** [יְשַׁעְיָה י, יז] זֶה שֶׁאָמַר הַכָּתוּב **This is what the verse says (Yeshayah 10:17):** וְהָיָה אוֹר יִשְׂרָאֵל לְאֵשׁ **"And the light of Yisrael shall be for a fire,** וּקְדוֹשׁוֹ

[1090] **Pesikta Rabbasi 14:6, Parah** — "This section too is refined sevenfold: it contains forty-nine purifications. How? Seven cows, seven burnings, seven sprinklings, seven priests, seven impure ones, seven pure ones, and seven washings. Moreover, when they wished to burn the sin-offering cow, they sprinkled upon its priest all seven days, seven sprinklings each day: thus forty-nine sprinklings, refined sevenfold." Rav Tzadok compares this forty-ninefold statement with the Mishnah and Yoma's practical rule excluding Shabbos sprinkling. His final resolution assigns Shabbos an inward purifying force.

[1091] **Mishnah Parah 3:1** — "Seven days before the heifer is burned, the priest who will burn it is separated from his home to the chamber northeast of the Temple court, called the Stone House. They sprinkle upon him all seven days from all the purification offerings that were there. Rabbi Yosei says: They sprinkled only on the third and seventh. Rabbi Chanina, deputy of the priests, says: Upon the priest who burns the heifer they sprinkle all seven days; upon the Yom Kippur priest, only on the third and seventh." The phrase from all the purification offerings is the subject of the differing interpretations that follow.

[1092] **Mishnah Parah 3:5** — "If they did not find ashes from seven, they prepared from six, five, four, three, two, or one. Who prepared them? Moshe prepared the first and Ezra the second; five were prepared from Ezra onward, according to Rabbi Meir. The Sages say: Seven were prepared from Ezra onward." Rabbi Meir's five after Ezra, together with Moshe's and Ezra's, give seven in total. The Sages' count gives nine; Rav Tzadok follows Rabbi Meir in explaining the sevenfold sprinkling.

לְלֶהָבָה. **and his Holy One for a flame."** אוֹר יִשְׂרָאֵל זֶה מָרְדְּכַי **"The light of Yisrael" — this is Mordechai;** וּבְעֵרָה וְאָכְלָה זֶה הָמָן[1093] **"and it shall burn and devour" — this is Haman —** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** וּבְפָשׁוּטוֹ דָּרַשׁ לָהָבָה **And simply, he expounded "flame"** עַל אֶסְתֵּר **as referring to Esther** דְּלָהָבָה לְשׁוֹן נְקֵיבָה. **because "lehavah" is a feminine word.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁהוּא **But it may be said that it is** [עובדיה א, יח] עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **in line with what it says (Ovadyah 1:18):** וְהָיָה בֵּית יַעֲקֹב אֵשׁ **"And the house of Yaakov shall be a fire,** וּבֵית יוֹסֵף לָהָבָה וְגוֹמֵר **and the house of Yosef a flame," etc.** דְּיַעֲקֹב מִדָּתוֹ אֱמֶת **For Yaakov's attribute is truth,** זוֹ תּוֹרָה **which is Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ה, ב) **(as it says in Berachos 5b),** וְהוּא אֵשׁ **and it is fire,** מִימִינוֹ [דְּבָרִים לג, ב] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Devarim 33:2), "From His right hand** אֵשׁ דָּת לָמוֹ. **a fiery law for them."** וְיוֹסֵף גִּבּוֹר **And Yosef is the mighty one** הַכּוֹבֵשׁ אֶת יִצְרוֹ **who conquers his inclination,** לֶהָבָה שֶׁאוֹכֶלֶת **a flame that consumes** אֵשׁ שֶׁל יֵצֶר הָרָע **the fire of the yetzer hara;** דְּשָׁלֹשׁ קְלִיפּוֹת **for the three kelipos —** הַקִּנְאָה תַּאֲוָה וְכָבוֹד **jealousy, desire and honor —** נִקְרְאוּ אֵשׁ **are called fire,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. **as has been explained many times.** וְזֶה שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ אוֹר יִשְׂרָאֵל **And this is why "the light of Yisrael" is expounded** עַל מָרְדְּכַי **as Mordechai,** דִּכְתִיב וַתָּשֶׂם אֶסְתֵּר **as it is written, "And Esther set** אֶת מָרְדְּכַי עַל בֵּית הָמָן **Mordechai over the house of Haman,"** שֶׁהָיָה מָרְדְּכַי שׁוֹרֵשׁ **for Mordechai was the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** רֹאשׁ לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים **head of all the spices,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְתוֹרָה אוֹר **And Torah is light,** וְהוּא נִקְרָא אוֹר יִשְׂרָאֵל **and he is called "the light of Yisrael"** עַל שֵׁם הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **on account of the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהִיא אוֹרָה **which is "orah,"** וְהַיְינוּ אוֹר ה׳ **that is, the light of Hashem,** כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **Knesses Yisrael;** וְכֵן כָּאן נִקְרָא אוֹר יִשְׂרָאֵל **and so here it is called "the light of Yisrael":** אוֹר דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁמִּצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל **which is from the side of Yisrael;** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן **and it too is fire,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יִרְמְיָה כג, כט] הֲלֹא כֹה דְּבָרִי כָּאֵשׁ **as it says (Yirmeyah 23:29), "Is not My word like fire?"** וְהַיְינוּ דְּבָרַי **that is, "My words** אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּפִיךָ [יְשַׁעְיָה נט, כא] **which I have placed in your mouth" (Yeshayah 59:21);** דְּדִבּוּר הַיְינוּ **for speech is** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh;** וְכֵן לָמְדוּ מִפָּסוּק זֶה **and so they learned from this verse** (תַּעֲנִית ד, א) **(Taanis 4a)** לְצוּרְבָא מֵרַבָּנָן **regarding a young Torah scholar**[1094] דְּרָתַח **who flares up, etc. —** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וּקְדוֹשׁוֹ לְלֶהָבָה זוֹ אֶסְתֵּר **"And his Holy One for a flame" — this is Esther;** הוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **it is in line with what they said** (תִּקּוּן כא נח, א) בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **in the Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 21, 58a):** דְּכַסֵּי קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **that Hakadosh Baruch Hu covered** בְּאוֹת דִּילֵיהּ עַל אֶסְתֵּר **with His sign over Esther,** דְּאִיהִי קְדוּשָּׁה דִּילֵיהּ **for she is His holiness —** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there;** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאֶסְתֵּר גַּם כֵּן **meaning that Esther too** הָיְתָה מִבְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק **was of the aspect of Yosef HaTzaddik,** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said** (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה קְדוֹשִׁים כד, ו) **(Vayikra Rabbah, Kedoshim 24:6):** כָּל מָקוֹם שֶׁאַתָּה מוֹצֵא קְדוּשָּׁה וְכוּלֵי **"Wherever you find** אַתָּה מוֹצֵא גָּדֵר עֶרְוָה **a fence against immorality,** נִקְרָא קָדוֹשׁ. **you find holiness," etc.;** שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁגּוֹדֵר עַצְמוֹ **for whoever fences himself off** מִן הָעֶרְוָה **from immorality is called holy.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **And this is what they said in the Gemara** (מְגִילָּה יג, א) **(Megillah 13a):** אֶסְתֵּר שְׁמָהּ **"Her name was Esther;** וְלָמָּה נִקְרָא שְׁמָהּ הֲדַסָּה **why then was she called Hadassah?** עַל שֵׁם הַצַּדִּיקִים **After the tzaddikim,** שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ הֲדַסִּים[1095] וְכוּלֵי **who are called hadassim," etc.** וְהַצַּדִּיקִים **And the tzaddikim are called hadassim** הוּא עַל שֵׁם **on account of the fact** דַּהֲדַס נוֹתֵן רֵיחַ טוֹב **that the myrtle gives a good**

[1093] **Bartenura, Parah 3:1** — "From all the purification offerings that were there: from all the cows prepared from Moshe our teacher's days until that time, for a little from each cow was set aside as a reserve. On the first day they sprinkled upon him from one cow's ashes, on the second from another, and on the third from another." Bartenura assigns a different cow's ashes to each day. Rav Tzadok argues instead for sprinkling from every available cow each day.

[1094] **Tosafos Yom Tov, Parah 3:1, s.v. Mikol** — "Bartenura explains: On the first day they sprinkle from one cow's ashes, on the second from another. So Rambam wrote in his commentary: each day he should be sprinkled with ashes other than those used on any preceding day. What compels this explanation, it appears to me, is the later Mishnah, If they did not find from seven. If every day they sprinkled from all that were there, why mention seven? ... Rather, each day means from one purification offering." Rav Tzadok disputes this proof. The source's reasoning is quoted before his counterargument, rather than rewritten to agree with him.

[1095] **Gra, Eliyahu Rabbah, Parah 3:1** — "We read: From all seven purification offerings that were there. ... The anonymous Mishnah follows Rabbi Meir, who says five were prepared after Ezra; under the Sages' view there would be nine. Sprinkling from all seven is an added safeguard: perhaps one cow had been prepared more correctly than another. Each day they sprinkled from all seven for that reason, so that throughout all seven days he would receive sprinkling from the more correctly prepared one." This explicitly supports Rav Tzadok's reading, including the textual addition seven and the use of all seven every day.

fragrance; וְאִיתָא (עירובין כא, ב) **and it is stated (Eruvin 21b):** "הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ [שיר השירים ז, יד] **"The mandrakes give a fragrance" (Shir HaShirim 7:14) —** אֵלּוּ בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **these are the young men of Yisrael** שֶׁלֹּא טָעֲמוּ טַעַם חֵטְא[1096] **who have not tasted the taste of sin;** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **and we have already said many times** דְּמִדְּנָקַט לְשׁוֹן **that since it used the expression** בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **"the young men of Yisrael,"** נִרְאֶה דְּמִיְּרֵי **it appears that it speaks** בְּחֵטְא דִּפְגַם הַבְּרִית **of the sin of blemishing the bris,** שֶׁגּוֹרֵם הַיַּלְדוּת וּבַחֲרוּת **which youth and young manhood bring on** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ מַרְחֶשְׁוָן [מאמר ג]) **(and it was explained in Rosh Chodesh Marcheshvan, maamar 3);** וְצַדִּיק שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה **and a tzaddik, who is a chariot** לְמִדַּת יְסוֹד עוֹלָם **for the attribute of Yesod Olam,** נִקְרָא הֲדַס **is called a myrtle** עַל שֵׁם שֶׁנּוֹתֵן רֵיחַ טוֹב **because he gives a good fragrance;** וּמִדְּנִקְרָאָה אֶסְתֵּר הֲדַסָּה **and since Esther was called Hadassah,** מִכְּלָל שֶׁהָיְתָה צַדֶּקֶת **it follows that she was a tzaddekes** וּקְדוֹשָׁה מִבְּחִינַת יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק. **and holy, of the aspect of Yosef HaTzaddik.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said:** דְּאִיהִי קְדוּשָׁה דִּילֵיהּ **"for she is His holiness,"** וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **and Hakadosh Baruch Hu** סָתִיר לָהּ מֵאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **hid her from Achashverosh** וְשַׁוֵּי בְּאַתְרָהּ שֵׁדִית **and put a she-demon in her place,** בְּדִיוּקְנָא דִּילָהּ. **in her likeness.** וְזֶה שֶׁדָּרַשׁ **And this is why it expounded** וּקְדוֹשׁוֹ לְלֶהָבָה זוֹ שֶׁל ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **"and his Holy One for a flame — this is Esther":** שֶׁהָיְתָה קְדוּשָׁה **for she was the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** מִבְּחִינַת צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם **from the aspect of "the tzaddik is the foundation of the world";** וְנַעֲשֵׂית לְלֶהָבָה **and she became a flame,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּבֵית יוֹסֵף לֶהָבָה **as it says, "and the house of Yosef a flame,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וּבָעֲרָה וְאָכְלָה זֶה הָמָן **"And it shall burn and devour" — this is Haman,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ עֲמָלֵק **who is the root of Amalek,** יִצְרָא בִּישָׁא **the evil inclination** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר ח"ג קס, א) **(as it says in Zohar III 160a);** וְאָז תִּקְנוּ יְמֵי מִשְׁתֶּה **and then they instituted days of feasting —** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh,** יֵינָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דִּבְעַל פֶּה **the wine of the Oral Torah,** שֶׁהוּא הָרַב חָכְמָה **which is the "abundance of wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרַב כַּעַס **to repair the "abundance of anger";** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה וְשִׂמְחָה **and through this, "and gladness,"** דְּנָתְיַישֵׁר הַלֵּב **for the heart was made upright,** שֶׁגַּם הַלֵּב כְּסִיל לְשִׂמְאֹלוֹ **so that even the heart of the fool, at his left,** נִתְרוֹקֵן מֵהָרַע **was emptied of evil** וְנַעֲשָׂה כּוּלּוֹ טוֹב **and became entirely good,** וּלְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב שִׂמְחָה. **"and for the upright in heart, gladness."** וּבְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **And with Avraham Avinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **peace be upon him,** גַּם כֵּן מָצִינוּ **we also find:** וַיַּעַשׂ אַבְרָהָם מִשְׁתֶּה גָּדוֹל [בְּרֵאשִׁית כא, ח] **"And Avraham made a great feast** בְּיוֹם הִגָּמֵל אֶת יִצְחָק. **on the day Yitzchak was weaned" (Bereishis 21:8).** וְנִרְאֶה **And it appears that** עִיקַּר הַסְּעוּדָה הַמִּשְׁתֶּה. **the main part of the meal was the drinking.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is in line with what they said** (זֹהַר ח"ב קעה, ב) **(Zohar II 175b):** וְחֶסֶד עִלָּאָה **"And supernal Chesed** נָפְקָא מֵחָכְמָה **issues from Chochmah;** גְּבוּרָה דְּהוּא דִּינָא תַּקִּיפָא **Gevurah, which is severe judgment,** נָפְקָא מִבִּינָה **issues from Binah";** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **that is, Avraham Avinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **peace be upon him,** שֶׁמִּדָּתוֹ חֶסֶד **whose attribute is Chesed,** הָיָה רֵאשִׁית הָאוֹר **was the beginning of the light,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, ב, ג) **(Bereishis Rabbah 2:3):** [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, ג] יְהִי אוֹר **"'Let there be light' (Bereishis 1:3) —** זֶה אַבְרָהָם וְכוּ' **this is Avraham," etc.;** וְיִצְחָק לָמַד מִמֶּנּוּ **and Yitzchak learned from him** וְהֵבִין דָּבָר מִתּוֹךְ דָּבָר **and understood one thing from another,** וּמִדָּתוֹ גְּבוּרָה **and his attribute, Gevurah,** נָפִיק מִבִּינָה **issues from Binah;** וְעַל כֵּן בְּיוֹם הִגָּמֵל **and therefore on the day of the weaning** עָשָׂה מִשְׁתֶּה **he made a drinking-feast,** מִיֵּינָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דִּבְעַל פֶּה. **of the wine of the Oral Torah.** רַק שָׁם כְּתִיב מִשְׁתֶּה גָּדוֹל שֶׁאָמְרוּ **Only, there it is written "a great feast," for they said** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה נג, י) **(Bereishis Rabbah 53:10):** גָּדוֹל עוֹלָמִים הָיָה שָׁם[1097] **"The Great One of the worlds was there";** וְהוּא מוֹרֶה עַל עַתִּיקָא **and this indicates Atika,** שֶׁכּוֹלֵל כָּל שְׁלֹשׁ רֹאשׁוֹנוֹת. **which includes all the first three.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהָיוּ מְפוֹרָשִׁים **That is, it was evident** שֶׁגַּם הַבִּינָה **that**

[1096] **Yoma 8b** — "Rava said: The High Priest for Yom Kippur, whose date depends on the calendar rather than our choice, must be separated on the third of Tishrei, whatever day it falls. But the priest who burns the heifer, whose timing is in our hands, is separated on Wednesday so that his fourth day will fall on Shabbos." The preceding discussion excludes Shabbos sprinkling. Rav Tzadok therefore asks how the Midrash counts forty-nine actual sprinklings, then explains Shabbos's inward contribution.

[1097] **Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos 18, third meal** — "Although judgment awakens at Minchah on the other weekdays, ... now, at Shabbos Minchah, all is simple mercy: supreme kindness is revealed in the brow of Arich Anpin, and when He looks below, all judgments are subdued. ... This meal is attached to the verse I shall feed you the inheritance of Yaakov your father. ... At the third meal judgments are not mentioned at all; all is complete mercy. Therefore Moshe departed at this hour rather than in the morning, to signify that he was concealed within simple mercy." The passage explains Shabbos Minchah as mercy prevailing at the time normally associated with judgment. Rav Tzadok applies that state to the inward purification supplied by Shabbos.

even the Binah, תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהֵם מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **is from Hashem Yisbarach,** וּכְמוֹ כָּלוּל בִּשְׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה **just as at the time of Matan Torah,** שֶׁהָיָה הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **when the Torah she'b'al peh** בְּהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **was included in the Written Torah,** וְהָיָה מְפוֹרָשׁ **and it was evident** שֶׁהוּא מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ. **that it is from Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּמוֹ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **like the Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי **which is called halachah l'Moshe miSinai** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן כָּאן **(and it was explained in Chanukah, maamar 2,** ד״ה וְהוּא) **s.v. "V'hu");** חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ב **whereas here** הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בְּהֶסְתֵּר **the Torah she'b'al peh is in concealment,** שֶׁנִּדְמֶה לַחֲכָמִים **in that it seems to the Sages** שֶׁהֵם הַמְּתַחֲדְּשִׁים **that they are the ones originating it,** וְהוּא מִבְּחִינַת מַלְכוּת **and it is of the aspect of Malchus:** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **"the mouth: Torah she'b'al peh** קוֹרְאִין לָהּ **we call it"** — וּכְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **like the Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁל רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **of Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues,** שֶׁהוּא הָרַב חָכְמָה **which is the "abundance of wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרַב כַּעַס. **to repair the "abundance of anger."** וּבֶאֱמֶת הֵם גַּם כֵּן **And in truth they too are** דִּבְרֵי אֱלֹהִים חַיִּים **the words of the Living God:** דְּבָרַי אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּפִיךָ **"My words which I have placed in your mouth";** וְזֶה בְּחִינַת הֶסְתֵּר **and this is the aspect of concealment,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְעַל כֵּן נֶאֱמַר כָּאן מִשְׁתֶּה **And therefore it says here "feast"** וְלֹא מִשְׁתֶּה גָּדוֹל **and not "great feast,"** כְּמוֹ בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **as with Avraham Avinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם. **peace be upon him.** וְעַל כֵּן דָּרְשׁוּ מִמִּשְׁתֶּה גָּדוֹל **And therefore they expounded from the "great feast"** דְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁעָתִיד הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **that Hakadosh Baruch Hu will in the future** לַעֲשׂוֹת סְעוּדָה לַצַּדִּיקִים **make a feast for the tzaddikim** בְּיוֹם שֶׁיִּגְמֹל חֶסֶד[1098] לְזַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יִצְחָק **on the day He bestows His kindness upon the seed of Yitzchak** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב פִּסְחִים קיט, ב) **(as it says in Pesachim 119b);** דְּעִיקַּר הַסְּעוּדָה הָעֲתִידָה **for the essence of the future feast** הוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת סוֹדוֹת הַתּוֹרָה **is the revelation of the secrets of the Torah** וְאוֹר ה׳ **and the light of Hashem,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ״ם[1099] **as the Rambam wrote** (פֶּרֶק ח מֵהִלְכוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה הֲלָכָה ד) **(chapter 8 of Hilchos Teshuvah, halachah 4);** וְאַף שֶׁהָרַאֲבַ״ד הִשִּׂיגוֹ[1100] **and although the Raavad disputed him,** כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ **we have already said** שֶׁכִּדְבְרֵי הָרַמְבַּ״ם **that the Rambam's position** מְפוֹרָשׁ בְּמִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם[1101] **is explicit in the Midrash HaNe'lam** (זֹהַר ח״א קלה, ב) **(Zohar I 135b)** — עַיֵּן שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת **see there at length** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר תְּרוּמָה מַאֲמָר יד) **(and it was explained in Terumah, maamar 14);** וְזֶהוּ מִשְׁתֶּה גָּדוֹל **and this is the "great feast,"** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לָעָתִיד **that will be in the future,** וְיִהְיֶה מְפוֹרָשׁ **when it will** דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא דִּבְעַל פֶּה **the wine of the Oral Torah,** יֵינָא

[1098] **Shabbat 89b** — "In the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will tell Avraham: Your children have sinned against Me. He will answer: Master of the world, let them be erased for the sanctity of Your Name. He will say: Let Me tell Yaakov, who endured the pain of raising children; perhaps he will ask mercy for them. He too answers: Let them be erased for the sanctity of Your Name. He says: There is no reason in the elders and no counsel in the children. He tells Yitzchak: Your children have sinned against Me. Yitzchak answers: My children, and not Your children? When they put We shall do before We shall hear, You called them My firstborn son; now they are my children, not Yours?" The Gemara presents Avraham, Yaakov, and Yitzchak in that sequence. The identification of Yaakov with the elder and Avraham with childhood is the teaching of Rav Tzadok's master reported in the discourse.

[1099] **Tosafos, Chullin 6a, s.v. Ashkechei** — "An elder found him: Some explain that wherever the expression that elder appears, it means Eliyahu. But it is impossible to say this in Bameh Madlikin, in the episode of Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai." Tosafos reports this identification as some explain and immediately excludes one occurrence. Rav Tzadok applies the identification to the elder who consoles Abaye; it should not be converted into an exceptionless rule.

[1100] **Avodah Zarah 3a** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, does not deal tyrannically with His creatures. Why is the sukkah called an easy commandment? Because it entails no financial loss." The Gemara discusses giving the nations an opportunity to fulfill the commandment of sukkah. Rav Tzadok applies its general principle to each person's capacity to resist his inclination.

[1101] Parallel: **Rabbi Shneur Zalman of Liadi, Tanya, Likkutei Amarim, chapter 27** — "If the sadness is not anxiety about sins but comes from bad thoughts and bad desires that enter his mind, then, when these arise outside the time of divine service, while he is occupied with his affairs and ordinary work, he should, on the contrary, rejoice in his portion, for although these thoughts enter his mind, he turns his attention away from them.... On the contrary, the sadness comes from haughtiness of spirit: he does not recognize his own place, and therefore his heart is troubled that he is not at the level of a tzaddik, to whom such foolish thoughts certainly do not occur.... Therefore a person should not lose heart or be greatly distressed, even if he remains in this battle all his life, for perhaps this is what he was created for, and this is his service: constantly to subdue the other side."

Connection: The consolation here concerns the continued presence of temptation, rather than indifference to an actual sin. Tanya identifies the sadness produced by an unrealistic demand to have already become a tzaddik, and treats sustained resistance as a possible lifelong task. This clarifies Rav Tzadok's instruction to persevere when desire is still felt: refusing the additional paralysis of sadness is itself part of the purification, rather than evidence that the original struggle has been ignored.

be evident שֶׁהוּא מֵה' יִתְבָּרַךְ. **that it is from Hashem Yisbarach.** וְזֶה אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהִתְגַּלּוֹת **And this cannot be revealed** כָּל זְמַן שֶׁהָאָדָם בְּגוּף. **so long as a person is in a body.** וְזֶהוּ נִקְרָא מִשְׁתֶּה גָּדוֹל **And this is called a "great feast,"** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְפוֹרָשׁ **for it will be evident** דְּגָדוֹל עוֹלָמִים שָׁם **that the Great One of the worlds is there,** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **when Hakadosh Baruch Hu** יְגַלֶּה הַסּוֹדוֹת לַצַּדִּיקִים: **will reveal the secrets to the tzaddikim.**

פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר ג׳ Purim — Maamar Gimmel

בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **In the Midrash Rabbah** [אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ז, יב] **(Esther Rabbah 7:12)** עַל פָּסוּק **on the verse** יֶשְׁנוֹ עַם אֶחָד **(Esther 3:8):** אָמַר לוֹ שְׁנֵיהוֹן רַבְרְבִין **He said to him, "Their years are great,** עוֹנֶג שַׁבָּת יוֹם טוֹב וְכוּ׳ **'Oneg Shabbos, oneg Yom Tov,' etc."** שֶׁאוֹכְלִין וְשׁוֹתִין וְאוֹמְרִים **for they eat and drink and say,** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **HaKadosh Baruch Hu said to him,** רָשָׁע אַתָּה מַפִּיל **"Wicked one, you cast** עַיִן רָעָה בְּמוֹעֲדֵיהֶם **an evil eye upon their festivals;** הֲרֵי אֲנִי מַפִּילְךָ לִפְנֵיהֶם **behold, I will make you fall before them,** וּמוֹסִיפִים לָהֶם מוֹעֵד אֶחָד **and they will add for themselves one festival** עַל מַפַּלְתְּךָ **over your downfall,** וְכוּ׳[1102] זֶה יְמֵי הַפּוּרִים **these are the days of Purim," etc.** הָעִנְיָן הוּא שֶׁהָמָן **The matter is that Haman** וְלֹא הֶאֱמִין שֶׁנִּמְצָא אֵיזֶה קְדוּשָׁה **looked upon this with an evil eye,** הָיְתָה עֵינוֹ רָעָה בָּזֶה **and did not believe that any holiness is found** בְּעִנְיְנֵי הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף **in matters of bodily pleasure,** כְּמוֹ אֲכִילָה וּשְׁתִיָּה.[1103] **such as eating and drinking.** שֶׁפִּיתָה לְאָדָם בָּזֶה **For this sprouts from the root of the serpent,** שֶׁזֶּה נִצְמַח מִשֹּׁרֶשׁ הַנָּחָשׁ. **who seduced Adam with this.** וְיֵשׁ בָּזֶה רֶמֶז בַּגְּמָרָא **And there is a hint to this in the Gemara** (חוּלִּין קלט, ב) **(Chullin 139b):** הָמָן הָעֵץ [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, יא] **'Is it from the tree...?'" (Bereishis 3:11)** מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן **"Where is Haman alluded to in the Torah?** וְהֵיינוּ דִּכְתִיב **That is, there it is written,** אֲשֶׁר צִוִּיתִיךָ לְבִלְתִּי **"which I commanded you not** אֲכָל מִמֶּנּוּ אָכָלְתָּ **to eat from, have you eaten?"** שֶׁזֶּה שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְלִיפַּת הָמָן **For this is the root of the kelipah of Haman:** לִהְיוֹת שָׁטוּף בְּתַאֲוַת אֲכִילָה **to be immersed in the lust for eating** לְשֵׁם הֲנָאַת הַגּוּף **for the sake of bodily pleasure,** כְּפִיתוּיוֹ שֶׁל הַנָּחָשׁ. **like the seduction of the serpent.** (נִדָּה לא, א) וְכֵן אָמְרוּ **And so they said (Niddah 31a):** וְעַל דָּבָר זֶה **"And over this matter** נִסְמֵית עֵינוֹ שֶׁל בִּלְעָם הָרָשָׁע **the eye of Bilam the wicked was blinded.** אָמַר מִי שֶׁהוּא טָהוֹר וְקָדוֹשׁ **He said: He Who is pure and holy,** וּמְשָׁרְתָיו טְהוֹרִים וּקְדוֹשִׁים **and His servants are pure and holy,** יָצִיץ בְּדָבָר זֶה וְכוּ׳ **should He gaze upon such a thing?" etc.** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה מַאֲמִין **For he did not believe** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְצִיאוּת קְדוּשָׁה **that there could exist holiness** בְּעִנְיָן זֶה[1104] **in this matter,** כַּיָּדוּעַ **as is known that this desire** דְּתַאֲוָה זוֹ **also derives from the blemish of the serpent,** גַּם כֵּן נִמְשָׁךְ מִפְּגַם הַנָּחָשׁ **who cast filth into Chavah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קמו, א) **(as stated in Shabbos 146a).** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר שֶׁהֵטִיל זוהֲמָא בְּחַוָּה **And regarding this,** לוֹ **HaKadosh Baruch Hu told him** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **that they would make yet another, new festival** שֶׁיַּעֲשׂוּ עוֹד מוֹעֵד חָדָשׁ **from his downfall.** מִמַּפַּלְתּוֹ. **And this is as they said (Megillah 7b):** (מְגִלָּה ז, ב) וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **"A person is obligated to become intoxicated** בְּפוּרְיָא עַד דְּלָא יָדַע **on Purim until," etc.** מֵימַר אִינָשׁ לְבַסּוּמֵי **For precisely through intoxication** שֶׁמִּדֵּיקָא עַל יְדֵי הַשִּׁכְרוּת **with wine, without awareness,** בְּיֵין שֶׁלֹּא מִדַּעַת **the inner holiness of Yisrael becomes clarified:** נִתְבָּרֵר פְּנִימִיּוּת קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **that even the matter of the pleasure** שֶׁגַּם עִנְיַן הֲנָאַת **of his eating and drinking** אֲכִילָה וּשְׁתִיָּה שֶׁלּוֹ **is in holiness,** הוּא בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **in the manner of what they said (Sanhedrin 38a):** (סַנְהֶדְרִין לח, א) עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **"Give the young ones more wine,** אִגְּבְרוּ חַמְרָא אַדַּרְדְּקֵי נְכַנַּס יַיִן יָצָא כִּי הֵיכִי דְּלֵימְרוּ מִילְתָא וְכוּ׳ **so that they will say something," etc.,** בִּשְׁלֹשָׁה דְּבָרִים **And they said (Eruvin 65b):** (עֵירוּבִין סה, ב) וְאָמְרוּ **"Wine enters, a secret comes out."** יַיִן נִכְנָס סוֹד.[1105]

[1102] **Bamidbar Rabbah 19:1** — "Those who work with the heifer from beginning to end render garments impure, while the heifer itself purifies garments. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: I have ordained a statute and decreed a decree; you are not permitted to transgress My decree." The Midrash places the heifer among transformations that defy a simple division between origin and result. Rav Tzadok applies its paradox to persevering in purification despite the painful awareness of impurity.

[1103] **Taanit 2a** — "To love Hashem your God and to serve Him with all your heart: What is service that is in the heart? You must say: this is prayer. And afterward it is written, I shall give the rain of your land in its season, the early and late rain." The Gemara uses this verse to connect rain with prayer. Rav Tzadok draws on its definition of prayer as the work of the heart.

[1104] **Rashi, Bereishis 1:1** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: The Torah should have begun only with This month shall be for you, which is the first commandment commanded to Israel. Why did it begin with Bereishis? Because He declared to His people the power of His works, to give them the inheritance of nations. If the nations tell Israel, You are robbers, for you conquered the lands of the seven nations, Israel answer: The whole earth belongs to the Holy One, blessed be He. He created it and gave it to whomever He saw fit." Rashi speaks of the first commandment addressed to Israel. Rav Tzadok develops its significance as the beginning of Israel's participation in sanctifying time.

[1105] **Zohar II 39b, Bo 7, s.v. Amar Rabbi Yitzchak** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: Torah needed to be written only from This month shall be for you, the head of months. Why? Because it was the moon's beginning; Torah should have begun here because the matter is bound to the Holy One, blessed be He. There is no difficulty that it does not say this in the feminine, for the masculine this and feminine this are bound together. Where male and female are together, praise is assigned to the male; therefore, It is first for you, for the months of the year. Rabbi Yehudah asked: Why for you

אָדָם נִיכָּר **"Through three things a person is recognized:** וְכוּלֵי[1106] בְּכוֹסוֹ **through his cup," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הַשִּׁכְרוּת דַּיְיקָא **That is, precisely through intoxication,** כְּשֶׁנְּטַל מִמֶּנּוּ הַדַּעַת **when awareness is taken from him,** אָז נִיכָּר וְנִתְבָּרֵר הַהֶבְדֵּל[1107] שֶׁל קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל לָעַמִּים **then the distinction becomes recognized and clarified between the holiness of Yisrael and the nations:** שֶׁבְּיִשְׂרָאֵל גַּם בְּעִנְיְנֵי הֲנָאוֹת **that in Yisrael, even in matters of the pleasures of this world,** יֵשׁ בִּפְנִימִיּוּת קְדוּשָׁה **there is holiness within.** (מְגִילָּה יב, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And as they said (Megillah 12b):** "יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי שַׁבָּת הָיָה **"The seventh day was Shabbos,** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל אוֹכְלִין וְשׁוֹתִין **when Yisrael eat and drink,** מַתְחִילִין בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **they begin with words of Torah** וּבְדִבְרֵי תִּשְׁבָּחוֹת **and with words of praise,** עַל יְדֵי אֲבָל וְכוּלֵי **but," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבְּיִשְׂרָאֵל נִתְבָּרֵר **That is, in Yisrael there becomes clarified,** הַפְּנִימִיּוּת שֶׁל מְכוּוָּן שֶׁלָּהֶם **the inner core of their intent,** שֶׁנִּמְצָא בַּאֲכִילָה וּשְׁתִיָּה **that is found in eating and drinking;** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵּן **and therefore** מַתְחִילִין בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **they begin with words of Torah,** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל:[1108] **as mentioned above.**

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twice? Rabbi Yitzchak answered: More is heard through them, as it is written, For Hashem's portion is His people. This bond is for you, not for the other nations." The original passage contains both questions developed in the discourse: the masculine demonstrative and the repeated for you. Rav Tzadok explains both through the union of Divine bestowal and Israel's reception of holiness.

[1106] **Shemot Rabbah 15:24** — "If an ordinary vessel becomes sanctified when filled with something holy, how much more Israel, who are holy and sanctify the month. The Holy One, blessed be He, said: I am holy; do I sanctify only Myself? Rather, I sanctify Israel, and they sanctify Me. Therefore it is written, You shall be holy to Me, and, For I, Hashem, who sanctifies you, am holy." The Midrash explicitly joins Israel's received holiness with their ability to sanctify the month. Rav Tzadok reads this as the union of the giver of light and its recipient.

[1107] **Zevachim 116a** — "Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Yosei bar Chanina disagreed: one said that the descendants of Noach offered peace-offerings, and one said that they did not. What is the reason of the one who says they did not? Awake, north, and come, south: the nation whose service is in the north should move aside, and the nation whose service is in both north and south should come." The Gemara preserves both views. Rav Tzadok expressly argues that even the view allowing peace-offerings does not overcome the Passover offering's explicit restrictions.

[1108] **Rosh Hashanah 25a** — "Rabbi Dosa ben Horkinas said: They are false witnesses. How can they testify concerning a woman that she gave birth, while on the following day her belly is between her teeth? Rabbi Yehoshua told him: I see the force of your words." The comparison concerns testimony to the new moon followed by the appearance of the old moon. Rav Tzadok takes its language of birth as an image of the moon's renewed light.

פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר ד׳ Purim — Maamar Daled

עִנְיַן מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **The matter of what they said** (מְגִלָּה ו, ב) **(Megillah 6b):** מִסְמַךְ גְּאוּלָּה לִגְאוּלָּה עָדִיף **"Juxtaposing redemption to redemption is preferable,"** וְהַיְנוּ **that is, the redemption of Egypt** לִגְאוּלַּת פּוּרִים. **to the redemption of Purim.** הוּא דִּגְאוּלַּת מִצְרַיִם **It is that the redemption of Egypt** הָיָה רֹאשׁ שֶׁל כָּל הַנִּיסִּים **was the head of all the miracles,** וְהָיָה רֵאשִׁית הִתְגַּלּוּת **and was the beginning of the revelation** קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל בָּעוֹלָם **of the holiness of Yisrael in the world;** וְהָיָה הַנֵּס גָּלוּי לְכָל הָעוֹלָם **and the miracle was revealed to the whole world,** שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ בָּחַר בָּנוּ לְעָם **that Hashem Yisbarach chose us as a nation** וְעָשָׂה נִסִּים נִגְלִים **and performed open miracles** שֶׁהֵם חוּץ לְדֶרֶךְ הַטֶּבַע **that are outside the way of nature,** [שְׁמוֹת טו, יד] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Shemos 15:14),** שָׁמְעוּ עַמִּים יִרְגָּזוּן וְגוֹ׳ **"Nations heard and trembled," etc.** אֲמָנָם גַּם פּוּרִים נִקְרָא **However, the miracle of Purim is called** סוֹף כָּל הַנִּסִּים **"the end of all the miracles"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא כט, א) **(as stated in Yoma 29a),** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהַכֹּל הָיָה בְּהֶסְתֵּר גָּדוֹל **because everything was in great concealment** וְהָיָה מְלוּבָּשׁ כִּמְעַט **and was clothed almost** בְּדֶרֶךְ הַטֶּבַע **in the way of nature:** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי סִיבָּה **that through the circumstance** שֶׁלָּקַח אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ אֶת אֶסְתֵּר **that Achashverosh took Esther,** וְנָשְׂאָה חֵן בְּעֵינָיו **and she found favor in his eyes,** עַל יְדֵי זֶה **through this she brought about** לְהַכְנִיעַ אֶת הָמָן **the subjugation of Haman** וּלְנַשֵּׂא אֶת הַיְּהוּדִים. **and the exaltation of the Jews.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (חוּלִּין קלט, ב) **And this is what they said (Chullin 139b):** אֶסְתֵּר מִן הַתּוֹרָה מִנַּיִן **"Where is Esther alluded to in the Torah?** [דְּבָרִים לא, יח] וְאָנֹכִי הַסְתֵּר אַסְתִּיר **'And I will surely hide'" (Devarim 31:18).** וּכְדַאִיתָא בַּסְּפָרִים הַקְּדוֹשִׁים **And as is brought in the holy sefarim** עַל פָּסוּק זֶה **on this verse,** נֶעְלָם מִמֶּנּוּ זֹאת כַּאֲשֶׁר הוּא **it is hidden from him** שֶׁהוּא בְּהֶסְתֵּר פָּנִים[1109] **that he is in a state of hester panim;** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **and this is what it says,** וְאָנֹכִי הַסְתֵּר אַסְתִּיר **"And I will surely hide,"** שֶׁיַּסְתִּיר הֶסְתֵּר פָּנִים.[1110] **that He will hide the hiding of the Face.** וְזֶה הָיָה עִיקַּר נֵס פּוּרִים **And this was the essence of the miracle of Purim:** שֶׁהָיוּ אָז בְּשֵׁפֶל הַמַּדְרֵגָה **that they were then at the lowest level,** שֶׁעוֹמְדִים בְּתַכְלִית הֶהֶסְתֵּר **that they stood in utter concealment,** וְכַאֲשֶׁר הִרְגִּישׁוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **and when Yisrael felt** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אֶסְתֵּר ד, ג] **as it says (Esther 4:3),** אֵבֶל גָּדוֹל לַיְּהוּדִים **"great mourning among the Jews,** וְצוֹם וּבְכִי וּמִסְפֵּד וְגוֹ׳ **and fasting, and weeping, and lamenting," etc.** וְכִידּוּעַ דְּעִנְיַן אֲבִילוּת וְהֶסְפֵּד **And as is known, mourning and eulogy** יוֹרֶה עַל דָּבָר **indicate a matter** שֶׁנֶּחְלַט בְּדַעַת הָאָדָם **that has been settled in a person's mind** שֶׁכְּבָר אָבְדָה תִּקְוָתוֹ **that his hope is already lost,** וּכְעִנְיַן אֵבֶל וְהֶסְפֵּד עַל מֵת **like mourning and eulogy for the dead,** שֶׁאֵין אוֹפֶן לְהַחֲזִירוֹ **whom there is no way to bring back;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁוּ **and through this that they felt** הֶהֱסְתֵּר פָּנִים **the hester panim,** נֶהְפַּךְ לָהֶם מֵאֵבֶל לְיוֹם טוֹב. **it was transformed for them from mourning to a festival.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (מְגִלָּה יא, א) **And this is what they said (Megillah 11a):** אֵימָתַי רָאוּ כָּל אַפְסֵי אֶרֶץ אֶת יְשׁוּעַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ **"When did all the ends of the earth see the salvation of our God?** בִּימֵי מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר. **In the days of Mordechai and Esther."** וְאֵין הַמְכוּוָּן בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **The intent of what it says,** רָאוּ כָּל אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ **"all the ends of the earth saw,"** עַל אוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם **is not the nations of the world,** דְּהֵם לֹא רָאוּ **for they did not see** אֶת יְשׁוּעַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ **the salvation of our God,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהָיָה מְלוּבָּשׁ **since it was clothed** קְרוֹב לְדֶרֶךְ הַטֶּבַע כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **close to the way of nature, as mentioned above.** וּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אֶסְתֵּר ח, יז] **And what it says (Esther 8:17),** וְרַבִּים מֵעַמֵּי הָאָרֶץ מִתְיַהֲדִים **"And many of the peoples of the land became Jews,"** הָיָה רַק מִפַּחַד הַיְּהוּדִים **was only out of fear of the Jews** וּמִפַּחַד מָרְדְּכַי **and fear of Mordechai,** שֶׁרָאוּ שֶׁגִּדְּלוֹ הַמֶּלֶךְ **for they saw that the king had elevated him** בִּשְׁבִיל כְּבוֹד אֶסְתֵּר הַמַּלְכָּה. **for the sake of the honor of Queen Esther.** רַק הַמְכוּוָּן **Rather, the intent of** שֶׁהָיוּ אָז בְּתַכְלִית הַשִּׁפְלוּת **who were then in utter lowliness,** עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **is Yisrael,** בְּהֶסְתֵּר עַד אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ **in the concealment, down to the ends of the earth;** רָאוּ כָּל אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ **"all the ends of the earth saw"**

[1109] **Shemot Rabbah 33:1** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel: I sold you My Torah; as it were, I was sold with it. ... This is compared to a king with an only daughter. Another king married her and wished to take her to his land. Her father said: I cannot part from her, and I cannot tell you not to take her, since she is your wife. Do me this kindness: wherever you go, make me a little chamber, so that I may dwell with you. ... So the Holy One, blessed be He, told Israel: Wherever you go, make Me one house in which to dwell, as it is said, They shall make Me a sanctuary." The Midrash interprets taking a contribution for Me through God's inseparability from His Torah. Rav Tzadok links that attachment with the doubled for you in the commandment of the month.

[1110] **Shemot Rabbah 25:11** — "What is meant by He gave to you? It was given to you, not to the nations. ... It says, Between Me and the children of Israel. This is compared to a king seated with the queen seated opposite him: whoever passes between them is liable." The original context is Shabbos as a covenant between God and Israel. Rav Tzadok borrows its image to explain the distinctive bond expressed by for you in HaChodesh.

וְדַיְיקָא עַל יְדֵי זֶה **and precisely through this** רָאוּ אֶת יְשׁוּעַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ **they saw the salvation of our God,** מִתּוֹךְ הַהֶסְתֵּר הַזֶּה דַּיְיקָא.[1111] **precisely out of this concealment.** וְעִנְיָן זֶה מִתְנוֹצֵץ בְּכָל שָׁנָה **And this matter sparkles forth every year** בִּימֵי פּוּרִים **in the days of Purim;** נִתְוַדַּע לְכָל פְּרָטֵי נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל **it becomes known to every individual Jewish soul:** כָּל מִי שֶׁיּוֹדֵעַ נִגְעֵי לְבָבוֹ **whoever knows the afflictions of his heart,** אֵיךְ הוּא בְּשִׁפָּל הַמַּדְרֵגָה **how he is at the lowest level,** וְהוּא מִתְמָרְמֵר עַל זֶה. **and he is embittered over this,** בָּזֶה עַצְמוֹ נוֹדָע וּמֵאִיר שֶׁנֶּהְפַּךְ לוֹ מִיָּגוֹן לְשִׂמְחָה: **through this itself it becomes known and shines in his heart that it has been transformed for him from sorrow to joy.**

[1111] **Pesikta Rabbasi 15:24, HaChodesh** — “They shall take for themselves a man: this is the Holy One, blessed be He, of whom it is written, Hashem is a man of war, whom you take through the two continual offerings. A lamb: this is the continual offering, as it says, The one lamb you shall offer in the morning.” The Midrash's immediate explanation is the two tamid offerings. Rav Tzadok extends its language of taking God to the Passover commandment in the surrounding section.

פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר ה׳ Purim — Maamar Hei

קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק וְהָמָן **The kelipah of Amalek and Haman** הוּא חוּצְפָּה וְנִיצּוּחַ כְּלַפֵּי שְׁמַיָּא **is brazenness and defiance toward Heaven,** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ קְלִיפַּת בִּלְעָם **and it is like the kelipah of Bilam:** לוֹ שֶׁאַף שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **for even though he was told,** לֹא תֵלֵךְ עִמָּהֶם **"Do not go with them;** לֹא תָאוֹר אֶת הָעָם וְגוֹ׳ [בְּמִדְבַּר כב, יב] **do not curse the people," etc. (Bamidbar 22:12),** וְאַף עַל פִּי כֵן הָלַךְ[1112] **nevertheless he went;** (סַנְהֶדְרִין קה, א) וְעָלָיו אָמְרוּ **and about him they said (Sanhedrin 105a):** חוּצְפָּא אֲפִילּוּ כְּלַפֵּי שְׁמַיָּא **"Brazenness, even toward Heaven,** וְכוּ׳[1113] מְהַנֵּי **is effective," etc.** וּכְמוֹ כֵן עֲמָלֵק וְהָמָן **And likewise Amalek and Haman** יָדְעוּ יְקָרוּת יִשְׂרָאֵל **knew the preciousness of Yisrael,** וְאַף עַל פִּי כֵן **and nevertheless** עָמְדוּ בְּחוּצְפָּה כְּלַפֵּי שְׁמַיָּא **they stood in brazenness toward Heaven** לְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל לְמַעְלָה **to prosecute against Yisrael Above,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ. **as we have said.** וְעִנְיָן מִדָּה זוֹ **And this trait** נִצְמַח מִבְּחִינַת **sprouts from the aspect of** זֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה **"one opposite the other":** שֶׁבָּרָא ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ בִּקְדוּשָׁה **for Hashem Yisbarach created in holiness** עִנְיַן הַנִּיצּוּחַ כְּלַפֵּי שְׁמַיָּא **the matter of prevailing over Heaven** לְטוֹבַת יִשְׂרָאֵל **for the good of Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (פְּסָחִים קיט, א) **as they said (Pesachim 119a):** זַמְּרוּ לְמִי שֶׁנּוֹצְחִין אוֹתוֹ **"Sing to the One Who is prevailed upon** וְשָׂמֵחַ וְכוּ׳ **and rejoices," etc.,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"HaKadosh Baruch Hu** וְכוּלֵי[1114] נוֹצְחִין אוֹתוֹ וְשָׂמֵחַ **is prevailed upon and rejoices," etc.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And in the manner of what they said** (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא נט, ב) **(Bava Metzia 59b):** מַאי עָבֵיד קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְכוּ׳ **"What did HaKadosh Baruch Hu do?" etc.** קָא חָיֵיךְ וְאָמַר **"He smiled and said,** וְכוּ׳[1115] נִצְּחוּנִי בָּנַי **'My children have prevailed over Me,'" etc.** שֶׁיִּוָּדְעִים יִשְׂרָאֵל **For Yisrael know** שֶׁזֶּהוּ בְּעַצְמוֹ רְצוֹן ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **that this itself is the will of Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁנַּחְצִיף פָּנֵינוּ לְנַצְּחוֹ **that we be bold-faced to prevail over Him** לְטוֹבַת יִשְׂרָאֵל.[1116] **for the good of Yisrael.** וּכְדְאִיתָא (תַּעֲנִית כה, א) **And as is brought (Taanis 25a)** עַל לֵוִי שֶׁהֵטִיחַ דְּבָרִים **about Levi, who spoke harsh words** כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה **toward Above,** וְאָמַר עָלִיתָ וְיָשַׁבְתָּ בַּמָּרוֹם וְכוּ׳ **and said, "You have ascended and sat on high," etc.;** וְהַגַּם דְּנֶעֱנַשׁ עַל זֶה **and although he was punished for this** דְּאִיטְּלַע **in that he became lame,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם **nevertheless** הוֹעִיל לְכָלַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **it helped Klal Yisrael,** וְאָתָא מִיטָרָא.[1117] **and the rain came.** וּמִזֶּה נִסְתָּעֵף **And from this branched out** עִנְיַן הַחוּצְפָּה וְהַנִּיצּוּחַ לְמַעְלָה **the brazenness and defiance toward Above,** בָּזֶה

[1112] **Rosh Hashanah 24a** — "The head of the court says: Sanctified! All the people answer after him: Sanctified, sanctified! ... From where is it learned that all the people answer after him? Rav Pappa said: Scripture says, Which you shall proclaim them; read it as you. ... Why twice, Sanctified, sanctified? Because it is written, Holy convocations. Whether it was seen at its expected time or was not seen at its expected time, they sanctify it." The Mishnah and Gemara include the people in the proclamation. Rav Tzadok reads their response as participation in the holiness conferred by the court.

[1113] **Eruvin 96a** — "Rabbi Akiva says: Could a person put on tefillin on Shabbosos and festivals? Scripture says, It shall be for you a sign upon your hand: those that require a sign. These are excluded, for they themselves are a sign." Rav Tzadok explains the festival itself as an embodied sign of holiness, corresponding to the holiness expressed by tefillin.

[1114] **Pesikta Rabbasi 15, conclusion, HaChodesh** — "Rabbi Berechyah said in Rabbi Yitzchak's name: This month—renew your deeds, for head and first are still to come. Head is the wicked Nevuchadnezzar, of whom it is written, You are the head of gold. First is the wicked Esav, of whom it is written, The first came out. Who will exact payment for you? The First: I, Hashem, am first, and with the last I am He." The Midrash sets the two hostile firsts against God, the First. Rav Tzadok distinguishes overt opposition to revealed wisdom from a concealed claim against Israel's inward character.

[1115] **Megillah 11a** — "Achasheverosh: Rav said, The brother of the head, and the counterpart of the head. Brother of the head means brother of wicked Nevuchadnezzar, who is called head: You are the head of gold. His counterpart: the one killed, and the other sought to kill; the one destroyed, and the other sought to destroy, as it is said, In the reign of Achasheverosh, at the beginning of his reign, they wrote an accusation against the inhabitants of Yehudah and Jerusalem." The comparison is one of destructive intention and action. Rav Tzadok places both kings opposite holy wisdom, through which the earth is founded.

[1116] **Yoma 9b** — "The second Temple: they occupied themselves with Torah, commandments, and acts of kindness. Why was it destroyed? Because it contained baseless hatred. This teaches that baseless hatred is equivalent to the three transgressions of idolatry, forbidden relations, and bloodshed. ... Rabbi Yochanan and Rabbi Elazar both said: The earlier ones, whose sin was revealed, had the end of their exile revealed; the later ones, whose sin was not revealed, did not have their end revealed." The Gemara contrasts visible religious achievement with destructive hatred and the differing revelation of the exile's end. Rav Tzadok links this inward failure with the concealed opposition of Edom.

[1117] **Megillah 27a** — "Perhaps study is different, because study leads to action. Marriage too is different: He did not create it for emptiness; He formed it to be inhabited. But exchanging Torah for Torah may not be permitted." The discussion concerns selling a Torah scroll to enable study or marriage. Rav Tzadok draws from its reason for preferring study the principle that renewal in Torah must bear fruit in action.

לְעוּמַּת זֶה **as "one opposite the other,"** בְּקִלִּיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **in the kelipah of Amalek,** לְהָרַע לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **to harm Yisrael;** וְאַחֲרִיתוֹ עֲדֵי אוֹבֵד **but "his end is to perish forever,"** [תְּהִלִּים ט, ז-ח] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 9:7–8),** הָאוֹיֵב תַּמּוּ וְגוֹ׳ **"The enemy is finished," etc.,** וַה׳ לְעוֹלָם יֵשֵׁב **"and Hashem sits enthroned forever;** כּוֹנֵן לַמִּשְׁפָּט כִּסְאוֹ: **He has established His throne for judgment."**

פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר ו׳ Purim — Maamar Vav

עַל כֵּן קָרְאוּ לַיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה **"Therefore they called these days** [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כו][1118] פּוּרִים עַל שֵׁם הַפּוּר. **Purim, after the name of the Pur" (Esther 9:26).** וְלִכְאוֹרָה יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **At first glance we must understand** לָמָּה קָרְאוּ שֵׁם הַיָּמִים כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כד] **why they named the days** עַל הָעִנְיָן שֶׁהָיָה הַצָּרָה **after the matter that was the trouble,** **as it says (Esther 9:24),** וְהִפִּיל פּוּר וְגוֹ׳ **"and he cast a Pur," etc.,** לְהוּמָם וּלְאַבְּדָם. **"to crush them and destroy them."** וְלָמָּה לֹא קָרְאוּ הַיָּמִים **And why did they not name the days** עַל שֵׁם הַנֵּס **after the miracle,** כְּמוֹ פֶּסַח **like Pesach,** [פְּסָחִים קטז, ב] וְכוּ׳ עַל שׁוּם שֶׁפָּסַח[1119] **because He passed over, etc. (Pesachim 116b);** וּבַתּוֹרָה חַג הַמַּצּוֹת **and in the Torah, the Festival of Matzos,** וְכוּ׳ עַל שׁוּם שֶׁלֹּא הִסְפִּיק בְּצֵקָם[1120] **because their dough did not have time, etc.** [נֻסַּח הַהַגָּדָה שֶׁל פֶּסַח] **(text of the Pesach Haggadah);** חַג הַסּוּכּוֹת **the Festival of Sukkos,** כִּי בַסֻּכּוֹת הוֹשַׁבְתִּי וְגוֹ׳ **"for I made them dwell in sukkos," etc.,** [וַיִּקְרָא כג, מג] בְּהוֹצִיאִי וְגוֹ׳ **"when I took them out," etc. (Vayikra 23:43).** הַכֹּל עַל שְׁעַת הַיְצִיאָה וְהַגְּאוּלָּה **All are named for the time of the Exodus and the redemption,** וְהָכָא הַפּוּר **whereas here, the Pur** הוּא בִּשְׁעַת הַגְּזֵרָה. **belongs to the time of the decree.** אֲבָל הָעִנְיָן **However, the matter is** כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת זֶה הַפּוּר **that in truth this Pur** שֶׁחָשַׁב הָמָן לְרָעָה **that Haman intended for evil** הָיָה בְּעַצְמוֹ לְטוֹבַת יִשְׂרָאֵל **was itself for the good of Yisrael,** כִּי פּוּר הָמָן נֶהְפַּךְ לְפוּרֵינוּ.[1121] **for the Pur of Haman was transformed into our Pur.** (מְגִילָּה י, ב) דְּאִיתָא **For it is brought (Megillah 10b):** רַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בֶּן לֵוִי פָּתַח וְכוּ׳ **"Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi opened," etc.:** וְהָיָה כַּאֲשֶׁר שָׂשׂ וְגוֹ׳ **"And it shall be, as He rejoiced," etc.,** כֵּן יָשִׂישׂ לְהָרַע אֶתְכֶם. **"so will He rejoice to do you harm."** וּפֵרֵיךְ וּמִי חָדֵי **And it asks: "But does** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **HaKadosh Baruch Hu rejoice** בְּמַפַּלְתָּן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים **at the downfall of the wicked?** וְהָא כְּתִיב בְּצֵאת וְגוֹ׳ **Behold it is written, 'As they went out,' etc.,** לֹא נֶאֱמַר כִּי טוֹב **'for it is good' is not said** זוֹ בְּהוֹדָאָה **in this thanksgiving,** שֶׁל בְּמַפַּלְתָּן **because HaKadosh Baruch Hu does not rejoice** לְפִי שֶׁאֵין הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שָׂמֵחַ **at the downfall of the wicked;** וְאָמַר רַבִּי יוֹחָנָן וְכוּ׳ **and Rabbi Yochanan said," etc.,** מַעֲשֵׂי יָדַי טוֹבְעִין בַּיָּם **"'The work of My hands is drowning in the sea,** וְאַתֶּם אוֹמְרִים שִׁירָה. **and you are saying song?'"** אָמַר רַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר **Rabbi Elazar said:** הוּא אֵינוֹ שָׂשׂ **"He does not rejoice,** וְכוּ׳[1122] אֲבָל אֲחֵרִים מַשְׁרִישׁ **but He causes others to rejoice," etc.** [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אֲחֵרִים] וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשׁ״י **And Rashi explained (s.v. Acherim):** וּכְשֶׁנִּתְחַיְּבוּ כְּלָיָה בִּימֵי הָמָן **"And when they were liable to annihilation in the days of Haman,** הָיוּ אוֹיְבֵיהֶן שְׂמֵחִים **their enemies were rejoicing";** עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1123] **see there.** וְהַדָּבָר צָרִיךְ בֵּירוּר **And the matter requires clarification:** מָה עִנְיַן פְּתִיחָה זוֹ

[1118] **Musaf for Shabbos HaChodesh, Rishon Immatzta, opening stanza and acrostic** — "O First One, You strengthened the rose-blossom. Give strength to awaken sleepers from slumber, as You remember the covenant of the first ones." The seven stanza-opening words mean, in order: First; to Zion; behold; here they are; and to Jerusalem; a herald; I shall give. They reproduce Isaiah 41:27. Their refrains successively name four New Years, four seasons, four periods, four portions, four cups, four kingdoms, and four craftsmen. The verse and the recurring fourfold pattern therefore belong to the original poem itself.

[1119] **Shemot Rabbah 15:1** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, is called first: I am first and I am last. Tziyon is called first: A throne of glory, exalted from the first, the place of our sanctuary. Esav is called first: The first came out. Mashiach is called first: First to Tziyon, behold, here they are. Let the Holy One, blessed be He, who is called first, come, build the Temple called first, exact payment from Esav called first, and bring Mashiach called first, in the first month." The Midrash joins Tziyon and the Temple through the verse naming the place of our sanctuary. Rav Tzadok explains their unity through the foundation stone.

[1120] **Yoma 54b** — "It was called Shesiyah: a teaching explains that from it the world was founded. Our Mishnah follows the view that the world was created from Tziyon. ... The Sages say: It was created from Tziyon, as it is said, God, Hashem God, spoke and called the earth from the rising of the sun to its setting; and it says, From Tziyon, the perfection of beauty—from it the beauty of the world was perfected." The Gemara preserves several views of creation's starting point. Rav Tzadok follows the view identified with the Mishnah's foundation stone.

[1121] **Pesachim 5a** — "The school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: As reward for three occurrences of first, they merited three firsts: cutting off Esav's seed, the building of the Temple, and Mashiach's name. ... Mashiach's name: First to Tziyon, behold, here they are." The surrounding discussion concerns first as applied to removing leaven, festival rest, and taking the lulav. Rav Tzadok links these rewards with the firstness proclaimed in HaChodesh.

[1122] **Pesachim 54a** — "Seven things were created before the world was created: Torah, repentance, Gan Eden, Gehinnom, the Throne of Glory, the Temple, and Mashiach's name. ... The Throne of Glory and the Temple: A throne of glory, exalted from the first, the place of our sanctuary. Mashiach's name: May his name endure forever; before the sun, may his name flourish." The Gemara's proof for Mashiach's name is from Tehillim 72:17. Rav Tzadok explicitly distinguishes that verse from first to Tziyon.

[1123] **Tikkunei Zohar, on Bereishis 1:2, digital unit 77[1,4]** — "Two thousand years of Torah: The spirit of God hovered over the face of the waters, and water is none other than Torah. The face of the waters is its two faces, positive

what is the connection of this opening לְמְגִילַּת אֶסְתֵּר **to Megillas Esther?** שֶׁהַפְּתִיחָה הוּא **For the opening is meant** לְבָאֵר עִנְיַן הַמְּגִילָּה **to explain the matter of the Megillah,** וְזֶה לֹא שַׁיָּיךְ כְּלָל **and this has no connection at all** לְהַאי פָּרְשְׁתָּא **to this passage;** וּמַאי נַפְקָא מִינָּהּ מִזֶּה **and what difference does it make** שֶׁמְּשִׂישׂ הָאוֹיְבִים לְפִירוּשׁ רַשִׁ״י. **that He causes the enemies to rejoice, according to Rashi's explanation?** גַּם לָמָּה נִצְרַךְ לִכְתּוֹב בַּתּוֹרָה **Also, why was it necessary to write in the Torah** שֶׁמְּשִׂישׂ אֶת הָאוֹיְבִים **that He causes the enemies to rejoice?** הֲלֹא זֶה אֵינוֹ מֵעִנְיַן הָעוֹנֶשׁ **Surely this is not part of the punishment,** דְּמַאי נַפְקָא מִינָּהּ **for what difference does it make** לְעִנְיַן הָעוֹנֶשׁ **regarding the punishment** אִם יִשְׂמְחוּ הָאוֹיְבִים **whether the enemies rejoice?** וְגַם מַה שַּׁיָּיךְ עַל זֶה הַדִּמְיוֹן **And also, how does the comparison apply here:** כַּאֲשֶׁר שָׂשׂ לְהֵיטִיב **"as He rejoiced to do good,** כֵּן יָשִׂישׂ וְגוֹ׳ **so will He rejoice," etc.?** וּמַה דְּמוּת יַעֲרוֹךְ **What likeness can be compared,** זֶה לָזֶה **the one to the other?** וְשָׁם הוּא שִׂמְחָה בֶּאֱמֶת **There it is true joy** לִפְנֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **before HaKadosh Baruch Hu;** וְאֵיךְ שַׁיָּיךְ לְדַמּוֹתוֹ **so how can one compare it** וְלוֹמַר כֵּן יָשִׂישׂ וְגוֹ׳. **and say "so will He rejoice," etc.?** גַּם מַה שֶּׁהִקְשׁוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **Also, what they asked in the Gemara,** וּמִי חָדֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא וְכוּ׳ **"But does HaKadosh Baruch Hu rejoice," etc.,** כְּפִי הַפְּשָׁט **according to the plain meaning** דְּקָאֵי עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that it refers to Yisrael,** וְלָמָּה הוּצְרַךְ לְהָבִיא רְאָיָה **why did it need to bring proof** מִמַּה שֶּׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר כִּי טוֹב **from the fact that "for it is good" is not said** בְּהוֹדָאָה **in the thanksgiving,** דְּקְרָא בְּמִלְחֶמֶת יְהוֹשָׁפָט **since that verse is about the war of Yehoshafat** עַל עַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב. **against Ammon and Moav;** וּמִדְּרָשָׁא דְּלֹא קָרַב זֶה אֶל זֶה **and from the derashah of "one did not come near the other,"** דְּהוּא דְּרָשָׁא בְּעָלְמָא **which is merely a derashah,** וְשָׁם מְדַבֵּר מִמִּצְרִיִּים. **and there it speaks of the Egyptians?** וַהֲלֹא כַּמָּה פְּסוּקִים מְפוֹרָשִׁים **Are there not many explicit verses** אֶלָּא עוֹד מִצְטַעֵר **but** דְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **that HaKadosh Baruch Hu** לֹא שֶׁאֵינוֹ שָׂמֵחַ **not only does not rejoice,** דֵּי **even suffers pain** בְּצָרַת יִשְׂרָאֵל **in the distress of Yisrael,** [תְּהִלִּים צא, טו] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Tehillim 91:15),** עִמּוֹ אָנֹכִי בְצָרָה **"I am with him in distress,"** [יְשַׁעְיָה סג, ט] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Yeshayah 63:9),** בְּכָל צָרָתָם לוֹ צָר **"In all their distress He is distressed,"** [זְכַרְיָה ט, ט] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Zechariah 9:9),** צַדִּיק וְנוֹשָׁע הוּא **"He is righteous and saved,"** וְאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **and our Sages of blessed memory said** (תַּנְחוּמָא אַחֲרֵי יב) **(Tanchuma Acharei 12):** וּמוֹשִׁיעַ אֵין כְּתִיב **"'And saving' is not written,** אֶלָּא צַדִּיק וְנוֹשָׁע הוּא **but rather 'He is righteous and saved':** כְּבָיְכוֹל הוּא נוֹשָׁע **as it were, He is saved,"** וּמַיְיתֵי מִכַּמָּה קְרָאֵי[1124] **and it brings several verses;** שָׁם. עַיֵּין **see there.** וְאִיתָא (מְגִילָּה כט, א) **And it is brought (Megillah 29a)** שֶׁבְּכָל מָקוֹם **that "wherever they were exiled,** גָּלְתָה שְׁכִינָה עִמָּהֶן **the Shechinah was exiled with them,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה מג, יד] **as it says (Yeshayah 43:14),** וּכְשֶׁנִּגְאָלִין שְׁכִינָה לְמַעַנְכֶם שִׁלַּחְתִּי בָבֶלָה **'For your sake I was sent to Bavel';** וְהַשִּׁיב עִמָּהֶן שָׁם **and when they are redeemed, the Shechinah is with them,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said there:** וַהֲרֵי דְּהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לֹא נֶאֱמַר **"'And He will bring back' is not said,** אֶלָּא וְשָׁב.[1125] **but 'and He will return.'"** **So we see that HaKadosh Baruch Hu,** כְּבָיְכוֹל מִצְטַעֵר בְּצָרָתָם **as it were, suffers in their distress;** וְאֵיךְ סָלְקָא דַּעְתָּךְ **so how could one imagine** שֶׁיִּשְׂמַח חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **that He would rejoice, chas v'shalom,** וְלָמָּה הוּצְרַךְ רְאָיָה. **and why was proof needed?** אֲבָל הִנֵּה בַּתּוֹרָה כָּתוּב **But behold, in the Torah it is written,** כֵּן יָשִׂישׂ ה׳ עֲלֵיכֶם **"so will Hashem rejoice over you** לְהַאֲבִיד אֶתְכֶם **to destroy you** [דְּבָרִים כח, סג] וּלְהַשְׁמִיד אֶתְכֶם **and to annihilate you" (Devarim 28:63),** וְזֶה תְּמִיהָא **and this is astonishing:** אֵיךְ שַׁיָּיךְ בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל לוֹמַר **how can one say regarding Yisrael** לְהַאֲבִיד **"to destroy"?** הֲלֹא כָּל הָעוֹלָם נִבְרָא **Was not the entire world created** בִּשְׁבִיל יִשְׂרָאֵל **for the sake of Yisrael,** [רַשִׁ״י בְּרֵאשִׁית א, א] שֶׁנִּקְרָא רֵאשִׁית **who are called "Reishis" (Rashi, Bereishis 1:1),** וְגַם בִּשְׁבִיל

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commandments and prohibitions, white and red, right and left. These are the two thousand years of Torah. Two thousand years of Mashiach's days: God said, Let there be light, and there was light." This is the exact original passage connecting the creation waters with Torah. The manuscript cites Tikkun 36,77b; the digital collection indexes it as unit 77, so its printed coordinate still requires collation.

[1124] **Musaf for Shabbos HaChodesh, Gevuros stanza and Four Seasons refrain** — "The month in which salvations encompass, strengthening those who take refuge in Him. ... Four seasons in the year—renew their light as at first! As we have heard, so again hasten [our deliverance], please. Sustain us with rain in the first of the year's months." The encompassing salvations and the four seasons occur together in the same blessing, providing the exact liturgical wording from which Rav Tzadok develops the image of being surrounded on four sides.

[1125] **Musaf for Shabbos HaChodesh, Hodaah and Sim Shalom refrains** — "Let us thresh the four kingdoms, please. ... Four craftsmen, as in the vision: You explained them, one from another, to the seer. As we have heard, so may we again behold; bless us with peace in this month." The four kingdoms are named in Hodaah; the four craftsmen occur in the following blessing, Sim Shalom, exactly as Rav Tzadok states. Earlier, the Avodah refrain names the four cups. The ellipsis passes from the first line of the Hodaah refrain to the complete Sim Shalom refrain.

and also for the sake of the Torah הַתּוֹרָה **that Yisrael received (ibid.),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת [שָׁם][1126] שֶׁקִּבְּלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **as they said (Shabbos 88a)** פח, א) עִם מַעֲשֵׂה **that HaKadosh Baruch Hu stipulated** שֶׁהִתְנָה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **with the work of Creation:** בְּרֵאשִׁית **"If Yisrael accept the Torah,** אִם יִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַבְּלִין הַתּוֹרָה אַתֶּם מִתְקַיְּמִין וְכוּ' **you will endure," etc.; and if, chas v'shalom, to destroy,** וְאִם חַס וְשָׁלוֹם לְהַאֲבִיד **the world would be destroyed.** יֶחֱרַב הָעוֹלָם. **And it is written (Melachim II 14:27),** וּכְתִיב [מְלָכִים ב יד, כז] **"And Hashem did not say** וְלֹא דִבֶּר ה' לִמְחוֹת אֶת שֵׁם יִשְׂרָאֵל **that He would blot out the name of Yisrael** מִתַּחַת הַשָּׁמָיִם **from under the heavens,"** [יְשַׁעְיָה סו, כב] **and it says (Yeshayah 66:22),** וְנֶאֱמַר כֵּן יַעֲמֹד **"so shall stand** זַרְעֲכֶם וְשִׁמְכֶם **your offspring and your name,"** [יִרְמְיָה לא, לו] **and it says (Yirmeyah 31:36),** וְנֶאֱמַר אִם יִמַּדּוּ שָׁמַיִם וְגוֹ' **"If the heavens can be measured," etc.,** גַּם אֲנִי אֶמְאַס **"I too will reject** בְּכָל זֶרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל וְגוֹ' **all the offspring of Yisrael," etc. So how can one imagine, chas v'shalom,** וְאֵיךְ יְצוּיַר חַס וְשָׁלוֹם לְהַאֲבִיד וּלְהַשְׁמִיד. **"to destroy and to annihilate"? But we find in Yitzchak's words to Esav:** אַךְ מָצִינוּ בְּדִבְרֵי יִצְחָק לְעֵשָׂו **"And it shall be, when you grieve,** וְהָיָה כַּאֲשֶׁר תָּרִיד [בְּרֵאשִׁית כז, מ] וּפָרַקְתָּ וְגוֹ' **you shall break," etc. (Bereishis 27:40).** וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י [שָׁם] **And Rashi explained (ibid.):** תָּרִיד לְשׁוֹן צַעַר **"Tarid" is an expression of pain,** שֶׁתִּצְטַעֵר עַל הַבְּרָכוֹת **that you will be pained over the blessings** כְּשֶׁיַּעַבְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל עַל הַתּוֹרָה **when Yisrael transgress the Torah,** אָז וּפָרַקְתָּ.[1127] **then "you shall break." And we must understand** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין לָמָּה כָּתוּב וְהָיָה **why it is written "And it shall be,"** שֶׁאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **for our Sages of blessed memory said** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה מב, ג) **(Bereishis Rabbah 42:3)** וְהָיָה לְשׁוֹן שִׂמְחָה[1128] **that "vehayah" is an expression of joy;** וּמַה זּוֹ שִׂמְחָה **and what joy is this?** וּטְפֵי הָיָה שַׁיָּיךְ לְשׁוֹן וְהָיָה **The expression "vehayah" would have been more fitting** בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **for what is said,** וְאֶת אָחִיךָ תַּעֲבוֹד. **"and you shall serve your brother."** אָכֵן שָׁמַעְתִּי מֵרַבֵּנוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ **However, I heard from our holy Rebbe,** זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה **may the memory of the holy tzaddik be for a blessing,** לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **for the life of the World to Come,** שֶׁאָמַר עַל זֶה **who said about this** שֶׁבְּעֵת שֶׁמַּגִּיעַ יְרִידַת עֵשָׂו **that when the time of Esav's downfall arrives,** אָז מְעַנֶּה וּמֵיצַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בְּיוֹתֵר **then he afflicts and distresses Yisrael the most,** וְתֵיכֶף יֵשׁ לוֹ יְרִידָה **and immediately he has a downfall;** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כַּאֲשֶׁר תָּרִיד **and this is what it says, "when you grieve,"** בִּזְמַן יְרִידָתוֹ **at the time of his downfall,** וּפָרַקְתָּ עֻלּוֹ וְגוֹ' **"and you shall break his yoke," etc.** וְאִדְּרַבָּה יִהְיֶה מֵיצַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **On the contrary, he will distress Yisrael,** וְתֵיכֶף יְהֶיה יְרִידָתוֹ **and immediately his downfall will come** בְּלֹא תְקוּמָה **with no rising again;** וְעַל כֵּן אָמַר לְשׁוֹן וְהָיָה **and therefore it uses the expression "vehayah,"** שֶׁאָז הוּא שִׂמְחָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל.[1129] **for then it is joy for Yisrael.** וְתַכְלִית יְרִידָתוֹ **And the culmination of his downfall comes** בְּעֵת הִתְרַבּוּת קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **at the time when the holiness of Yisrael increases.** וְקוֹדֶם מַתַּן תּוֹרָה **And before the giving of the Torah** הָיְתָה מִלְחֶמֶת עֲמָלֵק **there was the war of Amalek,** מִצַּד שֶׁהִרְגִּישׁ **because he sensed** שֶׁעֲתִידִין יִשְׂרָאֵל לְקַבֵּל הַתּוֹרָה **that Yisrael were destined to receive the Torah,** וְהִתְחַזְּקָה קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **and the kelipah of Amalek grew strong** לְהַרְחִיק אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **to distance Yisrael, chas v'shalom,** מִקַּבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה **from receiving the Torah;** וְתֵיכֶף הָיָה לוֹ יְרִידָה **and immediately he had a downfall:** [שְׁמוֹת יז, יג] וַיַּחֲלוֹשׁ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אֶת עֲמָלֵק וְגוֹ' **"And Yehoshua weakened Amalek," etc. (Shemos 17:13).** וַה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ עוֹרְרוֹ לָזֶה **And Hashem Yisbarach aroused him to this** כְּדֵי לְהַחֲלִישׁ כֹּחוֹ **in order to weaken his strength,** שֶׁהוּא הָרִאשִׁית גּוֹיִם **for he is "the first of the nations"** וְכֹחַ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **and the power of the yetzer**

[1126] **Sukkah 52b** — "Hashem showed me four craftsmen. Who are the four craftsmen? Rav Chana bar Bizna said in Rabbi Shimon Chasida's name: Mashiach ben David, Mashiach ben Yosef, Eliyahu, and the righteous priest." The Gemara gives these four identities. Rashi, quoted next in the discourse, explains the craftsmanship and identifies the righteous priest as Shem.

[1127] **Rashi, Sukkah 52b, s.v. Charashim and VeKohen tzedek** — "Craftsmen: artisans. Both messiahs are craftsmen for the building of the Temple. Eliyahu is a stone craftsman, who built an altar on Mount Carmel, and we find that he is destined to be sent. ... The righteous priest: this is Shem son of Noach. He is called a craftsman ... because he built the ark with his father." Rashi supplies the identification of the righteous priest with Shem and links his craftsmanship to the ark. Rav Tzadok asks how this earlier act belongs with the builders of the future Temple.

[1128] **Bereshit Rabbah 71:2** — "Rachel weeps over her children: Israel are called by Rachel's name, and also by her son's name: Perhaps Hashem, God of hosts, will favor the remnant of Yosef. And also by her grandson's name: Is Ephraim a precious son to Me?" The Midrash traces the collective naming through Rachel, Yosef, and Ephraim. Rav Tzadok relates the Yosef name to the covenantal righteousness clarified by Mashiach ben Yosef.

[1129] **Bereshit Rabbah 98:6** — "Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai said: All your brothers will be called by your name. A person does not say, I am a Reuvenite, or I am a Shimonite, but I am a Jew." The Midrash expounds Yehudah, your brothers shall acknowledge you. Rav Tzadok connects the common name Yehudi with David and Mashiach ben David's work of repentance.

hara, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג קס, א) **(vol. 3, 160a),** וְצָרִיךְ לְהַחֲלִישׁוֹ וּלְהוֹרִידוֹ **and he must be weakened and brought down** קוֹדֶם קַבָּלַת הַתּוֹרָה **before the giving of the Torah,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה **and through this** יִהְיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מוּכָנִים לָהּ. **Yisrael will be prepared for it.** וּכְמוֹ כֵן לֶעָתִיד **And likewise in the future,** קוֹדֶם בִּיאַת הַמָּשִׁיחַ **before the coming of Mashiach,** יַרְגִּישׁוּ כָּל הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **all the kelipos will sense** הִתְרַבּוּת קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **the increase of the holiness of Yisrael,** שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה תַּכְלִית שְׁלֵימוּת **for then there will be the ultimate perfection** קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **of the holiness of Yisrael;** וְעַל כֵּן אָז תִּתְעוֹרֵר **and therefore then there will be aroused** מִלְחֶמֶת גּוֹג וּמָגוֹג **the war of Gog and Magog,** דְּאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **for our Sages of blessed memory said** (תַּנְחוּמָא קֹרַח יב) **(Tanchuma Korach 12):** גּוֹג וּמָגוֹג בְּגִימַטְרִיָּא שִׁבְעִים **"Gog and Magog has the numerical value of seventy,"** שֶׁהֵם שִׁבְעִים אוּמּוֹת.[1130] **which are the seventy nations.** שֶׁיֶּאֱסוֹף כָּל הַשִּׁבְעִים אוּמּוֹת **For he will gather all the seventy nations,** וְהַשֹּׁרֶשׁ יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי עֵשָׂו **and the root will be through Esav,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (יוֹמָא י, א) **as they said (Yoma 10a)** דְּאֵין בֶּן דָּוִד בָּא **that the son of David does not come** עַד שֶׁתִּפָּשֵׁט כּוּלּוֹ **until it spreads** בְּכָל הָעוֹלָם **over the entire world** תֵּשַׁע חֳדָשִׁים[1131] **for nine months,** מִקְרָא דַּעַד עֵת יוֹלֵדָה יָלָדָה **from the verse "until the time that she who is in labor has given birth";** [מִיכָה ה, ב] **(Michah 5:2);** וְהַחֶבְלֵי מָשִׁיחַ **and the birth pangs of Mashiach** כְּמוֹ חֶבְלֵי לֵדָה **are like the pangs of childbirth;** וְאָז יִהְיֶה בֵּית עֵשָׂו לְקַשׁ **and then "the house of Esav will be straw" (Ovadiah 1:18),** שֶׁיְּלַהֵט אוֹתָם הַיּוֹם הַבָּא **which "the coming day will set ablaze,"** וְיִהְיֶה מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק לְגַמְרֵי **and there will be the complete erasure of Amalek,** וְלֹא יִהְיֶה שָׂרִיד וְגוֹ' [עוֹבַדְיָה שָׁם] **"and there will be no survivor," etc. (Ovadiah ibid.);** וְכָל הַשִּׁבְעִים קְלִיפּוֹת **and all seventy kelipos** יִבּוֹעֲרוּ לְגַמְרֵי **will be completely consumed,** שֶׁיִּבּוֹעֵר כָּל הָרַע **so that all evil will be consumed,** וּכְדִכְתִיב [דְּבָרִים לב, יב] **as it is written (Devarim 32:12),** ה' בָּדָד יַנְחֶנּוּ וְגוֹ'. **"Hashem alone will lead him," etc.** וְכֵן הָיָה בְּעִנְיַן פּוּרִים **And so it was with Purim:** שֶׁהִרְגִּישָׁה הַקְּלִיפָּה דַּעֲמָלֵק **that the kelipah of Amalek sensed** קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **the holiness of Yisrael,** שֶׁבָּא הַזְּמַן שֶׁיִּתְבַּלּוּ **that the time had come for them to receive** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the Torah she'b'al peh out of love,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת פח, א) **as they said (Shabbos 88a):** הָדָר קִבְּלוּהָ מַאַהֲבָה **"They accepted it anew in the days of Achashverosh,"** וְהַיְינוּ לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, the Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁעַל זֶה הָיָה **for regarding it there had been** כְּפִיַּת הַר כְּגִיגִית **the holding of the mountain over them like a barrel** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ ג) **(as stated in Tanchuma Noach 3);** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ [מְגִילָּה טז, ב] **and about this they said (Megillah 16b):** לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light":** בָּהּ', זוֹ תּוֹרָה. כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **in Hashem — "this is Torah," the Torah she'b'al peh —** שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **as we have said many times.** עַל יְדֵי אַנְשֵׁי שֵׁם **For then was the beginning of the Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁאָז הָיָה הַתְחָלַת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **through the Men of the Great Assembly;** וְעַל זֶה הָיָה הִתְגַּבְּרוּת הָמָן **and against this came Haman's ascendancy,** שֶׁרָצָה לְהוּמָם וּלְאַבְּדָם **who wished "to crush them and destroy them,"** וְהִפִּיל פּוּר הוּא **and "cast a Pur, that is, the lot."** הַגּוֹרָל **And the lot is from Heaven,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִשְׁלֵי טז, לג] וְהַגּוֹרָל הוּא מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם **"The lot is cast into the lap,** בַּחֵיק יוּטַל אֶת הַגּוֹרָל **but its every decision is from Hashem";** וּמַה' כָּל מִשְׁפָּטוֹ[1132] **as it says (Mishlei 16:33),** וְנָפַל הַגּוֹרָל עַל אֲדָר[1133] **and the lot fell on Adar,** כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת הָיָה רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **for in**

[1130] **Nedarim 32b** — "Rabbi Zecharyah said in Rabbi Yishmael's name: The Holy One, blessed be He, sought to bring the priesthood forth from Shem, as it is said, He was priest to God Most High. When he placed Avraham's blessing before the blessing of God, He brought it forth from Avraham." The Gemara explains the transfer through the order of Malkitzedek's blessings. Rav Tzadok considers Shem as the earliest priest before the later differentiation of the holy attributes.

[1131] **Rabbi Menachem Azariah of Fano, Asarah Maamaros, Eim Kol Chai III:23** — "They said of him that he offers continual offerings in the Temple even though it is desolate, for it stands in its holiness. This accords with what we learned at the end of Eduyos: offerings may be brought even though there is no house. It is possible that funds from the chamber contribution were stored away for him, so that they would be brought from the community's property." The subject is Eliyahu, identified in the surrounding passage with Pinchas. The author proposes the concealed communal funds as a possibility, not an established historical fact.

[1132] **Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 11** — "Why? For thus it is written: Hashem builds Jerusalem, and afterward He gathers Israel's dispersed. Israel said before the Holy One, blessed be He: Master of the world, was Jerusalem not already built and destroyed? He told them: It was destroyed through your sins, and you were exiled from it. But in the future I shall build it and never destroy it, as it is said, For Hashem has built Tziyon; He has appeared in His glory." This is the sequence Rav Tzadok quotes. The same digital paragraph begins by stating that Jerusalem is not built until the exiles are gathered, apparently reversing its final clause. That internal textual difficulty requires edition collation; the earlier wording is not silently harmonized here.

[1133] **Pesikta Rabbati 15** — "'Hope prolonged makes the heart sick' refers to Israel before they were redeemed. When Moshe came to Israel and said, 'The Holy One, blessed be He, told me: Go, tell Israel, I have surely remembered

truth it was His will, Yisbarach, לִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **to erase the memory of Amalek,** דְּעִקַּר מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **for the main erasure of Amalek** עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is through the Torah she'b'al peh.** וְהַזְּמַן לָזֶה בְּחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר **And the time for this is in the month of Adar,** עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **based on what they said** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא קכג, ב) **(Bava Basra 123b)** שֶׁאֵין זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל יוֹסֵף **that the offspring of Esav is delivered** אֶלָּא בְּיַד זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל עֵשָׂו נִמְסָר **only into the hand of the offspring of Yosef;** וְחֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר כְּנֶגֶד יוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק **and the month of Adar corresponds to Yosef HaTzaddik,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בְּסֵפֶר קְדוּשַׁת לֵוִי [לְפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל טַעַם] **as written in the sefer Kedushas Levi (on Parshas Shekalim, s.v. Ta'am),** לְפִי שֶׁאֲדָר הוּא לְפְעָמִים **because Adar is sometimes** שְׁנֵי חֳדָשִׁים **two months,** וְכֵן יוֹסֵף נִמְנֶה פְּעָמִים **and likewise Yosef is sometimes counted** לִשְׁנֵי שְׁבָטִים[1134] **as two tribes.** וְלָזֶה הָיָה **And for this reason it was caused** שֶׁיִּפִּיל גּוֹרָל **that he cast a lot,** וּמִן הַשָּׁמַיִם נָפַל עַל אֲדָר **and from Heaven it fell on Adar,** כְּדֵי לִמְחוֹת זִכְרוֹ בַּאֲדָר **in order to erase his memory in Adar;** וּבִלְעֲדֵי הַגּוֹרָל מִי יוֹדֵעַ **and without the lot, who knows** אִם הָיָה בְּדַעַת הָמָן **whether Haman would have** דַּיְיקָא עַל חֹדֶשׁ אֲדָר מוּסְכָּם. **settled specifically on the month of Adar.** וְהַפּוּר שֶׁנָּפַל עַל אֲדָר **And the Pur that fell on Adar** זֶה מֵעִיד **testifies to this:** שֶׁגַּם הַתְחָלַת הַגְּזֵרָה **that even at the start of the decree** הַכַּוָּנָה הָיָה עַל מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **the intent was toward the erasure of Amalek,** וְלֹא חַס וְשָׁלוֹם עַל הַיְּהוּדִים. **and not, chas v'shalom, against the Jews.** וְהַפּוּר הָיָה עַל **And the Pur was for the salvation,** הַיְשׁוּעָה דְּנַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא **that "it was turned about,"** דְּיִשְׁלְטוּ הַיְּהוּדִים הֵמָּה בְּשׂוֹנְאֵיהֶם **that "the Jews themselves ruled over their enemies";** וְזֶה הָיָה מִצַּד הַפּוּר **and this came about through the Pur,** שֶׁרָצָה לַהֲרוֹג וּלְאַבֵּד וְגוֹ׳ **with which he wished "to kill and to destroy," etc.;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הָיָה פִּתְחוֹן פֶּה לְאֶסְתֵּר **and through this Esther had an opening** לְבַקֵּשׁ עַל עַמָּהּ **to plead for her people** וְלַעֲשׂוֹת מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **and to carry out the erasure of Amalek.** שֶׁבְּלֹא גְּזֵרַת הָמָן מִקּוֹדֶם **For without Haman's prior decree** לַהֲרוֹג אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **to kill Yisrael,** לֹא הָיָה שַׁיָּיכוּת **it would not have been relevant** שֶׁתְּבַקֵּשׁ לַהֲרוֹג אוֹתָם **for her to ask to kill them** בְּלֹא טַעֲנָה **without any claim;** רַק עַל יְדֵי שֶׁגָּזַר הָמָן **only because Haman decreed** לַהֲרוֹג וּלְאַבֵּד **to kill and destroy Yisrael,** חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **chas v'shalom,** הָיָה הַשַּׁיָּיכוּת לְבַקֵּשׁ **was there room to ask** שֶׁיִּשְׁלְטוּ הֵמָּה בְּשׂוֹנְאֵיהֶם **that they rule over their enemies,** וְשֶׁיֵּהָפְכוּ הָרְאשׁוֹנִים.[1135] **and that the first letters be reversed.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן הַפְּתִיחָה בְּפָסוּק **And this is the meaning of the opening with the verse** וְהָיָה כַּאֲשֶׁר שָׂשׂ ה׳ **"And it shall be, as Hashem rejoiced over you** לְהֵטִיב אֶתְכֶם וְגוֹ׳ **to do you good," etc.,** כֵּן יָשִׂישׂ ה׳ עֲלֵיכֶם **"so will Hashem rejoice over you** לְהַאֲבִיד אֶתְכֶם **to destroy you** וּלְהַשְׁמִיד אֶתְכֶם **and to annihilate you":** כִּי שָׁהֲרֵי נִשְׁבַּע **for the decree to destroy** הַגְּזֵרָה לְהַאֲבִיד הוּא דָּבָר שֶׁאִי אֶפְשָׁר כְּלָל[1136] **is something utterly impossible,** שֶׁלֹּא לְהַאֲבִיד אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל[1137] **since HaKadosh Baruch Hu swore not to destroy Yisrael** (וְכֵן כָּתַב הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא

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you,' they said: 'Moshe Rabbeinu, is it not yet the time of remembrance? What is my strength, that I should hope? Is my strength the strength of stones? Is our flesh made of bronze?' Once he told them, 'In this month you are redeemed,' they said: 'This is a good sign; a tree of life is desire fulfilled.'" The passage expressly calls the announcement a good sign. Rav Tzadok asks why it describes a sign rather than merely a favorable promise. The verses woven into the Midrash are Mishlei 13:12, Shemos 3:16, and Iyov 6:11–12.

[1134] **Shir HaShirim Rabbah, on 2:8** — "When Moshe told Israel, 'In this month you are redeemed,' they said: 'Moshe Rabbeinu, how can we be redeemed when we have no good deeds?' He replied: 'Since He desires your redemption, He does not look at your evil deeds. At whom does He look? At the righteous among you and their deeds, such as Amram and his court.' ... The Sages say: They said, 'How can we be redeemed when all Egypt is defiled with our idolatry?' He replied: 'Since He desires your redemption, He does not look at your idolatry, but leaps over the mountains; mountains here mean idolatry.'" These are two distinct explanations in the Midrash: one invokes the righteous among Israel, and another God's desire to redeem despite their idolatry. Together they frame the anxiety about Israel's lack of merit.

[1135] **Berakhot 4a** — "David said before the Holy One, blessed be He: 'Master of the world, I am confident that You will pay a good reward to the righteous in the future, but I do not know whether I have a share among them or not'—lest sin cause it. Rabbi Yaakov bar Idi raised a contradiction: It is written, 'I am with you and will guard you wherever you go,' but it is also written, 'Yaakov was very afraid.' He said: 'Lest sin cause it.'" The Gemara applies this concern both to David and to Yaakov. Rav Tzadok emphasizes the future tense: fear of a possible lapse can remain even after an assurance.

[1136] **Exodus 10:23** — "They did not see one another, and no one rose from his place for three days; but all the children of Israel had light in their dwellings." The verse contrasts the Egyptians' darkness with Israel's light. Rav Tzadok develops the latter as an inward illumination accompanying the plague.

[1137] **Berakhot 32b** — "What is the remedy? Let him engage in Torah, as it is said: 'A tree of life is desire fulfilled'; and a tree of life means only Torah, as it is said: 'It is a tree of life to those who hold fast to it.'" The discussion concerns the heartache of disappointed expectation in prayer. Its remedy through Torah is particularly apt to Rav Tzadok's reading of prolonged hope and the good sign of redemption.

בַּזֹּהַר חָדָשׁ **(and so it is written in the Zohar Chadash,** כִּי תָבוֹא עג, ב עַיֵּין שָׁם**) Ki Savo 73b; see there).** אֲבָל הַכַּוָּנָה בָּזֶה יִהְיֶה נַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא דְּיִהְיֶה **Rather, the intent of this decree is that "it be turned about,"** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה **and through this there will be** לְהַאֲבִיד אֶת עֵשָׂו וַעֲמָלֵק **the destruction of Esav and Amalek;** וְהוּא שִׂמְחָה כְּמוֹ הַשִּׂמְחָה דְּלְהֵטִיב אֶתְכֶם **and it is a joy like the joy of "to do you good,"** דְּגַם זֶה הוּא לְהֵטִיב עוֹד יוֹתֵר **for this too is to do even more good,** וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **as mentioned above regarding what is said,** וְהָיָה כַּאֲשֶׁר תָּרִיד וְגוֹ׳. **"And it shall be, when you grieve," etc.** וְעַל כֵּן כָּתוּב בִּשְׁנֵיהֶם וְהָיָה **And therefore "vehayah" is written in both,** שֶׁהוּא לְשׁוֹן שִׂמְחָה. **for it is an expression of joy.** כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת לֹא יִגַּע בָּהֶם רַע **For in truth no harm will touch them,** בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **touch Yisrael;** רַק מִצַּד שֶׁמְּצִירִים לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **rather, because they distress Yisrael,** יִהְיֶה לָהֶם הַיְרִידָה בְּשִׁלֵּימוּת **they will have their complete downfall,** וְיִשְׂרָאֵל יִתְקָרְבוּ עַל יְדֵי זֶה **and through this Yisrael will draw closer** יוֹתֵר לִקְדוּשָׁתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **to His holiness, Yisbarach,** (מְגִילָּה יד, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Megillah 14a):** גְּדוֹלָה הֲסָרַת טַבַּעַת יוֹתֵר מֵאַרְבָּעִים וּשְׁמוֹנָה נְבִיאִים[1138] וְכוּלֵּי **"Greater was the removal of the ring than the forty-eight prophets," etc.,** שֶׁנִּתְנַבְּאוּ לָהֶן לְיִשְׂרָאֵל וְכוּ׳ **"who prophesied to Yisrael," etc.;** וְעַל יְדֵי כָּךְ יִרְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּמַפַּלְתָּן **Yisrael will witness their downfall.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא בְּלָשׁוֹן **And this is why they said in the Gemara the expression** כֵּן יָשִׂישׂ לְהָרַע אֶתְכֶם **"so will He rejoice to do you harm,"** תַּחַת מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּפָּסוּק **instead of what is said in the verse,** לְהַאֲבִיד וְגוֹ׳. **"to destroy," etc.** וְרָמְזוּ בָּזֶה **And they hinted at this** עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁמָּצִינוּ בְּמִצְרַיִם **based on what we find in Egypt:** שֶׁקּוֹדֶם הַגְּאוּלָּה **that before the redemption** הִתְגַּבְּרָה קְלִיפַּת מִצְרַיִם **the kelipah of Egypt grew stronger,** וּבִיטֵּל פַּרְעֹה מֵהֶם אֶת הַשַּׁבָּת[1139] **and Pharaoh abolished Shabbos from them,** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ה, יח) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shemos Rabbah 5:18);** וּמִצַּד זֶה הִתְנַצֵּל **and on account of this** מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Moshe Rabbeinu, alav hashalom, protested** וְאָמַר וּמֵאָז בָּאתִי אֶל פַּרְעֹה **and said, "And since I came to Pharaoh** לְדַבֵּר בִּשְׁמֶךָ **to speak in Your Name,** הֵרַע לָעָם הַזֶּה [שְׁמוֹת ה, כג]. **he has done evil to this people" (Shemos 5:23).** הַיְינוּ שֶׁעָשָׂה אוֹתָם רָעִים **That is, he made them bad,** שֶׁבִּיטֵּל מֵהֶם קְדוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת[1140] **in that he abolished from them the holiness of Shabbos** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בִּפְרִי צַדִּיק **(and this was explained in Pri Tzaddik,** שְׁמוֹת מַאֲמָר ג; וָאֵרָא מַאֲמָר ז**) Shemos, maamar 3; Va'eira, maamar 7).** וְכֵן רָמְזוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **And so they hinted in the Gemara** בְּלָשׁוֹן לְהָרַע אֶתְכֶם **with the expression "to do you harm,"** וְהַיְינוּ הִתְגַּבְּרוּת הָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת **that is, the ascendancy of the idolaters,** שֶׁרוֹצִים לְהַרְחִיק אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **who wish to distance Yisrael** מִקְּדוּשַׁת ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **from the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach;** וְאֶמְנָם הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **but HaKadosh Baruch Hu** שָׂמֵחַ בָּזֶה **rejoices in this,** כִּי אַדְרַבָּא תּוֹקֶף הַגְּזֵרָה **for on the contrary, the severity of the decree** יִגְרוֹם לְקָרֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל **will cause Yisrael to draw close** לַאֲבִיהֶם שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם **to their Father in Heaven** בְּיֶתֶר שְׂאֵת. **with greater intensity.** וּמַה שֶּׁיִּרְצוּ לְהַאֲבִיד **And what they wish, "to destroy** אֶתְכֶם וּלְהַשְׁמִיד **and to annihilate you,"** יְהִיֶה נַהֲפוֹךְ הוּא **will be "turned about,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בִּימֵי הָמָן. **as it was in the days of Haman.** וְעַל זֶה פָּרִיךְ בַּגְּמָרָא **And on this the Gemara asks,** וּמִי חָדֵי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"But does HaKadosh Baruch Hu rejoice** בְּמַפַּלְתָּן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים **at the downfall of the wicked?",** הַיְינוּ הָעוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת **meaning the idolaters,** אַף שֶׁמַּפַּלְתָּם בְּמִשְׁפָּט **even though their downfall is just,** כְּמוֹ בְּמִצְרַיִם **as with the Egyptians,** שֶׁנִּטְבְּעוּ מִדָּה בְּמִדָּה **who were drowned measure for measure,** כַּאֲשֶׁר גָּזְרוּ הַיְאוֹרָה תַּשְׁלִיכוּהוּ **as they had decreed, "Cast him into**

[1138] **Psalms 84:12** — "For Hashem God is a sun and a shield; Hashem grants favor and honor. He withholds no good from those who walk wholeheartedly." Rav Tzadok draws on the image of the sun in explaining an illumination that reaches the moon, his image here for the Oral Torah.

[1139] **Pesikta Rabbati 15** — "'This month shall be for you'—it is entrusted to you. Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: This is like a king who had a clock; when his son came of age, he handed him his clock. Rabbi Yosei bar Chanina said: Like a king who had a guard-post; when his son came of age, he handed him the guard-post. Rabbi Acha said: Like a king who had a ring; when his son came of age, he handed him his ring. Rabbi Yitzchak said: Like a king who had treasuries, with a key for each; when his son came of age, he handed him the keys. Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said: Like a king who had tools of his craft; when his son came of age, he handed him his tools. The Sages said: Like a physician who had a case of medicines; when his son came of age, he handed him his case." The parallel passage in Yerushalmi Rosh Hashanah 1:3 gives a carpenter with his tools, and says that the treasuries themselves were handed over. Rav Tzadok expressly distinguishes these readings in developing the parables. The Pesikta's traditional internal §18 is retained as the manuscript's locator; the complete digital chapter 15 supplies the checked wording.

[1140] **Yom Kippur Machzor, Ki Anu Amecha** — "For we are Your people and You are our God. We are Your children and You are our Father. We are Your servants and You are our Master. We are Your assembly and You are our portion. We are Your inheritance and You are our lot. We are Your flock and You are our Shepherd. We are Your vineyard and You are our Keeper. We are Your handiwork and You are our Maker. We are Your beloved and You are our Beloved." The vineyard and its keeper are one of the poem's paired images of Israel and God. Rav Tzadok applies this particular image to God's guarding Israel.

the river"; וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם **and nevertheless** אֵין הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא שָׂמֵחַ **HaKadosh Baruch Hu does not rejoice.** וְעַל דְּלֹא קָרַב זֶה אֶל זֶה **of "one did not come near the other,"** זֶה מֵיירְתֵי הַדְּרָשָׁה **And for this it brings the derashah** לוֹמַר שִׁירָה **to say song:** שֶׁלֹּא הִנִּיחַ לְמַלְאָכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת **that He did not allow the ministering angels** מַעֲשֵׂי יָדַי טוֹבְעִין בַּיָּם וְכוּ' **"The work of My hands is drowning in the sea," etc.;** וְכֵן מֵהָא **and likewise from the fact** דִּכְתִיב כִּי טוֹב בְּהוֹדָאָה **that "for it is good" is not said in the thanksgiving** דִּמְלְחֶמֶת יְהוֹשָׁפָט **of Yehoshafat's war** בְּעַמּוֹן וּמוֹאָב שֶׁרָדָפוּהוּ **against Ammon and Moav, who pursued him.** וְעַל זֶה מְתָרֵץ **And to this it answers:** הוּא אֵינוֹ שָׂשׂ **"He does not rejoice,** אֲבָל מַשִּׂישׂ אֲחֵרִים **but He causes others to rejoice,"** דִּכְתִיב כֵּן יָשִׂישׂ **for it is written "so will He cause rejoicing,"** וְהֵינוּ שֶׁיְשַׂמֵּחַ וְיָשִׂישׂ אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **that is, He will gladden and cause Yisrael to rejoice,** שֶׁיִּשְׂמְחוּ בְּמַפַּלְתָּן **so that they rejoice at their downfall,** כְּמוֹ בְּהָמָן כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as with Haman, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ אַחַר כָּךְ בַּגְּמָרָא **And this is what they said afterwards in the Gemara** [מְגִילָּה יא, א] **(Megillah 11a):** הַפִּתְיחָה זָכַר חַסְדּוֹ וֶאֱמוּנָתוֹ **the opening "He remembered His kindness and His faithfulness** לְבֵית יִשְׂרָאֵל **to the house of Yisrael;** רָאוּ כָּל אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ **all the ends of the earth saw** אֶת יְשׁוּעַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ **the salvation of our God":** אֵימָתַי רָאוּ וְגוֹ' **"When did they see," etc.?** בִּימֵי מָרְדְּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר **"In the days of Mordechai and Esther."** שֶׁאֵין הַמְּכוּוָּן כָּל אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ **For "all the ends of the earth" does not mean** עַל הָאוּמּוֹת **the nations,** שֶׁהֵם לֹא הִכִּירוּ הַנֵּס **since they did not recognize the miracle,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה קָרוֹב לַטֶּבַע **as it was close to nature,** (מַאֲמָר ד) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we said (maamar 4);** רַק הַמְּכוּוָּן כָּל אַפְסֵי אָרֶץ **rather, "all the ends of the earth" means** הַיְינוּ נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל **the Jewish souls** הַפְּחוּתִים וְהַשְּׁפָלִים **who are lesser and lowly;** גַּם כֵּן הִכִּירוּ אָז **they too recognized then** חַסְדּוֹ וֶאֱמוּנָתוֹ **His kindness and His faithfulness,** שֶׁהִכִּירוּ הָאֱמֶת **for they recognized the truth** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה דֶּרֶךְ הַטֶּבַע **that everything came from the salvation of our God,** שֶׁהַכֹּל הָיָה מִצַּד יְשׁוּעַת אֱלֹהֵינוּ **for it was not the way of nature** מַחֲמַת שֶׁלֹּא שָׁמְעָה **that a great king should kill his wife** שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ גָּדוֹל יַהֲרוֹג אִשְׁתּוֹ **because she did not obey him** לַעֲשׂוֹת תּוֹעֵבָה **to do an abomination,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ יִקַּח אִשָּׁה **and afterwards take a wife** אֲשֶׁר לֹא יָדַע **without knowing** עַמָּהּ וּמוֹלַדְתָּהּ **her people and her lineage;** וְהִכִּירוּ אֲפִילּוּ הַנְּפָשׁוֹת הַפְּחוּתוֹת **and even the lesser souls recognized** שֶׁהַכֹּל מִיַּד ה' הָיְתָה **that it all came from the hand of Hashem,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה מְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק **so that there would be the erasure of Amalek,** וּלְהַרְבּוֹת קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **and to increase the holiness of Yisrael** בְּאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **with the light of the Torah she'b'al peh,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וּבְוַדַּאי **And certainly, had it been His will, Yisbarach,** אִם הָיָה רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ לִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק לְגַמְרֵי **to erase the memory of Amalek entirely,** הָיָה יָכוֹל לְאַבְּדוֹ כְּרֶגַע **He could have destroyed him in an instant;** אַמְנָם רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **however, it is His will, Yisbarach,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַמִּלְחָמָה מִדּוֹר דּוֹר **that the war be "from generation to generation,"** שֶׁבְּכָל דּוֹר יִתְגַּבְּרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **that in every generation Yisrael grow strong** לַעֲקוֹר הַקְלִיפָּה דַּעֲמָלֵק **to uproot the kelipah of Amalek** וְיִנָּצְחוּ אוֹתוֹ **and defeat him,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא ד) **(Tanchuma Ki Seitzei 4):** אַתֶּם מַזְכִּירִין שְׁמוֹ מִלְמַטָּה **"You mention his name below,** וַאֲנִי מוֹחֵק שְׁמוֹ לְמַעְלָה **and I erase his name above";** הַיְינוּ שֶׁרְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **that is, it is His will, Yisbarach,** שֶׁבְּכָל דּוֹר יִלָּחֲמוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **that in every generation Yisrael fight** נֶגֶד קְלִיפָּה זוֹ **against this kelipah** וינצחוהו[1141] עַל יְדֵי עֶזְרַת ה' **and defeat it with the help of Hashem,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יִזְכּוּ אַחַר כָּךְ **and through this they will afterwards merit** לִהְגָּאוּלָּה שְׁלֵימָה **the complete redemption** וְהַמְּחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק בִּשְׁלֵימוּת **and the complete erasure of Amalek,** וְלֹא יִהְיֶה שָׂרִיד וְגוֹ'. **"and there will be no survivor," etc.** (מְגִילָּה ז, ב) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said (Megillah 7b):** מְחַיַּיב אִינָשׁ לְבַסּוּמֵי בְּפוּרְיָא **"A person is obligated to become intoxicated on Purim** עַד דְּלָא יָדַע **until he does not know** בֵּין אָרוּר הָמָן וְכוּ' **between 'cursed is Haman,'" etc.** שֶׁכָּתַב בְּפְרִי עֵץ חַיִּים **For it is written in Pri Etz Chaim** (שַׁעַר יט שַׁעַר הַפּוּרִים פֶּרֶק ו) **(Shaar 19, Shaar HaPurim, chapter 6)** שֶׁיֵּשׁ נִיצוֹץ שֶׁל קְדוּשָׁה **that there is a spark of holiness** בְּכָל קְלִיפָּה הַמְחַיֶּיה אוֹתָהּ **in every kelipah that gives it life,** וְאִם יִסְתַּלְּקוּ מִמֶּנּוּ **and if it were removed from it,** לֹא יוּשְׁאַר לוֹ חִיּוּת **no vitality would remain for it,** וְיִתְבַּטֵּל לְגַמְרֵי מִיָּד **and it would be completely nullified at once;** וַאֲנוּ רוֹצִים **and we want** שֶׁגַּם לְאוֹתוֹ הַנִּיצוֹץ **that this spark too** יַגִּיעַ לוֹ חִיּוּת לְעַצְמוֹ **should receive vitality for itself** מִזֶּה הַהָאָרָה דְּיוֹם זֶה **from the illumination of this day,** אֲבָל לֹא שֶׁיַּגִּיעַ כָּל כָּךְ **but not that it reach so far** לְהָאִיר הַקְלִיפָּה **as to illuminate the kelipah;** וְעַל כֵּן מִיחַיַּיב אִינָשׁ לְבַסּוּמֵי **and therefore a person is obligated to become intoxicated** עַד דְּלָא יָדַע **until he does not know,** וְאוּלַי מִתּוֹךְ הַשִּׁכְרוּת **and**

[1141] **Psalms 27:5** — "For He will conceal me in His shelter on the day of trouble; He will hide me in the hiding-place of His tent; He will raise me upon a rock." The shelter is the point of departure for Rav Tzadok's account of divine protection entrusted to Israel.

perhaps out of the intoxication יִתְבָּרֵךְ[1142] גַּם אוֹתוֹ נִיצוֹץ שֶׁבַּקְלִיפָּה **that spark within the kelipah will also be blessed,** אֲבָל לֹא תִּהְיֶה בְּרָכָה שְׁלֵימָה **but it will not be a complete blessing** בְּכַוָּונָה **with intent,** שֶׁאָז חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **for then, chas v'shalom,** יָאִיר גַּם אֶל הַקְלִיפָּה **it would shine also upon the kelipah;** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וּמִצַּד שֶׁנִּתְבָּרֵךְ בְּטָעוּת **And because it was blessed by mistake,** יֵשׁ כֹּחַ בְּנַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל **there is strength in the Jewish souls** לְנַצְּחוֹ וּלְהִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו **to defeat it, to overpower it,** וְלִמְחוֹת זִכְרוֹ **and erase its memory,** כִּי הַבְּרָכָה הָיְתָה בְּטָעוּת **for the blessing was by mistake,** רַק מִצַּד הַשִּׁכְרוּת.[1143] **only because of the intoxication.** וּבֶאֱמֶת אֲפִילּוּ בִּשְׁעַת שִׁכְרוּת **And in truth, even at the time of intoxication,** נַפְשׁוֹת יִשְׂרָאֵל מְדוּבָּקִים **the Jewish souls are cleaving** בִּקְדוּשָּׁתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ[1144] **to His holiness, Yisbarach Shemo,** (שָׁם יב, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **as stated in the Gemara (there, 12b):** "כְּשֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל אוֹכְלִין וְשׁוֹתִין **"When Yisrael eat and drink,** מַתְחִילִין בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **they begin with words of Torah** וּבְדִבְרֵי תִּשְׁבָּחוֹת **and with words of praise";** וְרַק בִּשְׁגִיאָה יָצְאָה הַבְּרָכָה **and only in error did the blessing go forth** מִבְּלִי דַּעַת **without awareness;** וְעַל כֵּן יֵשׁ לָנוּ כֹּחַ **and therefore we have the strength** לְהִלָּחֵם בְּכָל דּוֹר וָדוֹר **to fight against him in each and every generation,** וְלִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר כְּנֶגְדּוֹ וּלְנַצֵּחַ אוֹתוֹ: עֲמָלֵק **and to erase the memory of Amalek.**

[1142] **Pesikta Rabbati 15** — "'My beloved resembles a deer.' Rabbi Yitzchak said: Just as a deer leaps and springs from tree to tree, from shelter to shelter, and from fence to fence, so the Holy One, blessed be He, leaps from this synagogue to that synagogue, and from this study hall to that study hall. For what purpose? To bless Israel. Through what merit? Through the merit of his sitting at the oaks of Mamre, as it is written, 'Hashem appeared to him at the oaks ... while he was sitting at the entrance of the tent.'" The Midrash continues with God's assurance to Avraham that, while his descendants sit in synagogues and study halls, His glory will stand among them. This identifies the protection of the parable with an active divine presence in communal Torah and prayer; §9 is the manuscript's internal division.

[1143] **Bereshit Rabbah 10:9** — "Geniva said: This is like a king for whom they made a bridal chamber; they fashioned and decorated it. What was it lacking? A bride to enter it. So what was the world lacking? Shabbos. The Sages said: This is like a king for whom they made a ring. What was it lacking? A seal. So what was the world lacking? Shabbos." The two parables express completion through the arrival of Shabbos. Rav Tzadok develops the second specifically as the seal that gives creation its enduring character.

[1144] **Shabbat 55a** — "Reish Lakish said: Tav is the end of the seal of the Holy One, blessed be He, for Rabbi Chanina said: The seal of the Holy One, blessed be He, is truth." The final letter of emes, truth, explains the mark tav in the surrounding exposition of Yechezkel 9:4.

פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר ז׳ Purim — Maamar Zayin

לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **"The Jews had light** [אֶסְתֵּר ח, טז] וְשִׂמְחָה וְיקָר. **and gladness, and joy and honor" (Esther 8:16).** (מְגִילָּה טז, ב) וְאָמְרוּ **And they said (Megillah 16b):** אוֹרָה זוֹ תּוֹרָה **"Light" — this is Torah;** שִׂמְחָה זֶה יוֹם טוֹב **"gladness" — this is Yom Tov;** שָׂשׂוֹן זוֹ מִילָה **"joy" — this is milah;** וְיקָר אֵלּוּ תְּפִילִּין. **"and honor" — these are tefillin.** הָעִנְיָן דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְקוּדָּשִׁים **The matter is that Yisrael are sanctified** בְּשָׁלֹשׁ קְדוּשׁוֹת **with three holinesses,** [וַיִּקְרָא יא, מד] מִשּׁוֹרֶשׁ הַכָּתוּב **from the root of the verse (Vayikra 11:44):** וְהִתְקַדִּשְׁתֶּם וְהְיִיתֶם קְדוֹשִׁים כִּי קָדוֹשׁ אֲנִי **"You shall sanctify yourselves and be holy, for I am holy."** וְהַיְינוּ קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **That is: the holiness of Yisrael** מִצַּד עַצְמָם **from their own side,** מֵאִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְתַתָּא **from the awakening from below** — וְזֶהוּ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְהִתְקַדִּשְׁתֶּם. **and this is what is said, "You shall sanctify yourselves."** וּקְדוּשַׁת הָאָבוֹת **And the holiness of the Avos,** שֶׁנִּקְנָה בָּהֶם **which was acquired in them** מִצַּד שׁוֹרֶשׁ קְדוּשַׁת הָאָבוֹת **from the root of the holiness of the Avos** — עַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר וְהְיִיתֶם קְדוֹשִׁים כִּי קָדוֹשׁ אֲנִי **about this it is said, "and be holy," "For I am holy"** הַוְיוֹת הַקְּדוּשָׁה מֵהַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ. **a state of holiness from the root.** הוּא הַקְּדוּשָׁה דִּלְעֵילָּא **is the holiness from Above,** מִצַּד ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ.[1145] **from the side of Hashem Yisbarach.** וְעַל שָׁלֹשׁ קְדוּשׁוֹת אֵלּוּ **And to these three holinesses** מְרַמְּזִים הַשָּׁלֹשָׁה אוֹתוֹת **allude the three signs** שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל מְיוּחָדִים בָּהֶם. **with which Yisrael are distinguished.** וְהוּא רַק לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **and it belongs only to Yisrael,** תּוֹרָה הוּא מִצַּד אִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְתַתָּא **Torah is from the awakening from below,** דְּעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה חַיָּיב כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת[1146] **for an idolater who engages in Torah is liable,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין נט, א). **(as stated in Sanhedrin 59a).** וּמִצְוַת מִילָה הִיא **And the mitzvah of milah** הַקְּדוּשָׁה שֶׁנִּשְׁרַשׁ מֵהָאָבוֹת **is the holiness rooted in the Avos,** וְאֵין שַׁיָּכוּת לָהּ רַק יִשְׂרָאֵל **and only Yisrael have a connection to it,** דְּמוּלֵי עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים דִּינָם כַּעֲרֵלִים **for circumcised idolaters have the status of uncircumcised,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן יִשְׂרָאֵל **which is not so for Yisrael:** אַף עֲרֵל בְּכְלַל מָהוּל הוּא[1147] **even an uncircumcised one is in the category of circumcised** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב נְדָרִים לא, ב). **(as stated in Nedarim 31b).** וּקְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת **And the holiness of Shabbos** הִיא מִצַּד קְדוּשָׁה דִּלְעֵילָּא **is from the holiness from Above,** דְּקֻבְיָעָא כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שְׁמוֹת לא, יג] לָדַעַת **which is fixed and established by Hashem Yisbarach,** וְקַיְימָא מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ כִּי אֲנִי ה׳ מְקַדִּשְׁכֶם **as it is said (Shemos 31:13): "To know that I am Hashem Who sanctifies you,"** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן מְיוּחָד לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **and it too is exclusive to Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שָׁם, טז] בֵּינִי וּבֵין בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אוֹת הִיא לְעוֹלָם **as it is said (ibid. 16): "Between Me and the Children of Yisrael it is a sign forever,"** וְעוֹבֵד כּוֹכָבִים שֶׁשּׁוֹמֵר שַׁבָּת חַיָּיב[1148] **and an idolater who keeps Shabbos is liable** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין נח, ב). **(as stated in Sanhedrin 58b).** וַעֲמָלֵק יָדוּעַ **And Amalek, as is known,** שֶׁהוּא עִיקַּר הַמְקַטְרֵג עַל קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **is the chief accuser against the holiness of Yisrael,** וְקִיטְרוּגוֹ עַל שָׁלֹשׁ קְדוּשׁוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל. **and his accusation is against the three holinesses mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא י) שָׂהֳיָה חוֹתֵךְ מִילּוֹתֵיהֶם **And this is what they said (Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10),** וְזוֹרְקָן כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה וְכוּ׳ שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that he would cut off the circumcised members of Yisrael and fling them**

[1145] **Bereshit Rabbah 81:2** — "What is the seal of the Holy One, blessed be He? Our teacher said in the name of Rabbi Reuven: Truth. What is truth? Reish Lakish said: Alef is at the beginning of the letters, mem in the middle, and tav at the end, corresponding to 'I am first and I am last.'" The complete span of the alphabet grounds Rav Tzadok's reading of truth as embracing beginning, present continuity, and end.

[1146] **Siddur Ashkenaz, Shabbos Minchah, middle blessing** — "You are One, and Your name is One; and who is like Your people Israel, one nation on earth? Splendor and greatness, and a crown of salvation—a day of rest and holiness You have given Your people. Avraham rejoices, Yitzchak sings, and Yaakov and his sons rest upon it: a rest of love and generosity, a rest of truth and faith, a rest of peace, tranquility, quiet and security; a complete rest that You desire. May Your children recognize and know that their rest comes from You, and through their rest sanctify Your name." The prayer connects divine unity, Israel's unity, the patriarchs and the sanctity of rest. Rav Tzadok invokes its opening in explaining Shabbos as the seal.

[1147] **Shemot Rabbah 30:14** — "If a person learns Midrash, halachos, and aggados, but has no fear of sin, he has nothing. This is like a person who told his friend: 'I have a thousand measures of grain, a thousand of oil, and a thousand of wine.' His friend said: 'Do you have storehouses in which to place them? If you do, they are all yours; otherwise you have nothing.' So, if a person has fear of sin, everything is his; otherwise he has nothing." The Midrash cites "Fear of Hashem is His treasury." Its storehouses are the capacity to retain and make effective the accumulated learning, which explains the parable of handing over treasuries.

[1148] **Shabbat 31a–b** — "A person who possesses Torah but does not possess fear of Heaven resembles a treasurer to whom the inner keys were entrusted, but the outer keys were not entrusted. Through what can he enter? Rabbi Yannai proclaimed: Woe to one who has no courtyard, yet makes a gate for the courtyard!" The opening words of Rabbah bar Rav Huna's statement begin at the end of 31a and continue on 31b. Torah and reverence function together; the keys of the inner chambers are ineffective without access through the outer entrance.

upward, etc. וְהַיינוּ הַקִּיטְרוּג עַל אוֹת בְּרִית **This is the accusation against the sign of the covenant,** שֶׁאוֹמֵר שֶׁגַּם יִשְׂרָאֵל **saying that Yisrael too** אֵינָם שׁוֹמְרִים קְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית **do not guard the holiness of the covenant** אַף שֶׁנִּימּוֹלוּ **even though they were circumcised,** וְעַל כֵּן הֲוֵי לָךְ מַה שֶּׁבָּחַרְתָּ. **and therefore, "Here, take what You have chosen."** וְהָמָן מִזַּרְעוֹ **And Haman was of his seed,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ (מְגִילָה יג, ב) דְּלֵיכָּא דְּיָדַע **about whom they said (Megillah 13b) that there is none who knows** לִישָׁנָא בִּישָׁא כְּהָמָן **how to slander like Haman;** שֶׁכְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ **we have already said that the intent is** שֶׁקִּטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל לְמַעְלָה **that he accused Yisrael Above,** וְאָמַר שֶׁהַמְכוּוָּן וְרַבָּנָן גַּם כֵּן עַם אֶחָד הֵן **and the Rabbis too are "one people" —** וְהַיינוּ שֶׁקִּטְרֵג **that is, he accused** עַל קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל מִצַּד עַצְמָם **against the holiness of Yisrael from their own side,** עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת **through Torah and mitzvos,** וְאָמַר דְּכוּלָּם **and said that all of them,** אַף הַתַּלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **even the talmidei chachamim,** יְשֵׁנוּ מִן הַתּוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת.[1149] **are asleep from Torah and mitzvos.** וְגַם עַל קְדוּשַׁת הַזְּמַן **And also against the holiness of time,** דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַדְּשֵׁי לָהּ **which Yisrael sanctify,** אָמַר דְּמַפְקֵי לְכוּלָּא שַׁתָּא **he said that they pass the whole year** בְּשַׁבָּת הַיּוֹם פֶּסַח הַיּוֹם[1150] **with "today is Shabbos, today is Pesach"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם), **(as they said there).** וְהָיָה גַּם כֵּן הַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁלּוֹ **And his intent too was** לְקַטְרֵג לְמַעְלָה **to accuse Above,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמַר **as is expounded on what he said,** וְאֶת דָּתֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ אֵינָם עוֹשִׂים **"And the King's laws they do not keep,"** וּבְכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַמֶּלֶךְ סְתָם **for wherever "the King" is said unqualified** בַּמְּגִילָה מְשַׁמֵּשׁ קוֹדֶשׁ וְחוֹל **in the Megillah, it serves as both sacred and mundane** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ג, י) **(as stated in Esther Rabbah 3:10,** וַהֲיינוּ דְּקָאֵי עַל מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים **on the verse "Also Vashti"),** (עַל פָּסוּק גַּם וַשְׁתִּי) **meaning that it refers to the King of kings,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא גַּם כֵּן **the Holy One, blessed is He, as well.** וְכֵן כָּתוּב בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And so it is written in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג׳ בְּהַר קטז, א) **(III, Behar 109a)** עַל פָּסוּק בַּחֲצַר בֵּית הַמֶּלֶךְ וּבְכָל אֲתַר הַמֶּלֶךְ סְתָם [אֶסְתֵּר ה, א] וְגוֹ׳ **on the verse "In the court of the King's house," etc. (Esther 5:1):** דָּא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא. **"And in every place, 'the King' unqualified — this is the Holy One, blessed is He."** וְהַיינוּ שֶׁקִּטְרֵג הָמָן **That is, Haman accused:** וְאֶת דָּתֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ אֵינָם עוֹשִׂים **"And the King's laws they do not keep"** — שֶׁאֵין כַּוָּנָתָם לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם **that their intent is not for the sake of Heaven** בְּשִׂמְחַת הַמּוֹעֲדִים **in the rejoicing of the festivals,** רַק כַּוָּנָתָם לַהֲנָאַת גּוּפָם **but their intent is only for bodily pleasure,** כִּי הֵם מוּכָנִים לָזֶה **for they are given to this** כָּל יְמֵי הַשָּׁנָה. **all the days of the year.** וְעַל הַקְדוּשָׁה מִצַּד ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ **And regarding the holiness from the side of Hashem Yisbarach** אָמַר אוֹתוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בּוֹ **he said: "He of Whom it is said** ה׳ אֶחָד יָשַׁן לוֹ מֵעַמּוֹ **'Hashem is One' is asleep to His people"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּאֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ז, יב) **(as stated in Esther Rabbah 7:12** עַל פָּסוּק יֶשְׁנוֹ עַם אֶחָד). **on the verse "There is one people").** אָמְנָם ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ **However, Hashem Yisbarach,** בּוֹחֵן תַּעֲלוּמוֹת לֵב **Who examines the hidden places of the heart,** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל מְקוּדָּשִׁים **knows that in truth Yisrael are sanctified** בְּכָל הַשָּׁלֹשׁ קְדוּשׁוֹת הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל. **with all three holinesses mentioned above.** וְעַל כֵּן לְאַחַר הִתְגַּלּוּת הַנֵּס **Therefore, after the miracle was revealed,** כְּתִיב לַיְּהוּדִים הָיְתָה אוֹרָה **it is written, "The Jews had light" —** זוֹ תּוֹרָה **this is Torah;** וְשִׂמְחָה זֶה יוֹם טוֹב **"and gladness" — this is Yom Tov;** הַיינוּ הִתְגַּלּוּת קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **that is, the revelation of the holiness of Yisrael** מִצַּד עַצְמָם בְּאִתְעָרוּתָא דִּלְתַתָּא **from their own side, through the awakening from below,** שֶׁהֵם עוֹסְקִים בַּתּוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת **that they engage in Torah and mitzvos,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת פח, א) **as they said (Shabbos 88a):** הֲדַר קַבְּלוּהּ בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ. **"They accepted it anew in the days of Achashverosh."** וְגַם קְדוּשַׁת יוֹם טוֹב **And also the holiness of Yom Tov,** שֶׁהוּא קְדוּשַׁת הַזְּמַן **which is the holiness of time** דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַדְּשֵׁי לֵיהּ **that Yisrael sanctify,** (בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה שָׁם) וְעַל דָּרְךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said (in Midrash Rabbah there):** אָמַר לֵיהּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **The Holy One, blessed is He, said to him:** אַתָּה מַפִּיל עַיִן רָעָה בַּמּוֹעֲדִים שֶׁלָּהֶם **"You cast an evil eye upon their festivals?** הֲרֵינִי מַפִּילְךָ לִפְנֵיהֶם **I shall**

[1149] **Zohar I 5b, Introduction** — "Another Shabbos remained unmentioned and was ashamed. She said before Him: 'Master of the world, from the day You made me I have been called Shabbos, yet there is no day without night.' He said to her: 'My daughter, you are Shabbos and I call you Shabbos, but I now crown you with a higher crown.' He issued a proclamation: 'My Sanctuary you shall fear.' This is the Shabbos of Shabbos eve, which is fear, and fear rests within her." The passage's 5b marker precedes this teaching, and 6a follows it. The sanctity of Shabbos night is expressly joined to reverence, explaining its relation to the guarding aspect of Malchus.

[1150] **Zohar III 11b, Vayikra** — "The ninth is Shaddai, for He said to the world, 'Enough'; enough is sufficiency, and sufficiency comes to the world only from the tzaddik, who is the foundation of the world. The tenth is Adonai, for the law of kingship is assuredly law. This is to wage the King's battles in the world; this is the lower Gevurah, and this is righteousness." This is the second enumeration in the chapter; the preceding passage carries 11b. The final name belongs to the royal aspect, explaining Rav Tzadok's invocation of "If I am a master, where is My fear?" in Malachi 1:6.

make you fall before them, וּמוֹסִיפִים לָהֶם מוֹעֵד אֶחָד **and they will add for themselves one festival** עַל מַפַּלְתֵּךְ **for your downfall," etc.** וְכוּ׳. **And although Yom Tov with a prohibition of melachah** וְהַגַּם דְּיוֹם טוֹב בְּאִסּוּר מְלָאכָה **they did not accept upon themselves,** לָא קַבִּילוּ עֲלַיְיהוּ[1151] **as they said (Megillah 5b),** (מְגִילָּה ה, ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ, **nevertheless the rejoicing and the mitzvos practiced on Purim** מִכָּל מָקוֹם הַשִּׂמְחָה וּמִצְוֹת הַנּוֹהָגוֹת בְּפוּרִים **are at a time fixed by the month,** הוּא בִּזְמַן הַקָּבוּעַ מֵהַחֹדֶשׁ **which Yisrael sanctify,** דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַדְּשֵׁי לָהּ **for they intercalate the months, etc.** דְּקָא מְעַבְּרֵי יַרְחֵי[1152] וְכוּ׳. **(as stated in Pesachim 117b).** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב פְּסָחִים קיז, ב). **"And joy" — this is milah,** וְשָׂשׂוֹן זוֹ מִילָה **for the holiness of Yisrael was revealed** שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **from the side of being offspring of the Avos.** מִצַּד תּוֹלְדוֹת הָאָבוֹת. **For Mordechai and Esther subdued them,** כִּי מָרְדֳּכַי וְאֶסְתֵּר הִכְנִיעוּם **in line with what they said (Tanchuma, Ki Seitzei 10):** וְעַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא י) **It is a tradition of aggadah** מָסוֹרֶת אַגָּדָה **that Esav falls** שֶׁאֵין עֵשָׂו נוֹפֵל **only by the hand of Rachel's children.** אֶלָּא בְּיַד בָּנֶיהָ שֶׁל רָחֵל[1153] **And it is stated (Pesikta, parshah 13, siman 4):** (פְּסִיקְתָּא פָּרָשָׁה יג סִימָן ד) וְאִיתָא **"Forever 'after you, Binyamin,'** לְתִבּוֹעַ מִן זַרְעוֹ שֶׁל עֲמָלֵק לְעוֹלָם אַחֲרֶיךָ בִּנְיָמִין **to exact payment from the seed of Amalek," etc.** וְכוּ׳. **That is because they are guarded** וְהַיְינוּ מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהֵם נִשְׁמָרִים בִּקְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית בְּעֶצֶם[1154] **in the holiness of the covenant in essence** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר **(as stated in the Zohar** חֵלֶק א׳ וַיֵּצֵא קנג, ב). **I, Vayeitzei 153b).** **"And honor" — these are tefillin,** וְיָקָר אֵלּוּ תְּפִילִּין **that is, the revelation of the holiness of Yisrael** הַיְינוּ הִתְגַּלּוּת קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** מִצַּד הַשֵּׁם יִתְבָּרַךְ **as they said (Berachos 6a): "And they shall see," etc.,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ו, א) וְרָאוּ וְגוֹ׳ כִּי שֵׁם ה׳ **"that the Name of Hashem is called upon you,** נִקְרָא עָלֶיךָ [דְּבָרִים כח, י] **and they shall fear you" (Devarim 28:10) —** וְיָרְאוּ מִמֶּךָּ **these are the tefillin of the head;** אֵלּוּ תְּפִילִּין שֶׁבְּרֹאשׁ **that is, that they are bound to the root** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **(as explained in Parshas Zachor, maamar 13),** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת זָכוֹר מַאֲמָר יג) **and as it actually was at the time of the miracle,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה בִּשְׁעַת הַנֵּס בְּפֹעַל **as it is said (Esther 9:3): "And all the officials of the provinces," etc., "were exalting the Jews,** וְכָל שָׂרֵי [אֶסְתֵּר ט, ג] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מְנַשְּׂאִים אֶת הַיְּהוּדִים הַמְּדִינוֹת וְגוֹ׳ **for the fear of Mordechai had fallen upon them."** כִּי נָפַל פַּחַד מָרְדֳּכַי עֲלֵיהֶם:

[1151] **Bereshit Rabbah 49:2** — "Rabbi Berechyah, Rabbi Chiya, and the Sages there said in the name of Rabbi Yehudah: There is no day on which the Holy One, blessed be He, does not renew a halachah in the heavenly court. What is its basis? 'Listen carefully to the thunder of His voice, and the utterance that goes out from His mouth.' Utterance here means only Torah, as it is said: 'You shall meditate upon it day and night.' Even those halachos Avraham knew." The daily renewal of Torah gives content to the continuing use of the craftsman's tools, rather than limiting the image to creation in the past.

[1152] **Shabbat 114a** — "Who are the builders? Rabbi Yochanan said: These are Torah scholars, who occupy themselves with building the world throughout all their days." In its immediate discussion, the Gemara asks which people are designated by the Mishnah's term "builders." Rav Tzadok develops the answer as the formative power of their ongoing halachic work.

[1153] **Proverbs 4:22** — "For they are life to those who find them, and healing to all their flesh." The antecedent is the instruction to attend to the speaker's words and preserve them within the heart. Mishlei 3:8 similarly promises, "It will be healing to your navel and refreshment to your bones." The two verses underlie the medicine-case parable.

[1154] **Bereshit Rabbah 10:4** — "Before the first man sinned, the heavenly bodies traveled by a short course and swiftly. Once he sinned, He made them go round by a long course and slowly. ... But in the future the Holy One, blessed be He, will heal that wound, as it is said: 'He will heal the injury of its wound'—He will heal the injury of the world's wound." Yeshayahu 30:26 speaks of the day God binds His people's injury and heals its wound. The Midrash places the wound and its future healing within the cosmic consequence of Adam's sin.

פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר ח׳ Purim — Maamar Ches

כָּל מַעֲשֵׂה נֵס הַמְּגִילָּה **The entire episode of the miracle of the Megillah** הָיָה עַל יְדֵי מִשְׁתֵּה הַיַּיִן **came about through wine-feasts:** דְּהַתְחָלַת הַיְשׁוּעָה **for the beginning of the salvation,** שֶׁנֶּהֶרְגָה וַשְׁתִּי **when Vashti was killed,** הָיָה בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **was "on the seventh day,** כְּטוֹב לֵב הַמֶּלֶךְ בַּיָּיִן [אֶסְתֵּר א, י] **when the heart of the king was merry with wine" (Esther 1:10);** וְגַם עִיקַּר הַנֵּס **and also the main miracle** הָיָה בְּמִשְׁתֵּה הַיַּיִן **was at the wine-feast** [אֶסְתֵּר ז] שֶׁזִּמְּנָה אֶסְתֵּר אֶת הָמָן.[1155] **to which Esther invited Haman (Esther 7).** וְגַם אָמְרוּ (אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ג, י) **And they also said (Esther Rabbah 3:10,** עַל פָּסוּק גַּם וַשְׁתִּי **on the verse "Also Vashti")** שֶׁבְּכָל מָקוֹם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מְדַבֵּר גַּם מִמֶּלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים **that wherever it says in the Megillah** הַמֶּלֶךְ סְתָם **"the King" unqualified, it speaks also of the King of kings,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **the Holy One, blessed is He,** שֶׁמְּשַׁמֵּשׁ קֹדֶשׁ וְחוֹל **for it serves as both sacred and mundane;** שֶׁכָּל עִנְיַן הַמְּגִילָּה **for the whole matter of the Megillah** יוֹרֶה עַל עִנְיָן פְּנִימִיּוּת **points to the inner dimension** צְמִיחַת הַיְשׁוּעָה **of the sprouting of the salvation** שֶׁנִּתְעוֹרֵר מִלְּעֵילָּא **that was awakened from Above** עַל בִּנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **toward the building of the Beis HaMikdash,** שֶׁהוּא מָקוֹם הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **which is the place of the korbanos and the libations,** וְנֶאֱמַר [בְּמִדְבַּר כח, ב] אֶת קָרְבָּנִי לַחְמִי לְאִשַּׁי **and it is said (Bamidbar 28:2): "My offering, My bread for My fires,"** וְאָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה (בֵּיצָה כ, ב) **and our Sages said (Beitzah 20b):** שֻׁלְחָנְךָ רֵיקָן **"That your table not be full** וְשֻׁלְחָנוֹ שֶׁל יְהֵא שׁוּלְחָנְךָ מָלֵא **while your Master's table is empty."**[1156] וְרֵאשִׁית צְמִיחַת הַיְשׁוּעָה **And the beginning of the sprouting of the salvation** הָיָה בַּהֲרִיגַת וַשְׁתִּי **was in the killing of Vashti,** לְהַשְׁמִיד זֶרַע נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר **to destroy the seed of Nevuchadnetzar,** מַחֲרִיב הַבַּיִת **the destroyer of the Temple,** (מְגִילָּה י, ב) וּכְדְאִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא **as stated in the Gemara (Megillah 10b):** רֵאשִׁית הַפְּתִיחָה לְהַמְּגִילָּה מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה יד, כב] וְקַמְתִּי עֲלֵיהֶם וְגוֹ׳ **the very opening of the Megillah is what is said (Yeshayahu 14:22), "I will rise up against them," etc.,** וְהִכְרַתִּי לְבָבֶל וְגוֹ׳ **"and I will cut off from Bavel," etc.** וְנֶכֶד זוֹ וַשְׁתִּי.[1157] **"and grandchild" — this is Vashti.** וְלָכֵן כָּתִיב בַּיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **Therefore it is written, "On the seventh day,** כְּטוֹב לֵב הַמֶּלֶךְ בַּיָּיִן **when the heart of the king was merry with wine"** — כָּתִיב הַמֶּלֶךְ סְתָם **it writes "the King" unqualified,** וְהֵיינוּ מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים[1158] **meaning the King of kings,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **the Holy One, blessed is He** ([פָּרָשָׁה א] וְכֵן כָּתַב בְּמִדְרַשׁ אַבָּא גּוּרְיוֹן **(and so it is written in Midrash Abba Gurion (parshah 1):** כְּטוֹב לֵב הַמֶּלֶךְ בַּיָּיִן **"When the heart of the king was merry with wine"** — כְּטוֹב לִבּוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא[1159] וְכוּ׳) **as the heart of the Holy One, blessed is He, was good, etc.),** שֶׁנִּתְעוֹרֵר מִלְּעֵילָּא **for**

[1155] **Kiddushin 30b** — "The school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: If this repulsive one encounters you, draw him to the study hall. If he is stone, he will melt; if he is iron, he will shatter. If he is stone, he will melt, as it is said: 'All who thirst, go to water,' and 'Water wears away stones.' If he is iron, he will shatter, as it is said: 'Are not My words like fire, declares Hashem, and like a hammer that shatters rock?'" This passage specifies the study hall as the place of Torah's action against the inclination. Rav Tzadok emphasizes its character as the place where new halachic understanding emerges.

[1156] **Mishnah Rosh Hashanah 1:1** — "There are four new years. On the first of Nisan is the new year for kings and for the pilgrimage festivals. On the first of Elul is the new year for the tithe of animals; Rabbi Elazar and Rabbi Shimon say: On the first of Tishrei. On the first of Tishrei is the new year for years, for sabbatical years and jubilee years, for planting and for vegetables." The Mishnah groups together distinct annual beginnings. Rav Tzadok asks why the first of Nisan is called the beginning of the festival cycle when Pesach itself begins later in the month.

[1157] **Rosh Hashanah 4a** — "'For the pilgrimage festivals'—are the festivals on the first of Nisan? They are on the fifteenth of Nisan! Rav Chisda said: The festival that falls in it is the new year for the pilgrimage festivals. Its practical consequence concerns one who vows, so that he becomes subject to 'You shall not delay'; this follows Rabbi Shimon." The following teaching requires the three festivals in their order, beginning with Pesach, for Rabbi Shimon's rule concerning delayed fulfillment of a vow. Rav Tzadok develops the calendar's head as containing the sanctity of the subsequent cycle.

[1158] **Pesikta Rabbati 15** — "'He made the moon for appointed times; the sun knows its setting.' Rabbi Yochanan said: Only the orb of the sun was created to give light, for 'lights' is written defectively. If so, why was the moon created? To sanctify through it the beginnings of months and years." The opening of the HaChodesh Pesikta assigns the moon a calendrical function. Rav Tzadok reads that function as the capacity to impart sanctity to the festivals through the sanctification of the month.

[1159] **Menachot 29a** — "The school of Rabbi Yishmael taught: Three things were difficult for Moshe until the Holy One, blessed be He, showed them to him with His finger: the menorah, the new moon, and creeping creatures. The menorah, as it is written, 'This is the work of the menorah'; the new moon, as it is written, 'This month shall be for you, the beginning of months'; creeping creatures, as it is written, 'This shall be unclean for you.'" The teaching links the demonstrative "this" to the divine showing. Rav Tzadok's question is what difficulty remained beyond the astronomical and legal rules of seeing the new moon.

there was awakened from Above זְכוּת הַקְּרְבָּנוֹת וְהַנְּסָכִים **the merit of the korbanos and the libations,** וּכְמוֹ (מְגִילָּה יב, ב) שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **as they said in the Gemara (Megillah 12b):** [אֶסְתֵּר א, יד] "וְהַקָּרוֹב אֵלָיו וְגוֹ' **"And those next to him," etc. (Esther 1:14) —** כָּל פָּסוּק זֶה **this entire verse** עַל שׁוּם קָרְבָּנוֹת נֶאֱמַר וְכוּ' **was said on account of the korbanos, etc.,** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there,** שֶׁמַּלְאֲכֵי הַשָּׁרֵת **that the ministering angels** הִזְכִּירוּ זְכוּת הַקָּרְבָּנוֹת.[1160] **invoked the merit of the korbanos.** כִּי בֶּאֱמֶת הָיָה זְמַן הַפְּקִידָה אָז **For in truth it was then the time of remembrance,** (שָׁם יא, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (there, 11b):** בֶּלְשַׁאצַּר חָשַׁב וְטָעָה[1161] וְכוּ' **Belshatzar calculated and erred, etc.:** הָא שִׁבְעִין **"Here are the seventy;** הַשְׁתָּא וַדַּאי תּוּ לָא מִפַּרְקֵי **now surely they will no longer be redeemed" —** אַפֵּיק מָאנֵי דְּבֵי מַקְדְּשָׁא וְכוּ' **he brought out the vessels of the Mikdash, etc.** וְאִם הָיוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל זַכָּאִים **And had Yisrael been worthy,** הָיָה נֶחְשָׁב עֵת הַקֵּץ כֵּן **the time of the End would have been reckoned so,** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּחְשַׁב בְּמִצְרַיִם **just as in Egypt** מִלֵּידַת יִצְחָק **the four hundred years were reckoned** הָאַרְבַּע מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה **from the birth of Yitzchak,** וְהָיָה מְדַלֵּג עַל הֶהָרִים **and He was "leaping over the mountains,"** כְּתִיב בְּעִתָּהּ וּכְתִיב אֲחִישֶׁנָּהּ **It is written** (סַנְהֶדְרִין צח, א) וּכְעֵין שֶׁאָמְרוּ **similar to what they said (Sanhedrin 98a):** זָכוּ אֲחִישֶׁנָּה[1162] **"in its time" and it is written "I will hasten it" — if they merit, "I will hasten it."** וְרַק מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיָה קִטְרוּג שֶׁל הָמָן **And only because there was Haman's accusation** לָכֵן לֹא הָיָה בִּיכוֹלֶת לִהְיוֹת אָז **was it not possible that there then be** בִּנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ בְּפוֹעַל מַמָּשׁ **the building of the Beis HaMikdash in actual fact,** (מְגִילָּה טו, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Megillah 15b):** עַד חֲצִי הַמַּלְכוּת **"Up to half the kingdom" —** וְלֹא דָּבָר שֶׁחוֹצֵץ לְמַלְכוּת **but not a thing that divides the kingdom,** וּמַאי נִיהוּ בִּנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ.[1163] **and what is that? The building of the Beis HaMikdash.** עִם כָּל זֶה נִבְנָה אָז בְּהֶעְלֵם **Even so, there was built then, in concealment,** הַהֲכָנָה לִבְנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **the preparation for building the Beis HaMikdash,** עַל יְדֵי מִשְׁתֵּה הַיַּיִן דְּאֶסְתֵּר **through Esther's wine-feast,** אֲשֶׁר לֹא כַדָּת **for she said,** שֶׁאָמְרָה וּבְכֵן אָבוֹא אֶל הַמֶּלֶךְ **"And so I will go in to the king,** [אֶסְתֵּר ד, טז] **which is not according to the law" (Esther 4:16),** (שָׁם טו, א) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (there, 15a):** וְנוֹלַד מִזֶּה דָּרְיָוֶשׁ בֶּן אֶסְתֵּר **"Until now under duress,** עַד עַכְשָׁיו בְּרָצוֹן[1164] וְעַכְשָׁיו בְּאוֹנֶס **and now willingly";** **and from this was born Daryavesh son of Esther,** שֶׁבָּנָה אֶת בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ.[1165] **who built the Beis HaMikdash.**

[1160] **Shemot Rabbah 15:28** — "'This month shall be for you'—this is one of four things that the Holy One, blessed be He, showed Moshe with His finger, because he found them difficult. He showed him the making of the anointing oil ... He showed him the making of the menorah ... He showed him the creeping creatures ... and the moon, as it is said, 'This month shall be for you.'" This Midrash includes the anointing oil in its enumeration, whereas Menachos 29a lists three things in the basic teaching. Both attach the moon to a divine demonstration.

[1161] **Pesikta Rabbati 15** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, wrapped Himself in a garment with tzitzis. He placed Moshe on this side and Aharon on that side, called Michael and Gavriel, and made them like emissaries of the month. He said to them: 'On which side did you see the moon—before the sun or after the sun, to its north or to its south? How high was it, where did it incline, and how wide was it?' He said: 'In this order that you have seen, so shall My children intercalate the year below: through an elder, through witnesses, and through a garment with tzitzis.'" The checked digital text says "intercalate the year," while the manuscript paraphrases the procedure as sanctifying the month. The three elements—elder, witnesses, and garment—are expressly present. Rav Tzadok interprets their spiritual significance; the Pesikta's traditional internal §21 is the manuscript's locator.

[1162] **Berakhot 63a** — "He said to them: 'Did not Akiva ben Yosef intercalate years and establish months outside the Land?' They replied: 'Leave Rabbi Akiva aside, for he left no one like him in the Land of Israel.' He said: 'I too left no one like me in the Land of Israel.' They replied: 'The kids you left have become horned he-goats, and they sent us to you.'" Chanina, the nephew of Rabbi Yehoshua, had been establishing the calendar abroad. The reply distinguishes Rabbi Akiva's exceptional position from Chanina's present claim. Rav Tzadok explains the exceptional leader as the head of all Israel.

[1163] **Pesikta Rabbati 15** — "Rabbi Simon said: 'Your reckonings are toward us.' During all those two thousand four hundred and forty-eight years, before Israel went out of Egypt, the Holy One, blessed be He, sat and calculated reckonings, intercalated intercalations, sanctified years, and renewed months. Once Israel went out of Egypt, He handed these over to them, as it is said: 'Hashem spoke to Moshe and to Aharon ... This month shall be for you.' What is 'saying'? He told them: 'From now on, the beginnings of the months are entrusted to you.'" The Midrash reads the Psalm's machshevosecha, "Your thoughts," through calendrical reckoning. Rav Tzadok links the preceding "Your wonders" to the concealed divine root from which that authority proceeds.

[1164] **Rosh Hashanah 25a** — "'You'—even if unwitting; 'you'—even if deliberate; 'you'—even if misled. With these words he said to him: 'Akiva, you have comforted me; you have comforted me.'" Rabbi Akiva expounds the repeated word atem in the festival verses to uphold the court's calendar. The episode concerns Rabbi Yehoshua's submission to Rabban Gamliel's determination despite his own calculation.

[1165] **Rosh Hashanah 20a** — "Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said: They put pressure on witnesses concerning a moon seen at its expected time in order to make the month full, but do not put pressure on witnesses concerning a moon not seen at its expected time in order to sanctify it. Is that so? Rabbi Yehudah Nesi'ah sent Rabbi Ami: 'Know that throughout

וְכָל טַעֲנוֹת אֶסְתֵּר בְּמִשְׁתֵּה הַיַּיִן **And all of Esther's pleas at the wine-feast —** אִם מָצָאתִי חֵן בְּעֵינֶיךָ הַמֶּלֶךְ **"If I have found favor in your eyes, O King,** וְאִם עַל הַמֶּלֶךְ טוֹב [שָׁם ז, ג] **and if it please the King,** תִּנָּתֶן לִי נַפְשִׁי וְגוֹ' **let my life be given me," etc. (ibid. 7:3),** וְכֵן וְכָשֵׁר הַדָּבָר [שָׁם לִפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ וְגוֹ' **and likewise, "and the thing seem right before the King," etc. (ibid. 8:5) —** הַכֹּל הָיָה פְּנִימִיּוּת כַּוָּנָתָהּ [ח, ה בִּתְפִלָּה **all of it was, in her inner intent, prayer to the Holy One, blessed is He,** לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **the King of kings,** מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים וּדְבָרֶיהָ בִּפְשָׁטוּת הָיָה נִרְאֶה **while on the surface her words appeared** כְּמִדַּבֶּרֶת לַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **as if she were speaking to Achashverosh;** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁפֵּירֵשׁ הָרַמָ"ע **just as the Rama MiPano explained** [עֲשָׂרָה מַאֲמָרוֹת מַאֲמַר אִם כָּל חַי ח"א סִימָן ז] **(Asarah Maamaros, Maamar Em Kol Chai, part 1, siman 7)** גַּבֵּי נְחֶמְיָה דִּכְתִיב [נְחֶמְיָה ב, ד **regarding Nechemiah, where it is written (Nechemiah 2:4):** וָאֶתְפַּלֵּל אֶל אֱלֹהֵי הַשָּׁמָיִם **"And I prayed to the God of Heaven,** וָאוֹמַר לַמֶּלֶךְ וְגוֹ' **and I said to the king," etc. —** שֶׁאַף שֶׁלֹּא מָצִינוּ **that although we do not find any prayer that he prayed,** תְּפִלָּה שֶׁהִתְפַּלֵּל רַק הַדְּבָרִים שֶׁדִּיבֵּר לַמֶּלֶךְ **only the words he spoke to the king,** הָיָה כַּוָּנָתוֹ בִּתְפִלָּה לַה' יִתְבָּרַךְ.[1166] וְכֵן בְּכָאן הָיוּ דִּבְרֵי אֶסְתֵּר **his intent in them was prayer to Hashem Yisbarach. So too here, Esther's words were** דִּבְרֵי תְּפִלָּה לַה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **words of prayer to Hashem Yisbarach,** וְהָיוּ נִשְׁמָעִים בְּאָזְנֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ כְּמְבַקֶּשֶׁת מִמֶּנּוּ **yet they were heard in the ears of Achashverosh as though she were asking of him;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ [אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה שָׁם שֶׁמִּשְׁמַשׁ קֹדֶשׁ וְחוֹל: **and this is what they said (Esther Rabbah, ibid.), that it serves as both sacred and mundane.**

Rabbi Yochanan's life he taught us: They put pressure on witnesses concerning a moon not seen at its expected time in order to sanctify it; although they did not see it, they say, 'We saw it.'' Abaye said: There is no difficulty: one case concerns Nisan and Tishrei, and the other concerns the remaining months." The sugya gives distinctions and variant reports; Rav Dimi of Nehardea subsequently transmits the rule in the reverse form. Rav Tzadok invokes the striking formulation in his explanation of the court's access to the divine will, rather than erasing the surrounding discussion's qualifications.

[1166] **Bereshit Rabbah 3:4** — "Rabbi Shimon ben Yehotzadak asked Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman: 'Since I have heard that you are a master of aggadah, from where was light created?' He replied: 'It teaches that the Holy One, blessed be He, wrapped Himself in it like a garment, and the radiance of His splendor shone from one end of the world to the other.' He said this in a whisper. The other said: 'It is a complete verse: 'He wraps Himself in light like a garment,' and you tell it to me in a whisper?' He replied: 'As I heard it in a whisper, so I have told it to you in a whisper.'" The garment of light expresses a divine manifestation that shines outward. Rav Tzadok distinguishes it from the prior garment of majesty and splendor.

שׁוּשַׁן פּוּרִים

Shushan Purim

שׁוּשַׁן פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר א׳ Shushan Purim — Maamar Aleph

בְּרְאוֹתָם יַחַד תְּכֶלֶת מָרְדֳּכָי [פִּיּוּט לְאַחַר קְרִיאַת שׁוֹשַׁנַּת יַעֲקֹב צָהֲלָה וְשָׂמֵחָה הַמְּגִילָּה]. **"The rose of Yaakov exulted and rejoiced when they together beheld Mordechai's techeiles" (piyut after the reading of the Megillah).** לְשׁוֹן פִּיּוּט זֶה [אָסְתֵּר ח, טו] מְיֻסָּד עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **The wording of this piyut is founded on what is said (Esther 8:15):** וּמָרְדֳּכַי יָצָא מִלִּפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ בִּלְבוּשׁ מַלְכוּת תְּכֶלֶת וְגוֹ׳ **"And Mordechai went out from before the King in royal garments of techeiles," etc.,** וְהָעִיר שׁוּשָׁן צָהֲלָה וְשָׂמֵחָה.[1167] **"and the city of Shushan exulted and rejoiced."** וְהִנֵּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב בְּפִרְקֵי עֵץ חַיִּים **As written in Pri Etz Chaim** (שַׁעַר יט שַׁעַר הַפּוּרִים פֶּרֶק ו) **(Shaar 19, Shaar HaPurim, chapter 6);** וְהִיא שֶׁהִיא כְּשׁוֹשַׁנָּה בֵּין הַחוֹחִים[1168] **which is like a rose among the thorns,** וּכְדְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א׳, א, א) **as stated in the holy Zohar (I 1a):** מָה שּׁוֹשַׁנָּה אִית בָּהּ תְּלֵיסַר עָלִין **"Just as the rose has thirteen petals,** אַף כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל אִית בָּהּ תְּלֵיסַר מְכִילָן דְּרַחֲמֵי[1169] **so too Knesses Yisrael has thirteen attributes of mercy";** וּמִתֵּיבַת אֱלֹהִים עַד אֱלֹהִים תִּנְיָנָא **and from the word Elokim until the second Elokim** דְּרוּחַ אֱלֹהִים בֵּיהּ תְּלֵיסַר תֵּיבִין וְהֵינוּ נֶגֶד י״ג מְכִילָן **up to "the spirit of Elokim" there are thirteen words, corresponding to the thirteen attributes of mercy,** עַד תֵּיבַת וְרוּחַ אֱלֹהִים **up to the words "and the spirit of Elokim,"** הַמְרַמֵּז עַל רוּחוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ **which alludes to the spirit of Mashiach** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, ב, ד) **(as stated in Bereishis Rabbah 2:4),** שֶׁעַל זֶה הָיְתָה תַּכְלִית הַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁל הַבְּרִיאָה **for this was the ultimate intent of Creation with respect to Adam HaRishon.**[1170] וּמֵאֱלֹהִים תִּנְיָנָא **And from the second Elokim there are five more words until "And Elokim said, Let there be light" —** עַד וַיֹּאמֶר אֱלֹהִים יְהִי אוֹר **corresponding to the five strong leaves** נֶגֶד חֲמֵשׁ עָלִין תַּקִּיפִין דְּסָחֲרִין לְשׁוֹשַׁנָּה[1171] **that surround the rose; that is, corresponding to the five gevuros** שֶׁנִּמְתָּקִין עַל יְדֵי הָאוֹר **that are sweetened through the light, which is the light of teshuvah,** שֶׁהוּא אוֹר שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה **and through this it can be rectified** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יוּכַל לְיתָקֵן **to become gevurah within holiness.** לִהְיוֹת גְּבוּרָה שֶׁבִּקְדוּשָּׁה **And to this alludes the word "and the city,"** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז תֵּיבַת וְהָעִיר **which has five letters, corresponding to the five of the rose;** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּהּ חֲמֵשׁ אוֹתִיּוֹת נֶגֶד ה׳ שְׁבְּשׁוֹשַׁנָּה **and together with the word Shushan it is shoshanah.** וְעִם תֵּיבַת שׁוּשָׁ״ן הֵיא שׁוֹשַׁנָּ״ה. כִּי הָעִיר שׁוּשָׁן **For "the city of Shushan" alludes to the Jews in Shushan,** מְרַמֵּז עַל הַיְּהוּדִים שֶׁבְּשׁוּשָׁן וְהֵמָּה הָרַבָּנִים

[1167] **Pri Tzaddik, Chayei Sara 1:3** — "The Holy One emanated ten attributes for the creation of the world. This is what is counted in the Midrash ... and in the Pesikta, 'I will greatly rejoice,' according to the Yalkut's reading: ten garments that the Holy One wore from the day He created the world. These are the ten sefiros, ten garments. The Pesikta counts majesty and splendor as the first garment. This corresponds to the supreme crown, by which they are connected at the root. Afterward it says, 'He wraps Himself in light like a garment'—the utterance 'Let there be light,' which corresponds to wisdom." This is the internal cross-reference named in the manuscript. Chanukah 2:4 develops the same distinction between the concealed first utterance and the light through which wisdom first becomes accessible.

[1168] **Siddur Ashkenaz, Shabbos Maariv, middle blessing** — "You sanctified the seventh day to Your name, the culmination of the making of heaven and earth. You blessed it above all days and sanctified it above all seasons. So it is written in Your Torah." The prayer describes Shabbos as blessed above all other days and sanctified above all other seasons. Rav Tzadok uses it when explaining how Shabbos encompasses the holiness that will unfold during the following weekdays.

[1169] **Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 25:1** — "From the Holy One's side, the sanctity of Shabbos is certainly higher than the sanctity of the month; therefore it says, 'On the Shabbos day it shall open, and on the day of the month it shall open,' for there it speaks of what the Holy One will open. ... But from Israel's side, the sanctity of the month is dear to them because Israel sanctifies it, and a person prefers his own measure." This explicitly cited maamar explains why the month can be called more sanctified in the sacrificial comparison even though Shabbos has its fixed sanctity from God. It supplies the distinction between divine gift and Israel's sanctifying work.

[1170] **Zevachim 91a** — "Come and hear: The additional offerings of Shabbos precede the additional offerings of Rosh Chodesh. Does Rosh Chodesh confer benefit on its own additional offerings, but confer no benefit on the additional offerings of Shabbos?" The sugya weighs the claims of greater frequency and greater sanctity. Its reply refuses to restrict the day's added sanctity to one set of offerings: the Shabbos offerings are offered on Rosh Chodesh too. Rav Tzadok reads this shared effect as a mutual reception of sanctity.

[1171] **Rosh Hashanah 3a** — "Rav Chisda said: They taught this only concerning the kings of Israel, but for the kings of the nations of the world we count from Tishrei, as it is said, 'The words of Nechemyah son of Chachalyah: It happened in the month of Kislev, in the twentieth year ...'; and it is written, 'It happened in the month of Nisan, in the twentieth year of Artachshasta ...'." The two events retain the same regnal year across Nisan. The distinction between the two systems is the starting point of Rav Tzadok's account of solar and lunar kingship.

וְהַסַּנְהֶדְרִין **and they are the rabbis and the Sanhedrin** שֶׁהָיוּ בְּשׁוּשָׁן **who were in Shushan,** (מְגִילָה וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (יב, ב **as they said (Megillah 12b):** מַאן חֲכָמִים רַבָּנַן **"Who are the 'wise men'? The Rabbis.** יוֹדְעֵי הָעִתִּים **'Who know the times' —** שֶׁיּוֹדְעִין לְעַבֵּר שָׁנִים **who know how to intercalate years** וְלִקְבּוֹעַ חֳדָשִׁים.[1172] **and fix months."** גַּם חֲתָךְ זֶה דָּנִיֵּאל[1173] **Also, "Hasach — this is Daniel"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם טו, א). **(as stated there, 15a).** וְעַל כֵּן מְרַמֵּז הָעִיר שׁוּשָׁן עַל בְּחִינַת שׁוֹשַׁנָּה כְּנִזְכָּר לְעֵיל **Therefore "the city of Shushan" alludes to the aspect of the rose mentioned above,** שֶׁהִיא כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל. **which is Knesses Yisrael.** וּמַה שֶּׁנָּקַט תְּכֵלֶת **And why he chose techeiles** מִכָּל חֲמִשָּׁה לְבוּשִׁים הַנִּזְכָּרִים בַּפָּסוּק **from all five garments mentioned in the verse,** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר עַל פִּי פָּשׁוּט **one may say, in simple terms,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁנִּזְכַּר בָּרִאשׁוֹנָה. **because it is mentioned first.** אֲמָנָם פְּנִימִיּוּת הַדָּבָר **However, the inner meaning** שֶׁל חֲמִשָּׁה לְבוּשִׁים **of the five garments** יְרֻמַּז עַל עִנְיָן גָּדוֹל **alludes to a great matter,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שָׁם טז, ב) **as they said (there, 16b)** עַל פָּסוּק וּלְבִנְיָמִין נָתַן **on the verse "And to Binyamin he gave** [בְּרֵאשִׁית מה, כב] חָמֵשׁ חֲלִיפוֹת שְׂמָלֹת **five changes of clothing" (Bereishis 45:22):** שֶׁיּוֹסֵף רָמַז לוֹ **that Yosef hinted to him** שֶׁעָתִיד מָרְדֳּכַי לָצֵאת מִמֶּנּוּ **that Mordechai was destined to descend from him,** שֶׁיָּצָא מִלִּפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **who went out from before the King** בַּחֲמִשָּׁה לְבוּשֵׁי מַלְכוּת[1174] **in five royal garments;** וְהֵם לְבוּשֵׁי הַמִּצְוֹת **and these are the garments of the mitzvos** שֶׁעוֹשִׂים בְּגַן עֵדֶן **that are made in Gan Eden,** וּכְדְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as stated in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ג׳ קסט, ב) **(III 169b):** וַתִּלְבַּשׁ אֶסְתֵּר מַלְכוּת **"And Esther clothed herself in royalty" —** דָּא רוּחָא דְּקוּדְשָׁא וְכוּ׳ **this is the holy spirit, etc.;** מָרְדֳּכַי אוף הָכִי **Mordechai likewise,** דִּכְתִיב וּמָרְדֳּכַי יָצָא מִלִּפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ בִּלְבוּשׁ מַלְכוּת וְכוּ׳ **in royal garments," etc.** וּמְרַמֵּז שֶׁיָּצָא מִלִּפְנֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **It alludes that he went out from before the King,** מֶלֶךְ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **the King of the world,** שֶׁנִּתְלַבֵּשׁ בַּחֲמִשָּׁה לְבוּשֵׁי מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם **in royal garments, for he was clothed in five garments of the Kingdom of Heaven;** וּתְכֵלֶת מְרַמֵּז עַל גְּוָון הַיִּרְאָה **and techeiles alludes to the hue of yirah,** כַּיָּדוּעַ **as is known** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת וַיִּגַּשׁ מַאֲמָר ז **(and it was explained in Parshas Vayigash, maamar 7,** עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת) **see there at length);** וְלָכֵן מַזְכִּיר לְעִיקָּר **and therefore he mentions as primary** תְּכֵלֶת מָרְדֳּכַי **Mordechai's techeiles,** הַמְרַמֵּז עַל רֵאשִׁית חָכְמָה **which alludes to "The beginning of wisdom** יִרְאַת ה׳.[1175] **is the fear of Hashem."** וּמַה שֶּׁבִּקְּשָׁה אֶסְתֵּר **And as for Esther's request,** יִנָּתֵן גַּם מָחָר **"Let it be granted also tomorrow** לַיְּהוּדִים אֲשֶׁר בְּשׁוּשָׁן [אֶסְתֵּר ט, יג] **to the Jews who are in Shushan to do according to today's decree" (Esther 9:13) —** הוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִרְגִּישָׁה **it is because she sensed,** מִמַּה שֶּׁאָמַר לָהּ הַמֶּלֶךְ **from what the King said to her,** [שָׁם, יב] מַה בַּקָּשָׁתֵךְ עוֹד וְתֵעָשׂ **"And what is your further request? It shall be done" (ibid. 12),** בְּוַדַּאי רְצוֹן מֶלֶךְ מַלְכֵי הַמְּלָכִים **that it was surely the will of the King of kings,** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **the Holy One, blessed is He,** לַעֲשׂוֹת עוֹד אֵיזֶה תִּיקּוּן לְדוֹרוֹת **to make some further rectification for the generations;** וְהֵשִׂכִּילָה בָּזֶה **and she understood from this** שֶׁצָּרִיךְ לְהוֹסִיף עוֹד יוֹם אֶחָד **that one more day must**

[1172] **Shemot Rabbah 15:27** — "The Holy One, blessed be He, entrusted the secret of the moon to Israel so that they would count by it, while the nations count by the sun. This teaches: Just as the sun is only by day, so they rule only in this world; and just as the sun is of fire, so they will be judged through it. ... Just as the moon is visible by day and by night, so Israel rules in this world and in the world to come. Just as the moon is of light, so Israel inherits light, as it is said: 'Light is sown for the righteous, and gladness for the upright of heart.'" The Midrash's contrast is a symbolic exposition of inheritance and judgment. Rav Tzadok develops the distinction between receiving the sun's illumination and encountering its consuming fire.

[1173] **Nedarim 8b** — "Reish Lakish said: There is no Gehinnom in the world to come. Rather, the Holy One, blessed be He, brings the sun out of its sheath: the righteous are healed through it, and the wicked are judged through it, as it is said, 'For you who fear My name, a sun ... shall rise.' Not only that: they take delight in it, as it is said, 'You will go out and leap like calves of the stall.' The wicked are judged through it, as it is said, 'Behold, the day comes, burning like an oven.'" The same revelation brings healing or judgment. Rav Tzadok explains the righteous person's reception through the image of the moon receiving light.

[1174] **Rashi on Taanit 8b** — "'Those who fear My name'—those who keep Shabbos." Rashi identifies the verse's reverent recipients with Shabbos observers, which is the precise link used in the argument.

[1175] **Shemot Rabbah 15:26** — "The moon begins to shine on the first of Nisan. As it proceeds, it grows brighter until fifteen days, and its disk becomes full. From the fifteenth until the thirtieth its light diminishes; on the thirtieth it is not seen. So Israel has fifteen generations from Avraham until Shlomo. Avraham began to shine ... Yitzchak came and he too shone ... Yaakov came and added light. ... When Shlomo came, the disk of the moon became full, as it is said: 'Shlomo sat upon Hashem's throne as king.'" The Midrash lists the intervening generations and then the corresponding decline. Rav Tzadok focuses on Avraham as the beginning and Shlomo as the fullness of the royal illumination.

be added בְּשׁוּשָׁן לְהָאָרַת הַנֵּס.[1176] in Shushan, for the illumination of the miracle. וּפְנִימִיּוּת הָעִנְיָן יוּבַן The inner meaning of the matter will be understood (שָׁם יא, א) בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא from what they said in the Gemara (there, 11a): שְׁנֵי פְּתִיחוֹת לְהַאי פָּרָשְׁתָּא. two openings to this portion. אֶחָד, אֲרִי נוֹהֵם זֶה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר One: "A roaring lion" — this is Nevuchadnetzar; וְדוֹב שׁוֹקֵק זֶה אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ "and a ravenous bear" — this is Achashverosh; מוֹשֵׁל רָשָׁע זֶה הָמָן "a wicked ruler" — this is Haman; עַל עַם דַּל אֵלּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל "over a poor people" — this is Yisrael, שֶׁהֵם דַּלִּים מִן הַמִּצְוֹת[1177] who are poor in mitzvos. רַבִּי אֶלְעָזָר פָּתַח וְכוּ׳ Rabbi Elazar opened, etc.: בַּעֲצֵלְתַּיִם יִמַּךְ הַמְּקָרֶה [קֹהֶלֶת י, יח] "Through slothfulness the rafters sink" (Koheles 10:18) — בִּשְׁבִיל עַצְלוּת שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם לְיִשְׂרָאֵל because of the sloth that Yisrael had, שֶׁלֹּא עָסְקוּ בַּתּוֹרָה that they did not engage in Torah, נַעֲשָׂה שׂוֹנְאוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא עָנִי the "enemy" of the Holy One, blessed He, became poor — וְאֵין עָנִי אֶלָּא וְאֵין מְקָרֶה אֶלָּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא and mach means only poor, etc., and mekareh means only the Holy One, blessed is He, שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים קד, ג] הַמְקָרֶה בַמַּיִם עֲלִיּוֹתָיו.[1178] as it says (Tehillim 104:3), "Who roofs His upper chambers with water." וְלִכְאוֹרָה אֵין שׁוּם שַׁיָּיכוּת Seemingly there is no connection at all בֵּין פְּתִיחָה זוֹ לְעִנְיַן שׁוּם הַמְּגִילָּה between this opening and the matter of the Megillah, שֶׁלֹּא נִזְכַּר בְּהַפָּסוּק for the verse contains רֶמֶז לַאֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ וְהָמָן. no hint at all of Achashverosh and Haman. וְיוּבַן זֶה עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ This will be understood from what they said (עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ה, ב) (Avodah Zarah 5b): אַשְׁרֵיכֶם זוֹרְעֵי עַל כָּל מָיִם "Fortunate are you who sow beside all waters, מְשַׁלְּחֵי רֶגֶל הַשּׁוֹר וְהַחֲמוֹר [יְשַׁעְיָה לב, כ] who send forth the feet of the ox and the donkey" (Yeshayahu 32:20) — אַשְׁרֵיכֶם יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּזְמַן שֶׁעוֹסְקִין בַּתּוֹרָה fortunate are you, Yisrael, when you engage in Torah and in acts of kindness; יִצְרָם מָסוּר בְּיָדָם וְכוּ׳ their inclination is delivered into their hands, etc.; וְאֵין זְרִיעָה אֶלָּא צְדָקָה וְכוּ׳ וְאֵין מַיִם and "sowing" means only tzedakah, etc., and "water" means only Torah, etc. אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה וְכוּ׳ And as for the allusion to the yetzer hara, וְעִנְיַן הָרֶמֶז עַל יֵצֶר הָרָע כָּתְבוּ רַשִׁ״י [ד״ה מְשַׁלְּחֵי] וְתוֹסָפוֹת [ד״ה יִצְרָם] Rashi (s.v. Meshalchei) and Tosafos (s.v. Yitzram) wrote שֶׁהוּא לְשׁוֹן הִילּוּךְ which connotes walking, מִתֵּיבַת רֶגֶל that it is from the word "foot," דְּיֵצֶר הָרָע נִקְרָא for the yetzer hara is called a wayfarer,[1179] כִּדְכְתִיב [שְׁמוּאֵל ב יב, ד] וַיָּבֹא הַלָּךְ וְגוֹ׳ as it is written (II Shmuel 12:4), "And a wayfarer came," etc. וְהָעִיקָּר יִרְמֹז עַל קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק And chiefly it alludes to the kelipah of Amalek, שֶׁנִּקְרָא הֹלֵךְ כְּאוֹרֵחַ which is called a wayfarer, like a traveler, בְּרִפְיוֹן יָדַיִם in slackness of hands, שֶׁזֶּהוּ רֵאשִׁית דֶּרֶךְ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע for this is the first way of the yetzer hara: לְהַשְׁלִיךְ עַל הָאָדָם to cast upon a person עַצְלוּת וְקָרִירוּת[1180] sloth and coolness, כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [דְּבָרִים כה, יח] אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ בַּדָּרֶךְ as it is said (Devarim 25:18), "who happened upon you on the way," וְהוּא רֵאשִׁית דִּקְלִיפָּה. and he is the first of the kelipah. וּמִמֵּילָא מוּבָן And it is self-understood שֶׁעִיקַּר כֹּחַ עֲמָלֵק that the main power of Amalek לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל חַס וְשָׁלוֹם to overpower Yisrael, chas v'shalom, כַּאֲשֶׁר מַרְפִּים יְדֵיהֶם is when they slacken their hands מִן הַתּוֹרָה

[1176] **Shabbat 67a** — "'Princes may go out with bells.' Who is the tanna? Rabbi Oshaya said: It is Rabbi Shimon, who said: All Israel are princes. Rava said: The bell is woven into his garment, and the teaching follows everyone." The statement occurs in the discussion of what may be worn on Shabbos. Rav Tzadok develops the royal status through Israel's descent from the patriarchs.

[1177] **Bereshit Rabbah 59:8** — "Rabbi Pinchas said: Before I made Him known to His creatures, He was 'the God of heaven'; once I made Him known to His creatures, He was 'the God of the earth.'" The exposition compares Avraham's expressions in Bereishis 24:3 and 24:7. Rav Tzadok understands his making God known as establishing revealed divine kingship in the world.

[1178] **Bereshit Rabbah 42:5** — "'The valley of Shaveh'—Rabbi Berechyah and Rabbi Chelbo said in Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachman's name: There all the nations agreed, cut cedar trees, made him a great platform, and seated him above it. They praised him and said: 'Hear us, my lord; you are a prince of God among us.' They said: 'You are king over us, prince over us, a god over us.' He replied: 'Let the world not lack its King, and let the world not lack its God.'" The offer of rule is explicitly answered by Avraham's refusal to displace divine sovereignty. That qualification is central to Rav Tzadok's ensuing distinction between human elevation and God's kingship.

[1179] **Zohar III 210b, Balak** — "'For from the head of rocks I see him.' Rabbi Yitzchak said: 'From the head of rocks'—these are the patriarchs, as it is written, 'Look to the rock from which you were hewn.' 'From the hills I behold him'—these are the mothers. From this side and from that side they cannot be cursed." The 210b marker precedes this paragraph and 211a follows. Although the singular "rock" in Yeshayahu's context points to Avraham, the Zohar applies the plural rocks to all the patriarchs, precisely the extension that Rav Tzadok discusses.

[1180] **Zohar III 150a, Behaaloscha** — "'A well that princes dug, that the generous ones of the people excavated.' The well is the congregation of Israel. 'Princes dug it'—this is Father and Mother, who gave birth to her. 'The generous ones of the people excavated it'—these are the patriarchs, as it is written, 'The generous ones of the peoples gathered, the people of the God of Avraham.'" The quoted words precede the embedded 150b marker and belong to III 150a. The use of "patriarchs" despite the proof-verse naming Avraham is the point Rav Tzadok develops.

נִקְרָא בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי וּמִדְרָשִׁים **is used in the Yerushalmi and the Midrashim** מִצְוָה וְהַמִּצְוֹת. **from Torah and mitzvos.** כִּי סְתָם מִצְוָה **for the mitzvah of tzedakah and acts of kindness.** מִצְוַת צְדָקָה וּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים **For "mitzvah" unqualified** **And these were Haman's claims** (מְגִילָּה יג, ב) וְעַל זֶה הָיָה טַעֲנוֹת הָמָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Megillah 13b):** אָמַר לֵיהּ אִית בְּהוּ "Yeshno" — they are asleep from the mitzvos; יֶשְׁנוֹ שֶׁהֵם יְשֵׁנִים מִן הַמִּצְוֹת רַבָּנַן He said to him: "There are Rabbis among them" — meaning the power of Torah; וְהֵיינוּ כֹּחַ הַתּוֹרָה אָמַר לֵיהּ עַם אֶחָד הֵן He said to Him: "They are one people" — that in this too there is slackness of hands. שֶׁגַּם בָּזֶה יֵשׁ רִפְיוֹן יָדַיִם **Therefore the Men of the Great Assembly instituted** וְלָכֵן תִּקְנוּ אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה שְׁנֵי הָעִנְיָנִים הָאֵלּוּ **these two matters in the mitzvos of Purim,** בְּמִצְוַת פּוּרִים לְתַקֵּן שְׁנֵי הַקִּלְקוּלִים **to repair the two flaws** שֶׁגָּרְמוּ הִתְגַּבְּרוּת קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק עֲלֵיהֶם **that caused the kelipah of Amalek to overpower them:** מִשְׁלוֹחַ מָנוֹת וּמַתָּנוֹת לָאֶבְיוֹנִים **mishloach manos and matanos la'evyonim,** לְתַקֵּן הַקִּלְקוּל שֶׁל צָרוּת עַיִן **to repair the flaw of stinginess** מִמִּצְוַת צְדָקָה וּגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים **in the mitzvah of tzedakah and kindness.** וְעַל זֶה יְרַמֵּז הַפְּתִיחָה **And to this alludes the opening:** שֶׁהֶחֱרִיב בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ אֲרִי נוֹהֵם זֶה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר **"A roaring lion" — this is Nevuchadnetzar, who destroyed the Beis HaMikdash;** וְדוֹב שׁוֹקֵק זֶה אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ **"and a ravenous bear" — this is Achashverosh,** וּבְמַלְכוּת אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ וְגוֹ' [עֶזְרָא ד, ו] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Ezra 4:6), "And in the reign of Achashverosh," etc.,** כָּתְבוּ שִׂטְנָה וְגוֹ' **"they wrote an accusation," etc.** — גַּם כֵּן לְבַטֵּל בִּנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. **also to halt the building of the Beis HaMikdash.** מוֹשֵׁל רָשָׁע זֶה הָמָן **"A wicked ruler" — this is Haman;** עַל עַם דַּל **"over a poor people" — this is Yisrael,** שֶׁהָיוּ דַּלִּים מִן הַמִּצְוֹת אִלּוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **who were poor in mitzvos** — הַיְינוּ סְתָם מִצְוָה **that is, "mitzvah" unqualified,** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above,** שֶׁהוּא נוֹהֶגֶת בְּכָל אָדָם **which applies to every person,** וּבְכָל מָקוֹם וּבְכָל זְמַן. **in every place and at every time.** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה הָיָה שִׁלִּיטַת עֲמָלֵק **And through this came the dominion of Amalek,** זֶה הָמָן כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **which is Haman, as mentioned above.** וְגַם עַל יְדֵי זֶה **And also through this came** חוּרְבַּן וּבִיטּוּל בִּנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **the destruction and halting of the building of the Beis HaMikdash,** שֶׁעִיקַּר בִּנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הוּא עַל יְדֵי מַעֲשֵׂה הַמִּצְוֹת **for the essential building of the Beis HaMikdash is through the deeds of the mitzvos,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (כְּתוּבוֹת ה, א) וְאִלּוּ בְּמַעֲשֵׂיהֶם שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים **as they said (Kesubos 5a): whereas of the deeds of the tzaddikim** מָכוֹן וְגוֹ' [שְׁמוֹת טו, יז] כְּתִיב **it is written (Shemos 15:17), "The foundation," etc.,** מִקְדָּשׁ אֲדֹנָי כּוֹנְנוּ **"the Sanctuary, my Lord, which Your hands established"** — קְרוּ לַמִּקְדָּשׁ מַעֲשֵׂי יָדֶיךָ **they call the Mikdash the handiwork of the tzaddikim.**[1181] יְדֵיהֶם שֶׁל צַדִּיקִים **It is along the lines of what they said** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה לג, ח) וְהוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **(Shemos Rabbah 33:8): even a single one of Yisrael** אֶפִילּוּ אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **is able to make it,** יָכוֹל לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ **as it is said (Shemos 25:2), "From every man whose heart moves him."** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שְׁמוֹת כה, ב] מֵאֵת כָּל אִישׁ אֲשֶׁר יִדְּבֶנּוּ לִבּוֹ. **That is, through the generosity of his heart** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי נְדִיבוּת לִבּוֹ בּוֹנֶה בַּיִת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ.[1182] **he builds the Beis HaMikdash.** וְאָמְרוּ (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא י, ב) בַּמֶּה תָּרוּם **And they said (Bava Basra 10b): "By what shall the horn of Yisrael be raised?** בְּכִי תִשָּׂא **By 'Ki Sisa'"** — הַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי נְדִיבוּת לֵב קַרְנוֹ יִשְׂרָאֵל **that is, through generosity of heart for tzedakah** לִצְדָקָה (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב פֵּירוּשׁ רַשִׁ"י שָׁם ד"ה אָמַר). **(as Rashi explains there, s.v. Amar).** **And the mitzvah of feasting and gladness of Purim** וּמִצְוַת מִשְׁתֶּה וְשִׂמְחָה שֶׁל פּוּרִים **is to repair the flaw** הוּא לְתַקֵּן הַקִּלְקוּל **of sloth in the study of Torah,** שֶׁל עַצְלוּת בְּעֶסֶק הַתּוֹרָה וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ **along the lines of what is said (Mishlei 15:15):** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִשְׁלֵי טו, טו] כָּל יְמֵי עָנִי רָעִים **"All the days of the poor man are bad,"** וּמְרַמֵּז עַל הֶעָנִי בְּדַעַת **which alludes to one poor in understanding,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (נְדָרִים מא, א) אֵין עָנִי אֶלָּא בְּדַעַת **as they said (Nedarim 41a): "There is no poor man except in knowledge";** וְהוּא שֶׁאֵינוֹ שָׂם עַל לֵב **this is one who does not take to heart** כָּל יָמָיו יְקָרוּת הַדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **the preciousness of words of Torah** —

[1181] **Chagigah 3a** — "Rava expounded: What is meant by 'How beautiful are your steps in sandals, daughter of the generous one'? How beautiful are Israel's feet when they go up for the festival pilgrimage. 'Daughter of the generous one'—the daughter of Avraham our father, who is called generous, as it is said, 'The generous ones of the peoples gathered, the people of the God of Avraham.' 'The God of Avraham,' and not the God of Yitzchak and Yaakov? Rather, the God of Avraham, who was the first of the converts." The Gemara explains why this verse names Avraham particularly. Rav Tzadok compares this particular naming with the Zohar's inclusive application to the patriarchs.

[1182] **Bava Metzia 83a** — "His father said to him: 'My son, even if you make for them a banquet like Shlomo's in his time, you have not fulfilled your obligation to them, for they are the children of Avraham, Yitzchak, and Yaakov. Rather, before they begin work, go and tell them: On condition that you have a claim against me only for bread and legumes.' Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel said: He did not need to say this; everything follows the local custom." The Mishnah concerns a promise of food made to hired laborers without qualification. The mention of all three patriarchs is what Rav Tzadok compares with the Gemara's example drawn specifically from Avraham's hospitality.

רָעִים **all his days are bad,** וְזֶהוּ אֲפִילּוּ שַׁבָּתוֹת וְיָמִים טוֹבִים[1183] **and this means even Shabbosos and Yamim Tovim** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בָּבָא בַּתְרָא קמו, א) **(as stated in Bava Basra 146a);** וּמְרַמֵּז אֲפִילּוּ שַׁבָּתוֹת וְיָמִים טוֹבִים **and it alludes that even Shabbosos and Yamim Tovim,** שֶׁנִּתְּנוּ לַעֲסוֹק בַּתּוֹרָה[1184] **which were given for engaging in Torah,** [רְאֵה יְרוּשַׁלְמִי שַׁבָּת פט״ו ה״ג עח, א] **(see Yerushalmi Shabbos 15:3, 78a),** לֹא יוֹעִיל לְהָעָנִי בְּדַעַת **will not help one poor in understanding** לְהֵיטִיב לִבּוֹ. **to make his heart glad.** וְטוֹב לֵב הַיְינוּ **And "good of heart" is** מִי שֶׁעוֹסֵק בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה תָּמִיד **one who engages in words of Torah constantly,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (רות רַבָּה ה, טו) **along the lines of what they said (Rus Rabbah 5:15)** עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [רות ג, ז] וַיִּיטַב לִבּוֹ **on what is said (Rus 3:7), "And his heart was merry"** — שֶׁעָסַק בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **that he engaged in words of Torah.** מִשְׁתֶּה תָּמִיד **"A constant feast"** — [מִשְׁלֵי ט, ה] עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **along the lines of what is said (Mishlei 9:5),** וּשְׁתוּ בְּיֵינִי מָסָכְתִּי **"And drink of the wine I have mixed";** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁמְּשִׂים הַדְּבָרֵי תוֹרָה עַל לִבּוֹ **and by setting the words of Torah upon his heart,** מִזֶּה בָּא גַּם כֵּן הַשִּׂמְחָה **from this the gladness also comes,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים צז, יא] וּלְיִשְׁרֵי לֵב **as it is said (Tehillim 97:11), "And for the upright of heart, gladness"** (שִׂמְחָה וְנִתְבָּאֵר י״ד אֲדָר רִאשׁוֹן מַאֲמָר ב). **(and it was explained at the fourteenth of Adar Rishon, maamar 2).** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז פְּתִיחָה הַשֵּׁנִיָּה **And to this alludes the second opening:** בִּשְׁבִיל בַּעֲצַלְתַּיִם יִמַּךְ הַמְקֹרֶה **"Through slothfulness the rafters sink"** — **because of the sloth that Yisrael had,** עַצְלוּת שֶׁהָיָה לָהֶם לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **that they did not engage in Torah,** שֶׁלֹּא עָסְקוּ בַּתּוֹרָה **the "enemy" of the Holy One, blessed is He, became poor;** וְאֵין נַעֲשָׂה שׂוֹנְאוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מָךְ **and mekareh means only the Holy One, blessed is He,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַמְקָרֶה בַמַּיִם עֲלִיּוֹתָיו. מְקָרֶה אֶלָּא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **as it says, "Who roofs His upper chambers with water."** וּמַה שֶּׁכִּינּוּ בְּכָאן שְׁמוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **And why they designated here His Name, may He be blessed,** בִּלְשׁוֹן הַמְקָרֶה וְגוֹ׳ **with the term "Who roofs," etc.,** יוּבַן עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּזּוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק ב׳ סה, ב) **will be understood from what they said in the holy Zohar (II 65b):** אָמַר רַבִּי שִׁמְעוֹן לְעֵילָּא וְתַתָּא. **Rabbi Shimon said: Above and below.** קַטְרוּגָא דְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **The accusation against the Holy One, blessed is He,** הֲוָה לְעֵילָּא וְכוּ׳ **was Above, etc.** אָמַר מֹשֶׁה אֲנָא אַזְמִין גַּרְמִי **Moshe said: I will prepare myself** לְהַהוּא קְרָבָא דִּלְעֵילָּא **for that battle Above,** וְאַנְתְּ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ זְמִין גַּרְמָךְ **and you, Yehoshua, prepare yourself** לִקְרָבָא דִּלְתַתָּא[1185] וְכוּ׳ **for the battle below, etc.,** כִּי עִנְיַן קְרָבָא דִּלְתַתָּא בְּפוֹעַל עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** **For the matter of the battle below in practice** בְּמַעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוֹת הָיָה עַל מַה שֶּׁהָיוּ דַּלִּים **was over their being poor** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **in the deeds of the mitzvos, as mentioned above;** וְעַל זֶה הָיָה מוּכָן יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לְהַכְנִיעוֹ **and for this Yehoshua was prepared to subdue him,** שֶׁהוּא מִזֶּרַע יוֹסֵף **for he was of the seed of Yosef,** שֶׁהָיָה זָהִיר בְּמַעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוֹת **who was careful in the deeds of the mitzvos,** שֶׁהָיָה זָן וּמְפַרְנֵס **who fed and sustained,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּרֵאשִׁית מז, יב] וַיְכַלְכֵּל יוֹסֵף וְגוֹ׳. **as it is said (Bereishis 47:12), "And Yosef sustained," etc.** וּקְרָבָא דִּלְעֵילָּא **And the battle Above** הוּא שֶׁיּוּעִיל הַקִּטְרוּג לְמַעְלָה **is that the accusation should take effect Above,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה [אֶסְתֵּר ד, א] עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **on what is said (Esther 4:1),** [אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ז, יג] **as they said in Midrash Rabbah (Esther Rabbah 7:13)** וּמָרְדֳּכַי יָדַע אֶת כָּל אֲשֶׁר נַעֲשָׂה **"And Mordechai knew all that had been done,"** שֶׁהוֹדִיעוּהוּ שֶׁנֶּחְתַּם הַגְּזֵרָה **that they informed him that the decree had been sealed** לְמַעְלָה בְּטִיט. **Above in clay.** כִּי עַל יְדֵי הֶבֶל דַּל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **And this came only from sloth** וְהוּא בָּא רַק מִצַּד עַצְלוּת **in words of Torah,**

[1183] **Bava Metzia 86b** — "Does this mean that Avraham our father's banquet was superior to Shlomo's? ... Yet concerning Avraham it is written: 'Avraham ran to the herd and took a calf, tender and good'; Rav Yehudah said in Rav's name: 'A calf'—one; 'tender'—two; 'good'—three." The Gemara develops the comparison through the quantities and recipients of the meals. Rav Tzadok's point is that a proof drawn from Avraham can express the dignity of the descendants of all three patriarchs. The cited Gemara's banquet comparison is distinct from the Mishnah's general mention of all three patriarchs.

[1184] **Tikkunei Zohar 77b** — "Concerning these two lights it is said: two faces, male and female. 'Let there be light'—this is Pesach, 'on the evening of the fourteenth.' 'There was light'—this is Rosh Hashanah, of which it is said, 'It happened on the day': here 'it happened' and there 'it happened,' and in every place 'it happened' is an expression of distress." The original text explicitly juxtaposes Pesach and Rosh Hashanah through the two light phrases. Rav Tzadok explains the first as the beginning of the Oral Torah's renewal and the second as its illumination through reception from the Written Torah.

[1185] **Vayikra Rabbah 2:4** — "Rabbi Avin said: This is like a king who had purple garments. He would instruct his servant: 'Attend to this one; fold it and shake it.' The servant said: 'My lord king, of all your purple garments, you instruct me only concerning this one?' He replied: 'This is the one I wore on the day of my kingship.' So Moshe said before the Holy One, blessed be He: 'Master of the world, of the seventy nations in Your world, You instruct me only concerning Israel?' He replied: 'They first proclaimed Me king at the sea and said to Me, 'Hashem shall reign forever and ever.'" Israel's special place is explained through its first proclamation of God's kingship. The following parable in the Midrash separately speaks of Israel's acceptance at Sinai.

תּוֹרָה **for through even the slight breath of words of Torah** נַעֲשָׂה מְחִיצָה וְתִקְרָה **a partition and a ceiling is formed** בֵּין הַמְקַטְרֵג לַשָּׁמַיִם **between the accuser and Heaven,** שֶׁלֹּא יַעֲלֶה קִטְרוּגוֹ לְעֵילָּא. **so that his accusation does not ascend Above.** וְעַל זֶה רָמְזוּ **And to this they alluded:** בִּשְׁבִיל עַצְלוּת שֶׁהָיָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל בַּתּוֹרָה **because of the sloth Yisrael had in Torah,** הַיְינוּ הַתִּקְרָה וְהַמְּחִיצָה **that is, the ceiling and partition** **"the rafters sink" —** יְמַךְ הַמְּקֹרֶה **against the accusation, formed by the Torah,** בְּפָנֵי הַקִּטְרוּג עַל יְדֵי הַתּוֹרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַמְקָרֶה בַמַּיִם **as it is said, "Who roofs His upper chambers with water,"** עֲלִיּוֹתָיו. וְאֵין מַיִם אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה **and water means only Torah.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר מֹשֶׁה **And about this Moshe said,** אֶנָּא אַזְמִין גַּרְמֵי לְקַרְבָא דִּלְעֵילָּא **"I will prepare myself for the battle Above,"** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָיָה מוּכָן אָז **because he was then prepared** לְקַבֵּל הַתּוֹרָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **to receive the Torah for Yisrael,** וְזֶה יוֹעִיל לְבַטֵּל הַקִּטְרוּג **and this would serve to annul the accusation** וְלִהְיוֹת תִּקְרָה וּמְחִיצָה לְפָנָיו **and to be a ceiling and partition before it,** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְהִנֵּה אִיתָא בַּגְּמָרָא (מְגִילָּה יב, א) **Now it is stated in the Gemara (Megillah 12a):** מִפְּנֵי מָה נִתְחַיְּבוּ וְכוּ' **"Why were they deserving," etc.** אִם כֵּן שֶׁבְּשׁוּשָׁן יֵהָרְגוּ **"Because they partook** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁנֶּהֱנוּ מִסְּעוּדָּתוֹ שֶׁל אוֹתוֹ רָשָׁע **of the feast of that wicked one."** **"If so, those in Shushan should be killed," etc.** וְכוּ' אָמַר לָהֶם מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהִשְׁתַּחֲוִיתֶם לַצֶּלֶם וְכוּ' **He said to them: "Because they bowed to the image," etc.** וּשְׁנֵי הַפְּגָמִים הָאֵלּוּ **And these two blemishes** הֵם כְּשָׁנֵי הַקִּלְקוּלִים הַנַּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל. **correspond to the two flaws mentioned above.** **Bowing to the image** נֶגֶד פְּגַם שֶׁהִשְׁתַּחֲוִיתֶם לַצֶּלֶם **corresponds to the blemish of neglecting the mitzvos,** בִּיטּוּל הַמִּצְוֹת כִּי שְׁקוּלָה עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה **for avodah zarah is equal** נֶגֶד כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת **to all the mitzvos;** וּבָזֶה הָיָה הַפְּגָם בְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל **and in this blemish was in all of Yisrael,** וְנִתְתַּקֵּן זֶה בְּי"ג **and it was rectified on the thirteenth,** וְנוֹחַ בְּי"ד. **and they rested on the fourteenth.** וְהַפְּגָם הַשֵּׁנִי **And the second blemish, partaking of his feast,** שֶׁנֶּהֱנוּ מִסְּעוּדָּתוֹ הָיָה בְּשׁוּשָׁן[1186] **was in Shushan,** וְהַיְינוּ בְּרַבָּנָן וְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים שֶׁהָיוּ כּוּלָּם בִּסְעוּדָּה זוֹ **that is, among the Rabbis and talmidei chachamim, who were all at this feast** מְפְּנֵי שֶׁהֻכְנוּ לָהֶם מַאֲכָלִים כְּשֵׁרִים עַל פִּי מָרְדֳּכַי **because there were prepared for them kosher foods under Mordechai's direction,** (שָׁם) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ **as is expounded (there):** [אֶסְתֵּר א, ח] לַעֲשׂוֹת כִּרְצוֹן אִישׁ וְאִישׁ **"To do according to the will of every man" (Esther 1:8) —** וְכוּ' כִּרְצוֹן מָרְדֳּכָי[1187] **according to the will of Mordechai, etc.;** וְהָיוּ מוּכְרָחִים לָזֶה **and they were compelled to this** בְּמִצְוַת הַמֶּלֶךְ **by the King's command,** וְלֹא הָיָה שׁוּם אִיסּוּר בַּדָּבָר. **and there was no prohibition at all in the matter.** רַק מִצַּד שֶׁנֶּהֱנוּ מִסְּעוּדָּתוֹ דַּיְיקָא **It was only that they "partook of" his feast, precisely —** וְלֹא אָמְרוּ שֶׁאָכְלוּ. **and they did not say that they "ate";** וְזֶה בָּא עַל יְדֵי עַצְלוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **and this came through sloth in words of Torah,** כִּי מִי שֶׁדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה נְקְשָׁרִים בְּלִבּוֹ **for one in whose heart the words of Torah are bound** אֵינֶנּוּ מַרְגִּישׁ בַּהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף **does not feel bodily pleasure** בִּסְעוּדַּת הָרְשׁוּת.[1188] **at a non-mitzvah meal.** וְעַל זֶה הַפְּגָם **And regarding this blemish** הִשְׂכִּילָה אֶסְתֵּר **Esther understood** בְּתִיקּוּן דָּבָר זֶה **how to rectify this matter:** לַעֲשׂוֹת בְּשׁוּשָׁן **to act in Shushan** גַּם לְמָחָר כְּדַת הַיּוֹם. **also tomorrow according to today's decree.** (שַׁבָּת פח, א) וְהִנֵּה אָמְרוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **Now our Sages said (Shabbos 88a)** שֶׁבְּשָׁעַת מַתַּן תּוֹרָה **that at the time of Matan Torah** קָשְׁרוּ לְכָל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **they tied for each one of Yisrael** שְׁנֵי כְתָרִים **two crowns,** אֶחָד כְּנֶגֶד נַעֲשֶׂה **one corresponding to "we will do"** וְאֶחָד כְּנֶגֶד נִשְׁמַע.[1189] **and one corresponding to "we will hear."** **"We will do"** הוּא מַעֲשֶׂה הַמִּצְוֹת בְּפוֹעַל **is the actual performance of the mitzvos,** וְנִשְׁמַע הוּא לִהְיוֹת הַלֵּב שׁוֹמֵעַ לִדְבְרֵי תּוֹרָה **and "we will hear" is engagement in Torah,** הֶעֱסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה **that the heart should**

[1186] **Ezekiel 37:25** — "They shall dwell upon the land that I gave to My servant Yaakov, where your fathers dwelt; they, their children, and their children's children shall dwell upon it forever, and David My servant shall be their prince forever." The preceding verse 37:24 also calls David "king over them." Rav Tzadok focuses here on the designation nasi, prince, to explain human elevation that remains subordinate to the revealed kingship of God.

[1187] **I Samuel 8:7** — "Hashem said to Shmuel: Listen to the people's voice in all that they say to you, for it is not you whom they have rejected; it is Me whom they have rejected from reigning over them." The rebuke concerns the people's demand for a king in that episode. Rav Tzadok places it alongside the Torah's authorization of human kingship and explains the future prince's relation to God's sovereignty.

[1188] **Daniel 7:13** — "I was watching in the visions of the night, and behold, one like a human being was coming with the clouds of heaven. He reached the Ancient of Days, and they brought him near before Him." The verse supplies the movement toward the Ancient of Days. Rav Tzadok uses it in describing the elevation of the future prince toward the concealed divine root.

[1189] **Deuteronomy 17:15** — "You shall surely set over yourself a king whom Hashem your God chooses. From among your brothers shall you set a king over yourself; you may not place over yourself a foreign man who is not your brother." The Torah establishes the appointment and its restrictions. Rav Tzadok's wording here explains the authorized place of an earthly king within his distinction between present and future divine kingship.

listen to words of Torah. (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כז, ט) וְאָמְרוּ **And they said (Shemos Rabbah 27:9):** מָשָׁל וְכוּ׳ **A parable, etc.:** שְׁנֵי כוֹסוֹת מְזַגְתֶּם בְּסִינַי נַעֲשֶׂה וְנִשְׁמָע **"You mixed two cups at Sinai, 'we will do' and 'we will hear';** כָּךְ אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **So said the Holy One, blessed is He:** שְׁבַרְתֶּם נַעֲשֶׂה וְכוּ׳ **you broke 'we will do,'" etc.** הִזָּהֲרוּ בְּנִשְׁמָע. **"Be careful with 'we will hear.'"** כִּי הַכְּתָר שֶׁל נִשְׁמָע **For the crown of "we will hear"** נִשְׁאַר לָנוּ **remained ours through engagement in Torah;** עַל יְדֵי עֵסֶק הַתּוֹרָה וְעַל זֶה נִתְפַּשֵּׁט הַמִּנְהָג בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **and on this basis the custom spread in Yisrael** לִלְבּוֹשׁ בְּשַׁבָּת עַל הָרֹאשׁ **to wear on Shabbos on the head** כּוֹבַע מְשֻׁנֶּה בְּתָאֳרָהּ **a hat distinct in its form** מֵאוֹתָהּ שֶׁלּוֹבְשִׁים בִּימֵי הַחוֹל **from the one worn on weekdays,** וְהִיא מַקֶּפֶת הָרֹאשׁ **which encircles the head** כְּעֵין עֲטָרָה **like a crown;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בִּשְׁאָר הַבְּגָדִים **which is not so with the other garments,** רַק בְּמַה שֶּׁלּוֹבְשִׁים בְּגָדִים חֲשׁוּבִים יוֹתֵר **only in that they wear finer garments,** שֶׁמַּחֲלִיפִין אוֹתָם **which they change** וְלֹא בְּתְמוּנָה אַחֶרֶת מִיּוּחֶדֶת לְשַׁבָּת. **and not in a different form specific to Shabbos.** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהַכּוֹבַע יְרֵמֹז **This is because the hat alludes** עַל כֶּתֶר תּוֹרָה **to the crown of Torah** שֶׁנִּתַּן לָנוּ בְּשַׁבָּת **that was given to us on Shabbos** מִצַּד נִשְׁמָע כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **from the aspect of "we will hear," as mentioned above.** וְעַל סָמְךָ זֶה יֵשׁ נוֹהֲגִין **And based on this, some have the custom** לִלְבּוֹשׁ עַל הָרֹאשׁ **to wear on the head** גַּם בְּט״ו אֲדָר **also on the fifteenth of Adar** כּוֹבַע זוֹ שֶׁל שַׁבָּת **this Shabbos hat,** וְהוּא לְרַמֵּז דְּבָרֵינוּ הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל **and it is to allude to our words above,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבְּשׁוּשָׁן נִפְעַל בּוֹ הַנֵּס **because in Shushan the miracle was effected on it** עַל הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת הַנִּשְׁמָע בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **for the renewal of "we will hear" in words of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ [שַׁבָּת שָׁם] הָדַר קִבְּלוּהָ **as they said (Shabbos, ibid.): "They accepted it anew** בִּימֵי אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ מֵאַהֲבַת הַנֵּס. **in the days of Achashverosh, out of love for the miracle."** וּבְיִחוּד בְּיוֹם זֶה **And especially on this day,** יוֹם טוֹב שֶׁל שׁוּשָׁן **the Yom Tov of Shushan,** שֶׁהָיָה הַתִּיקּוּן עַל הַקִּלְקוּל **which was the rectification of the flaw** שֶׁל הָעַצְלוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **of sloth in words of Torah,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַמְּחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **And through the eradication of Amalek** מָחָר **on the morrow,** הוּחְזַר לָנוּ הַכֶּתֶר שֶׁל נִשְׁמָע **the crown of "we will hear" was restored to us,** עַל פִּי דְּבָרֵינוּ הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל: **according to our words above.**

שׁוּשַׁן פּוּרִים, מַאֲמָר ב׳ Shushan Purim — Maamar Bais

עַל כֵּן קָרְאוּ לַיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה **"Therefore they called these days** [אֶסְתֵּר ט, כו][1190] פּוּרִים עַל שֵׁם הַפּוּר. **Purim, after the name of the Pur" (Esther 9:26).** כְּבָר דְּקְדַּקְנוּ **We have already examined closely** לָמָּה קָרְאוּ הַיּוֹם **why they named the day** עַל שֵׁם הַגּוֹרָל **after the lot** וְלֹא עַל שֵׁם הַנֵּס **and not after the miracle** (כְּמוֹ בִּשְׁאָר מוֹעֲדִים **(as with the other festivals,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל פּוּרִים מַאֲמָר ו׳). **as mentioned above, Purim, maamar 6).** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר הָעִנְיָן **And one may explain the matter:** דְּאִיתָא (סַנְהֶדְרִין מג, ב) **for it is stated (Sanhedrin 43b)** בְּעָכָן שֶׁאָמַר **regarding Achan, that** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **the Holy One, blessed be He, said:** וְכִי דִּילָטוֹר אֲנִי לְךָ **"Am I then an informer for you?** וְהַפֵּל גּוֹרָלוֹת וְכוּ׳. **Cast lots," and so on.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **And this needs to be understood:** מַאי נָפְקָא מִינָּהּ **what difference does it make?** הָא הַגּוֹרָל גַּם כֵּן **For the lot too** עַל פִּי ה׳ **is by the word of Hashem,** וְלֹא בְּמִקְרֶה חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. **and not by chance, chas v'shalom.** דְּאִם לֹא כֵּן **For if it were not so,** מָה אָמַר לוֹ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **what did Yehoshua say to him?** בְּבַקָּשָׁה מִמְּךָ **"I beg of you,** אַל תּוֹצִיא לַעַז **do not cast aspersion** וְכוּ׳ עַל הַגּוֹרָלוֹת.[1191] **upon the lots," and so on.** וְאִם הָיָה בְּמִקְרֶה **And if it were by chance,** הָיָה טַעֲנַת עָכָן **Achan's claim** טַעֲנָה טוֹבָה **would have been a good claim.** אֶלָּא עַל כָּרְחָךְ **Rather, perforce,** שֶׁהָיָה הַגּוֹרָל עַל פִּי ה׳ **the lot was by the word of Hashem,** [מִשְׁלֵי טז, לג] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Mishlei 16:33):** בַּחֵיק יוּטַל הַגּוֹרָל **"The lot is cast into the lap,** וּמֵה׳ כָּל מִשְׁפָּטוֹ. **but its every decision is from Hashem."** וְכֵן מְפוֹרָשׁ בַּפְּסוּקִים **And so it is explicit in the verses:** [יְהוֹשֻׁעַ ז, יד] וְהָיָה הַשֵּׁבֶט **(Yehoshua 7:14) "And the tribe** אֲשֶׁר יִלְכְּדֶנּוּ ה׳ וְגוֹמֵר **which Hashem shall take," etc.,** וְהַמִּשְׁפָּחָה **"and the family** אֲשֶׁר יִלְכְּדֶנָּה ה׳ וְגוֹמֵר **which Hashem shall take," etc.,** וְהַבַּיִת **"and the household** אֲשֶׁר יִלְכְּדֶנּוּ ה׳ וְגוֹמֵר **which Hashem shall take," etc.** — הַכֹּל בְּשֵׁם הֲוָי״ה[1192] **all of it with the Name Havayah.** וּמַה נָּפְקָא מִינָּהּ **So what difference would it make** אִם הָיָה ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **whether Hashem Yisbarach** אוֹ שֶׁצִּוָּהוּ לְהַפִּיל גּוֹרָלוֹת **or commanded him to cast lots** עַל פִּי ה׳. **by the word of Hashem?** אַךְ בֶּאֱמֶת מָצִינוּ בַּתּוֹרָה **But in truth we find in the Torah** מִצְוַת גּוֹרָל **the mitzvah of the lot** בִּשְׁעִירֵי יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **with the goats of Yom Kippur,** אַף דִּשְׁנֵיהֶן שָׁוִין **even though the two are equal** בְּמַרְאֶה וּבְקוֹמָה וּבְדָמִים **in appearance, in height and in value** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁפָּתוּב יוֹמָא (סב, א) **(as stated in Yoma 62a);** וְלָמָּה הוּצְרַךְ הַגּוֹרָל **so why was the lot needed** — יִקַּח הַכֹּהֵן **let the Kohen take** אֶחָד לַה׳ וְאֶחָד לַעֲזָאזֵל.[1193] **one for Hashem and one for Azazel!** אֲכָן הַשָּׂעִיר לַעֲזָאזֵל **Indeed, regarding the goat for Azazel** אִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סה, טו) **it is stated (Bereishis Rabbah 65:15):** [וַיִּקְרָא טז, כב] וְנָשָׂא הַשָּׂעִיר **"And the goat shall bear" (Vayikra 16:22)** — זֶה עֵשָׂו אִישׁ שָׂעִיר **this is Esav, "a hairy man";** [שָׁם] אֶת כָּל עֲוֹנֹתָם **"all their iniquities" (ibid.)** — עֲוֹנוֹת תָּם **the iniquities of the tam, the wholesome one.** וְהוּא שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ מְבָרֵר **That is, Hashem Yisbarach clarifies** שֶׁהוּא הַחַיָּיב **that he is the one culpable** בְּכָל חַטָּאֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **for all the sins of Yisrael,** נִכְנַס גַּם בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל **there entered also into the heart of Yisrael** שֶׁנִּמְצָא בּוֹ בְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ **found in him at the root** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי הָרַע **for through the evil** הַשְׂאוֹר שֶׁבָּעִיסָּה. **the leaven in the dough.** וּכְתִיב [מַלְאָכִי א, ב] הֲלוֹא

[1190] **Isaiah 33:22** — "For Hashem is our judge, Hashem is our lawgiver, Hashem is our king; He will save us." The three titles ground Rav Tzadok's distinction between the Written Torah, the Oral Torah's judges, and royal judgment, whose ultimate unification reveals divine salvation.

[1191] Parallel: **Derashos HaRan, discourse 11:3–4** — "The Holy One assigned each of these matters to a distinct group. He commanded that judges be appointed to judge the judgment that is truly just. ... Since the civil order would not be perfected by this alone, God completed its arrangement through the commandment of the king. ... The king can judge without prior warning according to what he sees the political community requires. Thus the appointment of the king is shared by Israel and the other nations, who require civil order, while the appointment of the judges is especially necessary in Israel."

Connection: The Ran gives the precise institutional distinction presupposed here: Torah courts judge according to the Torah's judicial requirements, while royal authority can address the community's practical needs beyond those procedures. This clarifies why Rav Tzadok lists judge, lawgiver, and king as distinct functions before describing their unification in God. The Ran's civil explanation does not itself supply Rav Tzadok's mystical identification of the final salvation with Atika.

[1192] **Ezekiel 46:1** — "Thus says the Lord Hashem: The gate of the inner court that faces east shall be closed during the six working days, but on the Shabbos day it shall open, and on the day of the new moon it shall open." The verse names Shabbos and the new moon as the times of opening. Rav Tzadok asks why the festivals, discussed in the preceding prophecy, are not also named here.

[1193] **Isaiah 66:23** — "It shall be, from new moon to new moon, and from Shabbos to Shabbos, that all flesh shall come to bow before Me, says Hashem." The repeated specification of month and Shabbos parallels the opening in Yechezkel. Rav Tzadok reads the renewed sanctity as reaching bodily experience, not only the soul.

אָח עֵשָׂו **And it is written (Malachi 1:2): "Is not Esav a brother** לְיַעֲקֹב וָאוֹהֵב אֶת יַעֲקֹב **to Yaakov? Yet I loved Yaakov" —** וְהַיְינוּ אַף שֶׁנִּדְמֶה חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **meaning, even though, chas v'shalom, he appears** בְּמַעֲשָׂיו לְמַעֲשֵׂה עֵשָׂו **in his deeds like the deeds of Esav,** וְכֵן אִם מִתְנַהֵג עֵשָׂו **and likewise if Esav conducts himself outwardly, to the eye, like Yaakov,** בְּנִגְלֶה לְמַרְאֵה עַיִן כְּיַעֲקֹב **Hashem Yisbarach judges the hearts** ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ דָּן אֶת הַלְּבָבוֹת **and clarifies that Yisrael are bound** וּמְבָרֵר שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים **at the root to Hashem Yisbarach,** בְּשׁוּרֶשׁ בַּה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **which is not so with Esav.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן עֵשָׂו. **And for this a lot is needed,** וְלָזֶה נִצְרָךְ גּוֹרָל **which indicates the Supernal Will.** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל רָצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן **For whatever comes through prophecy** דְּכָל שֶׁבָּא בִּנְבוּאָה הוּא הָאָרָה בְּדַעַת הַנָּבִיא **is an illumination in the mind of the prophet,** [בַּמִּדְבָּר יב, ו] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Bamidbar 12:6):** בַּמַּרְאָה אֵלָיו אֶתְוַדָּע. **"In a vision I make Myself known to him."** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן הַגּוֹרָל **Not so the lot,** וְאֵין לְדַעַת הַמַּגְרִיל מֵעַתִּיקָא **from Atika,** שֶׁהוּא רַק מֵרָצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן **which is solely from the Supernal Will, and the mind of the one casting it** חֵלֶק בּוֹ.[1194] **has no share in it.** וְזֶה טַעַם מְצוַת הַגּוֹרָלוֹת **And this is the reason for the mitzvah of the lots** בִּשְׂעִירֵי יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים. **with the goats of Yom Kippur.** וְכֵן הָעִנְיָן בְּעָכָן **And so too the matter with Achan:** אִם הָיָה ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ מְגַלֶּה **had Hashem Yisbarach revealed** שֶׁהוּא הַחוֹטֵא **that he was the sinner,** נֶגֶד רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ. **against His will, yisbarach.** הָיָה מוֹרֶה שֶׁעָשָׂה חֵטְא **it would indicate that he had committed a sin** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **And about this He said,** וְכִי דִּילָטוֹר אֲנִי. **"Am I then an informer?"** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן כְּשֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה **Not so when it was revealed** עַל יְדֵי הַגּוֹרָל שֶׁהוּא מֵעַתִּיקָא **through the lot, which is from Atika,** שֶׁהוּא עָכָן עָשָׂה **that he, Achan, had done the deed.** דְּשָׁם מְבָרֵר שָׁם לֹא נִקְרָא חֵטְא כְּלָל **There it is not called a sin at all,** חֲטָאֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **for there Hashem Yisbarach clarifies the sins of Yisrael** אַחַר שֶׁעוֹשִׂין תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה. **after they do teshuvah out of love.** שֶׁכֵּן לְכַתְּחִלָּה **For from the outset** הָיָה רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **it was His will, yisbarach, that first there be darkness** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בְּרֵישָׁא חֲשׁוֹכָא **and afterward light,** וַהֲדַר נְהוֹרָא **for there is no light** דְּלֵית נְהוֹרָא אֶלָּא הַהוּא חֲשׁוֹכָא **except that** דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא **which emerges from within the darkness** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב (קפד, א) **(as stated in Zohar II 184a).** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ (שַׁבָּת פט, ב) **And as we have said,** שֶׁזֶּה מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **that this is what they said (Shabbos 89b):** אִם יִהְיוּ חֲטָאֵיכֶם כַּשָּׁנִים **"If your sins be like the years —** הַלָּלוּ שֶׁסִּדּוּרוֹת וּבָאוֹת **these that are arranged and come** מִשֵּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית **from the six days of Creation —** כַּשֶּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ **they shall become white as snow,"** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כִּזְכִיּוֹת. **that they become like merits.** וְעַל כֵּן לֹא נֶחְשַׁב דְּלֹטוֹרְיָא.[1195] **And therefore it is not considered informing.** [יְהוֹשֻׁעַ שָׁם, יא] וְכֵן כָּתוּב שָׁם **And likewise it is written there (Yehoshua, ibid. 11):** חָטָא יִשְׂרָאֵל **"Yisrael has sinned,"** (סַנְהֶדְרִין מד, א) שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ **which is expounded (Sanhedrin 44a):** אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁחָטָא **even though he sinned,** יִשְׂרָאֵל הוּא[1196] **he is Yisrael.** וְרָמְזוּ שָׁם בַּגְּמָרָא עָלָיו **And there the Gemara alluded in him** כָּל שָׁרְשֵׁי הַחֲטָאִים הַחֲמוּרִים **to all the roots of the grave sins,** רַחֲמָנָא לִיצְלַן. **may the Merciful One save us —** לְלַמֵּד שֶׁבְּכָל הָאוֹפָנִים **to teach that in every circumstance,** כָּל שֶׁהוּא מִזֶּרַע יַעֲקֹב **whoever is of the seed of Yaakov,** לֹא יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח. **"no banished one shall be banished from Him."** וְכֵן אָמַר לוֹ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ לְעָכָן [יְהוֹשֻׁעַ שָׁם, כה] **And so Yehoshua said to Achan (Yehoshua, ibid. 25):** בַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה אַתָּה עָכוּר וְאִי אַתָּה עָכוּר לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא[1197] **"On this day you are troubled, but you are not troubled in the World to**

[1194] **Midrash Tanchuma, Pinchas 15** — "It would have been fitting for the assembly after Sukkos to be fifty days after the festival, just as the assembly after Pesach is fifty days later. But the Holy One, blessed be He, said: 'It is winter, and they cannot leave their homes to come here. Instead, while they are with Me, let them hold the assembly.'" The Midrash explains Shemini Atzeres by the difficulty of returning in winter. Rav Tzadok invokes this as an example of the burden of travel in the present order of things.

[1195] **Pesikta Rabbati 1** — "How can all flesh come to Jerusalem every month and every Shabbos? Rabbi Levi said: Jerusalem is destined to be like the Land of Israel, and the Land of Israel like the whole world. How will they come on the new moon and Shabbos from the end of the world? Clouds will come, carry them, and bring them to Jerusalem, and they will pray there in the morning. ... If the new moon falls on Shabbos, Rabbi Pinchas the priest, son of Chama, said in Rabbi Reuven's name: They come twice, once for Shabbos and once for the new moon. The clouds carry them early and bring them to Jerusalem. ... 'Who are these who fly like a cloud'—this is the morning; 'and like doves to their windows'—this is the afternoon." The checked chapter explicitly supplies both the effortless transport and the double coming. Its internal §3 is the manuscript's locator; the chapter text is the verified digital witness.

[1196] **Shabbat 119a** — "Rabbi Chanina would wrap himself and stand toward the evening of Shabbos. He said: 'Come, let us go out to meet Shabbos the queen.' Rabbi Yannai dressed in fine garments and said: 'Come, bride; come, bride.'" The Gemara provides the paired images of queen and bride. Rav Tzadok develops the bridal image as a fresh encounter with sanctity each Shabbos.

[1197] **Zohar II 76a, Yisro** — "When Adam was created, what is written of him? 'You clothed me in skin and flesh.' If so, what is the human being? If you say he is nothing but skin, flesh, bones, and sinews, it is not so, for the human being is certainly nothing but the soul. What are called skin, flesh, bones, and sinews are all only a garment: they are the

Come," שָׁם [סַנְהֶדְרִין] כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּשְׁנָה. **as they said in the Mishnah (Sanhedrin) there.** וְכָאן הָמָן מִתְּחִלָּה **But here, Haman at first** הֵטִיל גּוֹרָל **cast a lot** שֶׁהָיָה סוֹמֵךְ עַל הַמִּקְרֶה **because he relied on chance,** שֶׁזֶּה קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **for this is the kelipah of Amalek,** דִּכְתִיב [דְּבָרִים כה, יח] אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ **as it is written (Devarim 25:18), "who happened upon you" —** לְתְלוֹת הַכֹּל בְּמִקְרֶה. **to attribute everything to chance.** (אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ח, ה) וּבְמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **And in Midrash Rabbah (Esther Rabbah 8:5),** [אֶסְתֵּר ד, ז] עַל פָּסוּק אֵת כָּל אֲשֶׁר קָרָהוּ **on the verse "all that had happened to him" (Esther 4:7):** בֶּן בְּנוֹ שֶׁל קָרָהוּ **the grandson of "happened upon you"** [1198]בָּא עֲלֵיכֶם וְכוּ'. **has come upon you, and so on.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ כְּשֶׁנָּפַל עַל אֲדָר **And afterward, when it fell on Adar,** כְּמוֹ שָׂמַח **he rejoiced (as stated in Megillah 13b),** שֶׁהָיָה סָבוּר **for he supposed** שֶׁה' יִהְיֶה בְּעֶזְרוֹ **that Hashem would be at his aid,** חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. **chs v'shalom.** [אֶסְתֵּר ג, ז] הִפִּיל פּוּר וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what is said (Esther 3:7): "He cast pur,** הוּא הַגּוֹרָל **that is, the lot."** וְלִפְשׁוּטוֹ דְּפוּר לְשׁוֹן פַּרְסִי **According to its plain sense, pur is a Persian word,** [1199]וּמְתַרְגְּמוֹ הוּא הַגּוֹרָל **and he translates it: "that is, the lot."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאֶבֶן עֶזְרָא [שָׁם] **But as the Ibn Ezra wrote (ibid.),** הָוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר **it should then have said** הוּא גּוֹרָל בְּלֹא ה'. **"that is, a lot," without the heh.** אֶבֶל הַמְּכוּוָּן **Rather, the intent is** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת בְּעָכָן **that in truth, with Achan** אוֹ בַּחֲלוּקַת **or with the division of Eretz Yisrael,** אֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **where Yehoshua was the one casting the lot,** שֶׁהָיָה יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הַמַּטִיל גּוֹרָל **certainly the lot was** בְּוַדַּאי הָיָה הַגּוֹרָל **from Atika Kadisha, as mentioned above.** מֵעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **Not so here,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן כָּאן **where Haman was the one casting the lot:** דְּהָמָן הָיָה הַמַּטִיל גּוֹרָל **the verse says "he cast pur,"** אָמַר הַכָּתוּב הִפִּיל פּוּר **for he wanted to establish the matter** שֶׁהוּא רָצָה לְהַעֲמִיד הַדָּבָר **on chance;** עַל מִקְרֶה **but in truth "it is the lot"** אֶבֶל בֶּאֱמֶת הוּא הַגּוֹרָל **with the heh of definiteness —** בְּה' הַיְדִיעָה **the known lot from Atika,** הַגּוֹרָל הַיָּדוּעַ מֵעַתִּיקָא **the Supernal Will —** רָצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן **for in truth there was turned** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת נֶהְפַּךְ פּוּר הָמָן לְפוּרֵינוּ. **the pur of Haman into our Purim.** וְעִנְיַן מְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **And the eradication of Amalek** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא חֲדָשָׁה **as they said in the Pesikta Chadasha** (וְהוּבָא בְּיִלְקוּט בְּשַׁלַּח רֶמֶז רסה) **(and cited in the Yalkut, Beshalach, remez 265):** הִפִּיל עֲלֵיהֶן גּוֹרָלוֹת. **he cast lots upon them.** וַיַּחֲלֹשׁ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ [שְׁמוֹת יז, יג] **"And Yehoshua weakened" (Shemos 17:13) —** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁלִּמְחִיַּת עֲמָלֵק **That is, for the eradication of Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא רֹאשִׁית דְּקִלִיפָּה **who is the beginning of kelipah,** שֶׁהוּא מֵרָצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן מֵעַתִּיקָא **which is from the Supernal Will, from Atika,** רֹאשִׁית דְּקְדוּשָׁה **the beginning of holiness.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיַּחֲלֹשׁ **And this is what is said, "and he weakened,"** שֶׁהֵטִיל גּוֹרָלוֹת **meaning that he cast lots.** וּמַסְיק כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר **And it concludes, "as it says:** וְכַאֲשֶׁר יָטִילוּ חַלָּשִׁים **'and as they cast lots** עַל הַמָּנוֹת **over the portions'";** וְהוּא טָעוּת סוֹפֵר **but this is a scribal error,** וּמְטִילִין חַלָּשִׁים עַל הַקָּדָשִׁים **and it should read, "as it says:** וְצָרִיךְ לוֹמַר כְּמָה דְּאַתְּ אָמַר **'they cast lots over the sacred portions** בְּיוֹם טוֹב **on Yom Tov,** אֲבָל לֹא עַל הַמָּנוֹת **but not over the ordinary portions'" —** (קמח, ב) וְהוּא לְשׁוֹן הַמִּשְׁנָה בְּשַׁבָּת[1200]. **and this is the language of the Mishnah in Shabbos**

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human being's clothing, and are not the human being. When that human being departs, he strips off those garments in which he was clothed." The 76a marker occurs within this paragraph. The distinction between the inward person and bodily clothing underlies Rav Tzadok's emphasis that "all flesh" itself will receive the renewed holiness.

[1198] **Rosh Hashanah 4b** — "Rabbi Elazar said in Rabbi Oshaya's name: From where do we know that Shavuos has compensatory days for all seven days? Scripture says, 'On the festival of matzos, on the festival of Shavuos, and on the festival of Sukkos.' It compares Shavuos to the festival of matzos: Just as the festival of matzos has compensatory days for all seven days, so Shavuos has compensatory days for all seven days." This concerns the opportunity to bring the festival offerings after the first day. Rav Tzadok notes that the seven-day period consequently includes a Shabbos even when Shavuos itself falls on a weekday.

[1199] **Rosh Hashanah 16b** — "Rabbi Yitzchak said: A person must receive the presence of his teacher on the festival, as it is said: 'Why are you going to him today? It is neither new moon nor Shabbos.' This implies that on new moon and Shabbos she ought to go." The proof is from the question addressed to the Shunammite woman in II Melachim 4:23. Rav Tzadok distinguishes the festival obligation from the additional responsiveness of someone who perceives the renewed holiness of each month and Shabbos.

[1200] **Zohar III 265b, Vaeschanan** — "Rabbi Abba was coming from seeing Rabbi Shimon when Rabbi Yitzchak encountered him. He said: 'From where have you come, master of light, a man who cleaves to the fire that consumes every day? Light indeed rests with him.' He replied: 'We learned that a person is obligated to receive the presence of the Shechinah on every new moon and Shabbos. Who is this? His teacher. All the more so the supernal holy lamp, whose presence all people of the world seek to receive.' Rabbi Yitzchak said: 'I will return with you, receive the presence of the Shechinah, and taste those supernal words that you tasted before him.'" The exact Aramaic is verified in Vaeschanan 16:5. The preceding chapter 15 carries the Hebrew folio marker 265b, and the next chapter 17 carries 266a. The story explicitly joins receiving one's teacher to tasting Torah.

(148b). וּלְכאוֹרָה טָפֵי הֲוָה לֵיהּ לְהָבִיא **Seemingly, it would have been better to bring** דְּחָלָשׁ לְשׁוֹן גּוֹרָל **that chalash means "lot"** מִדִּכְתִיב [יְשַׁעְיָה יד, יב] חוֹלֵשׁ עַל גּוֹיִם **from what is written (Yeshayahu 14:12), "who casts lots over nations,"** דְּמִינָּה מַיְיתֵי בַּגְּמָרָא שָׁם **from which the Gemara there derives** דְּחַלָּשִׁים לִישָׁנָא דְּפוּרָא וְגוֹרָל. **that chalashim is a term for pur and lot.** רַק שָׁם בְּכָתוּב **Only, the verse there** מְיַירֵי בְּגוֹרָל **speaks of the lot** שֶׁהִפִּיל נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הָרָשָׁע **that the wicked Nevuchadnetzar cast** לְתַאֲוָתוֹ[1201] **for his own lust,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא שָׁם **as they said in the Gemara there;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן כָּאן **which is not so here,** שֶׁהָיָה הַגּוֹרָל עַל יְדֵי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ **where the lot was through Yehoshua,** שֶׁהוּצְרַךְ לְהַפִּיל גּוֹרָלוֹת **who needed to cast lots** כְּעִנְיַן גּוֹרָלוֹת **like the lots** דִּשְׂעִירֵי יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **of the goats of Yom Kippur,** כִּדְבָרֵינוּ הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל. **as in our words above.** וְעַל כֵּן הֵבִיא הַדִּמְיוֹן **Therefore it brought the comparison** מִלְּשׁוֹן הַמִּשְׁנָה **from the language of the Mishnah:** דְּמְטִילִין חֲלָשִׁים עַל הַקֳּדָשִׁים **"they cast lots over the sacred portions** בְּיוֹם טוֹב. **on Yom Tov."** וְאָמַר שָׁם בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And it says there in the Pesikta:** אַרְבָּעָה שֵׁמוֹת נִקְרְאוּ לַגּוֹרָל **Four names are given to the lot** — חֲלָשׁ פּוּר גּוֹרָל חֶבֶל **chalash, pur, goral, chevel** — וּבְכוּלָּם לָקוּ בְּנֵי עֵשָׂו **and through all of them the children of Esav were smitten.** בְּחֲלָשׁ לָקָה עֲמָלֵק **Through chalash Amalek was smitten,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיַּחֲלֵשׁ יְהוֹשֻׁעַ. **as it is said, "And Yehoshua weakened."** בְּגוֹרָל וּבְפוּר לָקָה הָמָן[1202] **Through goral and pur Haman was smitten,** וְכוּלֵי. **and so on.** וְהָעִנְיָן דְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ הַנָּחָשׁ **The matter is that the root of the serpent** — כְּמוֹ וְהוּא עֲמָלֵק יְצִרָא בִּישָׁא **which is Amalek, the evil inclination,** בְּתַאֲוַת עִיקַּר פִּיתּוּיוֹ הָיָה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר (חֵלֶק ג קס, א) **as they said in the Zohar (III 160a): his main enticement was** לַהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף **for the pleasure of the body.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ הֵטִיל זוּהֲמָא בְּחַוָּה **And afterward he cast filth into Chavah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת קמו, א) **as they said (Shabbos 146a).** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה נַעֲשָׂה **And through this** אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן מָשׁוּךְ בְּעָרְלָתוֹ[1203] **Adam HaRishon became one who drew his foreskin,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סַנְהֶדְרִין לח, ב) **as they said (Sanhedrin 38b),** וְגָרַם פְּגַם **and he caused the blemish** מֵאָה וּשְׁלֹשִׁים שָׁנָה **of the hundred and thirty years;** וּמִזֶּה נִדְבְּקָה הַזּוּהֲמָא בְּזַרְעָהּ. **and from this the filth clung to her offspring.** וְהִנֵּה **Now, the accusation of Amalek** קִטְרוּג עֲמָלֵק הָיָה עַל קְדוּשַׁת הַבְּרִית **was against the holiness of the bris,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא [תֵּצֵא י] שֶׁזֶּה **as we have said many times, that this is what they said in Midrash Tanchuma (Tetzei 10):** שֶׁהָיָה חוֹתֵךְ מִילוֹתֵיהֶם **that he would cut off their circumcised organs** וְזוֹרְקָן כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה וְכוּלֵי **and fling them heavenward, and so on** — לְקַטְרֵג עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר **to accuse regarding what is said** [יְשַׁעְיָה ס, כא] וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים **(Yeshayahu 60:21), "And your people are all righteous,"** דְּכָל מַאן דְּאִתְגְּזַר **since whoever is circumcised** [זֹהַר הַקְדּוּשׁ חֵלֶק א צג, א][1204] **is called a tzaddik (Zohar I 93a);** וְהוּא אָמַר שֶׁגַּם בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **and he said that even in Yisrael** יֵשׁ שֶׁפּוֹגְמִים בִּקְדוּשָּׁה זוֹ **there are those who blemish this holiness,** אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁהֵם מוּלִים **even though they are circumcised** — וְטוֹל מַה שֶּׁבָּחַרְתָּ. **"so take what You have chosen."** וְהָמָן מִזַּרְעוֹ **And Haman, of his seed,** בָּא לְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **came to accuse Yisrael** בְּשׁוֹרֶשׁ תְּחִלַּת הַסָּתַת הַנָּחָשׁ **at the root of the serpent's first enticement,** שֶׁהָיָה בַּאֲכִילָה **which was through**

[1201] **Pesachim 96a** — "Rav Yosef taught: There were three altars there—upon the lintel and upon the two doorposts—and there was nothing else." The discussion concerns the blood of the Pesach offering in Egypt and whether any portion belonged on an altar. The lintel and two doorposts provide the three places of application to which Rav Tzadok refers.

[1202] **Zohar III 29b, Tzav** — "So Torah scholars, the children of the King and the Queen, are called Shabbosos and festivals. They have nothing of their own, for they are not craftsmen like the other servants, the children of the ordinary weekdays. Their reward in this world and the world to come is that they be delighted with every kind of food and drink and honored with fine garments, like Shabbos, of which it is said: 'Honor it with clean clothing.' Everything a person does for Shabbosos and festivals he must do for them." The 29b marker stands in the preceding paragraph. The analogy here is stated through the scholars' sacred status and the honor given them; Rav Tzadok develops the correspondence through the Shechinah's dwelling.

[1203] **Tikkunei Zohar 22b** — "When the Shechinah is in exile, it is said of her, 'The dove found no resting place,' except on Shabbos and festivals. At that time she unites with her husband, and many additional souls descend with her to dwell in Israel. This is what is written: 'The children of Israel shall keep Shabbos ... for their generations.' Fortunate is one who prepares for her a beautiful dwelling in his heart, beautiful vessels in his limbs, and a beautiful wife, which is his soul; on its account the supernal Shechinah, the soul of all living, rests upon him." The passage interprets ledorosam through the language of dwelling. It gives the heart, limbs, and soul as the human setting of that dwelling, which Rav Tzadok places alongside the physical Sanctuary.

[1204] **Zohar I 31b, Bereishis** — "Rabbi Yosei said: What is meant by 'Which has gods near to it'? Should it not have said 'near' in the singular? Rather: the supernal Elokim, the Elokim of the fear of Yitzchak, and the final Elokim. Therefore it says 'near' in the plural. There are many mighty powers that emerge from one, and all are one." The 31b marker occurs earlier in the chapter. The Zohar distinguishes several applications of the same divine name while maintaining their unity. Rav Tzadok invokes the final application in speaking of the indwelling attribute.

eating, [יב, אֶסְתֵּר רַבָּה ז, יב] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **as they said in Midrash Rabbah (Esther Rabbah 7:12)** עַל [אֶסְתֵּר ג, ח] פָּסוּק יֶשְׁנוֹ עַם אֶחָד **on the verse "There is a certain people" (Esther 3:8):** שִׁנֵּיהוֹן רַבְרְבִין **their teeth are large,** שֶׁאוֹכְלִין וְשׁוֹתִין **for they eat and drink** וְאוֹמְרִים עוֹנֶג שַׁבָּת **and say, "It is oneg Shabbos,** עוֹנֶג יוֹם טוֹב דְּעִיקָּר קְטָרוּגוֹ הָיָה לְעֵילָּא **it is the delight of Yom Tov," and so on.** וְכוּלֵי. וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **And we have already said that his main accusation was Above,** שֶׁאֵין כַּוָּנָתָם לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם **that their intent is not l'shem Shamayim** לִפְנֵי ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **before Hashem Yisbarach,** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר פּוּרִים מַאֲמָר ז **(as explained in Purim, maamar 7,** וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **and elsewhere).** וְחָשַׁב שָׁם כָּל סְעוּדוֹת מִצְוָה **And there he enumerated all the seudos mitzvah,** וְחָשַׁב חַד לְתָלָתִין יוֹמִין **and he counted "one in thirty days,** רֵישׁ יַרְחָא **the head of the month."** וּמִכָּאן יֵשׁ סָמֶךְ **And from here there is support** וּקְצָת רְאָיָה **and some proof** לְעִנְיַן סְעוּדַת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **regarding the Rosh Chodesh meal** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בִּפְרִי צַדִּיק לְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ כִּסְלָו מַאֲמָר א) **(explained in Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Kislev, maamar 1)** שֶׁהִיא סְעוּדַת מִצְוָה. **that it is a seudas mitzvah.** גַּם חָשַׁב בְּתִשְׁרֵי **He also counted in Tishrei:** רֵישׁ שַׁתָּא וְצוֹמָא רַבָּא וְכוּלֵי. **"the head of the year, and the Great Fast," and so on.** וּלְכָאוֹרָה לָמָּה חָשַׁב **Seemingly, why did he count** יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **Yom Kippur,** שֶׁאֵינוֹ זְמַן סְעוּדָה **which is not a time of feasting** רַק צוֹם. **but only a fast?** וְנִרְאֶה מִזֶּה **It appears from this** שֶׁהָיָה מוֹצָאֵי יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **that the night after Yom Kippur was** כְּיוֹם טוֹב **like a Yom Tov.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is based on what they said** (קֹהֶלֶת רַבָּה ט, ז) **(Koheles Rabbah 9:7)** עַל פָּסוּק [קֹהֶלֶת ט, ז] לֵךְ אֱכוֹל בְּשִׂמְחָה **on the verse "Go, eat in gladness" (Koheles 9:7):** שֶׁבְּמוֹצָאֵי יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **that on the night after Yom Kippur** יָצְתָה בַּת קוֹל[1205] **a Heavenly voice goes forth:** לֵךְ אֱכוֹל בְּשִׂמְחָה **"Go, eat in gladness** כְּבָר נִשְׁמְעָה תְּפִלָּתְכֶם **your prayer has already been heard"** (וְהוּבָא בָּרֹאשׁוֹנִים) **(and it is cited by the Rishonim).** וְהָיוּ נוֹהֲגִין **And they were accustomed** בְּמוֹצָאֵי יוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים **on the night after Yom Kippur** כְּיוֹם טוֹב **to treat it like a Yom Tov;** וְעַל כֵּן חָשַׁב גַּם כֵּן **and therefore he also counted** לְיוֹם הַכִּפּוּרִים. **under Yom Kippur.** וְהָיָה קִטְרוּג הָמָן **And Haman's accusation was** שֶׁעוֹשִׂין כָּל יְמֵיהֶם כַּחַגִּים **that they make all their days like festivals** וְאוֹמְרִים שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן **and say that it too** סְעוּדַת מִצְוָה **is a seudas mitzvah,** עַל דָּרְכָּךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said** (שַׁבָּת קיט, א) **(Shabbos 119a):** עֲבִידְנָא יוֹמָא טָבָא לְרַבָּנַן **"I make a festive day for the Rabbis"** בְּסִיּוּם מַסֶּכְתָּא.[1206] **at the completion of a tractate.** וְאָמַר שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת **And he said that in truth** כַּוָּנָתָם לַהֲנָאַת הַגּוּף. **their intent is the pleasure of the body.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (מְגִילָּה יג, ב) הַלָּשׁוֹן **And in the Gemara (Megillah 13b) the wording is** דְּמַפְקֵי לְכוּלָּא שַׁתָּא **that they pass the whole year** בְּשַׁהַ"י פַּהַ"י **with "ShaHaY PaHaY"** — שַׁבָּת הַיּוֹם פֶּסַח הַיּוֹם **"Shabbos today, Pesach today."** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁהַמְכַוְּנִין גַּם כֵּן **And one may say that this too refers** עַל הַסְּעוּדוֹת **to the meals;** וְעַל כֵּן זָכַר רַק שַׁבָּת וּפֶסַח **therefore he mentioned only Shabbos and Pesach,** וְלֹא זָכַר סוּכּוֹת **and did not mention Sukkos,** שֶׁהוּא שְׁמוֹנָה יָמִים. **which is eight days.** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבִּשְׁנֵיהֶם כְּתִיב בְּפֵירוּשׁ **For regarding both of them it is written explicitly** לְשׁוֹן אֲכִילָה **a term of eating:** דְּבִשַּׁבָּת כְּתִיב [שְׁמוֹת טז, כה] **for regarding Shabbos it is written (Shemos 16:25),** אִכְלוּהוּ הַיּוֹם **"Eat it today,"** וּמִשָּׁם יָלְפִינַן לִסְעוּדוֹת שַׁבָּת[1207] **and from there we derive the Shabbos meals** (שַׁבָּת קיז, ב); **(Shabbos 117b);** וּבְפֶסַח כְּתִיב [שְׁמוֹת יב, טו] **and regarding Pesach it is written (Shemos 12:15),** שִׁבְעַת יָמִים מַצּוֹת תֹּאכֵלוּ. **"Seven days you shall eat matzos."**

[1205] **Zohar I 172a, Vayishlach** — "'At the pace of the work'—what is the work? This is the mirror that does not shine, through which the work of the world is performed. 'Which is before me'—this is what is meant everywhere by 'from before Hashem.' 'And at the pace of the children'—this is the mystery of the cherubs, to show the mystery of faith to which he cleaved." The interpretation is of Yaakov's words in Bereishis 33:14. The non-shining mirror receives rather than originating its light; Rav Tzadok connects this receptive aspect with the divine action within creation. The preceding chapter 9 carries 172a.

[1206] **Yoma 72b** — "Rabbi Shmuel bar Nachmani said in Rabbi Yonasan's name: What is meant by 'Why is there a price in the fool's hand to acquire wisdom, while there is no heart'? Woe to the enemies of Torah scholars who occupy themselves with Torah but have no fear of Heaven. Rabbi Yannai proclaimed: Woe to one who has no courtyard, yet makes a gate for his courtyard!" "The enemies of Torah scholars" is the Gemara's indirect expression for the people being criticized. The exposition makes the absence of "heart" a lack of reverence despite learning, which is the connection Rav Tzadok requires.

[1207] **Zohar II 64a–b, Beshalach** — "Rabbi Abba said: There is a rock and there is a rock. From the side of the supernal rock another rock emerges. What is the supernal rock? The rock of all rocks. What is it? That which gave birth to Israel, as it is written, 'You weakened the Rock who bore you.' From the side of the supernal rock above, another rock emerges; from the side of the Mother, Gevurah emerges. ... 'Who can utter the mighty acts of Hashem?'—this includes the supernal Mother of all. Although she is not judgment, it is found from her side, for from her side Gevurah is found; therefore she is called the supernal rock." The wording crosses the embedded boundary from 64a into 64b. The distinction between the maternal source and the Gevurah emerging from it explains Rav Tzadok's distinction between the two rocks and two levels of reverence.

(פְּסָחִים קכ, א) וְאַף שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And although they said (Pesachim 120a),** מַה שְּׁבִיעִי רְשׁוּת **"Just as the seventh day is optional,** אַף שִׁשָּׁת יָמִים רְשׁוּת. **so too the six days are optional" —** מִכָּל מָקוֹם כֵּיוָן **nevertheless, since** שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בַּתּוֹרָה בְּפֵירוּשׁ **it is written in the Torah explicitly,** תֹּאכֵלוּ **"you shall eat,"** לֹא גָּרַע מִמַּה שֶׁמָּצִינוּ **it is no less than what we find** (שָׁם קיד, ב): **(there, 114b):** רָבָא הֲוָה מְהַדַּר **Rava would make a point of seeking** אַסִּילְקָא וַאֲרוּזָא **beets and rice,** הוֹאִיל וְנָפִיק **since it had come forth** מִפּוּמֵיהּ דְּרַב הוּנָא[1208] **from the mouth of Rav Huna;** וּכְעֵין זֶה (סוּכָּה לב, ב) **and similarly (Sukkah 32b),** רַב אַחָא בְּרֵיהּ דְּרָבָא **Rav Acha the son of Rava** מְהַדַּר וְכוּלֵּי **would make a point of seeking, and so on,** הוֹאִיל וְנָפִיק **since it had come forth** מִפּוּמֵיהּ דְּרַב כָּהֲנָא.[1209] **from the mouth of Rav Kahana.** כָּל שֶׁכֵּן כָּאן **All the more so here,** שֶׁנִּכְתַּב בְּפֵירוּשׁ בַּתּוֹרָה **where it is written explicitly in the Torah,** מַצּוֹת תֹּאכְלוּ **"you shall eat matzos"** — שֶׁיֵּשׁ מִצְוָה בַּאֲכִילַת מַצּוֹת **that there is a mitzvah in eating matzos** כָּל שִׁבְעָה יָמִים **all seven days;** אֶלָּא דְּמִצְוָה לְגַבֵּי חוֹבָה **only that a mitzvah, compared with the obligation** דְּלֵילָה רִאשׁוֹנָה **of the first night,** רְשׁוּת קָרֵי לֵיהּ.[1210] **is called "optional."** וְעַל כֵּן זָכַר שְׁתֵּי אֵלּוּ **And therefore he mentioned these two,** פֶּסַח וְשַׁבָּת **Pesach and Shabbos:** שֶׁתּוֹלִים כָּל הַשָּׁנָה **that they attribute the whole year** בְּסְעוּדַת מִצְוָה **to a seudas mitzvah,** כְּשַׁבָּת וּפֶסַח **like Shabbos and Pesach,** וּבֶאֱמֶת כַּנָּתָם **while in truth their intent** רַק לְתַאֲוַת הַגּוּף. **is only the lust of the body.** וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן **And this is the matter:** דִּלְמָחֵיית עֲמָלֵק **for the eradication of Amalek,** שֶׁהָיָה קִטְרוּגוֹ אָז **whose accusation then** בִּשְׁמִירַת הַבְּרִית. **concerned the guarding of the bris,** שֶׁבָּא מִיּוֹסֵף הַצַּדִּיק **who descended from Yosef HaTzaddik,** שֶׁהוּא מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת **who is a chariot for the attribute of** צַדִּיק יְסוֹד עוֹלָם. **"the tzaddik, foundation of the world."** וְלִמְחִיַּית עֲמָלֵק דְּהָמָן **And for the eradication of the Amalek of Haman,** שֶׁבָּא מִזַּרְעוֹ **who came from his seed** וְקִטְרֵג עַל פְּגַם הָאֲכִילָה **and accused regarding the blemish of eating,** רֵאשִׁית הֶסָּתַת הַנָּחָשׁ **the first enticement of the serpent,** הוּצְרַךְ לִהְיוֹת מָרְדְּכַי **it had to be Mordechai,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא רֹאשׁ לְכָל הַבְּשָׂמִים[1211] **that he is called the** (מְגִילָּה י, ב) **about whom they said (Megillah 10b)**

[1208] **Zohar II 118a, Mishpatim** — "Rise and awaken in judgments. The Faithful Shepherd opened: 'Adonai, open my lips, and my mouth shall declare Your praise.' Adonai, with its letters rearranged, is dina, judgment. Therefore the masters of the Mishnah said: 'The law of kingship is law.' All judgments are judged through this name. ... The middle column is the true judge: he judges from the side of Adonai, where he is the true judge; from the side of the name Elokim, he is called judge, as it is written, 'For Elokim is judge.'" The 118a marker occurs in the preceding chapter 14. The exact rearrangement of the divine name into dina is explicit; Rav Tzadok uses it to explain the royal aspect's relation to judgment.

[1209] **Maamar Kedishin, attributed to the Arizal, on the twelve simple letters** — "Hei: on the right hand, the little finger, inner joint; it goes through the channel from Keser to Chochmah, is given to Yehudah, and reigns over speech; it created Aries in the world and Nissan in the year.... Kuf: on the right hand, the thumb, outer joint; it goes through the channel from Binah to Chesed, is given to Naftali, and reigns over laughter; it created Pisces in the world, Adar in the year, and the spleen in the soul." The work assigns the months in the order of the banners: Nissan to Yehudah, Iyar to Yissachar, Sivan to Zevulun, Tammuz to Reuven, Av to Shimon, Elul to Gad, Tishrei to Ephraim, Cheshvan to Menasheh, Kislev to Binyamin, Teves to Dan, Shevat to Asher, and Adar to Naftali. HaGra on Sefer Yetzirah 5:3 reports the same scheme: "But in the writings of the Arizal he wrote laughter for Naftali and walking for Zevulun, and in place of Levi he wrote Menasheh; and it is all one, so that the tribes come in the order of the banners. And a proof for the words of the Arizal: 'Rejoice, Zevulun, in your going out' ... 'Naftali, satisfied with favor' — that is laughter." The Gra also cites the work by name in his commentary on Sefer Yetzirah 1:1 ("see Maamar Kedishin of the Arizal"). Further parallel: R. Yosef Gikatilla, Sha'arei Orah, Gate 5 (Tiferes) — "The twelve tribes of Yaakov's sons are divided into four banners: the first banner, Yehudah, Yissachar, Zevulun; the second, Reuven, Shimon, Gad; the third, Ephraim, Menasheh, Binyamin; the fourth, Dan, Asher, Naftali. These are the twelve months ... the first season Nissan, Iyar, Sivan ... the fourth season Teves, Shevat, Adar." Read together, the two lists assign Adar to Naftali. Shem MiShmuel, Kedoshim, transmits the same correspondence as the Arizal's: "According to the order of the Arizal, the months follow the order of the banners: Nissan to Yehudah, Iyar to Yissachar, Sivan to Zevulun." Maamar Kedishin is the "commentary of the Arizal on Sefer Yetzirah" that Rav Tzadok quotes in Rosh Chodesh Adar Sheni, maamar 2, and its Kuf entry is the passage he cites there word for word.

[1210] **Ein Yaakov, Taanis 29a** — "Rav Yehudah, son of Rav Shmuel bar Shilas, said in Rav's name: Just as, when Av enters, we reduce joy, so, when Adar enters, we reduce mourning and increase joy." The Vilna text of Taanis 29a reads only "so, when Adar enters, we increase joy" (מַרְבִּין בְּשִׂמְחָה). The Ein Yaakov adds the words "we reduce mourning" (מְמַעֲטִין בְּאֵבֶל) before "and increase joy," and spells the verb מרבים. The Glick edition of Ein Yaakov follows the Bavli and lacks the addition. Rav Tzadok quotes the Ein Yaakov reading and then explains which mourning is meant.

[1211] **Zohar III 258a, Pinchas (Raaya Mehemna)** — "The tefillin of the Master of the world are Keser. And what is the Keser of the Master of the world? Havayah: Yud is Chochmah, Hei is Binah, Vav is Tiferes, which comprises six sefiros, and Hei is Malchus." The four letters thus include the nine attributes from Chochmah to Malchus, and Keser is the crown above them. Rav Tzadok then refers the tip of the Yud to Keser, from Zohar III 65b.

head of all the spices; רֹאשִׁית דְּקְלִיפָּה. **and he is prepared to uproot** וְהוּא מוּכָן לַעֲקוֹר **the beginning of kelipah.** שֶׁהוּא מִבְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **And in both it had to come** וּבִשְׁנֵיהֶם הוּצְרַךְ לִהְיוֹת **through a lot,** עַל יְדֵי גּוֹרָל **which is from the aspect of Atika,** רָצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן. **the Supernal Will.** רַק דְּשָׁם יְהוֹשֻׁעַ הִגְרִיל **Only, there Yehoshua cast the lot** וְעַל כֵּן נִקְרָא הַגּוֹרָל **to arouse the eradication of** לְעוֹרֵר לְמֶחוֹת שְׁלָהֶם. הָרֹאשׁ וְהַשׁוֹרֶשׁ **their head and root.** שָׁם **Therefore the lot there is called** בִּלְשׁוֹן חָלָשׁ **by the term chalash,** מִלְּשׁוֹן חוֹלֵשׁ עַל גּוֹיִים **as in "who casts lots over nations,"** שֶׁהוּא כְּפִי הַנִּרְאֶה **which apparently is** גּוֹרָל בִּלְשׁוֹן אוּמּוֹת **"lot" in the language of the nations;** שֶׁלֹּא מָצִינוּ לוֹ חָבֵר **for we do not find for it a counterpart** בַּתַּנַ"ךְ **in Tanach** מִלְּשׁוֹן גּוֹרָל **in the sense of a lot,** וּמִסְתָּמָא בְּאֵיזוֹ לָשׁוֹן **and presumably in some language** נִקְרָא הַגּוֹרָל חָלָשׁ. **the lot is called chalash.** וְהוּא מִפְּנֵי שֶׁרָצָה **And this is because he wished** לִבְגּוֹעַ וְלִמְחוֹק **to strike and wipe out** הָרֹאשׁ דְּקְלִיפָּה **the head of the kelipah.** וְכֵן פֵּירוּשׁ וַיַּחֲלֹשׁ בִּפְשׁוּטוֹ **And so "and he weakened," in its plain sense, means** שֶׁהֶחֱלִישׁ כֹּחַ עֲמָלֵק **that he weakened the power of Amalek** שֶׁלֹּא יִתְפַּשֵּׁט כָּל כָּךְ **so that it should not spread so much;** וְעַל כֵּן נִזְכָּר הַגּוֹרָל **and therefore the lot is mentioned** בִּלְשׁוֹן אוּמּוֹת. **in the language of the nations.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן כָּאן **Which is not so here,** שֶׁבָּא הַזְּמַן **where the time came** לִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **to wipe out the memory of Amalek** וְלַעֲקוֹר שָׁרְשׁוֹ **and to uproot his root in his seed,** שֶׁהוּא הָמָן. **which is Haman.** וְהוּא הָמָן בְּעַצְמוֹ **And Haman himself** בְּזַרְעוֹ **made the lot,** עָשָׂה הַגּוֹרָל **only Hashem Yisbarach overturned it,** רַק ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ הֲפָכוֹ **so that the pur of Haman** לְהְיוֹת פּוּר הָמָן **was turned into our Purim** נֶהְפַּךְ לְפוּרֵינוּ — **a lot from Atika was needed.** הוּצְרַךְ לְגוֹרָל מֵעַתִּיקָא **And this is what is said, "he cast pur":** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הִפִּיל פּוּר **that Haman, for his part,** שֶׁהָמָן מִצִּדּוֹ **wanted to conduct things by chance —** רָצָה לְהִתְנַהֵג עַל פִּי מִקְרֶה **the lot in his own language;** הַגּוֹרָל בִּלְשׁוֹנוֹ **but in truth "it is the lot," the known one,** אֲבָל בֶּאֱמֶת הוּא שֶׁהוּא מֵרָצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן **which is from the Supernal Will,** הַגּוֹרָל הַיָּדוּעַ **from Atika, as mentioned above.** מֵעַתִּיקָא כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **And this is the matter of the mitzvah that comes,** (שָׁם ז, ב) דְּאִיתָא **as it is stated (there, 7b):** מִיחַיֵּיב אִינָשׁ לְבַסּוּמֵי **A person is obligated to become intoxicated** בְּפוּרְיָא עַד דְּלָא יָדַע. **on Purim until, and so on.** וּכְשֶׁהָאָדָם בָּא **And when a person comes** לְכָלָל **to such a degree of drunkenness,** שִׁכְרוּת כָּזֶה **he no longer knows how** שׁוּב אֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ **to direct his intent l'shem Shamayim.** לְכַוֵּין לְשֵׁם שָׁמַיִם. **Only, Purim is the time** רַק דְּבְפוּרִים הַזְּמַן **when Hashem Yisbarach makes clear,** שֶׁיִּתְבָּרַר ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **as it is said,** כְּדֶרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **"Yet I loved Yaakov" —** וְאוֹהַב אֶת יַעֲקֹב **a love without reason,** אַהֲבָה בְּלֹא טַעַם **only from the Supernal Will,** רַק מֵרָצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן **even though Esav is a brother to Yaakov,** אַף כִּי אָח עֵשָׂו לְיַעֲקֹב **the two being equal in deed,** שֶׁשְּׁנֵיהֶם שָׁוִים בְּמַעֲשֶׂה **chas v'shalom.** חַס וְשָׁלוֹם. **And this is from the aspect of Atika,** וְהוּא מִבְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **as mentioned above.** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **And this is what is said: "Therefore they called** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עַל כֵּן קָרְאוּ לַיָּמִים הָאֵלֶּה פּוּרִים **these days Purim,** עַל שֵׁם הַפּוּר **after the name of the Pur" —** שֶׁזֶּהוּ עִיקַּר שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹקֶף הַנֵּס **for this is the essential root of the power of the miracle,** וְכָאָמוּר: **as has been said.**

פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה

Parshas Parah

פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה, מַאֲמָר א׳ Parshas Parah — Maamar Aleph

אֲשֶׁר צִוָּה ה׳ לֵאמֹר[1212] וְגוֹמֵר [בַּמִּדְבָּר יט, ב] **which Hashem commanded, saying," etc. (Bamidbar 19:2).** זֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **"This is the statute of the Torah** יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **This needs to be understood:** דַּהֲוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר **it should have said** זֹאת חֻקַּת הַפָּרָה **"This is the statute of the parah,"** [שְׁמוֹת יב, מג] כְּדִכְתִיב זֹאת חֻקַּת הַפֶּסַח.[1213] **as it is written, "This is the statute of the Pesach" (Shemos 12:43).** אַךְ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתִי נִרְאֶה **But in the Pesikta Rabbasi it appears** שֶׁמְּיַישֵּׁב זֶה **that this is resolved,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סִימָן ו **for they said (siman 6** מִפִּיסְקָא דְּפָרָה פָּרָשָׁה יד) **of the Piska of Parah, parsha 14):** [תְּהִלִּים יב, ז] מְזֻקָּק שִׁבְעָתַיִם **"Refined sevenfold" (Tehillim 12:7) —** שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה נִדְרֶשֶׁת **that the Torah is expounded** אַרְבָּעִים וְתַשַׁע פָּנִים **in forty-nine ways;** וְאַף הַפָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **and this parsha too** מְזֻקָּק שִׁבְעָתַיִם וְכוּלֵי **is "refined sevenfold," and so on;** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה נִדְרֶשֶׁת **just as the Torah is expounded** בְּאַרְבָּעִים וְתַשַׁע פָּנִים **in forty-nine ways,** וְאַף זוֹ יֵשׁ בָּהּ **so too this one has** אַרְבָּעִים וְתַשַׁע פָּנִים **forty-nine ways,** שֶׁהִיא שְׁקוּלָה כְּנֶגֶד **for it is equal to** כָּל הַתּוֹרָה כּוּלָּהּ **the entire Torah;** עַיֵּין שָׁם.[1214] **see there.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **And this needs to be understood:** מַאי קָמַשְׁמַע לָן **what is it teaching us?** הָא כָּל פָּרָשָׁה בַּתּוֹרָה **Every parsha in the Torah** יֵשׁ בָּהּ אַרְבָּעִים וְתַשַׁע פָּנִים **has forty-nine ways,** וְכֵן כָּל פָּסוּק **and so too every verse** וְכָל תֵּיבָה מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **and every word of the words of Torah!** וְלָמָּה יִשְׁתַּנֶּה פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **So why should Parshas Parah differ** מִכָּל פָּרָשִׁיוֹת הַתּוֹרָה **from all the parshiyos of the Torah,** וְלָמָּה הוּצְרַךְ לוֹמַר **and why did it need to say** וְאַף הַפָּרָשָׁה זוֹ וְכוּלֵי **"and this parsha too," and so on,** וְאַף זוֹ וְכוּלֵי. **"so too this one," and so on?** גַּם לְהָבִין **Also to be understood** עִנְיַן מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **is the matter of what they said,** שֶׁשְּׁקוּלָה כְּכָל הַתּוֹרָה. **that it is equal to the whole Torah.** אַךְ בָּא לְיַישֵּׁב **But it comes to explain** דְּמִסְּתָם זֶה כְּתִיב **that for this reason it is written** זֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **"This is the statute of the Torah":** שֶׁהִיא שְׁקוּלָה **that it is equal** כְּנֶגֶד כָּל הַתּוֹרָה **to the whole Torah.** דְּאִיתָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א רב, א) **For it is stated (Zohar I 202a):** דְּהָא לֵית לָךְ מִלָּה **There is nothing** לְתַבְּרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע **that breaks the yetzer hara** אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא **except Torah.** וּפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה **And Parshas Parah** יֵשׁ בָּהּ כֹּחַ זֶה **has this power:** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **that through the reading of this parsha** פּוֹעֵל בַּלֵּב **it acts upon the heart** שֶׁיִּתְחַקְּקוּ כָּל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **so that all the words of Torah are engraved,** וּלְהִטָּהֵר **and to be purified** מִכָּל טוּמְאוֹת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. **from all the impurities of the yetzer hara.** וּכְמוֹ שַׁבָּת **And like Shabbos,** שֶׁשְּׁקוּלָה כְּנֶגֶד כָּל הַתּוֹרָה **which is equal to the whole Torah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **as they said in Midrash Rabbah** (בְּשַׁלַּח כה, יב) **(Beshalach 25:12),** דְּמִסְּתָם זֶה **that for this reason,** עַל שְׁמִירַת יוֹם אֶחָד שֶׁל שַׁבָּת **for the keeping of one day of Shabbos,** בֶּן דָּוִד בָּא.[1215] **the son of David comes.** וְכֵן כָּתוּב בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ[1216] **And so it is written in the holy**

[1212] **Pri Tzaddik, Lag BaOmer 1** — "Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, was the root of Torah she'bichsav, and Rabbi Akiva was the root of Torah she'b'al peh (as is stated in the writings of the Arizal)." Rav Tzadok states the teaching outright there, attributing it to the Arizal's writings, and he refers to it again in Parshas Zachor, Maamar Yud Bais, and Parshas Parah, Maamar Bais. The Arizal's teaching is in Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar Rosh Chodesh, chapter 3: Yitzchak loved Esav "because the hunt was in his mouth" for the sake of the holy spark within him, which drew from the three highest levels, the heads of Yisrael such as Shemayah and Avtalyon, Rabbi Meir and Rabbi Akiva. Rav Tzadok himself joins the two in Ohr Zarua LaTzaddik 5: "Moshe Rabbeinu is the foundation of Torah she'bichsav and Rabbi Akiva the foundation of Torah she'b'al peh; he was a descendant of converts and came from Esav, as is known from the Arizal on 'because the hunt was in his mouth,' and this is the secret of Torah she'b'al peh." Compare also Asarah Maamaros, Chakor Din 5:11, and Megaleh Amukos, Va'eschanan, ofen 72.

[1213] **Maamar Kedishin, attributed to the Arizal, on the letter Kuf** — "Kuf: on the right hand, the thumb, outer joint; it goes through the channel from Binah to Chesed, is given to Naftali, and reigns over laughter; it created Pisces in the world, Adar in the year, and the spleen in the soul." The Gra cites this work by name in his commentary on Sefer Yetzirah (1:1, "see Maamar Kedishin of the Arizal") and reports its order in 5:3: "in the writings of the Arizal he wrote laughter for Naftali ... so that the tribes come in the order of the banners." Rav Tzadok calls the work the Arizal's commentary on Sefer Yetzirah. His quotation follows its Kuf entry word for word.

[1214] Maamar Kedishin, attributed to the Arizal, which assigns the months to the tribes in the order of the banners and gives Adar to Naftali ("Kuf ... is given to Naftali and reigns over laughter ... and Adar in the year"); see the note on Rosh Chodesh Adar, maamar 6.

[1215] **HaGra on Sefer Yetzirah 5:3** — "But in the writings of the Arizal he wrote laughter for Naftali and walking for Zevulun, and in place of Levi he wrote Menasheh; and it is all one, so that the tribes come in the order of the banners." The Arizal's text is Maamar Kedishin, on the letter Kuf: "it is given to Naftali and reigns over laughter; it created ... Adar in the year." The Geonic version that Rav Tzadok has just cited assigns Kuf to sleep. See also the note on Rosh Chodesh Adar, maamar 6.

[1216] Maamar Kedishin, attributed to the Arizal, which assigns the months to the tribes in the order of the banners and gives Adar to Naftali ("Kuf ... is given to Naftali and reigns over laughter ... and Adar in the year"); see the note on Rosh Chodesh Adar, maamar 6.

Zohar (חֵלֶק ב פט, א וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת). **(II 89a and elsewhere).** וְנִקְרָא שַׁבָּת חֹק **And Shabbos is called chok,** וּכְמוֹ עַל מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר [בְּשַׁלַּח פָּרָשָׁה וַיַּסַּע א] שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמְּכִילְתָּא **as they said in the Mechilta (Beshalach, Parshas Vayisa 1)** חֹק וּמִשְׁפָּט שָׂם לוֹ שָׁם [שְׁמוֹת טו, כה] **on what is said (Shemos 15:25), "There He set for him a statute"** — זֶה שַׁבָּת **chok, this is Shabbos.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי מִצְוַת שַׁבָּת **That is, through the mitzvah of Shabbos** נֶחְקַק בַּלֵּב[1217] **there are engraved in the heart** כָּל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה. **all the words of Torah.** וְכֵן פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה נִקְרָא חֹק **And so Parshas Parah is called chok,** שֶׁנֶּחְקַק עַל יָדוֹ[1218] **for through it are engraved** כָּל הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **all the words of Torah;** וְזֶה וְנֶאֱמַר בְּפָרָשָׁה טַעַם שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר זאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה. **"This is the statute of the Torah."** כְּמוֹ שֶׁחָשַׁב שָׁם שֶׁבַע פְּעָמִים שֶׁבַע **seven times seven,** זוֹ בְּפָרָט **as it enumerates there,** שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה מְזוּקָק שִׁבְעָתַיִם. **that the Torah is "refined sevenfold."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And this is what they said in the holy Zohar** (חֻקַּת חֵלֶק ג קפ, ב) **(Chukas, III 180b):** חֹק הַתּוֹרָה מִיבָּעֵי לֵיהּ **It should have said chok haTorah;** מַאי חֻקַּת **why chukas?** וְאוֹקִימְנָא **And we have established:** ה׳ ד׳ הֲוַת **the heh was a dalet,** אֲבָל ת׳ הוּא **but the tav is** ד׳ נ׳ מְחַבְּר כַּחֲדָא וְכוּלֵּי. **a dalet and nun joined together, and so on.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז **That is, it alludes** עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **to Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא חֲמִשִּׁים שַׁעֲרֵי בִּינָה[1219] **which is the fifty gates of understanding;** וְד׳ הַיְינוּ מַלְכוּת **and the dalet is Malchus** — פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **"the mouth, Torah she'b'al peh,** קָרִינַן לָהּ. **we call her."** וְה׳ ד׳ הֲוַת **And "the heh was a dalet"** הַיְינוּ קוֹדֶם דְּקַבִּילַת עוּבָּרָה **means before she has conceived,** כְּשֶׁהִיא דַּלָּה. **when she is poor.** וְהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And Torah she'b'al peh** הוּא הָרֹב חָכְמָה **is the "much wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס **to repair the "much anger,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים.[1220] **as has been explained many times.** וְעִיקַּר הַתּוֹרָה **And the essence of the Torah** לְתַבְּרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע **that breaks the yetzer hara** הוּא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה נב, ב) **as they said (Sukkah 52b):** אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנוּוָּל זֶה **If this repulsive one encounters you,** מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ **drag him to the beis midrash;** וּבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ הוּא מָקוֹם **and the beis midrash is the place** חִידּוּשׁ הֲלָכוֹת **of the novel insights in halachos** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא הָרֹב חָכְמָה **which is the "much wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס. **to repair the "much anger."** וְלִימְּדָנוּ הַכָּתוּב **And the verse has taught us** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **that through the reading of Parshas Parah** נֶחְקַק בַּלֵּב הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **the words of Torah are engraved in the heart,** וּמוֹעִיל לְתַקֵּן הָרוֹב כַּעַס **and it helps to repair the "much anger,"** לְתַבְּרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע. **to break the yetzer hara.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **And this is what they said in the Yerushalmi** (מְגִילָּה פֶּרֶק ג הֲלָכָה ה כה, ב) **(Megillah, perek 3, halachah 5, 25b;** הוּבָא בְּרַשִׁ״י מְגִילָּה כט, א **cited in Rashi, Megillah 29a,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל בְּרַבִּיעִית) **s.v. Barevi'i):** בְּדִין הוּא **By rights,** שֶׁתַּקְדִּים הַחֹדֶשׁ לְפָרָה **HaChodesh should precede Parah,** שֶׁבְּאֶחָד בְּנִיסָן הוּקַם הַמִּשְׁכָּן **for on the first of Nissan the Mishkan was erected,** וּבַשֵּׁנִי נִשְׂרְפָה הַפָּרָה **and on the second the parah was burned;** וְלָמָּה פָּרָה קוֹדֶמֶת **so why does Parah come first?** שֶׁהִיא טָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל.[1221] **Because it is the purification of all Yisrael.** וְצָרִיךְ לְהָבִין **And it needs to be understood** לָמָּה נִקְרָא קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **why the reading of the parsha is called** טָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **the purification of Yisrael.** אַךְ בֶּאֱמֶת **But in truth,** לָמָּה תִּקְּנוּ קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **why did they institute the**

[1217] **Parallel: Maareches HaElokus, chapter 13** — "Because Yisrael were six hundred thousand, the sum of all minds of the upper world, they were fit for the Shechinah … perhaps for this Moshe was commanded to count them many times." The early Kabbalist gives the same reason for the counting: a complete number is the condition for the Shechinah, as Rav Tzadok says each soul is a letter the Torah cannot lack.

[1218] **Parallel: Maharal, Gur Aryeh on Shemos 18:1** — "Moshe is equal to all Yisrael because his mind includes all the minds in six hundred thousand people … one who sees an outstanding sage also blesses 'Knower of secrets.'" Maharal reads the same blessing over a great sage as Rav Tzadok does: such a sage's mind holds the six hundred thousand minds. He applies it to Moshe, the root of the leaders of each generation.

[1219] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Elul 1** — "Each one must say: the world was created for me … a kind of pride. In truth it is needed for serving Hashem, to repel the yetzer's claim that his service counts for nothing." Rav Tzadok there adds why this sense of being exalted is holy, not arrogance: it guards against the despair that says one's own part is worthless.

[1220] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Mishpatim 1** — "The place of Yisrael is Eretz Yisrael, which adds holiness, so one need not be distinguished by holy garments. Bavel is not their place; lacking holiness of place, they need holiness of garments." Mishpatim gives the reason behind this reading of "they are not in their own place": the garment of the talmid chacham takes the place of the holiness of the land, like the kohen's garments "for honor and for glory."

[1221] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayakhel 5** — "'Their crowns': those Yisrael merited at Sinai for 'we will do and we will hear' … but the crown of the Holy One Himself is only for one who makes himself a remnant." Vayakhel identifies the crowns of Berachos 17a just as here, and adds a second, higher crown: Hashem Himself, granted for self-effacement (Megillah 15b).

reading of the parsha? אִם לְהַזְהִיר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **If it is to caution Yisrael** שֶׁיַּעֲשׂוּ פִּסְחֵיהֶן בְּטָהֳרָה[1222] **to offer their Pesach offerings in purity** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשִׁ"י שָׁם **(as Rashi writes there,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל פָּרָה**) s.v. Parah) —** הֲלֹא **why, nowadays** בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה אֵין לָנוּ פֶּסַח **we have no Pesach offering!** וְאִם יִבָּנֶה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **And if the Beis HaMikdash is rebuilt,** בִּמְהֵרָה בְיָמֵינוּ **speedily in our days,** הֲלֹא אָז יִתְגַּלֶּה אֲפֶר פָּרָה **then the ashes of the parah will be revealed;** וְלָמָּה צְרִיכִין לְפַרְסֵם פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **so why must we publicize the parsha of Parah** שֶׁיַּעֲשׂוּ פִּסְחֵיהֶן בְּטָהֳרָה. **so that they offer their Pesach offerings in purity?** וְאִם כֵּן עַל כָּל פָּנִים **And if so, at any rate,** בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה **nowadays** הָוָה לֵיהּ לְהַקְדִּים פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **they should have put Parshas HaChodesh first;** וְלָמָּה הִקְדִּימוּ פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה. **so why did they put Parshas Parah first?** אֶלָּא הָעִנְיָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **But the matter is as we have said,** שֶׁקְּרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת הַפָּרָה מוֹעִיל לְטַהֵר הַלֵּב **that the reading of the parsha helps to purify the heart** מִטּוּמְאוֹת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע[1223] **from the impurities of the yetzer hara,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **And this is what they said in the Yerushalmi:** שֶׁהִיא טָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that it is the purification of all Yisrael —** שֶׁקְּרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **that the reading of Parshas Parah** מוֹעִיל לְטַהֵר הַלֵּב **helps to purify the heart;** כְּסִיל מְשֻׁמָּאלוֹ **the "fool's heart" at one's left,** מִטּוּמְאַת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע. **from the impurity of the yetzer hara.** וּמִפְּנֵי שֶׁעִנְיַן הַפָּרָה מוֹעִיל **And because the matter of the parah helps** לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **to repair the root of the yetzer hara,** וְשָׁרְשׁוֹ הוּא מֵהַנָּחָשׁ **and its root is from the serpent,** שֶׁהֵבִיא הַקְּלְקוּל לָעוֹלָם. **who brought ruin into the world.** וְעַל כֵּן מוֹעִיל הַזָּאַת הַפָּרָה **And therefore the sprinkling of the parah helps** לְטַהֵר מִטּוּמְאַת מֵת **to purify from the impurity of a corpse,** שֶׁזֶּה הֵבִיא הַנָּחָשׁ לָעוֹלָם. **for this the serpent brought into the world.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is the matter of what they said** בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא שָׁם **in the Pesikta there:** בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁעָלָה מֹשֶׁה לַמָּרוֹם **When Moshe ascended on high,** מְצָאוֹ לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **he found the Holy One, blessed be He,** עוֹסֵק וְסִפְרוֹ בְיָדוֹ **occupied, with His book in His hand,** וְעוֹסֵק וְקוֹרֵא הַפָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **occupied and reading this parsha,** בְּפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **in the parsha of the red heifer:** זֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **"This is the statute of the Torah."** וְלָמָּה. **And why?** אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **The Holy One, blessed be He, said:** אֵינִי עוֹסֵק אֶלָּא בְּטָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **I am occupied with nothing but the purification of Yisrael.** מְנַיִן **From where do we know this?** פִּי צַדִּיק יֶהְגֶּה חָכְמָה וְגוֹמֵר [תְּהִלִּים לז, ל] **"The mouth of the righteous utters wisdom," etc. (Tehillim 37:30).** פִּי צַדִּיקוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **The mouth of the Righteous One of the world** יֶהְגֶּה חָכְמָה **utters wisdom —** הוֹגֶה **He meditates in Torah.** בְּאֵיזוֹ תּוֹרָה **In which Torah?** בְּזֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה.[1224] **In "This is the statute of the Torah."** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אִיתָא בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And afterward it is stated in the Pesikta** (שָׁם סִימָן יג) **(there, siman 13):** בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁעָלָה מֹשֶׁה לַשָּׁמַיִם **When Moshe ascended to Heaven,** שָׁמַע קוֹלוֹ **he heard the voice** שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **of the Holy One, blessed be He,** שֶׁהוּא יוֹשֵׁב וְעוֹסֵק **that He sits occupied** בְּפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה **with the parsha of Parah,** וְאוֹמֵר הֲלָכָה בְּשֵׁם אוֹמְרָהּ **and saying a halachah in the name of its author:** רַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר אוֹמֵר וְכוּלֵי [פָּרָה פָּרָק א מִשְׁנָה א] **"Rabbi Eliezer says," and so on (Parah 1:1);** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there** (וְכֵן הוּא בְּבַמִּדְבַּר רַבָּה חֻקַּת יט, ז **(and so it is in Bamidbar Rabbah, Chukas 19:7,** וּבְתַנְחוּמָא חֻקַּת ח**) and in Tanchuma, Chukas 8).** וְהַיְינוּ **That is, at first** מַיְירֵי בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **the Pesikta speaks** בְּפָרָשָׁה פָּרָה **of the parsha of Parah** הַכְּתוּבָה בַּתּוֹרָה[1225] **written in the Torah,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ מַיְירֵי **and afterward it speaks** בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** בְּהִלְכוֹת פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **of the laws of the red heifer,** שֶׁזֶּה עִיקַּר טָהֳרַת יִשְׂרָאֵל **which is the essence of Yisrael's purification —** הָרֹב חָכְמָה **the "much wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס **to repair the "much anger,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְעַל כֵּן דִּקְדֵּק מִתְּחִלָּה **Therefore it was precise at first** וְהַיְינוּ סֵפֶר תּוֹרָה **that is, a Sefer** וְכָתַב וְסִפְרוֹ בְיָדוֹ **and wrote, "with His book in His hand"**

[1222] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Bava Basra 10b** — "Through their donation to the Mishkan Yisrael were raised above all nations … so the Midrash: 'tzedakah exalts a nation'—through their gift for the Mishkan He raised their heads." Maharsha shows that the Mishkan donation itself is called tzedakah, which bridges the gap Rav Tzadok notes between the verse and the Gemara's charity context.

[1223] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Seventh Night of Pesach 27** — "The light of the Exodus was only like 'points of silver': all its holiness was in this small point of 'the people believed,' the first impression from which Hashem began to build." The Radziner agrees that the Exodus left only a point. He adds that this point is the seed of the later service, set firm only at the Sea as "circlets of gold."

[1224] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pesach 52** — "Our master R. Bunim taught that a person's main effort is in fear, and afterward he merits love as a gift from Hashem, for 'it is the way of a man.'" Pesach 52 names the source of this principle, the Rebbe R. Bunim of Peshischa, and uses it to explain why the plunder of the Sea surpasses that of Egypt.

[1225] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pesach 39** — "The tzaddik's holiness spreads into his possessions … so too all the silver and gold they took from Egypt: they wished to bring out the holiness captive within them." Pesach 39 answers the same question, why they had to take wealth at all. It adds the basis: Yaakov risked himself for small jars (Chullin 91a), because what belongs to a tzaddik's soul must be retrieved.

Torah, שֶׁהָיָה קוֹרֵא בָּהּ **from which He was reading** פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה. **Parshas Parah.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר הַלָּשׁוֹן **And afterward it used the wording,** שֶׁשָּׁמַע קוֹלוֹ **"he heard the voice** שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **of the Holy One, blessed be He,** שֶׁהוּא יוֹשֵׁב וְעוֹסֵק **that He sits occupied** בְּפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה וְכוּלֵי **with Parshas Parah," and so on —** הַיְינוּ בְּבֵיאוּר **meaning, with the explanation of** הִלְכוֹת פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **the laws of the red heifer,** וְכִדְמַסֵּיק **as it concludes,** שֶׁאָמַר הֲלָכָה **that He said a halachah,** שֶׁהוּא מִשְׁנַת רֵישׁ פָּרָה.[1226] **which is the Mishnah at the beginning of Parah.** וּמַה שֶׁאָמַר קוֹלוֹ **And as for its saying "the voice** שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **of the Holy One, blessed be He" —** הַיְינוּ דְּקוֹל **this is because the voice** הוּא חִיּוּת הַדִּבּוּר **is the life-force of speech,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Zohar II 3a):** קוֹל אָתֵי לְדִיבּוּר וְכוּלֵי **The voice comes to speech, and so on;** קוֹל (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב ג, א) **voice is the general,** אֵיהוּ כְּלָל **speech is the particular;**[1227] דִּבּוּר אֵיהוּ פְּרָט. עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** דְּדִבּוּר הַיְינוּ **For speech is** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת קלח, ב) **as they said (Shabbos 138b):** דְּבַר ה׳ זוֹ הֲלָכָה **"The word of Hashem" — this is halachah;** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֵלֶק א לב, א) **and in the holy Zohar (I 32a):** דִּבּוּר אִקְרֵי דִּבּוּר **Speech is called Shabbos,**[1228] וְשַׁבָּת אִקְרֵי דִּבּוּר **and Shabbos is called speech.** וְהַיְינוּ מַלְכוּת **That is Malchus —** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **"the mouth, Torah she'b'al peh,** קָרִינַן לָהּ **we call her" —** וְהוּא יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **and it is the seventh day,** (שָׁם מז, ב) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ; **as they said (there, 47b);** וְזֶהוּ פְּרָט **and this is the particular.** וְקוֹל הוּא כְּלָל **And voice is the general,** הַיְינוּ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **that is, the Written Torah,** שֶׁהוּא חִיּוּת הַדִּבּוּר **which is the life-force of the speech** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **of Torah she'b'al peh.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And this is what they said in the Pesikta,** וּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה וְתַנְחוּמָא **Midrash Rabbah and Tanchuma:** שֶׁשָּׁמַע קוֹלוֹ **he heard the voice** שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **of the Holy One, blessed be He,** יוֹשֵׁב וְעוֹסֵק **sitting occupied** בְּפָרָשָׁה פָּרָה וְכוּלֵי **with the parsha of Parah, and so on:** רַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר אוֹמֵר **"Rabbi Eliezer says,** עֶגְלָה בַּת שְׁנָתָהּ **a calf in its first year," and so on.** וְהַיְינוּ חִיּוּת הַדִּבּוּר **This is the life-force of speech,** שֶׁהוּא הַכֹּחַ **which is the power** שֶׁנְּתָנוֹ ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **by which Hashem Yisbarach places** הַדִּבּוּר בְּלֵב הַחֲכָמִים **the speech in the heart of the Sages,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה נט, כא] **along the lines of what is said (Yeshayahu 59:21),** דְּבָרַי אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּפִיךָ.[1229] **"My words which I have placed in your mouth."** וְזֶה עִיקַּר הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And this is the essence of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁמְּתַקֵּן הָרֹב כַּעַס[1230] **which repairs the "much anger,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וּלְמַעְלָה בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And earlier in the Pesikta** מֵיירֵי מִפָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **it speaks of Parshas Parah** הַכְּתוּבָה בַּתּוֹרָה **as written in the Torah;** וְעַל כֵּן דִּקְדֵּק וְכָתַב **therefore it wrote,** וְסִפְרוֹ בְּיָדוֹ וְכוּלֵי. **"with His book in His hand," and so on.** וְעִנְיָן זֶה הוּא דַּיְיקָא **And this matter applies precisely** בְּשַׁבָּת שֶׁקּוֹרִין פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **to the Shabbos on which Parshas Parah is read,** שֶׁהִיא פָּרָשָׁה כְּתוּבָה **for it is a parsha written** בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **in the Written Torah,** וְחִיּוּב קְרִיָּיתָהּ **while the obligation to read it** הוּא מִתַּקָּנַת חֲכָמִים **is from an enactment of the Sages,** שֶׁתִּקְּנוּ לִקְרוֹתָהּ בְּשַׁבָּת זוֹ **who instituted reading it on this Shabbos —** וְהוּא כֹּחַ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **and this is the power of Torah she'b'al peh.** וּבְעוֹבָדָא דִּלְתַתָּא **And through the deed below** אִתְעַר עוֹבָדָא לְעֵילָּא[1231] **a deed**

[1226] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayishlach 10** — "Yaakov was distressed over the gift; he feared his property was not yet clarified. Afterward it became clear that nothing was lacking, for that portion belonged to Esav." Vayishlach describes Yaakov's own distress over the gift and how it was resolved, adding that through the gift he brought out Esav's holy sparks, so the loss was itself the completion of his wealth.

[1227] **Parallel: Tzidkas HaTzaddik 180** — "If he did not merit, there is great atonement through the oppressors, as the Zohar says the goat sent away is the secret of Yaakov's gift to Esav." Tzidkas HaTzaddik adds the other side of this Gemara: money taken by oppressors is itself an atonement, like the se'ir hamishtaleach, because the soul aches at money given where there is no mitzvah.

[1228] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pekudei 9** — "Through tzedakah too one merits the light of Atika, as it says: 'With what will Yisrael's horn be raised? With Ki Sisa' … 'ram' and 'tarum' indicate what is beyond comprehension, the aspect of Atika." Pekudei applies the same reading of "tarum" to tzedakah in general, so that the raising Rav Tzadok locates in Kesser is open to giving even now.

[1229] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Parshas Shekalim 14** — "Because Moshe himself took the shekalim and gave them to the work of the Ohel Moed, he effected for all generations that Yisrael always act through the shekalim from the root of Moshe's level." Maamar Yud Daled gives the reason the raising must come through Moshe: "you shall take the silver of atonement," said to Moshe himself, made his act the channel for every later giving.

[1230] **Parallel: Yismach Moshe, Ki Sisa 3** — "In Mordechai's days the Temple did not stand, yet the arousal of the reading was effective … which proves that Moshe did not die and stands and serves, then as now." The Yismach Moshe draws the same conclusion from the opposite direction: since the reading works without a Mikdash, Moshe himself is still present to lift their heads (Sotah 13b).

[1231] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Parshas Shekalim 5** — "'We will do and offer in love according to the commandment of Your will': through the longing to act, which is like the deed since he was prevented. It says 'Your will,' not 'Your

above is aroused, כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג לֹא, ב וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת) **(III 31b and elsewhere);** וְאָז ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ גַּם כֵּן **and then Hashem Yisbarach too** קוֹרֵא פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **reads the parsha of Parah,** שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ מְקַיֵּים **for Hashem Yisbarach fulfills** כָּל הַמִּצְוֹת **all the mitzvos,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה לֹה, ג) **as they said (Vayikra Rabbah 35:3 and elsewhere),** וְאַף מִצְוֹת וְתַקָּנַת זְקֵנִים **and even the mitzvos and enactments of the Elders** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **(as stated in Midrash Tanchuma,** נָשׂא כט**) Naso 29).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said:** פִּי צַדִּיק יֶהְגֶּה חָכְמָה **"The mouth of the righteous utters wisdom"** — פִּי צַדִּיקוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **the mouth of the Righteous One of the world** הוֹגֶה בַּתּוֹרָה **meditates in Torah.** בְּאֵיזוֹ תּוֹרָה **In which Torah?** בְּזֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **In "This is the statute of the Torah"** — וְהַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת יִשְׂרָאֵל **that is, through Yisrael's reading** פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ. **of this parsha.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ וְלָמָּה **And this is what they said: "And why?** אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **The Holy One, blessed be He, said:** אֵינִי עוֹסֵק **I am occupied with nothing** אֶלָּא בְּטָהֳרָתָן מוֹעִיל שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **but the purification of Yisrael"** — וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁקְּרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **that is, the reading of the parsha** מְטַהֶרֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **helps to purify Yisrael** מִטּוּמְאַת יֵצֶר הָרָע **from the impurity of the yetzer hara;** וְהוּא כֹּחַ כָּל הַדְּבָרִי תּוֹרָה **and this is the power of all the words of Torah together** לִתְבֹּר יֵצֶר הָרָע **to break the yetzer hara.** וּמִשּׁוּם זֶה כְּתִיב **And for this reason it is written,** וְלֹא חֻקַּת **"This is the statute of the Torah,"** חֻקַּת הַפָּרָה.[1232] **and not "the statute of the parah."** וְזֶהוּ הַמְכוּוָן **And this is the intent** בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ וְלָמָּה. **of what they said, "And why?"** רָצָה לוֹמַר **It means:** דְּמַאי טַעַם **for what reason** קוֹרֵא בְּפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **does He read in the parsha of the red heifer** זֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **"This is the statute of the Torah"?** וְעַל זֶה אָמְרוּ **And about this they said:** אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **The Holy One, blessed be He, said:** אֵינִי עוֹסֵק **I am occupied with nothing** אֶלָּא בְּטָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **but the purification of Yisrael.** וְעַל כֵּן כְּתִיב **And therefore it is written** חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **"the statute of the Torah":** שֶׁהִיא שְׁקוּלָה כְּכָל הַתּוֹרָה **for it is equal to the whole Torah** לִהְיוֹת מְטַהֵר הַלֵּב **in purifying the heart** מֵהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **from the yetzer hara,** וְכַנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל: **as mentioned above.**

Torah.'" Maamar Hei reads the same Musaf phrase and adds the reason the longing suffices: what Hashem desires in an offering is the satisfaction of His will, and "the Holy One wants the heart."

[1232] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Parshas Shekalim 13** — "The Jew has no part in the korbanos except to give his shekel; the treasurers buy the offerings … so once he gave it he completed the act from his side." Maamar Yud Gimmel answers the same difficulty, how shekalim help without an altar, by a different route: Yisrael's whole share was the giving, so the reading completes their part.

פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה, מַאֲמָר ב׳ Parshas Parah — Maamar Bais

[תְּהִלִּים לז, ל[1233]] פִּי צַדִּיק יֶהְגֶּה חָכְמָה **"The mouth of the tzaddik utters wisdom" (Tehillim 37:30).** אָמַר פִּי **It says "mouth"** עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **in line with what they said** [תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר הַקְדָּמַת תִּיקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפָתַח אֵלְיָהוּ] **(Tikkunei Zohar, Introduction, Pasach Eliyahu):** פֶּה מַלְכוּת **"Malchus is the mouth;** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרִינַן לַהּ **we call it Torah she'b'al peh."** (חֵלֶק ג רא, ב) וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And in the holy Zohar (vol. III 201b):** אִתְקַדַּשׁ יוֹמָא **"When the day is sanctified,** סָלִיק פּוּמָא **the mouth ascends** דְּשַׁלִּיט עַל כֹּלָּא **that rules over all"** — שָׁם פִּי ה׳ עַיֵּין **the mouth of Hashem; see there.** וְהוּא מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said** [פֶּרֶק ד] בְּסֵפֶר יְצִירָה **in Sefer Yetzirah (chapter 4):** יוֹם שַׁבָּת בַּשָּׁנָה **"The day of Shabbos in the year,** וּפֶה[1234] בַּנֶּפֶשׁ **and the mouth in the soul."** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ שֶׁהַפֶּה נִבְרָא בְּשַׁבָּת **And we have already said that certainly** אֵין הַמְּכוּוָּן **the intent is not that the mouth was created on Shabbos,** שֶׁהֲרֵי דִּיבֵּר אָדָם הָרִאשׁוֹן **for Adam HaRishon spoke** עִם בְּעֶרֶב שַׁבָּת **on Erev Shabbos** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, ט-יב] הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **with HaKadosh Baruch Hu (Bereishis 3:9–12),** [שָׁם ב, כ] וְקָרָא שֵׁמוֹת **and he gave names (ibid. 2:20)** בְּעֶרֶב שַׁבָּת **on Erev Shabbos.** רַק שֶׁבְּשַׁבָּת נִבְרָא הַכֹּחַ **Rather, on Shabbos the power was created** מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **from Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הָאָדָם מְדַבֵּר **that a person should speak** דְּבָרַי אֲשֶׁר שַׂמְתִּי בְּפִיךָ **"My words which I have placed in your mouth,"** וְיִהְיֶה פִּי ה׳.[1235] **and it will be the mouth of Hashem.** [בְּמַאֲמָר א] וְהָעִנְיָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And the matter is as we have said (Maamar 1):** דְּבָשַׁבָּת זֶה **that on this Shabbos,** בִּקְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **through the reading of the parsha,** שֶׁהִיא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **which is Torah she'b'chsav,** וְתִיקּוּן לִקְרוֹתָהּ **while the enactment to read it** הִיא מֵהַחָכְמִים **is from the Chachamim,** כֹּחַ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the power of Torah she'b'al peh —** וְאָז לְעֵילָּא **then Above,** גַּם ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ קוֹרֵא הַפָּרָשָׁה **Hashem Yisbarach too reads the parsha** וְעוֹסֵק בְּהִלְכוֹתֶיהָ. **and occupies Himself with its halachos.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר פִּי צַדִּיק **And this is what is said: "The mouth of the tzaddik"** — פִּי צַדִּיקוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **the mouth of the Tzaddik of the world —** יֶהְגֶּה חָכְמָה **"utters wisdom,"** הוֹגֶה בַּתּוֹרָה **meditating in the Torah.** וְאָמַר יֶהְגֶּה חָכְמָה **And it says "utters wisdom"** שֶׁהוּא עַל שֵׁם הַקּוֹל **because it is named for the voice,** חִיּוּת שֶׁל הַדִּיבּוּר **the vitality of speech,** שֶׁזֶּהוּ מְקַבְּלָא בְּחִינַת חָכְמָה **which is the aspect of wisdom** דְּסִיהֲרָא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of the moon, Torah she'b'al peh,** מִשְׁמְשָׁא **which receives from the sun,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **Torah she'b'chsav.** [שָׁם] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And as we said (ibid.)** בִּלְשׁוֹן מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **regarding the wording of what they said:** שָׁמַע קוֹלוֹ **"He heard the voice** שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **of HaKadosh Baruch Hu,** שֶׁהָיָה יוֹשֵׁב וְעוֹסֵק כּוּ׳ **Who was sitting and occupied," etc.** וְהַיְנוּ דְּעִנְיַן פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **That is, the matter of Parshas Parah** שֶׁמְּטַהֵר מִטּוּמְאַת מֵת **is that it purifies from the tumah of a corpse;** שֶׁגָּרַם **that is, it repairs the entire root** קִלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ **of the corruption of the serpent** וְהַיְנוּ שֶׁמְּתַקֵּן כָּל שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַמִּיתָה **which brought about death.** וְזֶה אִי אֶפְשָׁר לְתַקֵּן **And this cannot be repaired** רַק עַל יְדֵי הֶרֶב חָכְמָה **except through the "abundance of wisdom"** שֶׁבָּא לְתַקֵּן הֶרֶב כַּעַס. **which comes to repair the "abundance of anger."** [סִימָן יג] וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא שָׁם **And this is what they said in the Pesikta there (siman 13)** וּמִדְרָשׁ (רַבָּה וְתַנְחוּמָא חֻקַּת שָׁם) אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְמֹשֶׁה **and the Midrash (Rabbah and Tanchuma, Chukas, ibid.): HaKadosh Baruch Hu said to Moshe:** לְךָ אֲנִי מְגַלֶּה טַעַם פָּרָה **"To you I reveal the reason of the Parah,** וְלָאֲחֵרִים חוּקָּה כּוּ׳ **but for others it is a chok," etc.** דְּבָרִים הַמְּכוּסִים מִכֶּם **"Things that are concealed from you** עֲתִידִים לִהְיוֹת צְפוּיִים לָכֶם **are destined to be visible to you** כּוּ׳[1236] לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **in the World to Come," etc.** וְהַיְנוּ דְּתִקּוּן **That is, the repair** שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקִּלְקוּל **of the root of the corruption** עִקָּרוֹ לֶעָתִיד **is**

[1233] **Parallel: Taanis 31a** — "In the future the Holy One will make a circle for the tzaddikim … and each one will point with his finger, as it says: 'Behold, this is our God, we hoped for Him.'" This is the source of the rule Rav Tzadok says he has stated many times: "zeh" is said of what is so revealed that one can point to it with a finger.

[1234] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Parshas Shekalim 1** — "The half-shekel shows that Yisrael recognize they have no completeness without Hashem, and Hashem too says there is no completeness in the glory of Heaven without Yisrael's service; the joining is called a whole shekel." The Radziner, following the Zohar Chadash on Ki Sisa, makes the half-shekel itself the sign of this union, each side a half that the other completes.

[1235] **Parallel: Pri Yitzchak on Sefer Yetzirah 1:4** — "'Ten and not nine': not to exclude Kesser, though called Ayin; 'ten and not eleven': Da'as is not counted, for it is not a sefirah of its own but the union of Chochmah and Binah." R. Yitzchak Isaac Chaver gives the reading Rav Tzadok cites: Kesser and Da'as are one count, Da'as being Kesser as it appears within.

[1236] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vaera 6** — "'All precious and pleasant wealth': 'precious' indicates Kesser Elyon, as 'yekar: these are the tefillin of the head'; 'pleasant' indicates the World to Come; and Da'as is the inner aspect of Kesser." Vaera supplies the explanation "given elsewhere," mapping each word of the verse onto the upper sefiros.

essentially in the future, דִּכְתִיב [יְשַׁעְיָה כה, ח] **as it is written (Yeshayahu 25:8),** בִּלַּע הַמָּוֶת לָנֶצַח וְגוֹמֵר. **"He will swallow up death forever," etc.** אַךְ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **But Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁלֹּא יָדַע כְּלָל מֵרָע **who knew nothing at all of evil — for when he was born** נִתְמַלֵּא הַבַּיִת אוֹר **the house was filled with light** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סוֹטָה יב, א) **(as it says, Sotah 12a) —** הוּא הֵבִין שֶׁיְּכוֹלִים לְתַקֵּן **he understood that one can repair** כָּל הַקִּלְקוּל **all the corruption** כְּמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד **as it will be in the future.** וְהוּא בֶּאֱמֶת לֹא מֵת[1237] **And in truth he did not die,** (שָׁם יג, ב) **as they said (ibid. 13b):** מָה לְהַלָּן עוֹמֵד וּמְשַׁמֵּשׁ **"Just as there he stands and serves,** אַף כָּאן עוֹמֵד וּמְשַׁמֵּשׁ[1238] **so too here he stands and serves."** וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ב פט, א) **(vol. II 89a):** בְּגִין כָּךְ **"Therefore** וְלֹא יָדַע אִישׁ אֶת קְבוּרָתוֹ **'and no man knows his burial place'** כְּתִיב כּוֹ׳ **is written," etc.** וְהֵיכִי שָׁאִין שׁוּם אָדָם **That is, no person at all** יָכוֹל לְהָבִין **is able to understand** אֵיךְ יְצוּיַּר בָּאִישׁ **how it could be conceived regarding a man** כְּמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **like Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁיִּכָּתֵב בּוֹ עִנְיַן קְבוּרָה **that the matter of burial be written of him,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהוּא חַי וְקַיָּים **since he is alive and enduring,** שֶׁלֹּא יָדַע מְשׁוּם רָע.[1239] **for he knew nothing of any evil.** אֲבָל לַאֲחֵרִים חֻקָּה **But "for others it is a chok" —** הֵיינוּ לַאֲחֵרִים שֶׁקִּלְקְלוּ **that is, for others who corrupted,** עִנְיַן פָּרָה חוּקָּה **the matter of the Parah is a chok,** שֶׁאִי אֶפְשָׁר לְהָבִין כָּל הַפֶּגֶם אֵיךְ יִתְתַּקֵּן **for it is impossible to understand how all the blemish will be repaired** שֶׁגָּרַם הַמִּיתָה **that brought about death,** וְאֵיךְ יִהְיֶה טָהֳרָה **and how there can be purity** לְטוּמְאַת מֵת **for the tumah of a corpse.** שֶׁעוֹמֶק זֶה לֹא יִתְגַּלֶּה **For this depth will not be revealed** רַק לֶעָתִיד **until the future,** דִּכְתִיב בִּלַּע הַמָּוֶת לָנֶצַח[1240] **as it is written, "He will swallow up death forever,"** שֶׁאָז יִתּוּקַן **for then will be repaired** כָּל קִלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ.[1241] **all the corruption of the serpent.** וּמְסַיֵּים בַּמִּדְרָשׁ וּפְסִיקְתָא **And the Midrash and Pesikta conclude:** [יְשַׁעְיָה מב, טז] **"'These things I have done'** אֵלֶּה הַדְּבָרִים עֲשִׂיתִם **but 'I have done them'** וְלֹא עֲשִׂיתִים **it is not written 'I will do'** אֵין כְּתִיב אֶעֱשֶׂה **(Yeshayahu 42:16) —** לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וְחַבֵּירָיו **for Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues.** דְּבָרִים שֶׁלֹּא נִגְלוּ לְמֹשֶׁה **Things that were not revealed to Moshe** נִגְלוּ לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו **were revealed to Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues.** [אִיּוֹב כח, י] וְכָל יְקָר רָאֲתָה עֵינוֹ **'And every precious thing his eye saw' (Iyov 28:10) —** זֶה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו. **this is Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues."** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁעַל יְדֵי **That is, through** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא הֶרֶב חָכְמָה **which is the "abundance of wisdom,"** יְכוֹלִים לְתַקֵּן הֶרֶב כַּעַס **one can repair the "abundance of anger"** אַף אַחַר שֶׁקִּלְקְלוּ[1242] **even after they have corrupted.** וְזֶהוּ כֹּחַ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And this is the power of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהָיָה רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **for Rabbi Akiva was** שׁוֹרֶשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the root of Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאַרְי״ז זַ״ל **as the Arizal wrote;** וְהוּא שַׁעַר הַחֲמִשִּׁים **and it is the fiftieth gate** הַמִּתְגַּלֶּה לְבַעֲלֵי תְּשׁוּבָה.[1243] **that is revealed to baalei**

[1237] **Parallel: Derashos HaRan, Derush 1** — "A deficiency in one part can bring the perfections of the other parts from potential to actual. This is hinted in the galbanum: though unfit itself, it can arouse the qualities of the other spices." The Ran explains how the galbanum adds to the whole: it brings out the fragrance of the others, as Rav Tzadok goes on to say evil exists so that there will be "very good."

[1238] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Seitzei 15** — "R. Eliezer was born good; R. Akiva, the son of converts, was born with bad traits, conquered them and turned them to good. Therefore he was the root of Torah she'b'al peh." Ki Seitzei gives the inner reason the son of converts is the root: his own life was the repair of evil that Torah she'b'al peh accomplishes (Taanis 25b).

[1239] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 17** — "Dan was joined with the greatest tribe, for then there was a revelation like the future, when the circles will be revealed … for in a circle the end joins the head." Chanukah 17 explains why the Mishkan and the Mikdash were built by the greatest and the lowest tribes: they revealed the future circle (Taanis 31a), where the lowest touches the highest, as Dan will again stand with Mashiach.

[1240] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Purim Katan 1** — "Sefer Urim V'Tumim already wrote that we may interpret the wording of the Shulchan Aruch even if they did not intend it, for the true matter is included in their words, written with ruach hakodesh." There Rav Tzadok applies the same principle to the Rema's closing verse "v'tov lev mishteh tamid," showing how an accepted text carries meanings beyond its author's conscious intent.

[1241] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayechi 10** — "At the meal of Atika we ask for the revelation of the light… even though Atika is the intellect hidden from every thought, and of it is said 'He made darkness His hiding place.'" Rav Tzadok there resolves the same tension present here: we petition for the light of Atika upon us precisely because it is beyond all grasp.

[1242] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Bechukosai 9** — "Hashem created nothing evil in the world, for even the yetzer hara was not created for evil… and this is the 'refined expression': that from evil there comes 'very good.'" This explains why the Anshei Knesses HaGedolah could replace "ra" with "hakol": the word names evil already destined to become very good, which is why Hashem can atone for the sin of the Calf.

[1243] **Parallel: Berachos 6a (and Kiddushin 40a)** — "Even if a person intended to do a mitzvah and was prevented and did not do it, Scripture credits him as if he had done it." This is the halachic ground for Rav Tzadok's reading of

teshuvah. וְעַל כֵּן אֵין בּוֹ שַׁיָּיכוּת **Therefore it has no connection** לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **to Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁלֹּא יָדַע כְּלָל מֵרָע **who knew nothing at all of evil;** וְנִגְלָה לְרַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **and it was revealed to Rabbi Akiva,** שֶׁהָיָה בֶּן גֵּרִים.[1244] **who was a son of converts.** וְשׁוֹרֶשׁ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And the root of the Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** הוּא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is the Torah she'b'al peh** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה כָּלוּל בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **that was included within the Torah she'b'chsav,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה אִם לֹא חָטְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **as it would have been had Yisrael not sinned,** שֶׁלֹּא נִיתַּן לָהֶם **when nothing would have been given them** אֶלָּא חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה כּוּ׳ **but the five Chumashei Torah, etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב נְדָרִים כב, ב) **(as it says, Nedarim 22b),** וְהָיָה כָּל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כְּלוּל בַּחֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **and all of Torah she'b'al peh would have been included in the five Chumashei Torah.** וְהוּא בְּסוֹד הַדַּעַת **And this is in the secret of Daas,** וְהוּא עִנְיַן הֲלָכָה לְמֹשֶׁה מִסִּינַי **and it is the matter of halachah l'Moshe mi'Sinai,** שֶׁהוּא מְפוֹרָשׁ **which is explicit** שֶׁהוּא מִסִּינַי מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם[1245] **that it is from Sinai, from Heaven;** וְזֶה נִמְסַר רַק לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו **and this was transmitted only to Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him** הַשָּׁלוֹם (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ב) **(as was explained in Chanukah, maamar 2,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וְהוּא עִנְיָן). **the section beginning "V'hu inyan").** מַה שֶׁאֵין כֵּן רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא **This is not so of Rabbi Akiva,** שֶׁהָיָה בֶּן גֵּרִים **who was a son of converts;** הִשִּׂיג שַׁעַר הַחֲמִשִּׁים **he attained the fiftieth gate** הַמְיוּחָד לְבַעֲלֵי תְּשׁוּבָה. **which is unique to baalei teshuvah.** וְזֶהוּ כָּל יְקָר **And this is "every precious thing,"** עַל כָּל אֲשֶׁר עָשָׂה (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ט, ה-יג) **in the manner of what they said** (Bereishis Rabbah 9:5–13): דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **"'All that He had made,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, לא] וְהִנֵּה טוֹב מְאֹד **and behold it was very good'" (Bereishis 1:31),** שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ עַל כָּל הֵיפֶךְ הַטּוֹב **which is expounded regarding everything that is the opposite of good,** שֶׁהוּא כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה טוֹב מְאֹד **that it exists so that it should be very good;** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קפד, א) **and in the manner of what they said (Zohar II 184a):** "There is no light דְּלֵית נְהוֹרָא אֶלָּא מִגּוֹ חֶשׁוֹכָא דְּנָפִיק הַהוּא **except that which emerges from within darkness,** וְלֵית טוּב אֶלָּא מִגּוֹ בִּישָׁא. **and there is no good except from within evil."** וְזֶה כְּשֶׁנַּעֲשִׂין זְדוֹנוֹת כִּזְכֻיּוֹת **And this is when willful sins become like merits** עַל יְדֵי תְּשׁוּבָה מֵאַהֲבָה **through teshuvah out of love,** שֶׁאָז מִתְגַּלֶּה הָאוֹר **for then is revealed the light** מִמַּאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן **from the First Utterance,** שֶׁמִּרְמַז לְמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים **which alludes to the deeds of the wicked,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה [ב, ה] **as they said in Bereishis Rabbah (2:5);** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת פט, ב) **and as they said (Shabbos 89b):** "If your sins be like scarlet' אִם יִהְיוּ חֲטָאֵיכֶם כַּשָּׁנִים **— like these years** הַלָּלוּ שֶׁסְּדוּרוֹת וּבָאוֹת **that are arranged and come** מִשֵּׁשֶׁת יְמֵי בְרֵאשִׁית כּוּ׳ **from the six days of Creation," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמִּתְגַּלֶּה אָז **That is, it is then revealed** שֶׁכֵּן הָיָה רְצוֹנוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **that such was His will, may He be blessed,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נְהוֹרָא **that there be light** דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֶשׁוֹכָא **that emerges from within darkness;** וְאָז כַּשֶּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ **and then "they shall be white as snow,"** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ כְּזַכֻּיּוֹת. **that they become like merits.** וְזֶהוּ כָּל יְקָר **And this is "every precious thing,"** אֲלוּ דִּיקָר נִדְרָשׁ (מְגִילָּה טז, ב) **for "yekar" is expounded (Megillah 16b):** "These are tefillin," etc. תְּפִילִּין כּוּ׳ וְהַיְינוּ בְּחִינַת מַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן **That is, the aspect of the First Utterance,** שֶׁגָּנַד כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **which corresponds to Keser Elyon,** קַרְקָפְתָּא דִּתְפִילִּין **the head of the tefillin.** וְזֶה כָּל יְקָר **And this is "every precious thing"** — שֶׁמֵּאִיר מִתּוֹךְ הַהֵיפֶךְ **that which shines out of the opposite,** מִגּוֹ חֶשׁוֹכָא דְּנָפִיק נְהוֹרָא. **light that emerges from within darkness.** וְעַל יְדֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **And through Torah she'b'al peh** יְכוֹלִים לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקִּלְקוּל **one can repair the root of the corruption,** הָרַב כַּעַס. **the "abundance of anger."** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ כָּל זֶה אָמַר שְׁלֹמֹה **Shlomo said,** (שָׁם סִימָן ז) בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And this is what they said in the Pesikta (ibid., siman 7):** "'All this I tested with wisdom,' etc. (Koheles 7:23) — בְּכָל פָּרָשִׁיּוֹת שֶׁל תּוֹרָה [קֹהֶלֶת ז, כג] נִסִּיתִי בַּחָכְמָה וְגוֹמֵר **into all the parshiyos of the Torah** וּבְכָל עִמְקֵי הַחָכְמָה **and into all the depths of wisdom** נִכְנַסְתִּי וְעָמַדְתִּי עֲלֵיהֶם **I entered and grasped them,"** etc. [שָׁם] אָמַרְתִּי אֶחְכָּמָה **"'I said, I will become wise' (ibid.)** — עַל הַפָּרָשָׁה זוֹ כּוּ׳

"na'aseh v'nakriv b'ahavah": our longing to bring the Mussaf we cannot offer is reckoned as the offering itself.

[1244] **Parallel: Menachos 110a** — "Whoever engages in the Torah of the chatas is as if he offered a chatas, and whoever engages in the Torah of the asham is as if he offered an asham." The Gemara supplies the principle that reading the parsha of an offering stands in place of the deed, so that the reading of Parshas Shekalim itself counts as giving the shekalim.

[1245] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Tazria 4** — "The beginning of creation was that the Shechinah dwell among the lower beings; after the sin, the place of the Mikdash remained and was called 'field,' and so too after the actual destruction." Rav Tzadok there gives the reason behind the name used here: "field" is the Mikdash site as holiness not yet, or no longer, built, which is why it links Adam, Machpelah and the Mikdash.

over this parsha כּוּ׳ [1246]צָנַח אָחְכָּמָה **he cried out, 'I will become wise,'" etc.** וְכֵן הוּא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **And so it is in the Midrash** (חֻקַּת רַבָּה יט, ג תַּנְחוּמָא ו) **(Chukas Rabbah 19:3, Tanchuma 6):** וּפָרָשָׁה שֶׁל פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **"But the parsha of the Parah Adumah —** [1247]חָקַרְתִּי וְשָׁאַלְתִּי וּפִשְׁפַּשְׁתִּי **I investigated, asked and searched;** אָמַרְתִּי אָחְכָּמָה **'I said, I will become wise,** וְהִיא רְחוֹקָה מִמֶּנִּי **but it is far from me,'"** עַיִּין שָׁם **see there.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Now we must understand:** הֵיכָן נִרְמַז בְּפָסוּק זֶה **where is it alluded to in this pasuk** דְּקָאֵי עַל פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **that it refers to the parsha of the Parah Adumah?** [מִשְׁלֵי ב, ו] אַךְ כָּתִיב **But it is written (Mishlei 2:6):** כִּי ה׳ יִתֵּן חָכְמָה **"For Hashem gives wisdom" —** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **that is, Torah she'b'chsav,** שֶׁנָּתַן ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **which Hashem Yisbarach gave;** [שָׁם] מִפִּיו דַּעַת וּתְבוּנָה **"from His mouth, knowledge and understanding" (ibid.) —** הַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת פִּי ה׳ **which is the aspect of "the mouth of Hashem,"** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וְזֶהוּ תְּבוּנָה **And this is "tevunah,"** שֶׁמַּבִין דָּבָר מִתּוֹךְ דָּבָר.[1248] **understanding one thing from within another.** וְדַעַת שֶׁהוּא פְּנִימִיּוּת הַכֶּתֶר **And Daas, which is the inwardness of Keser,** כַּיָּדוּעַ **as is known,** וְהוּא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is the Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ מִשָּׁלָא דְּעַתִּיקָא **that shines forth from the dew of Atika,** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן מִבְּחִינַת הַדַּעַת **which is also of the aspect of Daas,** שֶׁהוּא רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **which is ruach hakodesh,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשׁ״י [שְׁמוֹת לא, ג] **as Rashi wrote** [1249]פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא **in Parshas Ki Sisa (Shemos 31:3);** וְהוּא הָרַב חָכְמָה **and it is the "abundance of wisdom"** שֶׁמּוֹעִיל לְתַקֵּן הָרַב כַּעַס **that is effective to repair the "abundance of anger,"** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Shlomo HaMelech, peace be upon him,** זָכָה לְכָל אוֹר **merited all the light** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh** בַּחֲלוֹם אֶחָד **in one dream,** מִצַּד ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** [מְלָכִים-א ה, ט] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (I Melachim 5:9):** וַיִּתֵּן אֱלֹהִים חָכְמָה לִשְׁלֹמֹה וְגוֹמֵר **"And Elokim gave Shlomo wisdom," etc.,** כַּחוֹל אֲשֶׁר עַל שְׂפַת הַיָּם[1250] **"like the sand that is on the seashore."** (חֻקַּת שָׁם) וְאִיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **And it says in the Midrash (Chukas, ibid.):** מַהוּ כַּחוֹל כּוּ׳ **"What is 'like the sand'? etc.** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁהַחוֹל עוֹשֶׂה לוֹ **Just as the sand makes for it** סְיָג וְגָדֵר **a fence and barrier** שֶׁלֹּא יֵצֵא וְיִשְׁטוֹף הָעוֹלָם **so that it not go out and flood the world,** כָּךְ הָיְתָה חָכְמָתוֹ **so his wisdom** עוֹמֶדֶת בִּפְנֵי יִצְרוֹ כּוּ׳ **stood against his yetzer** [1251]שֶׁלֹּא יֶחֱטָא **so that he not sin," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ חָכְמַת שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה תּוֹרָה **That is, the wisdom of Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁזָּכָה מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ בַּחֲלוֹם **which he merited from Hashem Yisbarach in a dream,** לְתַבְּרָא יֵצֶר הָרַע **for "there is nothing** דְּלֵית לָךְ מִלָּה **that breaks the yetzer hara** אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא **except Torah,"** [בְּמַאֲמָר א] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **and as we have said (Maamar 1),** שֶׁהוּא הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה. **that this is the Torah she'b'al peh.** אַךְ זֶה נֶחְסַר לוֹ לִשְׁלֹמֹה **But this Shlomo lacked:** הַכֹּחַ דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the power of Torah she'b'al peh** לְתַקֵּן הָרַב כַּעַס **to repair the "abundance of"** אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל **after the corruption,** שֶׁהוּא כֹּחַ רַבִּי עֲקִיבָא וַחֲבֵירָיו[1252] **which is the power of Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues,** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above.** וְהוּא עוֹמֶק וְעִנְיַן **And this is the depth and the matter** טָהֳרַת הַפָּרָה **of the purification of**

[1246] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Tetzaveh 5** — "The first thought of his creation was from the place of his atonement… that his service now be as in Gan Eden, 'to work it and guard it,' through repairing his deeds to atone for the corruption." This develops the point here: Adam's exile to the altar's site was not merely punitive but a return to the very purpose for which he was formed.

[1247] **Parallel: Kometz HaMincha II, 51** — "He paid four hundred for it, corresponding to Kiryas Arba… the number four hundred everywhere in the words of Chazal is the comprehensive measure that includes all parts of creation, from world to world." Rav Tzadok's earlier work gives the same reading of Efron's price: four hundred signifies completeness spanning all the worlds, here specified as ten times ten in each of the four.

[1248] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Chayei Sarah 2** — "After the Akeidah, when Avraham Avinu was completed in all ten middos… then he bought the field of Machpelah… and the light emerging from the cave is from the first light." Rav Tzadok there ties the timing of the purchase to this same completion, and identifies the cave's light with the fivefold "light" of creation that this maamar later connects to the five Chumashim.

[1249] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pinchas 1** — "Everywhere the term kin'ah means something without reckoning, as we find with Avraham Avinu, who pursued the four kings… only because the zeal of Hashem burned in him." Rav Tzadok there adds that such zeal, though beyond what law requires, flowed in Pinchas from chesed and love of Yisrael; so too Avraham's self-sacrifice here was love, not obligation.

[1250] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayakhel 5** — "The crown of the Holy One Himself is attained only by one who makes himself like remnants, to be as nothing; through this he attains the light of Keser Elyon, which is called Ayin… 'I dwell on high and in holiness, and with the crushed.'" This explains why Avraham's self-effacement as dust and ashes is precisely what opens the level of Atika.

[1251] **Parallel: Arvei Nachal, Vayera** — "Avraham said 'I am dust and ashes,' likening himself to the inanimate; Moshe Rabbeinu said 'and what are we,' that he is not even like the inanimate." The Arvei Nachal grades the same Gemara as Rav Tzadok: Moshe's humility goes past lowliness to non-existence, which Rav Tzadok identifies as becoming a chariot for the midda of Ayin.

the Parah: לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַקִּלְקוּל. **to repair the root of the corruption.** **And** וְעַל שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **regarding Shlomo HaMelech, peace be upon him,** אִיתָא (ראש השנה כא, ב) **it says (Rosh Hashanah 21b):** שֶׁהָיָה כְּמֹשֶׁה[1253] **"Among the prophets none arose,** בַּנְּבִיאִים לֹא קָם **among the kings one did arise,"** בַּמְּלָכִים קָם **that he was like Moshe.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר **And regarding this he said,** אָמַרְתִּי אֶחְכָּמָה **"I said, I will become wise"** — לְהָבִין מִצִּידִי **to understand from my own side** עִנְיַן פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **the matter of the Parah Adumah,** לְתַקֵּן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפְּגָם **to repair the root of the blemish** אַחַר הַקִּלְקוּל **after the corruption;** וְהִיא דַּיְקָא לְשׁוֹן נְקֵיבָה **"and it"** — **specifically in the feminine,** הָרוֹמֵז לְסִיהֲרָא **alluding to the moon** דְּמַקְבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **which receives from the sun,** הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the Torah she'b'al peh,** לְהָבִין מִתּוֹךְ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **understanding from within the Torah she'b'chsav** — רְחוֹקָה מִמֶּנִּי **"is far from me,"** שֶׁזָּכָה רַק מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **for he merited only, from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** לְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁל מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם. **of Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him.** וְכֵן אַחַר שֶׁנִּכְתַּב הַקִּלְקוּל **And so, after the corruption was recorded** עַל שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **concerning Shlomo HaMelech, peace be upon him,** רָצוּ אַנְשֵׁי כְּנֶסֶת הַגְּדוֹלָה **the Men of the Great Assembly wished** לְמַנּוֹתוֹ בְּכְלָל **to count him among** שֶׁאֵין לָהֶם חֵלֶק חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **those who have no share, chas v'shalom** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּסַנְהֶדְרִין קד, ב) **(as it says in Sanhedrin 104b);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁכֹּחַ זֶה נֶחְסַר לוֹ **that is, he lacked this power** לְתַקֵּן הַקִּלְקוּל **to repair the corruption,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְזֶה הָיָה כֹּחַ **And this was the power** דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of David HaMelech, peace be upon him,** [עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה][1254] שֶׁהֵקִים עוּלָּה שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה [א, ה]. **who raised up the yoke of teshuvah (Avodah Zarah 5a).** עַד שֶׁיָּצְתָה בַּת קוֹל[1255] כו' **Until a heavenly voice went forth, etc.** [סַנְהֶדְרִין שָׁם] **(Sanhedrin ibid.),** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת שְׁלֹמֹה לֹא חָטָא כְּלָל[1256] **for in truth Shlomo did not sin at all** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת נו, ב). **(as it says, Shabbos 56b).** וּבֶאֱמֶת יִהְיֶה מָשִׁיחַ **And in truth it will be Mashiach** שֶׁיְּתַקֵּן הַכְּלָל **who will repair the whole,** דְּכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בַּשּׁוֹרֶשׁ **for all of Yisrael are bound at the root** בַּה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **to Hashem Yisbarach** — [בְּרָכוֹת יז, א] דִּרְצוֹנֵנוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת רְצוֹנֶךָ כו' **"our will is to do Your will," etc. (Berachos 17a),** [יְשַׁעְיָה ס, כא] וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים **and "Your people are all tzaddikim" (Yeshayahu 60:21)** — וְאָז יְתוּקַן שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַפְּגָם **and then the root of the blemish will be repaired** וְיִבּוֹלַע הַמָּוֶת לָנֶצַח. **and death will be swallowed up forever.** וּפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **And Parshas Parah Adumah** — דְּהַפָּרָשָׁה מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **for the parsha is from Torah she'b'chsav** וְתִיקּוּן קְרִיאָתָהּ **and the enactment to read it** הוּא מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **is from Torah she'b'al peh** — זֶהוּ מְטַהֵר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **this is what purifies Yisrael,** [מַאֲמָר א] כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above (Maamar 1).** וּבְשַׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא זְמַן **And on Shabbos, which is the time** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **of Torah she'b'chsav,** נִיתְּנָה תּוֹרָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **the Torah was given to Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת פו, ב) **(as it says, Shabbos 86b);** וְאִיתָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and it says in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק א מז, ב) **(I 47b):** יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **"The seventh day** — דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּאִיהוּ יוֹם שְׁבִיעִי **which is the seventh day";** וְהַיְינוּ מַלְכוּת פֶּה **that is, "Malchus is the mouth;** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרִינָן לַהּ **we call it Torah she'b'al peh"** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּיקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפָתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] **(Tikkunei Zohar, Introduction, Pasach Eliyahu).** וְהוּא זְמַן שׁוֹרֶשׁ **And it is the time of the root** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב וְתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'chsav and Torah**

[1252] **Parallel: Tikkunei Zohar 69, 112a** — "Moshe is Hevel, he is Shes, and he is Moshe; and the extension of Moshe is in every generation and in every tzaddik." The Tikkunim supply the basis for Rav Tzadok's claim that a power from Moshe Rabbeinu resides in all Yisrael, so that each year's reading of Parshas Shekalim is as though Moshe himself stands and lifts their heads.

[1253] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Acharei Mos 1** — "Such revelation will be only in the future… but through emunah one can attain this light so that it is explicit, and it is called zos… therefore Shabbos is called zos, for then there is complete faith." Rav Tzadok there draws the corollary for this maamar's close: the explicit "zos" of faith belongs above all to Shabbos, the day on which Parshas Shekalim is read.

[1254] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 22** — "The letter dalet indicates the complete revelation of Malchus Shamayim, for the hei was a dalet: through lowliness and poverty (dalus) one attains the final hei, the culmination of the revelation of Malchus." This adds why the dalet of echad marks Knesses Yisrael: Malchus is reached through self-lowering, the inverse of the Calf that separated zeh from zos.

[1255] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Devarim 12** — "What must be repaired then is that we merit the revelation of the hidden, the three upper levels, so that Keser Elyon is Keser Malchus, as it will be in the World to Come." Rav Tzadok there places the same union in the repair sought in the three haftaros of punishment, showing that what the shekalim restore is a foretaste of the future revelation.

[1256] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 15** — "'Yaakov sought to dwell in tranquility; the anger of Yosef sprang upon him': these are the corruptions of the bris. That is the matter of the sale of Yosef, the level of tzaddik yesod olam, as a slave among the nations." Rav Tzadok there identifies the sale of Yosef as a flaw in yesod, which is why it can share one root with Adam's 130-year flaw and with the Calf.

she'b'al peh. וְעַל כֵּן נִיתְקַן לִקְרוֹת **Therefore it was enacted to read** פָּרָה בְּשַׁבָּת **Parshas Parah on Shabbos,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה **and through this** הוּא טָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **comes the purification of Yisrael;** וְזֶהוּ הֲכָנָה **and this is the preparation** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ נִגְאָלִין בְּנִיסָן **for their being redeemed in Nisan.** וְזֶה שֶׁכָּתַב רַשִׁ״י **And this is what Rashi wrote** (מְגִילָּה כט, א דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל פָּרָה) **(Megillah 29a, s.v. Parah):** פָּרָה אֲדוּמָּה **"Parah Adumah —** לְהַזְהִיר שֶׁיַּעֲשׂוּ פִּסְחֵיהֶן בְּטָהֳרָה **to caution Yisrael** אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **that they make their Pesach offerings in purity."** מְרַמֵּז לָזֶה **He alludes to this:** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ נִגְאָלִין בְּנִיסָן **that they will be redeemed in Nisan;** עַל יְדֵי שֶׁיִּטַּהֲרוּ **through their being purified,** עַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת פָּרָה **through the reading of Parshas Parah,** מִכָּל טוּמְאַת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **from all the tumah of the yetzer hara,** יִהְיוּ נִגְאָלִין בְּנִיסָן **they will be redeemed in Nisan** וְיַעֲשׂוּ פִּסְחֵיהֶן בְּטָהֳרָה. **and make their Pesach offerings in purity.**

פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה, מַאֲמָר ג׳ Parshas Parah — Maamar Gimmel

מִי יִתֵּן טָהוֹר מִטָּמֵא **"Who can bring the pure out of the impure?** [1257]לֹא אֶחָד [אִיּוֹב יד, ד **Is it not the One?" (Iyov 14:4).** בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה **In Midrash Rabbah** (חֻקַּת יט, א וְתַנְחוּמָא חֻקַּת ג) **(Chukas 19:1, and Tanchuma Chukas 3):** כְּגוֹן אַבְרָהָם מִתֶּרַח כּוּ׳ **"Such as Avraham from Terach, etc.;** יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם **Yisrael from the nations of the world;** הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא מִן הָעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **the World to Come from this world.** מִי עָשָׂה כֵן כּוּ׳ **Who did so? etc.** לֹא אֶחָד **Is it not the One** — יְחִידוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם.[1258] **the Unique One of the world?"** הַיְינוּ שֶׁכֵּן עָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה **That is, so it arose in Thought,** בְּמַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן **in the First Utterance,** שֶׁלֹּא נֶאֱמַר בּוֹ וַיֹּאמֶר **in which "And He said" is not stated,** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְכֶתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **which alludes to Keser Elyon,** שֶׁכָּל הַנֶּעֱלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן **the intellect hidden from all thought;** וְשָׁם נֶאֱמַר הַחֹשֶׁךְ **and there are stated "darkness"** וְתוֹהוּ וָבֹהוּ **and "tohu va'vohu,"** שֶׁמְּרַמֵּז לְמַעֲשֵׂיהֶן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים **which allude to the deeds of the wicked.** שֶׁכֵּן הָיָה בְּרִיָּיתוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **For thus was the creation of the world:** בְּרֵישָׁא חֲשׁוֹכָא **first darkness** וַהֲדַר נְהוֹרָא[1259] **and then light,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה נְהוֹרָא **so that there be light** דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא **that emerges from within darkness,** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קפד, א) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Zohar II 184a).** וְזֶהוּ מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **And this is what they said, "the World to Come,"** שֶׁהוּא אוֹר הָרִאשׁוֹן **which is the primordial light** וְהוּא יִתְגַּלֶּה מִן הָעוֹלָם **that was hidden away for the future to come,** שֶׁגְּנוּזָה לֶעָתִיד לָבוֹא **and it will be revealed out of this world** — הַזֶּה. נְהוֹרָא דְּנָפִיק מִגּוֹ חֲשׁוֹכָא **light that emerges from within darkness.** וּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאוּמּוֹת **And as for what they said, "Yisrael from the nations,"** אֵין הַכַּוָּנָה **the intent is not** שֶׁבָּאוּ מִתֶּרַח וַאֲבוֹתָיו **that they came from Terach and his forebears,** שֶׁעַל זֶה כְּבָר אָמַר **for about that it already said** אַבְרָהָם מִתֶּרַח **"Avraham from Terach."** רַק הַמְכוּוָן **Rather, the intent is** עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (פְּסָחִים פז, ב) **in line with what they said (Pesachim 87b):** לֹא הִגְלָה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"HaKadosh Baruch Hu did not exile** אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל כּוּ׳ **Yisrael, etc.,** אֶלָּא כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּתּוֹסְפוּ עֲלֵיהֶם גֵּרִים[1260] **except so that converts would be added to them."** וּפֵירְשׁוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **And they, of blessed memory, explained** שֶׁאֵין הַמְכוּוָן עַל גֵּרִים מַמָּשׁ **that the intent is not to actual converts** רַק עַל נִיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **but to the holy sparks** וְחִיּוּת[1261] שֶׁיֵּשׁ בָּאוּמּוֹת **and vitality that are in the nations,** [נְחֶמְיָה ט, ו] בְּסוֹד וְאַתָּה מְחַיֶּה אֶת כּוּלָּם **in the secret of "And You give life to them all" (Nechemiah 9:6);** וְזֶה מוֹצִיאִים עַל יְדֵי הַגָּלֻיּוֹת **and this is extracted through the exiles.** וּמִטַּעַם זֶה אִיתָא **And for this reason it says** (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה, ב, כב) **(Shir HaShirim Rabbah 2:22)** עַל פָּסוּק קוֹל דּוֹדִי **on the pasuk "The voice of my Beloved,** [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ב, ח] הִנֵּה זֶה בָּא **behold, He comes" (Shir HaShirim 2:8):** זֶה מָלְכָּךְ הַמָּשִׁיחַ כּוּ׳ **"This is the King Mashiach, etc.** לֹא כְּבָר נִשְׁבַּע הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **Did not HaKadosh Baruch Hu already swear** שֶׁהוּא מְשַׁעְבְּדָנוּ **that He would subjugate us** בְּשִׁבְעִים אוּמּוֹת כּוּ׳ **among the seventy nations? etc."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁכּוּלָּם יֵשׁ בָּהֶם **That is, all of them have in them** נִיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **holy sparks,** שֶׁמִּמֶּנָּה הַחַיִּים שֶׁלָּהֶם **from which comes their life,** וְלָזֶה נִצְרַךְ הַגָּלֻיּוֹת **and for this the exiles were needed** בְּכָל הַשִּׁבְעִים אוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם. **among all seventy nations of the world.** וְעַל זֶה מְשִׁיבָן אֶחָד גּוֹלֶה לְבַרְבָּרְיָא כּוּ׳ **And to this He answers them: "One is**

[1257] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 7** — "When they are bound in one aguda, even the chelbenah joins the levonah and gives a good fragrance… therefore the half-shekel, ten gerah, the letter yud." Rav Tzadok there ties the half-shekel to this same image: it gathers each individual into the whole of Yisrael, where even what was flawed is repaired and contributes.

[1258] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Beshalach 1** — "This light is only for the moment, so that a person see that there is the light of His G-dliness in the world; afterward it is hidden from him, and he sees all he has done against Hashem's will… his heart breaks and he returns in complete teshuvah." Rav Tzadok there explains what the withdrawal of the borrowed light produces: the broken heart through which one earns it by one's own toil.

[1259] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Savo 13** — "At the sea, though Atika was revealed, it was only as seeing, showing them what they could attain at Shavuos through acquisition… our holy Rebbe said the seeing at the sea was like the strength of piety at its beginning." There Rav Tzadok adds that this is why chametz is forbidden on Pesach yet brought in the Shavuos loaves: only once the light is acquired is the yetzer subdued.

[1260] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Yom Kippur 17** — "The divine will set in creation that every soul be nourished by things lower than itself, so that a person raise all things to their root; this is 'Yisrael sustain their Father in Heaven,' for by raising the lower things he makes a pleasing aroma to Hashem." The Radziner explains how eating, like an offering, can "sustain" above, the basis for calling the Shabbos meals the King's meals.

[1261] **Parallel: Radak on Hoshea 14:3** — "In place of bulls we will pay before You the confession of our lips, for You desire words of teshuvah more; the offerings avail nothing without confession of the sin." Radak shows that words were always the inner core of the offering, which grounds the piyut's plea that our reading of Parshas Shekalim be accepted as the shekalim themselves.

exiled to Barbaria, etc. — דּוֹמֶה כְּמוֹ שֶׁגָּלִיתֶם כּוּלְכֶם[1262] **it is as though you were all exiled";** וְעַל יָדוֹ מוֹצִיאִים **and through him are extracted** כָּל הַנִּיצוֹצוֹת קְדוֹשׁוֹת **all the holy sparks.** וְזֶהוּ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said,** יִשְׂרָאֵל מֵאוּמּוֹת. **"Yisrael from the nations."** מִי צִיוָּה כֵן **"Who commanded so?** לֹא יְחִידוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם **Is it not the Unique One of the world?"** שֶׁכֵּן מוֹרֶה הֲוָיָ"ה אֶחָד **For so the Name Havayah One indicates,** שֶׁהוּא אֶחָד מִשֶּׁנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם **that He is One since the world was created** כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם שֶׁנִּבְרָא **just as before it was created;** שֶׁאַף שֶׁנִּרְאֶה אַחַר הַבְּרִיאָה **for although it appears after Creation** שֶׁיֵּשׁ דֵּיעוֹת וּבְחִירָה **that there are minds and free choice,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם בֶּאֱמֶת **nevertheless in truth** הַכֹּל מֵה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ הוּא **it is all from Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּמוֹ קוֹדֶם שֶׁנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם.[1263] **just as before the world was created.** וּכְשֶׁמּוֹפִיעַ אוֹר זֶה בַּלֵּב **And when this light shines forth in the heart,** אָז הוּא תִּיקּוּן לְכָל הַפְּגָם **then it is a repair for all the blemish** שֶׁגָּרַם הַמִּיתָה. **that brought about death.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן פָּרָה **And this is the matter of the Parah,** שֶׁמְּטַהֵר אַף מִטּוּמְאַת מֵת **which purifies even from the tumah of a corpse,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁהוּא טָהֳרָתוֹ שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **since it is the purification of Yisrael** מִטּוּמְאַת הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **from the tumah of the yetzer hara,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל [בְּמַאֲמָר א] **as mentioned above (Maamar 1);** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיְּבָרֵר ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **that is, Hashem Yisbarach will make clear** שֶׁכֵּן עָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה לְפָנָיו **that so it arose in Thought before Him,** וְיִהְיוּ זְדוֹנוֹת כִּזְכִיּוֹת[1264] **and willful sins will be like merits,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ לְמַעְלָה [בְּמַאֲמָר ב]. **as we said above (Maamar 2).** וְעַל כֵּן בְּשַׁבָּת **And therefore on Shabbos,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **when there is a revelation of Atika,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג עט, ב) **as they said (Zohar III 79b),** וּבִפְרָט בַּבּוֹקֶר **and especially in the morning,** זְמַן סְעוּדְתָא דְּעַתִּיקָא[1265] **the time of the meal of Atika,** יְכוֹלִים לְהַשִּׂיג **one can attain** מַעֲיִן עוֹלָם הַבָּא **a semblance of the World to Come,** שֶׁהוּא מֵאוֹר הַגָּנוּז לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **which is from the light hidden away for the World to Come.** וְעַל כֵּן קוֹרִין אָז פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **And therefore Parshas Parah is read then,** שֶׁמּוֹרָה עַל אוֹר זֶה **for it points to this light,** כָּאָמוּר. **as was said.**

[1262] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pesach 40** — "Although afterward it was hidden from them… at least the longing and desire remained… at first Hashem shows a person, as a loan, what he can later attain through his toil, and then removes that light so that he acquire it by his labor." Rav Tzadok there explains why the desire left by Kerias Yam Suf is what leads to the acquisition at Sinai.

[1263] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Parshas Shekalim 1** — "The half-shekel shows that Yisrael recognize they have no completeness of their own without Hashem; and Hashem likewise says there is no completeness to the honor of Heaven without the service of Yisrael; their union is called a whole shekel." The Radziner gives the inner meaning of the Zohar Chadash's "half a body": each half becomes whole only through the other.

[1264] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Shevat 2** — "The letter tzadi indicates the midda of tzaddik… 'a bent tzaddik, an upright tzaddik': at first he must be bent, fighting with strength to bend the yetzer to good; afterward upright, meriting to straighten the heart." This shows the work of Shevat that prepares Parshas Shekalim: the repair of yesod proceeds from conquering the yetzer to a heart made wholly straight.

[1265] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Tzav 6** — "The completion of the deed is also from Hashem, as it says 'in your mouth and in your heart to do it,' and not 'in your deeds.'" Rav Tzadok there generalizes the principle at work here: a Jew's share in any mitzvah is what lies in his power, and once he has done that, the deed is reckoned complete even though others, or Hashem, carry it out.

פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה, מַאֲמָר ד׳ Parshas Parah — Maamar Daled

בִּפְסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתִי לְפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה (פָּרָשָׁה יד סִימָן יא) **In Pesikta Rabbasi on Parshas Parah (parshah 14, siman 11):** וְחֹק נָתַן לָמוֹ [תְּהִלִּים צט, ו-ז] **'they kept His testimonies and the statute He gave them' (Tehillim 99:6–7).** שֶׁשָּׁמְרוּ עֵדוֹתָיו **"'Moshe and Aharon,' etc.,** מֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן וְגוֹמֵר שֶׁשָּׁמַעְנוּ בְּמֹשֶׁה **We have heard regarding Moshe that the Torah was written in his name, etc.;** שֶׁנִּכְתְּבָה תּוֹרָה לְשִׁמוֹ כּוּ׳ וּבִשְׁמוּאֵל נִכְתַּב לוֹ סֵפֶר **and for Shmuel a book was written:** וַיִּכְתֹּב בַּסֵּפֶר [שְׁמוּאֵל-א י, כה] **'And he wrote it in the book and placed it before Hashem' (I Shmuel 10:25)."** וַיַּנַּח לִפְנֵי ה׳ וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמִּשְׁפַּט הַמְּלוּכָה **That is, the law of the kingship Shmuel wrote.** כְּתָבוֹ שְׁמוּאֵל אֲבָל בְּאַהֲרֹן לֹא שָׁמַעְנוּ **"But regarding Aharon we have not heard;** אֶלָּא מִלַּמֵּד **rather, this teaches that this parsha was given to him, nor from his sons,** שֶׁלֹּא תָזוּז מִמֶּנּוּ וְלֹא מִבָּנָיו **nor from his sons' sons, until the end of all the generations:** וְלֹא מִבְּנֵי בָנָיו עַד סוֹף כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת[1267] זֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **'This is the statute of the Torah.'"** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **Now we must understand:** הָא רַק בִּזְמַן שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הָיָה קַיָּים **only when the Beis HaMikdash was standing, the parsha of the Parah applies and also the sprinkling** וְגַם הַהַזָּאָה **and the ashes of the Parah have been hidden from us.** וְנִגְנַז אֵפֶר פָּרָה מֵאִתָּנוּ **However, along these lines it says in the Midrash** אָמְנָם כְּעִנְיָן זֶה **it is not specifically by kohanim.** אֵינוֹ בְּכֹהֲנִים דַּוְקָא אִיתָא בַּמִּדְרָשׁ **(Behaaloscha Rabbah 15:6, Tanchuma 5):** (בְּהַעֲלוֹתְךָ רַבָּה טו, ו תַּנְחוּמָא ה) **HaKadosh Baruch Hu said to Moshe:** אָמַר לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לְמֹשֶׁה **"Say to Aharon: Do not fear; for greater than this you are prepared, etc.** אֱמוֹר לְאַהֲרֹן אַל תִּתְיָרֵא לְגְדוּלָּה מִזּוֹ אַתָּה מְתוּקָּן כּוּ׳ הַקְּרְבָּנוֹת **The offerings — so long as the Beis HaMikdash stands they are in effect, but the lamps are forever, etc.** כָּל זְמַן שֶׁבֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ קַיָּים הֵם נוֹהֲגִים אֲבָל הַנֵּרוֹת לְעוֹלָם[1268] כּוּ׳ **And all the blessings I gave you to bless My children will never be nullified."** וְכָל הַבְּרָכוֹת שֶׁנָּתַתִּי לְךָ לְבָרֵךְ אֶת בָּנַי אֵינָן בְּטֵלִין לְעוֹלָם **Now, Birkas Kohanim is indeed forever; but the lamps of the Beis HaMikdash, which He said are forever — they have already raised the difficulty on this, and what the Ramban, for they ceased with the Churban.** וְהִנֵּה בִּרְכַּת כֹּהֲנִים הֵם לְעוֹלָם אֲבָל נֵרוֹת בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁאָמַר שֶׁהֵם לְעוֹלָם כְּבָר הִקְשׁוּ עַל זֶה שָׁהֵרֵי בָּטְלוּ בַּחוּרְבָּן וּמַה שֶּׁכָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ״ן [בְּמִדְבַּר ח, ב] זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה **of blessed memory, wrote (Bamidbar 8:2), that it refers to the Chanukah lights — the difficulty on this was already raised in the Alshich (Bamidbar ibid.); see there.** דְּקָאֵי עַל נֵרוֹת חֲנוּכָּה[1269] כְּבָר הִקְשָׁה עַל זֶה [בְּמִדְבַּר שָׁם] עַיֵּין שָׁם[1270] בָּאַלְשִׁיךְ **And we have said that the matter of the lamps of the Mikdash alludes to the light of Torah she'b'al peh, for HaKadosh Baruch Hu, as it were, and about this it says,** וְאָמַרְנוּ דְּעִנְיַן נֵרוֹת הַמִּקְדָּשׁ מְרַמֵּז לְאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא כִּבְיָכוֹל שׁוֹמֵעַ לְבֵית דִּין שֶׁלְּמַטָּה וְעַל זֶה אָמַר בֹּא וְהָאֵר לִי **"Come and give light for Me."** וְזֶה הַהָאָרָה נִיתַּן **And this illumination was**

[1266] **Parallel: Maharal, Gevuros Hashem 69** — on "I have already instituted for them the order of offerings; when they read it I count it as if they offered them": "The offering is the return of the effect to its cause in deed, and the Torah of the offerings is the order of that return." Maharal explains why reading can atone as the act did, the premise of Rav Tzadok's claim that reading Parshas Shekalim completes atonement as in Temple times.

[1267] **Parallel: Rashi on Bamidbar 1:1** — "Out of their dearness before Him He counts them at every moment: when they left Egypt He counted them, when they fell through the Calf He counted them to know the number of those remaining." Rashi supplies the premise of Rav Tzadok's point: being counted is itself a sign of each Jew's importance before Hashem, which is exactly what arouses the accuser's challenge.

[1268] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 26** — "Just as there are 600,000 letters in the Torah, every soul of Yisrael has a special portion in the Torah… and the count is called 'lift the head,' for each has a particular elevation, since every portion of Torah or the Mishkan is needed, and if one is missing it is invalid." This explains why Hashem's counting of each soul signals a portion in Torah that no other Jew can fill.

[1269] **Parallel: Yisrael Kedoshim 10** — "He considered himself a better servant than they: they give only a half-shekel, and he can weigh ten thousand talents… but 'better a dry morsel with quiet than a house full of quarrelsome sacrifices'… though asleep from the mitzvos, 'my heart is awake.'" Rav Tzadok there adds the ground of Hashem's verdict: Yisrael's true inner will is always to do His will, even when outward deeds fall short.

[1270] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Savo 6** — "Segulah is a thing without reason… 'Yet I loved Yaakov': love even without any reason… in the World to Come Esav wraps himself in his tallis like an elder and sits beside Yaakov, wishing to resemble him." There Rav Tzadok joins this maamar's two ends: against Esav's imitation, Hashem testifies that Yisrael are bound to Him at the root, "our will is to do Your will."

given לְאַהֲרֹן הַכֹּהֵן **to Aharon HaKohen,** שֶׁהוּא יָאִיר בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל[1271] **that he should light up in the heart of Yisrael** אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the light of Torah she'b'al peh;** וְזֶהוּ לְעוֹלָם **and this is forever,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מַלְאָכִי ב, ז] **as it is said (Malachi 2:7):** כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן וְגוֹמֵר **"For the lips of the kohen," etc.,** וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ **"and they shall seek Torah from his mouth"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר א **(and it was explained in Chanukah, maamar 1,** וּשְׁאָר מְקוֹמוֹת**) and elsewhere).** וְכֵן עִנְיַן בִּרְכַּת כֹּהֲנִים. **And so too the matter of Birkas Kohanim.** שֶׁהוּא יְבָרֶכְךָ ה׳ [בְּמִדְבַּר ו, כד] **For it is "May Hashem bless you" (Bamidbar 6:24)** — דְּכָל בְּרָכָה הוּא רִיבּוּי **for every blessing is increase,** כְּמוֹ בְּרָכָה דְּדָגִים **like the blessing of the fish** וּבְרָכָה דְּאָדָם **and the blessing of man;** וְכֵן כָּאן יְבָרֶכְךָ **and so here, "May He bless you"** בְּרִיבּוּי הַשְׁפָּעָה **with an abundance of bestowal** בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **in Torah she'b'al peh;** וְיִשְׁמָרֶךָ **"and guard you"** — עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the manner of what is said:** כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת **"For the lips of the kohen shall guard knowledge."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּשְׁמוֹר הַטָּהֳרָה **That is, he will guard the purity** שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **of Yisrael,** שֶׁמְּכוּנֶּה בְּשֵׁם דַּעַת **which is called by the name "daas,"** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת לא, א) **in the manner of what they said (Shabbos 31a):** חָכְמַת זֶה סֵדֶר קָדָשִׁים **"'Wisdom' — this is Seder Kodashim;** וְדַעַת זֶה סֵדֶר טָהֳרוֹת[1272] **'and knowledge' — this is Seder Taharos."** **For Chochmah is called the Supernal Holiness** דְּחָכְמָה קֹדֶשׁ עִלָּאָה אִיקְרֵי [חֵלֶק ג סא, א] **in the holy Zohar (vol. III 61a),** בְּזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and "the Torah emerged from Chochmah,** מֵאֲתַר דְּאִקְרֵי קֹדֶשׁ **from the place called Kodesh"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב קכא, א) **(as it says, Zohar II 121a).** וְהַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **That is Torah she'b'chsav,** דְּמַאֲמָר יְהִי אוֹר **for the utterance "Let there be light"** נֶגֶד מִדַּת חָכְמָה **corresponds to the attribute of Chochmah,** שֶׁהוּא תְּחִלַּת הַהַכָּרָה **which is the beginning of recognition,** יֵשׁ מֵאַיִן **something from nothing;** דְּמַאֲמָר רִאשׁוֹן **whereas the First Utterance** לֵית בֵּיהּ תְּפִיסָה כְּלָל **has no grasp at all,** שֶׁהוּא שֵׂכֶל הַנֶּעְלָם **for it is the intellect hidden** מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן **from all thought.** וְחָמֵשׁ פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה **And the five times "light"** שֶׁבְּמַאֲמָר יְהִי אוֹר **in the utterance "Let there be light"** נֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **correspond to the five Chumashei Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ג, ה) **(as it says, Bereishis Rabbah 3:5).** וְדַעַת זֶה טָהֳרוֹת **And "knowledge — this is Taharos"** נֶגֶד תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **corresponds to Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁבָּא הָרַב חָכְמָה **in which the "abundance of wisdom" comes** לְטַהֵר וּלְתַקֵּן הָרַב כַּעַס **to purify and repair the "abundance of anger."** שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת הַכֹּל כָּלוּל **For in truth everything is included** בַּחֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **in the five Chumashei Torah;** (קִידּוּשִׁין ל, ב) **and the essence of what they said (Kiddushin 30b),** וְעִיקַּר מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בָּרָאתִי יֵצֶר הָרָע **"I created the yetzer hara** וּבָרָאתִי לוֹ תּוֹרָה תַּבְלִין **and I created Torah as its antidote,"** הַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **refers to Torah she'b'chsav.** וְלוּלֵי הַקִּלְקוּל **And were it not for the corruption,** הָיָה דַּי בַּחֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **the five Chumashei Torah would have sufficed** לְתַבֵּל הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **to counteract the yetzer hara,** וְשֶׁלֹּא יִמָּסְרוּ בְּיָדוֹ **so that they not be delivered into its hand.** רַק אַחַר שֶׁקִּלְקְלוּ **Only after they corrupted** וְנִצְרָךְ לְתַקֵּן הָרַב כַּעַס **and it became necessary to repair the "abundance of anger"** הוּצְרְכוּ לְרַב חָכְמָה **did they need the "abundance of wisdom"** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh.** (כִּי תִשָּׂא, לא ג) וְזֶה דַּעַת שֶׁפֵּירֵשׁ רַשׁ״י **And this is "daas," which Rashi explained (Ki Sisa 31:3)** שֶׁהוּא רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **as ruach hakodesh** — כְּלוֹמַר רוּחַ **meaning, a spirit** מֵהַהוּא קֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא **from that Kodesh Above** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג סא, א) **(as it says, Zohar III 61a).** וּכְבָר כָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ״ן **And the Ramban already wrote** (בָּבָא בַּתְרָא יב, א דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל הָא) **(Bava Basra 12a, s.v. Ha)** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה בָּא **that Torah she'b'al peh comes** עַל יְדֵי רוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **through ruach hakodesh;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמְּקַבֵּל מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **that is, it receives from Torah she'b'chsav,** קֹדֶשׁ דִּלְעֵילָּא **the Kodesh Above.** וְזֶהוּ דַּעַת סֵדֶר טָהֳרוֹת **And this is "daas," Seder Taharos:** לְטַהֵר הַלֵּב **to purify the heart,** כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ **"the fool's at his left."** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And about this it is said:** שֶׁשּׁוֹמֵר הַטָּהֳרָה שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל — כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת **"For the lips of the kohen shall guard knowledge"** **that he guards the purity of Yisrael,** לְהוֹרִיק הָרַע מִלֵּב כְּסִיל **emptying out the evil from the fool's heart.** וְזֶה נִיתַּן גַּם כֵּן **And this too was given** לְאַהֲרֹן וּבָנָיו **to Aharon and his sons;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ וְיִשְׁמָרֶךָ **and this is what they said, "and guard you"** — מִן הָרַע **from evil,** שֶׁלֹּא יִכָּנֵס לְלֵב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ **that it not enter the heart, "the**

[1271] **Parallel: Be'er Mayim Chaim, Bereishis 44:18** — "When the will of the forehead of Atika Kadisha is revealed… then 'they remain outside and do not enter, these brazen dogs,' for this light blinds their eyes and they are forced to flee from it." This explains why the third meal's revelation of the will of wills is precisely what bars Amalek and Haman: their accusation cannot bear that light.

[1272] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Parshas Shekalim 12** — "At the plague of the firstborn … Yisrael were shown to be bound at the root … but only for the moment; afterward, at the splitting of the Yam Suf, the prince of Egypt accused." The parallel explains why the Nissan redemption had to come from Hashem alone. Yisrael's bond at the root was shown only for a moment, and the accusation that they were idolaters like Egypt was still open at the sea.

שֶׁזּוֹכִין בְּחִיבּוּר חָכְמָה שֶׁבַּמּוֹחַ עִם בִּינָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב. **which one merits by joining the wisdom in the mind with the understanding in the heart.** וְזֶהוּ עַל יְדֵי בְּחִינַת הַדַּעַת **And this is through the aspect of Daas, fool's at his left."**

וּמִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ הַסֵּדֶר מִקּוֹדֶם הַחָכְמָה **And from the side of Hashem Yisbarach, the order is first wisdom** וְאַחַר כָּךְ דַּעַת שֶׁהוּא הַטָּהֳרָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר מַאֲמַר אָנֹכִי **and afterward daas, which is the purity, as was said: the utterance "Anochi,"** שֶׁנִּתְקַע תַּלְמוּד תּוֹרָה בְּלִבָּם **through which Torah study was implanted in their heart,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ לֹא יִהְיֶה שֶׁנַּעֲקַר יֵצֶר הָרָע מִלִּבָּם[1273] **and afterward "Lo yihyeh," through which the yetzer hara was uprooted from their heart** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה, א, טו) **(as it says, Shir HaShirim Rabbah 1:15).**

וְכֵן אַבְרָהָם וְאַחַר כָּךְ יִצְחָק יָצַר ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ הַנְּפָשׁוֹת **And so Hashem Yisbarach formed the souls: Avraham and afterward Yitzchak.** אֲבָל מִצַּד הָאָדָם מָה ה' שֹׁאֵל כִּי אִם **But from the side of man, "What does Hashem ask** לְיִרְאָה **but to fear,"** וְאַחַר כָּךְ זוֹכִין לְחָכְמָה **and afterward one merits wisdom** וְהָאַהֲבָה מִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **and love from the side of Hashem Yisbarach —** סוּר מֵרָע וַעֲשֵׂה טוֹב[1274] **"Turn from evil and do good."**

וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And as they said** (יְרוּשַׁלְמִי שְׁקָלִים פֶּרֶק ג הֲלָכָה ג יד, ב) **(Yerushalmi Shekalim, perek 3, halachah 3, 14b):** טָהֳרָה מְבִיאָה לִידֵי קְדוּשָׁה[1275] **"Purity brings to holiness,** [וַיִּקְרָא טז, יט] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Vayikra 16:19),** וְטִהֲרוֹ וְקִדְּשׁוֹ **'and he shall purify it and sanctify it.'"**

וְכֵן סֵדֶר סְעוּדוֹת שַׁבָּת **And so the order of the Shabbos meals:** חָשַׁב הָאַרִ״י זַ״ל **the Arizal reckoned** [פְּרִי עֵץ חַיִּים שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת פֶּרֶק יז] **(Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos, chapter 17)** מִקּוֹדֶם **first** דְּלֵיל שַׁבָּת לְיִצְחָק **that of Shabbos night, for Yitzchak,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בַּבּוֹקֶר **and afterward, in the morning,** סְעוּדָתָא דְּאַבְרָהָם.[1276] **the meal of Avraham.**

וּבֶאֱמֶת זֶה הַכֹּחַ **And in truth this power** נִיתַּן לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **was given to Moshe Rabbeinu,** שֶׁכָּל עִיקַּר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **for the whole essence of Torah she'b'al peh** הוּא רָמוּז וְכָלוּל **is alluded to and included** בַּתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **in the Torah she'b'chsav,** (תַּעֲנִית ט, א) שֶׁאַף עַל פִּי כְּתוּבִים אֵיתָא **so that even about the Kesuvim it says (Taanis 9a):** מִי אִיכָּא כּוֹ׳ דְּלָא רְמִיזִי **"Is there anything, etc., that is not alluded to in the Torah?"** בְּאוֹרַיְיתָא[1277] וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And as we have said,** דְּמֵהַאי טַעְמָא נֶאֱמַר **that for this reason it is said** בְּפָרָשַׁת הַנֵּרוֹת [שְׁמוֹת כז, כ] **in the parsha of the lamps (Shemos 27:20),** וְיִקְחוּ אֵלֶיךָ שֶׁמֶן וְגוֹמֵר **"And they shall take to you oil," etc.** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת תְּצַוֶּה מַאֲמָר א) **(as was explained in Parshas Tetzaveh, maamar 1),** שֶׁצָּרִיךְ לִיקַּח זֶה **that this must be taken** לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **to Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** וְהוּא הַנּוֹתֵן הַכֹּחַ לְאַהֲרֹן **and he gives the power to Aharon,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹשְׁבִינָא דְּמַטְרוֹנִיתָא **who is the groomsman of the Queen,** לְהַעֲלוֹת נֵר תָּמִיד **to kindle the perpetual lamp —** אוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the light of Torah she'b'al peh —** בְּלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל. **in the heart of Yisrael.**

וְזֶה הָעִנְיָן שֶׁקּוֹרִין **And this is the matter of reading** פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **Parshas Parah** וְאַחַר כָּךְ פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **and afterward Parshas HaChodesh.** וְאִיתָא בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **And it says in the Yerushalmi** (מְגִילָּה פֶּרֶק ג הֲלָכָה ה כה, ב) **(Megillah, perek 3, halachah 5, 25b),** הוּבָא בְּפֵירוּשׁ רַשׁ״י **cited in Rashi's commentary** (מְגִילָּה כט, א דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל בִּרְבִיעִית) **(Megillah 29a, s.v. B'revi'is):** בְּדִין הוּא שֶׁבְּאֶחָד בְּנִיסָן הוּקַם הַמִּשְׁכָּן שֶׁתִּקְדִּים הַחֹדֶשׁ לְפָרָה **"By right HaChodesh should precede Parah, for on the first of Nisan the Mishkan was erected,** וּבַשֵּׁנִי נִשְׂרְפָה הַפָּרָה **and on the second the Parah was burned.** וְלָמָּה פָּרָה

[1273] **Parallel: Sefas Emes, Purim 5661** — "This is the portion of Torah she'b'al peh within the souls of Yisrael … through the miracle the love for Torah in Yisrael's hearts was awakened; this came through the fall of Haman and Amalek." The Sefas Emes adds that Purim's love for Torah was already latent in Yisrael's souls. Wiping out Amalek, who stands to cancel that love, released it, and the joy follows.

[1274] **Parallel: Maharal, Netzach Yisrael 11** — "When they took upon themselves on their own the reading of the Megillah, which they were not compelled to do … in the days of Achashverosh they accepted the whole Torah, with no coercion." Maharal explains how the acceptance in Achashverosh's days came from Yisrael's own side: they took on Megillah reading, a mitzvah beyond the Torah, voluntarily. That is the self-initiated acceptance from which, Rav Tzadok says, the joy comes.

[1275] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Parshas Zachor 13** — "'Honor' is the head-tefillin, showing that Yisrael are bound at the root above human understanding … therefore Torah she'b'al peh, which comes from the dew of Atika, is called 'every precious thing.'" The parallel gives the reason yakar means the Oral Torah: it flows from the level above intellect, so the sages could see what Moshe did not. This is the level Amalek's accusation tried to block.

[1276] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Purim 2** — "Even the galbanum, which alludes to the sinners of Yisrael, gives a good fragrance inside the ketores … 'these and those are destined to give fragrance' (Eruvin 21b)." Here Rav Tzadok gives the Talmudic basis for the idea that even the sinners give off a good fragrance at the root. It surfaces through Mordechai, the root of Torah she'b'al peh.

[1277] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 19** — "The revelation of this light is on every Purim and in the whole month of Adar … then it is revealed that their kingship too is in Hashem's hand—that is, in Yisrael's hand." Resisei Layla explains why a Jew should seek judgment in Adar: in this month the Shechinah within Yisrael is shown to rule even the nations' kings. So the holiness of the month comes through Yisrael.

קוֹדֶמֶת **So why does Parah come first?** שֶׁהִיא טָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **Because it is the purification of all Yisrael."** וְצָרִיךְ לְהָבִין **Now we must understand:** מַה זֶּה תֵּירוּץ **what kind of answer is this** בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **in the present time,** שֶׁאֵין לָנוּ מִקְדָּשׁ וְאֵפָר פָּרָה **when we have no Mikdash and no ashes of the Parah?** וְאִם נִזְכֶּה וְיִבָּנֶה הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **And if we merit that the Mikdash be built,** יוֹדִיעוּ מְקוֹם אֵפֶר פָּרָה **they will make known the place of the Parah's ashes,** וְיוּקְדַּם טָהֳרָתָן לְפֶסַח **and their purification will precede Pesach.** אַךְ נִרְאֶה **But it appears** דְּמִדְכְתִיב זֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **that since it is written "This is the statute of the Torah,"** וְלֹא כְּתִיב זֹאת חֻקַּת הַפָּרָה **and not "This is the statute of the Parah,"** [שְׁמוֹת יב, מג] כְּעֵין דִּכְתִיב זֹאת חֻקַּת הַפֶּסַח **as it is written "This is the statute of the Pesach" (Shemos 12:43),** בָּא לְרַמֵּז **it comes to allude,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁמָּצִינוּ **in the manner of what we find** (מְנָחוֹת קי, א) **(Menachos 110a),** [וַיִּקְרָא ו, יח] שֶׁדָּרְשׁוּ זֹאת תּוֹרַת הַחַטָּאת **that they expounded: "This is the law of the sin-offering" (Vayikra 6:18)** [שָׁם ז, א] וְזֹאת תּוֹרַת הָאָשָׁם **and "This is the law of the guilt-offering" (ibid. 7:1) —** כָּל הָעוֹסֵק בְּתוֹרַת חַטָּאת **"Whoever occupies himself with the law of the sin-offering** כְּאִלּוּ הִקְרִיב חַטָּאת[1278] **is as though he offered a sin-offering,** וְכוּלֵי **and whoever," etc.** וְכֵן זֹאת [שָׁם, לז] הַתּוֹרָה לָעוֹלָה **And likewise, "This is the law of the burnt-offering" (ibid. 37):** כָּל הָעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה **"Whoever occupies himself with Torah** אֵין צָרִיךְ לֹא עוֹלָה וכו' **needs neither a burnt-offering," etc.;** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** כֵּן נִרְמַז כָּאן **So too it is alluded to here,** בְּמַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ זֹאת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **in what they said, "This is the statute of the Torah,"** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **that through the reading of the parsha** יִהְיֶה כְּאִלּוּ הַכֹּהֵן **it will be as though the kohen** שׂוֹרֵף הַפָּרָה **burns the Parah** וּמְטַהֵר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **and purifies Yisrael.** וּכְעֵין שֶׁמָּצִינוּ **And similar to what we find** לְעִנְיַן פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **regarding Parshas Shekalim** (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא ג) **(Midrash Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 3):** כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאַתָּה עוֹמֵד כּוּ' **"Just as you stand, etc.,** וְאַתָּה זוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁן **and you raise up their heads,** כָּךְ בְּכָל שָׁנָה וְשָׁנָה **so every single year** שֶׁקּוֹרְאִין אוֹתָהּ לְפָנַי **that they read it before Me,** כְּאִלּוּ אַתָּה עוֹמֵד שָׁם **it is as though you stand there** בְּאוֹתָהּ שָׁעָה **at that time** וְזוֹקֵף אֶת רֹאשָׁן כּוּ' **and raise up their heads," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁפּוֹעֵל הַקְּרִיאָה בַּפָּרָשָׁה **That is, the reading of the parsha accomplishes,** וְהַחֶשֶׁק שֶׁיֵּשׁ בַּלֵּב[1279] **together with the longing in the heart** לְקַיְּמוֹ כְּפִי שֶׁיּוּכַל **to fulfill it when one is able,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהָיָה מְקַיְּמוֹ בְּפוֹעַל **as though he fulfilled it in deed** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר שְׁקָלִים מַאֲמָר ב) **(as was explained in Shekalim, maamar 2).** וּכְמוֹ כֵן פּוֹעֵל הַקְּרִיאָה **And likewise the reading accomplishes,** בְּפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה **in Parshas Parah,** עִנְיַן טָהֳרַת הַלֵּב **the purification of the heart** מִטּוּמְאַת הַנֶּפֶשׁ. **from the tumah of the soul.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said:** שֶׁהִיא טָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **"For it is the purification of all Yisrael."** וּמִכָּאן סַעַד וְסָמָךְ **And from here there is support and basis** לְהַפּוֹסְקִים **for the poskim** דְּקְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא[1280] **that the reading of Parshas Parah is d'Oraisa,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁהֵבִיא בְּשׁוּלְחָן עָרוּךְ **as the Shulchan Aruch brings** (אוֹרַח חַיִּים סִימָן תרפ"ה סָעִיף ז) **(Orach Chaim, siman 685, se'if 7).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **And this is what they said in the Yerushalmi,** דְּמֵהַאי טַעְמָא **that for this reason** הִקְדִּימוּהָ לְפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה **they put Parshas Parah first,** שֶׁהִיא טָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **for it is the purification of Yisrael;** וְלָכֵן צָרִיךְ לְהַקְדִּימָהּ **and therefore it must precede** לְפָרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **Parshas HaChodesh,** שֶׁהוּא הַתְחָלַת דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **which is the beginning of the words of Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב לט, ב) **as they said (Zohar II 39b),** שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה צָרִיךְ לְהַתְחִיל אֶלָּא מֵהַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם. **that it needed to begin only from "This month shall be for you."** וּמִצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **And from the side of Hashem Yisbarach,** נֶאֱמַר מִקּוֹדֶם פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **Parshas HaChodesh was said first,** שֶׁהוּא דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **which is the words of Torah,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ פָּרָה **and afterward Parah;** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **and as we said,** שֶׁמִּצַּד ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **that from the side of Hashem Yisbarach** מִקּוֹדֶם חָכְמָה קְדוּשָּׁה **first comes wisdom, holiness,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ טָהֳרָה. **and afterward purity:** אָנֹכִי וְלֹא יִהְיֶה. **"Anochi" and "Lo yihyeh."** אֲבָל מִצַּד יִשְׂרָאֵל **But from the side of Yisrael** פָּרָה קוֹדֶמֶת **Parah comes first,** שֶׁהִיא טָהֳרָתָן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **for it is the purification of**

[1278] **Parallel: Likkutei Maamarim, LeSiyum HaShas 11** — "His downfall is through the amei ha'aretz more than through talmidei chachamim … when Esav's hands rule, the victory is only through the hands—practical mitzvos, found mainly among the amei ha'aretz." The parallel gives a further reason the villagers come first in the war against Amalek: when the hands of Esav rule, their practical mitzvos are what defeat him.

[1279] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 4** — "Kuf is the ape that follows a man to resemble him in everything, for man was created 'in our image' only by way of resemblance, like an ape; from this comes the power of imagination." Rav Tzadok shows there that the same imitating power has two sides: as holy imitation of the Shechinah it is 'kuf kadosh,' and turned outward it builds the eshes zenunim. This prepares the turn here to the serpent's 'you will be like God.'

[1280] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 17** — "Through the forgetting they toiled … until Osniel ben Kenaz restored them through his pilpul; this is the beginning of Torah she'b'al peh … the nations thought his death was the abolition of Torah." This is Haman's mistake in its source. Moshe's death carved the power of Torah understanding into every Jewish heart, which the nations could not see.

Yisrael, כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל.[1281] **as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And this is what they said in the Pesikta,** שֶׁלֹּא תָּזוּז מִמֶּנּוּ הַפָּרָשָׁה הַזֹּאת **that there was given to Aharon** שֶׁנִּתְּנָה לוֹ לְאַהֲרֹן **this parsha,** וְלֹא מִבָּנָיו כּוּ׳ **that it shall not depart from him nor from his sons, etc.,** עַד סוֹף כָּל הַדּוֹרוֹת. **until the end of all the generations.** שֶׁעִנְיַן פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **For the matter of this parsha** נוֹהֵג לְעוֹלָם **applies forever:** שֶׁאַף בְּשָׁעָה שֶׁאֵין מִקְדָּשׁ **even at a time when there is no Mikdash,** מוֹעִיל קְרִיאַת תּוֹרַת הַפָּרָה **the reading of the Torah-portion of the Parah is effective,** כְּאִלּוּ נַעֲשָׂה הַפָּרָה **as though the Parah were made** עַל יְדֵי הַכֹּהֲנִים **by the kohanim,** וְשׁוֹמְרֵי דַּעַת **the guardians of the daas,** הַטָּהֳרָה שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **the purity of Yisrael.** וּבְפָרָשָׁה זוֹ נֶאֱמַר גַּם כֵּן **And in this parsha it also says,** שֶׁזֶּה גַּם כֵּן נִיתַּן **for this too was given** וְיִקְחוּ אֵלֶיךָ פָּרָה וְגוֹמֵר **"And they shall take to you a cow," etc.,** לְמֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **to Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹשְׁבִינָא דְּמַלְכָּא **who is the groomsman of the King,** שֶׁהוֹרִיד הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **who brought down the Torah she'b'chsav** מִן הַשָּׁמַיִם **from Heaven;** וּמֵהַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **and from the Torah she'b'chsav** בָּא הַכֹּחַ לְאַהֲרֹן **comes the power to Aharon,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹשְׁבִינָא דְּמַלְכְּתָא[1282] **who is the groomsman of the Queen** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֶלֶק ג נג, ב) **(as it says, Zohar III 53b),** לְטַהֵר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **to purify Yisrael,** [מַלְאָכִי ב, ז] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Malachi 2:7):** כִּי שִׂפְתֵי כֹהֵן יִשְׁמְרוּ דַעַת **"For the lips of the kohen shall guard knowledge,** וְתוֹרָה יְבַקְשׁוּ מִפִּיהוּ. **and they shall seek Torah from his mouth."** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **And as we said** לְעִנְיַן פָּרָשַׁת הַנֵּרוֹת **regarding the parsha of the lamps,** דִּכְתִיב גַּם כֵּן **where it is also written,** וְיִקְחוּ אֵלֶיךָ שֶׁמֶן וְגוֹמֵר **"And they shall take to you oil," etc.,** וְעַל יְדֵי מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **and through Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** נִמְסַר הַכֹּחַ לְאַהֲרֹן **the power was transmitted to Aharon,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְקוֹרִין פָּרָשַׁת בְּשַׁבָּת פָּרָה **And Parshas Parah is read on Shabbos,** שֶׁאָז יִחוּד **for then is the union** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וּשְׁכִינְתֵּיהּ **of Kudsha Brich Hu and His Shechinah;** [וְעַל כֵּן אוֹמְרִים בַּזְּמָר **and therefore we say (in the Arizal's zemer for Shabbos night),** קְרִיבוּ שׁוֹשְׁבִינִין[1283] **"Draw near, groomsmen,"** שֶׁהֵם מֹשֶׁה שׁוֹשְׁבִינָא דְּמַלְכָּא **who are Moshe, groomsman of the King,** וְאַהֲרֹן שׁוֹשְׁבִינָא דְּמַלְכְּתָא **and Aharon, groomsman of the Queen,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** (וְאִיתָא תַּנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא טז) **And it says (Tanchuma, Ki Sisa 16):** שְׁנֵי לוּחוֹת **"Two Luchos —** כְּנֶגֶד חָתָן וְכַלָּה **corresponding to groom and bride,** וּכְנֶגֶד שְׁנֵי שׁוֹשְׁבִינִין[1284] כּוּ׳ **and corresponding to the two groomsmen," etc.** וּדְכוּלֵי עָלְמָא **And all agree** בְּשַׁבָּת נִיתְּנָה תּוֹרָה **that the Torah was given on Shabbos,** (שַׁבָּת פו, ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Shabbos 86b);** (וְאִיתָא זֹהַר חֶלֶק א מז, ב) **and it says (Zohar I 47b):** יוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **"The seventh day —** דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּאִיהוּ יוֹם שְׁבִיעִי **which is the seventh day";** וְהַיְינוּ מַלְכוּת פֶּה **that is, "Malchus is the mouth;** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרִינָן לַהּ. **we call it Torah she'b'al peh."** וּכְשֶׁיֵּשׁ חָתָן וְכַלָּה **And when there are groom and bride,** יֵשׁ שְׁנֵי שׁוֹשְׁבִינִין **there are two groomsmen;** וְאָז זְמַן חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **and then is the time of "the statute of the Torah,"** שֶׁיּוּחְקַק דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה בַּלֵּב **that the words of Torah be engraved in the heart.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what is said:** וְחֹק נָתַן לָמוֹ. **"And the statute He gave them."**

[1281] **Parallel: Beis Yaakov, Purim, s.v. BaLaylah HaHu** — "Adar was created with the letter kuf … all the laughter and joy given to this world is only like a monkey before a man." The Izhbitz tradition reads the same Sefer Yetzirah line in the same way. Laughter in this world is only an imitation of the laughter of 'then our mouth will be filled,' so even the joy of the redemption will seem like a monkey's copy beside what follows it.

[1282] **Parallel: Kedushas Levi, Terumah** — "When the worlds gaze at the Creator's brightness they are in awe until they are nullified, and have no joy … the main joy is when they return to themselves … this is 'when Adar enters.'" Like Rav Tzadok, the Berditchever puts the joy of Adar after awe. He adds that Adar (from aderes, a garment) is the clothing of the light in nature, the way the Purim miracle came.

[1283] **Parallel: Tzidkas HaTzaddik 260** — "This is the reason for 'He plays with Leviathan,' as I wrote elsewhere: Leviathan and the wild ox are the yetzer of desire and of murder, which the Holy One will slaughter in the future." Rav Tzadok gives the same pairing there. He adds that since the destruction there is no laughter above, because the Shechinah is in exile and the forces of evil draw from human sin, the same reason given here.

[1284] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 19** — "The Purim feast tasted of the holiness of the future meal of Leviathan, the wild ox and the preserved wine, merited through victory over three yetzarim: desire, anger and pride." This ties the future meal here to Adar. The Purim seudah, set in the month of laughter, is a foretaste of the joy that comes when the yetzarim are defeated.

פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה, מַאֲמָר ה׳ Parshas Parah — Maamar Hei

"We do not interrupt between Parah and HaChodesh. אֵין מַפְסִיקִין בֵּין פָּרָה לְהַחֹדֶשׁ **In the Yerushalmi (Megillah 3:5, 25b):** (מְגִילָּה פֶּרֶק ג הֲלָכָה ה כה, ב בַּיְרוּשַׁלְמִי

Rabbi Levi said: אָמַר רַבִּי לֵוִי[1285] **The sign for these parshiyos is** סִימָנֵיהוֹן דְּאִילֵּין פָּרָשָׁתָא **'Between these cups — if he wishes to drink, he may drink; between the third and the fourth he may not drink.'"** [פְּסָחִים בֵּין הַכּוֹסוֹת הַלָּלוּ אִם רָצָה לִשְׁתּוֹת יִשְׁתֶּה בֵּין הַשְּׁלִישִׁי לָרְבִיעִי לֹא יִשְׁתֶּה[1286]

And certainly the words of the Yerushalmi are not said merely as a mnemonic sign, but rather because in essence they are one root: וּבְוַדַּאי אֵין דִּבְרֵי הַיְרוּשַׁלְמִי נֶאֱמָרִים רַק מִפְּנֵי שֶׁבְּעֶצֶם הַמָּה רַק לְסִימָן בְּעָלְמָא שֹׁרֶשׁ אֶחָד עִנְיַן קְרִיאַת הָאַרְבַּע פָּרָשִׁיוֹת

the matter of reading the four parshiyos together with the four cups, which correspond to the four expressions of redemption stated in Egypt: עִם הָאַרְבָּעָה שֶׁהֵם כְּנֶגֶד אַרְבַּע לְשׁוֹנוֹת כּוֹסוֹת שֶׁל גְּאוּלָה[1287] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בְּמִצְרַיִם **"I will take out," "I will rescue," "I will redeem," and "I will take."** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פח, ה). **(As is written in Bereishis Rabbah 88:5.)** וְהוֹצֵאתִי וְהִצַּלְתִּי וְגָאַלְתִּי וְלָקַחְתִּי **Now, "I will take out," "I will rescue," and "I will redeem" — and they allude to the purification of the soul** וְהֵם מְרַמְּזִים עַל טָהֳרַת הַנֶּפֶשׁ **all of them signify going out from evil, from the three kelipos of impurity:** כּוּלָּם מַשְׁמָעוּתָם הֲיצִיאָה מֵרָע מִשָּׁלֹשׁ קְלִיפּוֹת הַטּוּמְאָה

jealousy, desire, and honor, which remove a person from the world [אָבוֹת הַקִּנְאָה וְהַתַּאֲוָה וְהַכָּבוֹד שֶׁמּוֹצִיאִין אֶת הָאָדָם מִן הָעוֹלָם[1288] **(Avos 4:21).** פֶּרֶק ד מִשְׁנָה כא]. **And they are the three kinds of impurity of the soul: the metzora, the zav, and one impure through a corpse.** וְהֵם שָׁלֹשׁ מִינֵי טוּמְאַת הַנֶּפֶשׁ צָרוּעַ וְזָב וְטָמֵא לָנֶפֶשׁ

For tzaraas is anger and jealousy, for which he is sent out even from the camp of Yisrael, because this trait has no root at all in holiness. כִּי צָרַעַת הִיא הַכַּעַס וְהַקִּנְאָה אֲשֶׁר הוּא מְשׁוּלָּח גַּם מִמַּחֲנֵה יִשְׂרָאֵל מִפְּנֵי שֶׁמִּדָּה זוֹ אֵין לָהּ שׁוּם שׁוֹרֶשׁ בִּקְדוּשָּׁה וְעַל זֶה בָּא

And for this the rectification comes in Parshas Shekalim, for it is stated (Bereishis Rabbah 84:18): וְעַל זֶה הַתִּיקּוּן בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים דְּאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פד, יח **"You sold Rachel's son for twenty pieces of silver;** אַתֶּם מְכַרְתֶּם בְּנָהּ שֶׁל רָחֵל בְּעֶשְׂרִים כֶּסֶף[1289] **therefore each and every one shall owe a beka per head, half a shekel"** (וְכֵן הוּא בְּתַנְחוּמָא כִּי תִשָּׂא י לְפִיכָךְ יִהְיֶה כָּל אֶחָד וְאֶחָד מַגִּיעוֹ בֶּקַע לַגּוּלְגֹּלֶת מַחֲצִית הַשֶּׁקֶל

(and so it is in Tanchuma Ki Sisa 10 and in Yerushalmi Shekalim 2:3, 9b). וּבִירוּשַׁלְמִי שְׁקָלִים פֶּרֶק ב הֲלָכָה ג ט, ב

And the sale of Yosef came from jealousy, וּמְכִירַת יוֹסֵף הָיָה מִצַּד קִנְאָה **as it says (Bereishis 37:11), "His brothers were jealous of him."** [בְּרֵאשִׁית לז, יא] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וַיְקַנְאוּ בוֹ אֶחָיו.

And the zav, which comes from desire, is sent out only from the Levite camp, because it has a root in holiness — the yearning for Torah — וְזָב הַבָּא מִצַּד תַּאֲוָה אֵינוֹ מְשׁוּלָּח רַק מִמַּחֲנֵה לְוִיָּה מִפְּנֵי שֶׁיֵּשׁ לוֹ שֹׁרֶשׁ בִּקְדוּשָּׁה לַחֲמִידוּ דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא שֶׁלָּזֶה נִבְרָא הַיֵּצֶר[1290] **for this the yetzer was created, being a longing, along the lines of what is said (I Divrei HaYamim** שֶׁהוּא חֵשֶׁק עַל דָּרָךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א כט, יח

[1285] **Parallel: Shem MiShmuel, Pekudei (Adar Sheni)** — "Adar is the sign of fish, which have no warmth; therefore Haman's lot fell in Adar, which suits their nature and power." The Shem MiShmuel connects the fish-month to the cooling of Amalek ('asher karcha') and to Achashverosh's feast, where laughter leads to lewdness. Yisrael, like Moshe, born in Adar, stand above mazal and can turn its sign around.

[1286] **Parallel: Megaleh Amukos, VaEschanan, ofen 124** — "Yehoshua began to fight Amalek, whose power is the dog … therefore Esther said, 'from the power of the dog, my only one' (Megillah 15b), for she called Achashverosh a dog." The Kabbalistic tradition also names Amalek's power 'dog.' It ties this to the Purim story: the kelipah that Esther faced in Achashverosh's palace is the same dog-kelipah that Adar's war on Amalek must break.

[1287] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Parshas Shekalim 12** — "Shevat was formed with tzadi, the time to repair the tzaddik's flaw … then comes Adar, formed with kuf, 'kuf kadosh,' set apart for wiping out Amalek, the opposite of the tzaddik's holiness." The same order of months appears there, and it adds a step. The repair of Shevat and the kedushah of Adar together prepare for Nissan, 'in which they are destined to be redeemed.'

[1288] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 58** — "The end of all the holiness of times that Yisrael establish—excluding Shabbos, which is fixed and permanent; after it there is no further holiness of time until Rosh Chodesh Nissan." Resisei Layla gives the place of Adar in the year. As the last month, it completes the holiness that comes from Yisrael's side, and Nissan opens a new order.

[1289] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 19** — "Shabbos is called a 'good gift,' for it is holiness fixed and permanent from Hashem Himself … and a Yom Tov, which Yisrael sanctify, is also called Shabbos, for fixed holiness was drawn down to them." Rav Tzadok explains there how the two holinesses meet. Yisrael's effort to bring holiness draws down the fixed holiness from above. This is why Rosh Chodesh Adar on Shabbos makes holiness easy to reach.

[1290] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pesach 43** — "'To know (le'de'ah) what would be done to him'—it should have said 'to see'; so it was through ruach hakodesh … this is da'as, the inner aspect of Keser." Citing the Mechilta ('de'ah is nothing but ruach hakodesh'), Rav Tzadok gives the Midrashic basis for equating da'as with ruach hakodesh, which is assumed here. Miriam's 'standing' by the river was da'as from above, beyond what the mind could see.

29:18), לְיֵצֶר מַחְשְׁבוֹת לְבַב עַמֶּךָ. **"the inclination of the thoughts of the heart of Your people."** רַק אַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה אוֹתוֹ רָע[1291] **It is only you who make it bad** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא בְּרֵאשִׁית ז). **(as is written in Midrash Tanchuma Bereishis 7).** וְעַל כָּל פָּנִים בְּמַחֲנֵה לְוִיָּה **And in any case, into the Levite camp,** שֶׁהֵם בְּנֵי תוֹרָה **who are bnei Torah,** [כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר דְּבָרִים י, ט] **as it says (Devarim 10:9),** ה' הוּא נַחֲלָתוֹ **"Hashem is his inheritance,"** וְנוֹטֵל מַעֲשֵׂר **and he takes ma'aser** כְּדֵי שֶׁיִּהְיֶה פָּנוּי לַתּוֹרָה. **so that he will be free for Torah** — לְשָׁם אֵינוֹ נִכְנָס **there it does not enter,** כִּי הַתּוֹרָה הוּא תַּבְלִין לְיֵצֶר הָרָע **for the Torah is the antidote to the yetzer hara,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה נב, ב) **as they said (Sukkah 52b):** אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנוּוָּל זֶה **"If this repulsive one meets you"** — וְהֵיינוּ יֵצֶר הָרָע דְּתַאֲוָה. מְשָׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ **meaning the yetzer hara of desire — "drag him to the beis medrash."** וְעַל זֶה בָּא קְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת זָכוֹר **And for this comes the reading of Parshas Zachor,** לִמְחוֹת זֵכֶר עֲמָלֵק **to wipe out the memory of Amalek** שֶׁל קְלִיפָּה זוֹ **of this kelipah,** [כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר דְּבָרִים כה, יח] **as it says (Devarim 25:18),** אֲשֶׁר קָרְךָ **"who happened upon you,"** (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תֵּצֵא ט) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Midrash Tanchuma Ki Seitzei 9):** קָרְךָ טִמְּאֲךָ **"'Karcha' — he defiled you,** [דְּבָרִים כג, יא][1292] כְּמָה דְאַתְּ אָמַר **as it says (Devarim 23:11),** אֲשֶׁר לֹא יִהְיֶה טָהוֹר מִקְרֵה לָיְלָה, **'who will not be pure from a nocturnal occurrence';** וְגַם שֶׁהָיָה זוֹרֵק מִילוֹת **and also that he would hurl the circumcised members** כְּלַפֵּי מַעְלָה וְכוּ'. **toward Heaven," etc.** וְטָמֵא לָנֶפֶשׁ **And impurity through the dead** בָּא מִצַּד כָּבוֹד וְהִתְנַשְּׂאוּת **comes from honor and self-exaltation,** שֶׁזֶּה בָּא מֵעֲטָיוֹ שֶׁל נָחָשׁ **for this comes through the counsel of the serpent,** שֶׁהֵבִיא מִיתָה לָעוֹלָם **who brought death to the world** בְּמַה שֶׁהִכְנִיס בְּלִבָּם **by what he put into their hearts:** [בְּרֵאשִׁית ג, ה] וִהְיִיתֶם כֵּאלֹהִים. **"and you will be like God" (Bereishis 3:5).** וְזֶה עִיקַּר שֹׁרֶשׁ **And this is the main root** שֶׁל מַלְכִין קַדְמָאִין דְּמִיתוּ **of the primordial kings who died** מִצַּד הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת שֶׁלָּהֶם **because of their self-exaltation** — אֲנִי אֶמְלוֹךְ כְּיָדוּעַ **"I will reign" — as is known.** וְזֶה נִסְתָּעֵף מִצַּד **And this branched out from** הִשְׁתַּלְשְׁלוּת צִמְצוּם הַבְּרִיאָה **the unfolding of the tzimtzum of creation,** שֶׁהָיָה בִּלְבוּשׁ הִתְנַשְּׂאוּת **which was in a garment of exaltation,** שֶׁאֵין מֶלֶךְ בְּלֹא עַם[1293] **for there is no king without a people,** [כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר תְּהִלִּים צג, א] **as it says (Tehillim 93:1),** ה' מָלָךְ גֵּאוּת לָבֵשׁ. **"Hashem reigns, He is clothed in majesty."** וְזֶהוּ אֵינוֹ מְשׁוּלָּח **And this one is sent out** רַק מִמַּחֲנֵה שְׁכִינָה **only from the camp of the Shechinah,** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁמַּבִּירוּר זֶה **because the refinement of this** נוֹגֵעַ גַּם בִּבְנֵי אָדָם גְּדוֹלִים **applies even to great people** שֶׁיֵּשׁ לָהֶם נְפָשׁוֹת גְּבוֹהִים **who have lofty souls,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁמַעְנוּ מֵרַבֵּינוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as we heard from our holy Rebbe,** זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **of blessed and holy memory, for the life of the World to Come,** עַל פָּסוּק וַיְהִי בִישֻׁרוּן מֶלֶךְ **on the verse, "And he was king in Yeshurun** [דְּבָרִים לג, ה] בְּהִתְאַסֵּף רָאשֵׁי עָם **when the heads of the people gathered" (Devarim 33:5)** — שֶׁרַק מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that only Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה מְנוּקֶּה בָּזֶה **was completely cleansed of this,** נֶגֶד כָּל רָאשֵׁי הָעָם **compared to all the heads of the people,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בּוֹ **as it says about him,** וְהָאִישׁ מֹשֶׁה עָנָו מְאֹד וְגוֹמֵר **"And the man Moshe was very humble," etc.** [בְּמִדְבַּר יב, ג]. **(Bamidbar 12:3).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר שֶׁהָיָה מֶלֶךְ **And this is why it says that he was king** בְּהִתְאַסֵּף וְגוֹמֵר. **"when there gathered," etc.** וְגַם מֵהַגְּאוּת נִסְתָּעֵף **And from arrogance there also branches out** בְּחִינַת הָעֲצָבוּת **the aspect of sadness,** שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי גַּאֲוָה **which comes through pride,** שֶׁנִּחְסַר לוֹ לְפִי מַדְרֵגָתוֹ **when he feels lacking relative to his level,** [חֲבַקּוּק ב, ה] וְנִרְמָז בְּפָסוּק **and it is alluded to in the verse (Chavakuk 2:5),** גָּבֶר יָהִיר וְלֹא יִנְוֶה[1294] **"An arrogant man will not abide"** (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סוֹטָה מז, ב). **(as is written in Sotah**

[1291] **Parallel: Dover Tzedek, Likkutim 1** — "Da'as is recognition … therefore 'whoever has de'ah, it is as if the Beis HaMikdash was built in his days,' for the Beis HaMikdash is the place of clear recognition." The parallel gives the reason for the Gemara's comparison. The Mikdash was where Hashem was clearly seen, so one whose heart has that clear da'as carries the Mikdash within him.

[1292] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Berachos 4b** — "Opening the lips is the beginning of speech; David asked for Divine help at the beginning of speech, and afterward 'my mouth,' which includes all the instruments of speech, 'will declare Your praise.'" Maharsha reads the verse as Rav Tzadok does here: the first opening of the mouth for praise is not in one's own power. Rav Tzadok names that help: da'as from above.

[1293] **Parallel: Avodas HaKodesh (R. Meir ibn Gabbai), part 2, ch. 44** — "Rav Bruna joined redemption to prayer, which is the unification demanded of the complete servant … and his joy grew and continued even after the mitzvah was done." The Kabbalistic reading agrees that Rav Bruna's joining was more than words. It was a unification in the upper worlds, and the lasting laughter was its result: joy below drawing down joy above, like 'the Jews had light and joy.'

[1294] **Parallel: Tzidkas HaTzaddik 208** — "One who joins redemption to prayer merits recognition of the Present One through prayer … this is a ben Olam Haba in the present, with complete recognition and not by assurance." This is Rav Tzadok's own fuller statement of the reading proposed here. Emunah only promises the World to Come, but emes, reached through semichas geulah, makes a person already part of it.

47b). (שָׁם ה, א) וְהִנֵּה אָמְרוּ **Now, they said (ibid. 5a):** כָּל אָדָם שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ גַּסּוּת הָרוּחַ **"Any person who has haughtiness of spirit,** כּוּלֵּי[1295] אֵין עֲפָרוֹ נִנְעָר **his dust will not be stirred," etc.** [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל כָּל] וְהִקְשׁוּ תּוֹסָפוֹת **And Tosafos (s.v. Kol) asked:** אַמַּאי לֹא חָשְׁיב לָהּ **why is it not counted** [סַנְהֶדְרִין צ, א] [בְּמִשְׁנַת חֶלֶק][1296]. **in the Mishnah of Chelek (Sanhedrin 90a)?** אֲמְנָם יֵשׁ לוֹמַר **However, one can say** שֶׁאֵין הַמְכוּוָּן בַּגְּמָרָא **that the Gemara's intent is not** שֶׁלֹּא יַעֲמוֹד לִתְחִיַּית הַמֵּתִים כְּלָל **that he will not rise at the resurrection of the dead at all,** חַס וְשָׁלוֹם **Heaven forbid,** דְּאִם כֵּן לָא שָׁבָקְתְּ חַיֵּי **for if so, you have left no life** לְכָל בְּרִיָּה כִּמְעַט. **for almost any creature.** רַק הַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁאֵין עֲפָרוֹ נִנְעָר **Rather, the intent of "his dust will not be stirred"** שֶׁלֹּא יַעֲמוֹד בַּעֲפָרוֹ **is that he will not rise in his dust** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּיעוֹר מִשֵּׁינָתוֹ **like one who wakes from his sleep,** כִּדְדָרֵשׁ הָקִיצוּ וְרַנְּנוּ **as it expounds, "Awaken and sing,** שׁוֹכְנֵי עָפָר **you who dwell in the dust"** — מִי שֶׁנַּעֲשָׂה שָׁכֵן לֶעָפָר בְּחַיָּיו **one who made himself a neighbor to dust during his life;** שֶׁזֶּה יִהְיֶה כְּמַקִּיץ מִשֵּׁינָתוֹ **such a one will be like one waking from his sleep.** וְהוּא נוֹהֵג רַק **And this applies only** בִּנְפָשׁוֹת גְּבוֹהִים וּקְדוֹשִׁים **to lofty and holy souls,** דְּעַל כֵּן מְכוּנֶּה **which is why death is called,** הַמִּיתָה **in the words of Chazal,** בְּדִבְרֵי חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **"kad damach," a term of sleep.** (סוֹטָה כא, א) וְכֵן אָמְרוּ **And so they said (Sotah 21a):** [מִשְׁלֵי ו, כב] בְּשָׁכְבְּךָ תִּשְׁמֹר עָלֶיךָ **"'When you lie down, it will guard you' (Mishlei 6:22)** — זוֹ מִיתָה **this is death;** [שָׁם] וַהֲקִיצוֹתָ הִיא תְשִׂיחֶךָ **'and when you awaken, it will converse with you' (ibid.)** — לֶעָתִיד לָבוֹא. **in the time to come."** וְאִיתָא הַלָּשׁוֹן (עֵירוּבִין סה, א) **And the expression appears (Eruvin 65a):** אָתוּ יוֹמֵי דַּאֲרִיכֵי וּקְטִינֵי **"The long and short days have come;** וְנֵינוּם טוּבָא.[1297] **let us sleep plenty."** אֲבָל אֵין כַּוָּנַת חֲכָמֵינוּ זִכְרוֹנָם לִבְרָכָה **But Chazal's intent is not** לֹא יְהֶיֶה לוֹ תִּקּוּמָה חַס **that one whose soul is not completely purified of this** שְׁמִּי שֶׁלֹּא נִטְהַר נַפְשׁוֹ מִזֶּה בְּתַכְלִית וְשָׁלוֹם.[1298] **will have no rising, Heaven forbid.** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז קְרִיאַת פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **And to this the reading of Parshas Parah alludes:** גַּם מִבְּחִינַת טוּמְאַת מֵת **to the ultimate purification of the soul,** עַל תַּכְלִית טָהֳרַת הַנֶּפֶשׁ **even from the aspect of impurity of the dead,** שֶׁהוּא בְּדַקּוּת וּבְרוּחָנִיּוּת. **which is subtle and spiritual.** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז טָהֳרַת הַפָּרָה **And to this the purification of the parah alludes,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עַל יְדֵי אֵזוֹב **through hyssop,** [בְּמִדְבַּר יט, יח] **as it says (Bamidbar 19:18),** וְלָקַח אֵזוֹב וְטָבַל **"And he shall take hyssop," etc.,** הַמְרַמֵּז עַל שִׁפְלוּת **which alludes to lowliness of the soul** בְּעַצְמוֹ בְּתַכְלִית **within oneself, completely.** וּבָזֶה נִשְׁלָם וְנִכְלָל **And with this are completed and included** כָּל שָׁלֹשׁ טָהֳרוֹת הַנֶּפֶשׁ שֶׁלְּפָנֶיהָ **all three purifications of the soul before it,** וְנַעֲשִׂים בָּזֶה מוּכָנִים מִיָּד **and through this they become immediately prepared** לְהַשְׁרָאַת הַקְּדוּשָׁה בַּנֶּפֶשׁ **for the resting of holiness in the soul** בְּפָרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **in Parshas HaChodesh,** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד כּוֹס רְבִיעִית **which corresponds to the fourth cup** וּלְשׁוֹן וְלָקַחְתִּי **and the expression "I will take,"** שֶׁהוּא הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְהַקְּדוּשָׁה **which is the words of Torah and holiness** לְלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל **entering the heart of Yisrael** — לֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ **"the heart of the wise is at his right"** — וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (יְרוּשַׁלְמִי שְׁקָלִים) **as they said (Yerushalmi Shekalim** פֶּרֶק ג הֲלָכָה ג יד, ב**) 14 ,3:3b):** טָהֳרָה מְבִיאָה לִידֵי קְדוּשָׁה **"Purity brings to holiness,** [וַיִּקְרָא טז, יט] וְטִהֲרוֹ וְקִדְּשׁוֹ. כְּתִיב **as it is written (Vayikra 16:19), 'And he shall purify it and sanctify it.'"** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ הַסִּימָן **And this is what they said in the sign:** בֵּין שְׁאֵין מַפְסִיקִין בֵּין פָּרָה לְהַחֹדֶשׁ **"between the third and the fourth he may not drink"** — שְׁלִישֵׁי לְרִבִיעִי לֹא יִשְׁתֶּה **that we do not interrupt between Parah and HaChodesh,** דְּפָרָה נָגֶד וְגָאַלְתִּי **for Parah corresponds to "I will redeem,"** שֶׁהוּא גְּמַר הַגְּאוּלָּה מִן הָרָע **which is the completion of the redemption from evil,** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וְהַחֹדֶשׁ נָגֶד וְלָקַחְתִּי **And HaChodesh corresponds to "I will take,"** שֶׁהוּא הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְהַקְּדוּשָׁה

[1295] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Adar 7** — "'I am wearing tefillin'—tefillin are called pe'er, that is, Keser, showing that he is bound at the root, and then revealed joy is permitted, as it says 'Then our mouth will be filled.'" A second case of the same rule. Like Rav Bruna, the sage wearing tefillin (Berachos 30b) stood at the level of Keser, where the revealed joy of the future is already allowed.

[1296] **Parallel: Degel Machaneh Ephraim, Likkutim** — "The main intent is to redeem the prayer, which is the holy Shechinah; this is great joy … and this is 'when Adar (a-dar) enters,' uniting the Master of the world with dar, the Shechinah." Like this maamar, the Degel moves from Rav Bruna's laughter to the laughter of Adar. The joy comes when the Shechinah is redeemed and united, which sweetens the judgments at their root.

[1297] **Parallel: Sefas Emes, Devarim, Sukkos 26** — "On holy Shabbos, when there is an extra soul, the joy is in the essence of the day … even without shelamim, as Chazal said: 'On the day of your joy—these are the Shabbosos.'" The Sefas Emes reads the Sifrei the same way: Shabbos needs no commanded act of joy. He names its source as the neshamah yeseirah, which parallels the revelation of Atika that Rav Tzadok names here.

[1298] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 58** — "'There is no mazal for Yisrael'—the ayin is their mazal; that is, the root of their life and strength of soul is that they are nothing of themselves, only what Hashem bestows." Resisei Layla adds the inner side of 'ayin': to be bound to Atika means to have no being apart from Hashem. Amalek, by contrast, is the mazal of the nations, and his fall cuts off their flow.

which is the words of Torah and holiness, וְהֵם רְצוּפִים וְטָהֲרוֹ וְקִדְּשׁוֹ׃ **and they are contiguous: "he shall purify it and sanctify it."**

פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה, מַאֲמָר ו׳ Parshas Parah — Maamar Vav

וְאָסַף אִישׁ טָהוֹר אֵת אֵפֶר הַפָּרָה **In the Pesikta for Parah (section 14, siman 16):** בְּפִסְיקְתָּא לְפָרָה (פָּרָשָׁה יד סִימָן טז)
"'And a pure man shall gather the ashes of the parah' [בְּמִדְבַּר יט, ט] **(Bamidbar 19:9) —** זֶה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא
this is the Holy One, blessed be He, שֶׁכָּתוּב בּוֹ וְנָשָׂא וְגוֹמֵר **of Whom it is written, 'And He will raise,' etc.,**
[יְשַׁעְיָה יא, יב] וְאָסַף נִדְחֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל. **'and He will gather the dispersed of Yisrael' (Yeshayah 11:12).** אִישׁ זֶה הַקָּדוֹשׁ
בָּרוּךְ הוּא **'Man' — this is the Holy One, blessed be He,** [שְׁמוֹת טו, ג] ה׳ אִישׁ מִלְחָמָה. דִּכְתִיב **as it is written**
(Shemos 15:3), 'Hashem is a Man of war.' טָהוֹר זֶה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **'Pure' — this is the Holy One, blessed**
be He: [חֲבַקּוּק א, יג] טְהוֹר עֵינַיִם וְגוֹמֵר. **'pure of eyes,' etc. (Chavakuk 1:13).** אֵת אֵפֶר הַפָּרָה **'The ashes of the**
parah' — וְכוּ׳ [1299]אֵלּוּ גָּלוּיוֹתֵיהֶם שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל, **these are the exiles of Yisrael," etc.;** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.**
וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין לְפִי מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר אַחַר כָּךְ [בְּמִדְבַּר שָׁם, י] **what is said afterward (Bamidbar ibid. 10):** וְכִבֶּס הָאוֹסֵף אֶת אֵפֶר הַפָּרָה **"And the one who gathers the ashes of the parah**
shall wash אֶת בְּגָדָיו וְגוֹמֵר **his garments," etc.** [יְשַׁעְיָה סג, א-ג] אַךְ הָעִנְיָן דִּכְתִיב **But the matter is, as it is written**
(Yeshayah 63:1–3): מִי זֶה בָּא מֵאֱדוֹם וְגוֹמֵר **"Who is this who comes from Edom," etc.,** מַדּוּעַ אָדֹם לִלְבוּשֶׁךָ וְגוֹמֵר
"Why is Your clothing red," etc., פּוּרָה דָּרַכְתִּי לְבַדִּי **"I trod the winepress alone,** וּמֵעַמִּים אֵין אִישׁ אִתִּי וְגוֹמֵר **and**
of the peoples there was no man with Me," etc., וְיֵז נִצְחָם עַל בְּגָדַי **"and their lifeblood spattered on My**
garments, וְכָל מַלְבּוּשַׁי אֶגְאָלְתִּי. **and I have stained all My clothing."** וְלָמָּה אָמַר **And why did He say,**
וּמֵעַמִּים אֵין אִישׁ אִתִּי. **"and of the peoples there was no man with Me"?** רַק דְּאָז יִהְיֶה הַבֵּירוּר **Rather, at that time**
there will be the refinement, וְלֹא יִהְיֶה שָׂרִיד לְבֵית עֵשָׂו **and "there will be no survivor of the house of Esav,"**
שֶׁמְּקַלְּפָה זוֹ **for of this kelipah** לֹא יוּשְׁאַר מְאוּמָה. **nothing will remain.** וּכְפִי הַדָּרְשׁ **And according to the**
exposition, [בְּמִדְבַּר שָׁם, ב] אֲשֶׁר לֹא עָלָה עָלֶיהָ עוֹל **"upon which no yoke has come" (Bamidbar ibid. 2) —** זוֹ
this is Edom; [שָׁם, ה] וְשָׂרַף **"and he shall burn" (ibid. 5) —** וְיהִיבַת לִיקִידַת אֶשָׁא **"and it was given over**
to the burning of fire" (וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּפִסְיקְתָּא **(as they said in the Pesikta** [לְפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה פָּרָשָׁה יד סִימָן טו] **(on**
Parshas Parah, section 14, siman 15) (וּבַזּוֹהַר פְּקוּדֵי רלז, א). **and in the Zohar, Pekudei 237a).** וְאֵין הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ
הוּא שָׂמֵחַ **And the Holy One, blessed be He, does not rejoice** בְּמַפַּלְתָּן שֶׁל רְשָׁעִים **at the downfall of the**
wicked, (מְגִילָּה י, ב) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Megillah 10b):** מַעֲשֵׂי יָדַי טוֹבְעִים בַּיָּם **"The work of My hands is**
drowning in the sea, וְאַתֶּם אוֹמְרִים שִׁירָה. **and you are singing song?"** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וּמֵעַמִּים אֵין אִישׁ אִתִּי **And this is**
what it says, "and of the peoples there was no man with Me" — שֶׁלֹּא יִהְיֶה שָׂרִיד וְגוֹמֵר **that there will be no**
survivor, etc.; וְיֵז נִצְחָם עַל בְּגָדַי **"and their lifeblood spattered on My garments,** וְכָל מַלְבּוּשַׁי אֶגְאָלְתִּי **and I**
have stained all My clothing" — שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה נִצְרָךְ כִּבְיָכוֹל לְכַבֵּס כָּל **for then it will be necessary, so to speak,**
הַלְּבוּשִׁים. **to wash all the garments.** דְּמֶלֶךְ בַּעֲשָׂרָה לְבוּשִׁים **For the King is in ten garments,** [1300]הַיְינוּ הָעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת
שֶׁהֵם הַהַנְהָגָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **meaning the ten sefiros which Hashem Yisbarach emanated** לִבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם **for the**
creation of the world, וּמֵהֶם הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **and among them are the words of Torah,**
which are the conduct of things in this world. (שׁוֹשׁ אָשִׁישׁ פָּרָשָׁה לז סִימָן ב) וּבְפִסְיקְתָּא **And in the Pesikta (Sos**
Asis, section 37, siman 2) חָשַׁב לִבְגוּשׁ אַחֲרוֹן **it counts as the last garment:** מַדּוּעַ אָדֹם לִלְבוּשֶׁךָ.[1301] **"Why is Your**
clothing red?" [יְשַׁעְיָה נא, ד] וּכְתִיב **And it is written (Yeshayah 51:4),** כִּי תוֹרָה מֵאִתִּי תֵצֵא **"For Torah will go**
forth from Me," (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה יג, ג) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Vayikra Rabbah 13:3):** תּוֹרָה חֲדָשָׁה מֵאִתִּי תֵצֵא **"A**
new Torah will go forth from Me — חִדּוּשׁ תּוֹרָה מֵאִתִּי תֵצֵא[1302] **a renewal of Torah will go forth from Me";**
meaning that then the garments מִדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה לְבוּשִׁים חֲדָשִׁים וְהַיְינוּ דְּאָז יִהְיוּ הַלְּבוּשִׁים **of the words of Torah will**

[1299] **Parallel: Tzidkas HaTzaddik 171** — "They found the keruvim intertwined although they were not doing His will, for then the abundance of light was at its height … this is the birth of Mashiach on Tishah b'Av." Tzidkas HaTzaddik gives a different answer to the Ritva's question. The light overflowed at the moment of destruction, as one 'sees' at the moment of death. Both answers tie the keruvim to Mashiach's birth.

[1300] **Parallel: Tzidkas HaTzaddik 256** — "'Megillah' means revelation, for then it was revealed that the way of nature too is Hashem's conduct … recognizing that nature too is from Hashem is a more open recognition." Rav Tzadok, citing what he heard from his teacher, explains why the 'ends of the earth' saw at Purim and not at the Exodus. A miracle hidden in nature, once recognized, reveals more than an open one.

[1301] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Megillah 13b** — "His death on the seventh of Adar is partly explicit in the verses, but his birth on the seventh of Adar is only a derashah of the sages … and Haman did not know this derashah." Maharsha explains why Haman could not know. Moshe's birth in Adar is known only through the sages' teaching, so Haman read the month as one of loss alone.

be new garments, תּוֹרָה שֶׁאָדָם לָמֵד בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (קֹהֶלֶת רַבָּה יא, ז) **as they said (Koheles Rabbah 11:7):** **"The Torah a person learns in this world** הֶבֶל הוּא לִפְנֵי תּוֹרָתוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ **is vanity before the Torah of Mashiach."** וְכֵן אָמְרוּ (שָׁם ב, א) **And so they said (ibid. 2:1):** **"All the Torah you learn in this world** כָּל הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁאַתְּ לָמֵד בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הֶבֶל הוּא לִפְנֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא[1303] **is vanity before the Torah of the World to Come."** **That is, then there will be** וְהוּא שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה לִבּוּשׁ אַחֵר לְדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה[1304] **another garment for the words of Torah.** **And in truth, regarding the entire feast of the future,** וּבֶאֱמֶת כָּל הַסְּעוּדָה דְּלֶעָתִיד כָּתַב הָרַמְבַּ״ם (הִלְכוֹת תְּשׁוּבָה פֶּרֶק ח הֲלָכָה ד) **the Rambam wrote (Hilchos Teshuvah 8:4)** שֶׁהוּא דֶּרֶךְ מָשָׁל **that it is by way of parable** עַל הַשָּׂגוֹת גְּבוֹהוֹת **for lofty perceptions,** וְהָרַאֲב״ד הִשִּׂיגוֹ עָלָיו **and the Ra'avad disputed him;** אֲבָל כְּדִבְרֵי הָרַמְבַּ״ם מְפוֹרָשׁ **but the Rambam's view is stated explicitly** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **in the holy Zohar** (מִדְרַשׁ הַנֶּעְלָם חֶלֶק א קלה, ב) **(Midrash HaNe'elam I 135b):** **that the feast and the preserved wine** שֶׁהַסְּעוּדָה וְיֵין הַמְּשׁוּמָּר **are ancient matters** הֵיינוּ דְּבָרִים עַתִּיקִים **which have not yet been revealed** שֶׁלֹּא נִתְגַּלּוּ עוֹד **and will be revealed in the future;** וְיִתְגַּלּוּ לֶעָתִיד. עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת **see there at length.** וְאָז תּוֹרָה חֲדָשָׁה מֵאִתִּי תֵּצֵא **And then "a new Torah will go forth from Me,"** וְיִהְיֶה לִבּוּשׁ מְחוּדָּשׁ בְּדִבְרֵי תּוֹרָה[1305] **and there will be a renewed garment in the words of Torah,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין לָנוּ תְּפִיסָה בָּזֶה **something we cannot grasp** בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **in this world,** וְכָל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה הֶבֶל הוּא לִפְנֵי תּוֹרָה שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא. **and all the Torah of this world is vanity before the Torah of the World to Come.** **And this is what it says, "and I have stained all My clothing"** — שֶׁאָז יִהְיֶה נִצְרָךְ כִּיבּוּס לְכָל הַלְּבוּשִׁים כִּבְיָכוֹל. **that then there will be need for washing all the garments, so to speak.** וּבֶאֱמֶת מָצִינוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ [מַלְאָכִי ג, כא] שֶׁהֵבִיא הַפְּסוּק **And indeed we find in the holy Zohar (Pekudei 237b) that it cites the verse (Malachi 3:21),** **"And you shall trample the wicked,** כִּי יִהְיוּ אֵפֶר **for they will be ashes** תַּחַת כַּפּוֹת רַגְלֵיכֶם **under the soles of your feet"** — שֶׁמִּכָּל הָרְשָׁעִים יִוָּשֵׁאַר **that of all the wicked something will remain,** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ אֵפֶר תַּחַת רַגְלֵי הַצַּדִּיקִים[1306] **so that they will be ashes under the feet of the tzaddikim;** וּמֵאֱדוֹם כָּתוּב **but of Edom it is written,** שֶׁמְּמֻנּוּ וּקְלִיפָּתוֹ **that of it and its kelipah** לֹא יִוָּשֵׁאַר מְאוּמָה **nothing will remain.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר וְלֹא יִהְיֶה שָׂרִיד וְגוֹמֵר **"and there will be no survivor," etc.,** וְעַל זֶה נִצְחָם עַל בְּגָדַי וַיְגֹאֲלוּ כָּל מַלְבּוּשַׁי אֶגְאָלְתִּי. **And of this it says, "and their lifeblood spattered on My garments, and I have stained all My clothing."** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר שֶׁיִּהְיֶה צָרִיךְ כִּבְיָכוֹל לְכַבֵּס הַלְּבוּשִׁים וְכִבֵּס רָאוֹסַף וְגוֹמֵר **And of this it says, "And the one who gathers shall wash," etc. — that He will need, so to speak, to wash the garments,** וְיִהְיֶה חִידּוּשׁ תּוֹרָה מֵאִתִּי תֵּצֵא **and "a renewal of Torah will go forth from Me,"** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** **For it is written** [דְּבָרִים לג, ב] דִּכְתִיב **(Devarim 33:2),** **"From His right hand, a fiery law for them,"** מִימִינוֹ אֵשׁ דָּת לָמוֹ **and this is according to** מַה שֶּׁכָּתַב רַשִׁ״י [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, א] **what Rashi wrote (Bereishis 1:1)** מִבְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה (יב, טו) **from Bereishis Rabbah (12:15):** **that at first He wished to create the world** שֶׁבַּתְּחִלָּה בִּיקֵּשׁ לִבְרוֹא הָעוֹלָם בְּמִדַּת

[1302] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Nissan 1** — "Orah — this is Torah, that is, Torah she'b'al peh, called orah with a heh … for it receives from Torah she'b'ksav; and they said, 'They accepted it anew in the days of Achashverosh.'" There Rav Tzadok joins this reading to Shabbos 88a: the light of the Megillah is the Oral Torah that Yisrael accepted willingly at that time, which is why its light belongs to the month of Purim.

[1303] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Acharei Mos 5** — "The term 'finding' refers to something that comes unawares; so too milah, for an infant is circumcised at eight days without his knowledge, and through this he is included in 'Your people are all tzaddikim.'" This gives the definition behind the reading here: a find is what comes without one's intent. Milah, done before the child knows anything, is therefore the model of holiness given as a gift rather than earned by toil.

[1304] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Korach 14** — "Revayah means satiation, and in this world there is no satiation in words of Torah, as it says, 'One who loves money will not be sated,' expounded: one who loves Torah will not be sated." There Rav Tzadok applies the same verse to Torah and places true satiation in the future revelation of Torah she'b'al peh. Naftali's "sated with favor" is thus a foretaste of what this world otherwise lacks.

[1305] **Parallel: Maharal, Be'er HaGolah, Be'er 4** — "The essence of laughter is nothing but connection and union with the thing… laughter is complete will … as it is written, 'Then our mouth will be filled with laughter.'" Maharal defines laughter as the full union of will. This explains how Rav Tzadok can derive Naftali's rule over laughter from his being "sated with will" drawn from Atika.

[1306] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Sisa 9** — "'On the day Hashem gives you rest from your sadness and your anger' … then is the time to obliterate Amalek… so every Motzaei Shabbos before Havdalah we say 'The Jews had light.'" There the reason is given: Amalek falls only once Hashem "gives you rest from all your enemies," and Shabbos, above all its third meal, brings that rest. The Havdalah verse was spoken after Amalek fell.

הַדִּין[1307] **with the attribute of judgment,** וְרָאָה שֶׁאֵינוֹ מִתְקַיֵּים **and He saw that it would not endure,** וְשִׁיתֵּף מִדַּת הָרַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין **so He joined the attribute of mercy to the attribute of judgment.** וְזֶהוּ שֶׁהַתּוֹרָה נִקְרְאָה אֵשׁ **And this is why the Torah is called fire,** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם הִיא מִימִינוֹ **and nevertheless it is "from His right hand,"** שֶׁשִּׁיתֵּף מִדַּת הָרַחֲמִים לְמִדַּת הַדִּין **for He joined the attribute of mercy to the attribute of judgment — that is, in the garment of the words of Torah** וְהַיְינוּ בִּלְבוּשׁ הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **for the creation of the world.** לְבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם **And this is what they said in the holy Zohar (II 206b):** (חֶלֶק ב רו, ב) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ דְּהָא אוֹרַיְיתָא מִתְּרִין סְטָרִין אִתְיְהִיבַת **"For the Torah was given from two sides,** דִּכְתִיב מִימִינוֹ אֵשׁ דָּת לָמוֹ **as it is written, 'From His right hand, a fiery law for them' — right and left";**[1308] יְמִינָא וּשְׂמָאלָא; וְהַיְינוּ כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and this is as mentioned above.** כְּמוֹ שֶׁעָלָה בְּמַחֲשָׁבָה וְלֶעָתִיד יִהְיוּ הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **And in the future the words of Torah will be** בְּמִדַּת הַדִּין[1309] **as it first arose in thought, with the attribute of judgment,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב הָאַרִ״י הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as the holy Arizal wrote,** דְּלֶעָתִיד יִהְיֶה הַהֲלָכָה כְּבֵית שַׁמַּאי[1310] **that in the future the halachah will follow Beis Shammai,** שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת גְּבוּרָה[1311] **which is the attribute of gevurah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בַּזוֹהַר חֶלֶק ג רמה, א). **(as is written in the Zohar III 245a).** וְאוֹרַיְיתָא וְקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא חַד הוּא **And "the Torah and the Holy One, blessed be He, are one,"** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזוֹהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (חֶלֶק ב ס, א) וְאוֹלִיפְנָא דְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **as they said in the holy Zohar (II 60a):** תּוֹרָה אִיקְרֵי **"And we have learned that the Holy One, blessed be He, is called Torah,** וְאֵין תּוֹרָה אֶלָּא קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא וְכוּ׳ וְזֶהוּ וְכָל מַלְבּוּשַׁי אֶגְאָלְתִּי **and Torah is nothing but the Holy One, blessed be He," etc. And this is "and I have stained all My clothing,"** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר וְכִבֶּס הָאוֹסֵף וְגוֹמֵר **and of this it says, "And the one who gathers shall wash," etc.,** שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ עַל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **which is expounded about the Holy One, blessed be He,** שֶׁמְּקַבֵּץ וּמְאַסֵּף נִדְחֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **Who gathers and assembles the dispersed of Yisrael,** כַּנַּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וּבְשַׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא מַעֵין עוֹלָם הַבָּא **And on Shabbos, which is a semblance of the World to Come** וְאֶחָד מִשִּׁשִּׁים לָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **and one-sixtieth of the World to Come** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת נז, ב) **(as is written in Berachos 57b),** יְכוֹלִים לִזְכּוֹת לְהוֹפָעָה **one can merit a manifestation** שֶׁבָּעוֹלָם הַבָּא **resembling the Torah of the World to Come.**[1312] מַעֵין תּוֹרָה

[1307] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Parshas Shekalim 4** — "When all the clarifications are complete … through this laughter they will see the connection of all Yisrael's service, which in this world looks like laughter and small things." The Radziner Rebbe, citing his father, explains why the revelation of joy waits for the future. Only then will it be seen that even the humblest service of Yisrael is rooted in Atika.

[1308] **Parallel: Maharal, Netzach Yisrael 23** — "Tefillin are a crown and splendor upon a person… I rejoice in the Cause Himself, that He is my Master and His Name is called upon me… the true bond is the tefillin." Maharal gives the reason Abaye's answer worked. One who is bound to his Source may rejoice openly, because his joy comes from that bond and not from himself. This is Rav Tzadok's "bound to the root."

[1309] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 18** — "The letter ayin first mentioned in the Torah comes after the word 'and darkness was upon…' … there is the root of the letter's power, as they learned (Bava Kamma 55a) regarding tes." Rav Tzadok applies the same rule to the ayin of Teves. The first place a letter appears marks its root, whether that root is the light of the kuf or the darkness that Teves's anger must repair.

[1310] **Parallel: Kav HaYashar 93** — "When the Beis HaMikdash stood, two lights shone for Yisrael from two upper worlds, of which it says 'Let there be light, and there was light'… and twice 'or' equals in gematria sechok." The gematria links laughter (414) to the light of the first day in so many words. It supports Rav Tzadok's reading that the kuf's rule over laughter means the revealing of the hidden first light.

[1311] **Parallel: Zohar I 48b** — "That additional soul… through it they rejoice, and all weekday matters, all pains and distresses, are forgotten from them, as it says, 'On the day Hashem gives you rest from your sadness and your anger.'" The Zohar names the means by which Shabbos "adds no sorrow." The neshamah yeseirah, drawn from the World to Come, wipes away the grief that the serpent brought.

[1312] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Va'eschanan 17** — "The essence of the yetzer hara is Amalek, first of the nations … to slacken from Torah, because his deeds are not proper, so his Torah and service accomplish nothing." This shows the mechanism behind the slackness named here. Amalek uses a person's awareness of his own shortcomings to convince him that his learning is worthless.

פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה, מַאֲמָר ז׳ Parshas Parah — Maamar Zayin

מִהַפְּטָרַת פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **From the haftarah of Parshas Parah,** שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְדַבֵּר כְּלָל **which does not speak at all** מִטָּהֳרַת הַטּוּמְאוֹת **of purification from impurities** רַק מִטָּהֳרָה מֵהַחֲטָאִים וַעֲוֹנוֹת **but only of purification from sins and transgressions,** [יְחִזְקֵאל לו, כה-כז] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Yechezkel 36:25–27),** וְזָרַקְתִּי עֲלֵיכֶם וְגוֹמֵר **"And I will sprinkle upon you," etc.,** וּמִכָּל גִּלּוּלֵיכֶם אֲטַהֵר אֶתְכֶם[1313] **"and from all your idols I will purify you,** וְנָתַתִּי לָכֶם לֵב חָדָשׁ וְגוֹמֵר **and I will give you a new heart," etc.,** וְעָשִׂיתִי אֵת אֲשֶׁר בְּחֻקַּי תֵּלֵכוּ וְגוֹמֵר **"and I will bring it about that you walk in My statutes," etc.,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ [שָׁם, לג] **and afterward (ibid. 33),** בְּיוֹם טַהֲרִי אֶתְכֶם **"on the day I purify you** מִכָּל עֲוֹנוֹתֵיכֶם. **from all your iniquities"** — וּמַה שַּׁייכוּת הַפָּטָרָה זוֹ **what is the connection of this haftarah** לְפָרָשַׁת פָּרָה. **to Parshas Parah?** מִזֶּה מְבוֹאָר כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **From this it is clear, as we said,** דְּעִיקַּר הַטָּהֳרָה בַּפָּרָה **that the main purification of the parah** הוּא מִשֹּׁרֶשׁ הַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **is from the root of the yetzer hara,** וּמְטַהֵר מִכָּל טוּמְאָה **and it purifies from all impurity,** אַף מִטּוּמְאַת מֵת **even from the impurity of the dead,** שֶׁהֵבִיא הַנָּחָשׁ לָעוֹלָם. **which the serpent brought into the world.** וְהִנֵּה יֵשׁ שָׁלֹשׁ טוּמְאוֹת **Now, there are three impurities** נֶגֶד שָׁלֹשׁ קְלִיפוֹת **corresponding to the three kelipos:** הַקִּנְאָה וְהַתַּאֲוָה וְהַכָּבוֹד **jealousy, desire, and honor.** טוּמְאַת צָרַעַת **The impurity of tzaraas** שֶׁבָּא עַל לָשׁוֹן הָרָע **comes for lashon hara,** שֶׁהוּא מִשִּׂנְאַת הַבְּרִיּוֹת **which stems from hatred of people** וּקְלִיפַּת כַּעַס וְקִנְאָה **and the kelipah of anger and jealousy,** וְהוּא קְלִיפַּת עֵשָׂו. **and it is the kelipah of Esav.** וְטוּמְאַת זִיבָה **And the impurity of zivah** שֶׁבָּא עַל יְדֵי תַּאֲוָה **comes through desire,** קְלִיפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל **the kelipah of Yishmael,** שֶׁהוּא חֲמְדּוֹת וְאַהֲבוֹת זָרוֹת. **which is strange cravings and loves.** וְטוּמְאַת מֵת **And the impurity of the dead** כְּנֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת הַגַּאֲוָה וְהַכָּבוֹד **corresponds to the kelipah of pride and honor,** וְהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ הַסָּתַת הַנָּחָשׁ **and it is the root of the serpent's enticement:** וִהְיִיתֶם כֵּאלֹהִים. **"and you will be like God."** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר מַאֲמָר ה) **(This was explained in maamar 5.)** וּמִשָּׁלֹשׁ קְלִיפוֹת אֵלּוּ **And from these three kelipos** נִסְתָּעֵף שָׁלֹשׁ עֲבֵירוֹת הַחֲמוּרוֹת **branch out the three severe sins:** עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה גִּלּוּי עֲרָיוֹת וּשְׁפִיכוּת דָּמִים **idolatry, illicit relations, and bloodshed.** דְּתַכְלִית הַגַּאֲוָה הוּא **For the ultimate end of pride is** עַד שֶׁאָמַר אֶעֱלֶה עַל בָּמֳתֵי עָב אֶדַּמֶּה לְעֶלְיוֹן. **I will be like the Most High."** **to the point that he said, "I will ascend above the heights of the clouds,** וְגִלּוּי עֲרָיוֹת וּשְׁפִיכוּת דָּמִים **And illicit relations and bloodshed** תַּאֲוָה וְקִנְאָה. **are desire and jealousy.** וּמָצִינוּ עוֹד טוּמְאַת נְבֵילָה וְשֶׁרֶץ **And we also find the impurity of neveilah and sheretz,** שֶׁזֶּה אֵינוֹ בְּגוּפוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם. **which is not in a person's own body.** (תַּעֲנִית טז, א) וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם מָצִינוּ **Nevertheless we find (Taanis 16a)** שֶׁהִמְשִׁילוּ מִי שֶׁיֵּשׁ בְּיָדוֹ עֲבֵירָה **that they compared one who has a sin in his hand** וּמִתְוַדֶּה וְאֵינוֹ חוֹזֵר בּוֹ **and confesses but does not turn back from it** לְאָדָם שֶׁתּוֹפֵס שֶׁרֶץ בְּיָדוֹ[1314] **to a person holding a sheretz in his hand,** שֶׁאֲפִילּוּ טוֹבֵל כּוּלֵי לֹא עָלְתָה לוֹ טְבִילָה **who, even if he immerses, etc., his immersion does not take effect.** וְהוּא שֶׁבֶּאֱמֶת כָּל הַטּוּמְאוֹת **And this is because in truth all the impurities** שֶׁנִּמְצְאוּ בְּבַעֲלֵי חַיִּים **found in animals** הוּא רַק עַל יְדֵי קִלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ **come only through the corruption of the serpent,** שֶׁהִכְנִיס הַתַּאֲוָה וְהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע בָּאָדָם **who put desire and the yetzer hara into man;** מִזֶּה נִמְצָא טוּמְאָה בְּבַעֲלֵי חַיִּים **from this impurity is found in animals,** כְּמוֹ שְׂרָצִים וְכַדּוֹמֶה. **such as sheratzim and the like.** וְעַל כֵּן הֵבִיאוּ מִטּוּמְאַת שֶׁרֶץ **And therefore they cited the impurity of a sheretz:** אַף שֶׁהוּא טוּמְאָה דְּבַעַל חַי **though it is an impurity of a living creature,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם כָּל זְמַן שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְתַקֵּן הַחֵטְא **nevertheless, as long as he does not rectify the sin,** לֹא עָלְתָה לוֹ הַטָּהֳרָה וְהַטְּבִילָה. **the purification and immersion do not take effect.** וְעַל יְדֵי טָהֳרַת הַלֵּב מֵהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע **And through purifying the heart from the yetzer hara,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה לֶעָתִיד **as will be in the future,** [יְחֶזְקֵאל שָׁם, כו] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Yechezkel ibid. 26),** וַהֲסִירוֹתִי אֶת לֵב הָאֶבֶן מִבְּשַׂרְכֶם וְגוֹמֵר **"And I will remove the heart of stone from your flesh," etc.** — עַל יְדֵי זֶה יִתְבַּטֵּל כָּל הַטּוּמְאוֹת **through this all the impurities will be nullified** הַבָּאִים עַל יְדֵי יֵצֶר הָרָע **that come through the yetzer hara and the kelipos,** וְהַקְּלִיפּוֹת. כָּאָמוּר. **as stated.** [שָׁם, כה] וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what it says (ibid. 25),** וְטִהַרְתֶּם מִכָּל טוּמְאוֹתֵיכֶם **"And you will be purified from all your impurities,** וּמִכָּל

[1313] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Megillah 13b** — "It should have written only 'yesh'; therefore they expounded 'yeshno' — either they change their mitzvos … 'one people': just as the rest are not in mitzvos, so the Rabbanan." Maharsha shows the textual basis for the accusation Rav Tzadok builds on. The extra letters of the verse itself carry Haman's charge of sleep and his denial that the Sages' merit protects the people.

[1314] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Va'eira 14** — "Amalek is the kelipah of the dog, as the holy Zohar says … all the accusations Haman spoke, he meant as accusations against them above: 'they are asleep from the mitzvos.'" Rav Tzadok shows that Haman's slander is Amalek's essential kelipah, the accuser on high. He adds that at the third Shabbos meal, as on Yom Kippur, it has no permission to accuse.

גִּלּוּלֵיכֶם וְגוֹמֵר. **and from all your idols," etc.** וְכֵן טָהֳרַת הַפָּרָה מוֹרָה **And likewise the purification of the parah indicates** שֶׁמְּטַהֵר אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁקִּלְקוּל הַנָּחָשׁ **that He purifies Yisrael from the entire root of the serpent's corruption,** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה יֵשׁ טָהֳרָה לְכָל הַטּוּמְאוֹת **and through this there is purification for all the impurities,** וְאַף לְטוּמְאַת מֵת שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְשׁוּלָּח אַף מִמַּחֲנֵה לְוִיָּה **even for the impurity of the dead, for which one is not sent out even from the Levite camp,** שֶׁקְּלִיפָּה זוֹ נוֹהֶגֶת אַף בַּגְּדוֹלִים **because this kelipah applies even to great people** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר בְּמַאֲמָר ה שָׁם). **(as explained there, in maamar 5).** וּכְנֶגֶד טוּמְאָה זוֹ קְלִיפַּת עֲמָלֵק **And corresponding to this impurity is the kelipah of Amalek,** שֶׁנִּדְרָשׁ (וּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה נָשׂא יג, ג) פְּסִיקְתָא לַחֲנוּכָּה **as is expounded (Pesikta for Chanukah,** פָּרָשָׁה ז סִימָן ג **section 7, siman 3,** גַּאֲוַת [מִשְׁלֵי כט, כג] אָדָם תַּשְׁפִּילֶנּוּ **and Midrash Rabbah Naso 13:3): "'A man's pride will bring him low' (Mishlei 29:23) —** זֶה עֲמָלֵק כּוּלֵי **this is Amalek," etc.;** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** וְהוּא רֵאשִׁית דְּקִלְיפָּה. **And it is the first of the kelipah.** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם אַחַר שֶׁאָמַר **Nevertheless, after it says,** וְאֶת רוּחִי אֶתֵּן **"And I will give you a new heart," etc.,** בְּקִרְבְּכֶם וְגוֹמֵר [יְחֶזְקֵאל שָׁם, כט] כְּתִיב אַחַר כָּךְ **"and My spirit I will put within you," etc., it is written afterward (Yechezkel ibid. 29),** וְהוֹשַׁעְתִּי אֶתְכֶם מִכָּל טוּמְאוֹתֵיכֶם וְגוֹמֵר **"And I will save you from all your impurities," etc. —** שֶׁעֲדַיִן צְרִיכִין יְשׁוּעָה. **for they still need salvation.** וְהוּא שֶׁבְּבִיאַת מָשִׁיחַ **And this is that at the coming of Mashiach,** שֶׁמּוֹחֲלִין לְכָל שֶׁיִּהְיֶה יָחִיד שֶׁעָשָׂה תְּשׁוּבָה **who will be an individual who did teshuvah,** הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ בִּשְׁבִילוֹ[1315] (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא פו, ב) **for whose sake the whole world is forgiven (as is written in Yoma 86b) —** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהוּא יַכְנִיס הִרְהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה בְּלֵב כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל[1316] **meaning that he will put thoughts of teshuvah into the heart of all Yisrael,** (כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we have said (several times) —** מְקוֹם יִהְיוּ שֶׁנִּטְמְעוּ וְהַיְינוּ **meaning those who assimilated** בֵּין עוֹבְדֵי כּוֹכָבִים וּמַזָּלוֹת **among the idolaters,** וְהֵם לֹא יָדְעוּ כְּלָל **and they do not know at all** שֶׁהֵם מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל[1317] **that they are of Yisrael;** וְעִם כָּל זֶה עַל יְדֵי הַשּׁוֹפָר גָּדוֹל **and even so, through the great shofar** יִהְיֶה לָהֶם יְשׁוּעָה **they will have salvation —** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ מִצִּדּוֹ **meaning that Hashem Yisbarach, from His side,** יְעוֹרֵר לִבָּם **will arouse their hearts** מִבְּחִינַת תְּשׁוּבָה עִלָּאָה **from the aspect of the higher teshuvah,** שֶׁהוּא בִּינָה[1318] **which is Binah, the great shofar,** וְלֹא יִדַּח מִמֶּנּוּ נִדָּח **and "no outcast shall be cast away from Him" —** כָּל שֶׁהוּא מִזֶּרַע יִשְׂרָאֵל **anyone who is of the seed of Yisrael.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And of this it says,** וְהִנֵּה שַׁבָּת אֵיתָא (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב רד, א) וְהוֹשַׁעְתִּי אֶתְכֶם מִכָּל טוּמְאוֹתֵיכֶם. **"And I will save you from all your impurities."** **Now, regarding Shabbos it is stated (Zohar II 204a):** שִׁין בַּת **"Shin, bas:** שִׁין רָזָא דְּתִלַּת אַבָּהָן **the shin is the secret of the three Avos,** וּבַת מִתְעַטְּרָא בְּהוּ **and the bas, the daughter, is crowned with them" —** וְהַיְינוּ **meaning that Yisrael merit** לִקְדוּשַׁת שְׁלֹשֶׁת הָאָבוֹת. **the holiness of the three Avos.** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **And we have already said** דִּקְדוּשַׁת הָאָבוֹת **that the holiness of the Avos serves** לְבַטֵּל הַשָּׁלֹשׁ קְלִיפּוֹת וְטוּמְאוֹת. **to nullify the three kelipos and impurities.** **For Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה אוֹהֵב אֶת הַבְּרִיּוֹת **loved people,** וּכְנֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת הַקִּנְאָה. **countering the kelipah of jealousy.** וְיִצְחָק כְּנֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת הַתַּאֲוָה **And Yitzchak counters the kelipah of desire,** דְּעַל יְדֵי הַפַּחַד מֵה' **for through fear of Hashem** נִיצּוֹל מִכָּל הַתַּאֲוּוֹת. **one is saved from all desires.** **And Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** נֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת הַגַּאֲוָה וְהַכָּבוֹד **counters the kelipah of pride and honor,** שֶׁהוּא הָיָה שָׁפָל בְּעֵינָיו **for he was lowly in his**

[1315] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Tzav 2** — "Korach claimed, 'All the congregation are holy, and Hashem is in their midst.' And this is true, for otherwise the Torah would not write the false words that Korach said." Rav Tzadok applies the same rule to Korach: words of the wicked recorded in Scripture still contain truth. Haman's charge that Yisrael "sleep from the mitzvos" therefore had real grounds, and the remedy is found in the hidden holiness of the heart, not in denying the charge.

[1316] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Devarim 16** — "The intent is that he merits and sees: even at the time of mourning he feels the illumination of the joy, like the Arab who, at the Destruction, sensed that Mashiach had been born." Rav Tzadok gives a concrete model for joy "in the present." It is a joy felt within the mourning itself, the redemption perceived at the very hour of loss (Eichah Rabbah 1).

[1317] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pesach 43** — "Through joining Chochmah, the mind, and Binah, the heart … it is as if the Beis HaMikdash was built in his days — that is, his heart becomes a Beis HaMikdash." This explains why daas brings "as if the Mikdash were built." The bond of mind and heart turns the heart itself into the dwelling place of the Shechinah, so its joy can be felt even in exile.

[1318] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Beshalach 7** — "Shevat was formed with the letter tzaddik… suited to repairing the blemish… the holy Arizal set the time of repair in the parshiyos of Shovavim, and the main repair is on their Shabbosos." This places Shevat's work, conquering the yetzer, within the Arizal's Shovavim. That is the same period which the Shelah, as cited at the opening of this maamar, extends through Terumah and Tetzaveh in a leap year.

own eyes (וְנִתְבָּאֵר כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים)[1319] **(as explained several times).** וְאָז כְּשֶׁזּוֹכִין לִקְדוּשַּׁת הָאָבוֹת **And then, when they merit the holiness of the Avos,** זוֹכִין לְהִטָּהֵר מִכָּל הַקְּלִיפּוֹת **they merit to be purified from all the kelipos** וּמִכָּל הַטּוּמְאוֹת. **and from all the impurities.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּפְסִיקְתָא לְפָרָה **And this is what they said in the Pesikta for Parah** (פָּרָשָׁה יד סִימָן ו) **(section 14, siman 6):** וְאַף הַפָּרָשָׁה הַזּוֹ **"This parshah too** מְזוּקָּק שִׁבְעָתַיִם **is refined sevenfold:** יֵשׁ בָּהּ אַרְבָּעִים וְתִשַּׁע טָהֳרוֹת **it contains forty-nine purifications.** כֵּיצַד יֵשׁ בָּהּ שֶׁבַע פָּרוֹת כּוּלֵי **How so? It contains seven cows," etc.,** וְלֹא עוֹד אֶלָּא **"and not only that, but** כֵּינָן שֶׁהָיוּ מְבַקְּשִׁים לִשְׂרוֹף כּוּלֵי **when they were about to burn," etc.,** וְשִׁבְעָה הַזָּיוֹת בְּכָל יוֹם **"they sprinkle upon him all seven days,** מַזִּין עָלָיו כָּל שִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים **seven sprinklings each day;** הֲוֵי נִמְצֵאתָ אוֹמֵר[1320] כּוּלֵי אַרְבָּעִים וְתִשַּׁע הַזָּיוֹת **thus you find forty-nine sprinklings," etc.** וְהַמְכוּוָּן שֶׁבְּכָל יוֹם הָיוּ מַזִּין **And the intent is that each day they would sprinkle** שָׁם מִכָּל חַטָּאוֹת שֶׁהָיוּ[1321] **from all the chataos that were there,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּפָרָה (פָּרָק ג מִשְׁנָה א **as they said in Parah (3:1),** וְהֵיינוּ מִכָּל הַחַטָּאוֹת **that is, from all the chataos** שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ מִימוֹת מֹשֶׁה **made since the days of Moshe,** וּכְרַבִּי מֵאִיר **and according to Rabbi Meir** שֶׁהָיוּ שֶׁבַע חַטָּאוֹת[1322] **there were seven chataos** (שָׁם מִשְׁנָה ה). **(ibid., mishnah 5).** וּמַהַפְּסִיקְתָּא רְאָיָה לְפֵירוּשׁ זֶה **And the Pesikta is a proof for this explanation,** דְּאִלּוּ לְפֵירוּשׁ הָרַ״ע מִבַּרְטְנוּרָא **for according to the Bartenura's explanation,** שֶׁהָיוּ מַזִּין בְּכָל יוֹם **that each day they would sprinkle** מֵאֵפֶר פָּרָה אַחֶרֶת[1323] **from the ash of a different cow,** לֹא הָיוּ כָּאן אַרְבָּעִים וְתִשַּׁע הַזָּיוֹת **there would not be forty-nine sprinklings here.** אֶלָּא עַל כָּרְחָךְ **Rather, perforce,** שֶׁהָיוּ מַזִּין בְּכָל יוֹם מִכָּל הַחַטָּאוֹת **they sprinkled each day from all the chataos;** [שָׁם] וּתְנַן לֹא מָצְאוּ מִשֶּׁבַע וְכוּ׳ **and we learned (ibid.), "If they did not find from seven," etc.,** וּשְׁמַע מִינָּהּ **and we learn from this** שֶׁהָיוּ צְרִיכִין לְכַתְּחִילָּה מִשֶּׁבַע **that ideally they needed from seven,** וְהָיוּ אַרְבָּעִים וְתִשַּׁע הַזָּיוֹת. **making forty-nine sprinklings.** וּמַה שֶּׁכָּתַב בְּתוֹסְפוֹת יוֹם טוֹב[1324] **And as for what the Tosfos Yom Tov wrote** [שָׁם דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל מִכָּל] **(ibid., s.v. Mikol)** מִמַּה רְאָיָה לְפֵירוּשׁ הָרַ״ע מִבַּרְטְנוּרָא **as proof for the Bartenura's explanation,** וּמֵהֵיכִי תֵּיתֵי דְּצְרִיכִין שֶׁאָמְרוּ לֹא מָצְאוּ מִשֶּׁבַע וְכוּ׳ **from what they said, "If they did not find from seven," etc. —** כֵּינָן שֶׁלֹּא הוּזְכַּר שֶׁבַע לְשֶׁבַע **"for from where would we know that seven are needed, since seven is not mentioned?"** — עַיֵּן שָׁם. **see there —** אַדְּרַבָּה מִשָּׁם רְאָיָה מוּכְרַחַת לְהֵיפָךְ **on the contrary, from there is a compelling proof to the opposite,** דְּאִי לְפֵירוּשׁ הָרַ״ע מִבַּרְטְנוּרָא וְהָרַמְבַּ״ם **for according to the Bartenura and the Rambam** תִּיקְשֵׁי הֲלֹא בְּשַׁבָּת **it would be difficult: on Shabbos** לֹא הָיוּ מַזִּין כּוּלֵי **they would not sprinkle, etc.,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (יוֹמָא ח, ב) **as they said (Yoma 8b),** וְאִם כֵּן לֹא הָיוּ צְרִיכִין **and if so, they would never need** יוֹתֵר מִשֵּׁשׁ לְעוֹלָם. **more than six.** אֲךָ לְפִי מַה שֶּׁכָּתַבְנוּ **But according to what we wrote,** שֶׁהָיוּ צְרִיכִין לְהַזּוֹת **that they needed to sprinkle** מִשֶּׁבַע פָּרוֹת בְּכָל יוֹם **from seven cows each day,** וְהָיָה יָדוּעַ דְּכָל חַטָּאוֹת **and it was known that "all the chataos"** הַיְינוּ שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ מִימֵי מֹשֶׁה שֶׁבַע **means the seven made since the days of Moshe,** וְעַל זֶה תְּנַן לֹא מָצְאוּ מִשֶּׁבַע כּוּלֵי **regarding this we learned, "If they did not find from seven," etc. —** שֶׁאֵינוֹ מְעֻכָּב. **that it is**

[1319] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayechi 15** — "Yaakov put Efrayim before Menasheh, for to him the main thing was the holiness Hashem sends from His side… since he recognized that all is from Hashem, he put Efrayim first." This gives Yaakov's reasoning in full. Even a person's own effort against the yetzer is Hashem's help, so he also blessed with "the God who shepherds me" before "the angel who redeems me."

[1320] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Taanis 15a** — "Rashi explains that the upright surpass the tzaddikim, but the Rashba wrote that the upright are a level below the tzaddikim." Rav Tzadok follows Rashi's order. First comes the light sown for the tzaddik, the Torah she'b'al peh that repairs the yetzer; then, once the heart is wholly straightened, comes the higher gift of joy.

[1321] **Parallel: Arizal, Shaar HaKavanos, Derushei Rosh Chodesh 3** — "This explains why we say 'Keser' in the Mussaf of Rosh Chodesh as on Shabbos … whereas on Rosh Chodesh only the Nukva rises to the Keser of Z'eir Anpin." The Arizal measures how much of Atika is revealed on Rosh Chodesh. The rise is real but partial, which is why its joy is only hinted.

[1322] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Av 1** — "Then the light of the moon will be like the light of the sun… and the holiness of the month will be revealed… This custom began in Bavel; in Eretz Yisrael they did not." Rav Tzadok adds that the full festival quality of Rosh Chodesh belongs to the future. Bavel's partial Hallel, with its skipped passages, reflects a holiness only partly grasped.

[1323] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Hashanah 10** — "Mazla is the name for the root of the soul, which a person himself cannot grasp, as it says (Megillah 3a): 'Even though they do not see, their mazal sees.'" This identifies the mazal that is "healthy" in Adar with the soul's own hidden root in Atika. Adar's joy therefore comes from a bond with Hashem that lies deeper than anything a person can perceive in himself.

[1324] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Va'eschanan 10** — "Torah she'b'al peh has levels, and one must learn it from another, unlike the Written Torah … Hashem provided his two kidneys like two teachers… this language too alludes only to Torah she'b'al peh." Rav Tzadok explains why Avraham's Torah counts as Oral Torah. It grew from within him rather than from a written text, and so it belongs to Malchus, the "bas" the Zohar says was given to Avraham.

not indispensable. וְכֵן פֵּירֵשׁ הַגְּאוֹן רַבִּי אֵלְיָהוּ[1325] זֵכֶר צַדִּיק לִבְרָכָה **And so the Gra, of blessed memory, explained in Eliyahu Rabbah (Parah ibid.),** וּמַגִּיהַּ מִכָּל שֶׁבַע חַטָּאוֹת [פָּרָה שָׁם] בְּאֵלְיָהוּ רַבָּה **and he emends the text to "from all seven chataos";** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** אַךְ עַל כָּל פָּנִים יֵשׁ לְהָבִין **But in any case we must understand what they said in the Pesikta,** מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בְּפִסְיקְתָּא שֶׁהָיוּ אַרְבָּעִים וְתִשַּׁע הַזָּיוֹת **that there were forty-nine sprinklings —** דְּמַפְרִישִׁין לֵיהּ בִּרְבִיעִי הָא לֹא הָיוּ הַזָּאוֹת **for there were sprinklings** רַק בְּשִׁשָּׁה יָמִים **on only six days,** כִּי הֵיכִי דְּנִתְרְמֵי רְבִיעִי שֶׁלּוֹ בְּשַׁבָּת[1326] **since they set him apart on the fourth day of the week** **so that his fourth day would fall on Shabbos,** (שָׁם) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא. **as they said in the Gemara (ibid.).** וּלְפִי מַה שֶּׁאָמַרְנוּ **And according to what we said,** דְּשַׁבָּת הוּא גַּם כֵּן **Shabbos too is** כְּמוֹ כֹּחַ הַזָּיוֹת הַפָּרָה **like the power of the parah's sprinklings,** דְּבְשַׁבָּת מִתְעַטְּרָא בַּאֲבָהָן **for on Shabbos she is crowned with the Avos,** וְזוֹכִין לִקְדוּשַּׁת הָאָבוֹת **and we merit the holiness of the Avos,** וַהֲוָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ הַהַזָּאוֹת **and it is as if the sprinklings were done** גַּם בְּשַׁבָּת כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **on Shabbos too, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה דְּחָשַׁב אַרְבָּעִים וְתִשַּׁע הַזָּיוֹת **And this is why it counted forty-nine sprinklings,** עִם כֹּחַ הַשַּׁבָּת **together with the power of Shabbos,** שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן כְּמוֹ הַשֶּׁבַע הַזָּיוֹת **which is also like the seven sprinklings;** וְזֶהוּ מְזוּקָּק שִׁבְעָתַיִם. **and this is "refined sevenfold."** וּבְסָעוּדָה שְׁלִישִׁית **And at the third meal,** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם[1327] **which corresponds to Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him** [פְּרִי עֵץ חַיִּים שַׁעַר הַשַּׁבָּת פֶּרֶק יח] **(Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos ch. 18),** שָׁזּוֹכֶה הַיִּשְׂרָאֵל לִקְדוּשָּׁתוֹ **when the Jew merits his holiness —** שֶׁהָיָה שָׁפָל בְּעֵינָיו כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **for he was lowly in his own eyes, as mentioned above —** [בַּזְּמָר בְּנֵי הַיכָלָא אוֹמְרִים] **we say (in the zemer Bnei Heichala),** לְבַר נַטְלִין וְכוּ' **"They are cast outside," etc.,** דְּקִלִּיפַּת עֲמָלֵק הוּא כֶּלֶב הָנֵי כַּלְבִּין דַּחֲצִיפִין **"these brazen dogs";** **for the kelipah of Amalek is a dog,** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב סה, א כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ) **as they said (Zohar II 65a),** וְהוּא כְּנֶגֶד טוּמְאַת מֵת **and it corresponds to the impurity of the dead,** שֶׁהוּא מִקְּלִיפַּת הַגַּאֲוָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **which is from the kelipah of pride, as mentioned above.** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ טָהֳרַת הַפָּרָה **And it is like the purification of the parah,** שֶׁמְּטַהֵר אַף מְטוּמְאַת מֵת. **which purifies even from the impurity of the dead.** וְכֵן קוֹרִין הַפָּרָשָׁה מִפָּרָה בְּשַׁבָּת **And so we read the parshah of Parah on Shabbos,** שֶׁהַכֹּל אֶחָד כָּאָמוּר: **for it is all one, as stated.**

אַחַר הַבְדָּלָה After Havdalah

הִנֵּה יָדוּעַ דְּקִדּוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת **It is known that the holiness of Shabbos** מוֹפִיעַ לְקַדֵּשׁ יְמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה **shines forth to sanctify the weekdays** מֵעֵין קְדוּשָּׁה דְּאוֹתָהּ שַׁבָּת. **with a semblance of the holiness of that Shabbos.** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁהַשַּׁבָּת הָיְתָה פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **And since the Shabbos was Parshas Parah,** וְאָמְרוּ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **and they said in the Yerushalmi** [מְגִילָּה פֶּרֶק ג הֲלָכָה ה כה, ב] **(Megillah 3:5, 25b)** שֶׁאֵין מַפְסִיקִין בֵּינָהּ לְפָרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **that we do not interrupt between it and Parshas HaChodesh** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּמַאֲמָר ה) **(as explained in maamar 5),** וּמְבוֹאָר בְּפִסְיקְתָּא **and it is explained in the Pesikta** [לְפָרָה פָּרָשָׁה יד סִימָן ו] **(on Parah, section 14, siman 6)** [חֻקַּת ה] וּמִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא **and Midrash Tanchuma (Chukas 5)** שֶׁטָּהֳרַת פָּרָה מְזוּקָּק שִׁבְעָתַיִם **that the purification of the parah is refined sevenfold —** שֶׁשֶּׁבַע פָּרוֹת וְשֶׁבַע הַזָּיוֹת כּוּלֵי **seven cows and seven sprinklings, etc. —** שְׁמֶרֶמֶז עַל טָהֳרַת בְּוַדַּאי נִטְהָרִים בִּימֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה **which alludes to the purification of all seven sefiros of holiness,** כָּל הַשֶּׁבַע סְפִירוֹת שֶׁבְּקִדּוּשָּׁה **certainly they are purified in the weekdays** שֶׁאַחַר כָּךְ בְּכָל יוֹם **that follow, each day** בְּמִדָּה אַחַת **in one attribute,** עַד הַשַּׁבָּת קֹדֶשׁ פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **until Shabbos Kodesh of Parshas HaChodesh,** שֶׁנִּבְנָסִים לְתַכְלִית הַקְּדוּשָּׁה וְהִנֵּה רֵאשִׁית הַמִּדּוֹת בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **when they enter the ultimate holiness in completeness. Now, the first of the attributes in holiness** חֶסֶד לְאַבְרָהָם **is "kindness to Avraham,"** שֶׁנִּצְטָרֵךְ לְהִטָּהֵר **which needs to be purified and guarded from its opposite,** שֶׁהוּא חֲסָדִים זָרִים **which is strange kindnesses,** וְתַאֲוֹת וְלִהְיוֹת נִשְׁמָר מֵהַהֵיפּוּךְ

[1325] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ha'azinu 6** — "The tzaddikim will go from strength to strength… from Shabbos to Shabbos … and there is no satiation in Torah except through Shabbos, which is a semblance of the future." Rav Tzadok answers the Maharsha's question on Berachos 64a. The future has rest only from the yetzer, never from ascent, and Shabbos already gives a taste of that ceaseless ascent.

[1326] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Eikev 3** — "They will merit to bring out the nine kabin of wisdom of Eretz Yisrael that were captive … all the exiles are for this… Had they merited, Yehoshua would have been Mashiach ben Yosef." This shows how Torah she'b'al peh will repair everything. Yosef's line, from Yehoshua to Mashiach ben Yosef, has the task of gathering the wisdom scattered among the nations, and that is the purpose of the exiles.

[1327] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 15** — "The Tumim already noted… that since it was accepted throughout all Yisrael … for all their words are to us complete Torah, within the Torah she'b'al peh." Rav Tzadok applies the same principle to the siman numbering of the Tur and Shulchan Aruch. He gives its basis: a code accepted by all Yisrael becomes part of the Oral Torah, where nothing happens by chance.

וְאַהֲבָה זָרָה **desires, and strange love** — שֶׁהִיא קְלִיפַּת יִשְׁמָעֵאל **the kelipah of Yishmael,** פְּסוֹלֶת שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **the dross of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא חֶסֶד וְאַהֲבָה שֶׁבַּקְּדוּשָּׁה. **who is the kindness and love of holiness.** וְעִיקַּר הִתְגַּבְּרוּת הַתַּאֲוָה **And the main surge of desire** הוּא בִּימֵי הַנְּעוּרִים **is in the days of youth;** יְזַכֶּה לְבְחִינַת חֶסֶד נְעוּרַיִךְ בִּכְדֵי שֶׁיַּכְנִיעַ הַתַּאֲוָה לְהַקְּדוּשָּׁה **by subduing desire to holiness he will merit the aspect of "the kindness of your youth,"** שֶׁהוּא רֵאשִׁית הַתְחָלַת הַקְּדוּשָּׁה **which is the very beginning of holiness,** (עירובין כא, ב) וּכְאָמְרָם **as they said (Eruvin 21b):** הַדּוּדָאִים נָתְנוּ רֵיחַ **"'The dudaim give off fragrance'** — אֵלּוּ בַּחוּרֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **these are the young men of Yisrael** שֶׁלֹּא טָעֲמוּ טַעַם חֵטְא. **who have not tasted the taste of sin."** וְזֶה הָיָה שֹׁרֶשׁ נֶפֶשׁ **And this was the root of the soul** אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him:** רֵאשִׁית הַתְחָלַת הַקְּדוּשָּׁה **the very beginning of holiness,** בְּחִינַת אַהֲבַת חֶסֶד. **the aspect of love of kindness.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁשָּׁמַעְנוּ מֵרַבֵּנוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And as we heard from our holy Rebbe,** זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה הַפֵּירוּשׁ עַל מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת פט, ב) **of blessed and holy memory, for the life of the World to Come, the explanation of what they said (Shabbos 89b):** לָא בְּסָבֵי סַעְמָא **"Neither is there sense in the elders,** וְלָא בְּדַרְדְּקֵי עֵצָה.[1328] **nor counsel in the young children"** — שֶׁסָּבָא הוּא יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **the elder is Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁכְּבָר נִזְדַּקֵּן **who had already grown old** וְנִשְׁתַּלֵּשׁ בּוֹ בְּחִינַת הַקְּדוּשָּׁה. **and in whom the aspect of holiness had become threefold.** וְלָא בְּדַרְדְּקֵי **"Nor in the young children"** קָאֵי עַל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **refers to Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהוּא הָיָה הַתְחָלַת הַקְּדוּשָּׁה **who was the beginning of holiness,** כְּמוֹ בִּימֵי הַנְּעוּרִים.[1329] **as in the days of youth.** וְעַל יְדֵי שֶׁמִּתְגַּבְּרִים בַּיָּמִים הָלָלּוּ **And by overcoming, in these days,** עַל תַּאֲוֹת הַמְּדוּמּוֹת **the imaginary desires,** זוֹכִין לְאַהֲבָה שֶׁבַּקְּדוּשָּׁה הַמְשׁוּלֶּשֶׁת **one merits the threefold love of holiness:** אַהֲבַת ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **love of Hashem Yisbarach,** וְאַהֲבַת הַתּוֹרָה וְאַהֲבַת יִשְׂרָאֵל **love of the Torah, and love of Yisrael,** שֶׁהֵמָּה תְּלָתָא קִשְׁרִין **which are the three bonds:** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא אוֹרַיְיתָא וְיִשְׂרָאֵל. **the Holy One, blessed be He, the Torah, and Yisrael.** וּכְמוֹ כֵן נִמְצָא בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **And likewise, these are found in Avraham Avinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **peace be upon him** — הַשָּׁלֹשׁ אֲהֲבוֹת הַלָּלּוּ. **these three loves.** אַהֲבַת ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **Love of Hashem Yisbarach** — כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה מא, ח] **as it says (Yeshayah 41:8),** אַבְרָהָם אוֹהֲבִי. **"Avraham, who loved Me."** וְאַהֲבַת תּוֹרָה **And love of Torah** — כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה סא, א) **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 61:1),** שֶׁזִּימֵּן לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **that the Holy One, blessed be He, provided him** שְׁתֵּי כְּלָיוֹתָיו כְּמִין שְׁנֵי רַבָּנִים **with his two kidneys like two teachers,** וְהָיוּ נוֹבְעוֹת וּמְלַמְּדוֹת אוֹתוֹ תּוֹרָה כּוּלֵּי **which would well forth and teach him Torah, etc.** וְאַהֲבַת הַבְּרִיּוֹת **And love of people** — שֶׁהָיָה מַכְנִיס אוֹרְחִים **for he would take in guests** וּמְקָרְבָן לַה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ כַּיָּדוּעַ. **and bring them close to Hashem Yisbarach, as is known.** וְהִנֵּה כַּאֲשֶׁר שָׁמַעְנוּ מֵרַבֵּנוּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ **Now, as we heard from our holy Rebbe,** זֵכֶר צַדִּיק וְקָדוֹשׁ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **of blessed and holy memory, for the life of the World to Come,** דְּעִנְיַן טוּמְאַת מֵת הוּא מִדַּת הָעַצְבוּת **the matter of impurity of the dead is the trait of sadness,** שֶׁעַל זֶה הוּא מְנִיעָה **which is a hindrance** לִכְנוֹס לַקְּדוּשָּׁה **to entering holiness,** שֶׁהוּא מַחֲנֵה שְׁכִינָה **which is the camp of the Shechinah;** וְעַל יְדֵי זֶה מְרַמֵּז טָהֳרַת פָּרָה **and to this the purification of the parah alludes:** לִהְיוֹת נִטְהָר מִבְּחִינַת הָעַצְבוּת **to be purified from the aspect of sadness,** שֶׁהוּא הִתְרַשְּׁלוּת גָּדוֹל **which is a great slackening** וּמְנִיעָה גְּדוֹלָה.[1330] **and a great hindrance.** וְגַם אִם הוּא מֵאוֹתוֹ עִנְיָן עַצְמוֹ **And even if it comes from that very matter** — שֶׁמַּרְגִּישׁ שֶׁאֵינוֹ נָקִי מִתַּאֲוָה **that he feels he is not clean of desire** עִם כָּל זֶה לֹא יַרְפֶּה אֶת **and the yetzer hara overpowers him in this** — וְיֵצֶר הָרָע מִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו בָּזֶה. עַצְמוֹ **nevertheless he should not let himself go slack,** שֶׁיְּהֵא וְיִתְחַזֵּק בְּעַצְמוֹ **but should strengthen himself.** **It is like what they said (Sukkah 52a):** שֶׁלֹּא דְּאַבַּיֵי הֲוָה מְצַטַּעַר **Abaye was distressed** כְּעִנְיָן שֶׁאָמְרוּ (סוּכָּה נב, א) עַד דְּאָתָא לֵיהּ הַהוּא סָבָא **until a certain elder taught** הֲוָה מָצֵי לְאוֹקוֹמֵי נַפְשֵׁיהּ **that he could not restrain himself,**

[1328] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Shevat 5** — "The yetzer hara… sits between the heart's two openings … Joy comes only when the yetzer hara is entirely nullified and the heart becomes one heart to its Father in Heaven." This explains why the Geonim's "removal of the heart" and Chachmoni's "joy of the heart" are one reading. Constant joy belongs only to a heart whose left chamber has also been cleared.

[1329] **Parallel: Shem MiShmuel, Tetzaveh (Purim Katan) 12** — "The miracle of Purim was a double miracle… even had there been no decree against Yisrael … mitzvah of eradicating Amalek in so exalted a way, that too would have been a wondrous miracle." The Sochatchover treats the eradication of Amalek as a miracle in its own right. This sharpens Rav Tzadok's claim that the decree itself was the path to that eradication.

[1330] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, The Fifteenth of Av 1** — "Through this they instituted the blessing HaTov VeHaMeitiv, as they said (Pesachim 50a) … it is all 'Who is good and does good,' for then they will see that everything was for the good." Rav Tzadok finds the same pattern at Beitar. Once the slain were brought to burial, the catastrophe itself was seen to hold its repair, and so the blessing of the World to Come was instituted in this world.

him — וְהַיְינוּ אֵלִיָּהוּ[1331] **that is, Eliyahu** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תּוֹסָפוֹת חוּלִּין ו, א) **(as Tosafos writes, Chullin 6a,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל אַשְׁכְּחֵיהּ) **— s.v. Ashkecheih) —** יִצְרוֹ גָּדוֹל הֵימֶנּוּ כָּל הַגָּדוֹל מֵחֲבֵירוֹ **"Whoever is greater than his fellow, his inclination is greater than his."** דְּאִדְּרַבָּא כָּל מַה שֶּׁנִּכְנָס הָאָדָם **For on the contrary, the more a person enters** יֵשׁ עָלָיו הִתְגַּבְּרוּת הַהֵיפֶךְ בָּזֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה **into this, with extra vigilance, correspondingly the opposite surges against him;** וַה׳ לֹא יַעַזְבֶנּוּ בְיָדוֹ **and "Hashem will not leave him in his hand,"** שֶׁאֵין הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **for the Holy One, blessed be He, does not** בָּא בִּטְרוּנְיָא עִם בְּרִיּוֹתָיו[1332] **make unreasonable demands of His creatures** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה ג, א), **(as is written in Avodah Zarah 3a),** וְהַיֵּצֶר הָרָע שֶׁל כָּל אֶחָד בִּכְּרָט **and the yetzer hara of each individual** לֹא הוּטְבַּע בּוֹ יוֹתֵר מִכֹּחוֹ **was not implanted in him beyond his strength,** רַק כְּפִי מַה שֶּׁיּוּכַל לְהִתְגַּבֵּר עָלָיו **but only as much as he can overcome.** וְדַיְיקָא בְּדָרָךְ זֶה **And precisely in this way —** כְּשֶׁהוּא מִתְחַזֵּק וּמִתְגַּבֵּר **when he strengthens himself and prevails** לְבַל יִפּוֹל בְּעַצְבוּת **so as not to fall into sadness —** בָּזֶה יוּכַל לְהַגִּיעַ **through this he can reach** אַהֲבָה שֶׁבַּקְּדוּשָּׁה.[1333] **the aspect of holy love.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן טָהֳרַת פָּרָה **And this is the matter of the purification of Parshas Parah,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר עַל זֶה **about which it is said,** מִי יִתֵּן טָהוֹר מִטָּמֵא **"Who can bring purity out of impurity?" —** שֶׁכָּל הָעוֹסְקִין בְּפָרָה מִתְּחִלָּה וְעַד סוֹף **for all who are involved with the parah from beginning to end** מְטַמְּאִין בְּגָדִים **render garments impure,** וְהִיא גּוּפָהּ מְטַהֶרֶת בְּגָדִים[1334] **while it itself purifies garments** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה חֻקַּת יט, א). **(as is written in Midrash Rabbah Chukas 19:1).** וְהוּא מֵעִנְיַן דְּבָרִים **And this belongs to the category of things** שֶׁצְּרִיכִין חִיזּוּק **that need strengthening:** תּוֹרָה וּתְפִלָּה וּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים **Torah, tefillah, and good deeds** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת לב, ב). **(as is written in Berachos 32b).** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז הַפָּסוּק **And one may say that the verse alludes to this:** [דְּבָרִים ל, יא] כִּי הַמִּצְוָה הַזֹּאת וְגוֹמֵר **(Devarim 30:11): "For this mitzvah," etc.,** וְלֹא רְחוֹקָה הִיא. **"it is not far."** שֶׁלֹּא יְתַדֵּמֶּה לְהָאָדָם **A person should not imagine** שֶׁמְּרַחֲקִים אוֹתוֹ **that he is being pushed away from entering holiness,** מִלְּכְנוֹס לְהַקְּדוּשָּׁה שֶׁאֵינוֹ כֵן **for it is not so;** רַק כִּי קָרוֹב מְאֹד הַדָּבָר אֵלֶיךָ **rather, "the matter is very near to you,** הַיְינוּ שֶׁהוּא קָרוֹב אֵלֶיךָ **meaning it is near to you** בְּשִׁלּשָׁה דְּבָרִים **in the three things mentioned above.** בְּפִיךָ הַיְינוּ בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **"In your mouth" — that is, in words of Torah,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה נט, כא] לֹא יָמוּשׁוּ מִפִּיךָ. **as it says (Yeshayah 59:21), "it shall not depart from your mouth."** וּבִלְבָבְךָ בִּתְפִלָּה **"And in your heart" — in tefillah,** שֶׁהִיא עֲבוֹדָה שֶׁבַּלֵּב[1335] **which is the service of the heart** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תַּעֲנִית ב, א) **(as is written in Taanis 2a).** וְלַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ הַיְינוּ **"To do it" — that is,** הִתְחַזְּקוּת בְּמַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים: **strengthening in good deeds.**

[1331] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 19** — "The essence of feasting is the bonding of people in love … and the first feast mentioned in the Torah is Lot's for the angels, and through it he was saved." Rav Tzadok explains there why the whole Purim story turns on feasts. The feast and the sending of portions are means of uniting hearts, so their inner purpose can apply in Adar Rishon as well.

[1332] **Parallel: Mei HaShiloach I, Megillah 7a** — "When the Men of the Great Assembly investigated where this decree sprang from and found it was from narrowness of eye … afterward they instituted these two mitzvos, whose root is a good eye." The Izhbitzer gives a parallel account of what mishloach manos repairs. It works on the heart, the root of the decree, which supports Rav Tzadok's point that its intent belongs to the heart rather than to the deed alone.

[1333] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pinchas 17** — "On Shabbos there is rest for Yisrael; even one still in hard labor has rest from everything … then it is all 'Who is good and does good'; therefore we say 'You are One.'" Rav Tzadok finds this awareness in the Shabbos Minchah prayer. On Shabbos the oneness of "Hashem is One" is already felt as the goodness of everything, as in the World to Come.

[1334] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shavuos 20** — "One who merits to be engraved on the Tablets does not die … and it is written, 'When you awaken, it will converse with you' — in the time to come." This names the condition for such a death. Torah that frees a person from the yetzer hara makes death a passing sleep, which is the life the "Orach Chaim" leads to.

[1335] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Iyar 1** — "The main light of the month is included in Rosh Chodesh … for it is the head of the month, and all follows the head." Rav Tzadok uses this to explain why Iyar is called "Ziv": its Rosh Chodesh was the first after the Avos were born in Nissan, so their radiance is credited to it.

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ

Parshas HaChodesh

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר א׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Aleph

בִּרְבִיעִית **On the fourth Shabbos we read** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **"This month shall be for you"** (מְגִילָּה כט.) **(Megillah 29a),** וְנִקְרָא פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **and it is called Parshas HaChodesh,** וְלֹא נִקְרָא פָּרָשַׁת הַפֶּסַח **and not called Parshas HaPesach,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּקְרָא פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים **just as Parshas Shekalim is so called** וְלֹא נִקְרָא פָּרָשַׁת כִּי תִשָּׂא **and not called Parshas Ki Sisa,** וְכֵן פָּרָשַׁת פָּרָה **and likewise Parshas Parah,** שֶׁלֹּא נִקְרָא פָּרָשַׁת חֻקַּת הַתּוֹרָה **which is not called Parshas Chukas HaTorah,** רַק עַל שֵׁם הָעִנְיָן **but only after the subject:** שְׁקָלִים פָּרָה **Shekalim, Parah;** וְכֵן הָיָה לֵיהּ לִקְרוֹת פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ פָּרָשַׁת הַפֶּסַח. **so too it ought to have called this parshah Parshas HaPesach.** רַק עִיקַּר הַמְכוּוָּן בְּהַפָּרָשָׁה **Rather, the main intent of the parshah** מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **is what it says, "This month shall be for you,"** שֶׁהוּא הַתְחָלַת דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **which is the beginning of words of Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ אָמַר רַבִּי יִצְחָק **as they said: Rabbi Yitzchak said,** לֹא הָיָה צָרִיךְ לְהַתְחִיל אֶת הַתּוֹרָה **"The Torah should not have needed to begin** אֶלָּא מֵהַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם[1336] **except from 'This month shall be for you,'** שֶׁהִיא מִצְוָה רִאשׁוֹנָה כּוּלֵי **which is the first mitzvah" etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתַב רַשׁ״י רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת בְּרֵאשִׁית) **(as Rashi writes at the beginning of Parshas Bereishis);** וְכֵן הוּבָא בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **and so it is brought in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב לט, ב) **(vol. II 39b):** לָא אִצְטְרִיךְ אוֹרַיְיתָא לְמִכְתַּב **"The Torah need not have been written** אֶלָּא מֵהַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם וְגוֹמֵר **except from 'This month shall be for you' etc.** מַאי טַעְמָא **What is the reason?** מִשּׁוּם דְּשֵׁירוּתָא דְּסִיהֲרָא הֲוֵי. **Because it is the beginning of the moon.** וְעַל דָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא **And therefore the Torah** הֲוָה אִצְטְרִיךְ לְמִכְתַּב מֵהָכָא **should have been written from here,** דְּהָא בְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **for with the Holy One, blessed be He,** אִתְקַשַּׁר מִלָּה[1337] **the matter is bound up.** וְלָא קַשְׁיָא **And it is no difficulty** דְּלָא כְּתִיב זֹאת הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֹּאת **that it does not say 'zos hachodesh,' 'hazos,'** דְּהָא זֶה וְזֹאת **for zeh and zos** כְּחַד מִתְקַשְּׁרָן כּוּלֵי **are bound together as one" etc.** וְהָעִנְיָן דְּסִיהֲרָא **The point is that the moon** הִיא מְקַבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **receives from the sun,** [תְּהִלִּים פד, יב] וּכְתִיב **and it is written (Tehillim 84:12),** כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן **"For a sun and a shield** ה׳ אֱלֹהִים **is Hashem Elokim,"** וְהַשְּׁכִינָה בְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא **and the Shechinah is the aspect of the moon** דִּמְקַבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **that receives from the sun;** וַהֲוָה לֵיהּ לְמִכְתַּב **so it should have written** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֹּאת **"hachodesh hazos," in the feminine.** וְכָאן תְּחִלַּת הַהַכָּרָה **And here is the beginning of recognition,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ אוֹר שֶׁמַּכִּירִין **that there is a light that is recognized,** וְיכוֹלִים לְהַרְאוֹת בְּאֶצְבַּע זֹאת. **and one can point to it with a finger: "This."** וְזֶהוּ דְּשֵׁירוּתָא דְּסִיהֲרָא הֲוֵי. **And this is "for it is the beginning of the moon."** וַהֲוָה לֵיהּ לְהַתְחִיל הַתּוֹרָה **And the Torah should have begun there,** דְּהָא בְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא אִתְקַשַּׁר **"for it is bound up with the Holy One, blessed be He"** — וְהַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **that is, as they said** בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ (בְּשַׁלַּח ס, א) **in the holy Zohar (Beshalach 60a):** וְאוֹלִיפְנָא דְּקוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא **"And we have learned that the Holy One, blessed be He,** תּוֹרָה אִיקְרֵי כּוּלֵי **is called Torah" etc.,** וְאֵין תּוֹרָה אֶלָּא **and there is no Torah but** קוּדְשָׁא בְּרִיךְ הוּא. **the Holy One, blessed be He.** וְכָאן נִיתַּן מִצְוָה רִאשׁוֹנָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל[1338] **And here the first mitzvah was given to Yisrael:** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **"This month shall be for you"** — כָּזֶה רְאֵה וְקַדֵּשׁ **"Like this, see and sanctify"** — שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל יְכוֹלִים **meaning that Yisrael are able** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה לַחֹדֶשׁ **to bring holiness into the month,** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה טו, כד וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ) **as they said (Shemos Rabbah 15:24):** וְאִם כְּלִי חוֹל **"If a mundane vessel,** בְּשֶׁמִּתְמַלֵּא מִן הַקָּדֹשׁ **when it is filled from the holy,** מִתְקַדֶּשֶׁת **becomes sanctified,** עַל אַחַת כַּמָּה וְכַמָּה יִשְׂרָאֵל **how much more so Yisrael,** שֶׁהֵם קְדוֹשִׁים **who are holy** וּמְקַדְּשִׁים אֶת הַחֹדֶשׁ[1339] כּוּלֵי **and sanctify the month" etc.** וְאָמַר דְּהָא זֶה וְזֹאת **And it says, "for zeh and zos** כְּחַד מִתְקַשְּׁרָן **are bound together as one,"** שֶׁהַקְּדוּשָׁה

[1336] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shavuos 12** — "Tosafos say it was a dream fast… except on Purim, where the term 'feasting' is used … and on Atzeres the eating is like a korban, which is the main intent of a fast." Here Rav Tzadok gives a second reason for Mar bar Ravina's exceptions. On these three days the eating itself fulfills what a fast is meant to accomplish.

[1337] **Parallel: Divrei Soferim 36** — "Of them they said in Tanchuma that there is great pain and sleeplessness, likened to darkness … this is the Talmud of Bavel; for Talmud is the delving into the depths of Torah." Rav Tzadok explains the "darkness" of the Bavli as its depth. Those sunk in that depth become people whose every word is Torah.

[1338] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Acharei Mos 6** — "There is a level in the kelipah called snow, and it is the first of nations … what is his Torah and service worth?… And against this there are two kinds of Gehinnom." This shows what the cold of Amalek does. It humbles even great people until they stop learning, as Osniel ben Kenaz feared, and so its punishment is the Gehinnom of snow.

[1339] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Seitzei 2** — "In the Zohar Chadash: 'When you go out to war against your enemy' — this is the yetzer hara … and then he will be given into a person's hand." The Zohar Chadash supports Rebbe Bunim's reading. Rav Tzadok adds why the war is won through Torah: Torah is the Name of Hashem, so "Hashem your God will give him into your hand."

בְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **for the holiness in Yisrael** הוּא מִצַּד הַקְּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **comes from the side of the Holy One, blessed be He,** הוֹאִיל וְנִקְדַּשְׁתֶּם לִשְׁמִי כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא קְדוֹשִׁים ב) **as they said (Midrash Tanchuma, Kedoshim 2):** "מֵאַחַר שֶׁנִּתְקַדַּשְׁתֶּם לִי הֱיוּ קְדוֹשִׁים כְּשֵׁם שֶׁאֲנִי קָדוֹשׁ כּוּלֵי **"Since you have been sanctified to My Name" etc., "Be holy, just as I am holy" etc.;** אֲנִי מֶלֶךְ וְאַתְּ מָשָׁל לְמָה הַדָּבָר דּוֹמֶה כּוּלֵי **"A parable — to what may this be compared?" etc.: "I am king and you are queen" etc.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ דָּבָא זֶה וְזֹאת **And this is what they said, "for zeh and zos** כְּחַד מִתְקַשְּׁרָן. **are bound together as one."** וְזֶהוּ הַקְּדָּמָה לְמִצְוַת הַפֶּסַח **And this is a preface to the mitzvah of the Pesach offering,** דִּבְנֵי נֹחַ אֵין לָהֶם כֹּחַ **for the descendants of Noach have no power** לֶאֱכוֹל אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָּׁה **to eat an eating in holiness,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (זְבָחִים קטז.) **as they said (Zevachim 116a):** "לֹא קָרְבוּ שְׁלָמִים בְּנֵי נֹחַ **"The descendants of Noach did not offer shelamim."**[1340] וְאַף לְמַאן דְּאָמַר קָרְבוּ שְׁלָמִים **And even according to the view that they did offer shelamim,** מִכָּל מָקוֹם בְּפֶסַח מְפוֹרָשׁ **nonetheless regarding the Pesach it is explicit:** "כָּל בֶּן נֵכָר לֹא יֹאכַל בּוֹ [שְׁמוֹת יב, מח] וְכָל עָרֵל לֹא יֹאכַל בּוֹ **"No foreigner shall eat of it," and "no uncircumcised man shall eat of it" (Shemos 12:48).** וְאַחַר שֶׁנִּתַּן לָהֶם פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **And after they were given Parshas HaChodesh,** שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ אוּמָּה יִשְׂרְאֵלִית **through which they became the Jewish nation,** בְּחִינַת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **the aspect of Knesses Yisrael,** אָז נִיתַּן לָהֶם מִצְוַת הַפֶּסַח. **then they were given the mitzvah of the Pesach.** וְאָמַר דָּבָא זֶה וְזֹאת **And it says, "for zeh and zos** כְּחַד מִתְקַשְּׁרָן **are bound together as one,** וּבְאַתַר דְּאִית לֵית שְׁבָחָא אֶלָּא לִדְכוּרָא **and in a place where male and female are together, the praise goes only to the male;** וְעַל דָּא רֵאשׁוֹן הוּא לָכֶם לְחָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה. **and therefore: 'It is first for you of the months of the year.'"** דְּשָׁנָה נִקְרֵאת שְׁנַת הַחַמָּה **For "year" refers to the solar year,** שֶׁהִיא שׁוֹנָה בְּכָל פַּעַם **which repeats itself each time** בְּגִמַר הַהֵיקֵף **at the completion of the cycle,** וְהִיא הִיא בְּרֵאשׁוֹנָה **and the sun is exactly as it was at first;** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן הַלְּבָנָה **whereas the moon** נִקְרֵאת חֲדָשָׁה בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ **is called new every month,** מוֹלֶדֶת הַלְּבָנָה **at the birth of the moon,** (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כה.) דְּאִיתָא **as is stated (Rosh Hashanah 25a)** עַל הָאִשָּׁה שֶׁיָּלְדָה **about "a woman who gave birth** כּוּלֵי וְלִמָּחָר כְּרֵיסָהּ בֵּין שִׁנֶּיהָ[1341] **and the next day her belly is between her teeth" etc.;** וְזֶהוּ **that is, the moon receives** אוֹר חָדָשׁ מֵאוֹר הַחַמָּה **new light from the light of the sun,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת הַלְּבָנָה חָדָשׁ מֵחָדָשׁ. **and this is its being born anew.** וּכְשֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לְחָדְשֵׁי הַשָּׁנָה. **And when it says "of the months of the year,"** חָדְשֵׁי הַיְינוּ **"months" means** חִדּוּתוֹ דְּסִיהֲרָא **the renewal of the moon, as mentioned above,** שֶׁשּׁוֹנָה בְּכָל שָׁנָה כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **which repeats every year, as mentioned above;** וְהַשָּׁנָה הַיְינוּ הַחַמָּה **and "the year" is the sun,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא חֹדֶשׁ. **which is called chodesh;** וְזֶהוּ דְּזֶה וְזֹאת **and this is "zeh and zos** כְּחַד מִתְקַשְּׁרָן. **are bound together as one."** אַחַר כָּךְ מַקְשֶׁה **Afterward it asks:** אָמַר רַבִּי יְהוּדָה **"Rabbi Yehudah said:** לָכֶם תְּרֵי זִמְנֵי מִנַּיְיהוּ אִשְׁתְּמַע יַתִּיר **From them more is understood,** אָמַר רַבִּי יִצְחָק **Rabbi Yitzchak said:** לָמָּה **Why does it say 'for you' twice?** כְּמָה דִּכְתִיב [דְּבָרִים לב, ט] **as it is written (Devarim 32:9),** כִּי חֵלֶק ה' עַמּוֹ כּוּלֵי **'For Hashem's portion is His people'" etc.** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **And this follows what they said** בְּמִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה לג, א) **in Midrash Rabbah (Shemos Rabbah 33:1):** "וְיִקְחוּ לִי כּוּלֵי **"'And they shall take for Me' etc. — I sold you My Torah;** מָכַרְתִּי תּוֹרָתִי לָכֶם כּוּלֵי[1342] כְּבָיָכוֹל נִמְכַּרְתִּי עִמָּהּ **as it were, I was sold along with it" etc.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ חֵלֶק ה' **That is, they became Hashem's portion,** שֶׁלֹּא נִיכַּר קְדוּשַׁת ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **for the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach is not recognized** רַק עַל יְדֵי קְדוּשַׁת יִשְׂרָאֵל **except through the holiness of Yisrael,** שֶׁמְּקַבְּלִין מִקְּדוּשַׁת ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ. **who receive from the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach.** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר יִתְרוֹ מַאֲמָר ז) **(And it was explained in Yisro, maamar 7.)** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר לָכֶם תְּרֵי זִמְנֵי **And on this it says "for you" twice:** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה רֹאשׁוֹן הוּא לָכֶם **"It is first for you"** שֵׁירוּתָא דְּסִיהֲרָא. **the beginning of the moon;** לָכֶם **"This month shall be for you"** הַיְינוּ ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **that is, Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא רֹאשׁוֹן **who is called "First,"**[1343] הוּא גַּם כֵּן לָכֶם. **He too is "for you."** וְאָמַר אִתְקַשְּׁרוּתָא דָּא לָכֶם **And it says, "This bond is 'for you'** וְלֹא לְאַחֵר **and not for**

[1340] **Parallel: Kometz HaMincha II 64** — "Before every ascent to a higher level there is a fall … for such is the order of creation: 'day and night shall not cease'… but in the future… there will be no fall." Rav Tzadok reads the night between every two days as the pattern of spiritual life. Darkness is the necessary ground of light until the yetzer is slaughtered.

[1341] **Parallel: Likkutei Maamarim, Compositions on the Festivals 13** — "This separation is made through deep sleep, as 'a descent for the sake of an ascent' … he wakes, returns and regrets, and thereby evil is separated from good little by little." This explains how sleep and laziness lead to greater alacrity. The fall followed by waking is how teshuvah separates evil from good in this world.

[1342] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayishlach 4** — "The yetzer hara was created for good; only man spoils it and makes it evil. … desire: 'Were it not for the yetzer hara, the joy of learning would not exist.'" Rav Tzadok extends the point beyond desire. Each root of the yetzer, envy and honor as well, has its holy use in the service of Hashem.

the other nations," עַל דָּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **along the lines of what they said** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כה, יא) **(Shemos Rabbah 25:11):** מָשָׁל לְמֶלֶךְ יוֹשֵׁב **"A parable of a king sitting,** וּמַטְרוֹנָא יוֹשֶׁבֶת כְּנֶגְדּוֹ **and the matron sits opposite him;** כּוּלֵי הָעוֹבֵר בֵּינֵיהֶן[1344] **whoever passes between them" etc.** וּבַפְּסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתִי **And in Pesikta Rabbasi** (פָּרָשָׁה טו [שְׁמוֹת יב, ג] וְיִקְחוּ לָהֶם אִישׁ **"'And they shall take for themselves, each man' (Shemos 12:3)** — זֶה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **this is the Holy One, blessed be He,** דִּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ **of whom it is written,** [שָׁם טו, ג] ה' אִישׁ מִלְחָמָה **'Hashem is a Man of war' (ibid. 15:3)."** וְהֵיינוּ שֶׁבְּמִצְוַת הַפֶּסַח **That is, through the mitzvah of the Pesach** לוֹקְחִים לַה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ[1345] **they take Hashem Yisbarach;** דְּלֹא יִתָּכֵן מִצְוַת הַפֶּסַח לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **the mitzvah of the Pesach could not apply to Yisrael** רַק אַחַר שֶׁנִּתְקַשְּׁרוּ **except after they became bound** בִּקְדוּשַׁת ה' יִתְבָּרֵךְ **to the holiness of Hashem Yisbarach** וְיוּכְלוּ לֶאֱכוֹל אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה. **and could eat an eating in holiness.** וְאָמַר מִקּוֹדֶם **And it first stated** מִצְוַת הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **the mitzvah of "This month shall be for you"** לְמֹשֶׁה וְאַהֲרֹן **to Moshe and Aharon,** שֶׁנָּתַן לָהֶם כֹּחַ **for He gave them the power** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה לַחֹדֶשׁ **to bring holiness into the month;** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִיתַּן מִצְוַת הַפֶּסַח **and afterward the mitzvah of the Pesach was given** לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל **to all Yisrael,** שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם **for all Yisrael have** קְדוּשָׁה בַּגּוּף **holiness in the body** וְיכוֹלִים לֶאֱכוֹל אֲכִילָה בִּקְדוּשָׁה **and can eat an eating in holiness.** (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כד.) וְזֶה דִּתְנַן **And this is what we learned (Rosh Hashanah 24a):** רֹאשׁ בֵּית דִּין אוֹמֵר מְקוּדָּשׁ **"The head of the beis din says, 'Sanctified,'** וְכָל הָעָם עוֹנִין אַחֲרָיו **and all the people answer after him,** מְקוּדָּשׁ מְקוּדָּשׁ.[1346] **'Sanctified, sanctified.'"** דְּכֵיוָן שֶׁאָמַר רֹאשׁ בֵּית דִּין מְקוּדָּשׁ **For once the head of the beis din said "Sanctified,"** שׁוּב הָיָה כֹּחַ לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל **all Yisrael then had the power** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה לַחֹדֶשׁ. **to bring holiness into the month.** וְאָמַר אַחַר כָּךְ בְּאוֹתוֹ פָּרָשָׁה [שָׁם, טז] **And afterward it says in that same parshah (ibid. 12:16):** וּבַיּוֹם הָרִאשׁוֹן מִקְרָא קֹדֶשׁ **"And on the first day, a holy convocation,** וּבַיּוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי מִקְרָא קֹדֶשׁ. **and on the seventh day, a holy convocation."** דְּכֵיוָן שֶׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל יֵשׁ לָהֶם קְדוּשָׁה **For since Yisrael have holiness,** יוּכְלוּ לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה לַזְּמַן. **they can bring holiness into time.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ [שָׁם, כד] נֶאֱמַר לָהֶם **And afterward (ibid. 12:24) they were told** מִצְוָה זוֹ לְדוֹרוֹת **this mitzvah for all generations,** [שָׁם יג, ט-טז] וְאַחַר כָּךְ נֶאֱמַר לָהֶם **and afterward (ibid. 13:9–16) they were told** מִצְוַת תְּפִילִּין **the mitzvah of tefillin,** שֶׁהוּא כֶּתֶר עַל הָרֹאשׁ. **which is a crown upon the head.** וְאַף שֶׁעִיקַּר הִתְגַּלּוּת עַתִּיקָא **And although the main revelation of Atika** זָכוּ בִּקְרִיעַת יַם סוּף **they merited at the splitting of the Yam Suf,** כֵּינָן שֶׁכְּבָר בְּמַכַּת בְּכוֹרוֹת **since already at the plague of the firstborn** נִקְרְאוּ בְּנִי בְכוֹרִי יִשְׂרָאֵל [שָׁם ד, כב] **they were called "My son, My firstborn, Yisrael" (ibid. 4:22),** שֶׁקִּשּׁוּרִים בְּרֵאשִׁית בִּשְׁבִיל יִשְׂרָאֵל **meaning that they are bound to the beginning of Thought —** בְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה **"Bereishis": for the sake of Yisrael,** שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ רֵאשִׁית **who are called "reishis"** — נֶאֱמַר לָהֶם פָּרָשַׁת תְּפִילִּין. **the parshah of tefillin was told to them.** וּבְשַׁבָּת שֶׁהֵן גּוּפָן אוֹת **And on Shabbos, which is itself a sign,** לָאו זְמַן תְּפִילִּין[1347] [עֵירוּבִין צו, א] **it is not a time for tefillin (Eruvin 96a),** שֶׁאָז כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל קְשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **for then all Yisrael are bound to the root,** וְהֵם כְּהוֹלְכִים כָּל הַיּוֹם בִּתְפִילִּין[1348] **and they are like those who go about all day in tefillin** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פְּקוּדֵי מַאֲמָר ט)**: (and it was explained in Pekudei, maamar 9).**

[1343] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayigash 12** — "Of the kelipah of desire something will remain in the future too… and the yearning for Torah will remain from it … for the meaning of yetzer is desire, as in 'l'yetzer machshevos levav.'" Rav Tzadok grounds the claim in the word itself. Yetzer means desire, and that desire, once cleansed, is the holiness Yisrael drew out of Mitzrayim.

[1344] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, The Fifteenth of Av 5** — "Night, the aspect of the moon that receives from the sun … of reasoning they said, 'Your teachings are sharp — they are from the daytime.'" This identifies the night's work as review, the human labor of keeping the Oral Torah. For that reason learning at night is added from the fifteenth of Av, and "there is no song of Torah except at night."

[1345] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 12** — "In the future, when all of Torah she'b'al peh is complete … 'and the light of the sun sevenfold, like the light of the seven days': the light of the first Tablets." Rav Tzadok reads Yeshayah's verse as a statement about Torah. The equalizing of moon and sun is the Oral Torah reaching the standing of the Written Torah.

[1346] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Bereishis 2** — "The lights were diminished and separated, the light of the moon … the Written Torah; and through the holiness of Shabbos they become included in one another as in the future." What the nineteen-year cycle prepares for, Shabbos already grants for a time. Each week it gives a foretaste of the moon's light equaling the sun's.

[1347] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Acharei Mos 1** — "The gates of prayer are sometimes open, sometimes locked… but the sea is always open … and they merit the fiftieth gate, Binah, which is the World to Come." The Midrash's image of the sea supports Rav Tzadok's link between "yam," numerically fifty, and the gate of fifty. Like the sea, that gate is never closed to the baal teshuvah.

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר ב׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Bais

"This month shall be for you הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **the head of months;** רֹאשׁ חֳדָשִׁים [שְׁמוֹת יב, ב] רֹאשׁוֹן הוּא לָכֶם וְגוֹמֵר **it is first for you" etc. (Shemos 12:2).** בִּפְסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתִי **In Pesikta Rabbasi** (פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ סוֹף פָּרָשָׁה טו) **(Parshas HaChodesh, end of Parshah 15):** חַדְּשׁוּ מַעֲשֵׂיכֶם **"Renew your deeds,** שֶׁעֲתִידִין רֹאשׁ וְרִאשׁוֹן לָבֹא[1349] **for 'head' and 'first' are still to come.** רֹאשׁ זֶה נְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר הָרָשָׁע **'Head' — this is Nevuchadnetzar the wicked,** דִּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ [דָּנִיֵּאל ב, לח] **of whom it is written (Daniel 2:38),** אַנְתְּ הוּא רֵישָׁא דִּדְהַבָּא **'You are the head of gold.'** רִאשׁוֹן זֶה עֵשָׂו **'First' — this is Esav,** דִּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ [בְּרֵאשִׁית כה, כה] **of whom it is written (Bereishis 25:25),** וַיֵּצֵא הָרִאשׁוֹן אַדְמוֹנִי. **'And the first came out ruddy.'"** וְהַיְינוּ דִּנְבוּכַדְנֶצַּר בַּקְלִיפָּה רֹאשׁ **That is, Nevuchadnetzar is "head" in the kelipah,** כְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת חָכְמָה בַּקְּדוּשָׁה **corresponding to the attribute of Chochmah in holiness** — חָכְמָה מוֹחָא **Chochmah is the brain,** שֶׁהוּא תְּחִלַּת הַהַכָּרָה. **which is the beginning of recognition.** וְגַם אֲחַשְׁוֵרוֹשׁ נִקְרָא **And Achashverosh too is called** אָחִיו שֶׁל רֹאשׁ **"the brother of the head"** וּבֶן גִּילוֹ שֶׁל רֹאשׁ **and "the contemporary of the head":** הוּא הָרַג הוּא בִּיקֵּשׁ לַהֲרוֹג **"the one killed, the other sought to kill;** הוּא הֶחֱרִיב הוּא בִּיקֵּשׁ לְהַחֲרִיב[1350] **the one destroyed, the other sought to destroy"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מְגִילָּה יא.) **(as it says, Megillah 11a).** וּלְעוּמַּת שֶׁבַּקְּדוּשָׁה **And opposite what is in holiness** — ה׳ בְּחָכְמָה יָסַד אָרֶץ **"Hashem founded the earth with wisdom,"** כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל שֶׁנִּקְרָא אָרֶץ **Knesses Yisrael, which is called "earth"** — וְהֵם זֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה **they, as the counterpart,** בִּקְּשׁוּ לַהֲרוֹג וּלְהַחֲרִיב הַכֹּל. **sought to kill and destroy everything.** וְרִאשׁוֹן קְלִיפַּת עֵשָׂו **And "first" is the kelipah of Esav,** שֶׁהוּא שֶׁהָיָה כְּנֶגֶד מִדַּת כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **which corresponded to the attribute of Keser Elyon,** נֶעְלָם מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן. **which is hidden from all thought.** וְכֵן לְעוּמַּת זֶה הָיָה כֹּחוֹ **And so, as its counterpart, his power was** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בְּיִצְחָק אָבִינוּ **as we find with Yitzchak Avinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **peace be upon him,** שֶׁהָיָה עֵשָׂו צָדוֹ בְּפִיו[1351] **that Esav would "trap him with his mouth":** וּכְשֶׁהָיָה אוֹמֵר לוֹ **when he would ask him,** הֵיכָן הָיִיתָ **"Where were you?"** הָיָה אוֹמֵר בְּבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ **he would say, "In the beis midrash —** לֹא כָךְ הֲלָכָה **is not the halachah thus,** מִן כָּךְ וְכָךְ כּוּלֵי **from such-and-such?" etc.** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא תּוֹלְדוֹת ח) **(as it says in Midrash Tanchuma, Toldos 8).** וּבְוַדַּאי יִצְחָק אָבִינוּ **And certainly Yitzchak Avinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה יוֹדֵעַ בְּרוּחַ הַקּוֹדֶשׁ **knew through ruach hakodesh** לְהַבְדִּיל בֵּין אֱמֶת לְשֶׁקֶר **how to distinguish between truth and falsehood;** רַק זֶהוּ כֹּחַ עֵשָׂו **but this is Esav's power,** לְהַסְתִּיר עַצְמוֹ **to conceal himself** עַד שֶׁלֹּא יוּכְלוּ לְהַכִּיר בּוֹ.[1352] **until he cannot be recognized.** וְאִיתָא (חוּלִּין צא.) **And it is stated (Chullin 91a):** כְּתַלְמִיד חָכָם נִדְמָה לוֹ **"He appeared to him as a talmid chacham,** דְּאָמַר מָר הַמְהַלֵּךְ לִימִין רַבּוֹ כּוּלֵי **for Mar said: one who walks at his teacher's right" etc.;** שֶׁהַשַּׂר שֶׁלּוֹ הִסְתִּיר עַצְמוֹ **his angelic minister concealed himself** עַד שֶׁנִּדְמָה לְיַעֲקֹב כְּמוֹ רַבּוֹ **until he appeared to Yaakov like his teacher** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה לוֹ דֶּרֶךְ הַטּוֹב. **who shows him the good path.** וְכֵן לֶעָתִיד אִיתָא **And so regarding the future it is stated** (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא צַו, ב) **(Midrash Tanchuma, Tzav 2):** מָה עֵשָׂו עוֹשֶׂה **"What does Esav do?** מִתְעַטֵּף בְּטַלִּיתוֹ

[1348] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 38** — "The inception of evil does not entice one to set out to sin… rather an opportunity presents itself… This is 'asher karcha ba'derech': it comes through chance and incidental encounter, not by design." There Rav Tzadok draws the practical counsel from this: the remedy for Amalek's "chance" approach is zechirah, recalling at once, the moment the opportunity arises, that Hashem forbade it.

[1349] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayeilech 1** — "An angel is called 'standing,' for it always stands at one level, whereas a person must always be 'going,' rising from level to level until he completes himself and reaches his eternal home." There Rav Tzadok also explains Moshe's "I can no longer go out and come in": one who can no longer fall from his level can no longer rise, so that rest comes only at life's end.

[1350] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 16** — "Since his root is that he 'feared not God,' he was able to put this into the hearts of Yisrael through the enticing yetzer, for their root is 'a woman who fears Hashem.'" Rav Tzadok there applies the same principle to fear of Heaven: what Amalek implants in Yisrael is foreign to their root, and it enters only gradually, beginning with a cooling of their fervor.

[1351] **Parallel: Shem MiShmuel, Vayakhel** — "They were drained of vitality, did not believe in themselves, and were like those in despair… and through this loss of inner vitality Amalek gained power to draw them out from beneath the clouds." The Sochatchover's reading adds that despair is the inner flaw through which Amalek rules, whether it comes first or Amalek implants it. He finds the same pattern in Haman's "yeshno am," a people asleep and despairing of redemption.

[1352] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Purim Katan 2** — "Menasheh… is the time of erasing Amalek, who is the evil inclination; and from Efrayim came Yehoshua, who bequeathed Eretz Yisrael to Yisrael, which is the root of the holiness of Torah she'b'al peh." There Rav Tzadok reads the two halves of Adar in a leap year as these two forces, so the war on Amalek is paired with Yehoshua's inheritance of Torah she'b'al peh, as in the two conditions of the pasuk here.

כְּזָקֵן **He wraps himself in his tallis like an elder** וּבָא וְיוֹשֵׁב לוֹ אֵצֶל יַעֲקֹב כּוּלֵי **and comes and sits beside Yaakov" etc.;** עַד שֶׁאֲפִילּוּ מַלְאָכִים שֶׁזֶּה כֹּחוֹ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַסְתִּיר עַצְמוֹ **for this is his power, that he can conceal himself until even angels** לֹא יָבִינוּ עָרְמָתוֹ. **will not grasp his cunning.** [עובדיה א, ד] וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And about this it is said (Ovadiah 1:4):** "וְאִם בֵּין כּוֹכָבִים שִׂים קִנֶּךָ מִשָּׁם אוֹרִידְךָ נְאֻם ה׳ **"And if your nest is set among the stars, from there I will bring you down, says Hashem"** — שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁדָּן אֶת הַלְּבָבוֹת **for Hashem Yisbarach, who judges the hearts,** הוּא יוֹרִידֵנוּ אָרֶץ. **will bring him down to earth.** [שם, ו] וּכְתִיב בָּתַר הָכִי **And it is written right after that (ibid. 1:6):** "אֵיךְ נֶחְפְּשׂוּ עֵשָׂו נִבְעוּ מַצְפּוּנָיו **"How Esav has been searched out, his hidden places sought out"** — שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ יִגַּלֶּה **for Hashem Yisbarach will reveal** מַצְפּוּנֵי לְבָבוֹ שֶׁמְּלֵא תּוֹעֵבָה. **the hidden places of his heart, which is full of abomination.** וְכֵן הָיָה גָּלוּת רִאשׁוֹן **And so the first exile was** עַל יְדֵי בָּבֶל **through Bavel,** (יוֹמָא ט :) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Yoma 9b):** "רִאשׁוֹנִים שֶׁנִּתְגַּלָּה עֲוֹנָם **"The earlier ones, whose sin was revealed";** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאָז הָיָה טְעָנוֹת עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that is, then there were claims against Yisrael** בְּנִגְלוֹת **over revealed matters,** שֶׁעָבְרוּ עַל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **for they transgressed the words of the Torah** בִּשְׁלֹשׁ עֲבֵירוֹת הַחֲמוּרוֹת. **in the three severe sins.** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן בְּבֵית שֵׁנִי **Not so in the Second Temple era,** שֶׁהָיוּ עוֹסְקִין בְּתוֹרָה וּמִצְוֹת **when they were engaged in Torah and mitzvos** וּבִגְמִילוּת חֲסָדִים **and in acts of kindness;** רַק שֶׁהָיָה טַעֲנָה עֲלֵיהֶם בְּנִסְתָּרוֹת.[1353] **only there was a claim against them over hidden matters.** וְזֶה קְלִיפַּת עֵשָׂו וַעֲמָלֵק **And this is the kelipah of Esav and Amalek,** שֶׁהוּא כֶּלֶב **which is a dog,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֶלֶק ב סה, א) **(vol. II 65a):** נוֹבֵחַ וּמְקַטְרֵג **it barks and accuses;** מְסֻפָּק יוֹדֵעַ אוֹ אֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ **out of doubt — whether he knows or does not know —** מְקַטְרֵג עַל יִשְׂרָאֵל **he accuses Yisrael;** וַה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ שֶׁהוּא אוֹהֵב מִשְׁפָּט **and Hashem Yisbarach, who loves justice,** כְּשֶׁיֵּשׁ מְקַטְרֵג עוֹשֶׂה דִּין **when there is an accuser, executes judgment;** וְלָכֵן הָיָה גָּלוּת שֵׁנִי **and therefore the second exile was** עַל יְדֵי אֱדוֹם. **through Edom.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said:** שֶׁעֲדַיִן רֹאשׁ וְרִאשׁוֹן לָבֹא. **"for 'head' and 'first' are still to come."** וְאָמַר חַדְּשׁוּ מַעֲשֵׂיכֶם **And it says "Renew your deeds,"** אַף דְּעִיקַּר חִדּוּשָׁא דְּסִיהֲרָא הָאוֹר תּוֹרָה וְלֹא **even though the main renewal of the moon** הַמַּעֲשֶׂה. **is the light of Torah, not deeds.** אֲבָל עִיקַּר אוֹר תּוֹרָה **But the essence of the light of Torah** גַּם כֵּן הַמַּעֲשֶׂה **is also deeds,** (מְגִלָּה כז.) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Megillah 27a),** שֶׁהַלִּימּוּד מֵבִיא לִידֵי מַעֲשֶׂה.[1354] **that learning leads to deeds.** רַק כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים [דְּבָרִים ל, יד] **Only, we have already said many times** דִּכְתִיב **that it is written (Devarim 30:14),** וְלֹא כָּתוּב בְּמַעֲשֶׂיךָ **"in your mouth and in your heart, to do it,"** בְּפִיךָ וּבִלְבָבְךָ לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ **and it does not say "in your deeds,"** דְּגְמַר הַמַּעֲשֶׂה מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ[1355] **for the completion of the deed comes from Hashem Yisbarach** (וְנִתְבָּאַר פְּקוּדֵי מַאֲמָר ג עַיֵּין שָׁם בַּאֲרִיכוּת) **(and it was explained in Pekudei, maamar 3; see there at length).** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ חַדְּשׁוּ מַעֲשֵׂיכֶם **And this is what they said, "Renew your deeds":** הַיְינוּ עַל יְדֵי חִידּוּשׁ הָאוֹר **that is, through the renewal of light** בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **in words of Torah,** וּמִזֶּה יָבֹא לְמַעֲשֶׂה **and from this one will come to deeds,** שֶׁהַגְּמַר מַעֲשֶׂה **for the completion of the deed** יִהְיֶה עַל יְדֵי ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **will be through Hashem Yisbarach,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לַעֲשׂוֹתוֹ. **as it says, "to do it."** וְכֵן סוֹפֵר מֵהַיְהוּדִי הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And so it is related of the Yid HaKadosh,** זִכְרוֹנוֹ לִבְרָכָה לְחַיֵּי הָעוֹלָם הַבָּא **may his memory be for a blessing for the life of the World to Come,** שֶׁאָמַר שֶׁבְּשַׁבָּת זֶה **that he said that on this Shabbos** יֵשׁ בּוֹ הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּשֶׁפַע **there is a renewal in abundance** בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה. **in words of Torah.** "הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם רֹאשׁ חֳדָשִׁים **"This month shall be for you the head of months"** — שֶׁכָּל חֹדֶשׁ יֵשׁ לוֹ קְדוּשָּׁה מְיוּחֶדֶת **for each month has its own particular holiness,** וְיוֹם רִאשׁוֹן נִקְרָא רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **and the first day is called Rosh Chodesh,** שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ שֶׁל כָּל הַחֹדֶשׁ **for it is the head of the whole month,** דְּבָתַר רֵישָׁא גּוּפָא אָזִיל **for "the body follows the head"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֵירוּבִין מא.) **(as it says,**

[1353] **Parallel: Bnei Yissaschar, Adar 3:3** — "Be the children of Avraham — he was the first to wage war on the kelipah of Amalek… and he likened himself to dust, nullified to His will." Expounding the same midrash, the Bnei Yissaschar likewise sets Avraham against Amalek, noting that "ram" (haughty) equals Amalek in gematria and that Avraham's "dust and ashes" is the self-nullification that undoes Amalek's pride.

[1354] **Parallel: Mei HaShiloach I, Ki Seitzei, s.v. Zachor es asher asah** — "Zachor: that he remember each time how we were in bondage and how our yetzer overpowered us, and from this new desire will come to us each time." The Izhbitzer reads the same midrash of the "empty plate" as the memory of the struggle against Amalek's power. He adds that this very memory renews a person's desire for Hashem's service, which supports Rav Tzadok's point that Amalek is erased through a person's own avodah.

[1355] **Parallel: Pri Etz Chaim, Shaar HaShabbos 1** — "A person must intend that some of this addition remain with him for the weekdays… and he is assured that he will not sin… and the yetzer hara will not prosecute him." The Arizal's words give the mechanism: the added soul-light of Shabbos stays into the first three weekdays, and the coming Shabbos is drawn upon from the fourth. This is how Shabbos guards a person all week, as Rav Tzadok says here.

Eruvin 41a), וְהוּא כּוֹלֵל כָּל קְדוּשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ. **and it contains all the holiness of the month.** וְנִיסָן כּוֹלֵל כָּל קְדוּשַׁת **And Nissan contains all the holiness** שְׁנֵים עָשָׂר הֶחֳדָשִׁים **of the twelve months,** וְנִקְרָא רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ שֶׁלּוֹ **and so its Rosh Chodesh is called** רֹאשׁ חֳדָשִׁים. **"the head of months."** רִאשׁוֹן הוּא לָכֶם וְגוֹמֵר **"It is first for you" etc.** — שֶׁהוּא גַּם כֵּן רִאשׁוֹן **for it is also "first,"** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה שֶׁקְּשׁוּרִים בַּשֹּׁרֶשׁ **indicating that they are bound to the root,** בְּרֵאשִׁית הַמַּחֲשָׁבָה **to the beginning of Thought,** שֶׁהוּא שֵׂכֶל הַנֶּעְלָם **which is the intellect hidden** מִכָּל רַעְיוֹן. **from all thought.** וְזֶהוּ בַּקְּדוּשָׁה **And this is in holiness,** בְּזֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה **as the counterpart,** נֶגֶד קְלִיפַּת בָּבֶל וְעֵשָׂו **opposite the kelipah of Bavel and Esav,** שְׁתֵּי הַגָּלֻיּוֹת כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **the two exiles, as mentioned above.** וְשַׁבָּת הוּא כּוֹלֵל **And Shabbos contains** כָּל קְדוּשַׁת יְמֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה שֶׁאַחֲרָיו **all the holiness of the weekdays that follow it;** וְעַל כֵּן **therefore on the Shabbos** שֶׁחָל בַּשָּׁבוּעַ שֶׁאַחַר כָּךְ **in whose following week falls** רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן **Rosh Chodesh Nissan,** קוֹרִין פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **we read Parshas HaChodesh;** וּכְשֶׁחָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ נִיסָן בְּשַׁבָּת **and when Rosh Chodesh Nissan falls on Shabbos,** הוּא עַצְמוֹ רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **it is Rosh Chodesh itself,** שֶׁאָז יוּכְלוּ לְהַשִּׂיג **for then one can attain** שֶׁפַע הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה: **an abundance of renewal in words of Torah.**

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר ג׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Gimmel

הַפַּיְיטָן [בַּפִּיּוּט לְתְפִלַּת מוּסָף] **The paytan (in the piyut for the Musaf prayer)** תָּפַס בְּרָאשֵׁי הַחֲרוּזִים **took for the openings of his stanzas** פָּסוּק רִאשׁוֹן לְצִיּוֹן **the pasuk "First to Zion:** [יְשַׁעְיָה מא, כז][1356] הִנֵּה הִנָּם וְגוֹמֵר **behold, here they are" etc. (Yeshayah 41:27),** וְהוּא מְיוּסָּד **and it is founded** עַל פִּי מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **on what they said** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה טו, א) **(Shemos Rabbah 15:1):** כְּבֶיכוֹל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **"As it were, the Holy One, blessed be He,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא רִאשׁוֹן **who is called 'First,'** וְצִיּוֹן נִקְרָא רִאשׁוֹן **and Zion is called 'first,'** וְעֵשָׂו נִקְרָא רִאשׁוֹן **and Esav is called 'first,'** וּמָשִׁיחַ נִקְרָא רִאשׁוֹן **and Mashiach is called 'first,'** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר רִאשׁוֹן לְצִיּוֹן הִנֵּה הִנָּם וְגוֹמֵר **as it says, 'First to Zion: behold, here they are' etc. —** יָבֹא הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **let the Holy One, blessed be He, come** וְיִבְנֶה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **and build the Beis HaMikdash,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא רִאשׁוֹן[1357] כּוּלֵי **which is called 'first'" etc.** וּפָתַח צִיּוֹן נִקְרָא רִאשׁוֹן **It opened with "Zion is called first,"** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר **and afterward said,** וְיִבְנֶה בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ שֶׁנִּקְרָא רִאשׁוֹן. **"and build the Beis HaMikdash, which is called first."** אַךְ הַכֹּל אֶחָד **But it is all one,** בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ הַיְינוּ צִיּוֹן **for the Beis HaMikdash is Zion,** (יוֹמָא נד:) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Yoma 54b):** שְׁתֵּיָה שֶׁמִּמֶּנָּה הוּשְׁתְּתָה הָעוֹלָם **"'Shesiyah' — for from it the world was founded;** תְּנַן כְּמַאן דְּאָמַר **our Mishnah follows the one who says** מִצִּיּוֹן נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם כּוּלֵי **the world was created from Zion" etc.;** [תְּהִלִּים נ, ב] מִצִּיּוֹן מִכְלַל יוֹפִי **"'From Zion, the perfection of beauty' (Tehillim 50:2) —** מְמֻנֶּה מוּכְלָל יָפְיוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם[1358] **from it the beauty of the world was perfected";** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** אַף דְּאָבֶן שְׁתִיָּה **Even though the Even Shesiyah** בִּמְקוֹם אָרוֹן בְּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **is at the place of the Aron in the Beis HaMikdash,** מַיְיתֵי לָהּ **the Gemara cites it** לְמַאן דְּאָמַר מִצִּיּוֹן נִבְרָא הָעוֹלָם. **for the view that the world was created from Zion.** (פְּסָחִים ה.) וּבַגְּמָרָא **And in the Gemara (Pesachim 5a):** בִּזְכוּת שְׁלֹשָׁה רִאשׁוֹנִים **"In the merit of three 'first's** זָכוּ לִשְׁלֹשָׁה רִאשׁוֹן כּוּלֵי **they merited three 'first's" etc. —** לִשְׁמוֹ שֶׁל דִּשְׁמוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ **"to the name of Mashiach,** דִּכְתִיב רִאשׁוֹן לְצִיּוֹן[1359] וְגוֹמֵר **as it is written, 'First to Zion' etc."** שֶׁנִּבְרָא קוֹדֶם שֶׁנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם[1360] נִקְרָא רִאשׁוֹן **For the name of Mashiach is called "first," since it was created before the world was created,** (שָׁם נד.) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (there, 54a);** רַק דְּשָׁם מַיְיתֵי **only, there it derives it** [תְּהִלִּים עב, יז] מִפָּסוּק לִפְנֵי שֶׁמֶשׁ יִנּוֹן שְׁמוֹ **from the pasuk "Before the sun, his name is Yinon" (Tehillim 72:17).** דְּרוּחוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ נִדְרָשׁ **For the spirit of Mashiach is expounded** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, ב, ד) **(Bereishis Rabbah 2:4)** בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **from what it says,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית א, ב] וְרוּחַ אֱלֹהִים מְרַחֶפֶת **(Bereishis 1:2) "And the spirit of Elokim hovered" —** זוֹ רוּחוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ כּוּלֵי **"this is the spirit of Mashiach" etc.,** בִּזְכוּת הַמַּיִם **"in the merit of the water,"** שֶׁנִּמְשְׁלָה לַמַּיִם **which is likened to water;** בִּזְכוּת הַתְּשׁוּבָה **in the merit of teshuvah,** אָמַר דְּלִית מַיִם אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא.[1361] **it says that** וּבְתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּקּוּן לוֹ עז, ב) **and in Tikkunei Zohar (Tikkun 36, 77b)**

[1356] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 16** — "Bilam and Amalek are joined as one level in evil, for Amalek is the Keser of the kelipah, and Bilam… is its Da'as; Keser and Da'as are one." There Rav Tzadok adds the holy counterpart: Moshe is the Da'as of holiness, and when he "raised his hand," lifting Da'as to its root in Keser, the root of Amalek was erased.

[1357] **Parallel: Ohr HaChaim on Shemos 17:8** — "Because they grew lax in Torah… and did not engage in the battle of Torah, He punished them with thirst, corresponding to water, and with the fire of Amalek's war." The Ohr HaChaim also reads Refidim as laziness in Torah. He adds why Amalek's war was the fitting consequence: those who failed to wage the "war of Torah" were made to face a war of the sword.

[1358] **Parallel: Tzidkas HaTzaddik 244** — "All of David's toil all his days was to be saved from alien thoughts, which surrounded him from birth… though he truly slew the evil inclination, it was not entirely cleansed in his days." Rav Tzadok there explains why the inborn flaw resists full erasure: the inclination of desire cannot be slain, since it is needed for the world and for passion for Torah.

[1359] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shemos 5** — "The kelipah of Amalek, of whom it is written 'asher karcha,' casts laziness and coldness, and this causes sadness and neglect of Torah, as in 'l'vilti otzbi.'" Rav Tzadok there reads Yaavetz's prayer the same way. He adds the antidote: the alacrity of the Avos, rooted in Avraham, which is drawn on at the Shabbos morning meal of Atika and nullifies Amalek's kelipah.

[1360] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 5** — "The war is in the heart of man… Hashem's help is His war against Amalek, clothed in the heart of man… and all of a person's effort in this is only through remembering." Rav Tzadok there also reads "when He gives you rest" inwardly, as the calm of a heart no longer troubled by fantasies. At that point one erases Amalek "from every chamber of his mind and heart," which is the work this world allows.

[1361] **Parallel: Likkutei Maamarim, Inyan Shimshon 4** — "The clouds of glory were for them a surrounding light, and the well and the manna an inner light, which are the three crowns of Torah, kehunah and malchus that Moshe, Aharon and Miriam merited." Rav Tzadok there maps the three redeemers onto the levels of light. Malchus, Miriam's crown, is the last level, the nefesh, and as the final level it is the head of what follows. This fits Miriam's link to Torah she'b'al peh here.

"water" is none other than Torah. וּבֶאֱמֶת הַכֹּל אֶחָד **And in truth it is all one,** שֶׁמֶּלֶךְ הַמָּשִׁיחַ יִהְיֶה **for the King Mashiach will be** יָחִיד שֶׁעָשָׂה תְּשׁוּבָה **the individual who did teshuvah** שֶׁמְּחַלִּין לְכָל הָעוֹלָם כּוּלּוֹ בִּשְׁבִילוֹ **for whose sake the whole world is forgiven** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב יוֹמָא פו:) **(as it says, Yoma 86b),** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוּפְיַע הִרְהוּר תְּשׁוּבָה **meaning that a stirring of teshuvah will shine forth** בְּלֵב כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל. **in the heart of all Yisrael.** וְכֵן עַל יְדֵי מָשִׁיחַ יִהְיֶה **And likewise through Mashiach will come** גְּמַר הִתְפַּתְּחוּת תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the full unfolding of Torah she'b'al peh** (קֹהֶלֶת רַבָּה יא, ז) **as they said (Koheles Rabbah 11:7):** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁאָדָם לָמַד בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **that the Torah a person learns in this world** הֶבֶל הִיא **is vanity** לְפָנֵי תּוֹרָתוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ. **compared to the Torah of Mashiach.** וְזֶהוּ רוּחוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ **And this is "the spirit of Mashiach"** שֶׁנִּזְכַּר בְּמַאֲמַר בְּרֵאשִׁית **mentioned in the utterance of Bereishis,** שֶׁהוּא הַתְחָלַת הַבְּרִיאָה **which is the beginning of Creation;** וּשְׁמוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ **and the name of Mashiach** הַיְינוּ עִיקַּר הַחַיִּים שֶׁלּוֹ **is the essence of his life,** שֶׁזֶּהוּ שְׁמוֹ **for this is what his name is,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בִּסְפָרִים הַקְּדוֹשִׁים **as is written in the holy sefarim,** דְּכָל אֶחָד שְׁמוֹ עִיקַּר חִיּוּתוֹ **that each person's name is the essence of his vitality,** וְעַל כֵּן כְּשֶׁקּוֹרְאִין אוֹתוֹ בְּשְׁמוֹ **and therefore when he is called by his name** נֵיעוֹר מִשְּׁנָתוֹ.[1362] **he wakes from his sleep.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said,** דִּשְׁמוֹ שֶׁל מָשִׁיחַ **that the name of Mashiach** נִבְרָא קוֹדֶם שֶׁנִּבְרָא הָעוֹלָם. **was created before the world was created.** וְעַל פִּי זֶה זָכַר הַפַּיְטָן **And on this basis the paytan mentioned** בְּרָאשֵׁי הַחֲרוּזִים **at the openings of his stanzas** פָּסוּק רִאשׁוֹן לְצִיּוֹן וְגוֹמֵר **the pasuk "First to Zion" etc.,** שֶׁבְּנִיסָן עֲתִידִין לְהִגָּאֵל **for in Nissan they are destined to be redeemed** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה יא.) **(as it says, Rosh Hashanah 11a);** וְזָכַר כָּל לְשׁוֹנוֹת שֶׁל אַרְבַּע **and he mentioned all the expressions of four,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה עַל הֶיקֵּף רוּחוֹת מֵאַרְבַּע. **which indicates encompassing from the four directions:** הַחֹדֶשׁ אֲשֶׁר יְשׁוּעוֹת בּוֹ מְקוּפוֹת[1363] **"The month in which salvations surround."** וְהַשּׁוֹרֶשׁ בָּזֶה אַרְבָּעָה כּוֹסוֹת **And the root of this is the four cups,** כְּנֶגֶד אַרְבַּע לְשׁוֹנוֹת שֶׁל גְּאוּלָּה **corresponding to the four expressions of redemption:** וְהוֹצֵאתִי וְהִצַּלְתִּי **"And I will take out," "And I will rescue,"** וְגָאַלְתִּי וְלָקַחְתִּי **"And I will redeem," "And I will take"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פח, ה) **(as it says, Bereishis Rabbah 88:5);** שֶׁהָיְתָה מְקֻפֶּת מִכָּל צַד בְּמִצְרַיִם **that** וְהַיְינוּ הַגְּאוּלָּה מִן הַקְּלִיפָּה **that is, the redemption from the kelipah surrounded them on every side in Mitzrayim.** וְהָיָה מֵצִיר וּמֵעִיק לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **and was distressing and oppressing Yisrael.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ בַּבְּרָכָה שֶׁאַחֲרֶיהָ **And afterward, "four kingdoms" etc.,** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אַרְבַּע מַלְכֻיּוֹת כּוּלֵי **and afterward, in the blessing after it,** וְהוּא עַל פִּי מַאֲמַר הַכָּתוּב [זְכַרְיָה ב, ד] **And this follows the words of the verse (Zechariah 2:4):** וַיַּבְּאוּ אֵלֶּה לְהַחֲרִיד אוֹתָם **"And these have come to terrify them,** לְיַדּוֹת אֶת קַרְנוֹת הַגּוֹיִם וְגוֹמֵר **to cast down the horns of the nations" etc.** דְּאַרְבַּע מַלְכֻיּוֹת **For the four kingdoms** הֵם אַרְבַּע קְלִיפּוֹת **are four kelipos** הַמַּקִּיפוֹת מִכָּל צַד **that surround from every side,** וּכְנֶגְדָּן אַרְבָּעָה חָרָשִׁים לְבַטְּלָן.[1365] **and corresponding to them are four craftsmen to nullify them.** וּבַגְּמָרָא (סוּכָּה נב:) **And in the Gemara (Sukkah 52b):** מַאן נִינְהוּ אַרְבָּעָה חָרָשִׁים כּוּלֵי **"Who are the four craftsmen?" etc.** מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד וּמָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף **"Mashiach ben David and Mashiach ben Yosef,** וְאֵלְיָהוּ וְכֹהֵן צֶדֶק[1366] **and Eliyahu and the**

[1362] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Sukkos 23** — "The souls of the generation of the Dispersion were from the root of Torah she'b'al peh — 'it is not in Heaven'… From this came their kelipah, to wage war against Hashem." Rav Tzadok there explains the "opposing power": the authority of Torah she'b'al peh, which can "defeat" Heaven, turned in them into a rebellious ascent to the heavens. Their mutual love is why a remnant survived.

[1363] **Parallel: Rabbeinu Bachya on Devarim 23:10** — "'Guard yourself from every evil thing': that a person not think by day and come to impurity at night; therefore it is juxtaposed with 'a man who is not pure from a night occurrence.'" The pasuk Rav Tzadok uses for "karcha" stands in the Torah's laws of the camp going out to war. So the defense of Yisrael's camp is the purity of daytime thought, the very point Amalek attacked to draw souls out from under the cloud.

[1364] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Savo 8** — "'Af ki amar Elokim' — what does it matter that God said it… Amalek's kelipah is to cool a person so that he not care so much for Hashem's command." There Rav Tzadok draws the consequence: while this cooling remains, Torah and mitzvos cannot be done in full love and fear, so the Name (Yud-Hei with Vav-Hei) is not whole.

[1365] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Bo 1** — "The evil inclination from the beginning of the kelipah does not incite openly to evil; rather he disguises himself as one guiding toward good… 'like a Torah scholar he appeared to him.'" Rav Tzadok there traces this disguise to the serpent. "You shall surely not die" was offered as concern for Chavah's own good, "taste only the good." So this is the deepest root of the kelipah, which only Yaakov's truth sees through.

[1366] **Parallel: Ohr HaChaim on Shemos 17:9** — "Recognizing that the sin was the neglect of the battle of Torah, Moshe said only Yehoshua is fit to go out to war, of whom it says 'he did not depart from within the tent.'" The Ohr HaChaim gives the plain-sense reason for choosing Yehoshua that Rav Tzadok gives in Kabbalistic terms. Amalek's claim came through Torah, so it is defeated by the one wholly bound to Torah.

Kohen Tzedek." [דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל חָרָשִׁים] וּפֵירֵשׁ רַשִׁ"י **And Rashi explained (s.v. Charashim):** מְשִׁיחִים שְׁנֵיהֶם **the two Mashiachs are both craftsmen** לִבְנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **for the building of the Beis HaMikdash;** חָרָשִׁים. אֵלִיָּהוּ חָרָשׁ שֶׁבָּנָה מִזְבֵּחַ. **Eliyahu is a craftsman, for he built an altar;** וְשֵׁם נִקְרָא חָרָשׁ **and Shem is called a craftsman,** שֶׁבָּנָה הַתֵּיבָה.[1367] **for he built the Ark.** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין מַה טִּיבוֹ שֶׁל שֵׁם **And we need to understand what Shem has to do,** שֶׁבָּנָה הַתֵּיבָה **he who built the Ark,** לְאַרְבָּעָה חָרָשִׁים **with four craftsmen** בּוֹנֵי בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ. **who build the Beis HaMikdash.** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן **But the matter is** דִּשְׁנֵי הַמְּשִׁיחִים **of the two Mashiachs,** בּוֹנֵי בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **the builders of the Beis HaMikdash,** הוּא דְּמֵה שֶׁכָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **is this: that all Yisrael,** נִקְרָאִים עַל שֵׁם יוֹסֵף **being called by the name of Yosef —** שְׁאֵרִית יוֹסֵף[1368] **"the remnant of Yosef"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה עא, ב) **(as it says, Bereishis Rabbah 71:2) —** הַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוֹסֵף מְבָרֵר כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **means that Yosef clarifies all Yisrael,** שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ צַדִּיקִים **who are called tzaddikim,** [כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר יְשַׁעְיָה ס, כא] **as it says (Yeshayah 60:21),** וְעַמֵּךְ כּוּלָּם צַדִּיקִים וְגוֹמֵר **"And your people are all tzaddikim" etc.,** וְכָל מַאן דְּאִתְגְּזַר אִיקְרֵי צַדִּיק **and "whoever is circumcised is called a tzaddik"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֶלֶק ב כג, א) **(as it says, Zohar II 23a);** וְזֶה יִתְבָּרֵר **and this will be clarified** עַל יְדֵי מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן יוֹסֵף. **through Mashiach ben Yosef.** וְכֵן כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **And likewise all Yisrael** נִקְרְאוּ עַל שֵׁם יְהוּדָה[1369] **are called by the name of Yehudah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה צח, ו) **(as it says, Bereishis Rabbah 98:6);** הַיְינוּ גַּם כֵּן **this too means** שֶׁדָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **that David HaMelech, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהֵקִים עוֹלָהּ שֶׁל תְּשׁוּבָה **who raised up the yoke of teshuvah —** וְכֵן מָשִׁיחַ בֶּן דָּוִד יִהְיֶה **and so too Mashiach ben David will be** יָחִיד וְיבָרֵר כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **the individual who did teshuvah etc.,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **as mentioned above —** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ זְדוֹנוֹת נַעֲשׂוֹת כִּזְכֻיּוֹת **will clarify all Yisrael, so that deliberate sins become like merits:** כַּשֶּׁלֶג יַלְבִּינוּ. **"they shall become white as snow."** וְכֹהֵן צָדֹק **And the Kohen Tzedek** הוּא הַכֹּהֵן הָרִאשׁוֹן[1370] **is the first kohen,** [דִּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ בְּרֵאשִׁית יד, יח] **of whom it is written (Bereishis 14:18),** וְהוּא כֹּהֵן לְאֵל עֶלְיוֹן. **"And he was a kohen to the Most High God,"** שֶׁאָז לֹא נִתְגַּלָּה עֲדַיִן **for then there was not yet revealed** הִתְחַלְּקוּת הַמִּדּוֹת **the division into the middos,** וְהָיָה כֹּהֵן לְאֵל עֶלְיוֹן **and he was a kohen to the Most High God,** וּבֵירַךְ לְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **and he blessed Avraham Avinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם בָּזֶה **peace be upon him, with this:** [שָׁם, יט] בָּרוּךְ אַבְרָם לְאֵל עֶלְיוֹן. **"Blessed be Avram to the Most High God" (ibid. 14:19).** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר גַּם אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **And afterward Avraham Avinu too said,** [שָׁם, כב] עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **peace be upon him (ibid. 14:22),** הֲרִימוֹתִי יָדִי אֶל ה' אֵל עֶלְיוֹן **"I have raised my hand to Hashem, the Most High God";** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם זָכָה **and Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him, merited** וְקִיבֵּל מִמֶּנּוּ הַכְּהוּנָּה לְדוֹרוֹת[1371] **and received from him the kehunah for all generations** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב נְדָרִים לב:). **(as it says, Nedarim 32b).** וְאֵלִיָּהוּ הוּא הַכֹּהֵן הָאַחֲרוֹן **And Eliyahu is the last kohen,** וְאִיתָא בְּסֵפֶר עֲשָׂרָה מַאֲמָרוֹת (מַאֲמַר אִם כָּל חַי חֵלֶק ג סִימָן כג) **and it is stated in Sefer Asarah Maamaros (Maamar Em Kol Chai, part 3, siman 23)** שֶׁאַף בִּזְמַן הַזֶּה **that even nowadays** אֵלִיָּהוּ מַקְרִיב תְּמִידִין **Eliyahu offers the tamid offerings** בִּמְקוֹם הַמִּזְבֵּחַ **at the site of the altar;** וְכָתַב שֶׁאִיפְשָׁר **and he wrote that it is possible** שֶׁאֵלִיָּהוּ יֵשׁ לוֹ מִקּוּפַּת הַלִּשְׁכָּה **that Eliyahu has, from the fund of the Chamber,** מָעוֹת גְּנוּזִים לָזֶה[1372] **coins stored away for this** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר בְּפָרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים מַאֲמָר ב) **(and it was explained in Parshas Shekalim, maamar 2).** וְאֵלִיָּהוּ

[1367] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Beshalach 11** — "'In all My house he is faithful'… one who restrains his mouth from speaking and his heart from musing; and this is 'faithful,' that he does not touch what is above his portion." Rav Tzadok there grounds Moshe's faithfulness in the "belimah" of Sefer Yetzirah: "if your heart runs, return to the place." Through that silence and self-nullification ("what are we"), all the secrets were revealed to him.

[1368] **Parallel: Dover Tzedek, Likkutim 3** — "At first 'a maidservant saw,' and afterward suddenly everything was hidden from them, and the great desire was lost… for they thought they would at once be changed permanently into masters of great perception." There Rav Tzadok traces the same path from the Sea to Refidim. When the light of the Sea was withdrawn they despaired, slackened from seeking, and so asked about the hidden root, "ayin," and Amalek came.

[1369] **Parallel: Avodah Zarah 18a** — "'The iniquity of my heels surrounds me': the sins a person tramples with his heels in this world surround him on the day of judgment." The Gemara states the principle Rav Tzadok draws from Amalek. The sins a person treats as trivial bring the reckoning, so he may not be lenient in anything.

[1370] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 17** — "He thought that since Moshe died in Adar the Torah's influence ceased; he did not know that Moshe was also born in Adar… and his decree prepared for 'they accepted it anew.'" Rav Tzadok there explains why Haman's attack on the Torah turned into its renewal. Yisrael stand above time and determine what a season is ready for.

[1371] **Parallel: Poked Akarim 5** — "The first of the soul of Mashiach ben Yosef revealed in this world, it seems to me, was Yonasan ben Shaul… as I saw in Asarah Maamaros on 'And I shall be second to you.'" Rav Tzadok there fills out the picture: Shaul's kingship, which preceded David's, was like Eliyahu's coming before ben David. Free of sin and given rest from evil, Shaul was charged with uprooting Amalek's very root.

כֹּחַ הָיָה לוֹ **And Eliyahu had the power** שֶׁהַקְרִיב בְּזְמַן הַבַּיִת בַּחוּץ **to offer outside while the Temple stood,** שֶׁהָיָה אִיסּוּר כָּרֵת **which was a prohibition punishable by kares,** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם זִיכָּה עַל יְדֵי זֶה **and nonetheless through this he brought merit** אֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **to Yisrael,** שֶׁאָמְרוּ כוּלָּם **for they all said,** [מְלָכִים א יח, לט] ה׳ הוּא הָאֱלֹהִים. **"Hashem, He is God" (I Melachim 18:39).** וְזֶהוּ רִאשׁוֹן לְצִיּוֹן הִנֵּה הֵנָּם **And this is "First to Zion: behold, here they are,"** שֶׁמְּקוֹדָם בּוֹנֵה יְרוּשָׁלַיִם ה׳ **for first "Hashem builds Yerushalayim,"** וְאַחַר כָּךְ נִדְחֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל יְכַנֵּס[1373] **and afterward "He gathers in the dispersed of Yisrael"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא נֹחַ יא) **(as it says in Midrash Tanchuma, Noach 11);** וְעַל יְדֵי אַרְבָּעָה חָרָשִׁים **and through the four craftsmen,** שֶׁהֵם הַמְיַסְּדִים **who are the founders** בִּבְנְיַן בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ וְהַקָּרְבָּנוֹת **of the building of the Beis HaMikdash and the offerings,** יְבַטְּלוּ קְלִיפַּת הָאַרְבַּע מַלְכֻיּוֹת **they will nullify the kelipah of the four kingdoms** שֶׁמַּקִּיפִים הַקְּדוּשָּׁה **that surround holiness,** וְאָז נִדְחֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל יְכַנֵּס: **and then "He gathers in the dispersed of Yisrael."**

[1372] **Parallel: Chida, Chomas Anach, Emor** — "'Esav falls only by the hand of Rachel's sons': Yosef is the aspect of Yesod… and Yesod is shalom, which equals Esav in gematria, to nullify him." The Chida gives a Kabbalistic reason for the Gemara Rav Tzadok cites. Yosef, the Yesod who "sustained" and made peace among the creatures, is the exact counterweight to Esav, the murderer and robber who "hated blood."

[1373] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Avodah Zarah 5b** — "Because the evil inclination distances a person from giving his money as tzedakah and from taking further trouble with the poor… one who does tzedakah this way has his inclination in his hand." The Maharsha explains why chessed in particular subdues the yetzer. It demands both money and effort, the very things the inclination resists. This supports Rav Tzadok's pairing of Yosef's chessed with Yissachar's Torah.

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר ד׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Daled

בִּפְסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתַי **In Pesikta Rabbasi,** (פָּרָשָׁה טו סִימָן ג) **פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ Parshas HaChodesh (Parshah 15, siman 3):** תּוֹחֶלֶת מְמוּשָׁכָה מַחֲלַת לֵב **"'Hope deferred makes the heart sick.'** כֵּיוָן שֶׁבָּא מֹשֶׁה אֵצֶל יִשְׂרָאֵל **When Moshe came to Yisrael** וְאָמַר לָהֶם **and said to them,** אָמַר לִי הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **'The Holy One, blessed be He, told me:** אֱמוֹר לָהֶם פָּקוֹד פָּקַדְתִּי אֶתְכֶם **Say to them, I have surely remembered you,'** אָמְרוּ לוֹ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **they said to him, 'Moshe Rabbeinu,** לֹא עֲדַיִן זְמַן פְּקִידָה **it is not yet the time of remembrance;** מַה כֹּחִי כִּי אֲיַחֵל **what is my strength, that I should hope?** אִם כֹּחַ אֲבָנִים כֹּחִי **Is my strength the strength of stones?' etc.** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁאָמַר לוֹ **And when he told them,** אָמְרוּ הָא סִימָן טוֹב **they said,** בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה נִגְאָלִים **'In this month you are redeemed,'** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין מַה זֶּה הַלָּשׁוֹן **'This is a good sign'** — וְעֵץ חַיִּים תַּאֲוָה בָאָה.[1374] **'and a desire fulfilled is a tree of life.'"**

We need to understand what this expression means, הָא סִימָן טוֹב **"This is a good sign"** — הָא הַבְטָחָה **it was an explicit promise!** וַהֲוָה לֵיהּ לְמֵימַר **It should have said** הַבְטָחָה טוֹבָה. **"a good promise."** אֲמָנָם עִנְיַן הַתּוֹחֶלֶת מְמוּשָׁכָה **However, the matter of "hope deferred"** [שָׁם סִימָן ז] הוּא מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בִּפְסִיקְתָּא **is what they said in the Pesikta (ibid. siman 7)** (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה, ב, כא) **and in the Midrash (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 2:21):** אָמְרוּ לוֹ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **"They said to him, 'Moshe Rabbeinu,** הֵאֵיךְ אָנוּ נִגְאָלִין **how can we be redeemed** וְאֶרֶץ מִצְרַיִם מְלֵיאָה **when the land of Mitzrayim is full** מִטְּנוּפֹת עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה שֶׁלָּנוּ כּוּלֵי **of the filth of our idolatry?' etc.** אֵינוֹ מַבִּיט בְּמַעֲשִׂים שֶׁלָּכֶם **'He does not look at your deeds;** [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ב, ח] מְדַלֵּג עַל הָהָרִים **"leaping over the mountains" (Shir HaShirim 2:8)** — וְאֵין הָרִים אֶלָּא עֲבוֹדָה זָרָה כּוּלֵי **and "mountains" means nothing but idolatry' etc.** רַבֵּינוּ מֹשֶׁה **'Our teacher Moshe,** הֵאֵיךְ אָנוּ נִגְאָלִין **how can we be redeemed** וְאֵין בְּיָדֵינוּ מַעֲשִׂים כּוּלֵי **when we have no deeds in our hands?' etc.** אֵינוֹ מַבִּיט לְמַעֲשֵׂיכֶם הָרָעִים **'He does not look at your evil deeds.'** וּבְמִי הוּא מַבִּיט **'And at whom does He look?'** בַּצַּדִּיקִים שֶׁבָּכֶם **'At the tzaddikim among you,** כְּגוֹן עַמְרָם וּבֵית דִּינוֹ כּוּלֵי **such as Amram and his beis din'" etc.;** שָׁם.[1375] **see there.** וְעַל זֶה אָמַר תּוֹחֶלֶת מְמוּשָׁכָה כּוּלֵי **And about this he said, "Hope deferred" etc.,** מַה כֹּחִי כִּי אֲיַחֵל **"What is my strength, that I should hope?"** — כֵּיוָן שֶׁאֵין בָּנוּ מַעֲשִׂים טוֹבִים **since we have no good deeds,** וְאַדְרַבָּה יֵשׁ בָּנוּ הַהֵיפֶךְ **and on the contrary, we have the opposite,** מַה כֹּחִי כִּי אֲיַחֵל **"what is my strength, that I should hope"** עַד שֶׁיִּיטִיבוּ מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם. **until they improve their deeds?** וַאֲפִלּוּ שֶׁיִּיטִיבוּ מַעֲשֵׂיהֶם **And even if they improve their deeds,** אֵין הַבְטָחָה לַצַּדִּיקִים בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **there is no guarantee for tzaddikim in this world;** וְרָאִינוּ שֶׁנִּכְנְסוּ לְמִצְרַיִם **and we saw that there entered Mitzrayim** יַעֲקֹב וְזַרְעוֹ שִׁבְטֵי יָהּ **Yaakov and his offspring, the tribes of Kah,** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם זַרְעָם נִתְקַלְקְלוּ כָּל כָּךְ **and nonetheless their descendants became so corrupted** וְנִשְׁתַּקְּעוּ בִּקְלִיפַּת מִצְרַיִם. **and sank into the kelipah of Mitzrayim.** וּמִי לָנוּ גָּדוֹל מִיַּעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ **And who is greater for us than Yaakov Avinu,** עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם שֶׁהוּבְטַח **peace be upon him, who was promised,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כח, טו] וְשָׁמַרְתִּיךָ בְּכָל אֲשֶׁר תֵּלֵךְ **"And I will guard you wherever you go" (Bereishis 28:15),** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם דָּאַג **and nonetheless he worried,** פֶּן יָבֹא וְהִכַּנִי **"lest he come and strike me,** [שָׁם לב, יב] אֵם עַל בָּנִים **mother with children" (ibid. 32:12);** וְאָמְרוּ (בְּרָכוֹת ד.) **and they said (Berachos 4a):** שְׁמָא יִגְרוֹם הַחֵטְא **"Perhaps sin will cause it,"** וְאָמְרוּ יִגְרוֹם לְשׁוֹן עָתִיד **and they said "will cause," in the future tense** — בְּיוֹם אוֹ יוֹמַיִם **within a day or two** — שֶׁלֹּא הָאֱמִין בְּעַצְמוֹ.[1376] **for he did not trust himself.** וְכֵן דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם אָמַר **And likewise David HaMelech, peace be upon him, said:** אֵינִי יוֹדֵעַ אִם יֵשׁ לִי חֵלֶק בֵּינֵיהֶם **"I do not know whether I have a share among them** אִם לָאו **or not** — שְׁמָא יִגְרוֹם הַחֵטְא[1377] **perhaps sin will cause it"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם) **(as it says there).** וְזֶהוּ תּוֹחֶלֶת מְמוּשָׁכָה **And this is "hope deferred,"** שַׁיָּיךְ אַף כְּשֶׁהוּבְטָחוּ **which applies even when they were promised,** בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה נִגְאָלִים.

[1374] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Mishpatim 9** — "Just as in holiness Keser Elyon is crowned in Malchus… so in the kelipah the end is bound up in the beginning, and the primordial serpent is bound with the Nukva of the kelipah." Rav Tzadok there takes up the same Zohar on the ox, the donkey and the dog ("kelev," the reverse of "bakol"). He explains how Amalek can be both the "first" of kelipah and its lowest, insolent dog.

[1375] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Beshalach 11** — "'In thought before Me' — that is Atika, which is before thought… and why He said to him 'Be silent': through silence one merits the secret of Da'as… the inner depth of Keser." Rav Tzadok there reads the same Gemara of Moshe and Rabbi Akiva. He adds that the very command "Be silent" is the way to this level, since Atika is reached only by "belimah," restraining mouth and heart.

[1376] **Parallel: Arizal, Shaar Maamarei Razal, Shabbos** — "'Every precious thing his eye saw' — this is Rabbi Akiva… for he and his colleagues, of the Ten Martyrs, came from the drops that Yosef cast… and 'yakar' is the letters of 'keri.'" The Arizal makes explicit the root Rav Tzadok assumes here. The souls of the Ten Martyrs are those very drops of Yosef, so their death rectified the one flaw that left an opening for Amalek's charge against the covenant.

"In this month you are redeemed." וְגַם זְמַן חֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר יוֹם **And even a span of fifteen days** הוּא תּוֹחֶלֶת מְמוּשָׁכָה. **is hope deferred.** אַךְ לְאַחַר מַכָּה תְּשִׁיעִית **But after the ninth plague** וּלְכָל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל [שְׁמוֹת י, כג] כְּתִיב **it is written (Shemos 10:23), "And for all the Children of Yisrael** הָיָה אוֹר וְגוֹמֵר[1378] **there was light" etc.** וְאָמַרְנוּ גָּבַד עָשָׂר מִפִּי הַמַּכּוֹת הָיוּ דְּהַמַּכּוֹת מִתַּתָּא לְעֵילָּא[1379] **And we have said that the plagues went from below to above,** **corresponding to the ten sefiros,** וְהָיָה בְּסוֹד **and it was in the secret of** נָגוֹף לְמִצְרַיִם וְרָפוֹא לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **"striking Mitzrayim and healing Yisrael"** (עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב לו, א) **(along the lines of what they said, Zohar II 36a);** וּבְכָל מַכָּה יָצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **and with each plague Yisrael came out** מִקְּלִיפָּה אַחַת **of one kelipah,** שֶׁהִיא בְּזֶה לְעוּמַּת זֶה **which is the counterpart,** וְנִכְנְסוּ בַּקְּדוּשָׁה **and entered into holiness** בַּמִּדָּה שֶׁכְּנֶגְדָּהּ **in the attribute opposite it;** וּמַכָּה תְּשִׁיעִית **and with the ninth plague,** שֶׁכְּנֶגֶד חָכְמָה **which corresponds to Chochmah,** שֶׁהוּא מֵאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **which is the utterance "Let there be light,"** זָכוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **Yisrael merited** וּלְכָל בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל הָיָה אוֹר **"and for all the Children of Yisrael there was light"** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת בֹּא מַאֲמָר ב) **(and it was explained in Parshas Bo, maamar 2).** וּבְמַאֲמַר יְהִי אוֹר **And in the utterance "Let there be light"** חָמֵשׁ פְּעָמִים אוֹרָה **"light" appears five times,** כְּנֶגֶד חֲמִשָּׁה חוּמְשֵׁי תוֹרָה **corresponding to the five Chumashim of the Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ג, ה) **(as it says, Bereishis Rabbah 3:5).** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לָהֶם **And since they were told** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **"This month shall be for you,"** שֶׁכְּבָר הִתְחִיל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **where the words of Torah already begin,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ [רַשִׁ"י בְּרֵאשִׁית א, א] **as they said (Rashi, Bereishis 1:1),** לֹא הָיָה הַתּוֹרָה צְרִיךְ לְהַתְחִיל **"The Torah should not have needed to begin** אֶלָּא מֵהַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **except from 'This month shall be for you,'"** אָמְרוּ הָא סִימָן טוֹב **they said, "This is a good sign,"** וְלֹא אָמְרוּ הַבְטָחָה טוֹבָה **and did not say "a good promise,"** שֶׁאֵין הַבְטָחָה בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה **for there is no guarantee in this world,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל שֶׁמָּא יִגְרוֹם הַחֵטְא **as mentioned above, "perhaps sin will cause it";** רַק סִימָן טוֹב **only a good sign:** וְעֵץ חַיִּים תַּאֲוָה בָּאָה **"and a desire fulfilled is a tree of life"** — אֵין עֵץ חַיִּים[1380] אֶלָּא תּוֹרָה **"tree of life" means nothing but Torah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת לב:) **(as it says, Berachos 32b);** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם הוֹלָעַת דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁאָז הִתְחִיל **that is, then began the shining forth of words of Torah:** **"This month shall be for you"** — סִיהֲרָא דְּמִקַּבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **the moon that receives from the sun,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה מְקַבֵּל מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **Torah she'b'al peh receiving from the Written Torah;** וְהִרְגִּישׁוּ הָאוֹר גַּם מֵהַשֶּׁמֶשׁ **and they sensed the light from the sun as well,** כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן ה' שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים פד, יב] **as it says (Tehillim 84:12),** **"For a sun and a shield is Hashem" etc.;** וְלֵית לָךְ מִלָּה וְגוֹמֵר[1381] **and "there is nothing to break the yetzer hara** לְתַבְּרָא יֵצֶר הָרָע **except the Torah"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א רב, א) **(as it says, Zohar I 202a);** אֶלָּא אוֹרַיְיתָא **that they would be redeemed.** וְאָז זָכוּ שֶׁיִּהְיוּ נִגְאָלִין. **and they said, "This is a good sign"** וְאָמְרוּ הָא סִימָן טוֹב **And then they merited the attribute of Knesses Yisrael,** וְהַיְינוּ אֲנִי ה' שׁוֹכֵן לְמִדַּת כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **that is, "I am Hashem who dwells** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **in the midst of the Children of Yisrael,"** **for the Holy One, blessed be He, is the heart of Yisrael,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים עג, כו] **as it says (Tehillim 73:26),** **"Rock of my heart** צוּר לְבָבִי **and my portion is God forever"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה, ב) **(as it says, Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2);** וְהוּא סִימָן טוֹב **and it is a good sign** שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְהוֹצִיא

[1377] **Parallel: Divrei Soferim 32** — "In the days of Achashverosh, though 'they accepted it anew with love,' it was not through revelation of Godliness but from within concealment and darkness." Rav Tzadok there defines the "orah" of Purim: Torah she'b'al peh, the light that shines in darkness, as in "He set me in dark places — this is the Talmud of Bavel." This is why Purim will never be annulled.

[1378] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Sisa 9** — "At the third meal Yisrael attain rest from the evil inclination's accusation… therefore every Motzaei Shabbos before Havdalah we say 'The Jews had light'… for that erasure was only for its time." Rav Tzadok there links the custom to Shabbos as "the day Hashem gives you rest," when "Yaakov and his sons rest." That rest is the condition the pasuk sets for erasing Amalek.

[1379] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 22** — "Every festival, through a miracle and salvation, renewed an addition, and in the future 'Hashem will be your light' and there is no renewal; but the days of Purim are this very light." Rav Tzadok there gives a second reason for Midrash Mishlei: the other festivals add holiness and so can lapse, while Purim adds nothing but reveals Yisrael's constant bond, and so cannot be nullified.

[1380] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayishlach 8** — "Since the holiness of Yisrael was fixed in Yaakov forever, he 'inherited the world without measure': he can sanctify places outside the Land with the holiness of Eretz Yisrael." Rav Tzadok there grounds the same claim in Shabbos techumin, showing how Yaakov's holiness makes every encampment of Yisrael holy ground.

[1381] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Tavo 8** — "Yud-Hei allude to fear and love, Vav-Hei to Torah and mitzvos … to keep Torah and mitzvos only in fear and love one must be wholly refined, and while Amalek's seed exists, he prevents it." Rav Tzadok there gives the same division of the Name, and adds why Amalek blocks the union: his "karcha" cools a person toward Hashem's command, as the serpent began.

וּלְהוֹרִיק הָרַע **that they will be able to remove and empty out the evil** מִלֵּב כְּסִיל לִשְׂמֹאלוֹ **from "the heart of the fool, at his left,"** וְשֶׁיִּכָּנֵס קְדוּשָּׁה וְדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **and that holiness and words of Torah will enter** בְּלֵב חָכָם לִימִינוֹ **"the heart of the wise, at his right,"** וְיִהְיוּ נִגְאָלִין. **and they will be redeemed.** וְזֶה עִנְיַן פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **And this is the point of Parshas HaChodesh:** שֶׁיַּרְגִּישׁוּ קְדוּשָּׁה זוֹ. **that they should sense this holiness.** וְקוֹרִין אוֹתָהּ בְּשַׁבָּת **And we read it on Shabbos,** (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּקּוּן מח) דְּאִיתָא **for it is stated (Tikkunei Zohar, Tikkun 48):** לְדֹרֹתָם זַכָּאָה מַאן דְּעָבִיד לוֹן בְּשַׁבָּת **"'For their generations' — fortunate is one who makes for them on Shabbos** דִּירָה בְּתַתֵּי לִבָּא כּוּלֵּי[1382] **a dwelling in the two chambers of the heart" etc.;** וְיכוֹלִים לְזְכּוֹת לְהָאוֹר **and they can merit the light** מֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ וְחַג הַבָּא **of the coming Rosh Chodesh and Yom Tov;** וְהוּא סִימָן טוֹב **and it is a good sign** שֶׁבְּנִיסָן נִגְאָלִין: **that in Nissan they are redeemed.**

[1382] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Purim 1** — "On this day Hashem revealed openly to Yisrael the light of all these things that Amalek denies; therefore it says 'the Jews had light.'" The Radziner shows each of the four, Torah, festival, milah and tefillin, answering a specific denial of Amalek, which explains why the four could appear only after Amalek's erasure.

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר ה׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Hei

In the Pesikta (ibid., siman 18), בְּפִסְקִיתָא (שָׁם סִימָן יח) **and so too in the Yerushalmi** (ראש הַשָּׁנָה פֶּרֶק א הֲלָכָה ג ז, ב) **(Rosh Hashanah, perek 1, halachah 3, 7b):** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **"'This month shall be for you' — it is handed over to you.** מָסוּר לָכֶם **Rabbi Yehoshua ben Levi said:** אָמַר רַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ בֶּן לֵוִי **It is like a king who had a clock; when his son grew up,** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁעָמַד בְּנוֹ **he handed over his clock to him.** מָסַר לוֹ אוֹרְלוֹגִין שֶׁלּוֹ **Rabbi Yose bar Chanina said:** אָמַר רַבִּי יוֹסֵי בַּר חֲנִינָא **Like a king who had watchmen; when his son grew up,** וְכֵיוָן שֶׁעָמַד בְּנוֹ **he handed over the watch to him.** מָסַר לוֹ שׁוֹמְרָה **Rabbi Acha said:** אָמַר רַבִּי אַחָא **Like a king who had a ring; when his son grew up, he handed it to him.** כֵּיוָן שֶׁעָמַד בְּנוֹ מְסָרָהּ לוֹ **Rabbi Yitzchak said:** אָמַר רַבִּי יִצְחָק **Like a king who had treasuries; when his son grew up, he handed him the keys.** כֵּיוָן שֶׁעָמַד בְּנוֹ מָסַר לוֹ הַמַּפְתְּחוֹת **Rabbi Chiya bar Abba said:** אָמַר רַבִּי חִיָּא בַּר אַבָּא **Like a king who had craftsman's tools" etc.** כֵּיוָן שֶׁעָמַד בְּנוֹ מָסַר לוֹ כֵּלֵי אוּמָנוּת כּוּלֵּי **"The Rabbanan say:** אָמְרֵי רַבָּנָן **Like a physician who had a case of remedies; when his son grew up, he handed it to him" etc.** לְרוֹפֵא שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ נַרְתִּיק שֶׁל רְפוּאוֹת כֵּיוָן שֶׁעָמַד בְּנוֹ מָסַר לוֹ כּוּלֵּי

וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין עִנְיַן הַמָּשָׁלִים.[1383] **We need to understand the meaning of these parables.** דְּאוֹרְלוֹגִין שֶׁהוּא כְּלֵי שָׁעוֹת **For a clock, which is an instrument of hours,** יִתָּכֵן שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל **it makes sense that he used it as a parable** קִידּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ שֶׁהוּא עַל הַזְּמַן **for the sanctification of the month, which concerns time;** אֲבָל אֵיזוֹ עִנְיָן שׁוֹמְרָה **but what is the point of the watch,** וְטַבַּעַת וּמַפְתְּחוֹת **and a ring, and keys,** וְכֵלֵי אוּמָנוּת וְנַרְתִּיק רְפוּאוֹת **and craftsman's tools, and a case of remedies,** שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל. **that he used as parables?** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ [בַּמַּאֲמָר הַקּוֹדֵם] **But the matter is as we said (in the previous maamar)** בְּמַה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר וְעֵץ חַיִּים תַּאֲוָה בָּאָה **on "and a desire fulfilled is a tree of life":** שֶׁהוּא הַדִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **that it is the words of Torah** שֶׁמָּסַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **that He handed to Yisrael** מַאֲמַר וְאָמַר שֶׁמָּסַר לָהֶם הַשּׁוֹמְרָה **And it says He handed them the watch, in the utterance "This month shall be for you."** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **(the piyut Ki Anu Amecha for Yom Kippur):** [פִּיּוּט כִּי אָנוּ עַמֶּךָ לְיוֹם כִּפּוּר] וְהַיְינוּ עַל דָּרֶךְ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים[1384] אָנוּ כַרְמֶךָ וְאַתָּה נוֹטְרֵינוּ **"We are Your vineyard and You are our Keeper" —** שֶׁה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ שׁוֹמֵר יִשְׂרָאֵל **for Hashem Yisbarach is the Guardian of Yisrael;** וּכְתִיב [תְּהִלִּים כז, ה] **and it is written (Tehillim 27:5),** כִּי יִצְפְּנֵנִי בְּסוּכּוֹ וְגוֹמֵר[1385] **"For He will hide me in His shelter" etc.,** שֶׁכְּבָיְכוֹל ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ **that, as it were, Hashem Yisbarach** יוֹשֵׁב בְּסוּכָּה **sits in a booth,** סוּכַּת שׁוֹמְרִים. **a watchmen's booth.** וְזֶה מָסַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **And this He handed over to Yisrael,** דְּהַיְינוּ בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **namely the Beis HaMikdash,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא סוּכַּת שָׁלוֹם **which is called a "shelter of peace"** וְנַעֲשָׂה עַל יְדֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **and was made by Yisrael.** וּכְתִיב [שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים ב, ט] **And it is written (Shir HaShirim 2:9),** דּוֹמֶה דוֹדִי לִצְבִי **"My beloved is like a gazelle,"** (שָׁם סִימָן ט) וּבְפִסְקִיתָא רַבָּתִי **and in Pesikta Rabbasi (ibid., siman 9):** מָה הַצְּבִי מְדַלֵּג כּוּלֵּי **"Just as this gazelle leaps" etc.,** כָּךְ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מְדַלֵּג **"so the Holy One, blessed be He, leaps** מִבֵּית הַכְּנֶסֶת זוֹ לְבֵית הַכְּנֶסֶת **from this shul to that shul,** וּמִבֵּית הַמִּדְרָשׁ זֶה לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ זֶה כּוּלֵּי[1386] **and from this beis midrash to that beis midrash" etc.;** וְהַיְינוּ אַחַר הַחוּרְבָּן **that is, after the Destruction,** דִּכְתִיב [יְחֶזְקֵאל יא, טז] **as it is written (Yechezkel 11:16),** וָאֶהְיֶה לָהֶם לְמִקְדָּשׁ מְעַט **"And I will be for them a small sanctuary,"** (מְגִילָּה כט.) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Megillah 29a):** אֵלּוּ בָּתֵּי כְנֵסִיּוֹת שֶׁבְּבָבֶל כּוּלֵּי **"These are the shuls** וּבָתֵּי מִדְרָשׁוֹת **and batei midrash**

[1383] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 53** — "A tzaddik is bounded in his deeds even though his heart is not yet whole … but joy is only in Hashem, to whom one cleaves—even one far off who seeks Him." Rav Tzadok there explains the Taanis 15a distinction cited here: light belongs to the perfected deed, while joy belongs to the upright heart, even before its deeds are complete.

[1384] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Eikev 11** — "In the Zohar, 'the tzaddik is called sasson … "you shall draw water in sasson," this is the tzaddik, from the wellsprings of salvation, these are Abba and Imma.'" Rav Tzadok there joins the same verse, Zohar and Yerushalmi, adding that what is drawn is Torah she'b'al peh, which, like milah done without the child's knowledge, comes as a find.

[1385] **Parallel: Kedushas Levi, Kedushos for Purim, Kedushah Shelishis** — "'Mishloach manos ish lerei'ehu': ish is HaKadosh Baruch Hu, as in 'Hashem is a man of war'; lerei'ehu, to the tzaddikim … at this level Yisrael are called 'my brothers and my friends.'" The Berditchever adds what Hashem sends: the gift of prayer that can annul a sealed decree, which is how Mordechai and Esther overturned it.

[1386] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Chullin 139b** — "These four had other names … one could argue their particular names are not rooted in the Torah, for Pharaoh's daughter named Moshe; therefore it asks where his name is from the Torah." Maharsha answers the same question about Moshe by the foreign origin of the names, which sets off Rav Tzadok's answer: the Gemara seeks the root of the Torah itself.

in Bavel" etc., זֶה בֵּית רַבֵּינוּ שֶׁבְּבָבֶל. **"this is the house of our Rebbe in Bavel."** וְאוֹהֵב ה׳ שַׁעֲרֵי צִיּוֹן **And "Hashem loves the gates of Zion"** — הַמְצוּיָנִים בַּהֲלָכָה **the gates distinguished in halachah,** יוֹתֵר מִכָּל מִשְׁכְּנוֹת יַעֲקֹב **more than the shuls and batei midrash etc.:** אַרְבַּע אַמּוֹת שֶׁל הֲלָכָה **the four amos of halachah** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת ח.) **(as it says, Berachos 8a).** וּבֵית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **And the Beis HaMikdash** — מִשָּׁם שׁוֹרֶשׁ **from there is the root of Torah she'b'al peh,** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [יְשַׁעְיָה ב, ג **as it says (Yeshayah 2:3),** כִּי מִצִּיּוֹן תֵּצֵא תוֹרָה וְגוֹמֵר **"For from Zion will Torah go forth" etc.;** וְשָׁם לִשְׁכַּת הַגָּזִית **and there is the Chamber of Hewn Stone,** שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ יוֹצְאָה תוֹרָה לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל[1387] **from which Torah goes forth to all Yisrael** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב סַנְהֶדְרִין פו:) **(as it says, Sanhedrin 86b).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **And this is what it says: "This month shall be for you"** — חִידּוּשׁ תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the renewal of Torah she'b'al peh** שֶׁמָּסַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **which He handed to Yisrael;** וְהוּא בֵּית הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **and this is the Beis HaMikdash** וְאַרְבַּע אַמּוֹת שֶׁל הֲלָכָה **and the four amos of halachah,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא סוּכַּת שָׁלוֹם **which are called a "shelter of peace";** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמָּשָׁל **and this is what they said in the parable,** לְמָסַר לִבְנוֹ הַשּׁוֹמִירָה. **that he handed his son the watch.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר לְמָשָׁל **And afterward it gives the parable** הוּא עַל דֶּרֶךְ מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ **it is along the lines of what they said** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה י, ט) **(Bereishis Rabbah 10:9):** לְמֶלֶךְ שֶׁעָשׂוּ לוֹ טַבַּעַת **"Like a king for whom they made a ring;** מָה הָיְתָה חֲסֵרָה חוֹתָם **what was it lacking? A seal.** כָּךְ הָיָה הָעוֹלָם חָסֵר שַׁבָּת[1388] **So too the world was lacking Shabbos";** עַיֵּין שָׁם **see there.** דִּבְרִיאַת שָׁמַיִם וָאָרֶץ הַטַּבַּעַת **The creation of heaven and earth is the ring,** וְשַׁבָּת הַחוֹתָם **and Shabbos is the seal,** הַיְינוּ שֶׁיִּשָּׁאֵר כָּךְ **meaning that it should remain so,** [אֶסְתֵּר ח, ח עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **in the manner of what it says (Esther 8:8),** וְנַחְתּוֹם בְּטַבַּעַת הַמֶּלֶךְ **"And what is sealed with the king's ring** אֵין לְהָשִׁיב. **cannot be revoked."** וְחוֹתָמוֹ שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֱמֶת[1389] **And the seal of the Holy One, blessed be He, is truth,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת נה.) **as they said (Shabbos 55a);** וְאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה פא, ב) **and it is stated (Bereishis Rabbah 81:2):** מַהוּ אֱמֶת **"What is emes?** אָלֶ״ף בָּרֹאשׁוֹן שֶׁל אוֹתִיּוֹת **Alef at the beginning of the letters,** מֵ״ם בָּאֶמְצַע תָּי״ו בַּסּוֹף **mem in the middle, tav at the end";** עַל שֵׁם אֲנִי רִאשׁוֹן וַאֲנִי אַחֲרוֹן.[1390] **after "I am first and I am last."** וַהֲיְינוּ שֵׁם הֲוָיָ״ה **That is, the Name Havayah,** שֶׁמּוֹרֶה הָיָה הוֹוֶה וְיִהְיֶה **which signifies "was, is and will be";** וְזֶהוּ שַׁבָּת שֶׁהוּא הַחוֹתָם.[1391] **and this is Shabbos, which is the seal.** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים בְּשַׁבָּת [בַּתְּפִלַּת מִנְחָה] **As we say on Shabbos (in the Minchah prayer),** אַתָּה אֶחָד וְשִׁמְךָ אֶחָד[1392] **"You are One and Your Name is One"** — כָּל קְדוּשַׁת הֲוָיָ״ה עַד עַתִּיקָא **all the holiness of Havayah up to Atika,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג רנח,) שֶׁשָּׁם הֲוָיָ״ה כּוֹלֵל הַתֵּשַׁע מִדּוֹת **for the Name Havayah contains the nine middos** וְקוֹצוֹ דְּיוּד דְּלְעֵילָּא **and the upper tip of the Yud** רְמִיזָא לְאֵין כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **alludes** א)[1393] **(as it says, Zohar III 258a),**

[1387] **Parallel: Be'er Mayim Chaim, Bereishis 6:9** — "Haman wished to climb after Mordechai to the fiftieth gate, and therefore made a tree fifty amos high, for Mordechai … rose to the great Jubilee, the fifty gates of Binah." The Chernowitzer also reads the height as the fifty gates, and adds that Haman's attempt to reach that level was itself his fall, as a small flame dies before a great fire.

[1388] **Parallel: Divrei Soferim 38** — "Though it is darkness and hiding of the Face, the darkness is through the shadow of His hand … 'I have put My words in your mouth,' which is Torah she'b'al peh." Rav Tzadok there develops the same link of Esther, haster astir and the Oral Torah, adding that prophecy was withdrawn so that a greater light could come through the Sages' seemingly human insight.

[1389] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 22** — "How can one speak of giving Haman's house? In his destruction no house of Haman remains to inherit … only in this world, while Amalek's memory is not erased, do they seem part of creation." Rav Tzadok there raises the same difficulty and resolves it from the other side: what Yisrael take is only the apparent share of creation Amalek holds, which Yisrael can still absorb.

[1390] **Parallel: Poked Akarim 5** — "Shaul sensed that one soul of Yisrael would come from his descendants … the compassion awakened in all Yisrael was also from Heaven, over that spark destined to emerge." Rav Tzadok there explains Shaul's pity in the same way, and adds the test it contained: being "overly righteous" where no bodily desire is involved, so that the yetzer presents evil as good.

[1391] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 17** — "Gladness and feasting stand against 'to destroy,' his decree to abolish the Torah … this is the wine that gladdens which we drink on Purim, for 'they accepted the Torah again out of love.'" Rav Tzadok there joins the same ideas, the Purim feast as wine of Torah set against Haman's aim to uproot it, and traces the salvation back to Achashverosh's own feast.

[1392] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 49** — "In a time of drunkenness, when the body acts without the soul's reflection … then comes the clarification that the power of Amalek is not planted in the bodies of Yisrael at all." Rav Tzadok there gives the mechanism of "a person is recognized through his cup": once the guiding mind is removed, only what is rooted in the body itself acts, and so Yisrael's bodily nature is shown to be holy.

[1393] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pekudei 6** — "Achashverosh imagined his heart was merry with wine, but through the wine his vileness was revealed … in Yisrael, the wine revealed the depths of their heart, opening their mouths to songs and

to Ayin, Keser Elyon (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם סה, ב) **(as stated there, 65b);** וּשְׂפַת אֱמֶת תִּכּוֹן לָעַד **and "The lip of truth shall be established forever,"** וְנַחְתּוֹם בְּטַבַּעַת הַמֶּלֶךְ אֵין לְהָשִׁיב **and "what is sealed with the king's ring cannot be revoked."** וְזֶה מָסַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **And this He handed to Yisrael,** שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ אָז מֶרְכָּבָה **for they then became a chariot** לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **for the attribute of Malchus;** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת. **Keser Elyon is the Crown of Malchus.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר הַמָּשָׁל **And afterward it says the parable** לְמֶלֶךְ שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ אוֹצָרוֹת כּוּלֵי **"Like a king who had treasuries" etc.:** הַיְינוּ יִרְאַת ה' הִיא אוֹצָרוֹ **that is, "the fear of Hashem is His treasure,"** שֶׁאֵין לוֹ לְהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא אֶלָּא אוֹצָר שֶׁל יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם **for the Holy One, blessed be He, has nothing but a treasury of fear of Heaven** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת לג: **(as it says, Berachos 33b).** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה ל, יד **And so we find (Shemos Rabbah 30:14):** יֵשׁ לָךְ אֲפוֹתִיקָאוֹת לִיתֵּן אוֹתָם בָּהֶם כּוּלֵי **"Do you have storehouses to put them in?" etc.,** אִם יֵשׁ לָךְ יִרְאַת חֵטְא כּוּלֵי[1394] **"if you have fear of sin" etc. —** הִמְשִׁיל הַיִּרְאָה לְאוֹצָרוֹת.[1395] **it likened fear to storehouses.** וּמַפְתְּחוֹת הַיינוּ מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (שַׁבָּת לא: **And "keys" refers to what they said (Shabbos 31b):** מַפְתְּחוֹת הַפְּנִימִיּוֹת **"the inner keys** וּמַפְתְּחוֹת הַחִיצוֹנוֹת **and the outer keys,"** שֶׁהֵם תּוֹרָה וְיִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם.[1396] **which are Torah and fear of Heaven.** וּמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **And the attribute of Malchus —** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרִינָן לָהּ **"the mouth: we call it Torah she'b'al peh"** [הַקְדָּמַת תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר בְּפָתַח אֵלִיָּהוּ] **(Introduction to Tikkunei Zohar, Pasach Eliyahu),** וְכֵן אִיהִי יִרְאָה **and likewise "it is fear,** וְשָׁרְיָא בָּהּ יִרְאָה[1397] **and fear dwells in it"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק א ה, ב **(as it says, Zohar I 5b);** וְהַשֵּׁם כְּנֶגֶד מִדָּה זוֹ **and the Name corresponding to this attribute** הוּא שֵׁם אֲדנ"י[1398] **is the Name Adnus** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג יא, ב **(as it says, Zohar III 11b),** וְהוּא מוֹרָה עַל יִרְאָה **and it denotes fear,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מַלְאָכִי א, ו **as it says (Malachi 1:6),** וְאִם אֲדוֹנִים אָנִי **"And if I am a master,** אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי. **where is My fear?"** וְזֶה שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל **And this is why he likened** מַה שֶּׁנֶּאֱמַר הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **what it says, "This month shall be for you" —** שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת מַלְכוּת **which is the attribute of Malchus,** מִשְּׁמָשָׁא דְּמִקַּבְּלָא בְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא. **the aspect of the moon that receives from the sun —** לְאוֹצָרוֹת שֶׁמָּסַר לִבְנוֹ **to treasuries he handed over to his son,** כְּגִירְסַת יְרוּשַׁלְמִי **according to the version of the Yerushalmi,** אוֹ לְמַפְתְּחוֹת שֶׁמָּסַר לִבְנוֹ **or to keys he handed over to his son,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא. **as they said in the Pesikta.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר הַמָּשָׁל **And afterward it says the parable** לְמֶלֶךְ שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ כְּלֵי אוּמָּנוּת **"Like a king who had craftsman's tools,"** וּבִירוּשַׁלְמִי לְנַגָּר **and in the Yerushalmi, "Like a carpenter** שֶׁהָיָה לוֹ כְּלֵי נַגָּרוּת. **who had carpentry tools."** וְהַיְינוּ גַּם כֵּן הַמְכוּוָּן **This too is aimed** עַל תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **at Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּאִיתָא (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, א, א **for it is stated (Bereishis Rabbah 1:1):** הַתּוֹרָה אוֹמֶרֶת **"The Torah says:** אֲנִי הָיִיתִי כְּלִי אוּמָּנְתּוֹ **I was the craftsman's tool** שֶׁל הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **of the Holy One, blessed be He";** שֶׁבְּרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם הָיָה בַּתּוֹרָה **for the creation of the world was through the Torah;** וּבְטוּבוֹ מְחַדֵּשׁ בְּכָל יוֹם **"and in His goodness He renews each day** מַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית **the work of Creation" —** עַל יְדֵי חִידּוּשׁ הַהֲלָכָה **through the new halachah** שֶׁמְּחַדֵּשׁ בְּבֵית דִּין שֶׁל מַעְלָה בְּכָל יוֹם[1399] **that He innovates in the**

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praises." Rav Tzadok there reads the same Megillah 12b as a contrast: wine discloses the inner self of both, and in Yisrael the inner self is Torah and praise.

[1394] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Nasso 12** — "The main error is that the aspect of concealment is hidden from a person, and it seems to him that nothing is hidden from his mind." Rav Tzadok reads the same doubled "haster astir" there as concealment of the concealment, and draws the remedy that matches this maamar: safety begins once a person knows that something is hidden from him.

[1395] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Purim 22** — "When Hashem saves, He illuminates even the concealment that came before, showing that in the time of hiddenness there was also light." The Radziner adds that the salvation does not only end the concealment but lights it up after the fact, which is how the salvation could be seen precisely from within it.

[1396] **Parallel: Tzidkas HaTzaddik 46** — "'Audacity is kingship without a crown' … they derived it from Bilam, for Bilam gazed unto the footsteps of Mashiach and therefore knew this secret." Rav Tzadok there explains why Bilam's audacity worked at all: it imitates a holy audacity, Knesses Yisrael drawing near on its own initiative, which belongs to Israel in the time before Mashiach. This is the root of the "one opposite the other" drawn below.

[1397] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 49** — "In truth audacity does not apply to Israel at all, for Hashem desires and yearns for His children to prevail over Him … Among the nations, it is audacity against the true will of Hashem." Rav Tzadok there gives the reason for the distinction drawn here: the tzaddik's forceful words are audacity only in appearance, while Amalek's and Bilam's succeed for a moment but have no true existence.

[1398] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 18** — "Shabbos is fixed by Hashem, Yom Tov and Rosh Chodesh Yisrael sanctify, but Purim was chosen by the lot through Haman, selected for the erasure of Amalek: 'from itself the axe-handle comes.'" Rav Tzadok there answers the same question with a sharper point: Amalek, who attributes all to chance, is defeated by his own lot, since "from Hashem is all its judgment."

[1399] **Parallel: Yisrael Kedoshim 7** — "'When you break loose (tarid)': at the end of descent you shake off his yoke—your downfall … though Hashem does not rejoice at the fall of the wicked, at Amalek's fall He surely rejoices." Rav Tzadok there joins the same two points as his Rebbe here, tarid as yeridah and "vehaya" as joy, and adds the root:

heavenly court every day (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם מט, ב) **(as it says there, 49:2);** וְזֶה חִידּוּשׁ הֲלָכוֹת מָסַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **and this renewal of halachos He handed to Yisrael,** שֶׁעַל שֵׁם כָּךְ נִקְרְאוּ בַּנָּאִין **on account of which they are called "builders,"** שֶׁעוֹסְקִין בְּבִנְיָנוֹ שֶׁל עוֹלָם[1400] **for they are engaged in the building of the world** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת קיד.) **(as it says, Shabbos 114a).** וְזֶה שֶׁהִמְשִׁיל לִכְלֵי אוּמָנוּת **And this is why he likened it to craftsman's tools** שֶׁמָּסַר לִבְנוֹ **that he handed over to his son,** שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ בּוֹנָיִךְ כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **for they are called "your builders," as mentioned above.** וְאַחַר כָּךְ אָמַר הַמָּשָׁל **And afterward it says the parable** לְנַרְתִּיק שֶׁל רְפוּאוֹת **of a case of remedies** שֶׁהָיָה לְרוֹפֵא **that a physician had;** וְהַיְינוּ גַּם כֵּן עַל דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **this too refers to words of Torah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מִשְׁלֵי ג, ח] **as it says (Mishlei 3:8),** רִפְאוּת תְּהִי לְשָׁרֶךָ וְגוֹמֵר **"It shall be healing to your navel" etc.,** וּלְכָל בְּשָׂרוֹ מַרְפֵּא **and "healing to all his flesh" —** שֶׁבִּדְבָרֵי תוֹרָה יְכוֹלִים לְרַפְּאוֹת הַכֹּל[1401] **for with words of Torah everything can be healed,** (קִידּוּשִׁין ל :) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Kiddushin 30b):** בָּרָאתִי יֵצֶר הָרָע **"I created the yetzer hara,** וּבָרָאתִי לוֹ תּוֹרָה תַּבְלִין **and I created Torah as its antidote";** וְזֶה מוֹעִיל לְתַקֵּן שֹׁרֶשׁ הַקִּלְקוּל **and this helps to repair the root of the corruption.** וְהִמְשִׁיל כָּאן ה' יִתְבָּרַךְ לְרוֹפֵא **And here he likened Hashem Yisbarach to a physician,** דִּכְתִיב [יְשַׁעְיָה ל, כו] **as it is written (Yeshayah 30:26),** מַחַץ מַכָּתוֹ יִרְפָּא **"He heals the wound of His blow" —** מַחַץ מַכַּת שֶׁל עוֹלָם יִרְפָּא[1402] **"He will heal the wound of the world's blow"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה י, ד) **(as it says, Bereishis Rabbah 10:4);** וְהַיְינוּ בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **that is, through Torah she'b'al peh,** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ קִידּוּשִׁין שָׁם) **as they said (Kiddushin, ibid.):** אִם פָּגַע בְּךָ מְנוּוָל זֶה **"If this repulsive one encounters you,** מָשְׁכֵהוּ לְבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ[1403] **drag him to the beis midrash";** וּבֵית הַמִּדְרָשׁ הוּא מְקוֹם חִידּוּשׁ הֲלָכוֹת **and the beis midrash is the place where halachos are renewed,** שֶׁזֶּהוּ הֶרֶב חָכְמָה **for this is the "much wisdom"** לְתַקֵּן הֶרֶב כַּעַס **that repairs the "much anger."** וְזֶה מָסַר לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **And this He handed over to Yisrael,** דִּכְתִיב הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **as it is written, "This month shall be for you,"** וְהַיְינוּ הַשְׁפָּעָה בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **namely the flow of influence in Torah she'b'al peh;** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּמָּשָׁל **and this is what they said in the parable,** שֶׁמָּסַר לוֹ נַרְתִּיק שֶׁל רְפוּאוֹת **that he handed him a case of remedies.** (זֹהַר חֲלָק א מז, ב) וְשַׁבָּת אִיתָא **And regarding Shabbos it is stated (Zohar I 47b):** בְּיוֹם הַשְּׁבִיעִי **"'On the seventh day' —** דָּא תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **this is Torah she'b'al peh,** דְּאִיהוּ יוֹם שְׁבִיעִי **which is the seventh day";** וְהַיְינוּ מַלְכוּת **that is, Malchus —** פֶּה תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה קְרִינָן לָהּ **"the mouth: we call it Torah she'b'al peh";** וְכֵן קוֹרִין פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **and so we read Parshas HaChodesh** תָּמִיד בְּשַׁבָּת: **always on Shabbos.**

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throwing off Yisrael's yoke is Amalek's power within Esav, and so is always the moment of his fall.

[1400] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Purim 6** — "A lot exists only to human eyes; from Hashem's side there is no lot, for from Him everything is by judgment." The Radziner adds that the lot's appearance of chance is a deliberate concealment cast from above, through which Yisrael clarify themselves until Amalek's kelipah is undone, which complements Rav Tzadok's point that the lot itself carried the Divine intent to erase Amalek.

[1401] **Parallel: Likkutei Maamarim, Chodashim U'Moadim 16** — "Long ago I reasoned that Adar corresponds to Yosef, who became two tribes, sometimes counted as one and sometimes as two … and afterwards I found this in Kedushas Levi." Rav Tzadok there records reaching the Kedushas Levi's idea on his own, and adds that Adar is the month of laughter, for "a great laughter" is when the hopes of the wicked are overturned.

[1402] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Megillah 10b** — "There, with Achav, the end of the verse, 'to destroy you,' was also fulfilled; but here with Haman the end 'to destroy' was not fulfilled." Maharsha draws the same distinction from the opening verse, that only the rejoicing of the enemy came true in Haman's day, and so supports Rav Tzadok's reading that the decree to destroy Yisrael was never truly possible.

[1403] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 5** — "Above, how can war apply at all, when everything is in His hand? The war is only in the heart of man … Hashem's help is His war against Amalek." Rav Tzadok there explains why Amalek is fought "from generation to generation" and not erased at once: the battle is Yisrael's own inner struggle, won only with Divine help.

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר ו׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Vav

In the Mishnah (at the beginning of Rosh Hashanah): בְּאֶחָד בְּנִיסָן רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה (רֵישׁ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה בְּמִשְׁנָה) **"On the first of Nissan is the new year for kings and for the festivals."**[1404] לַמְּלָכִים וְלָרְגָלִים (שָׁם ד.) **And in the Gemara (there, 4a):** וּבְגְמָרָא רֶגֶל שֶׁבּוֹ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָרְגָלִים.[1405] **"The festival that falls in it is the new year for the festivals."** **This is difficult, for it should have said** וְקָשֶׁה דַּהֲוָה לֵיהּ לוֹמַר בְּנִיסָן רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָרְגָלִים. **"In Nissan is the new year for the festivals."** **But we have already said** אַךְ כְּבָר אָמַרְנוּ דְּמַהַאי טַעְמָא נִקְרָא רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **that for this reason it is called Rosh Chodesh, "the head of the month,"** וְלֹא תְּחִלַּת חֹדֶשׁ **and not "the beginning of the month": because it is the head of the entire month.** שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ שֶׁל כָּל הַחֹדֶשׁ **That is, the entire holiness of the month is included in Rosh Chodesh,** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁכָּל קְדוּשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ כָּלוּל בְּרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **and "the body follows the head"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב עֵירוּבִין מא.) **(as is written, Eruvin 41a).** וְצָרִיךְ לְהַרְגִּישׁ הַקְּדוּשָׁה **And one must sense the holiness of the festival that falls in it** מֵהֶרֶגֶל שֶׁבּוֹ בְּאֶחָד בּוֹ **already on its first day,** שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ. **which is Rosh Chodesh.** וְכֵן רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה פֵּירוּשׁוֹ **Likewise "Rosh Hashanah" means** רֹאשׁ שֶׁל כָּל הַשָּׁנָה **the head of the entire year.** וְזֶהוּ רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָרְגָלִים **And this is "the new year for the festivals":** שֶׁכָּל קְדוּשַׁת הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת כְּלוּלוֹת בֶּרֶגֶל דְּפֶסַח **that the holiness of all the festivals is included in the festival of Pesach.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר רֹאשׁ חֳדָשִׁים הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם [שְׁמוֹת יב, ב] **"This month shall be for you the head of the months":** כָּל הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת שֶׁבְּכָל הֶחֳדָשִׁים שֶׁנִּכְלָל בּוֹ קְדוּשַׁת **that included in it is the holiness of all the festivals in all the months.** וְזֶה שֶׁפָּתַח בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And this is why the Pesikta opened** (לְפָרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ פָּרָשָׁה טו) **(on Parshas HaChodesh, parshah 15)** בְּפָסוּק עָשָׂה יָרֵחַ לְמוֹעֲדִים **with the verse "He made the moon for appointed times"** [תְּהִלִּים קד, יט] **(Tehillim 104:19):** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁכָּל הַמּוֹעֲדִים בָּאִים **that is, all the festivals come** עַל יְדֵי קִידּוּשׁ הַיָּרֵחַ[1406] **through the sanctification of the moon** וְנִכְלָלִים בִּקְדוּשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **and are included in the holiness of the month;** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי שֶׁנָּתַן ה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ **for through Hashem Yisbarach having given** כֹּחַ לְיִשְׂרָאֵל **Yisrael the power** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה לַחֹדֶשׁ **to bring holiness into the month,** אַף שֶׁלֹּא נִמְצָא בַּתּוֹרָה **even though in the Torah** בּוֹ קְדוּשָׁה **no holiness is found in it** — רַק רֹאשׁ בֵּית דִּין **only the head of the beis din** אוֹמֵר מְקוּדָּשׁ וְכוּ׳ **says "Sanctified!" etc.** [רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כד.] **(Rosh Hashanah 24a)** — עַל יְדֵי זֶה יְכוֹלִים **through this they are able to make a holy convocation,** לַעֲשׂוֹת מִקְרָא קוֹדֶשׁ **they are able to fix all the festivals.** וְיוּכְלוּ לְקַבּוֹעַ כָּל הַמּוֹעֲדוֹת. **And this is why, before the section of Pesach, it placed first** מִצְוַת קִידּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ. **the mitzvah of sanctifying the month.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said** (מְנָחוֹת כט. וּשְׁמוֹת רַבָּה טו, כח) **(Menachos 29a and Shemos Rabbah 15:28)** שֶׁהָיָה קָשֶׁה לְמֹשֶׁה **that it was difficult for Moshe,** עַד שֶׁהֶרְאָה לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא בְּאֶצְבָּעוֹ הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה.[1407] **until HaKadosh Baruch Hu showed him with His finger: "This month."** **We must understand: why did he not learn** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין לָמָּה לֹא לָמַד **the laws of sanctifying the month** דִּינֵי קִידּוּשׁ הַחֹדֶשׁ **from HaKadosh Baruch Hu** — מֵהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **after all, all the Sages of Yisrael** וְהֲלֹא כָּל חַכְמֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל קִדְּשׁוּ עַל פִּי הָרְאִיָּה **sanctified it by sighting** וְלָמָּה הוּצְרַךְ[1408] **and the rules, and why did**

[1404] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 32** — "If they seek to extract the holy spark from him intentionally, they cannot … we accept converts from them only when they convert of their own accord, for the holy spark in them is non-knowledge." Rav Tzadok there gives the reason the Ari's blessing must come only in drunkenness: Amalek's spark can be reached only without daas.

[1405] **Parallel: Mei HaShiloach, Megillah 7b** — "'Until he does not know' refers to knowledge and recognition visible to the eye … only through the understanding in the heart will he know 'cursed is Haman' and 'blessed is Mordechai.'" The Izhbitzer explains how Yisrael stay bound to holiness even in drunkenness: what is lost is outward knowledge, while the heart's binah, its link to its root, remains.

[1406] **Parallel: Yisrael Kedoshim 8** — "'Oraisa, Yisrael and Kudsha Brich Hu are one' are the three holinesses: Oraisa, what a person strives for through Torah; Yisrael, the holiness rooted in the Avos; Kudsha Brich Hu, His sanctifying them from Above." Rav Tzadok there maps the same three-part verse onto Torah, Yisrael and Hashem, and adds that the holiness from Above rests on a person only in proportion to his preparation below.

[1407] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim, Purim 13** — "The holiness of the bris is fixed in Yisrael even without their deed … yet a person can recognize it only after first circumcising himself; then it is revealed retroactively." The Radziner explains "sasson zo milah" from the same Nedarim 31b, and shows why an inherited holiness, rooted in the Avos, still needs the act that reveals it.

[1408] **Parallel: Maharsha, Chiddushei Aggados, Megillah 13b** — "They expounded the superfluous word 'one': he told Him … 'one people'—just as the other peoples are not in mitzvos, so the Rabbanan among them do not keep mitzvos." Maharsha shows how the verse's extra words yield the charge, and so supplies the textual basis for Rav Tzadok's point that Haman denied the self-made holiness of even the talmidei chachamim.

ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ לְהַרְאוֹתוֹ בְּאֶצְבַּע. **Hashem, blessed be His Name, need to show it to him with a finger?** אַךְ נִתְקַשָּׁה מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **But Moshe Rabbeinu, peace be upon him, found it difficult:** הָאֵיךְ יוּכְלוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **how could Yisrael bring holiness into the month,** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָּׁה לַחֹדֶשׁ וּבַתּוֹרָה לֹא נִמְצָא בּוֹ קְדוּשָּׁה. **when in the Torah no holiness is found in it?** וְכֵן הָאֵיךְ יַעֲשׂוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **And likewise, how could Yisrael make** מִקְרָא קוֹדֶשׁ. **a holy convocation?** עַד שֶׁהֵאִיר לוֹ ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ זֶה.[1409] **Until Hashem Yisbarach illuminated this for him.** וְיֵשׁ לוֹמַר דְּמִטַּעַם זֶה **And one may say that for this reason** נִקְרָא פָּרָשָׁה זוֹ **this section is called** פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **"Parshas HaChodesh"** וְלֹא פָּרָשַׁת הַפֶּסַח **and not Parshas HaPesach,** עַל שֵׁם הָעִנְיָן **after its subject,** כְּמוֹ שְׁאָרֵי. **as the others are named.** אַךְ כָּל עִיקַּר עֶסֶק הַפָּרָשָׁה **Rather, the entire essence of the section's concern** הוּא הָאֵיךְ יוּכְלוּ **is how Yisrael can bring holiness into the month,** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָּׁה לַחֹדֶשׁ יִשְׂרָאֵל וּמִמֵּילָא יוּכְלוּ **and consequently they can bring holiness into the festivals.** לְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָּׁה לַמּוֹעֲדִים וְזֶהוּ בְּאֶחָד בְּנִיסָן **And this is "On the first of Nissan is the new year for the festivals":** רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָרְגָלִים רֹאשׁ לְכָל הָרְגָלִים **the head of all the festivals,** וּבָתַר רֵישָׁא גּוּפָא אָזִיל **and the body follows the head.** (שָׁם סִימָן כא) וְאָמַר בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And it says in the Pesikta (there, siman 21):** נִתְעַטֵּף בְּטַלִּית מְצוּיֶצֶת **"He wrapped Himself in a tallis with tzitzis,** וְהֶעֱמִיד לְמֹשֶׁה מִכָּאן **and stood Moshe on one side** וּלְאַהֲרֹן מִכָּאן **and Aharon on the other,** וְקָרָא לְמִיכָאֵל וּלְגַבְרִיאֵל **and called Michael and Gavriel** וְעָשָׂה אוֹתָם כִּשְׁלוּחֵי הַחֹדֶשׁ כּוּ׳ **and made them like the messengers of the month, etc.** אָמַר לָהֶם כַּסֵּדֶר הַזֶּה **He said to them: "In this order, etc.,** לְמַטָּן עַל יְדֵי זָקֵן בָּנַי מְקַדְּשִׁין אֶת הַחֹדֶשׁ כּוּ׳ **My children sanctify the month below, through an elder,** וְעַל יְדֵי עֵדִים **and through witnesses,** וְעַל יְדֵי טַלִּית מְצוּיֶצֶת.[1410] **and through a tallis with tzitzis."** וּמַה שֶּׁאָמַר עַל יְדֵי זָקֵן **What it says, "through an elder,"** הוּא מַה שֶּׁאָמְרוּ בַּמִּשְׁנָה **is what they said in the Mishnah** (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כד.) **(Rosh Hashanah 24a):** רֹאשׁ בֵּית דִּין אוֹמֵר מְקוּדָּשׁ **"The head of the beis din says: Sanctified!"** וְלָמָּה לֹא אָמַר אַב בֵּית דִּין **Why did it not say "av beis din,"** כִּרְגִילוּת הַשַּׁ״ס. **as is the usual usage of the Shas?** רַק רוֹמֵז **Rather, it alludes to** רֹאשׁ שֶׁל הַבַּיִת דִּין **the "head" of the beis din:** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַשִּׂיג **that is, that he can attain** עַד הָרֹאשׁ **up to the head,** דְּחָכְמָה מוֹחָא **for Chochmah is the brain,** וְהָרֹאשׁ הוּא בְּחִינַת **and the head is the aspect of** קַרְקַפְתָּא דְּתְפִילִּין **the skull on which the tefillin rest,** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן. **Keser Elyon.** וְזֶהוּ עַל יְדֵי זָקֵן **And this is "through an elder":** שֶׁיּוּכַל לְהַשִּׂיג עַד עַתִּיקָא **that he can attain up to Atika,** שֶׁהוּא מִדַּת זָקֵן כַּיָּדוּעַ **which is the attribute of the elder, as is known;** וְנִצְרָךְ לָזֶה הַגָּדוֹל שֶׁבַּדּוֹר. **and for this is needed the greatest of the generation.** וּמִי שֶׁלֹּא הִנִּיחַ כְּמוֹתוֹ בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **And one who has not left his equal in Eretz Yisrael** יוּכַל לְקַדֵּשׁ חֳדָשִׁים **may sanctify months** גַּם בְּחוּץ לָאָרֶץ[1411] **even outside the Land** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרָכוֹת סג.) **(as is written, Berachos 63a),** מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהוּא רֹאשׁ **because he is the head** שֶׁל כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל וְיָכוֹל לְהַשִּׂיג עַד עַתִּיקָא. **of all Yisrael and can attain up to Atika.** וְכֵן מַה שֶּׁאָמַר עַל יְדֵי עֵדִים **Likewise what it says, "through witnesses,"** הַיְינוּ כְּמוֹ הָעֵדִים **means like the witnesses** שֶׁהֶרְאָה לוֹ מִיכָאֵל וְגַבְרִיאֵל **that He showed him, Michael and Gavriel;** וְכֵן הָעֵדִים צְרִיכִין **and so too the witnesses must aim at** לְכַוֵּן בִּרְצוֹן דְּעַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא. **in the will of Atika Kadisha.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא (שָׁם סִימָן, ב) **And this is what they said in the Pesikta (there, siman 2):** רַבּוֹת עָשִׂיתָ וְגוֹמֵר **"Many things have You done, etc.,** נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ וּמַחְשְׁבֹתֶיךָ אֵלֵינוּ וְגוֹמֵר **Your wonders and Your thoughts toward us, etc."** [תְּהִלִּים מ, ו] **(Tehillim 40:6):** עַד שֶׁלֹּא יָצְאוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם **before they left Egypt,** הָיָה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **HaKadosh Baruch Hu would** יוֹשֵׁב וְחוֹשֵׁב חֶשְׁבּוֹנוֹת **sit and calculate the calculations** וּמְעַבֵּר עִיבּוּרִים כּוּ׳ **and intercalate the leap years, etc.,** עַד שֶׁיָּצְאוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל מִמִּצְרַיִם **until Yisrael left Egypt,** וּמְסָרָם לָהֶם.[1412] **and then He handed them over to them.** דָּרַשׁ מַחְשְׁבוֹתֶיךָ **He expounded "Your thoughts"** לְשׁוֹן חֶשְׁבּוֹנוֹת שֶׁלְּךָ וְכֵן נִדְרַשׁ בִּירוּשַׁלְמִי **in the sense of "Your calculations," and so it is expounded**

[1409] **Parallel: Divrei Soferim 38** — "Corresponding to Achashverosh's first feast, the beginning of the cure through his drunkenness when Vashti was killed, and its completion at Esther's wine-feast … Haman drank the cup of poison." Rav Tzadok there frames the same two feasts as the start and finish of one cure, and adds the contrast within the second feast: the same wine was Haman's downfall and Esther's joy.

[1410] **Parallel: Resisei Layla 32** — "This feast is the feast of the King of the world … only in outward guise did they enjoy the wicked one's banquet; in truth they enjoyed the banquet of the King of the world." Rav Tzadok there reads the whole seven-day feast through "the king" unqualified, adding that the seven days built a complete structure of the cure, finished on the seventh "when the king's heart was merry."

[1411] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Bechukosai 1** — "Shabbos is also called chok, 'chok — this is Shabbos': on Shabbos one merits Torah she'b'al peh, engraved in the heart without toil." Rav Tzadok there adds the mechanism: what weekday toil achieves, Shabbos engraves in rest, and so it guards against the yetzer hara's anger. This is why Parshas Parah, a chok like Shabbos, can work the same engraving.

in the Yerushalmi (ראש השנה פרק א הלכה ג ז:) **(Rosh Hashanah, perek 1, halachah 3, 7b).** וּכְתִיב נִפְלְאוֹתֶיךָ **And it is written "Your wonders":** נִפְלָאוֹת שֶׁלְּךָ **wonders that are Yours,** בְּחִינַת פֶּלֶא עֶלְיוֹן **the aspect of the supernal Wonder** וְהוּא מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה כה.) מֵעַתִּיקָא הַמְכוּסֶּה וְנֶעְלָם. **from Atika, which is covered and hidden.** **And this is what they said (Rosh Hashanah 25a):** אַתֶּם אֲפִילּוּ שׁוֹגְגִין **"'You' — even if unwitting,** אַתֶּם אֲפִילּוּ מְזִידִין כּוּ׳[1413] **'you' — even if deliberate, etc."** (שָׁם כ.) וְזֶהוּ סוֹד מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is the secret of what they said (there, 20a):** מְאַיְּמִין עַל הָעֵדִים כּוּ׳ **"They pressure the witnesses, etc.,** אַף עַל פִּי שֶׁלֹּא רָאוּהוּ **even though they did not see it,** לֵאמֹר רָאִינוּ.[1414] **to say 'We saw it.'"** וּמְלַמְּדִים אוֹתָן לְשַׁקֵּר **and they coach them to say what is untrue;** רַק רָאשׁ בֵּית דִּין **Rather, the head of the beis din,** שֶׁהוּא הַזָּקֵן **who is the elder,** מַשִּׂיג **grasps the wonders,** הַנִּפְלָאוֹת שֶׁצָּרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת כֵּן לְשַׁעְתּוֹ **that it must be so for that time,** וְזֶהוּ רְצוֹן הָעֶלְיוֹן.[1415] **and this is the supernal will.** **And this is what He showed him:** וְזֶה שֶׁהֶרְאָה לוֹ **through an elder and through witnesses,** עַל יְדֵי זָקֵן וְעַל יְדֵי עֵדִים. **and the whole matter is from the wonders.** וְכֵן מַה שֶׁאָמַר **And likewise what it says,** שֶׁהוּא אוֹר מַקִּיף[1416] **it is the encompassing light.** עַל יְדֵי טַלִּית מְצוּיֶּצֶת **"through a tallis with tzitzis":** וְאוֹמְרִים בַּעֲטִיפָתוֹ **And upon wrapping oneself in it we say** בָּרְכִי נַפְשִׁי וְגוֹמֵר **"Bless, my soul, etc.,** הוֹד וְהָדָר לָבָשְׁתָּ **You have clothed Yourself in majesty and splendor,** עוֹטֶה אוֹר כַּשַּׂלְמָה וְגוֹמֵר **wrapping Yourself in light like a garment, etc."** [תְּהִלִּים קד, א] **(Tehillim 104:1)** — דְּמֶלֶךְ בַּעֲשָׂרָה לְבוּשִׁים **that the King is in ten garments,** הַיְינוּ שֶׁנִּתְלַבֵּשׁ **meaning that He clothed Himself** בְּעֶשֶׂר סְפִירוֹת **in the ten sefiros** שֶׁהֶאֱצִיל לְבְרִיאַת הָעוֹלָם **which He emanated for the creation of the world.** וְחָשַׁב בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And the Pesikta (Sos Asis, parshah 37, siman 2) counts** לְבוּשׁ הָרִאשׁוֹן הוֹד וְהָדָר **the first garment as "majesty and splendor,"** וְהַיְינוּ דְּעוֹטֶה אוֹר כַּשַּׂלְמָה **that is, "Who wraps Himself in light like a garment."** הוּא שֶׁשָּׁגַּב מִדַּת חָכְמָה **This corresponds to "Let there be light,"** נֶגֶד יְהִי אוֹר **which corresponds to the attribute of Chochmah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה ג, ד) **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 3:4)** שֶׁנִּתְעַטֵּף בָּהּ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **that HaKadosh Baruch Hu wrapped Himself in it** כַּשַּׂלְמָה כּוּ׳ **like a garment, etc.,** עוֹטֶה אוֹר וְגוֹמֵר[1417] **"Who wraps Himself in light, etc."** **And "majesty and splendor" is the first garment,** שֶׁנֶּגֶד הוֹד וְהָדָר לְבוּשׁ רִאשׁוֹן **corresponding to Keser Elyon** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן **(this was explained at the beginning of Parshas Chayei Sarah** [מַאֲמָר א] **(maamar 1** וְנִתְבָּאֵר רֵישׁ פָּרָשַׁת חַיֵּי שָׂרָה **and in Chanukah, maamar 2,** וַחֲנוּכָּה מַאֲמָר ב דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל וְהִנֵּה **section beginning "VeHinei,"** עַיֵּין שָׁם בְּאֹרֶךְ[1418]**) see there at length).** **And this is the encompassing light** וְזֶהוּ הָאוֹר מַקִּיף שֶׁזּוֹכִין עַל יְדֵי טַלִּית מְצוּיֶּצֶת **that one merits through a tallis with tzitzis,** וְעַל כֵּן אוֹמְרִים **and**

[1412] **Parallel: Likkutei Torah (Baal HaTanya), Chukas 1** — "'Chukas haTorah' is the language of engraving (chakikah)… for the mitzvah of the red heifer is the sum (kelalus) of the Torah." From another school, the same two claims: chok means engraving, and the parah carries the whole Torah. That is why the verse says "statute of the Torah."

[1413] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Sisa 3** — "The second Luchos included all of Torah she'b'al peh… this was needed after the corruption, the 'much wisdom' to repair the 'much anger,' as Nedarim 22b says." This supplies the Gemara behind Rav Tzadok's formula. Had Yisrael not sinned, only the five books would have been given. The Oral Torah was given as the answer to the anger of the yetzer.

[1414] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 7** — "Now that we have no ashes of the parah, 'let our lips pay for bulls' (Hoshea 14:3) through reading the parashah, which works to bring this into the heart little by little." Here Rav Tzadok answers the same question about our time. The reading itself does the purifying that the ashes once did, and it comes before Pesach on purpose.

[1415] **Parallel: Mei HaShiloach, vol. I, Bo** — "The statute of the Pesach corresponds to 'I am Hashem,' which includes all positive mitzvos; the statute of the parah, to 'You shall have no other gods,' which includes all negative mitzvos." The Izhbitzer also starts from the contrast with "the statute of the Pesach." For him too the parah is not one rite. It is the cleansing of the heart from evil that underlies the whole Torah.

[1416] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Yisro 13** — "Like Yaakov Avinu, who was like Adam HaRishon before the corruption and knew nothing of bodily pleasure, and so did not die; so too we find of Moshe Rabbeinu, 'Moshe did not die.'" Rav Tzadok there gives the reason. Death came through the serpent's corruption, so one wholly untouched by it is not subject to death. That is why Moshe could grasp the parah's reason, a purity that reaches the root of death.

[1417] **Parallel: Akeidas Yitzchak, Sha'ar 79** — on "things not revealed to Moshe were revealed to Rabbi Akiva": "The prophet knows the future only in general… but the sage knows the particulars too, and understands the cause of each detail." The Akeidah reads the midrash as the sage's power of detail. Rav Tzadok takes it further: the Oral Torah draws its power to repair from the very corruption Moshe never knew.

[1418] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Yisro 1** — "The giving of the Torah is written in the parashah of Yisro the convert, for it belongs to Torah she'b'al peh, which comes to repair the much anger after the corruption." There too Rav Tzadok calls Rabbi Akiva, the son of converts, the root of the Oral Torah. The same link between converts and the Oral Torah explains why Matan Torah stands in Parshas Yisro.

therefore we say פְּסוּקִים הַנִּזְכָּרִים לְעֵיל׃ **the verses mentioned above.** וְעַל יְדֵי הַטַּלִּית מְצוּיֶצֶת **And through the tallis with tzitzis** זוֹכֶה רֹאשׁ בֵּית דִּין **the head of the beis din merits** לְהוֹפָעַת עַתִּיקָא **the shining forth of the aspect of Atika,** וּלְהַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה לַחֹדֶשׁ **and to bring holiness into the month;** שֶׁעַל יְדֵי זֶה **for through this** מַאוֹר עַתִּיקָא כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל **holiness is brought into the festivals,** שֶׁצָּרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת **which must be** מְכֻנָּסִין קְדוּשָׁה לַמּוֹעֲדוֹת **from the light of Atika, as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁנִּתְקַשָּׁה בּוֹ מֹשֶׁה רַבֵּינוּ **And this is what Moshe Rabbeinu found difficult,** עַד שֶׁהָרְאָה לוֹ הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא׃ **until HaKadosh Baruch Hu showed him.** וְזֶהוּ הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **And this is "This month shall be for you** רֹאשׁ חֳדָשִׁים **the head of the months":** שֶׁזֶּה הַקְּדָמָה לַפֶּסַח **that this is the preparation for Pesach,** שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לַעֲשׂוֹת מִקְרָא קוֹדֶשׁ׃ **so that they can make a holy convocation.** וּמֵרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **And from Rosh Chodesh one must** צָרִיךְ לְהַשִּׂיג וּלְהַרְגִּישׁ **attain and sense** קְדוּשַׁת הַמּוֹעֵד **the holiness of the festival** שֶׁיָּבֹא בְּחֹדֶשׁ זֶה **that will come in this month;** וְהוּא רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לָרְגָלִים **and this is the new year for the festivals,** שֶׁמִּמֶּנּוּ מִסְתַּעֵף **from which branches out** כָּל קְדוּשַׁת הָרְגָלִים׃ **all the holiness of the festivals.** וּכְשֶׁחָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ בְּחוֹל **When Rosh Chodesh falls on a weekday,** צָרִיךְ לִקְרוֹת בַּשַּׁבָּת **one must read on the Shabbos** שֶׁקּוֹדֶם רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **before Rosh Chodesh** פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **Parshas HaChodesh;** שֶׁבַּשַּׁבָּת שֶׁלְּפָנָיו **for on the Shabbos before it** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה בִּימֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה שֶׁאַחֲרָיו **that will be in the weekdays after it,** קְדוּשַׁת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **the holiness of Rosh Chodesh** צָרִיךְ לְהַרְגִּישׁ **one must sense** דְּשַׁבָּת כּוֹלֵל כָּל כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים **as we have said many times,** קְדוּשׁוֹת **that Shabbos includes all the holinesses** שֶׁיָּבֹאוּ בִּימֵי הַמַּעֲשֶׂה שֶׁאַחֲרָיו **that will come in the weekdays after it,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאוֹמְרִים **as we say** [תְּפִלַּת עַרְבִית לְשַׁבָּת] **(Shabbos evening prayer):** כוּ׳[1419] **"He** בֵּרַכְתּוֹ מִכָּל הַיָּמִים **blessed it above all the days," etc.** וְכָלוּל בְּשַׁבָּת זֶה **And included in this Shabbos** קְדוּשַׁת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **is the holiness of Rosh Chodesh,** שֶׁכּוֹלֵל רֶגֶל שֶׁבּוֹ **which includes the festival in it,** שֶׁהוּא שׁוֹרֶשׁ כָּל הַמּוֹעֲדִים׃ **which is the root of all the festivals.** וּכְשֶׁחָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ בְּשַׁבָּת **And when Rosh Chodesh falls on Shabbos,** קוֹרְאִין הַפָּרָשָׁה **we read the section on that Shabbos,** בַּשַּׁבָּת וְאָז הַקְּדוּשָׁה כְּפוּלָה **and then the holiness is doubled:** דִּקְדוּשַׁת שַׁבָּת וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **for the holiness of Shabbos receives** מִקְּדוּשַׁת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **from the holiness of Rosh Chodesh,** מְקַבֵּל **and Rosh Chodesh from Shabbos;** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּמָה שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ **as we said on what they said** (זְבָחִים צא.) **(Zevachim 91a)** דְּחָשֵׁב רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **regarding "frequent" and "more sanctified,"** לְעִנְיַן תָּדִיר וּמְקוּדָּשׁ **that it considers Rosh Chodesh** מְקוּדָּשׁ טְפֵי **more sanctified,** מִצַּד שֶׁהוּא מְקוּדָּשׁ מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **because it is sanctified by Yisrael;** וְעִנְיַן תָּדִיר הוּא **and the matter of "frequent" is** מַה שֶּׁיִּשְׂרָאֵל עוֹשִׂין תָּדִיר **what Yisrael do frequently;** וּמְקוּדָּשׁ דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל מְקַדְּשֵׁי **and "sanctified," for Yisrael sanctify it** (וְנִתְבָּאֵר חֲנוּכָה) **(this was explained in Chanukah,** רֵישׁ מַאֲמָר כה[1420]**) at the beginning of maamar 25).** (שָׁם) וְאָמְרוּ בַּגְּמָרָא **And they said in the Gemara (there):** אַשּׁוּ רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **"Is it that Rosh Chodesh** לְמוּסָפִין דִּידֵיהּ אַהֲנֵי **is effective for its own musaf offerings,** לְמוּסְפֵי שַׁבָּת לָא אַהֲנֵי[1421] **but for the Shabbos musaf offerings is not?"** עַיֵּין שָׁם׃ **See there.** וְהֵיינוּ **That is, both of them** שֶׁשְּׁנֵיהֶן מְקַבְּלִין הַקְּדוּשָׁה ז�ֶה מִזֶּה׃ **receive the holiness from one another.** וּמִמֵּילָא יִהְיֶה **And consequently** גְּדוֹלָה יוֹתֵר מִכָּל שָׁנָה **the holiness of the festival that comes after it** קְדוּשַׁת הַמּוֹעֵד שֶׁיָּבוֹא אַחֲרָיו **will be greater than in any other year,** כֵּינָן שֶׁמַּרְגִּישִׁין הַקְּדוּשָׁה **since they sense the holiness** עַל יְדֵי קְרִיאַת הַפָּרָשָׁה **through the reading of the section** בַּשַּׁבָּת וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **on Shabbos and Rosh Chodesh;** דְּשַׁבָּת מוֹעִיל לְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **for Shabbos benefits Rosh Chodesh,** וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ לְשַׁבָּת׃ **and Rosh Chodesh benefits Shabbos.**

[1419] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Seitzei 15** — "Wherever 'halachah l'Moshe miSinai' is said, it does not mean the halachos were handed to Moshe… what was given to Moshe was the power to derive them from the Torah through his pilpul." This spells out what Moshe's Oral Torah "contained in the Written Torah" means. The halachah is drawn out of the text itself. It is not a separate tradition added beside it.

[1420] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shemini 5** — "David, who raised up the yoke of teshuvah, through teshuvah, which comes from a person's own effort; and Shlomo HaMelech, who merited wisdom in a dream without his effort." The same contrast stands behind "far from me." Shlomo's Oral Torah was given from Above. The power to repair after a fall comes only from below, through effort and teshuvah.

[1421] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim (Radzin), Parshas Parah 4** — "To see purity in the very garment that before seemed the opposite… is possible only when it shines from the highest place, called 'One,' the will stripped of all garments." Like Rav Tzadok, the Radziner reads "Is it not the One" as the level above choice and its garments. There purity shows itself within the impure thing itself, with nothing changed.

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר ז׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Zayin

"On the first of Nissan בְּאֶחָד בְּנִיסָן רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לַמְּלָכִים **is the new year for kings"** [רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה ב׳]. **(Rosh Hashanah 2a).** וּבַגְּמָרָא (שָׁם ג׳) **And in the Gemara (there, 3a):** לֹא שָׁנוּ אֶלָּא לְמַלְכֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **"They taught this only for the kings of Yisrael,** אֲבָל לְמַלְכֵי אוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם **but for the kings of the nations of the world** מִתִּשְׁרֵי מָנִינַן[1422] **we count from Tishrei,"** דְּתִשְׁרֵי רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לַשָּׁנִים **for Tishrei is the new year for years,** הַיְינוּ שְׁנוֹת הַחַמָּה **meaning the years of the sun;** וְאוּמּוֹת הָעוֹלָם מוֹנִין לַחַמָּה **and the nations of the world count by the sun,** מוֹנִין לַלְּבָנָה **count by the moon,** מַה שֶּׁאֵין כֵּן יִשְׂרָאֵל **whereas Yisrael** שֶׁהִיא שֶׁל אוֹר וְהוּא אֵשׁ כּוּ׳ **which is fire, etc.;** כָּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה טו, כז) **so too Yisrael inherit the light** כָּךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל נוֹחֲלִין הָאוֹר[1423] **(as is written, Shemos Rabbah 15:27).** וְהַיְינוּ דִּלְבָנָה **That is, the moon** רַק מְקַבֶּלֶת אוֹר מֵאוֹר הַחַמָּה **only receives light from the light of the sun,** וְאֵינָהּ שֶׁל אֵשׁ[1424] **and is not of fire.** (נְדָרִים ח׳:) וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said (Nedarim 8b):** הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא מוֹצִיא חַמָּה מִנַּרְתִּיקָהּ **"HaKadosh Baruch Hu will bring the sun out of its sheath;** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁמַּשִּׂיגִים צַדִּיקִים מִתְרַפְּאִין בָּהּ כּוּ׳ **That is, they attain the tzaddikim are healed by it, etc."** רַק אוֹר מֵהַחַמָּה **only the light from the sun,** כְּלְבָנָה שֶׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת הָאוֹר **like the moon, which receives the light;** וּרְשָׁעִים נִידּוֹנִים בָּהּ כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [מַלְאָכִי ג׳, יט] **as it is said (Malachi 3:19):** וְלִהַט אוֹתָם הַיּוֹם הַבָּא **"The coming day shall set them ablaze."** (תַּעֲנִית ח׳:) וְכֵן דָּרְשׁוּ **And so they expounded (Taanis 8b):** שֶׁמֶשׁ בְּשַׁבָּת צְדָקָה לָעֲנִיִּים **"Sun on Shabbos is charity for the poor,"** מִדִּכְתִיב [מַלְאָכִי ג׳, כ] **from what is written (Malachi 3:20):** וְזָרְחָה לָכֶם יִרְאֵי שְׁמִי **"And there shall shine for you who fear My Name";** דְּהַיְינוּ שׁוֹמְרֵי שַׁבָּת[1426] **that is, those who keep Shabbos** (כְּפֵירוּשׁ רַשׁ״י תַּעֲנִית שָׁם **(as Rashi explains, Taanis there,** דִּבּוּר הַמַּתְחִיל יִרְאֵי) **s.v. Yirei).** וְהַיְינוּ דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל **That is, Yisrael —** כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל בְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא **Knesses Yisrael — are the aspect of the moon** דְּמִקַּבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **that receives from the sun,** וְהַיְינוּ מִדַּת מַלְכוּת **that is, the attribute of Malchus,** דְּמָלְךָ מָרְכָּבָה לָהּ. **for a king is a chariot for it.** וְכֵן דָּוִד הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And so Dovid HaMelech, peace be upon him,** [תְּהִלִּים קט, ד] אָמַר **said (Tehillim 109:4):** וַאֲנִי תְּפִלָּה **"And I am prayer,"** דְּתִפְלָּה מִמִּדָּה זוֹ **for prayer is from this attribute,** (שָׁם נא, יז) כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (there, 51:17):** אֲדֹנָ״י שְׂפָתַי תִּפְתָּח. **"Hashem, open my lips."** וּשְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And of Shlomo HaMelech, peace be upon him,** [דִּבְרֵי הַיָּמִים א כט, כג] כְּתִיב בֵּיהּ **it is written (Divrei HaYamim I 29:23):** וַיֵּשֶׁב עַל כִּסֵּא ה׳ **"And he sat upon the throne of Hashem,"** וְהִשִּׂיג כָּל הַחָכְמָה תַּתָּאָה **and he attained all of the lower wisdom,** חָכְמַת שְׁלֹמֹה. **the wisdom of Shlomo.** וּבְשַׁבָּת הַשֶּׁמֶשׁ **And on Shabbos the sun** מַרְפֵּא בִּכְנָפֶיהָ **brings "healing in its wings":** שֶׁמַּשִּׂיגִין וּמְקַבְּלִין **for they attain and receive** מֵהַשֶּׁמֶשׁ הָאוֹר **the light from the sun,** בְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא **the aspect of the moon** דְּמִקַּבְּלָא מִשִּׁמְשָׁא **that receives from the sun,** [תְּהִלִּים פד, יב] שֵׁם דְּהַנָּ״ה כְּתִיב **the Name Havayah, as it is written (Tehillim 84:12):** כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן ה׳. **"For Hashem is a sun and a shield."** וְחָשַׁב בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא **And the Pesikta** [לְפָרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ פָּרָשָׁה טו סִימָן יז] **(on Parshas HaChodesh, parshah 15, siman 17)** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה טו, כו) וּמִדְרָשׁ **and the Midrash (Shemos Rabbah 15:26) count** חֲמִשָּׁה עָשָׂר דּוֹר **fifteen generations** מֵאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו

[1422] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Masei 11** — "Already in the first utterance darkness and the deeds of the wicked are mentioned… and willful sins become merits, when it is made clear that it was all only so that it be 'very good.'" Rav Tzadok there adds a warning. The yetzer hara uses this very truth to coax a person to sin, as Bilaam smoothed Yisrael's path to Shittim. The clarification comes only through teshuvah.

[1423] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Tetzaveh 12** — "'Come and give light to Me' is the light of Torah she'b'al peh, for the Sages were given the power to give light before Him, as it were, like 'My children have defeated Me.'" The Gemara there (Bava Metzia 59b) is the source for "He heeds the beis din below." This power was given to Aharon, so the lamps last forever as the Oral Torah's light in the heart.

[1424] **Parallel: Mei HaShiloach, vol. I, Bo** — "By reason, a person cannot grasp 'I am Hashem' before his heart is cleansed of 'You shall have no other gods'… but Hashem in His great mercy put 'I am' first." The Izhbitzer draws the same two orders as Rav Tzadok. From man's side purity comes first. From Hashem's side the light is given first, so that the heart can then be cleansed.

[1425] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Terumah 6** — "The Arizal assigned the Friday-night meal to Yitzchak and the Shabbos-morning meal to Avraham, though the order of the Avos is Avraham, Yitzchak… for that is the order from Yisrael's side, to repair the corruption." Rav Tzadok gives the same reason there for the Arizal's order. Fear and purification, Yitzchak's trait, come first from below. Avraham's kindness and wisdom follow.

[1426] **Parallel: Machshavos Charutz 7** — "Now that we have no actual shekalim, 'let our lips pay for bulls' through reading the parashah in public, for we are ready with all our heart, longing to fulfill it in deed." Rav Tzadok makes the same point about Shekalim there. The reading works because of the longing behind it. That is what lets the reading of Parah stand in for the act itself.

הַשָּׁלוֹם **from Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** עַד שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם.[1427] **until Shlomo HaMelech, peace be upon him.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **That is, Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה הַתְחָלַת יְהִי הָאוֹר **was the beginning of the light,** (בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה, ב, ג) כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (Bereishis Rabbah 2:3):** הַדִּבְּרֵי תוֹרָה וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהוּא הֵבִין **That is, he understood** אוֹר זֶה אַבְרָהָם **"'Let there be light' — this is Avraham."** מֵעַצְמוֹ **the words of Torah on his own,** (שָׁם סא, א) וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said (there, 61:1):** אֵב לֹא לִמֵּד וֹ **"No father taught him,** רַב לֹא הָיָה לוֹ כּוּ׳ **he had no teacher, etc.;** שְׁתֵּי כְלְיוֹתָיו כְּמִין שְׁנֵי רַבָּנִים **his two kidneys were like two teachers** וְהָיוּ מְלַמְּדוֹת אוֹתוֹ כּוּ׳ **and would teach him, etc."** וְהָיָה הַתְחָלָה **And he was the beginning** מֵאוֹר תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה[1428] **of the light of Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהָיָה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **being a chariot for the attribute of Malchus,** עַד שְׁלֹמֹה שֶׁהָיָה **until Shlomo, who was** אַשְׁלְמוּתָא דְּסִיהֲרָא. **the completion of the moon.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה נִקְרָא רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **was called Rosh Chodesh,** הַהַתְחָלָה מִבְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא. **the beginning of the aspect of the moon.** וְכֵן נִקְרְאוּ כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **And so all Yisrael are called** בְּנֵי מְלָכִים[1429] **children of kings** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שַׁבָּת סז.) **(as is written, Shabbos 67a),** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁהֵן בְּנֵי **that is, because they are the children of** אַבְרָהָם יִצְחָק וְיַעֲקֹב. **Avraham, Yitzchak and Yaakov.** וְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** הָיָה הָרִאשׁוֹן שֶׁפָּרְסֵם מַלְכוּת שָׁמַיִם **was the first to publicize the Kingship of Heaven,** כַּיְנוֹן שֶׁהוֹדַעְתִּיו לִבְרִיּוֹתָיו וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמַר **as He said:** אֱלֹהֵי הָאָרֶץ[1430] **"Once I made Him known to His creatures, He became God of the earth"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב בְּרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה נט, ח) **(as is written, Bereishis Rabbah 59:8);** וְנַעֲשָׂה מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **and he became a chariot for the attribute of Malchus.** וְכֵן כָּל הָאָבוֹת **And likewise all the Avos** פֵּרְסְמוּ מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ **publicized His Kingship, may He be blessed,** וְנִקְרְאוּ מְלָכִים. **and were called kings.** וּבְאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **Regarding Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** מָצִינוּ מְפוֹרָשׁ **we find it explicitly** (שָׁם מב, ה) **(there, 42:5):** עֵמֶק שָׁוֵה **"The Valley of Shaveh":** אָמְרוּ לוֹ מָלֵךְ אַתָּ עָלֵינוּ כּוּ׳[1431] **they said to him, "You are king over us," etc.** וְכֵן נִקְרְאוּ כָּל הָאָבוֹת מְלָכִים. **And so all the Avos are called kings.** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁמָּצִינוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **This is similar to what we find in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג רי:) **(part 3, 210b):** [בְּמִדְבַּר כג, ט] **"'From the top of the rocks' (Bamidbar 23:9) —** אִלֵּין אִינּוּן אֲבָהָתָא **these are the Avos,** [יְשַׁעְיָה נא, א] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Yeshayah 51:1):** הַבִּיטוּ אֶל צוּר חוֹצַבְתֶּם.[1432] **'Look to the rock from which you were hewn.'"** וְאַף דְּשָׁם קָאֵי **And even though there it refers** עַל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **to Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** [יְשַׁעְיָה נא, ב] כִּדְכְתִיב **as it is written (Yeshayah 51:2):** הַבִּיטוּ אֶל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם צוּר רַק כֵּיוָן שֶׁנִּקְרָא **nevertheless, since** אַבְרָהָם וְגוֹמֵר **"Look to Avraham, etc.,"** נִקְרְאוּ כֵּן כָּל הָאָבוֹת צוּרִים. **Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him, is called a rock, all the Avos are likewise called rocks.** וְכֵן מָצִינוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And so we find in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ג קנ.) **(part 3, 150a):** כָּרוּהָ נְדִיבֵי עָם דִּכְתִיב **"'The nobles of the people dug it' (Bamidbar 21:18) —** [בְּמִדְבַּר כא, יח] אִלֵּין אִינּוּן **these are the Avos,**

[1427] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pekudei 6** — "Of the kelipah of jealousy nothing will remain, but of the yetzer of desire there will remain in the future a longing for Torah." Rav Tzadok there cites Zohar I 138a: were it not for the yetzer, there would be no joy in learning. This is the source for the zav's root in holiness, and it explains why desire is kept out only of the camp of the Levi'im.

[1428] **Parallel: Chanah Ariel (R' Aharon of Staroselye), Vayechi 2** — "There is no king without a people… so the earlier kings each said 'I will reign': to bring worlds into being as separate things, so that his kingship be called over them." This develops Rav Tzadok's point in Kabbalistic terms. The self-assertion that shattered the first kings is built into creation itself, since kingship needs others to rule over.

[1429] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Nasso 3** — on the metzora, zav and tamei lanefesh as jealousy, desire and honor: "So that a person not lose heart, each knowing the plagues of his own heart… the Torah teaches that for everything there is a repair." There too the same reassurance follows the same three impurities. No blemish of the heart cuts a Jew off from Knesses Yisrael.

[1430] **Parallel: Arizal, Sha'ar HaHakdamos, Introductions 1** — "Occupying oneself with the Torah in its plain sense, the Torah of this world, which is vanity before the Torah of Mashiach and the Torah of the World to Come." The Arizal applies the same midrash to the plain garment of the present Torah. Rav Tzadok says this garment will one day be washed and renewed.

[1431] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Hashanah 7** — "At the start of creation man was made upright, always cleaving to eternal life; this is called the attribute of judgment, for such is the conduct of the perfect tzaddikim." This explains what the future Torah "in judgment" means. It is not harshness. It is the exacting closeness of the perfect tzaddik, as Yaakov took even mercy as judgment (Zohar I 151b).

[1432] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Kedushas Shabbos 7** — "The blessing of the Shabbos day, a semblance of the World to Come, is renewal of the light of Torah of the days of Mashiach… when every heart will flow with wisdom." This spells out what the "semblance" is. On Shabbos the heart already tastes the Torah that will one day well up from within.

[תְּהִלִּים מז, י] **as it is written (Tehillim 47:10):** נְדִיבֵי עַמִּים נֶאֱסָפוּ **'The nobles of the peoples are gathered,** עַם אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם.[1433] **the people of the God of Avraham.'"** וְאַף שֶׁנִּזְכָּר רַק אַבְרָהָם **And even though only Avraham is mentioned,** (חֲגִיגָה ג.) וְכֵן בַּגְּמָרָא **and so too in the Gemara (Chagigah 3a)** לָמְדוּ מִזֶּה **they learned from this:** בַּת נָדִיב **"'Daughter of the noble' —** בְּתּוֹ שֶׁל אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ **the daughter of Avraham Avinu,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא נָדִיב כּוּ'[1434] **who is called noble, etc.:** אֱלֹהֵי אַבְרָהָם **'the God of Avraham,'** וְיַעֲקֹב וְלֹא אֱלֹהֵי יִצְחָק **and not the God of Yitzchak and Yaakov,** כּוּ' אֶלָּא **but rather, etc." —** מִכָּל מָקוֹם בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **nevertheless the holy Zohar** יָלִיף מִינַּהּ **derives from it** לְכָל הָאָבוֹת שֶׁנִּקְרְאוּ נְדִיבִים **that all the Avos are called nobles,** כֵּיוָן שֶׁאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **since Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** נִקְרָא נָדִיב **is called noble,** שֶׁהָיָה תְּחִלָּה לַגֵּרִים **for he was the first of the converts** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם) **(as they said there),** וְקִיֵּים כָּל הַתּוֹרָה **and kept the entire Torah** קוֹדֶם שֶׁנִּיתְּנָה **before it was given,** רַק מִנְּדִיבוּת **purely out of nobility of spirit;** מִמֵּילָא כָּל הָאָבוֹת **consequently all the Avos** נִקְרְאוּ נְדִיבִים **are called nobles,** וְכֵן צוּרִים כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **and likewise rocks, as mentioned above.** (בָּבָא מְצִיעָא פג.) **And so we find (Bava Metzia 83a):** שֶׁאֲפִילּוּ אַתָּה עוֹשֶׂה לָהֶם כְּסָעוּדַת שְׁלֹמֹה בְּשִׁלְמוּתוֹ **"For even if you make for them a feast like Shlomo's in his time,** לֹא יָצָאתָ יְדֵי חוֹבָה **you have not fulfilled the obligation,** שֶׁהֵן בְּנֵי אַבְרָהָם יִצְחָק וְיַעֲקֹב[1435] **for they are the children of Avraham, Yitzchak and Yaakov,"** שֶׁסְּעוּדַת הָאָבוֹת **for the feast of the Avos** גְּדוֹלָה מִשֶּׁל שְׁלֹמֹה **is greater than that of Shlomo;** (שָׁם פו:) וּבַגְּמָרָא **and in the Gemara (there, 86b)** מַיְיתֵי רַק **it brings only** מִסְּעוּדַת אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ.[1436] **the feast of Avraham Avinu.** וְכֵן כָּאן דְּמָצִינוּ **So too here: since we find** בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **regarding Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהִמְלִיכוּהוּ **that they crowned him king,** וּבְנֵיהֶם בְּנֵי מְלָכִים. **and their children, children of kings.** וְאִיתָא בְּתִקּוּנֵי זֹהַר **And it is stated in the Tikkunei Zohar** (תִּיקּוּן לוֹ עז:) **(tikkun 36, 77b):** דָּא פֶּסַח כּוּ' יְהִי אוֹר **"'Let there be light' — this is Pesach, etc.;** וַיְהִי אוֹר **'and there was light' —** רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה.[1437] **this is Rosh Hashanah."** דְּבְפֶסַח הִתְחִיל **For on Pesach began** הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת בְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **the renewal in Torah she'b'al peh,** כְּמוֹ בְּאַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **just as with Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהָיָה רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **who was Rosh Chodesh** וְלָמַד מֵעַצְמוֹ **and learned on his own,** רַק שֶׁה' יִתְבָּרַךְ **except that Hashem Yisbarach** אָמַר יְהִי אוֹר. **said, "Let there be light."** וַיְהִי אוֹר רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה **"And there was light" is Rosh Hashanah,** שָׁאָז הוּא הִתְגַּלּוּת הָאוֹר **for then is the revelation of the light** דְּתוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **of Torah she'b'al peh,** אֵיךְ שֶׁמְּקַבֵּל מִתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב **how it receives from Torah she'bichsav;** וְלָכֵן מַתְחִילִין אָז **therefore we then begin** מֵחָדָשׁ הַתּוֹרָה שֶׁבִּכְתָב. **the Written Torah anew.** וְהִתְגַּלּוּת מִדַּת מַלְכוּתוֹ **And the revelation of the attribute of His Kingship** הָיָה גַּם כֵּן בְּנִיסָן **was also in Nissan,** [תְּהִלִּים צח, ב] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Tehillim 93:2):** נָכוֹן כִּסְאֲךָ מֵאָז **"Your throne is established from then (me'az),"** (שְׁמוֹת רַבָּה כג, א) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Shemos Rabbah 23:1):** בְּאָז יָשִׁיר עַיֵּין שָׁם **with "Then (az) sang" — see there.** וְהוּא כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is as they said** (וַיִּקְרָא רַבָּה, ב, ד) **(Vayikra Rabbah 2:4):** הֵן שֶׁהִמְלִיכוּנִי תְּחִלָּה עַל הַיָּם **"They are the ones who first crowned Me at the Sea** וְאָמְרוּ לִי **and said to Me:** ה' יִמְלוֹךְ לְעוֹלָם וָעֶד[1438] **'Hashem shall reign forever and ever'** [שְׁמוֹת טו, יח]. **(Shemos 15:18)."** וּכְמוֹ אַבְרָהָם אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **And just as Avraham Avinu, peace be**

[1433] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayigash 5** — "Mashiach is the individual who did teshuvah, for whose sake the world is forgiven: he will put a thought of teshuvah into the whole. For surely they will not forgive the whole world for nothing." This explains why the forgiveness is not arbitrary. Mashiach ben Yosef purifies those who never fell. Mashiach ben David brings teshuvah into the hearts of those who did.

[1434] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shemos 10** — "Just as Moshe had to be raised in Pharaoh's house… so Mashiach, who must bring out even those lost in Ashur though they are sunk deep, must dwell with them in the land." This adds how even the fully assimilated are reached. The redeemer stands among them, as Moshe did in Egypt, and their kelipah does not touch him.

[1435] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shemos 8** — "The great shofar is Binah (Zohar III 266b): when fear enters the point in the heart, the awakening in the depths of the heart helps even those cast away… and even those lost in Ashur." This explains how Binah reaches those who do not know they are Jews. The awakening comes from beneath awareness, at the point of the heart, and not through their own understanding.

[1436] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayera 1** — "These three kelipos stand against the three Avos in holiness: Avraham brings all loves into holiness, Yitzchak the strengths… and honor stands against Yaakov the small, as it says, 'I am too small.'" Rav Tzadok there also ties the three to Avos 2:11 (evil eye, yetzer hara, hatred of people) and to Bilaam's traits. He shows why lowliness frees one from desire as well.

[1437] **Parallel: Tzidkas HaTzaddik 202** — "In youth passion and love surge in a person, and then is the time to use love… and measure for measure Hashem loves a person in youth: 'When Yisrael was a youth, I loved him.'" There Rav Tzadok gives the order of a life: love in youth, then fear with Torah, then settled da'as in old age. It follows the three Avos, with Avraham as the beginning.

upon him, שֶׁפִּרְסֵם מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ **who publicized His Kingship, blessed be His Name,** נַעֲשָׂה מֶלֶךְ **became a king** וְזָכָה לִבְחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **and merited the aspect of Atika,** [בְּרֵאשִׁית כד, א] דִּכְתִיב **as it is written (Bereishis 24:1):** וְאַבְרָהָם זָקֵן **"And Avraham was old,"** וְכֵן כָּל הָאָבוֹת נִקְרְאוּ מְלָכִים **and likewise all the Avos were called kings** וְזָכוּ לִבְחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **and merited the aspect of Atika,** דִּכְתִיב בְּהוּ גַּם כֵּן **for of them too is written** לְשׁוֹן זְקֵנָה. **the language of old age —** כֵּן כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל אוּמָּה שְׁלֵימָה **so too all Yisrael, a complete nation,** שֶׁקִּבְּלוּ מַלְכוּתוֹ יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ **who accepted His Kingship, blessed be His Name,** זָכוּ לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **merited the attribute of Malchus,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שְׁמוֹת יט, ו] **as it is said (Shemos 19:6):** וְאַתֶּם תִּהְיוּ לִי מַמְלֶכֶת כֹּהֲנִים וְגוֹי **"And you shall be for Me a kingdom of kohanim, etc."** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ וְכֵן זָכוּ לִבְחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **And likewise they merited the aspect of Atika,** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ב נד, א) **as they said (Zohar, part 2, 54a):** אָז יָשִׁיר **"'Then sang' —** אָלֶ"ף אַנְקִיט בַּחֲשׁוֹכֵי כּוּ' **the alef engraved in the darkness, etc.,** וּמָטוּ לְזַיִ"ן **and reached the zayin."** וְזֶהוּ נָכוֹן כִּסְאֲךָ מֵאָז **And this is "Your throne is established from then,"** בְּאָז יָשִׁיר. **through "Then sang."** וְכֵן בְּנִיסָן הָיָה **And so in Nissan was** הַתְחָלַת מַלְכוּת יִשְׂרָאֵל **the beginning of the kingship of Yisrael,** כְּשֶׁיָּצְאוּ מִמִּצְרַיִם **when they left Egypt** וְנֶאֱמַר לָהֶם **and were told, "This month shall be for you,"** הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **and were told, "This month shall be for you,"** בְּחִינַת סִיהֲרָא **the aspect of the moon.** וְזֶה מַה **And this is what they said:** שֶׁאָמְרוּ בְּנִיסָן רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה לַמְּלָכִים. **"In Nissan is the new year for kings."** וּבְאַבְרָהָם **And of Avraham Avinu, peace be upon him,** אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם [יְשַׁעְיָה מא, ב] כְּתִיב **it is written (Yeshayah 41:2):** מִי הֵעִיר מִמִּזְרָח צֶדֶק **"Who aroused from the east, righteousness,"** [ב, ג] וּמִזֶּה לָמְדוּ בְּבְרֵאשִׁית רַבָּה **and from this they learned in Bereishis Rabbah (2:3):** יְהִי אוֹר זֶה אַבְרָהָם **"'Let there be light' — this is Avraham,"** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְהוּא מְרַמֵּז **And it alludes to** צֶדֶק מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישָׁא **Tzedek, the holy Malchus:** שֶׁהָיָה הוּא הַתְחָלַת הָאוֹר **that he was the beginning of the light,** אוֹר הַלְּבָנָה סִיהֲרָא **the light of the moon, Sihara,** עַד שְׁלֹמֹה הַמֶּלֶךְ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם **until Shlomo HaMelech, peace be upon him,** שֶׁהָיָה אַשְׁלְמוּתָא דְּסִיהֲרָא. **who was the completion of the moon.** וּמָשִׁיחַ יִהְיֶה נִקְרָא נָשִׂיא **And Mashiach will be called "Nasi,"** דְּשֵׁם נָשִׂיא גַּם כֵּן מוֹרֶה **for the name Nasi also indicates** שֶׁהוּא מְנוּשָּׂא **that he is exalted;** וּכְבָר אָמַרְנוּ **and we have already said** דִּלְשׁוֹן נָשָׂא בְּדִבְרֵי תוֹרָה **that the term "nasa" in the words of Torah** מוֹרֶה עַד לְמַעְלָה מֵהַתְּפִיסָה **indicates up to what is beyond grasp,** שֶׁהוּא בְּחִינַת עַתִּיקָא **which is the aspect of Atika** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּתְבָּאֵר פָּרָשַׁת שְׁקָלִים מַאֲמָר ז) **(as was explained on Parshas Shekalim, maamar 7).** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר בַּהַפְטוֹרָה **And this is what is said in the haftarah** [לְפָרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ - יְחֶזְקֵאל מו, טז] **(of Parshas HaChodesh, Yechezkel 46:16):** כִּי יִתֵּן הַנָּשִׂיא וְגוֹמֵר **"When the Nasi gives, etc.,"** וְכֵן כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. **and so several times.** [שָׁם לז, כה] וְנֶאֱמַר **And it is said (there, 37:25):** וְדָוִד עַבְדִּי **"And Dovid My servant** נָשִׂיא לָהֶם לְעוֹלָם.[1439] **shall be Nasi for them forever."** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבַּתְּחִלָּה **That is, at first,** כְּשֶׁשָּׁאֲלוּ לָהֶם מֶלֶךְ **when they asked for a king,** [שְׁמוּאֵל א ח, ז] כְּתִיב **it is written (Shmuel I 8:7):** כִּי אוֹתִי מָאָסוּ **"For it is Me they have rejected** מִמְּלוֹךְ עֲלֵיהֶם[1440] **from reigning over them."** וְהוּא דְּיִשְׂרָאֵל הָיוּ צְרִיכִין לוֹמַר **That is, Yisrael should have said** שֶׁה' יִתְבָּרַךְ מֶלֶךְ יִשְׂרָאֵל **that Hashem Yisbarach is the King of Yisrael;** וְכֵן מְבַקְּשִׁים בִּבְרָכַת הַשִּׁיבָה **and so we ask in the berachah of "Hashivah":** וּמְלוֹךְ עָלֵינוּ אַתָּה ה' לְבַדֶּךָ. **"And reign over us, You, Hashem, alone."** וּבְרֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה **And on Rosh Hashanah:** וְתִמְלוֹךְ אַתָּה כּוּ' **"And You shall reign," etc.,** יִמְלוֹךְ ה' לְעוֹלָם **"Hashem shall reign forever."** וְצָרִיךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה רַק נָשִׂיא. **And there should be only a Nasi.** וְהוּא גַּם כֵּן **He too is** מֶרְכָּבָה לְמִדַּת מַלְכוּת **a chariot for the attribute of Malchus;** כֶּתֶר עֶלְיוֹן אִיהוּ כֶּתֶר מַלְכוּת **Keser Elyon is the crown of Malchus.** וְכֵן כְּתִיב **And so it is written:** וְעַד עַתִּיק יוֹמַיָּא מְטָה **"And he reached the Ancient of Days,** וּקְדָמוֹהִי הַקְרֵבוּהִי.[1441] **and they brought him near before Him."** וּמִכָּל מָקוֹם בָּעוֹלָם הַזֶּה

[1438] **Parallel: Sod Yesharim (Radzin), Parshas Parah 8** — "The main impurity is this despair, by which a person gives up on hope; therefore it says, as counsel, 'Let them take a parah.'" Rav Tzadok heard from his rebbe that corpse-impurity is sadness. The Izhbitzer's grandson develops the same teaching here. The parah answers despair by revealing a root from which nothing is ever lost.

[1439] **Parallel: Beis Yaakov (Izhbitz), Bereishis 8** — on the Zohar's "because it is the beginning of the moon": "This means that there the true intent of creation begins to be revealed, since human sanctification and the mitzvos start at that point." The Izhbitzer's son reads the Zohar the same way. The Torah "should have begun" here because this is where Yisrael first bring holiness into creation themselves.

[1440] **Parallel: Zohar II 186a (Tetzaveh)** — "'This month is for you': it is Mine, but I have handed it over to you; yours is in revelation, but the seventh is Mine, and so it is covered and not revealed." The Zohar supports Rav Tzadok's reading of the double "for you." Hashem, the First, gives Himself over to Yisrael through Nisan, the month of revelation.

[1441] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Kedoshim 8** — "At Matan Torah each of Yisrael was crowned with the two crowns… and though they later removed them, Pri Etz Chaim says that on Shabbos Moshe Rabbeinu returns the crowns to Yisrael." This gives the Arizal's reason why Shabbos needs no tefillin. The crowns that tefillin restore are already given back

Nevertheless, in this world [דְּבָרִים יז, טו] כְּתִיב **it is written (Devarim 17:15):** שׂוֹם תָּשִׂים עָלֶיךָ מֶלֶךְ **"You shall surely set a king over yourself":** שֶׁאִם יִרְצוּ יִשְׂרָאֵל **if Yisrael wish,** יְמַנּוּ מֶלֶךְ.[1442] **they may appoint a king.** [יְשַׁעְיָה לג, כב] וְהָיינוּ דִּכְתִיב **And this is what is written (Yeshayah 33:22):** כִּי ה׳ שׁוֹפְטֵנוּ **"For Hashem is our Judge,** ה׳ מְחוֹקְקֵנוּ ה׳ מַלְכֵּינוּ **Hashem is our Lawgiver, Hashem is our King;** הוּא יוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ.[1443] **He will save us."** מְחוֹקְקֵנוּ הַיְינוּ תּוֹרָה **"Our Lawgiver" is Torah she'bichsav,** עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [דְּבָרִים לג, כא] **in the way it is said (Devarim 33:21):** כִּי שָׁם חֶלְקַת מְחוֹקֵק סָפוּן **"For there the portion of the lawgiver is hidden";** וְהַיְינוּ עַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [שְׁמוֹת לב, טז] **that is, that the words of Torah** הַדְּבָרִי תוֹרָה **are engraved in the heart,** **in the way it is said (Shemos 32:16):** חָרוּת עַל הַלֻּחוֹת. **"Engraved upon the tablets."** שׁוֹפְטֵנוּ הַיְינוּ **"Our Judge" is** תּוֹרָה שֶׁבְּעַל פֶּה **Torah she'b'al peh,** שֶׁהֵם בְּחִינַת שׁוֹפְטִים. **which is the aspect of judges.** מַלְכֵּנוּ הוּא **"Our King" is** שֶׁיֵּשׁ דִּינֵי הַמֶּלֶךְ **that there are the laws of the king,** שֶׁדָּן בְּדִינֵי מַלְכוּת **who judges by the laws of the kingdom,** שֶׁלֹּא עַל פִּי דִּינֵי הַתּוֹרָה.[1444] **not according to the laws of the Torah.** וְלֶעָתִיד שֶׁיִּהְיֶה הַכֹּל **And in the future, when everything will be** בְּיַד ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **in the hand of Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁיִּתְגַּלֶּה ה׳ שׁוֹפְטֵנוּ **when it will be revealed that Hashem is our Judge,** ה׳ מְחוֹקְקֵנוּ ה׳ מַלְכֵּנוּ **Hashem is our Lawgiver, Hashem is our King,** אָז הוּא יוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ **then "He will save us":** שֶׁיִּתְגַּלֶּה מִדַּת הוּא **the attribute of "Hu" will be revealed:** עַתִּיקָא קַדִּישָׁא **Atika Kadisha,** דְּאִקְרֵי הוּא **which is called "Hu"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **as they said** (אִדְּרָא זוּטָא הַאֲזִינוּ **(Idra, holy Zohar, Haazinu,** חֵלֶק ג רצ א) **part 3, 290a).** וְאָז יִהְיֶה הַיְשׁוּעָה הָאֱמִיתִית **And then there will be the true salvation:** הוּא יוֹשִׁיעֵנוּ **"He will save us,"** וְדָוִד עַבְדִּי **"and Dovid My servant** נָשִׂיא לָהֶם לְעוֹלָם: **shall be Nasi for them forever."**

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on Shabbos.

[1442] **Parallel: Rashi on Bereishis 25:27** — "'Who knew trapping': to trap and deceive his father with his mouth, asking him, 'Father, how does one tithe salt and straw?' so that his father thought he was meticulous in mitzvos." Rashi shows what the hiding looked like. Esav dressed himself in the finest points of halachah, the very form of a ben Torah.

[1443] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayigash 4** — "Yitzchak wished to draw Esav close because Esav had the choice, being called 'a Yisrael who is a mumar,' and it hung in the balance whether he could enter the holiness of Yisrael." The Gemara cited there is Kiddushin 18a. This adds to Rav Tzadok's point. Yitzchak was not simply fooled. Esav's concealment worked on a real potential in him, which is why it could not be seen through.

[1444] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pekudei 3** — "It says 'in your mouth and in your heart to do it,' not 'in your deeds,' for the completion of the deed is from Hashem, who asks of us only the desire of the heart." This is the passage Rav Tzadok refers to here. It adds the Zohar source (III 160a). It also shows why "renew your deeds" begins with renewed Torah in the heart.

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר ח׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Ches

In the haftarah בַּהַפְטָרָה [לְפָרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ - יְחֶזְקֵאל מו, א] **(of Parshas HaChodesh, Yechezkel 46:1):** וּבְיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת **"And on the Shabbos day it shall be opened,** יִפָּתֵחַ **and on the day of the new moon it shall be opened."** וּבְיוֹם הַחֹדֶשׁ יִפָּתֵחַ.[1445] **We must understand:** וְיֵשׁ לְהָבִין **why were they not mentioned on the festivals,** לָמָּה לֹא נִזְכְּרוּ בַּחַגִּים **of which it spoke above?** שֶׁדִּיבֵּר מֵהֶם לְמַעְלָה **Likewise one must examine what is said** [יְשַׁעְיָה סו, כג] **(Yeshayah 66:23):** וְהָיָה מִדֵּי חֹדֶשׁ בְּחָדְשׁוֹ **"And it shall be, every new moon in its month** וּמִדֵּי שַׁבָּת בְּשַׁבַּתּוֹ **and every Shabbos in its Shabbos, all flesh shall come** יָבוֹא כָל בָּשָׂר **to bow down before Me";** לְהִשְׁתַּחֲוֹת לְפָנַי **and here too the festivals are not mentioned,** וְלֹא נִזְכַּר גַּם כֵּן בָּרֶגֶלִים שֶׁיֵּשׁ מִצְוַת רְאִיָה.[1446] **though on them there is the mitzvah of appearing. Now, that they were not commanded at present to go up for pilgrimage** וְהִנֵּה מַה שֶּׁלֹּא נִצְטַוּוּ בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה לַעֲלוֹת לָרֶגֶל **every new moon and Shabbos,** בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ וְשַׁבָּת **one can say it is because of the burden,** יֵשׁ לוֹמַר שֶׁהוּא מִפְּנֵי הַטּוֹרַח **in the way they said** (מִדְרַשׁ תַּנְחוּמָא פִּנְחָס טו) **(Midrash Tanchuma, Pinchas 15)** וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ שֶׁאָמְרוּ **regarding Shemini Atzeres,** בְּשְׁמִינִי עֲצֶרֶת **that it should properly have been** שֶׁהָיָה רָאוּי לִהְיוֹת **fifty days after the festival,** חֲמִשִּׁים יוֹם אַחַר הֶחָג **like Atzeres after Pesach,** כַּעֲצֶרֶת אַחַר הַפֶּסַח **but HaKadosh Baruch Hu said:** אֶלָּא אָמַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא חוֹרֶף הוּא כו׳.[1447] **"It is winter," etc. But in the future there will be no burden,** וְלֶעָתִיד לֹא יִהְיֶה טוֹרַח **as they said in Pesikta Rabbasi** (לְשַׁבָּת רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ פָּרָשָׁה א סִימָן ג) **(on Shabbos and Rosh Chodesh, parshah 1, siman 3),** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בִּפְסִיקְתָּא רַבָּתַי **that the clouds will come** שֶׁיִּהְיוּ הֶעָבִים בָּאִים **and carry them** וְטוֹעֲנִין אוֹתָם **and bring them to Yerushalayim, etc.** וּמְבִיאִין אוֹתָם לִירוּשָׁלַיִם כו׳ **Therefore they will come** וְלָכֵן יָבֹאוּ **every Shabbos and Rosh Chodesh,** בְּכָל שַׁבָּת וְרֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ **and when Rosh Chodesh falls on Shabbos** וּכְשֶׁחָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ בְּשַׁבָּת יָבֹאוּ שְׁתֵּי פְּעָמִים **they will come twice,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ שָׁם.[1448] **as they said there.** אֲבָל עַל כָּל פָּנִים בָּרֶגֶלִים **But at any rate, on the festivals,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ מִצְוָה גַּם בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה **when there is a mitzvah even now** לַעֲלוֹת וְלֵירָאוֹת **to go up and appear,** **why is it not mentioned** לָמָּה לֹא נִזְכַּר **that they will come to bow down?** שֶׁיָּבֹאוּ לְהִשְׁתַּחֲוֹת וַהֲלֹא הַתּוֹרָה לֹא תִּשְׁתַּנֶּה.[1449] **Surely the Torah will not change! But the matter is** אַךְ הָעִנְיָן **that in all the festivals there is a holiness** שֶׁבְּכָל הַחַגִּים יֵשׁ קְדוּשָּׁה **which a Jew,** שֶׁהַיִּשְׂרָאֵל **when he comes to the place of the Mikdash,** כְּשֶׁבָּא לִמְקוֹם הַמִּקְדָּשׁ **can sense.** יָכוֹל לְהַרְגִּישׁ קְדוּשָּׁה זוֹ. **And this will be opened in the future** וְזֶה יִפָּתֵחַ לֶעָתִיד **to all Yisrael,** לְכָל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that they will be able to sense,** שֶׁיּוּכְלוּ לְהַרְגִּישׁ **in every place in Eretz Yisrael,** בְּכָל מָקוֹם בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **the holiness of the festival.** הַקְּדוּשָּׁה מֵהֶחָג. **Only regarding the new moon:** רַק בְּחֹדֶשׁ **that in every month there is** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ **a renewal of holiness;** הִתְחַדְּשׁוּת קְדוּשָּׁה **for so the birth of the moon is called** שֶׁכֵּן נִקְרָא מוֹלַד הַלְּבָנָה **"the renewal of the moon,"** חִדּוּתָא דְּסִיהֲרָא **since every month it receives** שֶׁבְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ מְקַבֶּלֶת אוֹר מְחוּדָּשׁ מֵהַחַמָּה. **renewed light from the sun. And it alludes Above** וְרוֹמֵז לְמַעְלָה **to the moon, Knesses Yisrael,** סִיהֲרָא כְּנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל **which receives from Hashem Yisbarach,** שֶׁמְּקַבֶּלֶת מֵה׳ יִתְבָּרֵךְ **who is called a sun,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא שֶׁמֶשׁ **as it is said: "For Hashem is a sun and a shield."** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר כִּי שֶׁמֶשׁ וּמָגֵן ה׳. **And likewise with Shabbos:** וְכֵן בְּשַׁבָּת **every Shabbos has a renewed holiness,** יֵשׁ בְּכָל שַׁבָּת קְדוּשָּׁה מְחוּדָּשֶׁת שֶׁכֵּן נִקְרֵאת שַׁבָּת **for so Shabbos is called** כַּלָּה מַלְכְּתָא[1449] **"the bride, the queen";** וְאִם הָיָה בְּכָל שַׁבָּת **and if in every Shabbos**

[1445] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Vayera 3** — "A person's vitality is his name, as the holy books write that a father, naming his son, intends the root of the son's vitality; so one called by name wakes from sleep." This adds the father's intent in naming. A name is the root of a person's life, so Mashiach's name, made before the world, is his very life.

[1446] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shemini 8** — "The three kingdoms stand against the three kelipos of jealousy, desire and honor: Bavel, 'you are the head of gold'… Persia and Madai against desire… and jealousy and anger against Yavan"; Edom's evil lies hidden in the depth of its heart. This names which kelipah each kingdom is. It also shows why Edom, the fourth, can be undone only when Hashem uncovers what it hides.

[1447] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Chanukah 14** — "Shem was the first kohen and taught Torah; he is called a craftsman because he built the Beis HaMikdash in the heart and soul by teaching Torah. Eliyahu is the last kohen." There Rav Tzadok answers the question another way. Shem builds the Mikdash within, through Torah, and so he is counted among its builders.

[1448] **Parallel: Rashi on Bereishis 32:11** — "My merits have been lessened by the kindness You did me; so I fear that since You promised me I have become soiled with sin, and it may cause me to be handed to Esav." Rashi shows that Yaakov did not doubt the promise. He feared for himself. That is exactly why a promise in this world is no guarantee.

[1449] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Va'eira 5** — "The plagues of Egypt were ten, and everywhere ten points to the ten sefiros; with each plague Yisrael left one of the ten kelipos that stand opposite, and entered one attribute in holiness." Rav Tzadok there cites Zohar II 29a, "HaKadosh Baruch Hu began from below." This is the source for the order from

הַקְּדוּשָׁה שָׁוָה **the holiness were the same,** לֹא הָיְתָה נִקְרֵאת כַּלָּה **it would not be called a bride,** דְּכֻלָּה רַק כָּל שִׁבְעָה. **for a bride is a bride only for the seven days.** רַק בְּכָל שַׁבָּת יֵשׁ קְדוּשָׁה חֲדָשָׁה **Rather, each Shabbos has a new holiness,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמַרְנוּ כַּמָּה פְּעָמִים. **as we have said many times.** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And about this it is said:** מִדֵּי חׇדֶשׁ בְּחׇדְשׁוֹ דַּיְיקָא **"Every new moon in its month** וּמִדֵּי שַׁבָּת בְּשַׁבַּתּוֹ **and every Shabbos in its Shabbos" —** בְּחׇדְשׁוֹ **"in its month," precisely;** בְּשַׁבַּתּוֹ דַּיְיקָא. **"in its Shabbos," precisely.** יָבֹא כָל בָּשָׂר **"All flesh shall come":** הַיְינוּ הַגּוּף **that is, the body,** שֶׁנִּקְרָא בָּשָׂר **which is called flesh;** דְּהַנְּשָׁמָה נִקְרָא אָדָם **for the soul is called "man,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֶלֶק ב עו, א). **(as is written, Zohar, part 2, 76a).** וְהַגּוּף בְּשַׂר אָדָם **and the body is "the flesh of man,"** שֶׁהוּא לְבוּשׁ[1450] **which is a garment** יַעֲקֹב אָבִינוּ עָלָיו הַשָּׁלוֹם וְזֶהוּ מִקְּדוּשַׁת **And this is from the holiness of Yaakov Avinu, peace be upon him,** דְּאִיתָא (תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּיקּוּן יג כט, א) **for it is stated (Tikkunei Zohar, tikkun 13, 29a)** דְּאִיהוּ גּוּפָא **that he is the "body":** שֶׁהוּא מַכְנִיס קְדוּשָׁה **he brings holiness** לְכָל גּוּף יִשְׂרָאֵל **into every Jewish body,** שֶׁיֵּשׁ בּוֹ קְדוּשָׁה **so that it has holiness,** שֶׁכּוּלָּם מִזַּרְעוֹ **since they are all his offspring.** וְזֶה הַקְּדוּשָׁה יְקַבְּלוּ מַחָדָשׁ **And this holiness they will receive anew** בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ וְשַׁבָּת. **every new month and Shabbos.** וּבַחַגִּים אַף שֶׁלֹּא **And on the festivals, although** תִּתְבַּטֵּל הַתּוֹרָה **the Torah will be annulled** וְיַעֲלוּ לָרֶגֶל **and they will go up for the pilgrimage,** אַךְ עִיקַּר הָרְאִיָּיה יִהְיֶה **yet the main appearance will be** בִּשְׁבִיל הַשַּׁבָּת שָׁבּוֹ **for the sake of the Shabbos within it;** שֶׁבְּפֶסַח וְסוּכּוֹת **for on Pesach and Sukkos** יֵשׁ תָּמִיד שַׁבָּת **there is always a Shabbos,** וְשָׁבוּעוֹת אַף שֶׁהוּא יוֹם אֶחָד **and Shavuos, although it is one day,** יֵשׁ לוֹ תַּשְׁלוּמִין כָּל שִׁבְעָה[1451] **has make-up days for all seven** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה ד:) **(as is written, Rosh Hashanah 4b).** אֲבָל הַקְּדוּשָׁה שֶׁמַּרְגִּישִׁין בָּהֶן **But the holiness that one senses on the festival** בַּזְּמַן הַזֶּה **at present,** יִזְכּוּ לְהַרְגִּישׁ **they will merit to sense** בְּכָל מָקוֹם בְּאֶרֶץ יִשְׂרָאֵל **in every place in Eretz Yisrael,** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כִּירוּשָׁלַיִם. **for it will be like Yerushalayim.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what is said:** מִדֵּי חׇדֶשׁ בְּחׇדְשׁוֹ **"Every new moon in its month** וּמִדֵּי שַׁבָּת בְּשַׁבַּתּוֹ **and every Shabbos in its Shabbos** יָבֹא כָל בָּשָׂר. **all flesh shall come."** וְכֵן בַּשּׁוּנַמִּית כְּתִיב **And so regarding the Shunamite it is written:** לֹא חֹדֶשׁ וְלֹא שַׁבָּת **"It is neither new moon nor Shabbos,"** (רֹאשׁ הַשָּׁנָה טז:) וּבַגְּמָרָא **and in the Gemara (Rosh Hashanah 16b):** שֶׁחַיָּיב אָדָם **that a person is obligated** לְהַקְבִּיל פְּנֵי רַבּוֹ בָּרֶגֶל.[1452] **to greet his teacher on the festival.** וְהַיְינוּ שֶׁבָּרֶגֶל כָּל אֶחָד מִיִּשְׂרָאֵל **That is, on the festival every single Jew** מַרְגִּישׁ הַקְּדוּשָׁה **senses the holiness,** וּמִי שֶׁמַּרְגִּישׁ קְדוּשָׁה[1453] וְצָרִיךְ לְהַקְבִּיל פְּנֵי רַבּוֹ אָז **and he must greet his teacher then; and one who senses holiness** בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ וְשַׁבָּת **every new moon and Shabbos** צָרִיךְ לְהַקְבִּיל פְּנֵי רַבּוֹ **must greet his teacher** בְּכָל חֹדֶשׁ וְשַׁבָּת. **every new moon and Shabbos.** (חֵלֶק ג רסה, ב) וּבַזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **And in the holy Zohar (part 3, 265b):** דְּחִיּוּבָא עֲלַיְיהוּ דְּבַר נָשׁ לְקַבְּלָא אַפֵּי שְׁכִינְתָּא **"It is an obligation upon a person to greet the face of the Shechinah** בְּכָל יַרְחֵי וְשַׁבְּתֵי **on every new moon and Shabbos;** וּמַאן אִיהוּ רַבַּיְיהּ כּוּ'[1454] **and who is his teacher," etc.,** עַיֵּין שָׁם. **see there.** וְהוּא הִכִּיר בָּהּ **And he recognized in her** שֶׁמַּרְגֶּשֶׁת קְדוּשָׁה **that she sensed holiness** בְּכָל רֹאשׁ חֹדֶשׁ וְשַׁבָּת **every Rosh Chodesh and Shabbos,** וּבְחׇדְשׁ וְשַׁבָּת **so that on a new moon and Shabbos** אִיבָּעֵי לָהּ לְמֵיזַל

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below to above. That order is why the ninth plague, against Chochmah, brought light.

[1450] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Rosh Chodesh Iyar 5** — "'Fortunate is one who makes them a dwelling in the two chambers of the heart, and the yetzer hara is cleared from there': the yetzer hara sits between the two openings of the heart." The Gemara cited there is Berachos 61a. Holiness dwelling in both chambers leaves the yetzer no place, and this is what Rav Tzadok says of the heart's left side.

[1451] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Beha'aloscha 3** — "Once the Mishkan was set up, where the Shechinah rests, which is Malchus, called Torah she'b'al peh… the essence of the Oral Torah was in the Lishkas HaGazis in the Mikdash." This explains why the Mikdash is the root of the Oral Torah. The place of the Shechinah is Malchus, the "mouth," and so the Oral Torah goes forth from there.

[1452] **Parallel: Agra DeKallah (R' Tzvi Elimelech of Dinov), Bereishis Rabbah 10** — "The ring is the natural order, conducted by the Name Elokim, which equals 'hateva'; to those who keep Shabbos is given the conduct above nature, through the Name Havayah." From another school this matches Rav Tzadok's reading. The ring is creation. The seal of Shabbos is the Name Havayah set upon it.

[1453] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Bechukosai 2** — on "I have a good gift in My treasure-house, and Shabbos is its name" (Shabbos 10b): "this is fear, as it says: Hashem has in His treasure-house only a treasury of fear of Heaven." Rav Tzadok there links the treasury, fear and Shabbos. This is why the treasury entrusted to Yisrael in Nisan is read on Shabbos.

[1454] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Emor 3** — "Even so, the holiness of the festivals depends on Yisrael, who bring holiness into those days by fixing Rosh Chodesh, and this is beyond comprehension: that they can bring holiness into time." This names exactly what Moshe found hard. It was not the reckoning. It was that human beings can make time holy, a thing beyond understanding.

she would have to go; וְשָׁאַל מַדּוּעַ הוֹלֶכֶת **and he asked why she was going** וְלֹא חֹדֶשׁ וְלֹא שַׁבָּת.[1455] **when it was neither new moon nor Shabbos.** וְעַל כֵּן בְּפָרָשָׁה זוֹ **Therefore in this section,** הַמְדַבֵּר מִן הֶעָתִיד **which speaks of the future,** וּבְיוֹם הַשַּׁבָּת יִפָּתֵחַ כְּתִיב **it is written: "On the Shabbos day it shall be opened,** וּבְיוֹם הַחֹדֶשׁ יִפָּתֵחַ **and on the day of the new moon it shall be opened":** שֶׁאָז יִפָּתֵחַ **for then there will be opened** אוֹר חָדָשׁ **a new light** שֶׁיָּאִיר ה׳ יִתְבָּרַךְ **that Hashem Yisbarach will shine** לִכְנֶסֶת יִשְׂרָאֵל כָּאָמוּר. **upon Knesses Yisrael, as was said.** וּכְשֶׁמִּתְחַבְּרִין שַׁבָּת וְחֹדֶשׁ **And when Shabbos and the new moon join together,** יוּכְלוּ לְהַרְגִּישׁ **they can sense** מִקְדּוּשַׁת הַשַּׁבָּת וְהַחֹדֶשׁ: **the holiness of both Shabbos and the new moon.**

[1455] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Emor 3** — on "you, even if unwitting, even if deliberate, even if misled": "the unwitting and misled are surely called mikra, by chance, yet they bring holiness into these times, and the deliberate as well." This develops Rav Tzadok's point. The beis din's declaration works even against the facts, because it draws on a will above reckoning.

פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ, מַאֲמָר ט׳ Parshas HaChodesh — Maamar Tes

שֶׂה לְבֵית אָבוֹת **a lamb for the father's house,** וְיִקְחוּ לָהֶם אִישׁ **"They shall take for themselves, each man,** שֶׂה לַבָּיִת **a lamb for the household"** [שְׁמוֹת יב, ג]. **(Shemos 12:3).** בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא לְפָרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **In the Pesikta on Parshas HaChodesh** (פָּרָשָׁה טו סִימָן כד) **(parshah 15, siman 24):** **"'They shall take for themselves, a man'** — זֶה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **this is HaKadosh Baruch Hu,** דִּכְתִיב בֵּיהּ **of whom it is written** ה׳ אִישׁ מִלְחָמָה [שְׁמוֹת טו, ג] **'Hashem is a Man of war' (Shemos 15:3)** — שֶׁאַתָּה לוֹקֵחוֹ בִּשְׁנֵי תְמִידִים **whom you take through the two tamid offerings;** שֶׂה זֶה קָרְבַּן תָּמִיד כּוּ׳ **'a lamb' — this is the tamid offering," etc.** הוּא עַל פִּי כִּי לֶקַח טוֹב **This follows what they said** (מִדְרָשׁ רַבָּה תְּרוּמָה לג, א) **(Midrash Rabbah, Terumah 33:1):** מַה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **"'For I have given you a good teaching, etc.' (Mishlei 4:2):** מָכַרְתִּי לָכֶם תּוֹרָתִי **I have sold you My Torah,** כִּבְיָכוֹל נִמְכַּרְתִּי עִמָּהּ **and, as it were, I was sold with it,** [שְׁמוֹת כה, ב] שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it says (Shemos 25:2):** וְיִקְחוּ לִי תְּרוּמָה. **'And let them take for Me an offering.'** מָשָׁל כּוּ׳ **A parable, etc.:** קִיטוֹן אֶחָד עָשָׂה לִי **make for Me one small chamber** שֶׁאָדוּר אֶצְלָכֶם כּוּ׳ **so that I may dwell among you," etc.,** שָׁם **see there;** וְהַיְינוּ הַמִּשְׁכָּן **and this is the Mishkan.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמְרוּ **And this is what they said,** שֶׁאַתָּה לוֹקֵחוֹ בִּשְׁנֵי תְמִידִים **"whom you take through the two tamid offerings,"** דִּכְתִיב בֵּהּ [בְּמִדְבַּר כח, ב] **for of them it is written (Bamidbar 28:2):** אֶת קָרְבָּנִי לַחְמִי לְאִישַׁי **"My offering, My bread for My fire-offerings";** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג ז, ב) וְאִיתָא **and it is stated (Zohar, part 3, 7b):** לַאֲבִיהֶן שֶׁבַּשָּׁמַיִם יִשְׂרָאֵל מְפַרְנְסִי **"Yisrael sustain their Father in Heaven."** וְהַיְינוּ וְיִקְחוּ לִי **And this is "let them take for Me":** שֶׁהוּא דָּר עִמָּהֶם כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **that He dwells with them, as mentioned above.** וְתֵיכֶף כְּשֶׁנֶּאֱמַר לָהֶם **And immediately when they were told** פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ **Parshas HaChodesh,** שֶׁהוּא עֵץ חַיִּים **which is "a tree of life,** תַּאֲוָה בָּאָה **a desire fulfilled,"** שֶׁהוּא הַתְחָלַת דִּבְרֵי תוֹרָה **being the beginning of the words of Torah,** נֶאֱמַר לָהֶם וְיִקְחוּ לָהֶם אִישׁ **they were told, "They shall take for themselves a man"** — זֶה הַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא **this is HaKadosh Baruch Hu;** וְהַיְינוּ דְּכְבְיָכוֹל נִמְכַּרְתִּי עִמָּהּ **that is, "as it were, I was sold with it,"** וַעֲשׂוּ לִי קִיטוֹן **"and make for Me a chamber** שֶׁאָדוּר אֶצְלָכֶם. **so that I may dwell among you."** וְאַף שֶׁעֲדַיִין לֹא הָיָה **And even though there was not yet** מִקְדָּשׁ וּמִשְׁכָּן. **a Mikdash or Mishkan,** לֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל[1456] הוּא מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **the heart of Yisrael is a dwelling for the Shechinah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא [שָׁם סִימָן ו] **as they said in the Pesikta (there, siman 6)** וּמִדְרָשׁ (שִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה ה, ב) **and the Midrash (Shir HaShirim Rabbah 5:2)** שֶׁהַקָּדוֹשׁ בָּרוּךְ הוּא לִבָּן שֶׁל יִשְׂרָאֵל **that HaKadosh Baruch Hu is the heart of Yisrael,** שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר [תְּהִלִּים עג, כו] **as it is said (Tehillim 73:26):** צוּר לְבָבִי **"The Rock of my heart** וְחֶלְקִי אֱלֹהִים לְעוֹלָם. **and my portion is God forever."** וְאַף שֶׁלֹּא הָיָה אָז **And even though there was not then** מִזְבֵּחַ וְקָרְבָּנוֹת **an altar and offerings,** הַמַּשְׁקוֹף וּשְׁתֵּי הַמְּזוּזוֹת **the lintel and the two doorposts** הָיוּ[1457] שְׁלוֹשָׁה מִזְבְּחוֹת **were three altars** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב פָּסְחִים צו.) **(as is written, Pesachim 96a);** וּכְתִיב [וַיִּקְרָא ז, לז] **And it is written (Vayikra 7:37):** זֹאת הַתּוֹרָה לָעֹלָה וְגוֹמֵר **"This is the law of the olah, etc.,"** (מְנָחוֹת קי.) **and they expounded (Menachos 110a):** כָּל הָעוֹסֵק בַּתּוֹרָה **"Whoever engages in Torah** אֵין צָרִיךְ לֹא עוֹלָה כּוּ׳ **needs neither an olah, etc.";** וְנֶאֱמַר [וַיִּקְרָא ו, יח] **and it is said (Vayikra 6:18):** זֹאת תּוֹרַת הַחַטָּאת **"This is the law of the chatas":** כָּל הָעוֹסֵק בְּתוֹרַת חַטָּאת **whoever engages in the laws of the chatas** כְּאִילּוּ הִקְרִיב חַטָּאת. **is as if he offered a chatas.** וְתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **And talmidei chachamim** שֶׁעוֹסְקִין תָּדִיר בַּתּוֹרָה **who engage constantly in Torah** הֵם תָּמִיד מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **are always a dwelling for the Shechinah,** וְאִתְקְרִיאוּ שַׁבָּתוֹת[1458] **and they are called "Shabbosos"** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב זֹהַר חֵלֶק ג קטז, ב) **(as is written, Zohar part 3, 29b).** וּבְשַׁבָּת כָּל יִשְׂרָאֵל **And on Shabbos all Yisrael** כְּתַלְמִידֵי חֲכָמִים **are like talmidei chachamim,** וְלִבָּם מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **and their heart is a dwelling for the Shechinah,** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר

[1456] **Parallel: Arizal, Sha'ar HaKavanos, Derushei HaTzitzis 2** — "The tallis itself, from which the tzitzis come out and on which they hang, is the aspect of the encompassing light (or makif) over all of Z'eir Anpin." This is the Kabbalistic source for Rav Tzadok's statement. The tallis carries a light above the inner attributes, which fits its role in drawing down Atika to sanctify the month.

[1457] **Parallel: Likkutei Maamarim, Yehoshua 1** — "Therefore Yisrael reckon by the moon and the nations by the sun, for the nations imagine they eat and drink of their own, self-sufficient and lacking nothing." Rav Tzadok there gives the inner meaning of counting by the moon. Yisrael know nothing is their own and only receive. The nations' "fire" is a claim to self-sufficiency.

[1458] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Chayei Sarah 5** — "All of Avraham Avinu's words of Torah were at the level of Torah she'b'al peh alone, for he kept even the rabbinic mitzvos; all the Torah he learned was from his heart." The Gemara cited there is Yoma 28b. This shows why Avraham is the beginning of the Oral Torah's light. He had no Written Torah to receive from, and his own heart was the source.

דְּעָבִיד דִּירָה נָאָה **that one makes a beautiful dwelling (dirah)** לְדֹרֹתָם **"for their generations" (ledorosam)** — [שְׁמוֹת לא, יג] **as it is said (Shemos 31:13):** לְשָׁכִינְתָּא בְּלִיבֵּיהּ[1459] **for the Shechinah in his heart** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב תִּקּוּנֵי זֹהַר תִּיקּוּן ו כב, ב) **(as is written, Tikkunei Zohar, tikkun 6, 22b).** וְאָז הוּא פְּרִיסַת **And then is the spreading of** סוּכַּת שְׁלוֹם עָלֵינוּ כּוּ׳ **"the shelter of peace over us," etc.,** וְעַל יְרוּשָׁלַיִם **"and over Yerushalayim":** שֶׁזּוֹכִין לִקְדוּשַׁת יְרוּשָׁלַיִם **for they merit the holiness of Yerushalayim,** וְלֵב יִשְׂרָאֵל מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה. **and the heart of Yisrael is a dwelling for the Shechinah.** וְהַתּוֹרָה לְכוּ לַחֲמוּ בְלַחְמִי **And the Torah is "Come, eat of My bread":** נַהֲמָא דְּאוֹרַיְיתָא **the bread of Torah,** וּכְמוֹ קָרְבָּנוֹת **just like the offerings,** שֶׁהֵם לַחְמִי לְאִישֵׁי. **which are "My bread for My fire-offerings."** וּבְתִיקּוּנֵי זֹהַר (תִּיקּוּן מח פה, א) **And in the Tikkunei Zohar (tikkun 48, 85a):** תְּרִין זִמְנִין אַדְכַּר הָכָא שַׁבָּת **"Twice Shabbos is mentioned here,** לְקֵבֶל שְׁכִינְתָּא עִלָּאָה וְתַתָּאָה. **corresponding to the upper and the lower Shechinah.** לְדֹרֹתָם זַכָּאָה אִיהוּ **'For their generations' — fortunate is he** מַאן דְּעָבִיד לוֹן דִּירָה בְּשַׁבָּת **who makes for them a dwelling on Shabbos** בִּתְרֵי בָּתֵּי לִבָּא כּוּ׳ **in the two chambers of the heart," etc.** וְהוּא דִּשְׁכִינְתָּא תַּתָּאָה **That is, the lower Shechinah,** מִדַּת מַלְכוּת **the attribute of Malchus,** וּכְמוֹ נִקְרָא צוּר **is called "Rock,"** ה׳ שׁוֹכֵן בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **Hashem dwelling amid Bnei Yisrael,** בְּפִסְיקְתָא רַבָּתִי וְשִׁיר הַשִּׁירִים רַבָּה **in Pesikta Rabbasi and Shir HaShirim Rabbah** שֶׁלָּמְדוּ **as they learned** מִדְּכְתִיב צוּר לְבָבִי וְגוֹמֵר **from what is written, "The Rock of my heart, etc."** וְהוּא אֱלֹהִים בַּתְּרָאָה[1460] **And this is the latter Elokim** (זֹהַר חֵלֶק א לא, ב) **(Zohar, part 1, 31b),** וְהַיְינוּ שֵׁם אָדנָ״י **that is, the Name Adnus,** הַמּוֹרֶה עַל **which indicates fear,** הַיִּרְאָה כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said:** וְאִם אֲדוֹנִים אָנִי אַיֵּה מוֹרָאִי **"And if I am a Master, where is My fear?"** — אַסְפַּקְלַרְיָא דְּלָא נְהִירָא **the speculum that does not shine,** דְּבַהּ אִתְעֲבִיד עֲבִידְתָּא דְּעָלְמָא[1461] **through which the work of the world is done** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם קעב, א) **(as is written there, 172a).** וּבְכָל מַעֲשֵׂה בְרֵאשִׁית **And throughout the work of Creation** נִזְכַּר שֵׁם אֱלֹהִים **the Name Elokim is mentioned,** וְהַיְינוּ אֱלֹהִים בַּתְּרָאָה **that is, the latter Elokim,** כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **as mentioned above.** וּמִדָּה זוֹ נִקְרֵאת לֵב **And this attribute is called "heart,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁנִּדְרַשׁ (יוֹמָא עב:) **as is expounded (Yoma 72b)** עַל מִי שֶׁאֵין בּוֹ יִרְאַת שָׁמַיִם **about one who has no fear of Heaven:** [מִשְׁלֵי יז, טז] וְלֵב אָיִן[1462] **"and he has no heart" (Mishlei 17:16).** וּבִינָה לִבָּא **And "Binah is the heart"** הַיְינוּ גַּם כֵּן יִרְאָה **is also fear,** [מִשְׁלֵי ב, ה] כְּמוֹ שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **as it is said (Mishlei 2:5):** אָז תָּבִין יִרְאַת ה׳ **"Then you will understand the fear of Hashem";** וְהַיְינוּ כְּשֶׁנִּכְנָס הַיִּרְאָה לְעוֹמֶק נְקוּדָּה **that is, when the fear enters** שֶׁבַּלֵּב **into the depth of the point within the heart,** הוּא בְּחִינַת בִּינָה לִבָּא. **that is the aspect of "Binah is the heart."** וְזֶה נִקְרָא צוּר **And this is called "Rock,"** כְּמוֹ שֶׁאָמְרוּ בַּזֹּהַר הַקָּדוֹשׁ **as they said in the holy Zohar** (חֵלֶק ב סד, א) **(part 2, 64a):** וּבְגִין כָּךְ צוּר עִלָּאָה אִיקְרֵי[1463] לְאַכְלָלָא אִימָּא עִלָּאָה כּוּ׳ **"To include the Supernal Mother, etc.,** וּלְעֵיל מִינַּהּ אָמַר **and above that it says:** מִסִּטְרָא דְּצוּר עִלָּאָה **"From the side of the Supernal Rock** נָפִיק צוּר אָחֳרָא כּוּ׳ **there issues another rock," etc.** וְהַיְינוּ דְּצוּר מוֹרֶה עַל גְּבוּרָה **That is, "rock" indicates Gevurah;** וּבִינָה אִימָּא עִלָּאָה **and Binah, the Supernal Mother,** אַף עַל גַּב דְּלָאו אִיהִי דִּינָא **"even though she is not judgment,** מִסִּטְרָהָא אִשְׁתְּכַח כּוּ׳. **from her side it is found," etc.** וְצֶדֶק מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישָׁא **And Tzedek, the holy Malchus,** דִּינָא דְּמַלְכוּתָא דִּינָא **is "dina" — "the law of the kingdom is law" —**

[1459] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shoftim 2** — on the Baal HaTurim's link between "all your males shall appear" and the duty to greet one's teacher: "The mitzvah of appearing on the three festivals corresponds to the three Avos, that their holiness appear in Yisrael's heart." This adds what the festival holiness is. It is the holiness of the Avos coming into the heart, and that is why one goes to his rebbe then.

[1460] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shelach 14** — "In the future the clouds will carry them to Yerushalayim, and then there will be an obligation every month and Shabbos; in this world it is optional, as we find, 'neither new moon nor Shabbos.'" This draws the halachic line. Going each month and Shabbos is a matter of choice in this world, for one who feels its holiness. In the future it will be required of all.

[1461] **Parallel: Bas Ayin, Terumah, citing the Alshich** — "'And I will dwell in their midst': it does not say 'in its midst' but 'in their midst,' teaching that HaKadosh Baruch Hu dwells within each and every one of Yisrael." The Chassidic reading reaches the same principle from the verse of the Mishkan. The building is secondary. The true dwelling is the heart of each Jew, and so it existed even before there was a Mishkan.

[1462] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Tzav 3** — on "no one ever spent the night in Yerushalayim with sin in his hand": "The olah comes only for the thoughts of the heart (Vayikra Rabbah 7), and the Zohar says the olah is for evil thought." This explains how a tamid can atone at all. The sins it covers are those of the heart, and they come most of all when a person is alone in his house at night.

[1463] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Ki Seitzei 15** — "Moshe Rabbeinu did not know what Rabbi Akiva was saying, for he could not sense the taste that Rabbi Akiva and his colleagues sensed … he heard only as he heard at Sinai all that a seasoned student would innovate." Rav Tzadok there gives the reason this was not Moshe's portion: the taste of Torah she'b'al peh is felt by one who has repaired a fault, and Moshe had none to repair.

שֵׁם אֲדנ״י בְּהֵיפֶךְ אַתְוָון[1464] **the Name Adnus with its letters reversed** (כְּמוֹ שֶׁכָּתוּב שָׁם קיח, א) **(as is written there, 118a).** וְזֶהוּ דְּנָפִיק צוּר אָחֳרָא. **And this is "there issues another rock."** וּבְהַתְחָלַת הַתּוֹרָה **And at the beginning of the Torah,** שֶׁהוּא פָּרָשַׁת הַחֹדֶשׁ הַזֶּה לָכֶם **which is the section "This month shall be for you,"** נֶאֱמַר לָהֶם וְיִקְחוּ לָהֶם אִישׁ **they were told, "They shall take for themselves a man":** שֶׁיִּהְיֶה כָּל אֶחָד **that each one should be** מִשְׁכָּן לַשְּׁכִינָה **a dwelling for the Shechinah,** וּכְמוֹ שֶׁזָּכוּ אַחַר כָּךְ **just as they merited afterward** בְּמַתַּן תּוֹרָה. **at Matan Torah.** וְאַחַר שֶׁקִּלְקְלוּ **And after they spoiled it** וְזָכוּ אַחַר כָּךְ לַעֲשׂוֹת מִשְׁכָּן **and later merited to make a Mishkan,** כְּתִיב וְיִקְחוּ לִי כַּנִּזְכָּר לְעֵיל. **it is written "Let them take for Me," as mentioned above.** וְזֶה שֶׁאָמַר **And this is what it says:** שֶׁאַתָּה לוֹקְחוֹ בִּשְׁנֵי תְּמִידִים. **"whom you take through the two tamid offerings."** וְעַל זֶה נֶאֱמַר **And about this it is said:** שֶׂה לְבֵית אָבוֹת שֶׂה **"a lamb for the father's house, a lamb for the household";** וְהוּא מַה שֶּׁכָּתוּב בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא סָמוּךְ לָזֶה. **and this is what is written in the Pesikta right next to this:** מִימָיו לֹא לָן אָדָם בִּירוּשָׁלַיִם וּבְיָדוֹ עָוֹון **"Never did a person stay overnight in Yerushalayim with sin in his hand:** תָּמִיד שֶׁל שַׁחַר מְכַפֵּר עַל עֲבֵירוֹת שֶׁל לַיְלָה **the morning tamid atoned for sins of the night,** תָּמִיד שֶׁל בֵּין הָעַרְבַּיִם מְכַפֵּר עַל עֲבֵירוֹת שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ בַּיּוֹם כּוּ׳ **the afternoon tamid atoned for sins committed by day," etc.** וְזֶה שֶׁנֶּאֱמַר **And this is what is said:** שֶׂה לְבֵית אָבוֹת **"a lamb for the father's house"** — הַיְינוּ תָּמִיד שֶׁל בֵּין הָעַרְבַּיִם **that is, the afternoon tamid,** שֶׁמְּכַפֵּר עַל עֲבֵירוֹת שֶׁל יוֹם שֶׁנַּעֲשׂוּ עַל יְדֵי חֶבְרַת אֲנָשִׁים **which atones for the sins of the day, committed through the company of people;** וְעַל זֶה מְרַמֵּז **and to this alludes** שֶׂה לְבֵית אָבוֹת. **"a lamb for the father's house."** שֶׂה לַבָּיִת מְרַמֵּז **"A lamb for the household" alludes** עַל תָּמִיד שֶׁל שַׁחַר **to the morning tamid,** שֶׁמְּכַפֵּר עַל עֲבֵירוֹת שֶׁל לַיְלָה **which atones for the sins of the night** שֶׁאָדָם עוֹבֵר **that a person commits** כְּשֶׁהוּא בִּפְנֵי עַצְמוֹ **when he is by himself,** בְּבֵיתוֹ[1465] דָּבָר **alone in his house;** וְזֶהוּ שֶׂה לַבָּיִת. **and this is "a lamb for the household."** וּמַסִּיק בַּפְּסִיקְתָּא מַה טַּעַם **And the Pesikta concludes: What is the reason?** [יְשַׁעְיָה א, כא] צֶדֶק יָלִין בָּהּ **"Righteousness lodged in her" (Yeshayah 1:21)** — צַדִּיק יָלִין בָּהּ. **a tzaddik lodged in her.** וְהַיְינוּ צֶדֶק מַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישָׁא **That is, Tzedek, the holy Malchus;** וְהַיְינוּ דִּכְתִיב עֲשׂוּ לִי קִיטוֹן וְיִקְחוּ לִי **and that is "Let them take for Me,"** שֶׁאֶדּוֹר אֶצְלָכֶם **"make for Me a chamber so that I may dwell among you."** [תְּהִלִּים קיח, יט] וּכְתִיב **And it is written (Tehillim 118:19):** פִּתְחוּ לִי שַׁעֲרֵי צֶדֶק **"Open for me the gates of righteousness,"** [שָׁם, כ] וּכְתִיב בַּתְרֵיהּ **and after it is written (there, 20):** זֶה הַשַּׁעַר וגו׳ צַדִּיקִים יָבֹאוּ בוֹ **"This is the gate, etc., the righteous shall enter through it."** לְמַלְכוּתָא קַדִּישָׁא **For to enter the gates of Tzedek, the holy Malchus,** צָרִיךְ שֶׁיִּהְיֶה צַדִּיק **one must be a tzaddik.** וְזֶה שֶׁדָּרַשׁ **And this is what he expounded:** צֶדֶק יָלִין בָּהּ **"Tzedek lodges in her"** — שֶׁיִּהְיֶה צַדִּיק יָלִין בָּהּ **"a tzaddik lodges in her":** לְזַכּוֹת צֶדֶק יָלִין בָּהּ **to merit "Tzedek lodges in her"** — צָרִיךְ לִהְיוֹת בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל **there must be amid Bnei Yisrael** צַדִּיק יָלִין בָּהּ **that Hashem should dwell** שׁוֹכֵן ה׳ **"a tzaddik lodging in her";** וְעַל יְדֵי כֵן צֶדֶק יָלִין בָּהּ **and through that, "Tzedek lodges in her":** יִתְבָּרַךְ שְׁמוֹ **that Hashem Yisbarach dwells** בְּתוֹךְ בְּנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל: **amid Bnei Yisrael.**

תַּם וְנִשְׁלַם שֶׁבַח לָאֵל בּוֹרֵא עוֹלָם **Finished and complete; praise to God, Creator of the world**

[1464] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Shemini 11** — "When he said 'I am dust and ashes,' he agreed that he truly deserved to be burned in Ur Kasdim, even though he gave himself over for the sanctification of Hashem's Name." Rav Tzadok there reads the same midrash as Avraham justifying the judgment upon himself: by strict din his self-sacrifice did not earn rescue, so the miracle came only because Hashem concurred with him.

[1465] **Parallel: Pri Tzaddik, Pesach 15** — "His accusation was that the eating of Shabbos and Pesach clarifies the whole year's eating in holiness … At the Omer it was clarified that even those who resemble an animal also have holiness." Rav Tzadok there places Haman's denial in the Omer season and shows how it was answered: the barley offering, animal fodder, proves that bodily eating too can carry holiness.